# The Northern Epics

## *The Poetic Edda and Other Old Germanic Alliterative Poetry*

*edited and translated by*

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Corrections and questions are gratefully accepted at
`kon6studios@gmail.com`.

*Om drömmar ſkola rinna bort, ſom ſnö,*
*när lyktas vintern, åter blottas Jord,*
*från ſinne ſömnomhöljt, och dermed dö,*
*jag båd' att efter lefde deſſa ord.*
*Dem tage, hålle hon ſom intet vet,*
*om fällde i ſin ovetſkap blott en*
*fullärlig tår—men ſkedde icke det,*
*då bränn dem under Månens klara ſken,*
*att det ſom ſjungits utan kraft och mod*
*förglömmes, och ej mer förnedrar dem*
*ſom förr för intet mer utguto blod*
*än yrig dröm om himmelrikets hem.*
*Ty knappt ens Månen ſkiner för vår ſkull*
*om vi förblifva halfva. Han är full.*

*History takes many turns:*
*A man is born. Another burns.*
*(And who can tell where e'er it goes?)*
*The dust that was his body blows*
*And plays upon the mellow air*
*And lands upon some white, washed hand.*
*The girl that combs her yellow hair*
*Takes pause, then blows away the man.*

*Lifir hann of allar aldir ok stjórnar ǫllu ríki sínu ok rǫ́ðr ǫllum hlutum, stórum ok smǫ́m.* [...] *Hann smíðaði himin ok jǫrð ok lopt'in ok alla eign þeira.* [...] *Hitt er þó mest, er hann gerði mann'inn ok gaf hónum ǫnd þá, er lifa skal ok aldri týna=sk, þó't lík-amr fúni at moldu eða brenni at ǫsku; ok skulu allir menn lifa, þeir er rétt eru siðaðir, ok vera með hónum sjǫlfum þar sem heitir Gim·lé eða Vin·gólf.*

*Gylfa ginning* 3:7–11

*Dęyr fé, · dęyja frę́ndr,*
*dęyr sjalfr hit sama;*
*ek vęit ęinn · at aldri=gi dęyr*
*dómr of dauðan hvęrn.*

*Hǫva mǫ́l* 77

*Meðal-snotr · skyli manna hvęrr,*
*ęva til snotr séi;*
*því't snotrs manns hjarta · verðr sjaldan glatt,*
*ef sá 's al-snotr es á.*

*Hǫva mǫ́l* 106

*Ullar hylli · hęfr ok allra goða*
*hvęrr's tękr fyrstr à funa*
*því't opnir hęimar · verða umb àsa sonum,*
*þà's hęfja af hvera.*

*Grímnis mǫ́l* 43

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# Contents

**Acknowledgments** **v**

**Contents** **vi**

**Abbreviations** **xvii**
Languages, language families, and scripts . . . . . xvii
General abbreviations . . . . . xviii
Primary sources . . . . . xx

**Bibliography** **xxv**
List of Abbreviations . . . . . xxv
Bibliography . . . . . xxvi

**List of Figures** **xl**

**General Introduction (incomplete!)** **xli**
Note . . . . . xli
The historical and cultural context . . . . . xlii
Germanic alliterative poetry . . . . . xliv
The corpus . . . . . xlviii
The presentation of the text . . . . . l

**Introduction to Eddic Poetry** **1**
Character . . . . . 1
Dating . . . . . 1
Manuscripts . . . . . 4

**Norse Mythic Poetry** **9**

**Introduction to Norse Mythic Poetry** **11**
The poems . . . . . 11
Table of manuscripts . . . . . 14

**Vǫlu spǫ́** **15**

Introduction . . . . . 15
Text . . . . . 24
Appendix . . . . . 69

**Hǫ́va mǫ́l** **75**
Introduction . . . . . 75
Text . . . . . 80

**Vaf·þrúðnis mǫ́l** **153**
Introduction . . . . . 153
Text . . . . . 157

**Grímnis mǫ́l** **183**
Introduction . . . . . 183
Text . . . . . 187
Appendix . . . . . 217

**Baldrs draumar** **221**
Introduction . . . . . 221
Text . . . . . 223

**Skírnis mǫ́l** **229**
Introduction . . . . . 229
Text . . . . . 232
Appendix . . . . . 247

**Hár·barðs ljóð** **251**
Introduction . . . . . 251
Text . . . . . 256

**Hymis kviða** **273**
Introduction . . . . . 273
Text . . . . . 281

**Loka sęnna** **299**
Introduction . . . . . 299
Text . . . . . 302
Appendix . . . . . 326

**Þryms kviða** **329**
Introduction . . . . . 329
Text . . . . . 333

**Vǫlundar kviða** **347**
Introduction . . . . . 347
Text . . . . . 352

**Al·víss mǫ́l** **367**

Introduction . . . . . 367
Text . . . . . 369

**Rígs þula** **379**
Introduction . . . . . 379
Text . . . . . 384
Appendix . . . . . 397

**Hyndlu ljóð** **399**
Introduction . . . . . 399
Text . . . . . 400

**Fragments from Snorre's Edda** **413**
Introduction . . . . . 413
I. A lost riddle-poem (*Gylf* 2:15–20) . . . . . 414
II. Nearth and Shede (*Gylf* 23:1–14) . . . . . 415
III. Homedall's Galder (*Hęim·dallar-galdr*, *Gylf* 27) . . . . . 418
IV. Gna and the Wanes (*Gylf* 35:21–26). . . . . 420
V. Balder's death (*Gylf* 49:77–82) . . . . . 421
VI. Thunder's journey to Garfrith (*Skm* 26) . . . . . 423
VII. The tree Glazer (*Skm* 42) . . . . . 426
VIII. On the making of Glapner (*Lítla skálda*) . . . . . 427

**Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle** **429**

**Introduction to Norse Heroic Poetry** **431**
The Walsing-Cycle . . . . . 431
The poems . . . . . 436
Table of manuscripts . . . . . 438

**I Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana** **441**
Introduction . . . . . 441
Text . . . . . 443

**Hęlga kviða Hjǫr·varðs-sonar** **459**
Introduction . . . . . 459
Text . . . . . 461

**II Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana** **479**
Introduction . . . . . 479
Text . . . . . 481

**Grípis spǫ́** **499**
Introduction . . . . . 499
Text . . . . . 503

**Ręgins mǫ́l** **519**

Introduction . . . . . 519
Text . . . . . 521

**Fáfnis mǫ́l** **533**
Introduction . . . . . 533
Text . . . . . 537

**Sigr·drífu mǫ́l** **553**
Introduction . . . . . 553
Text . . . . . 556

**Fragments from the Walsing-Cycle** **569**
Introduction . . . . . 569
Fragments from *Vǫls* . . . . . 569
Fragment from *Sv* . . . . . 571

**Brot af Sig·urðar kviða** **573**
Introduction . . . . . 573
Text . . . . . 575

**I Guð·rúnar kviða** **583**
Introduction . . . . . 583
Text . . . . . 585

**Sig·urðar kviða in skamma** **595**
Introduction . . . . . 595
Text . . . . . 597

**Hęl-ręið Bryn·hildar** **617**
Introduction . . . . . 617
Text . . . . . 619

**II Guð·rúnar kviða** **625**
Introduction . . . . . 625
Text . . . . . 627

**III Guð·rúnar kviða** **641**
Introduction . . . . . 641
Text . . . . . 643

**Odd·rúnar grátr** **647**
Introduction . . . . . 647
Text . . . . . 648

**Atla kviða** **657**
Introduction . . . . . 657
Text . . . . . 660

**Atla mǫ́l in grøn-lęndsku** **679**
Introduction . . . . . 679
Text . . . . . 681

**Guð·rúnar hvǫt** **709**
Introduction . . . . . 709
Text . . . . . 712

**Ham·ðis mǫ́l** **721**
Introduction . . . . . 721
Text . . . . . 723

**West Germanic Heroic Poetry** **733**

**Beo·wulf** **735**
Introduction . . . . . 735
Text . . . . . 736

**Fight at Finnsbury** **743**
Introduction . . . . . 743
Text . . . . . 745

**Wald·hęre** **749**
Introduction . . . . . 749
Text . . . . . 750

**Wíd·sīþ** **755**
Introduction . . . . . 755
Text . . . . . 756

**Deor** **765**
Introduction . . . . . 765
Text . . . . . 767

**Wulf and Éad·wacer** **771**
Introduction . . . . . 771
Text . . . . . 772

**Hildebrandslied** **775**
Introduction . . . . . 775
Text . . . . . 781

**Poetry on Christian Subjects** **789**

**Introduction to Old Saxon Christian Poetry** **791**

**Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** **793**
Introduction . . . . . 793
Text . . . . . 794

**Hêljand** **795**
Introduction . . . . . 795
NOTE! . . . . . 801
Text . . . . . 802

**Old Saxon Genesis** **973**
Introduction . . . . . 973
Text . . . . . 975

**Genesis B** **985**
Introduction . . . . . 985
Text . . . . . 986

**Wessobrunn Hymn** **1005**
Introduction . . . . . 1005
Text . . . . . 1007

**Muspilli** **1009**
Introduction . . . . . 1009
Text . . . . . 1013

**Cadman's Hymn** **1023**
Introduction . . . . . 1023
Text . . . . . 1024

**Galders (INCOMPLETE!)** **1025**

**Introduction to Galders** **1027**

**Continental Germanic Galders** **1029**

**The Merseburg Galders** **1031**
Introduction . . . . . 1031

**German Wyrm-galders** **1037**
Against wyrms (*Contra vermes*) . . . . . 1037
For Nesse (*Pro Nessia*) . . . . . 1039

**The Knosping Galder** **1041**
Introduction . . . . . 1041

**Old English Galders** **1043**

**Nigon wyrta galdor** **1045**
Introduction . . . . . 1045
Text . . . . . 1045

**Wið dweorh** **1051**
Introduction . . . . . 1051
Text . . . . . 1051

**Wið fær-stice** **1053**
Introduction . . . . . 1053
Text . . . . . 1053

**Three Galders for Birth** **1057**
Introduction . . . . . 1057
Text . . . . . 1057

**For Theft of Cattle** **1061**
Introduction . . . . . 1061
Text . . . . . 1061

**Wið ymbe** **1063**
Introduction . . . . . 1063
Text . . . . . 1063

**Wið Wennan** **1065**
Introduction . . . . . 1065
Text . . . . . 1065

**Wið Wæter-ælf-ádle** **1067**
Introduction . . . . . 1067
Text . . . . . 1067

**Æcer-bót** **1069**
Introduction . . . . . 1069
Text . . . . . 1069

**Old Norse galders** **1073**

**SJy 41 (SJy 41; Ribe galder-stick)** **1075**
Introduction . . . . . 1075
Transliteration . . . . . 1075
Text . . . . . 1076

**The Canterbury Galder (E DR419)** **1079**
Introduction . . . . . 1079
Text . . . . . 1079

**Sigtuna rib (U NOR1998;25)** **1081**

Introduction . . . . . 1081
Text . . . . . 1081

**Sigtuna Plate I (U Fv1933;134)** **1083**
Introduction . . . . . 1083
Text . . . . . 1083

**Högstena plate (Vg 216)** **1085**
Introduction . . . . . 1085
Text . . . . . 1085

**Galders from Bryggen** **1087**
Introduction . . . . . 1087
N B257 . . . . . 1087
N B380 . . . . . 1089

**Runic Poetry** **1091**

**Introduction to Runic Poetry** **1093**

**Introduction to the Rune Poems** **1095**
Runes and other European alphabets . . . . . 1095
The Rune poems . . . . . 1095

**The Old English Rune Poem** **1099**
Introduction . . . . . 1099
Text . . . . . 1099

**The Icelandic Rune Poem** **1105**
Introduction . . . . . 1105
Text . . . . . 1106

**The Norwegian Rune Poem** **1109**
Introduction . . . . . 1109
Text . . . . . 1111

**Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland** **1115**
Introduction . . . . . 1115
G 113 (Ardre) . . . . . 1117
G 188 . . . . . 1118
G 203 (Hogräns) . . . . . 1119
G 207 . . . . . 1121
G 208 . . . . . 1122
G 343 . . . . . 1123
G 370 . . . . . 1124
Nä 29 . . . . . 1125
Sm 5 . . . . . 1126

Sm 16 . . . . . 1127
Sm 29 . . . . . 1128
Sm 35 (Replösa) . . . . . 1129
Sm 37 (Rörbro) . . . . . 1130
Sm 39 . . . . . 1131
Sm 44 . . . . . 1132
Sm 45 . . . . . 1133
Sm 46 . . . . . 1134
Sm 60 . . . . . 1135
Sö 9 (Lifsinge) . . . . . 1136
Sö 14 (Gåsinge) . . . . . 1137
Sö 33 . . . . . 1138
Sö 34–35 (Tjuvstigen) . . . . . 1139
Sö 41 . . . . . 1141
Sö 47 . . . . . 1142
Sö 54 . . . . . 1143
Sö 55 (Bjudby) . . . . . 1144
Sö 56 (Fyrby) . . . . . 1145
Sö 61 . . . . . 1146
Sö 65 (Djulefors) . . . . . 1147
Sö 85 . . . . . 1148
Sö 106 . . . . . 1149
Sö 122 (Skresta) . . . . . 1150
Sö 126 . . . . . 1151
Sö 130 . . . . . 1152
Sö 131 . . . . . 1153
Sö 136 . . . . . 1154
Sö 137 (Aspa) . . . . . 1155
Sö 145 . . . . . 1156
Sö 148 . . . . . 1157
Sö 154 (Skarpåker) . . . . . 1158
Sö 159 . . . . . 1159
Sö 163 . . . . . 1160
Sö 164 . . . . . 1161
Sö 165 . . . . . 1162
Sö 171 . . . . . 1163
Sö 173 (Tystberga) . . . . . 1164
Sö 174 (Aspö) . . . . . 1165
Sö 179 (Gripsholm) . . . . . 1166
Sö 198 (Mervalla) . . . . . 1167
Sö 204 (Överselö church) . . . . . 1168
Sö 206/208 . . . . . 1169
Sö 207 . . . . . 1170
Sö 213 . . . . . 1171
Sö 320 . . . . . 1172
Sö 335 . . . . . 1173
Sö 338 . . . . . 1174

Sö 340 . . . . . 1175
Sö 345 . . . . . 1176
Sö Fv1948;289 (Aspa) . . . . . 1177
Sö Fv1954;22 . . . . . 1178
U 11 . . . . . 1179
U 69 . . . . . 1180
U 102 . . . . . 1181
U 112 . . . . . 1182
U 114 . . . . . 1183
U 127/164/165/261 . . . . . 1184
U 136 . . . . . 1186
U 153/155 . . . . . 1187
U 166 . . . . . 1188
U 207–8 . . . . . 1189
U 214–15 . . . . . 1190
U 225–26 (Bällsta) . . . . . 1191
U 300 (Skånela) . . . . . 1193
U 323 (Sälna) . . . . . 1194
U 336 . . . . . 1196
U 349 . . . . . 1197
U 358 . . . . . 1198
U 437 (Broby) . . . . . 1199
U 512 . . . . . 1200
U 605 . . . . . 1201
U 614 . . . . . 1202
U 617 (Bro) . . . . . 1203
U 644 . . . . . 1204
U 654 . . . . . 1205
U 661 . . . . . 1206
U 703 (Västra Väppeby) . . . . . 1207
U 707/710 (Husby) . . . . . 1208
U 729 . . . . . 1209
U 735 (Långarnö) . . . . . 1210
U 739 (Gådi) . . . . . 1211
U 778 . . . . . 1212
U 792 . . . . . 1213
U 805 . . . . . 1214
U 838 . . . . . 1215
U 887 . . . . . 1216
U 1016 . . . . . 1217
U Fv1983;228 . . . . . 1218
U Fv1986;84 . . . . . 1219
U Fv1992;157 . . . . . 1220
U Fv1912;8 . . . . . 1221
Vg 32 . . . . . 1222
Vg 59 . . . . . 1223
Vg 61 (Härlingstorp) . . . . . 1224

Vg 187 . . . . . 1225
Vs 15 (Kyringe) . . . . . 1226
Vs 24 (Hassmyra) . . . . . 1228
Ög 8 (Kälvesten) . . . . . 1230
Ög 66 . . . . . 1231
Ög 68 . . . . . 1232
Ög 77 . . . . . 1233
Ög 81 (Högby) . . . . . 1234
Ög 136 (Rök) . . . . . 1236
Ög 155 . . . . . 1237
Ög 165 (Skänninge) . . . . . 1238
Ög 212 . . . . . 1239
Öl 1 (Karlevi) . . . . . 1240
Öl 39 (Bägby) . . . . . 1241
Index of proper nouns . . . . . 1242
Index of carvers . . . . . 1242

**Runic Poetry from Denmark and Scania** **1243**
Introduction . . . . . 1243
Bh 33 (DR 379; Nylarsker-sten 1) . . . . . 1244
Bh 34 (DR 380; Nylarsker-sten 2) . . . . . 1245
Bh 42 (DR 387; Vestermarie-sten 5) . . . . . 1245
MJy 37 (DR 94; Ålum-sten 1) . . . . . 1247
MJy 71 (DR 131; Års-sten) . . . . . 1248
MJy 79 (DR 68; Århus-sten 5) . . . . . 1249
NJy 41 (DR 149; Ydby-sten) . . . . . 1250
Sj 93 (DR 229; Sandby-sten 3) . . . . . 1251
SJy 5 (DR 37; Egtved-sten) . . . . . 1252
SJy 14 (DR 40; Randbøl-sten) . . . . . 1253
Sk 5 (DR 263; Skabersjö-fibula) . . . . . 1254
Sk 42 (DR 337; Valleberga-sten) . . . . . 1255
Sk 51 (DR 279; Sjörup-sten) . . . . . 1256
Sk 80 (DR 295; Hällestad-sten 1) . . . . . 1257
Sk 81 (DR 296; Hällestad-sten 2) . . . . . 1258
SlB 3 (DR Schl3; Slesvig-pind) . . . . . 1259
Syd 11 (DR 212; Tillitse-sten) . . . . . 1260

**Index** **1261**

**Index (INCOMPLETE!)** **1263**
Cultural and religious terms and expressions (C) . . . . . 1263
Proper nouns (P) . . . . . 1269
Poetic formulæ (F) . . . . . 1286

# Abbreviations

## Languages, language families, and scripts

- AS = Anglo-Saxon
- EF. = Elder Futhark
- Eng. = Modern English
- Ger. = Modern German
- Got. = Gotnish (or Gothic)
- IE = Indo-European
- Lomb. = Lombardic
- MHG = Middle High German
- NGmc. = North Germanic
- ODan. = Old Danish
- OE = Old English
- OF = Old Frisian
- OHG = Old High German
- OI = Old Indian
- OIr. = Old Irish
- ON = Old Norse
- OS = Old Saxon
- OSwe. = Old Swedish
- PGmc. = Proto-Germanic
- PIE = Proto-Indo-European

- PN = Proto-Norse
- PNWGmc. = Proto-North-West Germanic
- PWGmc. = Proto-West Germanic
- WGmc. = West Germanic
- YF = Younger Futhark

## General abbreviations

- 1st = first-person
- 2nd = second-person
- 3rd = third-person
- abbrev. = abbreviated
- acc. = accusative case
- add. = is added
- adj. = adjective
- approx. = approximately
- c. = century
- ca. = circa
- cert. = certainly
- cf. = *confere*; compare
- corr. = corrected in the ms.
- cpd. = compound
- dat. = dative case
- e. = excerpt (not the whole stanza)
- ed. = edition, edited (by)
- e.g. = *exemplio gratia*; for instance
- emend. = emendation, emended (by)
- esp. = especially
- f. = feminine
- fol., foll. = folio, folios

- gen. = genitive case
- id. = *idem*; the same
- i.e., = *id est*; that is
- imper. = imperative mood
- ind. = indicative mood
- instr. = instrumental case
- l., ll. = line, lines
- lit. = literal, literally
- m. = masculine
- metr. emend. = emended based on metrical criteria
- ms., mss. = manuscript, manuscripts
- n. = and note, (see) note to aforementioned passage
- nom. = nominative case
- norm. = normalised from the ms. spelling
- ntr. = neuter
- om. = omitted by
- p., pp. = page, pages
- pl. = plural number
- pr. = *principium*; the unnumbered introductory paragraph of a section or speech marker before a stanza
- pres. = present
- pres. ed. = present edition
- prob. = probably
- rev. = reversed (of lines or words)
- sens. emend. = emended due to lack of sense
- sg. = singular number
- st., sts. = stanza, stanzas
- subj. = subjunctive mood
- s.v. = *sub verbo*; under the word

- tr. = translation, translated (by)
- viz. = *vidēlicet*; namely, to wit
- wo. = without
- wrt. = with regard to
- < = (deriving) from
- > = whence

## Primary sources

For ease of reference, those texts which are included in the present edition are marked in bold text.

- *AB* = *Aitareyá Bráhmaṇa*
- ***Akv*** = *Atla kviða* ('Lay of Attle')
- ***Alv*** = *Alvíss mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Allwise')
- ***Am*** = *Atla mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Attle')
- *AV* = *Atᵇarva-vēdá*, in the *Ṣāúnaka* recension unless otherwise specified
- ***Bdr*** = *Baldrs draumar* ('Dreams of Balder')
- *Beow* = *Beowulf*
- ***Birth*** = Three Galders for Birth
- ***Brot*** = *Brot af Sig·urðar kviða* ('Fragment of a Lay of Siward')
- ***Cadman*** = Cadman's Hymn
- ***Cant*** = Canterbury Galder
- ***ContVerm*** = *Contra Vermes* ('Against Wyrms')
- ***Déor*** = *Déor* ('Deer')
- ***Dweorh*** = *Wið dweorh* ('Against a Dwarf')
- *Eb* = *Eyr-byggja saga* ('Saw of the Ere-dwellers')
- ***Eddbr*** = *Brot ór Snorra Edda* ('Fragments from Snorre's Edda')
- *Eirm* = *Ęi·ríks mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Eric'), Anon *Eirm* in SkP 1
- ***Fáfn*** = *Fáfnis mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Fathomer')
- *Fbr* = *Fóstr-bróðra saga* ('Saw of the Foster-brothers')

- ***Finn*** = The Fight at Finnsbury
- *Fjǫl* = *Fjǫl·svinns mǫ́l* ('The Speeches of Fellswith')
- *Fornk* = *Sǫgu-brot af nǫkkurum forn-konungum í Dana- ok Svía-veldi* ('Fragment of a Saw from Some Ancient Kings in the Danish and Swedish Realms')
- *Frost* = *Frosta·þings lǫg* ('Law of the Frost-Thing'), ed. NGL I (pp. 119–258)
- ***Férst*** = *Wið Fér-stice* ('Against a Sudden Stitch')
- *Gautr* = *Gaut·reks saga* ('Saw of Geatric')
- ***GenB*** = *Genesis B*
- *Gldr* = *Glym-drápa* ('Glim-Drape'), Þhorn *Gldr* in SkP 1
- ***Ghv*** = *Guð·rúnar hvǫt* ('Instigation of Guthrun')
- *Gr* = *Grettis saga* ('Saw of Gretter')
- *Grg* = *Gróu galdr* ('Galder of Growe')
- ***Grí́p*** = *Grípis spǫ́* ('Spae of Griper')
- ***Grm*** = *Grímnis mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Grimner')
- *Grot* = *Grotta sǫngr* ('Song of Grotte')
- ***1 Guðr*** = *1 Guð·rúnar kviða* ('First Lay of Guthrun')
- ***2 Guðr*** = *2 Guð·rúnar kviða* ('Second Lay of Guthrun')
- ***3 Guðr*** = *3 Guð·rúnar kviða* ('Third Lay of Guthrun')
- *Gula* = *Gula·þings lǫg* ('Law of the Gole-Thing'), ed. NGL I (pp. 1–118)
- *Gut* = *Guta saga* ('Saw of the Gutes')
- *Gylf* = *Gylfa ginning* ('Beguiling of Yilver')
- *HákGóð* = *Hǫ́·konar saga góða* ('Saw of Hathkin the Good')
- *Hákm* = *Hǫ́·konar mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Hathkin'), Eyv *Hák* in SkP 1
- *Hálf* = *Hálfs saga ok Hálfs rekka* ('Saw of Hathwolf and Hathwolf's Champions')
- *Hált* = *Há·leygja tal* ('Tally of the Highlies'), Eyv *Hál* in SkP 1
- ***Hamð*** = *Ham·ðis mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Hamthew')
- ***Hárb*** = *Hár·barðs ljóð* ('Leeds of Hoarbeard')
- *Haustl* = *Haust-lǫng* ('Harvest-Long'), Þjóð *Haustl* in SkP 3

- ***Háv*** = *Hǫ́va mǫ́l* (‘Speeches of the High One’)
- ***Hdl*** = *Hyndlu ljóð* (‘Leeds of Hindle’)
- *Heiðr* = *Her·varar saga ok Heið·reks* (‘Saw of Harware and Heathric’)
- ***Heli*** = *Heliand*
- ***Helr*** = *Hel-reið Bryn·hildar* (‘Hell-ride of Byrnhild’)
- ***HHj*** = *Hęlga kviða Hjǫr·varðs-sonar* (‘Lay of Hallow Harwardson’)
- ***1 HHund*** = *1 Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana* (‘First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane’)
- ***2 HHund*** = *2 Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana* (‘Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane’)
- ***Hild*** = *Hildebrandslied* (‘Lay of Hildbrand’)
- *Hrafnk* = *Hrafn·kels saga* (‘Saw of Ravenkettle’)
- *Húsdr* = *Hús-drápa* (‘Drape for a House’), ÚlfrU *Húsdr* in SkP 3
- ***Hym*** = *Hymis kviða* (‘Lay of Hymer’)
- ***RunIce*** = The Icelandic Rune Poem
- ***RunNor*** = The Norwegian Rune Poem
- ***RunOE*** = The Old English Rune Poem
- *Il* = Homer’s Ἰλιάς (*Iliad*)
- *Ldn* = *Land-náma bók* (‘Book of Land-Claims’)
- ***Lok*** = *Loka senna* (‘Flyting of Lock’)
- *MB$^{b}$* = *Mahábᵇārata*
- ***Mers*** = The Merseburg galders
- *Mhkv* = *Máls-hátta kvęði* (‘Poem of Sayings’), Anon *Mhkv* in SkP 3
- *Norn* = *Norna-Gests þáttr* (‘Strand of Norn-Guest’)
- ***Nwyrt*** = *Nigon wyrta galdor* (‘Galder of Nine Worts’)
- *Od* = Homer’s Ὀδύσσεια (*Odyssey*)
- ***Oddr*** = *Odd·rúnar grátr* (‘Weeping of Ordrun’)
- ***ProNessia*** = *Pro Nessia* (‘For Nesse’)
- *Rdr* = *Ragnars drápa* (‘Drape of Rainer’), Bragi *Rdr* in SkP 3
- ***Reg*** = *Regins mǫ́l* (‘Speeches of Rein’)

- *ṚV* = *Ṛg-vēdá*, with translations from Jamison and Brereton (2014) unless otherwise specified
- ***Rþ*** = *Rígs þula* ('Thule of Righ')
- ***SaxGen*** = Old Saxon Genesis
- ***Sigrdr*** = *Sigr·drífu mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Syedrive')
- ***Sigsk*** = *Sig·urðar kviða in skamma* ('Short Lay of Siward')
- ***Skí*** = *Skírnis mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Shirner')
- *Skm* = *Skald-skapar mǫ́l* ('Matter of Scaldship')
- *SKVR* = *Suomen kansan vanhat runot* ('Ancient Songs of the Finnish People')
- *SnE* = *Snorra Edda* ('Snorre's Edda'), the Prose Edda
- *Sól* = *Sólar-ljóð* ('Leeds of the Sun'), Anon *Sól* in SkP 7
- *Sont* = *Sona-tor·rek* ('Grievous Loss of Sons'), Egill *Sont* in SkP 5
- *Sǫrla* = *Sǫrla þáttr* ('Strand of Sarle')
- *Styrb* = *Styr·bjarnar þáttr Svía-kappa* ('Strand of Stirbern Champion of the Swedes')
- *Sv* = *Sverris saga* ('Saw of Swerrer')
- *Theog* = Hesiod's Θεογονία (*Theogony*, 'Birth of the Gods'), West (1966) ed.
- ***Vafþ*** = *Vaf·þrúðnis mǫ́l* ('Speeches of Webthrithner')
- *Vatn* = *Vatns-døla saga* ('Saw of the Waterdellings')
- ***Vkv*** = *Vǫlundar kviða* ('Lay of Wayland')
- *Vǫls* = *Vǫlsunga saga* ('Saw of the Walsings'), normalised from Olsen (1906–1908) ed.
- *Vǫlsa* = *Vǫlsa þáttr* ('Strand of Walse')
- ***Vǫlsbr*** = *Brot ór* Vǫls ('Fragments from *Vǫls*')
- ***Vsp*** = *Vǫlu spǫ́* ('Spae of the Wallow')
- ***Wald*** = *Wald·hęre* ('Walder')
- ***Wessobrunn*** = The Wessobrunn Hymn
- ***Wíd*** = *Wíd·siþ* ('Widsith')
- ***Wulf*** = *Wulf and Éad·wacer* 'Wolf and Edwaker'

- ***Ymbe*** = *Wiđ Ymbe* (‘Against a Swarm’)
- *Yng* = *Ynglinga saga* (‘Saw of the Inglings’)
- *Yt* = *Ynglinga tal* (‘Tally of the Inglings’), Þjóð *Yt* in SkP 1
- ***Æcer*** = *Æcer-bót* (‘Acre-Boot’)
- *Þiðr* = *Þið·reks saga* (‘Saw of Thedric’)
- *Þdr* = *Þórs drápa* (‘Drape of Thunder’)
- ***Þrk*** = *Þryms kviða* (‘Lay of Thrim’)

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For the sigla of manuscripts see the introductions to the relevant sections.

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# List of Figures


1 The Tullstorp stone (DR 271), showing a wolf above a ship, perhaps the Fenrerswolf and Nailfare. Wiking Age, ca. 1000 AD. . 23
2 The gilt (day) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. Nordic Bronze Age, ca. 1400 BC. . . . . 161
3 The ungilt (night) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. . . . . 162
4 Detail of Thunder on the Altuna stone. Wiking Age, ca. 1000 AD. 279
5 Hammer-amulet with face from unknown findspot, Scania. Wiking Age, ca. 900 AD. . . . . 298
6 The gilt bronze disc-on-bow brooch from Othemars, Gotland. Wiking Age, ca. 900 AD. . . . . 338
7 The front panel of the Franks casket. Anglo-Saxon, ca. 725 AD. 349
8 Hilt of the Snartemo sword, front and reverse. Migration period, ca. 500 AD. . . . . 465
9 The Ramsund carving. Wiking Age, ca. 1030 AD. . . . . 536
10 Detail of a struggling stag and serpent on the Urnes Stave Church, a common motif of the Urnes style. Middle Ages, ca. 1140 AD. . 539
11 Guther in the snake-pit, detail on the left portal of the now-demolished Hylestad Stave Church in Setesdal, Norway. Mediaeval, ca. 1170 AD . . . . . 673

# General Introduction (incomplete!)

## Note

What is this book? It is a book of poems, really, of songs—songs dating to the first millennium AD or some time thereafter. What is their nature? They were sung by the Germanic peoples about their Gods and heroes through Dark Ages, through the fall of Rome and the volcanic winter of 536, in ships and shores of England, in frozen settlements on Iceland and Greenland, in Danish fields, Swedish forests, and Norwegian firths, in English monasteries and the ear of Charlemagne.

Compared to the epic traditions of Classical Antiquity the Germanic songs of heroes do not tell of a very ancient past. On the contrary, many of them concern events documented in contemporary Classical sources far more accurate than these illiterate ballad-singers working centuries after-the-fact could ever aspire to be. But their goal was never historical accuracy. For them the old times were long past; who could faithfully recall them but the High One, the One-Eyed Himself? These were bards and storytellers and prophetesses, keepers of an ancient poetic tradition far predating the subjects with which it dealt. This was a tradition infused with the Indo-European spirit of the unending steppes and the snowcapped mountains, the soaring eagle and the galloping steed. In their stoic fatalism, in their tales of great love and struggle, deprivation and human tragedy, heroic friendship and betrayal, these stories were far older than the more factually correct mediaeval chroniclers which chronologically predated them. In this way they were, in their oft rough-hewn simplicity, as old as Homer, as old as the Vedas—or maybe older still.

The Northern epics are the songs the Germanic-speaking West for many centuries forgot. We forgot them when we became just that, Westerners—Christians, Romans. It was Alcuin, the English scholar, who in a letter upbraided his less learnèd English brethren who would rather sing pagan Saxon songs about Ingeld than the Psalms of David—"what does Ingeld have to do with Christ?" he asked. It was Louis the Pious, king of the Franks, who burned his father Charlemagne's great collection of German epic poetry. For these new men steeped in Roman learning, whose souls were circumcised, even if their bodies were not, the ethos of the old folk-songs was too warlike, too fatalistic, in a word, too *pagan*.

The echoes of the same stories in time suffered a tragic fate in England and the Continent. The heavily damaged copies written in idioms and hands far too archaic to be understood by later ages were cut up and used for their thick leather as covers for younger, more modern books. And yet measuring fate would not have it that they were, like so many other European pagan traditions, forever lost. It was on Iceland, that northern island outpost on the edge of the known world, where the songs of Gods and heroes lived longest upon the lips of hoary upholders of tradition. It was that most distant offshoot of Germandom, whose unyielding settlers sailed as far as Greenland and North America, which in time came to preserve what the center had lost.

The Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda, the last surviving storehouse of the songs of the Germanic gods, was rediscovered in Iceland in 1642. Together with the Prose Edda it laid the ground for the new field of the study of Germanic antiquity, which over time developed in lockstep with the evolution of Western science and culture in general and that of philology and linguistics in particular. Over the centuries it was joined by the rediscoveries of *Beowulf*, the Exeter Book, *Hildebrandslied*, the Merseburg charms, the Gallehus horns and countless other minor sources.

No work could aim to give a complete overview of all scholarly efforts since the 17th century. The goal of the present edition must only be to provide a small selection of previous insights, together with some new ones, which (it is hoped) may inspire the curiosity of the English-speaking reader and increase his or her understanding and respect for these very important, frequently very difficult texts.

## The historical and cultural context

It is presupposed throughout this book that the Germanic-speaking peoples—the English, Scandinavians, Dutch, Frisians, and Germans—were originally united by much more than their languages alone; that these nations, although greatly splintered by the turns of history, ultimately share not only language, but a common ancestral culture, religion, and origin.

All Germanic languages—like the Romance languages from Latin—ultimately descend from Proto-Germanic. Unlike its contemporary Classical Latin, Proto-Germanic is a reconstructed language attested only in a few borrowed names and short, late runic inscriptions. Still, we have enough data to be able to reconstruct it confidently, and such reconstructions will appear throughout the book.

Proto-Germanic in turn derives from the wholly unattested Proto-Indo-European, from which also spring the Albanian, Armenian, Baltic and Slavic, Celtic, Greek, Italic, and Indo-Iranian tongues along with the now-extinct Anatolian and Tocharian and a likely myriad other now-lost languages. The Germanic branch most likely broke away from its closest known Indo-European linguistic relatives in the early 3rd millennium BC and has developed on its own since, undergoing important changes in its sounds, word-hoard, word-order, and grammar.

Around the start of the first millennium AD the Germanic family itself broke apart into three branches: the Northern, Western, and Eastern. Only the first two are presently extant. To the first belong the Scandinavian languages descended from Old Norse; to the second English, Frisian, Dutch, Low and High German (including Yiddish); to the third the extinct Gothic. It is generally held to be the case on the basis of a number of common innovations that Northern and Western branches form a single subclade, Northwest Germanic, to the exclusion of East Germanic (Kim 2024). Since the Wielbark culture, which is probably to be identified with the early ancestors of the Gots, emigrated from Scandinavia around 50 BC, this forms a useful reference point for the time of the splintering of the Germanic language family.

The cultural affinities of the Germanic-speaking peoples are of course greater the further back in time one looks. During the Migration Period there was something of a cultural flow between all Germanic peoples, especially those who were not yet Christianized, as seen both archaeologically and in later literary sources like *Wíd* (Neidorf 2013). Customs like the husband's "morning-gift" to his wife on the day of their wedding or the twelve-man jury were spread far and wide by these expanding tribes, as was the two-stemmed naming system also found among other Indo-Europeans (in English e.g. Edwin < Old English *Éad-wine* < Proto-Germanic **Auda-winiz* 'Friend of Wealth').

Nor were these affinities entirely lost on the tribes themselves. Both Gots and Longbeards (i.e., Lombards) remembered their old homeland of Scandinavia and many of the related tribes living there (Jordanes, *Getica* 10, 16–25; *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1, edited under the appendix to *Grm*); the Anglo-Saxons, too, never forgot that they had come from Northern Germany and Jutland (Gretzinger et al. 2022), nor that there were still related people living there (Neidorf 2013, pp. 173–176).

As for the religion, the worship of many Gods (the Eese, ON *ęsir*, OE *ęse*, Gothic *Ansis* in Jordanes, *Getica* 78, 79; cf. *Hamð* 25/1 n.) is attested throughout the historical and geographic range of the Germanic peoples, as are the use of sacred rings (the Gothic 'holy' ring of Pietroassa (Antonsen 2002, p. 280; MacLeod and Mees 2006, pp. 173–174), cf. Ambrose of Milan's letter 10:9 which suggests the wearing of bracelets by Gothic priests (Capelle 2010, p. 425); *Háv* 110, *Hild* 32), animal sacrifices, and certain forms of ritual warfare (*Vsp* 23 n.). Also widely attested is the worship of the gods Weden, Ing, and Thunder, the former of whom appears in His name Geat at the head of both Gothic and Anglo-Saxon genealogies (*Hamð* 25/1 n.).

Turning to shared ancestry, recent genetic advances have shown that the lines of linguistic expansion line up with signals of genetic kinship, and have in effect confirmed what earlier scholars of the 19th and early 20th centuries presumed, namely that speakers of related languages always ultimately descend, to greater or lesser degree, from a single group of speakers of a proto-language.

What the genetics show us is that the Germanic peoples originate in Northern Europe, chiefly Scandinavia and Northern Germany, and that the speakers of Proto-Germanic were genetically indistinguishable from mod-

ern indigenous Scandinavians. They in turn derived much of their ancestry from the early Indo-Europeans of the Pontic-Caspian steppe, who mixed with Early European Farmers to the west to form the Corded Ware Culture, which over time expanded in all directions (McColl et al. 2024).

In the West this early Indo-European culture formed the Bell Beakers who conquered Ireland and Iberia; in the South it formed the Italic peoples who eventually became the Romans; in the East it formed the Sintashta culture, or Proto-Indo-Iranians, whose descendants became the Iranians and Vedic Indians who founded the Zoroastrian and Vedic religions; in the Northeast it formed the Balts and Slavs; and in Scandinavia it formed the Battle Axe and Single Grave cultures which eventually gave way to the Nordic Bronze Age, the ancestors of the Germanic peoples.

In all cases, including Scandinavia, the expansion of the Indo-Europeans was that of a warlike and patriarchal culture not unlike its later descendants, whether Roman or Germanic. Indeed, present-day native Scandinavians, who are largely the direct biological descendants of the Nordic Bronze Age, carry almost no ancestry from the Stone Age Scandinavian Hunter Gatherers that preceded them (Allentoft et al. 2024).

Although the genes for light eyes and hair colour were present already on the Pontic-Caspian steppe, it was in the later Corded Ware that the heavy selection for these traits was effected (Wilde et al. 2014; Ju and Mathieson 2021; Perretti et al. 2025), traits which to this day reach their highest frequency in Northern Europe (Frost 2006).

## Germanic alliterative poetry

The historical and literary significance of the poetry in this edition may be thought of in two ways: as the beginning of documented Germanic literature and also as the last stage of an ancient oral tradition with distant Indo-European roots.

On the one hand, alliterative verse is the medium for the oldest indigenous Germanic-language literary monuments (the Gothic literature, chiefly consisting of Wulfila's translation of the Bible, being wholly foreign in origin). It is our earliest native source of knowledge about the Iron Age folk-life of Northern Europe and our most important source for the pre-Christian Germanic religion; it represents the worldview of the Germanic peoples in their earliest historical stages. As the earliest recorded medium for the transmission of song and story amongst the ancestors of numerous great nations it has to some extent influenced all later Germanic languages and literatures. The alliterative poetry, albeit together with Latin, Greek, and Hebrew models, laid the ground for the German *Minnesänger*, the *Nibelungenlied*, and Chaucer, which in turn precede such great writers as Goethe, Wagner, and Shakespeare.

On the other hand, this poetic genre is hardly a new art-form by the time we first encounter it in manuscript form in the 7th century Cadman's Hymn, nor is its characteristic feature, alliteration between initial sounds.

In the 1st century AD Tacitus (*Germania* 2) speaks shortly of the 'ancient songs' in which the Germani documented their mythology and history. He mentions the myth of three brothers, the sons of *Mannus* 'Man', who founded three tribes, the *Ingaevones, Herminones* and *Istaevones*. In their Proto-Germanic forms the names of the three tribes all begin with a vowel, and this is thus the earliest secure example of alliteration.

Tacitus may also give us the earliest example of the Germanic long-line, the same meter as *Beow* and the Poetic Edda, when he (*Germania* 40) lists the following tribes as worshipping *Nerthus*: *Reudigni, Aviones, Anglii, Varini, Eudoses, Suardones, Nuithones*. If *Nuithones* is emended to **Unithones*, which unlike *Nuithones* actually looks like a Germanic word, the list may be arranged into two long-lines, both with vowel-alliteration (Malone 1934; Malone 1936):

*Reudigni, Aviones, · Anglii, Varini,*
*Eudoses, Suardones, · *Unithones.*

A more secure example of the same phenomenon is found in the 2nd century, when Ptolemy (*Geography* 2, 11:7) lists the following tribes on the Cimbric peninsula: *Saxones, Sigulones, Sabalingii, Cobandi, Chali, Phunusii, Charudes*. This example has the advantage of not requiring any emendation, and forms two clean long-lines with typical alliterative patterns (a a : a x, a x : a [x]) (Malone 1936; Neidorf 2013, p. 179):

*Saxones, Sigulones, · Sabalingii, Cobandi,*
*Chali, Phunusii, · Charudes.*

The most likely explanation for these early alliterations is rather straightforward: the Germanic informers recited the tribes in the order they had learnt them, namely as alliterative lists or rigamaroles not unlike what we find in later texts like *Wíd* or the Icelandic poetic lists, the so-called *þulur* 'thules' (Malone 1936).

The earliest indisputable native attestations of the long-line are in runic inscriptions from the early centuries AD, the oldest of which is an early 3rd century sword-chape from Thorsberg moor in Schleswig. These inscription are edited in the pres. ed. under Runic Poetry.

In these finds we see not just the fully formed long-line but also examples of stylistic traits common to all later Germanic alliterative poetry. Thus the 5th century Tjurkö bracteate (DR IK184) calls gold *walha-kurné* (dat. sg.) 'Roman grain', a kenning-like reference to the melting of Roman solidi; the 3rd century Thorsberg chape (DR 7) expresses being 'famous' with the litotes *ni wajé-márɪʀ* 'not ill-famed' (cf. *Akv* 13/1); and the 6th century Noleby stone (Vg 63) mirrors the formula *rúnó ragina-kundó* (acc. sg.) 'rune born of the Gods' later found in the 9th century *Hǫ́va mǫ́l*, st. 80.

Of course, a far greater trove of rich expressions and images, many of great antiquity, is found in the extensive corpus of poetry written in mediaeval manuscripts. In *Beow* and the Edda 'sea-stallions' sail across the ocean like in Homer; in *Grm* 38 the sun is drawn across Heaven in her chariot like in *Ṛ̊V*

and the Trundholm Sun Chariot; in *Beow*, *Heli*, *Akv* and other poems feasts are held in great chiefly 'mead-halls', not unknown from the archaeology of the Nordic Bronze and Iron Ages.

The richness of the poetic tradition is expressed through a language of kennings, stock phrases and exclusive synonyms found only in poetry. Many of these synonyms are quite ancient, being Indo-European words otherwise extinct in all Germanic languages which find their last refuge in poetry. Such are the Old English *eoh*, Old Norse *jór*, corresponding to the Sanskrit *áṣva*, Latin *equus*, all meaning 'horse'; Old Norse *týr*, corresponding to Sanskrit *dēvá*, Latin *deus*, all meaning 'god'; Old English *folde*, Old Norse *fold*, corresponding to Sanskrit *pr̥tʰivī́*, all meaning 'land, (mother) earth'. The fact that many of these relate to the cult perhaps suggests that the Germanic religion was not as innovative as is commonly supposed.

What a comparative investigation reveals is thus that these poetic motifs and words are seldom uniquely mediaeval, nor even inventions of the first centuries AD; instead they time and time again find parallels in texts and archaeological finds as old as the Bronze Age. The poems themselves are clearly much younger than this, but still not so young that their undoubtedly unlatinate authors could have been influenced by texts like the Iliad, which were still yet unknown in Northern Europe. Rather, they seem to retain ancient traditions which must have been passed down through an unbroken chain of poetry going back far into prehistory, to when the Indo-Europeans were still nomadic steppe-pastoralists and much of Europe was still covered by thick forest and marshlands.

## Structure

To describe the structure of Germanic alliterative poetry it is first necessary to describe the general characteristics of the common Germanic alliterative meter as found in the earliest runic inscriptions, West Germanic poetry, and Norse Eddic poetry in the meter Ancient-words-lay. The following description is thus not exhaustive, but does describe the bulk of the corpus.

Alliterative poetry has two primary structural elements: *stress* and *alliteration*. The exact count of syllables is less important, and end-rhyme is only used as a sporadic flourish.

Based on alliteration, words are grouped into *lines*.

### Stress

Each syllable is classed as having primary stress (p), secondary stress (s), or no stress (x). Syllables with p and s are stressed syllables, those with x are unstressed syllables.

Primary stress is reserved for the root syllable in a word, which is not always the same as the first syllable. Compare the English word *beginning*, where the stress pattern is xPx; the primary stress falls on the syllable *ginn-*. Note that not all primary stresses are equal; the general rule is that nouns and adjectives have stronger stress than verbs.

Secondary stress falls on the second element in a compound word, e.g. *hęimr* in *jǫtun-hęimr* 'Ettin-ham'.

No stress falls on inflectional syllables, pronouns and prepositions. The exception for pronouns and prepositions is that they can take primary stress if it coincides with semantic stress, e.g. in a statement like "It was *you*!", or when a preposition is placed after the noun it modifies (e.g. *Beow* 19b: *Scędelandum in* 'in the Northern lands').

### Alliteration

Alliteration is the resonance between two stressed syllables beginning with the same phoneme, e.g. *s*and with re*c*eive, or *g*reat with be*g*in.

Any vowel or diphthong can alliterate with any other vowel or diphthong.

*s* and the clusters *sk, sp* and *st* are counted as four distinct "sounds".

Further, in West Germanic poetry, *g* and *j* can alliterate with each other.

In Norse poetry *j* and *v* can alliterate with vowels, the former always, the latter sporadically.

In the present edition alliterating sounds are marked with red font.

### Positions

The smallest metrical division is the *position*, a concept related but not identical to the syllable. The position must be understood as broader than the syllable as several syllables can fill one position, whereas a single syllable can never fill multiple positions.

A short syllable followed by another syllable can resolve into a single position. Likewise several unstressed syllables can count as a single position.

### Verses

A *verse* or *half-line* is made up of 4 positions—typically 2 stressed, 2 unstressed—arranged according to set patterns. These patterns form the core of Sievers' description of alliterative poetry, and is the description followed here.

TODO: Sieversian types.

### Lines

2 verses are linked together by shared alliteration to form a couplet or *long-line* (often simply *line*). They are separated by a short pause or *cæsura*.

It is not uncommon for editions of Old Norse poetry to print each verse on its own line, e.g. *Vsp* 2/1–2:

> Ek man jǫtna
> ár of borna,
> þá's forðum mik
> fødda hǫfðu;

Editions of West Germanic poetry typically print each long-line on its own line separated by a space to designate the cæsura:

Ek man jǫtna ár of borna,
þá's forðum mik fǫdda hǫfðu;

The present edition follows the latter convention for all alliterative poetry, Norse or West Germanic, but replaces the space with the interpunct:

Ek man jǫtna · ár of borna,
þá's forðum mik · fǫdda hǫfðu;

The first verse (or *a-verse*) may have 1 or 2 alliterations, with preference for alliteration on its first position over the second.

The second verse (or *b-verse*) must have exactly 1 alliteration, almost always on its first stressed position.

### Fits and stanzas

The long-line is the highest metrical division, but long-lines can be combined into complete poems according to either a *stichic* or *stanzaic* manner.

West Germanic poetry is typically *stichic*. This means that long-lines simply follow one other, often with enjambment, so that a new sentence begins in the b-verse.

In longer epic poems lines may be grouped into *fits* which are sections or cantos. The fit does not have a fixed length, but is generally around 70–85 lines long. The 3182-line *Beow* is divided into 42 numbered fits for an average of 76 lines per fit; the surviving 5983 lines of *Heli* are divided into 71 for an average of 84 lines per fit. It is probably not a coincidence that the length of the fit is similar to the length of shorter legendary poems like *3 Guðr* or *Hild*.

In *Heli* a new fit can begin on a b-verse. This does not happen in *Beow*.

North Germanic poetry is always more or less *stanzaic* and does not have fits. Each *stanza* consists of several long-lines, and enjambment is rare. The regularity of the stanzas varies by poem and meter, but there is a general trend towards stanzas of exactly 4 lines.

In 4-line stanzas there is generally a semantic division between lines 2 and 3; each group of 2 lines (4 verses) form a *helming* or *half-stanza*.

## The corpus

The scope of the present corpus is large, and encompasses most of the alliterative poetry extant in Old Germanic languages. The poetry is divided into the following categories:

1. **Norse Mythic poetry**, i.e., that which directly treats the Germanic mythology. This category is exclusively Norse for the simple reason that no West Germanic or Gothic mythic narrative poetry survive.
2. **Norse Heroic poetry**, specifically the whole second half of the Codex Regius and then a few other works. With a few exceptions, subject matter outside of the Walsing cycle is not included.

3. **West Germanic Heroic Poetry** in Old English, Old Saxon, and Old High German.
4. **Poetry on Christian subjects**. This category includes explicitly Christian poems where the new religion or its mythology is at the core of the work. Christian heroic poems depicting native legends, like *Beow* and *Hild*, are not included.
5. **Galders**, i.e., alliterative spells and charms, both from runic inscriptions and mediaeval manuscripts.
6. **Runic Poetry**, apart from that already edited under Galders above.

## Exclusions

All Norse Scaldic poetry is excluded, as is the Eddic poetry found in the Saws of Icelanders and Saws of Antiquity (*forn-aldar sǫgur*). Three reasons justify this exclusion. First, these two categories of poetry have already been edited by the SkP series, in the case of the Scaldic poetry admirably so. Second, the underlying poetry is often impossible to take out of its prose context. Third, it is doubtful whether most of the Eddic poetry embedded in prose contexts ever had a life of its own or whether it was composed along with the prose. For these reasons I would only edit the poetry in its original context, that is, edit the whole Saws, which is an undertaking that falls far outside of the scope of the present edition as an edition of Eddic poetry.

Most non-legendary Old English poems are excluded. This includes poems on historical subjects embedded in the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, the Riddles of the Exeter Book, and the Biblical epics.

## Manuscripts

See the introduction to each category.

### Old English poetry

The edited Old English poetry primarily derives from a few manuscripts. Particularly important are the Exeter Book (**E**) and *Lâcn*.

### Old Saxon and High German poetry

There are no collections or anthologies of alliterative poetry in these languages; instead the manuscript situation will be discussed in the introduction to each individual text.

## Dating

Ways of dating poetry, which naturally differ greatly for each text and tradition, will be brought up in the respective introductions to sections or poems as seen fit.

The general methodology for dating adopted by the present edition is however one that prioritises linguistic criteria rather than literary analysis or vague historical speulation. It has been shown for both the Eddic (TODO: cite Males) and Old English poetic traditions (TODO: cite Neidorf Dating of Beowulf) that mediaeval scribes did not possess the necessary linguistic knowledge to produce archaizing poetry, or even to reproduce metrically required archaic features (e.g. the consonant cluster *vr-* in ON, for which see *Háv* 26/2 n.), and a text that displays linguistic features belonging to a certain century is thus taken to have been composed during that century. In this way the present methodology aligns closer with that upheld by scholars like Finnur Jónsson, R. D. Fulk, Leonard Neidorf, and Mikael Males and differs from that of Klaus von See or the "Toronto school" of Beowulf.

## The presentation of the text

The present edition is divided into two equally large parts, presented side by side. Each stanza or group of verse lines is presented first in the original language, and immediately below in English translation. In the right margin is a list of manuscript witnesses for the particular passage. Below the English translation are two layers of notes. The first contains critical notes, and the second contains all other notes and commentary. Broader commentary or particularly important critical notes are linked to ALL, while more specific notes are linked to separate lines and lemmas.

### The Old Germanic text

The present edition encompasses texts in four Old Germanic languages: Old Norse, Old English, Old Saxon, and Old High German. All texts have been normalised according to the author's standardised orthography for the respective language. The orthographies are designed to follow three core principles:

1. A faithfulness to the spoken language at the time when the texts were written, and the distinctions demonstrably found therein.

2. A respect for the etymological origin of words, and their distinctions.

3. A striving for a uniform orthography across the various languages, so that the same sound, where possible, should be written with the same character.

These choices often stand in conflict with the orthography of the original manuscripts and with most earlier philological tradition, whence there is some reason to justify them. My goal is to render the texts themselves in a manner that gives as much philological information to the reader as possible—not to present a facsimile edition for students of paleography. This follows the philological methods used for printing e.g. the *R̊V*, which is generally printed in an entirely scholarly latinized orthography, not the original

*Devanāgarī*. Regardless, such important traits of the original manuscript tradition as the long *ſ*, arbitrary punctuation, arbitrary spelling, and lack of line breaks, are seldom reproduced in modern editions of Old Germanic poetry.

**General orthographic conventions**

The following orthographic conventions are applied for all Old Germanic languages:

1. The voiceless dental fricative is always written with the letter *þ*, never *th*.
2. Long vowels are marked with the acute accent, never the macron or circumflex;
3. Excepting those long vowels which have their origin in earlier diphthongs, which are written with the circumflex.
4. In compounds where the first element has primary stress the elements are separated with a dash (-);
5. But where the first element is a preposition or unstressed prefix they are separated with an interpunct (·).
6. Non-inflectional suffixes and derivations are marked with a double oblique hyphen (⸗).

Below follow specifications for each specific language.

**Normalisation of Old Norse**

My Old Norse orthography is inspired by Finnur Jónsson (1932) in that it strives for a more archaic form than that of the surviving mss.; a form that instead represents the poetry as it may (in many cases, must) originally have looked. For this reason, it often has more in common with the proposed orthography of the First Grammatical Treatise than with the standard Old Icelandic orthography seen in most editions. The following list describes the differences from the standard Old Icelandic orthography:

1. I distinguish between short *e* (from etymological short *e*) and short *ę* (from etymological short *a* + *i*-umlaut).
2. I distinguish between long *á* and *ǫ́*, as done by the First Grammatical Treatise.
3. I use *ǿ* and *ę́* rather than the usual *œ* and *æ*, to represent the vowels descended from Proto-Norse *ó* and *á* after *i*-umlaut (cf. the short *ǿ, ę* < *o, a* + *i*-umlaut).
4. I distinguish long nasal *ą́, ę́, ı̨́, ǫ́, ų́* from long oral *á, é, í, ó, ú*, as done in the First Grammatical Treatise.

5. I restore the old *s* (which in modern Scandinavian and even in most Old Norse manuscripts has become *r*, but which is found in old manuscripts such as AM 237 a fol (c. 1150) and fossilized in forms like *þaz* (i.e., *þat's*) in **R**) in the words *es* 'which, that, where, when', and in inflections of *vesa* (later *vera*) such as *es* 'is' (3rd sg. pres. ind.) and *vas* (3rd sg. pret. ind.). The following forms of *vesa* retain the *r*, as it is there the result of Verner's law, and not of this (much younger) sound change: the pl. pres. ind. (*erum* etc.), the pl. pret. ind. (*vǫ́rum* etc.), and the pl. pret. subj. (*vǫ́rim* etc.)

6. When metrically benefactory, I contract *ek* 'I', *eru* 'are', and *es* 'which; is' to *'k*, *'ro* and *'s*, respectively.

7. I resolve *z* to *ts, ds, þs* or *ðs* depending on its underlying elements;

8. *x* is however still used instead of *ks*;

9. I follow Finnur Jónsson (1932) in distinguishing between the relative particle *es* and the verb *es*: the particle is appended to the previous word with only an apostrophe (e.g. *hann's* 'he who'), while the verb is separated by a space (e.g. *hann 's* 'he is').

10. Where metrically beneficient personal pronouns are removed, often silently (cf. Scaldic poetry, *Vkv* 21/1–2 vs. 23/3–4, *1 HHund* 32 vs. *2 HHund* 18)

**Normalisation of Old Swedish and Danish**

I generally employ the same conventions as those described for Old Norse above, including the marking of *u*-mutated *a* > *ǫ*. That this indeed occurred in the Eastern Nordic dialects is most proven by the third-person personal pronoun, which shows *u*-mutation in such forms as Swedish *honom* 'him' < *hǫ́num*, *hon* 'she' < *hǫ́n*).

A few changes are specific to OSwe and ODan. According to rule 3 in the general orthographic conventions above, I distinguish between *ǿ* (< *ǿ*) vs. *ô* (< *au, ey*), *é* (< *é*) vs. *ê* (< *ei*).

Where all unstressed vowels have been reduced to a schwa-like sound, this is written with *e*.

**Normalisation of Old English**

I spell fronted or brightened etymological *a* and *á* with *æ* and *ǽ*, for instance in *dæg* 'day' (< **dagaʀ*) and *rǽd* 'advice, counsel' (< *rádaʀ*). These are contrasted with *ę* and *ǫ́*, which represent *i*-mutated *a* and *á*, e.g. in *ęllen* 'zeal, courage' (< **aljanǫ*).

An assimilated *n* is marked with an overpoint, like in rule 3 of Old Norse above.

**Normalisation of Old Saxon**

**Normalisation of Old High German**

## The English translation

There is now a very large number of translations of the most popular alliterative poetic texts, namely *Beow* and the *Poetic Edda*. These generally fall into two camps:

1. *poetic* translations, which distort the precise meaning of the text for the sake of meter, often quite radically; and

2. *prose* translations, which nowise preserve the style or feeling of the original.

Almost all translations, of both types, also tend toward the following inadequacies: obscuring or glossing over difficult technical and cultural terminology; rendering identically repeated phrases and words (formulae) differently at various places; and simplifying or rewriting kennings and other poetic expressions. Even worse this is often done with little in the way of notes or commentary, to a point where the reader is sometimes left entirely oblivious to the sense of the original text.

What sets my translation apart from previous English translations is that it aims to follow the style and register of the original text closely, without sacrificing the literal sense of the words, e.g., by removing or inserting matter where it is not present in the original. The downside of this is that literality and consistency at times must come at the cost of fluid idiomatic English, but it has the advantage of giving the reader a good idea not just of *what* the original text says, but *how* it says it. The reader should keep in mind that he is venturing in a foreign land, that he is reading ancient and obscure words—not *The New York Times* or *The Guardian*.

Maybe this over-literality is a pointless effort? One could argue that a translation always is a betrayal, and that those truly interested in the exact sense of every word in the original text should study it in its original language. While I do agree that the sufficiently interested reader should learn the languages in which these texts were written (something greatly helped by the present parallel edition, with its notes and clear orthography), it is still a "hard ask" for those readers who are not philologically or linguistically inclined, but instead students and scholars of history, comparative mythology, religion, anthropology, or literature—those who, for whatever reason, are interested in exploring the oldest poetic heritage of the Germanic peoples of Northern Europe.

## The proper nouns

The single most idiosyncratic part of the present translation will undoubtedly be its handling of proper nouns. I have opted to render all cultural and religious terms, names of places, heroes, gods, and other entities by their natural

English cognates (e.g., *Thunder* for Old Norse *Þórr*); and, where such do not exist, by their philologically expected English (so-called "Anglish") forms (e.g., **wallow* for Old Norse *vǫlva*). Due to the parallel original-language edition and index, it is hoped that no vital information will be lost by this decision; the reader wishing to know the original form of Webthrithner can either look in the Old Norse, or, if the case endings confuse him, peruse the index.

There are three reasons behind this choice. The first is ideological. It is my belief that the Old Germanic myths and poems and gods and heroes are a shared Northern European heritage. When one compares these mediaeval texts from Germany, England, and Scandinavia, one cannot but notice the striking similarity of their diction, the reoccurence of figures and formulae, and the common worldview. Likewise, the personages are frequently the same: the Scandinavian hero *Vǫlundr* is the same character as the English *Wēlund*, the Norse god *Óðinn* is the same as the English *Wōden*, and this is how they were understood by the native speakers of the old tongues. Since English is a Germanic language and its speakers the linguistic heirs of the Anglo-Saxons and Norse—in many case their direct descendants—and since these varying names are ultimately mere distinctions in pronunciation which reflect shared underlying forms, it was felt important and valuable to render them in the English translation by their natural or expected English reflexes. The forms of the names thereby serve to reflect the continuity between the speakers of modern English and those of the Old Germanic languages.

The second reason is one of consistency. If we are to restore well-attested names like Weden and Thunder, it would not be consistent to retain others in an unadapted form (e.g., to have Weden conversing with *Vaf·þrúðnir*, or Thunder with *Hár·barðr*), which would produce a highly discordant effect. Since the Anglish names are to be restored in some places, consistency requires that they be restored in all, even where they do not survive in modern English (or even in Old English).

The third reason is one of linguistic aesthetics. It is an indisputable fact that the commonly accepted forms like *Odin*, *Thor*, *Midgard* etc. are debased. They do not even represent the Old Norse pronunciation as accurately as would be possible within the constraints of English ortography (e.g., *Odin* would be better anglicized as *Othin*). What is more, they are often difficult for English speakers to pronounce and lead to absurd errors and mispronunciations. The fluent reader of Old Norse cannot but shudder when he hears *ésir* and *Ás·garðr* pronounced as /aɪˈsɪːɹ/ and "ass-guard", or when he sees *Jǫrmun·gandr* spelled "Jormangander". The native English forms, on the other hand, fit well within English orthography, and their pronunciation is immediately recognisable.

# Introduction to Eddic Poetry

The following two sections (Norse Mythic Poetry and Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle) contain the bulk of preserved Old Norse Eddic poetry, most of which is preserved in only one manuscript, **R**. For this reason some notes about Eddic Poetry in general are in order.

## Character

Old Norse poetry is conventionally divided into two categories: the Eddic and the Scaldic.

Eddic poetry is anonymous, composed in one of three meters (Ancient-words-lay, Leeds-meter, Speeches-meter), and free from regular assonance or end-rhyme. It is easy to understand, uses kennings sparsely, and generally deals with heroic or mythological subjects.

By contrast, Scaldic poetry is usually attributed to named poets, is composed in a greater variety of meters (which apart from the three Eddic meters include the exclusively Scaldic Lay-meter and Court-spoken meter), and employs regular assonance or end-rhyme. It revels in purposeful obscurity by making great use of complex kennings and circumlocutions, and usually deals with historical or biographical subjects. It typically serves as praise poetry for a living king or other chieftain.

Although this categorization is not explicitly made in any Norse primary source, it is not entirely a philological construct, for it is clearly observed in *SnE*. In the first book, *Gylf*, we find almost exclusively citations made from Eddic poems (68 out of 70 sts.) while the second book, *Skm*, has the inverse distribution (TODO).

## Dating

Since Eddic poetry represents a mostly unified genre in a single language, it is useful to discuss some recent scholarly advancements in how this type of poetry can be dated. Dating the original time of composition is important, since it allows us to tell whether the religious or cultural ideas in these texts do infact represent the views—indeed, the very words—of Germanic Heathens,

or whether they are the recollections—in the worst case, the fantasies—of Christian antiquarians.

Before we discuss the dating, we must, however, clarify what we mean by a *poem*. We shall assume that the poems exist as authorial works independent of their manuscript form, that is, that a copy of a given poem in a certain manuscript represents a single written documentation of a poem, but is not synonymous or to be conflated with the poem itself. The poem was composed as a single work by a single author; it can exist in multiple copies, and has most likely been transmitted both orally and scribally. On the other hand, scribes make errors, and are not authors in their own right (Males 2023b; Males 2024a; Haukur Þorgeirsson 2020). Even if they were, it is the primary goal of the present work to attempt get back to the wording of the original authors, be they Heathen or Christian, for it is due to *them* alone that these texts fascinate us so much more than the contemporary output of the same scribes.

The ways of dating Eddic poetry can be divided into two categories. External ways of dating rely on circumstances outside of the poems themselves. These are citations in securely dateable texts, the lifetimes of the original authors or other documented circumstances of composition, and the dates of the individual manuscripts. Unfortunately, the bulk of Eddic poetry is not cited in any texts older than Snorre's Edda (composed ca. 1220); we have no surviving information about the original authors nor the compositional circumstances (beyond the attributed Greenlandish origin of *Akv* and *Am*); and even if we were able to use scribal characteristics to trace the origins of certain poems back to the very beginning of Icelandic vernacular scribal tradition—and Iceland is where all surviving Eddic manuscripts were produced—that tradition does not commence until the 12th century, which post-dates the time of conversion by over a century.

Internal ways of dating instead rely on the language, meter, allusions, and ideas of the poems themselves, and it is in these ways that the chief scholarly advancements of the last few decades have occurred. These criteria can also allow us to distinguish different layers within a given poem. For example, we can say that the Dwarf-tallies, *Vsp* 11–15, are later inserts into that poem.

To pinpoint the absolute date of when a certain linguistic or metrical change has occurred we require some external reference point, but, fortunately, this is found in the Scaldic corpus, which unlike the Eddic corpus is largely ascribed to named authors working within clear historical contexts. It turns out that the Scaldic poems ascribed to the oldest poets likewise show the greatest concentration of archaic traits, and that some of these traits only occur in poems composed before certain dates. Comparison with Scaldic poetry is therefore our best bet to date the Eddic corpus. A landmark study in this direction is Sapp (2022), which, although certainly not perfect, has generally been favourably received, and shown that fruitful results can be obtained at scale from applying linguistic dating criteria derived from Scaldic poetry to Eddic.

The most important linguistic criteria are the alliteration between etymological *vr-* and *v-* rather than *r-* (pointing to composition before ca. 1000

AD, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2017), the use of *of* in prenominal positions analogous to West Germanic *ga-* (pointing to composition before ca. 1030 AD, Males 2025b), the frequency of the particle *of* in prenominal or preverbal positions analogous to West Germanic *ga-* (a trait strongly correlated with *vr-*, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 54), the frequency of syntactical V2 violations in Ancient-words-lay (a trait correlated with other early features, Haukur Þorgeirsson 2012), and the use of metrically required hiatus forms like *sáa, fríi, séi* (pointing to composition before ca. 1150 AD). In addition to these, the forms of certain individual words (e.g. *haufuð* for *hǫfuð*, **Sig·vǫrðr* for *Sig·urðr*, *fjǫl* for *fjǫlð*) can also point to an earlier date.

When it comes to content-based criteria the applicability varies greatly from poem to poem. Such criteria may be divided into two categories: internal criteria, such as religious, cultural, and archaeological conceptions, and external criteria, viz. intertextual allusions and borrowings from other texts. These can hardly all be discussed at once, but a notable example of an internal criterion is the use of pagan god-names. It has been shown that the use of pagan kennings (e.g. *Hákm* 8/3: *Óðins veðr* 'Weden's storm [BATTLE]') diminishes drastically in Scaldic poetry immediately following the conversion of Iceland in 1000 AD, and only rises in frequency with the antiquarian revival in the middle of the 12th century (Males 2020, pp. 39–94). Likewise, no Scaldic poetry with mythological subjects appears to have been composed during the 11th century.

This observation can be qualified further: while the names of gods like *Njǫrðr* 'Nearth' and *Ullr* 'Wolder' remain in use in kennings after conversion, not a single dateable Scaldic stanza composed after 1000 AD uses the name *Óðinn* 'Weden' in a kenning of any type, nor indeed in any other way save explicitly condemning the god. This is not the case for synonyms for Weden like *Yggr* 'Ug ⟨= Weden⟩', and so it seems that there was a unique concern, not to say fear, about using the name Weden in particular. Of course, Scaldic poetry has different purposes to Eddic poetry, and it makes far more sense for a 12th century antiquarian poet to insert the god Weden into his own heroic Eddic composition than for an 11th century praise-poet to mention the god in his pious eulogy for a Christian Norwegian king. Even so, it seems likely that little poetry containing this particular name would have been composed in the period intervening between the conversion and the antiquarian revival. Therefore, a heroic poem which shows both old linguistic features and the presence of this theonym likely must be quite old.

This illustrates the important point that content-based criteria must always be considered critically alongside linguistic traits. We should not label poems late out of hand simply because they, for instance, portray pre-Christian gods in a humorous fashion (e.g. *Hárb*, *Lok*), nor should the presence of an archaic archaeological object like the ring-sword (*HHj* 9, *Sigsk* 68) make us conclude that the poem itself must go back to the Migration Period, when such swords were in active use. We cannot assume that pre-Christian poets never depicted the gods humorously (indeed, both *Il* and *R̥V* do, and they are undoubtedly pre-Christian), nor that a 12th century antiquarian poet could not have known about ring-swords even if he himself had

not personally seen them. In such cases, the linguistic evidence must take precedence.

To illustrate the methodology plainly, I wish to conclude with two complementary examples of content-based and linguistic criteria working together. When the term "burned" is used as a neutral synonym for "dead" in *Háv* 71/3, 81/1—a poem which also features prenominal *of* and *vr-*—it should be taken as a sign of pre-Christian composition, since cremation was a strong taboo in the post-conversion period (Males 2024b, pp. 93–96). Inversely, when *Am*—a poem displaying the sound change *vr-* > *r-* and a very low occurrence of preverbal *of*—links cremation to stoning as a severe punishment befitting an evil woman (a practice beloning to Judeo-Christian religion) and mentions Greenlandish fauna like polar bears, it clearly shows itself to be a late poem composed after the conversion to Christianity and the settlement of Greenland (both ca. 1000 AD).

## Manuscripts

### GKS 2365 4to, Codex Regius (R)

By far the most important manuscript of Norse Eddic Poetry is GKS 2365 4to (siglum **R**), the so-called Codex Regius. It dates to around 1270 and consists of 45 surviving foll., containing 29 poems. **R** is fragmentary, however, and would originally have consisted of 53 foll.; see below.

**R** ought properly to be divided into two parts or sections: the first, on foll. 1–20, contains 11 poems (*Vsp*–*Grm*, *Ski*–*Alv*) dealing chiefly with mythology; the second, on foll. 20–45, contains 18 poems (*1 HHund*–*Ghv*) dealing with heroic legend from the Walsing cycle. Distinct scribal and orthographic characteristics show that these two parts have been copied from two separate source manuscripts, likely by the scribe of **R** itself (Lindblad 1980, esp. pp. 160–163). Their distinct origin is supported by the characteristic that **R** introduces the first poem in each part, *Vsp* and *1 HHund*, with a particularly large initial (Lindblad 1980, p. 166).

If we are to look for relatives of these two source manuscripts, it seems likely that **A**, described below, is a collection of mythological poems of the same kind as that underlying the first half of **R**. Likewise, a manuscript closely related to the heroic half of **R** has clearly served as the main source for large swathes of the younger *Vǫls*.

**R** is not a mere anthology of poems, but shows substantial editorial input in the form of prose segments, likely accumulated over time. A short prose section (*Lok* P1) ties two of the mythological poems together into a loose overarching narrative, though it is clear from their meter, style, and language that they are separate works composed by various poets over time. When it comes to the heroic poems long prose segments occur both within and between them, creating a saw-like prosimetrical form where the prose sometimes comes to dominate the poetry. The two long prose segments *2 Guðr* P1 and *Brot* P1–*1 Guðr* P1 are often edited as separate works.

As noted above, a large gap famously occurs in the heroic half, the so-called Great Lacuna. Between foll. 32 and 33 one quire, consisting of 8 foll., has gone missing (Lindblad 1977, 6 n. 2). Its contents are mostly unknown, but it would at least have included the end of *Sigrdr* and the beginning of *Brot*, alongside other now-lost poems or prosimetra linking together these two poems. Some of the stanzas likely contained in the Lacuna may be restored from citations in *Vǫls*, and these are edited under *Vǫlsbr*.

## AM 748 I a 4to (A)

Second in importance stands AM 748 I a 4to (siglum **A**). It dates to around 1300 and is in fragmentary state, consisting of just 6 foll. The beginning and end are absent, and between foll. 2 and 3 there is a lacuna, so that at least 3 (but probably more) foll. are missing.

**A** contains seven poems. On 1r–2v are found in succession the latter half of *Hárb*, the full *Bdr*, and the first half of *Skí*. There is then the lacuna—Finnur Jónsson guesses that just one fol. is missing—and on 3r–6v are found in succession most of *Vafþ*, all of *Grm* and *Hym*, and the introductory prose to *Vkv*. Among mediaeval mss., *Bdr* is only attested in **A**, while the other six poems are also found in the first, mythological, half of **R**. The order of the poems varies drastically between **A** and **R**.

**A** has no trace of **R**'s frame narrative tying together *Hym* and *Lok* (and indeed the latter poem leaves no trace in **A**), but otherwise **A** and **R** do share a substantial amount of prose (*Grm* P1–P3, *Skí* P1, *Vkv* P1), a fact which proves that the two, rather than being independent witnesses of poems based on oral tradition, stem from a common manuscript archetype.

**A** is written in the same hand and on the same parchment as $\mathbf{A_b}$ (see below), a manuscript containing grammatical and poetic texts with which **A** was originally bundled.

## Manuscripts of Snorre's Edda

Snorre's Edda (*SnE*), also known as the Prose Edda, consists of three sections. The first two—*Gylf* and *Skm*—contain quotations from several Eddic poems. Snorre reproduces stanzas from the mythological *Vsp*, *Vafþ*, *Grm*, *Skí*, *Lok*, and *Hdl* in *Gylf* and stanzas from *Grm*, *Alv*, and *Reg* in *Skm*. In addition, he cites several otherwise unknown stanzas in Eddic meters, of which at least some appear to derive from now-lost mythological poems. These fragments are edited at the end of the present section under *Eddbr*.

The four main mss. of the Prose Edda are:

1. **S**: Codex Regius of the Prose Edda (GKS 2367 4to), dating to ca. 1300 AD.

2. **T**: Codex Trajectinus (Traj 1374), a paper copy of a ms. closely related to **S**, dating to ca. 1595.

3. **W**: Codex Wormianus (AM 242 fol.), dating to ca. 1350 AD. **W** also contains the *Rþ* and the four Icelandic grammatical treatises.

4. **U**: Codex Upsaliensis (DG 11), dating to ca. 1300 AD.

When all four mss. agree on a reading, the abbreviation **G** is used synonymously with **STWU**.

Of these mss., **ST** form their own stemmatic clade to the exclusion of **W** and **U**; **STW** in turn form their own clade to the exclusion of **U**. Stematically, **U** is therefore most archaic ms., but unfortunately it has been heavily shortened and is filled with errors, especially in its poetry; this makes it a questionable source. For detailed discussion on the internal stemmatics of the mss. of Snorre's Edda and their origins, I refer to Haukur Þorgeirsson (2017).

Parts of *Skm* are also preserved in three less extensive manuscripts:

5. **A$_b$**: AM 748 I b 4to

6. **B**: AM 757 a 4to

7. **C**: AM 748 II 4to

The first two of these (**A$_b$** and **B**) also preserve the short poetic treatise known as the *Lítla skálda* 'Little Scalda', which cites three mythological Eddic stanzas: *Grm* 41–42 and *Eddbr* VIII 1.

**A$_b$** further contains the Third Grammatical Treatise and a copy of the *Íslendingadrápa*, both written in the same hand as its text of *Skm*. What is more, **A$_b$** is written in the same hand and on the same parchment as **A**, and it is clear that the two originally made up a single manuscript, something confirmed by the fact that **A** and **A$_b$** were in fact originally bound together into a single codex (alongside the unrelated **C**).

TODO: **B** and **C**.

## NKS 1824 b 4to (N)

Although not a poetic codex, **N** (the main manuscript of *Vǫls*) contains citations for a number of heroic Eddic poems. For *Vǫls*, see the Introduction to Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle.

## Other manuscripts

Two other Eddic poems from various sources are included under Norse Mythic Poetry, namely *Rþ* and *Hdl*. As noted above, *Rþ* is attested in **W**. *Hdl* is found in **F**.

In addition, a younger complete redaction of *Vsp* is found in **H**. Stanzas only attested in miscellaneous quotation in various texts will be discussed in the relevant poems.

## Abbreviations

The following abbreviations are relevant for the preservation of Eddic poems and will be used in the critical notes. Some stanzas are cited on their own in unrelated texts, especially saws, preserved in various other manuscripts; these will be discussed in their individual places.

- **A** = AM 748 I a 4to (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/da/AM04-0748-I-a`)
- **$A_b$** = AM 748 I b 4to (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-Ib`)
- **B** = AM 757 a 4to (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0757a`)
- **C** = AM 748 II 4to (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/AM04-0748-II`)
- **F** = *Flateyjarbók*, GKS 1005 fol. (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/GKS02-1005`)
- **H** = *Hauksbók*, AM 544 4to (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/en/AM04-0544`)
- **G** = **STWU**
- **N** = NKS 1824 b 4to, the main ms. of *Vǫls* (`https://onp.ku.dk/onp/onp.php?m9641`)
- **R** = Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda, GKS 2365 4to (`https://eae.ku.dk/q?p=eae/vols/text/1`)
- **S** = Codex Regius of the Prose Edda, GKS 2367 4to (`https://handrit.is/manuscript/view/is/GKS04-2367`)
- **T** = Codex Trajectinus, Traj 1374[x]
- **U** = Codex Upsaliensis, DG 11
- **W** = Codex Wormianus, AM 242 fol. (`https://clarino.uib.no/menota/text/menota/AM-242-fol`)

# Norse Mythic Poetry

# Introduction to Norse Mythic Poetry

The present section contains almost all extant narrative poetry concerning the pre-Christian Germanic gods, most of which is found in the first half of **R**, and all of which is in Old Norse. Of all genres of Germanic poetry, the mythological is in fact the one of which we have the earliest mention. Tacitus, in *Germania*, ch. 2, talking about the ancient Germani, says that: *Celebrant carminibus antiquis, quod unum apud illos memoriae et annalium genus est, Tuistonem deum terra editum.* 'They celebrate in ancient songs, which is the only kind of memory and history among them, the earth-born god Tuisto.' In spite of this fact it is not due to any decision on the part of the editor that this type of poetry is exclusively in Old Norse, for outside of Iceland there survive no examples of this undoubtedly ancient genre. This must obviously not be taken to say that no such poetry existed, something disproven by the Tacitean quote above. In fact, as we shall see, many of the myths and gods dealt with in this genre are attested throughout the Germanic speech-area for a period of many centuries; in addition they show deep parallels to religious traditions as distant as Mesopotamia, India, and Egypt. And how should they have been told and transmitted through unreckoned illiterate ages if not in poetic form?

## The poems

The present section includes fourteen poems and eight smaller fragments.

### Short summaries

*Vǫlu spǫ́* ('**The Spae of the Wallow**', *Vsp*) is the prophecy of a wallow, a Germanic seeress, brought back from the dead by the chief god Weden. The wallow narrates the events of the world's creation and golden age, its degeneration and ultimate destruction, and at last its rebirth. The poem is mystical and contains numerous allusions to important myths; it serves as the major source for Snorre's *Gylf*.

*Hǫ́va mǫ́l* ('**The Speeches of the High One**', *Háv*) is the god Weden's wisdom, consisting of practical life advice about friends, wealth, wisdom and

women, two romantic escapades, and lastly stanzas about runes and galders. It is by far the longest poem in **R**.

*Vaf·þrúðnis mǫl* (‘**The Speeches of Webthrithner**’, *Vafþ*) describes Weden’s visit to the ettin Webthrithner and the ensuing wisdom-contest between them as they wager their heads. The two ask each other numerous mythological and cosmological questions and in the mouth of Weden these soon turn to the subject of the end times; expectedly the god eventually comes out on top with an unknowable question.

*Grímnis mǫl* (‘**The Speeches of Grimner**’, *Grm*) follows Weden as he sets out to test the hospitality of his former protégé King Garfrith as part of a wager with his wife Frie. The king is less than friendly and unwittingly tortures the god between two fires; Weden is however relieved by the king’s son, and in exchange gives him a great deal of gnomic wisdom about the dwellings of the gods, sacred locations and objects, the creation of the world, and finally his own nature. At the end the king dies by his own sword and his son is made king after him.

*Baldrs draumar* (‘**The Dreams of Balder**’, *Bdr*) is a short narrative poem which sees Weden set out to find answers about why his son Balder is having ominous dreams; he brings a wallow back to life and asks her a few questions.

*Skírnis mǫl* (‘**The Speeches of Shirner**’, *Skí*) sees the lovesick god Frea send his servant Shirner in order to win him the hand of the beautiful ettin-woman Gird; he does so by means of a curse.

*Hár·barðs ljóð* (‘**The Leeds of Hoarbeard**’, *Hárb*) is a long argument between the god Thunder and his father Weden, disguised as the ferryman Hoarbeard. The two stand on opposite sides of a sound and Thunder begs to be let over; he is, of course, refused.

*Hymis kviða* (‘**The Lay of Hymer**’, *Hym*) is a humorous poem that tells how the god Thunder and his companion Tew set out to find a huge cauldron for the gods to drink out of. The two find themselves on a strange adventure as they go fishing with the cauldron’s owner Hymer and Thunder nearly pulls up the Middenyardswyrm in what was undoubtedly one of the most popular myths of the Wiking Age.

*Loka sęnna* (‘**The Flyting of Lock**’, *Lok*) sees the evil god Lock berate the other gods at a feast, giving personal and often quite graphic insults to each one and alluding to a number of less favourable myths; at last he is banished, caught and placed to be tortured until the end of days like a Northern Προμηθεύς.

*Þryms kviða* (‘**The Lay of Thrim**’, *Þrk*) is another humorous poem about Thunder where the god’s hammer is stolen by the ettin Thrim; in order to retrieve it he has to dress up as the goddess Frow and pretend to marry the ettin, yet the poem ends with a great killing as soon as the hammer is brought out.

*Vǫlundar kviða* (‘**The Lay of Wayland**’, *Vkv*) is properly a heroic poem, but is placed in this section as it is in **R**. The poem tells the story of the masterful supernatural smith Wayland, who is kidnapped and hamstrung by the tyrant Nithad and forced to make jewels for him and his family. Wayland

takes his gruesome revenge by killing the tyrant's sons, impregnating his daughter, Beadhild, and flying away in a flight-suit of his own design.

*Al·víss mól* ('**The Speeches of Allwise**', *Alv*) is a short poem where a dwarf asks for the hand of Thunder's daughter. Thunder tricks him that he will win her if he can only tell him the various poetic names for things (beer, sun, clouds, and the like); the dwarf does so, but in his foolish lust continues for so long that eventually the sun rises and he turns to stone.

*Rígs þula* ('**The Thule of Righ**', *Rþ*) narrates the fathering of the three social castes—the thralls, churls, and earls—and the eventual establishment of kingship and elite runic knowledge at the hands of the mysterious god Righ. The poem is unfortunately incomplete.

*Hyndlu ljóð* ('**The Leeds of Hindle**', *Hdl*) describes how the goddess Frow asks the ettin-woman Hindle to reveal the genealogy of Frow's lover Oughter so that he will be able to claim his legitimate inheritance. The poem takes a mythological turn as Hindle briefly recounts the coming destruction of the world.

Following these poems, I offer 8 Eddic fragments (containing a total of 11 stanzas or half-stanzas) from *Gylf* and *Skm* under the heading "**Fragments from Snorre's Edda**" (*Eddbr*). The fragments are edited along with their surrounding prose contexts. Many of them have likely belonged to now-lost Eddic poems, and their inclusion completes the mythological Eddic corpus.

## Types of poetry

The above-listed poems may be categoried on a scale between narrative poetry on the one end and gnomic or wisdom poetry on the other. Although almost every poem has some type of narrative progression, a distinction can still be made based on the nature of the bulk of the content and whether the narrative exists merely as a frame for the gnomic material or whether it fills an important purpose in its own right. The exact categorisation is subjective, but for our purposes it may be said that on the far end of the narrative side stand *Þrk* and *Hym*, and on the far end of the gnomic side *Háv* and *Alv*.

## Exclusions

A few Eddic-style poems which one the reader may be familiar with from other editions have been excluded from the present edition due to their questionable and likely post-mediaeval provenance. It must be stressed that none of the excluded texts should be relied upon for knowledge of the authentic pre-Christian culture and religion.

The main exclusion when compared with most other modern editions is the antiquarian *Svip·dags mól* 'Speeches of Swebday', which properly consists of the two poems *Fjǫl·svinns mól* 'The Speeches of Fellswith' (*Fjǫl*) and *Gróu galdr* 'The Galder of Growe' (*Grg*). Although found only in post-reformation Icelandic paper mss., both parts probably date to the antiquarian period of the 13th century. Their late origin is proven by the fact that they contain allusions to Christianity and post-conversion language (e.g., *Fjǫl·svinns mól*:

46/3 *jartegn* 'evidence', *Grg* 13/3: *kristin dauð kona* 'a dead Christian woman'). The mythological references they do contain appear to be largely fabricated or derivative of earlier texts, and are likely to introduce much confusion about the mythology on the part of the reader. That they have recently been translated by Pettit (2023) further justifies their exclusion.

Apart from *Svip·dags mǫl*, two other exclusions found in some older (though not in most modern) eds. also merit discussion, since the reader may be surprised at their absence. The *Sólar-ljóð* 'Leeds of the Sun' is clearly a late, Christian poem, and is edited and translated by Carolyne Larrington and Peter Robinson in SkP 7. The *Hrafna-galdr Óðins* 'Raven-Galder of Weden' is undoubtedly a post-reformation pastiche, as seen by its late meter and use of the Low German loanword *mál-tíð* 'meal time'.

## Table of manuscripts

The following table shows the manuscript attestation for the included poems and their relative position in each manuscript. A *q* in *Gylf*/*Skm* represents one or more stanzas attested in quotation. For more precise details, see the Introductions to the individual poems.

| Signum | R | A | W | H | F | *Gylf*/*Skm* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Vsp* | 1 | – | – | + | – | *q* |
| *Háv* | 2 | – | – | – | – | *q* |
| *Vafþ* | 3 | 4 | – | – | – | *q* |
| *Grm* | 4 | 5 | – | – | – | *q* |
| *Skí* | 5 | 3 | – | – | – | *q* |
| *Hárb* | 6 | 1 | – | – | – | – |
| *Hym* | 7 | 6 | – | – | – | – |
| *Lok* | 8 | – | – | – | – | *q* |
| *Þrk* | 9 | – | – | – | – | – |
| *Vkv* | 10 | 7 | – | – | – | – |
| *Alv* | 11 | – | – | – | – | *q* |
| *Bdr* | – | 2 | – | – | – | – |
| *Rþ* | – | – | + | – | – | – |
| *Hdl* | – | – | – | – | + | *q* |

# Spae of the Wallow
# *(Vǫlu spǫ́)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.865)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Spae of the Wallow** (ON *Vǫlu spǫ́*, abbrev. Voluspa) is undoubtedly the most important Norse mythological text surviving from Heathen times. It is a spae (*spǫ́* 'prophecy') told by a wallow (*vǫlva* 'seeress, sibyl, prophetess') who has been summoned by Weden, the chief of the Gods, in order to relate the mythic history of the World.

### Origin and parallels

As a repository of mythic lore *Vsp* resembles *Vafþ*, *Grm*, *Bdr*, and *Alv*, but it differs from most of the aforementioned works in two key ways: *Vsp* is a tightly structured spae rather than a motley collection of scattered mythological lore, and a monologue rather than a dialogue or riddle contest. The unique importance of this poem lies in the fact that it offers a complete chronological overview of the Norse mythic timeline of the World from its creation to its coming destruction and rebirth.

The understanding of this timeline is, unfortunately for the study of Norse mythology, troubled by several factors. The first is that the wallow continually speaks in the most obscure terms and relates the myths in an allusive fashion which presupposes that the audience is already familiar with them. The second lies in the way we have to understand these allusions, for while some are entirely unknown to us, we can connect most of them to more complete narratives in Snorre's Edda (*SnE*). *SnE* is, however, not a perfect source and since Snorre is often relying on *Vsp* we risk running into circular reasoning. What is worse, in at least one instance (st. 38/1) Snorre shows willingness to alter the wording of *Vsp* in citation in order to fit his own narratives, which calls his reliability into question. The third factor is that

the witness manuscripts disagree over the order and inclusion of numerous stanzas.

In order to elucidate the myths and their broader religious and cosmic significance properly, we therefore have to take into account all available resources: comparative mythology, folkloristics, linguistics, historical sources, and archaeology, and nowhere is this more important than in *Vsp*. Although the body of Norse pre-Christian poetry is rather small, the available material for a broader comparative study is truly vast, and since there is still a tremendous amount of work to be done there will undoubtedly creep in both omissions and errors. Even so, it is hoped that the present commentary along with that of the other poems included in this edition will provide new and interesting perspectives to the general reader, student, and scholar, not just of Germanic mythology but of the history of religions in general.

**The wallow**

As noted above, *Vsp* is narrated by a wallow. This figure represents the northern European belief that women, especially in elder age, were invested with a unique psychic or prophetic foresight, a power which became even greater when they died and might come into possession of truly hidden knowledge—knowledge perhaps unknown even to the chief god Weden Himself. In *Vsp* this ability of sight is reflected in the continual repetition of the phrase *sá hǫ́n* 'she saw', or, in the later part of the poem, *sér hǫ́n* 'she sees'. In her trance the wallow *sees* the past and the future as if they were before her very eyes.

Accounts of famous northern European seeresses are found from the time of our earliest Roman sources. During the Batavian rebellion of the late 1st c. AD, the seeress Veleda (a Celtic word, cf. OIr. *filed* 'seer', Middle Welsh *gwelet* 'id.') of the Bructeri made herself famous for her spaes. Tacitus, *Germania* 8, mentions her by name when talking about the Germanic respect for women: *Inesse quin etiam sanctum aliquid et providum putant, nec aut consilia earum aspernantur aut responsa neglegunt. Vidimus sub divo Vespasiano Veledam diu apud plerosque numinis loco habitam.* 'Moreover, they think that there is in them something holy and prophetic, and they neither despise their counsels nor disregard their responses. We saw, under the deified Vespasian, that Veleda was held in the place of a deity for a long time among the multitude.'

In Jordanes, *Getica* 121, we find mention of the Gothic witches known as the *haliurunnae*, thought to be the ancestors of the hostile Huns. Their name is clearly cognate with OE *hęlli-rúne* 'witch, sorceress', formed from *hęll* 'hell, Underworld' + *rúne* 'whisperess, confidante', thus signifying 'those who convene with the dead'.

The Longbeards, too, were once led by a prophetic woman, Gambara, as told in their 7th c. *Origo* (see Appendix to *Grm*).

**Weden**

It was in order to acquire their numinous knowledge that Weden in his incessant quest for wisdom undertook frequent journeys in order to question

wallows and hell-whisperers alike about events past and future. *Vsp* is not the only Eddic poem reflecting that motif. The closest parallel is *Bdr*, wherein Weden summons a wallow from her grave in order to find out why the god Balder is having ominous nightmares, but Weden's journeys to convene with the dead are also alluded to in *Háv* 158 and *Hárb* 44–45.

For the god's general quest for knowledge there are numerous parallels in both poetry and prose: Weden's wisdom contest against the wise ettin Webthrithner (*Vafþ*), his theft of the mead of poetry (*Háv* 103–110, *Skm* 5–6), his self-hanging and acquisition of the runes (*Háv* 138–139), his necromancy (*Háv* 158, *Yng* 7) and his giving up his eye to Mimer in exchange for wisdom (*Vsp* 28, *Yng* 4).

### Cycles and eschatology

As has been impressively shown by Eliade (2005), pre-Abrahamic religions are centered around cycles and the power of *being* inherent in their return; they are based around cyclical mythic time rather than linear history. The sun at dawn, the new moon, the daylight at the winter solstice, the warmth of spring—traditional man did not think the return of these things certain. Rather, the sun, moon, year, and indeed the world itself had to be strengthened and re-established through rituals harkening back to mythic time and re-establishing Creation. So it is that modern man thinks little of that which traditional man worried about with great fright and consequently heralded with great rejoicing.

In the traditional worldview the world consists of nested cycles, a series of ever-revolving epicycles of rises and declines: the day, the month, the year, the human lifetime, and the world itself. Each must rise and fall, decline and be regenerated. In this way history is not linear, but cyclical; everything that is done has already been done before and in fact it is just this precedent which gives the present occurrence its realness.

*Vsp* focuses on the greatest cycle, that of the World itself, from its beginning as formless matter (3) through its Creation by the Gods (4–6) and Golden Age (7–8) to its gradual decline (8–42), destruction (43–55) and rebirth (56–62). Although the poem is not explicit about it, there is a hint that the seed of evil is not entirely defeated in the next world (cf. 62 n.), leaving the possibility open for yet another repetition of the cycle.

TODO: mention Indian yuga-s, Zoroastrian texts.

### The Wiking Age eschatological fixation

One of the most important developments of the Germanic religion when compared with other Indo-European religions is its unique obsession with eschatology. Although the relevant myths are preserved only in the Norse literature, likely traces of the same are found on continental West Germanic territory in the form of the OHG *Musp* and the OS *Heli*, both of which use the likely pre-Christian inherited term *Muspilli*, also found in ON as *Muspell*; see st. 49/1 n. below, *Musp* 56 n.

To be clear, what distinguishes the Germanic (and specifically Norse) religion from other Indo-European systems is not the mere presence of ideas of the destruction and rebirth of the World, which as discussed above are also found in Indo-Iranian sources, but specifically a fixation with the imminent Destruction of the World and most of the Gods at the hands of the evil cosmic forces during the so-called Rakes of the Reins (*ragna rǫk*).

We find allusions to the Destruction in a large number of pre-Christian Norse texts: many of the mythological poems (*Vsp* 43–55, *Vafþ* 17–18, 44–53, *Grm* 4/4, 17, 24, 40, *Bdr* 14, *Lok* 10/1, 39, 41–42, *Hdl* 41, 43), two Scaldic eulogies (*Hákm* 20–21, *Eirm* 7), and a few poetic pre-Christian runestones (Sö 154 Skarpåker, perhaps also Vg 119 Sparlösa and Ög 136 Rök).

The monsters of the Rakes of the Reins also figure iconographically, e.g. on the 10th c. Gosforth cross, which shows the god Wider slaying the Middenyardswyrm (*Vsp* 52, *Vafþ* 53). A common motif on pre-Christian memorial runestones is that of a single ravenous wolf, e.g. on N 84 Vang and DR 285 and 286 Hunnestad, perhaps the wolf Fenrer. Sometimes this wolf is accompanied by a ship (perhaps Nailfare, *Vsp* 48/4 n.), e.g. on DR 271 Tullstorp (Figure 1, p. 23) and Ög 181 Ledsberg. These pictorial funerary motifs should be considered in light of the literary evidence, most clearly in Sö 154, *Hákm* 20–21, and *Eirm* 7, which connects the destruction of the world to the personal grief felt by the individual mourner.

In the ubiquity of these allusions, including on memorial runestones, we see that the Rakes of the Reins were not a mere literary construct. The worry about the impending destruction of the world was felt acutely on a personal level by the practitioners of the pre-Christian religion. It is clear that the Heathens thought that the calamity was imminent and could come, as it were, "like a thief in the night" (cf. *Heli* 4358–61, pulling on Matthew 24:43, 1 Thessalonians 5:2). It is notable that the association is particularly strong in contexts relating to death, whether they be runestones for dead family members, raised by more or less normal people, or funerary poems for beloved kings, composed by elite poets. We do not know whether the practitioners of the religion found consolation in these eschatological events, but it is hard not to be moved by the feeling of the father who, having buried his own son, laconically proclaims that "Earth and Up-heaven shall be rent" (Sö 154).

## The climate catastrophe of 536 AD

If we are to look for a historical explanation for the above-mentioned eschatological fixation, the most likely candidate is undoubtedly the climate catastrophe of 536–537 AD. TODO. Gräslund (2008).

Although ideas of the Destruction probably existed before 536, the plague, massive depopulation and accompanying social upheaval, perhaps alongside Christian apocalypticism spreading from the converted Gots and Vandals, likely led to a new form of religious expression.

## Textual preservation and transmission

*Vsp* is attested in three independent recensions: **R**, **H**, and **G**.

The most important recension, **R**, is the second oldest (ca. 1275 AD). This is the complete version of *Vsp* preserved in **R** on foll. 1r–3r, where *Vsp* is the first poem.

The other complete recension, **H**, is the youngest (ca. 1310 AD). This is the version of *Vsp* preserved in **H** (foll. 20r–21r), where the poem is found in the middle of an impressive collection of native Norse-Icelandic saws and learned Catholic works.

The third recension, **G**, is the oldest (ca. 1225 AD). It represents all stanzas of *Vsp* (3, 5, 9, 10–13, 15, 18, 24–25, 28, 37–40, 44–46, 48–54, 61) cited in *Gylf*, the first part of *SnE*. The now-lost version of *Vsp* from which Snorre drew his excerpts and citations may be termed ***G**. The wording of some stanzas in ***G** may be gleaned through Snorre's paraphrases of them, even if he does not actually cite them in their original poetic form. At times, the paraphrases can provide important critical readings and serve as a tiebreaker for variants that differ between **R** and **H**, e.g., in st. 19/2, where *sal* 'hall' in the *Gylf* paraphrase agrees with **H** against **R** *sǫ́* 'lake'. For the four manuscripts of *Gylf* (**S**, **T**, **W**, and **U**), see the Introduction to Mythic Poetry above.

### Table of stanzas

The order of stanzas varies greatly across the three recensions and is best illustrated by a table.

Stanzas cited in *Gylf* have been handled in the following way: those cited independently are marked with a plus sign, while those belonging to a sequence of several stanzas are marked with an incrementing letter based on the sequence and a number for its position, so that *A1* is the first stanza in the first sequence, *B1* the first stanza in the second sequence, and so forth.

When a stanza found in a manuscript is strongly divergent (e.g. st. 10, where *Gylf* 14:15 omits the first two half-lines), its mark is followed by a star.

The stanzas beginning with the formula *Þá gingu regin ǫll* 'Then went all the Reins' etc. are represented by the immediately following half-line.

| | *pres. ed.* | **R** | **H** | **STW** | **U** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Hljóðs bið'k allar | 1 | 1 | – | – |
| 2 | Ek man jǫtna | 2 | 2 | – | – |
| 3 | Ár vas alda | 3 | 3 | + | + |
| 4 | áðr Burs synir | 4 | 4 | – | – |
| 5 | Sól varp sunnan | 5 | 5 | +* | +* |
| 6 | ... nǫ́tt ok niðjum | 6 | 6 | – | – |
| 7 | Hittu=sk ęsir | 7 | 7 | – | – |
| 8 | Tęflðu ǐ túni | 8 | 8 | – | – |
| 9 | ... hvęrr skyldi dverga | 9 | 9 | B1 | B1 |
| 10 | Þar vas Móð·sognir | 10 | 10 | B2* | B2* |
| 11–15 | *Dwarf-tallies* | 11–15 | 11–16 | + | + |
| 16 | Und's þrír kvǫ́mu | 16 | 17 | – | – |

| | *pres. ed.* | R | H | STW | U |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | Qnd þau né ǫ́ttu | 17 | 18 | – | – |
| 18 | Ask vęit'k standa | 18 | 19 | + | + |
| 19 | Þaðan koma męyjar | 19–20 | 20–21 | – | – |
| 20 | Þat man hǫn folk-víg | 21–22 | 27 | – | – |
| 21 | Hęiði hana hétu | 23 | 28 | – | – |
| 22 | ... hvárt skyldu ę́sir | 24 | 29 | – | – |
| 23 | Flęygði Óðinn | 25 | 30 | – | – |
| 24 | ... hvęrr hęfði lopt alt | 26 | 22 | C1 | C1 |
| 25 | Þórr ęinn þar vá | 27 | 23 | C2* | C2* |
| 26 | Vęit hǫn Hęim·dalar | 28 | 24 | – | – |
| 27 | Ę́in sat hǫn úti | 29 | – | – | – |
| 28 | Alt vęit'k, Óðinn | 29 | – | + | + |
| 29 | Valði hęnni Hęr-fǫ́ðr | 30 | – | – | – |
| 30 | Sá hǫn val-kyrjur | 31 | – | – | – |
| 31 | Ek sá Baldri | 32 | – | – | – |
| 32 | Varð af męiði | 33 | – | – | – |
| 33 | Þó ę́va hęndr | 34 | – | – | – |
| 34 | Hapt sá hǫn liggja | 35 | 32* | – | – |
| 35 | Ǫ́ fęllr austan | 36 | – | – | – |
| 36 | Stóð fyr norðan | 36 | – | – | – |
| 37 | Sal sá hǫn standa | 37 | 36 | E1 | E1 |
| 38 | Sá hǫn þar vaða | 38 | 37 | E2* | E2* |
| 39 | Austr býr hin aldna | 39 | 25 | A1 | A1 |
| 40 | Fylli=sk fjǫrvi | 40 | 26 | A2 | A2 |
| 41 | Sat þar á haugi | 41 | 34 | – | – |
| 42 | Gól of ǫ́sum | 42 | 35 | – | – |
| 43, 47, 55 | Gęyr (nú) Garmr mjǫk | 43, 46, 55 | 33, 38, 43, 48, 51 | – | – |
| 44 | Bróðr munu bęrja=sk | 44 | 39 | – | – |
| 45 | Lęika Míms synir | 45 | 40 | D1* | D1* |
| 46 | Hvat 's með ǫ́sum? | 49 | 42 | D2 | D2* |
| 48 | Hrymr ękr austan | 47 | 44 | D3 | – |
| 49 | Kjóll fęrr austan | 48 | 45 | D4 | – |
| 50 | Surtr fęrr sunnan | 50 | 46 | +, D5 (n.) | + |
| 51 | Þá kømr Hlínar | 51 | 47 | D6 | – |
| 52 | Þá kømr hinn mikli | 52 | – | D7 | – |
| 53 | Þá kømr hinn męri | 53* | 49* | D8 | – |
| 54 | Sól tér sortna | 54 | 50 | D9 | – |
| 56 | Sér hǫn upp koma | 56 | 52 | – | – |
| 57 | Finna=sk ę́sir | 57* | 53 | – | – |
| 58 | Þar munu ęptir | 58 | 54 | – | – |
| 59 | Munu ǫ·sánir | 59 | 55 | – | – |
| 60 | Þá kná Hǫnir | 60 | 56 | – | – |
| 61 | Sal sér hǫn standa | 61 | 57 | + | + |
| 62 | Þar kømr hinn dimmi | 62 | 59 | – | – |
| H31 | Þá kná Váli | – | 31 | – | – |
| H41 | Hrę́ða=sk allir | – | 41 | – | – |
| H48 | Gĩnn lopt yfir | – | 48 | – | – |

| | *pres. ed.* | **R** | **H** | **STW** | **U** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| H58 | Þá kømr hinn ríki | – | 58 | – | – |

## Summary

On the basis of its refrains and content, the poem may be divided into the following rough sections: introduction (1–2), Creation and the early age of the World (3–17), cosmological and mythological exposition and decline (18–42), Destruction (43–55), and Rebirth (56–62).

It seems that immediately prior to the poem's beginning, Weden has awakened the wallow out of her grave. He commands her to speak. The wallow's *spae* begins with a bid for silence, addressing Weden directly (1). She next recalls her earliest memories of being raised amongst ettins in the world of yore (2).

The mythic history of the world itself begins with the Creation (3–6) and the following Golden Age (7–8), which was brought to an end by the intrusion of three unidentified ettin-maidens (8). After this, the wallow describes the making of the dwarfs (9–10), whose names are listed in several separate *dwarf-tallies* which are without doubt later inserts (11–15). She mentions how the Gods next gave life and intelligence to the first human beings (16–17), and then describes the Ash of Ugdrassle (18) and the three norns living under it, who give orlay (fate) to mankind (19).

After st. 19, the order of the stanzas in the two full recensions—**R** and **H**—diverges significantly, and does not come to agree again until st. 43. With a single exception (st. 46), the order adopted for the present edition is that of **R**, but since it is hard to decide which one is more original both are summarised here.

In **R**, the wallow recalls how a woman named Goldwey was sacrificed and reborn three times (20), and how she, under the name Hode, practiced sorcery and witchcraft (21). She then recalls the first war in the world, between the Eese and Wanes (22–23), and the killing of the smith who was promised Frow and the sun and moon in exchange for building the wall of Osyard (24–25). This is followed by a cryptic verse describing the Well of Mimer (26). She then seems to tell of her own origin; how she was approached by Weden, who gave her rings and jewels in exchange for her wisdom (27–29). She then tells of the walkirries (30) and relates the death of Balder (31–33) and the subsequent binding of Lock (34). After this, she describes a sword-river (35) and two beer-halls (36), then the torture of criminals in the afterlife by Nithehewer (37–38). She sees Ironwood in the East, where the wolves who will swallow the Sun and Moon are being reared (39–40). She foresees the crowing of three cocks: one in Ironwood (41), the other among the Gods, and the third in Hell or the Underworld (42). After this, we get the first occurrence of the refrain-stanza of the destruction; it describes how the wolf breaks free, and is repeated several times throughout the part of the spae that deals with the destruction of the world (43).

In **H** the structure is quite different. The Eese immediately go to decide what action to take regarding the Master Builder (24–25), and the Well of Mimer is described (26). Then follow the two stanzas about the wolves which will swallow the sun and moon (40–41), and the story of Goldwey and the war between the Eese and Wanes (20–23). The stanzas about Goldwey's origin (27–29), the walkirries (30), and the death of Balder (31–33) are left out of **H**, along with the sword-river and beer-halls (35–36), but it does describe the binding of Lock (34). Next we get the first occurrence of the refrain-stanza (43), then the crowing of the three cocks (41–42), and lastly the punishment of criminals (38–39). **H** then repeats the refrain-stanza a second time, and **R** and **H** are now almost completely aligned for the rest of the poem.

The Destruction of the world begins with numerous catastrophes and a decay in human morality: kinslaying, incest, adultery, and great wars become widespread (44). Homedall blows the great Yellhorn, the Ash of Ugdrassle is set ablaze, and a trapped ettin comes loose (45). The Eese, Elves, and Dwarfs are all distressed (46). Here the refrain-stanza is repeated again (47). Now the enemies of the Gods launch their attack: the ettin Rim drives from the east, the wyrm Ermingand writhes in the sea and propels huge waves, and the ship Nailfare comes loose (48). The ship drives from the east and is led by Lock and the Wol, both of whom have at last come free (49). From the south Surt brings a flaming sword to set fire to the world; there is a crack in Heaven and Hell is joined by many men (50). Weden goes out to fight the Wolf and falls, as does Frea against Surt (51). Wider avenges Weden by killing the Wolf (52), while Thunder and the Wyrm kill each other; the great battle leaves the world uninhabited (53). Instead of 52, **H** has a stanza describing how the Wyrm gapes over the entire world, and how Thunder will 'meet its venom' (H48). The Destruction culminates in the sun turning black, the stars disappearing, and the earth sinking into the sea. The whole world burns (54). The refrain-stanza repeats a final time (55).

The world is reborn. The earth rises from the sea and soon turns green again; the cycle of nature is renewed (56). The surviving Eese find each other on the Idewold, where they had first settled, and reminisce (57). A new Golden Age begins (58). The fields grow high without toil and Hath and Balder reconcile (59). Heener becomes the head priest of the Gods and the sons of Hath and Balder settle the sky (60). The wallow sees a fair, golden hall in which virtuous generations reside (61), but her vision concludes with the sight of a flying, dusky dragon—it is Nithehewer, carrying corpses in its mouth, a sign that there is still a seed of evil left in the new world. With this portent she sinks back down into her grave (62).



Figure 1: The Tullstorp stone (DR 271), showing a wolf above a ship, perhaps the Fenrerswolf and Nailfare. The inscription is a memorial and not related to the iconography. Wiking Age, ca. 1000 AD. © Jorchr. CC BY-SA 4.0. `https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Tullstorpstenen,_DR_271,Tullstorp_1-1,_Runristning.jpg`

## Text

**1** „Hljóðs bið'k allar · hęlgar kindir, [R 1r/2, H 20r/1]
2 męiri ok minni · mǫgu Hęim·dalar;
vilt at, Val-fǫðr, · vęl fram tęlja'k
4 forn spjǫll fira, · þau's fręmst of man.

"For hearing I ask all holy tribes [GODS],
[and] the greater and lesser sons of Homedall [MEN].
Thou wouldst, O Walfather, that I well tell forth
the ancient sayings of men, the earliest I recall.

---

1 Hljóðs | *The* H *is an ornamented initial 5 lines in height, noticeably taller than any other initial save the one introducing* 1 HHund*, in* **R**; *introduced by a small initial 2 lines in height in* **H**. 1 hęlgar 'holy' | *so* **H**; *om.* **R**

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ALL | The wallow has just been awoken from her grave (cf. st. 62/4b below) and commences her speech by asking for the silence of gods and men, a meristic expression (West 2007, pp. 99–100). The whole introductory formula has Indo-European parallels; see West (2007, pp. 63, 92–93, 312).

1 Hljóðs bið'k 'For hearing I ask' | This is the only call for hearing found in an Eddic poem, but many parallels are found in Scaldic praise poetry, most often involving the related words *hljóð* 'hearing' and *hlýða* 'hear, listen' (Wood 1960, pp. 424, 250). Examples abound (see Wood 1960), but most notably among them, the same introductory expression is found in Eyel's Head-ransom (Egill *Hfl* 2 in SkP 5): *hljóðs biðjum hann* 'for hearing we [I] ask him'.

1 hęlgar 'holy' | That the omission of this word in **R** is nothing more than a scribal error is clearly shown by the meter; the a-verse in *Hljóðs bið ek · allar kindir* is only three syllables long and has highly unnatural alliteration on the unstressed pronoun *ek* rather than the first nominal *hljóðs*.

2 męiri ok minni 'greater and lesser' | It is ambiguous to which noun phrase these adjectives belong. It can either be (a) "all greater and lesser holy tribes", which might be equivalent to the phrase Eese and Elves (earthly and heavenly supernatural beings; see Index for occurrences), or (b) "the greater and lesser sons of Homedall". (b) is preferred as the simpler reading since it avoids enjambment. The sense of "greater or lesser" is then more likely to be literal and physical (i.e., the younger and older members of the audience) rather than figurative (i.e., the varying social classes).

2 mǫgu Hęim·dalar 'sons of Homedall [MEN]' | Usually interpreted as a kenning for MEN on the basis of *Rþ*, according to which Homedall sired the three social classes of mankind. This convention is followed here as it is felt to give the better sense and conforms to the Indo-European poetic phrase "gods and men" (see note to ALL), but such a kenning is otherwise unparallelled. A more typologically likely interpretation, following Meissner (1921, pp. 23, 252), would be to see *męgir* in the sense 'lads, comrades'. This makes the kenning equivalent to *Hropts męgir* 'Roft's lads' (*Lok* 45/3), *allar áttir Ingvi-Freys* 'all the kin of Ing-Frea [GODS]' (*Haustl* 10), *Njarðar niðjar* 'Nearth's kinsmen' (Hfr Lv 10 in SkP 5).

3 Val-fǫðr 'Walfather' | That is, the 'Father of the Slain', a name for Weden. The wallow probably uses this name since Weden, acting in his role as necromancer and psychopomp, has just awoken her out of her grave (perhaps with a *val-galdr* 'slain-galder' as in *Bdr* 4/3 and *Háv* 158).

4 þau's fręmst of man 'the earliest I recall' | Cf. *Vafþ* 34–35 with similar phrasing.

**2** Ek man jǫtna · ár of borna, [R 1r/4, H 20r/2]
2 þá's forðum mik · fødda hǫfðu;

níu man'k hęima, · níu ǐ·viðjur,
mjǫt-við mę́ran · fyr mold neðan.

I recall Ettins born of yore,
those who formerly had reared me.
I recall nine Homes, nine Inwithies,
the famed Measure-Tree beneath the soil.

3 ǐ·viðjur | *so* **RH***; previously read* 'iviði' *in* **R***, but this was made obsolete by an x-ray scan undertaken by Stefan Karlsson (1979) which revealed a previously overlooked abbrev. mark standing for* -ur.

3 níu ... hęima 'nine Homes' | Or 'nine realms'. The identity of these is by no means clear nor is there any canonical list of which realms are supposed to be included.

3 ǐ·viðjur 'Inwithies' | Evil-working women or ogresses; their identity is by no means clear. The f. *jōn*-stem *ǐ·viðja* also appears in a list of poetic synonyms for trollwomen (Þul *Trollkvenna* 3 in SkP 3). A commonly suggested etymology is *í* 'in' + *viðr* 'tree, forest' (i.e., 'tree, forest-dwellers'), but this would be an unusual formation and leaves the *-j-* unexplained. A more plausible etymology is a derivative of **ǐ·við* 'malice', attested in the cpd. *ǐ·við-gjarn* 'malicious' (*Vkv* 28). This derivation can also explain the *-j-*, since the WGmc. cognates OE *in·wid*, OS *in·wid*, and OHG *in·wit* show it to be a neutr. *ja*-stem.

4 mjǫt-við mę́ran · fyr mold neðan. 'the famed Measure-Tree beneath the soil.' | Probably the Ash of Ugdrassle, still but a seed. The sense of *mjǫt-viðr* 'Measure-Tree' is not clear. It is probably not the *mjǫtuðr* in 45/1 below.

**3** Ár vas alda · þar's Ymir byggði,
vas=a sandr né sę́r, · né svalar unnir;
jǫrð fann=sk ę́va · né upp-himinn;
gap vas ginnunga, · ęn gras hvęr=gi,

[**R** 1r/6, **H** 20r/4, **S** 2r/25, **T** 3r/2, **W** 5v/7, **U** 3v/23]

It was early of ages where Yimer dwelled;
there was not sand nor sea nor cool waves.
Earth was never found nor Up-heaven;
there was the gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE] but grass nowhere,

1 alda | halda **S** 1 þar's Ymir byggði 'where Yimer dwelled' | þat's ękki vas *'when nothing was'* **STW**; þar's ękki vas *'where nothing was'* **U** 2 sę́r | sjár **W**; sjór **HU** 2 svalar unnir | †sva†, *with a large space following* **T** 3 ę́va 'never' | ęigi *'not'* **STU** 4 hvęr=gi 'nowhere' | ękki *'not'* **HSTW**

ALL | The wallow begins her retelling of the mythic history of the World. Told in sts. 3–4 is the creation of the Earth and the Heavens. Other Norse poetic sources for the creation are *Grm* 41–42 and *Vafþ* 21. A Christian creation hymn apparently drawing on older Germanic pagan sources is the OHG *Wessobrunn* edited below under Poetry on Christian Subjects; cf. also the more thoroughly Christian *Cadman* in the same section. The beginning of the Norse creation narrative is treated at length in *Gylf* 4–5, according to which the world first consisted of two extremities: the frozen Nivelham in the north and the burning Muspellsham in the south. From Nivelham the icy venomous rivers called the Ilewaves rushed forth until they lost their momentum and froze to ice, while from Muspellsham flowed burning lava. The ice and the lava met in the Gap of Hawks (*Ginnunga-gap*, which *var svá hlętt sem lopt vind-laust* 'was as calm as windless air', *Gylf* 5:7) and there combined to form the first being, Yimer.

1 Ár vas alda ‘It was early of ages’ | By these words the wallow begins her narrative in mythic time, in the earliest age (*qld*, cf. st. 44/4–5 below), *in illo tempore*. It is formulaic for a mythological or heroic-legendary Eddic poem to begin with *ár* ‘of yore, early’; cf. *Hym* 1/1, *1 HHund* 1/1 (which likewise has *Ár vas alda*, prob. borrowed from the pres. st.), *1 Guðr* 1/1, *Sigsk* 1/1.

1 Ymir ‘Yimer’ | The first ettin, from whom the rest were begotten, at first a- or ambisexually. Yimer was the Heaven and Earth conjoined and as such hermaphroditic, containing both a male (heavenly) and female (earthly) aspect. He is described in *Gylf* 5:8: *Ok þá er móttisk hrím'in ok blér hita'ns svá at bráðnaði ok draup, ok af þeim kviku-dropum kviknaði með krapti þess er til sendi hita'nn, ok varð manns líkandi, ok var sá nefndr Ymir.* ‘And when the rime-frost and hot air from the heat met so that it thawed and dripped, then from those flowing droplets there arose a life with the power which brought the heat and became the likeness of a man, and he was named Yimer.’
The comparative mythological idea of Yimer as the reflex of a PIE cosmic twin must be disregarded, for his name derives from PIE **yṃH-yós*, which, although ultimately from the root **yemH-* ‘twin’ (whence OI *Yamá* ‘twin’), is most closely related to Latvian *jumis* ‘paired couple, double fruit’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 274) and thus seems to suggest hermaphroditism or the union of the copulating Earth-Heaven. Yimer is probably (so *Gylf* 5:9) to be identified with the ambisexually reproducing first ettin Earyelmer in *Vafþ* 30–33. Comparatively he corresponds to the sexually joined Οὐρανός (‘Heaven’) and Γαῖα (‘Earth’) prior to the castration of the former at the hands of their son Κρόνος (‘the Cutter’; *Theog* 159–172), who was only later identified trough folk etymology with Χρόνος (‘Time’). This violent separation ended the primæval hermaphroditic begetting and ushered in the patriarchal rule of the male Sons of Byre; it is of note that Yimer, like Οὐρανός, is described as evil (*Gylf* 5:15).
Yimer further resembles the Vedic *Púruṣa* and the Chinese *Pangu* in his role as the primæval being from whose body parts the World is shaped (Witzel 2017). Cf. *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 43 n.

3 jǫrð … né upp-himinn ‘Earth … nor Up-heaven’ | A well-attested formulaic cosmological word-pair found in all four Old Germanic languages with alliterative poetic traditions (ON, OE, OS, and OHG), especially in the context of the creation and destruction of the world. See Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

4 gap vas ginnunga ‘there was the gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE]’ | *gap ginnunga* ‘gap of hawks’ has usually been interpreted on the basis of the cosmogony in *Gylf* 4–5, where Snorre presents the *Ginnunga-gap* ‘Gap of Hawks’ as a primordial physical location where cold and hot elements combine to form the first differentiated cosmic being, Yimer, in the place where the Earth will later be situated. For this reason the phrase is typically rendered in translation simply as “Ginnungagap” and explained as a sort of supernatural void. The present stanza, however, is the only conjunction of the words *gap* and *ginnunga* outside of *SnE*, and his cosmogony is very peculiar. There is therefore good reason to reexamine these two words in the present context in order to determine the exact nature of the ‘gap’.
To begin with, we must reject the traditional renditions “yawning gap” or “supernatural void” as unlikely and unfounded. The former may be eliminated immediately, since the oft-connected ON verb *gína* ‘yawn, gape’ has a different root (*gín-*) than *ginnunga* (*ginn-*), and since there is no clear derivation from *gína* to *ginnunga*, which in any case must be a noun, not an adjective, and certainly not a present participle “yawning”. *ginnunga* has been explained in various ways. Finnur Jónsson (1932) sees it as gen. sg. of **ginnungi* (from the lost equivalent to OE *ginne* ‘wide, spacious’ + the nominal suffix *-ungi*). This is, however, a strange and decidedly non-Norse construction, especially since the suffix *-ungi* forms masculine nominals with animate senses, not abstract nouns. A more common explanation is to see *ginnunga* as gen. of a pl. **ginnungar* ‘supernatural beings’, derived from *ginn-* ‘yin-’ in expressions like *ginn-rúnar* ‘yin-Runes’, *ginn-heilǫg goð* ‘yin-holy Gods’ (st. 6/2 n. below), and *ginn-regin* ‘yin-Reins’. Yet it is by no means clear that *ginn-* means ‘supernatural’ in the first place. It is more likely to be cognate with OE *ginne* ‘wide, spacious’, and thereby serves to strengthen the nouns it follows (e.g., ‘vast runes, vast Powers’, etc.). This explanation also requires us to assume the existence of otherwise unattested nebulous ‘supernatural beings’ (the so-called “ginnings”) in the primæval nothingness, an idea for which there is no extenral support.

I find a much more plausible reading in Meissner, who sees *gap ginnunga* as a kenning 'gap of hawks [AIR/MIDSPACE]', where *ginnunga* is gen. pl. of the securely attested poetic word *ginnungr* 'hawk'. The proposed kenning is conventional and belongs to the type "land, path of the bird [AIR]" (Meissner 1921, p. 108). Indeed, the determinant *ginnungr* is also found in a SKY-kenning in *Haustl* 15: *ǫll endi-lǫ́g ginnunga vé* 'all the low mansions of hawks [SKIES] from end to end'. This interpretation is confirmed by an underappreciated passage in *Skm* 74 which lists *ginnunga-gap* among poetic synonyms for the air: *Lopt heitir ginnunga-gap ok meðal-heimr, fogl-heimr, veðr-heimr.* 'Air is called *ginnunga-gap* ('gap of hawks') and middle-home, bird-home, weather-home.' The sense of *Vsp*'s *gap ginnunga* 'gap of hawks' is thus the same as *Haustl*'s *vé ginnunga* 'mansions of hawks', viz. 'air, atmospheric sky'.

Having determined the likely sense of the phrase, we should consider its significance in the present context. This requires a cosmological excursion. The Old Germanic pagan cosmology, like that of many other ancient religions (e.g., the Vedic with its two *ródasī* 'World-Halves', *ṚV* 1.10.8, 5.85.3, 7.86.1, etc.) sees the cosmos as consisting of two world-halves: Earth and Up-heaven, the land of Men and the land of Gods. The Earth is held to be a flat disc, while the Heaven (or Firmament) is a round dome above it, held up by four dwarfs (ON *dvergar*, which can also mean 'structural pillars'), lest it fall down (*Gylf* 8:10; cf. Arn *Þorfðr* 24 in SkP 2). Both Earth and Heaven are believed to be physically concrete realms, made out of different parts of Ymer's body: the Earth from his torso and the Heaven from his skull (*Grm* 41, *Vafþ* 21). Like the Greek χάλκεος οὐρανός 'bronze sky/heaven' (Pontani 2011), the Heaven is solid, and like the Biblica Firmament it is made out of stone (cf. *Hárb* 15), which also explains the falling of meteors. Between the two solid World-halves, then, are the atmospheric skies, the Air (ON *lopt*) or the Midspace (ON *meðal-þeimr* 'middle-home') equivalent to the *antárikṣam* of the Vedic hymns (e.g., *ṚV* 4.40.5, 5.85.3), wherein the clouds—Ymer's brains—float (*Grm* 42). The important distinction between the empty skies and the solid Up-heaven or Firmament is seen in the aforementioned *Haustl*, which distinguishes between the 'low SKIES' (*Haustl* 15) and *upp-himinn* 'Up-heaven' (*Haustl* 16).

To conclude, the primordial state expressed in the present stanza is one where there is only emptiness or Chaos (cf. *Vafþ* 25/2 n.), while Earth and Stoney Heaven are still monstrously conjoined in the body of Ymer.

**4** áðr Burs synir · bjǫðum of ypðu, [R 1r/8, H 20r/5]
2 þęir es Mið·garð · męran skópu;
sól skęin sunnan · á salar stęina;
4 þá vas grund gróin · grønum lauki.

before the Sons of Byre raised the flatlands,
they who created famed Middenyard.
The sun shone from the south on the stones of the hall;
then was the ground grown with green leek.

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ALL | The Sons of Byre, the first Gods, came to life subsequent to Ymer. They sacrificed the primordial ettin through decapitation and created the World out of his body, as told in *Grm* 41–42, *Vafþ* 21, and *Gylf* 6–8.

1 Burs synir 'the Sons of Byre' | In *Gylf* 6:8–10 identified as the three brothers Weden (ON *Óðinn*), Will (*Vili*), and Wigh (*Vé*), the first Gods. For their identities cf. st. 16/2: *ęsir* n. below.

1 bjǫðum of ypðu 'raised the flatlands' | The verb *yppa* is a causative derived from ON *upp* 'up', *uppi* 'above, up, on high, remembered' (cf. below st. 15/6a). In poetry it typically means 'extol, lift up, announce'. Its OE cognate *yppan* means 'bring up, bring forth, reveal'.

There is an apparent contradiction here, since the verb seems to imply that the earth was covered by the sea, something clearly stated in st. 56 below. This is problematic since st. 3/2 say plainly that there was neither earth nor sea before the lifting. With this in mind the present verse can be understood in two ways. (1) According to *Gylf* 7:3–5, the killing of Yimer flooded the world with so much blood that it drowned all the ettins save for Bearyelmer and his family, who survived by taking refuge on his canoe (*lúðr*, see *Vafþ* 35 for discussion on this word and a citation of the relevant passage). Thus, the present verse would likewise allude to this primæval post-sacrificial flood and the subsequent raising of the Earth, Yimer's blood-covered body. (2) If the **G** version of l. 3/1b (*þat's ękki vas* 'when nothing was') is authorial, the wallow may not have intended to allude to the myth of Yimer at all, but may instead have been thinking of something like Genesis 1:2, 9–10, where Elohim makes the dry land rise up from the deep Waters. Something similar is found in *Il* 14.201 and 246, which state that Ὠκεανος, Ocean, is the origin of all Gods and, indeed, of all things. The problem with explanation (2) is that it does not resolve the contradiction: st. 3/2 still states plainly that there was not yet any sea before the Sons of Byre, and the boundless sea should still count as a sea. The parallels also fall: Greek Ocean is equivalent to the Ilewaves, the primæval venomous waters whence himself Yimer originated (*Vafþ* 31), and the Biblical Creation myth is certainly a secondary development from earlier pagan mythology. As such, (1) should be preferred.

2 Mið·garð 'Middenyard' | The Middle Enclosure, which was created as the home of Men (*Grm* 42).

4 grønum lauki 'green leek' | A sign of the golden age, for the leek (in the Old Germanic languages referring more broadly to any plant of the genus *Allium*) was in ancient times held to be the noblest plant. See Index.

**5**

Sól varp sunnan, · sinni Mána,
hęndi hinni hógri · of himin-jǫður;
Sól þat né vissi, · hvar hǫn sali átti;
Máni þat né vissi, · hvat hann męgins átti;
stjǫrnur þat né vissu, · hvar þęr staði ǫttu.

[**R** 1r/11, **H** 20r/7, **S** 3r/21, **T** 4r/2, **W** 6v/2, **U** 4v/19]

The Sun cast from the south—the Moon's companion—
her right hand over heaven's rim.
The Sun knew not where halls she had;
the Moon knew not what sort of might he had;
the Stars knew not where seats they had.

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1–2 Sól ... himin-jǫður 'The Sun ... heaven's rim' | *om.* **G**. 2 of himin-jǫður 'over heaven's rim' | *composite;* of himin-†iodyr† **R**; of jǫður **H**. 4–5 Máni ... ǫttu 'the Moon ... they had.' | *These lines are reversed (i.e., Sun, Stars, Moon) in* **RH**.

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ALL | The Sun lifts herself up over the horizon and rises for the first time, but she does not know her proper course. The heavenly bodies are in a state of confusion and chaotic disorder.

1 sinni Mána 'Moon's companion' | At times mistranslated as 'her moon', understanding *sinni* as dat. sg. f. of *sinn* 'its (reflexive)'. This cannot be correct since ON possessives are inflected based on the gender of the noun possessed, not the gender of the possessor. *máni* 'moon' is masculine, and so 'her moon' would be **sinum Mána*.

2 of himin-jǫður ‘over heaven’s rim’ | A problematic line. (1) The reading of **R** may be normalised as *of himin-jó-dýr* ‘over the heaven-horse-beast(s)’ (so some recent eds., e.g., Pettit 2023), but such a compound is nonsensical and gives the whole verse the otherwise unattested stress pattern x#pxSS. (2) On the other hand, the reading of **H** (*‘of ioður’* ‘over the rim, edge’) is clearly deficient, since it lacks the necessary alliteration on *h-*. (3) If we instead see **R**’s *‘iodyr’* as corrupted from an archetypal **iodur* (as attested in **H**), we can restore to *of *himin-jǫður*, as is done here (so also e.g. Finnur Jónsson 1932, Jónas Kristjánsson and Vésteinn Ólason 2014, p. 292). Although the better reading, (3) also has problems, since a type C verse with resolution on the first lift cannot have a short second lift in Ancient-words-lay, something which *of *himin-jǫður* (x#pxsx) has (Males 2024a, p. 161). It is, however, possible that this is a license on the part of the *Vsp*-poet, for which cf. st. 39/1b below.

4 Máni þat né vissi, · hvat hann męgins átti ‘the Moon knew not what sort of might he had’ | For a concrete example of this “might” cf. *Háv* 137/7, where the moon is to be invoked in a blood feud. A belief in the power of the moon is found in most ancient religions. Its influence on the human mind was remarked already by Pliny (1855), 2.102, 18.75 and is witnessed in folklore by the influence of the full moon on the werewolf; cf. in English the word *lunacy* (from Latin *lūna* ‘moon’). It is known that women are particularly affected by the moon through the synchronisation of the monthly and menstrual cycles (the two in fact being doublets, “menstrual” deriving from Latin *mēnsis* ‘month’, originally ‘moon’) likely caused by the moon’s gravitational pull on the body, as proven by modern science (Helfrich-Förster et al. 2025).

**6** Þá gingu rękin ǫll · á rǫk-stóla, [**R** 1r/13, **H** 20r/9]
ginn-hęilǫg goð, · ok umb þat gętt̄u=sk.
Nótt ok niðjum · nǫfn of gǫ́fu,
morgin hétu · ok miðjan dag,
undurn ok aptan, · ǫ́rum at tęlja.

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of that.
To the night and the moon-phases they gave names;
morning they named and mid-day:
afternoon and evening the years for to tally.

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ALL | The Gods continue with giving order of the World. They assemble at their Thing and resolve the problem of the disorder of the heavenly bodies by appointing them to turn around in the Heavens, each according to its proper course (cf. *Vafþ* 22–25, *Grm* 38). Thereafter they establish the reckoning of time by giving names to the newly emerged cycles. This name-giving, the establishment of norms, is part of the Godly ordering of the universe and therefore also done to the weal of mankind (Nordberg 2020, p. 737). In fact, it is the very act of naming (and thereby categorising) these phenomena which sets them apart from the disordered Chaos; in this way the categories and norms, rather than being arbitrarily invented by Man, are seen as stemming directly from the Gods (Eliade 2005, pp. 21–22). (Tangentially, it might be said that this view is not exactly identical to the modern, Christian scientific attitude towards nature, which is centered around understanding the order in the perfect design of an all-knowing Creator. In the Pagan Indo-European worldview, the raw matter already exists before the Gods in the chaotic form of Yimer and the other Ettins (cf. *Vafþ* 31) or in the confused heavenly bodies. The Creation thus consists in *shaping* or directing this matter according to the Godly Will, that is, the heroic masculine creative intellect.) An interesting comparative parallel is found in the Vedic myth of the god Índra’s freeing of the trapped Dawns through the uttering of sacred formulations. Like with the name-giving here, it is there the power of the *truth* inherent in Índra’s chanting which releases the dawns, and thereby invigorates the natural cycle between night and day (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71, 125).

1–2 Þá … gęttu=sk ‘Then … of that.’ | The first refrain (*stęf*) of the poem, describing the convening of the Thing of the Gods repeated below in sts. 9/1–2, 22/1–2, and 24/1–2. The establishment of the Thing of the Gods is further described in *Gylf* 14:2–7 as cited in st. 7 below; the Thing is also mentioned in st. 46/2 below, *Hym* 39/1, *Grm* 29–30, *Bdr* 1/1–3, *Þrk* 14/1–3, and *Haustl* 10/3.
A similar group of lines describing the convening of the Thing is found in *Bdr* 1/1–3 and *Þrk* 14/1–3, which follow the same structure as the present refrain. In every occurrence of either refrain outside of the present stanza, the demonstrative pronoun *þat* ‘this, that’ clearly refers to an immediately following question introduced by a *hv*-word, which describes a problem the Gods have to deal with (e.g., *Þrk* 14/3–4: “and of this counseled the mighty Tews: how they Loride’s hammer might find.”) Following this pattern, we would expect to find such a question following *umb þat gęttu=sk* ‘took counsel of that’ in the present stanza, and so it seems reasonably plausible (though not certain) that one has been lost in transmission.

1 regin ǫll ‘all the Reins’ | All the Gods (*regin* ‘Reins’, i.e., ‘Powers, Counsels’, a pantheistic word), here acting as one body. According to *Skm* 1, twelve Gods other than Weden were present at the Thing; these were Thunder, Nearth, Frea, Tew, Homedall, Bray, Wider, Wonnel, Wolder, Heener, Foresitter, and Lock. However, Wonnel and Lock can hardly have been seated at the Thing at the same time, since Wonnel was born to avenge Balder and Lock was bound soon after Balder’s death (cf. st. 34 below, *Lok* P8). After Balder’s death, the Gods at the Thing thus numbered twelve, including Weden (the chief); this is attested in the late 13th c. AD *Gautr* 7. The number twelve clearly belongs to historical Germanic Thing-proceedings and is the probable origin of the English twelve-man jury; cf. *Bdr* 1/1–3 n.

1 rǫk-stóla ‘council-seats’ | This word is only found in the present refrain but corresponds to the *sęti* ‘seats’ (*Gylf* 14:2, 4, 11) and *dóm-stólar* ‘judgment-seats’ (*Gylf* 42:18, *Skm* 43) in Snorre’s prose.

2 ginn-hęilǫg goð ‘yin-holy Gods’ | A reverent epithet, perhaps ‘the vast, holy Gods’. The adjective *ginn-hęilagr* ‘yin-holy’ is composed of the augmentative prefix *ginn-* ‘yin-’ (cf. OE *ġinn* ‘wide, vast, ample’) + *hęilagr* ‘holy, inviolable’. Outside of this refrain, *ginn-hęilagr* only has one other occurrence in the Norse corpus, *Lok* 11/2: *ǫll ginn-hęilǫg goð* ‘all yin-holy Gods’.

2 ok umb þat gęttu=sk | This verse is metrically unusual as it belongs to type A3 (x#x#x#Px), a type which is irregular (but not strictly prohibited) in the Ancient-words-layoff-verse (Suzuki 2014, 56 ff.); the other unique occurrence in *Vsp* is l. 34/3b below. Note that 61/2b is a type C due to the restoration of the old hiatus form—not a type A3, as Suzuki (2014, pp. 60, 187), following Neckel and Kuhn (1983), has it.

3 Nǫtt ok niðjum ‘the night and the moon-phases’ | Also found in *Vafþ* 24/4.

5 ǫrum at tęlja ‘the years for to tally’ | Cf. *Vafþ* 22–25, where it is said that the Gods made the sun and moon turn round in heaven and created the moon-phases *ǫldum at ár-tali* ‘for mankind’s tally of years’.

## 7

Hittu=sk ęsir · á Iða-vęlli, [R 1r/16, H 20r/10]
þęir’s hǫrg ok hof · hó-timbruðu;
afla lǫgðu, · auð smíðuðu,
tangir skópu · ok tól gǫrðu.

The Eese met each other on the Idewold,
they who timbered on high harrow and hove.
Hearths they laid; wealth they forged;
tongs they shaped and tools they made.

2 þęir’s hǫrg ok hof · hó-timbruðu ‘they who timbered on high harrow and hove’ | afls kostuðu · alls freistuðu *‘they exerted strength, they tried everything’* **H**

ALL | The Gods build their settlement. — The whole st. is clearly a source for *Gylf* 14:2–7: *Hárr mélti: „Í upp·hafi setti hann stjórnar-menn í sǽti ok beiddi þá at dóma með sér ør·lǫg manna ok ráða um skipun borgar'innar. Þat var þar, sem heitir Iða-vǫllr í miðri borg'inni. Var þat hit fyrsta þeira verk at gera hof þat, er sǽti þeira tólf standa í ǫnnur en há-sǽtit, þat er Al·fǫðr á. Þat hús er betst gert á jǫrðu ok mest. Allt er þat útan ok innan svá sem gull eitt. Í þeim stað kalla menn Glaðs-heim. Annan sal gerðu þeir; þat var hǫrgr, er gyðjur'nar áttu, ok var hann all-fagr. Þat hús kalla menn Vin-gólf. Þar nǽst gerðu þeir hús, er þeir lǫgðu afla í, ok þar til gerðu þeir hamar ok tǫng ok stǫðja ok þaðan af ǫll tól ǫnnur.* 'High spoke: "In the beginning He [= Weden, the Allfather] set men of authority in seats and summoned them to judge the orlays of men alongside Him and to rule the arrangements of the stronghold. It [= the judgment-place] was at the place called the Idewold in the middle of the stronghold. It was the first of their works to make the hove wherein there stand twelve seats of theirs other than the high-seat which Allfather owns. That house is the best one made upon the earth and the greatest. It is all without and within as if it were of gold alone. That place men call Gladsham. Another hall they made; it was a harrow, which the giddens owned, and it was all-fair. That house men call Wingolf. Thereafter they made houses wherein they laid hearths, and thereto they made a hammer and tongs and an anvil and with those all other tools.'

1 Iða-vǫlli 'the Idewold' | Dat. sg. of *Iða-vǫllr* 'the Plain of Industry.'

2 þǫ́ir's hǫrg ok hof · hǫ́-timbruðu 'they who timbered on high harrow and hove' | Two formulæ. — *hǫrgr ok hof* 'harrow and hove' is a merism, i.e., ritual structures made of stone and wood; cf. *Vafþ* 38 and *HHj* 4, as well as the Saw of Anlaf Trueson in **F**, which says that King Anlaf *lét* [...] *brenna hof en brjóta hǫrga ok reisa í stað'inn kirkjur* 'had hoves burnt and harrows broken and churches raised in their stead'. —*hǫ́-timbra* 'timber, build on high' is a rare poetic compound; its only other occurrence in the ON corpus is in *Grm* 16 where it describes a harrow ruled by Nearth. Identical cognates are found in OE poetry: the verb *héah-ge·timbrian* 'id.' (*Christ and Satan* 29) and the noun *héah-ge·timbru* 'a dwelling on high' (*Guthlac A* 584, *Christ C* 973, 1181, and *GenB* 739; the last deriving from a lost OS original). — This passage has often been wondered at. Why would the Gods themselves make cultic buildings? Whom do *they* worship? Let it be added to the present instance that they are also said to partake in the ritual sacrifice of animals, divining with their blood and feasting on their flesh (e.g., *Vsp* 61, *Hym* 1, 39, *Lok*, *Haustl* 2). This question is not necessarily as difficult as it has been made out to be, however, since the most probable answer be that the behaviour of the Gods serves as the model for virtuous human behaviour and justifies the ideology of settlement. Colonising new lands, tilling the earth, building houses and enclosures and ritual structures, sacrificing animals—if these are virtuous for humanity, they must find their model among the Gods, for "Man constructs according to an archetype", and all settlements reenact Creation (Eliade 2005, pp. 10, 76–78). This does not mean that the Gods worship themselves (or anything else); the Gods operate on the level of the macrocosm and it is from them that the Godly Will flows. Humans connect with this Godly Will through imitating the Gods on the level of the microcosm by sacrifice and settlement. Thus, the sacrifice of Yimer and the enclosing of "the famous Middenyard" are reenacted through the sacrifice of horses and oxen within ritual and settlement enclosures (Lincoln 1986, *passim*); see further *Grm* 41–43 and notes.

3 afla ‘Hearths’ | More specifically forges, by which we should understand that the Gods established fire in their settlement. The civilising role of fire is found in Norse sources in the description of Icelandic settlers carrying fire around their land-claims, so e.g., *Ldn* 3.6: *En meðan Sé·mundr fór eldi um land-nám sitt* ‘But while Seamund went with fire around his land-claim’, 5.3: *Þat land fór Jǫrundr eldi ok lagði til hofs* ‘Earwind went with fire throughout that land and laid it under the hove’, and *Eb* 4: *fór Þór·ólfr eldi um land-nám sitt* ‘Thurolf went with fire around his land-claim’. In *Ldn* 5.1, the practice is framed as a rule put in place by King Harold Fairhair to prevent Icelandic settlers claiming excessive tracts of land: *engi skyldi víðara nema en hann mętti eldi yfir fara á degi með skipverjum sínum. Menn skyldu eld gera, þá er sól vęri í austri. Þar skyldi gera aðra reyki, svá at hvára sęi frá qðrum, en þeir eldar, er gervir váru, þá er sól var í austri, skyldi brenna til nętr. Síðan skyldu þeir ganga til þess, er sól vęri í vestri, ok gera þar aðra elda.* ‘No one was to claim more [land] than that over which he might bring fire in a day with his shipmates. Men were to kindle fire when the sun was in the east. There they were to make other smoke-fires so that each fire could be seen from the other, but the fires which were made when the sun was in the east were to burn till night. Thereafter they were to walk until the sun was in the west and there make other fires.’ It seems likely that this explanation of the fire-ritual as a mere rule set down to prevent the excessive claiming of land is a later historicising explanation, developed after the original reason behind the use of fire had been forgotten. The ancient roots of the practice are demonstrated by the account of the legendary Gotlandish civilising founder, Thelver, in *Gut* 1: *Gut·land hitti fyrsti maðr þann, sum Þielvarr hít. Þá var Gut·land so eliust, et þet dagum sank ok náttum var uppi. En þann maðr kvam fyrsti eldi á land, ok síðan sank þet aldri.* ‘Gotland was first discovered by the man who was named Thelver. At that time, Gotland was so uncanny [?] that it sank during the days and was up during the nights. But that man was the first who brought fire to the land, and afterwards it never sank.’ In this account, the bringing of fire works to civilise and exorcise the land by making it conform to the natural, godly cosmic order. The use of fire in the establishment of settlements has Vedic parallels (Eliade 2005, p. 11; Eliade 1959, pp. 30–31), and fire also features elsewhere in Norse ritual (cf. *Grm* 43/2).

**8** [R 1r/18, H 20r/12]

Tęfldu í túni, · tęitir vǫ́ru,
vas þęim véttir=gis · vant ór golli,
und’s þríar kvǫ́mu · þursa męyjar,
ám-áttkar mjǫk, · ór Jǫtun-hęimum.

They played Tables in the courtyard; merry were they;
for them naught of gold was wanting—
until three came: the maidens of Thurses
most uncanny, out of the Ettinhomes.

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ALL | After having settled down, the Gods are merry and content, rejoicing in gold (ll. 1–2). This state is spoiled by the coming of three otherwise unidentified Ettin-women; cf. note to l. 3 below. — The whole stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 14:8–10, which explicitly identifies this period as the Golden Age (cf. l. 2 n.): *Ok því nést smíðuðu þeir málm ok stein ok tré ok svá gnóg=liga þann málm, er gull heitir, at qll bús-gogn ok qll reiði-gogn hofðu þeir af gulli, ok er sú qld kǫlluð gull-aldr, áðr en spillti=sk af til-kvámu kvinna’nna; þér kómu ór Jǫtun-heimum.* ‘And thereafter they forged metal and stone and wood, and so abundantly [did they forge] that metal which is called gold that all their household tools and riding tools were golden. And that age is called the golden age, before it was spoiled by the arrival of the women; they came out of the Ettinhomes.’

1 Tęfldu ‘played Tables’ | 3rd pl. pret. ind. of *tefla*, a causative verb derived from *tafl* ‘Tables, board game’, an old borrowing from Latin *tabula*. ‘Tables’ is used as a cognate translation; the exact type of board game referred to is unimportant, although it is certainly a game of strategy (e.g. *hnefa-tafl* or nine men’s morris) rather than one of chance. For *hnefa-tafl* (which held the role as the chief board game in Scandinavia before the introduction of chess in the C12th) and its relatives see Murray (1952, pp. 55–64).

2 vas þęim véttir=gis · vant ór golli ‘for them naught of gold was wanting’ | Indeed, even the bricks they played with were of gold (cf. st. 58). The Golden Age at the initial fulfillment of Creation is found in many mythologies (Eliade 2005, pp. 9, 112, 122, 127, 132, 135–136, 149, 154).

2 véttir=gis ‘nothing’ | An archaic gen. of *vétt=ki* ‘nothing’, the *-ir-* representing a fossilized *i*-stem gen. sg., as ON *váttr* ‘thing’ comes from PN **wihtiz*. The only other occurrence of this form is in the notably archaic Old Icelandic Homily Book (ms. Holm perg 15 4°, fol. 36v/30).

3 þríar … þursa męyjar ‘three … maidens of Thurses’ | These three maidens are never mentioned again (unless they are taken to be the three norns in st. 19, but they would then be introduced twice). It is possible that an additional stanza giving further information about them has been lost; if it originally existed, it was already absent in the version used for *Gylf*, since no additional information is found there. In any case, it seems that they are there to stay, since their arrival would not be problematic if they Gods could merely slay them and return to their happy state. Apart from their being the three norns, another possibility for their identity would be as the consorts of the three sons of Byre; the (male) Gods would then give them their gold (in the form of jewellery) in exchange for relations in order to birth the next generation of Gods.

4 ám-áttkar ‘uncanny’ | The word *ám-áttigr* has a clear association with supernatural ettins. It occurs in four other places in **R**: in *Grm* 11, *Skí* 10, and *HHj* 17 it is paired with *jǫtunn* ‘ettin’, while in *HHj* 14 it is used by the daughter of an ettin to refer to a human hero, a clear inversion of its usual use.

**9**

Þá gingu regin ǫll · á rǫk-stóla,
ginn-heilǫg goð, · ok umb þat gęttu=sk:
Hvęrr skyldi dverga · dróttof skępja
ór Brimis blóði · ok ór Bláins lęggjum?

[**R** 1r/20, **H** 20r/14, **S** 4v/3, **T** 5r/14, **W** 7v/19, **U** 5v/27]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:
Who should shape the troop of Dwarfs
out of Brimmer’s blood and out of Blown’s legs?

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3 Hvęrr skyldi dverga ‘Who should … of dwarfs’ | *so* **RWU**; at skyldi dverga *‘That they should … of dwarfs’* **ST**; hverir skyldu dvergar *‘Which Dwarfs should* [*shape the troops out of …*]*’* **H** 3 dróttof ‘the troop’ | *so* **G**; drotin *‘the lord’* **R**; dróttir *‘the troops’* **H** 3 of | *so* **G**; *om.* **RH** 3 skępja ‘shape’ | spękja *(norm.) ‘soothe’* **U** 4 Brimis blóði ‘Brimmer’s blood’ | *so* **RT**; brimi blóðgu *‘the bloody surf’* **HSWU**. 4 Bláins ‘Blown’s’ | *so* **HW**; †bláms† *(corrupted from* *Bláins*)* **STU**; blǫum (‘blám’) *‘blue-black’* **R**.

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ALL | After the abundance of the Golden Age is over, the Gods must procure more gold. For this they need the Dwarfs, who are associated with ore-veins, and who make many fabulous treasures for the Gods (e.g., the fetter Glapner, Freʀ’s ship Shidebladner, Thunder’s hammer Millner, Weden’s spear Gungner, and Sib’s hair; see *Grm* 44, *Eddbr* VIII, and *Skm* 43). The conception of spontaneous generation is apparently at play, as the dwarfs are believed to live in rocks. According to the prevalent view in antiquity, maggots and worms were thought to generate spontaneously in rotting flesh and earth, and likewise metal veins were thought to generate in stone. Although the latter is not explicitly stated in Old Norse sources, it was a widespread belief in the ancient and mediæval world (Carlotta and Martelli 2023).

The likeness between the dwarfs and spontaneously generated maggots is made by *Gylf* 14:11–14, which continues with its paraphrase: *Þar nęst settu=sk goð'in upp í sęti sín ok réttu dóma sína ok minntu=sk, hvaðan dvergar hǫfðu kviknat í mold'inni ok niðri í jǫrðu'nni, svá sem maðkar í holdi. Dvergar'nir hǫfðu skipat=sk fyrst ok tekit kviknun í holdi Ymis ok váru þá maðkar, en af at·kvęðum goða'nna urðu þeir vitandi mann-vits ok hǫfðu manns líki ok búa þó í jǫrðu ok í steinum. Móð·sognir var ôðstr ok annarr Durinn.* 'Thereafter the Gods set themselves high in their seats and made their judgments and remembered whence the Dwarfs had come to life in the ground and down in the earth like maggots in flesh. The dwarfs had first taken shape and come to life in Yimer's flesh and were then maggots, but by the decrees of the Gods they became knowing of manwit and had the forms of a man, and yet they live in the earth and in stones. Moodsowner was the first in rank, and second was Dorn.' Immediately after this passage, *Gylf* 14:15 quotes sts. 9 and 10/3–4 in sequence, introduced by the words *svá segir í Vǫlu-spá:* 'so it says in the Spae of the Wallow:'.

4 ór Brimis blóði · ok ór Bláins lęggjum 'out of Brimmer's blood and out of Blown's legs' | The adopted reading for this line is a composite, but is based on the distributions of variants across the mss. and the principle that the more difficult reading is the likelier. Both *brimi blóðgu* 'the bloody surf' and *blǫ́um ('blám')* 'blue-black' are thus to be taken as instances of trivialisation due to the confusion of rarely attested proper names (Males 2023b, pp. 196–197; Males and Myrvoll n.d., pp. 16–17). — The blood and legs are taken to be those of Yimer. From his bones were made the rocks and from his blood the sea (*Grm* 41, *Vafþ* 21). Explaining the creation of dwarfs out of Yimer's legs is simple, for in Germanic lore the dwarfs dwell in rocks (cf., e.g., *Yt* 2, where the Swedish king Swayther (ON *Svęigðir*) runs into a rock in pursuit of a dwarf). More difficult to explain is how the dwarfs would be made out of the sea. One suggestion is that this may be referring to the formation of salt-stones by means of evaporating salty sea-water. Another interpretation is that we are dealing with the motif of underwater stones, which may have been thought to have generated spontaneously in the sea; cf. Scaldic ROCK-kennings like *Hálf* 2: *sęvar bęin* 'bone of the sea' and *Þdr* 16: *fjarð-ępli* 'firth-apple' (Meissner 1921, p. 90).

4 Brimis blóði 'Brimmer's blood' | Brimmer is perhaps a name for an ettin in st. 36/4 below, in which case it should be taken as a generic name here, i.e., 'out of the ettin's blood'.

4 Bláins 'Blown's' | (1) *Bláinn* 'Blown' (from *blár* 'blue, black') has usually been read as a poetic name for the ettin Yimer, and this is assumed here, although it is not attested elsewhere as a name for him. (2) The name is, however, attested as a dwarf-name in Þul *Dverga* 1 (SkP 3), and following Gurevich (SkP 3, p. 693), we could therefore take the b-verse as a kenning 'the legs of Blown ⟨dwarf⟩ [STONES]'. This reading suffers from the artifice of the kenning, and from the fact that the dwarfs have not yet been created at this point in the narrative.

**10**

Þar vas Móð·sognir · męttstr of orðinn
dverga allra, · ęn Durinn annarr;
þęir man-líkun · mǫrg of gørðu,
dvergar ǐ jǫrðu, · sęm Durinn sagði.

[**R** 1r/21, **H** 20r/15, **S** 4v/5, **T** 5r/15, **W** 7v/21, **U** 6r/1]

There was Moodsowner made the chiefest
of all Dwarfs, but Dorn the second.
Those Dwarfs made many man-likenesses
in the earth, as Dorn said.

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1–2 Þar ... annarr 'There ... second' | *om.* **G** 1 Þar vas Móð·sognir | *so* **H**, *(in the paraphrase)* **G**; Þar Mót·sognir vitnir *'there Mootsowner wolf(?)'* **R**. 3 þęir man-líkun · mǫrg of gørðu | *so* **RHU**; þar man-líkun · mǫrg of gørðu=sk **STW** 4 ǐ 'in' | *so* **HG**; ór *'out of'* **R** 4 sęm Durinn sagði 'as Dorn said' | *so* **RHSW**; sem †dur menn† sagði *'as door-men(?) said'* **T**; sem †þeim dyrinn kendi† *'as the beasts(?) taught them'* **U**

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ALL | 10/3–4 are cited in *Gylf* 14:15, immediately following its citation st. 9 (see there).

1–2 Þar … annarr ‘There … second’ | These lines are not found in *Gylf*, but the author must have had the full stanza since *Gylf* 14:14 (“Moodsowner was the first in rank, and second was Dorn”, see st. 9) clearly derives from ll. 1–2. They were likely omitted by the author of *Gylf* as superfluous.

3 man-líkun ‘man-likenesses’ | The Dwarfs were in the shape of men, but not quite human. In the creation of the Dwarfs before men, we may find a reflex of a motif common throughout world mythology: the creation of several failed or incomplete generations of sentient beings by the God(s) prior to the current race of humanity. These failed or ancient generations are typically created out of other materials than those used for present humanity, display non-human features and uncanny abilities, and are either destroyed or turned into sprites or animals. Mythological parallels include the five ages of man (viz. the Golden Age, Silver Age, Bronze Age, Heroic Age, and Iron Age) in Hesiod’s *Works and Days* 109–201; the Jinn in Islam, created out of smokeless fire prior to the creation of Man out of clay (*Qur’ān* 15:26–27); and the several attempts at creating humans in the pre-Columbian Mayan *Popol Vuh*, where the first generation was made out of earth and mud, but destroyed for its weakness (ll. 434–517), the second out of effigies of carved wood, becoming the spider monkeys (518–837), while the third and successful creation of humanity was out of maize (4822–4939) (Christenson 2007, pp. 64–75, 178–181). The Norse Dwarfs fit surprisingly well into this typology. They are created out of stone (whereas the first humans are made out of wood), are described in sources as unusually lustful and greedy, but also as masterful craftsmen, and are a form of sprite or earthly dæmon.

3–4 þeir … sagði ‘Those … said.’ | The mss. readings offer two conflicting versions of the creation of the dwarfs. (1) **STW**: The dwarfs arise on their own through spontaneous generation; this is supported by the prose of *Gylf* 14:11–14 (see note to previous st.) and by the form of the stanza quoted there in the non-**U** mss., but it may have been changed to correspond to the author’s vision (cf. st. 38/3 n. below). (2) **RHU**: the dwarfs Moodsowner and Dorn shape “man-likenesses”, most likely lesser Dwarfs, out of the soil. For stemmatic reasons, the present ed. adopts (2).

(For sts. **11–15**—the *Dwarf-tallies*—see Appendix to the poem.)

**16** Und’s þrír kvǫmu · ór því liði [R 1v/1, H 20r/26]
ǫflgir ok ǫstkir · ęsir at húsi;
fundu á landi · lítt megandi
Ask ok Ęmblu · ør·lǫg-lausa.

Until three came out of that host,
strong and loving Eese along the settlement.
They found on the land the little availing
Ash and Emble, orlay-less.

1 þrír | *emend.;* þrjár **RH** 1 ór því liði | *so* **R**; þussa brúðir **H**. 2 ǫflgir ok ǫstkir ‘strong and loving’ | ǫstkir ok ǫflgir *‘loving and strong’* **H**

ALL | Sts. 16–17 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 9:3–7:
*Þá er þeir gengu með sévar-strǫndu Burs synir, fundu þeir tré tvau ok tóku upp tré’n ok skǫpuðu af menn. Gaf inn fyrsti ǫnd ok líf, annarr vit ok hróring, þriði á·sjónu, mál ok heyrn ok sjón; gófu þeim klęði ok nafn. Hét karl-maðr’inn Askr, en kona’n Embla, ok ólsk þaðan af mann-kind’in, sú er byggð’in var gefinn undir Mið·garði.* ‘When the sons of Byre (cf. n. to l. 2: *ęsir*) were walking along the sea-shore they found two pieces of wood (*tré*) and they took up the pieces of wood and shaped men out of them. The first one gave breath and life; the second one intelligence and movement; the third one outward appearance, speech and hearing and sight. They gave them clothes and names. The man was named Ash and the woman Emble, and from them was begotten mankind, to whom the settlement within Middenyard was given.’

Based on the just-cited passage, the Gods are generally understood to have created mankind out of pieces of driftwood, and that is most likely what is being referred to by Snorre. Yet no such detail is found in the present stanza; it may, therefore, instead be a later Icelandic or Snorronean reinterpretation. As pointed out by Hultgård (2006), the evidence from comparative mythology in fact suggests that the first humans were originally thought of as being made out of living, growing trees.
The descent of humans from trees is probably the reason behind the extensive use of tree-names as base-words in kennings for men and women in Norse poetry (see SkP I, p. lxxv ff., Meissner 1921, pp. 245, 266–272, 410). This kenning-type generally belongs to Scaldic poetry, but occasionally appears also in Eddic poetry (e.g., *Sigrdr* 5: *bryn-þings apaldr* 'apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]').

1 Und's 'Until' | The first line, beginning with the conjunction *und's* 'until', is clearly supposed to connect syntactically to an immediately preceding stanza describing some ongoing action, as in st. 4/1 above: *áðr* 'before'. For other instances of sts. beginning with *und's*, cf. *Hym* 30, *Sigsk* 3, 51, *2 Guðr* 3; in SkP, see *Haustl* 11, *Þdr* 10, Anon *Pl* 31.
If the dwarf-tallies (sts. 11–15) are later inserts, the preceding stanza would be st. 10, in which case the creation of men is probably to be understood as following and surpassing the creation of the dwarfs; cf. note to st. 10/3: *man-likun*.

1 þrír kvǫmu · ór því liði 'three came out of that host' | Both mss. show corruption from st. 8 in their use of the f. *þrjár* 'three' for the m. **þrír*. **H** goes further in replacing the b-verse *ór því liði* 'out of that host' with *þussa brúðir* 'brides of thurses'. That this is nothing other than corruption is clearly shown by the m. pl. *øflgir ok ǫstkir ęsir* 'strong and loving Eese' in l. 2.

2 ǫstkir 'loving' | The Wallow depicts the creation of Mankind as an act of love. For our benefit, the Gods also created Middenyard (*Vsp* 4/2, *Grm* 42), the sun, and the moon with its phases (*Vsp* 6, *Vafþ* 22–25).

2 ęsir 'Eese' | Weden, Heener, and Lother. This stands in contradiction to *Gylf* 9:3–4 which tells us that the gods who made the first men were the sons of Byre, in *Gylf* 6:8–10 (cf. st.4) identified with Weden, Will, and Wigh. If we are to reconcile this difficulty we would have to see Heener and Lother as the equivalents of the latter two, but that identification is rather unlikely.
To begin with, not even the notoriously systematising *Gylf* equates Heener with Will or Wigh, nor does it mention Lother at all. In Scaldic poetry the two gods Heener and Lother are found in a few kennings for Weden, but unlike kennings involving Will, these are always of the type 'friend of Lother/Heener' [= Weden] and never 'brother of Lother/Heener' [= Weden]. Heener and Lother instead seem to be distinct gods. See further the notes to their names in st. 17.

2 at húsi 'along the settlement' | Lit. 'along the house.' An adverbial; the Gods were walking on the outskirts of their settlement.

3–4 lítt megandi ... ør·lǫg-lausa 'little availing ... orlay-less' | Prior to the gifts from the Gods the human beings were immobile and without orlay (fate, destiny), which is thus seen to be one of the distinguishing features of mankind.

4 Ask ok Ęmblu 'Ash and Emble' | The ancestors of all human beings; cf. Life and Lafthrasher who repopulate the world after its rebirth (*Vafþ* 44–45). Ash (nom. *Askr*) is easily identified with the same-named wood species (*Fraxinus excelsior*), but the form Emble (nom. *Ęmbla*) is more difficult. Her name is often translated as "Elm", but the ON word for that tree (*Ulmus glabra*) is the m. *almr*. A possible etymology is metathesis from earlier **Ęlmla* (< PN **almilō* 'young elm tree'), a f. *n*-stem derivative of the same type as *þęlla* 'young fir tree' (< PN **þallilō*) ~ *þǫll* 'fir tree' (< PN **þallu*), although the *-b-* remains unexplained.

**17** [R 1v/3, H 20r/27]

Qnd þau né ǫ́ttu, · óð þau né hǫfðu,
lǫ́ né lę́ti · né litu góða;
ǫnd gaf Óðinn, · óð gaf Hønir,
lǫ́ gaf Lóðurr · ok litu góða.

Breath they had not; wode they had not,
not guile nor sound nor goodly hues.
Weden gave breath; Heener gave wode;
Lother gave guile and goodly hues.

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1 Ǫnd 'Breath' | The breath of life or life force which sets living beings apart from dead matter. The word *ǫnd* originally means simply 'breath' (cf. Gothic *uz·anan* 'to breathe out'), but the semantic development BREATH > VITALITY is by no means unparallelled, as seen by the Latin root-cognate *animus* 'life force, vitality; (later) soul' vs. the Greek ἄνεμος 'wind, breeze'. All these words are ultimately from PIE *$*h_2enh_1$*- 'breathe' (Kroonen 2013, pp. 26–27).

After the conversion to Christianity, ON *ǫnd* takes on the derived sense 'spirit, soul', as seen on Scandinavian memorial runestones where it is used interchangeably with the Anglo-Saxon borrowing *sǫl* 'soul' (e.g. Sö 10 *Guð hjalpi ǫnd hans* 'God help his breath' vs. Sö 8 *Guð hjalpi sǫlu hans* 'God help his soul') and paired with it in at least 14 separate inscriptions (e.g. U 358 *Guð hjalpi hans ǫnd ok sǫlu* 'God help his breath and soul'). This new semantic, probably calqued from the Latin *spiritus* 'breath; spirit', is also charted in the Scaldic corpus, where *ǫnd* (regardless of sense) makes it first securely dateable appearance in Hallfrith's memorial poem to Anlaf Trueson (Hfr *ErfÓl* 27 in SkP 1) dated to ca. 1001 AD.

The lack of pre-Christian Scaldic attestations of *ǫnd* may lead one to question the authenticity of the sense 'life (force)' in the pagan period, but I think that it must have existed to begin with in order for the new sense of 'spirit' to have been acceptable to the Norse converts. If *ǫnd* had meant merely 'respiration' it would probably have been displaced entirely by the Christian loan-word *sǫl* 'soul' rather than have seen acceptance even amongst former pagan poets like Hallfrith. In any case the sense 'life' is attested in the most likely pre-Christian Eddic poem *Sigsk* 33, 53 (*ǫndu látit* 'lost his life'), 60 (*ǫndu týna* 'id.'). Also in later poetry a person who dies is often said to *láta* or *týna ǫndu* (cf. *HHj* 37; in SkP Ótt *Knútdr* 9, Þorm Lv 13, ÞSjár *Þórdr* 3, Ív *Sig* 30, ESk *Geisl* 60, Bjbp *Jóms* 41, Þórðh Lv 9, ǪrvOdd *Ævdr* 12, 39, Anon *Brúðv* 27), whereas it is not said once of the *sǫl*; a Christian could hardly say that a person who dies "loses his soul".

The use of *ǫnd* in *Gylf* 3:10—printed at the beginning of this book for its simple beauty—is distinctly in the Christian sense 'spirit': *Hitt er þó mest, er hann gerði mann'inn ok gaf honum ǫnd þá, er lifa skal ok aldri týna=sk, þó't líkam'inn fúni at moldu eða brenni at ǫsku* 'Yet the greatest thing is when He [= Weden, the Allfather] made the man and gave him the "breath" which shall live and never perish although the body may moulder to dust or burn to ashes.'

1 óð 'wode' | Outside of the present st., ON *óðr* 'wode' (gen. sg. *óðar*) is used only in Scaldic poetry or in prose dealing with Scaldic poetry and then always with the sense 'poem, poetry'. This is most likely also its sense in the cpd. *Óð·rórir* 'Woderearer', one of the vats in which the Mead of Poetry was kept (*Háv* 107).

The present stanza thus gives us the word's only Eddic attestations, but its exact sense in the present st. is unlikely to be merely 'poetry' (which, after all, was given to men by Weden, not Heener, and that at a later time; see *Háv* 103–110). To determine the proper sense of 'wode' we must consider its etymology.

As a m. *u*-stem the noun *óðr* must derive from PGmc. **wópuz*. PGmc. words from the same root include the nouns **wódaz* 'madness, fury' (> OE *wód* 'madness', OHG *wuot* 'fury') and **wópó* (> OE *wóþ* 'song') and the adj. **wódaz* 'mad, furious' (> ON *óðr* 'id.', OE *wód* 'mad, rabid', Gothic *wóds* 'possessed with the devil').

Two Germanic theonyms are clearly derived from the root: Weden (ON *Óðinn* < PGmc. **Wódanaz*) and Wode (ON *Óðr* < PGmc. **Wódaz*). Weden literally means 'lord, possessor of wode' (suffixed with PIE **-nós* 'lord, master of', cf. his name *Hęrjann* < PGmc. **harjanaz* < PIE *kor-yo-nos* 'lord of hosts, chieftain' > Greek κοίρᾰνος 'king, ruler'), while Wode (unlike the noun *óðr* an *a*-stem as seen by *Vsp* 24) is probably a nominalisation of the adjective and thus means 'mad, frenzied, inspired'.

The PIE root, which is found only in Germanic, Italic, and Celtic, is **$wéh_2t$-* and the alternation between the senses 'poetry' ~ 'fury' is also seen in the other branches. PGmc. **wópuz* derives from PIE **$wéh_2t$-u-s* (> OIr. *fáth* 'cause, motive, subject, prophecy, composition', Old Welsh *gwawt* 'song of praise'). Also related are Latin *vātēs* 'prophet, seer; poet' and Gaulish ὀυάτεις 'a type of priest' (pl., found in Strabo's *Geography* 4.4.4) (Kroonen 2013, p. 592).

The IE root sense, clearly retained in Celtic and Germanic, thus appears to be a state of frenzied poetic inspiration, *furor poeticus*, but the sense in the present stanza may also cleave closer to 'intelligent thought, mind', or the power to express one's thoughts with words, which is unique to man.

2 lǫ́ 'guile' | The exact sense of this word is uncertain. It is otherwise found referring to seawater near the shore, poetically to the 'sea', for which reason its sense here has sometimes been interpreted as 'blood'. *Skm* 85 gives *lǫ́* as a poetic synonym for 'hair', but it seems unlikely that hair would be mentioned next to the breath of life and intellect. I tentatively take it to be an otherwise unattested variant of the poetic word *lę́* 'guile, deceit', here in the sense 'skill, craft, cunning'. For the vowel alternation cf. *hrę́* 'corpse' (declined identically and rhyming with *lę́*) < PGmc. **hraiwą*, irregularly metathesised from PIE **krow(h₂)-yóm* (Kroonen 2013, p. 242) vs. *hrár* 'raw, bloody' < **hrawaz* < PIE **krow(h₂)-os* (Kroonen 2013, p. 244).

2 litu góða 'goodly hues' | The ruddy complexion of the living in contrast to the pallor of the dead.
— The alternative reading *litu goða* 'hues of the Gods', proposed by Rydberg (1886, pp. 549–551), is rejected for metrical reasons, since the short second lift in *goða* 'of the Gods' is irregular (Males 2024a, p. 161); cf. st. 5/2 n. above.

3 Óðinn 'Weden' | The role of the god Weden in the birth of men is notable, and he is also called *Alda-fǫðr* 'Father of Mankind' (for distribution see *Vafþ* 4/3 n.). His giving of the breath of life (cf. note to l. 1) is probably related to his role as the god of wind and storms (as evinced by his name *Viðrir* 'Withrer, Stormer', *Háv* 74/4 n.), for in the ancient worldview breath and wind are often understood as the same substance.

3 Hønir 'Heener' | An obscure god. Heener is one of the twelve Eese present at the Thing of the Gods (*Skm* 1) and takes over the role as *sacerdos civitatis* of the Gods after Weden dies, for which cf. *Vsp* 60 below. His name is found thrice in Scaldic poetry, all three in kennings for Lock of the type 'FRIEND/COMPANION of Heener [= Lock]' in the poem *Haustl* (3/4b, 7/4a, 12/2a). Heener plays a minor role in the mythology. In *Yng* 4, he is one of the gods sent as a hostage from the Eese to the Wanes alongside Mimer, the wisest of the Eese. The Wanes in turn give over Quasher, their wisest man. Heener is soon made a chieftain among the Wanes but is not very clever, and, when present at the Thing without Mimer, the only words he can utter are *ráði aðrir* 'let others decide'. Heener further figures in two adventures alongside Weden and Lock, viz. in the encounter with Thedse (*Haustl* 1–13, *Skm* 2–3) and in the origin of the Nivling hoard (*Reg* P1–9, *Skm* 46), but he plays no active role in either narrative.
— Rydberg (1886, p. 552) convincingly argues that Heener is connected with the stork, deriving his name from the same root as Greek κύκνος 'swan' and Sanskrit *śakuná* 'bird of omen' (cf. Kroonen 2013, p. 240), and noting that his epithets *langi fótr* 'long foot' and *aur-konungr* 'mud-king' (both found in *Skm* 22) accurately describe that bird. According to Rydberg's theory, Heener's giving of wode would then be associated with the later folk-myth of the stork that brings children to their parents, just as it is Heener who gives humans their mental faculties and thereby their unique human aspect.

4 Lóðurr 'Lother' | An even more obscure god than Heener; his name is not found in the Poetic Edda and only twice in Scaldic poetry (*Hált* 8/4a (SkP 1) and HaukrV *Ísldr* 1/1b (SkP 4)), in both cases in the kenning *vinr Lóðurs* 'friend of Lother [= Weden]'. Lother is possibly to be identified with the obscure figure **logaþore** ('flame-darer(?)') who appears alongside the two gods **wodan** (*Wódan*, 'Weden') and **wigiþonar** ('battle(?)-Thunder') on the 6th c. German Nordendorf fibula I (KJ 151) from near Augsburg, Bavaria, although this is uncertain (Turville-Petre 1975, p. 143). Since the triad Weden, Heener, and Lock figures in other sources, Lother may also be identified with Lock, whose name may well be a nickname formed from the older Lother (Turville-Petre 1975, pp. 143–144). This identification is strongly supported if the above conjecture is right that Lother's gift *lǫ́* is an alternative form of *lę́* 'guile, deceit', a word closely associated with Lock.

**18**

Ask vęit'k standa, · hęitir Ygg·drasils,
hǫ́r baðmr, ausinn · hvíta auri;
þaðan koma dǫggvar · þǽr's í dala falla;

[**R** 1v/5, **H** 20r/29, **S** 5r/30, **T** 5v/33, **W** 8v/8, **U** 7r/5]

stęndr ę́ yfir grønn · Urðar brunni.

An ash I know standing; it is called Ugdrassle's,
a high tree sprinkled with white mud.
Thence come the dew-drops which fall in the dales;
it stands ever green over the Well of Weird.

1 standa 'standing' | *so* **RHU**; ausinn *'sprinkled'* **STW** 1 Ygg·drasils | *so* **S**; Ygg·drasill *all others* 2 baðmr 'tree' | borinn *'born' (wo. doubt corrupt)* **U**. 2 ausinn 'sprinkled' | hęilagr *'holy'* **G** 3 þę́r's | es **ST** 3 dala | dali **STU** 4 ę́ | *om.* **U** 4 grønn | †grvnn† **S**; †grein† **U**

ALL | St. 18 is cited in *Gylf*, introduced by *Gylf* 16:10–13: *Enn er þat sagt, at nornir þę́r, er byggja við Urðar brunn, taka hvern dag vatn í brunni'num ok með aur'inn þann, er liggr um brunn'inn, ok ausa upp yfir ask'inn, til þess at eigi skuli limar hans tréna eða fúna. En þat vatn er svá heilagt, at allir hlutir, þeir er þar koma í brunn'inn, verða svá hvítir sem hinna sú, er skjall heitir, er innan liggr við egg-skurn. Svá sem hér segir.* 'Furthermore, it is said that the Norns that dwell by the Well of Weird fetch water in the Well every day, and along with it the mud which lies around the well; and they sprinkle it up over the Ash so that its branches should not harden or rot. But that water is so holy that all things which come into the well turn as white as the membrane called the shell-membrane which lies inside of the eggshell. Just as it says here:'.
Following the st., *Gylf* 16:14–15 continues: *Sú dǫgg, er þaðan af fellr á jǫrð'ina, þat kalla menn hunang-fall, ok þar af fǫðask býflugur. Fuglar tveir fǫðask í Urðar brunni. Þeir heita svanir, ok af þeim fuglum hefir komit þat fugla-kyn, er svá heitir.* 'That dew which falls thereof onto the earth do men call 'honey-fall', and thereof bees feed themselves. Two fowls feed themselves in the Well of Weird. They are called 'swans', and from those fowls has come the race of fowls so called.'

1 Ask ... Ygg·drasils 'Ash ... Ugdrassle's' | The Ash of Ugdrassle, the World Tree. That the Ash stands in the very center of the world is shown by *Grm* 26/4, where we learn that all waters run their course from it, and *Grm* 31, which tells us that its roots reach and wrap around the world of Men, the Underworld, and the Ettinhomes.

2 ausinn · hvíta auri 'sprinkled with white mud' | Cf. st. 26/3–4 below.

**19** Þaðan koma męyjar · margs vitandi [R 1v/8, H 20r/31]
þríar ór þęim sal · es und þolli stęndr;
Urð hétu ęina, · aðra Verðandi,
—skǫ́ru á skíði— · Skuld ina þriðju
þę́r lǫg lǫgðu, · þę́r líf køru,
alda bǫrnum, · ør·lǫg sęggja.

Thence come maidens, much-knowing:
three out of the hall which stands beneath the tree.
Weird they called one, the other Werthing
—they scored billets—Shild the third.
They laid down laws; they chose lives
for the children of men, the orlay of youths.

2 sal 'hall' | *so* **H**, *(in the paraphrase)* **G** ; sę́ *'lake'* **R** 2 und 'under' | á *'on'* **H** 6 sęggja 'of youths' | at sęgja *'to say'* **H**

ALL | St. 19 is paraphrased in *Gylf* 15:26–29: *Þar stendr salr einn fagr undir aski'num við brunn'in, ok ór þeim sal koma þrjár meyjar, þér er svá heita: Urðr, Verðandi, Skuld. Þessar meyjar skapa mǫnnum aldr; þér kǫllum vér nornir.* 'There stands in a single fair hall beneath the ash-tree by the well, and out of that hall come three maidens who are called thus: Weird, Werthing, Shild. These maidens shape the ages of men; we call them Norns.' For the three Norns, we may compare a strikingly similar description in the late ancient Gallo-Roman source *De medicamentis* (TODO: cite), which relates a traditional Celtic myth of a tree standing in the middle of the sea, kept by three virgins. A similar motif is found on numerous syncretic Gallo-Roman altars from western Germany, which depict the three *Matronae Andrusteihae* 'Tree-Standing Mothers' next to a great tree (TODO: cite). The three Norns also correspond closely to the Greek Μοῖραι, the three weavers of fate (cf. *1 HHund* 3/1 n.).

2 þolli 'tree' | Literally 'fir', but the word is only used for the alliteration and the species is generic. The same may perhaps apply to *askr* 'ash' above.

3 Urð 'Weird' | Acc. of *Urðr* 'fated course of events,' lit. 'that which has become'. The cognates of this word feature prominently in a fatalistic context in West Germanic poetry (TODO).

3 Verðandi 'Werthing' | 'That which is becoming', the pres. participle of *verða* 'to become, happen'. The name is only found here and in *Gylf* 15:27.

4 skóru á skíði 'they scored billets' | *skíð* refers to a thin piece of split wood, esp. as used for firewood, but can also mean 'plank' or 'ski'. The sense here is most likely that the norns cut notches for the number of years allotted to each human being. This notion is unparallelled (TODO: is it?) in mediaeval literary sources, but the method of time keeping may represent a predecessor of the mediaeval calendars used by the Northern European peasantry to track the lunar cycle and the Catholic feast-days. These consist of carved wooden sticks where each day is represented either by a notch (in Norway and England) or by a rune of the futhark (in Sweden and Estonia) and go under a variety of names; *primstav* in Norway, *runstav* in Sweden, *sirvilaud* in Estonia, and clog almanac in England. Although these later wooden calendars are undoubtedly influenced by the timekeeping of the Church, the present line may just about hint that there existed a native, pre-Christian Germanic calendrical tradition.

4 Skuld 'Shild' | Acc. of *Skuld(r)* 'that which shall be'. The nom. should probably have an *-r*, though that is not attested in *Gylf* 15:27. The name is only found here and in *Gylf* 15:27.

5 lǫg 'laws' | With this word we should understand 'decisions, decrees', for pre-Christian Scandinavian Law was based on custom and precedent. Similar legalistic vocabulary for fate is found in the *dómar* 'judgments' and *kviðir* 'decrees, rulings' of the Norns (*Fáfn* 11/1, *Hamð* 30/4).

**20** [**R** 1v/11, **H** 20v/5]

Þat man hǫn folk-víg · fyrst í hęimi,
es Goll·vęigu · gęirum studdu
ok í hǫll Háars · hána bręnndu,
þrysvar bręnndu · þrysvar borna,
opt, ǫ·sjaldan, · þó hǫn ęnn lifir.

That troop-conflict she recalls first in the Home
when Goldwey they impaled with spears
and in the hall of Hougher ⟨= Weden⟩ [= Walhall] burned her.
Thrice they burned the one thrice born,
often, unseldom—yet she liveth still.

3 Háars | Hárs **RH** 4 þrysvar bręnndu | *written twice* **H**

ALL | A very cryptic stanza. The name Goldwey is not mentioned in any other source, nor is the underlying story, but she was apparently slain, burned, and reborn three times. Goldwey is perhaps to be identified with the wallow of the poem herself, which would explain the cryptic "yet she lives still".

1 folk-víg 'troop-conflict' | *folk* here carries its older meaning 'troop, band', as seen e.g. in the Slavic borrowing exemplified by Russian полк 'regiment, host, army'.

3 Háars 'Hougher' | Hiatus must be restored for metrical reasons; cf. Males (2023a, pp. 265–266). *Háarr*, usually normalised as *Hǫ́arr*, is a name for Weden also found in Scaldic poetry, perhaps < **haiha-harjaʀ* 'one-eyed warrior'. It should not be confused with Weden's names *Hárr* 'Hoary' and *Hór* 'High'.

3 hána | The meter requires the pronoun to have a long syllable.

**21** [R 1v/13, H 20v/7]

Hęiði hétu, · hvar's til húsa kom,
vǫlu vęl-spáa, · vitti ganda;
sęið hǫn hvar's kunni, · sęið hǫn hug lęikinn;
ę́ vas hǫn angan · illrar brúðar.

Hode they called her where to houses she came,
the well-spaeing wallow; she bewitched gands.
She ensorcelled where she could; she ensorcelled deluded minds;
she was always the delight of an evil bride.

1 kom, | *add.* ok **H** 3 hvar's | *so (*'hvars hvn'*)* **H**; *om.* **R** 3 hug | *so* **H**; *om.* **R**

1 Hęiði 'Hode' | Acc. sg. of **Hęiðr* 'bright, splendid'.

2 ganda 'gands' | Familiar spirits. TODO: elaborate.

**22** [R 1v/16, H 20v/9]

Þá gingu regin ǫll · á rǫk-stóla,
ginn-hęilǫg goð, · ok umb þat gętt̄u=sk:
Hvárt skyldu ęsir · af·ráð gjalda,
eða skyldu goð'in ǫll · gildi ęiga?

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:
Whether the Eese should yield tribute
or all the Gods should hold a banquet?

ALL | Sts. 22–23 deal with the obscure war between the Eese and the Wanes, two tribes of supernatural beings. The war is most fully described in *Yng* 4, which also features a long description of the hostages: *Óðinn fór með her á hendr Vǫnum, en þeir urðu vel við ok vǫrðu land sitt, ok hǫfðu ymsir sigr; herjuðu hvárir á land annarra ok gerðu skaða. En er þat leiddi=sk hvárum-tveggjum, lǫgðu þeir milli sín séttar-stefnu, ok gerðu frið ok seldu=sk gíslar.* 'Weden went with a host against the Wanes, but they responded well and defended their land, and both sides had alternating victories; either side raided the land of the other and did harm. But when that seemed loathsome to both sides, they held a conciliatory settlement between them and made peace and traded hostages.'

The war is also alluded to in *Gylf* 23:6 (edited in the pres. ed. under *Eddbr* II), which mentions how Nearth was one of the hostages sent by the Wanes, and *Skm* 5, which explains the origin of the Mead of Poetry (for which cf. *Háv* 103–110): *Þat váru upp-hǫf til þess, at goð'in hǫfðu ó·sętt við þat folk, er Vanir heita. En þeir lǫgðu með sér frið-stefnu ok settu grið á þá lund, at þeir gengu hvárir-tveggju til eins kers ok spýttu í hráka sínum* 'This was the origin of it, that the Gods had hostile relations with the folk called the Wanes. But they held a peace-settlement amongst each other and made a truce by the following means, that each of them went to a vat and spit their spittle into it.' As the relevant sources (the Prose Edda and *Yng*) are closely related and probably both written by the same author, Snorre, the Eese-Wane war and, indeed, the very existence of the Eese and the Wanes as distinct tribes (rather than synonyms for the Gods as a collective) has been argued by Simek (2010) to be a Snorronean concoction, as part of that author's learned pre-history of Scandinavia. This argument is supported by the analysis of Frog and Roper (2011), who show that the ON term *vanir* 'Wanes' is used only in Eddic poetry—not Scaldic—and, at that, exclusively in alliterative positions. Even so, a straightforward reading of *Vsp* 33/3–4 does see the *vanir* 'Wanes' breaking down the fortification of the *ęsir* 'Eese'. When we compare this with *Vafþ* 38–39, which explicitly contrasts the Wanes and the Eese, the two do in fact seem to be distinct groups also in the Poetic Edda. One point of nuance does remain: as pointed out by Frog (2021), the term *ǫss* 'Os', although turned into the name of a tribe by Snorre ('the Eese'), is originally likely nothing other than an animate poetic synonym for the neutral *goð* 'god'. In fact, even in most of our sources dealing with the Eese-Wane war, the former are described as *goð* 'Gods', which does not encompass the Wanes (so *Vafþ* 39, *Skm* 5, *Gylf* 23:6). A counterpoint to this argument is, however, that 'all the Gods' in l. 4 does seem to include both Eese and Wanes.

4 goð'in ǫll 'all the Gods' | The clitic definite *-in* is very rare in older ON poetry. This is its only occurrence in *Vsp*, but it should be understood in the context of its preceding the adjective *ǫll*, so that it is not in fact a true definite (cf. *Lok* 52/4). — Here all the Gods (viz., the Eese *and* the Wanes) seem to be contrasted with the Eese; cf. note to ALL above.

**23** [R 1v/17, H 20v/11]

Flęygði Óðinn · ok ǐ folk of skaut;
2 þat vas ęnn folk-víg · fyrr ǐ hęimi;
brotinn vas borð-vęggr · borgar åsa,
4 knǫ́ttu vanir víg-spǫ́ · vǫllu sporna.

Weden hurled and shot into the troop;
that was yet a troop-conflict earlier in the Home.
Broken was the plank-wall of the stronghold of the Eese;
the Wanes by a war-spae did tread the fields.

2 fyrr 'earlier' | *so* **H**; fyrst *'first'* **R**

1 Flęygði Óðinn · ok ǐ folk of skaut 'Weden hurled and shot into the troop' | The object, a spear, is understood. — This first spear-throw was ritually reenacted during battle, so *Eb* 44: *þá skaut Stein-þórr spjóti at fornum sið til heilla sér yfir flokk Snorra* 'then Stanthur shot a spear according to ancient custom for his fortune over Snorre's troop' and *Styrb* 2, where the Swedish king Eric devotes himself as a sacrifice within a period of ten years in exchange for victory. In return, Weden gives him a reed and tells him to hurl it into the opposing host with the phrase *Óðinn á yðr alla* 'Weden owns you all!' Eric does so, and the reed turns into a spear in the air (for this motif cf. *Gautr* 7 as summarized in *Háv* 138 n.). As it flies over his foes they are stricken by terror and blindness before being buried in a landslide.

It was customary among the Germanic pagans that the battle-slain (*valr*) were devoted to Weden; cf. Þhorn *Harkv* 12 (SkP 1): *Valr lá þar á sandi · vitinn inum ęin-ęygja // Friggjar faðm-byggvi* 'The slain lay there on the sand set apart for the one-eyed bosom-dweller [HUSBAND] of Frie [= Weden]'. The consecration could also be done as a thank-offering after a victory, as in *Heiðr* 7: *Heið·rekr kveð=sk nú gjalda fyrir son sinn þetta lið allt, er drepit var, ok gaf hann nú þennan val Óðni* 'Heathric now declares that he, in exchange for his son['s life], pays up the whole part of the army which was killed, and he now gave these battle-slain to Weden.' In the afterlife these men would join the god as Oneharriers in Walhall (cf. *Grm* 14, *Hárb* 24, runic inscription N B380 edited below under Galders). The sacrifice also included captives, which were at times executed by hanging (*Háv* 138 n.) and which may be the reason why Weden is also called *Hapta·guð* 'God of Captives' (*Gylf* 20:10). As seen below, even the weapons of the vanquished were part of the sacrifice.

This type of devotion of an entire army was not uncommon in Germanic antiquity and is securely attested in both history and archaeology. Among historical sources I particularly wish to mention Orosius, *History* 5.16.5–6, describing the battle of Arausio fought in 105 BC between the Romans and the Germanic tribes of the Cimbri and Teutons: "After capturing the two Roman camps and a vast amount of booty, the enemy destroyed everything that they had laid their hands on in some new, unexpected form of curse. 6 Clothing was ripped up and discarded, gold and silver thrown into the river, the men's armour was torn apart, the horses' harness scattered and the horses themselves drowned in the river, while the men had nooses tied round their necks and were hanged from trees. In this way the victor knew no booty nor the vanquished any mercy." (Orosius 2010, p. 235).

The most relevant archaeological finds are the various Northern European bogs and wetlands where horses and arms, presumably belonging to defeated foes, have been mutilated and defaced (e.g. by whipping the horses, bending the swords) before their submersion. This defacing is to be explained by the fact that the objects, having been devoted and made holy unto the god, had to be made materially worthless and unusable to men, thereby releasing their inherent worldly power. This is confirmed by Tacitus, *Annals* 13.57 who describes how the Chatti, *victores diversam aciem Marti ac Mercurio sacravere, quo voto equi, viri, cuncta occidioni dantur* 'had devoted, in the event of victory, the enemy's army to Mars and Mercury, a vow which consigns horses, men, everything indeed (on the vanquished side) to destruction.' For Germanic devotional sacrifice cf. further Schjødt (2020b, p. 617), Schjødt (2020a, pp. 1166–1168), for bog burials cf. *Vsp* 38 n. below, for human sacrifice to Weden generally cf. *Háv* 138 n.

Outside of the Germanic sphere similar customs of holy war were practiced among the Romans (Latin *devotio*), as told in cf. Livy 8.9–10 where the Roman consul of 340 BC, Publius Decius Mus, (like king Eric in *Styrb*) devotes not just the opposing legions but also himself, although Livy comments that this self-devotion was not strictly necessary for the ritual. Similarly, the Jews, as part of their martial rites (Hebrew חֵרֶם *ḥērem*; Lohfink 1986), would devote entire cities or nations to YHWH (Deuteronomy 20:16–17, Joshua 6:17–21, Joshua 8:1–29; note in Joshua 8:18 the detail of the god-given spear that leads to victory), after which, like in the Germanic bog deposits, also the arms and property of the vanquished were to be destroyed or set aside for the god (Leviticus 27:28–29).

2 fyrr 'earlier' | The **R** reading can hardly be correct, as this st. is describing a different war than the first (that of st. 20); it has probably arisen due to the similarity with st. 20/1.

3 borð-vęggr 'plank-wall' | A dis legomenon in the Old Norse corpus; its only other occurrence is in Þloft *Glækv* 6 (SkP 1) from ca. 1032, where it describes some kind of wooden structure in which church-bells ring, probably a part of a stave-church. I take it to refer to the wooden fortification of the stronghold of the Eese, i.e., Osyard. Cf. note to st. 24.

4 víg-spǫ́ 'war-spae' | The Wanes used a magic prophecy (*spǫ́* 'spae') to win the battle and sack Osyard, the stronghold of the Eese.

**24** Þá gingu rękin ǫll · á rǫk-stóla,
2 ginn-hęilǫg goð, · ok umb þat gętt=sk:
Hvęrr hęfði lopt alt · lęvi blandit
4 eða ętt jǫtuns · Óðs męy gefna?

[**R** 1v/19, **H** 20r/34, **S** 10v/25, **T** 11r/32, **W** 13v/16, **U** 13r/16]

Then went all the Reins onto their council-seats:
the yin-holy Gods, and from each other took counsel of this:
Who had blended all the air with deceit,
or to the ettin's lineage given Wode's maiden [= Frow]?

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ALL | After the wooden stronghold of the Eese, protected only by a plank-wall (*borð-vęggr*), has been sacked by the Wanes, they decide to build stronger fortifications. This leads into their encounter with the Master Builder, as told at length in the following way in *Gylf* 42, which concludes by citing *Vsp* 24–25: An ettin craftsman arrives at Osyard and offers to build the Eese a great wall in exchange for Frow's hand and the Sun and Moon. He further promises that he will finish the entire wall alone over a single winter—otherwise the contract will be void. This seems reasonable to the Eese, who assume that he cannot possibly finish it in time, but things go awry when the ettin asks for permission to have the help of his workhorse Swaddlefare. Lock grants him this in secret, without first consulting the other Gods, after which the agreement is sealed with strong oaths. The horse turns out to be unexpectedly strong, and when only three days remain before the start of summer, the wall is almost finished. The panicked Eese blame Lock and threaten him with violence if he does not get rid of the horse. His solution is to turn into a mare and distract the stallion. The trick works, and the two stay out all night; Lock is made pregnant, later giving birth to Slopner. When the ettin realises that he has been tricked, he comes into his greatest ettin wrath, at which point the Eese call on Thunder; the god soon appears and kills him.

4 Óðs męy 'Wode's maiden [= Frow]' | According to *Gylf* 35:7 and *Skm* 28, 44 *Óðr* 'Wode' (not to be confused with *Óðinn* 'Weden') was Frow's husband. — The ettins seem to have a particular obsession with abducting Frow, as seen also in *Þrk* 8. This may be explained if Frow is the Indo-European dawn-goddess, something suggested not only by her association with the Sun and Moon in the Master Builder myth, but also by her weeping of golden tears (*Gylf* 35:9, *Skm* 40, 44; possibly a poetic description of the dawn), her epithet Meredall (*Mar·dǫll* 'Sea-brilliant', another likely poetic description; for the second element see *Vafþ* 25), and her possession of the fire-symbolic Blaze-Necklace (*brísinga-męn*, cf. *Þrk* 13/3 n.).
For the attempted theft of the sun and moon we may compare *Kalevala* (songs 47–49), where the evil witch *Loubi* of the Underworld steals the sun, moon, and fire and thereby deprives the world of its light; for further Finnic parallels cf. the Introduction to *Þrk*. The attempted abduction of the Dawn has a more distant parallel in the Vedic *Valá*-myth (part of which is told in *ṚV* 10.108; Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70, 71). In that myth the enemies of the Gods, the *Paṇi*-s, hide the Dawns in the form of kine in the *Valá*-cave and thereby prevent the natural cycle between Night and Day. With his great song the Storm-god *Índra* breaks open the cave, killing *Valá* and releasing the dawns. The common thread in these narratives is the fear that evil forces will steal away the light and warmth of the world, which in the Norse mythology reflects itself as the Fimblewinter, for which cf. *Vafþ* 44/3–4 n.

**25** [R 1v/20, H 20r/36, S 10v/27, T 11r/34, W 13v/17, U 13r/18]

Þórr ęinn þar vá · þrunginn móði,
hann sjaldan sitr · es s·líkt of fregn;
á gingu=sk ęiðar, · orð ok søri,
mǫl ǫll męgin=lig, · es á meðal fóru.

Thunder alone fought there, urged by wrath;
he seldom sits when of such he learns.
Trampled were oaths, speeches, and vows,
all the mighty treaties which between them had gone.

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ALL | *The order of the lines follows* **RH**; *the two helmings are reversed (i.e., 3–4, 1–2) in* **G**. 1 þar vá 'fought there' | *so* **HTU**; þar var *'was there'* **R**; þat vann *'accomplished it'* **S**; þat vá *'fought it out'* **W** 3–4 á ... fóru. | *om.* **W** 4 fóru 'had gone' | vǫru *'had been'* **HT**

2 hann sjaldan sitr · es s·líkt of fregn; 'he seldom sits when of such he learns' | When he learns of an ettin encroaching on the Gods (see note to st. 24). Thunder, as the defender of the Gods (*Þrk* 18, Þdís *Þórr* in SkP 3), is willing to break even the strongest oaths if the safety of the Gods require it (cf. *Lok* 57–64).

**26** Vęit hǫn Hęim·dalar · hljóð of folgit [R 1v/23, H 20v/1]
2 und hęið-vǫnum · hęlgum baðmi;
à sér hǫn ausa=sk · aurgum forsi
4 af vęði Val-fǫðrs. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

She knows Homedall's sound [= Yellhorn] hidden
beneath the shady, holy tree [= the Ash of Ugdrassle].
She sees it being sprinkled with a muddy torrent
from Walfather's pledge [= the Well of Mimer]. *Know ye yet, or what?*

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ALL | The purpose of the stanza is quite obscure, but it appears to describe cryptically the Well of Mimer, into which Weden deposited his eye. Cf. *Gylf* 15:10–13, which talks about one of the roots of the Ash of Ugdrassle: *En undir þeiri rót, er til hrím-þursa horfir, þar er Mimis-brunnr, er spekð ok mann-vit er í folgit, ok heitir sá Mimir, er á brunn'inn. Hann er fullr af vísendum, fyrir því at hann drekkr ór brunni'num af horni'nu Gjallar-horni. Þar kom Al-fǫðr ok beiddi=sk eins drykkjar af brunni'num, en hann fekk eigi, fyrr en hann lagði auga sitt at veði.* 'But enclosed by the root which turns towards the Rime-Thurses there is the Well of Mimer. Wisdom and manwit are hidden within, and he who owns the well is called Mimer. He is full of wise sayings, for he drinks from the Well out of the horn Yellhorn. Thither Allfather came and asked for a single drink from the well, but He did not get it until He laid down his eye as a pledge.' Immediately after this passage *Gylf* 15:14 quotes st. 28; cf. there.

1 Hęim·dalar · hljóð 'Homedall's sound' | Interpreted by Snorre (see note to ALL) as the Yellhorn, for which cf. st. 45 below.

2 hęið-vǫnum 'shady' | Literally 'light-less', *hęiðr* referring especially to the light of a clear sky.

3–4 à ... Val-fǫðrs 'She sees ... pledge' | The interpretation of these lines is ambiguous, as *'á'* **R**, *'aa'* **H** can be read either (1) as the preposition *á* 'on' or (2) as the noun *ǫ́* 'river'. In the latter case, the lines would mean "She sees a river being fed by a muddy torrent from Walfather's pledge". Note that this ambiguity is not intentional, since the distinction between nasal and oral vowels and between long *á* and *ǫ́* was still upheld in the 12th century (*FGT* 1950). (1) is adopted here since it is clearly the interpretation preferred by Snorre, who, in his prose, has the Norns *ausa* 'sprinkle, pour' *aur'inn* 'the mud' over the ash (*Gylf* 16:10–11, cited in st. 19 n. above). Since Snorre's version of the poem may theoretically have preserved the distinction, and since he was a native speaker of the language, his opinion is deferred to.

3 aurgum 'muddy' | Most likely the same mud (*aurr*) as in st. 19, there said of the Well of Weird.

4 vęði Val-fǫðrs 'Walfather's pledge' | Weden's eye, which he gave up in exchange for a sip from the Well.

4 Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat? 'Know ye yet, or what?' | I.e., 'Do you, Weden, still know what I am saying, or what more do you want?' The second refrain (*stęf*) of the poem, repeated in 28, 33, 34, 38, 40, 46, 59, and 60. Similar refrains are found in *Bdr* 7/4 etc., *Hdl* 17/4 etc.

**27** Ęin sat hǫn úti, · þá's hinn aldni kom [R 1v/25]
2 Yggjungr ása · ok í augu lęit:
[Vǫlva:] ‚Hvęrs fregnið mik? · hví fręistið mín?

Alone she sat outside when the Olden One came,
the Frightener of the Eese [= Weden], and looked into her eyes.
[The wallow:] ‘Of what ask ye me? Why tempt ye me?

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ALL | Stanzas 27–29 appear to relate how the wallow was summoned by Weden.

1 Ęin sat hǫn úti ‘Alone she sat outside’ | ON *sitja úti* ‘sit outside’ has a cultural connotation of meditating in order to communicate with the otherworld; cf. the noun *úti-seta*. — This line is directly repeated in *Sigsk* 6/1a.

2 Yggjungr åsa ‘the Frightener of the Eese [= Weden]’ | To be understood as ‘the Frightener among the Eese’, i.e., ‘the Terrifying God’. Cf. the expression *Åsa-Þórr* ‘Thunder of the Eese’, and Weden’s name *Yggr* ‘Ug’, from the same root.

3 fręistið ‘tempt’ | *fręista* ‘tempt’ has a sense of testing someone, especially intellectually. Cf. *Háv* 26, *Vafþ* 3, 5.

**28**

Alt vęit’k, Óðinn, · hvar auga falt
ĭ inum męra · Mĭmis brunni;‘
drekkr mjǫð Mĭmir · morgin hvęrjan
af vęði Val-fǫðrs. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[**R** 1v/26, **S** 4v/27, **T** 5r/33, **W** 8r/7, **U** 6r/22]

I know fully, Weden, where thine eye thou hidst
in the famed Well of Mimer!’
Mimer drinks mead every morning
from Walfather’s pledge. *Know ye yet, or what?*

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1 falt | *add., but marked with erasure dots* þitt **R** 2 ĭ inum męra ‘in the famed’ | *so* **RW**; í þeim enom meira *‘in the greater’* **T**; i þeim enum męra *‘in the famed’* **U**; úr þeim enum męra *‘out of the famed’* **S** 4 vęði ‘pledge’ | †veiði† **S**

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ALL | This st. is quoted in *Gylf* 15:14, introduced by the words *svá segir í Vǫlu-spá:* ‘so it says in the Spae of the Wallow’. For the immediately preceding prose description of the Well of Mimer (*Gylf* 15:10–13), see note to st. 26 above.

3 Mĭmir ‘Mimer’ | A strange figure. According to *Yng* 4 (cf. sts. 7/3 n., 22 ALL n.), Mimer was originally the wisest of the Eese. He was sent alongside the god Heener as a hostage to the Wanes, but after the Wanes discovered that Heener could only rely on Mimer’s counsel during important deliberations, they beheaded Mimer and sent his head back to the Eese. The god Weden then mummified the head by means of herbs and sang galders over it to bring it back to life. Thereafter Weden brought the head with him as a companion, “and it told him many hidden things”. This myth seems to be what is alluded to in st. 45/4 below and likewise in *Sigrdr* 14/3. According to *Gylf* 15:10–13 (note to st. 26 above), Mimer was the owner of a Well which brought wisdom to whomever drank out of it. For Mimer’s role

**29**

Valði hęnni Hęr-fǫðr · hringa ok męn,
fe*kk* spjǫll spak=lig · ok spá-ganda;
sá vítt ok of vítt · umb ver-ǫld hvęrja.

[**R** 1v/29]

Host-Father chose for her rings and necklaces;
he got foresighted tidings and spae-gands—
she saw far and yet further through every world.

2 fe*kk* spjǫll spak▫lig ‘got foreseen tidings’ | *emend.;* ‘fe spioll spaclig’ **R**

2 fe*kk* spjǫll spak▫lig ‘got foreseen tidings’ | The reading of **R** may be interpreted either as (1) *fé▫spjǫll spak▫lig* ‘foresighted wealth-tidings’ or (2) *fé, spjǫll spak▫lig* ‘wealth, foresighted tidings’. Both are metrically deficient; (1) since a second element in a cpd. like *fé▫spjǫll* cannot carry alliteration, and (2) since it has three strongly stressed nominals. In both cases the first nominal *fé* would be metrically expected to carry the alliteration. The word *fé* ‘wealth, cattle’ also makes little sense in context, since there is no transaction; Weden would be giving her expensive golden jewellery, of which he himself has no lack, in exchange for more gold. The emendation replaces *fé* with the verb *fekk* ‘got, received’. Verbs carry less stress than nominals, and the line thus becomes metrically equivalent to 28/3b *drekkr mjǫð Mímir*. Semantically we get a parallel to st. 1, where the wallow likewise says that she will relate *spjǫll* ‘tidings, sayings’ (cf. English *gospel*, lit. ‘good news’ which originally translates the Greek εὐαγγέλιον). For further discussion on the metrics see Haukur Þorgeirsson (2020, pp. 51–53), Males (2023b, p. 16).

2 spá-ganda ‘spae-gands’ | Spirits (familiars, gands; cf. st. 21/2 above) sent out in order to gather hidden wisdom.

**30** Sá hǫn val-kyrjur · vítt of komnar, [R 1v/30]
gǫrvar at ríða · til goð-þjóðar:
Skuld hélt skildi, · ęn Skǫgul ǫnnur,
Gunnr, Hildr, Gǫndul · ok Gęir-skǫgul;
nú eru talðar · Nǫnnur Hęrjans,
gǫrvar at ríða · grund, val-kyrjur.

She saw Walkirries come from afar,
ready to ride to the folk of men.
Shild held a shield and Shagle another,
Guth, Hild, Gandle and Goreshagle—
now are tallied the Nans of Harn ⟨= Weden⟩,
Walkirries ready to ride o’er the earth.

2 goð-þjóðar ‘folk of men’ | The sense is uncertain, for in **R** the difficult cluster *tþ* in *got-þjóð* (attested with *-t-* in *Heiðr* st. 94/8b, SkP 8) has been changed to *ðþ*. This means that the word *goð-þjóð* may contain either (1) *goti* ‘Got, man’ (thus ‘folk of the Gots’ or ‘folk of men’) or (2) *goð* (‘folk of the Gods’). Of these two alternatives, the element *goti* in the sense ‘man’ is preferable, since the walkirries are presumably thought to be gathered in Walhall, ready to fly out into the world of men in order to attend battles and claim the best warriors for Weden (cf. *Hákm* 1). The present reading thus sees the cpd. as semantically identical to *ver-þjóð* ‘folk of men’, *Lok* 24/3. The Walkirries do also have a particular association with the Gots, who were remembered as having fought the greatest battles of the Migration Period (cf. note to *Vkv* 1/1). For the formally identical *Gót-þjóð* ‘folk, land of the Gots’ see *Helr* 8/1 n.

3–6 Skuld ... val-kyrjur. ‘Shild ... earth.’ | Judging especially by the phrase *nú eru talðar* ‘now are tallied’, these four lines seem to be a later insert from a thule counting the Walkirries.

5 Nǫnnur Hęrjans ‘Nans of Harn ⟨= Weden⟩’ | *Nanna* ‘Nan’ (the name itself is a nursery word) was the wife of Balder, but the word is here certainly being used to refer generically to ‘maidens, women’. Cf. Þul *Ásynja* (SkP 3), where the Walkirries are kenned *Óðins męyjar* ‘Weden’s maidens’.

**31** Ek sá Baldri, · blóðgum tífur, [R 2r/2]
Óðins barni, · ør·lǫg folgin;

stóð of vaxinn · vǫllu*m* hęri
mjór ok mjǫk fagr · mistil-tęinn.

I saw Balder's, the bloody victim's,
Weden's child's orlay hid:
there stood grown higher than the plains
a slender and most fair mistletoe.

3 vǫllu*m* | vǫllu *(with omitted abbreviation mark for* -m*)* **R**

ALL | Told allusively in sts. 31–33 is the myth about Balder's death. The outline of this myth is as follows: Balder, the son of Weden and Frie, was killed by a mistletoe shot by his blind half-brother Hath, whose hand was guided by Lock. As Balder's father, it was Weden's duty to avenge him, yet he could not kill Hath who was also his son. Weden thus devised a plan and through sorcery seduced the woman Wrind (so KormQ *Sigdr* 3, SkP 3: *sęið Yggr til Rindar* 'Ug won Wrind through sorcery'). Wrind gave birth to Wonnel, who grew up fast, and after just one day was big enough to kill Hath and avenge Balder.

Other sources for Balder's death include the poems *Bdr* 8–11, *Lok* 28, and *Hdl* 28 and the prose texts *Gylf* 49 and Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4.1–8. For the punishment of Lock for his role in the killing see sts. 34 and H31 below along with *Lok* P8.

The most similar text to *Vsp* 31–33 is *Bdr* 8–11, with which it is clearly textually related (cf. st. 32/4 n.). The chief narrative difference between the two passages is that *Bdr* 11/1 mentions Wrind, who is not found in *Vsp*.

Balder's death is treated at greater length in *Gylf* 49:3–25, which may be briefly summarised as follows: Balder has terrible nightmares about his own death, and so his mother Frie makes all sorts of things (fire, water, venom, metals, stones, trees, diseases, animals) swear oaths not to harm him. After this, the Eese make sport of shooting and cutting him since he cannot be harmed. Lock is annoyed by the spectacle and tricks Frie into telling him that there was one thing that did not swear the oath—the mistletoe, which was thought too young. Lock makes a mistletoe-arrow and gives it to the blind god Hath, guiding his hand towards Balder. Hath shoots and Balder dies. After this, *Gylf* 49 describes Balder's funeral, treated poetically in *Húsdr*, at some length, alongside how the Eese failed to "weep Balder out of hell" (see *Eddbr* V). The binding of Lock is described in *Gylf* 50 (cf. st. 34 below). Most notably, *Gylf* 49 neglects to mention both Wonnel and Wrind. That part of the myth may have been left out of the Prose Edda for moral reasons due to its motifs of rape and kinslaying, but that it was known to the author is proven by two passages: *Gylf* 30:1–2: *Áli eða Váli heitir einn, sonr Óðins ok Rindar. Hann er djarfr í orrostum ok mjǫk happ-skeytr.* 'Onnel or Wonnel is the name of one, the son of Weden and Wrind. He is brave in battles and a very lucky shot.' *Skm* 19: *Hvernig skal kenna Vála? Svá, at kalla hann son Óðins ok Rindar,* […] *hefni-ǫ́s Baldrs, dólg Haðar ok bana hans* […] 'How shall one ken Wonnel? Namely, by calling him the son of Weden and Wrind, […] avenging os of Balder, the foe of Hath and his bane […]'

The other lengthy prose retelling of the myth is Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4, which relates the revenge narrative in typical euhemerized form, turning the gods Hath and Balder into flawed human rulers. The outline of that version is as follows: After Balder (Latin *Balderus*) has succumbed to a mortal wound dealt to him by Hath (*Høtherus*) with a treacherous sword, his father Weden (*Othinus*) takes counsel from a group of wizards. One of them, Horsethief the Finn (*Rostiophus Phinnicus*), foresees that Wrind (*Rinda*), daughter of the Russian king, will bear him a son to avenge Balder.

Weden soon enlists in the Russian king's army and leads it to great victories, but he is spurned by his daughter. He tries various disguises but is continually refused, until at last he disguises himself as an old witch and volunteers himself as her private physician. When Wrind becomes ill, he binds her, ostensibly in order to administer a certain foul potion, but instead rapes her, implicitly with her father's consent. Their son Bo grows up to become a fierce raider. One day Weden summons him and reminds him of his duty to avenge his half-brother Balder; Bo slays Hath in a fierce duel but soon himself perishes from his wounds. It is worth noting that the seduction of Wrind as told by Saxo Grammaticus is unlikely to be a fantasy of that author, but on the contrary seems to derive from a now-lost West Norse source. The narrative bears a particular structural resemblance to Shirner's coercion of Gird in *Skí* 19–36; see further *Skí* 19 n., Brate (1913).

1 tífur ‘victim’s’ | This word is rather difficult and possibly corrupt. (1) It has been connected with *týr* ‘tew, god’, but the dat. sg. of *týr* is *tívi* and the intrusive *r* is unexplained. (2) A better explanation is given by CV, which connects it with OE *tiber, tifer* ‘victim, hostage’, but this also has problems. *blóðgum* ‘bloody’ is m. dat. sg., but OE *tiber* is neuter. If we are dealing with a m. noun **tífurr* with the same declension as *jǫfurr*, we would expect dat. sg. **tífri*— not *tífur* (which would, however, be the expected acc. sg.).

2 folgin ‘hid’ | The sense is either that it is Balder’s orlay to be hid, that is, in the Underworld, whither he goes after his death (see *Eddbr* V), or that his orlay is metaphorically sealed and unalterable. The verb *fela* ‘hide, conceal’, of which *folgin* is the n. acc. pl. past participle, is used in poetry to describe burial in mounds, as in *Yt* 24 (“[...] And afterwards the victory-raisers hid (*fólu*) the ruler on Borrey”) and the 10th c. Karlevi runestone (Öl 1, ed. below under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland).

**32** Varð af męiði, · þęim’s mjór sỳndi=sk, [R 2r/4]
harm-flaug hętt̨lig, · Hǫðr nam skjóta.
Baldrs bróðir vas · of borinn snimma,
sá nam, Óðins sonr, · ęin-nętt̨r vega.

There came from that tree which looked so slender
a baneful harm-flier—Hath took to shoot.
Balder’s brother [= Wonnel] was born early;
he took, Weden’s son, one night old, to fight.

4 sá nam, Óðins sonr, · ęin-nętt̨r vega | The three lines making up *Vsp* 32/4–33/2 are found near-identically (but with different tense) as *Bdr* 11/2–4. The direction of influence is unclear, since both poems appear fairly old. It is also plausible that both are borrowing from a now-lost third source dealing with Balder’s death; that such a text must have existed is proven by the stanza in *Eddbr* V.

**33** Þó ęva hęndr · né hǫfuð kęmði, [R 2r/6]
áðr á bál of bar · Baldrs and·skota;
ęn Frigg of grét · í Fęn-sǫlum
vǫ́ Val-hallar. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

He ne’er washed his hands nor combed his head
before onto the pyre he bore Balder’s opponent [= Hath],
but Frie lamented in the Fenhalls
the woe of Walhall. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1–2 Þó ... and·skota ‘He washed ... opponent’ | Found near-identically in *Bdr* 11/3–4; see note to st. 32/4 above.

1 Þó ... kęmði ‘washed ... combed’ | A collocation; see note to *Háv* 61 for discussion and other examples. Wonnel, being bound by the sworn mission to avenge his brother, could not engage in such acts of personal vanity. For the motif of a warrior bound not to engage in acts of personal hygiene until having fulfilled a vow we may compare the famous vow of Harold Fairhair, *at aldri* [...] *skera hár mitt né kemba, fyrr en ek hefi eignat=sk allan Nóreg með skǫttum ok skyldum ok for·ráði, en deyja at ǫðrum kosti.* ‘never to cut my hair nor comb it before I have come to own all of Norway with taxation and duties and stewardship, but to die otherwise.’ (*Haralds saga ins hár-fagra*, 4).

3 Fęn-sǫlum ‘the Fenhalls’ | Never mentioned elsewhere in poetry, but *Gylf* 35:1–2 explains: *Þá męlti Gangleri: „Hverjar eru ósynjurnar?“ Hárr segir: „Frigg er óðst. Hon á þann bú, er Fen-salir heita, ok er hann all-veg-liga.* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “Which are the Ossens?” High says: “Frie is the noblest. She owns the dwelling which is called the Fenhalls, and it is all glorious. [...]”’

4 vǫ Val-hallar ‘the woe of Walhall’ | The deaths of two sons: Balder and Hath.

**34** [R 2r/8, H 20v/13]

Hapt sá hǫn liggja · und Hvera-lundi
lę́-gjarns líki · Loka à·þękkjan;
þar sitr Sigyn · þey=gi of sínum
veri vęl-glýjuð. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

She saw a prisoner lying beneath Wharlund,
recognisable in the shape of the guile-eager Lock.
There Syein sits, not at all cheerful,
o’er her husband. *Know ye yet, or what?*

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1–2 Hapt ... à·þękkjan ‘A captive ... Lock’ | *om. and replaced by H31* **H**. 2 lę́-gjarns | *gramm. emend.;* lę́-gjarn *(nom. sg.)* **R**

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ALL | After Balder was avenged, the Eese went to catch his true killer, Lock, as told in *Lok* P8 and *Gylf* 50:3–25. They bound him with his own son’s intestines; to punish him further, a snake was hung above his face to drool venom onto it. His wife, Syein, sat over him and collected the venom in a small basin, but when she had to empty it, he writhed so furiously from the pain of the acidic venom that the earth shook.

1–2 Hapt ... à·þękkjan ‘A captive ... Lock’ | The grammar of the first two lines is not easy to decipher; in prose word order I take it as *Hǫn sá hapt liggja und Hvera-lundi, á·þękkjan líki lę́-gjarns Loka*, where *líki* is the dat. sg. of the n. noun *líki* ‘shape, likeness’.

2 lę́-gjarns ‘guile-eager’ | An epithet of Lock, who is strongly associated with *lę́* ‘guile, deceit’. His name also occurs paired with the adjective *lę́-viss* ‘guile-wise’, so *Hym* 37/4, *Lok* 54/5, and *Sǫrla* 2.

**35** [R 2r/10]

Ǫ́ fęllr austan · umb Ęitr-dala
sǫxum ok sverðum, · Slíðr hęitir sú.

A river falls from the east through the Atterdales,
[a river] of saxes and swords; Slide it is called.

---

ALL | Having recounted the death of Balder and the binding of Lock, the wallow moves on to describing the places of evil in the world (sts. 35–41). The world has lost its innocence and the forces of chaos and disorder in the east and north plot its destruction. The present stanza is somewhat obscure, likely because half of it is missing. It is not in any way alluded to in *Gylf*, nor is it found in **H**. The river Slide is also mentioned in the long list of rivers in *Grm* 28/4.

2 Slíðr ‘Slide’ | An adjective describing a blade so sharp that the finger is cut when slid across it. Cf. *Akv* 23: *saxi slíðr-bętitu* (dat. sg.) ‘slide-biting sax’.

**36** [R 2r/11]

Stóð fyr norðan · à Niða-vǫllum
salr ór golli · Sindra ętt ar;

ęn annarr stóð · à Ǫ́·kólni,
bjór-salr jǫtuns, · ęn sá Brimir hęitir.

To the north on the Nithwolds stood
a golden hall, of Sinder's lineage [DWARFS],
but another one stood on Uncolner,
an ettin's beer-hall, and he/it is called Brimmer.

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ALL | Sts. 36–38 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 52:1–10, describing the world after its destruction and rebirth:
*Þá mélti Gangleri: „Hvat verðr þá eptir, er brenndr er himinn ok jǫrð ok heimr allr, ok dauð goð'in ǫll ok allir Ein-herjar ok alt mann-folk, ok hafið ér áðr sagt, at hverr maðr skal lifa í nǫkkvǫrum heimi um allar aldir?" Þá svarar Þriði: „Margar eru þá vistir góðar ok margar illar; batst er þá at vera á Gim·léi á himni, ok all-gótt er til góðs drykkjar þeim, er þat þykkir gaman, í þeim sal, er Brimir heitir; hann stendr ok á himni. Sá er ok góðr salr, er stendr á Niða-fjǫllum, gǫrr af rauðu gulli; sá heitir Sindri. Í þessum sǫlum skulu byggja góðir menn ok sið-látir. Á Ná-strǫndum er mikill salr ok illr ok horfa norðr dyrr; hann er ok ofinn allr orma-hryggjum sem vanda-hús, en orma hǫfuð ǫll vitu inn í hús'it ok blása eitri, svá at eptir sal'num renna eitr-ár, ok vaða þér ár eið-rofar ok morð-vargar, svá sem hér segir:"*
'Then spoke Gangler: "What will then happen thereafter when the heaven and the earth and the whole world are burned, and the Gods all are dead and all the Oneharriers and all man-kind—and [yet] ye have said earlier that every man will live in a certain home for all ages?" Then answers Third: "Many good dwellings are there then, and many evil ones; then it is best to be in Gemlee in the heaven. And in the hall which is called Brimmer it is fully furnished with good drink for those who find it pleasurable; that one also stands on the heaven. Another good hall is the one which stands on the Nithfells, made out of red gold; it is called Sinder. In these halls shall dwell good and virtuous men. On Neestrand there is a great hall and evil, and its doors face north. It is all interlaced with the spines of serpents like a wicker-house, but the heads of the serpents all face into the house and blow venom so that there run through the hall rivers of venom, and in those rivers wade oath-breakers and murder-wargs, just as it says here:"'
After this passage *Gylf* cites sts. 37 and 38/1–2, followed by the prose: *En í Hver-gelmi er verst* 'But in Wharyelmer it is the worst', and a citation of st. 38/4.
It ought to be noted that the placement and contents of sts. 36–38 in *Vsp* itself strongly point against their being descriptions of the cosmology of the world to come. That interpretation instead seems to be one of Snorre's own inventions, as is further supported by the grammatical form *męin-svara* in st. 38/2 (n.).

1 Niða-vǫllum 'Nithwolds' | 'The dark plains'. The paraphrase of this st. in *Gylf* 52:6 suggests that the version of *Vsp* used by Snorre had the reading **Niða-fjǫllum* 'Nithfells' (cf. st. 62). The first element is, in any case, *nið* 'the waning of the moon' and refers to great darkness; cf. the adjective *niða-myrkr* 'pitch darkness'.

4 ęn sá Brimir hęitir 'and he/it is called Brimmer' | It is syntactically ambiguous whether Brimmer is the name of the ettin or the hall itself. *Gylf* 52:5 clearly considers it the name of the hall.

**37** Sal sá hǫn standa · sólu fjarri
Ná-strǫndu à, · norðr horfa dyrr;
falla ęitr-dropar · inn umb ljóra,
sá 's undinn salr · orma hryggjum.

[**R** 2r/13, **H** 20v/19, **S** 17v/1, **T** 6r/16, **W** 19v/32, **U** 18v/19]

A hall she saw standing far from the sun
on Neestrand; north face its doors.
Venom-drops fall in through its smoke-vent;
that hall is wound with the spines of snakes.

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1 sá hǫn 'she saw' | vęit'k *'I know'* **G.**

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ALL | Cited in *Gylf* 52; see note to st. 36 above.

3 ljóra 'smoke-vent' | In the Iron Age Germanic hall, the *ljóri* or louver (likely a borrowing from a Frankish cognate) was a sort of turret in the middle of the roof-ridge, above the central fire, through which smoke would exit and light shine down. This is the only poetic attestation of the word in ON, but it is well represented in prose.

**38**

Sá hǫn þar vaða · þunga strauma
męnn męin-svara · ok morð-varga
ok þann's annars glępr · ęyra-rúnu.
Þar saug Níð·hǫggr · nái fram-gingna;
slęit vargr vera. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[**R** 2r/15, **H** 20v/21, **S** 17v/2, **T** 18r/27, **W** 20r/2, **U** 18v/21]

There she saw wading through heavy streams
false-swearing men and murder-wargs
and him who seduces another man's ear-whisperess [WIFE].
There Nithehewer sucked passed-on corpses;
the warg tore apart men. *Know ye yet, or what?*

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1 Sá hǫn 'she saw' | *so* **R**; sér hǫn *'she sees'* **H**; skulu *'shall [wade]'* **G** 2 męin-svara ok morð--varga | *corr. from* morð-varga męin-svara ok *by an inversion mark in same hand* **R**. 2 męin-svara | męins-vara **R**; męin-svarar **U** 2 morð-varga 'murder-wargs' | morð-vargar *(nom. pl.)* **RSTW**; morðingjar *'murderers'* **U**. 3 ok þann's annars glępr · ęyra-rúnu. | *om.* **G.** 3 ęyra-rúnu | †eyrna runa† **H** 4 saug 'sucked' | *so* **H**; †svg† **R**; kvęlr *'torments'* **G**

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ALL | Ll. 1–2, 4 are cited in *Gylf* 52; see note to st. 36 above. — This st. takes a distinctly moralising tone otherwise rare in pre-Christian Norse poetry; cf. st. 44 below. The crimes are what one might expect in a source from Germanic antiquity: perjury, murder, and adultery. In Scandinavian and Anglo-Saxon laws, the perpetrator of such crimes (commonly termed "nithing's works") held the dishonourable title of nithing, that is, one afflicted with nithe ('evil, shame'), and was thereby stripped of his personal rights as a free man.

For the crimes, we may cf. the list of *ú·dáða-męnn* ('criminals', lit. 'men of misdeeds') not eligible for burial in church grounds according to *Gula* 23: *dróttins-svikar* 'traitors to their lord', *morð-vargar* 'murder-wargs', *trygg-rofar* 'truce-breakers', *þjófar* 'thieves', and those men who *sjalfir spilla ǫnd sinni* 'themselves destroy their spirit', i.e., commit suicide. According to that law, these men were instead to be buried in a *flóðar-mál* 'flood-mark', where *sęr móti=sk ok grón torfa* 'sea and green turf meet' (NGL I, p. 13).

This peculiar tradition of burial in the flood-mark has a clear parallel in the addition to the *Lex Frisionum* 'Law of the Frisians' entitled *De Honore templorum* 'On the Honour of the Temples', which states that if a man *fanum effregerit, et ibi aliquid de sacris tulerit, ducitur ad mare, et in sabulo, quod accessus maris operire solte, finduntur aures eius, et castratur, et immolatur Diis quorum templa violavit.* 'breaks into a shrine and steals sacred items from there, he shall be taken to the sea, and on the sand, which will be covered by the flood, his ears will be cleft, and he will be castrated and sacrified to the god, whose temple he dishonoured.' (*Additio Sapientum* 9:1, Nieuwenhuijsen 2010). Destruction of a temple must clearly be a particularly shameful act, and the castration adds to the social shame of the criminal through the loss of his manhood. Earlier in the Law of the Frisians (5:1), we find a provision for those who can be killed without paying a fine; these are the duellist killed in combat, the adulterer, the underminer of another's house, the arsonist, the destroyer of a shrine, and the infant killed by its mother. With the exception of the final case, these are all cases that classify as "nithing's works" in other Old Germanic laws (cf., e.g., Läffler 1879).

The practice of burying criminals deemed particularly shameful, not just in unhallowed ground, but specifically in bogs and flood-marks, is well attested both in archaeology and in literary sources relating to the Germanic peoples, from Tacitus (*Germania*, ch. 12) onwards. When one puts these parallels together, it is hard not to see the *þungir straumar* 'heavy streams' of the present stanza as a reflex of such customs. In this reading, then, the whole stanza appears to describe a Heathen religious belief about bog burials, namely, that those buried in them were punished by a watery dragon in the afterlife for their crime as nithings. It is fitting that such nithings should be tortured by a creature named Nithehewer (*Níð·hǫggr*, 'Nithe-striker'). For the cosmic impact of this crime, see further note to st. 44 below.
Watery punishment in the afterlife is also described in *Reg* 3–4 and possibly in *Grm* 21, and a perjurious woman is drowned in a bog in *3 Guðr* 10. The argument of this note is pursued at at greater length and with more examples in **RosenbergForthcoming**.

2 męin-svara 'false-swearing' | Acc. pl. of **męin-svari* or **męin-svarr*, an otherwise unattested adj. Related words are *męin-sóri* 'false oath, perjury' and *męin-svari* m. 'perjurer'. This adjective is in the acc. pl. in 3/4 mss. of *Gylf*, but this is grammatically irregular since the **G** version of line 1 has the verb *skulu* 'shall [wade]' which takes a nominative subject. The most likely explanation for this is that Snorre, when quoting the present stanza, deliberately changed the first words of l. 1 from an archetypal **sér/sá hǫ́n* 'she sees/saw' (shared with **RH**) to *skulu* in order to make the poetry fit better with his eschatological interpretation (cf. st. 36 n.). In doing so he overlooked the grammatical form of the object phrase *męnn męin-svara*, probably due to the rarity of the adjective. This has important consequences for our evaluation of Snorre's reliability when citing Eddic verse since it shows an instance of his deliberately changing the wording of a stanza to conform to his prose. Even so, the present instance should probably be considered exceptional, since most other textual variants in Eddic sts. cited in *Gylf* are better explained as resulting from scribal or oral transmission.

2 morð-varga 'murder-wargs' | Men outlawed for murder, which is not all instances of the taking of human life, but specifically when done clandestinely or in ways deemed particularly reproachable.

3 ęyra-rúnu 'ear-whisperess' | Acc. sg. of *ęyra-rúna*, with the second element derived from *rún* 'whisper, secret'; cf. the masculine *(of) rúni* 'friend, confidant', OE *ge·rúna* 'counsellor'. This word is also used in *Háv* 115 which likewise contains a warning not to seduce another man's wife.

4 Níð·hǫggr 'Nithehewer' | Also appearing in st. 62 below and further in *Grm* 36/4.

**39**

Austr býr hin aldna · í *Éa*rn-viði
ok fóðir þar · Fęnris kindir;
verðr af þęim ǫllum · ęinna nøkkurr
tungls tjúgari · í trolls hami.

[**R** 2r/17, **H** 20v/2, **S** 4r/10, **T** 4v/23, **W** 7r/24, **U** 5r/27]

In the east dwells the old hag in Ironwood
and there rears the brood of Fenrer [WOLVES].
Out of them all one becomes—I know not which—
a snatcher of the moon in a troll's hame.

1 býr 'dwells' | *so* **HG**; sat *'sat/stayed'* **R** 1 aldna 'old' | arma *'wretched'* **U** 1 *Éa*rn-viði 'Ironwood' | Járn-viði **RHSWU**; Járn-viðjum *'Ironwoods'* **T** 2 fóðir 'rears' | *so* **HG**; fóddi *'reared'* **R** 3 af | ór **ST** 4 tjúgari 'snatcher' | †tuigan† **T**; tregari *'troubler'* **U**.

ALL | The old hag, who is not identified in any other source, raises the cubs of the wolf Fenrer. One of these wolves, identified by Snorre as Moongarm (*Mána-garmr*), will eventually swallow the moon. For the myth of the wolves that chase the sun and moon cf. *Grm* 40, according to which the sun is chased by the wolf Sholl, while another wolf, Hate, runs in front of it, and *Vafþ* 46–47, where the sun is said to be swallowed by Fenrer. It is likely that even the Heathen poets themselves were not entirely in agreement about the exact details of these future events; for further "wolfish" confusion, cf. st. 43/1–2 below.

These wolves are dealt with in *Gylf* 12, which synthesizes from *Vsp* 39–40 along with the two aforementioned sources. Relevant for the present sts. is *Gylf* 12:7, 9–12:
*Gýgr ein býr fyrir austan Mið-garð í þeim skógi, er Járn-viðr heitir.* [...] *In gamla gýgr föðir at sonum marga jǫtna ok alla í vargs líkjum, ok þaðan af eru komnir þessir ulfar. Ok svá er sagt, at af ętt'inni verðr sá einna máttkastr, er kallaðr er Mána-garmr. Hann fylli≠sk með fjǫrvi allra þeira manna, er deyja, ok hann gleypir tungl, en støkkvir blóði himin ok loft ǫll. Þaðan týnir sól skini sínu, ok vindar eru þá ó·kyrrir ok gnýja heðan ok handan.* 'A lonely ogress lives to the east of Middenyard in the forest called Ironwood. The old ogress raises many ettins as her sons, all in the likenesses of wolves, and thereof these wolves [= Sholl and Hate] come. And so it is said that from that lineage a single one becomes the mightiest, and he is called Moongarm. He fills himself with the life of all those men who die and he swallows the moon and stains the heaven and all the air with blood. Thereof the sun loses her shine and then the winds are violent and howl hither and thither.'
Immediately after this passage *Gylf* 12:13 quotes *Vsp* 39–40, introduced by the words *svá segir í Vǫlu-spá:* 'so it says in the Spae of the Wallow:'.

1 Austr 'In the east' | The cardinal direction associated with ettins and other fiendish creatures; cf. *Hym* 5/1 n.

1 hin aldna 'the old hag' | Comparatively, the 'hag' (an insertion in the translation to clarify the gender of ON *aldna*) appears to correspond to the Finnish *Louhi*, the toothless mistress of *Pohjola* (the Northland). In *Kalevala* 47–49 she steals away the sun, moon, and fire (see st. 24 n. above). Both women are part of the evil forces that constantly struggle against the Gods by disrupting the natural cosmic order and its cycles.

1 Ár-viði 'Ironwood' | The older hiatus form *éarn* is supplied for *járn*, since the poem otherwise displays such forms. The resulting line, a type C, is however unusual, since type Cs with resolution on the first lift generally require a heavy second lift. Seeing as *járn* ~ *jarn* is securely attested in some 10th c. Skaldic poetry (e.g., Egill Lv 32, Hfr *Hákdr* 3, both in SkP), it may, then, be the case that the original form of this word was in fact *Járn-viði*. However, a short second lift following resolution in a type C may also be a license of the *Vsp*-poet, for which cf. st. 5/2b above.

4 tjúgari 'snatcher' | Hapax, generally understood as either **tjúga* 'drag, pull' or *tjúga* f. 'pitchfork' + *-ari* 'er'. The agentive suffix *-ari* is a young feature found nowhere else in the poem, and it is therefore possible that this word is corrupt. Note that **U**'s *tregari* 'troubler' is metrically impossible and prob. an instance of trivialisation from **tjúgari*, as found in the other mss. of *Gylf* (Males 2023b, pp. 181, 194). If the word is corrupt, it must have occurred early in transmission, since *tjúgari* is found in all three recensions (**RHG**).

**40**

Fylli≠sk fjǫrvi · fęigra manna,
rýðr ragna sjǫt · rauðum dręyra,
svǫrt verða sól-skin · of sumur ęptir,
veðr ǫll vá-lynd. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

[**R** 2r/19, **H** 20v/4, **S** 4r/11, **T** 4v/24, **W** 7r/25, **U** 5r/28]

He fills himself with the lifeblood of fey men;
he reddens the abode of the Reins [HEAVEN] with red gore.
Black do the sun's rays turn in the summers thereafter,
the winds all woeful. *Know ye yet, or what?*

3 svǫrt verða sól-skin 'Black turn the sun's rays' | *so* **HG**; svart var þá sól-skin *'Black was then the sun's shine'* **R** 4 vá-lynd | †va. ly.† **U**

3 svǫrt verða sól-skin 'Black turn the sun's rays' | As part of the Fimblewinter; see *Vafþ* 44/3–4 n. — The reading of **R**, although semantically meaningful, is outvoted by the other mss. It is also unlikely on its own merit, since the past tense of *var* 'was' disagrees with the present tense of the other verbs in this st. For this reason, **R**'s *'ý þa'* (resolving as *var þa* 'was then') is most likely a scribal error, where the archetypal **'ůþa'* (resolving as **verþa*, so **SU**) was miscopied as **'ůþa'* (resolving as **varþa*), and then reinterpreted as *var þá* by the addition of a space.

**41** Sat þar á haugi · ok sló hǫrpu [R 2r/21, H 20v/16]
gýgjar hirðir, · glaðr Eggþér;
gól umb hǫnum · í Gaglviði
fagr-rauðr hani, · sá's Fjalarr hęitir.

There he sat on the mound and struck the harp,
the gigh's herdsman, glad Edgethew.
For him crowed in Gagglewood
the fair-red cock who is called Feller.

1 Sat þar á haugi 'There he sat on the mound' | The motif of ettins sitting on burial mounds is also found in *Þrk* 6 and *Ski* 11. The precise significance of this is uncertain, but mounds are liminal spaces where the worlds of the dead and the living are particularly close, and they feature prominently in pre-Christian ritual (TODO: PCRN-HS reference).

3 gól umb hǫnum 'For him crowed' | The crowing of three cocks—the first in Ettinham, the second in Walhall, the third in Hell—heralds the destruction of the world.

3 Gaglviði 'Gagglewood' | An otherwise unknown location; the first element is *gagl* 'wild goose'. Gagglewood is perhaps the same as Ironwood.

**42** Gól umb ǫsum · Gollinkambi, [R 2r/23, H 20v/18]
sá vękr hǫlðа · at Hęrja-fǫðrs,
ęn annarr gęlr · fyr jǫrð neðan
sót-rauðr hani · at sǫlum Hęljar.

For the Eese crowed Goldencomb;
he wakes the heroes at the Father of Hosts',
but another one crows beneath the earth:
a soot-red cock in the halls of Hell.

1 Gollinkambi 'Goldencomb' | This cock may be depicted on two of the 11th or 12th c. tapestries from Överhogdal, Härjedalen in Sweden. The relevant tapestries show a great tree surrounded by a mass of animals, and on the top of the tree stands a bird; the pre-Christian nature of their symbolism is confirmed by the depiction of an eight-legged horse, certainly to be identified with Weden's horse Slopner.

2 at Hęrja-fǫðrs 'at the Father of Hosts'' | In Weden's hall, Walhall, where the Oneharriers reside.

**43** Gęyr Garmr mjǫk · fyr Gnipa-hęlli, [R 2r/25]
fęstr mun slitna, · ęn freki rinna;
fjǫlð vęit hǫn fróða, · framm sé'k lęngra
of ragna rǫk, · rǫmm sig-tíva.

Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;
the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.
She knows much lore; I see further ahead
about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

ALL | The first occurrence of the third refrain (*stef*), repeated several times in the section of the poem dealing with the Rakes of the Reins (ON *ragna røk*), culminating with st. 55. The destruction of the world, involving the deaths of all major Gods save Balder, is treated at length in *Gylf* 51. Furthermore, it is the subject of a wisdom contest in *Vafþ* 44–53 and alluded to in *Lok* 39, 41.

1–2 Garm … rinna 'Garm … run' | *Gylf* 51 distinguishes between the Fenrerswolf fought by Weden and the wolf Garm fought by Tew. Yet this is probably the result of later systematising. The wolf which is said to come loose in the present stanza must surely be the Fenrerswolf, and since in *Gylf* 34:10–42 it is primarily Tew who deals with the Fenrerswolf, we would naturally expect him to fight it during the Rakes of the Reins as well. The motif of unresolved rivalries coming to blows at the Rakes of the Reins is also seen in how Thunder and his rival, the Middenyardswyrm, kill each other, and how Lock and Homedall do the same (*Gylf* 51:48; see *Þrk* 13/3 n.). *Vsp* 51, however, sees *Weden* fight the Wolf instead of Tew, and this requires a separate wolf for Tew to fight, hence Garm in Snorre's version. It is thus likely that these two wolves were not always distinct creatures. For the story of the Fenrerswolf see *Lok* 38/3–4; for further "wolfish" confusion, cf. st. 39 above.

3 sé'k 'I see' | In **R** the use of the present tense *sé'k, sér* 'I see, she sees' marks a shift from the past tense (*sá* 'saw') of the Balder-episode (31–34) and the description of Neestrand (37–38), a subtle but important change. The use of the present tense continues for the rest of the poem. Note that in **H** the verb is found in the present tense already in 37–38, and we lack the Balder-episode to compare with.

**44**

Bróðr munu bęrja⸗sk · ok at bǫnum verða⸗sk,
munu systrungar · sifjum spilla;
hart 's í hęimi, · hór-dómr mikill,
skęggj-ǫld, skalm-ǫld, · skildir klofnir,
vind-ǫld, varg-ǫld, · áðr ver-ǫld stęypi⸗sk
mun ęngi maðr · ǫðrum þyrma.

[**R** 2r/28, **H** 20v/24, **S** 16r/34, **T** 17r/26, **W** 19r/2, **U** 18r/2]

Brothers will fight and become each other's banes;
the children of sisters will defile their kinship.
It is hard in the Home! Great whoredom,
axe-age, sword-age—shields split asunder—
wind-age, warg-age. Before the man-age tumbles
no man will spare another.

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2 systrungar 'the children of sisters' | †stystrungar† **T** 3 í hęimi 'in the Home' | *so* **RHU**; með hǫlðum *'among men'* **STW** 4 skildir 'shields' | *add.* 'ro *'are'* **R** 4 klofnir 'split' | klofna *'become split'* **U** 5 vind-ǫld 'wind-age' | *The* v *is capitalized, marking the beginning of a new stanza, in* **H** 5 áðr 'before' | unz *(norm.) 'until'* **U** 5 stęypi⸗sk 'tumbles down' | *add. after this l.* grundir gjalla · gífr fljúgandi *(norm.) 'foundations shrill, fiend(s) flying'* **H** 6 mun ęngi maðr · ǫðrum þyrma. 'no man will spare another' | *om.* **STW** 6 ęngi | †enn† **U**

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ALL | St. 44 is cited in *Gylf* 51, which puts the stanza in the context of three winters of war preceding the three winters that make up the Fimblewinter. The stanza is introduced by *Gylf* 51:5–7: *En áðr ganga svá aðrir þrír vetr, at þá er um alla verǫld orrostur miklar. Þá drepa⸗sk bróðr fyrir á-girni sakar, ok engi þyrmir fǫður eða syni í mann-drǫpum eða sifja-sliti. Svá segir í Vǫlu-spá:* 'But before them there come three other winters, whenas throughout all the world there are great battles. Then do brothers slay each other for reasons of covetousness, and no man spares his father or son in murder of men or the betrayal of inlawhood. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow:'. For the Fimblewinter, as described in the preceding *Gylf* 51:2–4, see note to *Vafþ* 44.

This stanza takes a noticeably moralising tone, which may be compared with st. 38 above. Its moralism may be seen as a sign of Christian influence (cf., e.g., *Musp* 59 for a similar condemnation of kinslaying), but all the crimes listed in sts. 38 and 44 (perjury, murder, adultery, kinslaying, and incest) were undoubtedly forbidden also in pre-Christian Germanic law. In the worldview of the wallow, then, it seems that human moral failures accompany the decline and ultimate destruction of the World; they may even hasten the arrival of the calamity, as the corpses of criminals and outlaws feed the monster Nithehewer who, in turn, gnaws at the roots of the World-Tree and thereby undermines the stability of the Cosmos as a whole (*Grm* 32, 36/4).

2 sifjum spilla 'defile their kinship' | I.e., 'commit incest', more specifically referring to unions between first cousins, which are prohibited in all mediaeval Scandinavian law codes. Related words are found in the laws, e.g., *frǽnd-semis-spell* 'incest' and especially *sifja-spell* 'id.' Snorre's paraphrase in *Gylf* 51 renders this word by *sifja-slit*, which in his context seemingly refers to the murder of in-laws rather than incest. — Comparatively, the idea of incest as a sign of later ages is also found in *ṚV* 10.10.10a–b (norm. and tr., N. S. Dwibhashyam.): *Á gᵇā tā́ gaccᵇān · úttarā yugā́ni, // yátra jāmáyaḥ · kṛṇávann ájāmi* 'There shall come indeed those later ages when relatives shall do (acts) not (fit for) relatives.'

5 ver-ǫld 'man-age' | Translated as such since it stands next to various other compounds with the second element *ǫld* 'age'. ON *ver-ǫld* is cognate with English "world" (cf. 29/3 above), but in ON the sense 'cosmos, universe' is usually expressed by *hęimr* (e.g., in l. 3 of the present stanza).

**45** [R 2r/32, H 20v/27, S 17r/7, T 17v/33, W 19v/7, U 18v/7]

Lęika Mímms synir, · ęn mjǫtuðr kyndi=sk
at hinu galla · Gjallar-horni;
hǫtt blęss Hęim·dallr, · horn 's á lopti;
mę́lir Óðinn · við Mímms hǫfuð;
skelfr Ygg·drasils · askr standandi,
ymr it aldna tré, · ęn jǫtunn losnar.

Mime's sons play and the Measurer advances
at [the sounding of] the shrill Yellhorn.
Homedall blows high; the horn is aloft;
Weden speaks with Mime's head.
The Ash of Ugdrassle quakes, standing:
the old tree whines and the ettin comes loose.

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1–2 Lęika ... Gjallar-horni; 'Mime's ... Yell.' | *om.* **G** 2 hinu | *so* **H**; †en† **R**. 4 mę́lir 'speaks' | †mey† **S**; †nie† **T** 4 Mímis | Mímis **TU** 5–6 | *These lines are reversed in* **R**. 6 ęn jǫtunn losnar 'and the ettin comes loose' | ęsir 'ro á þingi **U** 6 losnar | *add. H41* **H**.

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ALL | Sts. 45–54 are cited, with the omission of the refrain-stanza 47, in sequence following *Gylf* 51:50. Note that **U** only cites sts. 45–46 and 53. Immediately after these nine stanzas, *Gylf* cites *Vafþ* 18.

1 Mímis synir 'Mime's sons' | These sons may be taken to be ettins, but it is unclear whether Mime(r) himself is one. The long form of his name, *Mímir*, appears in various ettin-names, e.g., *Hręgg-Mímir, Søkk-Mímir,* and *Vet-Mímir*. TODO: Reference Schjødt (2008).

1 mjǫtuðr kyndi=sk 'the Measurer advances' | The sense seems to be that the destruction swiftly comes to pass through the great predestined calamities, but both words require some elucidation. ON *mjǫtuðr* 'the Measurer' often means merely 'Fate' (e.g. *Sigsk* 71), but is a m. agent noun and as such is not entirely impersonal, perhaps rather referring to an overarching fate-principle. In OS poetry the cognate *metod* means 'fate' (*Heli* 128, 511) and also occurs in the cpds. *metod-gi-skaft, metod(o)-gi-skapu* 'shapes of the Measurer', i.e., 'decrees of fate' (*Heli* 2190, 2210, 4827; cf. *regin(o)-gi-skapu* 'shapes of the Reins', *Heli* 2593, 3347, *wurd-gi-skapu* 'shapes of Weird', *Heli* 127, 3692); in OE poetry *meotod* comes to refer to the Christian God (e.g. *Cadman* 2). *kyndi=sk* 'advances' must be in the pres. sg. and is a form of *kynda=sk* 'be kindled, be set ablaze', which is here understood to refer metaphorically to the swift rising of the calamity. CV suggests emending to *kynni=sk* 'makes itself known'. The literal sense 'is kindled' could be used to argue for an emendation of *mjǫtuðr* to *mjǫt-viðr* 'Measuring-Tree' (cf. st. 2/4 above), but this would yield an A1 verse with anacrusis, which is not metrically acceptable in *Vsp*.

2 Gjallar-horni 'Yellhorn' | Or the 'Horn of Yell', viz. the river *Gjǫll* 'Yell', mentioned in *Grm* 28/6. The root of the river's name is the same as the English verb "yell".

**46** [**R** 2v/8, **H** 20v/30, **S** 17r/9, **T** 18r/1, **W** 19v/9, **U** 18v/9]

Hvat 's með ǫsum? · Hvat 's með ǫlfum?
gnýr allr Jǫtun-heimr, · ęsir 'ro á þingi,
stynja dvergar · fyr stęin-durum
vęgg-bergs vísir. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?
All Ettinham roars; the Eese are at the Thing.
The Dwarfs groan before gates of stone,
the lords of the cliff-side. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 ǫlfum 'Elves' | ǫsynjum *'Ossens'* **U** 2 gnýr … þingi | *om.* **U** 3 stęin-durum | steins dyrum **U**; stęin-dyrum **HW** 4 vęgg-bergs vísir | *om.* **U** 4 vęgg-bergs | veg-bergs **HTW**

1 Hvat 's með ǫsum? · Hvat 's með ǫlfum 'What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?' | A line indicating cosmic distress. It also occurs in *Þrk* 7/1, where it is answered by *Illt 's með ǫsum, · illt 's með ǫlfum!* ''Tis ill with the Eese! 'Tis ill with the Elves!'. Such is probably also the implication of the present stanza.

2 þingi 'the Thing' | The Thing of the Gods, where the Gods assemble in times of distress; see note to st. 6/1–2 above.

**47** [**R** 2v/4, **H** 20v/32]

Gęyr nú Garmr mjǫk · fyr Gnipa-hęlli,
fęstr mun slitna, · ęn freki rinna;
fjǫlð vęit hǫn fróða, · framm sé'k lęngra
of ragna rǫk, · rǫmm sig-tíva.

Now Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;
the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.
She knows much lore; I see further ahead
about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

**48** [**R** 2v/4, **H** 20v/32, **S** 17r/11, **T** 18r/3, **W** 19v/11]

Hrymr ękr austan, · hęf=sk lind fyrir,
snýr=sk Jǫrmun·gandr · í jǫtun-móði,

ormr knýr unnir, · ęn ari hlakkar,
slítr nái nęf-fǫlr; · Nagl·far losnar.

Rim drives from the east; he holds his shield before him;
Ermengand writhes in ettin-wrath.
The Wyrm drives forth the waves and the eagle screams,
the pale-beak tears at corpses; Nailfare comes loose.

3 ęn ari hlakkar 'and the eagle screams' | ǫrn mun hlakka *'the eagle will scream'* **ST**

4 Nagl·far 'Nailfare' | The ship on which the fiends sail from the east. It is described in *Gylf* 51:13–16: *Þá geysisk haf'it á lǫnd'in, fyrir því at þá snýsk Miðgarðs-ormr í jǫtun-móð ok sókir upp á land'it. Þá verðr ok þat, at Nagl·far losnar, skip þat, er svá heitir. Þat er gert af nǫglum dauðra manna, ok er þat fyrir því varnanar vert, ef maðr deyr með ó·skornum nǫglum, at sá maðr eykr mikit efni til skips'ins Nagl·fars, er goð'in ok menn vildi seint, at gert yrði. En í þessum sévar-gang flýtr Nagl·far.* 'Then the sea surges onto the lands because the Middenyardswyrm writhes in ettin-wrath and attacks the land. Then it also happens that Nailfare comes loose—the ship which is called thus; it is made from the nails of dead men, and therefore it is worth a warning if a man dies with uncut nails, that that man greatly increases the material for the ship Nailfare, which the Gods and men would rather were not done. But in this motion of the sea Nailfare floats.'
The motif of the Devil rowing a boat made out of improperly discarded nail clippings is widespread in Scandinavian and Finnish folklore (Krohn 1912), and thus the "nail-ship" cannot be a mere Snorronean invention. Specific rituals for disposing cut nails (and hair) are found in many Indo-European cultures, and clearly described ramifications for not observing them are also found in Zoroastrianism (*Vidēvdāt* 17.2–3: "[W]hen one arranges and cuts his hair and clips his nails and then lets them fall into holes in the earth or into furrows, [...] demons come forth, and from these improprieties monsters come forth from the earth which mortals call lice and which devour the grain in the fields and the clothes in the closets") (Lincoln 1977). Beyond the Indo-Europeans, Judaism also has a taboo against discarding nail-clippings wherever a pregnant woman might walk, lest they supernaturally cause her to miscarry.
An interesting psychological commonality presents itself in all three traditions, namely that the improper clipping or disposal of nails is thought to threaten the fundamental stability of the cosmos by bringing about the principal fear of each culture. In Judaism, singularly concerned with the fertility of its adherents (witness its famous ban on masturbation, *Shulchan Arukh, Even HaEzer* 23:1: ועון זה חמור מכל עבירות שבתורה 'more severe than all Torah transgressions') it is the miscarriage; in the dualistic Zoroastrianism, the proliferation of demons; and in the Germanic religion, with its Wiking Age eschatological obsession (cf. Introduction to the poem), it is the End Times.

**49** Kjóll fęrr austan · koma munu Mú·spells
of lǫg lýðir, · ęn Loki stýrir;
fara fífl-męgir · með freka allir,
þęim es bróðir · Býleists í fǫr.

[**R** 2v/6, **H** 20v/34, **S** 17r/13, **T** 18r/5, **W** 19v/13]

The ship fares from the east—come will Muspell's
subjects o'er the sea—and Lock steers it.
The devil-lads all fare with the Wolf;
with them comes the brother of Bilast [= Lock] along.

1 Kjóll 'The ship' | Nailfare, as mentioned in the previous st.

1–2 Mú·spells ... lýðir 'Muspell's subjects' | According to *Gylf* 4:5–8 *Mú·spell* 'Muspell' or *Mú·spells-bęimr* 'Muspellsham' is the name of the primordial realm of fire in the South, ruled over by Surt (cf. note to st. 3 above).

During the destruction the world will be assailed by the nebulous *Mú·spells-synir* 'Muspell's sons' (*Lok* 42, *Gylf* 13:9, 37:19, 51:21, 51:28) or *Mú·spells-męgir* 'Muspell's lads' (*Gylf* 13:6, 51:25), who are to be identified with *Mú·spells lýðir* and the *fifl-męgir* 'devil-lads' in the pres. st.
ON *Mú·spell* has West Germanic cognates in OHG *Mú·spilli* (*Musp* 56) and OS *Mú·spelle* (*Heli* 2591, 4358), both referring to the destruction of the world in a Christian context. For the etymology see *Musp* 56 n.

**50**

Surtr fęrr sunnan · með sviga lęvi,
skĭnn af sverði · sól val-tíva;
grjót-bjǫrg gnata, · ęn gífr rata,
troða halir hęl-veg, · ęn himinn klofnar.

[**R** 2v/10, **H** 20v/36, **S**$_1$ 2r/35, **S**$_2$ 17r/15, **T**$_1$ 3r/11, **T**$_2$ 18r/6, **W**$_1$ 5v/16, **W**$_2$ 19v/14, **U** 4r/4]

Surt fares from the south with the twig's betrayer [FIRE];
from the swords of the slain-Tews ⟨gods⟩ [it] shines [like] the sun.
Rocky cliffs clash, but the fiends roam;
men tread the Hellway, but the Heaven cracks.

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1 Surtr | Svartr **U** 3 gífr rata 'the fiends roam' | guðar hrata *'the gods(?) stagger' (wo. doubt corrupt)* **U** 4 troða | †traþa† **U** 4 hęl-veg | hęl-vega **U**

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ALL | This st. is cited twice in 3/4 mss. of *Gylf*; in **U**, it is only cited the first time. The second citation is in the sequence of sts. 45–54 cited in *Gylf* 51:50 (see st. 45 n.), but the first is alone, introduced by *Gylf* 4:5–9:
*Þá mélti Þriði: „Fyrst var þó sá heimr í suðr-hálfu, er Múspell heitir. Hann er ljóss ok heitr. Sú átt er logandi ok brennandi. Er hann ok ó-fǫrr þeim, er þar eru út-lendir ok eigi eigu þar óðul. Sá er Surtr nefndr, er þar sitr á lands-enda til land-varnar. Hann hefir loganda sverð, ok í enda ver-aldar mun hann fara ok herja ok sigra ǫll goð'in ok brenna allan heim með eldi. Svá segir í Vǫluspá:* 'Then spoke Third: "Yet, first there was the home in the southern half which is called Muspell. It is hot and bright. That domain is blazing and burning. It is also unpassable to those who are foreigners and do not have their home there. Surt is he called who sits there at the border of the land to defend the land. He has a blazing sword, and in the end of the world he will go and harry and vanquish all the Gods and burn all the Home with fire. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow.'

2 skĭnn af sverði · sól val-tíva 'from the swords of the slain-Tews ⟨gods⟩ [it] shines [like] the sun' | A difficult line. As the sun has been blackened (st. 40) the world is instead lit up by the flashing swords of the Gods as they head into the battle with Surt. Snorre instead interprets it as a reference to Surt's sword, *Gylf* 51:22–23: *Surtr ríðr fyrst ok fyrir honum ok eptir bęði eldr brennandi. Sverð hans er gott mjǫk; af því skínn bjartara en af sólu.* 'Surt rides first and both ahead of and behind him is a burning fire. His sword is very good; from it, it shines brighter than the sun.'
The main difficulty lies in the fact that *val-tíva* may be read either (1) as gen. pl. of the attested *val-tívar* 'the slain-Tews [GODS]' (so La Farge and Tucker (1992); cf. below st. 59 (n.) and *Hym* 1/1) or (2) as gen. sg. of an unattested m. *n*-stem **val-tívi* 'the slaughter-Tew [= Surt]' (so CV, Fritzner, and presumably also Snorre). Reading 1 is adopted here as the simpler explanation because it does not presuppose an otherwise unattested *n*-stem derivative of *týr* 'tew, god'—especially as Surt is not a god—and because the pl. *val-tívar* demonstrably occurs elsewhere in the poem.
A second issue arises over whether the gen. *val-tíva* modifies (a) *sverði* 'sword' or (b) *sól* 'sun'.
In readings 1a and 2a the sense would prob. be that the flashing sword shines like the sun, reflecting the intensity of the battle. Although one may expect a pl. *sverðum* 'swords' for 1a, that is not a major problem, since sg. forms are often used with pl. possessors in the Old Germanic languages (e.g. *Hárb* 39/3). Case 1b does not seem very likely since 'sun of the GODS' is not a known kenning-type. If 2b is adopted we may see a kenning "sun of Surt [FIRE]", but "from his sword shines the [FIRE]" seems excessively repetitive when compared to l. 1. In conclusion, my preferred reading is 1a.

3 gífr rata 'the fiends roam' | The reading of **U** is certainly corrupt; the anachronistic m. pl. ending *-ar* is proof enough, for the word *goð ~ guð* 'gods' was always neuter in heathen times.

4 troða halir hęl-veg ‘men tread the Hellway’ | The Hellway is the road between Earth and the Underworld (Hell) upon which one has to travel after death to reach one’s final resting place (cf. the story told in *Helr*). The verse may thus be understood as ‘men die off’. On the other hand, according to *Gylf* 51:27, Lock is followed by *allir Heljar sinnar* ‘all Hell’s companions’, who are presumably thought to be some sort of revenants, and so that may instead be what is being referred to here.

4 himinn klofnar ‘the Heaven cracks’ | As discussed above (st. 3) Heaven is thought of as a solid dome made out of stone (cf. *Hárb* 15/2 n.); its cracking in two is therefore a horrible sight. Cf. the prophetic line in Sö 154 Skarpåker (edited below under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland).

**51** Þá kømr Hlĭnar · harmr annarr framm,
es Óðinn fęrr · við ulf vega,
—ęn bani Bęlja · bjartr at Surti—
þá mun Friggjar · falla angan.

[**R** 2v/13, **H** 20v/37, **S** 17r/17, **T** 18r/8, **W** 19v/16]

Then comes Line’s second sorrow to pass,
when Weden goes to fight against the Wolf
—but the bane of Bellower [= Frea], bright, towards Surt—
then will Frie’s beloved [= Weden] fall.

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4 falla | *om., but add. above line in same hand* **S** 4 angan | *so* **HSTW**; angantyr **R**

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ALL | Sts. 51–53 describe the deaths of the major gods Weden, Thunder, and Frea as they fight against their respective enemies: the Fenrerswolf, the Middenyardswyrm, and Surt. The battle takes place on the great plain Wighride as told in *Vafþ* 18.
The fight between the Wolf and Weden is also mentioned in *Vafþ* 53, which further mentions his subsequent avenging by Wider, and *Grm* 24/3–4, which mentions that he is aided by the Oneharriers.
The relevant part of the battle is described in *Gylf* 51:34–38: *Ęsir her-vęða sik ok allir Ein-herjar ok sókja fram á vǫllu’na. Ríðr fyrstr Óðinn með gull-hjalm’inn ok fagra brynju ok geir sinn, er Gungnir heitir; stefnir hann móti Fenris-ulf, en Þórr fram á aðra hlið honum, ok má hann ekki duga honum, því at hann hefir fullt fang at berja-sk við Mið-garðs-orm. Freyr ber-sk móti Surti, ok verðr harðr sam-gangr, áðr Freyr fellr. Þat verðr hans bani, er hann missir þess ins góða sverðs, er hann gaf Skírni.* ‘The Eese and all the Oneharriers clothe themselves for war and rush forth on the plains. Weden rides first with the golden helmet and fair byrnie and his spear which is called Gungner; he faces against the Fenrerswolf, but Thunder goes forth on one of his sides; and he cannot avail him, for he has his hands full in fighting against the Middenyardswyrm. Frea fights against Surt and it becomes a hard-fought struggle before Frea falls. It will be his bane that he is missing the good sword which he gave Shirner.’

1 Hlĭnar harmr annarr ‘Line’s second sorrow’ | The first sorrow being the death of Balder. Line (*Hlĭn*) is described in *Gylf* 35:19 as a minor goddess *sett til gętslu yfir þeim mǫnnum, er Frigg vill forða við háska nǫkkurum* ‘placed to watch over those men whom Frie wants to save from any particular danger’. In spite of this, almost all modern translators and editors have understood Line as synonymous with Frie and posited that her existence as a distinct goddess is a systematising invention of *Gylf*. Hopkins (2017) convincingly argues that this need not be the case; as Frie’s servant put in charge of protecting those dearest to her mistress, Line’s two sorrows would consist in her failure to protect both Frie’s son and husband.

3 ęn bani Bęlja · bjartr at Surti ‘but the bane of Bellower [= Frea], bright, towards Surt’ | In this inset line the wallow relates the death of Frea; cf. note to ALL. Frea’s obscure fight against Bellower (ON *Bęli*) is mentioned in *Gylf* 37:16–19, which also contains the important detail that Frea will be without his sword:

*„Þessi sǫk er til þess, er Freyr var svá vápn-lauss, er hann barði=sk við Belja ok drap hann með hjartarhorni.“ Þá mélti Gangleri: „Undr mikit, er því=líkr hǫfðingi sem Freyr er vildi gefa sverð, svá at hann átti eigi annat jafn-gott. Geysi-mikit mein var honum þat, þá er hann barði=sk við þann, er Beli heitir. Þat veit trúa mín, at þeirar gjafar myndi hann þá iðra=sk.“ Þá svarar Hárr: „Lítit mark var þá at, er þeir Beli hittu=sk. Drepa mátti Freyr hann með hendi sinni. Verða mun þat, er Frey mun þykkja verr við koma, er hann missir sverðs'ins, þá er Múspells synir fara at herja.“* '"This event is the reason for why Frea was so unarmed when he fought against Bellower and slew him with a hart's antler." Then spake Gangler: "It is a great wonder that such a chieftain as Frea is would give away his sword for which he had nothing as good. It was a huge harm for him when he fought with the one called Bellower. It is my true belief that he would come to regret that gift." Then answers High: "It was of little harm when he and Bellower met each other. Frea could have slain him with his hand. Yet a thing will come to pass which will seem far worse to Frea: that he is missing his sword when the Sons of Muspell come harrying."'
Cf. *Ski* 8, *Lok* 42, and *Gylf* 37:1–15 (edited as an appendix to *Skí*).

**52** Þá kømr hinn mikli · mǫgr Sig-fǫður, [**R** 2v/15, **S** 17r/19, **T** 18r/9, **W** 19v/17]
Víð·arr vega · at val-dýri;
lętr męgi Hveðrungs · mund of standa
hjǫr til hjarta; · þá 's hefnt fǫður.

Then comes the great son of Syefather,
Wider, to fight that slaughter-beast.
He lets his hand through Whethring's lad [= the Wolf]
drive the sword to the heart—then is the father avenged!

1 Þá kømr hinn mikli · mǫgr Sig-fǫður 'Then comes the great son of Syefather' | Gęngr Óðins sonr · við ulf vega *'Weden's son goes the Wolf to fight'* **STW**. 2 vega | of veg **STW**

1 Sig-fǫður 'Syefather' | 'The Father of Victory', a name found only here and in *Lok* 58/4, likewise in the context of the battle with the Wolf.

3 Hveðrungs 'Whethring's' | Gen. of *Hveðrungr*, an obscure name for Lock, whose son is the Fenrerswolf. The name otherwise appears as a name of Lock in a kenning for Hell (*Yt* 24: *Hveðrungs mér* 'Whethring's daughter'). It is also found in a later antiquarian list (thule) of names of individual Ettins (Þul *Jǫtna I* 1, SkP 3), and in a thule of names for Weden (Þul *Óðins* 5, SkP 3), but both of these may derive from misinterpretations of the present stanza.

**53** Þá kømr hinn męri · mǫgr Hlǫðynjar, [**R** 2v/17, **H** 20v/41, **S** 17r/20, **T** 18r/11, **W** 19v/19]
gęngr fet níu · Fjǫrgynjar burr
nęppr frá naðri · níðs ó·kvíðnum;
munu halir allir · hęim-stǫð ryðja
es af móði drepr · Mið·garðs Véurr.

Then comes the famed son of Lathyn [= Thunder].
Nine steps takes Firgyn's son,
pained, away from the Adder unfearing of enmity.
All men will clear their homesteads
when Middenyard's Wighward strikes out of wrath.

ALL | *The present form of the stanza is an amalgamation of all three recensions (***R***,* **H***, and* **G***) based most closely on* **H** *and* **G***, which have the last 3 lines in the same order.* **R** *has the lines in the order 1, 5, 4,*

*2, 3 and inserts an additional line between 1 and 5.* 1 Þá kømr hinn méri · mǫgr Hlǫðynjar, ‘Then comes the famed lad of Lathyn’ | *om.* **H**; *add.* gengr Óðins sonr við ulf (*pro* *orm) vega. *‘Weden’s son goes the Wolf (error for ‘Wyrm’) to fight.’* **R**. 1 Þá kømr ‘Then comes’ | Gengr *‘Goes’* **STW** 2 gengr fet níu · Fjǫrgynjar burr ‘nine steps takes Firgyn’s son’ | *om.* **STW**. 4 hęim-stǫð | hęim-†steið† 5 es af móði drepr | drepr hann af móði **R**

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ALL | Thunder and the Middenyardswyrm kill each other, fulfilling their previous abortive encounter during the Fishing Trip (see *Hym*). From a comparative perspective, it is notable that the Norse religion makes the ancient *Chaoskampf*, the motif of a Storm God slaying a watery Serpent as part of Creation, a key part of its eschatology instead. It is surely for this reason that the Wyrm is not slain during the Fishing Trip (as it must have been originally, and as it actually is in *Húsdr*, one of the early Scaldic retellings; see Introduction to *Hym*), since it must remain alive to fight at the Rakes of the Reins. —
This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 51:41–42: *Þórr berr banaorð af Miðgarðs-ormi ok stígr þaðan braut níu fet. Þá fellr hann dauðr til jarðar fyrir eitri því, er ormr’inn blęss á hann.* ‘Thunder bears the bane-word from the Middenyardswyrm and strides nine steps away from it. Then he falls dead to the earth from the venom (*eitri*) which the Wyrm blows on him.’ Cf. also st. H48 below.

2–3 Hlǫðynjar, Fjǫrgynjar ‘Lathyn, Firgyn’ | Both names for the Earth, who is Thunder’s mother.

3 níðs ǫ·kvíðnum ‘unfearing of enmity’ | Dat. sg., modifying *naðri* ‘adder, serpent’. Numerous eds. emend to **ǫ·kvíðinn* (nom. sg.), referring to Thunder.

4 munu halir allir · hęim-stǫð ryðja ‘All men will clear their homesteads’ | After Thunder is slain the realm of men is no longer habitable. Cf. *Hárb* 23, *Þrk* 18.

5 Miðgarðs Véurr ‘Middenyard’s Wighward’ | Thunder, literally “the Sanctuary-Defender of Middenyard”, a fitting kenning.

**54** Sól tér sortna, · sígr fold ǐ mar,
2 hverfa af himni · hęiðar stjǫrnur;
gęisar ęimi · við aldr-nara;
4 lęikr hýr hiti · við himin sjalfan.

[R 2v/20, **H** 21r/1, **S** 17r/22, **T** 18r/13, **W** 19v/20, **U** 18v/10]

The Sun doth blacken; the land sinks into the sea;
from heaven fade the twinkling stars.
Smoke billows from the nourisher of life [FIRE];
the high heat licks against the very heaven.

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1 tér ‘doth’ | mun *‘will’* **G** 1 sígr fold ǐ mar | †sigrfolldinar† *(for* *sígr fold ǐ mar*) **U**, *cf. Males (2023b, 194, 198 n. 25)* 1 sígr ‘sinks’ | søkkr **STW** 3 við ‘from’ | ok *‘and’* **HG** 3 aldr-nara | aldr-nari *(nom. sg.)* **HG**

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ALL | This st. is verbally alluded to in Arn *Þorfdr* 24/1–2 (SkP 2, ca. 1060 AD) in an instance of *adynaton*: *Bjǫrt verðr sól at svartri; · søkkr fold ǐ mar døkkvan; / brestr ęrfiði Austra; · allr glymr sęr á fjęllum* ‘Bright, the sun turns black; the land sinks into the dark sea; // Eastre’s toil [HEAVEN] shatters; all the sea roars over the fells’. Another allusion is possibly found in SnSt *Ht* 13/2, 4 (SkP 3), which may, however, also be a reference to the Biblical deluge: *Stóð sęr á fjęllum;* [...] *skaut jǫrð ór gęima.* ‘The sea stood over the fells; the earth shot up from the ocean.’

1 sígr fold ǐ mar ‘the land sinks into the sea’ | The stemmatically excluded reading *søkkr* ‘sinks’ is probably influenced by Arn *Þorfdr* 24/1b (SkP 2).

3 aldr-nara ‘nourisher of life’ | A rare FIRE-kenning, found only here and in the thules or poetic lists of synonyms (Þul *Elds* 3 in SkP 3). It is notable that fire has two conflicting natures: it nourishes life, but it also consumes it. Here a kenning reflecting the former is used, somewhat discordantly, in the context of the latter.

**55** Gęyr nú Garmr mjǫk · fyr Gnipa-hęlli, [**R** 2v/22, **H** 21r/2]
fęstr mun slitna, · ęn freki rinna;
fjǫlð vęit hǫn fróða, · framm sé'k lęngra
of ragna rǫk, · rǫmm sig-tíva.

Now Garm barks loudly before the Gnip-Caves;
the rope will snap and the Wolf will run.
She knows much lore; I see further ahead
about the mighty Rakes of the Reins, of the Victory-Tews [GODS].

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ALL | With the sinking of the earth into the sea and the blackening of the heaven, the destruction has reached its climax, as signalled by the final repetition of the refrain stanza. To indicate the dramatic pause, which was likely indicated in some way in the original oral performance, a page break has been inserted.

**56** Sér hǫ́n upp koma · qǫ́ru sinni [R 2v/23, H 21r/4]
jǫrð́ ór ǽgi · iðja-grǿna;
falla forsar, · flýgr ǫrn yfir,
sá's á fjalli · fiska vǫ́iðir.

She sees coming up for a second time
the Earth from the ocean, ever green anew.
Torrents fall; o'er them flies the eagle
which in the fells catches fish.

ALL | Sts. 56–59 are paraphrased in *Gylf* 53:1–9:
*Þá mélti Gangleri: „Hvárt lifa nǫkkur goð'in þá, eða er þá nǫkkur jǫrð eða himinn?" Hárr segir: „Upp skýtr jǫrðu'nni þá ór sæ'num, ok er þá grǿn ok fǫgr. Vaxa þá akrar ó-sánir. Víð-arr ok Váli lifa, svá at eigi hefir sǽr'inn ok Surta-logi grandat þeim, ok byggja þeir á Iða-velli, þar sem fyrr var Ás-garðr, ok þar koma þá synir Þórs, Móði ok Magni, ok hafa þar Mjǫllni. Því nǽst koma þar Baldr ok Hǫðr frá Heljar, setja=sk þá allir samt, ok tala=sk við, ok minna=sk á rúnar sínar, ok róða of tíðendi þau, er fyrrum hǫfðu verit, of Mið-garðs-orm ok of Fenris-ulf. Þá finna þeir í grasi'nu gull-toflur þǽr, er ǽsir'nir hǫfðu átt."*
'Then spoke Gangler: "Do any Gods live then, or is there then any earth or heaven?" High says: "The earth then shoots up from the sea and it is then green and fair. Then acres grow unsown. Wider and Wonnel live, for the sea and Surt's flame have not scathed them, and they settle on the Idewold where Osyard once stood. And then come thither Thunder's sons, Mood and Main, and they have Millner with them. Next come Balder and Hath out of Hell. Then they all sit down together and make speech and think back on their runes and speak about the events of antiquity, about the Middenyardswyrm and the Fenrerswolf. Then they find in the grass those golden game-bricks which the Æse had owned."'
After this passage *Gylf* cites *Vafþ* 51. For more traditions of the world to come, cf. *Vafþ* 44–47.

1 qǫ́ru sinni 'a second time' | The first time probably being the lifting of the Earth in st. 4.

3–4 falla ... vǫ́iðir 'Torrents ... fish.' | The unusually vivid description paints a beautiful picture of the mountain-climate of Norway and Iceland. The sense is that the serene beauty of nature is restored from the fire of the destruction.

**57** Finna=sk ǫ́sir · á Iða-vǫ́lli [R 2v/24, H 21r/5]
ok umb mold-þinur · mǫ́tkan dǿma,
ok minna=sk þar · á mǫ́gin-dóma
ok á Fimbul-týs · fornar rúnar.

The Æse find each other on the Idewold
and of the mighty Earth-Cord [= Middenyardswyrm] speak,
and there think back on mighty verdicts
and on Fimble-Tew's ⟨= Weden's⟩ ancient runes.

1 Finna=sk 'find each other' | hitta=sk **H** 3 ok minna=sk þar · á mǫ́gin-dóma 'and there think back on mighty verdicts' | *so* **H**; *om.* **R**

1 Finna=sk 'find each other' | The **H** reading provides closer parallelism with 7/1 above, but for the same reason it may also have replaced an earlier *finna=sk*, as found in **R**.

2 mold-þinur 'Earth-cord' | Cf. the kenning for the Middenyardswyrm in *Húsdr* 4: *stirð-þinull storðar* 'the stiff cord of the land [= Middenyardswyrm]'.

**58** Þar munu ǫ́ptir · undr-sam=ligar [R 2v/26, H 21r/7]

gollnar tǫflur · ï grasi finna=sk,
þér's *ę́sir* ï ár-daga · áttar hǫfðu.

There will again the wondersome
golden game-bricks in the grass be found,
which in days of yore the Eese had owned.

1 ęptir 'again' | ęsir *'the Eese'* **H** 2 finna=sk 'be found' | finna *'find'* **H** 3 *ę́sir* | *om.* **RH**

ALL | A fine literary device. In st. 8 the golden age of the Eese, exemplified by their playing board games, was spoiled by the three ettin-women. The rediscovery of the golden board game then betokens a new golden age.

3 *ę́sir* 'the Eese' | The verb *hǫfðu* 'had' requires a plural subject, and this is found in the paraphrase of this st. in *Gylf* 53:9: *Þá finna þeir í grasi'nu gull-tǫflur þér, er ę́sir'nir hǫfðu átt* (see st. 56 n. above).

**59** Munu ȯ·sánir · akrar vaxa, [**R** 2v/28, **H** 21r/9]
bǫls mun alls batna, · mun Baldr koma;
búa Hǫðr ok Baldr · Hropts sig-toptir,
vęl val-tívar. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

Unsown will acres grow;
the bale will all be bettered; Balder will come.
Hath and Balder settle Roft's ⟨= Weden's⟩ victory-plots
well, the slain-Tews. *Know ye yet, or what?*

2 bǫls 'the bale' | The evil of Hath's slaying Balder (cf. sts. 31–34 above). It will be forgotten as the two brothers reconcile and live alongside each other.

4 val-tívar 'the slain-Tews' | A rare epithet otherwise only found in 50/2 above and *Hym* 1/1; it is not found in *SnE* or in Scaldic poetry. The first element is most likely *valr* 'the battle-slain'. This term probably originally referred exclusively to Hath and Balder, since just these are the two slain gods; it would later have been semantically widened to refer to the Gods in general (so *Vsp* 50/2, *Hym* 1/1).

**60** Þá kná Hønir · hlaut-við kjósa [**R** 2v/30, **H** 21r/11]
ok burir byggva · bróðra tvęggja
vind-hęim víðan. · Vituð ér ęnn eða hvat?

Then does Heener choose the leat-wood,
and the sons of the two brothers settle
the wide wind-home [SKY/HEAVEN]. *Know ye yet, or what?*

1 hlaut-við kjósa 'choose the leat-wood' | Foresee the future by means of lots, specifically twigs drenched in the blood of beasts killed during the bloot; cf. *Hym* 1. According to Tacitus (*Germania*, ch. 10) such divination was done *publice consultetur, sacerdos civitatis, sin privatim, ipse pater familiae* 'in public questions [by] the priest of the particular state, in private [by] the father of the family'. In later Scandinavian society the positions of high Gid (*goði*) and chieftain or king were largely synonymous, and so this would mean that in the world to come, the peaceful Heener takes over the role of the chief of the Gods after the more warlike Weden. I thank John Newman for this observation.

2 bróðra tveggja ‘of the two brothers’ | The present translation takes *tveggja* to be the gen. pl. of *tvęir* ‘two’. The two brothers are presumably Hath and Balder, mentioned in the previous stanza. Since the original mss. do not capitalize proper nouns, we could also read *bróðra Tveggja* ‘the brothers of Tway ⟨= Weden⟩’, but although Weden’s brothers are attested in *Gylf* 6:10 as Will and Wigh (cf. st. 4/1 above) they are never said to have children.

**61** [R 2v/31, **H** 21r/12, **S** 5v/12, **T** 18r/25, **W** 8v/23, **U** 7r/23]

Sal sér hǫ́n standa · sólu fęgra,
golli þakðan, · á Gim·lé*i*;
þar skulu dyggvar · dróttir byggva
ok umb aldr-daga · ynðis njóta.

A hall she sees standing fairer than the sun,
thatched with gold on Gemlee.
There faithful folk shall settle
and in their days of life enjoy delights.

1 sér hǫ́n ‘she sees’ | vęit’k *‘I know’* **G** 2 golli þakðan ‘thatched with gold’ | golli bętra *‘better than gold’* **ST** 2 Gim·léi | *metr. emend. by restoration of hiatus;* Gim·lé **RHG** 3 þar ‘there’ | þann *‘[in] that [hall]’* **TW**

ALL | This stanza is cited immediately following *Gylf* 17:10–12, which reads: *Á sunnan-verðum himins enda er sá salr er allra er fegrstr ok bjartari en sól’in, er Gim·lé heitir. Hann skal standa þá er bęði himinn ok jǫrð befir farit=sk, ok byggja þann stað góðir menn ok rétt-látir of allar aldir. Svá segir í Vǫlu-spǫ́:* ‘At the southern end of heaven is the hall which is the fairest of all and brighter than the sun, which is called Gemlee. It shall stand when both the heaven and the earth have been destroyed, and that place is settled by good men and righteous throughout all ages. So it says in the Spae of the Wallow:’
Following the stanza, *Gylf* 17:13–16 continues: *Þá męlti Gangleri: „Hvat gętir þess staðar, þá er Surta-logi brennir himin ok jǫrð?“ Hárr segir: „Svá er sagt, at annarr himinn sé suðr ok upp frá þessum himni, ok heitir sá And·langr, en inn þriði himinn sé enn upp frá þeim, ok heitir sá Víð·bláinn, ok á þeim himni byggjum vér þenna stað vera. En Ljós-alfar einir, byggjum vér, at nú byggvi þá staði.“* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “What protects that place when the flame of Surt burns the heaven and the earth?” High says: “So it is said, that there is another heaven southwards and upwards from this heaven and that one is called Endlong; but the third heaven is even further upwards from them and that one is called Wideblown, and in that heaven we think that this place is. But only Light-Elves, we think, do now inhabit those places.”’

**62** [R 3r/2, **H** 21r/15]

Þar kømr hinn dimmi · dręki fljúgandi,
naðr fránn neðan · frá Niða-fjǫllum;
berr sér í fjǫðrum · —flýgr vǫll yfir—
Níð·hǫggr nái; · nú mun hǫ́n søkkva=sk.“

Then comes the dusky Dragon flying,
the gleaming Adder up from the Nithfells.
He carries in his feathers—he flies o’er the field—
Nithehewer, corpses. Now will she sink!”

ALL | The function of the final st. is disputed. Earlier eds. see the last half-line as a reference to Nithehewer sinking down into the abyss, permanently ridding the world of evil and resulting in an everlasting world-to-come—a clearly Christian conception. Yet this interpretation requires either emending *hǫ́n* ‘she’ in l. 4 to *hann* ‘he’ (so Finnur Jónsson 1932) or removing it entirely (so Sijmons and Gering 1927, pp. 77–78).

I instead agree with Schjødt (1981) in seeing the last half-line as part of the frame of the wallow's recitation and taking the rest of the stanza as a reference to the pre-Christian Indo-European cyclical conception of the world. The presence of Nithehewer illustrates that the next world is still not entirely free from ills, for although most of the fiends have been slain in the great battle, a seed of evil still remains. The Dragon will infest the *axis mundi* (*Grm* 36) in the next world also, and the fact that he still has corpses to eat further shows that evil in mankind has not been eradicated (st. 38 above). Since there is still evil in the next world it too must at some point fall, be destroyed, and be reborn in the endless cosmic cycle; see Introduction to the poem above.

4 nú mun hǫ̣n søkkva=sk 'Now will she sink!' | The spae is concluded and the wallow, referring to herself in the third person, descends back down into the grave whence Weden woke her. Cf. *Helr* 14/4b, the very last half-line of that poem: *søkkst-u, gýgjar-kyn* 'sink, thou gigh's kin!'

# Appendix

## Dwarf-tallies (sts. 11–15)

The following five stanzas contain two or three originally separate lists of dwarf-names. They interrupt the flow of the whole poem so much that they have been moved to the Appendix. Their nature as later interpolations is in any case confirmed by their faulty meter (Males 2025a, p. 373).

That the lists themselves are originally distinct from each other is seen by the repetition of names (13/4, 15/4: *Ęikin·skjaldi* 'Oakenshield'; 11/4, 15/3: *Ái* 'Great-grandfather') and by the existence of two formulaic conclusions (12/3–4, 15/6–7). Sts. 11–13, having no repeated names, seem to belong together. If this is the case, st. 12, which contains the formulaic conclusion to the list, should probably switch places with 13. Sts. 14–15 form a second group, having an introduction and a conclusion which both mention the dwarf Loffer.

The form of these stanzas is rather different in *Gylf*; linking works have been dropped, as have the formulaic introductions, so that the originally poetic stanzas have been reduced to long prose lists of names (cf. the similar treatment of Weden's names in *Gylf* 20:11, taken from *Grm* 47–52). What is more, the order of the lines is drastically different from both **R** and **H**. In order to note the critical variants, however, the name-lists in *Gylf* have been taken as attestations of the stanzas themselves. Snorre's introductory note to the names from sts. 11–12 prove that the dwarf-names were present already in the lost ***G** version of *Vsp*.

TODO: The variants from the four *Gylf* manuscripts have not yet been collated.

**11** Nýi ok Niði, · Norðri, Suðri,
2 Austri, Vestri, · Al·þjófr, Dvalinn,
Bífurr, Bǫ́furr, · Bǫmburr, Nóri,
4 Ánn ok Ánarr, · Ái, Mjǫð·vitnir.

[**R** 1r/23, **H** 20r/17, **S** 4v/7, **T** TODO, **W** 7v/22, **U** 6r/2]

New and Nithe, Norther and Souther,
Easter and Wester, Allthief, Dwollen,
Biber, Babber, Bamber, Noor,
Own and Owner, Great-grandfather, Meadwitner.

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ALL | Sts. 11–12 are cited in *Gylf* 14:16, introduced by the words *Ok þessi segir hón nǫfn þeira* 'And in this way she says their names'.

1–2 Norðri, Suðri, Austri, Vestri 'Norther and Souther, Easter and Wester' | According to *Gylf* 8:10, these four dwarfs were placed by the gods to hold up the Heaven, Yimer's skull, one in each cardinal direction; cf. st. 3/4 n. above.

**12** Vęigr ok Gand·alfr, · Vind·alfr, Þráinn,
2 Þękkr ok Þorinn, · Þrór, Vitr ok Litr,
Nár ok Ný·ráðr, · —nú hęf'k dverga—

[**R** 1r/25, **H** 20r/18, **S** TODO, **T** 4v/9, **W** 7v/23, **U** 6r/4]

Ręginn ok Ráð·sviðr · —rétt of talða.

Wey and Gandelf, Windelf, Thrown,
Thetch and Thorn, Threw, Wit and Lit,
Nee and Newred—now have I the dwarfs—
Rain and Redswith—rightly tallied.

3 nú hęf'k dverga | *om.* **G** 4 rétt of talða | *om.* **G**

3–4 nú hęf'k dverga ... rétt of talða 'now have I the dwarfs ... rightly tallied' | An inset clause; since it does not list the names of any dwarfs, it was omitted by Snorre in *Gylf.*

**13** Fíli, Kíli, · Fundinn, Náli,
Hępti, Víli, · Hannarr, Svíurr,
Frár, Horn·bori, · Frégr ok Lóni,
Aur·vangr, Jari, · Ęikin·skjaldi.

[**R** 1r/28, **H** 20r/20, **S** 4v/9, **T** TODO, **W** 7v/24, **U** 6r/4]

Filer, Chiler, Found and Needler,
Hefter, Wiler, Hanner, Swigher,
Fraw, Hornborer, Fray and Looner,
Earwong, Earer, Oakenshield.

2 Svíurr | †Sviðrr†, / Nár ok Náinn, · Nípingr, Dáinn / Billingr, Brúni · Bildr ok Búri '... *Nee and Nowen, Nipng, Dowen, Billing, Brown, Bild and Boor'* **H**

**14** Mál es dverga · í Dvalins liði
ljóna kindum · til Lofars tęlja,
þęir es sóttu · frá salar stęini
Aur-vanga sjǫt · til Jǫru-valla.

[**R** 1r/30, **H** 20r/22]

It is time to tally the dwarfs in Dwollen's troop
back to Loffer for the race of men;
they who sought, from the stone of the hall,
the seat of the Earwongs unto the Erwolds.

3 þęir | þeim **H**

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 14:18 by the words: *En þessir kómu frá Svarins-haugi til Aur-vanga á Jǫru-vǫllu, ok er kominn þaðan Lofarr.* 'But these ones came from Swornshigh to the Earwongs on the Erwolds, and from them Loffer is come.' After this passage, *Gylf* cites st. 15/3–5.

1–2 Mál es ... tęlja 'It is time ... of men' | A variant of a standard genealogical introduction; cf. *Hálf* 1: *meðan hans ętt ... til goða tęljum* 'while we tally his line ... back to the Gods'. The patrilineal line of dwarfs is to be counted back to their progenitor, Loffer. This possibly disagrees with st. 10 where Moodsowner is said to be the foremost (and presumably the oldest) of the dwarfs, and Loffer is not mentioned, but consistency in such details can probably not be expected.

**15** Þar vas Draupnir · ok Dolg·þrasir,

[**R** 1r/32, **H** 20r/24]

Hár, Haug·spori, · Hlé·vangr, Glói,
Skirfir, Virfir, · Ská·fiðr, Ái,
Alfr ok Yngvi, · Ęikin·skjaldi,
Fjalarr ok Frosti, · Finnr ok Ginnarr;
Þat mun ę́ uppi, · meðan ǫld lifir,
lang-niðja-tal · Lofars hafat.

There was Dreepner and Dollowthrasher,
High, Highspurer, Leewong, Glower,
Sherver, Werver, Showfind, Great-grandfather,
Elf and Ing, Oakenshield,
Feller and Frost, Finn and Ginner.
That will ever be remembered while the age lives,
the recited tally of the ancestors of Loffer.

6 ę́ | *so* H; *om.* R

ALL | The dwarf-names in this st. are split up acros several sections in *Gylf* 14. In *Gylf* 14:17, variants of the names in ll. 1–2 are cited, followed by four names not found in *Vsp* and then by the names in st. 13/2. That name-list is introduced by the words *En þessir eru ok dvergar ok búa í steinum, en inir fyrri í moldu:* 'But these ones are also dwarfs and dwell in stones, but the former ones in the earth.' The names of ll. 3–5 are cited in *Gylf* 14:19 immediately following a paraphrase of st. 14, introduced by the words *þessi eru nǫfn þeira* 'these are their names'. Although these name-lists cannot be considered citations of this stanza proper, the variants of the names have been included (TODO!) in the critical edition.

6 Þat mun ę́ uppi, · meðan ǫld lifir 'That will ever be remembered while the age lives' | Both verse-halves are formulaic, though their use in a list of dwarf-names is unparallelled. For the first cf. *Heiðr* 119 (in SkP 7): *þat mun ę́ uppi; · illr es dómr norna!* 'That will always be remembered; evil is the judgement of the norns!' For the second cf. runic inscription U 323 Sälna (ca. 980–1015 AD), edited under Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland. What is essentially a Scaldic rewrite of the whole line is found in Þstf *Stuttdr* 5/1–2 (SkP 2): *Ey mun uppi · Ęndils, meðan stęndr // sól-borgar salr, · svǫr-góðis fǫr* 'Ever will be remembered—while the hall of the sun's stronghold [SKY/HEAVEN > EARTH] stands—the journey of the fattener of Andle's bird [RAVEN/EAGLE > WARRIOR].'

7 Lofars hafat | This line would be unmetrical in the rest of the poem since the first lift is on a short syllable (Males 2025a, p. 373). This strongly suggests that the Dwarf-tally section is a later insert.

## Stanzas from *Hauksbók*

**H** has a few substantial insertions and variants not found in **R**. The following four stanzas, H31, H41, H48, H58, are the only instances longer than a single line (but cf. st. 7/2 n. above).

The style and content of H41, H48, and especially H58, comes off as rather different from the rest of the poem; they are therefore unlikely to be authorial. H31 may, however, be genuine.

**H31** Þá kná Vála · víg-bǫnd snúa; [H 20v/12]
hęldr vǫ́ru harð-gǫr · hǫpt ór þormum.

Then did Wonnel the war-bonds twist:
the most sturdy fetters were made from entrails.

1 Vǫl*i* 'Wonnel' | Vála **H**

ALL | These two lines replace the present 34/1–2 in **H**. —
Lock was bound by Weden's son Wonnel, who thus avenged Balder by punishing both of those responsible for his death: he killed Hath (who held the weapon) and bound Lock (who guided Hath's hand). Cf. *Gylf* 50:20–22: *Þá vóru teknir synir Loka, Váli ok Nari eða Narfi. Brugðu ésir Vála í vargs líki ok reif hann í sundr Narfa, bróður sinn. Þá tóku ésir þarma hans ok bundu Loka með yfir þá þrjá egg-steina. Stendr einn undir herðum, annarr undir lendum, þriði undir knés-fótum, ok urðu þau bǫnd at járni.* 'Then were taken Lock's sons, Wonnel and Nare or Narve. The Eese turned Wonnel into the likeness of a wolf and he tore apart Narve, his brother. Then the Eese took his intestines and with them they bound Lock over three sharp stones. One stands under his shoulder-blades, the other under his lower back, the third under his houghs; and those bonds turned into iron.'
It is likely that Snorre's version of *Vsp* contained this st. and also had the oblique sg. form **Vála* in l. 1, which led him to misinterpret Wonnel as the name of one of Lock's sons, rather than the name of Weden's son Wonnel, the avenger of Hath. No other source attests Wonnel as the name of a son of Lock. Cf. the version of the binding of Lock found in *Lok* P8.

**H41** Hrǽða=sk allir · á hęl-vegum [H 20v/28]
2 áðr Surtar þann · sefi of glęypir.

All are frightened on the Hellways
before Surt's kinsman devours it.

ALL | St. 45 is followed by these lines in **H**, in effect forming another four-line stanza with 45/5–6. In context, the lines seem to be referring to an ettin swallowing the World Tree.

**H48** Gĩnn lopt yfir · lindi jarðar, [H 20v/39]
2 gapa ýgs kjaptar · orms í hǽðum;
mun Óðins son · *ęitr*i móta
4 vargs at da*uða* · Víð·ars niðja.

Over the air yawns the Girdle of the Earth [= Middenyardswyrm];
the jaws of the fierce Wyrm gape in the heights.
Weden's son [= Thunder] will meet the venom
of the Warg, after the deaths of Wider's kinsmen [= the Eese].

ALL | *The last part of the stanza is almost completely illegible in the ms. I have relied on the transliteration of Jón Helgason (1971, pp. 13, 44 ff.).* 3 *ęitr*i 'venom' | *emend.;* ormi '*Wyrm*' **H**. 4 da*uða* | 'da...' **H**

ALL | This stanza appears between 52 and 53 in **H**. It is not found in the sequence of stanzas cited in *Gylf* 51:50, but some details in the preceding paraphrase are not entirely dissimilar. *Gylf* 51:18–20: *En Fenris-ulfr ferr með gapandi munn, ok er inn neðri kjǫptr við jǫrðu, en in øfri við himin. Gapa myndi hann meira, ef rúm vęri til. Eldar brenna ór augum hans ok nǫsum. Mið-garðs-ormr blęss svá eitri'nu, at hann dreifir lopt ǫll ok lǫg, ok er hann all-ógur=ligr, ok er hann á aðra hlið ulfi'num.* 'But the Fenrerswolf fares with gaping mouth; and the lower jaw is on the earth, but the upper is in the heaven; he would gape yet broader if there were room for it. Fires burn from his eyes and nostrils. The Middenyardswyrm blows the venom so far that it covers the whole air and sea, and he is most terrible, and he is by the side of the Wolf.'

3 *ǫitr*i ‘venom’ | Cf. *Gylf* 51:41–42, cited in the notes to st. 53 above.

**H58** Þá kømr hinn ríki · at regin-dómi [H 21r/14]
2 ǫflugr ofan · sá’s ǫllu ræ̧ðr.

Then comes the powerful one to the Great Judgment,
strong down from above, he who rules everything.

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ALL | This half-stanza appears between sts. 61 and 62 in **H**. It is generally held to be a late Christian insert, since it betrays Christian theological sentiments. An omnipotent God coming down from above to the Great Judgment (*regin-dómr*)—none of these elements are found in the pre-Christian religion. Cf. *Hdl* 43, which is likely drawing on the present stanza.

# Speeches of the High One
# *(Hǫva mǫl)*

**Dating:** Likely varying, see below.
**Meter:** majority: Leeds-meter;
minority: Speeches-meter, Ancient-words-lay.

## Introduction

The **Speeches of the High One** (*Háv*) is a wisdom poem, most likely a collection of several poems, bound together by a common attribution to the Germanic god of wisdom, Weden.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Háv* is the second poem of **R** (foll. 3r/4–7v/9), where it follows *Vsp* and is followed by *Vafþ*. **R** is the only independent manuscript witness for the poem, but several isolated sts. (1, 58, 76–77, 84) are cited or alluded to in other texts.

### Contents

*Háv* is, as it comes down to us in **R**, a motley collection. It contains two or three poems of practical life advice, two mythological narratives, scattered gnomic poetry about runes, and a list of galders. Thematically these materials are united by their direct attribution to the high god Weden, or as he is called in sts. 109, 111, and 166, *Hǫvi* 'the High One'.

In the direct attribution of the totality of the poem to a god *Háv* stands utterly alone among Norse poetry, for although Weden also has much to say in *Vafþ*, *Grm*, and *Bdr*, in those poems his speech is reported speech enclosed in a narrative frame. Though internal frame-like devices do appear in sts. 1–2, 111, and 166, *Háv* has no external narrative frame. The poem is, as it were, the very Words of the High One.

**Sections of the poem**

On the basis of meter, style, content, and later manuscript tradition, I identify the following major strands, excluding various isolated sts. (e.g. 80) that are probably later inserts. In the present edition each is given its own short introduction:

1. The Guests' Strand (1–77, with 78–79 being later additions)
2. Various scattered sts. of advice (81–90)
3. Weden's tryst with Billing's daughter (91–102)
4. Weden's obtaining of the Mead of Poetry (103–110)
5. The Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137)
6. The Rune-Tally; sts. about runes and ritual (138–146)
7. The Leed-Tally; Weden's listing of 18 galders (146–165)

It can hardly be stated that every strand was originally its own poem. Weden's two romantic adventures (91–102 and 103–110), for instance, have much in common stylistically and individually seem too short to have ever stood on their own.

On the other hand it seems highly unlikely that the Guests' Strand (1–77) and the Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137) were ever a single composition, for they differ very much in tone, in style, and in structure.

The Guests' Strand is down to earth and sceptical, never mentions women (st. 79 is prob. a later insert), gives its advice in the form of maxims and similes and by reference to the behaviour of a "wise" or "unwise man", never makes use of the second imperative (and only thrice of the verb *skalt* '(thou) shalt', 44/3, 45/3, 46/3), and has a perfectly fitting conclusion in sts. 76–77.

On the other hand the Speeches of Loddfathomer places great emphasis on magical ideas (113–114, 126, 129, 137) and women (113–115, 118, 130, 131/5), gives its advice directly by means of the second imperative and never with reference to the behaviour of the "(un)wise man", and is much less clearly structured, concluding with a long list of folk magical remedies in st. 137.

There is direct repetition between the two sections (most notably between sts. 44 and 119), which would be redundant if both were originally a single work. In addition to notable differences in content there are also notable linguistic differences, for which cf. the section on Dating below.

**Prehistory and redaction into a single text**

Since the full *Háv* almost certainly consists of at least two originally separate compositions two questions naturally arise: *how* were these materials redacted into a single poem, and *why*? No answers to these problems can be certain and so the following is only the translator's own speculation.

To answer either question we first need to determine in what context the redaction took place: whether in an oral or scribal tradition, in a Heathen

hove or a Catholic monastery. St. 166, given that it explicitly mentions the title of the poem, must probably be associated with the final layer of the redaction, and so is of particular use. Its blessing of the reciter, hearers, and learners indicates that the poem was to be chanted and learned by heart, and its description of the contents of the poem (which includes unambiguous Heathen ritual advice like st. 145) as *all-þǫrf* 'most useful' to Men and *ó·þǫrf* 'harmful' to Ettins invokes the Heathen dichotomy between the Gods and Ettins as friends and enemies of Mankind, respectively (cf. Introduction to *Hym*).

Thus, on the basis of the final stanza and the pagan contents of the rest of the poem, we can say that *Háv* was probably redacted into something very close to its present form no later than the early 11th century, in an oral, Heathen context.

Moving on to the *how*, it is certain that in an oral transmission additions and inserts need not have happened all at once, but could have taken place successively in the form of layers appended to an original core. Thus the original Guests' Strand probably ended at st. 77, but sts. 78–90 may have been added shortly afterwards, later the two narratives about Weden's romantic escapades, thereafter the Speeches of Loddfathomer, the Rune-tally, and the Leeds. Even after the basic structure was obtained, stanzas such as 73 could have been inserted where they were felt most fitting in order to make the poem more "complete" in the eyes of the inserter. These inserts may well have continued into the period of scribal transmission.

For the *why*, we should consider what reason someone would have for redacting numerous materials into a single poem. St. 166, as discussed above, suggests that the main reason was utilitarian rather than antiquarian, and a picture then emerges of a redactor arranging a corpus of traditional poetry, selected both for its traditional attribution to the god Weden and for its *usefulness*—whether as practical life advice or as mythological and religious lore—into a single long poem meant to be learned by heart as a whole and recited for magical purposes. In practice this final redaction served as sort of Odinic "ark" (or "Hoardmimer's wood", *Vafþ* 45/2) in which the bulk of surviving pre-Christian Norse advice poetry was transmitted until it could be written down. Forever lost were whichever stanzas were not included in it—and many such must have existed.

## Meter and stanza

*Háv* consists of 722 lines (365 long-lines, 355 full-lines/c-verses, 2 unusual verses) distributed across 166 sts. It is the single longest preserved Norse poem of any genre, Eddic or Scaldic (the two parts of Guthley's *Merlínus spǫ* I and II together consist of 171 sts. but are two distinct poems; three other particularly long poems are *Hug·svinns mǫl* at 149 sts., Snorre's *Hátta-lykill* at 102 sts., the anonymous *Lilja* at 100 sts.).

### Leeds-meter

The meter of *Háv* is varied but primarily consists of varying configurations of Leeds-meter (1–72, 74–80, 84, 88, 91–108, 109/3–124/2, 129/1–3, 130–131/3, 132–137/3, 137/8–138/6, 140–141/2, 142–143, 145, 147/1–2, 148–166).

The most common configuration of the Leeds-meter stanza is the archetypal *abc abc* (2–5, 7–26, 28–72, 75–79, 84, 88, 91–101, 104, 106–108, 110, 114, 118, 123, 133, 136, 140, 149, 151–155, 159–162). A likely defective variant of this configuration is *abc ab* (145).

Also found is the syncopated configuration *abc* (148, 163) and the extended *abc abc abc* (6 sts.: 6, 27, 102–103, 138, 165).

### Galders-lay

Configurations with repeated full-lines are also represented. These fall under the label Galders-lay, although they are not properly a different meter. These may be seen as extended variants of the three basic Leeds-meter-types *abc, abc abc,* and *abc abc abc*.

Extensions of *abc* are *abccc* (143), *abcccc* (164), and *abcccc* (142).

Extensions of *abc abc* are *abc abcc* (105, 150, 156, 158), *abc abccc* (157), *abcc abc* (12 sts.: 1, 74, 112–113, 115–116, 120, 122, 127–128, 132, 135), and *abcc abcc* (125, 166).

Extensions of *abc abc abc* are *abc abc abccc* (111), *abcc abc abc* (117, 119, 121, 126, 130), and *abcc abc abccc* (134).

### Unusual verses

In addition to this there are two Leeds-meter-stanzas containing unusual verses, viz. verses that only carry one alliterating stave connecting to a previous long-line of type *ab*. The two stanzas are 61 (*abc abcx*) and 80 (*abxccc*), where *x* marks the unusual verse.

### Other meters

A minority meter is Speeches-meter (73, 81–83, 85–87, 89–90, 109/1–2, 124/3–4, 129/4, 131/4–6, 137/4–7, 141/3–4, 147/3–4). With the exception of the likely interpolated st. 73, stanzas composed exclusively in Speeches-meter are found only in the section sts. 81–90.

Several stanzas in sections 4–7 (sts. 103–165) mix Speeches-meter and Leeds-meter by having long-lines (*ab*) not directly followed by a *c*-verse. With the Speeches-meter lines bracketed the relevant configurations are: [*ab ab*] *abc* (109), *abc* [*ab ab*] (124, 141, 147), *abcc* [*ab*] *abc* (129), *abcc* [*ab ab ab*] (131), and *abcc* [*ab ab ab ab*] *abc* (137).

The Rune-Tally section (146–165) attests a few examples of Ancient-words-lay (139, 144, 146).

## Dating

Having above determined that the redaction of the poem most likely took place in pagan times, we should try to arrive at a more detailed dating of the individual strands.

On the purely linguistic side most archaic features are concentrated in the Guests' Strand (sts. 1–77). Old *vr-* alliterates with *v-* 2 times in non-formulaic word pairs (sts. 26/2, 32/2) and the particle *of* appears 3 times before nominals (4/3: *of øðis*, 21/4: *of mál*, 38/4: *of þǫrf*). That these archaic traits are all found in the Guests' Strand is notable but does not definitely prove that it is much older than the rest of the poem, since clear diagnostics like old *vr-* alliterating with *r-* are uncertain (though cf. 106/1).

The frequency of the old particle *of* before verbs and nouns varies by section. It is found at a rate of 0.363 occurrences per 10 unique lines in sections 1–4 (sts. 1–110) and a near-identical 0.385 in sections 6–7 (sts. 138–166), but only 0.137 in section 5 (sts. 111–137) (Sapp 2022, p. 70). Together with the notably different stylistic traits of this section compared to the Guests' Strand this observation strongly supports the hypothesis of *Háv* as a composite.

Content-based criteria for dating, chiefly the poem's unabashed endorsement of paganism, have been discussed above, but a few more can be mentioned briefly. As Males (2024b, pp. 93–96) points out, sts. 71 and 81 of the poem treat being "burned" as synonymous with being "dead" just like modern English "six feet under" assumes a custom of burials. This synonymity convincingly suggests a pagan date since cremation was strongly taboo in mediaeval Christianity and reserved for criminals and heretics (cf. *Am* 84 n.). Since these passages are merely giving neutral life-advice they should be expected to conform to their contemporary cultural context, and as such the neutral statement of "praising a woman when she is burned" (st. 81) is unlikely to belong to the Christian period.

## Text

### 1. The Guests' Strand (1–79)

The Guests' Strand (ON *Gęsta-þáttr*) is a wisdom-poem, taking its outset in the scene of a lone wanderer's arriving as a stranger at a farmstead. This "Wanderer" appears to be the speaker of the section, and he will henceforth be called by that term.

The Strand begins by describing the mutual responsibilites between guest and host, before moving on to discussing proper conduct in human interactions more broadly. The wisdom-poem is not clearly divided into thematic sections, but there is a tendency towards groups of a handful of stanzas that deal with the same subject. Throughout the poem, there is also a clear (though not entirely linear) progression from the subject of the guest-host relationship to increasingly more abstract concerns like gluttony and drinking, friendship, fate, wisdom, and lastly death and legacy. In the progression between themes, the Wanderer often makes use of transitions in order to move from one theme to another (e.g., between sts. 4–5 or 10–11). Evenso, previously discussed subjects may reappear, seemingly out of place, after having been dropped for a few stanzas.

The spirit of the advice is consistent throughout the section, which at all turns counsels shrewdness, caution, and moderation. Of particular importance is the idea of "manwit" (*man-vit*), or knowledge about the proper conduct in various situations; this encompasses being silent rather than speaking nonsense, not indulging in food or drink, not laughing at the misfortune of others, and so forth. The emphasis on wisdom is also found in the way the advice itself is imparted to the listener, namely through examples of the proper conduct of the "wise man", contrasted with the poor behaviour of an "unwise man".

A few themes are not dealt with at all; these are women (except for st. 79) and magico-religious ideas. Although the advice of the Strand is mostly of a "down-to-earth" nature, it can still be ascertained from the names in sts. 13–14 that the Wanderer is in fact the god Weden himself, and not just any wise old man.

It seems very likely that the original Guests' Strand ended with sts. 76–77. This finds internal support in their thematic conclusion of fame after death (whereas sts. 78 and 79 deal with wealth and women, and st. 80 with runic magic) and external support in *Hákm* 21, which most likely borrows its first two lines (*dęyr fé · dęyja fręndr* 'kine die, kinsmen die') from *Háv* 76–77, and which likewise uses them in a context of finality.

**1** Gȧttir allar · áðr gangi framm
of skoða=sk skyli,
of skyggna=sk skyli;
því't ȯ·víst 's at vita, · hvar ȯ·vinir
sitja ȧ flęti fyrir.

[**R** 3r/4, **S** 2r/3, **T** 2v/13, **W** 5r/16, **U** 3v/4]

All doorways—before one might go forth—
he should spy round;
he should pry round,
for it is unsure to know where enemies
sit on the benches within.

1 Gáttir allar 'All doorways' | Skatnar allir *'All warriors'* **U** 1 gangi 'one might go' | né gangim *'we might not go'* 2 of skoða=sk skyli | *om.* **SWU** 4 at vita | *om.* **W** 5 flęti | flętjum **U**

2–3 of skoða=sk skyli / of skyggna=sk skyli 'he should spy round / he should pry round' | I have borrowed the English translation of these two lines from Bray (1908).

**2** Gefęndr hęilir, · gęstr 's inn kominn, [R 3r/6]
hvar skal sitja sjá?
Mjǫk es bráðr · sá's á brǫndum skal
sĭns of frędista frama.

O givers, hail! A guest is come in;
where shall this one sit?
Most anxious is he who on the wood-pile shall
test his furtherance.

ALL | The speaker, who may be the guest himself, announces to the hosts (the 'givers') that a guest, frozen, wet and tired, is sitting outside waiting to be let in. With this stanza the frame of the guest arriving at a farmstead begins; it is from this scenario that the following advice gradually branches out.

3 á brǫndum 'on the wood-pile' | Many interpretations have been offered for this line, chiefly owing to the varied senses of ON *brandr* 'fire, firewood, sword'. I agree with Evans (1986, p. 77) that the best explanation is attained by reference to a Norwegian folk custom attested from much later times, wherein the guest would *sitja i brondo*, i.e., sit down on the wood-pile outside the door, waiting until being let in.

4 sĭns of frędista frama 'test his furtherance' | Try his luck, see how far he gets. The same line is also found in *Vafþ* 11, 13, 15, 17.

**3** Ędlds es þǫrf · þędm's inn es kominn [R 3r/8]
ok á knéi kalinn,
matar ok váða · es manni þǫrf,
þędm's hędfr of fjall farit.

Fire is needful for him who has come inside
and is chilled to the knee.
Food and clothing are needful for the man
who over the fell has fared.

**4** Vats es þǫrf · þędm's til verðar kømr, [R 3r/10]
þęrru ok þjóð-laðar,

góðs of óðis, · —ef sér geta mętti—
4 orðs ok ęndr-þǫgu.

Water is needful for him who comes for a meal,
[and] a towel and a hearty welcome,
a good mood—if he might get it—
a word, and silence in return.

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ALL | There is a good train of thought throughout the st.: the guest must first wash and dry himself, then be welcomed to sit and eat at the table. After the host has furnished him with these amenities the expectation of proper conduct now shifts onto the guest, who should introduce himself and speak wisely.

3 of óðis 'mood' | An instance of prenominal *of*, an archaic feature. *of óði* appears once in a Scaldic poem, Egill *Arkv* 2 (in SkP 5). Cf. st. 21/4 below.

4 ęndr-þǫgu 'silence in return' | One may note that the verb *þęgja* 'shut up, hush, be silent'—of which **þaga*, which only appears in the present cpd, is a derivative formed in the same way as *saga* 'saw, history' to *segja* 'say, speak'—and the related noun *þǫgn* 'silence' are frequently used at the beginning of Scaldic poems (e.g. Arn *Magndr* 1: *þegi sęim-brotar* 'may gold-breakers [GENEROUS MEN] be silent', Egill *Berdr* 1: *byggi … til þagnar þinn lýðr* 'may thy retinue focus on silence', Glúmr *Gráf* 1: *biðjum vér þagnar* 'we ask for silence').

**5** Vits es þǫrf · þęim's víða ratar; [R 3r/12]
2 dęlt es hęima hvat;
at auga-bragði · verðr sá's ękki kann
4 ok með snotrum sitr.

Wit is of use for him who widely roams;
everything is easy at home.
The subject of glances becomes he who nothing knows
and among the clever sits.

---

3 auga-bragði 'The subject of glances' | Idiomatic. *auga-bragð* literally means 'blink of an eye, moment' (so st. 78/3 below), and the sense here is thus something like 'a quick glance of derision'.

**6** At hyggjandi sínni · skyli=t maðr hrósinn vesa, [R 3r/14]
2 hęldr gętinn at gęði,
þá's horskr ok þǫgull · kømr hęimis-garða til,
4 sjaldan verðr víti vǫrum,
því't ǫ·brigðra vin · fęr maðr aldri=gi,
6 an man-vit mikit.

Of his thinking should man not be boastful,
rather guarding of his senses
when sharp and silent he comes to a homestead;
sudden harm seldom strikes the wary,
for a less fickle friend man never gets
than great manwit.

5 maðr ‘man’ | In **R** abbreviated with the rune ᛘ **m**, whose ON name is *maðr* ‘man’; the first of 45 such instances in the present poem. Whereas Anglo-Saxon Latin-script manuscripts use several runes ideographically (e.g., ᛟ **o** for OE *ēðel* ‘homeland, patrimony’), there do not seem to be any Scandinavian manuscript examples with runes other than ᛘ. The tradition of ideographic runes goes back to the Runic period itself, however, as shown by the pre-Christian inscriptions DR 357 (Stentoften) and Ög 43 (Ingelstad); DR 357 uses the rune ᛃ **j** for *ár* ‘year, good harvest’ and Ög 43 uses ᛞ **d** for *dagr* ‘day’. For the names of the runes see the three Rune Poems, edited below under Runic Poetry.

6 man-vit ‘manwit’ | The first introduction of this very important concept. The word is difficult to translate (which is why it has been calqued), but seems to refer to the opposite of Scandinavian “blue-eyed” naivité, viz., shrewdness, situational awareness, and familiarity with the correct behaviour in varied social contexts.

**7** Hinn vari gęstr · es til verðar kømr, [R 3r/17]
2 þunnu hljóði þęgir;
ęyrum hlýðir, · ęn augum skoðar,
4 svá nýsi=sk fróðra hvęrr fyrir.

The wary guest who comes for a meal
with sharp hearing shuts up.
With ears he listens and with eyes he watches;
so looks each learned man ahead.

2 þunnu hljóði ‘with sharp hearing’ | Lit., ‘with thin silence’.

2 þęgir ‘shuts up’ | The importance of silence and not speaking frivolously is very important in the poem, and is further brought up in sts. 17, 19, 22, 26–31, 45, 46, 63, 65, 73, 103, 117, 124, 125, and 132–135.

4 nýsi=sk … fyrir ‘looks … ahead’ | This phrasal verb underlies the noun *for·njósn* as found in *Sigrdr* 25, which offers similar advice.

**8** Hinn es sęll, · es sér of getr [R 3r/19]
2 lof ok líkn-stafi;
ǫ·dęlla ’s við þat, · es ęiga skal
4 annars brjóstum í.

*This one* is blessed, who for himself does earn
goodwill and friendly words.
It is less easy with that which one shall own
in another man’s breast.

2 lof ‘goodwill’ | Or ‘praise’, but *lof* here carries the specific sense of the favour or goodwill one earns through generous acts.

2 líkn-stafi ‘friendly words’ | A cpd. of *líkn* + *stafr*. *líkn* is defined by ONP as: ‘mercy, compassion, relief, comfort, help’; cf. its two other occurrences in the present poem: st. 120 and especially st. 123, where it is likewise paired with *lof* ‘goodwill, praise’.

**9** Sá es sęll, · es sjalfr of á [R 3r/20]

lof ok vit meðan lifir;
því't ill rǫ́ð · hęfr maðr opt þęgit
annars brjóstum ór.

*That one* is blessed, who himself does have
goodwill and wits while he lives,
for ill counsel has man oft taken
out of another man's breast.

1 Sá 'That one' | Contrasting with *hinn* 'this one' in the previous stanza.

**10** Byrði bętri · berr=at maðr brautu at, [R 3r/22]
an séi man-vit mikit;
auði bętra · þykkir þat í ǫ·kunnum stað;
s·líkt es vá-laðs vera.

A better burden bears man not on the road
than much manwit.
In an unknown place it seems better than wealth;
such is the destitute man's shelter.

**11** Byrði bętri · berr=at maðr brautu at, [R 3r/24]
an séi man-vit mikit;
veg-nest verra · vegr=a vęlli at,
an séi of·drykkja ǫls.

A better burden bears man not on the road
than much manwit.
Worse way-provision he drags not along on the plain
than an overdrinking of ale.

3 vęlli at 'on the plain' | I.e., 'in the wilderness, outside', in contrast to the safety of one's home village. The word *vǫllr* 'plain, (uncultivated) field' is used in the same sense in sts. 38 and 49 below. It is easily understood that the wild heaths and plains of Iron Age Norway were particularly unsafe places whereon a traveller needed to keep his wits about him, lest he fall prey to highwaymen (so st. 38).

**12** Es=a svá gótt, · sęm gótt kveða, [R 3r/25]
ǫl alda sonum;
því't fǽra vęit, · es flęira drekkr,
síns til gęðs gumi.

It is not so good as they call it good,
ale, for the sons of men,
for the less he knows as the more he drinks
man of his own sense.

**13** Ȯ·minnis-hęgri hęitir, · sá's yfir ǫlðrum þrumir, [R 3r/27]
hann stelr gęði guma;
þęss fogls fjǫðrum · ek fjǫtraðr vas'k
í garði Gunn·laðar.

Forgetfulness-heron is he called who hovers over ale-feasts;
he robs man of his senses.
By that bird's feathers I was fettered
in Guthlathe's yard.

---

1 Ȯ·minnis-hęgri 'Forgetfulness-heron' | Lit., 'unmemory-heron', the personification of drunkenness as a hovering bird.

3–4 þęss fogls fjǫðrum · ek fjǫtraðr vas'k í garði Gunn·laðar 'By that bird's feathers I was fettered in Guthlathe's yard.' | The first use of the first-person pronoun in the poem. — The myth alluded to is Weden's theft of the Mead of Poetry from Sutting's daughter, Guthlathe (Gunn·lǫð). For this myth see introduction to sts. 103–110 below. In the version told in *Skm* Weden does indeed drink all of the Mead, but he soon spits it out again and shows no adverse effects. On the other hand the implication behind the present stanza seems to be that the Mead had the drawbacks of normal alcohol. If this be the case it might lend support to the theory that the Guests' Strand and the later parts of *Háv* were originally separate compositions since no drunkenness is found in *Háv* 103–110, although it could also be taken symbolically since too great wisdom is not a good thing (cf. sts. 53–56 below). Cf. the following st. 14.

**14** Ǫlr ek varð, · varð ofr·ǫlvi, [R 3r/29]
at hins fróða Fjalars;
því es ǫlðr batst*, · at aptr of hęimtir
hvęrr sitt gęð gumi.

Drunk I became—became the dead-drunkest—
at the learned Fealer's.
Thus that ale-feast is best where every man
gets back to his senses.

---

3 batst* | *gramm. emend.;* batstr *(m. nom. sg.)* R

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1–2 Ǫlr ek varð ... at hins fróða Fjalars 'Drunk I became ... at the learned Fealer's' | Possibly another reference to the Mead of Poetry, for Fealer was one of the two dwarfs who slew Quasher and made the mead. Again the sense seems to be that Weden got drunk on it, but since Weden (in the attested versions of the myth) never meets the two dwarfs the mention of them may be metaphorical. Fealer may also be a variant name for Sutting, Guthlathe's father.

**15** Þagalt ok hugalt · skyli þjóðans barn [R 3r/31]
ok víg-djarft vesa;
glaðr ok rękifr · skyli gumna hvęrr,
und's sínn bíðr bana.

Silent and thoughtful should the king's child be
and battle-bold.

Glad and cheerful should every man be
till he suffers his bane.

**16** Ǫ́·snjallr maðr · hygg=sk munu ęy lifa, [R 3v/1]
ef við víg vara=sk;
ęn ęlli gefr hǫnum · ęngi frið,
þó'tt hǫnum gęirar gefi.

The unvalorous man thinks he will live for ever
if he is wary of war,
but old age gives him no peace
though the spears might give it to him.

ALL | The coward may have been spared pain by the spears, but he cannot avoid the suffering of infirm old age (which in a world before modern medicine was even greater than today, consider just as one example the loss of all teeth). *It* will never spare him. The subtext is that since death is unavoidable it is better to live an honourable life and die young than a cowardly one and die of old age. This appears related to the negative view of the *strá-dauði* 'straw-death' (actually a hapax, only attested in *Korm* 85, SkP 5), i.e., death in bed from old age or sickness. Compare the speech attributed to the 10th century warrior Eyel Woolserk before a battle, in *HákGóð* 23: *Þat óttuðumk ek um hríð, er friðr þessi inn mikli var, at ek mynda verða elli-dauðr inni á pall-strám mínum; en ek vilda heldr falla í orrostu ok fylgja hǫfðingja mínum; kann nú vera, at svá megi verða.* 'I long feared while this great peace lasted that I would die of old age indoors upon my straw bed, but I would rather fall in battle and follow my chieftain; now it may be that it turns out so.' A similar contempt for life as mere living is common in the older heroic literature (e.g., *Fáfn* 10, *Akv* 23–27), written as it was to celebrate (the lives of) young kings and warriors. Even so, it must be said that *Háv* is uniquely nuanced in this regard (cf. especially sts. 69–71 below), not unlikely since its author was himself an old man, rather than a young warrior-poet.

**17** Kópir af·glapi, · es til kynnis kømr, [R 3v/3]
þyl=sk hann umb eða þrumir;
allt es sęnn, · ef sylg of getr,
uppi 's þá gęð guma.

The oaf gapes when he comes to visit;
he mumbles about or loiters.
All at once if a sip he gets
exposed is the mind of the man.

**18** Sá ęinn vęit, · es víða ratar [R 3v/5]
ok hęfr fjǫlð of farit,
hvęrju gęði · stýrir gumna hvęrr,
sá es vitandi 's vits.

He alone knows who widely roams
and has journeyed much,
which sort of mind every man wields,
who is knowing of his wits.

ALL | Only he who has seen the world knows how a wise man should think and conduct himself.

2 hęfr fjǫlð of farit 'has journeyed much' | Cf. *Vafþ* 3, 44, et.c., where Weden repeats: *Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð frętaða'k, // fjǫlð ek reynda regin* 'Much I journeyed, much I tried, much I tested the Reins.'

**19** Haldi=t maðr á kęri, · drikki þó at hófi mjǫð, [R 3v/7]
2 męli þarft eða þęgi;
ǫ·kynnis þęss · váar þik ęngi maðr,
4 at þú gangir snimma at sofa.

Man ought not to hold onto the cask, ought yet to drink mead in moderation;
he ought to speak the needful or shut up.
For that uncouthness will no man blame thee,
that thou go early to sleep.

1 Haldi=t maðr á kęri 'Man ought not to hold onto the cask' | This line has been variously interpreted, but is generally understood as referring to a type of toast (cf. Olsen 1938, pp. 158–165). Finnur Jónsson suggests that we are dealing with a *svęitar-drykkja* 'company-toast', where the drinking vessel would be passed around in a circle and each recipient would drink in turn (Olsen 1938, pp. 160–161). Such toasts were drunk for a long time in Northern Europe, and are the likely the origin of the Scandinavian toasting-word, *skål* 'prosit, cheers!', lit. 'bowl!' "Holding onto" the vessel (and not letting the next person drink) would surely be seen as very rude, so the sense is that one should drink his share, but not too much; indeed, in 1519 a man in Jämtland was killed in an argument resulting from his refusal to pass on the bowl during a similar toast (Sjöberg 1907).
Olsen (1938)[161–165], who was not aware of the 1519 legal proceeding, doubts that such a delay could happen, and in any case thinks that it would not be common enough to justify a general warning against it in an advice-poem. He instead argues that the line refers to a type of drinking where each man is holding his own smaller legless horn, which cannot be put down except emptied. "Holding onto" the horn would thus be referring to holding a half-full horn in one's hand rather than drinking up and refilling it in order to keep partaking in the toasts. The sense of the whole stanza would then be that when one is at a party it is best to keep with the festive spirit and drink, rather than act "uncouthly" by sitting with a half-full horn and refusing to toast. One should still not drink too much, but, rather than "holding onto" a horn, it is better simply to go to sleep when one feels he has drunk enough; that is a lesser uncouthness than refusing to toast.

2 męli þarft eða þęgi 'he ought to speak the needful or shut up' | This line occurs identically in *Vafþ* 10/2.

**20** Grǫðugr halr, · nema gęðs viti, [R 3v/9]
2 etr sér aldr-trega;
opt fęr hlǿgis, · es með horskum kømr,
4 manni hęimskum magi.

The gluttonous man—unless he know his sense—
eats himself a life-sorrow.
Oft the belly when among the sharp he comes
brings the foolish man ridicule.

2 etr sér aldr-trega 'eats himself a life-sorrow' | Or, 'eats himself to death.'

**21** Hjarðir þat vitu, · nęr hęim skulu, [R 3v/11]
ok ganga þá af grasi;
ęn ó·sviðr maðr · kann évа=gi
sĩns of mál* maga.

Herds know it when they shall turn home
and then part from the grass,
but the unwise man never knows
his own belly's measure.

4 mál* | *gramm. emend.;* máls **R**

**22** Ve-sall maðr · ok illa skapi [R 3v/13]
hlér at hví-vetna;
hitt=ki hann vęit, · es vita þyrpti,
at hann es=*a* vamma vanr.

The wretched man and ill turned out
laughs at anything,
yet he knows not what he would need to know:
that he is not free of blemishes.

4 es=*a* | *sens. emend.;* es **R**

ALL | The wretched man laughs at the flaws of others, not realising that the same flaws are found just as much in himself.

4 hann es=*a* vamma vanr 'he is not free of blemishes' | Formulaic, cf. *Lok* 30: *es=a þér vamma vant* 'thou art not free of blemishes'.

**23** Ó·sviðr maðr · vakir umb allar nętr [R 3v/14]
ok hyggr at hví-vetna;
þá es móðr, · es at morni kømr;
alt es víl sęm vas.

The unwise man is awake during all nights
and thinks about anything.
Then he is weary when the morning comes;
all the trouble is as it was.

**24** Ó·snotr maðr · hyggr sér alla vesa [R 3v/16]
við·hlęjęndr vini;
hitt=ki hann fiðr, · þó'tt of hann fár lesi,
ef með snotrum sitr.

The unclever man thinks all those
who laugh with him are his friends,

yet he does not find that they make sport of him,
if among the clever he sits.

**25** Ǫ́·snotr maðr · hyggr sér alla vesa [R 3v/18]
2 við·hléjęndr vini;
þá þat fiðr · es at þingi kømr,
4 at á for·mélęndr fáa.

The unclever man thinks all those
who laugh with him are his friends.
Then he finds when to the Thing he comes
that he has spokesmen few.

---

4 á for·mélęndr fáa 'has spokesmen few' | Repeated in st. 62; cf. note there. The Thing was the Germanic legal assembly, where small disputes could easily turn into deadly feuds, so the import is that true friends are proven in conflict, not in drunken revelry.

**26** Ǫ́·snotr maðr · þykki=sk allt vita, [R 3v/20]
2 ef á sér í vǫ́ veru;
hitt=ki hann vęit, · hvat skal við kveða,
4 ef hans frękista firar.

The unclever man seems to know everything
if he takes shelter in a nook,
yet he knows not what he shall answer
if men test him.

---

2 vǫ́ 'nook' | From earlier **vrǫ́*; cf. Swedish *vrå* 'corner, nook', rare English *wroo* 'id.' The present stanza is one of two Norse attestations of this word in the form *vǫ́* (the other being *Sigsk* 29/3), featuring an irregular West Norse sound change from *vr-* > *v-*. The normal change *vr-* > *r-* yields *rǫ́*, which is the form this word otherwise takes in prose. This includes *FGT* 1950 where *rǫ́* is brought up as an example of a word with nasal *ǫ́* and contrasted with the oral *ǫ́* in *rǫ́* 'sailyard'. It is plausible that *vǫ́* be a form of earlier **vrǫ́* after alliteration between *vr-* and *v-* had become impossible due to the sound change *vr-* > *r-*. Since old *vr-* is never found in dateable Scaldic poetry composed after ca. 1000 AD, and only twice in poetry composed ca. 900 AD (Egill Frag 1 and Eil *Þdr* 22, both in SkP 3) this serves as a dating criterion for the present stanza, even moreso since there is nothing to suggest that the word pair **vrǫ́* and *vera* was ever formulaic. For a more certain instance of alliterating *vr-* and *v-* cf. *Háv* 32/2 below; for discussion of the validity this criterion see Haukur Þorgeirsson (2016), Males (2024b, pp. 87–92).

**27** Ǫ́·snotr *maðr* · es með aldir kømr, [R 3v/21]
2 þat 's batst at hann þęgi;
ęngi þat vęit, · at hann ękki kann,
4 nema hann méli til mart;
vęit=a maðr, · hinn's vét=ki vęit,
6 þó'tt hann méli til mart.

The unclever man who comes amidst folk—
it is best that he shut up.
No one knows that he nothing knows
unless he speak too much;
the man who knows nothing does not know
that he speaks too much.

1 *maðr* | *sens. emend.; om.* **R**.

**28** Fróðr sá þykk*i=sk, · es fregna kann, [R 3v/24]
ok sęgja hit sama,
ęy-vitu lęyna · męgu ýta synir
því es gęngr of guma.

Learned seems he who can ask
and answer in the same way.
In no way may the sons of men hide
that which eludes an earthling.

1 þykk*i=sk | 'þycciriz' *(with erroneous abbrev. mark for* -ir-*)* **R**

1–2 fregna ... sęgja 'ask ... answer' | These two verbs are also paired in st. 63.

3–4 ęy-vitu ... guma. 'In no way ... earthling.' | I.e., 'in no way may man hide his ignorance' when asked a question to which he does not know the answer; the mixing of singular and plural is unusual but not unparallelled in ON.

**29** Órna męlir, · sá's ęva þęgir, [R 3v/26]
stað-lausu stafi;
hrað-męlt tunga, · nema haldęndr ęigi,
opt sér ǫ·gótt of gęlr.

He who never shuts up speaks plenty
utterings of absurdity.
A quick-spoken tongue—unless it be held in place—
oft sings evil [into being] for itself.

3–4 hrað-męlt ... of gęlr 'A quick-spoken ... for itself' | Likely formulaic or proverbial. Cf. *Lok* 31.

3 nema haldęndr ęigi 'unless it be held in place' | Lit. 'unless holders own it' or 'unless it own holders' (both words are grammatically ambiguous), the "holders" perhaps being the teeth which hold the tongue in place. Cf. the modern Scandinavian idiom Swedish *hålla tand för tunga*, Danish *holde tand for tunge* 'keep one's mouth shut', lit. 'hold tooth before tongue'.

**30** At auga-bragði · skal=a maðr annan hafa, [R 3v/28]
þó'tt til kynnis komi;
margr fróðr þykki=sk, · ef freginn es=at

ok nái þurr-fjallr þruma.

Into the subject of glances shall man not make another,
although he comes to his home.
Many a one seems learned if he is not asked
and gets to loiter about dry-skinned.

4 þurr-fjallr 'dry-skinned' | I.e., 'untested', equivalent to the English idiom *get one's feet wet*. The word *fell* ~ *fjall* 'skin, pelt' is rare in Old Norse literature and only occurs in cpds, e.g. *Vkv* 11: *ber-fjall* 'bear-pelt'. It survives in modern Swedish *fjäll* 'scale (on fish and reptiles)'

**31** [R 3v/30]

Fróðr þykki=sk · sá's flótta tękr
gęstr at gęst hę̨ðinn;
vęit=a gǫr=la · sá's of verði glissir,
þó'tt með grǫmum glami.

Learned seems he who takes to flight,
the guest, from a hostile guest.
He knows not fully when he grins o'er the food
that he be flirting with fiends.

2 hę̨ðinn 'hostile' | *metr. emend.;* hę́ðinn *'scoffing'* **R**

ALL | The situation hinted at in sts. 31–32 is that two guests, each unknown to the other, have come to the same homestead. The sense of st. 31 is that when mocked by a stranger it is best not to engage since the dealing may quickly turn violent. Cf. sts. 122, 123, and 125.

2 hę̨ðinn 'hostile' | The short vowel is metrically required since a Leeds-meter c-verse cannot end in a trochée where the first syllable is long. The pres. ed. follows Finnur Jónsson (1932) in seeing an otherwise unattested **hę̨ðinn* derived from *hǫðr* 'battle', but most eds. retain the **R** form *hę́ðinn* 'scoffing'.

**32** [R 4r/1]

Gumnar margir · eru=sk gagn-hollir,
ę̨n at vir*ði *v*reka=sk;
aldar róg · þat mun ę́ vesa;
órir gęstr við gęst.

Many men are well true to each other,
but over food drive each other away.
The strife of mankind will that for ever be;
guest raves against guest.

2 vir*ði | 'viriþi' *(with confused abbrev. mark for* -ri-*)* **R**

2 at vir*ði *v*reka=sk 'over food drive each other away' | The archaic initial *vr-* in *vreka=sk* must be restored for metrical reasons; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n. above. This is a demonstrably archaic feature since the pairing *verðr* 'food, a meal', *vreka* 'drive away' does not appear to be formulaic and since *reka* (< *vreka*) alliterates exclusively with *r-* in the extant Scaldic corpus.

**33** Ár=liga verðar · skyli maðr opt fáa, [R 4r/3]
nema til kynnis komi;
sitr ok snópir, · lętr sęm solginn séi,
ok kann fregna at fǫ́u.

An early meal should man oft get
unless he should come to visit;
he sits and sulks, sounds as if starved,
and can ask about little.

**34** Af·hvarf mikit · es til ills vinar, [R 4r/4]
þó'tt á brautu búi,
ęn til góðs vinar · liggja gagn-vegir,
þó'tt hann séi firr farinn.

A great off-turn it is to a bad friend
though on the road he live,
but to a good friend lie pleasant ways
though he be far travelled.

**35** Ganga *skal*, · skal=a gęstr vesa [R 4r/6]
ęy í ęinum stað;
ljúfr verðr lęiðr, · ef lęngi sitr
annars flętjum á.

One shall go on; one shall not be a guest
for ever in one place.
The loved becomes loathed if for long he sits
on another man's benches.

1 *skal* | *sens. emend.; om. (by parablepsis)* **R**

ALL | It is best not to outstay one's welcome. The customary length of stay in old times was three nights, as noted in *Eg*, ch. 78: *þat var engi siðr, at sitja lengr en þrjár nętr at kynni* 'it was not customary to stay longer than three nights when visiting.' Compare a much more recent Jutlandish saying: *en tredje dags gjæst stinker* 'a third day's guest stinks', which closely resembles a contemporary American maxim popularly attributed to Benjamin Franklin: "Guests, like fish, begin to smell after three days." It is probably inspired by such proverbs that Auden and Taylor translate the last two lines of this stanza as "He starts to stink who outstays his welcome, / in a hall that is not his own."

**36** Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi, [R 4r/7]
halr es hęima hvęrr;
þó'tt tvę́r gęitr ęigi · ok taug-ręptan sal,
þat 's þó bętra an bǿn.

A dwelling is better though small it be;
each is a hero at home.
Though two goats he own and a cord-roofed hall,
that is yet better than begging.

---

1 Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi | The b-verse of the first line is missing the necessary alliteration, but no good emendation suggests itself and the sense is perfect.

1 bętra 'better' | I.e., better than the alternative.

3 taug-ręptan sal 'a cord-roofed hall' | A shack with the birch-bark shingles (cf. st. 60) hung on ropes rather than on proper wooden rafters.

**37** Bú es bętra, · þó'tt lítit séi, [R 4r/9]
halr es hęima hvęrr;
blóðugt es hjarta · þęim's biðja skal
sér ǐ mál hvęrt matar.

A dwelling is better though small it be;
each is a hero at home.
Bloody is the heart in him who shall beg
for his every meal of food.

**38** Vǫpnum sǐnum · skal=a maðr vęlli á [R 4r/10]
feti ganga framarr,
því't ǫ·víst 's at vita, · nęr verðr á vegum úti
gęirs of þǫrf guma.

From his weapons shall man on the plain
not take one step further,
for it is unsure to know when on the ways outside
man comes in need of a spear.

---

1 vęlli á 'on the plain' | Formulaic, see note to st. 11.

2 feti ganga framarr 'take one step further' | Formulaic c-line, also occurring in *Lok* 1/2 (*feti gangir framarr*) and *Ski* 40/2 (*stígir feti framarr*).

4 of þǫrf 'need' | The prenominal particle *of* is an archaic feature (cf. st. 4/3 above), but it does not appear to correspond to a prefix in West Germanic or Gothic.

**39** Fann'k=a mildan mann · eða svá matar góðan, [R 4r/12]
at vęri=t þiggja þegit;
eða sǐns féar · svá=gi [...],
at lęið séi laun, ef þegi.

I found no generous man nor one so good of meat
that a gift would not be accepted,

nor one with his money so not [stingy]
that repayments would be loathed if he might get them.

ALL | The Wanderer has found no man so generous that he would refuse a gift formally presented to him, nor decline a small present as thanks for his generosity.

1 matar góðan 'good of meat' | A positive Wiking Age expression also found in memorial inscriptions on Swedish runestones; see Index.

3 féar 'money' | The base sense of ON *fé* is 'cattle, livestock', but it also has the sense 'money, movable property' which is how it is used in the present stanza; see Index: fee. In the translation of the present poem the English word 'money' exclusively stands for ON *fé*, which however is also translated as 'kine'.

3 [...] '[stingy]' | It is doubtless that a word has been lost here, although no gap is indicated in **R**. Both meter and sense require a word, likely an adjective in the m. acc. sg. Finnur Jónsson (1932) suggests *gløggvan* 'miserly, stingy', giving a litotes 'so not stingy', i.e., 'so generous', and this is adopted in the translation.

**40** Féar síns, · es fęngit hęfr, [**R** 4r/14]
skyli=t maðr þǫrf þola;
opt sparir lęiðum · þat's hęfr ljúfum hugat;
mart gęngr verr an varir.

Of his own money which he has earned
should man not suffer need.
Oft one saves for the loathed what one has meant for the loved;
much goes worse than one expects.

ALL | The sense is that it is bad to hoard one's savings to the point of deprivation since one never knows quite how things will turn out.

**41** Vǫpnum ok vǫðum · skulu vinir glęðja=sk; [**R** 4r/16]
þat 's á sjǫlfum sýnst;
viðr-gefęndr ok ęndr-gefęndr · eru=sk vinir lęngst,
ef þat bíðr at verða vęl.

With weapons and garments shall friends gladden each other;
that is best seen on oneself.
Givers-back and givers-again are friends for the longest
if it awaits to turn out well.

ALL | Friends must help strengthen each other so that they may come to each other's aid in the future; friendship requires both giving and receiving. With this stanza, the Wanderer introduces a thematic group of stanzas (41–47) united by a discussion of friendship, its nature and importance. Friendship is further discussed in sts. 24–25, 34–35, 50–52, 66–67, 119–121, and 124. The importance of friendship has been dealt with by Aristotle in his *Nicomachean Ethics*, books 8–9, the contents of which may be compared with those of *Háv* for deeper understanding.

1 Vǫpnum ok vǫðum 'With weapons and garments' | I.e., with arms, for the *váðir* 'garments' are probably no women's silks. This alliterative word-pair is formulaic and in other occurrences exclusively refers to implements of war; cf., e.g., *Beow* 39, where Shield's pyre-ship is loaded with *hilde-wǽpnum · ǫnd heaðo-wédum* 'war-weapons and battle-garments'.

2 þat 's á sjǫlfum sýnst 'that is best seen on oneself' | I.e., in one's own lived experience.

4 þat 'it' | The friendship.

**42** Vin sínum · skal maðr vinr vesa, [R 4r/18]
ok gjalda gjǫf við gjǫf;
hlátr við hlátri · skyli hǫlðar taka,
ǫn lausung við lygi.

With his friend shall man be a friend
and pay gift against gift;
laughter for laughter should men employ—
but duplicity for lie.

**43** Vin sínum · skal maðr vinr vesa, [R 4r/19]
þeim ok þess vin;
ǫn ó·vinar síns · skyli engi maðr
vinar vinr vesa.

With his friend shall man be a friend,
with him and with his friend,
but his enemy's, should no man,
friend's friend be.

**44** Veitst, ef þú vin átt, · þann's vel trúir [R 4r/21]
ok vilt af hǫnum gótt geta,
geðði skalt við þann · ok gjǫfum skipta,
fara at finna opt.

Thou knowest, if thou hast a friend whom thou trustest well
and wilt get good things from him:
thoughts and gifts shalt thou exchange with him;
journey to find him oft.

---

ALL | Stanzas 44–46 are structurally identical. Lines 1 and 4 are repeated near-identically in st. 119 below.

3 skalt 'shalt thou' | This verb (also found in sts. 45/3 and 46/3) is the only direct admonition to the listener in the Guests' Strand, which, unlike the Speeches of Loddfathomer (sts. 111–137), entirely avoids imperative verbs; cf. Introduction to *Háv* above.

**45** Ef þú átt annan, · þann's illa trúir, [R 4r/23]
vilt af hǫnum þó gótt geta,
fagrt skalt méla við þann, · ǫn flátt hyggja
ok gjalda lausung við lygi.

If thou hast another whom thou trustest ill,
yet thou wilt get good things from him:
fairly shalt thou speak with him, but think falsely
and pay duplicity for lie.

---

3 fagrt … mę́la, flátt hyggja ‘fairly … speak, think falsely’ | Formulaic pair, cf. sts. 90, 91.

**46** Þat ’s ę́nn umb þann, · es þú illa trúir [R 4r/25]
ok þér es grunr at gę́ði,
hlę́ja skalt við þę́im · ok umb hug mę́la;
g·lík skulu gjǫld gjǫfum.

This is yet about him whom thou trustest ill
and about whom thou hast doubt:
laugh shalt thou with him, and speak with care;
repayments shall be equal to gifts.

**47** Ungr vas’k forðum, · fór’k ę́inn saman, [R 4r/28]
þá varð’k villr vega;
auðigr þótt=umk, · es annan fann’k,
maðr es manns gaman.

Young was I once; I journeyed alone;
then I became lost of ways.
Wealthy I thought me when another I found;
man is man’s pleasure.

---

ALL | This rightly acclaimed stanza serves to nuance the transactional view of friendship seen in sts. 42–46. Companionship is important in its own right.

**48** Mildir fróknir · mę́nn batst lifa, [R 4r/29]
sjaldan sút ala;
ę́n ó·snjallr maðr · uggir hvat-vetna,
sýtir ę́ gløggr við gjǫfum.

Generous, brave men live best;
seldom they nourish sorrow—
but the unvalorous man is frightened by anything,
the stingy always grieves over gifts.

---

3–4 ó·snjallr, gløggr ‘unvalorous, stingy’ | Contrasting respectively with *frókn, mildr* ‘brave, generous’ in the first half of the stanza; a very fine parallelism.

4 sýtir ę́ gløggr við gjǫfum ‘the stingy always grieves over gifts’ | After receiving a gift, one was culturally obliged to give something back. Cf. sts. 39, 145.

**49** Váðir mǐnar · gaf'k vęlli at [R 4r/31]
2 tvęim tré-mǫnnum;
rikkar þat þóttu=sk, · es ript hǫfðu;
4 nęiss es nǫkkviðr halr.

My garments I gave upon the plain
to two tree-men.
Champions they seemed when cloaks they had;
shameful is the naked hero.

---

ALL | This stanza is somewhat difficult, but I see in it the following scene: The Wanderer comes walking along on the plain when he sees the two unadorned tree-men. Taking pity for the sorry-looking stick figures, he lends them some clothes, and from afar they now look like imposing warriors. Just such a frail, freezing figure, thinks he, is man in his naked state; it is his clothes that afford the hero his status, and even the weak stick-man can look like a champion. Clearly this is quite a different view from the pre-Christian Greek celebration of the naked body, but in the cold Northern climes there was hardly room for public nakedness.

2 tré-mǫnnum 'tree-men' | Man-shaped wooden figures. Much has been made of their appearance here, including seeing them as cultic idols, but whatever the case, the tone in the stanza is more pessimistic than reverent. Cf. the three stanzas spoken by a tree-man in *Ragn* (*Ragn* 38–40 in SkP 8) and notes there.

4 halr 'hero' | The use of *halr* 'hero, warrior' (cf. sts. 36, 37) rather than the more neutral *maðr* 'man, person' is probably intentional.

**50** Hrørnar þǫll, · sú's stęndr þorpi á, [R 4r/33]
2 hlýr=*at* hęnni bǫrkr né barr;
svá es maðr, · sá's mann=gi ann;
4 hvat skal hann lęngi lifa?

Withers the pine that stands on the yard;
her shields no bark nor leaf.
So is the man who loves no man—
why shall he live for long?

---

2 hlýr=*at* | 'hlyrar' **R**

---

ALL | Ll. 1–2 give an analogical example taken from the natural world, which is then equated to the world of humans in ll. 3–4. The same stylistic trick is also used below in sts. 57 (fire) and 62 (the eagle).

2 hlýr=*at* hęnni bǫrkr né barr 'her shields no bark nor leaf' | For her (ON *þǫll* 'pine' is feminine) leaves and branches are eaten by the fourfoot, her bark stripped by the twofoot, perhaps for the making of bark-flour, as was done during hard times into the 19th century.

**51** Ęldi hęitari · brinnr með illum vinum [R 4v/2]
2 friðr fimm daga,
ęn þá sloknar, · es hinn sétti kømr,
4 ok versnar allr vin-skapr.

Hotter than fire among bad friends burns
love, for five days,
but then goes out when the sixth one comes
and all the friendship worsens.

2 fimm daga ‘for five days’ | I.e., “for a week”, which was originally five days long. The sense is that the bad friends quickly tire of each other when staying together for an extended period of time. See also st. 74 and Index: five days.

**52** Mikit ęitt · skal=a manni gefa; [R 4v/4]
opt kaupir sér ĩ lítlu lof;
með hǫlfum hlęif · ok með hǫllu kęri
fekk ek mér fé-laga.

Much at once shall one not give a man;
oft one buys himself goodwill for little.
With half a loaf and a sloping cask
I got myself a fellow.

4 fé-laga ‘fellow’ | A business partner or companion, one with whom one participates in a *fé-lag* ‘fellowship, common financial venture’. This word, which appears not infrequently on rune-stones, has been described as the single most important word for understanding the Wiking Age, when social ties were weakened and groups of sworn companions embarked on piratical and mercenary expeditions. Cf. Khlevov (2025).

**53** Lítilla sanda, · lítilla sęva, [R 4v/6]
lítil eru gęð guma;
því't allir mędnn · urðu=t jafn-spakir;
hǫlf es ǫld hvar.

Of small sands, of small seas:
small are the senses of man.
For all men have not become evenly wise;
man is everywhere half.

3 því't | því **R**

ALL | With this stanza the subject of the advice shifts from friendship to wisdom, carried through sts. 53–57.

1 Lítilla sanda, · lítilla sęva ‘Of small sands, of small seas’ | Most likely a partitive genitive, but the sense is not certain; in any case, the genitive excludes the translation “where sands are small, seas are small”. I find the most likely reading to be a declaration of the smallness of man’s horizons; the world will always be far greater than he, and there will always be much of which he is unwise.

3–4 því't allir mędnn · urðu=t jafn-spakir; hǫlf es ǫld hvar. ‘For all men have not become evenly wise; man is everywhere half.’ | I find the interpretation of Guðmundur Finnbogason (1929) most convincing: intellectual faculties have not been distributed evenly among men, and so every one has his own strengths and weaknesses; all men are “half” (or “incomplete”, for it should be noted that ON *halfr* ‘half’ has a sense of “incompleteness” not always found in its modern English cognate). This interpretation accords well with sts. 71 and 132 below. In the hyperspecialized modern world it is probably truer than ever.

**54** Meðal-snotr · skyli manna hvęrr, [R 4v/7]
ęva til snotr séi;
þęim es fyrða · fęgrst at lifa,
es vęl mart vitu.

Middle-clever should each man be;
never too clever.
For those folk it is fairest to live,
who know well enough.

**55** Meðal-snotr · skyli manna hvęrr, [R 4v/9]
ęva til snotr séi;
því't snotrs manns hjarta · verðr sjaldan glatt,
ef sá 's al-snotr es á.

Middle-clever should each man be;
never too clever,
for the clever man's heart is seldom glad,
if its owner is all-clever.

**56** Meðal-snotr · skyli manna hvęrr, [R 4v/10]
ęva til snotr séi;
ør·lǫg sín · viti ęngi maðr fyrir;
þęim es sorga-lausastr sefi.

Middle-clever should each man be;
never too clever.
His own orlay ought no man to know ahead;
his is the most sorrowless mind.

3 ør·lǫg 'orlay' | One's predetermined fate or course of life. See *Vsp* 19 n.

4 þęim es sorga-lausastr sefi 'his is the most sorrowless mind.' | His, who is ignorant of his fate. It is surely fitting that Weden should say this, having knowledge of the inevitable destruction of both the world and himself at the Rakes of the Reins (*Vsp* 51, *Vafþ* 52–53).

**57** Brandr af brandi · brinnr und's brunninn es, [R 4v/11]
funi kvęyki=sk af funa;
maðr af manni · verðr at máli kuðr;
ęn til dólskr af dul.

Fire from fire burns till it is burned;
flame is quickened by flame.
Man to man makes himself known through speech,
but the too boorish from folly.

ALL | For the stylistic device see st. 50 n. — The sense of the advice is not entirely clear; I take it to mean that a wise man uses careful speech to introduce himself and state his needs, whereas the fool speaks too much and thereby reveals his inexperience and naive character, in a word, his lack of manwit.

4 dólskr 'boorish' | Derived from an ablaut variant of *dalr* 'valley, dale' + *-iskr* '-ish', the sense being 'provincial, not having left his (home) valley'; cf. English hillbilly. The same ablaut underlies the Icelandic tribal names *vatns-dólir* and *lang-dólir* 'inhabitants of Waterdale (*Vatns-dalr*), Longdale (*Lang-dalr*)'.

**58** Ár skal rísa, · *sá*'s annars vill [R 4v/13]
fé eða fjǫr hafa;
sjaldan liggjandi ulfr · lęr of getr,
né sofandi maðr sigr.

Early shall he rise who another man's
money or life will have.
Seldom the resting wolf gets the thigh,
or the sleeping man victory.

1 *sá*'s | *emend. by analogy (st. 59/1);* es *('*er', *for* *'sa er', *by parablepsis)* **R**.

ALL | A close analogue to this stanza is found in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 5.7.3: *Pernox enim et pervigil esse debet alienum appetens culmen. Nemo stertendo victoriam cepit, nec luporum quisquam cubando cadaver invenit.* 'Whoever intends to scale another's pinnacle must be watchful and wakeful. Nobody has ever won victory by snoring, nor has any sleeping wolf found a carcass.'

2 fé eða fjǫr 'money or life' | A formulaic word-pair found over 30 times in Norse prose, especially in laws (ONP). The expression is also found in mediaeval English and Frisian laws, as OE *feoh and feorh*, OF *fia ande ferech*.

**59** Ár skal rísa, · sá's á yrkjęndr fáa, [R 4v/15]
ok ganga sĩns verka à vit;
mart of dvęlr · þann's umb morgin søfr,
halfr es auðr und hvǫtum.

Early shall he rise who has workmen few,
and go his work to meet.
Much is kept back from him who sleeps through the morning;
a half wealth is due the brisk.

ALL | The stanza contrasts *sá's umb morgin søfr* 'the one who sleeps through the morning' with the *hvatr* 'brisk, fleet, energetic' man. Though the manliness of the former does not come under direct attack here, similar comparisons occur throughout Norse literature, particularly between cowardly, uxorious stay-at-homes and brave, adventurous warriors (cf. Anon *Bjark* 2, Þhorn *Harkv* 6 in SkP). In contrast to those instances, the present stanza stands out in its setting being that of the farmstead rather than the battlefield, though this is in agreement with the rest of Guests' Strand (cf., e.g., sts. 32, 36–37, 40, 52, 60–61, 67, 70–71).

4 halfr es auðr und hvǫtum 'a half wealth is due the brisk' | The brisk man has already claimed a half fortune by waking up early.

**60** Þurra skíða · ok þakinna néfra, [R 4v/17]
2 þęss kann maðr mjǫt,
*o*k þęss viðar, · es vinna=sk męgi
4 mál ok missęri.

Dry billets and birch-bark shingles—
of this man knows the measure,
and of that wood which may be used
for a season and a half-year.

3 *o*k | †ðc† **R**

ALL | The import of the stanza is somewhat unclear. One interpretation is that man best knows the correct proportions or measure (*mjǫt*) of those things upon which he relies for his sustenance and survival, in this case the wood used for keeping him warm over the winter. The fact that he always seems to manage to find the right measure of things when he truly depends on them thus proves the correctness of moderation, and he would do best to apply this sense of moderation or measure in other aspects of his life, e.g., by not drinking, eating, or sleeping too much. The message of the stanza would thus be that of the whole Guests' Strand, namely one of moderation and caution in all things. There may also, however, be a contrast between ll. 1–2, which describe fast-burning wood and tinder, and ll. 3–4, which describe slower burning, heavier wood. In this case the correct proportions would be those between the kindling and heavy firewood, with the implication that one should not put all ones stock in that which burns quickly, yet not entirely neglect the kindling, either. I thank Lars Nordquist for this observation.

1 Þurra skíða 'Dry billets' | Likely referring to slivers of fatwood.

1 þakinna néfra 'birch-bark shingles' | Birch-bark used for roof-shingles, lit. 'thatching birch-bark'.

4 mál ok missęri 'for a season and a half-year' | I.e., 'over a long period', probably the colder months of the year. A *mál* 'season' was a period of three months, and each *missęri* 'half-year' was thus divided into two *mǫl*.

**61** Þvęginn ok męttr · ríði maðr þingi at, [R 4v/19]
2 þó'tt séi=t véddr til vęl;
skúa ok bróka · skammi=sk ęngi maðr
4 né hęsts in hęldr,
þó'tt hann hafi=t góðan.

Washed and fed ought man to ride to the Thing,
although he be not clothed too well.
Of his shoes and breeches ought no man to be ashamed,
nor the more of his horse,
although he haven't a good one.

1 Þveginn ok męttr ‘Washed and fed’ | A formulaic collocation. Cf. *Reg* 25 (*kęmbðr* ‘combed’, *þveginn* ‘washed’, *męttr* ‘fed’) and *Vsp* 33: (*þó* ‘washed’, *kęmbði* ‘combed’). These examples attest to the importance of personal hygiene in the culture, something further seen by the ubiquity of combs in pre-Christian graves (TODO: archaeological reference). The stanza reminds of the following passage from Tacitus *Germania* ch. 22: *Statim ē somnō, quem plērumque in diem extrahunt, lavantur, saepius calidā, ut apud quōs plūrimum hiems occupat. Lautī cibum capiunt: sēparātae singulis sēdēs et sua cuique mēnsa. Tum ad negōtia nec minus saepe ad convīvia prōcēdunt armātī.* ‘On waking from sleep, which they generally prolong to a late hour of the day, they take a bath, oftenest of warm water, which suits a country where winter is the longest of the seasons. After their bath they take their meal, each having a separate seat and table of his own. Then they go armed to business, or no less often to their festal meetings (*convivia*, i.e., the Things).’

5 þó’tt hann hafi=t góðan ‘although he haven’t a good one’ | A metrically unusual line. Without it, l. 4 can be scanned straightforwardly as a c-verse, but then l. 5 comes off as an isolated b-verse. Finnur Jónsson (1932) explains it away by considering l. 5 an interpolation, which is certainly a possibility since its content is entirely superfluous. In that case the interpolator would have interpreted l. 4 (the c-verse) as an a-verse and added l. 5 as a corresponding b-verse. It is also possible that it is an authorial, albeit rare verse-type, for which cf. st. 80/1–2 n.

**62** Snapir ok gnapir, · es til sę́var kømr, [**R** 4v/22]
ǫrn á aldinn mar;
svá es maðr, · es með mǫrgum kømr
ok á for·mę́lęndr fáa.

It snatches and stoops when to the sea it comes,
the eagle on the ancient ocean.
So is the man who comes among the many
and has spokesmen few.

ALL | *Sts. 62–63 are reversed in* **R**, *but a symbol at the start of each indicates that they should switch places.*

ALL | The naturalistic simile is notable; cf. st. 50 n. For an illustration of the situation alluded to see *Hrafnk* 8–11, where two men try to find the support of powerful men on the Icelandic All-Thing for a suit against a chieftain who has slain their young relative.

4 á for·mę́lęndr fáa ‘has spokesmen few’ | Shared with st. 25.

**63** Fregna ok sęgja · skal fróðra hvęrr, [**R** 4v/21]
sá’s vill hęitinn horskr;
ęinn vita · né annarr skal,
þjóð vęit ef þrír ’ro.

Ask and answer shall each learned man
who wishes to be called sharp.
*One* shall know—not another;
people know if there are three.

4 þjóð ‘people’ | By which we should understand ‘many people, everybody’.

**64** Ríki sitt · skyli ráð-snotra [**R** 4v/24]

hvęrr ǐ hófi hafa;
þá þat finnr, · es með fróknum kømr,
at ęngi es ęinna hvatastr.

His own power should each counsel-clever
man use in moderation.
This he then finds when among the brave he comes:
that none is boldest of all.

---

ALL | Man, regardless of his station, should never abuse his power. No height of political power or physical strength will make him invincible, and such abuses will only earn him enemies. Of course the historical examples of great men brought down for misuse of their power are myriad. In Germanic legend a notable example is Ermenric, who ruled the vast realm of the Gots with an iron fist (*Déor* 5), but was maimed by two young boys after he had their sister trampled by horses (*Ghv*, *Hamð*, Jordanes *Getica* 129).
Consider the similar thought of Hobbes ([1651] 1996), ch. 13: "Nature hath made men so equall, in the faculties of body, and mind; as that though there bee found one man sometimes manifestly stronger in body, or of quicker mind then another; yet when all is reckoned together, the difference between man, and man, is not so considerable, as that one man can thereupon claim to himselfe any benefit, to which another may not pretend, as well as he. For as to the strength of body, the weakest has strength enough to kill the strongest, either by secret machination, or by confederacy with others, that are in the same danger with himselfe."

3–4 þá ... ęinna hvatastr 'then ... boldest of all' | Almost identical to *Fáfn* 17/3–4, which however has *fleirum* 'more men' instead of *fróknum* 'the brave'.

**65** Orða þęira, · es maðr ǫðrum sęgir, [R 4v/25]
opt hann gjǫld of getr.

For those words which man says to another
he oft gets recompense.

---

ALL | This half-stanza is an orphan. It may plausibly be connected to the previous st. to form a 6-line Leeds-meter st., for which cf. sts. 6, 27, 102, 103, 138, 165.

**66** Mikils ti*l* snimma · kom'k ǐ marga staði, [R 4v/26]
ęn til síð ǐ suma;
ǫl vas drukkit, · sumt vas ȯ·lagat;
sjaldan hittir lęiðr ǐ lið.

Much too early I came to many places,
but too late to some:
The ale was drunk up, some was unbrewed—
seldom finds the loathed his place.

---

1 Mikils ti*l* 'Much too' | *emend.;* mikilsti **R**

---

ALL | In reality, there was never anything wrong with the ale; it was a mere pretext for dismissing the speaker. There are no wrong times, only wrong people, and it is bad to waste one's time where one is unwanted.

**67** Hér ok hvar · myndi mér hęim of boðit, [R 4v/28]
ef þyrpta'k at mǫlun=gi mat,
eða tvau lęr hęngi · at hins tryggva vinar,
þar's ek hafða ęitt etit.

Here and there would I be invited to a home
if at meal-time I needed no food,
or if two hams should hang at the trusty friend's,
where I had eaten one.

ALL | People are often stingy, especially with food, which was scarce and closely watched among the Norse subsistence farmers. The Wanderer sarcastically notes that even the "trusty friend" would invite him over oftener if he brought more food than he ate; how good of a friend is he, if he's not willing to share his food?

**68** Ęldr es batstr · með ýta sonum [R 4v/30]
ok sólar sýn,
hęil·yndi sitt, · ef maðr hafa náir,
án við lǫst at lifa.

Fire is best among the sons of men,
and the sight of the sun,
a man's good health if he gets to keep it,
[and] living free from vice.

ALL | Sts. 68–77 largely form a thematic unit, reflecting on life, legacy, and lastly death. — The Wanderer celebrates simplicity in life. The best pleasures are not power and wealth, but a hot hearth, the bright rays of the sun in springtime, and staying in good health.

1 Ęldr es batstr 'Fire is best' | And how could it not be, in this cold, northern clime? One is naturally reminded of the opening to Pindar's *Olympian* 1, even more so with the mention of the sun in l. 2, yet whether *batstr* here carries the same sense as Greek ἄριστον is naturally uncertain. Is the poet stressing the quality of fire as an element, or thinking more specifically of the blazing hearth-fire?

4 lǫst 'vice' | Used of an illicit sexual encounter in st. 98 below, but it may also refer to a physical blemish.

**69** Es=at maðr alls ve-sall, · þó'tt séi illa hęill, [R 4v/32]
sumr es af sonum sęll,
sumr af fręndum, · sumr af fé ørnu,
sumr af verkum vęl.

Man is not all unblessed though he be of poor health:
someone becomes blessed from sons,
someone from kinsmen, someone from ample kine,
someone from works done well.

ALL | The strain of thought continues from the previous stanza. Even the man whose health is failing can find joy in something. At the same time there is a difference in the pleasures of the old and the young. In youth good health is taken for granted, but the comforts of infirm old age—sons, kinsmen, kine, and good works—are things one must obtain through work. Thus, the man who neglects his work cannot expect happiness or fortune in old age; indeed, in the end there is no happiness without effort.

1 ve-sall 'unblessed' | I have elsewhere translated *ve-sall* as 'wretched', but in the present stanza I render it literally in order to show the etymological relationship to *sęll* 'blessed' used elsewhere in the stanza. The form *-sall* lacks i-umlaut due to a shortening of the vowel before the umlaut became phonemic; the ancestral Proto-Norse form would be **wajē-sālir*, for which cf. ᚠᚨᛃᛖ-ᛗᚨᚱᛁᛉ *wajē-marir* 'infamous' on the Tjurkö bracteate, where the second element is the ancestor of ON *mærr* 'renowned, famous'; the expected descendant of that word, ON ***ve-marr*, is not attested.
I translate *sęll* as 'blessed', based on the fact that it carries a certain sense of innateness largely foreign to post-Enlightenment Western culture, though it could also be rendered as 'lucky' or 'fortunate'. We may compare the idea of the king's 'luck' (ON *gipt*), which is thought to emanate from his person and shine over his land; in this vein a king whose land experiences bountiful harvests (*ár*) is said to be *ár-sęll* 'blessed with harvests', while one whose reign is one of peace (*friðr*) is said to be *frið-sęll* 'blessed with peace'. Thus the state of the realm is not due to uncontrollable environmental or political factors, nor due to the king's personal choices, but rather arises from the kingly person to the degree that he is favoured and blessed by the Gods. This is thought true also of the private person's life. Similar conceptions are found amongst many other peoples, e.g. the Chinese political concept of the "mandate of Heaven". (TODO: Reference PCRN chapter).

2–3 sonum ... fręndum 'sons ... kinsmen' | Cf. st. 72 below, which stresses the importance of sons and kinsmen. The male perspective may be noted.

**70** Bętra 's lifðum, · *an* sé*i ȯ*-lifðum, [R 5r/2]
2 ęy getr kvikr kú;
ęld sá'k upp brinna · auðgum manni fyr,
4 ęn úti vas dauðr fyr durum.

It is better for the living than it may be for the unliving:
always the quick gets a cow.
I saw a fire burning high for a wealthy man,
but outside he was dead before the doors.

---

1 *an* sé*i ȯ*-lifðum | *emend.; '*ȝ ſęl lıfðo*m'* **R**.

---

1 *an* sé*i ȯ*-lifðum 'than it may be for the unliving' | The reading of **R**, which would be normalised as *ok sęl-lifðum* 'and for the blessed living', is metrically defect, since *sęl-* is strongly stressed and should carry alliteration. For the original form of the line we have a close parallel in *Fáfn* 30: *Hvǫtum 's bętra · an sé ȯ-hvǫtum* 'It is better for the brisk than it may be for the unbrisk', on which the pres. ed. is based. The corruption has probably happened in the following way: **'en'* (younger form of *an* 'than') in the prototype was misinterpreted as *'en'* 'and, but' and copied as *'ȝ'* (the tironian *et*), while **'sé ólıfðo*m' (probably with the words cramped together) became '*sęl lıfðo*m'.

2 ęy getr kvikr kú 'always the cow gets the cow' | I.e., "new opportunities always present themselves for the living". A reference to the cattle-based economy (see also st. 76), the cow being used as a metonym for any means of subsistence. For "quick", cf. churchly English "the quick and the dead", i.e., "the *living* and the dead".

3–4 ęld ... durum. 'A fire ... the doors.' | The fire may be taken to be the man's funeral pyre burning on his farm, on which a considerable amount of his wealth has been spent—according to ibn Fadlan's 10th c. account of the Rus a third of a dead chieftain's wealth was spent on his funeral clothes and another third on alcohol for the wake (Lunde and Stone 2012, p. 49)—yet in spite of the great fire he is just as dead. The following stanza continues this thought. The fire has also been taken as referring to the burning hearth of the wealthy home, whose owner has died outside it. Another reasonable reading is presented by Evans (1986, p. 107), who sees *dauðr* as the noun 'death', and renders ll. 3–4 as "I saw the fire blazing (on the hearth) in front of the rich man; but (unknown to him) death was outside the door." As he notes, the expression *dauði er fyrir durum* 'death is at the door' is attested.

**71** Haltr ríðr hrossi, · hjǫrð rekr handar vanr, [R 5r/3]
2 daufr vegr ok dugir;
blindr es bętri · an bręnndr séi;
4 nýtr mann=gi nás.

A halt man rides a horse; a handless drives a herd;
a deaf man fights and avails.
Blind is better than to be burned;
no man has use for a corpse.

1 handar | *sens. and gramm. emend.;* hundar **R**

3 bręnndr 'burned' | On the funeral pyre. The word 'burned' here means 'dead', in the same way as "six feet under" in modern English; each expression refers to the typical custom of dealing with human remains in the respective culture. This synonymity is an important argument for dating *Háv* to the pre-Christian period, since cremation was reserved for criminals and adulterers in the mediaeval Catholic religion (cf. *Am* 84/1), whereas it in *Háv* seems to be the commonly accepted way of disposing the dead (Males 2024b, pp. 93–96). Cf. Introduction to the poem above and the same semantics in st. 81 below.

**72** Sonr es bętri, · þó'tt séi síð of alinn [R 5r/5]
2 ęptir ginginn guma;
sjaldan bautar-stęinar · standa brautu nęr,
4 nema ręisi niðr at nið.

A son is better though he late be born
after a passed man.
Seldom beat-stones near the highway stand,
save by kinsman for kinsman raised.

ALL | It is a boon and a blessing for a man to have an heir, even if he should die before the son is born. The son will inherit and carry on his father's name, lineage, and memory in a way few non-relatives can, as exemplified by the raising of a stone memorial. In a broader context we may consider how it is only a tiny few out of the great human masses who will leave behind any kind of lasting personal legacy beyond their direct familiar relations. The current generation must soon die off, and even those who in their lifetimes see influence and success in their fields are soon forgotten by posterity and relegated to the footnotes of the annals of history if they have no descendants to carry their names into future ages. It is rare for strangers to tend one's grave.

3 bautar-steinar ‘beat-stones’ | Uninscribed standing stones (sometimes arranged geometrically) raised in memory of the dead, which appear frequently in Norse literature. Cf. *Yng* 8, which describes the laws instituted by the euhemerized Weden: *en eptir alla þá menn, er nǫkkut manns-mót var at, skyldi reisa bauta-steina, ok held=sk sjá siðr lengi síðan.* ‘but in memory of all those men who had possessed masculine virtue beat-stones should be raised, and that custom was upheld for a long time since’. Standing stones are very common throughout Scandinavia and are not infrequently found near grave-mounds.
It must be noted that the raising of such unmarked beat-stones long precedes the rune-stone boom of the Wiking Age. The older, unmarked beat-stones are also more often found in direct funerary contexts. This is rarely the case with Wiking Age rune-stones, which, instead, tend to be placed near important roads or waterways as memorials. It should be noted that in Norway during the Migration Period this distinction between beat-stone and rune-stone was somewhat blurred, and a number of rune-stones from around 3rd to 5th centuries are placed near grave fields. Unlike the later Wiking Age inscriptions, these stones often hold only single personal names or genitive phrases, e.g., KJ 90 from Sunde in Sunnfjord, western Norway: ᚠᛁᛞᚢᚴᚨᛋᛏᛁᚱ **widugastiʀ** ‘Woodguest’ and KJ 78 from Bø, Rogaland, southwestern Norway: ᚺᚾᚨᛒᛞᚨᛋ ᚺᛚᚨᛁᚹᚨ **hnabdas hlaiwa** ‘Naved’s grave’. Others have longer inscriptions, e.g., KJ 75 from Kjølevik, Rogaland: ᚺᚨᛞᚢᛚᚨᛁᚴᚨᛉ ᛖᚲᚺᚨᚷᚢᛋᛏᚨᛞᚨᛉ ᚺᛚᚨᛁᚹᛁᛞᚩᛗᚨᚷᚢᛗᛁᚾᛁᚾᛟ **hadulaikaz ekhagustadaz hlaaiwidomaguminino** ‘Handlac [lies here]. I, Hawstald, buried my lad.’

**73** Tvęir ’ro ęins hęrjar, · tunga es hǫfuðs bani; [R 5r/7]
2 es mér í heðin hvęrn · handar vęni.

Two belong to one host; the tongue is the head’s bane;
in every cloak I expect a hand.

---

ALL | The tongue and head belong to the same body, but the former often leads to the demise of the latter, and thereby itself; it is best to be cautious with one’s words. — This st. is most likely a later insert. It is composed in Speeches-meter (unlike all surrounding sts., which are in Leeds-meter), its style is unusual, and its content fits poorly in the context, which at this point in the poem has moved away from the theme of cautious speech.

1 Tvęir ’ro ęins hęrjar ‘Two belong to one host’ | Lit. ‘two are of one host’. — *hęrjar* is an inflected form of *hęrr* ‘host, army’, but its function is ambiguous; it can either be (1) the gen. sg., as adopted here, or (2) the nom. pl. ‘harriers, raiders’ (cf. *ęin-hęrjar* ‘Oneharriers’) which would translate as “two are the destroyers of one”, i.e., “the tongue and head often lead to the demise of the body”.

1 tunga es hǫfuðs bani ‘the tongue is the head’s bane’ | Formulaic or proverbial. Cf. the Old Swedish “Heathen Law”, which describes how a duel should be conducted following an insult to a man’s honour (my norm. and trans. following Läffler (1879)): *Fallr þann orð havr givit—gløpr orða vęrstr, tunga hovuð-bani—liggi í ú·gildum akri* ‘If he who has given the [insulting] word falls—mockery is the worst of words; the tongue the head-bane—may he lie in an unenclosed field.’

2 handar ‘a hand’ | Holding a dagger.

**74** Nǫtt verðr fęginn, · sá’s nesti trúir, [R 5r/8]
2 skammar ’ro skips ráar,
hverf es haust-grĩma;
4 fjǫlð of viðrir · á fimm dǫgum,
ęn męirr á mánaði.

At night he rejoices who trusts in his provisions;
short are the ship’s sail-yards;
shifty is the stormy fall night.

The winds blow far in five days;
even more in a month.

---

ALL | It is best to rely on things in one's control, here the provisions you carry with you when at sea (cf. sts. 11, 116). The man at the mercy of the forces of nature can never sleep safe and sound at night. — In ll. 3–4 two names of Weden, a notoriously fickle god (cf. st. 110), may be subtextually implied, and the st. may then also be taken as a warning against resigning one's fate totally to the gods, who are perhaps not always fully trustworthy.

2 skammar 'ro skips ráar 'short are the ship's sail-yards' | Also found in *Mhkv* 12/1a: *skips láta menn skammar rár* 'men say the ship's sail-yards are short' or 'men make the ship's sail-yards short.' The sail-yards (ON *ráar*) are the arms on the mast from which the sails are set, but the sense of the l. is unclear and interpretations vary; for an overview see *Mhkv* 12 in SkP 3 and Evans (1986, pp. 110–111). In any case it would appear by the sense of ll. 3–5 that this l. should also refer to something untrustworthy; one suggestion is that during a shipwreck the man clinging onto the sail-yards would wish them longer.

3 haust-grĭma 'stormy fall night' | Lit. 'fall-mask', a cpd. of *haustr* 'fall, autumn' + *grĭma* 'mask'. The word paints an image of the dark cloudy evening or night-sky, the thick dusky clouds being the metaphorical 'mask'. Cf. Weden's names *Grĭmr* 'Grime; Mask', *Grĭmnir* 'Grimner; the Masked One' (*Grm* 47, 50).

4 fjǫlð of viðrir 'The winds blow far' | I.e., 'the weather changes much'. ON *(of) viðra* is a causative verb derived from *veðr* 'wind, storm'. Cf. Weden's name *Viðrir* 'Withrer; Stormer, Man of the Storm', which is most likely an agent noun formed to the same verb.

4 fimm dǫgum 'five days' | I.e., 'a week' (which was originally five days long), parallelling 'month' in the next line. See note to st. 51 above.

**75** Vęit=a hinn, · es vét=ki vęit, [R 5r/10]
margr verðr af *au*rum api;
maðr es auðigr, · annarr ò·auðigr,
skyli=t þann vítka váar.

The one who knows nothing does not know:
many a one is made an ape by silver.
A man is wealthy, another not wealthy;
one ought not to curse him for his woe.

---

2 af *au*rum 'by silver' | *emend. from meaningless* †aflaðrom† **R**

---

2 margr verðr af *au*rum api 'many a one is made an ape by silver' | Cf. *Sól* 34/4: *margan hefr auðr apat* 'wealth has made an ape of many a one', which also lends support to the emendation in the line.

**76** Dęyr fé, · dęyja frę́ndr, [R 5r/12]
dęyr sjalfr hit sama;
ęn orðs-tírr · dęyr aldri=gi
hvęim's sér góðan getr.

Kine die, kinsmen die,
oneself dies the same.

But a word-glory never dies
for whomever gets himself a good one.

---

ALL | It is likely that sts. 76–77 concluded the original Guests' Strand. This is supported internally by their tone of finality and their reflections on death, and externally by the fact that *Hákm* (composed ca. 961 AD) borrows the first line of its final stanza 21 (*dęyr fé · dęyja fręndr*) from their refrain. The sense of both stanzas is that the whole of man's earthly power will pass away with him, but a good reputation, fame and glory, will linger on.
The idea of "undying fame", as stressed in these two sts. through the repetition of *dęyr aldri≈gi* 'never dies', is an ancient Indo-European conception. Similar expressions feature prominently in sources including Homer, the Greek lyric poets, the *ṚV*, and the Irish saga-cycles (West 2007, pp. 396–98, 406–10). The common idea is that of fame as a living entity, which can be bestowed or laid upon (but also flee from) a man, and which can linger on above the earth after his death. The same idea is expressed in numerous ways throughout the IE languages, but of particular note is the formulaic expression 'imperishable fame', which is found in both Vedic OI *śrávaḥ … ákṣitam* (*ṚV* 1.9.7bc) and Greek κλέος ἄφθιτον (*Il* 9.413, etc.; a list of attestations is found in West 2007, p. 408). Since these two phrases are directly cognate, the ancestral PIE formula can be reconstructed as **kléwos n̥·dʰgʷʰitom* (West 2007, pp. 406–10; Watkins 1995, pp. 173–178).

1 fé … fręndr 'Kine … kinsmen' | In the early Germanic farming society a man's wealth was reckoned in heads of cattle (note that the Norman loan-word *cattle* is itself the same word as *capital*) and his socio-political power by the number of able male kinsmen and friends ready to side with him in conflict (cf. sts. 62, 72 above). For Indo-European poetic analogues, cf. West (2007, pp. 99–100).

**77** Dęyr fé, · dęyja fręndr, [R 5r/13]
2 dęyr sjalfr hit sama;
ek vęit ęinn · at aldri≈gi dęyr:
4 dómr umb dauðan hvęrn.

Kine die, kinsmen die,
oneself dies the same.
I know one that never dies:
the Doom o'er each man dead.

---

4 dómr 'Doom' | In ON this word otherwise means nothing other than 'judgment', but here it carries the unique sense 'fame'. This latter sense should probably not be taken as a semantic development of the former, but rather as an independent reflex of the original sense of the PIE ancestor **dʰoh₁·mos* 'thing put', from the verbal root **dʰeh₁-* 'to put, place, lay' (Orel 2003, p. 73, Kroonen 2013, p. 98—though neither discuss the sense 'fame'). In Greek and Indo-Iranian the root **dʰeh₁-* is in fact used formulaically with the object **kléwos* 'fame', which may be 'laid' on a man either by himself or the Gods (West 2007, pp. 397–98; Watkins 1995, pp. 177–78). Thereby, we may see in the semantic development from PIE **dʰoh₁·mos* 'thing put' > PGmc. **dômaz* > ON *dómr* 'fame' a periphrastic expression or kenning standing in for the lost word PGmc. **hlewaz* 'fame' (only attested in compound names like DR 12 Gallehus: *Hlewa·gastiz* 'Leeguest', i.e., 'Fame-guest'), originally deriving from the Pre-Germanic equivalent of the formula **dʰeh₁- kléwos*.

Within Germanic, the sense 'fame' is also found in the cognates OE *dóm*, OS *dóm*, which are most often used to refer specifically to fame after death. In *Heli* the best example is ll. 3996b–4002a, especially 4001b-4002a: *Þan lêbot ùs þoh duom after, / guod word for gumon* 'Then our Doom will still remain afterwards, the good words for men'. In *Beow* there are several examples. The best is 1384–1389, where Bewolf consoles King Rothgar after Grendle's mother has slain his trusted advisor Asher (*Æsc·hęrí*): *Ni sorgé snotr gumá! · Sélré bið ógˑhwém, / þæt hé his friond wrecé · þan hé felu murné. / Úsær ógˑhwęlc scæl · ęndi ġiˑbídan / werˑældé líbæs; · wyrcé sé þi móté / dómæs ær deaðé; · þæt bið dryhtˑguman / unˑlibjændum · æftær sélist.* 'Grieve not, O wise man! It is better for each that he avenge his friend than that he mourn for long. Each one of us shall suffer the end of life in this world. Let him who can win a Doom before death; that is for the unliving warrior afterwards the best.' Other illustrative examples in *Beow* include 884b–887a: [...] *Sigˑmundé ġiˑsprang / æftær deað-dæġé · dóm unˑlýtil, / síð-ðan wígæs hæᵘrd · wyrm áˑcwaldé / hordæs hiᵒrdí* [...] 'For Syemund sprang up after his death-day an unlittle [great] Doom, since he, hard in conflict, defeated the Wyrm, the keeper of the hoard', and 953b–955a: [...] *þú þé selb hæbæs / dædum ġiˑfrémid · þæt þín dóm libæð / âwá ti aldré, (...)* 'Thou hast for thyself by deeds accomplished that thy Doom shall live for ever and ever'.

**78** Fullar grindr · sá'k fyr Fitjungs sonum, [R 5r/14]
nú bera þęir vánar vǫl;
svá es auðr · sęm auga-bragð,
hann es valtastr vina.

Full folds I saw with Fitting's sons;
now they bear the staff of want.
So is wealth like the blink of an eye:
it is the ficklest of friends.

---

ALL | Sts. 78–80 are poorly placed and seem quite like later inserts. 78–79 at least resemble the general content of the Guests' Strand (although see 79/2 n.), but 80 is more difficult.

1 Fullar grindr 'Full folds' | Penfolds full of sheep or cattle.

1 Fitjungs sonum 'Fitting's sons' | Both Fitting (*Fitjungr*) and his sons are wholly unknown. The line may perhaps be a reference to a long-lost old folk-tale.

2 vánar vǫl 'the staff of want' | A beggar's staff.

3 sęm auga-bragð 'like the blink of an eye' | I.e., it may be gone in the blink of an eye.

**79** Ó·snotr maðr · es ęigna=sk getr [R 5r/16]
fé eða fljóðs mun-úð;
metnaðr hǫnum þróa=sk, · ęn man-vit aldri=gi;
framm gęngr hann drjúgt í dul.

The unclever man who comes to own
money or a maid's loving grace:
his pride flourishes, but never his manwit;
he goes forth far in folly.

---

2 fljóðs 'maid' | The poem's first mention of the fair sex, which indicates that this st. does not in fact belong to the original Guests' Strand.

**80** Þat 's þá rǫynt, · es þú at rúnum spyrr, [R 5r/18]
hinum rǫgin-kunnum,
þǫim's gørðu ginn-regin
ok fáði Fimbul·þulr;
þá hǫfr hann batst, ef hann þegir.

Proven is then what thou learnest from the runes
born of the Reins—
from those which the Yin-Reins made
and the Fimblethyle painted.
Then he has it best, if he shuts up.

---

ALL | This st. with its strange meter and its subject of runic magic does not fit well in its current place. It would have fit better in the Rune-Tally (*Háv* 138–146), with whose stanzas it also shares formulaic expressions. The last line with its shift in person is especially curious and possibly a later insert.

1–2 rúnum ... hinum rǫgin-kunnum 'the runes born of the Reins' | 'Runes of Godly origin', namely through Weden's Self-Hanging (sts. 138–139 below). The expression is formulaic and very old, for it also appears on the ca. C5th Noleby stone (in the acc. sg. *rúnó ragina-kundó* 'a rune born of the Reins'); an undeniable proof of the antiquity of some of the runic lore preserved in Norse poetry. See also Index: rune. — The form of the line *hinum regin-kunnum* is metrically unusual but need not be corrupt; cf. the similar form of *Hárb* 4/2, 6/2, 13/3. A possibly related phenomenon may be that of following a c-verse by another verse that joins it in alliteration (so st. 61/5 above, *Skí* TODO).

3–4 þǫim's gørðu ginn-rǫgin / ok fáði Fimbul·þulr 'those which the Yin-Reins made and the Fimblethyle painted' | Cf. st. 142 where these two lines occur almost identically, but in reverse order.

3 ginn-rǫgin 'Yin-Reins' | The 'vast, broad Gods', a pantheistic word.

4 fáði 'painted' | 3rd sg. past ind. of *fáa* 'paint, carve (runes); decorate, adorn'. The use of this verb in the context of runic writing is in fact a semantic archaism which merits discussion. The weak verb *fáa* (< PGmc. **faihijaną*) originally derives from the PGmc. adjective **faihaz* 'coloured, decorated' and is associated with runic writing from the earliest period of the script's existence; it is found in the very earliest Elder Futhark inscriptions, like the stones from Einang, Vetteland, Hole, and Rö (all ca. 100–400 CE), all of which feature the formulaic phrase *ek rúnó fa(i)hidó* 'I painted the rune' (in ON form **ek rún fáða*). In later inscriptions in the Younger Futhark, the 3rd sg. past ind. appears in the form **faþi**, identical to that of the present stanza. It is notable that the use of this verb in YF inscriptions is limited to archaic inscriptions (e.g., Ög 136, Sm 144, Vg 119, U Fv1912;8, Hs 7, DR 190, N 140; all ca. 800–1000 CE), many of which have explicitly pagan contents. Notably, the verb does not appear in the over 1000 inscriptions belonging to the Christian runestone trend of the 11th and 12th centuries, by which point the use of *fáa* in reference to runic carving was thus most likely either obsolete or considered too pagan. Although the verb most likely originally referred to the colouring or painting of runes (perhaps with mineral paint, or even blood), as early as the bracteate period (ca. 450–550 CE) it could be used for inscriptions in metal, including stamped ones (e.g., DR IK11, IK70, IK241,1–2). This usage continues into the YF period (e.g., the metal inscriptions U Fv1912;8 and Hs 7), and so the sense in ON was likely twofold: both 'paint, colour (runes)' (so probably sts. 144/2, 158/3 below) and also 'carve, fashion (runes)' with a solemn or ritual connotation (so likely the present st. and 142/4). In the rest of the Norse manuscript corpus, *fáa* mostly appears in the past participle carrying the sense 'decorated, adorned'. Indeed, outside of the inscriptions themselves, it is only in *Háv* (80/4, 142/4, 144/2, 158/3) that we find the verb used in a runic context at all. However, with the support of the numerous inscriptional examples above, we may fairly certainly say that at least the phrases *rúnum ... þǫim's fáði, rúnar ... es fáði* in *Háv* 80/4 and 142/4 reflect an archaic formula deriving from genuine pre-Christian runic tradition. For a similar instance, cf. 1–2: *rúnum … hinum regin-kunnum* n. above.

4 Fimbul·þulr ‘Fimblethyle’ | ‘The Great Thyle’, i.e., ‘the Great Chanter’, a name for Weden in his role as master of lore. For *þulr* ‘thyle’ cf. st. 111 below, *Vafþ* 9/4 n.

## 2. Scattered stanzas of practical advice (81–90)

The following stanzas are distinguished by a common subject matter (especially women, sts. 81, 82, 84, 86, 90) and style, and by a prevalence of Speechesmeter.

**81** At kveldi skal dag lęyfa, · konu es bręnnd es, [R 5r/20]
2 męki es ręyndr es, · męy es gefin es,
ís es yfir kømr, · ǫl es drukkit es.

By evening shall one praise a day, a woman when she is burned,
a sword when it is tried, a maiden when she is given,
ice when one comes over it, ale when it is drunk up.

ALL | Nothing shall be praised in advance since things often turn out differently than one may expect; the poet gives six examples.

2–3 konu … męy ‘a woman … a maiden’ | The mention of women marks a new section in *Háv*, since the Guests’ Strand proper (sts. 1–77), although certainly composed by a man for men (cf. esp. sts. 69, 72) steers entirely clear of the subject (but cf. st. 79). The perspective is clearly a man’s, and the theme of not trusting women continues throughout the rest of the poem.

1 bręnnd ‘burned’ | On the funeral pyre as ‘burned’ is here a neutral way of saying ‘dead’; cf. Introduction to the poem and st. 71/3 above.

2 męy es gefin ‘a maiden when she is given’ | A young unmarried woman’s chastity should not be praised until she has been given in marriage and is proven a virgin (*mér*).

**82** Í vindi skal við hǫggva, · veðri á sę róa, [R 5r/22]
2 myrkri við man spjalla: · mǫrg ’ro dags augu;
á skip skal skriðar orka, · ęn á skjǫld til hlífar,
4 męki til hǫggs, · ęn męy til kossa.

In wind shall one cut wood, in good weather row at sea,
in darkness speak with a maiden—many are the eyes of day.
A ship shall one have for speed and a shield for protection,
a sword for striking and a maiden for kisses.

ALL | Sts. 82–83 list various things or actions and their fitting place or context. They bear very close resemblance to the two OE poems titled *Maxims*, particularly *Maxims II*, and one is inclined to think that such lists were likely an important part of Proto-Germanic poetry.

1 veðri ‘good weather’ | The word *veðr* typically means ‘storm’, but that can hardly be the sense here.

**83** Við ęld skal ǫl drikka, · ęn á ísi skríða, [R 5r/24]

magran mar kaupa, · ęn męki saurgan,
hęima hęst fęita, · ęn hund á búi.

By fire shall one drink ale, but skate on ice,
buy a starved steed and a rusty sword,
fatten the horse at home and the hound on the farmstead.

2 mar ... męki 'steed ... sword' | Formulaic pair, also occurring in *Lok* 12/1, *Vkv* 33/3, *Akv* 7/3.

3 hęima hęst fęita, · ęn hund á búi | The exact sense of this advice is unclear.

**84** Męyjar orðum · skyli mann≠gi trúa, [R 5r/26, Thott 1768 4° 210r/22–210v/2]
né því's kveðr kona;
því't á hverfanda hvéli · vǫru þęim hjǫrtu skǫpuð,
brigð í brjóst of lagit.

A maiden's words should no man trust,
nor that which a woman speaks.
For on a whirling wheel their hearts were shaped,
fickleness laid in their breasts.

3 því't | *om.* 1768 3 vǫru þęim hjǫrtu skǫpuð 'their hearts were shaped' | er þeim hjarta skapat *'their heart is shaped'* 1768 4 brigð | ok brigð 1768 4 lagit | lagin 1768

3–4 því't ... lagið | Quoted in slightly divergent form in *Fbr* (ms. Thott 1768 4°, fol. 210r–v), where it is introduced with the words: *Kom honum þá í hug kvíðlingr sá, er kveðinn hafði verit um lausungar-konur:* 'And then he remembered the ditty which had been composed about loose women:'

**85** Bristanda boga, · brinnanda loga, [R 5r/28]
gínanda ulfi, · galandi krǫku,
rýtanda svíni, · rót-lausum viði,
vaxanda vági, · vellanda katli,

In bursting bow, in burning flame,
in yawning wolf, in crowing crow,
in roaring swine, in rootless tree,
in waxing wave, in boiling kettle,

ALL | Sts. 85–87 and 89 list a variety of things one should not trust. The things are a curious mix of natural phenomena, animals, tools, and people and together give a vivid insight into the lifestyle of Iron Age Norway.

**86** fljúganda flęini, · fallandi bǫru, [R 5r/30]
ísi ęin-nęttum, · ormi hring-lęgnum,
brúðar bęð-mǫlum · eða brotnu sverði,
bjarnar lęiki · eða barni konungs,

in flying spear, in falling billow,
in one-night old ice, in coiled-up serpent,
in bride's bed-speech, or in broken sword,
in bear's play, or in king's child,

---

4 eðа | †eð† **R**

**87** sjúkum kalfi, · sjalf-ráða þrę́li, [**R** 5r/32]
2 vǫlu vil-mę́li, · val ný-fę́ldum.

in sick calf, in self-willing thrall,
in wallow's pleasing speech, in newly felled corpses,

---

2 vǫlu vil-mę́li 'in wallow's pleasing speech' | I.e., in a too favourable prophecy (spae).

**89** bróður-bana sĭnum · þó'tt á brautu møti, [**R** 5v/2]
2 húsi half-brunnu, · hęsti al-skjótum,
þà 's jór ȯ·nýtr, · ef ę́inn fótr brotnar;
4 verðr-it maðr svá tryggr · at þęssu trúi ǫllu!

in one's brother's bane though on the road ye meet,
in half-burned house, in all-fleet horse—
the steed is useless if one foot breaks.
No man will be so trusting that he trust in all this!

---

ALL | The numbering of the sts. in the pres. ed. follows **R**, where sts. 88, 89 come in the reversed order from how they are printed here. They have been reversed as it seems apparent from its Speeches-meter meter and the dative case of the words that 89 should follow 87, and with its last line it nicely concludes the sequence begun in 85–87. On the other hand st. 88 with its Leeds-meter meter and self-enclosed form seems to be a separate composition; it has probably been inserted after 87 due to its first line (*akri ár-sǫ́num* 'In an early sown field'), which in the dat. sg. superficially resembles the structure of 85–87, 89.

**88** Akri ár-sǫ́num · trúi ę́ngi maðr, [**R** 5r/33]
2 né til snimma syni;
veðr rę́ðr akri, · ę́n vit syni;
4 hę́tt es þę́ira hvárt.

In an early sown field ought no man to trust,
nor too soon in a son.
The weather rules the field and the wits the son:
there is risk to them both.

**90** Svá 's friðr kvinna · þę́ira's flátt hyggja, [**R** 5v/4]
2 sęm aki jó ȯ·bryddum · á ísi hǫ́lum

tęitum, tvé-vetrum · ok séi tamr illa,
4 eða ï byr óðum · bęiti stjórn-lausu,
eða skyli haltr hęnda · hręin ï þá-fjalli.

So is the love of those women who falsely think
like one rode an unshod horse on slippery ice—
a wild one, two winters old and ill-tamed—
or in mad wind tacked a rudderless ship,
or a halt man should catch a reindeer on a thawing fell.

---

5 ï þá-fjalli 'on a thawing fell' | I.e., in springtime, when the melting ice on the ground is most slippery.

## 3. Weden's tryst with Billing's daughter (91–102)

The following two sections (sts. 91–102 and 103–110), which may be called Weden's love-adventures, are united by their narrative style, their composition in Leeds-meter, and their content; together they constitute a clear sub-poem within *Háv*. Properly, sts. 91–94 do not belong to the first adventure, but instead introduces the whole sub-poem. Both episodes (sts. 95–102, 103–110) describe Weden's romantic adventures in the first person, the first seeing the god be the victim of deception, the second seeing him as the deceiver. Their complementary and highly symmetrical structure has been shown well by McKinnell (2005), whose structural analysis is generally followed here, although his inclusion of st. 84 in the introduction is not considered since 91 is thought to provide a natural introduction to both sections. Like the two human sexes, the two adventures form a complementary pair. Each one begins with a reflecting, gnomic stanza (95, 103), has 6 central narrative stanzas (96–101, 104–109), and concludes with a final stanza reflecting on the situation as a whole (102, 110). Sts. 95–102 describe how Weden, a man, is deceived by Billing's daughter, a woman, while in 103–110 the roles are reversed and it is Weden who deceives the woman, Guthlathe.

The two adventures are introduced by the 4 general gnomic stanzas about love and sexual relations (91–94) which properly do not belong to the first adventure, although they are here included under it. 91 describes how men can be just as fickle and dishonest towards women as women towards men, setting up the two symmetrical episodes. This theme is continued in st. 92. 93–94 go on to describe the folly of love, and how even the wisest often fall victim to it.

The first adventure (sts. 95–102) begins with a gnomic stanza setting up the episode by detailing the danger and loneliness of forbidden or unreciprocated love (95). Sts. 96–101 describe how Weden was falsely promised a night with Billing's daughter. She instead summoned a mob, and when he returned in the morning, she had tied a bitch to the bed as a last insult. St. 102 concludes with the statement that many good women are fickle towards men. The underlying myth—if one existed—is completely unknown, and Billing and his daughter are not known from any other source (for the name *Billingr*

cf. 97/1 n.) Attempts to connect the myth to natural phenomena or later heroic ballads have not been convincing.

**91** Bęrt nú męli'k, · því't béði vęit'k, [R 5v/7]
2 brigðr es karla hugr konum,
þá fęgrst męlum, · es flást hyggjum;
4 þat tęlir horska hugi.

Plainly I now speak, for I know them both:
fickle are men's minds towards women.
Fairest we speak when falsest we think;
that entraps sharp minds.

---

1 béði 'them both' | The natures of both sexes; *béði* is neutr. pl., which in ON is used for mixed-sex groups. The poet, a man (cf. sts. 69, 81) declares that he will not attack the fair sex unfairly; he is also aware of men's faults. This sets up the balanced structure of the following two sections (see above).

3 fęgrst męlum ... flást hyggjum 'Fairest we speak ... falsest we think;' | Formulaic word-pair. Cf. st. 45.

4 þat tęlir horska hugi 'that entraps sharp minds' | Love (or sexual infatuation—the poet does not distinguish between them) turns even wise men into liars or otherwise dishonest persons. Cf. *Mhkv* 20/1–2, which is probably partly based on this stanza: *Ǫst-blindir 'ro seggir svá · sumir, at þykkja mjǫk fás gá; // þannig verðr um man-sǫng męlt: · marga hefr þat hyggna tęlt.* 'Some men are so love-blind that they seem to heed very little; // for that sake it is said about love-song: many thinking men has it entrapped.'

**92** Fagrt skal męla · ok fé bjóða, [R 5v/9]
2 sá's vill fljóðs ǫst fáa,
líki lęyfa · hins ljósa mans,
4 sá fęr, es fríar.

Fairly shall he speak and offer money,
whoso will win a lady's love:
praise the body of the bright girl—
he wins, who woos.

---

1 Fagrt skal męla 'Fairly shall he speak' | Formulaic. Cf. st. 45.

4 sá fęr, es fríar 'he wins, who woos' | Only he who courts her will win her hand.

**93** Ástar firna · skyli ęngi maðr [R 5v/11]
2 annan aldri=gi;
opt fáa á horskan, · es á hęimskan né fáa,
4 lost-fagrir litir.

Over love should no man
ever upbraid another;

oft they seize the sharp when they seize not the foolish,
the lust-fair hues.

4 lost-fagrir litir ‘lust-fair hues’ | A woman with a countenance so beautiful that men cannot help but lust after her.

**94** Ey-vitar firna, · es maðr annan skal, [R 5v/12]
þess es of margan gengr guma;
heimska ór hors*kum* · gerir hǫlða sonu
sá hinn mǫtt=ki munr.

In no way shall man blame another
for that which happens to many a man;
from sharp to fools are the sons of men
made by this mighty thing, love.

3 hors*kum* | *gramm. emend.;* horskan *(m. acc. sg.)* R

**95** Hugr einn þat veit, · es býr hjarta nær, [R 5v/14]
einn es hann sér umb sefa;
ong es sótt verri · hveim snotrum manni
an sér ongu at una.

The mind alone knows what dwells close to the heart;
it is alone with its thoughts.
No sickness is worse for each clever man
than with nothing to be content.

1 Hugr ‘The mind’ | ON *hugr* refers to the seat of emotions in the breast, which English “mind” does not entirely capture. Normally it could be translated by English “heart”, but since the present stanza uses *hjarta* ‘heart’ to refer specifically to the organ that would be very confusing for the reader.

**96** Þat þá rynda'k, · es í ryri sat'k, [R 5v/16]
ok vætta'k míns munar,
hold ok hjarta · vas mér hin horska mær,
þey=gi hana at heldr hef'k.

That I found out when I sat in the reeds
and awaited my love.
My own flesh and heart that sharp maiden was—
I have her none the more.

**97** Billings mey · ek fann beðjum á [R 5v/18]
sól-hvíta sofa;

jarls ynði · þótti mér ękki vesa
nema við þat lík at lifa.

Billing's maiden I found on the beds,
sun-white, asleep.
An earl's pleasure seemed me naught to be,
save living alongside that body.

---

1 Billings 'Billing's' | An unidentified dwarf or ettin. In the **H** manuscript of *Vsp* 13 Billing appears as a dwarf, and he may also be mentioned on the cryptic C9th Malt runestone (SJy 38): **bilikikʀ** (error for ***bilikʀ** *Billingr*?). He also appears in a Scaldic kenning for POETRY (Ormr *Woman* 2, SkP 3: *full burar Billings* 'the cup of Billing's son'), but this does not narrow down his identity since he is merely standing in as a generic DWARF/ETTIN (Meissner 1921, p. 428). Support for his being an ettin is found in the fact that his name is clearly similar to Gilling, an ettin who plays a part in the story of the Mead of Poetry (see introduction to sts. 103–110 below), and that a god lusting for a dwarf-maiden (to the degree they even exist) is a nonexistent motif, whereas the gods very frequently desire the daughters of the ettins (most famously in *Ski*).

1 męy 'maiden' | I.e., unmarried (virgin) daughter.

[Billings męr:] **98** „Auk nęr aptni · skalt Óðinn koma, [R 5v/20]
ef vilt þér męla man,
allt eru ǫ·skǫp, · nema ęin vitim
s·líkan lǫst saman."

[Billing's maiden:] "And by evening shalt thou, Weden, come,
if thou wilt win for thee the girl [me]!
The Shapes are all evil if we two alone might not know
such a vice together."

---

3 allt eru ǫ·skǫp 'The Shapes are all evil' | Lit. 'the evil Shapes are everything', that is 'the Shapes (i.e., fates, destinies) are all awry'. See Index: shape.

**99** Aptr ek hvarf · ok unna þótt=umk [R 5v/22]
vísum vilja frá;
hitt ek hugða, · at hafa mynda'k
gęð hęnnar allt ok gaman.

Back I turned, and thought myself in love,
away from my wise will,
yet I thought that I would have
her senses all, and pleasure.

---

2 vísum vilja frá 'away from my wise will' | I.e., 'against my better judgment'. The wise choice would have been to walk away, rather than fall into the girl's trap.

**100** Svá kom'k nęst, · at hin nýta vas [R 5v/23]

víg-drótt ǫll of vakin,
með brinnǫndum ljósum · ok bornum viði,
svá vas mér víl-stígr of vitaðr.

So next I came when the useful
war-troop was all awake
with burning lights and brandished clubs;
so for me a sad path was marked.

---

1 nýta 'useful' | Sarcastic. Billing's daughter has summoned a lynch mob.

3 bornum viði 'brandished clubs' | Lit. 'with carried wood'.

4 víl-stígr 'sad path' | Ambiguous, referring either to the beating he would have received at the hands of the mob, or to his walk of shame away from the hall. The latter is perhaps more likely.

**101** Auk nér morni, · es vas'k ęnn of kominn, [R 5v/25]
þá vas sal-drótt of sofin;
gręy ęitt þá fann'k · hinnar góðu konu
bundit bęðjum á.

And by morning when I had come again,
then was the hall-troop asleep.
A lone bitch I then found, by that good woman
bound upon the beds.

---

1 Auk nér morni 'And by morning' | Mirroring the beginning of st. 97 above.

3 gręy ęitt 'A lone bitch' | The insult is clearly understood; Weden is likened to a horny dog and mockingly asked to relieve his desire on the bitch instead of Billing's daughter—'this is all you get, you dog!'

3 góðu 'good' | Perhaps not sarcastic, but rather referring to her chastity; cf. 102/1.

**102** Mǫrg es góð mér, · ef gǫrva kannar, [R 5v/27]
hug-brigð við hali;
þá þat rǫynda'k, · es hit ráð-spaka
tęygða'k á flérðir fljóð;
hóðungar hvǫrrar · lęitaði mér hit horska man
ok hafða'k þęss vętt=ki* vífs.

Many a good maiden—if one comes to know her well—
is heart-fickle towards men.
I found that out when the counsel-wise
lady I lured into sins;
every disgrace that sharp girl sought out for me,
and I had naught of the woman.

---

6 vętt=ki* | vęttkis **R**

1 góð mér 'good maiden' | The 'goodness' here likely refers to faithfulness and chastity. Cf. *Skí* 12.

## 4. Weden's theft of the Mead of Poetry (103–110)

Sts. 103–110 contain Weden's second love adventure in *Háv* and deals with his theft of the Mead of Poetry from the ettin Sutting and his daughter Guthlathe.

Unlike the previous adventure (sts. 95–102), the underlying myth of this one is very well known and merits more extensive discussion. The main source for the narrative is *Skm* 5–6, which may be summarized as follows, with minor details left out:

Chapter 5:

> After the war between the Eese and the Wanes (cf. *Vsp* 22–23), the two tribes reconcile through spitting into a vat. Not wanting to discard this token of their truce, they instead make a man out of the spit and call him Quasher (*Kvasir*). He is so wise that he can answer any question posed to him, and so he travels around the world in order to share his learning with men.
>
> Quasher eventually comes to the dwelling of two dwarfs, Fealer and Galer (*Fjalarr ok Galarr*). They kill him and drain his blood into three vessels: the two vats Soon (*Són*) and Bothem (*Boðn*), and the cauldron Woderearer (*Óð·rørir*). They mix the blood with honey, and from the mixture they brew a mead which will make whomever drinks from it a *skald eða fróða-maðr* 'a scald or man of learning'. The dwarfs lie to the Eese about the murder, telling them that Quasher drowned in his own wisdom for a lack of good questions.
>
> Some time later, the dwarfs murder the ettin Gilling (*Gillingr*) and his wife. Gilling's son, Sutting (*Suttungr*), learns of this and prepares to drown the dwarfs. In exchange for their lives and as weregild for Sutting's parents, the dwarfs offer him the *mjǫð'inn dýra* 'dear mead' (cf. sts. 105 and 140). Sutting accepts the payment and brings the mead home with him. He places his daughter Guthlathe (*Gunn·lǫð*) in a cave to guard it.

Chapter 6:

> Weden is wandering through the world when he finds nine thralls mowing hay. He lends them aid by sharpening their scythes with a special whetstone, and they now cut much faster. He throws the whetstone into the air and the greedy thralls fight to the death over it, leaving none alive. By evening Weden comes to their master, Baye (*Baugi*), Sutting's brother. Baye laments the death of his workmen, and so Weden, calling himself Baleworker (*Bǫl·verkr* 'evil-doer'), offers to do their work over the summer in exchange for one drink of the mead. Baye tells the disguised god that Sutting alone owns the mead, but that he will accompany him to Sutting's to ask.
>
> In fall, the two arrive at Sutting's, who as expected refuses to give any part of the mead away. Weden then tells Baye that he will get to it any-

way. He takes out the drill Wrate (*Rati*) and tells Baye to drill through the mountains into the cave where the mead is stored. Baye first attempts to trick him by only drilling halfway through, but eventually creates a narrow passage. Weden turns himself into a snake and crawls through it; as he does, Baye tries to strike him with the drill, but misses.

On the other side, Weden finds Guthlathe watching over the mead. She is taken by him, and promises him three sips of the mead in exchange for sleeping with her for three nights. Weden sleeps with her and then takes his reward. With each sip he swallows the contents of one of the three vessels, so that all the mead ends up in his belly.

Having drunk the mead, he dons his eagle-hame and flies away from the mountain. Sutting sees him, takes on his own eagle-hame, and gives chase. The Eese see the chase overhead and set out several large vats on the ground, into which Weden, still flying, spits out the mead. At this point Sutting has almost caught up with him, and so Weden in eagle-form "sends back" (*senda aptr*, viz. from behind) some of the mead, presumably into Sutting's face. The text does not say, but it seems likely that Sutting crashes down and dies.

After the chase is over and Weden is back he distributes the mead. That part caught in the three vats is given to the Eese and to *þeim mǫnnum, er yrkja kunnu* 'those men who can compose verse', but the portion which was "sent back" becomes the *skald-fífla hlutr* 'lot of poet-fools'.

Surprisingly, the narrative core of this longwinded myth appears to go back at least as far as the Bronze Age. A close parallel is found in the Vedic myth of the origin of the psychoactive ritual drink *sṓma*, which in Vedic mythology is also a god (*Sṓma*) in its own right. The earliest version of that story is found in the two hymns *ṚV* 4.26–27, which tell how *Sṓma* is held inside 'a hundred bronze forts' (4.27.1c: *ṣatám púras áyasīs*) by the archer *Kr̥ṣánu*, before being stolen by the sweeping, mighty Eagle who brings it to *Mánu*, the first human sacrificer and ancestor of the Aryans. The guardian *Kr̥ṣánu* does not himself give chase, but shoots his arrows at the Eagle, missing.

Later Vedic texts clearly identify the Eagle with *Agní* (the god of fire), specifically in his form as the *gāyatrí* meter (Bloomfield 1896). One text in particular (*AB* 3.25–27) is interesting in its etiological function: "What (the *gāyatrī*) seized with her right foot, that became the morning pressure (*prātaḥ-savanam*). ... What she seized with her left foot became the noon pressure (*mādhyaṁdinaṁ savanam*). ... What she seized became the third pressure (*tr̥tīyam savanam*)." (Bloomfield 1896, p. 6). I may here note that Bloomfield in the same article offers a naturalistic explanation of the myth, which may be of interest since such explanations are much more rarely encountered for Norse myths: the Eagle is *Agní* in the form of lightning, who shoots forth "from the womb of the cloud; as the lightning shoots from the cloud, the heavenly fluid, the Soma, streams down upon the earth."

The close relation between the Norse and Vedic origin myths for the sacred drink may be explained in two ways: through common inheritance from the Indo-Europeans, or through Iranian steppe influence, which may have taken place as late as the Migration Period (probably by way of the Sarma-

tians, cf. the originally Iranian loanword "path" which must have entered Germanic after Grimm's Law, Kroonen (2013, p. 396)). It should here be said that linguistic and botanical facts preclude the Indo-Iranian *sṓma* cult's being originally Indo-European; it instead appears to have been borrowed in the late 3rd millennium BC from the Central Asian Bactria-Margian Archaeological Complex or BMAC (Lubotsky 2001, pp. 3–4, 6).

The original Proto-Indo-European sacred Drink was probably the Drink of Undying (OI *a·mr̥ta*, Greek ἀ·μβροσία < PIE **n̥·mr̥tós* 'undying, immortal'; Greek νέκ·ταρ 'death-overcoming'), which in the Greek mythology is brought to Zeús (Ζεύς) by doves (*Od* 12.62–63: πέλειαι τρήρωνες, ταί τ' ἀμβροσίην Διὶ πατρὶ φέρουσιν 'the trembling doves which bring ambrosia to Father Zeús') and in the Irish mythology was brewed for the Gods (OIr. *Tuath Dé* or *Tuatha Dé Danann*) by the smith *Goibniu* (Dobbs 1929, p. 193; MacKillop 1998, p. 228).

It seems probable from the Greek, Norse, and Irish attestations that this bird-brought Drink was originally mythological and believed to be the mystery behind the immortality of the Gods. In this vein it would likely have been invoked in the symbolic poetic language of the ritual toasts drunk by the PIE chieftains (probably originally consisting of fermented honey-wine—mead).

It was in the Indo-Iranian tradition that this symbolic language, together with the myth of the eagle stealing it from the mountains, was uniquely integrated into the borrowed cult of the *sṓma*, for which *a·mr̥ta* 'undying' became a poetic epithet (e.g. *ṚV* 5.2.3c). Perhaps unlike the earlier alcoholic drinks, this one was believed to make its human drinkers really immortal, as famously seen in the ecstatic *ṚV* 8.48.3: *Á·pāma sṓmam, a·mr̥tā a·bhūma, / á·ganma jyótir, á·vidāma dēvā́n. / Kiṃ nūnám asmā́n kr̥ṇavad árātiḥ / kím u dʰūrtír a·mr̥ta mártiyasya?* 'We have drunk the soma; we have become immortal; we have gone to the light; we have found the gods. What can hostility do to us now, and what the malice of a mortal, o immortal one?'

Having briefly discussed the non-Norse parallels to the relevant myth, we may now turn to its form in the present stanzas, and how this differs from *Skm* and other Norse poetry. To begin with, the biggest difference between the treatment of the myth in *Skm* 5–6 and *Háv* 103–110 is that the present stanzas are very allusive; far from being a linear retelling of events, the narrative thread is actually quite difficult to follow, especially without the help of *Skm*.

Notably, the Eagle, one of the key details shared between *Skm* and the Vedic hymns, is not found in *Háv*. Other important *Skm* elements, like Quasher, the two dwarfs, and Baye, are also missing. It is thus clear that Snorre's narrative cannot be exclusively based on *Háv*, but must in addition rely either on other, now-lost sources, or on his own imagination. That the former hypothesis is the correct one is proven by the large number of kennings for POETRY found in the Scaldic corpus, which hint at a similar narrative to that told in *Skm* 5–6, yet predate that text (ca. 1220 AD) by up to four centuries.

Scaldic kennings reference the following details from *Skm* not found in

*Háv* (Meissner 1921, pp. 427–430; all citations from SkP):

- The draining of Quasher's blood (Eskál *Vell* 1: *Kvasis dreyra* 'Quasher's blood [POETRY]');
- The ransom of the two dwarfs (Eyv *Hál* 1: *gjǫld Gillings* 'the payments for Gilling [POETRY]', Anon (*SnE*) 1: *sęin-fyrnð skip dverga* 'the late forgotten ships of dwarfs [POEMS]');
- Weden's companion Baye (Egill *Arkv* 22: *sǫku-nautr Sónar hvinna* 'adversary of the thieves of Soon <mythical vat> [= Weden and Baye (*Bauga* (gen. sg.) = *bauga* (gen. pl.) 'rings') > GENEROUS MAN]'—this kenning is not mentioned by Meissner due to his reliance on an earlier ed.);
- The theft by the Eagle (Egill *Berdr* 1: *ǫrð arnar kjapta* 'produce of the eagle's beak [POETRY]');
- And its "sending back" of a certain part of the mead (Þstf Lv 3: *lęirr ara ins gamla* 'dung of the ancient eagle [BAD POETRY]').

On the other hand there are elements found in *Háv* 103–110 which do not appear in *Skm* 5–6. The focus of *Háv* is squarely on Weden's visit to (and particularly his betrayal of) Sutting and his daughter Guthlathe, and the emphasis *Háv* places on Weden's *betrayal* contrasts sharply with the transactional and seemingly unemotional three-night affair in *Skm*. It is possible that the version of the myth underlying *Háv* even saw Weden marry Guthlathe, receiving the mead as a dowry. A marriage between them is supported by the unique legal expression *hins hindra dags* (st. 109), and would explain Weden's broken oath (110), which is not mentioned in *Skm*. The recipient of the oath may even have been Sutting, the father of the bride himself, as suggested by the description of him as *svikvinn* 'betrayed' and by the possibility that he hosted a banquet for Weden (110). An internal problem with that idea is that Weden is still said to have had to bore through the mountains (107), presumably to reach Guthlathe, in which case it comes off as unlikely that he would *then* have asked Sutting for her hand, rather than have sworn the oath to her, before or after seducing her then-and-there in her chamber. Further, the betrayer of Sutting need not be Weden directly but could of course also be Guthlathe, who broke her father's trust when she gave away the mead. See further notes to the individual stanzas.

Two other motifs to be considered with regard to Weden's dealings with Guthlathe are the beautiful ettin's daughter coveted by a god (cf. Billing's maiden above, Gird in *Skí*, and Rind in Saxo Grammaticus, *Vsp* 31 n.) and the horny ettin's daughter who attempts to seduce a young hero (cf. *HHj* P6–30).

*Háv* 103–110 begin with some social advice (103), after which the narrative is retold in non-linear fashion by Weden himself. He visits Sutting's home, but does not receive a good reception (104). Guthlathe falls in love with him and gives him a drink of the Mead, for which he cruelly repays her (105).

In order to get to her chamber Weden has to bore through the mountains with the drill Wrate (106). Weden has "bought" the Mead "well"; probably a euphemistic reference to sleeping with Guthlathe for it, and given it to mankind (107). Weden slept with Guthlathe and worries that he would not have made it out alive without her aid (108). "The following day" a group of Rime-Thurses come to Weden's hall to ask him whether Baleworker (presumably the name he gave Guthlathe) is among the Gods or whether he has been slain by Sutting (109). Weden, talking about himself in the third person, answers that he "thinks" that Weden has sworn an oath, but that his words cannot be trusted; after the simble he betrayed Sutting and made Guthlathe weep (110).

**103** Hęima glaðr gumi · ok við gęsti ręifr, [R 5v/30]
sviðr skal umb sik vesa;
minnigr ok mǫlugr, · ef vill marg-fróðr vesa;
opt skal góðs geta;
fimbul-fambi hęitir, · sá's fátt kann sęgja;
þat es ǫ·snotrs aðal.

At home shall man be glad and giving with his guest,
wise about himself.
Of good memory and speech if he wishes to be many-learned;
oft shall he speak of good.
A fimble-fool is he called who can say little;
that is the unclever man's nature.

**104** Hinn aldna jǫtun sótta'k, · nú em'k aptr of kominn; [R 5v/33]
fátt gat'k þęgjandi þar;
mǫrgum orðum · męlta'k í mínn frama
í Suttungs sǫlum.

The old ettin [= Sutting] I sought out; now am I come back;
I got little hearing there.
Many words I spoke to my furtherance,
in the halls of Sutting.

**105** Gunn·lǫð mér of gaf · gollnum stóli á [R 6r/2]
drykk hins dýra mjaðar;
ill ið-gjǫld · lét'k hana ęptir hafa
síns hins hęila hugar,
síns hins svára sefa.

Guthlathe gave me on the golden throne
a drink of the dear mead;
evil recompense I let her have afterwards,

for her whole heart,
for her heavy affection.

---

2 drykk hins dýra mjaðar ‘a drink of the dear mead’ | The same expression appears in *Skm* 5 and in st. 140/3 below.

**106** Rata munn · lét=umk rúms of fáa [R 6r/4]
ok umb grjót gnaga;
yfir ok undir · stóðu=mk jǫtna vegir,
svá hętta’k hǫfði til.

Wrate’s mouth I made to bring me room
and gnaw its way through the rocks.
Above and below me stood the roads of ettins [MOUNTAINS];
so I risked my head.

---

1 Rata ‘Wrate’s’ | According to *Skm* 6 (see above), *Rati* ‘Wrate’ was the drill used by Weden to bore through the mountain into the room where Guthlathe sat over the mead. The etymology of this term is uncertain (cf. Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *rati*), but if it is a cognate with Old Danish *vråde* ‘to rummage, bore’ then this would be an instance of alliteration between old *vr-* and *r-*, suggesting a later date for Weden’s love adventures than the Guests’ Strand (cf. sts. 26/2, 32/2). On the other hand, if *Rati* is derived from the verb *rata* (5/1, 18/1), the present instance is non-diagnostic.

**107** Vęl kęypts *hlu*tar · hęf’k vęl notit; [R 6r/6]
fás es fróðum vant;
því’t Óð·rørir · es nú upp kominn
á alda vés jaðar.

The well bought thing have I used well;
little do the learned lack,
for Woderearer has now come upon
the rim of the wigh of men [= Middenyard].

---

1 *hlu*tar ‘thing’ | litar *‘hue/colour’* **R**

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ALL | Weden has made good use of the Mead of Poetry by bringing it to the realm of men where those with skill and wisdom may now enjoy it.

1 Vęl kęypts *hlu*tar ‘The well bought thing’ | The Mead of Poetry, which was “well bought” in that the price Weden paid for it was three nights with Guthlathe, who should likely be thought of as very beautiful.

3 Óð·rørir ‘Woderearer’ | One of the vessels in with the Mead of Poetry was held (see introduction to sts. 103–110 above), here standing as a *pars pro toto* for all the Mead.

4 jaðar ‘rim’ | metr. emend.; *jarðar* **R** has a long root-syllable, and does not fit grammatically.

**108** Ifi ’s mér á, · at vęra’k ęnn kominn [R 6r/8]

2 jǫtna gǫrðum ór,
ef Gunn·laðar né nyta'k, · hinnar góðu konu,
4 es lǫgð=umk arm yfir.

I harbour doubt that I would yet have come
out of the yards of the Ettins,
if I had not made use of Guthlathe, that good woman
over whom I laid my arm.

---

1 Ifi 's mér á 'I harbour doubt' | Lit. 'There is doubt upon me'.

4 es lǫgð=umk arm yfir 'over whom I laid my arm' | Cf. *Lok* 20/4 (*lagðir lér yfir*).

**109** Hins hindra dags · gingu hrím-þursar [R 6r/9]
2 Hǫva ráðs at fregna, · Hǫva hǫllu í,
at Bǫl·verki spurðu, · ef véri með bǫndum kominn
4 eða hęfði hǫnum Suttungr of sóit.

The following day the Rime-Thurses went
to ask for the High One's counsel, in the High One's hall.
About Baleworker they asked, whether he had come into the midst of the Bonds,
or if Sutting had slain him.

---

1 Hins hindra dags 'The following day' | This is the only occurrence of the comparative *hindra* 'following, next' in the whole Old Norse-Icelandic corpus. The superlative *hindstr* 'last, final' does occur (e.g. *indsta sinni* 'the last time', with loss of the *h*-; see CV: *hindri*), and the possible derivative *hindar-dags* 'day after tomorrow, two days after' is found twice, both times in the *Gula*, chh. 37 and 266. In the broader Scandinavian sphere, however, we find in the Swedish provicial laws an exact equivalent of the present phrase, namely OSwe. *hindra-dagher*, a law-word referring specifically to the 'day after *the wedding night*', used both on its own and in the expression *hindra-dags gief* 'morning gift' (LMNL). If 'the day after the wedding night' is in fact the sense of *hindra dagr* in the present stanza, two interpretations are possible: (1) Weden refers sarcastically to the day after he slept with Guthlathe, as would be done during the wedding night. (2) Weden actually married, or promised to marry, Guthlathe. The latter interpretation may find further support in the "bigh-oath" of st. 110, but Guthlathe is never referred to in any surviving Norse sources as Weden's wife, only his lover (Steinþ Frag 1 (SkP 3)).

3 bǫndum 'the Bonds' | The Gods.

**110** Baug-ęið Óðinn · hygg at unnit hafi, [R 6r/12]
2 hvat skal hans tryggðum trúa?
Suttung svikvinn · hann lét sumbli frá
4 ok grøtta Gunn·lǫðu.

A bigh-oath I judge that Weden has sworn—
how shall one trust his truces?
Leaving the simble, he left Sutting betrayed
and Guthlathe brought to tears.

ALL | The exact narrative referred to in the stanza is hard to pin down. One possibility is that Weden swore an oath on a bigh (an armring) to marry Guthlathe; Sutting then hosted a banquet (simble) for the couple (cf. *bins bindra dags* in st. 109), and Weden slept with her and then stole the mead. The mention of Sutting as betrayed could however also be a reference to Guthlathe's betrayal of him, so that the sense is that Weden left both the father and daughter upset and weeping: the father furious over the loss of his mead and the harlotry of his daughter, the daughter heartbroken over the flight of her false lover.

## 5. The Speeches of Loddfathomer (111–137)

The so-called **Speeches of Loddfathomer** (ON *Loddfáfnismǫl*) is a series of advice stanzas addressed to Loddfathomer, an otherwise unknown figure who is clearly fictional. His name is a compound of *lodd-,* apparently related to ON *loddari* 'juggler, tramp', OE *loddere* 'pauper, beggar' + *Fáfnir* 'Fathomer', literally 'embracer', the name of the famous gold-hoarding wyrm. The name thus paints the picture of an archetypal greedy fool in desperate need of the wisdom taught by Weden, his intellectual superior.

Loddfathomer reappears in st. 164, which reveals that the galders of 147–165 are also addressed to him, but he is not found outside of *Háv*. If he belongs to a lost mythological or legendary episode he most likely played a similar role to King Heathric in *Heiðr* 10 or the ettin Webthrithner in *Vafþ*, namely as an arrogant challenger of Weden's wisdom soon bested by him.

The content of the advice in this section is generally similar and sometimes identical to that found in the Guests' Strand (1–79), but the focus is not identical. We here find items of a superstitious or religious nature (e.g. 113–114, 126, 129, 137) and advice regarding women (113–115, 118, 130, 131/5), both topics the Guests' Strand proper entirely avoids.

Most stanzas (112, 113, 115–117, 119–122, 125–132, 133–135, 137) are introduced by a repeated three-line refrain (*stef*) of type *abcc*.

**111** Mál 's at þylja · þular stóli á; [R 6r/14]
Urðar brunni at
sá'k ok þagða'k, · sá'k ok hugða'k,
hlýdda'k á manna mál;
umb rúnar heyrða'k dœma, · né umb rǫ́ðum þǫgðu
Hǫ́va hǫllu at,
Hǫ́va hǫllu í
heyrða'k segja svá:

It is time to chat upon the thyle's throne.
At the Well of Weird
I saw and I shut up; I saw and I thought;
I listened to the matters of men.
Of runes I heard them speak, nor did they shut up their counsel,
at the High One's hall,

in the High One's hall,
I heard them say so:

---

1 Mál | *The body of the* M *takes up a single line in height, but the right leg curves down to the line below; the letter is noticeably thicker than the capitals introducing individual sts., yet smaller than the initials introducing separate poems in* **R**.

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ALL | This stanza serves as an internal framing device and introduces the section.

1 þylja 'chant' | The verb corresponding to *þulr* 'thyle'.

1 þular 'thyle' | The reciter, chanter of ancient lore. See Index.

**112** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/17]
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 nǫ́tt þú rís=at, · nema á njósn séir,
eða lęitir þér innan út staðar.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Rise not at night unless thou be scouting
or looking to ease thyself outside.

---

1 Rǫ́ð=umk 'I counsel' | The use of the reflexive is unusual. It may derive from a hypercorrection of 1pl. pres. ind. *rǫ́ðum*, which is not uncommonly used in a singular sense in poetry.

1 Lodd·fáfnir 'Loddfathomer' | For the etymology of this name, see introduction to sts. 111–137 above.

5 lęitir þér innan út staðar 'looking to ease thyself outside' | Lit. 'looking for thy place outside'. To *lęita sér staðar* 'look for one's place' is euphemistic; the same expression is used by Snorre in *Yng* 11.

**113** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/19]
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 fjǫl-kunnigri konu · skal=at-tu í faðmi sofa,
svá't hǫn lyki þik liðum.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
In a manicunning woman's arms shalt thou never sleep,
lest she lock thee in her limbs.

---

4 fjǫl-kunnigri 'manicunning' | F. dat. sg. of *fjǫl-kunnigr* 'sorcerous', an adj. used of both men and women.

5 svá't hǫn lyki þik liðum 'lest she lock thee in her limbs' | The image of the seductress physically binding the man in her arms is not uncommon cross-culturally and is famously used in the Bible, Ecclesiastes 7:26: "And I find woman more bitter than death. For she is all snares, and nets her heart, and fetters her arms. He who is good before God will escape her, and an offender will be trapped by her." (Alter 2018).

**114** Hǫn svá gørir · at gàir ęigi [R 6r/21]
2 þings né þjóðans máls;
mat þú vill≀at · né manns≀kis gaman
4 fęrr þú sorga-fullr at sofa.

She makes it so that thou nowise heedest
the Thing nor the ruler's speech;
thou wilt not have food nor any man's pleasure;
thou goest sorrowful to sleep.

1 gàir 'heedest' | The nasal vowel in this verb is attested in Elfdalian *gå*.

**115** Rǫ́ð≀umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · at rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/22]
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 annars konu · tęyg þér aldri≀gi
ęyra-rúnu at.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Another man's wife do never entice
into becoming thy ear-whisperess [LOVER].

5 ęyra-rúnu 'ear-whisperess [LOVER]' | This word is also used in *Vsp* 38, in which male seducers of married women are among those being forced to wade through heavy streams in the afterlife. Cf. also st. 131/5 below.

**116** Rǫ́ð≀umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/23]
2 njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
4 à fjalli eða firði, · ef þik fara tíðir,
fá≀sk-tu at virði vęl.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
on fell or firth if thou desirest to journey—
furnish thyself well with food.

4 á fjalli eða firði ‘on fell or firth’ | Hiking through mountains or sailing along the shore; an expression just as well at home on Iceland as in western Norway. This word pair is a formulaic merism, and although this is its only poetic attestation it is also found several times in the Old Norwegian laws (e.g. *Gula* 73 (NGL I, p. 38), *Frost* 32 (NGL I, p. 142); see ONP for further occurrences).

**117** [R 6r/24]

Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir,
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
illan mann · lát aldri=gi
ȯ·hǫpp at þér vita,
því't af illum manni · fęr aldri=gi
gjǫld hins góða hugar.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Never let an evil man
know of thy mishaps,
for from an evil man wilt thou never get
recompense for thy good heart.

5 ȯ·hǫpp at þér vita | An unambiguous instance of *v* alliterating with a vowel.

**118** [R 6r/26]

Ofar=la bíta · sá'k ęinum hal
orð illrar konu,
flá-rǫ́ð tunga · varð hǫnum at fjǫr-lagi
ok þęy=gi umb sanna sǫk.

I saw sorely biting at a lonely man
the words of an evil woman;
a false-counseling tongue brought his life to its end
and yet nowise o'er a truthful charge.

1 Ofar=la ‘sorely’ | Contraction of *ofar=liga* ‘CV: high up, in the upper part’, presumably meaning that the words were particularly grievous or insulting and cut him deeply. Whether the man was murdered or committed suicide is not clear.

3 flá-rǫ́ð tunga ‘a false-counseling tongue’ | Cf. *Lok* 31/1: *flǫ 's þér tunga* ‘false is thy tongue’.

**119** [R 6r/28]

Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir,
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
vęitst, ef vin átt, · þann's vęl trúir,

far þú at finna opt;
því't hrísi vǫx · ok hǫ́u grasi
vegr, es vǫ́t=ki trøðr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Thou knowest, if thou hast a friend whom thou trustest well
journey to find him oft,
for with brushwood and with tall grass grows
the way which no one treads.

---

4–5 vǫitst ... oft 'Thou knowest ... oft' | Near-identical to st. 44/1, 4 above.

6 hrísi vǫx · ok hǫ́u grasi 'with brushwood and with tall grass grows' | Identical to *Grm* 17/1.

**120** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ǫn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/30]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
góðan mann · tǫyg þér at gaman-rúnum
ok nem líknar-galdr meðan lifir.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Draw a good man toward thee with pleasure-runes
and learn galders of kindness while thou livest.

---

4 gaman-rúnum 'pleasure-runes' | Here "rune" appears to carry its root meaning of 'whisper, counsel, speech', thus 'pleasing speech'. Cf. st. 129 where this word reoccurs.

5 líknar-galdr 'galders of kindness' | Metaphorical, i.e., ways of speaking which will make one liked; cf. the similar use of the related verb *gala* in 29/4 above.

**121** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ǫn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/31]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
vin þínum · ves aldri=gi
fyrri at flaum-slitum.
sorg etr hjarta, · ef þú sǫgja né náir
ǫin-hvǫrjum allan hug.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
With thy friend never be the first
to tear the relation apart.

Sorrow eats thy heart if thou canst not tell
anyone thy whole mind.

---

6–7 sęgja ... ęin-hvęrjum allan hug ‘tell anyone thy whole mind’ | Cf. st. 124 which uses almost the same expression.

**122** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6r/33]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
orðum skipta · skalt aldri=gi
við ȯ·svinna apa,

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Words shalt thou never exchange
with unwise apes,

---

ALL | Cf. st. 125 below which gives similar advice.

5 ȯ·svinna apa ‘unwise apes’ | Formulaic; cf. *Grm* 33, *Fáfn* 11.

**123** því't af illum manni · munt aldri=gi [R 6r/34]
góðs laun of geta,
ęn góðr maðr · mun þik gørva mega
líkn-fastan at lofi.

for from an evil man wilt thou never
get a reward for thy goodness,
but a good man will know to make thee
firmly liked through his goodwill.

---

1–2 því't ... geta ‘For ... praise’ | Cf. st. 117/6–7.

4 líkn-fastan ‘firmly liked’ | The first element *líkn* ‘liking’ is somewhat difficult; see st. 8 for definitions. For the cpd. La Farge and Tucker (1992) give a tentative ‘assured of favour’, while CV gives ‘fast in goodwill, beloved’.

**124** Sifjum 's þá blandit · hvęrr es sęgja rę́ðr [R 6v/2]
ęinum allan hug;
alt es bętra · an séi brigðum at vesa:
es=a sá vinr ǫðrum · es vilt ęitt sęgir.

Kinship is mingled whenever one resolves to tell
one man his whole mind.
Everything is better than to be with the fickle;
he's no friend to another who speaks pleasantries alone.

1–2 segja ... ęinum allan hug ‘tell one man his whole mind’ | Cf. st. 121 which uses almost the same expression.

**125** [R 6v/4]

Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir,
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
þrimr orðum sęnna · skal=at-tu þér við verra mann;
opt hinn bętri bilar,
þá's hinn verri vegr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
With three words shalt thou not flyte with a worse man;
oft the better one breaks
when the worse one strikes.

4 þrimr orðum ‘With three words’ | I.e., ‘not even with three words’. If one understands *orð* in its sense ‘speech’ we may understand that if one man says something (the first speech) to which another responds with an insult (the second speech), the first man should not retaliate (the third speech) and escalate the dispute.

**126** [R 6v/5]

Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir,
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
skó-smiðr þú vesir · né skępti-smiðr,
nema sjǫlfum þér séir.
Skór 's skapaðr illa · eða skapt séi rangt,
þá 's þér bǫls beðit.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Be not a shoe-maker nor a shaft-maker
unless thou be one for thyself.
If the shoe is ill shaped or the shaft be crooked—
then for thee a bale is summoned.

ALL | The plain sense is that the customer will place a curse on the maker if he dislikes his wares.

**127** [R 6v/7]

Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir,
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
hvar's bǫl kant, · kveð þér bǫlvi at

ok gef=at þǐnum fiǫndum frið.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Wherever thou knowest a bale call it baleful against thee,
and give thy foes no peace.

---

ALL | If somebody reveals himself to be your enemy (e.g. by putting a curse on you), then acknowledge it and act decisively. Do not tolerate minor or underhanded insults, for the disrespect afforded to you may soon escalate if it is not nipped in the bud. — This st. has often been interpreted as a command to call out evil or injustice, even when committed towards somebody else, and while there is nothing that speaks decisively against such a reading, it cannot be said to agree with the cautious and shrewd spirit of *Háv*.

**128** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6v/8]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
illu fęginn · ves aldri=gi,
ęn lát þér at góðu getit.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
In the bad do never rejoice,
but let thyself be pleased by the good.

---

ALL | No person would rejoice in that which is bad for him, and so the sense should be that one should not take joy in the misfortunes of others, but rather take pleasure in that which is good and true.

5 ęn lát þér at góðu getit 'but let thyself be pleased by the good' | This construction is equivalent to CV: *geta*, A. IV. with acc.

**129** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6v/9]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
upp líta · skal=at-tu í orrostu;
—gjalti g·líkir · verða gumna synir—
síðr þitt of hęilli halir.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Look upward shalt thou not in battle
—alike to a madman become the sons of men—
lest warriors bewitch thee.

---

ALL | An obscure superstition; the interpretation hinges on the etymology of the word *gjalti* 'madman' dat. sg., also found in the closely related phrase *verða at gjalti* 'turn into a madman'. (a) CV explains it as an old dative of *gǫltr* 'boar, hog'. This necessitates an irregular breaking of *ja* < *ę*, since *gǫltr* (< Proto-Norse **galtuʀ*) is an u-stem and should have a dat. sg. *gęlti* (< PN **galtiu*; cf. **kunimudiu**, dat. sg. of **Kunimunduʀ*, on the Tjurkö 1 bracteate). (b) The generally accepted explanation in modern scholarship seems to be a borrowing from Old Irish *geilt* 'insane, mad' (so La Farge and Tucker (1992) and others). A close Irish parallel to the present stanza is found in the C12th or 13th Gaelic tale of *Suibhne mac Colmáin* who was cursed by saint *Rónán Finn* to become mad. The curse took effect when he looked into the sky during a battle, after which he was known as Suibhne *geilt*. Since earlier versions of the same story are attested as early as the 840s (Males 2024b, p. 100), this word cannot be used to argue for a C13th dating for the Speeches of Loddfathomer section of *Háv*, but its Irish roots hint at an Icelandic rather than Norwegian origin for this part of the poem.

6 halir 'warriors' | Some sort of "supernatural sky warriors", to quote Pettit (2023); perhaps even the Oneharriers.

**130** R*ǫ*ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn r*ǫ*ð nemir, [R 6v/11]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
Ef vilt þér góða konu · kvęðja at gaman-rúnum
ok fáa fǫgnuð af,
fǫgru skalt hęita · ok láta fast vesa;
lęiði=sk mann=gi gótt ef getr.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
If thou wilt address a good woman with pleasure-runes
and get good cheer from her,
a fair thing shalt thou promise and let it stand firm;
no one loathes a good thing if he gets it.

---

4 gaman-rúnum 'pleasure-runes' | While easily interpreted as 'sexual intercourse', the word is used in st. 120 in a decidedly non-sexual sense. Its base meaning is probably 'good conversation'.

**131** R*ǫ*ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn r*ǫ*ð nemir, [R 6v/13]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
varan bið'k þik vesa · ok ęigi of·varan,
ves við ǫl varastr, · ok við annars konu
ok við þat hit þriðja, · at þjófar né lęiki.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
I bid thee be wary, and not overly wary;

be wariest with ale and with another man's woman,
and with this the third: that thieves do not outplay thee.

**132** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6v/15]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
at háði né hlátri · haf aldri=gi
gęst né ganganda.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
With scorn or laughter never treat
a guest or wanderer.

**133** Opt vitu ó·gǫr=la, · þęir's sitja inni fyrir, [R 6v/16]
hvęrs þęir 'ro kyns es koma;
es=at maðr svá góðr · at galli né fylgi,
né svá illr at ęinu=gi dugi.

Oft they who sit within do not fully know
of what kind are those who come;
there is no man so good that no flaw follows
nor so bad that he avails for nothing.

**134** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6v/17]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
at hǫ́rum þul · hlę aldri=gi,
opt 's gótt þat's gamlir kveða,
opt ór skǫrpum bęlg · skilin orð koma
þęim's hangir með hǫ́um
ok skollir með skrǫ́um,
ok váfir með vil-mǫgum.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
At a hoary thyle never laugh;
oft is good that which old men sing;
oft from a scorched leather-bag come discerning words;
from him who hangs amidst hides
and dangles amidst dry skins

and sways amidst calf-stomachs.

---

6 skǫrpum bęlg ‘from a scorched leather-bag’ | Metaphor for an ancient, thick-wrinkled man.

9 vil-mǫgum ‘calf-stomachs’ | A compound of *vil* ‘cattle-entrails’ + *magar* ‘stomachs’. A reading *víl-mǫgum* ‘lads of toil [THRALLS]’ is possible but gives no reasonable sense that adds to the description of a hanging leather-bag.

**135** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [R 6v/20]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
gęst þú né gęyj=a · né á grind hrękir;
get þú vǫ́-luðum vęl.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer—and thou oughtst to learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
At the guest do not bark nor spit at the gate;
furnish the destitute well.

---

4 né gęyj=a ‘At the guest do not bark’ | Note the occurrence of the archaic double verbal negation *né … =a(t)* which otherwise sees no use in *Hávi* (probably for metrical-syntactical reasons, since *né* cannot occur at the start of a line or clause). *né* is the original Germanic negation placed directly before the verb (cf. Gothic *ni*, OE *ne*) while *=a(t)* (also *-t*) is a West Norse innovation probably originally deriving from a shortening of *vętt(r)* ‘wight, thing’ (cf. English “not” < *n·á·wiht* ‘nothing’, originally *ne* + *á·wiht*). In an instance of Jespersen’s cycle (whereby a strengthening adverb eventually displaces the original negative; e.g. archaic French *je ne sais* ‘I do not know’ > modern standard *je ne sais pas* ‘id.’, lit. ‘I do not know a step’ > modern colloquial *je sais pas* ‘I don’t know) ON *=a(t)* comes to be the main productive negator in poetry, whereas both older *né* and intermediate *né … =a(t)* are marginalized (Jespersen [1917] 2025). For an overview of Norse negations in poetry see Sapp (2022, pp. 83–89).

4 né á grind hrękir ‘nor spit at the gate’ | The guest is presumably standing in front of the gate waiting for the farmer to open it and let him in.

**136** Rammt es þat tré, · es ríða skal [R 6v/21]
ǫllum at upp-loki;
baug þú gef · eða þat biðja mun
þér lęs hvęrs á liðu.

Strong is that wood which shall swing
to open up for all.
Give a bigh or it will summon
every kind of guile onto thy limbs.

---

ALL | This stanza is rather difficult, but due to the lack of a separate refrain most likely relates to the advice in st. 135. The sense is then that a man’s house (symbolised by its gate) will be strengthened by generosity, but weakened and cursed by greed and inhospitality, whether from the wrath of denied travellers or supernaturally from the anger of the gods (for which cf. *Grm* P2).

**137** Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, · ęn rǫ́ð nemir, [**R** 6v/23]
njóta munt ef nemr,
þér munu góð ef getr:
hvar's ǫl drekkir · kjós þér jarðar męgin,
því't jǫrð tękr við ǫlðri, · ęn ęldr við sóttum,
ękik við ab·bindi, · ax við fjǫl-kyngi,
hǫll við hý-rógi; · hęiptum skal Mána kvęðja,
bęiti við bit-sóttum, · ęn við bǫlvi rúnar;
fold skal við flóði taka.

*I counsel thee, Loddfathomer, that thou learn the counsels;*
*thou wilt profit if thou learnest,*
*they will be good for thee if thou gettest:*
Wherever thou drinkest ale choose for thee the earth's might,
for earth takes against drunkenness and fire against sicknesses,
oak against dysentery, the ear of corn against manicunningness,
elder against married strife—in feuds shall one hail Moon—
heather against bite-sicknesses and runes against a bale;
earth shall be taken against flood.

6 við | 'viþið' *(with corrupt abbreviation mark for* -iþ-*)* **R**

ALL | This stanza gives a rare glimpse into Wiking Age folk medicine. The exact application of the listed cures is highly uncertain; is the drunk man, for example, supposed to ingest earth, rub it against his belly, or invoke the personified Earth in some way?

6 fjǫl-kyngi 'manicunningness' | Sorcery.

7 hǫll við hý-rógi 'elder against married strife' | Both nouns are hapax legomena. *hǫll* (ms. *'haull'*) is tentatively connected by Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon (1989, s.v. *2 höll*) to Danish *hyld* 'elder tree, elderberry', New Norse *hyll* 'id.', OHG *holuntar* 'id.', although the phonology is irregular. *hý-rógi* (dat. sg. of **hý-róg*) is transparently a cpd. of *hý-* 'married couple, household' (cf. *Ski* 42/n.) + *róg* 'strife, slander'. The exact way the elderberry will help is unclear, but I see the present half-line as connecting to the following one since both deal with conflict: the former domestic, the latter violent. — CV (s.v. *haull*) consider this half-line corrupt and suggest the emendation **við haulvi hý-rógr* 'spurred rye (ergot of rye) against hernia'. Although interesting and closer in sense to the rest of the stanza their emendation is too conjectural to be adopted here.

7 hęiptum skal Mána kvęðja 'in feuds shall one hail Moon' | That the Moon had a certain "might" is also attested in *Vsp* 5; it is presumably for this might which he is invoked here, that he may give strength to the man in conflict. For *kvęðja* 'hail, invoke' cf. *Lok* P4.

## 6. The Rune-Tally (138–146)

This group of stanzas is introduced by a large initial in **R**, marking the beginning of a new section. In younger paper manuscripts, they have the header *Rúna-tals þáttr* 'Strand of the Rune-Tally'.

Outside of *Háv* 138–146 (but cf. st. 80 above, which would fit seamlessly into the present section), there are a few other manuscript attestations of similar Runic magic, but none of them show the unabashed heathendom

of the present stanzas. In **R** there is also *Skí* 36 and *Sigrdr* 5–17, although there are signs that point towards the latter text's being a later antiquarian composition, something sts. 138–146 are most likely not.

**138** Vęit'k at ek hekk · vin*ga-męiði á [R 6v/27]
nętr allar níu,
gęiri undaðr · ok gefinn Óðni,
sjalfr sjǫlfum mér,
á þęim męiði, · es mann=gi vęit,
hvęrs af rótum rinnr.

I KNOW THAT I HUNG on the hanging tree
for all nights nine,
wounded by a spear and given to Weden,
Myself to Myself
on that tree where no man knows
of whose roots it runs.

---

1 Vęit'k | V *has a descending initial with a height of two lines.* 1 vin*ga-męiði 'the hanging tree' | 'vindga meiði' **R**

---

ALL | The myth of Weden's self-sacrifice ("the Hanging") is told only here and nowhere else. Still, the god has a strong association with hanging throughout the Norse corpus. Weden is known by names like *Hangi* 'Hanged One' (Tindr *Hákdr* 1/5 in SkP 1, cf. note there), *Hanga-týr* 'Tew (i.e., god) of the Hanged' (*Skm* 7), and *Hanga-guð* 'God of the Hanged' (*Gylf* 20:10), and in st. 158 below he speaks of bringing a hanged man's corpse back to life.

The method of the sacrifice in the present st. bears remarkably close resemblance to an episode in *Gautr* 7. In exchange for good wind, king Wiker and his men, among which is Weden's protégé Starked, agree to hang one of their own number as a sacrifice to Weden. They draw lots and they fall upon king Wiker. Troubled by this they decide to honour their oaths by performing a mock hanging, and Starked, whom Weden has secretly given a spear disguised as a reed, is to carry it out. The rest is best repeated in full:

*Þar stóð fura ein hjá þeim ok stofn einn hár nér furu'nni. Neðar=liga af furu'nni stóð einn kvistr mjór ok tók í lim'it upp. Þá bjuggu þjónustu-sveinar mat manna, ok var kálfr einn skorinn ok krufðr. Starkaðr lét taka kálfs-þarma'na. Síðan steig Starkaðr upp á stofn'inn ok sveigði ofan þann inn mjóva kvist'inn ok knýtti þar um kálfs-þormu'num. Þá mélti Starkaðr til konungs: „Nú er hér búinn þér gálgi, konungr, ok mun sýnast eigi all-mann-héttr=ligr. Nú gakk-tu hingat, ok mun ek leggja snøru á háls þér.“ Konungr mélti: „Sé þessi um-búð ekki mér héttu=ligri en mér sýnist, þá vęnti ek, at mik skaði þetta ekki, en ef qðru-vís er, þá mun auðna ráða, hvat at gerist.“ Síðan steig hann upp á stofn'inn, ok lagði Starkaðr virgul'inn um háls honum ok steig síðan ofan af stofni'num. Þá stakk Starkaðr sprota'num á konungi ok mélti: „Nú gef ek þik Óðni.“ Þá lét Starkaðr lausan furu-kvist'inn. Reyr-sprot'inn varð at geir, ok stóð í gegnum konung'inn. Stofninn fell undan fótum honum, en kálfs-þarmar'nir urðu at viðju sterkri, en kvistr'inn reis upp ok hóf upp konung'inn við limar, ok dó hann þar.*

'There stood a tall pine close to them and a tall stump next to the pine. At the lower part of the pine there was a thin branch and it curved upwards into the leafage. Then the servant-boys made food for the men and a calf was cut by its throat and opened up. Starked had the calf-intestines taken. Thereafter Starked stepped onto the stump and pulled down the thin branch and tied around it the calf-intestines. Then Starked spoke to the king: "Now a gallows is readied for thee, O king, and it will not seem of risk to any man. Now come hither and I will lay the rope onto thy neck." The king spoke: "If this undertaking be of as little risk to me as it looks then I expect that this will not injure me, but if it is otherwise then fortune will decide what happens afterwards." Thereafter he stepped onto the stump and Starked laid the noose around his neck and thereafter stepped down from the stump. Then Starked stabbed the reed into the king and spoke: "Now I give thee to Weden." Then Starked let go of the pine-branch. The reed turned into a spear and it pierced through the king. The stump fell away from under his feet, but the calf-intestines became a strong withy, but the branch rose up and lifted the king up into the leafage, and there he died.'

Several motifs from the just-quoted passage are attested in other Norse sources. In *Styrb* 2 Weden gives king Eric a reed which upon the uttering of a devotional formula turns into a spear and inagurates a large-scale human sacrifice in the form of a landslide burying an enemy host (cf. *Vsp* 23 n.); in *2 HHund* P10 Weden lends Day his spear; in Saxo Grammaticus (2015, p. 77) 1.8.27 the Odinic king Harding ends his life by hanging himself before his people (for the Odinic nature of this sacrifice see Schjødt 2020a, pp. 1158, 1162, 1174–76); and in *Yng* 9 Weden marks himself with a spear on his deathbed and is followed by Nearth, who continues the practice by "marking" himself (presumably with a spear) to Weden before his own death.

With these parallels in mind it seems likely that the method of sacrifice described in the present st. has its origin in authentic pre-Christian ritual. It is only fitting that a sacrifice to Weden—even if the victim be the god himself—should be carried out in the way such sacrifices ought to be, and the past mythological actions of gods tend to serve as the basis for present human ritual (*Vsp* 7 n., *Grm* 41–43 n.). Further instances of hanging-sacrifices include Adam of Bremen (2002, p. 208) who mentions the hanging of nine men in a grove at the Temple of Upsele, and although the god to whom they are sacrificed is not named, it can only really be Weden. For discussion of the devotion of armies and war-captives to Weden, cf. *Vsp* 23 n.

Against the interpretation of a simple sacrifice, Sundqvist (2010) argues convincingly that the present stanza is the etiology behind an initatory ritual likely used to initiate cultic leaders, so-called thyles (*þulir*) or gids (*goðar*). According to his view, the nine nights are the liminal period during which Weden is being remade, halfway between the land of the living and the land of the dead, and his deprivation represents a passage ritual. When Weden reemerges, it is as an initiate: he has mastered the arts of runic writing, Scaldic poetry, and the bloot, and consequently flourished.

1 vin*ga-męiði 'the hanging tree' | The ms. form *vindga meiði* is generally understood to be a form of *vinga-męiðr* 'hanging tree, gallows tree', a word found in three Scaldic stanzas (SkP: Egill Lv 14, Eyv *Hál* 5, Anon (*FoGT*) 17). The form *vindga-* 'windswept, windy' is most likely a folk etymological substitution for *vinga-*, which has nothing to do at all with wind but is better interpreted as 'swaying' (related to words like Swedish *vingla* 'sway, wobble', German *wanken* 'sway, stagger', cf. *Þrk* 1/1 n.). This reading is further strengthened by *vindga* being in the unusual weak form rather than the expected strong dat. sg. m. **vindgum*. The original sense of *vinga-męiðr* is thus the 'tree which sways back and forth', viz. under the weight of the hanged man's body. —

The tree is probably the Ash of Ugdrassle (the World Tree), which is named after this hanging, being the "ash-tree of Ug's ⟨Weden⟩ gallows". The unknown origin of its roots clearly adds to the mystery of the self-sacrifice. Here we may compare with the description of the three roots of the tree in *Grm* 31, one going into the Underworld, the other into the land of the Ettins, the third into the land of Men. By hanging on the Ash while hovering between life and death, Weden was thus directly connected to the Underworld, which likely makes this episode an instance of the god's convening with the dead for wisdom (see Introduction to *Vsp*).

2 nętr allar níu 'for all nights nine' | TODO: magical number

**139** Við hlęifi mik søldu=t · né við horni=gi; [**R** 6v/29]
2 nýsta ek niðr, · nam'k upp rúnar,

ǿpandi nam, · fell'k aptr þaðan.

With no loaf they relieved Me, nor with any horn.
I peered down; I took up the runes;
screaming I took—I fell back thence.

---

1 Við hlęifi mik sǿldu=t · né við horni=gi 'With no loaf they relieved Me, nor with any horn' | I.e., 'I got neither bread to eat nor ale to drink.'

**140** Fimbul-ljóð níu · nam'k af hinum frégja syni [R 6v/31]
2 Bǫl·þorns, Bęstlu fǫður,
ok ek drykk of gat · hins dýra mjaðar
4 ausinn Óð·røri.

Nine fimble-leeds I learned from the famous son
of Balethorn, Bestle's father—
and a drink I got of the dear mead
poured from Woderearer.

---

ALL | Here the poem moves away from the subject of the Hanging to the subject of how Weden learned his galders (ll. 1–2) and the art of poetry (3–4).

1 Fimbul-ljóð níu 'Nine fimble-leeds' | Nine very great chants or spells (galders); compare the eighteen (9 times 2) leeds in *Háv* 147–165 below.

1–2 hinum frégja syni / Bǫl·þorns, Bęstlu fǫður 'the famous son of Balethorn, Bestle's father' | According to *Gylf* 6:9–10: *Hann fekk þeirar konu, er Bestla hét, dóttir Bǫl·þorns jǫtuns, ok fengu þau þrjá sonu; hét einn Óðinn, annarr Vili, þriði Vé.* 'He [= Byre] got to wife the woman called Bestle, the daughter of the ettin Balethorn, and they had three sons. One was called Weden, the other Will, the third Wigh.' This passage makes Balethorn's son Weden's maternal uncle and the present stanza is thus an example of the old Germanic custom of sending sons away to be fostered by the mother's male relations. This custom, not uncommon in the later saws, is attested already by Tacitus, *Germania* 20: *Sororum filiis idem apud avunculum qui ad patrem honor. Quidam sanctiorem artioremque hunc nexum sanguinis arbitrantur et in accipiendis obsidibus magis exigunt, tamquam et animum firmius et domum latius teneant.* 'The sons of sisters are held in the same esteem by their maternal uncle as by their father. Some even consider this bond of blood to be more sacred and more binding, and prefer to demand nephews when taking hostages, reasoning that they secure a firmer hold on the mind and a wider hold on the family.'

**141** Þá nam'k fręva=sk · ok fróðr vesa [R 6v/33]
2 ok vaxa ok vęl hafa=sk;
orð mér af orði · orðs lęitaði
4 verk mér af verki · verks lęitaði.

Then I began to flourish and be wise
and grow and have it well.
Word from word provided Me a word;
work from work provided Me a work.

---

ALL | After Weden obtained the wisdom he flourished; each good speech and deed multiplied and led to another. One wonders whether there is not something reminiscent of the Aristotelian εὐδαιμονίᾱ in the whole stanza.

1 nam'k fréva=sk 'I began to flourish' | *fréva=sk* 'flourish, thrive' is a reflexive verb derived from *fré* 'seed (of plants)'. A notorious mistranslation, originated by Talley (1974) and popularised by Greenberg (1988, p. 248), instead takes this phrase as 'I took (i.e., ingested) semen'; this reading is grammatically impossible and makes no sense in the context of the stanza, where the verb *nam* clearly means 'began', not 'took'.

**142** Rúnar munt finna · ok ráðna stafi, [R 6v/35]
mjǫk stóra stafi,
mjǫk stinna stafi,
es fáði Fimbul·þulr
ok gørðu ginn-regin
ok reist Hroptr r*a*gna.

Runes wilt thou find and interpreted staves,
very great staves,
very stiff staves,
which the Fimblethyle painted,
and the Yin-Reins made,
and Roft of the Reins ⟨= Weden⟩ carved.

6 r*a*gna 'of the Reins' | 'rǫgna' **R**

1 Rúnar munt finna · ok ráðna stafi 'Runes wilt thou find and interpreted staves' | A close parallel is found in the long-line on the mediaeval runestone N 13: *rúnar ek rist · ok ráðna stafi* 'runes I carve and interpreted staves.'

**143** Óðinn með ǫsum, · en fyr ǫlfum Dáinn, [R 7r/2]
Dvalinn dvergum fyrir,
Ásviðr jǫtnum fyrir,
ek reist sjalfr sumar.

Weden among the Eese but Dowen for the Elves,
Dwollen for the Dwarfs,
Oswith for the Ettins;
I myself carved some.

4 ek 'I' | The identity of the speaker is unclear, but, judging by line 1, it is apparently not Weden.

**144** Veitst, hvé rísta skal? · Veitst, hvé ráða skal? [R 7r/3]
Veitst, hvé fáa skal? · Veitst, hvé fregista skal?
Veitst, hvé biðja skal? · Veitst, hvé blóta skal?

Vęitst, hvé sęnda skal? · Vęitst, hvé sóa skal?

Knowest thou how one shall carve? Knowest thou how one shall read?
Knowest thou how one shall paint? Knowest thou how one shall try?
Knowest thou how one shall ask? Knowest thou how one shall bloot?
Knowest thou how one shall send? Knowest thou how one shall waste?

---

ALL | The first four verbs refer to runes: carving, interpreting, colouring, and divining, the latter four to sacrifice: praying, worshipping, sending (the sacrifice or the prayer), and slaying (the victim). — The structure of the stanza bears some resemblance to the Högstena galder (Vg 216, edited under Galders).

4 sóa 'waste' | I.e., kill the victim, as was done through stunning and decapitation (*Vafþ* 21/4 n.) This rare verb is never used in prose, and outside of *Háv* only in a single other poem, *Yt*, in st. 5 in the context of human sacrifice, and in st. 18 about the ambush of a king.

**145** Bętra 's ȯ·beðit · an séi of·blótit, [R 7r/5]
ęy sér til gildis gjǫf;
bętra 's ȯ·sęnt · an séi of·sóit;
[...]

It is better unasked than over-blooted;
a gift always looks for recompense.
It is better unsent than over-wasted;
[...]

---

ALL | An identical progression of four verbs suggests a close relation with the previous st.
I agree with Males (2024b) on the interpretation of this stanza: since a gift always requires recompense, an excessive sacrifice imposes an excessive debt on the part of the god to whom it is addressed, which might upset the sacrificer's relationship with the god. Males draws an analogy to an episode in *Eg* 78, where a rival poet leaves an expensive shield for the protagonist Eyel before riding off; the latter understands this as a demand to compose a poem about the shield and is greatly insulted.
The gift cycle between Gods and Men, of which the present st. is a Germanic attestation, is a very important concept in Indo-European pagan religions. The idea that sacrifices create (moral, if not legal) contractual obligations for recompense is prevalent in the Roman religion and summarized by the ritual concept *dō ut dēs* 'I give that thou might give' (Rüpke 2007, pp. 102, 149). A similar expression is found in an OI sacrificial prayer (*Taittirīya Saṃhitā* 1.8.4.1, during the *Rāja-sūya* or consecration of a king): *Dēbí mē, dádāmi tē; ní mē dʰēhi, ní tē dadʰē; ni·ɦáram ín ní mē ɦarā, ni·ɦáram* 'Give to me, I give to thee; bestow upon me, I bestow upon thee; bring gain indeed to me, [I bring] gain [to thee]'.

4 [...] | No gap is indicated in the ms., but the meter requires a c-verse in this position. Its loss is most unfortunate since the pres. st. is an unusual look into pre-Christian religious attitudes.

**146** Svá Þundr of ręist · fyr þjóða rǫk, [R 7r/7]
þar's upp of ręis, · es aptr of kom.

So did Thound ⟨= Weden⟩ carve before the history of men
where he rose up as he came back.

---

ALL | This stanza is somewhat obscure, and it is unclear to which section it belongs. The first word, *svá* 'so, thus', may be referring back either to the preceding sts. (138–145) or to the ones ahead (147–165); since the stanza has a conclusionary tone and likely refers to the Hanging, it is taken to belong with sts. 138–145. The stanza appears to describe the contents of the section as the verses which Weden wrote down immediately after learning the runes during the Hanging (sts. 138–139 above); it places this event in a time long before human history (*þjóða rǫk*).

1 Þundr 'Thound' | A common poetic name for Weden. It is unrelated to English "Thunder", which in fact corresponds to ON *Þórr*. Based on the genitive *Þundar*, *Þundr* must be an *i*- or an *u*-stem (< PGmc. **Þundiz* or **Þunduz*). The most promising etymology for that word is as a derivative of the IE root **ten-* 'stretch, extend' (surviving in the causative as ON *þenja* 'to stretch (out)'), extended with *-d-* (cf. Latin *tendō* 'to stretch'). A direct cognate for **Þunduz* is obtained in Lithuanian *tandùs* 'lazy, sloppy' < **ténd-u-s* ~ **tn̥d-éw-s*, with Germanic regularizing the oblique zero-grade stem to all cases (for which cf., e.g., PGmc. **burþiz* ~ **burþiz* 'birth' < PIE **bʰértis* ~ **bʰr̥téys*). The sense of the name would thus be 'stretched', likely referring to the god's neck during the hanging.

## 7. The Leed-Tally (147–165)

The final section of *Háv*, the so-called the Leed-Tally (*Ljóða-tal*), is not separated from the preceding Rune-Tally but is usually taken as separate since it is a self-contained list not much concerned with runes. The speaker, certainly Weden, once again addresses Loddfathomer and lists eighteen galders.

The spells themselves are not given, but only their purpose. They are aristocratic and Odinic in character and deal with such things as battle (galders 3, 4, 5, 8, 11, 13), healing (1, 2, 12), countering sorcery (6, 10), controlling the elements (7, 9), and seduction (16, 17). The 18th and last spell is a mystery; not even its purpose is told, and it is known only by Weden and the women closest to him.

Uniquely in this section we find Weden as a healer—a side of the god which is otherwise largely absent from the Old Norse literary corpus, where he rather chiefly takes on the role of War-God. On the other hand this aligns well with the god's appearance in West Germanic healing charms like the English *Nwyrt* 11 and the High German *Mers II*. Still we need not look in vain for West Germanic influence in the present section; this difference of character is most likely simply a matter of which genres of texts have survived from the different regions of the Germanic religious sphere.

Several of the numbered galders are reminiscent of other known Germanic spells. The fourth (st. 150) bears a strong likeness to *Grg* 10, and its effect (removing fetters) is shared with the High German *Mers I*, ostensibly an actual galder of that type (but cf. the Introduction there). The mysterious eighteenth spell (st. 165) finds an interesting numerological parallel in the unknowable eighteenth question posed by Weden in *Vafþ* 54.

**147** Ljóð þau kann'k, · es kann=at þjóðans kona [R 7r/8]
ok manns=kis mǫgr.
Hjǫlp hęitir ęitt, · þat þér hjalpa mun
við sorgum ok sǫkum, · ok sútum gǫrv-ǫllum.

Those leeds I know which the king's wife knows not,
and no man's lad.
Help is one called; it will help thee
against sorrows and suits and all griefs entire.

**148** Þat kann'k annat, · es þurfu ýta synir, [R 7r/10]
2 þęir's vilja lękna lifa.

This I know second, which those sons of men need
who wish to live as leechers.

---

1 þurfu ýta synir 'those sons of men need' | Cf. the similar wording in 166/2.

2 lękna 'leechers' | Physicians. A relation to 'leech' is likely but the direction of influence is unclear (Kroonen 2013, p. 331); the physicians may be named after the tool of their trade (leeches, for bloodletting), or the leeches named after the physicians.

**149** Þat kann'k þriðja, · ef mér verðr þǫrf mikil [R 7r/11]
2 hapts við mína hęipt-mǫgu,
ęggjar dęyfi'k · mínna and·skota,
4 bíta≠t þęim vǫ́pn né vęlir.

This I know third, if I come in great need
of hindrance against my feud-lads [FOES]:
I dull the blades of my enemies;
for them bite not weapons nor staffs.

---

4 vęlir 'staffs' | Plural of *vǫlr*, here referring to the magic staff or sceptre used by witches and warlocks; the word *vǫlva* 'wallow' (seeress, prophetess) is probably derived from this word. The reading *vélir* 'wiles, tricks, deceits' must be excluded for metrical reasons, since a c-verse in Leeds-meter cannot end in a trochée.

**150** Þat kann'k fjórða, · ef mér fyrðar bera [R 7r/13]
2 bǫnd at bóg-limum,
svá ek gęl, · at ganga má'k,
4 sprettr mér af fótum fjǫturr,
ęn af hǫndum hapt.

This I know fourth, if men bear
bonds onto my shoulder-limbs [ARMS]:
*so* do I gale that I may walk;
springs from my feet the fetter,
and from my hands the bond.

---

ALL | Cf. *Grg* 10, which is very similar to the present stanza, and *Mers I* (edited below under Galders), a galder that seems actually to have been used for loosening fetters.

**151** Þat kann'k fimta, · ef sé'k af fári skotinn [R 7r/15]
2 flęin ï folki vaða,
flýgr=a svá stint, · at stǫðvi'g=a'k,
4 ef hann sjònum of sé'k.

This I know fifth, if I see a dangerously shot
arrow in the troop wading:
it flies not so stiff that I cannot stop it
if I see it in my sights.

**152** Þat kann'k sétta, · ef mik sęrir þegn [R 7r/16]
2 à rótum rás viðar,
þann hal, · es mik hęipta kveðr,
4 þann eta męin hęldr an mik.

This I know sixth, if a thane wounds me
on the roots of a sappy tree:
that man who sings hatred against me—
*him* the harms hurt instead of me.

---

3 þann hal 'that man' | ok þann hal *'and that man'* **R**

---

1–2 ef mik sęrir þegn à rótum rás viðar 'if a thane wounds me on the roots of a sappy tree' | I.e., "if a man carves a runic curse against me".

2 à rótum rás | The alliteration of this line is problematic since the normal form of the adj. *rár* is *brár* (so *Skí* 32), but the required alliteration with *rótum* makes that an impossibility. Another alternative is to emend **v-* in **vrótum* for a line ***à vrótum brás viðar*. The emendation relies on an etymological relation between ON *rót* and OE *wyrt*, but as Kroonen (2013, pp. 597, 601) points out *rót* has an initial *r-* even in East Nordic which otherwise consistently preserves old *vr-*. This circumstance calls the existence of an early West Nordic form **vrót* into question. Furthermore *rót* alliterates with *r-* in st. 138 above.

2 rás 'sappy' | The sappy wood was apparently of importance for the curse; cf. the curious account of *Gr* 79, where a hag curses Gretter in the following way: after finding a small tree and planing a small smooth surface onto a scorched side of it, she carves runes in its roots and reddens them with her own blood. She then chants galders while walking counter-clockwise around it. Lastly she pushes it out to sea, praying for it to drift to Gretter's homestead and curse him. Cf. also *Skí* 32 where Shirner goes to a *brár viðr* 'sappy tree' to get a certain magic stick.

4 eta 'hurt' | Properly 'eat', but the verb here means 'consume' in an injurious sense. The import is, of course, that the enemy's own curses turn on him and consume him.

**153** Þat kann'k sjaunda, · ef sé'k hǫvan loga [R 7r/18]
2 sal of sess-mǫgum,
brinnr=at svá brętt, · at hǫnum bjargi'g=a'k;
4 þann kann'k galdr at gala.

This I know seventh, if I see a high hall
blazing over seat-lads [WARRIORS]:

it burns not so broadly that I cannot save it—
that galder I can gale.

---

1 loga ‘blazing’ | The syntax of l. 1 alone makes this word look like the acc. of the m. noun *logi* ‘flame’ (i.e., “if I see a high flame”), but the noun modified by the m. acc. sg. adj. *hǫvan* ‘high’ is in fact *sal* ‘hall’ in l. 2, and *loga* must thus be the verb ‘blaze, burn’.

4 galdr ‘galder’ | The use of this word reveals the synonymity of *galdr* ‘galder’ and *ljóð* ‘leed’.

**154** Þat kann’k átta, · es ǫllum es [R 7r/20]
2 nyt-sam=ligt at nema,
hvar’s hatr vęx · með hildings sonum,
4 þat má’k bǿta brátt.

This I know eighth, which for all men is
useful to learn:
wherever hatred grows among the sons of a prince,
it I may shortly mend.

---

3 hatr ‘hatred’ | Viz., over their father’s inheritance. As any reader of European history will know, such conflicts were a constant source of war and kinslaying, both in the mediaeval Germanic-founded kingdoms and in the Roman Empire that went before them.

**155** Þat kann’k níunda, · ef mik nauðr of stęndr [R 7r/22]
2 at bjarga fari mínu á floti,
vind ek kyrri · vági á
4 ok svęfi’k allan sę.

This I know ninth, if I come in need
of saving my ship as it floats:
the wind I calm upon the wave,
and put all the sea asleep.

**156** Þat kann’k tíunda, · ef sé’k tún-riður [R 7r/23]
2 lęika lopti á,
ek svá vinn’k, · at þęr villar fara
4 sinna hęim-hama
sinna hęim-huga.

This I know tenth, if I see fence-rideresses
playing aloft:
I work it so that they go astray
of their home-hames,
of their home-minds.

---

3 þęr villar fara ‘they (*f.*) go astray (*f.*)’ | *gramm. emend.;* þęir villir fara *‘they (*m.*) go astray (*m.*)’* **R**

ALL | The stanza requires explanation. To begin with, the *tún-riður* 'fence-rideresses' are generally understood to be shape-shifting witches who have detached from their bodies and are now flying around tormenting the people (Wallenstein 2019, p. 398). This concept has anthropological parallels in the idea of the "soul-flight", found in Saami, Siberian, and Native American religions and in later Scandinavian folklore (Wallenstein 2019, pp. 400–404).
The Old Norse conception of soul-flight, also found in sources outside of *Háv* (e.g., *Historia Norwegiæ*), was as follows: the witches were thought able to *ham-hlęypa* 'hame-leap', i.e., to leave their original (human) *hamir* 'hames' or 'skins'. This was called a *gand-ręið* 'gand-ride', during which they would torment and injure the folk; the *gandr* 'gand' was the familiar spirit with which they would be joined when riding. When the witches were out riding their human bodies (or hames) would be lying unconscious and vulnerable; they would also retain that part of the human soul which was thought inextricably linked to the hame: the *hugr* 'mind, seat of emotions'. That the hame was not merely dead "skin" is shown by a notable passage in *Vǫls* 8, wherein the heroes Syemund and Sinfittle find two wolf-hames, and, upon donning them, learn the speech of wolves, becoming blood-thirsty and ravenous.
A vivid description of the witches' ride, frequently compared with the present stanza, is found in the OSwe. Elder West-Geatish Law (ca. 1250 AD), RB 5:5: *Þetta eru ú·kvęðins-orð konu. „Iak sá, at þú rêt á kví-grindu lǫs-hárað ok í trolls ham, þá allt var iam-ript nátt ok dagr." Kallar hana kunna firi-gera konu ellr kó, þet er ú·kveðins-orð.* […] (SSGL 1, p. 38, my norm.) 'These are the words of insult to a woman: "I saw that thou rodest on the sheep-pen-fence loose-haired and in a troll's hame when everything was equally divided between day and night." If he says that she knows how to destroy (with magic) a woman or a cow, that is a word of insult.' It may be noted that the ms. word *quiggrindu* 'sheep-pen-fence' (dat. sg.) has also been interpreted as *kvið-grindu* 'womb-opening', i.e., the woman's (bared) nether parts, with a likely sexual implication (Sjöros 1919, pp. 224–228).
A persistent danger in any soul-flight is the "soul-loss". The flying soul (or parts of it) may be unable to return to its original body (whether by going astray or by being actively prevented from it by another magician) and this will cause pain and madness, and eventually the death of the witch or wizard (Wallenstein 2019, pp. 400–404). It is surely in this way we should read the present stanza, and here I agree with Wallenstein (2019, p. 406). With his unrivalled skill as a magician, Weden could see the rideresses. With his galder, he would prevent them from returning to their original hames or minds, eventually annihilating them. Weden brags elsewhere about doing this in *Hárb* 20, and this also mirrors his role as troll- and witch-hunter in the Wild Hunt of later folklore (TODO: cite Grimm). Since the noun *ríða* on its own means 'fever, chills' (Fr, s.v. *ríða*), we are also seeing Weden in his role as supernatural healer.

1 tún-riður 'fence-rideresses' | The sense of *tún* (cognate with English "town") is most likely 'hedged plot, courtyard', which perhaps allows us to connect it to the witch's riding on the *kví-grindu* 'sheep-pen-fence' in the Elder West-Geatish Law (see note to ALL). Numerous cpds. exist with the same second element, e.g. *kveld-riður* 'evening-rideresses' (*HHj* 15/4) and *myrk-riður* 'dark-rideresses' (*Hárb* 20).

**157** Þat kann'k ęllipta, · ef skal'k til orrostu [R 7r/25]
2 lęiða lang-vini,
und randir gęl'k, · ęn þęir með ríki fara,
4 hęilir hildar til,
hęilir hildi frá,
6 koma þęir hęilir hvaðan.

This I know eleventh, if I shall into the fray
lead old friends:
beneath the shield-rims I gale, and they go with power
hale to the battle,

hale from the battle;
they come hale anywhence.

---

2 lang-vini ‘old friends’ | Lit., ‘long-friends’. In Germanic paganism the followers and protégés of a god are frequently called his *vinir* ‘friends’, *ǫst-vinir* ‘beloved friends’, or *full-trúar* ‘trusted confidantes’. Already in *Beow* we see that the Shieldings are called the *Ing-winas* ‘friends of Ing’; in *Sigsk* 24/4 the hero Siward is called *Freys vinr* ‘Frea’s friend’; and in *Hym* 11 the god Thunder is called the *vinr ver-liða* ‘friend of manly retinues’. Two other places where Weden’s followers in particular are called his friends are *Sont* 22, where Eyel speaks about his friendship (*vinátt*) with Weden, and *Grm* 54, where Weden emphasises that his disgraced protegé is his *vinr* ‘friend’. There was thus clearly room for personal religion and deep devotion to a single patron god in the Germanic religion, and many illustrative examples of that are found in the saws. See further Hultgård (2018).

**158** Þat kann’k tolpta, · ef sé’k á tré uppi [R 7r/27]
váfa virgil-ná,
svá ek ríst · ok í rúnum fá’k,
at sá gęngr gumi.
ok męlir við mik.

This I know twelfth, if I see in a tree up high
sway a gallow-corpse:
so I carve and paint in the runes,
that that man walks
and speaks with me.

**159** Þat kann’k þrėt-tánda · ef skal’k þegn ungan [R 7r/29]
verpa vatni á,
mun=at hann falla · þó’tt í folk komi,
hnígr=a sá halr fyr hjǫrum.

This I know thirteenth, if on a young thane
I shall sprinkle water:
he will not fall though he come into battle;
that hero will not sink before swords.

---

1–2 ef skal’k þegn ungan verpa vatni á ‘if on a young thane I shall sprinkle water’ | A reference to the Heathen name-giving ceremony in which the infant would be sprinkled with water; cf. the attestations in *Rþ* 7, 22, 35.

**160** Þat kann’k fjór-tánda, · ef skal’k fyrða liði [R 7r/31]
tęlja tíva fyr,
ásа ok álfa · ek kann allra skil,
fár kann ó·snotr svá.

This I know fourteenth, if before the troop of men
I shall count forth the Tews:

of all Eese and Elves I know the distinctions;
few unwise men can do so.

---

3 skil 'distinctions' | Their unique attributes. Cf. *Hym* 38, where the corresponding verb *skilja* 'to discern, understand' likewise is used in the context of god-lore.

**161** Þat kann'k fimm-tánda, · es gól Þjóð·rørir [R 7r/33]
2 dvergr fyr Dęllings durum,
afl gól ǫsum, · ęn ǫlfum frama,
4 hyggju Hropta-týr.

This I know fifteenth, which Thedrearer galed,
the dwarf, before Delling's doors.
Strength he galed for the Eese, but fame for the Elves,
thought for Tew of the Rofts ⟨= Weden⟩.

---

4 Hropta-týr 'Tew of the Rofts ⟨= Weden⟩' | The older dative *-tívi* (*Haustl* 8/1a, *Þdr* 20/3a) is not allowed for metrical reasons as a Leeds-meter c-verse cannot end in a long syllable followed by another syllable.

**162** Þat kann'k sex-tánda, · ef vil'k hins svinna mans [R 7r/35]
2 hafa gęð allt ok gaman,
hugi hvęrfi'k · hvit-armri konu
4 ok sný'k hęnnar ǫllum sefa.

This I know sixteenth, if from the wise girl I will
have her senses all, and pleasure:
I change the heart of the white-armed woman,
and I twist her whole mind.

---

ALL | Galders 16 and 17 concern love. Compared to the other galders in the Leed-Tally, this theme may seem somewhat less supernatural, yet to any man acquainted with the stubbornness of women, such words as can change their hearts may seem yet more miraculous and hard-found than those which may extinguish fire or resurrect the dead.

**163** Þat kann'k sjau-tjánda · at mik sęint mun firra≈sk [R 7v/2]
2 hit man-unga man.

This I know seventeenth, that I will late be shunned,
by that girl-young girl.

**164** Ljóða þęssa · munt Lodd·fáfnir [R 7v/2]
2 lęngi vanr vesa;
þó séi þér góð ef getr,
4 nýt ef nemr,

þǫrf ef þiggr.

These leeds wilt thou, Loddfathomer,
long be lacking!
Though they might be good for thee if thou gettest,
profitable if thou learnest,
needful if thou takest.

---

ALL | A parathetical statement, but there is no reason why it should not be authorial. It precedes the final, unknowable spell.

**165** Þat kann'k át-tjánda, · es ǫ́va kǫnni'k [R 7v/4]
mǫ́y né manns konu,
—allt es bǫ́tra · es ǫ́inn of kann,
þat fylgir ljóða lokum—
nema þǫ́iri ǫ́inni, · es mik armi vǫ́rr,
eða mǐn systir sé́i.

This I know eighteenth, which I will never teach
a maiden nor man's woman,
(everything is better which one alone knows;
that follows the last of the leeds!)
save her alone who holds me in her arms,
or is my sister.

---

5 mik armi vǫ́rr 'holds me in her arms' | A similar expression is also used *Vkv* 2. The one who wraps Weden in her arm may be his wife, Frie.

**166** Nú eru Hǫ́va mǫ́l kveðin · Hǫ́va hǫllu ǐ; [R 7v/7]
all-þǫrf ýta sonum,
ȯ·þǫrf jǫ́tna sonum;
hǫ́ill sá's kvað, · hǫ́ill sá's kann,
njóti sá's nam,
hǫ́ilir þǫ́ir's hlýddu.

Now are the High One's speeches sung in the High One's hall,
most useful for the sons of men,
harmful for the sons of ettins.
Hail him who sang! Hail him who knows!
May he profit who learned!
Hail those who heeded!

---

3 jǫtna 'ettins' | *corr. by other hand from* ýta *'men'* **R**

---

ALL | This stanza is of great weight since it gives the whole poem a religious significance. The memorisation and recitation of the whole of *Háv* will both spiritually benefit mankind and injure the Ettins, the enemies of Gods and men; this dualistic worldview (Ettins–evil–wilderness against Gods–humans–settlement) is thoroughly pre-Christian. Cf. further Introduction to the whole poem above.

4–6 kvað, kann, nam, hlýddu ‘sang, knows, learned, heeded’ | The implicit object is the speeches. These verbs all indicate a fully oral cultural context.

# Speeches of Webthrithner
# *(Vaf·þrúðnis mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.894)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Webthrithner** (*Vafþ*) describes a wisdom-contest between the god Weden and the ettin Webthrithner.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Vafþ* is preserved in two mss.: in full in **R** and partially (from st. 20 onwards) **A**. In **R**, the poem appears on foll. 7v/9–8v/31, where it follows *Háv* and is followed by *Grm*. In **A**, it appears on fol. 3r/1–3v/22, where it is likewise followed by *Grm*. Since the beginning of the poem has been lost along with a number of folios in **A**, we cannot tell what text preceded it; *Skí* comes before the lacuna, but there may have been additional poems on the now-lost pages inbetween *Skí* and *Vafþ*.

*Vafþ* was clearly available to Snorre. Sts. 18, 30–31, 35, 37, 41, 45, 47, and 51 are cited in *Gylf*. These citations will be referred to collectively as the **G** redaction of the poem, and the lost source containing the complete poem may be called *__G__. In the critical edition, **G** will refer to agreement between all four mss. of *Gylf* (**STWU**).

Since both **R** and **A** are younger than *Gylf*, neither could have served as direct the source for **G**. It is notable that st. 31 has lost its second helming (ll. 3–4) in **RA**, whereas these two lines survive in **G**. Since this loss could hardly occur spontaneously in two independent traditions, it suggests that **RA** have a shared textual relationship and descend from a common manuscript archetype, which may be termed *__RA__. The retention of the helming in **G** shows that *__RA__ was a separate source from *__G__.

## Meter and stanza

*Vafþ* is composed in Leeds-meter and consists of 55 stanzas. Four lines may be considered defective and are irrestorable without conjectural emendation: 5/3, 34/1, 38/3 (see below), and 54/3. In addition, st. 40 is heavily emended.

The normal stanzaic configuration *abc abc* appears in 50 out of 55 sts. (1–26, 28–37, 39–41, 44–54). The singular configuration *abc* (27; see note) in the middle of the question-and-answer stanzas should undoubtedly be considered a defective variant of this configuration.

Four variant configurations are found. *abc abcc* (42) and *abcc abc* (43) are both variants of *abc abc*. They appear at an important transition in the poem, as Weden asks his last numbered question, introducing his final six questions about the end times. *abc abc abc* (55) only appears once, likewise at a charged location, namely in the final st., as Webthrithner admits defeat.

A stranger variant is *abc ab abc* (38). This configuration may be taken as a mixing of Leeds-meter and Speeches-meter, but it is also possible that a *c*-verse has been lost following the central long-line *ab*. The fact that the long-line does not alliterate further hints at potential corruption, but it is clearly semantically crucial and cannot be removed from the stanza.

## Narrative structure

The poem essentially consists of a riddle contest between the god Weden and the ettin Webthrithner. Far from being a loose collection of mythic lore, it has a tight structure and logical plan throughout. The whole may be divided into four sections: the first is the prologue, where Weden takes counsel from his wife Frie and sets out for Webthrithner's hall (sts. 1–10). The remaining three sections form the contest and consist of alternating stanzas where one side asks and the other answers. They are distinguished from each other by means of repeated refrains in the question stanzas and consist of Webthrithner's four unnumbered questions (11–19), Weden's twelve numbered questions (20–43), and Weden's six unnumbered questions about the end times (44–55).

The following table illustrates the refrains; for stanza 40 see note there:

| | |
|---|---|
| 11–17 | *Sęg mér/þat, Gang·ráðr, · alls à golfi vill / þíns of fręista frama* |
| 20–42 | *Sęg þat (it)* N*(:a)* · ... / ... *Vaf·þrúðnir vitir* |
| 44–54 | *Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð fręistaða'k, / fjǫlð of ręynda'k ręgin* |

Something ought to be said about the numerology of the questions. It is hardly a coincidence that Weden asks exactly eighteen questions, this being a multiple of the sacred number nine. It is especially notable that another Odinic list, Leed-tally (sts. 147–165) of *Háv*, also has eighteen items—even more so, since the eighteenth spell there, like the eighteenth question here, is a mystery known only to Weden himself. This circumstance reveals the care put into the structure of *Vafþ*.

## Summary

The first scene of the poem assumes that the god Weden and his wife, Frie, are sitting together. Weden asks Frie for counsel, as he is curious about the ancient wisdom which the ettin Webthrithner might possess (1). Frie expresses worry, since she considers Webthrithner stronger than all other ettins (2), but Weden says that he has travelled far and wide and wants to know what Webthrithner's hall is like (3). Frie wishes him good luck against the ettin (4), and he departs to challenge Webthrithner's *orð-spęki* 'word-wisdom' (5). The god arrives at the ettin's hall and introduces himself (6); Webthrithner promptly declares that his guest will not come out of the hall unless he be wiser than he (7). Weden introduces himself as Gangred, saying that he has come from afar in need of Webthrithner's hospitality (8). The ettin invites this Gangred to sit down (9), and the guest in turn utters a gnomic stanza (10) not unlike those of the first section of *Háv*.

Webthrithner begins by asking four mythological questions, each answered by Gangred in turn. The questions concern the horse that pulls the day (11–12), the horse that pulls the night (13–14), the river which divides the gods and ettins (15–16), and the plain where Surt and the gods will fight (17–18).

Webthrithner calls the guest learned and invites him to sit. He declares that the loser of the contest must give his head (19). The roles are now reversed, and Gangred poses twelve numbered questions to the ettin. The questions can be divided into three groups of four based on their subjects. Gangred first asks about the origins of cosmological phenomena: the earth and heaven (20–21), sun and moon (22–23), day and night (24–25), and winter and summer (26–27). His next four questions concern the earliest ettins: the ettin Earyelmer (28–29), Earyelmer's ancestry (30–31), how he reproduced without a partner (32–33), and what Webthrithner himself first remembers (34–35). The last four numbered questions are more sundry. Weden asks about the origin of the wind (36–37) and the god Nearth (38–39), about Walhall and the Oneharriers (40–41), and at last a meta-question: where Webthrithner learned such great wisdom (42–43).

The refrain and theme of the questions now change, as Gangred asks six unnumbered questions concerning the end times, all beginning with the same refrain. The disguised god asks which humans will survive the Fimblewinter (44–45), how the sun can rise after Fenrer has destroyed it (46–47), about some obscure maidens (48–49; see note), which Eese will survive after the flame of Surt goes out (50–51), and how Weden will die (52–53). Finally, he asks the unknowable question: what did Weden speak in the ear of Balder before he was burned on the pyre (54)?

Webthrithner at last understands the identity of his challenger, since only Weden himself could know the answer to that question. He laconically accepts his imminent death and the futility of his own wisdom; the poem ends with his admission that Weden will always be the wisest (55).

## Dating

*Vafþ* displays archaic formal characteristics. The poem has an especially high frequency of the archaic particle *of*, appearing at a rate of 0.438 occurrences per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70). In addition, it displays alliteration between *v-* and old *vr-* (st. 53/2; Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 37), a highly archaic trait indicative of composition before ca. 1000 AD. The pre-Christian subject matter, which shows no sign of antiquarian composition, and which was likely not fully understood even by Snorre (see st. 35), also suggests an early date. In conclusion, *Vafþ* was likely composed in the 9th or 10th century—at any rate during the pre-Christian period.

## Text

### Vaf·þrúðnis mǫl (‘The Speeches of Webthrithner’)

[Óðinn:] **1** „Ráð mér nú Frigg · alls mik fara tíðir [R 7v/9]
2 at vitja Vaf·þrúðnis;
for·vitni mikla · kveð'k mér á fornum stǫfum
4 við þann inn al-svinna jǫtun.“

[Weden:] “Counsel me now, Frie, as I long to journey
to visit Webthrithner.
Great curiosity I have for the ancient staves
of that all-wise ettin.”

---

3–4 for·vitni ... jǫtun. ‘Great ... ettin.’ | I.e., “I am very curious to learn his ancient words of wisdom.” Cf. st. 55.

[Frigg:] **2** „Hęima lętja · mynda'k Hęrja-fǫðr [R 7v/12]
2 í gǫrðum goða;
því't ęngi jǫtun · hugða'k jafn-ramman
4 sęm Vaf·þrúðni vesa.“

[Frie:] “At home would I keep the Father of Hosts
in the yards of the Gods,
for no ettin have I judged to be
as strong as Webthrithner.”

---

1 Hęrja-fǫðr ‘Father of Hosts’ | A name for Weden. For the second element, see *Vsp* 1/3 n.

[Óðinn:] **3** „Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð fręistaða'k, [R 7v/13]
2 fjǫlð *of* ręynda'k ręgin;
hitt vil'k vita, · hvé Vaf·þrúðnis
4 sala-kynni séi.“

[Weden:] “Much I journeyed, much I tried,
much I tested the Reins!
One more thing I wish to know: how Webthrithner's
halls may be.”

---

2 *of* | *emend. (cf. st. 44/2); om.* R

[Frigg:] **4** „Hęill þú farir, · hęill þú aptr komir, [R 7v/15]
2 hęill þú á sinnum séir;
óði þér dugi · hvar's skalt, Alda-fǫðr,

orðum méla jǫtun.“

[Frie:] “Hale mayest thou journey; hale mayest thou come back;
hale mayest thou be on thy paths!
May thy wisdom avail thee where thou, Father of Mankind,
with words shalt greet the ettin!”

3 skalt | *add.* †or† **R**

3 Alda-fǫðr ‘Father of Mankind’ | A rare poetic name for Weden, also found in st. 53/1, but not otherwise used in Eddic poetry. Among genuine compositions, the name is only found elsewhere in the Scaldic Bragi *Þórr* 1/1 (in SkP 3), although it also appears in an antiquarian poetic list of names for Weden, Þul *Óðins* 1/2 (in SkP 3).

**5** Fór þá Óðinn · at fręista orð-spęki [**R** 7v/17]
þęss ins al-svinna jǫtuns;
at hǫllu hann kom, · *es* átti Íms faðir;
inn gekk Yggr þegar.

Then journeyed Weden to test the word-wisdom
of that all-wise ettin.
He came to the hall which Ime’s father [= Webthrithner] owned;
Ug ⟨= Weden⟩ went soon inside.

3 *es* | *emend.;* ok **R**

3 Íms ‘Ime’s’ | Gen. sg. of *Ímr*, an unknown ettin. The name is probably corrupt, since alliteration on *h-* is required by the strongly stressed *hǫllu* in the a-verse. Finnur Jónsson (1932) emends to *Hymis* ‘Hymer’s’.

4 Yggr ‘Ug’ | ‘The Terrifier’, another name for Weden.

[Óðinn:] **6** „Hęill þú nú, Vaf·þrúðnir, · nú em’k í hǫll kominn [**R** 7v/18]
á þik sjalfan séa;
hitt vil’k fyrst vita, · ef fróðr séir
eða al-viðr, jǫtunn.“

[Weden:] “Hale be thou now, Webthrithner! Now I am come into the hall
to see thy very self,
yet I wish first to know if thou be learned
or all-wise, ettin!”

[Vaf·þrúðnir:] **7** „Hvat ’s þat manna, · es í mínum sal [**R** 7v/20]
verp=umk orði á?
út þú né kømr · órum hǫllum frá,
nema þú inn snotrari séir.“

[Webthrithner:] "What sort of man is this who in *my* hall
throws his word at me?
Out wilt thou not come from our halls
unless thou be the cleverer man!"

[Óðinn:] **8** „G*ang*·ráðr hęiti'k, · nú em'k af gǫngu kominn, [R 7v/22]
2 þyrstr til þǐnna sala;
laðar þurfi · hęf'k lęngi farit
4 ok þǐnna and-fanga, jǫtunn."

[Weden:] "Gangred I am called; now I am come from walking,
thirsty, to thy halls.
In need of a welcome I've journeyed for long,
and of thy reception, ettin!"

1 G*ang*·ráðr | Gagn·ráðr **R**

1 G*ang*·ráðr | 'One who decides to walk'. The emendation is supported by the b-verse, where *gǫngu* (dat. sg. of *ganga* 'walking, walk') is probably tying back to the name. *Gang·ráðr* is also found in Þul *Óðins* 3/1 (SkP 3, Gurevich ed.). The variant *Gagn·ráðr* would mean 'Victory-advisor' and is not attested elsewhere. Note that Gurevich is incorrect when she states in her note to Þul *Óðins* 3/1 that *Gylf* 5:12 records the variant *Gagn·ráðr*. The relevant source mss., **ST**, only have the abbreviation *Þá spurði G.* 'Then G. asked', which clearly does not point one way or the other.

[Vaf·þrúðnir:] **9** „Hví þú þá, Gang·ráðr, · męli=sk af golfi fyrir? [R 7v/24]
2 far þú í sess í sal;
þá skal frędista, · hvárr flęira viti,
4 gęstr eða inn gamli þulr."

[Webthrithner:] "Why then, Gangred, dost thou speak from off the floor ahead?
Take a seat in the hall!
Then it shall be tried which of the two might know more:
the guest, or the old thyle."

4 inn gamli þulr 'the old thyle' | Webthrithner himself, the thyle being the lorekeeper whose purpose it was to recite the old wisdom poems. See Encyclopedia: thyle.

[Óðinn:] **10** „Ó·auðigr maðr, · es til auðigs kømr, [R 7v/26]
2 męli þarft eða þęgi;
ofr-męlgi mikil · hygg'k at illa geti
4 hvęim's við kald-rifjaðan kømr."

[Weden:] "An unwealthy man who to a wealthy one comes
ought to speak the needful or shut up.
Great over-speaking I think will bring ill
for whomever comes upon a cold-ribbed man."

2 méli þarft eða þegi ‘ought to speak the needful or shut up’ | Formulaic, this line occurs identically in *Háv* 19.

4 kald-rifjaðan ‘cold-ribbed’ | Cold-hearted, cunning.

[Vaf·þrúðnir:] **11** „Segg mér, Gang·ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 7v/28]
2 þíns of frǫista frama,
hvé hęstr hęitir, · sá's hverjan dręgr
4 dag of drótt-mǫgu.“

[Webthrithner:] “Tell me, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt
test thy furtherance,
what the horse is called which pulls every
day over the lads of the folk [MEN].”

ALL | Sts. 11–14 deal with the two horses that pull the day and night through the heavens. Their origin is discussed in *Gylf* 10:1–10 (the whole chapter): *Nǫrvi eða Narfi hét jǫtunn, er byggði í Jǫtunheimum. Hann átti dóttur, er Nótt hét. Hon var svǫrt ok døkk, sem hon átti ętt til. Hon var gipt þeim manni, er Nagl·fari hét; þeira sonr hét Auðr. Því nęst var hon gipt þeim, er Ánarr hét; Jǫrð hét þeira dóttir. Síðast átti hana Dellingr, ok var hann ása ęttar; var þeira sonr Dagr; var hann ljóss ok fagr eftir faðerni sínu. Þá tók Al·fǫðr Nótt ok Dag, son hennar, ok gaf þeim tvá hesta ok tvęr kerrur ok sendi þau upp á himin, at þau skulu ríða á hverjum tveim dǫgrum um·hverfis jǫrð'ina. Ríðr Nótt fyrri þeim hesti, er kallaðr er Hrím·faxi, ok at morgni hverjum dǫggvir hann jǫrð'ina af mél-dropum sínum. Sá hestr, er Dagr á, heitir Skin·faxi, ok lýsir allt lopt ok jǫrð'ina af faxi hans.* ‘Narrow or Narve was the name of an ettin who dwelled in the Ettinhomes. He had a daughter whose name was Night. She was black and dark like her lineage bespoke. She was married off to the man whose name was Nailfarer. Their son was Ead. Thereafter she was married off to the one whose name was Oner. Earth was the name of their daughter. Lastly Delling got her, and he was of the lineage of the Ese. Their son was Day; he was bright and fair after his father's side. Then Allfather took Night and Day, her son, and gave them two horses and two chariots and sent them up into the heaven that they should ride every two half-days in a full circle around the earth. Night rides in front on the horse which is called Rimefax, and every morning he bedews the earth with the foam from his bit. The horse owned by Day is named Shinefax, and all the air and the earth is lit up by his mane.’
The steeds are mentioned again in *Skm* 72, which deals with legendary horses: *Ár·vakr ok Al·sviðr draga sól'ina, sem fyrr er ritat. Hrím·faxi eða Fjǫr·svartnir draga nótt'ina. Skin·faxi eða Glaðr fylgja degi'num.* ‘Yorewaker and Allswith pull the sun as is written earlier. Rimefax or Ferrowswartner pulls the night. Shinefax or Glad follows the day.’ For Yorewaker and Allswith see *Grm* 38. The alternative names Ferrowswartner (‘Life-Darkener’) and Glad probably derive from now-lost poetic sources, probably of a similar gnomic character to *Vafþ* 11–14 and *Grm* 38.
The motif of horses, especially mounted on chariots, pulling the heavenly bodies or day and night is very ancient, and is attested as far back as the Bronze Age. It is common in the hymns of *ṚV* and Greek texts, and is represented archaeologically by the beautiful Trundholm Sun Chariot from Denmark of the Nordic Bronze Age, the cultural and ethnic ancestors of the Germanic peoples. See Figures 2 and 3, and cf. *Grm* 38 n.

2 þíns of frǫista frama ‘test thy furtherance’ | I.e., “try your luck, see how far you get”. Formulaic; cf. *Háv* 2/4.

[Óðinn:] **12** „Skin·faxi hęitir, · es inn skíra dręgr [R 7v/30]
2 dag of drótt-mǫgu;
hęsta batstr · þykkir hann með *H*ręið-gotum;
4 ęy lýsir mǫn af mari.“

[Weden:] “Shinefax is he called who pulls the pure
day over the lads of the folk.
The best of horses he seems among the Reth-Gots;
for ever that stallion’s mane lights up.”

3 *H*ręið-gotum | *metr. emend.;* ‘reið-gotom’ **R**

1 Skin·faxi ‘Shinefax’ | I.e., ‘the one with a shining mane’.

3 *H*ręið-gotum ‘Reth-Gots’ | An old name for the Eastern Gots around the Black Sea, also found in *Wíd* 57 and Ög 136 Rök. The origin of the first element is unclear, but it appears to have a tribal significance (cf. the word *Hréð-cyning* ‘Reth-King’ in *Wíd* 7). They are apparently mentioned here due to their connection with the east, the direction of the dawn. There may also be a pun present, since *goti* can mean both ‘Got’ and ‘horse’.

[Vaf·þrúðnir:] **13** „Sęg þat, Gang·ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 7v/32]
2 þǐns of frękista frama,
hvé jór hęitir, · sá’s austan dręgr
4 nǫtt of nýt ręgin.“

[Webthrithner:] *“Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt*
*test thy furtherance,*



Figure 2: The gilt (day) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. Nordic Bronze Age, ca. 1400 BC. © Nationalmuseet. CC BY-SA 3.0. `https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvognen_Do_2010_1277.tif`

what the steed is called which from the east does pull
the night over the bountiful Reins."

4 nýt regin 'the bountiful Reins' | The Gods. *nýtr* 'bountiful' is one of several positive adjectives that can stand before *regin*, and recurs in the same position in *Vafþ* 14/2, 25/3 below. Cf. *holl regin* 'the hold Reins' (*Lok* 4/3), *fróð regin* 'the learned Reins' (*Vafþ* 26/4), and *blíð regin* 'the blithe Reins' (*Grm* 6/1, 38/3, 42/1; sarcastically in *Lok* 32/3).

[Óðinn:] **14** „Hrĭm·faxi hęitir, · es hverja dręgr [**R** 7v/33]
2 nǫ́tt of nýt regin;
mėl-dropa · fęllir hann morgin hverjan;
4 þaðan kømr dǫgg of dala."

[Weden:] "Rimefax is he called who pulls each
night over the bountiful Reins.
Foam from his bit he lets fall each morning;
thence comes dew through the dales."

2 of | *emend.;* ok **R**

1 Hrĭm·faxi 'Rimefax' | I.e., 'the one with a frozen mane'.

4 þaðan kømr dǫgg of dala 'thence comes dew through the dales' | For another explanation of the origin of dew, see *Vsp* 18.



Figure 3: The ungilt (night) side of the Trundholm sun chariot. © Nationalmuseet. CC BY-SA 3.0. `https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Solvognen_Do_2010_1278.tif`

[Vaf·þrúðnir:] **15** „Seg þat, Gang·ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 8r/1]
2 þǐns of fręista frama,
hvé ǫ́ hęitir, · sú's dęilir með jǫtna sonum
4 grund, ok með goðum.“

[Webthrithner:] *“Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt*
*test thy furtherance,*
what the river is called which divides the land
between the sons of Ettins and the Gods.”

[Óðinn:] **16** „Ífing hęitir ǫ́, · es dęilir með jǫtna sonum [R 8r/2]
2 grund, ok með goðum;
opin rinna · hǫn skal umb aldr-daga;
4 verðr=at íss á ǫ́u.“

[Weden:] “Iving is the river called which divides the land
between the sons of Ettins and the Gods.
Open shall it flow through its days of life;
there forms no ice on that river.”

---

1 Ífing ‘Iving’ | The border river is not known by this name from any other source, not even *Gylf*, which otherwise tends to relay even the most obscure lore.

4 verðr=at íss á ǫ́u ‘there forms no ice on that river’ | For ice would enable the Ettins to cross over into the lands of the Gods.

[Vaf·þrúðnir:] **17** „Seg þat, Gang·ráðr, · alls á golfi vill [R 8r/3]
2 þǐns of fręista frama,
hvé vǫllr hęitir, · es finna=sk vígi at
4 Surtr ok in svǫ́su goð.“

[Webthrithner:] *“Tell this, Gangred, since on the floor thou wilt*
*test thy furtherance,*
what the plain is called where they find each other at war,
Surt and the beloved Gods.”

Óðinn: **18** „Víg·ríðr hęitir vǫllr, · es finna=sk vígi at [R 8r/4, S 17r/24, T 18r/15, W 19v/22]
2 Surtr ok in svǫ́su goð;
hundrað rasta · hann 's á hvęrjan veg;
4 sá 's þęim vǫllr vitaðr.“

Weden: “Wighride is the plain called where they find each other at war,
Surt and the beloved Gods.
A hundred rests it reaches in each direction;
for them that plain is marked out.”

---

3 hvęrjan | hvęrn **T** 4 vǫllr | *add.* of **T**

---

ALL | For the fight between Surt and the Gods, cf. *Vsp* 48–53, *Fáfn* 14–15. St. 18 is explained or paraphrased in *Gylf* 51:25: *Mú·spells megir sókja fram á þann vǫll er Víg·ríðr heitir.* 'The lads of Muspell make their attack on the plain which is called Wighride.' and again in *Gylf* 51:28–29: *En Mú·spells synir hafa einir sér fylking, ok er sú bjǫrt mjǫk. Vǫllr'inn Víg·ríðr er hundrað rasta víðr á hvern veg.* 'But the sons of Muspell have a single formation, and it is very bright. The plain Wighride is a hundred rests wide in each direction.' The stanza itself is cited in *Gylf* 51:51, the very end of that chapter, following the citation of *Vsp* 45–54, introduced by the words *Hér segir enn svá* 'Here it further says so'. Note that it is omitted from **U**, one of the four *Gylf* mss.

3 rasta 'rests' | An old measurement of distance, ca. 1850 metres (CV, s.v. *rǫst*).

Vaf·þrúðnir: **19** „Fróðr est nú gęstr, · far á bękk jǫtuns, [**R** 8r/6]
2 ok mélum=k í sessi saman;
hǫfði vęðja · vit skulum hǫllu í
4 gęstr, of goð-spęki.“

Webthrithner: "Learned art thou now, guest; take the ettin's bench
and let us speak in the seat together!
Wager a head shall we two in the hall,
O guest, over god-wisdom!"

---

1 Fróðr est nú gęstr, · far á bękk jǫtuns 'Learned art thou now, guest; take the ettin's bench' | I.e., "Thou hast proven thy learning." Webthrithner acknowledges his guest's wisdom and repeats his invitation for the god to sit down. Weden accepts the offer, and the contest continues; now it is Weden's turn to ask, Webthrithner's to answer.

## Capitulum ('New Chapter')

Óðinn: **20** „Sęg þat it ęina, · ef þitt óði dugir [**R** 8r/9, **A** 3r/1]
2 ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan jǫrð of kom, · eða upp-himinn
4 fyrst, inn fróði jǫtunn.“

Weden: "TELL THIS ONE if thy wisdom avails
and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know
whence Earth came or Up-heaven,
first, O learned ettin."

---

1 Sęg | S *is a bold capital in* **R** 1 óði | *The first word on fol. 3r of* **A**; *from this point we have the poem in both manuscripts.* 2 ok | eða **A**

---

3 jǫrð ... eða upp-himinn 'Earth ... or Up-heaven' | An old Common Germanic formulaic merism, referring to the whole universe. See Index of formulae: Earth and Up-heaven.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **21** „Ór Ymis holdi · vas jǫrð of skǫpuð, [**R** 8r/10, **A** 3r/2]

ǫ́n ór bǫ́inum bjǫrg,
himinn ór hausi · ins hrím-kalda jǫtuns,
ǫ́n ór svǫ́ita sǫ́r.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “From Yimer’s flesh was the earth created,
but from his bones the mountains;
the heaven from the skull of that rime-cold ettin,
but from his blood the sea.”

---

ALL | The gods sacrificed Yimer and created the world from his body, as told more fully in *Grm* 41–42 and alluded to in *Vsp* 3–4. For Yimer, cf. sts. 30–33 below; for the deeper cosmological and religious significance of this myth see notes to *Vsp* 3–4 and also to *Grm* 43. — The whole st. bears very close resemblance to *Grm* 41; ll. 1 and 4 here are identical to ll. 1–2 there, and ll. 2 and 3a here are clearly related to ll. 3a and 4 there. Still, the sts. are distinct enough that the one cannot be a direct scribal copy of the other, and the relationship is more likely to be oral. Both have probably been composed in the same West Norwegian milieu, in turn deriving from an older Common Germanic tradition (cf. *Wessobrunn* under Poetry on Christian Subjects).

3 himinn ór hausi ‘the heaven from the skull’ | The heavens are understood as a dome, a view common to many ancient peoples. This also fits well with the floating clouds being Yimer’s brains, as told in *Grm* 42.

4 ór svǫ́ita sǫ́r ‘from his blood the sea’ | According to *Gylf* 7:3–4, the slaying of Yimer produced so much blood that it drowned the whole race of Rime-Thurses save one; see st. 35 below. For the method of slaying cf. *Sont* 3/3: *jǫtuns hals · undir þjóta* ‘the neck-wounds of the ettin [SEAS] roar’, which attests that Yimer was slain by decapitation, the typical way of wasting beasts of sacrifice (so e.g. *Hym* 15). That this is not a mere literary construct is proven by the excavation of the Wiking Age site Hove-steads (*Hofstaðir*) on Iceland, where bulls were seasonally slain in what was undoubtedly ritual sacrifice: “The most likely reconstruction from the forensics of the skulls requires at least a two-person team, one of whom struck the animal between the eyes (effectively killing it and certainly stunning it into momentary immobility) while the second swung a fairly broad-bladed axe at the neck or base of the skull for a beheading stroke.” (Lucas and McGovern 2007, p. 23). After the slaying (and presumed feasting on the meat), the heads of the bulls were displayed for a prolonged period of time. Lucas and McGovern further note that swift beheading was not the usual manner of slaughtering animals on Iceland, and even has practical downsides compared to a slower cutting of the throat, e.g., splintered bones and damage to the cutting blade. On the other hand, the violent cutting and following flow of blood would have great dramatic effect, and, what Lucas and McGovern do not mention, clearly reenact the slaying of Yimer: the separation of the skull (heaven) from the body (earth), and the great flow of blood (sea-water) from the neck-wound, lastly the burial of the consumed body in the earth, and the display of the skull on high to symbolize the heaven. —
The ancients believed that the earth was surrounded on all sides by an outer sea (ON *út-haf*); cf. *Hym* 5/1 n., 22/4 n.

4 svǫ́ita ‘blood’ | In poetry *svǫ́iti* ‘sweat’ almost always means ‘blood’. This is shared with OE *swât*, as seen e.g. in *Beow* 1286a: *sweord* swâte *fâh* ‘sword stained with “sweat”’, 2689b–2690: *hé ge-blódegod wearð / sâwul-dríore; · swât ýðum wéoll.* ‘he was bloodied in soul-gore; the “sweat” gushed in waves’.

Óðinn kvað: **22** „Sǫ́g þat annat, · ef þitt óði dugir [R 8r/12, A 3r/3]
ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan Máni of kom, · svá’t fǫ́rr mǫ́nn yfir,
eða Sól it sama.“

Quoth Weden: *“Tell this* other one, *if thy wisdom avails,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*

whence the Moon came which journeys over men,
or the Sun likewise."

1–2 ef ... vitir | *abbrev. as* 'e. þ. ę. d. ȝ þ. v.' **R**; *abbrev. as* 'e. þ. e. d.' **A**

ALL | For the origin of the Sun and Moon cf. *Grm* 38.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **23** „Mundil·fœri hęitir, · hann 's Mána faðir [**R** 8r/13, **A** 3r/4]
ok svá Sólar it sama;
himin hverfa · þau skulu hvęrjan dag
ǫldum at ár-tali."

Quoth Webthrithner: "Mundlefarer he is called—he is the father of the Moon,
and so of the Sun likewise.
Turn round heaven shall they every day,
for mankind's tally of years."

4 ár-tali | *corr. in same hand from* ald-tali **A**

ALL | This st. clearly serves as a source of *Gylf* 11:1–3: *Þá męlti Gangleri: „Hversu stýrir hann gang sólar eða tungls?" Hárr segir: „Sá maðr er nefndr Mundil·fari, er átti tvau bǫrn. Þau vóru svá fǫgr ok fríð, at hann kallaði son sinn Mána, en dóttur sína Sól ok gipti hana þeim manni, er Glenr hét.* […] 'Then spoke Gangler: "How does He [viz. Allfather] rule the track of the sun or the moon?" High says: "There is a man named Mundlefarer who had two children. They were so fair and beautiful that he called his son 'Moon', but his daughter 'Sun', and he married her off to the man who was called Glen. [...]' Cf. *Grm* 38 n., which cites *Gylf* 11:4–7.

1 Mundil·fœri 'Mundlefarer' | See Index for the etymology, which likens the cosmos to a Wiking Age flour-mill turned by a handle. His name is attested in *Gylf* 11:2 as *Mundil·fari*, which underlies the Anglish rendition Mundlefarer.

4 ǫldum at ár-tali 'for mankind's tally of years' | According to *Vsp* 6 the Gods gave names to night, the moon-phases, morning, midday, afternoon, and evening *órum at tęlja* 'the years for to tally'. — Numerous examples of the chronological reckoning of the Heathen Icelanders are found in Are's Book of Icelanders and in the Book of Land-Claims (*Ldn*). Both texts anchor the years to the Christian Common Era, but this is likely the result of later Christian learning. The counts were most likely originally based on the reigns of kings, of which many examples are found in those two books.

Óðinn kvað: **24** „Sęg þat it þriðja, · alls þik svinnan kveða [**R** 8r/15, **A** 3r/6]
ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan Dagr of kom, · sá's fęrr drótt yfir,
eða Nǫtt með niðum."

Quoth Weden: *"Tell this* third, *since they call thee wise,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*,
whence the Day came which journeys over the folk,
or the Night with the moon-phases."

2 ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir | *abbrev. as* 'ȝ þ. v. v.' **R** 2 ok | eða **A**

4 Nǫtt með niðum ‘Night with the moon-phases’ | Also found in *Vsp* 6/3.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **25** „Dęllingr hęitir, · hann ’s Dags faðir, [**R** 8r/17, **A** 3r/8]
2 ęn Nǫtt vas Nǫrvi borin;
ný ok nið · skópu nýt regin
4 ǫldum at ár-tali.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “Delling he is called; he is the father of Day,
but Night was born to Narrow.
The waxing and waning the bountiful Reins created
for mankind’s tally of years.”

---

1 Dęllingr ‘Delling’ | A derivative of the adjective *dallr* ‘(possibly) shining, brilliant’ (cf. Old English *deal* ‘proud, exalted’) which appears in two other ON mythological names, viz. *Hęim·dallr* (the god Homedall) and *Mar·dǫll* (Meredall, an epithet of the goddess Frow. Also in these two instances the root appears to have connotations of light and brilliance; for Meredall see *Vsp* 24 n., *Þrk* 8 n., and for Homedall see *Grm* 13, *Þrk* 13/3 n., *Gylf* 27 (ed. under *Eddbr* III).

2 Nǫrvi ‘Narrow’ | Dat. sg. of *Nǫrr*, to be identified with the *Nǫrvi* (or *Narfi*) of *Gylf* 10:1 (see st. 11 n.). His name may be a kenning for the Gap of Hawks or primordial chaos (cf. *Vsp* 3/4 n.) and thereby equivalent to the Greek χάος ‘gap, Chaos’, father of Νύξ ‘Night’ (*Theog* 123).

3 ný ok nið ‘The waxing and waning’ | The two halves of the moon cycle, by which months (’moon-ths’) were reckoned. The phrase also occurs in *Gut* 2: *um ný ok niðar*, *Gula* 57: *um ný bit nésta ok niðar*, and *Gylf* 11:8: *Máni stýrir gǫngu tungls ok rę̄ðr nýjum ok niðum* ‘Moon steers the track of the lunar body and rules over the waxings and wanings’. For the Norse-Germanic calendar see notes to *Vsp* 6.

Óðinn kvað: **26** „Seg þat it fjórða, · alls þik *fróðan* kveða, [**R** 8r/18, **A** 3r/9]
2 ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan vetr of kom · eða varmt sumar
4 fyrst með fróð regin.“

Quoth Weden: *“Tell this* fourth, *since they call thee learned,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*
whence the Winter came or the warm Summer,
first, amidst the learned Reins.”

---

1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. f.’ **RA** 4 með | of **A**

---

1 *fróðan* ‘learned’ | It seems indisputable that the word hiding behind the abbreviated *f.* of the mss. is the m. acc. sg. of the adj. *fróðr*, but as it is not written out explicitly it must be marked by italics.

Vaf·þrúðnir: **27** „Vind·svalr hęitir, · hann’s Vetrar faðir, [**R** 8r/20, **A** 3r/10]
2 ęn Svǫsuðr Sumars.“
[...]

Webthrithner: "Windswale is he called; he is the father of the Winter;
but Sosuth is the Summer's."

---

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 19:3–4: *Svásuðr heitir sá, er faðir Sumars er, ok er hann svá sél-lífr, svá at af hans heiti er þat kallat svásligt, er blítt er. En faðir Vetrar er ýmist kallaðr Vind·lóni eða Vind·svalr. Hann er Vásaðar son, ok vóru þeir ǫttungar grimmir ok sval-brjóstaðir, ok hefir Vetr þeira skap-lyndi.* 'Sosuth is the name of he who is the father of Summer, and he lives so joyously that from his name that which is glad is called 'delightful'. But the father of Winter is variously called Windloon or Windswale. He is the son of Wosuth, and those kinsmen were cruel and cool-breasted, and Winter has their temperament.'

3 [...] | The second half of the st. seems to be missing. Its contents are unknown, but may be preserved in the *Gylf* paraphrase. No lacuna is indicated in the mss.

Óðinn kvað: **28** „Seg þat it fimta, · alls þik *fróðan* kveða, [R 8r/21, A 3r/11]
ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hverr ása ældstr · eða Ymis niðja
yrði í ár-daga."

Quoth Weden: *"Tell this* fifth, *since they call thee learned,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*
who, oldest of the Eese or of Yimer's kinsmen [ETTINS],
arose in days of yore."

---

1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. f.' **R**; *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. f. k.' **A**

---

3–4 hverr ... ár-daga 'who ... days of yore.' | I.e., "Which is the very first being?" Cf. the question on the cryptic C9th Malt Stone (DR NOR1988;5): **huaʀisi : alistiąsa**, perhaps *Hvaʀ es inn ældsti ása?* 'Who is the eldest of the Eese?'

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **29** „Ør·ófi vetra · áðr véri jǫrð of skǫpuð, [R 8r/22, A 3r/12]
þá vas Ber·gelmir borinn;
Þrúð·gelmir · vas þess faðir,
en Aur·gelmir afi."

Quoth Webthrithner: "Uncountable winters before the Earth was created,
then was Bareyelmer born.
Thrithyelmer was that one's father,
and Earyelmer the grandfather."

---

2 vas | *om.* **A**

Óðinn kvað: **30** „Seg þat it sétta, · alls þik svinnan kveða, [R 8r/23, A 3r/14, S 2v/17, T 3r/28, W 5v/32]
ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan Aur·gelmir kom · með jǫtna sonum
fyrst, inn fróði jǫtunn."

Quoth Weden: *"Tell this* sixth, *since they call thee wise,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*
whence Earyelmer came amidst the sons of ettins,
first, O learned ettin."

---

1–2 Sęg ... vitir 'Tell ... know' | *om.* **G** 1 Sęg þat it | *abbrev. as* 'S. þ. þ. h.' *(for* *S. þ. h.*)* **A** 1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. s. q.' **R**; *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. f. k.' *(influenced by sts. 26, 28)* **A**

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ALL | In *Gylf* 5:12, Snorre cites *Vafþ* 30/3–4 and the full 31 in support of his lengthy and embellished creation narrative, introduced by the words *En hér segir svá Vaf-þrúðnir jǫtunn:* 'but here the ettin Webthrithner says so', though it is not certain that his vision is what the poet of *Vafþ* had in mind.

Vaf-þrúðnir kvað: **31** „Ór Éli-vǫ́gum · stukku ęitr-dropar, [R 8r/25, **A** 3r/15, **S** 2v/17, **T** 3r/29, **W** 6r/1, **U** 4r/21]
2 svá óx und's ór varð jǫtunn;
þar órar ę́ttir · kómu allar saman;
4 því's þat ę́ alt til atalt."

Quoth Webthrithner: "Out of the Ilewaves splashed droplets of venom;
so it grew until there became an ettin from it.
Thereof our lineages all came together;
therefore it is for ever all too fierce."

---

1 Ór | Þá's ór **S** 2 svá 'so' | ok *'and'* **G** 2 óx und's ór varð jǫtunn | vǫxtr vinds ok varð jǫtunn ór *'the growth of the wind and there became an ettin from it' (for* *óx unds varð jǫtunn ór*)* **U** 2 ór varð | *rev.* **TW** 3–4 þar ... atalt 'Thereof ... fierce' | *om.* **RA**. 3 þar | þǫ́r **U**; *add.* eru **S** 3 órar | †onar† **T**, ęinar **U** 3 kómu | komnar **S**; koma **U** 3 allar | *om.* **U** 4 því's þat ę́ alt til atalt | *om.* **U** 4 ę́ | *om.* **TW** 4 til | eða **T**; *om.* **W**

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ALL | Over æons, the splashing droplets from the primæval venomous rivers, the Ilewaves, combined until they formed a sentient being. This was Earyelmer, whom *Gylf* 5:9 (most likely correctly) identifies with Yimer, for whom cf. *Vsp* 3/1 n.

1 Éli-vǫ́gum 'Ilewaves' | Dat. pl. of *Éli-vágar*. The Ilewaves are the wild ettin-ish rivers near the edge of the world; cf. *Hym* 5/1. More broadly, the rivers are a likely reflex of the primæval salty Waters found in many West Eurasian mythologies, including Genesis 1:1–3 and *ṚV* 10.129. Of these two foundational religious sources, the latter agrees more closely with the present stanza and certainly holds the more archaic conception; for the Jewish Waters (Hebrew תְּהוֹם *tʰhóm*) and their Mesopotamian and Egyptian predecessors cf. Waschke (2006).
Whereas we in the Jewish narrative find a *creation out of nothing*—at the very beginning of time Elohim's spirit is on the Waters and He makes the light shine over them—we instead find in the two Indo-European texts *Vafþ* and *ṚV* a *spontaneous emergence* of a single primæval entity long before the Gods are born, here from the violent splashing of venom, in *ṚV* 10.129.3 from "the power of heat" (OI *tápasas mahinâ*). This entity in turn asexually begets sexual beings—here by rubbing his limbs together (*Vafþ* 33), in *ṚV* 10.129.4 by giving rise to the "desire" (*kā́ma*) that serves as the "primal seed of thought" (*mánasas rétas pratʰamám*). It is from these latter beings that the world is populated by the raw matter out of which the Gods eventually create (or *shape*) the World as we know it through the Creative Act of the First Sacrifice (see st. 21 above, *Vsp* 3–4, 6–7, *Grm* 41–43).
It should be noted that the Ilewaves also correspond to the Greek Earth-bounding river Ὠκεανός, especially in its more archaic conception as several rivers; cf. *Hym* 5/1 n.

1 ęitr-dropar ‘droplets of venom’ | This *ęitr* ‘venom’ of the Waves is probably to be understood as referring to extreme saltiness. Yimer’s blood gives rise to the salty sea; and the stoniness of his bones, perhaps originally thought of as salt-stone, is attested for both his skull (Heaven, the stoney Firmament; *Hárb* 15/2) and his body (the Earth and Bedrock; st. 21/2, *Grm* 41/3). To this day, something very salty is said to be *ettersalt* in modern Swedish.

4 þat ‘it’ | The ettin race.

Óðinn kvað: **32** „Sęg þat it sjaunda, · alls þik svinnan kveða, [R 8r/26, A 3r/16]
ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvé sá bǫrn gat · inn baldni jǫtunn,
es hann hafði=t gýgjar gaman.“

Quoth Weden: *“Tell this* seventh, *since they call thee wise,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*
how he begot children, that stubborn ettin,
when he knew no troll-woman’s pleasure.”

1 Sęg þat it | *abbrev. as* ‘S. þ. h.’ **A** 1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. s. q.’ **R**; *abbrev. as* ‘a. þ. s. k.’ **A** 3 baldni ‘stubborn’ | *so* **A**; aldni *‘olden’* **R**

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **33** „Und hęndi vaxa · kvǫðu hrím-þursi [R 8r/27, A 3r/17]
męy ok mǫg saman;
fótr við fǿti · gat ins fróða jǫtuns
sex-hǫfðaðan son.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “Under the arm of the rime-thurse, they said, did grow
a maiden and a lad together.
Foot against foot begat for the learned ettin
a six-headed son.”

3 gat | *om.* **A**

ALL | This stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 5:16–18: *Ok svá er sagt, at þá er hann svaf, fekk hann sveita. Þá óx undir vinstri hendi hónum maðr ok kona, ok annarr fótr hans gat son við ǫðrum. En þaðan af kómu ęttir. Þat eru hrím-þursar.* ‘And so it is said that when he slept he began to sweat. Then grew within his left hand a man and a woman, and one foot of his begat a son by the other. But thereof come lineages. Those are Rime-Thurses.’

1–3 Und hęndi ... fótr við fǿti ‘Under the arm ... Foot against foot’ | The image is masturbatory and monstrous; for its significance cf. st. 31 n.

Óðinn kvað: **34** „Sęg þat it ǫttunda, · alls þik *fróðan* kveða, [R 8r/29, A 3r/18]
ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvat fyrst of mant · eða fręmst of vęitst,
þú est al-sviðr jǫtunn.“

Quoth Weden: *“Tell this* eighth, *since they call thee learned,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*

what first thing thou recallest or earliest knowest—
thou art all-wise, ettin!"

1 Sęg þat it | *abbrev. as* 'S. þ. h.' **A** 1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. f.' **R**; *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. f. k.' **A** 3ª of | *om.* **R**

1 Sęg þat it ǫ́ttunda, · alls þik *fróðan* kveða 'Tell this eighth, since they call thee learned' | This line lacks the required alliteration, which has probably been lost in manuscript transmission due to the repetitive nature of the refrain. Alliteration may be obtained by replacing *alls þik fróðan kveða* with *ef þitt óði dugir* from sts. 20 and 22, or (less favourably) with *alls þik svinnan kveða* from 24, where the alliteration in the a-verse does not fall on the ordinal.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **35** „Ør·ófi vetra · áðr véri jǫrð of skǫpuð, [R 8r/30, **A** 3r/19, **S** 3r/4, **T** 3v/20, **W** 6r/20, **U** 4v/10]
2 þá vas Ber·gęlmir borinn;
þat ek fyrst of man, · es inn fróði jǫtunn
4 á vas lúðr of lagiðr."

Quoth Webthrithner: "Uncountable winters before the Earth was created,
then was Bareyelmer born.
This I first remember, when the learned ettin
on the canoe was laid."

3 ek | er **TW** 3 es inn fróði | at fróða **U** 4 á vas | *so* **ASWU**; *rev.* **RT**

ALL | St. 35 is cited in *Gylf* 7:6, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* 'just as it says here'. The preceding *Gylf* 7:2–5 explains the stanza in the following way: the sons of Byre (that is, Weden, Will, and Wigh) slew the ettin Yimer, but when he died, so much blood flowed from his wounds that the whole race of Ettins was drowned, save for Bareyelmer and his household, who survived by getting up on his *lúðr* (cf. note to this word below). The flood-myth in *Gylf* 7:2–5 is clearly related to the Great Flood or Deluge as known from many mythologies, most famously Genesis 6–9. Although this may be a genuine Germanic reflex of the ancient myth (cf. *Vsp* 4 n., 56/1 n.), it may also be Snorre's own invention based on the Bible in an attempt to explain the present stanza, which may in fact have been as obscure to him as it is to us.

4 lúðr 'canoe' | In Old Norse prose *lúðr* usually means 'trumpet, blowing horn', less commonly 'flour-bin', but the underlying sense seems to be 'hollowed-out wood', which is why it is presently translated as 'canoe'. As noted above Snorre seems to interpret it as a form of ark on which Bareyelmer found refuge from the flood, but considering the transitive nature of Bareyelmer's being laid (*of lagiðr*) upon it, the stanza may instead be interpreted as speaking of a ship burial, so that the first thing Webthrithner remembers is Bareyelmer's funeral.

Óðinn kvað: **36** „Sęg þat it níunda, · alls þik svinnan kveða, [R 8r/32, **A** 3r/21]
2 ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan vindr of kømr · svá't fęrr vág yfir,
4 ę męnn hann sjalfan of séa."

Quoth Weden: *"Tell this* ninth, *since they call thee wise,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*
whence the wind comes which fares o'er the wave—
always men see his very self."

1 Sęg þat it | *abbrev. as* 'S. þat h.' **A** 1–2 alls ... vitir | *abbrev. as* 'a. þ. s. q. e.' **R**; 'a. þ. s. k.' **A** 4 męnn hann sjalfan of séa | maðr of sjalfan hann sér **A**

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ALL | Sts. 36–37 are paraphrased by *Gylf* 18:1–7: *Þá mélti Gangleri: „Hvaðan kemr vindr? Hann er sterkr, svá at hann hrérir stór hǫf, ok hann ésir eld. En svá sterkr sem hann er, þá má eigi sjá hann; því er hann undar=liga skapaðr." Þá mélti Hárr: „Þat kann ek vel segja þér. Á norðan-verðum himins enda sitr jǫtunn sá, er Hrés-svelgr heitir. Hann hefir arnar-ham, en er hann beinir flug, þá standa vindar undan vęngjum hans. Hér segir svá:* 'Then Gangler spoke: "Whence comes the wind? It is so strong that it stirs great oceans and it fans flame. But as strong as it is yet one cannot see it. Therefore it is wondrously created." Then High spoke: "That I can tell thee well. At the northern end of heaven sits the ettin who is called Rawswallower. He has an eagle's hame, and when he takes to flight then the winds come from under his wings. Here it says so:"'. After this, the text cites st. 37.

4 é męnn hann sjalfan of séa 'always men see his very self' | Perhaps a reference to the sea which is never perfectly still, so that the wind is always seen on the waves. It is also possible that a negative clitic *-t* has been lost from the verb *séa* 'see', in which case the line should be interpreted as '*never* men see his very self'. The loss of an original negative is supported by *Gylf* 18:3: *má eigi sjá hann* 'one cannot see it'.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **37** „Hrés·svelgr hęitir, · es sitr á himins ęnda,
2 jǫtunn í arnar ham;
af hans vęngjum · kveða vind koma
4 alla męnn yfir."

[**R** 8r/34, **A** 3r/22, **S** 5v/21, **T** 6r/25, **W** 8v/31, **U** 12v/12]

Quoth Webthrithner: "Rawswallower is he called who sits at heaven's end,
an ettin in an eagle's hame.
From his wings they say the wind comes
over all men."

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1 hęitir | *add.* jǫtunn **U** 1 es | hann **U** 3 koma | standa **U**

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ALL | St. 37 is cited in *Gylf* 18; for the preceding passage see note to st. 36.

1 Hrés·svelgr 'Rawswallower' | 'Devourer of Carrion', a generic eagle-name.

Óðinn kvað: **38** „Sęg þat it tíunda, · alls þú tíva rǫk
2 ǫll Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,
hvaðan Njǫrðr of kom · með àsa sonum;
4 hofum ok hǫrgum · hann rés̨ðr hund-mǫrgum
ok varð=at hann ǫ́sum alinn."

[**R** 8v/1, **A** 3r/24]

Quoth Weden: "Tell this tenth, since thou the rakes of the Tews
all, Webthrithner, mightst know,
whence Nearth came in the midst of the sons of the Eese.
Of hoves and harrows he rules a hundred-many,
and he was not begotten by the Eese."

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1 Sęg þat it | *abbrev. as* 'S. þat h.' **A** 1 alls | *abbrev. as* 'a.' **RA** 5 varð=at | vas=at **A**

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1 tíva rǫk ‘rakes of the Tews’ | The fated events or narrations of the Gods.

3 hvaðan Njǫrðr of kom · með ása sonum | This line lacks both alliteration and a following c-verse, which may point towards textual corruption. Finnur Jónsson (1932) opts to change the b-verse to **með niðjum ása*, a perfectly sensible emendation, although the expected c-verse is still missing. For that reason, I instead wish to propose the following conjectural restoration: *hvaðan Njǫrðr of kom · af Nóa-túnum / ár með ása sonum* ‘whence Nearth of the Nowetons came of yore in the midst of the sons of the Eese’, where **af Nóa-túnum / ár* would have been omitted due to the visual similarity between **túnum* and *sonum*.

4 hofum ok hǫrgum ‘hoves and harrows’ | A formulaic merism for cultic sites. *hǫrgr* ‘harrow’ is a cultic place, not the agricultural implement; cf. *Vsp* 7 n. For Nearth in connection with harrows cf. *Grm* 16, where it is said that Nearth *rýðr hó-timbruðum hǫrgi* ‘rules the harrow timbered on high’. Also of interest is *Lok* 51, where the goddess Shede speaks of her *vé ok vangar* ‘wighs and wongs’, two terms common in religious place names. The underlying theological understanding seems to be that the god or goddess is physically present in his or her shrine as its ruler (Turville-Petre 1975, p. 238).

4 hund-mǫrgum ‘a hundred-many’ | Probably a reference to the large number of cultic sites named after Nearth; among modern place names Brink (2007) counts 13 in Norway, 17 in Sweden, and 3 in Denmark, but those numbers must have been much greater in the pre-Christian period.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **39** „Í Vana-heimi · skópu hann vís regin [R 8v/3, A 3r/26]
2 ok seldu at gíslingu goðum,
í aldar rǫk · hann mun aptr koma
4 heim með vísum vǫnum.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “In Waneham the wise Reins created him
and sold him as a hostage to the Gods.
In the Rakes of the Age he will come back
home amidst the wise Wanes.”

---

3 hann mun | *rev.* **A**

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ALL | In other sources we learn of a war between two tribes of supernatural beings, the Eese and the Wanes. As part of the settlement between them, Nearth, who belonged to the Wanes, was sent to the Eese as a hostage. Although the two are often called the two tribes of Gods, it should be noted that the Wanes are explicitly contrasted with *goð* ‘Gods’ in l. 2 both here and in *Gylf* 23:6, which on the other hand seems to refer exclusively to the Eese, so that it is unclear whether the Wanes as a tribe are actually considered to be Gods. For the war between Eese and Wanes cf. *Vsp* 22 n., *Gylf* 23:6 (edited in the pres. ed. as *Eddbr* II), and *Yng* 4. *Lok* 34–35 mentions that Nearth was sent as a hostage to the Ettins, but that is certainly a different episode, although the shared motif of Nearth as a hostage is notable.

1 vís regin ‘the wise Reins’ | ON *regin* ‘the Reins, Powers’ is normally one of a number of terms used to refer to the gods as a collective (Simek 2010, pp. 10–11), but here seems to refer specifically to the Wanes in opposition to the Eese.

3 aldar rǫk ‘the Rakes of the Age’ | The Rakes of the Reins, the End Times.

Óðinn kvað: **40** „Segg þat it ellipta, · *ef þitt óði dugir* [R 8v/5, A 3r/28]
2 *ok þú Vaf·þrúðnir vitir,*
hvar *allir* · ýtar túnum í

4 hǫggva=sk hverjan dag.“

Quoth Weden: *“Tell this* eleventh, *if thy wisdom avails,*
*and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know*
where all men in yards
strike each other every day.”

1 Sęg þat it | *abbrev. as* ‘S. þ. e.’ **A** 1–2 ef ... vitir, | *emend.; om. all.* 3 *a*llir | *emend.; om. all.*

ALL | This question-stanza is malformed in both **R** and **A** and thus has to be partly reconstructed on the basis of st. 41. The ms. preservation of *Vafþ* 40–41 is as follows: All four mss. of *Gylf* attest only st. 41 (the answer-stanza, cf. note there) with no textual variants. **R** has two half-stanzas which are clearly a mix between the question and the answer: *Segðv þat et .xi. hvar ytar tvnom i hæggvaz hverian dag. Ynom. Val þeir kiosa oc riþa vigi fra sitia meirr vm sáttir saman.* Although this forms a complete stanza it stands out by lacking a refrain in the first two lines, something found in all other question-sts. in *Vafþ* (see Introduction). The word *Ynom* (where the ‘Y’ has a vertical line going between the two branches at the top) is unexplained. **A** has two half-stanzas, separated by the speaker notes in the margins. The first one is spoken by Weden: *S. þ. e. xi. allir eins hæriar oðins tvnum i hæggvaz hværian dag*. The second is spoken by Webthrithner: *Val þæir kiosa ok riða vigi fra sitia mærr vm sattir saman*. This situation is also corrupt.
In order to restore st. 40 to a full stanza with four lines, two conjectural emendations have been adopted in the pres. ed.: (1) In ll. 1b–2 the refrain *ef þitt óði dugir ok þú Vaf-þrúðnir vitir* ‘if thy wisdom avails, and thou, Webthrithner, mightst know’ has been inserted from sts. 20 and 22, which also have ordinal numbers alliterating with vowels. (2) In l. 3a the word *allir* ‘all’ has been inserted from st. 41 to provide vowel-alliteration with 3b *ýtar*.

Vaf-þrúðnir kvað: **41** „Allir ęin-hęrjar · Óðins túnum í [**A** 3r/28, **S** 10r/17, **T** 10v/22, **W** 13r/9, **U** 12v/6]
2 hǫggva=sk hverjan dag;
val þęir kjósa · ok ríða vígi frá,
4 sitja męirr of sáttir saman.“

Quoth [Webthrithner]: “All the Oneharriers in Weden’s yards
strike each other every day.
The slain they choose and ride from the fray,
then sit agreed once more together.”

1 ęin-hęrjar | *so* **G**; ęins hęrjar **A**

ALL | St. 41 is cited in *Gylf* 41. The stanza is introduced by *Gylf* 41:1–5, which also provides context: *Þá mélti Gangleri: „All-mikill mann-fjǫlði er í Val-hǫll. Svá njóta trú minnar, at all-mikill hǫfðingi er Óðinn, er hann stýrir svá miklum her. Eða hvat er skemmtun Ein-herja, þá er þeir drekka eigi?“ Hárr segir: „Hvern dag, þá er þeir hafa klęðt=sk, þá her-vęða þeir sik ok ganga út í garð’inn ok berja=sk, ok fellir hverr annan. Þat er leikr þeira. Ok er líðr at dǫgurðar-máli, þá ríða þeir heim til Val-hallar ok setja=sk til drykkju. Svá sem hér segir:* ‘Then spoke Gangler: “There is an all-great gathering of men in Walhall; such things make me believe that Weden is an all-great chieftain when he wields such a great host. But what is the entertainment of the Oneharriers when they do not drink?” High says: “Every day when they have got dressed, they arm themselves for war and go out into the yard and fight, and each one slays the other; that is their game. And when it comes close to supper-time, they ride home to Walhall and seat themselves at their drinking. Just as it says here:”’. The remainder of *Gylf* 41 is cited in the note to *Grm* 45.

1 ęin-hęrjar ‘Oneharriers’ | The oathbound warriors in the service of the god Weden. For the Oneharriers, see also *Grm* 18/4, 24/3, 37/6, 53/3.

3 val þęir kjósa ‘The slain they choose’ | It is from this verbal phrase that the female agent noun *val-kyrja* ‘walkirrie’ is derived.

[Óðinn] kvað: **42** „Sęg þat it tolpta, · hví þú tíva rǫk [R 8v/6, A 3v/1]
2 ǫll Vaf·þrúðnir vitir?
Frá jǫtna rúnum · ok allra goða
4 þú it sannasta sęgir,
inn al-svinni jǫtunn.“

Quoth [Weden]: “Tell this twelfth, why thou the rakes of the Tews
all, Webthrithner, shouldst know?
From the runes of the ettins and all the gods
dost thou speak the truest,
O all-wise ettin!”

[Vaf·þrúðnir] kvað: **43** „Frá jǫtna rúnum · ok allra goða [R 8v/8, A 3v/2]
2 ek kann sęgja satt,
því’t hvęrn hęf’k hęim of komit,
4 níu kom’k hęima · fyr nifl-hęl neðan;
hinig dęyja ór hęlju halir.“

Quoth [Webthrithner]: “From the runes of the ettins and all the gods
I can speak truly,
for I have come into each Home.
Into nine Homes I came beneath Nivelhell;
that way men die out of Hell.”

---

4–5 níu ... halir. ‘Into nine ... of Hell.’ | Apparently lower Underworlds. Cf. Snorre, who writes about Lock’s daughter Hell in *Gylf* 34:6: *Hel kastaði hann í Nifl-heim ok gaf henni vald yfir níu heimum, at hón skyldi skipta ǫllum vistum með þeim, er til hennar vóru sendir, en þat eru sótt-dauðir menn ok elli-dauðir.* ‘He [Weden, the Allfather] threw Hell into Nivelham and gave her dominion over nine Homes that she would deal out all provisions between those who were sent to her—but those are men dead of sickness and dead of old age.’ Finnur Jónsson (1932) considers *ór hęlju* ‘out of Hell’ a later interpolation, probably for metrical reasons.

Óðinn kvað: **44** „Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð frędistaða’k, [R 8v/11, A 3v/4]
2 fjǫlð of rędynda’k rędgin;
hvat lifir manna, · þá’s inn męra líðr
4 fimbul-vetr með firum?“

Quoth Weden: *“Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
*much I tested the Reins!*
What remains of men when the famed Fimble-Winter
passes amidst the folk?”

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2 fjǫlð | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ **RA** 2 of | *so* **A**; *om.* **R**

ALL | This question (Weden's thirteenth) begins the third and final group of questions. The subject shifts toward eschatology and the first two lines of each question-stanza feature the refrain found in st. 3/1–2. For the events of the End Times, cf. *Vsp* 39–55 and *Gylf* 51; for the world to come, cf. *Vsp* 56–62, *Gylf* 52–53.

3–4 inn mę́ra … fimbul-vetr 'the famed Fimble-Winter' | The great winter of the end times. The Fimblewinter is not mentioned in *Vsp*'s description of the End Times, although bad weather and a blackening of the sun is mentioned in *Vsp* 40/3–4; snow during the End Times is also mentioned in *Hdl* 41/3.

*Gylf* 51:1–4 gives us a more detailed description of the Fimblewinter: *Þá mę́lti Gangleri: „Hver tíðendi eru at segja frá um ragna-røkr? Þess hef ek eigi fyrr heyrt getit." Hárr segir: „Mikil tíðendi eru þaðan at segja ok mǫrg, þau in fyrstu, at vetr sá kemr, er kallaðr er fimbul-vetr. Þá drífr snę́r ór ǫllum átum. Frost eru þá mikil ok vindar hvassir. Ekki nýtr sólar. Þeir vetr fara þrír saman ok ekki sumar milli.* 'Then spoke Gangler: "Which tidings are to be told about the Twilight of the Reins? I have not heard it spoken of before." High says: "There are great tidings to be told thereof and many are they; the first that the winter will come which is called the Fimblewinter. Then snow comes down from all directions. The cold is great then and the winds biting. The sun is of no use. Those winters pass three together and no summer between them.' For the immediately following prose in *Gylf* 51:5–6 see *Vsp* 44 n.

Comparatively, an eschatological winter is known also from Zoroastrian Iranian sources, as described by Hultgård (2007). In one version, the great winter sees numerous men and cattle killed, with the survivors finding refuge in a shelter. Although the parallels to the Norse Fimblewinter are not great in number, the Iranian narratives are similar enough for Hultgård (2007, pp. 116–118) to suggest that they may share a common Indo-European origin with the Norse.

In recent scholarship Gräslund (2008) has identified the Fimblewinter as a traumatic reflex of the archaeologically documented volcanic winter of 536–537 AD, where a cloud of volcanic ash blocked out the light of the sun during the summer. Gräslund rejects Hultgård's comparative explanation and argues that the details of the Fimblewinter (the length of three years, the lack of summer, and the high mortality rate) are "highly precise" and therefore unlikely to stem from a long-lasting oral traditions (Gräslund 2008, pp. 94–95). This is undoubtedly a subjective line of argument, since the details are in fact rather sparse and not in agreement with the archaeological record: all humans were not wiped out in 536, and the sun was not totally blocked out for three whole years. Gräslund also conveniently omits the prediction of three winters of violence immediately preceding the three winters of the Fimblewinter as found in *Gylf* 51:5, since that can hardly be tied to his view of a historical reflex (unless we are to believe that there was a huge war in 532–534!)

As further support for his idea of historical trauma, Gräslund (2008, pp. 99–101) cites an episode from the *Kalevala* (songs 47–49) wherein the evil witch *Louhi* steals the sun, moon, and fire and hides them in the Underworld. According to Gräslund this would also be a reflex of the climate catastrophe of 536 AD, but by making this connection he in fact undermines his own argument. Gräslund is undoubtedly correct that the core concern of the Fimblewinter is not that the winter itself is harsh, but rather that the summer itself does not come, but such fears about malevolent supernatural interruptions to vital cosmic cycles are by no means isolated to sources composed after 536 AD. As early as *ṚV* (ca. 1500–1200 BC) there is the myth of the Dawns imprisoned in a cave by the enemies of the Gods, thereby preventing the natural cycle between day and night (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71), and the motif of Ettins trying to steal away things vital for the survival of mankind and the gods, not just the sun and moon, but also Thunder's hammer, is found elsewhere in Norse myth (cf. *Vsp* 24/4 n., Introduction to *Þrk*).

It is clear that the return of the better side of the natural cycles (summer from winter, day from night, the full moon from the new) was of great concern to the ancients. Though the volcanic winter of 536–537 was exceptionally severe, it cannot be (as Gräslund claims) the historical basis of every reflex of that motif when the examples demonstrably go back as far as the Bronze Age and likely beyond. What is more, such worries could surely be fueled not just by volcanic trauma but by eclipses and cold summers (cf. Eyv Lv 12–14 in SkP 1) which have been occurring since time immemorial. To pre-modern farmers, for whom the performance of the fields meant life and death, the return of summer and daylight were by no means felt inevitable, but were rather fraught with worry and therefore heralded with great rejoicing. To conclude, I agree with Hultgård that the Fimblewinter may well be Indo-European.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **45** „Líf ok Lęif·þrasir, · ęn þau lęyna=sk munu
2 í holti Hodd·mímis;
morgin-dǫggvar · þau sér at mat hafa;
4 ęn þaðan af aldir ala=sk.“

[R 8v/13, A 3v/6, S 17v/17, T 18v/7, W 20r/14, U 19r/3]

Quoth Webthrithner: “Life and Lafthrasher—but they will hide themselves
in Hoardmimer’s wood.
The dews of the morn will they have for food,
but thereof is mankind begotten.”

1 Lęif·þrasir | *so* **ASW**; Líf·þrasir **R**; Lęið·þrasir **T**; †lifþræser† **U** 1 ęn þau lęyna=sk munu | er þar leynazt meyjar *‘who there hide, as maidens’* **U** 2 holti Hodd·mímis | Mímis holdi *‘Mimer’s corpse’* **U** 2 holti | holdi **A** 3 morgin-dǫggvar | morgin-dǫggva **U** 3 þau sér at mat hafa | þér **U** 4 ęn þaðan af aldir | ok þar of aldr **U** 4 ęn | *om.* **R** 4 ala=sk | allar **T**

ALL | The coming ancestors of mankind will, like Ash and Emble (*Vsp* 16–17), emerge from wood, most probably the Ash of Ugdrassle. As Schjødt (2008, p. 120) points out, this identification finds support in the motif that humanity survives in (and emerges from) the *central axis* of the universe. In archaic religions the cosmic center is imbued with a special form of holiness or *reality*, for which reason it must be the place of the creation of the world and of mankind, which is, in fact, a reenactment of the former (Eliade 1959, pp. 44–45). — Stanzas 45, 47, and 51 are cited in close succession in *Gylf* 53 in the order 51, 45, 47. St. 45 is the final stanza in *Gylf*, cited immediately following *Gylf* 53:11–13: *En þar, sem heitir Hodd·mímis·holt, leyna=sk menn tveir í Surta-loga, er svá heita, Líf ok Leif·þrasir, ok hafa morgin-dǫggvar fyrir mat. En af þessum mǫnnum kemr svá mikil kyn-slóð, at byggvi=sk heimr allr. Svá sem hér segir:* ‘But there, at the place called Hoardmimer’s wood, two humans hide during the Flame of Surt, which are called Life and Lafthrasher; and they have the dews of the morn for food. But from these humans there comes such a great line of descendants that the whole Home is settled, just as it says here.’

2 holti Hodd·mímis ‘in Hoardmimer’s wood’ | This term has generally been understood as the Ash of Ugdrassle. In fact, *holt* does not mean ‘tree’, but rather ‘wood, thicket’; such imprecision with regards to trees is hardly unparallelled in ON, however. Cf., e.g., how the word *mǫrk* ‘forested land’ can serve as the base-word in WOMAN-kennings, taking the place of regular f. tree-words like *þella* ‘young spruce’ or *lind* ‘linden’ (Meissner 1921, p. 410).

Óðinn kvað: **46** „Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð fręistaða’k,
2 fjǫlð of ręynda’k ręgin;
hvaðan kømr sól · á inn slétta himin,
4 þá’s þęssa hęfr Fęnrir farit?

[R 8v/15, A 3v/8]

Quoth Weden: *“Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
*much I tested the Reins!*
Whence comes the Sun onto the smooth heaven
when Fenrer has this one slain?”

1–2 ek … ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘e. f. f. e. f.’ **A** 1–2 fór … ręgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f. f. e. f.’ **R** 4 þá’s | *so (‘þa ær’)* **A**; ‘þa þa er’ **R**

4 þęssa ‘this one’ | The current sun, as explained in the following st.

4 Fęnrir ‘Fenrer’ | It is not certain that this is the same “Fenrerswolf” which fights against Weden (cf. st. 53 below); the word *fęnrir*, which prob. originally means ‘fen-dweller’, may here simply be a generic poetic synonym for ‘wolf’. For the wolves which chase and eventually devour the sun and moon see *Vsp* 39–40 (n.), *Grm* 40, *Gylf* 12.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **47** „Ęina dóttur · berr alf-rǫðull, [**R** 8v/16, **A** 3v/9, **S** 17v/20, **T** 18v/11, **W** 20r/17, **U** 19r/6]
2 áðr hana Fęnrir fari;
sú skal ríða, · þá's ręgin dęyja,
4 móður brautir męr.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “A single daughter the Elf-wheel [SUN] bears
before Fenrer might slay her.
She shall ride when the Reins die
her mother's roads, a maiden.”

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2 hana | hęnni **U** 3 sú skal ríða, · þá's ręgin dęyja | sú mun renna · eða ríða *(unmetrical and wo. doubt corrupt)* **U** 4 móður | ręgin **U**

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ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf*, immediately following *Gylf* 53:14–15: *Ok hitt mun þér undar=ligt þykkja er sól'in hefir getit dóttur eigi ó·fegri en hón er, ok ferr sú þá stigu móður sinnar. Svá sem hér segir:* 'And it will seem wondrous to thee that the Sun has begotten a daughter no less fairer than she herself is, and that one then journeys upon her mother's paths. Just as it says here:' The immediately following passage *Gylf* 53:16–17 concludes the account of the world to come and the mythological section of *Gylf* as a whole: *En nú ef þú kannt lengra fram at spyrja, þá veit ek eigi, hvaðan þér kemr þat, fyrir því at engan mann heyrða ek lengra segja fram aldar-far'it, ok njót-tu nú sem þú namt.* 'But now, if thou canst ask further ahead then I do not know for what reason thou mightst do so, for I have heard no man tell further ahead about the progression of the world; and now enjoy what thou hast learned.'

1 alf-rǫðull 'Elf-wheel' | A rare poetic synonym (*bęiti*) for the sun. It occurs independently in two other places: the Eddic *Ski* 4/3a and a Scaldic loose stanza by Eanwind Finnson (Eyv Lv 9 in SkP 1). It also appears in two lists of names for the sun: *Skm* 69 and Þul *Sólar* 1/7 (in SkP 3), but these do not count as independent attestations since they are antiquarian sources drawing on earlier poetry. Depending on the age of the cpd., *alf-* may either reflect the semantics of PIE *albʰós* 'white' (whence Latin *albus* 'id.') or ON *alfr* 'elf', the latter word deriving from the former and originally meaning 'white one'. That is not to say that *alf-rǫðull* goes back to PIE, but only that the sense "white" must have existed at some point in Germanic prehistory. The second element, *rǫðull*, is not the normal ON word for 'wheel' (*hvél* ~ *hjól*). It is inherited from PGmc. **radulaz* ~ **raduraz* (> OE *rǫdor* 'heaven, sky', OS *radul, radur* 'id.'), from **rapą* 'wheel' (> German *Rad* 'id.') + the nominal suffix **-ulaz* ~ **-uraz* '(habitually) doing' and thus means something like 'circler, turner, revolver'. The PIE root of **rapą* is **Hreth₂-* (whence also Latin *rota* 'wheel', Sanskrit *rátʰa* 'chariot'; Kroonen 2013, p. 405).

Óðinn kvað: **48** Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð fręistaða'k, [**R** 8v/18, **A** 3v/10]
2 fjǫlð of ręynda'k ręgin;
hvęrjar 'ro męyjar, · es líða mar yfir,
4 fróð-gęðjaðar fara?

Quoth Weden: *“Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
*much I tested the Reins!*
Who are the maidens that pass o'er the sea?
Wise-minded they go.”

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1–2 Fjǫlð ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* 'F. e. f. f. e. f.' **A** 1–2 fór ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* 'f. f.' **R**

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **49** Þríar þjóð-áar · falla þorp yfir [**R** 8v/19, **A** 3v/11]

męyja Mǫg·þrasis;
hamingjur ęinar · þǽr's í hęimi eru,
þó þǽr með jǫtnum ala=sk.

Quoth Webthrithner: "Three great rivers fall over the house
of the maidens of Maythrasher.
They are the only Hamings in the Home,
although they are raised amidst ettins."

3 þǽr's | *so* ('þær ær') **A**; þęira **R**

ALL | The identity of these maidens is entirely obscure. Considering all other questions introduced with the refrain *Fjǫlð ek fór* ... have something to do with the end times, they ought to as well, but that hardly clarifies their function. They are probably to be identified with the maidens about which Weden asks in *Bdr* 12.

Óðinn kvað: **50** „Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð fręistaða'k, [R 8v/21, A 3v/13]
fjǫlð of ręynda'k ręgin;
hvęrir ráða ęsir · ęignum goða,
þá's sloknar Surta-logi?"

Quoth Weden: *"Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
*much I tested the Reins!*
Which Eese will rule the estates of the Gods
when the flame of Surt goes out?"

1–2 Fjǫlð ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* 'F. e. f. f. e. f.' **A** 1–2 fór ... ręgin | *abbrev. as* 'f. f.' **R**

4 Surta-logi 'the flame of Surt' | The flame which reaches up to Heaven itself and scorches the whole world; see *Vsp* 50, 54.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **51** „Víð·arr ok Váli · byggva vé goða, [R 8v/22, A 3v/14, S 17v/12, T 18v/3, W 20r/10, U 19r/1]
þá's sloknar Surta-logi;
Móði ok Magni · skulu Mjǫllni hafa
Vingnis at víg-þroti."

Quoth Webthrithner: "Wider and Wonnel will settle the wighs of the Gods
when the flame of Surt goes out.
Mood and Main shall have Millner
after Wingner expires in war."

3 Móði | †megi† **S** 4 Vingnis | ok vinna **R**; *add.* synir **U** 4 víg-þroti | †vigroþi† **U**

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 53:10, introduced by the words *Svá er sagt* 'So it is said'. For the preceding prose passage *Gylf* 53:1–9, see *Vsp* 56 n.

4 Vingnis at víg-þroti 'after Wingner expires in war' | After Thunder dies in his fight against the Middenyardswyrm, for which see *Vsp* 53.

Óðinn kvað: **52** „Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð frǫistaða'k, [R 8v/24, A 3v/16]
fjǫlð of rǫynda'k rǫgin;
hvat verðr Óðni · at aldr-lagi,
þá's of rjúfa=sk rǫgin?“

Quoth Weden: *“Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
*much I tested the Reins!*
What brings Weden's life to an end
when the Reins are ripped?”

1–2 Fjǫlð ... rǫgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f.’ **A** 1–2 fór ... rǫgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ **R** 4 of | *so* **A**; *om.* **R**

4 þá's of rjúfa=sk rǫgin? ‘when the Reins are ripped?’ | Formulaic; see note to *Bdr* 14/4.

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **53** „Ulfr glǫypa · mun Alda-fǫðr, [R 8v/25, A 3v/17]
þǫss mun Víð·arr *v*reka;
kalda kjapta · hann klyfja mun
vitnis vígi at.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “The Wolf will devour the Father of Mankind;
that will Wider avenge.
The cold jaws he will split apart
of the beast at the battle.”

2 *v*reka | *metr. emend.;* reka **R** 4 vitnis ‘the beast’ | *so* **A**; Vingnis *‘Wingner’ (prob. influenced by st. 51)* **R**

ALL | For Weden's fight with the Wolf and Wider's subsequent avenging see *Vsp* 51–52, *Grm* 17, 24.

2 þǫss mun Víð·arr *v*reka ‘that will Wider avenge’ | The archaic initial *vr-* in *vreka* must be restored for metrical reasons (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 37). This serves as a solid dating criterion for composition before ca. 1000 AD; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n.

Óðinn kvað: **54** „Fjǫlð ek fór, · fjǫlð frǫistaða'k, [R 8v/27, A 3v/19]
fjǫlð of rǫynda'k rǫgin;
hvat mǫlti Óðinn, · áðr á bál stigi,
sjalfr í ǫyra syni?“

Quoth Weden: *“Much I journeyed, much I tried,*
*much I tested the Reins!*
What spoke Weden before he would step onto the pyre,
himself, into the ear of his son?”

1–2 Fjǫlð ... rǫgin | *abbrev. as* ‘F. e. f.’ **A** 1–2 fjǫlð ... rǫgin | *abbrev. as* ‘f.’ **R** 3 stigi, | *add.* ok **A**

3–4 Hvat męlti Óðinn … ĩ ęyra syni? ‘What said Weden … into the ear of his son?’ | Weden poses the eighteenth, unknowable, question. Only he himself can know what he whispered in Balder’s ear, and thus he has won the contest. For Balder’s death, cf. notes to *Vsp* 31–33 and *Bdr* 8–11. Weden asks the same question in Heathric’s Riddles in *Heiðr*, as the 37th and final riddle (for critical discussion cf. Heiðr 84/3 n. in SkP 8.). The half-stanza there is clearly related to *Vafþ* 54: *Segg þat þá fyrst, ef þú ert hvęrjum konungi vitrari: // Hvat męlti Óðinn · í ęyra Baldri, / áðr hann véri á bál of borinn?* ‘Then tell this first if thou art cleverer than every king: // What spoke Weden in Balder’s ear / before he would be borne onto the pyre?’

3 á bál stigi ‘step onto the pyre’ | The phrase *stíga á* ‘step onto, mount’ is also used to refer to one stepping aboard a ship or mounting a horse (see CV: *stíga* for citations). Its use for a person being borne onto the funeral pyre has been compared with *Beow* 1118b: *gúð-rinc á·stáh* ‘the war-champion mounted [his pyre]’, but the interpretation of that line is controversial. R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles (2008, p. 186) instead follow Grundtvig in emending *gúð-rinc* to *gúð-réc* ‘war-smoke’ and compare it with *Beow* 3144b (*wudu-réc á·stáh* ‘wood-smoke rose up’, which also describes a cremation. Thus, the present stanza “almost certainly refers not to Baldr but to Óðinn, probably imagined to mount the pyre in order to set fire to it” (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 186).

Vaf·þrúðnir kvað: **55** „Ey mann-*gi* vęit, · hvat þú ĩ ár-daga [R 8v/28, A 3v/19–22]
2 sagðir ĩ ęyra syni;
fęigum munni · mélta’k mĩna forna stafi
4 ok of ragna rǫk;
nú við Óðin · dęilda’k mĩna orð-spęki;
6 þú est ę vísastr vera.“

Quoth Webthrithner: “Never will man know what thou in days of yore
spokest in the ear of thy son.
With a fey mouth I spoke my ancient staves
and about the Rakes of the Reins.
Now with Weden have I shared my word-wisdom—
thou art for ever wisest of men!”

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1 mann-*gi* | *emend.;* manni *(dat. sg., impossible since a subject to* vęit *is needed)* **RA** 3 mélta’k | *add.* um *(‘*um’*)* **A**

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1 ár-daga ‘in days of yore’ | Relative to the events of the poem, Balder’s death has taken place in the far distant past. This therefore situates *Vafþ* in the last (and present) age of the World, namely the period of decline and degeneration immediately preceding the Rakes of the Reins.

3 fęigum ‘fey’ | “Death-doomed”, a word with fatalistic connections. Webthrithner realises that he was bound to die from the moment he proposed the wager (st. 19), as no being can outwit the god of wisdom.

3 mĩna forna stafi ‘my ancient staves’ | Referencing st. 1.

5 orð-spęki ‘word-wisdom’ | Referencing st. 5.

6 vera ‘of men’ | *verr* means ‘husband, man’ and is here used for reasons of alliteration; it does not imply that Weden is not a God.

# Speeches of Grimner
# *(Grímnis mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.976)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter (1–2/2, 3–26, 27/4–27/7, 28/1–28/2, 28/6–28/7, 29–33/2, 35–45/2, 46/1–46/2, 47–48/2, 49/3–52, 54–57), Ancient-words-lay (2/3–2/4, 28/3–28/5, 33/3, 45/3–45/5, 48/3–48/4, 49/1–49/2, 53), Galders-lay (27/1–27/3, 34, 46/3–46/5)

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Grimner** (*Grm*) is a mythological gnomic poem consisting of Weden's wisdom told to the young prince Ayner as the god sits bound between two fires.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Grm* is preserved whole in two mss.: **R** and **A**. In **R**, the poem is found on foll. 8v/31–11r/9; it there follows *Vafþ* and is followed by *Skí*. In **A**, it is found on foll. 3v/23–5v/25; it there follows *Vafþ* and is followed by *Hym*.

The near-identically lengthy prose passages shared between **RA** prove beyond any doubt that the version of *Grm* in these two manuscripts ultimately goes back to a single now-lost written archetype; this archetype may be called ***RA**.

22 stanzas (11–15, 18–20, 23–24, 29, 34–37, 41–42, 45, 47–49) of *Grm* are preserved in citation in *Gylf*, in the case of 23–24 and 37 explicitly attributed to *Grímnis mǫ́l*. A single stanza, 44, is cited in *Skm*. Numerous other stanzas (6–8, TODO) are paraphrased more or less closely throughout *Gylf*. All of the stanzas found in *Gylf* may be said to belong to a **G** redaction of the poem, deriving from a now-lost source ***G**, which almost certainly contained the whole poem.

*Gylf* predates both **R** and **A**, and ***G** must thus be distinct from either of them. Common innovations shared between **RA** (e.g. st. 18/4: om. *við*, 45/4: *Bil·rǫst* for *Bif·rǫst*) show that their common manuscript archetype

*RA was distinct from *G. It is unclear whether *G was a more distantly related manuscript or an alternative oral redaction of the poem.

## Structure

*Grm* essentially consists of several nested layers. The outermost layer is the prose passages which bracket the actual poem (P1–P2, P3). It is hard to say for how long these have accompanied the poetry, but since they are found in both **R** and **A** they must go back to a now-lost manuscript archetype.

The second layer is sts. 1–3 and 53–55, which together with the prose form a narrative frame dealing with King Garfrith and his imprisonment of Weden.

At the heart of the poem stand the gnomic wisdom stanzas 4–52, which make up the bulk of the poem. The wisdom is mythological and sometimes obscure, and aligns with other Eddic verse like *Háv*, *Vafþ*, *Bdr*, *Sigrdr*, and *Alv*.

## Origin and motifs

*Grm* consists at its core of the long speech given by the god Weden, and in this way it resembles *Háv*. Both poems may be said to fall squarely under the category of gnomic poetry, but whereas most of *Háv* deals with life-advice of a more general type, *Grm* focuses entirely on mythological and cosmological lore.

The lore found in *Grm* is very varied and most of it will be discussed at length in the notes to the individual stanzas, but a few broader motifs ought to be discussed here.

### The wandering god

Like in *Háv* we here see Weden in his role as the god of travellers and strangers, for he himself is a stranger and frequently travels among mankind. In *Grm* this is made explicit as the god sets out to test the hospitality of his protegé and punishes him harshly when he fails to uphold the duties of a king, which include generosity and hospitality.

The motif of a travelling god testing the hospitality of mankind has ancient and likely Indo-European origins. It is in any case very prevalent in the related Greek tradition. Already in Homer we find it said plainly, *Od* 17.483–487: "Antinoös, you did badly to hit the unhappy vagabond: / a curse on you, if he turns out to be some god from heaven. / For the gods do take on all sorts of transformations, appearing as / strangers from elsewhere, and thus they range at large through the cities, / watching to see which men keep the laws, and which are violent." (Homer 1965). Is it not just this wrath which we see in *Grm*, when in st. 55 the god, having assumed his true, terrible form, exclaims: "Draw near Me, if thou mayest!"

If any wandering stranger may be a god, indeed the highest god, it naturally follows that one should furnish the impoverished well, lest one incur

the wrath of the god(s). This in turn confers a level of heavenly protection on the hands of the traveller and makes hospitality a sacred duty. As much is seen in the Greek epithet of Zeus, Ζεύς ξένιος 'Zeus of hospitality' (Plato, *Laws* 12.953e), the term used for the high god in His role as the protector of strangers and sacred hospitality (ξενΐᾱ). With this in mind, we may rightly call Weden in this aspect **Wódanaz* ξένιος.

### The land of the Gods

TODO: the God-world, Shamanism, the Ash of Ugdrassle as the *axis mundi*. Cite: Eliade on shamanism, PCRN on the recreation of Osyard at a smaller scale.

## Summary

The text begins with the frame narrative, which tells the story of the two young king's sons Ayner and Garfrith. The elder Ayner is fostered by Frie while the younger Garfrith is fostered by her husband, Weden. After their father's death, Garfrith betrays his elder brother upon the advice of Weden and becomes king after his father (P1).

One day Weden and Frie are arguing over their respective foster-sons and Frie accuses Garfrith of torturing wayfaring guests. Weden sets out to test the hospitality of his protégé. Unbeknownst to him, Frie has already sent her handmaid in disguise to warn Garfrith about the coming of a dangerous wizard. When Weden arrives, he is promptly captured and tortured between two fires in order that he will reveal his name. Garfrith's young son, Ayner (clearly named after his uncle), kindly approaches the bound god and offers him a horn of drink. Weden, assuming the name of Grimner, drinks from it and then takes to speak (P2).

Weden begins by complaining about the fires which are now burning his cloak (1); he states that for eight nights not a soul has offered him any help save Ayner, Garfrith's son, who will soon become king after his father (2). As thanks for the drink he gives him good health, and will offer him holy knowledge (3).

Here the gnomic section begins as Weden lists the individual abodes of the Gods (4–17). The named Gods are Thunder (4), Wolder and Frea (5), Weden and Sey (7), Weden (8–10), Shede (11), Balder (12), Homedall (13), Frow (14), Foresitter (15), Nearth (16), and Wider (17).

After this list come several sts. relating to Weden and his hall, Walhall (18–23). Mentioned is the preparation of food in Walhall (18), Weden's wolves (19) and ravens (20), the river through which the dead have to wade (21) and the gate through which they have to pass (22), the count of doors in Walhall (23), the count of doors in Thunder's hall Bilshirner (24), and the goat and stag which stand on the hall and gnaw on the branches of the tree Leered. The goat fills the mead-vats in Walhall (25), and the stag from the antlers of the stag Oakthirner water-droplets fall into Wharyelmer, which is the origin of all rivers (26). This introduces a list of mythic rivers (27–28), ending with

the waters through which Thunder must wade on his way to Ugdrassle (29). This in turn leads to a list of the horses ridden by the other gods on their way to Ugdrassle (31), which is followed by a description of Ugdrassle's roots (31) and its animals (32–36).

Next follows some miscellaneous lore: a list of Walkirries (37), the horses that pull the sun (38), the shield that protects the earth from the sun's heat (39) and the wolves that chase the sun and moon, the things created from Yimer's body (41–42) with a digression on the significance of the bloot (43), the creation of the ship Shidebladner (44) and finally a list of the noblest of several categories of things and groups (45).

After these lists Weden utters an unclear stanza invoking the gods (46), before listing his many names (47–50). He then turns to Garfrith, disappointed by the inhospitality and poor conduct of his former protégé, and foresees his imminent death (51–53). He finally reveals himself by his true name, daring Garfrith to face him (53). After this he repeats several of his names (54), and the poem ends.

Upon learning that the wizard is Weden himself, King Garfrith jumps up from his throne to take the god away from the fires, but trips and falls upon his unsheathed sword and dies. After this his son Ayner becomes king and is said to have ruled the kingdom for a long time (P3).

## Text

### Frá sonum Hrauðungs konungs ('From the sons of king Reading')

**P1** Hrauðungr konungr átti tvá sonu. Hét annarr Agnarr, en annarr [R 8v/31, A 3v/23]
Geir·røðr. Agnarr var tíu vetra en Geir·røðr átta vetra. Þeir reru tveir á báti með dorgar sínar at smá-fiski. Vindr rak þá í haf út. Í nǫ́tt-myrkri brutu þeir við land ok gingu upp; fundu kot-bónda einn. Þar vǫ́ru þeir um vetr'inn. Kerling fostraði Agnar, en karl Geir·røð ok kenndi hǫ́num rǫ́ð.. At vári fekk karl þeim skip. En er þau kerling leiddu þá til strandar, þá mę́lti karl ein-mę́li við Geir·røð. Þeir fengu byr ok kvǫ́mu til stǫðva fǫður síns. Geir·røðr var fram í skipi. Hann hljóp upp á land en hratt út skipi'nu, ok mę́lti: „Far þú nú þar er smyl hafi þik!" Skip'it rak út en Geir·røðr gekk út til bójar. Hǫ́num var vel fagnat; þá var faðir hans andaðr. Var þá Geir·røðr til konungs tekinn, ok varð maðr á-gę́tr.

King Reading had two sons. One was called Ayner and the other Garfrith. Ayner was ten winters old, but Garfrith eight winters. The two were rowing in a boat with their trolling-lines for small fishing. The wind drove them out into the sea. In the dark of night they crashed onto land and walked ashore; they found a lone cottage farmer. There they stayed over the winter. The farmer's wife fostered Ayner but the farmer [fostered] Garfrith and taught him counsel. In the spring the farmer gave them ships, but when he and his wife led them to the shore, the husband spoke private speech with Garfrith. They caught good wind, and came to their father's harbour. Garfrith was in the front of the ship. He leapt onto land and pushed out the ship, and spoke: "Now go whither the fiends may have thee!" The ship drove out but Garfrith walked towards the farm. He was welcomed well; by then his father was ended. Garfrith was then taken as king, and became an excellent man.

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1 en | *add.* sonr **A** 1 annarr | *corr. above line in same hand* **A** 4 Í nǫ́tt-myrkri brutu þeir | Þeir brutu í nǫ́tt-myrkri **A** 6 karl | *add.* fostraði **A** 6 ok kenndi hǫ́num rǫ́ð. | *so* **A**; *om.* **R** 7 strandar | skips **A**. 10 nú | *so* **A**; *om.* **R** 10 rak | *add.* í haf **A** 11–12 þá var faðir hans | en faðir hans var þá **A** 12 Var þá Geir·røðr | Geir·røðr var þá **A**

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4–5 kot-bónda einn 'a lone cottage farmer' | The farmer and his wife were Weden and Frie as is clarified by the following prose.

6 en karl Geir·røð ok kenndi hǫ́num rǫ́ð. 'but the farmer Garfrith and taught him counsel' | The motif of Weden favouring the youngest brother is also found in *Rþ*; for Weden's counsel cf. *Háv*.

7–8 þá mę́lti karl ein-mę́li við Geir·røð 'the husband spoke a private speech with Garfrith' | Instructing him to push his brother out to sea.

10 Far þú nú þar er smyl hafi þik! 'Go thou whither the fiends may have thee!' | The same curse is attested with *gramir* for *smyl* in *Hárb* 60 and in a related form in *Brot* 10.

**P2** Óðinn ok Frigg sǫ́tu í Hlið-skjǫlfu ok sǫ́ um heima alla. Óðinn [R 9r/10, A 4r/3]
mę́lti: „Sér þú Agnar fóstra þinn, hvar hann elr børn við gýgi
í helli'num? En Geir·røðr, fóstri minn, er konungr ok sitr nú
at landi.“ Frigg segir: „Hann er mat-níðingr sá at hann kvelr
gesti sína ef hǫ́num þykkja of·margir koma.“ Óðinn segir at þat
er in mesta lygi. Þau veðja um þetta mál. Frigg sendi eskis-
mey sína, Fullu, til Geir·røðar. Hón bað konung vara=sk at eigi
fyr·gerði hǫ́num fjǫl-kunnigr maðr sá er þar var kominn í land,
ok sagði þat mark á at engi hundr var svá ólmr at á hann myndi
hlaupa. En þat var inn mesti hé-gómi at Geir·røðr vę́ri eigi mat-
góðr ok þó lę́tr hann hand-taka þann mann er eigi vildu hundar
á ráða. Sá var í feldi blǫ́m ok nefndi=sk Grímnir ok sagði ekki
fleira frá sér þó'tt hann vę́ri at spurðr. Konungr lét hann pína
til sagna ok setja milli elda tveggja ok sat hann þar átta nę́tr.
Geir·røðr konungr átti son tíu vetra gamlan ok hét Agnarr eptir
bróður hans. Agnarr gekk at Grímni ok gaf hǫ́num horn fullt
at drekka, sagði at konungr gerði illa er hann lét pína hann sak-
lausan. Grímnir drakk af. Þá var eldr'inn svá kominn at feldr'inn
brann af Grímni. Hann kvað:

Weden and Frie sat in the Lithshelf and looked about all the Homes. Weden spoke: "Dost thou see Ayner, thy foster-son, where he begets children with a troll-woman in her cave? But Garfrith, *my* foster-son, is king and now rules his land." Frie says: "He is such a meat-nithing that he torments his guests if he thinks too many are coming!" Weden says that this is the greatest lie; they make a wager over this matter. Frie sent her handmaid, Full, to Garfrith's hall. She bade the king be wary, lest he be destroyed by the manicunning man who had come to his land; and said that his mark was that no hound was so fierce that it would rush at him. But it was the greatest falsehood that Garfrith was not good of meat; and yet he has that man bound whom the hounds would not touch. He was in a blue cloak and called himself Grimner, and did not tell anything more about himself, even though he was asked. The king had him tortured that he would speak, and set him between two fires; and he sat there for eight nights. King Garfrith had a son ten winters old, and he was called Ayner after his brother. Ayner went up to Grimner and gave him a full horn to drink, saying that the king did badly as he had him tortured without cause. Grimner drank it up. Then the fire had grown so much that the cloak burned on Grimner. Quoth he:

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1 Hlið-skjǫlfu | Hlið-skjǫlf **A** 1 heima alla | *rev.* **A** 3 En Geir·røðr, fóstri minn, er konungr | En er konung fóstri minn *(corrupt)* **A** 3 nú | *om.* **A** 4 landi | lǫndum **A** 11 ok | en **A** 12 ráða | hlaupa **A** 14 tveggja | *om.* **A** 14 hann | *om.* **A** 15 átti | *add.* þá **A** 17 drekka, | *add.* ok **A** 17 konungr | faðir hans **A** 17 illa | *om.* **A** 17 lét pína hann | píndi þenna mann **A**

ALL | The motif of Weden and Frie sitting in their Heavenly Seat, looking out over the world and each picking a different side in a conflict is also found in the short 7th century text the Origin of the Nation of the Longbeards (i.e., the Lombards; Latin *Origo Gentis Langbardorum*). The narrative is clearly based on oral tradition brought from Northern Europe in the first centuries of the current era and as such attests the great age of the present motif. The relevant passage is edited at the end of the present poem under the Appendix.

1 Hlið-skjǫlfu 'the Lithshelf' | The lookout post of the Gods, which also appears in *Skí* P1. Cf. *Gylf* 9:11: *Þar er einn staðr, er Hlið-skjǫlf heitir, ok þá er Óðinn setti=sk þar í hǫ́-sǽti, þá sá hann of alla heima ok hvers manns at-háfi ok vissi alla hluti, þá er hann sá.* 'Thereat (viz. in Osyard) there is one place which is called the Lithshelf, and when Weden sat there in the high seat then he saw throughout all the Homes and each man's conduct, and knew all the things which he saw.' and *Gylf* 17:8–9, cited in st. 6 n. below.

2–3 Sér þú Agnar fóstra þinn, hvar hann elr bǫrn við gýgi í helli'num 'Dost thou see Ayner, thy foster-son, where he begets children with a troll-woman in her cave?' | This may relate to Frie's role as love-goddess. Ayner is in any case a weak, effeminate man who devotes his life to copulation rather than war.

## The Speeches of Grimner

**1** „Hęitr est hripuðr · ok hęldr til mikill, [R 9r/27, A 4r/17]
gǫng=umk firr funi!
Loði sviðnar, · þó'tt à lopt bera'k;
brinn=umk feldr fyrir.

"HOT ART THOU, SCORCHER, and far too great—
go far from me, O flame!
My wool cape is singed though I hold it aloft;
the cloak burns before me!

3 bera'k | vera **A**

2 gǫng=umk firr 'go far from me' | Equivalent to *gakk mér firr*. The word *gǫng=umk* 'go ... from me' merits some linguistic discussion on the form of the imperative (*gang-* rather than *gakk*) and the suffixed pronoun *=umk*. The normal 2sg imper. of ON *ganga* 'to go' is *gakk*, which goes back to a sound change in PN whereby word-final homorganic clusters were devoiced, and in the case of clusters of the form /NC/ assimilated into /C̥:/. Thus PN **gang* 'go!' (cf. Got. *gagg* /gaŋg/, OHG *gang*) > **gank* > *gakk*, also **stand* 'stand!' > *statt*, **bind* 'bind!' > *bitt*. This sound change was only active in early PN, and only affected those clusters which were word-final before syncope of unstressed vowels; thus in the ON 1sg pres. ind. *ek gęng, ek stęnd* (< **ek gangu, ek standu*) 'I go, I stand' etc. we find the original cluster preserved.
At some time in early PN, accusative personal pronouns were suffixed to certain verbs; those which survive into ON are 1sg *=umk* (= ON *mik*) and 3sg reflexive *=sk* (= ON *sik*). In later ON these clitics became the passive endings still found in modern North Germanic, but in archaic or poetic ON they could still serve as suffixed pronouns with a reflexive or even dative function, as is the case in this instance. The fact that the suffixion of the pronoun has prevented assimilation of the consonant cluster *ng* establishes its *terminus ante quem* as the first syncope period, the early 7th century, and since it is unlikely that such an irregular form as *gǫng=umk* could have survived for long alongside *gakk*, its presence here probably allows us to conclude that *Grm* is a rather old poem.
Other instances of dative *=umk* include *Lok* 35/1a: *es=umk*, *Fáfn* 1/4: *stǫnd=umk*, *Eddbr* II 1/1: *eru=mk*, and *Rdr* 7/2a: *gǫf=umk*.

**2** Átta nętr · sat'k milli ęlda hér, [R 9r/29, A 4r/18]
svá't mér mann=gi mat né bauð
nema ęinn Agnarr, · es ęinn skal ráða,
Gęir·røðar sonr, · Gotna landi.

For eight nights I sat between the fires here,
while no man offered me food,
save for Ayner alone, who alone shall rule—
Garfrith's son—the land of the Gots!

**3** Hęill skalt, Agnarr, · alls hęilan biðr [R 9r/31, A 4r/20]
þik Vera-týr vesa;
ęins drykkjar · skalt aldri=gi
bętri gjǫld geta:

Hale shalt thou be, Ayner, for hale
does Were-Tew ⟨= Weden⟩ bid thee be.
For a single drink shalt thou never get
better recompense.

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3 ęins drykkjar 'For a single drink' | The horn which Ayner offered Weden (P2 above).

4 bętri gjǫld 'better recompense' | Namely the mythic lore which takes up sts. 4–45.

**4** Land es hęilagt, · es liggja sé'k [R 9r/33, A 4r/22]
ǫsum ok ǫlfum nér;
ęn í Þrúð-hęimi · skal Þórr vesa
und's of rjúfa=sk rędin.

The land is holy which I see lying
near the Eese and Elves,
but in Thrithham shall Thunder dwell
until the Reins are ripped.

---

4 und's of rjúfa=sk rędin 'until the Reins are ripped' | Until the Rakes of the Reins. A formulaic expression; see note to *Bdr* 14/4 for further occurrences.

**5** Ý-dalir hęita, · þar's Ullr hęfir [R 9v/2, A 4r/23]
sér of gǫrva sali;
Alf-hęim Frędy · gǫ́fu í ár-daga
tívar at tann-féi.

Yewdales they are called where Wolder has
made for himself a hall.
Elfham to Frea in days of yore
the Tews as a tooth-gift gave.

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1 Ý-dalir 'Yewdales' | Little more is known about these valleys, of which this is the singular attestation. They are certainly named for the use of the yew-tree in bow-making, since the god Wolder is associated with bows and archery (*Gylf* 31:2).

3 Alf-hęim 'Elfham' | TODO.

4 tann-féi 'tooth-gift' | The gift the child receives when he sheds his first tooth.

**6** Bór es sá (hinn þriði), · es blíð rędin [R 9v/3, A 4r/25]
silfri þǫkðu sali;
Vala-skjǫlf hęitir, · es vélti sér
ǫss í ár-daga.

By is (the third) one, where the blithe Reins
with silver thatched the halls.

Waleshelf is the name of the one which he won through wiles,
the Os in days of yore.

ALL | This stanza is paraphrased in *Gylf* 17:8–9: *Þar er enn mikill staðr, er Vala-skjǫlf heitir. Þann stað á Óðinn. Þann gerðu goð'in ok þǫkðu skíru silfri, ok þar er Hlið-skjǫlf'in í þessum sal, þat há-sæti, er svá heitir, ok þá er Al-fǫðr sitr í því sæti, þá sér hann of alla heima.* 'There is yet another great place which is called Waleshelf. That place Weden owns. The Gods made it and thatched it with pure silver, and in these hall is the Lithshelf, the high-seat which is called so, and when Allfather sits in that seat then he sees throughout all the Homes.'

1 (hinn þriði) '(the third)' | The first numbering of a location; the numbering continues up to st. 16. Although parallelled by other numbered poetic lists (*Háv* 147–165, *Vafþ* 20–42) some circumstances speak against the numbers in *Grm* being authorial. First, the alliteration is never reliant on the numbers, which is quite different from the numbered items in *Háv* 147–165 and *Vafþ* 20–42. Secondly the numbering is inconsistent; Thunder's realm (st. 4) is not counted, and Wider's land (st. 17) has no numeral (perhaps since the form of the stanza would not allow it.) Third, in *Gylf*'s citations of sts. 11–15 the numbers are missing.

1 blið regin 'the blithe Reins' | A reverent epithet for the Gods, also occurring in sts. 38/3, 42/1 below. Parodied by Lock in *Lok* 32/3. For other epithets cf. *Vafþ* 13/4 n.

3 es vélti sér 'won through wiles' | Several previous editors and translators (e.g. Finnur Jónsson (1932), Pettit (2023), Larrington (2014)) have rendered this phrase with variants of "craftily made for himself", where the verb *véla* would mean 'craftily make'. To my knowledge this sense is never otherwise attested, and its common meaning is 'defraud, trick, betray'. A simpler reading would be to see this as a reference to the myth of the ettin Master Builder who built the wall of Osyard as alluded to in *Vsp* 24–25 and told at length in *Gylf* 42. The Gods had promised him Frow and the Sun and Moon if he could build it within a year, but to slow him down they made use of various tricks. When at last it seemed like he would make it in time, they called upon Thunder who arrived and killed him.

**7** [R 9v/5, A 4r/26]

Søkkva-bękkr hęitir (hinn fjórði), · ęn þar svalar knegu
unnir *glymja yfir*;
þar þau Óðinn ok Sága · drekka umb alla daga
glǫð ór gollnum kęrum.

Sinkbench is (the fourth) one called, but there do cool
waves clash overhead;
there Weden and Sey drink for all days,
glad, out of golden casks.

2 *glymja yfir* | *metr. emend.; rev.* **RA**

ALL | This stanza is likely paraphrased in *Gylf* 35:3: *Qnnur er Sága. Hón býr á Søkkva-bekk, ok er þat mikill staðr.* 'The other [goddess] is Sey. She lives in Sinkbench, and that is a great place.'

**8** [R 9v/7, A 4r/28]

Glaðs-hęimr hęitir (hinn fimti) · þar's hin goll-bjarta
Val-hǫll víð of þrumir;
ęn þar Hroptr · kýss hverjan dag
vápn-dauða vera.

Gladsham is (the fifth) one called, where the gold-bright
Walhall, wide, stands fast,

but there Roft ⟨= Weden⟩ chooses every day
weapon-dead warriors.

1 hęitir | es **A** 2 of | *om.* **A**

ALL | For Gladsham see *Gylf* 14:2–7, which likely paraphrases this stanza, cited in *Vsp* 7 n.

3–4 ęn … vera 'but … warriors.' | For Weden's chosing of the slain see st. 14.

**9** Mjǫk 's auð-kęnnt · þęim's til Óðins koma [**R** 9v/10, **A** 4r/30]
2 sal-kynni at séa,
skǫptum 's rann rępt, · skjǫldum 's salr þakiðr,
4 brynjum of bękki stráat.

Very easily recognized by those who come to Weden
is the hall to see:
With shafts is the house roofed, with shields is the hall thatched;
with byrnies the benches strewn.

1 til | *om.* **A**

ALL | In **R** the order of sts. 9 and 10 is reversed, but a sign at the start of each suggests they should switch places; this is further indicated by the abbreviation of ll. 1–2 in st. 10.

3 skǫptum 'shafts' | Spear-shafts.

3 skjǫldum 's salr þakiðr 'with shields is the hall thatched' | The same is said in *Gylf* 2:6–7: *Þak hennar var lagt gylldum skjǫldum svá sem spán-þak. Svá segir Þjóð-ólfr inn hvin-verski, at Val-hǫll var skjǫldum þǫkð.* 'Its roof was covered with gilt shields like a shingle-roof. So does Thedwolf the Whine-dweller say that Walhall was thatched with shields.' After this, *Gylf* cites Þhorn *Harkv* 11/1–2, which uses the kenning *Sváfnis sal-néfrar* 'Swebner's hall-shingles [SHIELDS]', where Swebner is a name for Weden (cf. st. 57 below).

**10** Mjǫk 's auð-kęnnt · þęim's til Óðins koma [**R** 9v/9, **A** 4r/31]
2 sal-kynni at séa,
vargr hangir · fyr vestan dyrr
4 ok drúpir ǫrn yfir.

Very easily recognized by those who come to Weden
is the hall to see:
A wolf hangs before the western door
and an eagle droops down over it.

2 sal-kynni at séa | †sia at sia† **A**

3–4 vargr hangir · fyr vestan dyrr / ok drúpir ǫrn yfir. 'A wolf hangs before the western door and an eagle droops down over it.' | Something very similar is found in Widukind of Corvey's *History of the Saxons* 1:12. The Saxons had just conquered a fortress, and *mane* [...] *facto ad orientalem portam ponunt aquilam, aramque victoriae construentes secundum errorem paternum sacra sua propria veneratione venerati sunt* 'at the coming of morning they set an eagle at the eastern gate, and, building an altar of victory, they worshipped it with their own holy worship in accordance with their ancestral error.' Widukind tells us that the altar was pledged to Ermen, whom Widukind identifies with the Greco-Roman Mars or Hermes; this all but certifies that Old Saxon Ermen, like its Old Norse cognate *Jǫrmunr*, was another name for Weden, who is both a war-god (like Mars) and a psychopomp (like Hermes). According to Hyltén-Cavallius (1863, p. 156), it was customary in Wärend in southern Sweden to hang the bodies of killed wolves high up in old oaks and those of killed birds of prey above one's stable-door.

**11** Þrym-hęimr hęitir (hinn sétti), · es Þjatsi bjó,
sá hinn ám-átki jǫtunn;
ęn nú Skaði byggvir, · skír brúðr goða,
fornar toptir fǫður.

[**R** 9v/12, **A** 4v/2, **S** 6v/20, **T** 7r/23, **W** 9v/27, **U** 8v/11]

Thrimham is (the sixth) one called, where Thedse dwelled,
that uncanny ettin;
but now Shede bedwells—the pure bride of the Gods—
the ancient plots of her father.

1 Þrym-hęimr | Þrúð-hęimr **U** 1 (hinn sétti) 'the sixth' | *om.* **G** 1 es 'where' | þar nú *'where now'* **U** 1 bjó 'dwelled' | *om.* **W**; býr *'dwells'* **U** 2 ám-átki | mátki **U** 3 goða 'of the Gods' | guma *'of men'* **U** 4 fornar | forna **A**; †førnir† **T**

ALL | St. 11 is cited in *Gylf* 23:15, following a description of Nearth and Shede. For the text of the chapter, see *Eddbr* II.

2 ám-átki jǫtunn 'uncanny ettin' | Formulaic. See note to *Vsp* 8.

**12** Bręiða-blik eru (hin sjaundu), · ęn þar Baldr hęfir
sér of gǫrva sali,
á því landi · es liggja vęit'k
fęsta fęikn-stafi.

[**R** 9v/14, **A** 4v/3, **S** 6v/4, **T** 7r/8, **W** 9v/14, **U** 8r/22]

Broadblicks are (the seventh), but there Balder has
made for himself a hall,
in that land where I know lie
the fewest wicked deeds.

1 Bręiða-blik | Bręiða *(with* blik *added above the line in other hand)* **R**; Bręiða-†blio† **A** 1 eru (hin sjaundu) 'are (the seventh)' | hęita *'[they] are called'* **STW**; hęitir *'is one called'* **U**. 4 fęikn-stafi | †fæing†-stafi **U**

ALL | St. 12 is cited in *Gylf* 22:22, introduced by the words *Svá sem hér segir* 'Just as it says here' and concluding the chapter, which tells about Balder. *Gylf* 22:21 provides context: *Hann býr þar, sem heitir Breiða-blik. Þat er á himni. Í þeim stað má ekki vera ó-hreint.* 'He [viz. Balder] lives at the place called Broadblicks. That is in Heaven. In that place there may be nothing unclean.'

4 fękikn-stafi ‘wicked deeds’ | This sense of *stafir* (lit. ‘staffs, staves’) is common in poetry. Cf. the direct cognate in *Beow* 1018b: *fǣcen-stafas*, generally taken as referring to treacherous intrigues among the Shieldings (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 177).

**13** Himin-bjǫrg eru (hin ǫ́ttu), · ęn þar Hęim·dall [R 9v/16, **A** 4v/5, **S** 7r/21, **T** 7v/24, **W** 10r/27, **U** 9r/20]
2 kveða valda véum;
þar vǫrðr goða · drekkr í vę́ru ranni
4 glaðr hinn góða mjǫ́ð.

Heavenbarrows are (the eighth), but there Homedall,
they say, wields over wighs.
There the Watchman of the Gods drinks in the tranquil house,
glad, the good mead.

1 eru (hin ǫ́ttu) ‘are (the eighth)’ | hęita *‘[they] are called’* **STW**; hęitir *‘is one called’* **U**. 1 Hęim·dall | Hęim·dallr býr **U** 3 þar | *om.* **U** 3 vǫrðr | vǫrðum **U** 4 hinn | *so* **AG**; *om.* **R**

ALL | St. 13 is cited in *Gylf* 27:14, the chapter dealing with Homedall, introduced by the words: *Hér er svá sagt* ‘Here it is said so’. For the full chapter see *Eddbr* III.

3 vǫrðr goða ‘Watchman of the Gods’ | Formulaic epithet of Homedall, also occurring in *Lok* 48/4 and possibly in *Skí* 28 (*vǫrðr með goðum* ‘the Watchman among the Gods’). A similar epithet is found in *Húsdr* 2, *vári ragna* ‘Defender of the Reins’. *Gylf* 27, where the present stanza is cited, gives some further details; see *Eddbr* III.

**14** Folk-vangr es (hinn níundi), · ęn þar Frǫyja rę́ðr [R 9v/17, **A** 4v/6, **S** 6v/27, **T** 7r/29, **W** 10r/1, **U** 8v/18]
2 sessa kostum í sal;
halfan val · hǫn kýss hvęrjan dag,
4 ęn halfan Óðinn á.

Folkwong is (the ninth), but there Frow rules
the choice of seats in the hall;
half the slain she chooses each day,
but half does Weden own.

1 es (hinn níundi) ‘is (the ninth)’ | hęitir *‘[one] is called’* **G** 2 sessa kostum í | kosta bętstum **U** 3 hvęrjan dag | hvęrn dag **U**

ALL | St. 14 is cited in *Gylf* 24:9, introduced by the words *svá sem hér segir* ‘just as it says here’. The immediately preceding *Gylf* 24:6–8 provides context: *En Freyja er á-gętust af ǫsynjum. Hón á þann bú á himni er Fólk-vangar heita, ok hvar sem hón ríðr til vígs þá á hón halfan val, en halfan Óðinn.* ‘But Frow is the most distinguished of the Ossens. She has the dwelling in Heaven which is called the Folkwongs, and wherever she rides into battle she owns half of the slain, but Weden [has the other] half’.

3 halfan val · hǫn kýss hvęrjan dag ‘half the slain she chooses each day’ | Apart from the paraphrase in *Gylf* this statement is unprecedented; in all other sources the battle-slain are devoted exclusively to Weden and chosen by his walkirries.
The roots of *kjósa val* ‘choose the slain’ are the same as those in *val-kyrja* ‘walkirrie’, lit. ‘chooser of the slain’), and as Frow is a prominent goddess this could be seen to make her the chief walkirrie. This is parallelled by *Sǫrla*, where Frow assumes the name Gandle (*Gǫndul*, a name attested in several lists of walkirries; see *Vsp* 30 n.) and incites the legendary never-ending Conflict of the Headenings (*Hjaðningavíg*).

In spite of this there is reason to believe that the chief walkirrie was rather Frie, Weden's wife. First, one of the functions of the Walkirries is to bear ale to the Oneharriers (*Grm* 37). This mirrors a real custom at Germanic banquets attested where the host's wife or daughter would pour ale to his retainers and guests (the so-called "lady with a mead cup" ritual most famously seen in *Beow*; see Enright (1996) and Riseley (2014)). As Weden's wife, we would expect Frie to have this role. Second, at Balder's funeral (*Gylf* 49:49–52), Frie rides with Weden and the Walkirries while Frow rides alone with her cats; if Frow were the chief walkirrie we would probably expect her to ride at the head of them. Third, there are two separate myths where Frie and Weden contend over the fates of armies and men; these are the prose introduction to the present poem (P2 above) and the Longbeard origin myth (see Appendix below), whereas Frow and Weden do not otherwise come into conflict over the slain.
Whether the present stanza originally referred to Frie is hard to say, although confusion between Frow and Frie would probably not be expected in a source as old as *Grm*.

**15** Glitnir es (hinn tíundi), · hann 's golli studdr [**R** 9v/19, **A** 4v/8, **S** 7r/34, **T** 8r/3, **W** 10v/7, **U** 9v/5]
2 ok silfri þakðr it sama;
ęn þar For·seti · byggvir flęstan dag
4 ok svęfir allar sakir.

Glitner is (the tenth): it is supported by gold,
and thatched with silver likewise,
but there Foresitter dwells for most days,
and puts all disputes to sleep.

1 es (hinn tíundi) 'is (the tenth)' | 'h. e. x.' *(for* *'e. h. x.')* **A**; hęitir salr *'a hall is called'* **G** 1 's | *om.* **U** 2 þakðr it | *om.* **U** 3 þar | þat **ST**; þá **W**

ALL | St. 15 is cited in *Gylf* 32:4, introduced by the words *Svá segir hér.* 'So it says here.' *Gylf* 32:2–3 provides context: *Hann á þann sal á himni, er Glitnir heitir. En allir, er til hans koma með sakarvand-rędi, þá fara allir sáttir á braut. Sá er dóm-staðr betstr með goðum ok mønnum.* 'He has the hall in heaven which is called Glitner. But all who come to him with difficult disputes then all go away reconciled. That is the best judgment place amongst gods and men.'

**16** Nóa-tún eru (hin ęlliptu), · ęn þar Njǫrðr hęfir [**R** 9v/21, **A** 4v/9]
2 sér of gǫrva sali;
manna þęngill · hinn męins-vani
4 hǫ́-timbruðum hǫrgi rędr.

Nowetons are (the eleventh), and there Nearth has
made for himself a hall.
The lord of men, the guiltless one,
rules the harrow timbered on high.

3 manna þęngill · hinn męins-vani 'The lord of men, the guiltless one' | Interesting epithets probably relating to Nearth's roles in upholding the prosperity of the land and the law. Cf. my article on pre-Christian oaths (TODO).

4 hǫ́-timbruðum hǫrgi rędr 'rules the harrow timbered on high' | The rare verb *hǫ́-timbra* 'timber on high' otherwise only occurs in *Vsp* 7, likewise in connection with the *hǫrgr* 'harrow'. The harrow is an outdoors holy place; see there. Cf. also *Vafþ* 38 where Nearth is said to rule a great many *hofum ok hǫrgum* 'hoves and harrows'.

**17** Hrísi vęx · ok hǫ́u grasi [R 9v/23, A 4v/11]
Víð·ars land, viði,
ęn þar mǫgr of lę́t=sk · af mars baki
frókn *at* hęfna fǫ́ður.

With brushwood and with tall grass grows,
Wider's land, with wood,
but there the lad vows from the back of his steed,
brave, to avenge his father.

4 *at* | ok ('ꝛ') **RA**

ALL | At the Rakes of the Reins Wider must avenge his father, Weden. See *Vsp* 51–52, *Vafþ* 53.

1 Hrísi vęx · ok hǫ́u grasi 'With brushwood and with tall grass grows' | Identical to *Háv* 119/6.

**18** And·hrímnir · lętr í Ęld·hrímni [R 9v/24, A 4v/12, S 9v/12, T 10r/18, W 12v/7, U 12r/2]
Sę́·hrímni soðinn,
flęska bętst, · ęn þat fáir vitu,
við hvat ęin-hęrjar ala=sk.

Andrimner lets in Eldrimner
Sowrimner be cooked,
the best of meats, but few know this:
by what the Oneharriers are nourished.

1 And·hrímnir | And·runnir **T** 1 Ęld·hrímni | Ęld·runni **T** 2 Sę́·hrímni | Sę́·runni **T** 3 flęska | †felska† **S** 4 við | *so* **G**; *om.* **RA**

ALL | The poem moves away from the dwellings of the individual gods to an extended description of Walhall and its surroundings. The cook Andrimner 'Face-sooty' cooks the boar Sowrimner 'Sow-sooty' in the cauldron Eldrimner 'Fire-sooty'; by this meat are the Oneharriers nourished. — Sts. 18–20 are cited in the very same order in *Gylf* 38, interspersed by short prose explanations. St. 18 is cited first, introduced by *Gylf* 38:3, 5–6: *En aldri er svá mikill mann-fjǫlði í Val-hǫll at eigi má þeim enda=sk flesk galtar þess er Sę́·hrímnir heitir. Hann er soðinn hvern dag ok heill at aptni.* [...] *And·hrímnir heitir steikari'nn en Eld·hrímnir ketill'inn. Svá er hér sagt:* 'But there is never such a great gathering of men in Walhall that they should not be fully furnished with the flesh of that boar which is called Sowrimner. He is cooked every day and is healthy and alive in the evening. [...] Andrimner is the name of the cook, but Eldrimner the kettle. So it is said here:'

**19** Gera ok Freka · sęðr gunn-tamiðr, [R 9v/26, A 4v/14, S 9v/17, T 10r/23, W 12v/11, U 12r/7]
hróðigr Hęrja-fǫðr,
ęn við vín ęitt · vápn-gǫfugr
Óðinn ę́ lifir.

Gar and Freak does the battle-accustomed
glorious Father of Hosts ⟨= Weden⟩ feed,
but on wine alone, esteemed of weapons,
Weden ever lives.

1 gunn-tamiðr | †gunnta midr† **T** 3 vápn-gǫfugr | vápn-gafigr **ST**; vápn-†gaffiþr† **U** 4 ę́ | er **T**

ALL | St. 19 is cited in *Gylf* 38. The stanza is introduced by *Gylf* 38:7–10: *Þá mélti Gangleri: „Hvárt hefir Óðinn þat sama borð-hald sem Ein-herjar?“ Hárr segir: „Þá vist, er á hans borði stendr, gefr hann tveim úlfum, er hann á, er svá heita, Geri ok Freki. En enga vist þarf hann: Vín er honum þǫði drykkr ok matr. Svá segir hér:* 'Then spoke Gangler: "Does Weden have the same dining on his table as the Oneharriers?" High says: "The foodstuff which stands on his table he gives to the two wolves he owns, which are called thusly: Gar and Freak. But *he* needs no foodstuffs; for him wine is both his drink and food. So it says here:'.

1 Gera ok Freka 'Gare and Freak' | Weden's two hounds. It is not said with what food Weden feeds them, but if we consider Weden's relation to the common 'beasts of battle' motif, it is most likely the corpses of dead warriors.

3 vín 'wine' | The wine on which Weden himself subsists may perhaps be identified with drink offerings. For hallowing of alcohol to this god cf. the 7th c. *Vita Columbani*, ch. 53, describing a heathen rite of the Swabians (Jonas of Bobbio 1851, 1040D–1041A, my translation):
*Quo cum moraretur, et inter habitatores loci illius progrederetur, reperit eos sacrificium profanum litare velle, vasque magnum, quod vulgo cupam vocant, quod viginti et sex modios amplius minusve capiebat, cervisia plenum in medio habebant positum. Ad quod vir Dei accessit, et sciscitatur quid de illo fieri vellent. Illi aiunt deo suo Vodano, quem Mercurium vocant alii, se velle litare.* 'While he was staying there and going about the dwellers of that place, he found out that they were going to offer a profane sacrifice, and a large cask called a *cupa*, which held about twenty-six measures, was filled with beer and set in their midst. When the man of God asked what they wanted to do with it they answered that they wanted to offer it to their god *Vodan*, whom others call Mercury.'

**20** Huginn ok Muninn · fljúga hvęrjan dag
2 jǫrmun-grund yfir;
ó=umk of Hugin, · at aptr né komi=t;
4 þó sé=umk męirr of Munin.

[**R** 9v/28, **A** 4v/15, **S** 9v/22, **T** 10r/28, **W** 12v/15, **U** 12r/11]

Highen and Minden fly every day
over the ermen-ground [EARTH].
I worry for Highen that he might not come back,
yet I fear more for Minden.

1 hvęrjan dag | hvęrn dag **U** 3 ó=umk | †otunk† **T**; †unz† **U** 3 of | ek **G** 3 né | *om.* **TU** 3 komi=t | komi **ASTW**; kømr **U**

ALL | St. 20 is cited in *Gylf* 38, where its citation concludes the chapter. The stanza is introduced by *Gylf* 38:11–13: *Hrafnar tveir sitja á ǫxlum hónum ok segja í eyru hónum ǫll tíðendi, þau er þeir sjá eða heyra. Þeir heita svá, Huginn ok Muninn. Þá sendir hann í dagan at fljúga um heim allan, ok koma þeir aptr at dǫgurðar-máli. Þar af verðr hann margra tíðenda víss. Því kalla menn hann Hrafna-guð. Svá sem sagt er:* 'Two ravens sit upon his shoulders and tell into his ears all the tidings which they see or hear. They are called so: Highen and Minden. He sends them out at dawn to fly throughout all the Home, and they come back at supper-time; thereof he is made aware of many tidings. For this reason men call him Raven-god. As it is said:'

2 jǫrmun-grund 'ermen-ground' | The 'world-ground', i.e., 'the whole wide world', a poetic compound denoting the earth as a flat, spacious expanse of land, surrounded by the unbounded outer sea. In ON this word only occurs elsewhere at two places: in a kenning on the late C10th Karlevi stone (Öl 1), which refers to the unbounded sea as *Endils jǫrmun-grund* 'Andle's ermen-ground' (Andle being a known sea-king), and in the C13th Sturl *Hryn* 16/2 (SkP 2), referring generically to land. A direct cognate, OE *eormen-grund*, appears only once, in *Beow* 859, where it carries the same sense as in the present stanza.

**21** Þýtr Þund, · unir Þjóð·vitnis [R 9v/30, A 4v/17]
2 fiskr flóði ǐ;
áar straumr · þykkir of-mikill
4 val-glaumi at vaða.

Thound roars; Thedwitner's fish
thrives in the flood.
The river-stream seems far too great
for the noisy slain host to wade.

3 þykkir | *so* **A**; *om.* **R** 4 val-glaumi | val-glaumni **A**

ALL | A difficult stanza. Considering the st. is in the middle of others describing Weden and Walhall, Thound is possibly the river moat which the dead warriors have to pass over to reach Walhall. The stanza may also be referring to the punishment of criminals in waters (for which see *Vsp* 38 n.).

1–2 Þjóð·vitnis fiskr 'Thedwitner's fish' | *Þjóð·vitnir* is easily analysed as *þjóð-* 'great, main' + *vitnir* 'wolf' and the great wolf is of course the Fenrerswolf. The Wolf is called the brother of the Middenyardswyrm (*Hym* 23), and so that may be its "fish". That the Wyrm can be called a fish is shown by *Hym* 24. The "fish" can also be Nithehewer, the dragon who tortures slain criminals (*Vsp* 38).

**22** Val-grind hęitir · es stęndr vęlli á [R 9v/32, A 4v/18]
2 hęilǫg fyr hęlgum durum;
forn 's sú grind, · ęn þat fáir vitu,
4 hvé hǫn 's ǐ lás of lokin.

Walgrind it is called which stands on the plain,
holy, before the holy doors.
Ancient is that gate, but few do know
how its lock is locked.

4 of | *so* **A**; *om.* **R**

1 Val-grind 'Walgrind' | 'Slain-gate', the gate standing before Walhall.

**23** Fimm hundruð golfa · ok umb fjórum tøgum [R 9v/34, A 4v/22, S 6r/24, T 6v/27, W 9r/31, U 8r/4]
2 svá hygg'k Bil-skirni með bugum;
ranna þęira, · es ek rępt vita,
4 mǐns vęit'k męst magar.

With five hundred floors and around fourty—
so I judge Bilshirner altogether.
Of those houses which I might know rafted
I know my lad's [= Thunder] is the greatest.

ALL | *Sts. 23 and 24 come in reverse order in* **A**. 1 umb | *om.* **U** 2 hygg'k | *add.* á Val-hǫll vesa *(dittography through homoioarcton)* **A** 3 rępt | rę́fr **U** 4 mǐns | †murs† **T**

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 21, the chapter describing Thunder. The stanza is introduced by *Gylf* 21:4–6: *Hann á þar ríki er Þrúð-vangar heita, en hǫll hans heitir Bil-skirnir. Í þeim sal eru fimm hundruð gólfa ok fjórir tigir. Þat er hús mest svá at menn viti. Svá segir í Grímnis-mǫlum:* 'He has his domain in the place called the Thrithwongs, but his hall is called Bilskirner. In that hall there are five hundred and fourty floors. That is the greatest house which men know of. So it says in the Speeches of Grimner:'.

1 Fimm hundruð 'five hundred' | Since "hundred" is the long hundred, there are in fact 600 doors.

**24** [R 10r/2, A 4v/20, S 10r/10, T 10v/16, W 13r/3, U 12v/1]

Fimm hundruð dura · ok umb fjórum tøgum,
svá hygg á Val-hǫllu vesa;
átta hundruð Ęin-hęrja · ganga sęnn ór ęinum durum,
þá's fara við vitni at vega.

Five hundred doors and around fourty—
so I judge there to be on Walhall.
Eight hundred Oneharriers march at once out of one door,
when to fight with the Wolf they fare.

1 hundruð | hund **T** 1 umb | *om.* **AU** 1 fjórum tøgum | *abbrev. as* .xl. **A**; fjóra tugu 2 hygg | kveð'k **A** 2 á | at **R**; *om.* **T** 2 Val-hǫllu | Val-hǫll **ATW** 3 sęnn | *om.* **RU** 4 fara | ganga **U** 4 við | *so* **AWU**; at **R**; með **ST**

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf* 40. It is introduced by *Gylf* 40:1–4, which also provides context: *Þá męlti Gangleri: „Þetta eru undr=lig tíðendi, er nú sagðir þú. Geysi-mikit hús mun Val-hǫll vera. All-þrøngt mun þar opt vera fyrir durum." Þá svarar Hárr: „Hví spyrr þú eigi þess, hversu margar dyrr eru á hǫll'inni eða hversu stórar? Ef þú heyrir þat sagt, þá munt=u segja, at hitt er undr=ligt, ef eigi má ganga út ok inn hverr, er vill. En þat er með sønnu at segja, at eigi er þrøngra at skipa hana en ganga í hana. Hér mátt-u heyra í Grímnis-mǫlum.* 'Then spoke Gangler: "These are wondrous tidings which thou hast now told. An enormously great house must Walhall be; it must often be fully cramped indoors there." Then answers High: "Why askest thou not how many doors there are on the hall, or how great they are? If thou wouldst hear that told then thou wouldst say that on the other hand, it is wondrous that every one should not be able to go out and in as he pleases. But with truth it is to be said that it is not more crowded to stay inside it than to enter it. Here mayest thou hear it in the Speeches of Grimner:'.

3 átta hundruð 'eight hundred' | The hundred is probably here the long hundred (120, rather than 100), which gives a sum of 640 * 960 = 614 400 Oneharriers.

4 þá's fara við vitni at vega 'when to fight with the Wolf they fare' | At the Rakes of the Reins by Weden's side. Cf. *Vsp* 51–52, *Vafþ* 53.

**25** [R 10r/4, A 4v/24]

Hęið·rún hęitir gęit, · es stęndr hǫllu á (Hęrja-fǫðrs)
ok bítr af Lę́·raðs limum;
skap-kęr fylla · skal hins skíra mjaðar,
kná=at sú vęig vana=sk.

Heathrune is the goat called which stands on the hall (of the Father of Hosts)
and bites from Leered's branches.
The shape-vat she shall fill with the pure mead;
those draughts do not wane.

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Gylf* 39:4–5: *Geit sú, er Heiðr·rún heitir, stendr uppi á Val-hǫll ok bítr barr af limum trés þess, er mjǫk er nafn-frégt, er Læ̨-raðr heitir, en ór spenum hennar rennr mjǫðr sá, er hón fyllir skap-ker hvern dag. Þat er svá mikit, at allir Ein-herjar verða full-drukknir af.* 'That goat which is called Heathrune stands upon Walhall and bites the leaves from the branches of that tree which is very renowned, which is called Leedred. But out of her teats flows such mead that she fills the shape-vat every day. It is so great that all the Oneharriers become fully drunk thereof.'

1 hǫllu á (Hęrja-fǫðrs) 'on the hall of the Father of Hosts' | On Walhall. *Hęrja-fǫðrs* 'of the Father of Hosts' is almost certainly an unmetrical later insert in order to clarify which hall the poet is referring to and has therefore been placed in parentheses.

2 Læ̨·raðs 'Leered' | The Ash of Ugdrassle, as is seen by the mention of the stag in st. 26/1 and again in st. 36/3.

3 skap-kęr 'shape-vat' | According to CV the central beer-vat, from which drinks were poured into smaller vessels.

3 hins skíra mjaðar 'the pure mead' | The goat's milk is mead.

**26** [R 10r/6, A 4v/26]

Ę̨ik·þyrnir hę̨itir hjǫrtr · es stęndr *hǫllu á* (Hęrja-fǫðrs)
ok bítr af Læ̨·raðs limum;
ę̨n af hans hornum · drýpr í Hver-gę̨lmi
þaðan ę̨iga vǫtn ǫll vega:

Oakthirner is the hart called which stands on the hall (of the Father of Hosts)
and bites from Leered's branches,
but from his antlers it drips into Wharyelmer;
thereof all waters have their courses:

1 *hǫllu á* | *emend.; rev.* **RA** 1 *hǫllu* | 'hællu' **A** 3 Hver-gę̨lmi | †hvergælgji† *(for* *'hvergælmi'*)* **A**

ALL | Upon Walhall there also stands a stag, Oakthirner. He gnaws from the branches of the tree Leered, probably the Ash of Ugdrassle, but on his antlers the condensed dew drips into the spring Wharyelmer. *Gylf* 39:7–8 continues with its paraphrase: *Þá mę̨lti Hárr: „Enn er meira mark at of hjǫrt'inn Eik·þyrni, er stendr á Val-hǫll ok bítr af limum þess trés, en af hornum hans verðr svá mikill dropi, at niðr kemr í Hver-gę̨lmi* 'Then spoke High: "Yet a more remarkable feature of it [viz. Walhall] is the hart Oakthirner, who stands upon Walhall and bites at the branches of that tree [viz. Ugdrassle]. But from his antlers there arises such a great dripping that it comes down into Wharyelmer'.

3 Hver-gę̨lmi 'Wharyelmer' | The heavenly reservoir which is the spring of all waters. Snorre (*Gylf*) located . This motif has parallels in wider Indo-European and even Near Eastern mythologies; in Ancient Greek, the epithet διῒπετής 'fallen from Heaven' is used of rivers (*Il* 6.174, *Od* 4.477); in Zoroastrianism, the river-goddess *Anāhitā* is said to be the mountainous source of all rivers (*Yašt* 5:3–5, EIr, s.v. *Anāhid* (Mary Boyce)); in the Bible, the אֲרֻבּוֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם 'windows of heaven' famously open during the Deluge, releasing the heavenly waters (Genesis 7:11).

**27** [R 10r/9, A 4v/28]

Síð ok Víð, Sę̨kin ok Ę̨ikin, · Svǫl ok Gunn·þró,
Fjǫrm ok Fimbul·þul,
Rín ok Rinnandi,
Gipul ok Gǫpul, · Gǫmul ok Gę̨ir·vimul,
þę́r hverfa umb hodd goða,

Þyn ok Vin, · Þǫll ok Hǫll,
Grǫ́ð ok Gunn-þorin.

Side and Wide, Shin and Oaken, Swale and Guththrew,
Ferm and Fimblethule,
Rhine and Rinning,
Gipple and Gapple, Gamble and Garwimble—
they circle round the hoard of the Gods [= Osyard]—
Tyne and Ween, Thuil and Huil,
Gread and Guththorn.

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ALL | Sts. 27–28 list numerous rivers, many of which are undoubtedly mythological. For the sake of having somewhat more natural Anglicized renditions I have taken many of the names from Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (CV, p. 780), who identified them with real rivers in Scotland and England, although it must be said that many or all of their identifications are entirely unverifiable and probably incorrect. —
*Gylf* 39:9–10 immediately continues with its paraphrase (cf. sts. 25–26 above), clearly deriving from sts. 27–28: *ok þaðan af falla þér ár, er svá heita: Síð, Víð, Sekin, Ekin, Svǫl, Gunn-þró, Fjǫrm, Fimbul-þul, Gipul, Gǫpul, Gǫmul, Geir-vimul. Þessar falla um ása byggðir. Þessar eru enn nefndar: Þyn, Vín, Þǫll, Hǫll, Grǫ́ð, Gunn-þráin, Nyt, Nǫt, Nǫnn, Hrǫnn, Vína, Veg-svinn, Þjóð-numa.* 'and thereof fall the rivers which are called so: Side, Wide, Shin, Ecken, Swale, Guththrew, Ferm, Fimblethule, Gipple, Gapple, Gamble, Garwimble. These fall around the settlements of the Eese. These are yet named: Tyne, Ween, Thuil, Huil, Gread, Guththrown, Nit, Nat, Nan, Ran, Wine, Wayswith, Thednumb.' A similar list of rivers likewise deriving from sts. 27–28 is found in *Gylf* 4:3–4: *Þá mélti Jafn·hár: „Fyrr var þat mǫrgum ǫldum en jǫrð var skǫpuð er Nifl·heimr var gerr, ok í honum miðjum liggr bruðr sá, er Hver·gelmir heitir, ok þaðan af falla þér ár, er svá heita: Svǫl, Gunn-þrá, Fjǫrm, Fimbul-þul, Slíðr ok Hríð, Sylgr ok Ylgr, Víð, Leiptr. Gjǫll er næst Hel-grindum.*" 'Then spoke Evenhigh: "It was many ages before the earth was created that Nivelham was made, and in the middle of it lies the well which is called Wharyelmer, and thereof fall the rivers which are called so: Swale, Guththrew, Ferm, Fimblethule, Slide and Ride, Sellow and Wellow, Wide, Lafter. Yell is closest to the gates of Hell."' To distinguish the variants the manuscript is followed by a subscript number: 1 for the paraphrase in *Gylf* 4:3–4, 2 for 39:9–10, so that e.g. **U**$_2$ refers to the form of a name in *Gylf* 39:9–10 in **U**. TODO: Incorporate these variants into the edition.

**28** Vina hęitir ęnn, · ǫnnur Veg-svinn, [**R** 10r/12, **A** 5r/1]
þriðja Þjóð-numa;
Nyt ok Nǫt, · Nǫnn ok Hrǫnn,
Slíð ok Hríð, · Sylgr ok Ylgr,
Víð ok Vǫ́n, · Vǫnd ok Strǫnd,
Gjǫll ok Lęiptr; · þǽr falla gumnum nǽr
en falla til hęljar heðan.

Wine is yet one more called, another Wayswith,
a third Thednumb;
Nit and Nat, Nan and Ran,
Slide and Ride, Sellow and Wellow,
Wide and Ween, Wand and Strand,
Yell and Lafter—they fall near to men,
but fall hence to Hell.

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1 Vina | 'Viná' **R**; †Vma† *(for* *Vina*)* **A** 5 Vǫ́n | Vǫ́ð **A** 7 en | *so* **A**; es **R**

**29** Kǫrmt ok Ormt · ok kęr-laugar tvér [R 10r/15, **A** 5r/4, **S** 5r/1, **T** 5v/5, **W** 8r/14, **U** 6v/2]
2 þér skal Þórr vaða
dag hvęrn · es dœma fęrr
4 at aski Ygg·drasils;
því't Ǫs-brú · brinn ǫll loga
6 hęilǫg vǫtn hlóa.

Carmet and Armet and the two Carlays—
these shall Thunder wade
every day, when he goes to judge
at the Ash of Ugdrassle,
for the Os-bridge [RAINBOW] all will burn with flame;
the holy waters boil.

---

1 Kǫrmt ok Ǫrmt | †kaurnit ok aurnit† **T** 3 dag hvęrn | *so* **ASTW**; *rev.* **U**; hvęrjan dag **R** 5 loga | *add.* ęn **U** 6 hlóa 'boil' | flóa *'turn hot'* **U**

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ALL | Thunder's movement is so powerful that he cannot ride across the rainbow bridge as this would cause it to burn up; for the violent movement of this god cf. *Þrk* 21, *Lok* 55. — St. 29 is cited in *Gylf* 15:21, the chapter about how the Gods get to their Thing, introduced by the words: *En Þórr gengr til dóms'ins ok veðr ár þér, er svá heita:* 'But Thunder walks to the Judgment and wades through the rivers which are called so:'.

1 Kǫrmt ok Ǫrmt 'Carmet and Armet' | Two interesting river-names. *Kǫrmt* 'Carmet' is the well-attested ON name of the island Karmøy in Rogaland, Norway (e.g. ÞSjár Frag 1, ESk Lv 9, Þul *Eyja* 3 in SkP 3), on whose northern side the ancient royal seat Awaldsness (ON *Ǫg-valds-nęs*) is located. The present stanza, however, cannot be referring to the island itself but instead seems to refer to Karmsund, the sound separating the island from the mainland. (For reference, at its narrowest point—the place of the Karmsund bridge—the sound is only ca. 190 m wide, while at Ogwaldsness two km south it is ca. 300 m.)
The rhyming *Ormt* is a hapax only otherwise found in the duplicate line in Þul *Á* 6. No descendant is attested in Norway, but Cleasby and Guðbrandur Vigfússon (CV, p. 780) connect it to the river Armet in Scotland. Still, such a geographic spread seems quite unlikely, and it is more probable that the Scottish river-name, if related at all to *Ormt*, is taken from that of a now-lost Norwegian sound or island in the vicinity of Carmet.
Olsen (1925) derives the names from *karmr* and *armr*, terms for the parallel parts of a pen in a sheep-fold, which would give them a sense like 'low protective wall'. Olsen considers the present use of the names mythological and of likely Icelandic origin, deriving from a confusion of vaguely remembered names of real locations; he argues that the use of the island-name for the sound would be offensive to a Norwegian with good geographic awareness. And yet the likeness of the islands or their sounds to a sheep-fold fits very well geographically with the area around Karmøy, so that this argument is not entirely convincing.

1 Kǫrmt ... tvér 'Carmet ... Carlays' | This line also appears in a thule or list of poetic synonyms (Þul *Á* 6 in SkP 3), where however *ok* 'and' in the a-verse is replaced with the name *Lęiptr* 'Lafter' as found in st. 28/6 above.

2 þér skal Þórr vaða 'these shall Thunder wade' | Thunder is commonly associated with wading; cf. *Hárb* 13/3 n., *Eddbr* VI.

5 Ǫs-brú 'Os-bridge' | The Rainbow Bridge, Bivrest. Cf. st. 45/4 below.

6 hlóa 'boil' | A hapax, **U**'s reading is unmetrical. Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon (1989, s.v. *hlóa*) connects it with the adj. *hlér* 'hot, mild', and this seems likely enough.

**30** Glaðr ok Gyllir, · Glęr ok Skęið·brimir, [R 10r/17, **A** 5r/6]

Silfrin·toppr ok Sinir,
Gísl ok Fal·hófnir, · Goll·toppr ok Lėtt·feti,
þęim ríða ęsir jóum
dag hvęrn · es dœma fara
at aski Ygg·drasils.

Glad and Gilder, Glare and Sheathbrimmer,
Silvrentop and Sinewer;
Yissel and Fallowhooven, Goldtop and Lightfeet;
on these horses ride the Eese
every day when they go to judge
at the Ash of Ugdrassle.

3 Fal·hófnir | 'falæpnir' **A** 5 fara | *om.* **A**

ALL | This stanza clearly serves as a source for *Gylf* 15:18–20: *Hestar ása'nna heita svá: Sleipnir er batstr, hann á Óðinn; hann hefir átta fœtr. Annarr er Glaðr, þriði Gyllir, fjórði Glenr, fimmti Skeið·brimir, sétti Silfrin·toppr, sjaundi Sinir, átti Gísl, níundi Fal·hófnir, tíundi Gull·toppr, ellipti Létt·feti. Baldrs hestr var brenndr með hónum.* 'The horses of the Eese are called so. Slopner is the best; Weden owns him; he has eight legs. The second is Glad, third Gilder, fourth Glen, fifth Sheathbrimmer, sixth Silvrentop, seventh Sinewer, eighth Yissel, ninth Fallowhooven, tenth Goldtop, eleventh Lightfeet. Balder's horse was burned with him.' TODO: Incorporate variants from **G**.

**31** Þríar rœtr · standa á þría vega [**R** 10r/20, **A** 5r/8]
undan aski Ygg·drasils;
Hęl býr und ęinni, · annarri hrím-þursar,
þriðju męnnskir męnn.

Three roots stretch in three directions
from beneath the Ash of Ugdrassle.
Hell lives enclosed by one, by the other the Rime-Thurses,
by the third manly men.

2 undan | und **A**

ALL | The Ash of Ugdrassle, the World Tree, stands at the center of the World, being the *axis mundi* around which the Cosmos revolves. This is how we should understand its being the origin of the three roots going into the three realms. Through these roots it is also possible to travel from the land of men to the land of the dead (and vice-versa), and this is likely significant to the myth of Weden's self-hanging upon the Tree (*Háv* 138). Note that the Gods are not mentioned, for the Ash stands beside Walhall, as shown by sts. 25–26 above. — *Gylf* 15:4–9 describes Ugdrassle and its three roots, certainly drawing on the present stanza: *Þá segir Jafn-hárr: „Askr'inn er allra trjá mestr ok betstr. Limar hans dreifask um heim allan ok standa yfir himni. Þrjár rœtr trés'ins halda því upp ok standa afar-breitt. Ein er með ósum, en ǫnnur með hrím-þursum, þar sem forðum var Ginnunga-gap. In þriðja stendr yfir Nifl-heimi, ok undir þeiri rót er Hver-gelmir, en Níð·hǫggr gnagar neðan rót'ina.* 'Then Evenhigh says: "The ash is the greatest and best of all trees. Its branches reach through all the world and stretch above the heaven. The tree roots of the tree hold it up, and they stretch immensely far. One is with the Eese, but another with the Rime-Thurses, where the Gap of Hawks erstwhile was. The third stretches over Nivelham, and enclosed by that root is Wharyelmer, but Nithehewer gnaws at the root from below.' The description continues with Mimer's well; see *Vsp* 26 n.

3 und ‘enclosed by’ | ON *undir* (short form *und*) ‘under’ can also refer to something enclosed, e.g., by a high wall, so that the residents of a walled city are said to live “under” that city. Since the roots are prob. not thought to be literally *above* the worlds, this translation of the preposition gives better sense.

**32** Rata·toskr hęitir íkorni · es rinna skal [R 10r/22, A 5r/9]
2 at aski Ygg·drasils;
arnar orð · hann skal ofan bera
4 ok sęgja Níð·hǫggvi niðr.

Wratetusk is the squirrel called which shall run
along the Ash of Ugdrassle.
The eagle’s words shall he carry from above
and tell to Nithehewer below.

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ALL | Sts. 32–36 describe the various animals around and beside the Ash of Ugdrassle. Religiously, we ought to understand that the World Tree is under attack by the forces of evil and entropy, chief among them Nithehewer, the corpse-eating dragon of *Vsp* 38 and 62. — St. 32 is paraphrased in *Gylf* 16:1–5: *Þá mélti Gangleri: „Hvat er fleira at segja stór-merkja frá aski'num?“ Hár segir: „Mart er þar af at segja. Qrn einn sitr í limum asks'ins, ok er hann margs vitandi, en í milli augna honum sitr haukr sá, er heitir Veðr-fǫlnir. Íkorni sá, er heitir Rata-toskr, rennr upp ok niðr eptir ask'inum ok berr ofundar orð millum arnar'ins ok Nið·hǫggs.* ‘Gangler spoke: “Which other great features are there to be told about the ash?” High says: “There is much to tell about it. An eagle sits in the branches of the ash and he is much knowing; but between his eyes sits the hawk called Weatherfalner. The squirrel which is called Wratetusk runs up and down along the ash and carries words of insult between the eagle and Nithehewer.”’

**33** Hirtir ’ro ok fjórir · þęir’s af hęfingar à [R 10r/23, A 5r/11]
2 gag-halsir gnaga:
Dáinn ok Dvalinn, · Dùn·ęyrr ok Dura·þrór.

There are four harts, too, who from the buds thereon
with turned necks gnaw:
Dowen and Dwollen, Downear and Doorthrew.

---

1 hęfingar | hęfingjar **A** 2 gag-halsir | *so* **A**; ‘á gag-halsir’ **R** 2 gnaga | ganga **A** 3 Dùn·ęyrr | Dyn·ęyrr **A** 3 Dura·þrór | Dyra·þrór **A**

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ALL | St. 33 is paraphrased in *Gylf* 16:6, immediately following the paraphrase of st. 32: *En fjórir hirtir renna í limum asks'ins ok bíta barr; þeir heita svá: Dáinn, Dvalinn, Dún-eyrr, Dura-þrór.* ‘But four harts run in the limbs of the ash and bite its leaves; they are called thus: Dowen, Dwollen, Downeer, Doorthrew.’

2 gag-halsir gnaga ‘with turned necks gnaw’ | An iconographic parallel to this line presents itself in the common Wiking Age depictions of great horned beasts turning their necks backwards, e.g. on the runestone E 2 or the round brooch from Espinge, Scania (HST 108124).

**34** Ormar fląiri · liggja und aski Ygg·drasils [R 10r/25, A 5r/12, S 5r/24, T 5v/26, W 8v/2, U 6v/26]
2 an þat of hyggi hvęrr
ò·sviðra apa:

More wyrms lie under the Ash of Ugdrassle
than any one would think
among unwise apes:

2 þat | *om.* **A**

ALL | Sts. 34–36 are cited in *Gylf* 16 in the order 36, 34–35; note that *Gylf* treats 34–35 as a single stanza. St. 36 is introduced first by *Gylf* 16:7–8: *En svá margir ormar eru í Hvergelmi með Níð·hǫgg, at engi tunga má telja; svá segir hér:* 'But there are so many wyrms in Wharyelmer with Nithehewer that no tongue may tally them. So it says here:' Between 36 and 34–35, *Gylf* 16:9 reads: *Svá er enn sagt:* 'Further it is said so:'.

**35** Góinn ok Móinn, · þęir 'ro Graf·vitnis synir,
Grá·bakr ok Graf·vǫlluðr,
Ófnir ok Sváfnir, · hygg'k at ę skyli
męiðs kvistu máa.

[**R** 10r/26, **A** 5r/13, **S** 5r/25, **T** 5v/27, **W** 8v/3, **U** 6v/27]

Gowen and Mowen—they are Gravewitner's sons—
Greyback and Gravewalled.
Ovner and Swebner I think always shall
maim the branches of the tree.

1 Góinn ok Móinn | Góni ok Móni **U** 1 synir 'sons' | liðar *'comrades'* **U** 2 Graf·vǫlluðr | Grap·vǫlluðr **W** 3 Ófnir | Ópnir **A** 4 męiðs | męiðar **A**; †meðs† **ST** 4 kvistu | kvistum **STW**; kostum **U**

**36** Askr Ygg·drasils · drýgir ęrfiði
męira an męnn of viti:
hjǫrtr bítr ofan · ęn á hliðu fúnar,
skęrðir Níð·hǫggr neðan.

[**R** 10r/28, **A** 5r/14, **S** 5r/22, **T** 5v/24, **W** 8r/32, **U** 6v/24]

The Ash of Ugdrassle suffers hardship
more than men might know:
A hart bites it from above, but it rots on the side;
Nithehewer harms it from below.

2 of | *so* **AU**; *om.* **RSTW** 3 ofan | neðan *(corruption from l. 4)* **U**

**37** Hrist ok Mist · vil'k at mér horn beri,
Skeggj·ǫld ok Skǫgul,
Hildr ok Þrúðr, · Hlǫkk ok Hęr·fjǫtur,
Gǫll ok Gęira·hǫð,
Rand·gríð ok Ráð·gríð, · ok Regin·lęif;
þér bera ęin-hęrjum ǫl.

[**R** 10r/30, **A** 5r/16, **S** 9r/4, **T** 9v/11, **W** 12r/4, **U** 11v/8]

Rist and Mist I would have bring me a horn—
Shedgeld and Shagle,

Hild and Thrith, Lank and Harfetter,
Gall and Garhath,
Randgrith and Redegrith and Rainlaf;
they bring the Oneharriers ale.

---

2 Skeggj·ǫld | *so* **RSTW**; Skęgg·ǫld **AU**. 3 Hildr ok Þrúðr 'Hild and Thrith' | Hildi ok Þrúði **R** 3 Hęr·fjǫtur 'Harfetter' | Hęr·fjǫtra **U** 4 Gǫll | Gjǫll **U** 4 Gęira·hǫð 'Garhath' | *so* **G**; Gęir·ǫlul *'Garalel'* **R**; Gęir·rǫmul *'Garramble'* **A**. — *add.* ok *'and'* **U**. 5 Rand·gríð | Rand·gríðr **U** 5 Ráð·gríð | Ráð·gríðr **U** 5 ok | *om.* **R** 6 ǫl | ǫl *corrected from* ǫll *in same hand* **A**

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ALL | St. 37 is cited following *Gylf* 36:2. *Gylf* 36:1–2 introduces it: *Enn eru þér aðrar er þjóna skulu í Val-hǫll, bera drykkju ok gęta borð-búnaðar ok ǫl-gagna. Svá eru þér nefndar í Grímnis-mǫ́lum:* 'Yet there are other [heavenly] women who shall serve in Walhall, carry the drinks and prepare the table-cloth and ale-stuffs. So are they named in the Speeches of Grimner:'.

3 Hildr ok Þrúðr 'Hild and Thrith' | The **R** reading stems from **ðz, *ðz* with *r* rotunda being mistakenly copied as *ðı, ðı* and is certainly not an independent oral variant of these well-attested walkirrie names. This is apparent upon viewing the facsimile images.

6 þér bera ęin-hęrjum ǫl 'they bring the Oneharriers ale' | As cupbearers in Walhall. In Iron Age Germanic society pouring drinks at a feast was traditionally done by the ruler's kinswomen, the most famous literary example being Rothgar's wife and daughter in *Beow*; see Enright (1996) and Riseley (2014). The Walkirries may have been thought of as the daughters of Weden; see note to *Vsp* 30/5. For the reception of dead warriors see also note to st. 53/3 below.

**38** Ár·vakr ok Al·sviðr, · þęir skulu upp heðan [R 10r/32, A 5r/18]
svangir sól draga;
ęn und þęira bógum · fǫlu blíð ręgin,
ęsir, ísarn-kol.

Yorewaker and Allswith—they shall upward hence,
famished, pull the sun,
but under their shoulders the blithe Reins hid,
the Eese, iron-cooling.

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ALL | Sts. 38–40 deal with phenomena concerning the sun. The description of the sun as being pulled by a horse-driven chariot is attested in literature and archaeology going back to the Bronze Age. A notable archaeological find from the Germanic cultural area is the ca. 1400 BC Trundholm sun chariot found on Zealand, Denmark. This cultic object belonging to the Nordic Bronze Age features a large disc placed on a six-wheeled chariot pulled by a horse (figg. 2, 3, page 161). Only one side of the disc is gilt and so the chariot may also depict the horses pulling the Day and Night, for which see *Vafþ* 11–14. Indo-European literary parallels for horses pulling the sun include the Vedic *ṚV* 1.50.8–9, 4.13.3, 5.45.9 and the Greek Homeric Hymn to Ἥλιος.
This st. is referenced in *Gylf* 11:4–7, about the origin of the Sun and Moon: *En goð'in reiddu=sk þessu of-drambi tóku þau systkin ok settu upp á himin, létu Sól keyra þá hesta, er drógu kerru sólar'innar, þeirar er goð'in hǫfðu skapat til at lýsa heimana af þeiri síu, er flaug ór Múspells-heimi. Þeir hestar heita svá, Ár·vakr ok Al·sviðr. En undir bógum hesta'nna settu goð'in tvá vind-belgi at kǫla þá, en í sumum fróðum er þat kallat ísarn-kol.* 'But the Gods were angered by this arrogance and took the two siblings and placed them up in the heaven; they let Sun drive the horses that pulled the chariot of the sun which the Gods had created to brighten the Homes from the sparks which flew out of Muspellsham. Those horses are so named: Yorewaker and Allswith. But under the shoulders of the horses the Gods placed two air bellows to cool them, but in some sources [presumably this st.] those are called iron-cooling.' Cf. *Vafþ* 23 n., which cites *Gylf* 11:1–3.

1 Ár·vakr ok Al·sviðr 'Yorewaker and Allswith' | The two horses which pull the sun-chariot also appear in *Sigrdr* 15/2; cf. note to the next st.

2 svangir 'famished' | M. nom. pl. of *svangr* 'hungry, starved'. This adj. is used particularly of horses exhausted after long exertion, for which cf. *Oddr* 3/4, *1 HHund* 42/4, Sigv *Austv* 11 (in SkP 1).

**39** Svalinn hęitir, · hann stęndr sólu fyrir, [R 10v/2, A 5r/20]
skjǫldr skínanda goði;
bjǫrg ok brim · vęit'k at brinna skulu,
ef hann fęllr í frá.

Swalen it is called; it stands before the sun—
a shield before the Shining God [SUN].
Crags and surf I know shall burn,
if it falls away.

1 Svalinn | *so ('svalin')* **A**; Svǫl **R**

ALL | The sun-disc was apparently thought to be a translucent shield which protected the earth from the full power of the sun behind it. Without it the "crags and surf" (LAND and SEA; the totality of the earth) would burn. Cf. *Sigrdr* 15/1 which mentions the "shield that stands before the Shining God [SUN]" and is probably drawing on the present stanza.

1 Svalinn | The **A** reading is preferred since the shield is described by the m. *hann* in both mss., whereas **R**'s *Svǫl* looks like a feminine. *Svalinn* is confirmed by its inclusion in the poetic list of synonyms for shields, Þul *Skjaldar* 2/3 (in SkP 3).

**40** Skoll hęitir ulfr, · es fylgir hinu skír-ląita [R 10v/4, A 5r/21]
goði til varna viðar,
ęn annarr Hati · Hróð·vitnis sonr,
sá skal fyr hęiða brúði himins.

Sholl is the wolf called which follows the Pure-Faced
God [SUN] to the shelter of the woods,
but the other one is called Hate, Rothwitner's son;
he shall stay ahead of the bright Bride of Heaven [SUN].

2 varna | †vaurna† **A** 3 Hati | *add.* hann 's *'he is'* **R**.

ALL | For discussion on these wolves see *Vsp* 40 n. — This stanza is closely paraphrased in *Gylf* 12:4–5, following a question about why the sun hurries so quickly: *Hárr segir: „Þat eru tveir ulfar, ok heitir sá, er eptir henni ferr, Skoll. Hann hrędi=sk hón, ok hann mun taka hana. En sá heitir Hati Hróð·vitnis-son, er fyrir henni bleypr, ok vill hann taka tungl'it, ok svá mun verða.*" 'High says: "It is due to the two wolves, and the one who runs behind her is called Sholl. She fears him, and he would catch her. But the one who runs ahead of her is called Hate Rothwitner's son, and he wants to catch the moon, and so it will remain."'

2 til varna viðar 'to the shelter of the woods' | The sun is said to set in the forest. This is an interesting geographic detail since it points away from most of coastal (western) Norway, where the sun sets in the sea, and Iceland, which does not have any expansive forests. The description would however fit well for the Oslofjord area.

**41** Ór Ymis holdi · vas jǫrð of skǫpuð,
2 ęn ór svęita sjór,
bjǫrg ór bęinum, · baðmr ór hári,
4 ęn ór hausi himinn.

From Yimer's flesh was the Earth created,
but from his blood the sea,
mountains from his bones, woods from his hair,
but from his skull the Heaven.

[R 10v/6, **A** 5r/23, **S** 3r/30, **T** 4r/10, **W** 6v/9, **U** 4v/26, **A**$_b$ 9v/14, **B** 3v/11]

2 svęita 'his blood' | hans sára svęita *'the blood of his wounds'* **A**$_b$**B** 2 sjór 'sea' | *so* **AUA**$_b$**B**; sęr *'id.'* **R**; sjár *'id.'* **STW**. 3–4 bjǫrg ... himinn. | *Abbrev. as* b. or. b. b. or. h. En or. h. h. **U**, *cf. Mårtensson and Pálsson (2008, pp. 137, 145–146).* 3 bęinum | bęinu'num **T** 3 baðmr | †baðrmr† **A** 4 ór hausi himinn 'from his skull the heaven' | himinn ór hausi hans *'the heaven from his skull'* **A**$_b$**B**

ALL | St. 41 is clearly closely related to *Vafþ* 21; for the Creation see there and *Vsp* 3–4. — Sts. 41–42 are cited in sequence directly following *Gylf* 8:20–25, which describes the Earth: [...] *Hón er kring-lótt útan, ok þar útan um liggr inn djúpi sjár, ok með þeiri sjávar-strǫndu gǫfu þeir lǫnd til byggðar jǫtna ęttum. En fyrir innan á jǫrðu'nni gerðu þeir borg um·bverfis heim fyrir ó-friði jǫtna. En til þeirar borgar hǫfðu þeir brár Ymis jǫtuns ok kǫlluðu þá borg Mið-garð. Þeir tóku ok heila hans ok kǫstuðu í lopt ok gerðu afský'in. Svá sem hér segir:* 'It is round without and surrounding it there lies the deep sea; and along that sea-shore they [= the Gods] gave the land to the settlement by the lineages of the Ettins. But further within upon the Earth they made a stronghold around the Home against the enmity of the ettins, but for that stronghold they used the eyebrows of the ettin Yimer and they called the stronghold Middenyard. They also took his brains and cast them into the air and thereof made the clouds, just as it says here:' — Sts. 41–42 are also cited with numerous variants in *Lítla Skálda*, a short text on Scaldic poetics that likely served as a source for *SnE* (cf. *Eddbr* VIII).

3 bjǫrg ... baðmr 'mountains ... woods' | Formulaic alliterative pair describing the natural world in a context of creation or destruction, also found in the OHG *Wessobrunn* 3 (*paum noh perek*) and *Musp* 50 (*perga, poum*).

**42** Ęn ór hans brǫ́um · gørðu blíð ręgin
2 Mið·garð manna sonum,
ęn ór hans hęila · vǫ́ru þau hin harð-móðgu
4 ský ǫll of skǫpuð.

But from his brows the blithe Reins made
Middenyard for the sons of men,
but from his brains were the hard-minded
clouds all created.

[R 10v/8, **A** 5r/25, **S** 3r/31, **T** 4r/11, **W** 6v/11, **U** 4v/27, **A**$_b$ 9v/16, **B** 3v/12]

3 ęn | ok **U** 3 hin | *om.* **T** 3 harð-móðgu 'hard-minded' | hríð-fęldu *'stormy'* **A**$_b$**B**

1–2 Ęn ór hans brǫ́um · gørðu blíð ręgin / Mið·garð manna sonum 'But from his brows the blithe Reins made Middenyard for the sons of men' | The Gods fenced in Middenyard ('the Middle Enclosure') by using the strands of Yimer's eyebrows as poles, as explained in *Gylf* 8:22–23 (cited in note to st. 41). The creation of this Enclosure was in fact a gift from the kind Gods to Mankind in order to protect us from the chaotic forces of destruction without; cf. *Vsp* 16/2 n.

**43** Ullar hylli · hęfr ok allra goðа [**R** 10v/9, **A** 5r/26]
hvęrr's tękr fyrstr á funa,
því't opnir hęimar · verða umb ásа sonum,
þá's hęfja af hvera.

Wolder's holdness and that of All Gods
has whoever first kindles the fire,
for the Homes become open for the sons of the Eese [GODS],
when men lift off the cauldrons.

4 þá's | *add.* þęir **A**

ALL | This st. is one of the most difficult in the poem and many interpretations have been made. The traditional view (e.g., Finnur Jónsson 1932, Bellows, Sijmons and Gering 1927, p. 208) relates it to the poem's frame narrative. Weden, bound between the two fires, cryptically asks for a cauldron hanging above him from the roof to be moved aside so that the Gods will be able to see him through the smoke-vent and rescue him. This explanation, however, leaves much unexplained, namely the stanza's placement in the gnomic wisdom section of the poem, the invocation of the obscure god Wolder, the lack of mention of any cauldron elsewhere in the poem, and the question of why the gods would bestow their grace unto the person who first set the fire which is presently torturing Weden (assuming *tękr á funa* means 'kindles the fire'; see note to that phrase).
I find the interpretation of Nordberg (2005) more convincing. Nordberg argues that the st. is another piece of gnomic wisdom, referring to the cooking of the sacrificial meal in large cauldrons during the Bloot. The importance of cauldrons is seen in the common name second element *-kętill* or *-kęll* (cognate with English "kettle") and has textual support, e.g. in *HákGóð* 14, describing the traditional bloot in the Throndlaw (*Þrónda-lǫg*), Norway: *At veitslu þeiri skyldu allir menn ǫl eiga; þar var ok drepinn alls konar smali ok svá hross,* [...] *en slátr skyldi sjóða til mann-fagnaðar; eldar skyldu vera á miðju gólfi í hofi'nu ok þar katlar yfir.* 'At that gathering all men were to have ale; thereat also was every kind of small cattle slain and likewise horses, [...] and the fresh meat should be cooked for the enjoyment of men. There should be fires in the middle of the floor in the hove and kettles above them.' According to this view, the stanza is speaking of the Heavenly favour (*hylli*) earned by the ritualist who kindles the cooking fire, since that act enables the Gods to become guests at the ritual meal.
Nordberg's interpretation becomes especially interesting when one considers the immediately preceding stanzas 41–42, which describe the ordering of the world by the Gods through the killing and dismembering of Yimer, the primordial victim. That the killing of Yimer was in fact a sacrifice is supported by the manner in which it was done: beheading, which was the typical manner of slaying sacrificial bulls in the Wiking Age (cf. *Vafþ* 21/4 n., Lucas and McGovern 2007). In other Indo-European religions the first sacrifice of a Great Being (most famously the Vedic *Púruṣa*, *ṚV* 10.90) serves as the model for all future sacrifice, the performance of which reenacts the Creation and thereby re-establishes the continued existence of the World and upholding the social order (Lincoln 1986, *passim*; cf. *Vsp* 7/2 n.). That the purpose of the sacrifice is the re-establishment of Creation is said explicitly in the ritual language of the Vedic fire-sacrifice (Eliade 2005, pp. 11, 78–80). With this in mind we may consider how the sequence *Grm* 41–43 likely forms a unit: sts. 41–42 describe the Creation of the World through the First Bloot (sacrifice) in the mythic past (*in illo tempore*), and st. 43 connects it with the Bloot in the present.

1 Ullar 'Wolder's' | It is uncertain why the obscure god Wolder is invoked here but it cannot be simply for the sake of alliteration, since the much more well-known *Óðins* 'Weden's' would work just as well. It is possible that Wolder had a particular role in the setting of the ritual fire, something which finds support in the large number of fire-striker-shaped iron amulet-rings dating to ca. 660–780 AD found at the archaeological site of *Lilla Ullevi* ('Wolder's little wigh') in Sweden (af Edholm 2009).
In Wiking Age and High Mediaeval sources Wolder plays a very minor role, but his earlier significance is proven by the impressive number of cultic places named after him (Brink 2007, pp. 116–118) and is, apart from the present stanza, also hinted at by *Akv* 33/4.

1 hylli ‘holdness’ | ‘Favour, loyalty, grace’. This word, derived from the adjective *hollr* ‘hold; favourable, loyal, gracious’ along with the verb *hylla* ‘to make hold’ is used to refer to the grace of god(s) in both Heathen and Christian texts. See Index: hold and holdness.

1 allra goða ‘All Gods’ | Cf. *Sigrdr* 3–4, *Lok* 11, which both hail the Gods as a collective (the former as part of a genuine prayer, the latter subversively), and *Hákm* 18, where the piety of the dead king Hathkin is shown by his being greeted by *rǫ́ð ǫll ok regin* ‘all the Redes and Reins’.
The ritual use of this phrase proves that the pre-Christian Germanic religion did in fact believe in a form of Oneness of the Gods and their identity as a united body, something also seen in the idea of the Thing of the Gods (see *Vsp* 6 n.), where all the Gods gather to steer the fates of the world. Similar expressions are found in other old Indo-European religions, e.g., OI *víśvē dēvâḥ* ‘All Gods’, to Whom are dedicated numerous hymns of *ṚV* (Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 68), and Greek πάντες θεοί ‘id.’, found as early as the Mycenaean ritual inscriptions of the Bronze Age (Ziegler 1949; Ventris and Chadwick 1973, pp. 127, 303, 567; Killen 2024, pp. 860, 861, 1001).
This idea of Godly Oneness may have been the subject of dispute in the Norse world. Saxo Grammaticus (2015, pp. 53–54), 1.7.2 gives us an interesting anecdote. After Weden departs he is usurped by the obscure *Mithothin* (perhaps “With-Weden”), who reforms the cult:
*Cuius secessu Mithothyn quidam prestigiis celeber, perinde ac celesti beneficio vegetatus, occasionem et ipse fingende divinitatis arripuit barbarasque mentes novis erroris tenebris circumfusas prestigiarum fama ad cerimonias suo nomini persolvendas adduxit. Hic deorum iram aut numinum violationem confusis permixtisque sacrificiis expiari negabat ideoque eis vota communiter nuncupari prohibebat, discreta superum cuique libamenta constituens. Qui cum Othino redeunte relicta prestigiarum ope latendi gratia Pheoniam accessisset, concursu incolarum occiditur.*
‘A certain Mithodin, a famous illusionist, was animated at his departure as if by a kindness from heaven and snatched the chance to pretend divinity himself; his reputation for magicianship clouded the barbarians’ minds with the murk of a new superstition and led them to perform holy rites to his name. He asserted that the gods’ wrath and the profanation of their divine authority could not be expiated by confused and mingled sacrifices; so he arranged that they must not be prayed to as a group, but separate offerings (*libamenta*) be made to each deity. When Odin returned, the other no longer resorted to his conjuring but went off to hide in Funen, where he was rushed upon and killed by the inhabitants.’
It is not impossible that this obviously mythologised retelling may in fact reflect an actual theological conflict or attempted religious reform within the late Norse religion.

2 tękr … á funa ‘kindles the fire’ | Viz. the hallowed fire above which the holy cauldrons are hung; for the role of fire in Germanic and Vedic sacrifice see Kaliff (2005). — An otherwise unattested phrase which is here taken as equivalent with *taka ęld* ‘kindle fire’, although this is problematic since the preposition *á* ‘on’ modifies the sense of the verb and the phrase *taka á* has a variety of idiomatic senses like ‘touch, react to, get involved in, get on’, though **taka á ęld* is not attested. Another possibility is to read the ms. *afuna* as an error for *af funa* ‘from the fire’, which would yield the superior sense ‘whoever first takes [the cauldrons] from the fire’ (Nordberg 2005, p. 55).

3 opnir hęima verða ‘the Homes become open’ | The Bloot opens up the human world to that of the Gods above. Similar language is used in several hymns of *ṚV* which pray for the Heavenly Doors (*dvâraḥ dēvíḥ*) to open up, e.g. *ṚV* 1.13.6, 1.142.6, 2.3.5.

4 hvera ‘cauldrons’ | Acc. pl. of *hverr*, from PGmc. **hweraz*, from PIE **kʷer-* ‘pot, vessel’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 265). The Sanskrit cognate *carú* is occasionally used in reference to the vat from which the ritual drink *sṓma* is drunk (*ṚV* 10.167.4), but a particular religious significance for the PIE root cannot be reconstructed.

**44**

Í·valda synir · gingu ï ár-daga
Skíð·blaðni at skapa,
skipa bętst · skírum Fręy,
nýtum Njarðar bur.

[R 10v/11, A 5r/28, *Skm* TODO]

Iwald’s sons went in days of yore

Shidebladner for to shape:
the best of ships for the pure Frea,
for the useful Son of Nearth.

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ALL | The ship Shidebladner is also described in *Gylf* 43, which is quite likely pulling from the present stanza. This stanza is in fact cited in *Skm* 14, where it is introduced by the words: *Hann er eigandi Skíð·blaðnis ok galtar þess, er Gullin·bursti heitir, svá sem hér er sagt:* 'He is the owner of Shidebladner and of the boar which is called Goldenbristle, just as it is said here:'.

**45** [**R** 10v/13, **A** 5r/29, **S** 10r/20, **T** 10v/25, **W** 13r/11, **U** 12v/13]

Askr Ygg·drasils, · hann 's óðstr viða
ǫn Skíð·blaðnir skipa,
Óðinn ása · ǫn jóa Slęipnir,
Bif·rǫst brúa · ǫn Bragi skalda,
Hǫ·brók hauka · ǫn hunda Garmr.

The Ash of Ugdrassle—it is the noblest of trees,
but Shidebladner of ships,
Weden of the Eese, but Slopner of steeds,
Bivrest of bridges, but Bray of scalds,
Highbrook of hawks, but Garm of hounds.

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1 hann | *om.* **U** 4 Bif·rǫst 'Bivrest' | *so* **G**; Bil·rǫst *'Bilrest'* **RA**. — *om., but add. above the line by same hand* **A** 5 hunda Garmr 'Garm of hounds' | *add.* ǫn Brimir sverða *'but Brimmer of swords'* **A**. 5 Garmr | Gramr **ST**

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ALL | St. 45 concludes Weden's mythological wisdom-poetry with a list of the greatest things in sundry categories. It seems plausible that this stanza originally concluded with *Bif·rǫst brúa* 'Bivrest of bridges' as a Leeds-meter c-verse, and that the three following verses are later interpolations owing to the antiquarian tendency for categorising things; unlike the previous things listed, the last three (Bray, Highbrook, and Garm) seem more trivial. An interpolating tendency is, in fact, visible in action in **A**, which adds a final unmetrical verse at the end of the stanza with yet another object. —
The stanza is cited in *Gylf* 41, introduced by *Gylf* 41:6–7: *En satt er þat, er þú sagðir. Mikill er Óðinn fyrir sér. Mǫrg dómi finna=sk til þess. Svá er hér sagt í orðum sjalfra ásanna:* 'But true is that which thou hast said. Weden is formidable; many examples attest to that. So it is said here in the words of the Eese themselves.' For the preceding *Gylf* 41:1–5, see *Vafþ* 41 n.

**46** [**R** 10v/15, **A** 5v/2]

Svipum hęfi'k nú ypt · fyr sig-tíva sonum,
við þat skal vil-bjǫrg vaka,
ǫllum ǫ́sum · þat skal inn koma
Ę́gis bękki á
Ę́gis drekku at.

My gaze I've now lifted up before the sons of the victory-Tews;
by that shall the willed rescue awake!
All the Eese shall it bring in,
upon Eagre's bench,
at Eagre's drinking.

1 nú | *om.* **A**

ALL | Weden announces that he has raised his gaze and made the Gods aware of his situation; they will leave their feasting at Eagre's hall (cf. *Hym* and *Lok*) and come to his rescue.

**47** Hét=umk Grĩmr, · hét=umk Ganglęri, [**R** 10v/17, **A** 5v/4, **S** 6r/5, **T** 6v/10, **W** 9r/15, **U** 7v/14]
2 Hęrjann ok Hjalm·beri,
Þękkr ok Þriði, · Þuðr ok Uðr,
4 Hęl·blindi ok Hǫ́r.

I called myself Grim; I called myself Gangler,
Harn and Helmbearer.
Theck and Third, Thith and Ith,
Hellblinder and High.

1 hét=umk | ok **ASWU**; *om.* **T** 1 Ganglęri | *so* **RAU**; Gangari **S**; Gangi **T**; Ganglari **W**. 2 ok | *om.* **G** 3 ok | *om.* **G** 3 Þuðr | *so* **AG**; Þunðr *('Þv̄ðr')* **R** 3 ok | *om.* **G** 4 Hęl·blindi | *so* **RG**; Hęr·blindr **A** 4 ok | *om.* **G** 4 Hǫ́r | Hárr **W**

ALL | Weden begins his list of names which takes up sts. 47–52; more names are given in a second list in 56–57. Note that the name *Óðinn* 'Weden' itself does not appear in the first list. — The names from sts. 47–52 and 56 (but not 57) are also found in a list in *Gylf* 20:11, introduced by the words: *ok enn hefir hann nefnt=sk á fleiri vega, þá er hann var kominn til Geir·røðar konungs:* 'and he has named himself in yet more ways when he was come to visit King Garfrith:' The names in the list are given in the order they appear in each stanza of *Grm*, and the stanzas themselves come in the order: 47, 48, 49, 51, 52, 50, 56. For the purpose of the present critical edition, variant names from the list in *Gylf* 20:11 are noted for all relevant stanzas, but only sts. 47–49 are treated as being actually cited in *Gylf*, since the rest of the "stanzas" contain nothing other than the names. Note that all 4 mss. of *Gylf* append *Vera-týr* to the end of the list, likely taken from st. 3 above.

**48** Saðr ok Svipall · ok Sann·getall, [**R** 10v/19, **A** 5v/5, **S** 6r/6, **T** 6v/11, **W** 9r/16, **U** 7v/15]
2 Hęr·tęitr ok Hnikarr,
Bil·ęygr, Bál·ęygr, · Bǫl·verkr, Fjǫlnir,
4 Grímr ok Grímnir, · Glap·sviðr ok Fjǫl·sviðr.

Sooth and Swiple and Soothgettle,
Hartote and Nicker,
Bileye, Baleeye, Baleworker, Fillner,
Grim and Grimner, Glapswith and Fellswith.

1 ok | *om.* **G** 1 ok | *om.* **G** 2 ok | *om.* **G** 4 Grímr ok | *om.* **G** 4 ok | *om.* **G**

**49** Síð·hǫttr, Síð·skęggr, · Sig·fǫðr, Hnikuðr, [**R** 10v/21, **A** 5v/7, **S** 6r/7, **T** 6v/12, **W** 9r/17, **U** 7v/16]
2 Al·fǫðr, Val·fǫðr, · At·ríðr ok Farma·týr;
ęinu nafni · hét=umk aldri=gi
4 síðst ek með folkum fór.

Sidehat, Sideshaw, Syefather, Nicked,
Allfather, Walfather, Atrider, and Farm-Tew—
by a single name I never called Myself
since among man-folk I fared.

1 Síð·hǫttr | Síð·hófr **T** 1–2 Hnikuðr ... At·ríðr | At·ríðr, Hnikuðr, Al·fǫðr **U** 2 Val·fǫðr 'Walfather' | *om.* **AG** 2 At·ríðr | †ettridr† **T** 2 ok | *om.* **G** 3–4 ęinu ... fór. 'by ... fared.' | *om.* **G** 3 aldri=gi 'never' | *om.* **A** 4 með | *om.* **A**

**50** Grímni mik hétu · at Gęir·raðar, [**R** 10v/23, **A** 5v/9]
2 ęn Jalk at Ǫs·mundar;
ęn þá Kjalar · es ek kjalka dró,
4 Þrór þingum at,
Viður *vígum at*.

Grimner they called me at Garfrith's
but Gelding at Osmund's,
but Keller when I pulled the sled,
Throo at Things,
Wither in battles.

2 Ǫs·mundar | *This name is spelled* 'ǫsmundar' *in* **R**, *an archaic scribal feature suggesting that the poem was likely put to paper in the 12th century.* 3 Kjalar | *so* **RG**; Jalk **A**. 5 Viður *vígum at* 'Wither in battles' | *metr. emend. from* Viður at vigum *'id.'* **A**; *om.* **R**

ALL | Apart from the first line, which of course refers to the present situation, the underlying stories are not known. They presumably refer to other now-lost myths involving Weden travelling in disguise. — The Weden-names in this stanza are found in *Gylf* 20:11 following those of st. 52. They appear in the order *Jalkr, Kjalarr, Viðurr, Þrór* 'Gelding, Keller, Wither, Throo' in all mss., indicating that ll. 4 and 5 were reversed in the version of the poem used by Snorre.

4 Þrór þingum at 'Throo at Things' | Perhaps a reference to a name under which Weden was invoked at the start of Things or legal assemblies.

5 Viður *vígum at* 'Wither in battles' | That this line is not an insertion by **A** is shown by the presence of *Viðurr* in the corresponding part of the name-list in *Gylf* 20:11.

**51** Óski ok Ómi, · Jafn·hár ok Biflindi, [**R** 10v/24, **A** 5v/10]
2 Gǫndlir ok Hár·barðr með goðum.

Wisher and Omer, Evenhigh and Bivling,
Gandler and Hoarbeard among Gods.

1 Biflindi | Blindi **S** 2 Gǫndlir | Gęldnir **U**

ALL | The names in this st. appear in the list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 49 in the order *Óski, Ómi, Jafn·hár, Biflindi, Gǫndlir, Har·bárðr*.

2 Hár·barðr með goðum 'Hoarbeard among Gods' | Viz. in *Hárb*, when conversing with the god Thunder.

**52** Sviðurr ok Sviðrir · es ek hét at Søkk·mímis [R 10v/25, A 5v/11]
ok dulða'k þann hinn aldna jǫtun
þá's Mið·vitnis vas'k · hins méra burar
orðinn ęin-bani.

Swither and Swithrer, as I was called at Sackmimer's,
and I deceived that olden ettin,
when of Midwitner's famous son
I became the lone slayer.

3 Mið·vitnis | *so* **A**; Mið·viðnis **R**

ALL | The myth alluded to in this stanza is not otherwise attested. — The two Weden-names in this st. appear in the list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 51 in the order *Sviðurr, Sviðrir* with no critical variants.

1 Søkk·mímis 'Sinkmimer's' | Gen. sg. of *Søkk·mímir*. This ettin is by all likelihood the same as the one mentioned in Þul *Jǫtna I* 6/3 (in SkP 3) and *Yt* 2/5. The first element is disputed and may also be normalised as *søk-* 'conflict, (legal) charge', which is the form of the name in *Yt* 2/5. Following Kock (*NN*, 1783A), I take the first element to be the poetic term *søkk* 'treasure' (cf. OE *sinc* 'id.'), which provides a parallel with *Hodd·mímir* 'Hoardmimer' (i.e., 'Treasure-Mimer') in *Vafþ* 45/2. An alternative explanation is a derivative of the verb *søkkva* 'sink', i.e., the one who lives in the depths (of the ocean?).

**53** Qlr est Gęir·røðr, · hęfr þú of·drukkit; [R 10v/28, A 5v/13]
miklu est hnugginn, · es þú est mínu gęngi,
ǫllum ęin-hęrjum · ok Óðins hylli.

Thou art worse for ale, Garfrith; thou hast drunk too much!
Much hast thou lost when thou hast [lost] My support,
all the Oneharriers, and Weden's holdness.

2 gęngi 'support' | *so* **R**; gęði *'mind'* **A**

ALL | Weden now turns to King Garfrith. He reproaches his former protegé and foresees his imminent death.

3 ǫllum ęin-hęrjum 'all the Oneharriers' | It is important to note that Garfrith is not said to have lost the support (*gęngi*) of the Oneharriers but rather the Oneharriers themselves, yet the sense is the same: by breaking the Odinic code of conduct befitting his station, Garfrith has lost Weden's favour and thus been excluded from the community of oath-bound warriors, his adopted sons, the Oneharriers. On the other hand, a righteous king could expect their truce, as was the case for Hathkin the Good according to *Hákm*, composed after his death. Thus *Hákm* 16/1–2 sees the god Bray greeting Hathkin in Walhall with the words: *ęin-hęrja grið · skalt allra hafa; / þigg þú at ǫsum ǫl.* 'the truce of all the Oneharriers shalt thou have. Receive ale from the Eese!'

3 Óðins hylli 'Weden's holdness' | Weden's grace or favour; cf. st. 43/1 n.

**54** Fjǫlð þér sagða'k, · ęn þú fátt of mant, [R 10v/30, A 5v/15]
of þik véla vinir;
męki liggja · sé'k míns vinar

allan ĩ dręyra drifinn.

Many things have I told thee, but thou recallest few;
'tis friends that deal with thee!
A sword I see lying, in My friend's
dreary blood all drenched.

2–3 vinir, mĩns vinar 'friends, my friend' | Weden stresses his friendship with Garfrith by repeating the word *vinr* 'friend'. The followers of a god were his friends; see *Háv* 157 n.

3–4 męki liggja · sé'k mĩns vinar / allan ĩ dręyra drifinn. 'A sword I see lying, in my friend's / dreary blood all drenched.' | A prophetic statement.

**55** Ęgg-móðan val · nú mun Yggr hafa, [**R** 10v/31, **A** 5v/16]
þitt vęit'k líf of liðit;
varar 'ro dísir, · nú knátt Óðin séa;
nálga=sk mik ef þú męgir!

An edge-wearied corpse will Ug now have;
I know thy life to be past.
Wary are the Dises; now dost thou see Weden.
Draw near Me, if thou mayest!

3 varar | †vvárro† **A**

1 Ęgg-móðan 'edge-wearied' | Euphemistic; "slain by a piercing blade." Also found in *Hamð* 30/2a.

3 dísir 'the Dises' | The Norns, fates, who have determined Garfrith's hour of death. Cf. *Fáfn* 11–13, *Am* 25/4, *Hamð* 30.

**56** Óðinn nú hęiti'k, · Yggr áðan hét'k, [**R** 11r/2, **A** 5v/18]
hét=umk Þundr fyr þat,
Vakr ok Skilfingr, · Vǫfuðr ok Hropta-týr
Gautr ok Jalkr með goðum.

Weden am I now called; Ug was I called earlier;
I called myself Thound before that;
Wacker and Shilving, Waved and Roft-Tew,
Geat and Gelding among the Gods.

3 Vǫfuðr | *so* **RAS**; Ná·fǫðr *('*nafodr*')* **T**; Vá·fǫðr **W**; *om.* **U**

ALL | The names in this st. (other than *Óðinn* 'Weden') appear in the name-list in *Gylf* 20:11 immediately following those of st. 50. They have the archetypal order *Yggr, Þundr, Vakr, Skilfingr, Vǫfuðr, Hropta-týr, Gautr, Jalkr*, although only the ms. **T** keeps all names; **S** and **W** omit. *Jalkr* while **U** omits the first 6 names (*Yggr–Hropta-týr* 'Ug ... Roft-Tew') and therefore only has *Gautr, Jalkr* 'Geat, Gelding'.

1 Óðinn nú hęiti'k 'Weden I am now called' | Having dropped all disguises, the guest is no longer Grimner but Weden himself; note that his earlier list of names did not contain this name.

**57** Ófnir ok Sváfnir · es hygg'k at orðnir sé [R 11r/4, A 5v/20]
2 allir af ęinum mér."

Ovner and Swebner, whom, I ween, have come
all from Me alone."

1 es | *om.* **A** 2 af | at **A**

ALL | No trace of this stanza is found in the list of names in *Gylf* 20:11 which suggests that it may be a later addition common to **R** and **A**. It is also possible that these names were left out since Snorre considered them to be serpent-names on the basis of st. 35 above, which is quoted in *Gylf* 16:9.

1 Ófnir ok Sváfnir 'Ovner and Swebner' | Both names are listed among poetic names of Weden in Þul *Óðins* (in SkP 3). They are also the names of two serpents in 35/3 above.

**P3** Geir·røðr konungr sat, ok hafði sverð um kné sér ok brugðit til [R 11r/5, A 5v/21]
2 miðs. En er hann heyrði, at Óðinn var þar kominn, stóð hann
upp, ok vildi taka Óðin frá eldi'num. Sverð'it slapp ór hendi
4 hǫ́num, vissu hjǫlt'in niðr. Konungr drap fǿti, ok steypti=sk á-
fram, en sverð'it stóð í gǫgnum hann, ok fekk hann bana. Óðinn
6 hvarf þá. En Agnarr var þar konungr lengi síðan.

King Garfrith sat and had a sword about his knee, and it was brandished half-way up. And when he heard that Weden had come there, he stood up and would take Weden from the fire. The sword slipped out of his hand; the hilt pointed downwards. The king lost his footing and fell forward, but the sword went through him and he received his bane. Weden then disappeared, but Ayner was king there for a long while afterwards.

2 kominn, | *add.* þá **A** 4 hǫ́num, | *add.* ok **A** 5 hann | þar af **A** 5–6 Óðinn hvarf þá. | *om.* **A** 6 var þar | varð **A** 6 lengi síðan. | *om.* **A**

## Appendix

### *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 'Origin of the Nation of the Longbeards'

The following excerpt is the first chapter of a 7th century text dealing with the legendary prehistory of the Longbeards or Lombards. The text is presented here due to its close resemblance to *Grm* P2, and since certain name-forms require linguistic discussion. The original text is preserved in three manuscripts some centuries younger. The Latin edition is that of Waitz (1878), with minor revisions (8 *Godam* > *Godani*; 7, 9 *sol* > *sole*), while the translation is my own. It is of note that the same narrative occurs in highly condensed form in the Chronicle of Fredegar, 3:65 (Krusch 1888, p. 110). Fredegar has more archaic linguistic forms than the *Origo*, and therefore cannot

be directly reliant on it; the relevant names are *Scathanavia* 'Shedeney' and *Wodan* 'Weden' (for *Origo*'s *Scadanan* and *Godan*, respectively).

[1]Est insula qui dicitur Scadanan, quod interpretatur excidia, in partibus aquilonis, ubi multae gentes habitant; inter quos erat gens parva quae Winnilis vocabatur. [2]Et erat cum eis mulier nomine Gambara, habebatque duos filios, nomen uni Ybor et nomen alteri Agio; ipsi cum matre sua nomine Gambara principatum tenebant super Winniles. [3]Moverunt se ergo duces Wandalorum, id est Ambri et Assi, cum exercitu suo, [4]et dicebant ad Winniles: "Aut solvite nobis tributa, aut praeparate vos ad pugnam et pugnate nobiscum". [5]Tunc responderunt Ybor et Agio cum matre sua Gambara: "Melius est nobis pugnam praeparare, quam Wandalis tributa persolvere". [6]Tunc Ambri et Assi, hoc est duces Wandalorum, rogaverunt Godan, ut daret eis super Winniles victoriam. [7]Respondit Godan dicens: "Quos sole surgente antea videro, ipsis dabo victoriam". [8]Eo tempore Gambara cum duobus filiis suis, id est Ybor et Agio, qui principes erant super Winniles, rogaverunt Fream, uxorem Godani, ut ad Winniles esset propitia. [9]Tunc Frea dedit consilium, ut sole surgente venirent Winniles et mulieres eorum crines solutae circa faciem in similitudinem barbae et cum viris suis venirent. [10]Tunc luciscente sol dum surgeret, giravit Frea, uxor Godan, lectum ubi recumbebat vir eius, et fecit faciem eius contra orientem, et excitavit eum. [11]Et ille aspiciens vidit Winniles et mulieres ipsorum habentes crines solutas circa faciem; et ait: "Qui sunt isti longibarbae?" [12]Et dixit Frea ad Godan: "Sicut dedisti nomen, da illis et victoriam". [13]Et dedit eis victoriam, ut ubi visum esset vindicarent se et victoriam haberent. [14]Ab illo tempore Winnilis Langobardi vocati sunt.

[1]There is an island which is called Shedeney, which is interpreted as 'destruction', in the parts of the north, where many nations dwell; among whom was a small nation which was called *Winnilis*. [2]And there was with them a woman named *Gambara*, and she had two sons, the name of one was *Ybor* and the name of the other *Agio*; they with their mother named Gambara held the chieftainship over the Winnilis. [3]Then the princes of the *Wandali*, that is *Ambri* and *Assi*, moved with their host, [4]and said to the Winnilis: "Either pay tributes to us, or prepare yourselves for battle and fight with us." [5]Then Ybor and Agio with their mother Gambara answered: "It is better for us to prepare for battle than to pay out tributes to the Wandali." [6]Then Ambri and Assi, that is the princes of the Wandali, asked Weden that he might give to them

victory over the Winnilis. [7]Weden answered, saying: "Those whom I shall see first at the rising sun, to them I will give the victory." [8]At that time Gambara with her two sons, that is Ybor and Agio, who were chieftains over the Winnilis, asked Frie, the wife of Weden, that she might be favorable toward the Winnilis. [9]Then Frie gave counsel, that at the rising sun the Winnilis should come and their women, having let down hair around the face in the likeness of a beard, and they should come with their men. [10]Then as it grew light while the sun was rising, Frie, wife of Weden, turned the bed where her husband was reclining, and made his face turn toward the east, and awakened him. [11]And he, looking out, saw the Winnilis and their women having let down their hair about the face; and he said: "Who are these long-beards?" [12]And Frie said to Weden: "As thou hast given the name, give them also the victory." [13]And he gave them victory, so that whenever it seemed [fit] they might defend themselves and have victory. [14]From that time the Winnilis are called *Langobardi*.

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1 Scadanan, quod interpretatur excidia 'Shedeney, which is interpreted as "destruction"' | *Scadanan* 'Shedeney' is the same word as Scandinavia or Scania, *Scanza* in Jordanes, *Scathanavia* in Fredegar. The word derives from PGmc **Skadin-awjō* 'Shede's island', where Shede is probably the goddess (ON *Skaði*) known from Norse sources. — The gloss reveals that the author was not unfamiliar with Germanic idiom; cf. OHG *skado* 'damage'.

12 Godan 'Weden' | A form derived from earlier *Wōdan* (attested in runes on the Nordendorf fibula) through the sound change *w-* > *g(u)-*. This sound change is also found in some ms. renderings of the tribal names *Wandalis* and *Winnilis*, which become *Guandalis* and *Guinnilis*, respectively.

16 Fream 'Frie' | Weden's wife, Frie. Acc. sg. of *Frea*, cognate with OHG *Frija* (*Mers II* 4), ON *Frigg*, both from PGmc. **Frijō*. Frie is not to be confused with the different goddess Frow (ON *Fręyja*, whose name, though superficially similar to *Frea*, in fact comes from PGmc. **frawjō* 'lady', corresponding to OHG *frouwa*.

24–25 Sicut dedisti nomen, da illis et victoriam 'As thou hast given the name, give them also the victory' | Likely an early attestation of the custom of the name-gift (ON *gefa at nafn-fęstr* 'give for the fastening of a name') found in numerous later Norse Saws. Cf. *Skm* 53: *Þá svarar konungr: „Þú, sveinn, hefir gefit mér nafn, at ek skal heita Hrólfr kraki, en þat er títt, at gjǫf skal fylgja nafn-festi.* [...]*"* 'Then answers the king: "Thou, swain, hast given me a name, that I shall be called Rotholf the pole; yet it is customary that a gift should follow the fastening of a name. [...]"'

# Dreams of Balder
# *(Baldrs draumar)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.890)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Dreams of Balder** (*Bdr*) is a short narrative mythological poem. The god Balder has been having ominous dreams, and so his father the high god Weden, rides down to Hell, the Underworld, in order to ask a dead wallow about his son's future.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Bdr* is preserved only in **A**, on foll. 1v/17–2r/11, where it follows *Hárb* and is followed by *Skí*.

A younger redaction characterised by a number of post-mediaeval inserts is transmitted in several copies in later paper manuscripts. Metrical characteristics make it clear that these inserts are very late (Ragnar Ingi Aðalsteinsson 2009), and they are therefore excluded from this edition without further comment.

### Meter and stanza

*Bdr* is a short poem consisting of 57 long-lines across 14 stanzas. The meter is Ancient-words-lay. The typical length of the stanza is 4 (13/14: 1–10, 12–14), and this is upheld consistently. A single stanza, 11, has 5 lines.

### Origin and motifs

The main source for the death and subsequent avenging of the god Balder is *Gylf* 49–50 (for a summary of which, see *Vsp* 31 n.). Compared to that narrative, *Bdr* corresponds only to the very beginning, namely Balder's ominous dreams, and does not go into great depth about its subject; at just 14 sts. the

poem is the shortest surviving mythological Eddic poem. In isolation, the purpose of *Bdr* seems somewhat unclear, and it must originally have been part of a longer cycle of lost poetry dealing with Balder's death. That such a cycle likely existed is supported by the fragmentary stanza *Eddbr* V.

## Dating

*Bdr* has a particularly high rate of the archaic particle *of*, with a frequency of 0.463 occurrences per 10 lines (Sapp 2022, p. 77), although it must be noted that *Bdr* is so short that this number may not be as reliable as for longer poems. St. 3/4a may require a hiatus form, suggesting a date of composition before ca. 1150 AD, but is an uncertain attestation (see note). The alliteration of *vr-* with *v-* in 11/1 suggests a date before ca. 1000 AD (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016), but unfortunately that line is partly emended, and the presence of *vr-* in **Vrindr* (> *Rindr*) cannot be considered fully certain due to a lack of parallels. To conclude, *Bdr* is likely an old poem, but it is too short to contain clear diagnostics.

## Summary

The poem begins *in medias res*: Balder has been having nightmares, which the Gods meet at their Thing to discuss (1). Weden rides down to Hell where he has an encounter with a bloody hound; he passes it and continues to "the high house of Hell" (2–3) from which he rides west to the grave of a certain wallow whom he revives using magic (4).

The wallow asks who it is that has forced her out of the grave (5) and Weden introduces himself as Waytame, before asking for whom the benches of Hell are covered with gold (6). The wallow responds that barrels of mead stand brewed for Balder and that the Gods must be very anxious (7). Weden asks her who will slay Balder (8), and she responds that it is Hath, carrying a "tall, famous wood" (9). The god next asks who will avenge Balder's death (10), and the wallow responds that Wrind will give birth to Weden's son Wonnel, who will slay Hath when only one night old (11). Weden then asks about some mysterious maidens (12), which apparently betrays his identity. The wallow announces that she now knows that her accoster is Weden, not Waytame; the god in turn retorts that she is not a wallow but rather the "mother of three thurses" (13). The wallow tells him to ride home and "be renowned", taunting him over his unavoidable death at the Rakes of the Reins (14).

## Text

### The Dreams of Balder

**1** Sęnn vǫ́ru ę́sir · allir á þingi [A 1v/18]
ok ǫ́synjur · allar á máli,
ok umb þat réðu · ríkir tívar:
hví vę́ri Baldri · ballir draumar?

Soon were the Eese all at the Thing,
and the Ossens all at speech,
and of this counseled the mighty Tews:
Why did Balder have troubling dreams?

4 Baldri | *corr. from* baldrs *above line in same hand* **A**

1–3 Sęnn ... tívar 'Soon ... Tews' | Identically shared with *Þrk* 14/1–3. — The 'Thing' is the Thing of the Gods (cf. *Vsp* 6/1–2 n., *Hym* 39/1). It is of note that the male Gods (*ę́sir* 'Eese') are said to be *á þingi* 'at, upon the Thing', while the Goddesses (*ǫ́synjur* 'Ossens') are on the sidelines chatting; this detail appears to relate to actual Norse Thing-proceedings. To be *á þingi* should here be understood as being seated specifically within the ritual enclosure at the legal assembly, where the judgments were decided by a group of twelve elders (sometimes several groups of twelve) seated inside of a holy enclosure (the so-called *vé-bǫnd* 'wigh-bonds', i.e., 'holy cords'), into which all others were forbidden to enter. Indeed, according to several prose sources, there were precisely twelve gods, all male, seated at the Thing of the Gods (see *Vsp* 6/1 n.). In the patriarchal society of the Old Germani, it appears that women could not enter the ritual enclosure, and this was true even of the Goddesses. *Eg* 56 gives us a description of the Gole-Thing in Norway: *En þar er dómr'inn var settr, var vǫllr sléttr ok settar niðr hesli-stengr í vǫll'inn í hring, en lǫgð um útan snóri um·hverfis. Vǫ́ru þat kǫlluð vé-bǫnd. En fyrir innan í hringi'num sǫ́tu dómendr, tolf ór Firða-fylki ok tolf ór Sygna-fylki, tolf ór Hǫrða-fylki; þǽr þrennar tylftir manna skyldu þar dóma um mǫ́l manna.* 'But where the court was established there was a smooth plain, and hazelwood-poles were set down into the plain in a ring and cords tied around them on the outside; those were called the 'wigh-bonds'. But inside of the ring the judges sat: twelve from Firth-county and twelve from Sown-county, twelve from Harth-county—there those three groups of twelve men each would judge the cases of men.' The Norwegian New Law of the Land 1:3 specifies the proceedings of the Gole-Thing, noting: *Svá er ok mélt at engi maðr þeirra er eigi er nefndr skal fírir innan vé-bǫnd setja=sk útan or·lofs.* 'So it is also said that noone amongst them who was not named shall be seated inside the wigh-bonds without permission.' (NGL II, p. 14).

**2** Upp rǫis Óðinn, · ald*inn* Gautr, [A 1v/19]
ok hann á Slęipni · sǫðul of lagði,
rǫið niðr þaðan · nifl-hęljar til;
mótti hvelpi, · þęim's ór hęlju kom.

Up rose Weden, the olden Geat,
and he on Slopner the saddle did lay,
rode down thence to Nivelhell,
met the whelp that came out of Hell.

1 ald*inn* | *emend. (cf. 13/2 below);* alda **A**

2 ok hann á Slęipni · sǫðul of lagði ‘and he on Slopner the saddle did lay’ | Possibly formulaic; cf. *Oddr* 2/4.

4 hvelpi, · þęim’s ór hęlju kom ‘the whelp that came out of Hell’ | An otherwise unknown dog, sometimes identified with Garm. The motif of the Hellhound guarding the underworld is well known throughout world mythology, most famously in the form of the Greek Κέρβερος (*Theog* 300–312).

**3** Sá vas blóðugr · umb brjóst framan, [A 1v/21]
ok galdrs fǫður · gól *of* lęngi,
framm ręið Óðinn, · fold-vegr dunði,
hann kom at hǫu · Hęljar ranni.

It was bloody at the front of its chest
and at the father of galder [= Weden] for a long time bayed.
Forth rode Weden—the fold-way [EARTH] resounded—
he came to the high house of Hell.

2 gól *of* | ‘golv’ *(corruption of* *gol ū*)* **A**

2 galdrs fǫður ‘the father of galder [= Weden]’ | An unparallelled expression for Weden, the master of magical spells and chants (galders). Cf. *Háv* 140, 147–165.

3 framm ręið Óðinn, · fold-vegr dunði ‘Forth rode Weden—the fold-way [EARTH] resounded’ | The movement of gods often causes cosmic disturbance; cf. the description of Thunder’s riding in *Haustl* 14: *Ók at ísarn-lęiki · Jarðar sunr ok dunði … mána vegr und hǫnum* ‘The Son of Earth drove to the iron-play [BATTLE] … and the moon’s way [SKY/HEAVEN] resounded beneath him’. See further *Þrk* 21.

4 hann kom at hǫu | The hiatus form in *hǫu* ‘high’ (*‘háfu’* **A**) is not diagnostic for the dating since it may be due to analogy with other forms in *hǫv-* in the adjective, that is, it may an old uncontracted *hǫu* (which would be contracted to *hǫ* post-1150), but it may also be a young analogical *hǫvu*. Regardless of the presence of the analogical glide in *hǫ(v)u*, the line may be read either as a type A1 (with stress on *hann*) or a type A3.

**4** Þá ręið Óðinn · fyr austan dyrr, [A 1v/22]
þar’s hann vissi · vǫlu lęiði;
nam hann vittugri · val-galdr kveða,
und’s nauðug ręis, · nás orð of kvað:

Then Weden rode east from its doors,
whither he knew the wallow’s grave.
He took to sing a slain-galder for the cunning woman
until forced she rose; a corpse’s words quoth she:

3 val-galdr ‘slain-galder’ | A galder to quicken the dead, in this case the wallow. Cf. *Háv* 158 where Weden tells how He can bring hanged men back to life with a galder.

**5** „Hvat ’s manna þat · mér ǫ·kunnra, [A 1v/24]

es mér hęfr aukit · ęrfitt sinni?
Vas'k snifin snjóvi, · ok slęgin regni,
ok drifin dǫggu, · dauð vas'k lęngi."

"What sort of man is this, unknown to me,
who has caused for me this toilsome journey?
I was snowed by snow and struck by rain
and bespattered by dew—dead was I for long."

---

2 ęrfitt sinni 'this toilsome journey' | The "journey" out of the grave.

3–4 Vas'k snifin ... lęngi. 'I was snowed ... long.' | Cf. the similar description of a buried person in *2 HHund* 44–45.

[Óðinn kvað:] **6** „Veg·tamr ek hęiti, · sonr em'k Val·tams, [A 1v/25]
sęg mér ór hęlju, · ek man ór hęimi;
hvęim eru bękkir · baugum sánir,
flęt fagr=liga · flóuð golli?"

[Quoth Weden:] "Waytame I am called; I am Waltame's son;
tell me [the tidings] from Hell—I will [tell those] from the Home.
For whom are the benches sown with bighs,
the floors fairly flooded with gold?"

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1 Veg·tamr ek hęiti, · sonr em'k Val·tams 'Waytame I am called, I am Waltame's son' | Neither name is attested elsewhere, but both are Odinic in character: the first alludes to Weden's role as patron of wayfaring strangers (*Háv*, *Grm*), the second to his role as gatherer of dead warriors (*Vsp* 23/1, *Vafþ* 40–41, *Grm* 8–10, *Hárb* 24).

2 hęimi 'the Home' | I.e., the world of the living.

4 flęt 'the floors' | In an Iron Age Germanic hall, the *flęt* was the raised flooring alongside the walls upon which the benches stood; here it is synonymous with the living quarters.

[Vǫlva kvað:] **7** „Hér stęndr Baldri · of brugginn mjǫðr, [A 1v/27]
skírar vęigar, · liggr skjǫldr yfir,
ęn ǫs-męgir · í of·vęni;
nauðug sagða'k, · nú mun'k þęgja."

[Quoth the wallow:] "Here for Balder mead stands brewed,
pure draughts—a shield lies over them—
but the Os-Lads [= Eese] stand in great suspense—
forced I spoke, now I will shut up!"

[Óðinn kvað:] **8** „Þęgj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil'k fregna, [A 1v/29]
und's al-kunna, · vil'k ęnn vita:
hvęrr man Baldri · at bana verða,

4 ok Óðins son · aldri rękna?“

[Quoth Weden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!
Until all is known I wish yet to know:
Who will become Balder’s bane
and rob Weden’s son of life?”

[Vǫlva kvað:] **9** „Hǫðr berr hóvan · hróðr-baðm þinig, [A 2r/1]
2 hann man Baldri · at bana verða,
ok Óðins son · aldri rękna;
4 nauðug sagða’k, · nú mun’k þęgja.“

[Quoth the wallow:] “Hath bears the high, famous wood [MISTLETOE] thither.
*He* will become Balder’s bane
and rob Weden’s son of life—
forced I spoke, now I will shut up!”

1 hróðr-baðm | *emend.;* hróðr-barm **A**

[Óðinn kvað:] **10** „Þęgj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil’k fregna, [A 2r/3]
2 und’s al-kunna, · vil’k ęnn vita,
hvęrr man hęipt Hęði · hęfnt of vinna,
4 eða Baldrs bana · á bál vega?“

[Quoth Weden:] “Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!
Until all is known I wish yet to know:
Who will avenge that evil on Hath,
or drag onto the pyre Balder’s bane?”

[Vǫlva kvað:] **11** „*V*rindr berr *Vála* · í vestr-sǫlum, [A 2r/4]
2 sá man Óðins sonr · ęin-nęttr vega;
hǫnd of þvér-*at* · né hǫfuð kęmbir,
4 áðr á bál of berr · Baldrs and·skota;
nauðug sagða’k, · nú mun’k þęgja.“

[Quoth the wallow:] “Wrind bears Wonnel in the western halls:
he will, Weden’s son, one night old, fight.
He washes not his hand nor combs his head
before onto the pyre he bears Balder’s shooter—
forced I spoke, now I will shut up.”

1 *V*rindr ‘Wrind’ | *metr. emend.;* Rindr **A** 1 *Vála* ‘Wonnel’ | *required by meter and sense; om.* **A**
3 *at* | *required by meter and sense; om.* **A**

1 *V*rindr 'Wrind' | As the first nominal in the verse, ms. *Rindr* is expected to carry alliteration with *vestr-sǫlum*. This is obtained by restoring an archaic initial *vr-* cluster, for which cf. *Háv* 26/2 n. Unlike other instances of this cluster, **Vrindr* is etymologically obscure. A likely theory connects the name with Gutnish *rind* m. 'ivy, common clubmoss', in which case Wrind may be a minor plant goddess (Lundberg 1913). If so, there is prob. an obscure ritual significance to the notion that it is the son of the Ivy who is born to avenge the harm done by the mistletoe. Lundberg argues that worship of Wrind is indicated by the OSwe. place name *Vrinda-vi* (modern-day Vrinnevid, supposedly gen. sg. of **Vrindr + ví* 'wigh, shrine'), although Sahlgren (1924, pp. 66, 78–80) considers this etymology false and instead explains the name as containing the second element OSwe. *viði* 'wood, forest'.

1 *Vála* 'Wonnel' | The name must be restored. Without it the verse is only two syllables long, which is absolutely forbidden in Norse Ancient-words-lay meter, and the verb *berr* 'bears, gives birth to' is left without an object.

2–4 sá ... and-skota 'he will ... shooter' | These lines are, apart from the tense of the verbs, almost identical to *Vsp* 32/4–33/2. The direction of influence is unclear, and it is not impossible that both are borrowing from a now-lost third poem.

[Óðinn kvað:] **12** „Þegj=at-tu vǫlva, · þik vil'k fregna, [A 2r/6]
2 und's al-kunna, · vil'k ęnn vita,
hvęrjar 'ro męyjar, · es at muni gráta
4 ok á himin verpa · halsa-skautum?"

[Quoth Weden:] "Shut not up, wallow—thee I wish to ask!
Until all is known I wish yet to know:
Which are the maidens that heartily weep,
and onto heaven throw the front-sheets?"

ALL | The question in this stanza is quite obscure. If it is connected to the myth of Balder's death in any way, it ought to be the episode where the all things in the world wept for Balder. According to *Gylf* 49:70–82 (see *Eddbr* V below), Hell promised to give Balder back to the Eese if all things in the world would weep for him. The Eese relayed this message, and all things wept for Balder, save Lock in disguise. It may thus be that these maidens were among the weepers (perhaps they were the Walkirries, and this is what reveals Weden's identity?), but in any case their identity is otherwise unknown. They may tentatively be identified with the equally mysterious daughters of Maythrasher in *Vafþ* 49, who are also young women (*męyjar*) who appear to have something to do with the End Times.

4 á himin verpa · halsa-skautum 'onto heaven throw the front-sheets' | Unexplained. Perhaps an astrological allusion.

[Vǫlva kvað:] **13** „Est=at Veg·tamr, · sęm ek hugða, [A 2r/8]
2 hęldr est Óðinn, · aldinn Gautr!"
[Óðinn kvað:] „Est=at vǫlva · né vís kona,
4 hęldr est þriggja · þursa móðir!"

[Quoth the wallow:] "Thou art not Waytame as I thought,
rather art thou Weden, the olden Geat!"—
[Quoth Weden:] "Thou art no wallow nor wise woman,
rather art thou three Thurses' mother!"

2 aldinn | *corr. from* alda *above line in same hand* **A**

[Vǫlva kvað:] **14** „Hęim ríð Óðinn · ok ves hróðigr, [A 2r/9]
2 svá komi=t manna · męirr aptr á vit,
es lauss Loki · líðr ór bǫndum
4 ok ragna rǫk · rjúfęndr koma.“

[Quoth the wallow:] “Ride home, Weden, and be renowned!
So may no man come again to visit
when, loose, Lock slips out of his bonds,
and at the Rakes of the Reins the rippers come.”

---

1 ok ves hróðigr ‘and be renowned’ | A sarcastic taunt, the sense being: “Your fame, Weden, will not save you!”

4 rjúfęndr ‘rippers’ | Presumably Surt and Lock with his children, as described in *Vsp* 39–40, 48–50. The verb *rjúfa* ‘to break, rip up, break a hole in’ (CV) is used in the same context in the formulaic *(of) rjúfa=sk ręgin* ‘the Reins are ripped’ (*Vafþ* 52/4, *Grm* 4/4, *Lok* 41/2, *Sigrdr* 17/7).

# Speeches of Shirner
# *(Skírnis mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.897)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter; minority: Galders-lay, Speeches-meter

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Shirner** (*Skí*) is a mythological dialogue-poem dealing with Frea's servant Shirner who is sent to get the hand of the beautiful ettin's daughter Gird for his master by any means necessary.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Skí* is preserved in two independent mss.: completely in **R** and partially (P1, 1–27) in **A**. In **R**, the poem is found on foll. 11r/10–12r/29; it there follows *Grm* and is followed by *Hárb*. In **A**, it is found on foll. 2r/11–2v/27; it there follows *Bdr* and is followed by *Vafþ*, although there may originally have been additional poems in-between them.

The prose passages P1–P3, found in both **R** and **A**, indicate that the two manuscripts stem from a common manuscript archetype which may be designated as ***RA**.

The title of *Skí* varies by manuscript: in **A**, it is named *Skírnis-mǫ́l* 'Speeches of Shirner', the name adopted here; in **R**, it is instead called *Fǫr Skírnis* 'Shirner's journey'. This difference suggests that ***RA** did not give a title to the poem.

A version of *Skí* was available to Snorre, who summarises the poem in *Gylf* 37:1–15 and cites st. 42 in variant form. As will be described below, it seems likely that Snorre had access to the full text of *Skí* as it is found in **RA**, including its prose introduction.

### Meter and stanza

*Skí* consists of 178 lines (86 long-lines, 92 full-lines) across 42 stanzas. The meter of the poem is Leeds-meter, with a few lines in Speeches-meter and

some irregular full-lines.

The poetry exclusively represents speech and all narrative development is conveyed in the embedded prose.

The normal Leeds-meter configuration *abc abc* is also the most common (1–9, 11, 13–14, 16–23, 25–26, 33, 36–42); likely defective variants of it are *ab abc* (12) and *abc* (15).

Configurations with consecutive *c*-verses/full-lines (what may be called Galders-lay) are also found, chiefly in Shirner's curse (sts. 26–36). These are *abcc* (32), *abcc abc* (10), *abc abcc* (29), *abc abcc abc* (30), and *abc abc abcc* (35).

In addition there are the unusual configurations *abcx abc* (27, 28) and *abcxx abc* (31), where *x* stands for a verse that, although it takes the place of a normal full-line or *c*-verse, does not behave exactly as a normal type *c*-verse, e.g. by ending in a trochée or by connecting with a previous *c*-verse by alliteration rather than standing on its own.

Two sts. mix Speeches-meter and Leeds-meter according to the configurations *abc* [*ab ab*] (24) and [*ab ab*] *abc* (34), where Speeches-meter is bracketed.

## Origin and motifs

### Parallels

The whole of *Skí* is paraphrased in *Gylf* 37:1–15; for comparative purposes, this part of the chapter is edited in full as an Appendix to this poem. Following *Gylf* 37:15, the text cites a variant form of *Skí* 42. It is of note that the introductory prose passage P1 shares strong verbal similarities with the equivalent part in *Gylf* (37:1–6). In both texts, Frea's servant Shirner is called a *skó-sveinn* 'shoe-swain', and it is said of Frea himself that he *einn dag* 'one day' had *set=sk í* 'sat down in' or *gengit í* 'walked to' *Hliðskjálf ok sá of heima alla* 'the Lithshelf, and was looking out over all the Homes'.

It seems most likely that Snorre, the author of *Gylf*, had access to *Skí* directly (whether in oral or written form), rather than a prose retelling of the story accompanied by a solitary stanza. The best reason for presuming this is that there is no detail in the latter part of Snorre's paraphrase that is not found in the poetic part of *Skí*, whereas there are many elements found in **RA** that are absent from *Gylf*, most notably Shirner's curse. However, *Gylf* 37:1–6, which corresponds to *Skí* P1, has many additional details not found in the latter.

One explanation for these circumstances would be if the version of *Skí* available to Snorre were in the form of oral tradition. This would explain the textual variants in st. 42 and the fact that the narrative variation is greater in the introductory prose (*Gylf* 37:1–6 vs. P1) than in Snorre's retelling of the poem itself (*Gylf* 37:7–14 vs. 3–41); a prose narrative can vary greatly with each retelling, whereas poetry is a bound form and less liable to drastic change.

On the other hand, it is also possible that Snorre chose to expand a pre-existing written prose passage by adding his own details, something likely

done to the prose of *Lok* P8 (see there) and then supplied the stanza with its minor variants based on his own memory, even if he had access to a written form of the poem. An expansion of an earlier written text is supported by the presence of similarities in wording between Snorre's narrative and *Skí* P1, as mentioned above.

The treatment of *Skí* in *Gylf* 37 may conform to a *modus operandi* of Snorre's, for to sum up a narrative mythic poem in prose form and then quote one or two stanzas from it is something likely done elsewhere in *Gylf*; see *Eddbr* below.

**Interpretations**

TODO.

Fertility? Frea gives away his sword for sex (st. 8).

## Text

### The Speeches of Shirner

**P1** Freyr, sonr Njarðar, hafði einn dag set=sk í Hlið-skjǫlf ok sá of heima alla; hann sá í Jǫtun-heima ok sá þar mey fagra, þá er hón gekk frá skála fǫður síns til skemmu; þar af fekk hann hug-sóttir miklar. Skírnir hét skó-sveinn Freys. Njǫrðr bað hann kveðja Frey máls. Þá męlti Skaði: [R 11r/10, A 2r/11]

FREE, son of Nearth, had one day sat down in the Lithshelf, and looked out over all the Homes. He looked into the Ettinhomes and saw there a fair maiden as she walked from her father's hall to her bower; thereof he got great heart-aches. Shirner was the name of Frea's shoe-swain; Nearth asked him to get Frea to speak. Then Shede spoke:

1 Hlið-skjǫlf 'the Lithshelf' | The high lookout-post of the Gods; see note to this word in *Grm* P2.

4 skó-sveinn 'shoe-swain' | A young boy who ties the shoes for his master.

**1** „Rís-tu nú Skírnir · ok gakk at bęiða
okkarn mála mǫg,
ok þęss at fregna · hvęim inn fróði séi
of-rękiði afi.“ [R 11r/14, A 2r/15]

"RISE NOW, SHIRNER, and go to ask
our lad for speech,
and to find out at whom the wise
man might be cross."

1 Rís-tu ... bęiða 'Rise ... beg' | Alliteration is missing here. A simple solution would be to replace *gakk* 'go' with a synonym like *rinn* 'run' or *ráð* 'resolve', but this lessens the semantic mirroring with l. 2/2 below (though the verb *ganga* in the present stanza may in fact be due to influence from 2/2).

4 afi 'man' | While this word usually means 'father' or 'grandfather', it should here mean 'man' without a connotation of old age. See further CV.

Skírnir kvað: **2** „Illra orða · es mér ǫn at ykkrum syni,
ef ek gęng at męla við mǫg,
ok þęss at fregna, · hvęim inn fróði séi
of-rękiði afi.“ [R 11r/15, A 2r/17]

Quoth Shirner: "Ill words I expect from your son
if I go to speak with the lad,

and to find out at whom the wise
man might be cross."

Skírnir: **3** „Seg þat Freyr, · folk-valdi goða, [R 11r/17, A 2r/18]
2 ok ek vilja vita,
hví þú einn sitr · end-langa sali,
4 mínn dróttinn, of daga?"

Shirner: "Tell this, O Frea, troop-wielder of the gods—
I too would wish to know
why thou sittest alone in the endlong halls,
my lord, during the days."

Freyr: **4** „Hví of segja'k þér, · seggr inn ungi, [R 11r/19, A 2r/20]
2 mikinn móð-trega?
Því't alf-rǫðull · lýsir of alla daga
4 ok þey=gi at mínum munum."

Frea: "Why should I tell thee, O young youth,
of my great heartache?
For the Elf-wheel [SUN] shines during all days
and nowise to my liking."

3 alf-rǫðull 'Elf-wheel' | A rare poetic synonym (*heiti*) for the sun; see note to *Vafþ* 47/1.

Skírnir: **5** „Muni þína · hykk=a svá mikla vesa, [R 11r/20, A 2r/21]
2 at þú mér seggr né segir;
ungir saman · vórum í ár-daga,
4 vel méttim tveir trúa=sk."

Shirner: "Thy liking I do not think so great
that thou, O youth, shouldst not tell me.
Young together were we in days of yore;
we two might well trust each other."

2 seggr 'youth' | This word, which usually means simply 'man', here seems to have a specific connotation with daring youth. The sense of 'young man' is also seen in *Vkv* 23 where it is used in reference to king Nithad's two young sons. In the present context it answers Frea's addressing Shirner as *seggr inn ungi* 'the young youth'; Shirner seems to point out that the two are of equal age, and so Frea is as much of a young man as he.

Freyr: **6** „Í Gymis gǫrðum · ek ganga sá [R 11r/22, A 2r/23]
2 mér tíða mey;
armar lýstu, · en af þaðan
4 allt lopt ok lǫgr.

Frea: “In Gymer’s yards I saw walking
a maiden desirable to me.
Her arms shone, but thereof too
all the air and sea.

---

4 lopt ok lǫgr ‘air and sea’ | Formulaic word-pair and very old, also parallelled in OE. TODO.

**7** Mér ’s mér tíðari · an manna hvęim [R 11r/24, A 2r/24]
ungum ǐ ár-daga;
ása ok alfa · þat vill ęngi maðr,
at vit sǫtt séim.“

The maiden is more desirable to me than [a maiden] to any man
young in days of yore.
Of the Eese and Elves does no one wish
that we two should be agreed.”

---

1–2 Mér ... ár-daga ‘The maiden ... of yore.’ | Frea compares his own love to the great loves of earlier ages; his, he says, is far greater than theirs.

3 ęngi maðr ‘no one’ | Lit., ‘no man’, where ‘man’ means ‘person, individual’ and does not imply that the Gods are literally human beings. Cf. note to *Vafþ* 55.

Skírnir: **8** „Mar gef mér þá, · es mik of myrkvan beri [R 11r/25, A 2r/25]
vísan vafr-loga,
ok þat sverð, · es sjalft vegi=sk
við jǫtna ętt.“

Shirner: “Then give me the steed which might bear me o’er the dark,
inevitable wavering flame,
and that sword which by itself might strike
against the race of Ettins.”

---

3 þat sverð ‘that sword’ | This sword appears to have filled greater function in an earlier version of the poem, since according to *Gylf* 37:16 Shirner gave it away, perhaps as a dowry to Gird, and Frea did not get it back (cf. *Vsp* 51/3 and the insult in *Lok* 42). It is notable that Frea, a god especially associated with the erect phallus, trades away his actual sword (a symbol of martial power) for sex.

Freyr: **9** „Mar þér þann gef’k, · es þik of myrkvan berr [R 11r/27, A 2r/27]
vísan vafr-loga,
auk þat sverð, · es sjalft mun vega=sk,
ef sá ’s horskr es hęfr.“

Frea: “I will give thee that steed which bears thee o’er the dark,
inevitable wavering flame,
and that sword which by itself will strike
if he be wise who holds it.”

---

1–4 berr ‘bears’; mun vega=sk, ef sá ’s horskr es hęfr ‘will strike if he be wise who holds it’ | In his response Frea replaces the subjunctive verb forms (*beri* ‘might bear’, *vegi=sk* ‘might strike’) with indicative and future forms, giving a sense of certainty and authority. The steed and sword are faultless, and if Shirner fails on the mission, it would be only due to his own fault (“if he be wise who holds it.”).

**P2** Skírnir męlti við hest’inn:

Shirner spoke with the horse:

**10** „Myrkt es úti, · mál kveð’k okkr fara [R 11r/29, A 2r/28]
úrig fjǫll yfir
þursa þjóð yfir;
báðir vit komum=k · eða okkr báða tękr
sá inn ám-áttki jǫtunn.“

“It is dark outside; I call it time for us to journey
over the drizzling mountains,
over the land of the Thurses.
Either we both make it through or he takes us both,
that uncanny ettin.”

3 þursa ‘of the Thurses’ | *so* **A**; ‘þyria’ **R**

ALL | Shirner expresses his resolute loyalty to Frea. He will not abandon the horse given to him by his lord; either they both make it or both perish.

5 ám-áttki jǫtunn ‘uncanny ettin’ | Formulaic; the adjective *ám-áttigr* ‘uncanny’ is used exclusively for evil supernatural beings. See note to *Vsp* 8.

**P3** Skírnir reið i Jǫtun-heima til Gymis garða; þar vǫ́ru hundar [R 11r/31, A 2v/1]
ólmir ok bundnir fyrir skíð-garðs-hliði þess, er um sal Gerðar var. Hann reið at þar, er fé-hirðir sat á haugi, ok kvaddi hann:

Shirner rode into the Ettinhomes toward Gymer’s yards. Thereat there were fierce hounds bound in front of the gate of the paled fence which surrounded Gird’s hall. He rode up to where a shepherd sat on a mound and greeted him:

2 Gerðar ‘Gird’ | It is only now that we find out the maiden’s name.

**11** „Sęg þat hirðir, · es á haugi sitr [R 11v/2, A 2v/4]
ok varðar alla vega:
hvé ek at and-spilli · kom=umk hins unga mans
fyr grę̨yjum Gymis.“

"Tell this, O herdsman who sittest on the mound
and watchest all the ways,
how to discourse I might come with the young girl
past Gymer's greyhounds."

---

1 á haugi sitr 'who sittest on the mound' | For this motif cf. *Vsp* 41/1 n.

[Hirðir] kvað: **12** „Hvárt est fęigr, · eða est framm ginginn [R 11v/4, A 2v/5]
2 [...];
and-spillis vanr · þú skalt ę vesa
4 góðrar męyjar Gymis."

Quoth [the herdsman]: "Regardless of whether thou art fey or passed-on,
[...]
discourseless shalt thou for ever be
with Gymer's good maiden!"

---

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in the mss. but it is certain that a c-line is missing here, probably containing a vocative 'O stranger', or similar.

4 góðrar męyjar 'good maiden' | Formulaic, carrying with it a sense of chastity. See note to *Háv* 102/1 for further occurrences.

[Skírnir] kvað: **13** „Kostir 'ro bętri · an kløkkva séi [R 11v/6, A 2v/7]
2 hvęim es fúss es fara,
ęinu dógri · mér vas aldr of skapaðr
4 ok alt líf of lagit."

Quoth [Shirner]: "Choices are better than sobbing might
for whomever is eager to journey.
In one half-day my age was shaped,
and all my life laid down."

---

1 an 'than' | *so* **A**; hęldr an at *'rather than to* [*be*]*'* **R**

---

ALL | An excellent formulation of the Old Germanic fatalistic world-view. After uttering these words Shirner rides through the fire surrounding the fortress.

1 Kostir 'Choices' | I.e., 'alternatives, other ways'.

3 ęinu dógri · mér vas aldr of skapaðr 'In one half-day my age was shaped' | Formulaic. The single half-day is both the time of one's birth when the norns or dises arrive (cf. *1 HHund* 1–4 and *Hákm* 19/1–2: *Góðu dógri · verðr sá gramr of borinn, / es sér getr s·líkan sefa* 'On a good half-day will that lord be born who gets for himself such heart') and the fixed time of one's inevitable death (*Gríp* 25/4). For the norns shaping one's age (ON *(of) skapa aldr*) cf. *1 HHund* 2/2 and *Gylf* 15:30: *Enn eru fleiri nornir, þér er koma til hvers barns, er borit er, at skapa aldr* 'There are yet more norns, those which come to every child which is born to shape its age'; for the use of the verb shape in this context cf. also *Reg* 2/3, 6/3, *Sigsk* 7/3.

4 alt lif of lagit ‘all my life laid down’ | The causative *leggja* ‘to lay (down, in place)’ is closely connected to fate; the expression is formulaic. Cf. *Lok* 48: *í ár-daga vas þér hit ljóta líf of lagit* ‘in days of yore was thy ugly life laid down’ and *Vsp* 19: *þǽr lǫg lǫgðu* ‘they [= the Norns] laid down laws’.

[Gęrðr] kvað: **14** „Hvat ’s þat hlym hlymja · es hlymja hęyri’k nú til [R 11v/7, A 2v/8]
ossum rǫnnum ï?
jǫrð bifa=sk, · ęn allir fyr
skjalfa garðar Gymis.“

Quoth [Gird]: “What is this din of dins which I now hear dinning
in our houses?
The earth trembles, but before us all
Gymer’s yards do quake.”

Ambǫ́tt kvað: **15** „Maðr ’s hér úti, · stiginn af mars baki, [R 11v/9, A 2v/10]
jó lętr til jarðar taka.“

The maid-servant: “A man is here without, stepped down off horse-back;
he lets his steed graze the earth.”

---

2 jó lętr til jarðar taka ‘he lets his steed graze the earth’ | Lit. ‘he lets his steed take to the earth’. According to Finnur Jónsson (1932) this expression is still used in modern Icelandic.

[Gęrðr] kvað: **16** „Inn bið hann ganga · ï okkarn sal [R 11v/10, A 2v/11]
ok drekka inn męra mjǫ́ð,
þó ek hitt ó=umk, · at hér úti séi
mïnn bróður-bani.“

Quoth [Gird]: “Bid him go into our hall
and drink the renowned mead;
though I fear that here outside might be
my brother’s bane.”

[Gęrðr] kvað: **17** „Hvat ’s þat alfa · né ása sona, [R 11v/12, A 2v/13]
né víssa vana;
hví ęinn of komt · ęikinn fúr yfir
ór sal-kynni at séa?“

[Quoth Gird:] “Which one of the Elves is this; not of sons of the Eese,
nor of the wise Wanes?
Why camest thou alone o’er the raging fire,
to see the state of our hall?”

---

ALL | Gird addresses Shirner and asks him about his origin. She can tell that he is not a god, and so asks him what he is, apparently thinking him an elf.

[Skírnir kvað:] **18** „Em'k=at alfa · né ása sona [R 11v/14]
né víssa vana,
þó ęinn of kom'k · ęikinn fúr yfir
yður sal-kynni at séa.

[Quoth Shirner:] "I am not of Elves, nor of sons of the Eese,
nor of wise Wanes—
though I came alone o'er the raging fire,
to see the state of your hall.

**19** Ępli ęllifu · hér hef'k al-gollin, [R 11v/15, A 2v/14]
þau mun'k þér Gęrðr gefa,
frið at kaupa, · at þú þér Fręy kveðir
ò·lęiðastan at lifa."

Eleven apples have I here, all-golden;
them will I to thee, Gird, give
to buy thy love, that thou mightst call Frea
the most unloathsome [beloved] in thy life."

---

ALL | Shirner begins his coercion of Gird, which takes up sts. 19–36. Shirner first offers Gird gold (sts. 19–22), then threatens her with violence (23–25) and finally curses her with a long spell (26–36), which breaks her.
It has been noted by Brate (1913) that the structure of this passage bears some resemblance to Weden's seduction of Wrind in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 3.4.1–8. In Weden's seduction of Wrind he disguises himself first as a warrior, then as a gold-smith, then again as a warrior but is spurned each time. Finally he makes himself out to be a witch, and having tied Wrind down, proceeds to rape her (cf. *Vsp* 31 n.) If the first disguise is omitted, we see in both texts a three-fold progression consisting of giving gold, using force of arms, and at last employing magic.

1 Ępli ęllifu 'Eleven apples' | Probably the apples of Idin, which grant perpetual youth to the Gods. So *Gylf* 26:7: *Hon varð-veitir í eski sínu epli þau, er goð'in skulu á bíta, þá er þau elda=sk, ok verða þá allir ungir, ok svá mun vera allt til ragna-røkrs.* 'She keeps in her casket the apples which the Gods should bite into when they age, and then they all grow young, and so it will be all until the Twilight of the Reins'. Idin's apples and the theft thereof are dealt with in *Skm* 2–3 and *Haustl* 1–13. It is not clear whether Shirner actually has the apples in his possession or whether he is merely making a big promise.

4 at lifa 'in thy life' | *at lifa* here seems to mean 'in life/living' rather than the typical infinitive sense 'to live'; cf. st. 22 *at dęila* 'in sharing' below. This may be an archaism.

[Gęrðr] kvað: **20** „Ępli ęllifu · ek þigg aldri=gi [R 11v/17, A 2v/15]
at manns-kis munum,
né vit Fręyr, · meðan okkart fjǫr lifir,
byggjum bęði saman."

[Quoth Gird:] “Eleven apples will I never take
to any man’s liking,
nor will I and Frea—while our life remains—
dwell both together.”

[Skírnir kvað:] **21** „Baug þér þá gef’k, · þann’s brǫnndr vas [R 11v/19, A 2v/17]
2 með ungum Óðins syni;
átta ’ro jafn-hǫfgir, · es af drjúpa
4 hina níundu hverja nótt.“

[Quoth Shirner:] “The bigh I then give thee, which was burned
with Weden’s young son [= Balder].
Eight even-heavy ones do drip thereof
every ninth night.”

3–4 átta ... nótt ‘Eight ... night.’ | *om. (by parablepsis)* **A**

1 Baug ‘The bigh’ | Bigh, meaning ‘armlet’ or ‘ring’. While not named, the bigh is clearly Dreepner. It is known from *Gylf* 49:54, which describes Balder’s funeral and probably draws on the present stanza: *Óðinn lagði á bál’it gull-bring þann, er Draupnir heitir. Hónum fylgði sú náttúra, at ina níundu hverja nótt drupu af hónum átta gull-bringar jafn-hǫfgir.* ‘Weden laid on the pyre that gold ring which is called Dreepner. Its nature was such that every ninth night eight even-heavy golden rings dripped from it.’ The Eese later regained the bigh, which is presumably why Shirner can promise to give it. *Gylf* 49:73–74 tells us that when the god Harmod rode to Hell in order to try to bring Balder back, Balder gave Harmod the bigh and told him to bring it back to Weden, their father, as a keepsake.

[Gerðr] kvað: **22** „Baug þikk=a’k, · þó’tt brǫnndr séi, [R 11v/21, A 2v/18]
2 með ungum Óðins syni;
es=a mér golls vant · í gǫrðum Gymis
4 at dǫila fé fǫðgur.“

[Quoth Gird:] “The bigh I will not take although it may have been burned
with Weden’s young son [= Balder].
I have no want of gold in Gymer’s yards,
sharing the wealth of my father.”

1–2 Baug ... syni ‘The bigh ... son’ | *om. (by parablepsis)* **A**

[Skírnir kvað:] **23** „Sér þú mǫ́ki, mér, · mjóvan, mál-fáan, [R 11v/23, A 2v/19]
2 es hǫf’k í hǫndi hér?
hǫfuð hǫggva · mun’k þér halsi af,
4 nema mér sǫ́tt sǫgir.“

[Quoth Shirner:] “Seest thou the sword, maiden—slender, picture-painted—
which I have here in my hand?

I will cut the head from off thy neck
unless thou agree with me!”

---

1 mękiask ... mál-fáan ‘sword ... picture-painted’ | The sword is inlaid with metal (perhaps gold or silver) forming a pattern; this may also be a reference to a damascened blade. The expression *mękiask mál-fáan* (acc. sg.) ‘picture-painted sword’ also occurs in *Sigsk* 4/2.

[Gęrðr kvað:] **24** „Á·nauð þola · vil’k aldri≠gi [R 11v/25, A 2v/20]
2 at manns-kis munum,
þó hins get’k, · ef it Gymir finnið≠sk
4 vígs ó·trauðir · at ykkr vega tíði.“

[Quoth Gird:] “Sexual coercion will I never stand
to any man’s liking,
though I still know that if thou and Gymer meet—
men unreluctant of conflict—ye will desire to fight.”

---

2 manns-kis ‘any man’s (lit. ‘no man’s)’ | manns ęnskis **A**

---

3 þó ‘although’ | The interpretation of this word changes the tone of the stanza. If it means ‘although, even though’ then Gird is expressing her fear of violence between Shirner and her father, i.e., “I will not give in, even if it should lead to violence, as I fear”. If, on the other hand, it means ‘still, yet’, she may be expressing pride, i.e., “I will not give in, and what is more, my father will be eager to fight thee”. I find the former understanding more natural.

[Skírnir kvað:] **25** „Sér þú mękiask, męr, · mjóvan, mál-fáan, [R 11v/27, A 2v/22]
2 es hęf’k í hęndi hér?
fyr þęssum ęggjum · hnígr sá inn aldni jǫtunn,
4 verðr þinn fęigr faðir.

[Quoth Shirner:] “Seest thou the sword, maiden—slender, picture-painted—
which I have here in my hand?
By these edges will that olden ettin sink down;
fey becomes thy father!

**26** Tams-vęndi þik drep’k, · ęn ek þik tęmja mun, [R 11v/28, A 2v/24]
2 męr, at mínum munum,
þar skalt ganga · es þik gumna synir
4 síðan ęva séi.

With the taming-wand I strike thee, but I will tame thee,
maiden, to my liking!
Thou shalt go whither the sons of men
never since will see thee!

---

ALL | With this stanza Shirner's turns away from his direct threats of violence and begins his long curse (sts. 26–36). He curses Gird to be loveless, joyless, captive, and the subject of sexual abuse at the hands of loathsome ettins if she does not give in to his demands.

1 Tams-vęndi 'taming-wand' | Probably a cane or whip, perhaps of a magical nature. The imagery is uncomfortably sexual, and Shirner threatens to 'tame' Gird like an animal.

**27** [R 11v/30, A 2v/26]

Ara þúfu à · skalt ár sitja,
horfa hęimi ór;
snugga hęljar til;
matr séi þér męir lęiðr · an manna hvęim
inn fràni ormr með firum.

On an eagle's perch shalt thou sit for long,
turn away from the world,
hanker after Hell!
Be the food more loathsome to thee than to any man
the gleaming Wyrm among folk.

1 Ara þúfu à · skalt ár sitja 'On an eagle's perch shalt thou sit for long' | ár skalt sitja · ara þúfu à *'for long shalt thou sit on an eagle's perch'* **A** 2–3 horfa hęimi ór; / snugga hęljar til 'turn away from the world, / hanker after Hell' | horfa ok snugga hęljar til *'turn and hanker after Hell'* **A** 2 ór | *add. in marg.* **R** 5 firum | *The last word on* **A** *2v, after which the text cuts off; apart from the very last stanza, the rest of the poem is preserved only in* **R**.

ALL | Shirner threatens Gird with captivity on a high mountain. The structure of sts. 27 and 28 is identical; both feature a direct threat in ll. 1–3 followed by a mythological hyperbole in ll. 5–6.

2–3 horfa hęimi ór; / snugga hęljar til 'turn away from the world, / hanker after Hell' | On the mountain-perch Gird will be able to see both Earth and the Underworld, but her situation will be so miserable that she will turn her face away from the former and long for her own death.

4–5 matr ... firum 'Be ... folk.' | Gird's disgust over her food will be greater than the hatred of the Middenyardswyrm among mankind, which is understood to be extreme. For this hatred cf. *Hym* 22.

**28** [R 11v/32]

At undr-sjónum verðir · es þú út kømr,
à þik Hrímnir hari
à þik hot-vetna stari,
víð-kunnari verðir · an vǫrðr með goðum,
gapi þú grindum frà.

A wondrous sight mayest thou be when thou comest out;
at thee may Rimner ogle;
at thee may anyone stare!
Mayest thou be more widely known than the watchman with the Gods;
mayest thou gape from the gates.

2 Hrímnir ‘Rimner’ | An unknown ettin whose name derives from *hrím* ‘rime ice’; he is one the many who will jeer at Gird.

4 vǫrðr með goðum ‘the watchman with the Gods’ | Homedall, who guards Bivrest from the ettins; cf. *Gylf* 27:8 (edited under *Eddbr* III). The poetic epithet is also found in *Grm* 13/3 and *Lok* 48/4.

**29** Tópi ok ópi, · tjǫsull ok ǫ·þoli, [R 12r/2]
vaxi þér tǫr með trega;
sęt=sk þú niðr · ęn mun'k sęgja þér
sváran sús-breka,
ok tvinnan trega.

Toop and woop, tarsle and restlessness—
may thy tears grow with grief!
Sit thee down, but I will tell thee
a hard roaring-breaker
and a twined grief.

1 Tópi ok ópi, · tjǫsull ‘Toop and woop, tarsle’ | Otherwise unknown magic curse words without clear meaning; I have left them untranslated. *ópi* resembles *óp* ‘scream’, and *tjǫsull* ‘tarsle’ may perhaps be related to OE *teors* ‘penis’ and mean ‘little phallus’.

4 sváran sús-breka ‘hard roaring-breaker’ | Unclear. A curse that will hit Gird like a breaking wave (*breki*)?

**30** Tramar gnęypa · þik skulu gęrstan dag [R 12r/3]
jǫtna gǫrðum í,
til hrím-þursa hallar · þú skalt hvęrjan dag
kranga kosta-laus;
kranga kosta-vǫn;
grát at gamni · skalt í gǫgn hafa
ok lęiða með tǫrum trega.

Fiends shall pine thee on a dismal day
in the yards of the Ettins.
To the hall of Rime-Thurses shalt thou every day
crawl choice-less,
crawl choice-lacking.
Weeping shalt thou have in exchange for joy,
and nurse thy grief with tears.

1 Tramar ‘Fiends’ | TODO: reference ordsifjabók.

**31** Með þursi þrí-hǫfðuðum · þú skalt ę nara [R 12r/7]
eða ver-laus vesa;

þitt gęð grípi,
4 þik morn morni;
ves þú sem þistill, · sá's þrunginn vas
6 í ofan-verða ǫnn.

With a three-headed thurse shalt thou always live
or be husband-less.
May thy senses seize;
may murrain mourn thee!
Be thou like the thistle which was pressed
during highest harvest!

---

1 þursi þrí-hǫfðuðum 'three-headed thurse' | Ettins often have an abnormal number of body parts. For their many-headed-ness see note to *Hym* 8/2.

5–6 ves ... ǫnn 'Be ... harvest' | The thistle was considered a weed; cf. the Old English galder against a cattle-thief ("For Theft of Cattle" under Galders) cursing him to be *swá bréðel … swá þystel* 'as useless as the thistle'. The 'pressing' of the thistle has been connected with an Estonian folk-ritual wherein a thistle would be crushed by stones at the beginning of harvest to prevent further weeds (TODO: reference).

**32** Til holts ek gekk · ok til hrás viðar [R 12r/9]
2 gamban-tęin at geta
gamban-tęin ek gat.

To the grove I went and to the sappy tree,
the gombentoe for to get;
the gombentoe I got.

---

1 til hrás viðar 'to the sappy tree' | The wood of a sapling was apparently thought to be the most effective for magic; cf. *Háv* 152, which speaks about a runic curse carved on *rótum rás viðar* 'the roots of a sappy tree'.

2 gamban-tęin 'gomben-toe' | Perhaps 'mighty twig', also found in *Hárb* 20/4. The word is a cpd. of the very rare prefix *gamban-* 'magic/curse?' (cf. *Lok* 8/4 n.) and *tęinn* 'twig, branch' (cf. *mistil-tęinn* 'mistle-toe'). This may be the stick on which the runic curse in st. 36 below should be carved, or it is to be identified with the *tams-vǫndr* 'taming-wand' of st. 26 above. *Hárb* 21 suggests that it is an object of some value.

**33** Ręiðr 's þér Óðinn, · ręiðr 's þér Ásа-bragr, [R 12r/10]
2 þik skal Freyr fia=sk,
hin firin-illa mér, · ęn fingit hęfr
4 gamban-ręiði goða.

Wroth with thee is Weden; wroth with thee is Eesebray ⟨= Thunder⟩;
thee shall Frea come to hate,
O wickedly evil maiden, if thou hast earned
the gomben-wrath of the gods.

---

1 Àsa-bragr ‘Eesebray’ | ‘The pinnacle of the Eese’, Thunder.

**34** Hęyri jǫtnar, · hęyri hrím-þursar, [R 12r/12]
synir Suttunga, · sjalfir ǫs-liðar,
hvé ek fyrir býð, · hvé ek fyrir banna
manna glaum mani,
manna nyt mani.

Hear may Ettins, hear may Rime-Thurses,
sons of Sutting [ETTINS], even the Eese-folk,
how I forbid, how I forban
men’s fellowship from the maid,
men’s joy from the maid!

**35** Hrím-grimnir hęitir þurs, · es þik hafa skal [R 12r/14]
fyr Ná-grindr neðan,
þar þér víl-męgir · á viðar rótum
gęita-hland gefi;
óðri drykkju · fá þú aldri=gi,
męr, af þínum munum,
męr, at mínum munum.

Rimegrimner is the name of the thurse who shall have thee
down beneath Neegrind,
where lads of toil [THRALLS] on the roots of a tree
goat-piss will give thee.
Never fetch a finer drink,
O maiden, against thy liking,
O maiden, to *my* liking!

**36** Þurs ríst’k þér · ok þría stafi, [R 12r/16]
ęrgi ok óði ok ǫ·þola,
svá ek þat af ríst · sem ek þat á ręist,
ef gøra=sk þarfar þęss.“

Thurse I carve for thee, and three staves:
queerness and madness and restlessness.
So will I carve it *off* like I carved it *on*,
if there arise need for that.”

---

ALL | With the carving of the rune-stick Shirner threatens to fulfill the curse predicted in sts. 26–35. He hints to Gird that he will scrape the runes off and nullify if she will accept his demands.

1 Þurs ‘thurse’ | Thurse is the name of the **þ**-rune (ᚦ); it is carved as part of the curse.

1 þría stafi ‘three staves’ | Three runic letters (or phrases) representing the three following words (*ęrgi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’ etc.). The magic notion of carving “three staves” is also found on the C7th Gummarp stone: **haþuwolafr sate staba þria fff** ‘Hathwolf placed three staves: fff’, where the **f**-rune (ᚠ) stands for its name **feh* (> ON *fé* ‘wealth, cattle’) and is thus meant to bring wealth.

2 ęrgi ok óði ok ó·þola ‘queerness and madness and restlessness’ | Both *ęrgi* ‘queerness, degeneracy’ and *ó·þoli* ‘restlessness’ (here probably from strong lust) are found in the love magic charm on the rune stick B257 from Bryggen (edited below under Galders). *ęrgi* is also found in the curse-formula on the C7th Proto-Norse runestones from Stentoften and Björketorp. See further introduction to B257.

[Gęrðr kvað:] **37** „Hęill ves þú hęldr, svęinn, · ok tak við hrím-kalki [R 12r/19]
2 fullum forns mjaðar,
þó hafða’k ętlat, · at mynda’k aldri=gi
4 unna vaningja vęl.“

[Quoth Gird:] “Hale be thou rather, swain, and receive the rime-chalice,
full of ancient mead,
although I had intended that I never would
love the Waning [= Frea] well.”

---

1–2 Hęill … mjaðar ‘Hale … mead’ | Formulaic; repeated identically in *Lok* 53/1–2.

1 hrím-kalki ‘rime-chalice’ | Some kind of expensive glazed drinking vessel; the second element *kalkr* ‘chalice’ is a borrowing from Latin *calix* and suggests a Roman origin. Cf. the *kalkr* in *Hym* 28/4b.

4 vaningja ‘the Waning [= Frea]’ | The ‘descendant of the Wanes’. A rare word. Its only other occurrence in the Norse corpus is in a thule of boar-names. Boars were sacred to Frea, TODO.

[Skírnir kvað:] **38** „Ęyręndi mǐn · vil’k ǫll vita, [R 12r/21]
2 áðr ríða’k hęim heðan,
nęr à þingi · munt inum þroska
4 nęnna Njarðar syni?“

[Quoth Shirner:] “My errands all I wish to know
before I ride home hence:
when on the Thing wilt thou to the virile
son of Nearth [= Frea] submit?”

[Gęrðr kvað:] **39** „Barri hęitir, · es vit bǽði vitum, [R 12r/23]
2 lundr logn-fara,
ęn ępt nętr níu, · þar mun Njarðar syni
4 Gęrðr unna gamans.“

[Quoth Gird:] “Barrey is the name—as we both do know—
of a grove of calm breezes,
and after nine nights there will to the son of Nearth
Gird her pleasure grant.”

1 Barri 'Barrey' | Derived from *barr* 'leaf, foliage', perhaps a reference to a cornfield (of wheat or barley, not maize!) which would fit in an interpretation of the poem as an analogy for agricultural fertility.

2 logn-fara 'calm breezes' | A *hapax* compound, here read as a gen. pl. of *logn* n. 'calm (wind)' + *far* 'trail, passage', i.e., 'where one travels calmly'. Another interpretation is a gen. sg. of an unattested proper noun *Logn-fari* 'Calm-farer', 'the one who causes calm winds' (cf. *Mundil-fari* in *Vafþ* 23), probably a name for Frea in his role as a fertility god.

**P4** Þá reið Skírnir heim. Freyr stóð úti ok kvaddi hann ok spurði [R 12r/24]
2 tíðenda:

Then Shirner rode home. Frea stood outside and greeted him and asked for the tidings:

**40** „Sęg mér, Skírnir, · áðr verpir sǫðli af mar [R 12r/25]
2 ok stígir feti framarr,
hvat þú árnaðir · í Jǫtun-hęima
4 þíns eða mínns munar?“

"Tell me, Shirner, before thou mightst throw the saddle off the steed
and take a step further,
what thou accomplished in the Ettinhomes
to thy or my liking?"

2 ok stígir feti framarr 'and take a step further' | Formulaic; a variant of *feti ganga/gangir framarr* (*Háv* 38/2, *Lok* 1/2).

[Skírnir kvað:] **41** „Barri hęitir, · es vit báðir vitum, [R 12r/27]
2 lundr logn-fara,
ęn ępt nętr níu, · þar mun Njarðar syni
4 Gęrðr unna gamans.“

[Quoth Shirner:] "Barrey is the name—as we both do know—
of a grove of calm breezes,
and after nine nights there will to the son of Nearth
Gird her pleasure grant."

ALL | *Abbrev.* 'Barri. h. l. er. vi. l. l. e. e. n. n. þ. m. n. s. g. u. gamans' **R**.

[Fręyr kvað:] **42** „Lǫng es nótt, · langar 'ro tvér, [R 12r/28, S 9r/32, T 9v/35 W 12r/25]
2 hvé of þręyja'k þríar?
opt mér mánaðr · minni þótti
4 an sjá hǫlf hý-nótt.“

[Quoth Frea:] "Long is a night, long are two—
how can I yearn for three?
Oft a month to me seemed less
than this half wedding-night!"

---

1 langar 'ro tvęr 'long are two' | lǫng es ǫnnur *'long is another'* **G** 2 hvé of þręyja'k þríar? | hvé męga'k þręyja þríar **G**

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ALL | This stanza is cited following *Gylf* 37:15; see the Appendix to the poem below. Note that **U**'s form of *Gylf* 37, being heavily abbreviated, omits this stanza.

4 hǫlf hý-nǫ́tt 'half wedding-night' | *hý-nǫ́tt* is a hapax cpd. of *hý-* + *nǫ́tt* 'night'. *hý-* has been variously explained, e.g. as a form of the demonstrative pronoun stem PGmc. **hiz*, but is most likely the same prefix found in words like *hý-býli* 'farmstead'. It is equivalent to Gothic *heiwa-* 'marriage, household', OHG *hí-* 'marriage', and the dual preserved in ON *hjón* 'married couple, household'. For the root cf. Kroonen (2013, p. 227). On the basis of the first element, the most likely sense of the cpd. is 'wedding-night', more specifically referring the consummation of the marriage. The word *hǫlf* 'half', then, should probably be taken not as a measurement of time (like 'half a night'), but rather as 'incomplete' or 'divided' (cf. e.g. *Háv* 53/4). The wedding-night may be called 'incomplete', for, although Frea and Gird are now betrothed, they are still separated; each is 'half'.

## Appendix

### *Gylf* 37:1–15

NOTE: The following excerpt has not yet been critically edited.

*Gylf* 37:1–7 corresponds to *Skí* P1, sts. 1–2 and 37:8–13 paraphrases sts. 3–9. The rest of the poem is summed up very succinctly by 37:14–15, following which the text cites a variant of st. 42.

The remainder of the chapter (37:16–19), not edited here, deals with Frea's lack of his sword. This part is cited in *Vsp* 51/3 (n.). Cf. also st. 8 above and *Lok* 42.

[1]Gymir hét maðr, en kona hans Aur·boða. Hón var berg-risa
2 ęttar. [2]Dóttir þeira er Gerðr, er allra kvinna var fegrst. [3]Þat var
einn dag, at Freyr hafði gengit í Hlið-skjálf ok sá of heima alla.
4 [4]En er hann leit í norðr-ętt, þá sá hann á einum bó mikit hús ok
fagrt, ok til þess húss gekk kona, [5]ok er hón tók upp hǫndum
6 ok lauk hurð fyrir sér, þá lýsti af hǫndum hennar bęði í lopt ok á
lǫg, ok allir heimar birtusk af henni. [6]Ok svá hefnði hónum þat
8 mikla mikil-lęti, er hann hafði setsk í þat it helga sęti, at hann
gekk í braut fullr af harmi. [7]Ok er hann kom heim, męlti hann
10 ekki. Ekki svaf hann, ekki drakk hann. Engi þorði ok at krefja
hann orða.

[1]Gymer was the name of a man, and his woman was Earbode; she was of the lineage of barrow-risers. [2]Their daughter is Gird who was fairest of all

women. [3]It was one day when Frea had gone to the Lithshelf and looked out over all the Homes. [4]But when he looked north he saw on a farm a large and fair house, and to that house walked a woman, [5]and when she raised her hands and closed the doors behind her then it shone from her hands into both the air and the waters, and all the homes were brightened by her. [6]And so greatly did the greatness which he had beheld in the holy seat harm him that he walked away filled with grief, [7]and when he came home he said nothing. He slept nothing; he drank nothing. No one dared to get words out of him.

[8]Þá lét Njǫrðr kalla til sín Skírni, skó-svein Freys, ok bað hann ganga til Freys ok beiða hann orða ok spyrja, hverjum hann vǫri svá reiðr, at hann mélti ekki við menn. [9]En Skírnir létsk ganga mundu ok eigi fúss ok kvað illra svara vera ván af honum. [10]En er hann kom til Freys, þá spurði hann, hví Freyr var svá hnipinn ok mélti ekki við menn. [11]Þá svarar Freyr ok sagði, at hann hefði sét konu fagra ok fyrir hennar sakir var hann svá harm-fullr, at eigi myndi hann lengi lifa, ef hann skyldi eigi ná henni, [12]„ok nú skaltu fara ok biðja hennar mér til handa ok hafa hana heim hingat, hvárt er faðir hennar vill eða eigi, ok skal ek þat vel launa þér.“ [13]Þá svarar Skírnir, sagði svá, at hann skal fara sendi-ferð, en Freyr skal fá honum sverð sitt. Þat var svá gott sverð, at sjálft vást. En Freyr lét eigi þat til skorta ok gaf honum sverðit.

[8]Then Nearth had Shirner, Frea's shoe-swain, summoned before him and asked him to go to Frea and bid him to speak and ask at whom he was so wroth that he would not speak with men. [9]And Shirner said that he would go, although not eagerly, and said that he expected ill answers from him. [10]And when he came to Frea he asked why Frea was so downcast and spoke nothing with men. [11]Then Frea answers, and said that he had seen a fair woman and for her sakes was he so full of grief that he would not live long if he should not reach her, [12]"and now shalt thou journey to ask for her hand on my behalf, and bring her home hither whether her father wants to or not, and I shall reward thee well for that." [13]Then Shirner answers; said so, that he will go on the errand-journey, but Frea shall give him his sword; it was such a good sword that it struck by itself. And Frea did not deny him that and gave him the sword.

[14]Þá fór Skírnir ok bað honum konu'nnar ok fekk heit hennar, ok níu nóttum síðar skyldi hon þar koma, er Barrey heitir, ok ganga þá at brul-laupinu með Frey. [15]En er Skírnir sagði Frey sitt erindi, þá kvað hann þetta: [...]

[14]Then Shirner journeyed and asked for the woman's hand for him [Frea] and got her promise that nine nights later she would come to that place which is called Barrey and have a wedding with Frea. [15]And when Shirner told Frea his errand then he quoth this: [...]

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4 [...] | Here the text cites its own variant of st. 42; see there for critical notes.

# Leeds of Hoarbeard
# *(Hár·barðs ljóð)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.578)–late C11th (0.377)
**Meter:** Varied

## Introduction

The **Leeds of Hoarbeard** (*Hárb*) is a mythological narrative poem consisting of a dialogue between the two mythological figures Thunder and Hoarbeard.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hárb* is preserved in two manuscripts: in full (sts. 1–60) in **R**, and partially (sts. 19/4b–60) in **A**. In **R**, the poem is found on foll. 12r/30–13v/26, where it follows *Skí* and precedes *Hym*. In **A**, it is found on foll. 1r/1–1v/17, where it is the first preserved poem and is followed by *Bdr*.

The closeness of the two versions and the probable existence of scribal errors (see esp. st. 30) suggest that the *Hárb* in **R** and **A** goes back to a shared manuscript archetype which may be termed *__RA__.

### Origin and motifs

*Hárb* is a dialogue between two mythological figures: the god Thunder (*Þórr*) and the mysterious Hoarbeard (*Hár·barðr*, i.e., 'grey-beard'). The two meet at a sound and Thunder, the traveller, asks Hoarbeard, the ferryman, for passage; an argument ensues, and Thunder is finally forced to depart disgraced and without passage.

#### Characters

Thunder is of course the well-known god, but Hoarbeard merits discussion. Considering his name, which appears in *Grm* 51 as a name for Weden, and his generally Odinic character (cf. esp. st. 24), he is near-universally considered to be the god Weden in disguise.

The difference in personality between the two gods is striking, and *Hárb* does not take the character of a "flyting" contest between two warriors of equal stature (contrast *1 HHund* 32–46). Throughout the poem, Thunder is portrayed as moral and altruistic, but also as rather naive and the foil for Hoarbeard's insults. On the other hand, Hoarbeard is egoistic and sly. He is the first to insult Thunder, and gets the last laugh by denying him passage.

The poem may be seen as an allegory on class relations, namely between the self-owning yeomen farmers and the warlike earls, represented by their patron gods. TODO.

**Humour and satire**

*Hárb* stands out from the six preceding poems in **R** (*Vsp–Skí*, and particularly the first five) in its humorous and irreverent tone towards the gods. This lighter tone is further shared with *Lok* and, to a somewhat lesser degree, with *Þrk* and *Hym*. Since *Hárb* is the first such "irreverent" poem, it is reasonable to deal with the phenomenon here.

It has to be emphasised that irreverence and humour in themselves are a sign neither of Christian influence nor of a weakening or degradation of the pre-Christian religion. To begin with, it must be stated that the tone never crosses into direct blasphemy. All insults towards gods are uttered either by the Gods themselves or by their enemies, and not directly by the poet. Nor does the poet himself denounce the gods or call them false or dæmonic; on the contrary, there are respectful and even reverent statements about or attributed to the gods in all four poems mentioned above (e.g., *Hárb* 23, 47, *Hym* 21–24, 36, *Lok* 55, 57, 59, 61, 63, *Þrk* 21, 31–32).

Furthermore, light-hearted treatment of the Gods in mythology is by no means unique to the late Germanic religion of the Wiking Age. An example is found in Homer's *Il* 21.385–440, 458–513, where several gods and goddesses are humorously described as fighting with their fists over the fate of the Trojans. A less extreme example is found in *ṚV* 10.119, where the God *Índra*, madly drunk on *sṓma*, boasts about his own greatness.

In the case of both the Norse and the Greeks, the most likely explanation for this treatment is that the texts we are dealing with are chiefly mythological, a narrative genre where the Gods are depicted in situations that are often absurd and at times plainly immoral. They are not hymns nor documents of cultic Law, genres in which both the Gods and the Godly in general are treated with great reverence, and which, although not well-represented in Old Norse literature, can still be shown to have existed (cf. Läffler 1895, Lindow 1988, Ruthström (1990), Nordberg 2005).

In Paganism (unlike Judeo-Christianity, which does away almost entirely with mythology as such), it is apparent that these supposedly irreverent descriptions were generally not felt to damage the credibility or ritual efficacy of the Gods, and that mythology not only could coexist with ritual and Law, but also justify and underpin it (cf. *Vsp* 3–7, *Grm* 41–43, *Hym* 39). That the light-hearted poems themselves are not Christian is certain; several of them have archaic linguistic features (cf., e.g., *Hym* 23/1, 28/2, *Lok* 15/3, 18/4, 27/4,

*Þrk* 1/1), and they assume an intimate familiarity with the nature and character of the various gods and the religion as a whole.

## Meter and stanza

Of all Eddic poems, *Hárb* is certainly the strangest in terms of form. It consists of 149 lines divided across 60 "stanzas", some of which consist merely of single unmetrical prose lines. No narrative prose is embedded apart from P1 at the very beginning, which sets the stage for the rest of the poem.

Stanza length varies greatly. 4 lines is by no means the standard; in fact, only a single fully regular Leeds-meter-stanza of type *abc abc* occurs, viz. st. 47. TODO.

The meter itself is an irregular mix of Leeds-meter and a peripheral form of Speeches-meter. Many lines contain an unusually high number of unstressed syllables (e.g., 4/3b, 56/5a, 59/1–2); others have no discernable metrical qualities at all (17/1, 31/1, 41/1, 44–46, 57/1, 60/1).

## Language

The language of *Hárb* comes across as unusually young and informal.

The clitic definite *-inn* is employed with unique frequency throughout *Hárb* in both the prose and poetic lines. This grammatical feature is probably the clearest identifiable informal feature of the poem; the clitic, although attested in Wiking Age runic inscriptions from the 11th c. onwards, only rarely appears in poetry older than the 14th c., suggesting that it was not otherwise considered appropriate for use in poetic composition. (TODO: cite this.)

The particle *of*, an old trait, is found 3 times (18/5, 19/5, 33/1), with a total frequency of 0.120 per 10 unique lines. This is a relatively low rate compared to most Eddic poems (Sapp 2022, p. 70).

The normal or prosaic forms *hingat* and *þangat* are used in the respective sense 'hither' and 'thither' for the older *hinig* and *þinig*. On the other hand, there is the presence of the rare and likely old words *ǫgurr* 'burden(?)' (st. 13) and *gamban-tęinn* (st. 20).

## Possibilities of performance

The loose meter and non-formal language demand discussion. To begin with, we should disregard the notion that *Hárb* is heavily corrupt and requires restoration. It must be stated clearly that no amount of emendation could "restore" *Hárb* to a pure Leeds-meter resembling what we find in poems like *Háv*, *Vafþ*, or *Lok*. Furthermore, most lines of *Hárb*, including those of unusual length or without clear metrical qualities, are readily understandable and fit well both within their immediate context and the poem as a whole. If there is such great "corruption" that it has rendered the meter of the lines entirely unrecognisable, it has still produced a remarkably consistent and in-

telligible, at times witty and well-written, text. Even so, the poem is unconventional.

Since all Norse poetry, at least prior to the antiquarian period of the 12th c., was originally oral, the poetry must have been performed in some way. If we assume that *Hárb* is older than the 12th c., it should not be an exception. With this in mind the traits described above may be explained quite nicely if we assume that *Hárb* was originally acted out, perhaps in a carnivalesque theatre with two actors standing on a stage, separated by a staged body of water and shouting at each other; alternatively with one actor playing both roles by the use of props, gestures, and voices.

The whole poem in fact seems remarkably fit for such a performance, and with this assumption many pieces fall into place. Take Thunder's talk of his breakfast and the pack on his back (st. 3), which invites the actor to point to his back and then rub his belly; Hoarbeard's insult of Thunder's dress (st. 6), which would work much better if there was in fact an actor with his pants pulled up to his knees; or Hoarbeard's declaration that he will not cross the water but instead remain *hér* 'here' (st. 14), which invites stomping on the ground.

A theatric performance would also explain the metrical variations and the use of informal features like the clitic definite as vulgar elements, deliberately contrasting with the more formal language expected for a mythological poem. The prose lines may even have been shouted out, which would explain their lack of meter as a discordant stylistic feature meant to catch the audience by surprise; the regular metrical sts., like 47, become all the more powerful when standing immediately surrounded by prose.

(TODO: mention the concept of the "double scene" by Lars Lönnroth?)

Circumstantial support is found in the structure of the dialogue, which has a remarkable affinity to a fixture in modern comedic duos: the straight man (Thunder) and the funny man (Hoarbeard). The by Wiking Age standards ever-moral Thunder serves as the perfect foil to the egoistic Hoarbeard and falls effortlessly for the ferryman's "trolling". It is hard not to imagine the audience laughing more and more as Thunder gets angrier and angrier.

The god truly is the butt of the joke for much of the poem. As noted above, his threat in st. 47 is quite impressive, but it is soon neutralized by Hoarbeard's accusation that his wife Sib is currently engaged in adultery behind his back. Even so, Thunder's great feats are never made fun of directly (beyond st. 37–39, where Thunder has the last word); in the pagan religion such stories served not just as entertainment, but also as ritual etiology (Lindow 1988).

## Dating

The formal and linguistic criteria of *Hárb* may be taken to point towards a later date for the poem than for most other mythological poems, but as discussed above, the loose meter and use of the clitic definite may also be stylistic features belonging to the relaxed and vulgar comedic register of the text.

There are also things that speak against a late date. When it comes to content-based criteria, the most notable one is that the humour of *Hárb* requires a deep understanding of the personalities of the two gods featured and may be taken to reflect felt tensions between the cults of the two gods current in paganism (see above). It is unlikely that this familiarity would have survived long after the conversion of Iceland in the popular mind, and although later Icelandic antiquarians were certainly familiar with the gods, the dialogue of *Hárb* does not come off as antiquarian. On the other hand, it is humorous and highly engaging and appears to have been intended for public performance. Of course, as concluded above, the humorous treatment of the gods in the poem can not serve as a content-based criteria for a late dating.

A smaller thing of note is the use of the ettin-name *Fjalarr* 'Feller' for the attested narrative in st. 26; in the other sources (*Lok* 62 and *Gylf* 45), this ettin is known as *Skrymir* 'Shrimer'. This variant most likely points away from an antiquarian composition, since an antiquarian regurgitating a familiar story would have been more likely to have inserted the familiar name from authoritative sources.

The model devised by Sapp (2022) gives *Hárb* a 57.8% likelihood of being from the early 11th c., and a 37.7% likelihood of being from the late 11th. These percentages are most similar to those obtained by *Grím* (a poem recognised as very young—at earliest from the latter half of the 12th c.) but *Hárb* shares so little in common with it that the similar results must be considered meaningless.

## Text

### The Leeds of Hoarbeard

**P1** Þórr fór ór austr-vegi ok kom at sundi einu. Qðrum megum [R 12r/30]
2 sunds'ins var ferju-karl'inn með skip'it. Þórr kallaði:

THUNDER JOURNEYED out of the Eastern Way and came to a sound. At the other side of the sound was the ferryman with the ship. Thunder called out:

**1** „Hvęrr 's sá svęinn svęina · es stęndr fyr sund'it handan?“ [R 12r/32]
"Who is this swain of swains, standing yonder across the sound?"

1 svęinn svęina 'swain of swains' | The word *svęinn* 'swain, lad' generally refers to a prepubescent boy, later on a page (the servant of a knight, who was aged approx. 7–14), but can also mean 'servant' (cf. English boy as a term of address), as is most likely the case here. It is presumably offended by this address that the decidedly non-servile Hoarbeard decides to insult Thunder. — The construction "X of Xs" may ultimately stem from Biblical language, although it appears fairly early on in Norse poetry; cf. *2 Guðr* 1/1.

Hann svaraði: **2** „Hvęrr 's sá karl karla · es kallar of vág'inn?“ [R 12v/1]
He answered: "Who is this churl of churls, calling out o'er the wave?"

1 karl karla 'churl of churls' | Hoarbeard directs an insult to Thunder by denigrating his social status as a lowly peasant. The construction should not be read as a compliment like modern Swedish *karlakarl* 'a real man, manly man'. Although *karl* 'churl' is an unmarked word for 'adult human being' in later NGmc., including modern Icelandic, in the oldest Norse poetry it specifically refers to a 'churl, peasant, old man' (so *Hym* 10/4, 31/3, 32/3, *2 HHund* 2/2, *Reg* 18/3, *Rþ* 23/4; in SkP: Vitg Lv 1, KormQ Lv 16, EVald *Þórr* 1, Gunnl Lv 5) unless occurring in the collocation *konur ok karlar* 'women and menfolk' (*Háv* 91/2, *Helr* 14/2, *Am* 70/1). The only exception to this in the Poetic Edda is *Am* 63/3, but *Am* is a fairly late poem and so the general rule holds.

[Þórr kvað:] **3** „Fęr þú mik of sund'it, · fóði'k þik á morgun; [R 12v/2]
2 męis hęfi'k á baki, · verðr=a matr inn bętri.
Át'k í hvíld · áðr ek hęiman fór,
4 síldr ok hafra; · saðr em'k ęnn þęss.“
[Quoth Thunder:] "Ferry me o'er the sound; I'll feed thee in the morning.
A basket I have on my back; better food will not be found.
I ate, while at rest, before I journeyed from home,
herring and oatmeal/he-goats—I am still full thereof."

4 hafra 'oatmeal/he-goats' | The easiest reading (preferred by Finnur Jónsson (1932), Pettit (2023) and others) is an acc. pl. of *hafr* 'he-goat'. Thunder also eats his goats in *Gylf* 44:11–16, where he butchers and cooks them in the evening and brings them back to life at dawn by blessing them with his hammer (cf. *Hym* 37–38), and this seems to be a common motif of the god. For his goats cf. *Hym* 20, 31, *Þrk* 21.

Other scholars instead read an acc. pl. of *hafri* ‘oat’, i.e., ‘porridge, oatmeal’. Stiles (2023) connects this with the porridge-eating of the Vedic god *Pūṣán* (*ṚV* 6.56.1, 57.2), who is “partner and yokemate” (*ṚV* 6.56.2) of *Índra*, Thunder’s Vedic equivalent. Another similarity Stiles notes between Thunder and *Pūṣán* is that both have chariots driven by goats (*ṚV* 6.57.3: “Goats are the draft-animals for the one”, 6.58.2: “Having goats as his horses”). Whether the Vedic tradition has split the Thunder-god in two or whether the Germanic Thunder has absorbed elements of an earlier yokemate is hard to say. Like *Índra*, Thunder is frequently joined by companions, as is in fact one of his most identifying characteristics (Lindow 1988, p. 123).

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **4** „Ár=ligum verkum · hrósar þú, vǫrði’num; [R 12v/5]
2 vǫitst=at-tu fyr gǫr=la,
dǫpr ’ro þín hǫim-kynni, · dauð hygg’k at þǐn móðir sé.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Of early morning works thou boastest—of thy *eating*!
Thou seest not clearly ahead;
dire is the state of thy home; I think that thy mother is dead!”

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1 Ár=ligum verkum · hrósar þú, vǫrði’num ‘Of early works thou boastest, of thy eating’ | A difficult line, not unlikely corrupt. The present interpretation sees it as an insult directed against Thunder for bragging about the quality of his food; that is not the type of *ár=ligt verk* ‘early morning work’ a real man should boast about (cf. *Háv* 33, 58–59).

2 vǫitst=at-tu fyr gǫr=la | A third verse appended to the previous two; for this form cf. 6/2, 13/3 below, *Háv* 80/2.

[Þórr kvað:] **5** „Þat sǫgir þú nú · es hvǫrjum þikkir [R 12v/6]
2 mǫst at vita: · at mín móðir dauð sé.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Now sayest thou that which to every man seems
of most weight to know—that my mother is dead!”

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **6** „Þǫy=gi ’s sǫm þú · þrjú bú góð ǫigir; [R 12v/8]
2 bǫr-bǫinn þú stǫndr · ok hǫfir brautinga gørvi,
þat-ki at þú hafir brókr þǐnar.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Yet it’s not as if *thou* mightst own three good farms—
bare-legged thou standest and hast the gear of a tramp;
thou hast not even thy breeches on!”

[Þórr kvað:] **7** „Stýr þú hingat ǫikju’nni, · ek mun þér stǫð’na kǫnna [R 12v/9]
2 eða hvǫrr á skip’it · es þú hǫldr við land’it?“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Steer hither the boat! I will show thee to the harbour—
or who owns the ship which thou holdest by the shore?”

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **8** „Hild·ólfr sá hǫitir · es mik halda bað, [R 12v/11]
2 rekkr inn ráð-svinni · es býr í Ráðs-ǫyjar-sundi;

bað=at hann hlǫnni-mǫnn flytja · eða hrossa-þjófa,
góða ǫina · ok þá's ek gǫrva kunna;
sǫg-ðu til nafns þíns · ef þú vill of sund'it fara.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Hildolf is he called who bade me hold it,
the counsel-wise man who lives in Redeseysound.
He bade me not ferry highwaymen nor horse-thieves—
good ones alone and those I know well—
speak to thy name if thou wilt come o'er the sound!”

1 Hild·ólfr ‘Hildolf’ | Perhaps the son of Weden mentioned in the thule Þul *Ása* I 1/3a in SkP 3, although that god is otherwise unattested and quite likely fabricated. The name can probably not be identified with any concrete figure.

2 Ráðs-ǫyjar-sundi ‘Redeseysound’ | An island named Redey (New Norse *Radøy*) is in fact attested in Harthland, Western Norway, so that this may be a real place. For another place-name from Western Norway found in the mythology cf. *Grm* 29/1.

[Þórr kvað:] **9** „Sǫgja mun'k til nafns míns · þó'tt ek sǫkr sjá'k [R 12v/15]
ok til alls øðlis: · Ek em Óðins sonr,
Mǫila bróðir · ǫn Magna faðir,
þrúð-valdr goða · við Þór knátt-u hér dœma!
Hins vil'k nú spyrja, · hvat þú hǫitir.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “I will speak to my name—though I may be charged—
and to all my origin: I am Weden's son,
Male's brother and Main's father,
the strength-wielder of the Gods—with Thunder dost thou here speak!
I will now ask in turn what thou art called.”

1 sǫkr ‘charged’ | I.e., involved in an unresolved blood feud.

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **10** „Hár·barðr ek hǫiti, · hyl'k umb nafn sjaldan.“ [R 12v/18]

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Hoarbeard I am called; I seldom conceal my name.”

1 hyl'k umb nafn sjaldan ‘I seldom conceal my name’ | Clearly sarcastic; the audience (who is expected to know the pilot's true identity) would likely have found this quite amusing.

Þórr kvað: **11** „Hvat skalt-u umb nafn hylja · nema þú sakar ǫigir?“ [R 12v/18]

[Quoth Thunder:] “Why shalt thou conceal thy name unless thou have charges?”

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **12** „Ǫn þó'tt ek sakar ǫiga, · fyr s·líkum sem þú est [R 12v/19]
þá mun'k forða fjǫrvi mínu · nema ek fǫigr sé.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “Yet even though I had charges, from such a one as thou art
I would then preserve my life—unless I were fey.”

ALL | The sense is that even if Weden had outstanding charges he would still give his true name, since such a wretched man as the *brautingi* 'tramp' Thunder can hardly pose a threat. This insult to Thunder's strength is what provokes him finally to retort.

2 fęigr 'fey' | Doomed (by fate) to die shortly.

[Þórr kvað:] **13** „Harm ljótan mér þikkir í því [R 12v/21]
at vaða of vág'inn til þĭn
ok vęta ǫgur mĭnn;
skylda'k launa kǫgur-svęini · þĭnum kangin-yrði
ef ek kom=umk yfir sund'it."

[Quoth Thunder:] "An ugly harm it seems to me
to wade o'er the wave to thee,
and wet this burden of mine.
I would repay thee, swaddle-swain, for thy mocking words
if I might get myself over the sound."

1 Harm ljótan mér þikkir í því 'An ugly harm it seems to me' | The meter is clearly faulty. Rhythmically the whole line comes off as an a- and b-verse of Leeds-meter (*Harm ljótan* · ...), but the verses are not linked by alliteration, which instead falls on *þ* in the b-verse.

3 ǫgur 'burden' | The sense of this word is not clear, though it is probably the same as the first element of the compound *ǫgur-stund* 'burdensome hour' found in *Vkv* 42. I find the most convincing interpretation to be that it refers to the food Thunder carries on his back, as previously mentioned in st. 3. Thunder then uses his desire not to get his food wet as an excuse not to wade. Some authors have read it as a euphemism for 'bollocks', but this is discordant with the angered but quite serious tone of the rest of the stanza and with Thunder's general role in the poem as the "straight man" next to the scurrilous Hoarbeard. It is also a very poor excuse for Thunder's unwillingness to wade, since wading is a frequent attribute of this god (e.g. *Grm* 29, *Eddbr* VI), who on those occasions shows no fear of "getting his bollocks wet".

4 skylda'k launa kǫgur-svęini · þĭnum kangin-yrði | Both words are rare. *kǫgur-svęinn* 'swaddle-swain', i.e., a babe swaddled in cloth rather than clothed like an adult, is clearly an insult and only attested at one other place; cf. the more common *kǫgur-barn* 'swaddle-child'. *kangin-yrði* 'mocking words' is a hapax due to the otherwise unattested first element, which is however most likely cognate with Swedish *kångas* 'to banter inappropriately' (Åsgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *kanginyrði*). The whole line has a close parallel in the latter half of *Gylf* 45:35: *Nú mun ek ráða yðr heil-ręði: látið þér eigi stór=liga yfir yðr. Ekki munu hirð-menn Útgarða-Loka vel þola því=líkum kǫgur-sveinum kǫpur-yrði.* 'Now I will give you a piece of wholesome counsel: do not speak too haughtily about yourselves. Nowise will the hirdmen of Outyards-Lock suffer insulting words from such swaddle-swains.'

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **14** „Hér mun'k standa · ok þĭn heðan bíða; [R 12v/23]
fannt=a-tu mann inn harðara · at Hrungni dauðan."

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] "*Here* will I stand and from *here* await thee.
Thou foundest no harder man since Rungner died!"

2 Hrungni 'Rungner' | Rungner was a famous ettin slain by Thunder in a fierce battle (*Skm* 24–25, *Haustl* 14–20).

[Þórr kvað:] **15** „Hins vilt-u nú geta · es vit Hrungnir dęildum, [R 12v/25]
sá inn stór-úðgi jǫtunn, · es ór stęini vas hǫfuð'it á,
þó lét'k hann falla · ok fyrir hníga;
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Now wilt thou bring up something else: how I and Rungner dealt with each other,
that great-minded ettin on whom the head was of stone.
Yet I made him fall and kneel down before me—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

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2 es ór stęini vas hǫfuð'it á ‘on whom the head was of stone’ | Cf. *Hym* 29–30, where the ettin Hymer's head is harder than stone. This characteristic part of ettin-physiology can probably be explained by reference to pre-Christian cosmology.
In numerous Indo-European cosmologies the Firmament is believed to be made of stone, as is seen in the PIE root **h₂éḱmō* whose descendants can mean both ‘heaven, sky’, ‘meteorite’ and ‘stone’, sometimes varying even within branches (West 2007, p. 342; Calin 1996, p. 3); cf. e.g. OI *áṣman* ‘stone, rock’ against Old Persian *asman* ‘sky, heaven’ and ON *himinn* ‘sky, heaven’ against *hamarr* ‘cliff, rock’ (Kroonen 2013, pp. 206–207, 220). In the Germanic cosmology the Stoney Heaven was made out of the skull of Yimer, the primordial ettin sacrificed by the Gods (*Vsp* 3–4, *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 41), and as the ancestor of the Ettins he thus passed his stone-skull on to his descendants.

4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr? ‘what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?’ | This question begins the argument over their respective accomplishments or *mann-jafnaðr* which takes up the bulk of the poem (sts. 16–40). — The metricality of this line and the corresponding *hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?* is questionable. Both lines are most likely non-metrical prose, but since they do have words that can be taken to alliterate with the names those words have been marked.

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **16** „Vas'k með Fjǫl·vari · fimm vetr alla [R 12v/27]
í ęy þęiri · es Al-grøn hęitir;
vega vér þar knǫttum · ok val fęlla,
margs at frękista, · mans at kosta.“

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] “I was with Felwar for five winters all
in that island which is called Allgreen.
There we did fight and fell the slain;
many a girl did we tempt and win.”

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1 Fjǫl·vari ‘Felwar’ | The name is clearly equivalent to the adj. *fjǫl-varr* ‘reluctant, very wary’ but is not attested elsewhere.

4 margs at frękista, · mans at kosta ‘many a girl did we tempt and win’ | I read *margs* ‘many a’ as modifying *mans* ‘girl’.

[Þórr kvað:] **17** „Hversu snúnuðu yðr konur yðrar?“ [R 12v/30]

[Quoth Thunder:] “How did your women turn out for you?”

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1 snúnuðu ‘turn out’ | A rare verb only found in poetry.

[Hár·barðr kvað:] **18** „Sparkar ǫ́ttum vér konur · ef oss at spǫkum yrði; [R 12v/30]
horskar ǫ́ttum vér konur · ef oss hollar vǽri,
þǽr ór sandi · síma undu
ok ór dali djúpum
grund of grófu;
varð'k þǽim ǽinn ǫllum · øfri at rǫ́ðum;
hvílda'k hjá þǽim systrum sjau
ok hafða'k gǽð þǽira allt ok gaman;
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?"

[Quoth Hoarbeard:] "We had smart women if they were to our enjoyment;
we had wise women if they were hold toward us.
Out of sand they wound a string
and out of a deep dale
dug up the ground.
I alone became superior to them all in counsel;
I rested by those sisters seven
and had their senses all, and pleasure—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?"

---

ALL | The sense of the whole stanza, but especially ll. 3–5, is quite unclear. If it is referring to a specific myth it is wholly lost. If we take it to be a astrological analogy (cf. st. 19/2–5) then the seven sisters may tentatively be identified

3 þǽr ór sandi · síma undu 'Out of sand they wound a string' | Unclear. If it is to be understood that they spun string out of sand that is clearly a reference to some sort of magic.

8 gǽð þǽira allt ok gaman 'their senses all, and pleasure' | Formulaic word-pair, occurring in *Háv* 99/4 and 162/2.

Þórr kvað: **19** „Ek drap Þjatsa, · hinn þrúð-móðga jǫtun, [R 13r/2, A 1r/1]
upp ek varp augum · All·valda sonar
á þann inn hǽiða himin;
þau 'ro mǽrki mǽst · minna verka,
þau's allir mǽnn síðan of séa;
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?"

Quoth Thunder: "I slew Thedse, the strength-minded ettin;
up I threw the eyes of Allwald's son [= Thedse]
onto the shining heaven.
Those are the greatest marks of my works,
those which all men since do see—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?"

---

4 minna | *From this word forwards the poem is also attested in* **A**. 5 síðan | *om.* **A**

ALL | For the slaying of Thedse, cf. *Lok* 50 n. The detail of Thedse's eyes becoming stars is also found in *Skm* 4, but there we read that *Óðinn gerði þat til yfir-bóta við Skaða, at hann tók augu Þjatsa ok kastaði upp á himin ok gerði af stjǫrnur tvær* 'Weden, in order to compensate Shede, did so that he took the eyes of Thedse and threw them up onto the heaven and made out of them two stars'. This is a rare example of native Germanic star-lore embedded in the mythology, but it is not unparallelled. Another example is Earendel's toe, also thrown onto the heaven by Thunder, as told in *Skm* 25 (Lindow 1996, pp. 17–18).

Hár·barðr kvað: **20** „Miklar man-vélar · hafða'k við myrk-riður [**R** 13r/5, **A** 1r/1]
2 þá's ek vélta þér frá verum.
Harðan jǫtun · hugða'k Hlé·barð vesa;
4 gaf hann mér gamban-tęin
ęn ek vélta hann ór viti."

Quoth Hoarbeard: "Great girl-tricks I had against mirk-rideresses
when I lured them away from men.
A hard ettin I judged Leebeard to be;
he gave me a gombentoe
but I tricked him out of his wits."

---

1 myrk-riður 'mirk-rideresses' | The *riður* 'rideresses, fevers' were witches thought to torment people and cause disease and delirium. See *Háv* 156 for discussion.

2 frá verum 'from men' | Alternatively 'from their husbands', but that makes less sense in the context of rideresses who are out tormenting mankind, not consorting with their husbands. For *verar* 'men, husbands' in the general sense 'mankind' cf. st. 53/3 below, *Lok* 24/3.

3 Hlé·barð 'Leebeard' | *hlé* 'lee, calm, shelter (from bad weather)' + *barðr* 'beard', an otherwise unattested ettin. For alternative explanations of the first element see note to Þul Óðins 4/1: *Hléfęðr* in SkP 3.

4 gamban-tęin 'gombentoe' | An unknown magical object also occuring in *Skí* 32/2. Etymologically it is clearly some type of stick (*tęinn* 'stick, branch'), perhaps for carving runes into.

Þórr kvað: **21** „Illum huga launaðir þú þá góðar gjafar." [**R** 13r/7, **A** 1r/3]

Quoth Thunder: "With an evil heart didst thou then repay the good gifts."

---

1 þá | *om.* **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **22** „Þat hęfir ęik · es af annarri skęfr; [**R** 13r/8, **A** 1r/4]
2 umb sik es hvęrr í s·líku—
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?"

Quoth Hoarbeard: "An oak has that which it chafes from another;
it is every man for himself in such matters—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?"

---

1 Þat hęfir ęik · es af annarri skęfr 'An oak has that which it chafes from another' | Proverbial, also appearing in *Mhkv* 26/3a.

Þórr kvað: **23** „Ek vas austr · ok jǫtna barða'k [R 13r/9, A 1r/4]
2 brúðir bǫl-vísar · es til bjargs gingu;
mikil myndi ętt jǫtna · ef allir lifði,
4 vętr myndi manna · undir Mið·garði—
hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?

Quoth Thunder: "I was in the east and bashed Ettins,
bale-wise brides who were walking to a mountain.
Great would the lineage of Ettins be if they all lived;
naught would remain of men within Middenyard—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?"

---

ALL | Thunder here makes a moral response to Hoarbeard's egoism as expressed in the previous stanza. In the religion, Thunder is the defender of the Gods and Middenyard (the home of Men) against the Ettins, for which cf. *Vsp* 25, 53, *Þrk* 18. For Thunder's killing of ettin-women in particular cf. sts. 37–39 below, *Eddbr* VI, and Lindow (1988).

Hár·barðr kvað: **24** „Vas'k á Val-landi · ok vígum fylgða'k, [R 13r/11, A 1r/6]
2 atta ek jǫfrum · ęn aldri sętta'k;
Óðinn á jarla · þá's í val falla
4 ęn Þórr á þręla kyn."

Quoth Hoarbeard: "I was in Walland and followed wars;
I incited princes and never reconciled them.
Weden owns the earls which fall among the slain—
but Thunder owns the race of thralls."

---

ALL | Weden brushes off Thunder's moralism and instead expresses a characteristic aristocratic disregard for lower life and life as mere life. Where the altruistic Thunder boasts of protecting mankind, the ambivalent Weden sarcastically responds that he incited war and conflict in order to take the best of them for himself.

1 Val-landi 'Walland' | The normal term for France in ON, originally referring to Roman Gaul. The idea of continental Europe as particularly war-torn certainly goes back to the Migration Period; cf. the similar view about the Gots in *Vsp* 30/2, *Vkv* 1.

3 Óðinn á 'Weden owns' | For Weden's "owning" of men see *Vsp* 23 n.

4 Þórr á þręla kyn 'Thunder owns the race of thralls' | This has been connected (TODO: cite) with the sacrifice of prisoners and criminals to Thunder, which, if true, would support a pre-Christian origin for the poem, as such an allusion would soon fade out of relevance following the Conversion.

Þórr kvað: **25** „Ó·jafnt skipta · es þú myndir með ǫ́sum liði [R 13r/13, A 1r/8]
2 ef þú ęttir vil=gi mikils vald."

Quoth Thunder: "Unfairly wouldst thou deal out troops amidst the Eese
if thou hadst unrestrained power."

---

1 ǫ́sum | ásа **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **26** „Þórr á afl órit · ęn ękki hjarta; [R 13r/14, A 1r/9]
af hréðslu ok hug-blęyði · vas þér í handska troðit
ok þótti=sk=a þú þá Þórr vesa;
hvár=ki þú þá þorðir · fyr hréðslu þínni
hnjósa né fisa · svá't Fjalarr hęyrði.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Thunder has ample strength but little heart.
Out of fear and heart-softness wast thou driven into a glove
and didst not then seem to be Thunder.
Thou daredst neither for thy fear
sneeze nor fart lest Feller should hear.”

2 vas þér | þér vas **R** 5 hnjósa né fisa ‘sneeze or fart’ | fisa né hnjósa *‘fart or sneeze’* **A**

ALL | The story to which this stanza alludes is also hinted at in *Lok* 60 and told in full in *Gylf* 45:5–16: Lock, Thunder, and his servants Thelve and Wrash had journeyed east for a long time and the day was drawing late when they found before them a great hall, with an opening on one end as wide as the building itself. They took lodgings inside, but in the middle of the night they were awakened by a great earthquake. Thunder rose and led the party into a side-room to the right in the middle of the hall. He stood closest to the opening with his hammer ready while the terrified others cowered further inside; so they stood for the whole night and heard great noise outside. At daybreak they left the building and found the huge ettin Shrimer asleep outside. His snoring had caused the earthquakes and noise, and the house was his mitten; the side-room was its thumb.

5 Fjalarr ‘Feller’ | To be identified with Shrimer in *Lok* 60 and *Gylf* 45. The use of an alternative name for the same figure suggests a variant tradition and strengthens the idea that *Hárb* is not an antiquarian product.

Þórr kvað: **27** „Hár·barðr inn ragi, · ek munda þik í hęl drepa [R 13r/17, A 1r/11]
ef ek mętta sęila=sk of sund.“

Quoth Thunder: “Hoarbeard the queer, I would strike thee into Hell
if I could sail o'er the sound!”

2 sund | sundit **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **28** „Hvat skyldir of sund sęila=sk · es sakir 'ro alls øngar? [R 13r/18, A 1r/12]
Hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Why shouldst thou sail o'er the sound when there are no charges at all?
What didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?”

1 skyldir | skalt-u **A** 1 sakir | sakar **A**

Þórr kvað: **29** „Ek vas austr · ok ǫ'na varða'k [R 13r/19, A 1r/13]
þá's mik sóttu þęir Svárangs synir;
grjóti mik bǫrðu, · gagni urðu þó lítt fęgnir,
þó urðu mik fyrri · friðar at biðja—

hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“

Quoth Thunder: “I was in the east and guarded the river
when I was set upon by Sweering’s sons.
With rocks they bashed me, yet in victory rejoiced little;
yet they sooner had to beg for peace—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?”

2 mik sóttu þęir | þęir sóttu mik **A** 3 þó | *om.* **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **30** „Ek vas austr · ok við ęin-hvęrja dømða’k, [R 13r/22, A 1r/15]
2 lék’k við ina lín-hvítu · ok laun-þing háða’k,
gladda’k ina goll-bjǫrtu, · gamni mér unði.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in the east and flirted with a certain someone;
I played with the linen-white one and held secret trysts:
I gladdened the gold-bright one—the maiden enjoyed pleasure.”

1 ęin-hvęrja | ęin-hęrju **A** 2 lín-hvítu | *so* **A**; lind-hvítu *‘linden-white’* **R** 2 laun-þing ‘secret trysts’ | *so* **A**; laung þing *‘long trysts’* **R** 3 goll-bjǫrtu ‘gold-bright’ | goll-hvítu *‘gold-white’* **A**

ALL | Weden’s answer is sarcastic and subverts a common Norse literary trope where men who stay at home with women are presented as cowardly and soft against those who “go out” to wage war (e.g. Þhorn *Harkv* 6 in SkP 1).

1 ęin-hvęrja ‘a certain someone’ | The **A** reading *ęin-hęrju* looks like the acc. sg. of an otherwise unattested **ęin-hęrja*, f. of *ęin-hęri* ‘Oneharrier’ and perhaps a synonym for a walkirrie.

Þórr kvað: **31** „Góð ǫ́ttuð ér man-kynni þar þá.“ [R 13r/24, A 1r/17]

Quoth Thunder: “Then ye had good experiences with the girls there.”

1 ǫ́ttuð ér | *so (‘*ǫ́ttu þér*’)* **A***;* ǫ́ttu þęir *‘ye had’* **R** 1 man-kynni | mann-kynni *(‘*mañ*’-, with erroneous macron above the* n*)* **A**

1 Góð ǫ́ttuð ér man-kynni þar þá. | Thunder is once again distracted by Weden’s mention of women; cf. st. 17 above. — The line is clearly prose.

Hár·barðr kvað: **32** „Liðs þíns vę́ra’k þá þurfi, Þórr, · at ek hęlda þęiri inni lín-hvítu męy.“ [R 13r/24, A 1r/17]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I might have needed thy aid then, Thunder, that I might have held that linen-white maiden.”

1 vę́ra’k | vas’k **A**

Þórr kvað: **33** „Ek mynda þér þá þat vęita · ef ek viðr of køm=umk.“ [R 13r/25, A 1r/18]

Quoth Thunder: “I would then have offered it to thee, if I were able.”

1 þá þat | þat þá **A** 1 kǫm=umk | *so (*'kæmvmz'*)* **A**; kómist **R**

Hár·barðr kvað: **34** „Ek mynda þér þá trúa, · nema mik í tryggð véltir.“ [**R** 13r/26, **A** 1r/18]
Quoth Hoarbeard: "I would then have trusted thee, if thou wouldst not have betrayed my trust."

Þórr kvað: **35** „Em'k=at ek sá hǫ́l-bítr · sem húð-skór forn á vár.“ [**R** 13r/27, **A** 1r/19]
Quoth Thunder: "I am not such a heel-biter as an old hide-shoe in spring."

1 Em'k=at ek sá hǫ́l-bítr · sem húð-skór forn á vár 'I am not such a heel-biter as an old hide-shoe in spring' | Likely proverbial; a heel-biter is someone who betrays his companions, and the old shoe-leather becomes stiff over the winter.

Hár·barðr kvað: **36** „Hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Þórr?“ [**R** 13r/28, **A** 1r/20]
Quoth Hoarbeard: "What didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Thunder?"

Þórr kvað: **37** „Brúðir ber-sǫrkja · barða'k í Hlés-ǫyju; [**R** 13r/28, **A** 1r/20]
2 þǫ́r hǫfðu verst unnit, · vélta þjóð alla.“
Quoth Thunder: "The brides of bearserks I bashed in Leesey;
they had done the worst thing: tricked the whole people."

1 Hlés-ǫyju | Hlés-ǫy **A**

1 Hlés-ǫyju 'Leesey' | Læsø in Denmark. This island figures in mythology. TODO.

Hár·barðr kvað: **38** „Kléki vannt-u þá, Þórr, · es þú á konum barðir.“ [**R** 13r/29, **A** 1r/21]
Quoth Hoarbeard: "A disgrace didst thou accomplish, Thunder, when thou bashedst women!"

1 á | 'á' *with small corr. above* **A**

Þórr kvað: **39** „Vargynjur vǫ́ru þǫ́r · ǫn var=la konur, [**R** 13r/30, **A** 1r/22]
2 skǫlldu skip mitt · es skorðat hafða'k,
ógðu mér járn-lurki · ǫn ǫltu Þjálfa—
4 hvat vannt-u þá meðan, Hár·barðr?“
Quoth Thunder: "She-wolves were they, but hardly women.
They overturned my ship which I had propped up,
terrorised me with iron cudgels and chased Thelve around—
what didst thou accomplish in the meantime, Hoarbeard?"

1 vǫ́ru þǫ́r | þat vǫ́ru **A** 3 mér | *add.* þǫim **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **40** „Ek vas'k í hęr'num · es hingat gørði=sk [R 13r/32, A 1r/23]
2 gnéfa gunn-fana, · gęir at rjóða.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I was in the host which readied itself hither
to raise the war-standard, to redden the spear.”

Þórr kvað: **41** „Þęss vilt-u nú geta, es þú fórt oss ǫ·ljúfan at bjóða!“ [R 13v/1, A 1r/24]

Quoth Thunder: “Now wilt thou bring up how thou didst set out to bring hatred against us!”

1 ǫ·ljúfan | ‘óliyfan’ **A**; †olubann† **R**

ALL | The exchange shifts away from the comparison of deeds.

1 ǫ·ljúfan ‘hatred’ | Lit. ‘un-lovely’, a rare m. dat. sg. adverbial.

Hár·barðr kvað: **42** „Bøta skal þér þat þá · munda baugi [R 13v/2, A 1r/25]
2 sem jafnęndr unnu · þęir's okkr vilja sętta.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Then I shall repay thee for that with a hand-bigh
bestowed by the mediators who wish to reconcile us two.”

1 þat þá | *om.* **A** 2 þęir's okkr vilja sętta | þęir's okkr vilja sętt hafa **A**

Þórr kvað: **43** „Hvar namt þęssi · in hnófi=ligu orð [R 13v/3, A 1r/26]
2 es hęyrða'k aldri=gi · in hnófi=ligri?“

Quoth Thunder: “Where didst thou learn these scornful words
when I never heard more scornful ones?”

2 in | *so* **A**; *om.* **R**

Hár·barðr kvað: **44** „Nam'k at mǫnnum þęim inum aldr-ónum es búa í [R 13v/5, A 1r/27]
hęimis-skógum.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I learned them from the elderly men who dwell in the homely forests.”

1 mǫnnum | *om.* **A**

Þórr kvað: **45** „Þó gefr þú gótt nafn dysjum, es þú kallar þat hęimis-skóga.“ [R 13v/5, A 1v/1]

Quoth Thunder: “Though thou givest a good name to poor cairns when thou callest them
‘homely forests’.”

1 dysjum ‘poor cairns’ | A reference to Weden's consultation of the dead for knowledge as attested e.g. in *Vsp* and *Bdr*.

Hár·barðr kvað: **46** „Svá dœmi'k umb s·líkt far.“ [**R** 13v/6, **A** 1v/2]

Quoth Hoarbeard: "So do I speak about such matters."

1 umb | *om.* **A**

Þórr kvað: **47** „Orð-kringi þĭn · mun þér illa koma
2 ef ek réð á vág at vaða;
ulfi hęrra · hygg'k at ópa mynir
4 ef hlýtr af hamri hǫgg.“ [**R** 13v/7, **A** 1v/2]

Quoth Thunder: "Thy glibness of word will bring thee ill
if I decide to wade on the wave.
Louder than a wolf I think thou wilt scream
if thou gettest a strike from the hammer!"

3 at ópa mynir | þik ópa munu **A**

ALL | This perfectly regular Leeds-meter-stanza marks a sudden shift in the exchange from the previous laconic one-line prose lines. Thunder's threat of hammer-based violence is parallelled by *Lok* 57–63.

Hár·barðr kvað: **48** „Sif á hó hęima, · hans munt fund vilja,
2 þann munt þręk drýgja, · þat 's þér skyldara.“ [**R** 13v/9, **A** 1v/4]

Quoth Hoarbeard: "Sib has a lover at home; *him* wilt thou wish to seek out;
on *him* wilt thou use thy strength—that is more urgent for thee!"

2 skyldara | skyldra **A**

1 hó 'lover' | Most editors take this acc. sg. word as an alternative form of *hórr* m. 'adulterer' (gen. *hórs*), containing the same root as *hóra* f. 'whore, prostitute', *hór* n. 'adultery, fornication', ModEngl. whore. The *-r* has presumably been reinterpreted as the m. nom. sg. ending, yielding nom. sg. **hór*, gen. sg. **hós*, although neither form is attested. The same accusation is found in *Lok* 54, where Lock says that he has been Sib's lover (*hórr*).
On formal grounds CV (s.v. *hór*) interpret this word as the unrelated *hór* m. 'pot-hook', "insinuating that Thor busied himself with cooking and dairy-work." If that reading is correct *hans, þann* 'him' should be translated 'it' instead, but the whole thing seems rather unlikely when we consider Thunder's strong response: 'I think thou liest', which fits well against an accusation of his wife's adultery, not so much about her owning a pot-hook.

Þórr kvað: **49** „Męlir þú at munns ráði · svá't mér skyldi vęrst þikkja,
2 halr inn hug-blauði, · hygg'k at þú ljúgir.“ [**R** 13v/10, **A** 1v/5]

Quoth Thunder: "Thou speakest after thy mouth's counsel what should seem worst to me—
O heart-soft man, I think thou liest!"

Hár·barðr kvað: **50** „Satt hygg'k mik sęgja, · sęinn est at fǫr þĭnni, [**R** 13v/12, **A** 1v/6]

2 langt myndir nú kominn, Þórr, · ef þú litum fórir.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “I think I speak truly. Thou art late on thy journey;
far wouldst thou have come by now, Thunder, if thou hadst changed colour!”

1 mik | þik **A**

2 litum fórir ‘changed colour’ | An unclear expression, probably metaphorically ‘if thou hadst not been so stubborn’.

Þórr kvað: **51** „Hár·barðr inn ragi, · hęldr hęfir nú mik dvalðan!“ [**R** 13v/14, **A** 1v/8]

Quoth Thunder: “Hoarbeard the queer, thou hast now much delayed me!”

1 dvalðan | dvalit **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **52** „Ása-Þórs · hugða’k aldri=gi myndu
2 glępja fé-hirði farar.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Eese-Thunder’s journeys I never thought
a shepherd would divert.”

1 Ása-Þórs | Ása-Þór **A**

1 Ása-Þórs ‘Eese-Thunder’ | Or ‘Thunder of the Eese’. A reverent, majestic epithet, here used sarcastically, i.e., ‘the high and mighty Thunder’. It is also found in *Gylf* (9:17, etc.) and *Skm.*

Þórr kvað: **53** „Ráð mun’k þér nú ráða: · ró hingat báti’num,
2 hętttum hótingi, · hitt fǫður Magna!“

Quoth Thunder: “I will now counsel thee a counsel: row the boat hither;
let us cease the taunting; meet the father of Main [= Thunder = me]!”

Hár·barðr kvað: **54** „Far þú firr sundi, · þér skal fars synja!“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Go far away from the sound; passage shall be denied thee!”

1 firr | frá **A**

Þórr kvað: **55** „Vísa þú mér nú lęið’ina, · alls þú vill mik ęigi of vág’inn fęrja.“

Quoth Thunder: “Now show me the way since thou wilt not ferry me o’er the wave.”

1 nú | *om.* **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **56** „Lítit ’s at synja, · langt ’s at fara;

stund 's til stokks'ins, · ǫnnur til stęins'ins,
halt svá til vinstra vegs'ins · und's þú hittir Ver-land;
þar mun Fjǫrgyn · hitta Þór, son sínn,
ok mun hǫn kęnna hǫnum ǫ́ttunga brautir · til Óðins landa.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “It is little to deny. It is long to journey:
an hour to the log, another to the stone.
Hold so to the left road until thou findest Wereland;
there will Firgyn find Thunder, her son,
and she will show him the ancestral roads to Weden's lands.”

1 at | *om.* **R** 2 stokks'ins | stokks **A** 2 stęins'ins | stęins **A** 3 vegs'ins | vegs **A** 3 Ver-land 'Wereland' | Valland **A**

3 Ver-land 'Wereland' | The 'Land of Men'.

4 Fjǫrgyn 'Firgyn' | Another name for Earth, Thunder's mother.

Þórr kvað: **57** „Mun'k taka þangat í dag?“ [**R** 13v/22, **A** 1v/14]

Quoth Thunder: “Will I come thither today?”

ALL | *Due to the trimming of the margin on fol. 13v, only the abbreviation* q. *(for* kvað *'quoth, said') is visible for sts. 57–60* **R**; *the names of the speakers, although unambiguous, are therefore supplied from* **A**. 1 í dag | á dęgi **A**

Hár·barðr kvað: **58** „Taka við víl ok ęrfiði · at upp-vesandi sólu [**R** 13v/22, **A** 1v/14]
es ek get þána.“

Quoth Hoarbeard: “[Thou wilt] come thither with toil and hardship by the rising of the sun,
as I believe it is thawing.”

1 ok | við **A** 1 upp-vesandi | upp-rennandi **A**

Þórr kvað: **59** „Skammt mun nú mál okkat vesa, · alls þú mér skǫtingu ęinni svarar; [**R** 13v/23, **A** 1v/15]
launa mun'k þér far-synjun · ef vit finnum=sk í sinn annat.“

Quoth Thunder: “Our speech will now be short since thou answerest me with scoffing alone.
I will repay thee for this ferry-denial if we meet another time!”

Hár·barðr kvað: **60** „Far þú nú þar's þik hafi allan gramir!“ [**R** 13v/25, **A** 1v/17]

Quoth Hoarbeard: “Now go whither the fiends may have thee whole!”

ALL | The speaker is uncertain. This line is introduced with the speech marker *'H. q.'* (= *Hár·barðr kvað* 'Quoth Hoarbeard') in **A**; in **R** it belongs to 59 and is thus spoken by Thunder. Since it seems more likely for a speech marker to be dropped than erroneously added the **A** reading is preferred.

1 þik hafi allan gramir ‘the fiends may have thee whole’ | The *gramir* ‘fiends’, lit. ‘wroth, cross ones’ are (male) dæmons. The adjective *gramr* is commonly used specifically with a connotation of divine wrath and they may thus be supernatural avengers for severe crimes. The same curse is found in *Grm* P1 with *smyl* for *gramir* and in related form in *Brot* 10.

# Lay of Hymer
# *(Hymis kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.694)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Lay of Hymer** (*Hym*) is a narrative mythological poem which tells the story of how the gods Thunder and Tew go on an adventure into Ettinland in order to fetch a great cauldron from the ettin Hymer. The three end up on a single fishing boat, and, in one of the most famous Norse mythological scenes, Thunder manages to bait the world-encircling serpent itself, the Middenyardswyrm, on his hook.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hym* is attested in full in both main manuscripts of mythological poetry: **R** and **A**. In **R** the poem belongs to the first, mythological part of the manuscript and is found on foll. 13v/26–15r/3; it follows *Hárb* and is followed by *Lok*. In **A**, the poem is found on foll. 5v/25–6v/25, where it follows *Grm* and is followed by the prose introduction to *Vkv*.

The two mss. agree very well with each other and share the same number of stanzas in the same order. Like the other mythological poems shared between **R** and **A**, the two versions clearly go back to the same written archetype, and are thus not two independent attestations of an oral tradition. The most substantial difference between the two is in fact the title: **A** has *Hymis kviða* 'the Lay of Hymer', while **R** instead has *Þórr dró Mið·garðs·orm* 'Thunder pulled the Middenyardswyrm'. This circumstance, also shared with *Skí*, probably suggests that the scribal archetype did not have clear titles for the poems it contained.

## Story and motifs

*Hym* belongs to a genre of comedic stories about Thunder's adventures in Ettinland. These stories all see Thunder set out from Osyard followed by one or more companions. Together, the party undergoes various fantastical tests and hardships on their way through the Ettinhomes, and return home after Thunder has slaughtered yet another hostile ettin-clan. The popularity of this genre is seen by the large number of stories belonging to it. In the Poetic Edda it is also represented by *Þrk* and, to some extent, *Hárb*. Other examples are Thunder's journey to Outyards-Lock in *Gylf* 44–47, his fight with Thedse in *Skm* 2–3 and *Haustl* 2–13, his fight with Rungner in *Skm* 24 and *Haustl* 14–20, and his journey to Garfrith in *Skm* 26 (in which two sts. are cited; see *Eddbr* VI).

### The otherness of the Ettins

In these stories, the Ettins are very much an *other* to the Gods, and this is something which *Hym* strongly emphasises in several ways. In the poem,

- The Ettins live in the far east (st. 5) in an inhospitable, frozen climate (st. 10) of mountains (sts. 2, 17) and lavafields (sts. 36, 38).
- They are physically deviant: misshapen (st. 10), grey-haired (st. 16), many-headed (sts. 8, 35), having heads harder than stone (sts. 30–31);
- they are also likened to apes (st. 20), whales (st. 36) and Danes (st. 17, see note!).
- In terms of character, they are stingy and inhospitable (sts. 9, 16)
- and snide and cowardly (sts. 19–20, 25–26, 28–32).

These traits of the Ettins stand in direct opposition to the Old Germanic social norms as represented and upheld by the Gods, who live in a lush green land and are young, beautiful, generous, and brave. The one exception in the poem is Tew's mother in st. 8, who is blonde, beautiful and hospitable. The mother of a god should also be godlike, and this likely reflects the broader motif of a beautiful ettin-woman who is taken by a god, for which cf. the st. 8 n. and *Skí* above.

As natural inferiors and a threat to the social order the Ettins must be subjugated by the Gods, and the agent of this subjugation is the strength-wielder of the gods, Thunder. Throughout the poem he recurringly humiliaties the ettins Eagre and Hymer through completing their various challenges and performing tests of strength. These tests follow a similar outline: Thunder is given a dangerous or near-impossible challenge but accomplishes it anyway with surprising ease through a combination of brawn and brain to the humiliation of the challenger. The challenges consist of finding an enormously large kettle (st. 3, explicitly called Eagre's "revenge"), wrestling one of Hymer's oxen for bait (sts. 17–18), carrying home Hymer's whales and boat (st. 26), breaking Hymer's finest chalice (st. 28), and perhaps also taking away

the cauldron (st. 33)—though that may just be Hymer's wish to be finally rid of the pestering gods. In the end Thunder delivers justice by slaughtering Hymer and his whole clan of many-headed Ettins.

**The fishing expedition**

At the center of the poem stands Thunder's famous fishing trip, where the god gets the Middenyardswyrm on his hook but ultimately fails to catch it. In this section of *Hym*, especially in sts. 22–24, we find a noticeably more reverent tone than elsewhere in the poem.

Thunder's abortive encounter with the Wyrm was clearly very popular in the Wiking Age and is, apart from *Hym*, also dealt with in five fragmentary Scaldic poems from the 9th or 10th centuries and extensively in *Gylf* 48:3–31. The story is also represented pictorally on numerous objects from the Wiking Age.

The Scaldic fragments are all found in citations scattered throughout *Skm*, all edited in SkP 3. They are, by descending number of long-lines: Bragi *Þórr*, *Húsdr* 3–6, EVald *Þórr*, and Ggnæv *Þórr*, Qlv *Þórr*.

In their present state none of these fragments are complete narratives, but mainly focus on the scene of Thunder in the boat facing off against the hooked Wyrm pressed against the gunwale. From what little we can glean from them they also disagree on the course of events. In Bragi *Þórr* 6 the encounter ends when the cowardly Hymer cuts the fishing line and the Wyrm sinks back unscathed into the sea in *Húsdr* 6 and probably also Ggnæv *Þórr* 1 Thunder strikes the head off the Wyrm with his hammer Millner.

Other than *Hym* the only complete retelling of the myth is found in *Gylf* 48:3–31, which may be summarized as follows:

> Thunder goes out alone into Middenyard in the shape of a young man (*ungr drængr*) without his goats and chariot. In the evening he comes to the ettin Hymer and asks to stay the night. At dawn Hymer plans to go fishing and Thunder asks to join him. Hymer says that Thunder will not be of much help since he is "small and but a young man" (*lítill ok ung-mænni ætt*), and warns him that he usually takes long and arduous trips. Thunder, angered, says that he will row very far, and then asks Hymer what bait they will use. Hymer tells him to find it himself, and so he turns to his flock of oxen; he tears off the head from the greatest ox, one called Heavenrid (*Himin-hrjóðr*). The two go out to sea, and Thunder rows far past Hymer's usual fishing waters. Hymer, unhappy, warns him that if they row any further out they will be in danger of the Middenyardswyrm, but Thunder keeps on. After some time he puts down the oars, readies his fishing line, hooks the ox-head and lowers it. The Wyrm soon bites, and struggles so hard that Thunder is pressed against the gunwale. In rage he brings himself into his Os-might (*ós-mægin*) and pulls back with such force that his feet go through the bottom of the ship and press into the seabed. The Wyrm's head goes up against the gunwale. The two enemies ferociously stare at each other, Thunder "sharpening his eyes" and the Wyrm spitting venom. Hymer

> is frightened, reaches for his bait-cutting knife, and cuts the line—the Wyrm then sinks back into the sea. Thunder throws his hammer after it, "and men say that he struck off the monster's head, but I think it true to tell thee that the Middenyardswyrm still lives and is lying in the outer sea." Thunder gives Hymer a punch to the ear so that he flies headfirst overboard; the god then wades back to land.

Snorre's account is clearly based on multiple sources, certainly including the Scaldic fragments he himself cites in *Skm*. It is hard to say whether Snorre had access to *Hym*; the closest verbal agreement is when it is said in *Gylf* 48:22 that *Miðˑgarðs-ormr gein yfir uxa-hǫfuð'it, en ǫngull'inn vá í góm'inn orm'inum* 'The Middenyardswyrm snapped at the ox-head and the hook went into the roof of the wyrm's mouth', which has some resemblance to st. 22.

Some details in *Gylf* 48 not found in *Hym* must derive from now-lost texts available to Snorre; most famously the detail of Thunder's feet going through the boat is also found on the Swedish Altuna stone and the Danish Hørdum stone (but see note to st. 34/2 below). The name of the ox Heavenrid is attested in thules listing names of oxen.

In addition to the literary sources there are also numerous pictorial depictions of the myth from the Wiking Age. These are the Swedish runestones from Altuna (U 1611, figure 4, p. 279) and Linga (Sö 352), several Jutlandic picture stones from Hørdum, a Cumbrian picture stone from Gosforth, and the Gotlandic picture stone GP 21 from Ardre church. The images depict the same scene as the Scaldic fragments: Thunder stands in the boat above the hooked Wyrm, often depicted as a fish; next to him is one companion. Some of them have additional details like the use of the ox-head for bait (U 1611, Sö 352), Thunder's foot going through the boat (U 1611, Hørdum), or Thunder raising his hammer (U 1611).

More broadly, Thunder's fishing reflects the archetypal fight (the *Chaoskampf*) between the Storm-God and the Dragon, as found in a great many mythologies. Important examples of this include Vedic *Índra* and *Vr̥trá* (*ṚV* 1.32 etc.), Babylonian *Marduk* and *Tiamat* (*Enūma Eliš* TODO), Greek Ζεύς (*Zeús*) and Τῦφῶν (*Tūphôn*), Hebrew YHWH and Leviathan (TODO: references). With these analogies in mind it seems that the versions where Thunder slays the Wyrm reflect an older layer of Germanic mythology, before the lethal fight between Thunder and the Wyrm had been transposed to the End Times (see *Vsp* 53).

### *Hym* as a composite

The narrative of *Hym* can be subdivided into the following episodes:

1. Sts. 1–6: The Gods wish to drink ale and Thunder goes to Eagre to force him to brew it; Eagre in turn asks for a cauldron big enough to brew enough ale for all the Gods.

2. 7–16: Thunder and Tew go to visit Tew's father, the stingy ettin Hymer, who owns such a cauldron; horrified at Thunder's great appetite during the evening he tells them that they must go fishing for food.

3. 17–19: Thunder says that he will do it, if he is given bait; Hymer challenges him to kill one of his oxen; Thunder tears off the head from one of them.

4. 20–25: The three go fishing; Hymer pulls up some whales; with the ox-head as bait Thunder manages to hook the Middenyardswyrm itself; he loses it.

5. 26–27: Hymer challenges Thunder to carry the boat and whales back to his farm; he does.

6. 28–32: Hymer challenges Thunder to break a supposedly indestructible chalice; he succeeds by smashing it against the ettin's forehead.

7. 33–36: Thunder and Tew depart with the cauldron; they find themselves followed by Hymer and his ettins; Thunder kills them all.

8. 37–38: One of Thunder's goats goes halt.

9. 39: Thunder returns to the Gods with Hymer's cauldron; they host a banquet.

The fishing expedition found in the Scaldic fragments and *Gylf* 48 is represented by episodes 3–4. *Hym* is the only source to place the fishing expedition within the broader context of Thunder and Tew obtaining a cauldron from Hymer for the sake of brewing ale (episodes 1–2, 9).

It seems inescapable, both on the basis of the other Norse sources and broader comparative mythology, that both the frame narrative and the additional episodes (e.g. number 8) originally had nothing to do with Thunder's encounter with the Wyrm. They have in any case been woven together into a single narrative, probably by the poet himself, for the sake of a more entertaining story for an audience which was likely expecting certain common "Thunder's journey" tropes.

Although the poem is skilfully written this weaving-together has not been entirely successful and has resulted in a few few loose threads. The halt goat of sts. 37–38 (episode 8) finds a parallel in *Gylf* 44:17–21 where it serves as the origin story of Thunder's two child servants Thelve and Wrash who accompany him on the way to Outyards-Lock. These two children play an important part in the narrative of *Gylf* 44–47, but in *Hym* are an entirely superfluous detail—something the poet himself anticipates in his address to the audience. It is also strange that Lock should appear so late in the poem when he is not mentioned before or after; he too plays an important role in the Outyards-Lock story of *Gylf* 44–47.

A major superfluous element is the god Tew, who plays no role at all in the fishing expedition. He is last alluded to in st. 16 where Hymer speaks of

"[us] three", only to reappear in st. 33 where he fails to lift the cauldron. It is also rather strange that Tew shows no reaction to the murder of Hymer, his father, taking place right before his eyes (sts. 35–36), but for the paternity cf. *Hym* 5/3 n.

The simplest explanation for this is however that Tew originally had nothing to do with the encounter between Thunder and the Wyrm, and within the confines of *Hym* mainly serves to segue from the narrative of the cauldron-fetching to the fishing expedition. Strong support for this is found in the fact that Thunder in the other variants of the fishing-story only has one companion—Hymer. These variants include the pictoral depictions, which only show two figures seated in the boat.

## Style

When speaking of a composite poem, one must distinguish between a text where several originally separate works have been put together mostly unchanged, and a text composed by a single author drawing from multiple narrative sources. A likely example of the former is *Háv*, but *Hym* undoubtedly belongs to the latter category.

*Hym* has a distinct style and rhythm throughout which stands alone in the Poetic Edda. Indeed, the sharpest stylistic contrast is with the poem most similar content-wise, *Þrk*. Where *Þrk* is written in a rustic style with fairly loose Ancient-words-lay meter, repeats lines and even whole stanzas, *Hym* instead uses an unusually strict meter, avoids repetition, and revels in kennings, difficult grammatical constructions, and highly unnatural word order (see especially sts. 16/3–4, 20, and 39/3–4). These are all traits one associates more closely with Scaldic poetry in complex measures like Court-spoken meter than with Eddic poetry in Ancient-words-lay, and it seems certain that the anonymous poet of *Hym* must have had some training in the Scaldic art and familiarity with compositions in that genre. Two kennings (17/4a *brjótr berg-Dana*, 22/4 *umb-gjǫrð allra landa*) are even shared identically with Scaldic poems in Court-spoken meter.

## Meter and stanza

*Hym* consists of 152 long-lines divided into 39 stanzas. The typical length of a stanza is 4 lines (32/39 sts.: 1–5, 7–10, 12–23, 28–35, 37–39). Deviant stanzas with 2 lines (1 st.: 6), 3 lines (4 sts.: 24–26, 36), and 5 lines (2 sts.: 11, 27) are also represented. The 4-line stanzas generally have a semantic division between ll. 2 and 3 and thus consist of two helmings.

Of the deviant stanzas, st. 6 appears to represent an isolated helming and is thus likely missing two lines. 2/4 3-line sts. (24 and 25) are clearly corrupt owing to syntactical issues; on the other hand the 2 others (26 and 36) show no obvious corruption. The 2 5-line stanzas do not seem to be missing any lines; in both of them one may identify an additional fifth line (11/1, 27/5) which could be removed without hindering the form of the other 4, although that is not to say that these lines are necessarily later inserts. To conclude, the



Figure 4: Detail of Thunder on the Altuna stone. Wiking Age, ca. 1000 AD. © Bengt A. Lundberg, RAÄ. CC BY 4.0. `https://pub.raa.se/dokumentation/a4396e83-dac1-4f69-9cab-ff877da64e8d`

original *Hym* most likely only tolerated 4-line sts., with occasional exceptions for 5-line stanzas with a marked fifth line.

The meter of *Hym* is Ancient-words-lay, but of a stricter variant than that of any other poem in the Poetic Edda; this is especially true when it comes to the count and weight of syllables. Three-syllable lines are rare, and the ones that do exist can all be corrected by restoring older hiatus forms (see note to 23/1b below). The poet also has a notable tendency to avoid lines of type C1 (xP#Px) where both stresses are heavy, something shared with Scaldic poems in Lay-meter and with Eyel's Headransom. This probably explains his unique tendency to place the two-syllable preposition *fyrir* 'before, in front, (up) ahead' at the end of the b-verse (never the a-verse), which he does 6 times—more frequently than in any other Ancient-words-lay poem of the Poetic Edda.

## Dating

TODO. Hiatus forms, Þöarr, likely ritual reference, Icelandic.

## Text

### The Lay of Hymer

**1** Ár val-tívar · vęiðar nǫ́mu [R 13v/26, A 5v/25]
ok sumbl-samir · áðr saðir yrði,
hristu tęina · ok á hlaut sǫ́u,
fundu at Ę́gis · ør·kost hvera.

Of yore the slain-Tews ⟨Gods⟩ had caught game,
and, assembled at the simble before they might eat,
they shook the twigs and looked upon the leat;
they found at Eagre's a great choice of cauldrons.

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1 val-tívar 'slain-Tews' | The Gods, a rare epithet only otherwise found in *Vsp* 50/2, 59/4 (n.).

1 vęiðar 'game' | The root *vęið-* may refer both to hunting/catching food more broadly and to fishing specifically, although the latter sense predominates and is certainly the way it is used in 10/2 and 16/4 below.

2 sumbl-samir 'assembled at the simble' | A simble being a drinking-feast or banquet. For the simble of the Gods see *Grm* 37/6, 46/4–5, *Lok* (*passim*).

2 áðr saðir yrði 'before they might eat' | Lit. 'might become sated'.

3 hristu tęina · ok á hlaut sǫ́u 'they shook the twigs and looked upon the leat' | The Gods performed an augury, the details of which are not clear from this line alone. The term *hlaut* 'leat' is explained in *HákGóð* and *Eb* as the sacrificial blood of the slaughtered beasts, which was sprinkled by means of *hlaut-tęinar* 'leat-twigs'. These two words are also found together in an OE glossary, where *tán-hlyta* 'twig-allotter' glosses Latin *sortilegus*. Etymologically ON *hlaut* is identical to OS *hlôt* 'lot' (*Heli* 5547b), Gothic *hlauts* 'lot, inheritance' (Streitberg 1910, p. 58). If we trust these sources the simplest explanation is that the Gods sprinkled the animal blood and interpreted the patterns. In any case they found it most auspicious to feast at Eagre's.

4 Ę́gis 'Eagre's' | *Ę́gir* 'Eagre' is the spirit of the Sea, an ettin.

**2** Sat berg-búi · barn-tęitr fyrir, [R 13v/28, A 5v/27]
mjǫk g·líkr męgi · Miskur·blinda,
lęit í augu · Yggs barn í þrá:
„þú skalt ǫ́sum · opt sumbl gøra!“

The crag-dweller [ettin = Eagre] sat merry like a child ahead,
much like the son of Misherblind.
Into his eyes looked Ug's ⟨Weden's⟩ child [= Thunder] defiantly:
"For the Eese shalt thou oft make simbles!"

---

4 gøra 'make' | gefa *'give'* **A**

---

ALL | Having seen that the ettin Eagre has a great store of cauldrons, Thunder visits him and orders him to brew ale for the thirsty Eese.

2 mjǫk g·líkr męgi · Miskur·blinda 'much like the son of Misherblind' | An unexplained reference. *Miskur·blindi* 'Misherblind' might be another name for Firneet (*Fornjótr*), the father of Eagre (Sea), Lay (*Logi* 'Fire'), and Wind (*vindr*) (*Skm* 35, 36, *Yt* 4). The line would then be a tautology: "he looked just like the son his father"; for a similar tautology cf. *Vsp* 34/1–2.

**3** [R 13v/31, A 5v/29]

Ǫnn fekk jǫtni · orð-bęginn halr,
hugði at hęfndum · hann nęst við goð,
bað Sifjar ver · sér føra hver,
„þann's ek ǫllum ǫl · yðr of hęita."

Great toil for the ettin the word-peevish man [= Thunder] caused;
he thought of revenge, soon, against the god.
He bade Sib's husband [= Thunder] bring him a cauldron,
"that one with which I for you all might warm ale."

2 hęfndum | *composite;* hęfnd **A**; †hefdom† **R**

ALL | Eagre is upset at the demand but too cowardly to challenge Thunder openly. He instead gets back at him by demanding a single cauldron big enough to supply ale for all the Eese.

**4** [R 14r/1, A 5v/30]

Né þat mǫ́ttu · męrir tívar
ok ginn-regin · of geta hvęr≠gi,
und's af tryggðum · Týr Hlór·riða
ǫ́st-ráð mikit · ęinum sagði:

Yet of one could not the famous Tews
and the Yin-Reins anywhere get hold—
until, out of loyalty, Tew to Loride
a great loving counsel in private told:

3 Hlór·riða 'Loride' | 'The Loud/Bellowing Rider', a name for Thunder.

**5** [R 14r/3, A 6r/2]

„Býr fyr austan · Éli-vága
hund-víss Hymir · at himins ęnda;
á mǐnn faðir · móðugr kętil,
rúm-brugðinn hver · rastar djúpan."

"To the east of the Ilewaves dwells
the hundred-wise Hymer, at heaven's end.
My father [= Hymer] owns, fierce, a kettle:
a roomy cauldron one rest deep."

4 rúm-brugðinn | †rumbrygðan† **A**

1 fyr austan Éli-vága ‘To the east of the Ilewaves’ | According to *Vafþ* 31 the Ilewaves were the poisonous wild rivers from which the ettins emerged, and so it makes sense that they would be found in the east, where the ettins dwell. That Hymer should dwell even to the east of the Ilewaves then illustrates his unusually ettin-like nature.
For the notion we may compare the Greek Ὠκεανός ‘Ocean’, the world-encircling river, beyond which the world is supernatural and uncanny (*Od* 11.13–22, 155–160). In *Theog* 790–1, Ὠκεανός consists of nine rivers which flow out into the world-sea that surrounds the Earth (cf. West (1966, p. 201)), which has a Norse parallel in the Outer Sea (*Út-haf*), the sea surrounding the Earth in which the Middenyardswyrm dwells (cf. l. 2 n., 22/4 n. below). Like the Middenyardswyrm which bites its tail, so is Ὠκεανός given the epithet ἀφορρόος ‘back-flowing, flowing into itself’ (*Il* 18.399, *Od* 20.65, *Theog* 776).

2 hund-víss ‘hundred-wise’ | Alternatively “hound-wise”; the prefix simply means “very”, but the word is used exclusively for ettins, typically in the collocation *hund-víss jǫtunn* (so *HHj* 25, *Skm* 24, 26, *Gautr* 3, etc.).

2 himins ęnda ‘at heaven’s end’ | The heaven is thought of as a solid dome of stone, the earth as a flat disc (*Vsp* 3 n., *Hárb* 15 n.) Hymer thus lives at the very edge of the disc, next to the Outer Sea which encircles all lands and in which the Wyrm lies. For another ettin living at the edge of heaven cf. *Vafþ* 37.

3 mǐnn faðir ‘my father’ | A notable detail since Tew is elsewhere called the son of Weden (*Skm* 16) and it would be rather strange for the son of a male ettin to be afforded a place among the Eese due to the Norse patriarchal concern for male lineage. A possible explanation for this discrepancy is if Weden slept with Tew’s mother, the beautiful woman of st. 8, which would be an instance of the motif of a god mating with a beautiful ettin-woman as seen e.g. in *Skí*.

[Þórr kvað:] **6** „Vęitst, ef þiggjum · þann lǫg-velli?“ [**R** 14r/4, **A** 6r/4]
[Týr kvað:] 2 „Ef, vinr, vélar · vit gørum til!“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Knowest thou if we’ll get that liquid-boiler [CAULDRON]?” —
[Quoth Tew:] “If, friend, we two make use of wiles!”

ALL | Like elsewhere in this poem the speakers are not indicated, but it is most sensible that Thunder asks and Tew answers.

**7** Fóru drjúgum · dag frá≀liga [**R** 14r/5, **A** 6r/4]
2 Ǫs·garði frà · und’s til Ęgils kvǫmu;
hirði hafra · horn-gǫfgasta;
4 hurfu at hǫllu · es Hymir átti.

They journeyed far, swiftly at day,
away from Osyard until they came to Eyel;
he took care the he-goats noblest of horns—
they turned to the hall which Hymer owned.

1 dag frá≀liga ‘swiftly at day’ | *so* **A**; dag þann framm *‘on that day forth’ (unmetrical)* **R**. 2 Ęgils ‘Eyel’ | *so* **R**; Ęgis *‘Eagre’* **A**.

1 dag frá≀liga ‘swiftly at day’ | Finnur Jónsson (1932) proposes the emendation *dag þann framan* ‘from the beginning of the day’, but since **A** has a metrically sufficient reading its form is adopted here.

2 Ęgils 'Eyel' | The reading of **A** is probably from confusion with the ettin Eagre, who is mentioned earlier in the poem. Eyel, who takes Thunder's goats in possession, is not otherwise known. He may perhaps be identified with the farmer in *Gylf* 44:10–21, for which see Note to st. 37 below.

**8** [**R** 14r/7, **A** 6r/6]

Mǫgr fann ǫmmu, · mjǫk lęiða sér,
hafði hǫfða · hundruð níu,
ęn ǫnnur gekk · al-gollin framm
brún-hvít bera · bjór-vęig syni:

The lad [= Tew] found his grandmother very loathsome;
of heads she had nine hundred.
But another woman, all-golden, stepped forth,
white-browed, bringing a beer-draught for her son [= Tew]:

2 hafði hǫfða · hundruð níu 'of heads she had nine hundred' | Malformed bodies, especially with a deviant number of body parts, are typical of ettins. Other examples include a three-headed thurse in *Skí* 31, the nine-headed ettin Thriwold (Bragi Frag 3 in SkP 3), and the eight-armed Starked Eeldreng. Cf. Introduction and st. 35 below.

3 ǫnnur 'another woman' | The use of the word "son" in the following line reveals this as Tew's mother. The poet stresses her beauty of dress and countenance, in contrast to the grandmother.

[Týs móðir:]

**9** [**R** 14r/9, **A** 6r/8]

„Átt-niðr jǫtna · ek vilja'k ykkr
hug-fulla tvá · und hvera sętja;
es mínn frí*i* · mǫrgu sinni
gløggr við gęsti · gǫrr ills hugar."

[Tew's mother:]

"O clansman of ettins [= Tew]! I would wish to place
you two, full of heart, beneath the cauldrons.
Many a time has my lover [= Hymer] been
stingy with guests, quick to ill mood."

2 hug-fulla | hug-fulla hug-fulla **R** 3 frí*i* 'lover' | *so* **R**; faðir *'father'* **A**

2 tvá 'two' | Here an instance of contraction < **tvâa* also found in st. 15/4 below, but cf. 21/2b which has the disyllabic form. It appears the poet was willing to use either form to accomodate the meter.

4 gløggr ... hugar 'stingy ... mood' | Ettins are characteristically inhospitable, in stark opposition to the Old Germanic social norms; see Introduction to the poem above. This statement foreshadows the later fishing expedition starting at st. 16 below.

**10** [**R** 14r/11, **A** 6r/9]

Ęn vá-skapaðr · varð síð-búinn,
harð-ráðr Hymir, · hęim af vęiðum;
gekk inn í sal, · glumðu jǫklar,
vas karls, es kom, · kinn-skógr frørinn.

But the misshapen one was come late,
hard-minded Hymer, home from fishing.

He entered the hall; icicles clattered;
on the churl who came was the cheek-shaw [BEARD] frozen.

1 síð-búinn ‘delayed’ | *om.* **A**

3 jǫklar ‘icicles’ | In Hymer’s frozen beard. In modern Icelandic the word *jökull* has come to mean ‘glacier’, but its original sense (as found here) is that of its English cognate “icicle”.

4 karls ‘churl’ | The first of three instances in the poem of Hymer being called a *karl* ‘churl, old man, peasant’; a reference to his boorish nature. For the sense of this word in ON poetry (in contrast to both ON prose and later Scandinavian languages) see *Hárb* 2 n.

[Týs móðir:]

**11** „Ves hęill, Hymir, · ĩ hugum góðum! [**R** 14r/13, **A** 6r/11]
Nú ’s sonr kominn · til sala þĩnna,
sá’s vit vęttum · af vegi lǫngum;
fylgir hǫnum · Hróðrs and·skoti,
vinr ver-liða; · Vé·urr hęitir sá.

[Tew’s mother:]

“Be thou hale, Hymer, in good spirits!
Now the son has come to thy halls,
he whom we’ve awaited, from a long way off.
He is followed by Rooder’s enemy [= Thunder],
the friend of manly retinues—Wighward is he called.

1 Ves hęill, … ĩ hugum góðum! ‘Be thou hale … in good spirits!’ | A formulaic greeting; cf. the almost identical greeting in N B380 (edited below under Galders). Further afield cf. the type exemplified by *Beow* 407a: *Wæs þú, Hróð-gâr, hâl* ‘Be thou, Rothgar, hale!’

5 Vé·urr ‘Wighward’ | The guardian of wighs (sanctuaries), a name of Thunder.

**12** Sé hvar sitja · und salar gafli, [**R** 14r/15, **A** 6r/13]
svá forða sér, · stęndr súl fyrir.“
Sundr stǫkk súla · fyr sjǫn jǫtuns,
ęn áðr ĩ tvau · áss brotnaði.

See where they sit beneath the hall’s gable:
so they save themselves—a column stands before them!”
The column burst apart before the ettin’s gaze,
but earlier the roof-beam broke in two.

2 forða sér | forða=sk **A** 2 súl ‘column’ | sól **A**

2 súl ‘column’ | A hapax in ON, though attested in modern Icelandic. *súl* is the strong form of the weak *súla* ‘id.’ as found in the very next line.

**13** Stukku átta, · ęn ęinn af þęim [**R** 14r/17, **A** 6r/15]
hverr harð-slęginn · hęill af þolli;
framm gingu þęir, · ęn forn jǫtunn

sjǫnum lęiddi · sínn and·skota.

Eight [cauldrons] crashed down, but one of them,
a hard-forged cauldron, [came] whole off its peg.
Forth they went, but the ancient ettin
with his gaze tracked his enemy.

1–2 Stukku … þolli ‘Eight … peg.’ | Nine cauldrons were hanging from the roof-beam supported by the column behind which the gods were hiding. Eight of them broke from the fall, but one remained whole; we may presume that this one was the famed cauldron which the gods had come to get.

**14** Sagði=t hǫnum · hugr vel þá's sá [**R** 14r/19, **A** 6r/16]
gýgjar gróti · á golf kominn,
þar vǫru þjórar · þrír of tęknir,
það sęnn jǫtunn · sjóða ganga.

His heart did not please him when he saw
the gigh's distresser [= Thunder] come upon the floor.
There were three bulls a-taken;
the ettin bade them at once go cook.

2 gróti ‘distresser’ | gęti *‘keeper, warder’* **A** 4 sęnn ‘at once’ | sun *‘[bis] son [= Tew]?’* **A**

1 Sagði=t hǫnum · hugr vel ‘His heart did not please him’ | Lit. “his heart did not speak well to him”.

**15** Hvęrn létu þęir · hǫfði skęmmra [**R** 14r/21, **A** 6r/18]
auk á sęyði · síðan bóru,
át Sifjar verr · áðr sofa gingi,
ęinn með ǫllu · øxn tvá Hymis.

Each one they made shorter by a head
and onto the cooking-pit then did carry.
Sib's husband [= Thunder] ate, before he went to sleep,
alone by himself two of Hymer's oxen.

3–4 át … Hymis. ‘Sib's … oxen.’ | Cf. *Þrk* 24 for another instance of Thunder's great eating, which curiously also uses the kenning *Sifjar verr* ‘Sib's husband [= Thunder]’.

**16** Þótti hǫrum · Hrungnis spjalla [**R** 14r/23, **A** 6r/19]
verðr Hlór·riða · vęl full-mikill,
[Hymir:] „munum at aptni · ǫðrum verða
við vęiði-mat · vér þrír lifa.“

To Rungner's hoary friend [= Hymer] did seem
Loride's eating far too great—

"Next evening will we three
on fished food have to live."

ALL | Hymer's stinginess—he refuses to share more of his own food but instead forces his guests to go fish—breaks all Indo-European rules of hospitality and illustrates the otherness of the Ettins; see Introduction above.

3–4 munum ... lifa. 'Next ... live.' | The poet is pushing at the limits of Old Norse syntax. In prose word order it should be construed as: *at ǫðrum aptni munum vér þrír verða lifa við vęiði-mat*, where *verða* 'have to, must' is used like its modern German cognate *werden*.

**17** [R 14r/24, A 6r/21]

Vé·urr kvað=sk vilja · á vág róa,
ef ballr jǫtunn · bęitur gęfi.
[Hymir:] „Hverf til hjarðar, · ef hug trúir,
brjótr berg-Dana, · bęitur sókja.

Wighward called himself willing to row on the wave
if the stubborn ettin might give pieces of bait.
[Hymer:] "Turn to the herd if thou trustest thy heart—
O breaker of boulder-Danes [ETTINS > = Thunder]—to seek pieces of bait.

3 Hverf | *so (*'hverf þu'*)* **A**; †hverfo† *(for* *'hverf þu'*)* **R**. 3 hjarðar | hallar *corr.* **A**

4 brjótr berg-Dana 'breaker of boulder-Danes [ETTINS > = Thunder]' | The same kenning for Thunder also occurs in *Haustl* 18. The kenning-type, which is not uncommon, emphasises the otherness of the Ettins (see Introduction to the poem) by equating them with ethnic foreigners or enemies (Marold 1990). The most prolific use of it is seen in *Þdr*, where ettins are called Scots, Brythons, Swedes, Danes, Ruges and Harths, all peoples hostile to the Norwegian Earl Hathkin, at whose court that poem may have been composed.

**18** [R 14r/26, A 6r/23]

Þęss vęntir mik, · at þér myni=t
ǫgn at oxa · auð-fęng vesa."
Sveinn sýsliga · sveif til skógar,
þar's oxi stóð · al-svartr fyrir.

I expect that the bait from the ox
will not be an easy catch for thee!"
The swain [= Thunder] swiftly turned to the wood
where an ox stood, all-black, ahead.

1 vęntir mik | *so* **A**; vęnti ek *(norm.)* **R** 1 myni=t 'will not' | *so* **A**; myni *'will'* **R**. *The* **A** *reading is preferable since it makes this the first of Hymer's several challenges of strength to Thunder, which the god, to the ettin's humiliation, easily accomplishes.*

3 Sveinn 'The swain' | Thunder was in the shape of a young boy (cf. *Hárb* 1/1 for the semantics of *sveinn*), a detail which is also found in *Gylf* 48:4; see Introduction to the poem.

4 oxi ... al-svartr 'ox ... all-black' | Formulaic, also occuring in *Þrk* 23; see note there for further parallels to the custom of sacrificing animals of certain colours. It seems that all-black oxen were thought the noblest, and so Thunder's slaying one instead of an inferior beast is probably intended to humiliate the stingy Hymer. — We learn more about this ox in *Gylf* 48:13: *Hann tók inn mesta uxa'nn, er Himin-brjóðr hét, ok sleit af hǫfuð'it ok fór með til sjávar.* 'He took the greatest ox, which was called Heavenrid, and tore off its head and went with it to the sea'.

**19** Braut af þjóri · þurs ráð-bani [R 14r/28, A 6r/24]
hǫ́-tún ofan · horna tveggja.
[Hymir:] „Verk þikkja þín · verri myklu
kjóla valdi · an kyrr sitir.“

Off from the bull the thurse's death-planner [= Thunder]
broke the high meadow of two horns [HEAD] from above.—
[Hymer:] "Worse by far thy works appear
to the wielder of keels [= Hymer = me] than if thou wouldst sit calm!"

4 kjóla valdi 'wielder of keels' | I.e., 'master of ships', foreshadowing the later fishing expedition. — *valdi* is here taken as dat. sg. of *valdr* 'wielder, master' and as the indirect object of *þykkja* 'seem, appear'. The word can however also be read as the semantically identical nom. sg. *valdi*, in which case the phrase would be a vocative addressing Thunder. In context the former reading makes more sense: the kenning 'ruler of keels' fits better for Hymer than Thunder and *þykkja* gets an indirect object.

**20** Bað hlunn-gota · hafra dróttinn [R 14r/30, A 6r/26]
átt-runn apa · útar føra,
ǫn sá jǫtunn · sína talði,
lítla fýsi · at róa lǫngra.

The Lord of He-goats bade the kinsman of the ape [ETTIN = Hymer]
push the launcher-steed [BOAT] further out,
but that ettin told of his
little wish to row any longer.

2 átt-runn | †atrænn† **A** 3 talði | milldi *corr.* **A**

ALL | The scene shifts and the party is out at sea. It is possible that a stanza has been lost here, or that the transition would have been indicated in some other way during oral performance.

1 hafra dróttinn 'Lord of He-goats' | Thunder. Reoccurs in 31/1 below; cf. *Þrk* 21/1.

2 apa 'ape' | The specific sense of *api* 'ape' is uncertain. It seems generally to refer to a fool, but see Index.

3–4 ǫn ... róa. 'but ... longer.' | Thunder's humorous humiliation of Hymer continues with the snide ettin now forced to row against his will.

4 at róa lǫngra | The alliteration falls on the second stressed word which is not expected; emendation to **lǫngra at róa* is metrically convenient but not supported by either ms.

**21** Dró mǫ́rr Hymir · móðugr hvali [R 14r/31, A 6r/27]
ǫ́inn á ǫngli · upp sǫnn tvá*a*;
ǫn aptr í skut · Óðni sifjaðr
Vé·urr við vélar · vað gǫ́rði sér.

Famous Hymer, fierce, pulled whales:
one on the hook, soon up two—

but back in the stern the Weden-affinitive
Wighward ⟨= Thunder⟩ craftily fixed his line.

1 mę́rr ‘famous’ | *so* **R**; męirr *‘more, further’* **A**

1 hvali | A rare acc. pl. form also occurring in 26/2b.

3 Óðni sifjaðr ‘Weden-affinitive’ | I.e., the one related to Weden, an adjective describing Wighward (Thunder).

**22** Ęgnði á ǫngul · sá’s ǫldum bergr, [R 14v/1, A 6r/29]
2 orms ęin-bani · oxa hǫfði;
gęin við agni · sú’s goð fía
4 umb-gjǫrð neðan · allra landa.

On the hook baited he who rescues men—
the Wyrm’s lone slayer—the ox’s head.
At the bait snapped the one whom the Gods hate—
the engirdler of all lands—from below.

3 agni ‘bait’ | *so* **A**; ǫngli *‘hook’* **R**

ALL | This stanza skilfully juxtaposes Thunder and the Wyrm by employing strong parallelism across the two helmings (ll. 1–2 and 3–4). The poetic juxtaposition between the two primordial enemies, Storm-God and Serpent, is also found in the Scaldic fragments (e.g. Qlv *Þórr*; see note to l. 4) and, further afield, in the Vedic tradition (e.g. *ṚV* 1.32.13c: *Índraṣ ca yád · yuyudʰ́āt ē Áhiṣ ca* ‘When Índra and the Wyrm (*áhi*) fought each other.’)

2 orms ęin-bani ‘Wyrm’s lone slayer’ | Watkins (1995, pp. 419–424) sees in this kenning for Thunder a reflex of the ancient IE formula HERO SLAY (PIE **gʷʰen-*) SERPENT, where the root **gʷʰen-* ‘slay, kill’ is reflected in ON by the agent noun *bani* ‘bane, slayer’ < **gʷʰon-ō* (so e.g. Seebold 1967, pp. 113–114, although the sound change **gʷʰ-* > **b-* is not universally accepted; see Kroonen 2013, pp. xxxviii, 51). The IE formula, reconstructed as **hₑé·gʷʰent hₑógʷʰim* ‘he slew the Serpent’, occurs directly only as OI *áhann Áhim* (11 times in *ṚV*; see Watkins 1995, pp. 304 ff.), but has parallels throughout the IE family, including Greek and Hittite (Watkins 1995, *passim*).
On the basis of the rare sound combination **-gʷʰ- : -gʷʰ-*, Wikander (2021) argues brilliantly that the IE formula was likely phono-semantically calqued from IE into Northwest Semitic as the formulaic rhyming phrase **maḫaṣa naḫaša(m)* ‘he struck the serpent’ (which features another rare and highly marked phoneme, the ejective **ṣ́* [ᵗɬ]), perhaps along with the Chaoskampf myth as a whole.

4 umb-gjǫrð ... allra landa ‘engirdler of all lands’ | The same kenning is found in a fragment by Alewigh Snub (Qlv *Þórr* in SkP 3) quoted in *Skm* 11: *Ósti=sk allra landa · umb-gjǫrð ok sonr Jarðar* ‘The engirdler of all lands and the son of Earth surged.’ Closely related is the kenning in a 9th c. fragment by Bray the Old quoted in the same chapter (Bragi *Þórr* 3 in SkP 3): *ęndi-sęiðr allra landa* ‘boundary-saithe of all lands’. Both kennings relate to the cosmological idea of the Outer Sea (ON *Út-haf*) which surrounds the solid Earth; in this sea lies the Wyrm, biting its tail and enwrapping the lands. Cf. st. 5/1 n. above.

**23** Dró djarf=liga · dáð-rakkr Þó*a*rr [R 14v/3, A 6v/1]
2 orm ęitr-fá*a*n · upp at borði;
hamri kníði · hǫ́-fjall skarar

4 of-ljótt ofan · ulfs hnit-bróðr.

Bravely, deed-ready Thunder pulled
the venom-gleaming Wyrm up on the gunwale.
With the hammer he struck the high mountain of hair [HEAD]—
very hideous, from above—on the Wolf's clash-brother [= the Wyrm].

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1 djarf=liga | *so* **A**; †diafliga† **R**

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1 Þòarr 'Thunder' | Out of 8 three-syllable lines in *Hym*, this is the only one which is deficient in both **R** and **A** and cannot easily be emended by restoring an hiatus form. In the quite strict meter (see Introduction above) observed by the *Hym* poet we should expect a disyllabic form in this spot, and this may be had if we restore an archaic **Þóarr* or **Þórr*. Such a form is less secure than other hiatus forms, but is also metrically required in *Hym* 28/2b below and further in the Scaldic *Þdr* 2/2b. This issue is treated in depth by Haukur Þorgeirsson (2023), who argues for the form **Þórr*.

3 hǫ́-fjall skarar 'high mountain of hair [HEAD]' | A rather unfitting kenning, since serpents do not have hair.

**24** Hr*au*n-gǫlkn hrutu, · ęn hǫlkn þutu, [**R** 14v/5, **A** 6v/2]
2 fór hin forna · fold ǫll saman;
[...]
søkkði=sk síðan · sá fiskr í mar.

The waste-monsters [ETTINS] bounded and bedrock resounded;
the ancient earth moved all at once.
[...]
Thereafter sank that Fish into the sea.

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1 Hr*au*n-gǫlkn 'The waste-monsters' | *emend.;* hręin-gǫlkn **AR** 1 hrutu | *so* **A**; hlumðu *'dashed'* **R**.

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1 Hr*au*n-gǫlkn 'The waste-monsters' | Both mss. have *hręin-*, which may mean either 'clean' or 'reindeer', neither of which make sense Semantically. On the other hand *braun* ONP: 'stone/barren area, wasteland; lavafield' is well attested in Scaldic kennings for ettins, including in the present poem (36/4, 38/3). The precise meaning of *galkn* 'monster' (plural *gǫlkn*) is unclear, but it is attested in 3 Scaldic verses, in all cases as the base-word in kennings of the type "troll-woman of the shield [AXE]", which may suggest that it (like another neuter word, *flagð*) refers specifically to female malevolent beings.
While the mss. spelling '*galkn*' (norm. *gálkn*) could reflect either singular or plural, the form of the verb is plural. This means that the word cannot be referring to the Middenyardswyrm as Larrington (2014) understands it in her translation: "the sea-wolf shrieked".

1 hrutu | The **A** reading is preferred since it has the metrically required short root syllable. End rhyme is parallelled elsewhere in the poem (st. 3/3); here it heightens the dramatic impact of the verse.

2 [...] | It is very likely that a line is missing here, since the stanzas in the poem fairly consistently have 4 lines and since the *síðan* 'thereafter' in l. 3 is left without a referent. In other tellings of the myth it is at this point that Hymer cuts Thunder's fishing line, so that is probably what has been lost. Cf. *Gylf* 48:26–27: *Þá er sagt, at jǫtunn'inn Hymir gerði=sk lit-verpr, fǫlnaði ok hréddi=sk, er hann sá orm'inn ok þat er sér'inn fell út ok inn of nǫkkvann. Ok í því bili, er Þórr greip hamar'inn ok fórði á loft, þá fálmaði jǫtunn'inn til agn-saxi'nu ok hjó vað Þórs á borði, en ormr'inn søkkði=sk í sę́'inn.* 'Then it is said that the ettin Hymer lost his colour, turned pale and was frightened when he saw the Wyrm and how the sea fell in and out of the boat. And in that moment when Thunder gripped the hammer and brought it aloft then the ettin reached for the bait-cutting knife and cut Thunder's fishing-line against the gunwale. But the Wyrm sunk into the sea.'
Based on this account we may reconstruct a hypothetical line **und's fǫlr Hymir · fekk á saxi* 'until pale Hymer grasped the knife'.

3 fiskr 'fish' | A good example showing that pre-modern speciation, especially in poetry, was not exact. The appellation is not a mere fancy of the poet, for the Wyrm appears in the shape of a fish in various pre-Christian pictorial sources (e.g. GP 21). It may also be called a fish in *Grm* 21 (see note there), and in Scaldic sources it is often called a saithe (*sęiðr*).

**25** Ǫ́·tęitr jǫtunn, · es aptr røru, [R 14v/6, A 6v/3]
[...]
2 svá't ár Hymir · ękki mélti,
vęifði róði · veðrs annars til.

The unmerry ettin [= Hymer], as they rowed back,
[...]
so that for a long time Hymer said not a thing;
he pulled the oar against the wind:

---

1 [...] | Another likely missing line. As noted in the previous stanza the meter usually requires four lines; more importantly the first half of the sentence is incomplete without a verb.

2 svá't ár 'so that for a long time' | Finnur Jónsson (1932) suggests *svá't at ýr* 'so that by the oar', but this burdens the strict meter. For this sense of *ár* cf. *Ski* 27.

[Hymir:] **26** „Munt of vinna · verk halft við mik, [R 14v/8, A 6v/4]
2 at hęim hvali · haf til bójar
eða flot-brúsa · fęstir okkarn.“

[Quoth Hymer:] "Thou wilt accomplish a half work compared to me,
if thou bringest home the whales to the farm,
or our float-buck [BOAT] thou dost fasten."

---

ALL | Hymer tells Thunder, who having let go of the Wyrm has nothing to show for the trip, that he can accomplish something half as great as the catching of the whales if he carries them home and ties the boat by the shore.

**27** Gekk Hlór·riði · gręip á stafni [R 14v/9, A 6v/6]
2 vatt með austri · upp lǫg-fáki;
ęinn með ǫ́rum · ok með aust-skotu

bar til bójar · brim-svín jǫtuns
ok holt-riða · hver í gęgnum.

Loride went, grasped the stern,
hurled up the lake-nag [BOAT] with the bilge-water.
Alone with the oars and the bilge-bucket
he bore to the farm the ettin's brim-swines [WHALES],
even through the spring of woodland ridges.

1 á | til á **R** 5 holt-riða | †holtriba† **R**

2 með austri 'with the bilge-water' | That is, the bilge-water was still inside the boat; another impressive work of strength.

5 holt-riða hver 'spring of woodland ridges' | An uncertain geographical description apparently meant to impress the audience as a particularly impressive feat. In Iceland *hverr* 'cauldron' also carries the sense '(hot) spring', in which case this could be an attestation of Thunder's prowess in wading (for which see *Grm* 29). TODO: What do other editors and translators say?

**28** Ok ęnn jǫtunn · umb afr-endi, [**R** 14v/12, **A** 6v/7]
þrá-girni vanr, · við Þóar sęnti,
kvað=at mann ramman, · þó'tt róa kynni,
krǫptur=ligan, · nema kalk bryti.

And yet the ettin, used to stubbornness,
over strength of hand with Thunder flyted.
He would call no man strong, even though he could row
mightily, unless he broke the chalice.

1 Ok | Enn **A**

ALL | Even after witnessing several great feats of strength Hymer still refuses to admit Thunder's superiority. He now insists on challenging him to break his indestructible chalice.

**29** Ęn Hlór·riði, · es at hǫndum kom, [**R** 14v/14, **A** 6v/9]
brátt lét bresta · bratt-stęin glęri,
sló sitjandi · súlur í gǫgnum;
bǫru þó hęilan · fyr Hymi síðan,

But Loride, when it came to his hands,
impatiently crushed steep stone with the glass.
He struck right through the standing columns,
yet they brought it, whole, before Hymer thereafter,

2 bratt-stęin glęri 'steep stone with the glass' | Thunder broke the stone columns in Hymer's house with the glass chalice.

3 sitjandi 'standing' | This word is ambiguous and can modify either Thunder (in which case it would mean "sitting") or the columns (*súlur*). I have chosen the latter and read it as signifying their stability.

**30** und's þat hin fríða · friðla kęndi [R 14v/16, A 6v/10]
ǫst-ráð mikit, · ęitt es vissi,
„drep við haus Hymis, · hann 's harðari,
kost-móðs jǫtuns, · kalki hvęrjum!“

until the handsome mistress [= Tew's mother] gave
a great loving counsel, the one she knew:
"Strike against Hymer's skull! It is harder—
the choice-weary ettin's—than any chalice."

1 hin | *so* **A**; 'ið' *(n. nom. sg.)* **R** 4 hvęrjum | *so* **A**; hvęrju *(n. dat. sg.)* **R**.

1–2 und's ... vissi, 'until ... knew:' | Harkening back to st. 4.

3 haus Hymis, · hann 's harðari 'Hymer's skull! It is harder' | Ettins characteristically have hard skulls; cf. *Hárb* 15 and note for the significance of this minor detail.

4 kost-móðs 'choice-weary' | Hymer can justly be called "choice-weary" since at this point the gods have destroyed eight of his nine cauldrons and slain three of his bulls.

**31** Harðr ręis á kné · hafra dróttinn, [R 14v/18, A 6v/12]
fórðisk allra · í ǫs-męgin;
hęill vas karli · hjalm-stofn ofan,
ęn vín-fęrill · valr rifnaði.

On his knee rose the hard Lord of He-goats;
he brought himself to his highest Os-might.
Whole on the churl [= Hymer] was the helm-stump [HEAD] above,
but the round wine-track [CHALICE] rent apart.

1 ręis | *om.* **A**

2 fórðisk allra · í ǫs-męgin 'brought himself into his fullest Os-might' | The exact meaning of this is not clear, but a likely reading is that Thunder brings himself into his true form as the mighty, red-bearded man; recall that he was previously (st. 18/3) in the shape of a young boy. Cf. *Gylf* 48:24 in its description of Thunder attempting to pull up the Wyrm: *Þá varð Þórr reiðr ok fórði=sk í ǫs-megin* […] 'Then Thunder turned wroth and brought himself into his Os-might' and Eddic fragment 6, st. 1.

[Hymir kvað:] **32** „Mǫrg vęit'k męti · mér gingin frá, [R 14v/20, A 6v/13]
es kalki sé'k · fyr knéum hrundit,“
karl orð of kvað: · „ká'k=at sęgja
aptr ęva=gi: · ‚þú 'st ǫlðr of hęitt.‘

[Quoth Hymer:] "I know many treasures parted from me
when I see the chalice thrown before [my] knees!"—
The churl [= Hymer] spoke words: "I cannot say
ever again: 'Thou art, ale, well warmed!'

2 es | *om.* **R** 2 fyr | ýr **R**; firi **A** 2 kn*é*um | *metr. emend.;* knjám *(norm.)* **RA** 4 hęitt | *so* **A**; †hętt† **R**.

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3–4 kná'k=at ... of hęitt. 'I cannot ... warmed!' | Hymer laments that with the loss of his finest vessel he will never be able to enjoy his drink again, ironically since it was he who challenged Thunder to break it in the first place. For 'warmed' (*hęitt*) ale cf. st. 3/4 above.

**33** Þat 's til kostar · ef koma mętti ð [**R** 14v/22, **A** 6v/15]
úr hór ǫru · ǫl-kjól hofi."
Týr lęitaði · tysvar hróra;
stóð at hvǫru · hverr kyrr fyrir.

It would be choicest if ye might bring
that ale-vessel [CAULDRON] out from our hall."
Tew attempted twice to move it—
each time stood the cauldron unmoved ahead.

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2 ǫl-kjól 'ale-vessel [CAULDRON]' | *ǫl-kjól* is the accusative of *ǫl-kjóll*, but in this construction (CV: *koma*, B) we would expect the dative *ǫl-kjóli*. Since the meter does not allow for this the poet has probably taken a grammatical liberty.

2 hofi 'hall' | This is the only Old Norse occurrence of the word *hof* in the sense "hall, house"—it otherwise only means "temple" (hove). The West Germanic cognates consistently mean "hall", but that is probably the original sense, so it is unclear if this is an instance of foreign (if so, most likely Anglo-Saxon) influence or just a poetic archaism.

**34** Faðir Móða · fekk á þrępmi [**R** 14v/24, **A** 6v/16]
ok í gęgnum stęig · golf niðr í sal;
hóf=sk á h*au*fuð upp · hver Sifjar verr,
ęn á hęlum · hringar skullu.

The father of Moody [= Thunder] grasped the brim
and stepped through the floor in the hall.
Up onto his head heaved Sib's husband [= Thunder] the cauldron,
but by his heels the rings clattered.

---

2 stęig 'stepped' | *so* **R**; stóð *'stood'* **A** 2 í | á *(norm.)* **A**

---

2 ok í gęgnum stęig · golf niðr í sal 'and stepped through the floor in the hall' | In *Gylf* 48:24 Thunder is said to have stepped through the boat when trying to pull up the Middenyardswyrm, a detail famously depicted on the Altuna runestone (U 1611) from Uppland, Sweden and the Hørdum stone from Denmark. It is very likely that the original detail of Thunder exerting himself to the point of his feet going through the bottom of the boat has later been transposed to this place in the narrative, although it is unclear whether this is the work of the poet himself or of an earlier tradition.

3 h*au*fuð 'head' | The archaic long form *haufuð* rather than the short *hǫfuð* is metrically superior in a type B verse (TODO: cite MalesTODO note). Cf. the similar line 36/1 below.

4 hringar skullu 'the rings clattered' | I.e. the chain-links. This detail is mentioned in an example sentence contrasting long and short phonemes in *FGT* 1950: *heyrði til hǫddu, þá er Þórr bar hverinn* 'the sound of the pot-links (*hadda*) was heard when Thunder bore the cauldron'. According to Finnur Jónsson (1932) the chain (or *hadda*) on a Wiking-age cauldron would reach across it, being bound on two opposing points along the rim, in which case this would be a reference to the cauldron's enormous size, with its diameter—mentioned in st. 5 as one rest—being roughly the same as Thunder's height.

**35** [R 14v/26, A 6v/18]

Fóru=t lęngi, · áðr líta nam
aptr Óðins sonr · ęinu sinni;
sá ór hręysum · með Hymi austan
folk-drótt fara · fjǫl-hǫfðaða.

They did not journey for long before Weden's son
took to look back a single time.
He saw out of stone-heaps with Hymer from the east
a war-troop coming, many-headed.

4 folk-drótt ... fjǫl-hǫfðaða 'war-troop ... many-headed' | The adjective *fjǫl-hǫfðaðr* means 'many-headed, polycephalic' and is not referring to the size of the host. For many-headed ettins see st. 8 and for their malformed bodies in general see Introduction to the poem.

**36** [R 14v/28, A 6v/19]

Hóf sér af hęrðum · hver standandi,
vęifði Mjǫllni · morð-gjǫrnum framm,
ok hraun-hvala · hann alla drap.

He heaved off his shoulders the cauldron, standing,
swung the murder-eager Millner forth,
and all the whales of the waste [ETTINS] he slew.

ALL | For another light-hearted instance of Thunder's ettin-bashing cf. *Þrk* 31–32.

2 morð-gjǫrnum 'murder-eager' | By this adjective the poet gives the Hammer something of a will of its own; cf. *Skm* 43, where the Hammer is said to always return to Thunder when thrown, perhaps by its own will. With this may be connected the curious fact that several pagan hammer-amulets of the Wiking Age depict the Hammer with a mouth, nose, and eyes. Three such finds are the silver hammer from Bredsättra, Öland, Sweden (item number 106666 HST), the gilt silver hammer from Ödeshög, East Geatland, Sweden (108249 HST), and the silver hammer from Baron Claes Kurck's collection found somewhere in Scania (106659 HST), the last of which is reproduced in Fig. 5, p. 298.

**37** [R 14v/30, A 6v/21]

Fóru=t lęngi, · áðr liggja nam
hafr Hlór·riða · half-dauðr fyrir,
vas skęr skǫkuls · skakkr á bęini,
ęn því hinn lę́-vísi · Loki of olli.

They did not journey for long before Loride's he-goat
took to lie half-dead ahead.

The colt of the cart-pole [GOAT] was halt in the leg,
but that the guile-wise Lock had caused.

3 skę́r | *emend. from meaningless* †skirr† **RA** 3 bę́ni | banni **R**

ALL | Sts. 37–38 deal with one of Thunder's goats going halt and an ettin farmer giving up two of his children in return. A related story is also found in *Gylf* 44:9–21 and may be summarized as follows:
Thunder and Lock were on the way to visit Outyards-Lock and stayed the night with a certain farmer. For supper Thunder cut his two goats and invited the farmer and his family to dine with him. After they had eaten he spread the goatskins before the fire and bade the housefolk throw the bones of the goats on top of them. The farmer's son stealthily pried open the thigh of one of the goats and ate the marrow. At dawn Thunder blessed the goatskins with his hammer and the goats came back to life, but the one Thelve had cut had a halt leg. Thunder was enraged, but the farmer begged for his life and offered to give up his two children, namely his son Thelve and his daughter Wrash. Thunder spared him, and the two became his servants.
The present stanza may reference a version of the same myth wherein Lock has a part to play in the halting of the goat, perhaps by encouraging Thelve to pry the bone open; this is strongly supported by *Skm* 23 where Lock is called *þjóf* […] *hafrs* 'thief of the he-goat', almost certainly Thunder's. The farmer may be identified with Eyel, with whom the goats were left in st. 7 above, so it is probably also Eyel who gives away his two children (Thelve and Wrash) in st. 38.

**38** Ę́n ér hę́yrt hafið, · hvę́rr kann umb þat [**R** 14v/32, **A** 6v/22]
goð-mǫ́lugra · gørr at skilja,
hvę́r af hraun-búa · hann laun of fekk,
es bę́ði galt · bǫrn sín fyrir.

But ye have heard—about that can each
god-speaking man more clearly discern—
what recompense *he* [= Thunder] got from the waste-dweller [ETTIN]
when he [= the ettin] paid up both of his own children for it.

1 ér 'ye' | The listeners. A direct address to the audience of this type is otherwise unparallelled in Eddic mythological poetry. Such are, however, typical for the Scaldic poems with which *Hym* shares several traits; see Introduction above. Cf. st. 39/3–4 n.

1–2 hvę́rr … goð-mǫ́lugra 'each god-speaking man' | Literally "each of the god-speaking ones". *goð-mǫ́lugr* 'god-speaking' is an hapax, but easily understood as "learned in the lore of the gods".

**39** Þrótt-ǫflugr kom · á þing goða [**R** 15r/1, **A** 6v/24]
ok hafði hver, · þann's Hymir átti;
ę́n véar hvę́rjan · vę́l skulu drikka
ǫlðr at Ę́gis · ę́itt hǫr-mę́itið.

The one strong of vigour came to the Thing of the Gods
and had the cauldron which Hymer had owned—
but the Wighers ⟨Gods⟩ shall drink well
one ale-feast at Eagre's every flax-cutter [SUMMER?].

1 Þrótt-ǫflugr 'The one strong of vigour' | Thunder.

3–4 ęn véar hvęrjan · vęl skulu drikka / ǫlðr at Ęgis · ęitt hǫr-męitið ‘but the Wighers ⟨Gods⟩ well shall drink / one ale-feast at Eagre’s every flax-cutter [SUMMER?].’ | Regardless of whether *(ęitt) hǫr-męitið* means [SUMMER] or [WINTER] (see note), these concluding lines seems to describe the Gods celebrating a yearly seasonal festival (*ǫlðr*). The fact that this is mentioned at the very end of the poem seems to give an etiological purpose to the whole narrative; with the claiming of the cauldron the Gods are henceforth able to enjoy an abundance of drink at a specified point each year. The festival alluded to is probably equivalent to an annual agricultural festival celebrated by humans, since the cult of the Gods serves as the model for the human religion (*Vsp* 7/2 n.), and with that in mind we can deduce that *Hym* was likely composed for recitation either at a festival taking place in late July or at Yule—a unique insight into the performance of Eddic poetry. This is further supported by the address of the audience in st. 38 above. — The word order is unusually complex for an Eddic poem but is not unprecedented in *Hym* (e.g. st. 16/3–4). In prose word order: *ęn véar skulu drikka vęl ęitt ǫlðr at Ęgis hvęrjan hǫr-męitið*; or with emendation from La Farge and Tucker: *ęn véar skulu drikka vęl ǫlðr at Ęgis hvęrjan ęitr-hǫr-męitið.*

4 ęitt hǫr-męitið ‘one … flax-cutter’ | The latter word is an *hapax* and very obscure. It clearly belongs with *hvęrjan* ‘every, each’ (m. acc. sg.); its nom. sg. form should be **hǫr-męitiðr*. I take this as a compound formed from *hǫrr* ‘flax, cord’ + *męita* ‘to cut’ with an agent noun suffix *-ðr*. Since the determiner *hvęrjan* implies seasonality the word is easily read as a kenning for SUMMER, or specifically the time when flax is cut around late July. This is however unprecedented amongst kennings for SUMMER, which otherwise always belong to the type “mercy of the SERPENT” (Meissner 1921, p. 109). — Following the ms. evidence the pres. ed. reads *ęitt* ‘one’ n. acc. sg. as modifying *ǫlðr* ‘ale-feast’, but based on typical WINTER-kennings of the type “harm of the SERPENT” La Farge and Tucker (1992, p. 46) suggest the emendations *ęitr-hǫr-męitir* ‘venom-rope-cutter [SNAKE > WINTER]’ and *ęitr-*orm-męðir* ‘venom-worm-schather [WINTER]’.



Figure 5: Hammer-amulet with face from unknown findspot, Scania. Wiking Age, ca. 900 AD. © Ola Myrin, Historiska museet/SHM. CC BY 4.0. https://samlingar.shm.se/media/1B654576-D251-475F-B366-6EF893A1D537

# Flyting of Lock
# *(Loka sęnna)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.965)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Flyting of Lock** (*Lok*) is a narrative poem dealing with Lock's insults of the gods at their simble and the consequences that follow.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The poem is preserved only in **R** on foll. 15r/3–17r/12. It follows *Hym* and precedes *Þrk*.

In **R**, *Lok* is tied together into a continuous narrative with *Hym* by the prose passage "From Eagre and the Gods" (edited as P1–P2 of the present poem), but the two poems are so drastically different in style that they are certainly distinct compositions.

In the related Eddic manuscript **A**, *Hym* stands alone with no trace of a frame narrative while no trace of *Lok* survives, which strongly suggests that the frame narrative is a later addition on the part of the **R** tradition.

A stanza that appears to belong to *Lok* is found in *Gylf*; it is edited below following the end of the poem. The poem—and especially its introductory prose (*Lok* P1, P2)—is also alluded to in *Skm* 41.

### Meter and stanza

*Lok* is composed entirely in Leeds-meter. The poem has 266 lines across 65 stanzas. Most stanzas (60/65) follow the typical four-line structure *abcabc*, but the variants *abcabcc* (13, 54, 62, 65) and even *abcabccc* (23) are also represented.

The stanzas exclusively represent dialogue, and all narrative elements are told in prose. Apart from the short speaker notes before stanzas longer prose

interjections are also found between sts. 5 and 6 (P3), 10 and 11 (P4), 52 and 53 (P5), 53 and 54 (P6), and 56 and 57 (P7).

Two unambiguous instances show that alliteration can fall between *v* and a vowel: 2/4 (*orði : vinr*) and 10/1 (*Víð·arr : ulfs*). Cf. 36/4 (n.). Still, the numerous other instances of normal *v*- or vowel-alliteration show that this was not preferred, and it is notable that both *orð* 'word' and *ulfr* 'wolf' contained a *v*- in an earlier stage of the language; see note to 2/4.

One line lacks suitable alliteration: 39/3. The alliteration in 14/2 is highly questionable.

## Origin and motifs

It is easy to interpret *Lok* as a blasphemous composition belonging to the period after the conversion to Christianity. Surely no pious pagan would have written a poem insulting his own gods. Yet, as discussed in the introduction to *Hárb*, this argument is not very strong since examples of humorous or irreverent descriptions of Gods can be found in many other pagan poetic traditions in the context of mythology, which is what *Lok* is. What is more, many of Lock's insults are likely taken out of their original contexts or baseless, and the taunting god is ultimately forced to flee before the might of Thunder, which the poet by no means denigrates.

If anything, the fact that *Lok* assumes a deep familiarity with the pagan mythology and the characters and incidents of the gods probably speaks for a pre-Christian origin. The gods are after all insulted on their own merits, not as idols powerless before Almighty God and His holy men, which was the Christian view. If the goal was to make fun of the gods there would surely have been easier and more effective ways to do so.

## Dating

Notably for the question of dating *Lok* has three occurrences of alliteration between old *vr*- (> *r*-) and *v*-: 15/3 (*vega : vrę́ðr*), 18/4 (*vrę́ðir : vegi=sk*), and 27/4 (*vrę́ðum : vegit*). Since all Scaldic attestations of *vr*- alliterating with *v*- rather than with *r*- date to before 1000 AD (cf. *Háv* 26/2) this is a solid dating criterion for pre-Christian composition (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016).

A feature in the alliteration which tentatively suggests a very earlier dating is the fact that secure alliteration between *v*- and a vowel is isolated to two instances (2/4 and 10/1), both of which have vowel-words which in Proto-Norse began with *w*-; see note to 2/4.

When it comes to the occurrence of the preverbal particle *of*, a trait strongly correlated with *vr*-, *Lok* shows the high rate of 0.326 per 10 unique lines (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2016, p. 54; Sapp 2022, p. 70).

In addition *Lok* preserves two archaic Germanic hapax legomena in their etymological senses: the noun *fjǫrg* 'Farrows, Gods' (19/4) and the adj. *tilr* 'conciliatory' (38/2).

Linguistic and metrical factors thus strongly suggest that *Lok* is a pre-Christian poem from the 9th or 10th c.

## Summary

*Overview of speakers by stanza, first occurrence in bold:*

1 **Lock**, 2 **Elder**, 3 Lock, 4 Elder, 5 Lock — 6–7 Lock, 8 **Bray** — 9 Lock, 10 **Weden** — 11 Lock, 12 Bray, 13 Lock, 14 Bray, 15 Lock — 16 **Idin**, 17 Lock, 18 Idin — 19 **Yiven**, 20 Lock — 21 Weden, 22 Lock, 23 Weden, 24 Lock — 25 **Frie**, 26 Lock, 27 Frie, 28 Lock — 29 **Frow**, 30 Lock, 31 Frow, 32 Lock — 33 **Nearth**, 34 Lock, 35 Nearth, 36 Lock — 37 **Tew**, 38 Lock, 39 Tew, 40 Lock — 41 **Frea**, 42 Lock — 43 **Bewer**, 44 Lock, 45 Bewer, 46 Lock — 47 **Homedall**, 48 Lock — 49 **[Shede]**, 50 Lock, 51 [Shede], 52 Lock — 53 **Sib**, 54 Lock — 55 **Beal**, 56 Lock — 57 **Thunder**, 58 Lock, 59 Thunder, 60 Lock, 61 Thunder, 62 Lock, 63 Thunder, 64–65 Lock

The poem begins with two prose passages (P1–P2), the first one connecting to the previous poem, *Hym* and introducing the gods and their banquet, the second one describing the immediate events leading up to the poem, Lock's wanton killing of one of the servants.

Lock meets the servant Elder outside and asks him of what the Eese are speaking at the banquet (1). Elder answers that they speak of their prowess and splendid arms, and in no way favourably about Lock (2). Lock declares that he will go inside to insult the Eese (3). Elder warns him that he will regret it, (4) but Lock insults his intellect (5) and goes inside (P3).

Lock greets the Gods sarcastically and asks for a drink (6). When they ignore him he tells them to make a choice: either to invite him to sit or to drive him away (7). Bray answers and tells him that they will never let him drink (8), but Lock ignores him and turns to Weden, calling to mind a blood-oath between them (9). Weden, acknowledging the oath, asks his son Wider to give Lock a drink and let him sit (10). He does (P4).

Lock now begins his insults, first turning to Bray (11). From Lock's insult of Bray in st. 11 until Thunder's arrival in P7 the poem has a very regular structure. Lock and a god take turns insulting each other for one or two pairs of stanzas before another god comes to the defence of the previous one and becomes the new target for Lock's insults. There is no point in summarising the insults beyond the overview of speakers above, although it may be noted that Lock's insults towards the Gods are considerably more creative than those towards the Goddesses, which almost exclusively consist of accusations of adultery.

Immediately after Lock mentions Thunder (54) his arrival is heralded (55), and he arrives (P7). Thunder and Lock take turns (sts. 57–63), before Lock is at last forced to yield as he knows that Thunder alone will break the law of non-violence even inside the hall (64). Lock curses the Eese and Eagre one last time and departs (65). After this the prose tells us that Lock hid himself in a river in the shape of a salmon, but was eventually caught and bound upon three sharp stones with a venomous serpent set above his face to torment him. When he writhed from the pain the whole earth shook in what is now known as earth-quakes (P8).

## Text

### Frá Ǫ́gi ok goðum ('From Eagre and the Gods')

**P1** Ǫ́gir, er ǫðru nafni hét Gymir, hann hafði búit ǫ́sum ǫl þá er hann hafði fengit ketil inn mikla sem nú er sagt. Til þeirar veitslu kom Óðinn ok Frigg kona hans. Þórr kom eigi því at hann var í austr-vegi. Sif var þar, kona Þórs; Bragi, ok Iðunn kona hans. Týr var þar, hann var ein-hendr; Fenrisulfr sleit hǫnd af hánum, þá er hann var bundinn. Þar var Njǫrðr ok kona hans Skaði; Freyr ok Freyja; Víð·arr son Óðins. Loki var þar, ok þjónustumenn Freys, Byggvir ok Beyla. Mart var þar ása ok alfa.

Eagre, who by another name was called Gymer—he had prepared an alefeast for the Eese when he had got the great kettle as was just told. To that gathering came Weden and Frie his wife. Thunder came not, for he was on the Eastern Way. Sib was there, Thunder's wife; Bray and Idin, his wife. Tew was there. He was one-handed; the Fenrerswolf tore his hand from him when it was bound. Nearth was there and his wife Shede, Frea and Frow, Wider the son of Weden. Lock was there and the servants of Frea, Bew and Beal. In that place there was a multitude of Eese and Elves.

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2 sem nú er sagt 'as was just told' | In immediately preceding *Hym*.

5–6 Fenrisulfr sleit hǫnd af hánum, þá er hann var bundinn 'the Fenrerswolf tore his hand off when it was bound' | This detail is presumably brought up on the basis of sts. 38–39; for the myth see there.

**P2** Ǫ́gir átti tvá þjónustu-menn, Fima·fengr ok Eldir. Þar var lýsigull haft fyr elds-ljós; sjalft bar=sk þar ǫl. Þar var griða-stadr mikill. Menn lofuðu mjǫk hversu góðir þjónustu-menn Ǫ́gis vóru. Loki mátti eigi heyra þat, ok drap hann Fimafeng. Þá skóku ǫ́sir skjǫldu sína ok óptu at Loka, ok eltu hann braut til skógar, en þeir fóru at drekka. Loki hvarf aptr ok hitti úti Eldi; Loki kvaddi hann:

Eagre had two servants, Femfinger and Elder. In that place glowing gold was used instead of fire; the ale there carried itself. It was a great place of griths. The folk greatly praised how good the servants of Eagre were. Lock could not stand to hear that and he slew Femfinger. Then the Eese shook their shields and screamed at Lock and chased him away to the woods, but they went to drink. Lock turned back and hit upon Elder outside. Lock greeted him:

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2 griða-stadr ‘place of griths’ | A *griðr* ‘grith’ being a form of temporary truce of non-violence (LMNL, s.v. *grip*). The *griða-stadr* was thus a place wherein all violence was forbidden, as was typical in shrines (wighs) and at legal assemblies (Things). This detail is important for the narrative, since it explains why Lock can insult the Gods without repercussions for most of the poem.

4–5 Þá skóku ęsir skjǫldu sína ok óptu ‘Then the Eese shook their shields and screamed’ | Apparently in some sort of ancient war dance. Cf. the Old Swedish Heathen Law: *ópr hann þrý ní-óp* “He screams three nithing-screams TODO”.

## Loka sęnna (‘The Flyting of Lock’)

**1** „Sęg þú þat, Ęldir, · svá’t ęinu=gi [R 15r/17]
feti gangir framarr,
hvat hér inni · hafa at ǫl-mǫ́lum
sig-tíva synir.“

“Tell this, Elder, so that thou not
takest one step further:
What here within they say over their ale,
the sons of the victory-Tews.”

1–2 svá’t ... framarr ‘so that ... further’ | Shared with *Háv* 38.

3 hafa at ǫl-mǫ́lum ‘they say over the ale’ | Lit. “they have for their ale-speeches”.

4 sig-tíva synir ‘sons of the victory-Tews’ | The gods, the ‘sons of the Gods’ [= the Gods] being a common kenning-type.

Ęldir: **2** „Of vǫ́pn sĭn dœma · ok of víg-risni sĭna [R 15r/18]
sig-tíva synir;
ásа ok alfa, · es hér inni eru,
mann=gi ’s þér í orði vinr.“

Quoth Elder: “Of their weapons they speak and of their battle-prowess,
the sons of the victory-Tews.
Of the Eese and Elves which are here within
none is thee a friend in words.”

4 mann=gi ’s þér í orði vinr. ‘none is thee a friend in words.’ | I.e., ‘nobody says anything good about you’.

Something may be said about the alliteration in this line and also in 10/1 below (*Víð·arr* : *ulfs*). It is unambiguous in both instances that the semi-vowel *v* (/w/) is participating in vowel-alliteration with *o*, something occasionally allowed in Norse Eddic poems but never in Norse Scaldic or West Germanic poetry. These are however the only occurrences of this type of alliteration in *Lok* (cf. st. 36/4 below). An intriguing explanation is if the alliteration originally fell exclusively on *v-*. This is possible due to the fact that in both the present st. and 10/1 the vowel-words *orð* 'word' and *ulfr* 'wolf' originally began with *v-* (PN **worda, *wulfaʀ*), which in the case of *ulfr* is attested in archaic runic inscriptions. For metrical reasons *Lok* must postdate the syncope of unstressed short vowels in some positions, but on the basis of the three closely related 7th c. runestones from Blekinge (DR 357 Stentoften, DR 358 Gummarp, DR 359 Istaby) this syncope is known to predate the loss of *w* before rounded vowels (e.g. DR 359 **haÞuwulafʀ** *Haþu·wulᵃfʀ*).
If we look away from the possibility of pure coincidence, which is not impossible, there are two explanations. The first is that *Lok* was in fact composed in the 7th or perhaps 8th c. when the semi-vowel was still retained; certainly the poem has archaic features (see Dating above), but this is extremely daring. A more likely explanation is that the alliteration reflects archaic poetic formulae or perhaps a vague intuition that only certain vowel-words should alliterate with *v-*. The fact that West Germanic does not allow alliteration between vowels and *w-* suggests that this license most likely arose in North Germanic following the loss of *w-* before rounded vowels, and an intuition for which pairs felt 'right' would likely have existed in the earliest period of composition following this change. In any case this seems to be yet another argument for an early date of *Lok*, for which cf. also 15/3 n. below.
In the C7th the Proto-Norse form of this line would have been **mann-gí 's þéʀ in worðé winiʀ*.

Loki kvað: **3** „Inn skal ganga · Égis hallir ǐ [**R** 15r/20]
2 à þat sumbl at séa,
jǫll ok ǫ́fu · fǿri'k ásа sonum
4 ok blęnd'k þęim svá męini mjǫ̋ð.“

Quoth Lock: "I shall go into Eagre's halls,
on that simble for to see.
Scorn and hatred I bring the sons of the Eese,
and so I mix their mead with evil."

---

2 sumbl 'simble' | The Germanic word for "feast, banquet".

3 jǫll ok ǫ́fu 'scorn and hatred' | Two rare words to which the present translation hardly does justice. The former occurs nowhere else, while the latter only otherwise occurs in *Sigsk* 33. They have been interpreted in a variety of ways: CV sees the first word as *jóll* 'wild angelica', whereas the second is taken to be an error for *áfr* ("a beverage [...] translated by Magnaeus by *sorbitio avenacea*, a sort of common ale brewed of oats"). TODO: What do other editors say? Esp. Kommentar.

4 blęnd'k ... męini mjǫ̋ð 'I mix ... mead with evil' | Formulaic, cf. *Sigrdr* 8 (and others TODO).

Ęldir kvað: **4** „Vęitst, ef inn gęngr · Égis hallir ǐ [**R** 15r/22]
2 à þat sumbl at séa,
hrópi ok rógi · ef ęyss á holl ręgin,
4 á þér munu þau þęrra þat.“

Quoth Elder: "Thou knowest, if thou goest into Eagre's halls,
on that simble for to see—
if slander and strife thou pourest on the hold Reins,
on *thee* will they dry it off!"

Loki kvað: **5** „Vęitst þat Ęldir, · ef ęinir skulum [R 15r/24]
2 sár-yrðum saka=sk,
auðigr verða · mun'k í and-svǫrum,
4 ef þú męlir til mart!“

Quoth Lock: "Thou knowest, Elder, if one-on-one we shall
bandy wounding words,
wealthy will I in my answers grow
if thou speak too much!"

---

2 sár-yrðum saka=sk 'bandy wounding words' | Reoccuring at st. 19/2.

4 ef þú męlir til mart! 'if thou speak too much!' | Formulaic; cf. *Háv* 27.

**P3** Síðan gekk Loki inn í hǫll'ina; en er þeir sá, er fyrir váru, hverr [R 15r/25]
2 inn var kominn, þǫgnuðu þeir allir.

Thereafter Lock went into the hall, but when those who were within saw who had come inside they all turned silent.

Loki kvað: **6** „Þyrstr ek kom · þęssar hallar til [R 15r/27]
2 Loptr of langan veg,
ǫsu at biðja, · at mér ęinn gefi
4 męran drykk mjaðar.

Quoth Lock: "Thirsty I came to these halls,
Loft ⟨= Lock⟩, over a long way,
to bid the Eese that they give me but one
famed drink of mead.

---

4 męran drykk mjaðar 'famed drink of mead' | Formulaic language for describing mead; cf. *Háv* 105, 140, *Ski* 16. TODO: more parallels.

**7** Hví þęgið ér svá · þrungin goð, [R 15r/28]
2 at męla né męguð;
sessa ok staði · vęlið mér sumbli at,
4 eða hęitið mik heðan!“

Why shut ye up so, ye pressed Gods,
that ye cannot speak?
Choose seats and places for me at the simble,
or call me away hence!"

---

3–4 sessa ... heðan! 'Choose ... hence!' | That is, "Cease your dallying; give me a seat or tell me to leave!"

Bragi: **8** „Sessa ok staði · vęlja þér sumbli at [R 15r/30]
2 ęsir aldri=gi;
því't ęsir vitu · hvęim alda skulu
4 gamban-sumbl of geta.“

Bray: “Choose seats and places for thee at the simble
the Eese will never do,
for the Eese know for which man they shall
prepare the gomben-simble.”

---

3 hvęim alda ‘which man’ | Here “person, being”. See note to *Vafþ* 55/6.

4 gamban-sumbl ‘gomben-simble’ | *gamban-* ‘gomben-’ being an obscure prefix which apart from the present instance also occurs in *Skí* 32, 33 and *Hárb* 20. CV suggest it means something like ‘costly’, but most editors connect it with magic.

[Loki:] **9** „Mant þat Óðinn, · es vit ǽr-daga [R 15r/32]
2 blendum blóði saman?
ǫlvi bęrgja · lét=sk ęigi mundu,
4 nema okkr véri bǫðum borit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Recallest thou, Weden, when we in days of yore
blended our blood together?
Thou didst declare thou wouldst ne’er taste ale,
unless it were for us both borne forth!”

---

ALL | Lock turns to Weden, chief of the Eese, and reminds him of an oath of blood-brotherhood the two undertook in the early days of the world. The circumstances of this oath are otherwise entirely unknown.

[Óðinn:] **10** „Rís þá Víð·arr · ok lát ulfs fǫður [R 15r/34]
2 sitja sumbli at,
síðr oss Loki · kvęði lasta-stǫfum
4 Ęgis hǫllu ǽ.“

[Quoth Weden:] “Then rise, Wider, and let the Wolf’s father [= Lock]
sit at the simble,
lest Lock address us with words of blame
in Eagre’s hall.”

---

1 Rís þá Víð·arr · ok lát ulfs fǫður ‘Then rise, Wider, and let the Wolf’s father’ | For the alliteration see note to st. 2/4. In the C7th the Proto-Norse form of this line would have been **Rís þan Wiðarʀ · auk lát wulfs fǫður*.

**P4** Þá stóð Víð·arr upp ok skenkti Loka, en áðr hann drykki, kvaddi [R 15v/1]
2 hann ǫsu’na:

Then Wider stood up and poured a drink to Lock, but before he [= Lock] drank, he greeted the Eese:

**11** „Hęilir ęsir, · hęilar ǫsynjur [R 15v/3]
ok ǫll ginn-hęilǫg goð,
nema sá ęinn ǫss · es innar sitr
Bragi bękkjum á.“

“Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens,
and all yin-holy Gods!
But for that one os who sits further within:
Bray, upon the benches.”

---

ALL | The first line is identical to the prayer in *Sigrdr* 4. An intriguing possibility suggests itself, viz. that this formula for hailing the Gods may actually have been used in Heathen drinking-toasts, where the second helming (ll. 3–4) would follow the hailing by asking for gifts. If this is the case it would greatly increase the dramatic effect of Lock's insult in ll. 3–4, since he, instead of asking for a boon, subverts the prayer by insulting one of the gods present, something that would have have come off as shocking to the Heathen audience expecting a typical prayer.

[Bragi] kvað: **12** „Mar ok męki · gef'k þér mǐns féar [R 15v/4]
ok bøtir þér svá baugi Bragi,
síðr þú ǫsum · ǫfund of gjaldir;
gręm þú ęigi goð at þér!“

Quoth [Bray]: “Steed and sword I give thee of my own wealth
and so Bray restores thee with a bigh,
lest thou with envy repay the Eese;
anger not the Gods against thee!”

---

1 Mar ok męki ‘Steed and sword’ | Formulaic pair; cf. *Háv* 83/2.

2 bøtir þér svá baugi ‘restores thee with a bigh’ | Cf. the comment in *Hárb* 42.

[Loki] kvað: **13** „Jós ok arm-bauga · munt ę vesa [R 15v/6]
bęggja vanr Bragi,
ásа ok alfa, · es hér inni eru,
þú est við víg varastr,
ok skjarrastr við skot.“

Quoth [Lock]: “Of horse and arm-bighs wilt thou always be
both lacking, Bray!
Of the Eese and Elves which are here within
thou art wariest of war
and shiest of shot.”

[Bragi] kvað: **14** „Vęit'k, ef *f*yr útan vé́ra'k, · svá sem fyr innan em'k, [R 15v/8]
Ǽgis hǫll of kominn,
hǫfuð þitt · bé́ra'k í hęndi mér;
lít*'k þér þat fyr lygi.“

Quoth [Bray]: "I know if I were without, as I am within
come into Eagre's hall,
that head of thine would I hold in my hands;
this I see for thy lie."

1 *f*yr | 'þyr' **R** 4 lít*'k þér þat fyr lygi | 'litt ec þer þat fyr lygi' **R**

1 Vęit'k, ef *f*yr útan vé́ra'k, · svá sem fyr innan em'k 'I know if I were without, as I am within' | As said in P1, the law of grith (a legally binding pact or pledge of non-violence, even between enemies) applies inside the hall, and Bray and the other gods are bound by it not to injure Lock.

2 Ǽgis hǫll of kominn | The alliteration in this line is highly questionable since the particle *of* is otherwise always unstressed, let alone subject to alliteration. Any metrical investigation should exclude it as likely corrupt.

4 lít*'k þér þat fyr lygi | In the ms. *'tt'* (in *'litt'*) is written with a single *t* with a small dot above which marks it out as doubled. I see this abbreviation as an erroneous insertion. A variety of other emendations have been proposed for this line, e.g. *litt es þér þat fyr lygi* 'that is little [punishment] for thee for lying'. Based on the similarity of *ċ* (= *tt*) and *c* Finnur Jónsson (1932) gives *lyka'k þér þat fyr lygi* 'that I would bring thee for thy lie'.

[Loki] kvað: **15** „Snjallr est í sessi, · skal=at-tu svá gęra, [R 15v/10]
Bragi bękk-skrautuðr;
vega þú gakk · ef *v*rę́iðr séir;
hygg=sk vętr hvatr fyrir.“

Quoth [Lock]: "Valiant art thou in the seat. Thou shalt not do so,
Bray the bench-adorner!
Go to strike if thou art wroth;
the bold thinks not ahead."

ALL | Lock calls out Bray's excuse. A truly brave (*hvatr*) man would break even the grith to avenge such a severe personal insult, as Thunder indeed is willing to do (st. 64 below).

3 vega ... vrę́iðr 'strike ... wroth' | Formulaic, the alliterative word-pair *vega : vrę́iðr* otherwise also occurs in *Fáfn* 7/2, 17/2, 30/2, *Sigrdr* 25/2. — The restoration of *v-* before *r* is required by the meter, likewise at 18/4, 27/4. This is an archaic feature; cf. *Háv* 26/2 n.

[Iðunn] kvað: **16** „Bið'k *þik*, Bragi, · barna-sifjar duga [R 15v/11]
ok allra ǫsk-maga,
at þú Loka · kvę́ðir=a lasta-stǫfum
Ǽgis hǫllu í.“

Quoth [Idin]: "I bid thee, Bray, to suit the ties of children
and all adopted sons,

that thou not address Lock with words of blame
in Eagre's hall."

1 *þik* 'thee' | *sens. emend.; om.* **R**

[Loki] kvað: **17** „Þęgi þú, Iðunn, · þik kveð'k allra kvinna [R 15v/13]
ver-gjarnasta vesa
síðst þú arma þĭna · lagðir ítr-þvęgna
umb þĭnn bróður-bana."

Quoth [Lock]: "Shut up, Idin! I call thee of all women
the most man-eager,
since thou didst lay thy brightly washed arms
around thy brother's bane."

[Iðunn] kvað: **18** „Loka ek kvęð'k=a · lasta-stǫfum [R 15v/15]
Ęgis hǫllu ĭ;
Braga ek kyrri · bjór-ręifan,
vil'k=at at it *v*ręiðir vegi=sk."

Quoth [Idin]: "I do not address Lock with words of blame
in Eagre's hall;
I do calm Bray, made rowdy from beer—
I wish not that ye two, wroth, should fight."

ALL | Idin tries to calm the argument by pointing out that she did not address Lock, but her own husband, Bray.

[Gęfjun] kvað: **19** „Hví it ęsir tvęir · skuluð inni hér [R 15v/16]
sár-yrðum saka=sk?
Lopt*-ki þat vęit · at hann lęikinn es
ok hann fjǫrg *ǫ*ll f*ía.

Quoth [Yiven]: "Why shall ye two Eese here within
bandy wounding words?
Loft ⟨= Lock⟩ knows not that he is crazed,
and all the Farrows ⟨= Gods⟩ hate him."

3 Lopt*-ki | 'lopzci' **R** 4 fjǫrg *ǫ*ll 'all the Farrows' | 'fiorgvall' **R**. 4 f*ía 'hate' | fría **R**

ALL | By reading l. 3a *lopzci þat veit* as an impersonal construct, adopting the sense 'playful' of l. 3b *lęikinn* and not emending l. 4 *fría* the rhetorical function of the stanza has been understood by some editors (e.g., Sijmons and Gering (1927, p. 286), Pettit (2023)) as Yiven's attempt to play down Lock's insults: "Is it not well known that Lock is playful and that all the Gods love him?" Yet in the context of the narrative this can hardly be accurate, since Lock has already killed a servant and insulted both Bray and Idin.

3 Lopt*-ki þat vęit ‘Loft knows not’ | For the rare poetic construction where a verb is negated by suffixing *-gi* ‘not, no’ to the stem of the subject cf. sts. 29/4 and 39/3 below. — Sijmons and Gering (1927, p. 286), Pettit (2023), and others here read an impersonal construction ‘is it not known about Lock’, etc.

3 lęikinn ‘crazed’ | This word typically occurs in the sense ‘playful’ but the sense ‘bewitched’, here understood as ‘crazed’, is attested in ON; cf. *Vsp* 21/3 and *Prestssaga Guðmundar góða* 19 in *Sturlunga* (*leikinn af flagði einu* ‘bewitched by a certain trollwoman’).

4 fjǫrg ǫll ‘all the Farrows’ | *‘fiorgvall’* is taken as an error for **‘fiorg avll’*, norm. *fjǫrg ǫll*. Mezger (1944)’s suggestion of a masc. acc. pl. *fjǫrgu alla* is metrically impossible and leaves the verb without a subject.
*fjǫrg* ‘Farrows’ (sg. *fjarg*) is a rare and archaic (pantheistic) neuter term for the Gods most likely derived from PGmc. **fergą* ‘vital forces(?)’, related to the root of **ferhwą* ‘body, life-force’ (> ON *fjǫr* ‘id.’). The term has no direct equivalents in other Gmc. languages, but the related word **ferhwą* is found in the name of the Roman-era Germanic goddesses, the *Alaferhviae* (< PGmc. **ala-firhwijōz* ‘all-life giving ones(?)’), as attested on Latin-inscribed altars from the Rhineland (TODO: cite). ON *fjarg* is never otherwise used as a simplex, but it does appear in the cpds. *fjarg-hús* ‘god-house(?)’ (*Akv* 43/4, 46/3) and *fjarg-vefr* ‘god-weave, silk’ (ÞKolb Lv 12 in SkP 5; a poetic variant of *goð-vefr* ‘id.’), the latter of which confirms that its sense is ‘god’. It is also found in a few additional cpds. in modern Icelandic (Ásgeir Blöndal Magnússon 1989, s.v. *fjarg-*).

4 f*ía ‘hate’ | *fría* means ‘love’ but is emended to its antonym *fia* ‘hate’ since the statement that all the Gods love Lock can hardly be defended when he has already killed one of their servants and it is only very reluctantly that they let him back in. Cf. *Hym* 22 for the Gods’ hatred of one of Lock’s children, the Middenyardswyrm.

[Loki] kvað: **20** „Þęgi þú, Gęfjun, · þęss mun’k nú geta [R 15v/18]
2 es þik glapði at gęði:
sveinn inn hvíti · es þér sigli gaf
4 ok þú lagðir lęr yfir.“

Quoth [Lock]: “Shut up, Yiven! *Him* will I now mention,
who seduced thy senses:
the white-hued swain who gave thee a necklace,
and thou laidest o’er him thy leg!”

---

ALL | The truth of the insult is questionable since Yiven is said to be a virgin. So *Gylf* 35:5: *Fjórða er Gefjun. Hón er mér, ok henni þjóna þér, er meyjar anda-sk.* ‘The fourth [goddess] is Yiven. She is a maiden and those women serve her who die as maidens.’

3 sigli ‘necklace’ | A very rare poetic word ultimately derived from Latin *sigillum*. It only occurs in two other places in the Old Norse corpus: *Sigsk* 49/3 and KormǪ Lv 56 (SkP 5).

4 lagðir lęr yfir ‘laidest o’er him thy leg’ | A cynical variant of *Háv* 108/4 (*lǫgð=umk arm yfir*).

[Óðinn kvað] þat: **21** „Órr est, Loki, · ok ør·viti, [R 15v/20]
2 es þú fęr þér Gęfjun at gręmi
því’t aldar ør·lǫg · hygg at ǫll of viti
4 jafn-gǫr=la sem ek.“

This [quoth Weden]: “Mad art thou, Lock, and out of thy wits
when thou rousest Yiven’s wrath against thee,

for all the orlays of men I think she knows
quite as clearly as I."

---

1 Ørr … ok ør·viti 'Mad … and out of thy wits' | Formulaic line, also occuring in *2 HHund* 34 and *Oddr* 15. Cf. also st. 47 and G1 below.

[Loki] kvað: **22** „Þęgi þú, Óðinn, · þú kunnir aldri=gi [R 15v/22]
2 dęila víg með verum;
opt þú gaft · þęim's gefa skyldir=a,
4 inum slęvurum, sigr."

Quoth [Lock]: "Shut up, Weden! Thou couldst never
deal out war amidst men—
oft thou gavest to those thou shouldst not have given,
to the duller men victory."

[Óðinn] kvað: **23** „Vęitst ef ek gaf · þęim's gefa né skylda, [R 15v/24]
2 inum slęvurum, sigr,
átta vetr · vast fyr jǫrð neðan
4 kýr mólkandi ok kona
ok hęfir þar *bǫrn of* borit
6 ok hugða'k þat args aðal."

Quoth [Weden]: "Thou knowest, if I gave to to those I should not have given,
to the duller men victory,
for eight winters wast thou beneath the earth
a milch cow and a woman,
and there hast thou borne children,
and I've judged that a queer's nature!"

---

5 *bǫrn of* | *sens. and metr. emend. (cf. st. 33/4 below); om.* R

---

4 kýr mólkandi 'a milch cow' | This phrase may also be read as "milking cows", the form *kýr* being grammatically ambiguous between nom. sg. and acc. pl., and *mólka* meaning both 'to milk' and 'to give milk'. "Milch cow" (cows, of course, only giving milk after calving) is preferable for several reasons. Firstly, the phrase is followed by *ok kona* 'and a woman' rather than *sem kona* 'as a woman' or similar; secondly, it conforms to a known pattern of insults between men where the insultee is equated with a woman and said to have been impregnated (cf. *1 HHund*); thirdly, it agrees well with another instance where Lock shapeshifts into a female animal and gives birth, namely the episode of the building of the wall around Osyard as told in *Gylf* 42 and alluded to in *Vsp* 24–25 (n.).

[Loki] kvað: **24** „Ęn þik síga kóðu · Sáms-ęyju í [R 15v/26]
2 ok drapt á vett sem vǫlur,
vitka líki · fórt ver-þjóð yfir,
4 ok hugða'k þat args aðal."

Quoth [Lock]: “But thou, they said, didst sink down into Samsey,
and didst beat on the drum like wallows.
In a warlock’s likeness didst thou journey o’er the folk of men
and I’ve judged that a queer’s nature!”

---

ALL | For Weden taking the shape of a witch or warlock cf. the story of Wrind (*Vsp* 31 n.) TODO: elaborate on the feminine nature of this type of magic.

1 Sáms-ęyju ‘Samsey’ | *Samsø* in Denmark, which features prominently in later legendary literature. TODO: cite.

2 drapt á vett sem vǫlur ‘didst beat on the drum like wallows’ | A reference to “shaman”-like drums as attested in the later Lappish religion. TODO: elaborate.

[Frigg kvað:] **25** „Ør·lǫgum ykkrum · skylið aldri≀gi [R 15v/28]
2 sęgja sęggjum frá,
hvat it ęsir tvęir · drýgðuð í ár-daga;
4 firri≀sk ę́ forn rǫk firar.“

[Quoth Frie:] “Of your orlays should ye two never
speak to the youth.
Whatsoever ye two Eese did in days of yore,
let ancient tales be ever shunned by folk.”

[Loki kvað:] **26** „Þęgi þú, Frigg, · þú est Fjǫrgyns mér [R 15v/30]
2 ok hęfir ę́ ver-gjǫrn vesit,
es þá Véa ok Vilja · létst þér, Viðris kvęn,
4 báða í baðm of tękit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Frie! Thou art Firgyn’s maiden
and hast always been eager for men,
[like] when thou Wigh and Will—O Withrer’s wife—
both in thy bosom didst take.”

---

3 Véa ok Vilja ‘Will and Wigh’ | Weden’s brothers. The event alluded to here is a myth where Weden is exiled from the Eese and his wife, Frie, instead marries his two brothers. So *Yng* 3: *Óðinn átti tvá bróðr, hét annarr Vé, en annarr Vili; þeir bróðr hans stýrðu ríki’nu, þá er hann var í brottu. Þat var eitt sinn, þá er Óðinn var farinn langt í brott ok hafði lengi dvaltsk, at ǫsum þótti ør·vęnt hans heim; þá tóku bróðr hans at skipta arfi hans, en konu hans Frigg géngu þeir báðir at eiga. En litlu síðar kom Óðinn heim, tók hann þá við konu sinni.* ‘Weden had two brothers; one was called Wigh, the other Will. Those brothers of his ruled the realm when he was departed. It was one time when Weden had journeyed far away and had tarried for long that the Eese thought his homecoming unlikely. Then his brothers took to divide his inheritance, but his wife Frie they both went to own. But a short while later Weden came home; then he took back his wife.’

[Frigg kvað:] **27** „Vęitst ef inni ętta’k · Ę́gis hǫllum í [R 15v/32]
2 Baldri líkan bur
út né kvęmir · frá ása sonum

4 ok vęri þà at þér *v*ręiðum vegit.“

[Quoth Frie:] “Thou knowest, if I had within Eagre’s halls
a boy like Balder,
thou camest out from the sons of the Eese,
and wouldst, wroth man, be fought!”

[Loki kvað:] **28** „Ęnn vill þú, Frigg, · at ek fląiri tęlja [R 16r/1]
2 mína męin-stafi:
ek því réð · es þú ríða sér*=*at
4 síðan Baldr at sǫlum.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Still wilt thou, Frie, that I recount more
of my evil deeds:
It was my doing that thou dost not henceforth see
Balder ride to the halls.”

ALL | Lock caused the death of Balder, as alluded to in *Vsp* 31–33 (see note there) and *Bdr* 8–11 and described in depth in *Gylf* 49. It is probably this admission of guilt that seals Lock’s fate.

[Frǫyja kvað:] **29** „Ørr est, Loki, · es þú yðra tęlr [R 16r/3]
2 ljóta lęið-stafi;
ør·lǫg Frigg · hygg at ǫll viti
4 þó’tt hǫn sjǫlf*=*gi sęgi.“

[Quoth Frow:] “Mad art thou, Lock, when thou dost recount
your ugly, loathsome deeds!
All orlays I think Frie knows,
though she says them not herself.”

[Loki kvað:] **30** „Þęgi þú, Frǫyja, · þik kann’k full-gǫrva; [R 16r/4]
2 es*=*a þér vamma vant:
ása ok alfa, · es hér inni eru,
4 hvǫrr hęfir þǐnn hór vesit.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Shut up, Frow! I know thee full well—
thou art not free of blemishes.
Of the Eese and Elves which are here within
each has been thy lover!”

ALL | For Frow’s promiscuity cf. *Þrk* 13/4 n.

2 vamma vant ‘free of blemishes’ | Formulaic, cf. *Háv* 22/4: *hann es*=*a vamma vanr* ‘he is not free of blemishes’.

[Frǫyja kvað:] **31** „Flǫ ’s þér tunga, · hygg at þér frǫmr my*ni* [R 16r/6]

ò·gótt of gala;
*v*reįðir 'ro þér ęsir · ok ǫsynjur,
hryggr munt hęim fara."

[Quoth Frow:] "False is thy tongue, I think it further will
sing evil [into being] for thee.
Wroth with thee are the Eese and the Ossens:
grieved wilt thou journey home."

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1 my*ni* | 'mý' **R**

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ALL | Frow foresees the future and makes a prophecy. Lock will come to regret his insults.

1 Flǫ 's þér tunga 'False is thy tongue' | Cf. *Háv* 118/3: *flá-rǫð tunga* 'false-counseling tongue'.

2 ò·gótt of gala; 'sing evil [into being] for thee' | The same expression is found in *Háv* 29/4, which also advices keeping one's tongue in check.

Loki: **32** „Þęgi þú, Fręyja, · þú est for·dǫ́ða [**R** 16r/8]
ok męini blandin mjǫk,
síðst-u at bróðr þínum · siðu blíð ręgin
ok myndir þà, Fręyja, frata."

Lock: "Shut up, Frow! Thou art an evil-working woman,
and mixed with much evil,
since towards thy brother the blithe Reins bewitched thee
and then wouldst thou, O Frow, fart."

---

ALL | Lock accuses Frow of committing incest with her brother (Frea) while bewitched by the Gods. Incest between siblings is particularly associated with the family of Nearth; cf. how Nearth is said to have begotten Frea by his sister in st. 36 below.

3 blíð ręgin 'the blithe Reins' | A reverent formulaic epithet for the Gods, here used blasphemously. It otherwise occurs in *Grm* 6/1, 38/3 and 42/1. For another instance of Lock sarcastically using reverent language cf. st. 11/1–2 above.

4 þà 'then' | In the act of (incestual) coitus, an especially graphic insult.

Njǫrðr: **33** „Þat 's vǫ́-lítit · þó'tt sér varðir vers fái, [**R** 16r/10]
hós eða hvárs;
hitt 's undr, es ǫ́ss ragr · es hér inn of kominn
ok hęfir sá bǫrn of borit."

Nearth: "It is little woe that women get themselves a man,
a lover or whomever else,
on the other hand it is a wonder when a queer Os has come here within,
and that man has borne children!"

Loki: **34** „Þęgi þú, Njǫrðr, · þú vast austr heðan [**R** 16r/12]

gísl of sęndr at goðum;
Hymis męyjar · hǫfðu þik at hland-trogi
ok þér í munn migu.“

Lock: “Shut up, Nearth! Thou wast to the east hence
sent as hostage for the Gods.
Hymer’s daughters had thee for a lant-trough
and pissed thee in the mouth!”

---

ALL | For Nearth as a hostage cf. *Vafþ* 39.

Njǫrðr: **35** „Sú es=umk líkn · es vas’k langt heðan [R 16r/14]
gísl of sęndr at goðum:
þá ek mǫg gat · þann’s mann=gi fíar,
ok þikkir sá ásа jaðarr.“

Nearth: “This is my relief since I was far-away hence
sent as hostage for the Gods,
when I begot the lad whom no man hates
and he seems the peak of the Eese.”

---

3 mǫg … þann’s mann=gi fíar ‘the lad whom no man hates’ | Frea.

Loki: **36** „Hętt-u nú, Njǫrðr, · haf á hófi þik; [R 16r/16]
mun’k=a því lęyna lęngr:
við systur þínni · gatst s·líkan mǫg,
ok es=a þó *vǫ́*nu verr.“

Lock: “Cease now, Nearth; restrain thyself!
I will no longer hide it:
by thy own sister didst thou beget such a lad
and naught can be expected worse.”

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4 *vǫ́*nu | ónu **R**.

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4 ok es=a þó *vǫ́*nu verr | **R**’s *ónu* is dat. sg. of *vǫ́n* ‘expectation’ with fronting of nasal *ǫ́* > *ó* and loss of *v* before *o*. This fronting, which is an irregular sound change often flattened by analogy, can be tracked in Scaldic poetry using the name *Ǫ́·lęifr* ~ *Ó·láfr* ‘Anlaf’ (< Proto-Norse **Anu·laibaz*) with a nasal root vowel. In Scaldic poetry the earliest instance of the name forming an ethelhending with *ó* rather than an *á* or *ǫ́* is from c. 1070 AD, Steinn *Óldr* 5/4b: *Ó·láfr borinn sólu* (SkP 2). Since *Lok* is undoubtedly older than 1070 (see Dating above) it is justified to restore *vǫ́nu*.

Týr: **37** „Fręyr ’s bętstr · allra ball-riða [R 16r/17]
ásа gǫrðum í;
męy né grøtir · né manns konu,

ok lęysir ór hǫptum hvęrn.“

Tew: “Frea is the best of all bold riders
in the Yards of the Eese;
he makes no maiden weep nor any man’s woman,
and loosens each from his bonds!”

2 åsa gǫrðum ‘the Yards of the Eese’ | I.e., Osyard.

Loki: **38** „Þęgi þú, Týr, · þú kunnir aldri=gi [R 16r/19]
bera tilt með tvęim;
handar ennar hógri · mun’k hinnar geta
es þér slęit Fęnrir frå.“

Lock: “Shut up, Tew! Thou couldst never
settle strife between two;
the right hand will I mention next,
which from thee Fenrer tore.”

2 bera tilt með tvęim ‘settle strife between two’ | Lit. ‘carry conciliatory [words] between two.’ This statement appears to be what Snorre alludes to in *Gylf* 25:12: *ok er hann ein-hendr ok ekki kallaðr sęttir manna* ‘and he is one-handed, and not called a reconciler of men’. The sense seems to be that Tew’s one-handedness is also the reason why he, as a war god, cannot grant equal victory to both sides. — *tilt* ‘conciliatory [words]’ is a hapax, n. acc. sg. of **tilr*, cognate with OE *til* ‘good, upstanding’, Gothic *ga·tils* ‘fitting, convenient’. The use of this old Germanic word in the poem is undoubtedly an archaism.

3–4 handar ... frå. ‘the right ... tore.’ | A reference to a myth told in *Gylf* 25:9–12 and at greater length in *Gylf* 34:10–42. Lock begat three children with the ettin-woman Angerbode, one of which was the Fenrerswolf. It grew quickly and Tew alone was brave enough to feed it. When the spaes of the Eese foretold that the Wolf would be of great harm to them they resolved to bind it. They twice tried to make fetters and convinced the Wolf to prove its strength by breaking them, yet both times it did so. At last they made the great fetter Glapner (for which cf. *Eddbr* VIII), but the Wolf was clever and understood that it would not be able to break it. The Gods promised to release him even if he could not break it, but the Wolf did not trust them and as a pledge of their honesty he asked one of them to place his hand in his mouth. Only Tew dared to do so. When the Wolf could not break the fetter he knew that he had been tricked, and so he bit off his hand. After this the Eese dragged the Wolf deep into a cave and bound him there to a great stone; in his mouth they stuck a sword so that he could not bite. The wolf drooled, and thereof flowed the great river named Ween, and in the cave he shall lie until the Twilight of the Reins.
For the difference between Garm and the Fenrerswolf, if such a one originally existed, see *Vsp* 43/1–2.

Týr: **39** „Handar em’k vanr · ęn þú hróðrs vitnis; [R 16r/21]
bǫl es bęggja þráa;
ulf=gi hęfir ok vel · es í bǫndum skal
bíða ragna røkrs.“

Tew: “A hand am I missing, but thou the Famous Wolf;
both yearnings are a bale!
Nor does the Wolf have it well which in its bonds
shall await the Twilight of the Reins.”

3 ulf=gi hęfir ok vel · es ï bǫndum skal | Alliteration is absent from this otherwise metrically acceptable line and no obvious emendation suggests itself.

Loki: **40** „Þęgi þú, Týr, · þat varð þïnni konu [R 16r/23]
2 at hǫn átti mǫg við mér!
Ǫln né pęnning · hafðir þęss aldri=gi
4 van-réttis, vę-sall.“

Lock: “Shut up, Tew! It happened to thy woman
that she had a son by me!
No ell [of wool] nor penny gotst thou ever for that
injustice, O wretch!”

ALL | This event is entirely unsubstantiated, and Tew’s nameless wife is not known from any other source.

3 Ǫln ‘ell [of wool]’ | Wool, measured in ells, was often used for barter in Iceland and Norway.

3 pęnning ‘penny’ | A hapax in the Poetic Edda, *pęnningr* only appears thrice in Scaldic poetry. Its use by Bray the Old (*Rdr* 12) does however suggest its early presence in the language.

Freyr: **41** „Ulf sé’k liggja · áar-ósi fyrir [R 16r/25]
2 und’s rjúfa=sk rędin;
því munt nést, · nema nú þęgir,
4 bundinn, bǫlva smiðr!“

Frea: “The Wolf I see lying before the river-mouth
until the Reins are ripped;
there wilt thou next—unless thou now shut up—
be bound, O smith of bales!”

1 áar-ósi fyrir ‘before the river-mouth’ | The river Ween, which flows from the Wolf’s mouth. For Snorre’s explanation of this see st. 38/3–4 n.

2 und’s rjúfa=sk rędin ‘until the Reins are ripped’ | During the Rakes of the Reins. Formulaic; see note to *Bdr* 14/4.

Loki: **42** „Golli kęypta · létst Gymis dóttur [R 16r/26]
2 ok sęldir þitt svá sverð,
en es Mú·spells synir · ríða Myrk-við yfir
4 vętst=a þá, vę-sall, hvé vegr!“

Lock: “With gold thou hadst Gymer’s daughter [= Gird] bought,
and didst so sell thy sword,
but when Muspell’s sons ride over Mirkwood
then thou knowest not, O wretch, how to fight!”

ALL | Lock alludes to the events of *Skí*: Frea gave his sword to his servant Shirner and sent him on a mission to convince Gird, Gymer's daughter, to wed him. The mission was successful and Frea and Gird were united, yet he did not get back his sword, for which he will suffer at his fight with Surt. See *Vsp* 51/3 n.

3 Mú·spells synir 'Muspell's sons' | See *Vsp* 49/1 n.

Byggvir: **43** „Vętitst ef øðli ętta'k · sem Ingunar-Freyr, [R 16r/29]
2 ok svá sęl=ligt setr:
mętgi sméra · mølða'k þá męin-króku
4 ok lęmða alla í liðu."

Bewer: "Thou knowest, if I had pedigree like Ingwin-Frea
and such blessed pasture—
finer than bone-meal would I mill this harm-crow,
and beat all his limbs lame!"

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ALL | Frea's servant Bewer (*Byggvir*, < *bygg* 'barley') comes to his defence.

1 øðli 'pedigree' | Frea is the son of Nearth and the legendary ancestor of the Ingling dynasty originally based at Upsele.

1 Ingunar-Freyr 'Ingwin-Frea' | A rare (probably cultic) name for the god Frea, whose usual name *Freyr* originally simply means 'Lord'. The first element, *Ingunar-*, appears to be the gen. sg. of a name **Ingunn* and is probably related to OE *Ing-winas* 'friends of Ing [DANES]' (*Beow* 1044, 1319) and Latin *Ingaevōnēs* 'a Germanic tribe around the North Sea' (Tacitus, *Germania* 2). It clearly contains the same root as *Yngvi* 'Ing', an earlier name for Frea found in the C1st male given name *Inguiomerus* (Tacitus, *Annals* 1.60, 1.68, 2.17 etc.), the ON compound *Yngvi-Freyr* 'Ing-Frea' (i.e., "Lord Ing"), and the OE Rune Poem (rune ᛝ, st. 22, where it is again associated with the Danes).

Loki: **44** „Hvat 's þat it litla · es þat lǫggra sé'k [R 16r/31]
2 ok snap-víst snapir?
At ęyrum Freys · munt ę́ vesa
4 ok und kvętnum klaka."

Lock: "What's this little thing I see wagging its tail
and snap-wisely snapping?
At Frea's ears wilt thou always be
and chirping under mills!"

---

1 lǫggra 'wagging its tail' | A hapax; cognate with Danish and Norwegian *logre* 'wag (one's tail)'.

[Byggvir kvað:] **45** „Byggvir ek hętiti, · en mik bráðan kveða [R 16r/32]
2 goð ǫll ok gumar;
því em'k hér hróðugr · at drekka Hropts męgir
4 allir ǫl saman."

[Quoth Bewer:] "Bewer I am called, and hurried do call me
all Gods and men.

Therefore I am honoured here when Roft's lads [the EESE] drink
ale all together."

1 Byggvir | 'Beyggv*ir*' **R**

2 goð ... ok gumar 'Gods and men' | This pairing also occurs in *Lok* 55/4 and *Reg* 19.

[Loki kvað:] **46** „Þęgi þú, Byggvir, · þú kunnir aldri=gi [R 16v/1]
dęila með mǫnnum mat;
ok þik í flęts strái · finna né mǫ́ttu
þá's vǫ́gu verar."

[Quoth Lock:] "Shut up, Bewer! Thou couldst never
deal out food amidst men,
and in the bench-straw they could not find thee
when the warriors fought."

[Hęim·dallr kvað:] **47** „Qlr est, Loki · svá't es ør·viti, [R 16v/3]
hví né lęt=sk=a þú, Loki?
því't of-drykkja · vęldr alda hvęim
es sína męlgi né man=at."

[Quoth Homedall:] "Drunk art thou, Lock, so that thou art out of thy wits;
why holdest thou not back, O Lock?
For over-drinking makes every man
no more mind his speech."

[Loki kvað:] **48** „Þęgi þú, Hęim·dallr, · þér vas í ár-daga [R 16v/5]
it ljóta líf of lagit;
ǫrgu baki · munt ę vesa
ok vaka vǫrðr goða."

[Quoth Lock:] "Shut up, Homedall! For *thee* in days of yore
was thy ugly life laid down.
With a stiff back wilt thou always be
and waking, O Watchman of the Gods."

2 líf of lagit 'life laid down' | His course of life was decreed by the Norns. Formulaic language; cf. *Skí* 13/4.

3 ǫrgu 'stiff' | *'ærgo'* **R** is ambiguous since *æ* can represent both *ǫ* and *au*. It is here read as a form of *ǫrðigu*, n. dat. sg. of *ǫrðigr* 'upright, arduous, harsh', but it can also be read as *aurgu* 'muddy'. The former is thought to give better sense since it specifies Homedall's *ljóta líf* 'ugly life'; "all that standing must hurt your back, Watchman of the Gods!"

4 vǫrðr goða 'Watchman of the Gods' | Formulaic epithet of Homedall, who had to guard the rainbow bridge of the Gods against their enemies. See *Grm* 13 n.

[Skaði kvað:] **49** „Lętt ’s þér, Loki; · mun=at-tu lęngi svá [R 16v/7]
2 lęika lausum hala,
því’t þik à hjǫrvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar
4 gǫrnum binda goð.“

[Quoth Shede:] “Thou takest it lightly, Lock—thou wilt not so for long
play with a loose tail,
for on a sword with thy rime-cold lad’s
guts the Gods shall bind thee.”

---

ALL | The speaker of sts. 49 and 51 is not indicated in **R** and is not directly named in Lock’s answers, but is certainly Shede. She would otherwise be the only deity mentioned in P1 without a speaking role, and Lock’s mention of the killing of Thedse (st. 50) is only effective if it relates personally to whomever he is attacking, which is only the case for Shede.

3–4 því at þik à hjǫrvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar / gǫrnum binda goð. ‘for on a sword with thy rime-cold lad’s / guts the Gods shall bind thee’ | See P8 below.

[Loki kvað:] **50** „Vęitst ef mik à hjǫrvi skulu · ins hrím-kalda magar [R 16v/9]
2 gǫrnum binda goð,
fyrstr ok øfstr · vas’k at fjǫr-lagi
4 þar’s vér à Þjatsa þrifum.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Thou knowest, if on a sword with my rime-cold lad’s
guts the Gods shall bind me,
first and highest was I in life-taking
where we laid hands on Thedse.”

---

4 þar’s vér à Þjatsa þrifum ‘where we laid hands on Thedse’ | A reference to a longwinded myth told most fully in *Skm* 2–4 and *Haustl* 2–13, and referenced in *Hárb* 19. After Idin was abducted by the ettin Thedse, the Eese forced Lock to recover her, which he set out to do by flying to his home in the shape of a hawk. When he found Idin he turned her into a nut, took her in his claws, and turned back to Osyard. Thedse quickly spotted him, set chase in the shape of an eagle, and was soon closing the distance. Standing in Osyard, the Eese saw the chase from afar and hurriedly threw wood shavings on the ground; just as Lock had flown over them they set fire to the shavings; the fire rose and scorched the wings of Thedse, who fell down to the ground and was killed. Not long thereafter, Shede, Thedse’s daughter, came to Osyard to avenge her father, but the gods convinced her to settle with them, after which she married Nearth. It is most sensible that Lock brings this myth up in order to insult Shede; cf. note to the previous st.

[Skaði kvað:] **51** „Vęitst ef fyrstr ok øfstr · vast at fjǫr-lagi [R 16v/11]
2 þà’s ér à Þjatsa þrifuð,
frà mínum véum · ok vǫngum skulu
4 þér ę kǫld rǫ́ð koma.“

[Quoth Shede:] “Thou knowest that if thou wert first and highest in life-taking
when ye laid hands on Thedse:
from my wighs and wongs shall for thee
ever cold counsels come.”

3 frá mínum véum · ok vǫngum ‘from my wighs and wongs’ | From her cultic sites; viz. her sanctuaries and sacred meadows.

[Loki kvað:] **52** „Lèttari í mǫ́lum · vast við Lauf·eyjar son [R 16v/12]
2 þá's lét=sk mér á bęð þínn boðit;
getit verðr oss s·líks · ef vér gǫrva skulum
4 tęlja vǫmm'in vǫ́r.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Lighter in thy words wast thou with Leafie's son [= Lock, me]
when thou didst summon me to thy bed.
Such will be said of us if we clearly shall
recount our blemishes.

**P5** Þá gekk *Sif* framm ok byrlaði Loka í hrím-kalki mjǫð ok męlti: [R 16v/15]

Then Sib stepped forth and poured for Lock mead in a rime-chalice, and spoke:

1 *Sif* | ; *(prob. pointing to a corr. in the no longer extant margin)* **R**

1 *Sif* | That Sib is the speaker is supported by the mention of her in P1 and by the fact that st. 54 mentions Thunder, her husband.

**53** „Hęill ves þú nú, Loki, · ok tak við hrím-kalki [R 16v/12]
2 fullum forns mjaðar,
hęldr þú hana ęina · látir með ása sonum
4 vamma-laus*a* vesa.“

“Hale be thou now, Lock, and receive this rime-chalice,
full of ancient mead,
but thou oughtst to let me alone among the sons of the Eese
remain blemish-less.”

4 vamma-laus*a* | *gramm. emend.;* vamma-lausum *(dat. pl.)* **R**.

1–2 Hęill ... mjaðar ‘Hale ... mead’ | Formulaic; repeated identically in *Ski* 37/1–2.

3 hana ‘her’ | Sib speaks in the third person.

**P6** Hann tók við horni ok drakk af: [R 16v/17]

He received the horn and drank thereof:

**54** „Ęin þú vęrir · ef þú svá vęrir, [R 16v/18]
2 vǫr ok grǫm at veri;

ęinn ek vęit, · svá't ek vita þikkj=umk,
hór ok af Hlór·riða,
ok vas þat sá inn lę́-vísi Loki."

"Alone wouldst thou remain, *if* thou hadst remained
wary and wroth against menfolk.
I know one—whom I think me to know—
adulterer behind even Loride's back—
and that was the guile-wise Lock!"

4 Hlór·riða 'Loride' | "The Loud Rider", a common name for Thunder. It seems that Lock's mere mention of Thunder invites his presence, probably a suggestion of the efficacy of invoking this god when threatened by evil supernatural forces (see Lindow 1988).
The same thing occurs in several other myths, e.g. the Gods' dealing with the Master Builder (see *Vsp* 24–25) and when ettin Rungner is at the banquet of the Eese in *Skm* 24: *En er ǫ́sum leiddu=sk ofr·yrði hans, þá nefna þeir Þór. Því nést kom Þórr í hǫll'ina ok hafði á lopti hamar'inn ok var all-reiðr ok spyrr, hverr því rę́ðr, er jǫtnar hund-vísir skulu þar drekka, eða hverr seldi Hrungni grið at vera í Val-hǫll eða hví Freyja skal skenkja honum sem at gildi ása.* 'But when the Eese grew tired of his boasting words, then they mention Thunder's name. Just thereafter Thunder came into the hall and had his hammer in the air and was all-wroth, asking whose doing it is that hundred-wise ettins shall drink there, or who gave Rungner grith to be in Walhall, or why Frow shall pour forth drinks for him like at the banquets of the Eese.'

5 lę́-vísi Loki 'guile-wise Lock' | Formulaic, also occuring in *Hym* 37. Cf. also *Vsp* 35 where Lock is called *lę́-gjarn* 'guile-eager' and *Vsp* 17 where Lother (possibly to be identified with Lock) gives men *lǫ́*, which may be an accusative form of *lę́*.

[Bęyla kvað:] **55** „Fjǫll ǫll skjalfa, · hygg á fǫr vesa [R 16v/20]
hęiman Hlór·riða;
hann rę́ðr ró · þeim's rǫgir hér
goð ǫll ok guma!"

[Quoth Beal:] "The fells all quake—I think on his journey
from home Loride must be.
He will bring to rest the one who here maligns
all the Gods and men!"

ALL | The mention of Thunder has invited his presence and Beal announces his coming.

1 Fjǫll ǫll skjalfa 'The fells all quake' | The movement of gods, especially Thunder, is often signalled by cosmic disturbance. Cf. *Þrk* 21 n.

[Loki kvað:] **56** „Þęgi þú, Bęyla, · þú est Byggvis kvęn [R 16v/21]
ok męini blandin mjǫk;
ǫ·kynja'n męira · kom=a með ásа sonum;
ǫll est, dęigja, dritin."

[Quoth Lock:] "Shut up, Beal! Thou art Bewer's wife,
and mixed with much evil.
A greater disgrace came not amidst the sons of the Eese;
thou art all, dough-girl, dungy!"

4 ǫll est, dęigja, dritin ‘thou art all, dough-girl, dungy’ | *dęigja* ‘dough-girl’ is a derivative of *dęigr* ‘dough’ and refers to a young maid at a farm who carries out tasks like kneading dough, milking the cows, and carrying water. Lock insults her; she’s still covered with cow dung.

**P7** Þá kom Þórr at ok kvað: [R 16v/23]

Then Thunder arrived and quoth:

**57** „Þęgi þú, rǫg véttr, · þér skal mínn þrúð-hamarr, [R 16v/24]
Mjǫllnir, mál fyr·nema!
Hęrða klett · drep’k þér halsi af,
ok verðr þá þínu fjǫrvi of farit.“

“Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
Millner, deprive of speech!
The rock of thy shoulders [HEAD] I will cut from thy neck,
and then is thy life destroyed!”

ALL | The threatening st. bears some resemblance to *Hárb* 47.

1 þrúð-hamarr ‘thrith-hammer’ | “Strength-hammer”, *þrúðr* ‘thrith’ being an obsolete word for strength generally used only in connection with Thunder or ettins. *Þrúðr* ‘Thrith’ is also the name of Thunder’s daughter.

[Loki kvað:] **58** „Jarðar *burr* · es hér nú inn kominn; [R 16v/26]
hví þrasir þú svá, Þórr?
Ęn þá þorir ękki · es skalt við ulf’inn vega
ok svelgr hann allan Sig-fǫður.“

[Quoth Lock:] “Earth’s Son is here now come inside,
why thrashest thou so, Thunder?
Yet thou wilt nowise dare when thou shalt fight the Wolf
and he swallows Syefather ⟨= Weden⟩ whole.”

1 *burr* | *metr. and sens. emend.; om.* R

3–4 es skalt við ulf’inn vega / ok svelgr hann allan Sig-fǫður ‘when thou shalt fight the Wolf / and he swallows Syefather ⟨= Weden⟩ whole.’ | A reference to the Rakes of the Reins, where Weden is slain by the Wolf. Thunder, meanwhile, dies while slaying the Wyrm; see *Vsp* 51–53, *Vafþ* 53.

[Þórr kvað:] **59** „Þęgi þú, rǫg véttr, · þér skal mínn þrúð-hamarr, [R 16v/28]
Mjǫllnir, mál fyr·nema!
Upp ek þér verp · ok á austr-vega,
síðan þik mann≠gi sér.“

[Quoth Thunder:] "Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
Millner, deprive of speech!
I will throw thee up and onto the eastern ways,
whereafter no man will see thee!"

3 austr-vega 'eastern ways' | The desolate eastern wastelands where Thunder hunts ettins, troll-women and other unnatural creatures.

[Loki kvað:] **60** „Austr-fǫrum þínum · skalt aldri≠gi [R 16v/29]
2 sęgja sęggjum frá
síðst í hanska þumlungi · hnúkðir þú, Ęin-hęri,
4 ok þótti≠sk≠a þá Þórr vesa!"

[Quoth Lock:] "From thy eastern journeys shalt thou never
speak to the youth,
since into a glove's thumb thou crawledest, Oneharrier,
and didst not seem to be Thunder then!"

2 sęgja sęggjum frá 'speak to the youth' | Lock here borrows from Frie's use of this expression in st. 25 above.

3 í hanska þumlungi · hnúkðir þú 'since into a glove's thumb thou crawledest' | Sts. 60 and 62 allude to Thunder's journey to Outyards-Lock as told in *Gylf* 44–47, during which he encounters the ettin Shrimer (*Gylf* 45:5–38). Lock (not to be confused with Outyards-Lock) is also present on that journey. For the part of the narrative alluded to in st. 60 see the summary of *Gylf* 45:5–16 in the note to *Hárb* 26, although the ettin is there called Feller.

[Þórr kvað:] **61** „Þęgi þú, rǫg vęttr, · þér skal mínn þrúð-hamarr, [R 16v/31]
2 Mjǫllnir, mál fyr·nema!
hęndi inni hógri · drep'k þik Hrungnis bana,
4 svá't þér brotnar bęina hvat."

[Quoth Thunder:] "Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
Millner, deprive of speech!
With my right hand I will beat thee with Rungner's bane [= Millner]
so that every bone in thee breaks!"

3 Hrungnis bana 'Rungner's bane [= Millner]' | For Rungner, a famous ettin slewn by Thunder, cf. *Hárb* 14.

[Loki kvað:] **62** „Lifa ętla'k mér · langan aldr [R 16v/32]
2 þó'tt hótir hamri mér;
skarpar álar · þóttu þér Skrymis vesa
4 ok máttir≠a þá nęsti náa
ok svalt≠sk þá hungri hęill."

[Quoth Lock:] "I intend for myself to live a long life
although thou mightst threaten me with the hammer.

Strong seemed Shrimer's knots to thee,
and then couldst thou not get to thy provisions,
and then wast thou dying, healthy, of hunger!"

---

3 skarpar âlar · þóttu þér Skrymis vesa 'Strong seemed Shrimer's knots to thee' | Another allusion to Thunder's encounter with Shrimer, this part found narrated in *Gylf* 45:18–22: After the gods took on Shrimer as a companion he offered to carry their provisions in his knapsack. They agreed to this, and by evening they rested beneath a big oak. Shrimer went to sleep but told the companions to get a meal from the sack. Thunder took it and tried untying the straps, but the knots were so firmly tied by the ettin that he could nowise untie or even move them. In *Gylf* 47:9 the incident is revealed to have been an illusion; Shrimer was Outyards-Lock in disguise and the cords tying up the sack were made of unbreakable iron (*grés-járn*).

[Þórr kvað:] **63** „Þęgi þú, rǫg véttr, · þér skal mĩnn þrúð-hamarr, [R 17r/1]
2 Mjǫllnir, mál fyr·nema!
Hrungnis bani · mun þér í hęl koma
4 fyr Ná-grindr neðan."

[Quoth Thunder:] "Shut up, thou queer wight! Thee shall my thrith-hammer
Millner, deprive of speech!
Rungner's bane will take thee to hell,
down beneath Neegrind!"

[Loki kvað:] **64** „Kvað'k fyr ǫsum, · kvað'k fyr ásа sonum, [R 17r/2]
2 þat's mik hvatti hugr,
en fyr þér ęinum · mun'k út ganga
4 því't ek vęit at þú vegr.

[Quoth Lock:] "I spoke before the Eese; I spoke before the sons of the Eese
whatever my heart did goad me,
but for thee alone will I walk out
for I know that thou dost strike.

**65** Ǫl gørðir þú, Ęgir, · en þú aldri munt [R 17r/4]
2 síðan sumbl of gøra;
ęiga þĩn ǫll, · es hér inni es,
4 lęiki yfir logi
ok brenni þér á baki."

Ale hast thou made, Eagre, but thou wilt never
henceforth make a simble!
All thy estate which is here within—
let flame play over it
and burn thee in the back!"

### Frá Loka ('From Lock')

**P8** En eptir þetta fal=sk Loki í Frán·angrs-forsi í lax líki. Þar tóku [R 17r/6]
2 ęsir hann. Hann var bundinn með þǫrmum sonar Nara; en Narfi,
sonr hans, varð at vargi. Skaði tók eitr-orm ok festi upp yfir and-
4 lit Loka; draup þar ór eitr. Sigyn, kona Loka, sat þar ok helt
munn-laug undir eitr'it, en er munn-laug'in var full bar hón út
6 eitr'it, en meðan draup eitr'it á Loka. Þá kippti=sk hann svá hart
við, at þaðan af skalf jǫrð ǫll; þat eru nú kallaðir land-skjálftar.

But after this Lock hid himself in Freanangersforce in the likeness of a salmon. There the Eese took him. He was bound with the intestines of his son Nare, but his son Narve was made a wolf/outlaw. Shede took a venomous serpent and fastened it up over Lock's face; out of it ran venom. Syein, Lock's wife, sat there and held a basin under the venom and when the basin was full she carried out the venom, but meanwhile the venom ran onto Lock. Then he struggled so hard that thereof all the earth quaked; such are now called earth-quakes.

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ALL | The myth of the binding of Lock is alluded to in *Vsp* 34 and H31 and told at length in *Gylf* 50:3–25, which does not entirely agree with the present passage, although numerous details are shared between them (e.g. the name of the force and the comment about earth-quakes at the end).
According to *Gylf* 50:20–22 (cited in *Vsp* H31 n.; cf. there) the Eese captured two of Lock's sons, Wonnel and "Nare or Narve". They turned Wonnel into a wolf (*vargr*, which also means 'outlaw') and forced him to tear his brother Narve apart. Then they took Narve's intestines used them to bind Lock on top of three sharp stones. The intestines hardened into iron and Lock was bound fast.
Since the author of *Gylf* knew *Vsp* it is possible that he combined a prose text similar to the present *Lok* P8 with the stanza *Vsp* H31, interpreting the form *Váli víg-bǫnd* as 'Wonnel's war-bonds' (whereas the present ed. adopts the emendation to nom. sg. *Váli*).
Wonnel is the son of Weden who avenges Balder by killing Hath (*Vsp* 31 n., *Bdr* 11/1, *Gylf* 30:1–2, *Skm* 19), and there is no reason as to why he could not have bound Lock.

## Appendix

### Stanza from *Gylf*

**G1** „Órr est, Loki, · ok ør·viti, [S 5v/36, T 6v/5,
2 hví né lęt=sk=a þú, Loki? W 9r/11, U 7v/7]
ør·lǫg Frigg · hygg at ǫll viti
4 þó'tt hǫn sjǫlf=gi sęgi."

"Mad art thou, Lock, and out of thy wits,
why holdest thou not back, O Lock?

All orlays I think Frie knows,
    though she says them not herself."

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ALL | In *Gylf* 20:7 this stanza is cited as proof of Frie's foresight regarding the orlays of men. It is introduced by the words *svá sem hér er sagt, at Óðinn mélti sjalfr við þann ós, er Loki heitir* 'just as it is said here, that Weden himself spoke to that Os who is called Lock'. — The stanza looks like an amalgamation of several *Lok* stanzas, which is why it has been placed here, rather than under *Eddbr*; l. 1 corresponds to st. 21/1 (spoken by Weden), l. 2 to st. 47/2 (spoken by Homedall), and ll. 3–4 to st. 29/3–4 (spoken by Frow). It is possible that the st. derives from an alternate version of *Lok*, but it could also be the result of faulty memory on Snorre's part, since the first line corresponds to the one spoken by Weden in st. 21.

# Lay of Thrim
# *(Þryms kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C9th (0.741)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Lay of Thrim** (*Þrk*) is a narrative poem dealing with the god Thunder's adventure to retrieve his hammer from the ettin Thrim.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Þrk* is only found in **R**, on foll. 17r/12–18r/4, where it follows *Lok* and precedes *Vkv*.

No sts. are found in other sources, although there is a possible allusion to (a variant of) stanza 29 in *Gylf*; see *Þrk* 29/5 n.

### Structure and form

The poem consists of 32 stanzas and 129 long-lines. 4 lines is the typical length of a stanza (sts. 1–3, 7, 8, 10–12, 14–16, 18, 21–23, 25–28, 30–31), but lengths of 2 (4), 3 (5, 6, 17, 20), 5 (9, 13, 24, 29, 32), and 6 (19) lines are also represented.

The meter is Ancient-words-lay of a somewhat looser variety. No prose is embedded in the poem itself, which consists of both narrative and dialogue.

## Style and Language

*Þrk* consists of both narrative and dialogue and much of the poetry is notably formulaic. Numerous passages are repeated throughout the poem (1/1 ~= 13/1, 3/1–2 ~= 12/1–2, 5/1–3 ~= 9/1–3, 8/3–4 ~= 11/3–4, 12/3 ~= 15/3, 12/4 = 20/3, 15/3–16/4 = 19/1–6, 26/1–4 ~= 28/1–4) and several long-lines are shared or closely related with other poems (1/3, 2/1, 7/1, 14/1–3, 15/1, 18/2, 23/1b–2a, 31/1).

Some of the long-lines of the latter group (viz. 1/3, 2/1, 14/1–3, 15/1) are of the oral-formulaic type, in that they do not fill a function unique to the particular narrative of a given poem. Instead they carry the narrative forward by describing generic actions, e.g. by introducing someone's entering a hall or commencing speech. This type of line is only found in a few select narrative poems in Ancient-words-lay and should probably be considered a sign of an early date. To that effect speak two reasons: first, such lines hardly figure at all in younger antiquarian Eddic poetry, indicating that they had fallen out of favour by the antiquarian revival of the 12th c.; second, they very frequently contain the particle *of* before verbs, an archaic feature not used to a great extent in 12th c.

A unique trait of *Þrk* is that the archaic particle *of* here appears at a higher rate than in any other Eddic poem (0.688 occurrences / 10 unique half-lines), and more than 40% as often as the poem with the second-highest incidence, *Oddr* (Sapp 2022, p. 70), which notably also shares numerous formulaic long-lines (cf. in particular *Oddr* 3).

Alliteration between **vr-* and *v-* is uncertain for *Þrk*, although it is likely the case in *Þrk* 1/1 (n.).

## Story

*Þrk* tells the story of the theft of Thunder's hammer Millner by the ettin Thrim, and his regaining of it through (cross-)dressing as the goddess Frow, after which he slays the whole ettin clan.

### Origin and motifs

At the core of the narrative lies the ancient motif where the Ettins, the enemies of the Gods, desire to rob them of their weapon and to possess a goddess, viz. the light-bringing Dawn, and hide Her under ground. The concealment of the strength and light of the heavens threatens not merely the Gods but also Mankind, who rely on their protection.

*Þrk* is not the only Norse source for this motif. The closest parallel is the story of the ettin Master Builder in *Gylf* 42:3–29 (cf. *Vsp* 24–25 nn.), where an ettin craftsman in exchange for building the wall of Osyard asks for the hand of Frow and the Sun and the Moon as a dowry—a price which would effectively steal away all the light in the world. For the inevitable catastrophic consequences of the theft of the light we may compare the eschatological Fimblewinter (*Vsp* 40/3–4, *Vafþ* 44/3–4 (n.), *Hdl* 41/3, *Gylf* 51:1–4), which occurs when the enemies of the Gods at last succeed in robbing the world of the sun.

The motif of the enemies of the Gods wishing to steal and hide the heavenly light(s), usually symbolized by the Goddesses, has ancient roots. It is also found in Finnic mythology. In *Kalevala* 47–49, the evil witch *Louhi* of the Northland successfully steals the sun, moon, and fire (note the fire-symbolism of the *Brísinga-męn*, st. 13/3 n.!) and thereby deprives the world of its light. This motif is authentic and not the invention of Lönnroth, for

in Finnish folk-songs both the Sun (or its goddess Päivätär, the mother of the Panu, the fire-god) and the Moon are varyingly said to have been locked up in a stone (*SKVR* XII1 99) or an iron stronghold (*SKVR* XV 220.1–7). A much older form of the same motif is found in the Vedic *Valá*-myth (part of which is told in *ṚV* 10.108), where the enemies of the Gods, the *Paṇi*-s, lock up the Dawns in the form of kine in the *Valá*-cave and thereby prevent the natural cycle between Night and Day. With his great song the Storm-god *Índra* breaks open the cave, killing *Valá* and releasing the light-bringing Dawns (Brereton and Jamison 2020, pp. 70–71).

In this way *Þrk* also comes to symbolise cyclical cosmic renewal. The weapon of the Gods is stolen from them and they find themselves at a low point, powerless against the forces of evil (st. 18), but they are at last redeemed, and the enemy defeated and humiliated in comical fashion (sts. 31–32). Although we know nothing about the performance context of *Þrk*, it is perhaps not unlikely that it would have been performed as part of a festival, perhaps at the winter solstice, when the year is at its darkest point and the light seems furthest away. In this way the poem gives its listeners hope: Thunder has vanquished the ettins and shown them to be of no threat, even laughable in their weakness. The light will return.

More generally, comedic stories involving Thunder and his ettin-bashing seem to have been very popular in Wiking age Norway and Iceland, and in these the god himself is not infrequently the butt of the joke. Apart from *Þrk* there are also the Eddic poems *Hym* and *Hárb*, and the Scaldic poems *Haustl* and *Þdr*. Fragment from a lost Eddic poem about Thunder's fight with the ettin Garfrith and his daughters also survive in *Gylf*; see *Eddbr* VI below.

**Later parallels**

The story of Thunder getting back his stolen hammer by impersonating the goddess Frow was clearly extremely popular, for numerous later reflexes in the form of folk-ballads are found in all four major North Germanic-speaking countries (Sweden, Norway, Denmark, and Iceland); for a useful overview and discussion of their features see Vijūnas (2019).

The oldest such ballad is the 15th c. Icelandic *ríma Þrymlur*. Judging by numerous direct textual parallels (e.g. *Þrk* 27/3 = *Þrymlur* 2.22; see Vijūnas 2019, pp. 46–47, 54), *Þrymlur* is clearly closed related to *Þrk*, if not directly drawing on it, although it also adds numerous details not found in *Þrk* and on the whole greatly embellishes the story. In addition, however, *Þrymlur* shares some details with the later Scandinavian ballads that are absent from *Þrk*, most notably the bringing of the hammer for the bride (Vijūnas 2019, pp. 57–58); these parallels suggest that it is not a mere rewrite of the older *Þrk* by a learned antiquarian, but rather based on the same common proto-myth as both *Þrk* and the later ballads.

The later continental ballads are numerous and documented from 1591 to the 20th c.; Vijūnas (2019, pp. 43–44) lists 1 from Sweden, 6 from Norway, and 9 from Denmark. These ballads, though the names of the gods in them

are more or less corrupt and though their nature as gods is forgot, still feature a plot remarkably identical to *Þrk*.

This is all the more notable since the oldest example was printed in Denmark in 1591, decades before the first edition of the Poetic Edda, for which reason direct influence from *Þrk* must be discounted. Nor is direct influence from the Icelandic *Þrymlur* possible, for the numerous embellishments found in it but not in *Þrk* do not appear in the ballads (Vijūnas 2019, pp. 41–42).

## Dating

*Þrk* has often been considered the oldest poem in the **R** collection, and Sapp (2022)'s model agrees with that judgment by placing it solidly (0.741) in the 9th c., earlier than any other Eddic poem. An early date is supported by the unusually high incidence of the particle *of* before verbs, the use of narrative formulaic lines (see Style and Language above), and the likely alliteration between **vr-* and *v-* (st. 1/1).

## Text

### Lay of Thrim

**1** *V*reįðr vas þá Ving-Þórr · es hann vaknaði [R 17r/13]
ok sĭns hamars · of saknaði,
skęgg nam at hrista, · skǫr nam at dýja,
réð Jarðar burr · umb at þręifa=sk.

Wroth was then Wing-Thunder when he woke,
and of his hammer was bereft.
His beard he took to rustle, his locks he took to rip;
the son of Earth resolved to grope about.

1 *V*reįðr | Reiðr **R**

1 *V*reįðr | Initial **vr-* is restored for the sake of alliteration, since the first nominal in a line must typically carry alliteration. In *Þrk* 13/1, it definitely does not, but that may well be due to that line mirroring the present line and therefore breaking convention for the sake of parallelism. Mikael Males adduces the parallelism between the regular 26/3 and irregular 28/3 as support for this tendency; outside of the present poem, another example is found in *Brot* 7/2 and 9/3. For **vr-*, cf. *Háv* 32/2 n.

1 Ving-Þórr 'Wing-Thunder' | A rare poetic name for Thunder; it only elsewhere occurs in *Alv* 6. The first element is not *vęngr* 'wing (of a bird)' but perhaps means 'swinging' (cf. Swedish *vingla*), referring to his swinging of his hammer, or 'victorious', representing a n-infixed extension of the verb *vega* 'to strike, smite, fight' (cf. Latin *vincere* 'to win, vanquish'). Cf. the related name Wingner (ON *Vingnir*) in *Vafþ* 51/4.

3 skęgg nam at hrista, · skǫr nam at dýja 'His beard he took to rustle, his locks he took to rip' | *N1 nam at V1; N2 nam at V2* appears to be a formulaic long-line; cf. *Brot* 13/1.

**2** Ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað: [R 17r/15]
„Hęyr-ðu nú, Loki, · hvat ek nú męli
es ęigi vęit · jarðar hvęr=gi
né upp-himins: · ǫss es stolinn hamri!“

And he this word first of all did say:
"Hear thou now, Lock, what I now will speak,
which no man knows anywhere on Earth
nor in Up-heaven: the os [I] is robbed of His hammer!"

1 Ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað 'And he this word first of all did say' | The whole line is formulaic, occuring in five other places: *Þrk* 3/2, 9/5, and 12/2 below, *Oddr* 3/5, *Brot* 5/2.

3–4 jarðar ... upp-himins 'Earth ... Up-heaven' | A formulaic meristic expression for the whole cosmos; see Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

**3** Gingu þęir fagra · Fręyju túna [R 17r/17]

ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:
„Munt-u mér, Freyja, · fjaðr-hams léa
ef ek mínn hamar · mętta'k hitta?“

They went to the fair courts of Frow
and he this word first of all did say:
“Wilt thou to Me, O Frow, the feather-hame lend,
if I My hammer might find?”

---

2 hann ‘he’ | The speaker is Thunder, since he speaks about “my hammer”.

3 fjaðr-hams ‘feather-hame’ | A “feather-cloak” by which the wearer can transform or fly like a bird. TODO.

Freyja kvað:

**4** „Þó mynda'k gefa þér · þó'tt ór golli vęri [R 17r/19]
ok þó sęlja · at vęri ór silfri.“

[Quoth Frow:] “I would yet give it to Thee though it were golden,
and yet hand it to Thee if it were silvern.”

---

2 sęlja ‘hand’ | *sęlja*, cognate of English *sell*, here has its older sense of ‘hand over’, cf. Gotish *saljan* ‘*opfern*; θύειν’ (Streitberg 1910, p. 116).

**5** Fló þá Loki, · fjaðr-hamr dunði, [R 17r/20]
und's fyr útan kom · ása garða
ok fyr innan kom · jǫtna hęima.

Then flew Lock—the feather-hame rustled—
until he came outside the Yards of the Eese,
and he came inside the Homes of the Ettins.

---

1 Loki ‘Lock’ | Though Thunder is the one asking for the feather-hame (3/4 “if I *my* hammer might find”), it is Lock who takes off flying.

2 ása garða ‘the Yards of the Eese’ | Semantically identical to Osyard (st. 18/3 below).

**6** Þrymr sat á haugi, · þursa dróttinn, [R 17r/22]
greyjum sínum · goll-bǫnd snøri
ok mǫrum sínum · mǫn jafnaði.

Thrim sat on the mound, the lord of Thurses:
on his greyhounds the golden leashes he twirled,
and on his steeds the manes he cut even.

---

1 sat á haugi ‘sat on the mound’ | Probably a sign of his power, the mound representing his wealth and ancient estate. Cf. *Vsp* 41 n. for other attestations.

1 þursa dróttinn ‘lord of Thurses’ | This formulaic half-line also occurs in Runic charms against such thursen lords (*Cant* and U Fv1933;134 under Galders). *Cant* in particular is a prayer to Thunder himself, and thus goes to show that even light-hearted poems like *Þrk* held religious significance by serving as examples of Thunder’s prowess as daemon-slayer, for which he could be invoked also in the present. Cf. .

2–3 grȩyjum sínum … mǫrum sínum ‘his greyhounds … his steeds’ | Thrim sits surrounded by dogs and horses. The scene is reminiscent of the ancient “master of animals” motif, especially as attested on panel A of the Gundestrup cauldron.

[Þrymr kvað:] **7** „Hvat ’s með ǫ́sum? · Hvat ’s með ǫlfum? [R 17r/23]
2 Hví est ę́inn kominn · í jǫtun-hęima?“
[Loki kvað:] „Illt ’s með ǫ́sum, · *illt ’s með ǫlfum*!
4 Hęfir þú Hlór·riða · hamar of folginn?“

[Quoth Thrim:] “What’s with the Eese? What’s with the Elves?
Why art thou alone come into the Ettin-Homes?”—
[Quoth Lock:] “’Tis ill with the Eese! ’Tis ill with the Elves!
Hast thou Loride’s hammer hid?”

3 *illt ’s með ǫlfum* | *required by sense and meter; om.* **R**

1 Hvat ’s með ǫ́sum? · Hvat ’s með ǫlfum? ‘What is with the Eese? What is with the Elves?’ | Formulaic, the same line occurs in *Vsp* 46/1.

2 jǫtun-hęima ‘Ettin-Homes’ | Semantically identical to the *jǫtna hęimar* ‘Homes of the Ettins’ in 5/3 above. The distinction is purely metrical, since **í jǫtna hęima* would be an illegal type C verse of Ancient-words-lay.

4 Hlór·riða ‘Loride’ | “The Loud Rider”, Thunder.

[Þrymr kvað:] **8** „Ek hęfi Hlór·riða · hamar of folginn [R 17r/25]
2 átta rǫstum · fyr jǫrð neðan;
hann ę́ngi maðr · aptr of hęimtir
4 nema føri mér · Fręyju at kvęn.“

[Quoth Thrim:] “I have Loride’s hammer hid
eight rests beneath the earth.
It will no man fetch back again,
unless he bring me Frow to wife.”

2 átta rǫstum ‘eight rests’ | Eight leagues; a “rest” being an old distance measurement. See Index.

4 Fręyju ‘Frow’ | Frow, who is probably originally the Indo-European dawn-goddess. The Ettins apparently have a great desire to obtain her; in *Gylf* 42:5 the ettin who builds the wall of Osyard asks specifically for Frow in return, along with the Sun and the Moon (cf. *Vsp* 24).

**9** Fló þá Loki, · fjaðr-hamr dunði, [R 17r/27]
2 und’s fyr útan kom · jǫtna hęima
ok fyr innan kom · ásа garða;

4 møtti hann Þór · miðra garða
ok *hann þat* orða · alls fyrst of kvað:

Then flew Lock—the feather-hame rustled—
until he came outside the Homes of the Ettins
and he came inside the Yards of the Eese.
He met Thunder in the middle yards,
and he [= Thunder] this word first of all did say:

5 *hann þat* | *emend. (cf. st. 2 n.);* þat hann *with elsewhere unprecedented word order* **R**

4 møtti hann Þór 'He met Thunder' | This line is compatible with the reconstructed disyllabic form **Þóar* acc. sg. if the pronoun *hann* is excised; for that form see note to *Hym* 23/1.

**10** „Hęfir þú ęyręndi · sem ęrfiði? [R 17r/29]
2 Seg-ðu á lopti · lǫng tíðendi!
Opt sitjanda · sǫgur of falla=sk,
4 ok liggjandi · lygi of bęllir."

"Hast thou an errand for thy hardship?
Tell thou the long tidings aloft!
Oft the sitting man's stories fail each other
and the lying down blows up his lie."

1 Hęfir þú ęyręndi · sem ęrfiði? 'Hast thou an errand for thy hardship?' | Thunder asks Lock whether he has found out anything from his long journey. The rhyming pair *ęyręndi* 'errand' ... *ęrfiði* 'trouble, hardship' also occurs in *HHj* 5/1.

3–4 Opt sitjanda · sǫgur of falla=sk, // ok liggjandi · lygi of bęllir. 'Oft the sitting man's stories fail each other // and the lying down blows up his lie.' | Proverbial. If one waits and mulls over bad news after receiving them, details will be left out and excuses thought up. It is therefore best that Lock immediately tell Thunder what he has learned. ON *liggja* 'lie (recline)' and *ljúga* 'lie (speak untruth)' are entirely different verbs; it is unfortunate that they sound the same in English.

[Loki kvað:] **11** „Hefi'k ęyręndi, · ęrfiði ok: [R 17r/31]
2 Þrymr hęfir þínn hamar, · þursa dróttinn;
hann ęngi maðr · aptr of hęimtir
4 nema hǫnum føri · Freyju at kvęn."

[Quoth Lock:] "I have an errand, hardship also:
Thrim has thy hammer, the lord of Thurses.
It will no man fetch back again,
unless he bring him Frow to wife."

**12** Ganga þęir fagra · Freyju at hitta [R 17r/33]
2 ok hann þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:
„Bitt-u þik, Freyja, · brúðar líni;

vit skulum aka tvau · í jǫtun-heįma.“

They go the fair Frow to find,
and he this word first of all did say:
“Bind thyself, Frow, with bridal linen.
We two shall drive into the Ettin-Homes!”

---

2 hann ‘he’ | The speaker is either Thunder or Lock.

3 brúðar líni; ‘bridal linen’ | The dress of the bride.

**13** *V*reið varð þá Freyja · ok fnasaði, [R 17v/1]
allr ásа salr · undir bifði̯sk,
stǫkk þat it mikla · męn brísinga:
„Mik vęitst verða · ver-gjarnasta
ef ek ęk með þér · í jǫtun-heįma.“

Wroth became Frow then, and snorted;
all the hall of the Eese beneath her shook;
down crashed the great Necklace of Blazes—
“Thou knowest I’ll become most eager for men
if I drive with thee into the Ettin-Homes!”

---

1 fnasaði | ‘fnasasi’ **R**

---

1 fnasaði ‘snorted’ | A rare word. TODO.

3 męn brísinga ‘Necklace of Blazes’ | The *Brísinga-męn* (second element *męn* ‘neckring, necklace, jewel’) is a jewel worn by Frow. It is probably a symbol of fire and light, as shown by the first element *brísingr*, which is listed as a poetic synonym for fire in Þul *Elds* 4 (SkP 3) and appears in the sense ‘blaze’ in Norwegian dialects. This strengthens Frow’s identification with the Dawn, for which cf. *Vsp* 24. The association of the Necklace with fire is further supported by the obscure myth wherein the two probable fire-figures Lock and Homedall fight over it, as mentioned in *Skm* 15, 23 and *Húsdr* 2. Lock is identified in later folklore with the Ash-lad, a wight living in or under the fire-place (Heide 2011), while Homedall’s fire-related epithets include *Heįm·dallr* ‘World-Brilliant’, *vǫrðr goða* ‘Watchman of the Gods’ (*Grm* 13/3 n., *Lok* 48/4, *Gylf* 27:8), *vári ragna* ‘Guardian of the Gods’ (*Húsdr* 2) *hvítastr ása* ‘whitest of the Eese’ (*Þrk* 15/1), *hviti óss* ‘the White Os’ (*Gylf* 27:2), *Gollin·tanni* ‘Goldentooth’, and *Hallin·skíði* ‘One with leaning sticks’ (*Gylf* 27:5).
For the opposition between these two Gods cf. *Gylf* 51:48, about the Rakes of the Reins: *Loki á orrostu við Heim·dall ok verðr hvárr annars bani.* ‘Lock battles against Homedall, and each one slays the other.’ For further discussion about Homedall and his epithets see *Eddbr* III. Lock’s role in the theft is also alluded to in *Haustl* 9, where he is called *girði-þjófr brísings* ‘girdle-thief of the blaze’, i.e., ‘thief of the girdle of the blaze [= the Necklace of Blazes]’.

Archaeologically, the Necklace of Blazes seems to appear in various finds depicting a lady or goddess wearing an oversized brooch (Arrhenius 1962, pp. 79–84). Such oversized brooches of the disc-on-bow type are in fact known from Wiking Age Scandinavia, including Western Norway (Arrhenius 1962, p. 86), where *Þrk* is likely to have been written, and are some of the finest pieces of jewelry surviving from the period (Arrhenius 1962, p. 87). These brooches, which with their original *cloisonée*-fitted red garnets give off a beautiful fire-like lustre, are doubtless cultic objects. They are far too large and heavy to have been worn as part of dress (e.g., the fragmentary brooch from Kårsta, Uppland, Sweden, item number 267203 HST, would have been as long as 28.5 cm, Arrhenius 1962, p. 93); nor are they found in graves as part of women's dress, which further suggests that they were not worn as status objects (Arrhenius 1962, pp. 84–85, 97). On the basis of the lack of association between their find circumstances and cultic sites, Arrhenius (1962, p. 97) suggests that they were probably venerated as independent objects rather than adorning wooden statues. As a representative symbol of Frow the brooches would thus have served to connect the worshipper to the goddess in the same way as amulets depicting Thunder's hammer Millner (cf. *Hym* 36/2 n.) or Weden's spear Gungner. A particularly beautiful example from the village Othemars in Othem parish, Gotland (item number 453312 HST) is depicted in Figure 6, p. 338.

4 verða · ver-gjarnasta 'become most eager for men' | Presumably Frow is speaking out of self-awareness of her lustful inclinations, i.e., she will be siezed by uncontrollable desire if surrounded by strange men. It is also possible that she worries about being accused of promiscuity by the other gods, but that is not the literal sense of the words. For Frow's alleged looseness cf. *Lok* 30; in *Lok* 26 another goddess, Frie, is likewise called *ver-gjǫrn* 'eager for men'.

**14** Sęnn vǫru ęsir · allir á þingi [R 17v/3]
ok ǫsynjur · allar á máli,
ok umb þat réðu · ríkir tívar:
hvé þęir Hlór·riða · hamar of sǿtti?



Figure 6: The gilt bronze disc-on-bow brooch from Othemars, Gotland. Wiking Age, ca. 900 AD. © Ola Myrin, Historiska museet/SHM. CC BY 4.0. https://samlingar.shm.se/object/AECAAAD2-4C29-4164-BB36-E6F589FDE1A5

Soon were the Eese all at the Thing,
and the Ossens all at speech,
and of this counseled the mighty Tews:
how they Loride's hammer might find.

---

1–3 Sęnn ... tívar 'Soon ... Tews' | The very same three lines also occur in *Bdr* 1/1–3; see Note there.

**15** Þá kvað þat Hęim·dallr, · hvítastr ása, [R 17v/5]
vissi vęl framm · sęm vanir aðrir:
„Bindu vér Þór þá · brúðar líni;
hafi hann it mikla · męn brísinga!

Then this quoth Homedall, whitest of the Eese;
he knew well ahead like the other Wanes:
"We shall bind Thunder, then, with bridal linen;
let Him have the great Necklace of Blazes!

---

1 Þá kvað þat ... 'Then this quoth ...' | Formulaic way of introducing speech in a certain type of Ancient-words-lay-poetry. The template is *þá kvað þat X · Y*, where the name X can be either mono- or disyllabic and Y (taking up the b-verse) is an epithet or descriptor and always alliterates with X. This formula has been exceptionally productive and is found in 21 other instances in the Poetic Edda; it never occurs in poetry in SkP. The other precise occurrences are: *Þrk* 17/1, 18/1, 20/1, 22/1, 25/1, 30/1; *Rþ* 44/3; *1 HHund* 54/3; *Brot* 7/1, 10/1; *1 Guðr* 6/1, 12/1, 17/1, 23/1, 24/1, 25/1; *Akv* 13/3, 25/1; *Ghv* 4/1, 8/1; *Hamð* 12/1 (n.). *1 Guðr* 4/1 has *þá kvað Gjaf·laug, · Gjúka systir*, but judging by the use of *þá kvað þat X ...* at 6 other places in that poem, it is probably a scribal error from earlier **þá kvað* ***þat*** *Gjaf·laug ...*, in which case the total rises to 22.
A variant formula is *hitt kvað þá X · Y*, as found in *Sigsk* 31/1, and *Hamð* 6/1, 9/1, 22/1, 24/1, 26/1. A rare variant is *Akv* 27/1: *mérr kvað þat Gunn·arr, · gęir-Niflungr*.

1 hvítastr ása 'whitest of the Eese' | A likely fire-epithet; cf. st. 13/3 n. above

2 vissi vęl framm 'he knew well ahead' | I.e., 'saw the future well'. Compare the derived adjective *fram-víss* 'forth-wise, prescient.'

2 sęm vanir aðrir 'like the other Wanes' | Homedall is not otherwise considered one of the Wanes, which are generally held to encompass only the gods Nearth, Frea, and Frow, in *Yng* 4 also the being Quasher (cf. *Vsp* 17/3, but contrast the introduction to *Háv* 103–110). This verse has been thought to undermine the existence of the Wanes as a group distinct from the Eese, since the word *vanir* here can be plausibly taken to mean nothing other than 'Gods'; for this distinction cf. *Vsp* 22 n.

**16** Lǫ́tum und hǫ́num · hrynja lukla [R 17v/6]
ok kven-váðir · umb kné falla
en á brjósti · breiða stęina
ok hag≈liga · umb hǫfuð typpum!"

We shall hang by His side keys to jingle,
and women's garments to fall about His knees,
but on His breast broad stones,
and skilfully shall We tip His head!"

ALL | A unique description of Wiking Age bridal dress. Cf. the description's of dress in *Rþ*, which is, however, a much younger poem than *Prk*. Being the mistress of the household, keys were the mark of a respectable married woman. The "broad stones" on the breast may be tortoise brooches (also mentioned in *Vkv* 25, 36.) or beads in a large necklace. The "tipping" of the head refers to some sort of bridal hat which would have included a veil (cf. st. 27 below).

**17** Þá kvað þat Þórr, · þrúðugr ǫss: [R 17v/8]
„Mik munu ęsir · argan kalla
ef ek binda=sk lęt · brúðar líni!"

Then this quoth Thunder, the mighty Os:
"Me will the Eese call queer
if I let Myself be bound with bridal linen!"

2 argan kalla 'call queer' | Although reminiscent of schoolyard taunting, such an insult in fact carried legal consequences, for a man deemed *argr* (or *ragr* the metathesised form) 'queer, effeminate, unmanly' suffered the loss of personal rights and could no longer marry or swear oaths. Laws explicitly concerning this word are found among both the Icelanders and the Longbeards. In Iceland the word was explicitly banned as one of the three great words of insult, and punished by *skóg-gangr* 'forest-walk', i.e., full outlawry. So the Grey-Goose of the *Staðarhólsbók*, 376 (Vilhjálmur Finsen 1879, p. 392): *Þau eru orð þrjú* [...] *er skóg-gang varða ǫll, ef maðr kallar mann ragan eða stroðinn eða sorðinn.* 'These are the three words which all incur full outlawry: if a man calls a man queer or sodomised or catamited.'
In older times an insult of masculinity had to be either retracted or settled by duel. So the Longbeardish Edict of Rothari, codified in 643 AD (TODO): *Si quis alium* arga *per furorem clamaverit et negare non potuerit et dixerit, quod per furorem dixisset, tunc iuratus dicat, quod eum* arga *non cognovisset; postea conponat pro ipso iniurioso verbo solidos duodecim. Et si perseveraverit, convincat per pugnam, si potuerit, aut certe conponat, ut supra.* 'If anyone calls another man *arga* 'queer' in anger, and cannot deny it, and says that it was said in anger, then in his oath he says that he does not know him as queer; let him thereafter settle for the insulting word with twelve solidi. But if he persists, let him prove it by fighting if he can, or otherwise settle it as above.' The same is found in the Old Swedish Heathen law, which however does not explicitly mention the word *argr* (Läffler 1879; Friesen 1902; **RosenbergForthcoming**).

**18** Þá kvað þat Loki · Lauf·ęyjar sonr: [R 17v/9]
„Þęgi þú, Þórr, · þęira orða!
Þegar munu jǫtnar · Ǫs·garð búa
nema þínn hamar · þér of hęimtir."

Then this quoth Lock, Leafie's son:
"Shut up Thou, Thunder, with those words!
Shortly will the Ettins settle Osyard,
unless Thou Thy hammer for Thyself dost fetch!"

2 Þęgi þú, Þórr, · þęira orða! 'Shut up thou, Thunder, with those words!' | Formulaic line; cf. *1 Guðr* 24/2: *Þęgi þú, þjóð-lęið, · þęira orða.*

3–4 Þegar ... hęimtir. 'Shortly ... dost fetch!' | Guarding the lands of the Gods and men from transgressive and destructive forces is Thunder's task, and the Hammer his most important tool. Cf. *Vsp* 24–25, *Hárb* 23–24, *Hym* 22, and a couplet by the obscure poet Thurbern Dise-scald, cited in *Skm* 11 (Þdís *Þórr* in SkP 3): *Þórr hefr Yggs með órum · Ós-garð af þrek varðan.* 'Thunder has with the messengers of Ug [GODS] mightily guarded Osyard.'

**19** Bundu þęir Þór þá · brúðar líni [R 17v/11]
ok inu mikla · męni brísinga,
létu und hónum · hrynja lukla
ok kven-váðir · umb kné falla
en á brjósti · breiða stęina
ok hag=liga · umb hǫfuð typpðu.

They bound Thunder then with bridal linen
and with the great Necklace of Blazes.
They hung by his side keys to jingle,
and women's garments to fall about the knees,
but on the breast broad stones,
and skilfully they tipped his head.

**20** Þá kvað þat Loki · Lauf·ęyjar sonr: [R 17v/13]
„Mun'k auk með þér · ambótt vesa,
vit skulum aka tvau · í jǫtun-hęima.“

Then this quoth Lock, Leafie's son:
"I too will with Thee be a handmaid;
We two shall drive into the Ettin-Homes."

3 vit ... tvau 'we two' | It is a fundamental characteristic of Thunder in the Norse mythology that he is very seldom alone on his adventures, but almost always has a travel companion or sidekick (Lindow 1988, p. 123). — *tvau* 'two' is here in the neuter, which is used for mixed-sex groups. This is either an error due to mindless copying of st. 11, or a backhanded insult against Thunder by Lock.

**21** Sęnn vóru hafrar · hęim of *v*reknir, [R 17v/14]
skyndir at skǫklum, · skyldu vęl rinna;
bjǫrg brotnuðu, · brann jǫrð loga;
ók Óðins sonr · í jǫtun-hęima.

Soon were the he-goats driven home,
hastened onto the cart-poles; they were to run well.
Crags burst, the earth burned with flame;
Weden's son [= Thunder] drove to the Ettin-Homes.

1 hafrar 'he-goats' | Thunder's chariot is driven by his two goats; cf. the kenning *hafra dróttinn* 'Lord of He-goats' (*Hym* 20, 31).

3 bjǫrg brotnuðu, · brann jǫrð loga ‘Crags burst, the earth burned with flame’ | Thunder’s driving is often heralded by cosmic disturbance and fire. So his arrival in *Lok* 55 is signalled by the mountains quaking. It is for this reason he must wade to the Thing of the Gods rather than ride across the Rainbow Bridge (Bivrest), *Grm* 29. The description most similar to the present stanza is found in Thedwolf’s *Haustl* 14–16, where crags (*bjǫrg*) burst asunder and fires rage before him as he drives to fight Rungner. A possibly Indo-European parallel is the Vedic myth of Índra breaking the mountains and releasing the rivers (as described most famously in *ṚV* 1.32). Cf. also *Bdr* 3 where the ground rumbles beneath the riding Weden.

**22** Þá kvað þat Þrymr, · þursa dróttinn: [R 17v/16]
„Standið upp, jǫtnar, · ok stráið bękki!
Nú fǿrið mér · Freyju at kvǫn,
Njarðar dóttur · ór Nóa-túnum.

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:
“Stand up, ye ettins, and strew the benches!
Now bring me Frow to wife,
Nearth’s daughter from the Nowetons!

**23** Ganga hér at garði · goll-hyrnðar kýr, [R 17v/18]
øxn al-svartir, · jǫtni at gamni,
fjǫlð á’k męiðma, · fjǫlð á’k męnja;
ęinnar mér Freyju · á·vant þykkir.“

Here march to my farmstead golden-horned kine,
all-black oxen to the ettin’s [my] pleasure.
I own a multitude of treasures; I own a multitude of torcs;
only Frow I think me missing!”

1–2 goll-hyrnðar kýr, øxn al-svartir ‘golden-horned kine, all-black oxen’ | Two releated formulae. Together they emphasise the great value and sacrifical purpose of the oxen; both have Indo-European parallels and also appear together in Latvian *Daina* 33863 (*Melni vērši, zelta ragi, / nāk par jūru baurodami* ‘Black oxen, golden horns, come bellowing over the sea’, Calin 1996, pp. 37–40). TODO: write about the IE parallels. *goll-hyrnðar kýr* is also found in *HHj* 4/2a, and the term *gollin-horni* ‘golden-horned one’ appears as a poetic synonym for “ox” in the Þul *Øxna* 3. — The singular *oxi al-svartr* ‘all-black ox’ appears in *Hym* 18, likewise of an animal to be sacrificed. For sacrificial black beasts cf. Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.8.12, where the hero Hadding has to atone for his slaying of a heavenly being by a sacrifice of dark-coloured victims (*furvae hostiae*): *Siquidem propiciandorum numinum gratia Frø deo rem divinam furvis hostiis fecit. Quem litationis morem annuo feriarum circuitu repetitum posteris imitandum reliquit. Frøblod Sveones vocant.* ‘In order to mollify the divinities he [= Hadding] did indeed make a holy sacrifice of dark-coloured victims to the god Frø. He repeated this mode of propitiation at an annual festival and left it to be imitated by his descendants. The Swedes call it Frøblot.’ This ancient ritual taboo even finds a parallel in the Tanakh, where animals dedicated to YHWH were to be unblemished (Hebrew תְּמִים, Leviticus 1:3), which prob. includes being of a single colour.

**24** Vas þar at kveldi · of komit snimma [R 17v/20]
ok fyr jǫtna · ǫl framm borit;
ęinn át oxa, · átta laxa,

krásir allar, · þǫ́r's konur skyldu,
drakk Sifjar verr · sǫ́ld þrjú mjaðar.

There the evening was come early,
and for the ettins ale brought forth.
He [= Thunder] alone ate an ox, eight salmons,
all the dainties meant for the women;
Sib's husband [= Thunder] drank three sieves of mead.

3–5 Ę́inn ... mjaðar. 'He alone ... of mead.' | Thunder is renowned for his great appetite; cf. *Hym* 15 where he eats two of Hymer's oxen and *Gylf* 46–47 where he drinks a large part of the sea.

5 Sifjar verr 'Sib's husband' | It is curious that the same kenning is used in *Hym* 15, which also describes Thunder's eating; it is perhaps a borrowing from the present stanza.

**25** Þá kvað þat Þrymr, · þursa dróttinn: [R 17v/23]
„Hvar sátt-u brúðir · bíta hvassara?
Sá'k≠a brúðir · bíta ǫnn breiðara
né ǫnn mę́ira mjǫ́ð · mę́y of drekka!“

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:
"Where sawest thou brides bite sharper?
I never saw brides bite yet broader;
nor yet more mead a maiden drink!"

**26** Sat in al-snotra · ambǫ́tt fyrir [R 17v/25]
es orð of fann · við jǫ́tuns máli:
„Át vę́tr Frę́yja · átta nǫ́ttum,
svá vas hǫ́n óð-fús · í jǫ́tun-hę́ima.“

Sat the all-clever handmaid [= Lock] in front,
who found a word against the ettin's speech:
"Frow ate naught for eight nights;
so madly She longed for the Ettin-Homes."

**27** Laut und línu, · lysti at kyssa, [R 17v/27]
en hann útan stǫkk · ǫ́nd-langan sal:
„Hví eru ǫ́ndótt · augu Frę́yju?
Þykkj*a* mér ór augum · *ę́ldar* brinna!“

He [= Thrim] looked 'neath the linen, lusted to kiss—
but flung back out across the length of the hall—
"Why are the eyes of Frow so hostile?
Methinks there are fires burning from her eyes!"

4 *ę́ldar* 'fires' | *emend.; om.* **R**

1 lĭnu ‘linen’ | Like in many other Eurasian cultures, the face of the bride was thickly veiled.

2 ęnd-langan sal ‘across the length of the hall’ | Lit. ‘[across] the endlong hall’. — A formulaic b-verse. In Ancient-words-lay it otherwise occurs as part of a formulaic long-line expressing people entering halls; cf. *Vkv* 8 n. In Leeds-meter the acc. pl. *ęnd-langa sali* is found in *Skí* 3 and in Speeches-meter a variant dat. sg. *ęnd(i)-lǫngu húsi* is attested in *Am* 18/1b, 24/1b; .

3 ǫndótt ‘so hostile’ | A rare word. TODO.

4 Þykkj*a* mér ór augum · *ęldar* brinna! ‘Methinks there are fires burning from her eyes!’ | The line is clearly corrupt in **R** (*‘ þicci mer or avgom brenna’*); if we place the cæsura between *ór* and *augum* the a-verse is only three syllables long and alliteration must quite unnaturally fall on the weakly stressed preposition *ór* ‘from’. Since vowel alliteration is required by *augum*, **ęldar* ‘fires’ has been inserted between ‘eyes’ and *brenna* ‘burns’. This requires the form of 3sg. pres. ind. *þykki* ‘it seems, -thinks’ **R** to be changed to 3pl. *þykkja*, for which reason Finnur Jónsson (1932) has the b-verse as **ęldr of brinna* instead, but the pre-verbal particle *of* is not otherwise used before the verb *brinna* ‘burn’ in *Þrk*, and inserting it seems too hypothetical. An alternative emendation of the line that does not require the changing of the verb is **þykki mér ęldr · ór augum brinna*, but the b-verse with anacrusis is unmetrical and does not appear anywhere else in *Þrk*. — The same expression is attested in *Gylf* 51:19: *eldar brenna ór augum hans ok nǫsum* ‘fires burn from his eyes and nostrils’ (cf. *Vsp* H48 n.).

**28** [R 17v/29]

Sat in al-snotra · ambǫ́tt fyrir
es orð of fann · við jǫtuns máli:
„Svaf vętr Fręyja · átta nóttum,
svá vas hǫn óð-fús · í jǫtun-hęima.“

Sat the all-clever handmaid in front,
who found a word against the ettin’s speech:
“Frow slept naught for eight nights;
so madly She longed for the Ettin-Homes.”

1 fyrir | *add.* †f.† **R**.

3 Svaf vętr Fręyja · átta nóttum | This line parallels 26/3 above, but lacks alliteration. Mikael Males suggests that metrical regularity has been sacrificed in favour of parallelism and compares the similarity between ll. 1/1 (n.) and 13/1. A further instance of the same phenomenon is found in *Brot* 9/3.

**29** [R 17v/30]

Inn kom in arma · jǫtna systir,
hin’s brúð-féar · biðja þorði:
„Lát þér af hǫndum · hringa rauða
ef þú ǫðla=sk vill · ástir mínar,
ástir mínar, · alla hylli!“

In came the wretched sister of the ettins,
she who for the bride-fee had dared ask:
“Slide off from thy hands the red rings,
if thou wilt win my affections,
my affections, [and] all [my] holdness.”

ALL | The sister, who was apparently the one who asked for the Hammer, now has the audacity to ask Thunder (disguised as Frow) to give her the very rings on his hands.

2 brúð-féar 'the bride-fee' | Thunder's hammer.

5 ástir mínar, · alla hylli 'my affections, [and] all [my] holdness'' | Possibly formulaic. There are no preserved parallels in poetry but there may be one in *Gylf* 49:31–32, following the death of Balder: *En er goð'in vitkuðu=sk, þá mélti Frigg ok spurði, hverr sá véri með ósum, er* eigna=sk vildi „allar ástir mínar (so **TW**; *ástir hennar 'her affections'* **SU**) ok hylli, *ok vili hann ríða á hel-veg ok freista, ef hann fái fundit Baldr, ok bjóða Helju út·lausn, ef hón vill láta fara Baldr heim í Ás·garð.*" 'But when the gods came back to their wits, then Frie spoke and asked which one among the Eese *would win "all my affections and holdness* and would ride upon the Hellway and try whether he may find Balder and offer Hell a ransom if she will let Balder come home to Osyard."'
We can tell from the citation of a Leeds-meter stanza at the end of *Gylf* 49 (*Eddbr* V 1 below) that Snorre had access to now-lost Eddic poetry concerning Balder's death, and it may thus be the case that one of these poems contained the same two long-lines as the present ll. 4–5. For such a sharing of several lines cf. st. 14/1–3 above, which is identical to *Bdr* 1/1–3, a Ancient-words-lay poem dealing with the earliest part in the Balder-cycle.

**30** Þá kvað þat Þrymr, · þursa dróttinn: [R 17v/32]
„Berið inn hamar · brúði at vígja,
lęggið Mjǫllni · í męyjar kné,
vígið okkr saman · Várar hęndi!"

Then this quoth Thrim, the lord of Thurses:
"Bear ye in the hammer the bride for to bless;
lay ye Millner in the maiden's lap;
bless us two together by the hand of Ware!"

4 Várar 'Ware' | According to *Gylf* 35:16 *Vǫr* 'vow, covenant' is the goddess who governs vows between men and women. Here she is apparently invoked as a witness in the wedding ceremony, perhaps a reflex of authentic pagan wedding customs of the Wiking Age. This word may however also be read as the formally identical noun *vár*, which would give us a phrase *várar hǫnd* 'hand of the vow', perhaps a reference to a certain hand gesture, and leave out the goddess.

**31** Hló Hlór·riða · hugr í brjósti [R 17v/34]
es harð-hugaðr · hamar of þękkði;
Þrym drap hann fyrstan, · þursa dróttin,
ok ętt jǫtuns · alla lamði.

Loride's heart laughed in his chest,
when, hard-hearted, he recognised the hammer.
Thrim he smote first, the lord of Thurses,
and all the ettin's lineage he beat lame.

1 Hló Hlór·riða · hugr í brjósti 'Loride's heart laughed in his chest' | Cf. *3 Guðr* 9/1: *Hló þá Atla · hugr í brjósti* 'Then laughed Attle's heart in his chest'.

**32** Drap hann ina ǫldnu · jǫtna systur, [R 18r/1]

hin's brúð-féar · of beðit hafði;
hǫn skell of hlaut · fyr skillinga,
en hǫgg hamars · fyr hringa fjǫlð.
Svá kom Óðins sonr · ęndr at hamri.

He smote the olden sister of the ettins,
she who for the bride-fee had asked.
She got a smiting for shillings,
and a blow of the hammer for a multitude of rings.
So came Weden's son back to his hammer.

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3 skillinga 'shillings' | *skillingr* 'shilling' is commonly used in ON prose and has cognates in other Germanic languages: OE *scilling*, OS, OHG *skilling*, Gothic *skilliggs*. This is however its only attestation in Norse poetry of any kind, whether Eddic or Scaldic.

# Lay of Wayland
# *(Vǫlundar kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.428)–early C11th (0.475)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Lay of Wayland** (*Vkv*) is a psychologically complex narrative poem dealing with the capture and revenge of the famous smith Wayland.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Vkv* only survives in full in **R** (foll. 18r/4–19v/6), where it follows *Þrk* and is followed by *Alv*. The beginning of the prose introduction is also found on the very last foll. of **A** (6v/26–28), where it follows *Hym*.

Although arguably more of a heroic poem, *Vkv* is part of the mythological section of **R**, to which it conforms orthographically (Lindblad 1980, pp. 160–166). The poem is also found in the otherwise exclusively mythological **A**. It does not belong to the cycle of the Walsings, nor to the Hallow-poems, which are the subjects of the heroic part of **R**. For these reasons, and following the choices of the mediaeval editors, *Vkv* is placed under Norse Mythic Poetry in the pres. ed.

### Origin and motifs

*Vkv* is a narrative poem telling the story of Wayland the Smith (ON *Vǫlundr*, OE *Wēland* or *Wēlund*, MHG **Welent*). Wayland was one of the most popular figures in early mediaeval Germanic legend and independent versions of his tale are found in Germany, England, and Iceland.

In his archetypal form, Wayland is an uncannily talented smith who is taken captive and hamstrung by the greedy tyrant King Nithad (ON *Níð·uðr*, OE *Nīþhad*, MHG **Nîdung*). Nithad forces Wayland to make jewels for him and his household but Wayland carries out a cruel revenge against the king: he murders his two sons and rapes his daughter, Beadhild (ON *Bǫðv·ildr*, OE

*Beaduhild*, MHG **Botil*), making her pregnant. At last, he makes a flight-suit out of feathers, typically (though not in *Vkv*) with the help of his brother Eyel (ON *Egill*, OE *Ægili*). Having regained his mobility through ingenuity he makes his escape and leaves the ruined king's household behind.

There is a strong parallelism throughout the narrative in that Wayland gets his revenge on the whole royal household by doing unto them what was done to him. This theme is developed very effectively in the present poem (but cf. the treatment in the OE *Déor* 1–2). Like Wayland was taken while waiting for his wife, so he murders Nithad's two young sons and ends his family line. Like he was made powerless, he defangs Nithad's *kunnig kvǫn* 'cunning wife' by reducing her once powerful counsels to cold words. Like he lost his wife's golden ring, so he rapes Beadhild, depriving her of her maidenhood.

In this way the royal household is reduced to the very same state of abject powerlessness that Wayland himself experienced, something signalled by the repetition of the adjective *vilja-lauss* 'powerless'. In st. 12 this word describes Wayland after he awakes in shackles, but in st. 31 it is King Nithad who uses it to refer to his own mental state after the deaths of his sons. This sense of hopelessness also concludes the poem with Beadhild's haunting words: "In no way did I know how to withstand him; in no way could I withstand him."

**Parallels**

As mentioned above, *Vkv* is not the only retelling of Wayland's story. The other relevant retellings are the 9th century OE *Déor* and the 13th century Norse *Þiðr*; the former represents the older, Anglo-Norse version, while the latter represents the younger Low German version.

Wayland is alluded to in numerous other sources, from which we learn a little about the fate of Beadhild. After Wayland abandoned her she gave birth to a son, Woody (OE *Wudga*, *Þiðr Viðga*, in Danish ballads *Vidrik Verlandsøn*). He went on to become a great hero, and in the later heroic ballads far eclipses his father in fame. His birth seems heavily foreshadowed by Wayland forcing Nithad to swear an oath on the unborn child in st. 33, but he is nowhere directly mentioned in the poem, probably for artistic reasons: dwelling on the tragic image of Beadhild is certainly a powerful ending.

*Déor* shortly relates the lives of five figures from Germanic legend. Stanzas 1–2 deal with Wayland and Beadhild, and the underlying story is identical to that of *Vkv*: Wayland is imprisoned by Nithad, then kills his sons and rapes Beadhild. Like *Vkv*, *Déor* particularly emphasises the powerlessness felt by Wayland and how his revenge in turn inflicted the same on Beadhild.

An Anglo-Saxon pictoral depiction of the story is found on the early C8th Franks casket, which shows Wayland drugging Beadhild, Nithad's decapitated sons, and his brother Eyel collecting swan-feathers for the flight-suit (Fig. 7). The fact that the Wayland-Story is as prominent as the depiction of the Adoration of the Magi is a testament to the weight with which it was regarded in early mediaeval England.



Figure 7: The front panel of the Franks casket. Anglo-Saxon, ca. 725 AD. © John W. Schulze. CC BY 2.0. `https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Franks_Casket_front.jpg`

The other full retelling of Wayland' life is found in the much younger *Þiðr*. While written in Old Norse, it is clear from the linguistic forms of the proper names and content in it that it is based on Low German sources, probably heroic ballads. Thus the native Norse forms *Vǫlundr* and *Níð·uðr* are replaced with the Low German *Velent* [*sic*] and *Níðungr*. The 13th century author makes an interesting note which reveals that native Norse stories about Wayland were not yet entirely extinct in his time: he mentions "*Velent*, the excellent smith, whom Warrings (*væringjar* 'Varangians') call *Vǫlundr*. [...] *Velent* is so famous in the whole northern hemisphere that all men seem to praise his workmanship in such a way that the craftsman of any piece which is crafted better than others is called a *Vǫlundr* with regards to craftmanship."

It is not merely in dialect that *Þiðr* departs from the older retellings; far more important is the difference in tone. The psychological complexity and tragedy of *Vkv* and *Déor* are entirely gone, and Wayland is no longer a mysterious supernatural wild man, but a chivalrous knight who can escape from any peril through his ingenuity and skill. He is not kidnapped out of Nithad's greed nor hamstrung on the suspicions of his cruel wife, but is instead a loyal servant of Nithad's, banished from the kingdom after defending himself against the king's corrupt steward and hamstrung after being caught attempting to poison the king's food.

Yet the biggest change in the narrative is without doubt that the personality of Beadhild is entirely expunged. Far from the Anglo-Norse version she has here become the anonymous "king's daughter", a nameless *jungfrú* 'maiden' (a borrowing from Low German) whom Wayland seduces by means of a vulgar sex joke ("Now the king's daughter comes into the smithy and asks Wayland to mend the ring, but he says that he firsts wants to 'forge'

something else.") and who quickly falls in love with him.

Likewise gone is the person of Nithad's cunning wife, and the murder of his sons no longer ends his lineage, since he has another son who survives him and takes over the kingdom. Wayland still flies away laughing after telling Nithad what he has done, but only four years later reconciliates with Nithad's living son, retrieves Beadhild and their three-year old son and lives a long and happy life as a famous smith.

By the time of the *Þiðr* the old story of Wayland had been heavily bowlderized, a tragic victim of chivalric sensibilities. This younger version does not have any high literary value, but is of course still of interest since it shows the wide reception and variation of the narrative.

**Origin and motifs**

If we are to search for the origins of the Wayland-myth we can hardly look in Scandinavia. As we have seen above the story was particularly popular in Anglo-Saxon England, and it is probably hence that it made its way to Scandinavia.

*Vkv* does indeed show signs of Old English influence in its vocabulary (1/2: *al-vitr*, 11/2: *ljóði*, 36/3: *aukin*), nor do the proper names of its characters (particularly Beadhild and Thankred, the thrall) seem North Germanic. Of course, the poem cannot be a direct translation from OE. The impossibility of that is shown by the use of formulaic Norse lines (e.g. 16/1–2, 30/1–2) and by lines requiring North Germanic sound changes to alliterate (e.g. 14/3: *óra aura · í Ulf-dǫlum* 'our ounces in the Wolfdales' vs. reconstructed OE: **ūre éaras · in Wulf-dalum*, and note that OE **éaras* 'ounces' is not even a real word).

Even older versions of the story must needs remain forever lost. It is clear from their names that Wayland and Nithad are fairy-tale characters, not historical figures, for Wayland's name means 'Crafty Hand' (< PGmc. **wéla-handuz*, Brate 1908) and Nithad's 'Shameful Fighter' (< PGmc. **níþa-haduz*).

Comparatively there are striking similarities between Wayland and the Greek smith Δαίδαλος. Both are legendary inventors trapped on an island by an evil tyrant for whom they have been forced to work, and both make their escape alongside a near relation (Wayland's brother Eyel, Δαίδαλος' son Ἴκαρος) by means of a flight-suit. The difficulty with these parallels is that the Wayland-story, anchored as it is in Germanic legend, is attested long before knowledge of Greek mythology can have existed in Northern Europe. We may therefore be dealing with much older folklore, perhaps even going back to the Bronze Age (as the image of the Labyrinth definitely does) or the Neolithic European Farmers, although such connections cannot but remain speculation.

A unique narrative feature of the Norse *Vkv* is its incorporation of the motif of the swan-wife at the beginning of the poem. This motif, widespread throughout world mythology (TODO: cite), is not otherwise found in connection with story of Wayland. Whether this is the due to the incomplete-

ness of our early parallel sources or a genuine innovation of the Norse Wayland-tradition remains unclear.

## Text

### Frá Vǫlundi ('From Wayland')

**P1** Níð·uðr hét konungr í Sví-þjóð. Hann átti tvá sonu ok eina dóttur; hón hét Bǫðv·ildr. Bróðr vǫru þrír, synir Finna konungs. Hét einn Slag·fiðr, annarr Egill, þriði Vǫlundr. Þeir skriðu ok veiddu dýr. Þeir kvǫmu í Ulf-dali ok gerðu sér þar hús. Þar er vatn, er heitir Úlf-sjár. Snemma of morgin fundu þeir á vatsstrǫndu konur þrjár, ok spunnu lín. Þar vǫru hjá þeim álftarhamir þeira; þat vǫru val-kyrjur. Þar vǫru tvér dǿtr Hlǫð·vés konungs: Hlað·guðr svan-hvít ok Her·vǫr al·vitr. In þriðja var Ql·rún Kjárs dóttir af Val-landi. Þeir hǫfðu þér heim til skála með sér. Fekk Egill Ql·rúnar, en Slag·fiðr svan-hvítrar, en Vǫlundr al·vitrar. Þau bjuggu sjau vetr. Þá flugu þér at vitja víga ok kvǫmu eigi aptr. Þá skreið Egill at leita Ql·rúnar, en Slag·fiðr leitaði svan-hvítrar, en Vǫlundr sat í Ulf-dǫlum. Hann var hagastr maðr, svá at menn viti í fornum sǫgum. Níð·uðr konungr lét hann hǫndum taka, svá sem hér er um kveðit: [R 18r/4, A 6v/26]

Nithad was the name of a king in Sweden. He had two sons and a daughter; she was called Beadhild. There were three brothers, the sons of a king of the Finns. The one was called Slayfinn, the other Eyel, the third Wayland. They fared on skis and hunted wild beasts. They came into the Wolfdales and made for themselves houses there. There is a lake there which is called the Wolfsea. Early in the morning they found by the lake-shore three women, and they were spinning linen. There beside them were their swan-hames; those were Walkirries. There, there were the two daughters of King Ludwigh: Ladguth the Swanwhite and Harware the Elwight. The third was Alerune, daughter of Coser of Walland. The men took the women to their halls with them. Eyel got Alerune, and Slayfinn the Swanwhite, and Wayland the Elwight. The couples lived there for seven winters; then the women left to attend battles, and they did not come back. Then Eyel fared on skis to search for Alerune, and Slayfinn searched for Swanwhite, but Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales. He was the most skilled craftsman whom men know of in the ancient saws. King Nithad had him taken captive, about which it is here sung:

2 hón hét 'she was called' | *ok hét hón 'and she was called'* **A** 2 vǫru 'were' | *om.* **R** 4 gerðu 'made' | *after this word the rest of the ms. ends for loss of following foll.* **A**

9 Kjárs ... af Val-landi 'Coser of Walland' | I.e. 'Caesar of Rome/France'. Of course no specific historical emperor can be identified by this name, but rather it is an anachronistic reflex of the position, a title which has been misunderstood as a proper name. Cf. *Wid* 4/3, where Coser (OE *Câsere*) is said to rule the Greeks. For the form see st. 15/4 n., for other occurrences see Index.

## Frá Vǫlundi ok Níð·aði ('From Wayland and Nithad')

**1** Męyjar flugu sunnan · Myrk-við ĩ gǫgnum [R 18r/19]
al-vitr ungar, · ør·lǫg drýgja;
þér à sévar strǫnd · sęttu=sk at hvíla=sk,
drósir suð-rønar · dýrt lĩn spunnu.

Maidens flew from the south through Mirkwood
—young elwights—to fulfill orlay.
By a lake-shore they set down to rest;
the southern ladies span costly linen.

2 ungar | *gramm. emend.;* unga **R**

1 Myrk-við 'Mirkwood' | A great border forest, surely referenced for its association with the war-ravaged lands of the Gots and Huns; a natural environment for Walkirries.

2 al-vitr 'elwights' | "Strange beings, foreign wights", from Proto-Norse **alja-wihtiz* or borrowed from OE *æl-wihta* pl. 'strange creatures, monsters'.

2 ør·lǫg drýgja 'to fulfill orlay' | That is, to fulfill their preordained destinies, viz. to attend battles as Walkirries and choose which men to take away (cf. P1 and st. 3). Clunies Ross (2005, p. 103), La Farge and Tucker (1992, p. 319) and others see these words as a sign of English influence and translate *drýgja ør·lǫg* as 'engage in war', considering *ør·lǫg* a semantic borrowing from OE *or·lęge* 'war, strife' (cf. Dutch *oorlog* 'war'). This is unnecessary. ON *ør·lǫg* otherwise only means 'fate, destiny', as may OE *or·lęg* as seen by an equivalent phrase found in l. 29 of a poem on the Christian Doomsday (TODO?), where a man going to Hell for his sins *þonne â tó ealdre · or·lęg dreógeð* 'then for ever and ever suffers his orlay'.

**2** Ęin nam þęira · Ęgil at vęrja [R 18r/21]
fǫgr mér fira · faðmi ljósum;
ǫnnur vas Svan·hvít, · svan-fjaðrar dró,
[...]
ęn in þriðja · þęira systir
varði hvítan · hals *Vǫl*undar.

One of them took to embrace Eyel
—the fair maiden among men—in her shining bosom.
Second was Swanwhite; her swan-feathers she rustled,
[...]
but the third sister among them
embraced the white throat of Wayland.

6 *Vǫl*undar | *sens. emend.;* Ǫnundar **R**

ALL | The three swan-maidens meet the three brothers, and each one takes a husband.

4 [...] | A line mentioning Slayfinn has probably been lost here.

6 hvítan 'white' | Pale skin being a sign of noble ancestry; cf. 17/3.

**3** Sǫ́tu síðan · sjau vetr at þat, [R 18r/24]
ęn hinn átta · allan þrǫ́ðu,
ęn hinn níunda · nauðr of skilði,
męyjar fýstu=sk · á myrkvan við,
al-vitr ungar · ør·lǫg drýgja.

They stayed then for seven winters after that,
but during all the eighth they yearned,
and during the ninth need did part them.
The maidens longed for the Mirky Wood,
the young elwights to fulfill orlay.

5 ungar | *gramm. emend.;* unga **R**

**4** Kom þar af vęiði · veðr-ęygr skyti [R 18r/26]
*Vǫlundr líðandi · of langan veg,*
Slag·fiðr ok Ęgill, · sali fundu auða,
gingu út ok inn · ok umb sǫu=sk.

There from the hunt came the stormy-eyed shooter,
Wayland passing over a long way.
Slayfinn and Eyel found the halls deserted;
they walked out and in and looked about.

1 veðr-ęygr | *emend., cf. st. 9/3;* †vegr†-ęygr **R** 2 Vǫlundr ... veg 'Wayland ... way' | *emend. based on st. 9/3–4; om.* **R**

**5** Austr skręið Ęgill · at Ǫl·rúnu, [R 18r/27]
ęn suðr Slag·fiðr · at Svan·hvítu,
ęn ęinn Vǫlundr · sat í Ulf-dǫlum.

To the east skied Eyel after Alerune,
but to the south Slayfinn after Swanwhite,
and alone Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales.

**6** Hann sló goll rautt · við gim fastan, [R 18r/29]
lukði alla · lin*n*-bauga vel;
svá bęið hann · sinnar ljóssar
kvánar, ef hǫnum · koma gęrði.

He struck red gold against fastened gemstone;
he enclosed all the serpent-bighs well.
So did he await his shining wife,
if for him she might come.

2 lin*n*-bauga ‘serpent-bighs’ | *emend.;* ‘lind bauga’ **R** 3 ljóssar | *emend.;* ljósar **R**

1 sló goll rautt · við gim fastan ‘struck red gold against fastened gemstone’ | A description of the *cloisonné* technique wherein red garnet is encased in thin gold plates. Finds featuring this technique are very common in the period between ca. 300–700 AD, but almost non-existent afterwards (Nerman 1931, pp. 33–37). As *Vkv* was most likely composed one or two centuries after 700 this reflects a memory of the material culture of an earlier period. For a similar instance cf. *HHj* 9.

2 lin*n*-bauga ‘serpent-bighs’ | It is unclear whether this word refers to rings actually fitted with snake-heads or is merely a poetic description of twisted rings or spirals. Archaeological examples of the former include the so-called “snake-head rings” (German *Schlangenkopfringe*, Swedish *ormhuvudringar*) from the early Migration Period (Nerman 1931, p. 38), and the snake- or dragon-shaped armlet from the Wiking Age found in a hoard in Undrom, Ångermanland, northern Sweden (item number 108822 HST; `https://samlingar.shm.se/object/5C5658C4-0813-4DFF-947F-E5E4C4BAB965`).

**7** Þat spyrr Níð·uðr, · Níara dróttinn, [R 18r/31]
at ęinn Vǫlundr · sat í Ulf-dǫlum;
nóttum *f*óru sęggir, · nęglðar vóru brynjur,
skildir bliku þęira · við inn skarða mána.

Nithad learns it, lord of the Nears,
that alone Wayland stayed in the Wolfdales.
At night journeyed warriors—nailed were their byrnies—
their shields gleamed by the sickle moon.

3 *f*óru | *emend.;* vóru **R** 3 sęggir | *emend.;* segir **R**

1 Níara ‘the Nears’ | An obscure tribe. The fact that they are located in Sweden (P1 above) may allow us to connect them with the inhabitants of the Swedish province of Närke, who in OSwe. are known as *Nærikjar*, most likely from the tribal/geographical root *nær-* + *-íkjar* ‘inhabitants’. The stem *nær-* (with unclear vowel length) is also found in the adjective OSwe. *nær-iskęr* ‘belonging to Närke, Närikian’ and could then be the equivalent of OWN *níar-* ~ *njár-*. For further discussion on the origin of OSwe. *nær-* see Sahlgren (1925).

3 nęglðar vóru brynjur ‘nailed were their byrnies’ | The byrnies here are some kind of plate armour.

**8** Stigu ór sǫðlum · at salar gafli, [R 18r/33]
gingu inn þaðan · ęnd-langan sal,
sóu á bast · bauga dręgna,
sjau hundruð allra, · es sá sęggr átti.

They stepped off their saddles by the hall’s gables,
went thence inside the endlong hall.
They saw on a bast-rope bighs drawn up,
the seven hundred in all which that man owned.

2 gingu ... sal ‘went ... hall’ | The line appears to be a variant of the formulaic *hann/hǫn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal* ‘he/she went inside the endlong hall’ which also occurs in below *Vkv* 16/2 and 30/2 and in *Oddr* 3/3. For *ęnd-langan sal* ‘endlong hall’ in general cf. *Þrk* 27/2 n.

**9** Ok þęir af tóku · ok þęir á létu [R 18v/2]
fyr ęinn útan, · es af létu.
Kom þar af vęiði · veðr-ęygr skyti
Vǫlundr líðandi · of langan veg.

And they took them off and they slid them on,
save for one which they slid off.—
There from the hunt came the stormy-eyed shooter,
Wayland passing over a long way.

2 fyr ęinn útan, · es af létu 'save for one which they slid off' | This bigh is probably the one mentioned in sts. 17 and 26, since Beadhild has it already when Wayland is brought back after being captured. It may have been kept for its particular beauty. Finnur Jónsson (1932) writes, in my translation from the Danish: "The ring which Nithad kept must have had special properties and distinguished itself before others. There is no doubt that the ring is a flight ring; whether this was clear to the poet is however questionable. This much is certain: that Wayland seems to be able to fly away only after he has got back the ring; that is, the one which Beadhild brings him." This is by no means certain. Wayland was a craftsman of legendary skill and could certainly have built wings for himself without a magical flight-ring. That is what he does in the Low German version; it is also what happens in the related Daidalos myth. For both of these see the introduction to the present poem.

**10** Gekk *hann* brúnni · beru hold stęikja; [R 18v/4]
ár brann hrísi · all-þurr fura,
viðr inn vind-þurri, · fyr Vǫlundi.

He went the brown she-bear's flesh to roast.
In early morn burned the twigs of all-dry pine,
the wind-dry wood, before Wayland.

1 *hann* | *om.* **R** 2 ár | *metr. emend.;* hár **R**

**11** Sat á ber-fjalli, · bauga talði, [R 18v/5]
alfa ljóði · ęins saknaði;
hugði at hęfði · Hlǫð·vés dóttir,
al-vitr unga · vęri aptr komin.

He sat on the bear-pelt, the bighs he counted—
the prince of elves was missing one!
He thought that Ludwigh's daughter [= Harware] might have it,
that the young elwight might be come again!

1 bauga talði 'bighs he counted' | Wayland's grief and loneliness is skilfully illustrated by his counting all seven hundred rings, something which has apparently become habitual for him.

2 alfa ljóði 'prince of elves' | Probably referring to Wayland's nature as a wild man; this is further seen by his bear-hunting, skiing, and fierce gaze, all associated with the Finns or Saami. Cf. 14/2b and 32/1b, where Nithad calls him *vísi alfa* 'chief of elves'.

**12** Sat svá lęngi, · at sofnaði, [R 18v/7]
ok vaknaði · vilja-lauss;
vissi sér á hǫndum · hǫfgar nauðir,
ęn á fótum · fjǫtur of spęnntan.

He sat so long that he fell asleep,
and he awoke, powerless.
He knew on his hands heavy restraints,
and on his feet a fetter tightened.

[Vǫlundr kvað:] **13** „Hvęrir 'ro jǫfrar · þęir's á lǫgðu [R 18v/9]
bęsti*-síma · ok bundu mik?“

[Quoth Wayland:] "Which are the princes that have laid on
the bast-cordage, and bound me?"

2 bęsti*-síma | *emend.;* 'besti-byr-sima' **R**

**14** Kallaði nú Níð·uðr, · Níara dróttinn: [R 18v/10]
„Hvar gatst, Vǫlundr, · vísi alfa,
óra aura, · í Ulf-dǫlum?
Goll vas þar ęigi · á Grana lęiðu,
fjarri hugða'k várt land · fjǫllum Rínar.“

Now Nithad called, lord of the Nears:
"Where didst thou, Wayland, O chief of elves,
get *our* ounces in the Wolfdales?
Gold was there not on Grane's path;
far I've thought our land from the fells of the Rhine!"

ALL | Grane was the horse of the legendary hero Siward, who slew the dragon Fathomer and took his gold (see *Fáfn*); these events are here, as in the later German *Nibelung* tradition, supposed to have taken place around the Rhine. Nithad's speech is sarcastic: "How did you get so rich, Wayland? Was there a dragon's hoard in the Wolfdales? Clearly not, so you must have stolen from me."

[Vǫlundr kvað:] **15** „Man'k at męiri · męti ǫttum, [R 18v/13]
es vér hęil híu · hęima vǫrum:
Hlað·guðr ok Hęr·vǫr · borin vas Hlǫð·véi,
kunn vas Ql·rún · Kíars dóttir.“

[Quoth Wayland:] "I recall that we owned a greater treasure
when we a whole household were at home.
Ladguth and Harware were born to Ludwigh;
known was Alerune, Coser's daughter."

ALL | Wayland responds rather cryptically and almost seems to be speaking to himself. By asserting the noble lineages of the three swan-wives he gives a legitimate origin for his wealth, but is at the same time aware that Nithad neither believes him nor cares.

2 híu 'household' | The meter (a normal type C, x#x#P#px) requires the restoration of the old hiatus form *híu* for *hjú*, a sign of composition before ca. 1150. The alternative scansion would be catalectic.

4 Kíars 'Coser's' | For the sense of this name see note to P1 above. — For the sake of meter the uncontracted hiatus form *Kíarr* must be restored from *Kjárr*; the verse is otherwise only three syllables long and catalectic. The uncontracted form is also metrically necessary in *Akv* 8/1b and Edáð *Banddr* 2 (SkP 1). — The development from Latin *Caesar* to ON *Kíarr* ~ *Kjárr* requires some elucidation. The word was first borrowed from Classical Latin into PGmc. as **kaisaraz* (cf. OHG *khęisur-* in *Hild* 33, OE *Câsere* in *Wíd* 4/3), which would be expected to yield ON ***kęisarr* were it not for an obscure Norse sound change causing the debuccalization of **s* > **h* > ∅ in the first syllable of 3-syllable words when followed by *r* in a following syllable (cf. ON *órr* ~ *várr* 'our' < **ôarr* < **ôsarr* < PN **onsaraR* < PGmc. **unseraz*; ON *járn* ~ *éarn* < *ísarn*), so that **kęisarr* > *kíarr* (~ **kéarr*). The loss of the diphthong is not unexpected, ***-ęi(j)a-* being an utterly illegal vowel glide. The later ON *keisari, keiseri* is undoubtedly borrowed from Low German.

**16** *Úti stóð kunnig · kvǫn Níð·aðar* [R 18v/15]
*ok* hǫn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal,
stóð á golfi, · stilti rǫddu:
„es=a sá nú hýrr, · es ór holti fęrr."

Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad;
and she went inside the endlong hall,
stood on the floor, steered her voice:
"He is not mild now, who comes out of the wood."

1 *Úti stóð kunnig · kvǫn Níð·aðar* 'Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad' | *emend. required by the sense (cf. st. 30/1–2); om.* **R**

1 *Úti stóð kunnig · kvǫn Níð·aðar* 'Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad' | Formulaic long-line template; cf. *1 HHund* 48/3, *Brot* 5/1. That it in fact a formulaic line is shown by its combination with other formulaic lines, both here and in *Brot* 5.

2 *ok* hǫn inn of gekk · ęnd-langan sal 'and she went inside the endlong hall' | Formulaic; cf. st. 8/2 n. above.

**P2** Níð·uðr konungr gaf dóttur sinni Bǫðv·ildi gull-hring þann er hann tók af basti'nu at Vǫlundar, en hann sjalfr bar sverð'it er Vǫlundr átti. En dróttning kvað: [R 18v/16]

King Nithad gave his daughter Beadhild the golden ring which he took from the bast rope in Wayland's hall, but he himself carried the sword which Wayland had owned. But the queen said:

**17** „Tęnn hǫnum tęygja=sk · es hǫnum 's tét sverð, [R 18v/19]
ok hann Bǫðv·ildar · baug of þękkir,

ǫ́mun eru augu · ormi inum frána;
sníðið ér hann · sin*v*a magni,
ok sętið hann síðan · í Sę́var-stǫð.“

“His teeth are bared when he is shown the sword,
and Beadhild’s bigh he recognises!
Reminiscent are his eyes to the gleaming serpent’s!
Snithe ye from him the might of his sinews,
and set him thereafter on the Seastead!”

4 sin*v*a | *metr. emend.;* sina **R**

4 sin*v*a | The meter requires a heavy syllable for the lift, which may be obtained by restoring the archaic gen. pl. **sinva* of *sin* ‘sinew’ (< PGmc. **sin(a)wō*) (Robert D. Fulk 2016, p. 265). For the medial *-v-* cf. *bǫl* ‘bale, curse’ (< PGmc. **balwą*), gen. pl. *bǫlva*.

**P3** Svá var gǫrt, at skornar vǫ́ru sinar í knés-fótum ok settr í holm einn, er þar var fyrir landi, er hét Sę́var-staðr. Þar smíðaði hann konungi alls-kyns gǫr-simar; engi maðr þorði at fara til hans, nema konungr einn. Vǫlundr kvað: [R 18v/21]

So it was done that the sinews in his houghs were cut and he was placed on the lonely islet which lay there before the land and which was called the Seastead. There he forged for the king every kind of jewel. No man dared go to him, save for the king alone. Quoth Wayland:

**18** „Skínn Níð·aði · sverð á linda, [R 18v/24]
þat’s ek hvęsta · sęm hagast kunna’k
ok ek hęrða’k · sęm hógst þótti;
sá ’s mér fránn mękir · ę́ fjarri borinn;
sé’k=a þann Vǫlundi · til smiðju borinn.

“The sword does shine on Nithad’s belt,
which I sharpened as most handily I could,
and I hardened as most pleasingly seemed.
That gleaming blade is ever further from me carried;
I see it not for Wayland to the smithy carried!

1 Skínn ‘shines’ | Metrically deficient, since *sk-* and *s-* cannot alliterate. A possible emendation is *se’k* ‘I see’.

**19** Nú berr Bǫðv·ildr · brúðar minnar [R 18v/27]
—bíð’k=a þęss bót— · bauga rauða.“

Now does Beadhild bear my bride’s
—I await no recompense for that—red bighs.”

**20** Sat—né svaf à·valt— · ok sló hamri; [R 18v/28]
vél gęrði hęldr · hvatt Níð·aði;
drifu ungir tvęir · á dýr séa
synir Níð·aðar · í Sęvar-stǫð.

He sat—never slept—and struck the hammer;
he most boldly planned wiles for Nithad.
Two young ones were drifting to see costly things,
Nithad's sons, to the Seastead.

1 Sat—né svaf à·valt— 'He sat—never slept—' | Compare *Ghv* 13/3: *hófu mik—né drękkðu—* '[they] lifted me—drowned [me] not—'.

**21** Kvómu til kistu, · krǫfðu lukla, [R 18v/30]
opin vas ill-úð, · es þęir í sóu,
fjǫlð vas þar męina, · es mǫgum sýndi=sk
at véri goll rautt · ok gǫr-simar.

They came to the chest, demanded the keys;
open was the evil when they looked inside.
A host was there of harms, which looked to the lads
like were it red gold and jewelry.

[Vǫlundr kvað:] **22** „Komið ęinir tvęir, · komið annars dags; [R 18v/33]
ykkr lęt'k þat goll · of gefit verða;
sęgið-a męyjum · né sal-þjóðum,
manni øngum, · at mik fyndið."

[Quoth Wayland:] "Come alone ye two, come another day;
to you, I say, this gold will be given.
Tell no maidens nor folk of the hall
—not a man!—that *me* ye met."

**23** Snimma kallað*i* · sęggr à annan, [R 19r/1]
bróðir à bróður: · „gǫngum baug séa!"
Kvómu til kistu, · krǫfðu lukla,
opin vas ill-úð · es þęir í litu.

Early one youth called out to another,
brother to brother: "Let us go see the bighs!"
They came to the chest, demanded the keys;
open was the evil when they gazed inside.

1 kallað*i* | *emend.;* kallað **R**

**24** Snęið af hǫfuð · hùna þęira [R 19r/3]
ok und fęn fjǫturs · føtr of l*a*gði,
ęn þér skálar, · es und skǫrum vǫru,
svęip útan silfri, · sęldi Níð·aði.

He sliced off the heads of those bear-cubs,
and under the fetter's fen their feet he laid,
but the bowls which were under their curls
he coated with silver, gave to Nithad.

2 l*a*gði | *emend.;* †logði† **R**

1 hùna 'bear-cubs' | This word is common in prose, but only in the sense 'bear-cub', never used as here about humans. The affectionate sense for young boys perhaps relates to warrior-initiations done in bear-skins. Its only occurrence in the sense 'young boys' outside of *Vkv* is in *Ghv* 12/1, but it is repeated by Nithad in st. 32 and mirrored by Wayland in st. 34 below.

2 fęn fjǫturs 'the fetter's fen' | Unclear. The smithy or islet may be Wayland's "fetter", in which case he buried them in a fen on the island.

3 þér skálar, · es und skǫrum vǫru 'the bowls which were under their curls' | Their skulls.

**25** Ęn ór augum · jarkna-stęina [R 19r/5]
sęndi kunnigri · k*vǫ́n* Níð·aðar;
ęn ór tǫnnum · tvęggja þęira
sló brjóst-kringlur, · sęndi Bǫðv·ildi.

But out of their eyes arkenstones
did he send to the cunning wife of Nithad,
and out of the teeth of the two
he struck breast-brooches, sent them to Beadhild.

2 k*vǫ́n* | *emend.;* konu **R**

1 jarkna-stęina 'arkenstones' | Generally held to be a borrowing from OE. Probably round crystals.

**26** Þà nam Bǫðv·ildr · baugi at hrósa [R 19r/7]
[...] · es brotit hafði,
„þori'g=a'k sęgja, · nema þér ęinum."

Then Beadhild began to praise the bigh,
[...] which she had broken,
"I dare not tell it, save to thee alone!"

ALL | Something appears to be missing before this stanza, but the narrative can be gleaned. Beadhild breaks the bigh given to her by Nithad (mentioned above in sts. 10—see note there—and 17), and fears her father's anger. She goes to Wayland in secret and begs him to fix it. The sight of the ring reminds Wayland of his wife and he is furious; he decides to begin with his revenge, and rapes Beadhild.

2 [...] | The meter requires a half-line here, perhaps containing a repetition of 1a: *baugi at brósa* 'to praise the bigh'.

Vǫlundr kvað: **27** „Ek bøti svá · brest á golli, [R 19r/8]
2 at fęðr þínum · fęgri þykkir,
ok móðr þínni · miklu bętri,
4 ok sjalfri þér · at sama hófi.“

Quoth Wayland: "I will so mend the crack on the gold,
that to thy father it seems fairer,
and to thy mother even better,
and to thyself of the self-same rank."

**28** Bar hana bjóri, · því't bętr kunni, [R 19r/10]
2 svá't hǫn í sessi · of sofnaði.
[Vǫlundr kvað:] „Nú hęfi'k hęfnt · harma mínna
4 allra nema ęinna · í·við-gjar*n*a.“

He overcame her with beer—for he knew better—
so that she in the seat did fall asleep.
"Now have I avenged my harms,
all, save one, on the insidious ones."

4 í·við-gjar*n*a | *emend.;* í·við-†giarira† **R**

1 því't bętr kunni 'for he knew better' | He was more cunning than she.

4 nema ęinna 'save one' | Presumably the deprivation of his mobility due to the hamstringing, which he resolves by crafting his flight suit.

4 í·við-gjar*n*a 'insidious ones' | King Nithad and his house.

**29** „Vęl ek,“ kvað Vǫlundr, · „verða'k á fitjum, [R 19r/12]
2 þęim's mik Níð·aðar · nǫmu rekkar.“
Hléjandi Vǫlundr · hóf=sk at lopti,
4 grátandi Bǫðv·ildr · gekk ór ęyju,
tregði fǫr friðils · ok fǫður ręiði.

"Well I", quoth Wayland, "do fall on my paddles,
those of which Nithad's men bereaved me!"
Laughing, Wayland threw himself in the air;
weeping, Beadhild went from the island,
grieved her lover's flight and her father's wrath.

1 fitjum 'paddles' | CV: *fit* 'the webbed foot of water-birds', here a reference to the flight-suit which allows Wayland to regain his freedom.

**30** Úti stóð kunnig · kvǫn Níð·aðar, [R 19r/14]
ok hǫn inn of gekk · ǫnd-langan sal,
ǫn hann á sal-garð · sętti=sk at hvíla=sk,
„Vakir þú Níð·uðr, · Níara dróttinn?“

Outside stood the cunning wife of Nithad
and she went inside the endlong hall,
but he on the courtyard set down to rest—
“Art thou awake, O Nithad, lord of the Nears?”

1 stóð ‘stood’ | *emend.;* stęndr *‘stands’* **R**

[Níð·uðr kvað:] **31** „Vaki’k á·valt · vilja-lauss, [R 19r/17]
sofna’k minst, · síðst sonu dauða,
kęll mik í hǫfuð, · kǫld eru=mk rǫ́ð þǐn,
vilnumk þęss nú, · at við Vǫlund dǿma’k.“

[Quoth Nithad:] “I am always awake, powerless;
I sleep the least since my sons did die.
My head turns cold; cold seem thy counsels—
would now but that I could speak with Wayland!”

1 Vaki’k á·valt · vilja-lauss ‘I am always awake, powerless’ | This line references sts. 12 and 20, but there Wayland was the powerless man who never slept. By his revenge the suffering has been transferred onto Nithad.

3 kǫld eru=mk rǫ́ð þǐn ‘cold seem thy counsels’ | A severe insult to a woman of power, for such counsels to her husband was how she would influence worldly affairs. In this way Wayland’s revenge reaches also Nithad’s wife.

[Níð·uðr kvað:] **32** „Sęg mér þat Vǫlundr, · vísi alfa, [R 19r/19]
af hęilum hvat · varð *hú*num mǐnum?“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Tell me this, Wayland, O chief of elves:
what became of my healthy bear-cubs?”

2 *hú*num | *metr. emend.;* sonum **R**

ALL | The scene shifts again. King Nithad, standing on the ground, sees Wayland hovering in the sky. He calls out to him.

[Vǫlundr kvað:] **33** „Ęiða skalt mér áðr · alla vinna, [R 19r/20]
at skips borði · ok at skjaldar rǫnd,
at mars bógi · ok at mękis ęgg
at þú kvęlj=at · kvǫn Vǫlundar,
né brúði mǐnni · at bana verðir,

þó'tt kvǫn ę*i*gim, · þá's *ér kunnið,
eð*a* jóð ęigim · innan hallar.

[Quoth Wayland:] "Oaths shalt thou first swear to me, all:
by side of ship and rim of shield,
by bough of steed and edge of sword—
that thou shalt not torture the wife of Wayland,
nor of my bride become the bane,
although we might own a wife which ye might know,
or might own a babe within your hall.

6 ę*i*gim | *emend.;* †ęgim† **R** 6 *ér | *metr. emend.;* þér **R** 7 eð*a* | *emend.;* †eþ† **R**

2–3 at skips ... ęgg 'by side ... of sword' | Nithad must swear oaths by the tools of trade of the warrior i.e., on his martial honour. Cf. *2 HHund*, where broken oaths are to come back "biting" the oath-breaker by cursing his ship, horse, and sword, in that order.

4 kvęlj=at 'shalt not torture' | A negative imperative. The 2nd. sg. imper. of *kvęlja* 'torture' is *kvęl*, but the negative clitic *=at* causes the *-j-* of the stem to reappear in a rare *liaison* effect. This indicates that forms like *kvęl* were still understood to contain *-j*, just no longer pronounced, but which could reappear in the correct circumstance.

4–5 kvǫn Vǫlundar 'wife of Wayland', brúði mǐnni 'my bride' | Beadhild, who is now pregnant.

**34** Gakk til smiðju, · þęirar's gørðir, [**R** 19r/24]
þar fiðr bęlgi · blóði stokna,
snęið'k af hǫfuð · hùna þǐnna
ok und fęn fjǫturs · fǿtr of lagða'k.

Go to the smithy, which thou madest;
there wilt thou find the bellows blood-besprinkled.
I sliced off the heads of thy bear-cubs,
and under the fetter's fen their feet I laid.

**35** Ęn þér skálar, · es und skǫrum vǫru, [**R** 19r/26]
svęip'k útan silfri, · sęlda'k Níð·aði,
en ór augum · jarkna-stęina,
sęnda'k kunnigri · kvǫn Níð·aðar.

But the bowls which were under their curls,
I coated with silver, gave to Nithad,
and out of the eyes arkenstones
did I send to the cunning wife of Nithad.

**36** Ęn ór tǫnnum · tvęggja þęira [**R** 19r/28]
sló'k brjóst-kringlur, · sęnda'k Bǫðv·ildi;
nú gęngr Bǫðv·ildr · barni aukin,

ęinga dóttir · ykkur bęggja.“

But out of the teeth of the two
I struck breast-brooches, sent them to Beadhild.
Now Beadhild goes swollen with child,
the only daughter of you both.”

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3 barni aukin ‘swollen with child’ | A likely sign of OE influence, as this is the only ON occurrence of the past participle of *auka* ‘to increase, augment’ in the sense ‘pregnant’, whereas this is otherwise attested in OE. Indeed, in *Déor* 11, Beadhild is also described as *éacen*, the direct cognate.

4 ęinga dóttir · ykkur bęggja. ‘the only daughter of you both’ | Formulaic, near-identical to *Heiðr* st. 25/1–2: (*Vaki, Angantýr, · vękr þik Hęrvǫr, // ęinga dóttir · ykkur Svófu.* ‘Wake, Ongentew: Harware awakes thee, the only daughter of thee and Sweve.’ Cf. also *Beow* 375a, 2997b: *ángan dohtor* ‘only daughter (accusative)’.)

[Níð·uðr kvað:] **37** „Męltir=a þat mál, · es mik męirr tregi, [R 19r/30]
né þik vilja’k Vǫlundr · verr of níta;
es=at svá maðr hǫr, · at þik af hęsti taki,
né svá ǫflugr, · at þik neðan skjóti,
þar’s þú skollir · við ský uppi.“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Thou couldst not have spoken a speech which would grieve me more,
nor could I wish worse, O Wayland, to deny thee!
There is no man so tall that he might take thee from a horse,
nor so strong that he might shoot thee from below,
there as thou jeerest by the clouds on high!”

**38** Hlęjandi Vǫlundr · hóf=sk at lopti, [R 19v/1]
ęn ǫ·káta Níð·uðr · sat þá ęptir.

Laughing, Wayland threw himself in the air;
but, gloomy, Nithad stayed behind.

[Níð·uðr kvað:] **39** „Upp rís Þakk·ráðr, · þręll minn batsti, [R 19v/2]
bið Bǫðv·ildi, · męy ina brá-hvítu,
gangi fagr-varið · við fǫður róða.“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Rise up, O Thankred, my best thrall!
Bid Beadhild, the brow-white maiden,
to go, fair-clothed, with her father to counsel.”

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1 Þakk·ráðr ‘Thankred’ | A German name never found elsewhere in ON, but equivalent to MHG *Dancrât*.

2–3 męy hina brá-hvítu ... fagr-varið ‘the brow-white maiden ... fair-clothed’ | Nithad still has some doubt in his heart and by these words tries to convince himself of the innocence of his daughter (*męr* ‘maiden, virgin’).

[Nið·uðr kvað:] **40** „Es þat satt Bǫðv·ildr, · es sǫgðu mér, [R 19v/3]
2 sǫ́tuð it Vǫlundr · saman í holmi?“

[Quoth Nithad:] “Is it true, Beadhild, as they told me—
did thou and Wayland stay together on the islet?”

[Bǫðv·ildr kvað:] **41** „Satt ’s þat Níð·uðr · es sagði þér: [R 19v/4]
2 sǫ́tum vit Vǫlundr · saman í holmi
ę́ina ǫgur-stund, · ę́va skyldi;
4 ek vę́tr hǫ́num · *vinna* kunna’k,
ek vę́tr hǫ́num · vinna mátta’k.“

[Quoth Beadhild:] “It is true, Nithad, which *he* told thee.
I and Wayland stayed together on the islet
for one heavy hour—it should never have been.
I nowise knew withstand him;
I nowise could withstand him.”

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4 *vinna* | *metr. and sens. emend.; om.* **R**

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1 sagði ‘*he* told’ | Beadhild knows that Wayland is the only one aware of the rape and thus deduces that *he* told her father. She makes a subtle change in the conjugation from her father’s general third person plural (“what they told”), to the specific singular form (“what *he* told”).

4–5 kunna’k ‘knew’, mátta’k ‘could’ | Beadhild did not know (*kunna* ‘to know, understand’) how to ward him off, yet even if she had been wise enough, she would still have been overpowered, for she had not the strength (*mega* ‘to have strength to, avail’). A touching final stanza.

# Speeches of Allwise
# *(Al·víss mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.851)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Allwise** (Alvissmal) is a list of poetic synonyms set in a frame narrative of Thunder being visited by a dwarf insisting that he has been promised his daughter's hand.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Alv* is found in whole in **R** on foll. 19v/7–20r/19, where it follows *Vkv* and is followed by *1 HHund*. It concludes the mythological group of poems (to which also *Vkv* belongs) in the manuscript; the immediately following *1 HHund* introduces the heroic group.

The poem was known to Snorre. Sts. 20 and 30 are cited in *Skm*, where they are attributed to *Al·víss mǫ́l* in TODO (A, C) and to *Al·svinns mǫ́l* 'the Speeches of Allswith' in all other mss. (TODO).

### Origin and motifs

There is not much of a story in *Alv*, but two elements of the frame narrative (sts. 1–8, 35) are of interest.

The first is the motif of an enemy of the Gods wishing to steal away one of their women. This is also attested in the myth of the ettin Master Builder (*Vsp* 24 nn., *Gylf* 42) and in *Þrk* (see Introduction to that poem), where the ettin Thrim demands the hand of the goddess Frow as a ransom for Thunder's hammer Millner.

The second motif is that of a dwarf perishing (usually by turning to stone, e.g. *HHj* 29–30, although that is not stated explicitly in *Alv*) when exposed to sunlight at daybreak, a motif famously employed by J.R.R Tolkien in *The Hobbit*.

### The language of the Gods

The bulk of the poem (sts. 9–34) is however taken up by the listing of poetic synonyms for various phenomena. *Alv* contrasts the normal terms used by men with those used by the Elves, Dwarfs, Gods, and those in Hell or the Underworld. Some of these synonyms, especially those said to be used by the Gods, are quite archaic and represent older common Indo-European and Germanic words that have been displaced by younger words in the common register (10/1 *fold*, 26/1 *funi*, 32/1 *barr*) or alternate forms of the same IE root (16/1 *sunna*). Others are transparent kennings not found elsewhere.

The fascinating idea of a language of the Gods is not unique to the Norse but is also attested in other cultures.

Notably, Homer often mentions that things have different names among Gods and mortals. So a certain hill at Troy "do men truly call 'Thorny Hill' (Βατίειαν), but the Undying 'the Barrow of much-springing Myrina' (σῆμα πολυ·σκάρθμοιο Μυρίνης)" (*Il* 2.813–814); a certain bird "do Gods call Bronzen (χαλκίδα), but men κύμινδιν" (*Il* 14.291); and the river Scamander "do Gods call Xanthus (Ξάνθον), but men Scamander (Σκάμανδρον)" (*Il* 20.74).

## Meter and stanza

The meter of *Alv* is Leeds-meter. The poem consists of 140 lines (71 full-lines, 70 long-lines) divided into 35 sts., all of which follow the typical structure *abcabc* except for the final st. 35 which has the 5-line structure *abcabcc*.

## Summary

As mentioned above the frame narrative of the poem consists of sts. 1–8 at the beginning and 35 at the very end.

The section dealing with names (sts. 9–34) is tightly structured and the phenomena are frequently paired according to their nature, e.g. earth and heaven (9–12), sun and moon (15–18), water and fire (23–26). The following phenomena are dealt with:

Sts. 9–10: earth, 11–12: heaven, 13–14: moon, 15–16: sun, 17–18: clouds, 19–20: wind, 21–22: calm weather, 23–24: water, 25–26: fire, 27–28: wood, 29–30: night, 31–32: grain, 33–34: ale.

## Text

### The Speeches of Allwise

[Al·víss kvað:] **1** „Bękki brę́iða · nú skal brúðr með mér [R 19v/7–8]
2 hę́im í sinni snúask;
hratat of mę́gi · mun hvę́rjum þikkja;
4 hę́ima skal=at hvíld nema.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Spread out on the benches shall now the bride with me,
[and] turn home by my side.
A hurried engagement it will seem to each;
at home shall she not take rest!”

[Þórr kvað:] **2** „Hvat ’s þat fira; · hví est svá fǫlr umb nasar; [R 19v/9–10]
2 vast-u í nótt með ná?
Þursa líki · þikki mér á þér vesa;
4 est=at-tu til brúðar borinn.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “What sort of man is this; why art thou so pale about the nose;
wast thou tonight with a corpse?
The likeness of a thurse methinks thou hast;
thou wast not born for this bride!”

[Al·víss kvað:] **3** „Al·víss ek hę́iti · bý’k fyr jǫrð neðan [R 19v/10–12]
2 á’k undir stę́ini stað.
vagna vers · ek em á vit kominn
4 bręgði ęngi fǫstu hę́iti fira.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Allwise I am called; I live beneath the earth;
I own under a stone my home.
The man of wagons [= Thunder] I am come to visit;
let no man break a firm vow!”

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3 vagna vers ‘man of wagons’ | The “wagons” may here be constellations in the heavens, namely the *Charles’ Wain* (Great Bear, Big Dipper) and *Women’s Wain* (Little Bear, Little Dipper). Cf. *Skm* 31, where heaven/the sky is kenned *land sólar ok tungls ok himin-tungla, vagna ok veðra* ‘the land of sun and moon, and the heavenly bodies, wagons and winds.’

[Þórr kvað:] **4** „Ek mun bręgda · því’t ek brúðar á [R 19v/12–14]
2 flęst umb rǫ́ð sem faðir.
vas’k=a ek hę́ima · þá’s þér hę́itit vas
4 at sá ęinn es gjǫf es með goðum.“

[Quoth Thunder:] "*I* will break it, for about the bride
I have the greatest say, as her father.
I was not at home when it was vowed to thee,
but he [I] alone is the giver among the Gods."

[Al·víss kvað:] **5** „Hvat 's þat rekka · es í rǫðum tęlsk [R 19v/14–16]
fljóðs ins fagr-glóa;
fjarra-flęina · þik munu fáir kunna;
hvęrr hęfir þik baugum borit?"

[Quoth Allwise:] "What sort of champion is this who claims to have a say
about the fair-glowing girl?
O foreign tramp, few men will know thee;
who has borne bighs to thee?"

[Þórr kvað:] **6** „Ving-Þórr ek hęiti · ek hęfi víða ratat [R 19v/16–18]
sonr em'k Síð·grana;
at ǫ·sátt mínni · skalt þat it unga man hafa
ok þat gjaf-orð geta."

[Quoth Thunder:] "Wing-Thunder I am called; I have widely roamed;
I am the son of Sidegrane.
Against my assent shalt thou have this young girl,
and get that gift-word!"

[Al·víss kvað:] **7** „Sáttir þínar · es ek vil snemma hafa [R 19v/18–20]
ok þat gjaf-orð geta.
ęiga vilja · heldr an án vera
þat it mjall-hvíta man."

[Quoth Allwise:] "Thy assents I wish to have soon,
and get that gift-word,
I would rather have than be without
this snow-white girl."

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4 þat it mjall-hvíta man 'this snow-white girl' | For whiteness as a symbol of nobility cf. Introduction to *Rþ*.

[Þórr kvað:] **8** „Męyjar ǫstum · mun=a þér verða [R 19v/20–21]
vísi gęstr of varit,
ef þú ór hęimi kant · hvęrjum at sęgja
allt þat's ek vil vita.

[Quoth Thunder:] "The maiden's love will not be,
O wise guest, denied thee,
if thou from every home canst tell
all I wish to know:

**9** Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 19v/21–23]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir,
hvé sú jǫrð hęitir · es liggr fyr alda sonum
4 hęimi hvęrjum ǐ."

Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the earth is called which lies before the sons of men
in every home."

1 ǫll of rǫk fira 'all rakes of men' | To be understood as 'all lore'.

[Al·víss kvað:] **10** „Jǫrð hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn með ǫ́sum fold, [R 19v/23–25]
2 kalla vega vanir.
ǐ-grǿn jǫtnar · alfar gróandi
4 kalla aur upp-rękin."

[Quoth Allwise:] "Earth it is called among men but among the Eese 'fold';
call it 'ways' the Wanes,
'evergreen' Ettins, Elves 'growing';
call it 'mud' the Up-reins."

1 ǫ́sum 'Eese' | ǫlfum *'Elves'* **R**

1 ǫ́sum 'Eese' | The emendation from Elves to Eese is non-controversial. The second verse in each answer-stanza otherwise always mentions the Gods, either with *ǫ́sum* 'Eese' and the same structure as the present verse (so sts. 26 and 34), or with *goðum* 'Gods' (so 12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 28, 30, 32). Aside from this argument, there is otherwise a repetition, as elves are mentioned in l. 3. The error is in any case easily understandable, since the two words are written similarly and both refer to supernatural beings.

[Þórr kvað:] **11** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 19v/25]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sá himinn hęitir · erakendi
4 hęimi hvęrjum ǐ."

[Quoth Thunder:] "Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the heaven is called …
in every home."

3 erakendi '...' | A string too corrupt to restore without excessive conjecture; it at least appears to contain the relative pronoun *er* 'which', younger form of *es* and the adjective *kęnndr* 'known'. Based on the first line, the alliteration must have fallen on *h-*, and the root that first suggests itself is *hę́ð* 'height'. A possible restoration is then *es á hę́ð es kęnndr* 'which is known on high'.

[Al·víss kvað:] **12** „Himinn hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn Hlýrnir með goðum [R 19v/26–27]
kalla Vind-ófni vanir;
upp-hęim jǫtnar · alfar fagra-ręfr
dvergar drjúpan sal.“

[Quoth Allwise:] "Heaven it is called among men but 'Lerner' among the Gods;
'Wind-ovner' call it the Wanes;
'upham' Ettins, Elves 'fair roof',
Dwarfs 'dripping hall'."

[Þórr kvað:] **13** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 19v/27–28]
vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvęrsu máni hęitir · sá's męnn sjá
hęimi hvęrjum ï.“

[Quoth Thunder:] "Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
how the moon is called which men do see
in every home."

[Al·víss kvað:] **14** „Máni hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn Mylinn með goðum, [R 19v/28–30]
kalla hverfanda hvél hęlju ï;
skyndi jǫtnar · ęn skin dvergar
kalla alfar ár-tala.“

[Quoth Allwise:] "Moon it is called among men, but 'Milen' among the Gods,
they call it 'turning wheel' in Hell,
'haster' Ettins and 'shine' Dwarfs;
Elves call it 'year-tallier'."

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4 ár-tala 'year-tallier' | The moon was important in the Germanic calendar (witness *month*, a "moon-th"). Cf. *Vsp* 6 and *Vafþ* 23, 25.

[Þórr kvað:] **15** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 19v/30]
vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sú sól hęitir · es sjá alda synir.
hęimi hvęrjum ï.“

[Quoth Thunder:] "Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the sun is called, which the sons of men see,
in every home."

[Al·víss kvað:] **16** „Sól hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn sunna með goðum [R 19v/31–32]
kalla dvergar Dvalins lęika;
Ey-glói jǫtnar · alfar fagra-hvél
al-skír ása synir."

[Quoth Allwise:] "Sun it is called among men, but 'Swail' among the Gods,
Dwarfs call it 'Dwollen's playmate';
'ever-glower' Ettins, Elves 'fair wheel',
'all-bright' the sons of the Eese."

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1 Sól ... sunna 'Sun ... Swail' | A problem arises for the translation since *sól* is the normal word for 'sun' in ON, whereas the direct cognate to English "sun" *sunna* is a poetic synonym. *sól* and *sunna* are in fact doublets, ultimately deriving from different declensions of the IE heteroclitic noun nom. *$séh_2$u-el, gen. *$sh_2$-en- ~ *$sh_2$u-n-ós (Kroonen 2013, pp. 463–464). To retain this symmetry in the translation ON *sunna* has been rendered as 'swail' (< OE *swęġel*), a cognate of *sól* that preserves the old nominative-accusative *-*l* of the PIE noun.

[Þórr kvað:] **17** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 19v/32–33]
vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé þau ský hęita · es skúrum blanda=sk
hęimi hvęrjum ï."

[Quoth Thunder:] "Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the clouds are called which are mixed with showers
in every home."

[Al·víss kvað:] **18** „Ský hęita með mǫnnum, · ęn skúr-vǫ́n með goðum; [R 19v/33–20r/1]
kalla vind-flot vanir;
úr-vǫ́n jǫtnar, · alfar veðr-męgin;
kalla ï hęlju hjalm huliðs."

[Quoth Allwise:] "Clouds they are called among men, but 'shower-hope' among the Gods;
'wind-fat' the Wanes call them;
'drizzle-hope' the Ettins, Elves 'weather-strength';
in Hell they call them 'helmet of the hidden'."

[Þórr kvað:] **19** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/1]
vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;

hvé sá vindr hęitir · es víðast fęrr
4 hęimi hvęrjum ï.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the wind is called where travels widest
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **20** „Vindr hęitir með mønnum, · ęn vǫfuðr með goðum; [R 20r/2–3 TODO]
2 kalla gnęggjuð ginn-regin.
ópi jǫtnar · alfar dyn-fara
4 kalla ï hęlju hviðuð.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Wind it is called among men but ‘waver’ among the Gods,
‘neigher’ call it the Yin-Reins;
‘weeper’ Ettins, Elves ‘din-farer’;
in Hell they call it ‘stormer’.”

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ALL | This st. is cited in *Skm* 74.

[Þórr kvað:] **21** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/3–4]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé þat logn hęitir · es liggja skal
4 hęimi hvęrjum ï.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the calm is called, which shall lie
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **22** „Logn hęitir með mønnum, · ęn lęgi með goðum, [R 20r/4–5]
2 kalla vinds flot vanir;
of-hlý jǫtnar · alfar dag-sefa,
4 kalla dvergar dags veru.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Calm it is called among men and ‘lowering’ among the Gods,
‘wind’s fat’ the Wanes call it;
‘great lee’ Ettins, Elves ‘day-sleep’,
call it Dwarfs ‘day’s rest’.”

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2 kalla vinds flot vanir “wind’s fat’ the Wanes call it’ | Most likely corruption from st. 18/2 above.

[Þórr kvað:] **23** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/5]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;

hvé sá marr hęitir · es męnn róa
4 hęimi hvęrjum ǐ.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the ocean is called where men do row
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **24** „Sér hęitir með mǫnnum, · ęn sǐ-lęgja með goðum, [R 20r/6–7]
2 kalla vág vanir;
ál-hęim jǫtnar, · alfar laga-staf,
4 kalla dvergar djúpan mar.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Sea it is called among men but ‘ever-low’ among the Gods;
‘wave’ the Wanes call it;
‘eelhome’ Ettins, Elves ‘staff of waters’;
Dwarfs call it ‘deep ocean’.”

[Þórr kvað:] **25** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/7–8]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sá ęldr hęitir · es brenn fyr alda sonum
4 hęimi hvęrjum ǐ.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the fire is called, which burns for the sons of men,
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **26** „Ęldr hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn með ǫ́sum funi [R 20r/8–9]
2 kalla vág vanir;
frekan jǫtnar · ęn for-brędni d*vergar
4 kalla ǐ hęlju hrǫðuð.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Fire it is called among men but among the Eese ‘flame’,
‘wave’ the Wanes call it;
‘the greedy’ Ettins, but ‘burner’ Dwarfs;
in Hell they call it ‘hurrier’.”

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2 kalla vág vanir ‘‘wave’ the Wanes call it’ | Certainly an error based on st. 24/2 above; fire is not otherwise known as ‘wave’.

[Þórr kvað:] **27** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/9–10]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé viðr hęitir · es vęx fyr alda sonum

4 hęimi hvęrjum ï.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the wood is called, which grows for the sons of men,
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **28** „Viðr hęitir með mǫnnum. · ęn vallar fax með goðum [R 20r/10–11]
2 kalla hlíð-þang halir;
ęldi jǫtnar · alfar fagr-lima
4 kalla vǫnd vanir.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Wood it is called among men but ‘mane of the plain’ among the Gods;
‘slope-kelp’ heroes call it;
‘firewood’ Ettins, Elves ‘fair-limb’;
‘wand’ the Wanes call it.”

1 vallar fax | *emend.;* vallar far **R**.

[Þórr kvað:] **29** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/11–12]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé sú Nǫtt hęitir · in Norvi kęnda
4 hęimi hvęrjum ï.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the Night is called, born to Narrow,
in every home.”

3 in Norvi kęnda ‘born to Narrow’ | See *Vafþ* 25/2 n.

[Al·víss kvað:] **30** „Nǫtt hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn njól með goðum, [R 20r/12–13 TODO]
2 kalla grímu ginn-regin;
ó·ljós jǫtnar · alfar svefn-gaman
4 kalla dvergar draum-Njǫrun.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Night it is called among men but ‘nivel’ among the Gods;
‘mask’ the Yin-Reins call it,
‘un-light’ Ettins, Elves ‘sleep-joy’;
Dwarfs call it ‘dream-Narn’.”

ALL | This st. is cited in *Skm* 78.

[Þórr kvað:] **31** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫll of rǫk fira [R 20r/13–14]
2 vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;

hvé þat sǫ́ð hęitir · es sáa alda synir
hęimi hvęrjum ǐ.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the seed is called, which the sons of men sow
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **32** „Bygg hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn barr með goðum [R 20r/14–15]
kalla vǫxt vanir.
ę́ti jǫtnar · alfar laga-staf
kalla ǐ hęlju hnipinn.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Barley it is called among men but ‘leaf’ among the Gods;
‘growth’ the Wanes call it;
‘eating’ Ettins, Elves ‘staff of waters’;
in Hell they call it ‘wilting’.”

[Þórr kvað:] **33** „Sęg-ðu mér þat Al·víss · ǫ́ll of rǫk fira [R 20r/15–16]
vǫr=umk dvergr at vitir;
hvé þat ǫ́l hęitir · es drekka alda synir
hęimi hvęrjum ǐ.“

[Quoth Thunder:] “Tell me this, Allwise—of all rakes of men,
I think, dwarf, thou dost know:
what the ale is called, which the sons of men drink,
in every home.”

[Al·víss kvað:] **34** „Ǫ́l hęitir með mǫnnum · ęn með ǫ́sum bjórr; [R 20r/16–17]
kalla vęig vanir;
hrę́ina-lǫg jǫtnar · ęn ǐ hęlju mjǫ́ð;
kalla sumbl Suttungs synir.“

[Quoth Allwise:] “Ale it is called among men but among the Eese ‘beer’;
‘draughts’ the Wanes call it;
‘pure water’ the Ettins but in Hell ‘mead’;
‘simble’ Sutting’s sons call it.”

[Þórr kvað:] **35** „Í ęinu brjósti · ek sá’k aldri=gi [R 20r/18–19]
flęiri forna stafi;
miklum tǫ́lum · ek kveð tę́ldan þik:
uppi est dvergr of dagaðr;
nú skǐnn sól ǐ sali.“

[Quoth Thunder:] "In a single breast I never saw
more ancient staves—
with mighty tricks I call thee tricked:
thou art, dwarf, dayed up;
now shines the sun into the halls!"

# Thule of Righ
# *(Rígs þula)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C13th (0.280)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Thule of Righ** (*Rþ*) is an incomplete narrative poem describing the origin of the social classes and the monarchy.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Rþ* is preserved only on a single folio (78rv) in the 14th century ms. **W**, where it follows the Prose Edda and four grammatical treatises all written in the same hand as the poem.

Numerous leaves are unfortunately missing from the original **W**, and among them the conclusion to *Rþ*. Still, part of what would have been found in the lost part of the poem can be gleaned from parallel sources, as will be dealt with below.

### Origin and motifs

*Rþ* is a powerful and, due to its incompleteness, enigmatic poem. It has something of the folk-tale about it and serves as an etiology for the origin of the Wiking Age Norwegian class system and a celebration of the superiority of the warrior-nobility.

In the poem the mysterious Righ (ON *Rígr*) fathers in succession three human sons with three women, *Ędda* 'Great-grandma', *Amma* 'Grandma', and *Móðir* 'Mother'. Their respective sons become *Þrǫll* 'Thrall', *Karl* 'Churl', and *Jarl* 'Earl', each in turn serving as the ancestor for each of the three classes: the slaves, the freeholders or farmers, and the nobility. In turn, the youngest of Earl's twelve sons, Kin the young (*Konr ungr*), becomes the first to hold the title of 'king' (*konungr*).

### The identity of Righ

The main mystery of the poem is the obscure figure Righ (*Rígr*), identified in the prose introduction as Homedall. His name has traditionally been seen as a sign of Irish influence on the basis of Old Irish *rí* (oblique sg. stem *ríg-*) 'king'.

Righ does not appear in any other poetic source, but his name is found in two related genealogies: in *Yng* 17 and in the epitome of the lost *Skjǫldunga saga*, both of which are included in the Appendix to the poem below.

These genealogies, although conflicting, are clearly related to an episode we only get a hint about at the very end of this poem (st. 46), namely Kin the young's visit to Dene and Danp.

In the parallel sources these two figures are ancestral to the later Danish and Norwegian monarchies through their relation to Righ, and this was almost certainly the case also in *Rþ*, as shown by the pun on the name of Kin the young (ON *Konr ungr*) and the title king (*konungr*). According to *Yng* 17, Righ was the first ruler to be called 'king' in the Scandinavian cultural sphere.

Having already laid out the origins of the thralls, churls, and earls, it seems inevitable, then, that the remaining sts. would have dealt with the establishment of monarchy.

Although Righ is identified as Homedall in the prose introduction, his role in the poem is really more reminiscent of what we know about the god Weden. Like Weden, Righ is an aristocrat, an inciter of war, and a teacher of runes; like Weden he bestows favour on his protegé, who tends to be the youngest son (cf. *Grm* P1–P2).

Since the introductory prose is likely the work of a learned writer, viz. the compiler of the **W** manuscript, it is not at all unlikely that it could be drawing on *Vsp* 1/2, where the unparallelled expression *męgir Hęim·dalar* 'sons of Homedall' seems to be a kenning referring to men. It is of course not impossible that Homedall also had the aforementioned Odinic traits, but we learn of no such thing from other sources where the runes are always the exclusive domain of Weden alone (so e.g. *Háv* 138–139). For these reasons, Righ is probably more likely to be identified with Weden than Homedall, the prose introduction notwithstanding.

### Class, race, and essentialism

One of the most striking aspects of *Rþ* is its long and detailed physical descriptions of the founders of the human social classes, which includes both dress and phenotype. Thus Thrall is swarthy and crooked (sts. 7–8), Churl is red-haired, ruddy, and well-turned out, with wandering eyes (18–19), and Earl is blonde and pale, with a piercing gaze (33). That piercing gaze is important as it symbolizes the acquisitive nature of earldom, unlike the wandering eyes of the freeholder. The aristocratic earl, the type of man celebrated by *Rþ*, is content with nothing but the best and will pursue it unrelentingly until victory or death.

It should not be controversial to say that *Rþ* is by all accounts an essentialist poem which posits that distinctions in class are fundamentally racial. According to this worldview one's birth is not drawn by lot, nor are souls randomly assigned to their station; everything is due to blood, and the superior man breeds superior children who prove their natural superiority in warlike conquest.

If we are to search for a historical circumstance to explain the phenotypical differences described in the poem, the taking of "swarthy" (in comparison to the Nordic Scandinavians) slaves from the British Isles, especially Ireland, quite likely played a role. As shown by Rodríguez-Varela et al. (2023), this slave traffic left a lasting and substantial effect on the genetics of all of Scandinavia, although Celtic ancestry gradually decreased after the Wiking Age. A likely explanation for this is that the Celtic ancestry was negatively correlated with total fertility due to its concentration in the lower social strata.

It is common knowledge that to this day the Western Norwegians have both the highest rate of Celtic ancestry (e.g. as measured by the haplogroup R1b-L21) and the greatest incidence of red and black hair amongst non-Uralicised Norwegians (Bryn and Schreiner 1929), something also shared with the heavily Celtic-influenced Icelanders (Coon 1939, p. 326). As the Celtic slave populations were gradually assimilated (largely but not exclusively through concubinage) into the freeholding farmers the prevalence of red hair also in the mixed children would have been noticed and made them stand out against the blonde Nordic aristocracy among whom redness was likely nearly nonexistent, as still in our time amongst the Swedes.

Apart from the explanation of Celtic influence (which certainly was a reality), we should also remember that in a stratified society with an emphasis on breeding, attractive traits tend to accumulate in the upper strata. Most Neolithic Eurasian societies have historically strongly favoured light skin, especially in women, as a sign of wealth and beauty, and Northern Europe, where the genes for light hair and blue eyes could also be selected for, was no exception to this rule, as shown by evidence both genetic (Wilde et al. 2014) and literary (most notably *Rþ* itself). As the Nordic upper classes were bred for beauty, strength, and intelligence these traits would co-mingle and gradually become strongly correlated, leading to a racialised in-group sense.

A curious anecdote known in somewhat varying form from two sagas, *Ldn* 2.19 and *Hálf* 17, reveals some complexities of the Norse essentialist worldview: A Norse king took to wife a daughter of a king of Barmland (*Bjarma-land*, i.e., Permia) and she begot two sons with him, Garmund and Highmund, who came out swarthy and very ugly (*Hálf* 17: *svartir ok furðu ljótir*, implying Mongoloid features). Upset, the queen switched out the two sons with a blonde and beautiful slave-boy, Loaf, of the same age. One day when the boys were three years old all men had gone away save for the poet Bray the Old. Loaf was sitting in the king's high seat and playing with some gold, while Garmund and Highmund were down in the straw; jealous, the brothers pulled him down from the seat and took all the gold. Loaf wept. At that moment Bray knew that Loaf could not be the son of two noble parents, and announced it in a stanza, after which Garmund and Highmund regained

their status as the king's sons.

Even in this supposedly non-racialist anecdote the moral of the story is none other than biological essentialism. The boy Loaf's slavelike nature can instantly be ascertained by his behaviour, regardless of the way in which he is raised. Like Churl, he does not have the eyes of acquisition which signify true nobility. Being put on the king's throne in no way entitles him to it, and when given the chance the king's true sons quickly retake it.

TODO: Dumezil three-part society.

## Meter and stanza

*Rþ* consists of 183 total long-lines divided into 46 stanzas. The length of the stanza is extremely irregular. Stanzas of 3 (14/46: 1, 3, 5–6, 9–10, 15, 19, 24–25, 28, 32, 44–45) and 4 lines (15/46: 11, 14, 17, 20, 22–23, 26–27, 29, 33, 37–39, 43, 46) are most common, followed by 5 lines (10/46: 2, 8, 13, 16, 21, 30(?), 35, 40–42). Other represented lengths are 2 (7, 18, 31), 6 (4, 34, 36), and 7 lines (12).

Metrically *Rþ* is in an unusual form of Ancient-words-lay. The meter is notable for its unusually high incidence of 3-syllable verses, which are not allowed in all types of Ancient-words-lay, and for the extremely high incidence of type A verses at 77.7 %, higher than any other Eddic poem (Sapp 2022, p. 152).

## Language and style

*Rþ* has a very low occurrence of the particle *of* at 0.082 per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70).

The language is exceptionally formulaic and repetitive, with many expressions, lines and even whole stanzas repeated identically throughout as Righ visits each of the three households. This repetition gives the poem something of an incantatory feeling.

## Dating

On the basis of the loose and unusual meter, the likely Celtic influence in the name *Rígr*, its connection to later legendary material in the form of the textual parallels, and the extremely low prevalence of the particle *of* *Rþ* is most likely to be a late antiquarian poem composed after the conversion to Christianity, likely in the 12th or even 13th century. To signs of a late composition may be added the poem's central premise (but cf. above for a comparative discussion), since it is questionable to what degree the social structure evinced in the poem actually existed in the Wiking Age, when even the wealthiest noble families were closely allied with freeholding farmers, compared to the more stratified High Middle Ages.

A late dating agrees with Sapp's model, which yields a most likely dating to the 13th c., although at 0.280 the confidence is rather low.

Another dimension for dating is the detailed descriptions of dress and lifestyle which may be considered archaeologically, particularly in sts. 15–16, 26–27, 29–30, 33. On the basis of these Nerman (1969) estimates the composition of the poem to the Wiking Age, but this assumes that knowledge of earlier material culture cannot have survived after a certain period had passed, an assumption we know based on other sources (e.g. *HHj* 9/1, *Sigsk* 68/1) to be incorrect.

## Text

**P1** Svá segja menn í fornum sǫgum, at einn-hverr af ǫ́sum, sá er [W 78r/1–3]
Heim·dallr hét, fór ferðar sinnar ok framm með sjóvar-strǫndu
nǫkkurri, kom at einum húsa-bø ok nefndi≈sk Rígr; eptir þeiri
sǫgu er kvéði þetta.

So do men say in the ancient saws that one of the Eese, he who was called Homedall, went upon his journey, and, going forth along a certain lake shore, he came upon a lone homestead and called himself Righ. After that saw is this poem.

**1** Ár kvǫ́ðu ganga · grønar brautir [W 78r/4–5]
ǫflgan ok aldinn · ǫ́s kunnigan,
ramman ok rǫskvan · Ríg stíganda.

Of yore, they said, did walk on green roads
a mighty and ancient [Os], cunning:
the strong and brisk Righ, striding.

1 Ár ‘Of yore’ | *emend.;* ‘at’ **W**

1 Ár ‘Of yore’ | Formulaic; it is very common for poems to begin with *ár* ‘of yore, in the beginning’. Cf. *Vsp* 3/1, *Hym* 1/1, *1 HHund* 1/1, *1 Guðr* 1/1, *Sigsk* 1/1.

**2** Gekk męirr at þat · miðrar brautar, [W 78r/5–6]
kom hann at húsi, · hurð vas á gętti;
inn nam at ganga, · ęldr vas á golfi,
hjón sótu þar · hór at arni,
Ái ok Ędda · aldin-falda.

He walked further thereafter on the middle of the road,
came to a house; the door was wide open.
He took to go inside; fire was on the floor;
a couple sat there, hoary by the hearth:
Great-Grandpa and Great-Grandma in an old-time shawl.

4 at | *sens. emend.;* af **W**

2 á gętti ‘wide open’ | Lit. ‘on the threshold’, in contrast to 14/2 and 24/3.

**3** Rígr kunni þęim · rǫ́ð at sęgja; [W 78r/7–8]
męirr sętti≈sk hann · miðra flętja

ęn á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Righ knew to tell them counsels,
further he set himself down on the middle of the bench,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

**4** Þá tók Ędda · økkvinn hlęif, [W 78r/8–10]
2 þungan ok þykkvan, · þrunginn sǫ́ðum,
bar hǫn męirr at þat · miðra skutla,
4 soð vas í bolla · sętti á bjóð;
vas kalfr soðinn · krása bętstr;
6 rędis hann upp þaðan, · réð=sk at sofna;

Then Great-Grandma took a lumpy loaf—
heavy and thick, stuffed with chaff—
carried it further thereafter in the middle of a trencher;
broth was in a bowl—she set it on a platter.
A cooked calf was the best dainty;
he [= Righ] rose up thence, resolved to sleep.

**5** Rígr kunni þęim · rǫ́ð at sęgja; [W 78r/10–11]
2 męirr lagði=sk hann · miðrar rękkju,
ęn á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Righ knew to tell them counsels;
further he laid himself down on the middle of the bed,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

**6** Þar vas hann at þat · þrjár nętr saman; [W 78r/11–12]
2 gekk hann męirr at þat · miðrar brautar;
liðu męirr at þat · mǫnuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;
he walked further thereafter in the middle of the road;
further thereafter passed nine months.

**7** Jóð ól Ędda, · jósu vatni [W 78r/12]
2 hǫr*und*-svartan, · hétu Þręl.

Great-Grandma begot a child—they sprinkled it with water:
swarthy of skin, they called it Thrall.

---

2 hǫr*und*-svartan 'swarthy of skin' | *emend.;* hǫrfi svartan *'swarthy with flax(?)'* W

1 jósu vatni ‘they sprinkled it with water’ | A reference to the Heathen naming ceremony wherein water would be poured on a newborn, somewhat resembling the Christian baptism. See *Háv* 156.

**8** Hann nam at vaxa · ok vęl dafna; [W 78r/12–14]
vas þar á hǫndum · hrokkit skinn,
kropnir knúar, · [...]
fingr digrir, · fúl=ligt and-lit,
lotr hryggr, · langir hęlar.

He took to grow and have it well;
there on his hands was wrinkled skin,
crooked knuckles, [...],
stubby fingers, loathsome face,
stooping back, long heels.

**9** Nam męirr at þat · magns of kosta, [W 78r/14–15]
bast at binda, · byrðar gørva;
bar hęim at þat · hrís gęrstan dag.

He took further thereafter to try his strength:
bast to bind, burdens to make;
he carried home thereafter brushwood on a gloomy day.

**10** Þar kom at garði · gęngil-bęina, [W 78r/15–16]
aurr vas á iljum, · armr sól-brunninn,
niðr-bjúgt es nęf, · nęfndi=sk Þír.

There to the farm came a gangle-boned girl:
mud was on her footsoles, her arm sunburnt,
downturned her nose; she called herself Thew.

---

1 gęngil-bęina ‘gangle-boned girl’ | Derogatory, somebody who (due to poverty) only travels by foot.

3 Þír ‘Thew’ | A variant of *þýr* ‘maid-servant, female slave’. Unlike Thrall, this word is not attested in any prose texts, but it is found in poetry (chiefly in the plural) and in legal compounds like *þý-borinn* ‘born of a female slave or concubine’. It is related to OS *thiwi* ‘maid(-servant)’, being the female form of the Proto-Norse **þewaR** ‘servant’, OE *þéow* ‘slave, servant’, ultimately from the root of the verb *þéa* ~ *þjá* ‘to enthral’.

**11** Męirr sętti=sk hǫn · miðra flętja, [W 78r/16–17]
sat hjá hęnni · sonr húss,
róddu ok rýndu, · rękkju gørðu
Þręll ok Þír · þrungin døgr.

Further she set herself down on the middle of the bench;
by her sat the son of the house [= Thrall].
They spoke and whispered, made a bed—
Thrall and Thew—in hard-pressed nights.

---

1 Męirr sętti=sk hǫn · miðra flętja | *emend. based on other sts.;* miðra flętja · męirr sętti=sk hǫn W

**12** Bǫrn ólu þau, · bjuggu ok unðu; [W 78r/17–19]
hygg'k at héti · Hręimr ok Fjósnir,
Klúrr ok Klęggi, · Kęfsir, Fúlnir,
Drumbr, Digraldi, · Drǫttr ok Hǫsvir,
Lútr ok Lęggjaldi; · lǫgðu garða,
akra tǫddu, · unnu at svĩnum,
gęita gęttu, · grófu torf.

Children they begot, settled and were content.
I think that they were called Rame and Feesner,
Clour and Cledge, Chafser, Foulner,
Drumber, Digrald, Drant and Hazer,
Lout and Leggald. They laid yard-fences,
dunged fields, looked after swine,
herded goats, dug turf.

**13** Døtr vǫru þér · Drumba ok Kumba, [W 78r/20–21]
Økkvin-kalfa · ok Arin-nęfja,
Ysja ok Ambǫtt, · Ęikin-tjasna,
Tǫtrug-hypja · ok Trǫnu-bęina;
þaðan eru komnar · þréla ættir.

The daughters were these: Drumb and Cumb,
Inkencalf and Arnneb,
Eaze and Ambight, Oakentarsen,
Tattryhip and Tranebone—
thereof are come the lines of thralls.

**14** Gekk Rígr at þat · réttar brautir [W 78r/21–22]
kom hann at *hǫllu*, · hurð vas á skíði,
inn nam at ganga, · ęldr vas á golfi,
hjón sǫtu þar · heldu á syslu.

Righ walked thereafter on straight roads,
came to a hall; the door was hinged.

He took to go inside; fire was on the floor;
a couple sat there, kept to their chores.

2 *hǫllu* 'hall' | *sens. and metr. emend. (cf. st. 38); om.* **W**

**15** Maðr tęlgði þar · męið til rifjar, [**W** 78r/23–24]
vas skęgg skapat, · skǫr vas fyr ęnni
skyrtu þrǫngva · skokkr vas á golfi.

The man there carved a stick into a loom-beam.
His beard was shapely; locks hung down his forehead,
his shirt tight; a toolbox was on the floor.

**16** Sat þar kona, · svęigði rokk, [**W** 78r/24–25]
bręiddi faðm, · bjó til váðar;
svęigr vas á hǫfði, · smokkr vas á bringu,
dúkr vas á halsi, · dvergar á ǫxlum;
Afi ok Amma · ǫttu hús.

There sat the woman, twirled a distaff,
stretched out her arms, readied the cloth.
A scarf was on her head, a smock on her breast,
a kerchief on her throat, dwarfs on her shoulders—
Grandpa and Grandma owned a house.

ALL | This st. contains an extremely interesting description of female dress. Nerman (1969) deals with this. TODO.

4 dvergar 'dwarfs' | Nerman (1969) explains this word as referring to an archaeological find. TODO.

**17** Rígr kunni þęim · rǫð at sęgja, [**W** 78r/25–27]
ręis frá borði · réð at sofna.
Męirr lagði=sk hann · miðrar rękkju
ęn á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Righ knew to tell them counsels,
rose from the table, resolved to sleep.
Further he laid himself down on the middle of the bed,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

**18** Þar vas hann at þat · þrjár nętr saman; [**W** 78r/27]
liðu męirr at þat · mǫnuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;
further thereafter passed nine months.

**19** Jóð ól Amma, · jósu vatni, [W 78r/27–28]
kǫlluðu Karl · kona sveip ripti
rauðan ok rjóðan · riðuðu augu.

Grandma begot a child, they sprinkled it with water,
called it Churl; the woman wrapped him in cloth,
red-haired and ruddy; his eyes wandered.

**20** Hann nam at vaxa · ok vęl dafna, [W 78r/28–30]
ǫxn nam at tęmja · arðr at gørva
hús at timbra · ok hlǫður smíða
karta at gørva · ok kęyra plóg.

He took to grow and turn out well;
oxen he took to tame, the ard to make,
houses to timber and storehouses to forge,
carts to make and drive the plough.

**21** Hęim óku þà · Hangin-luklu [W 78r/30–31]
gęita-kyrtlu · giptu Karli.
Snǫr hęitir sú, · sętti=sk und ripti.
Bjuggu hjòn, · bauga dęildu,
brędiddu blę́jur, · ok bú gørðu.

Home they then drove with Hangenkey,
in a goatskin-skirt, married her to Churl.
Daughter-in-law she is called; she sat down beneath a felt.
The couple settled, shared their wealth,
hung tapestries and made a home.

**22** Bǫrn ólu þau, · bjuggu ok unðu; [W 78r/31–78v/1]
hét Halr ok Drengr, · Hǫlðr, Þegn ok Smiðr,
Brędiðr, Bóndi, · Bundin-skęggi,
Búi ok Boddi · Bratt-skęggr ok Sęggr.

Children they begot, settled and were content.
They were called Hale and Drang, Health, Thane and Smith,
Broad, Bond, Boundenshag,
Bower and Bod, Brantshag and Seg.

**23** Ęnn hétu svá · ǫðrum nǫfnum [W 78v/1–2]
Snot, Brúðr, Svanni, · Svarri, Sprakki,
Fljóð, Sprund, ok Víf, · Fęima, Ristill;

4 þaðan eru komnar · karla ęttir.

Further they were called thus by other names:
Snoot, Bride, Swannie, Swarrie, Sprackie,
Fleed, Sprund and Wife, Fome, Ristle—
therof are come the lines of churls.

---

ALL | Most of these names are mentioned in *Skm* 84. TODO.

**24** Gekk Rígr þaðan · réttar brautir [W 78v/2–3]
2 kom hann at sal, · suðr horfðu dyrr,
vas hurð hnigin, · hringr vas í gętti.

Right walked thence on straight roads;
he came to a hall, south faced the doors;
the door was opened, a ring was on the gate.

**25** Gekk hann inn at þat · golf vas stráat [W 78v/3–4]
2 sǫtu hjón · sǫu=sk í augu
faðir ok móðir · fingrum at lęika.

He walked in thereafter; the floor was strawed;
the couple sat, looked eachother in the eyes,
Father and Mother, playing with their fingers.

**26** Sat hús-gumi · ok snøri stręng [W 78v/4–5]
2 alm of bęndi · ǫrvar skępti;
en hús-kona · hugði at ǫrmum,
4 strauk of ripti · sterti ęrmar.

The man of the house sat and twisted the bow-string,
bent the elmwood, shafted arrows—
but the wife of the house minded her arms,
smoothened the fabric, tightened the sleeves.

**27** Kęisti fald, · kinga vas á bringu, [W 78v/6–7]
2 síðar slóðr, · sęrk blá-fáan;
brún bjartari, · brjóst ljósara,
4 hals hvítari · hręinni mjǫllu.

The linen hood jutted out, a brooch was on her chest,
a trailing gown, a serk dyed blue;
her brow was brighter, her chest lighter,
her throat whiter than purest snow.

**28** Rígr kunni þęim · rǫ́ð at sęgja; [W 78v/7–8]
męirr sętti=sk hann · miðra flętja
en á hlið hvára · hjón sal-kynna.

Righ knew to tell them counsels,
further he set himself down on the middle of the bench,
and on either side: the couple of the hall.

**29** Þá tók Móðir · męrktan dúk, [W 78v/8–9]
hvítan af hǫrvi, · hulði bjóð;
hón tók at þat · hlęifa þunna,
hvíta af hvęiti, · ok hulði dúk.

Then Mother took an embroidered cloth,
white of flax—she covered the platter.
She took thereafter thin loaves,
white of wheat—and covered the cloth.

---

ALL | Note the strong parallelism between the helmings. The rich household can afford such an excess of expensive fabric and bread that they can cover a plate with an embroidered (*męrktr*) flaxen cloth, and then cover that cloth with loaves of wheat-bread.

**30** Framm sętti hǫn · skutla fulla [W 78v/9–11]
silfri varða á bjóð
fáin* flęski · ok fugla stęikta;
vín vas í kǫnnu, · varðir kálkar
drukku ok dømðu, · dagr vas á sinnum.

She set forth full trenchers,
silver-covered on platters
shining with pork, and roasted fowls.
Wine was in a flagon; the women from goblets
drank and discussed; the day was waning.

---

3 fáin* 'shining' | *emend.;* 'faan ok' **W**

---

ALL | The description of the opulence of Father and Mother's household continues.

1–2 Framm ... bjóð 'She ... platters' | These lines are clearly corrupt: l. 1, although rhythmically regular, has no alliteration and l. 2 is entirely malformed. Alliteration may be restored in l. 1 by reversing *skutla* and *fulla* (so Finnur Jónsson 1932).

3 fáin* 'shining' | The present emendation follows Finnur Jónsson (1932). Olsen (1923, pp. 307–312) (followed by Hesselman 1948, p. 59) explains *fán* as a variant of *fóarn* 'gizzard', but this is problematic. Formally it requires some level of scribal corruption Olsen (1923, pp. 311–312) and grammatically it is in the acc. sg. unlike the paired *flęski* (dat. sg. of *flęsk* 'pork'). The grammatical inconsistency may be solved if *flęski* is acc. sg. of the rare form *flęski* 'id.' (Fr, s.v. *fleski*), but the formal concerns remain.

**31** Rígr kunni þęim · rǫ́ð at sęgja, [W 78v/11]
ręis Rígr at þat, · rękkju gørði.

Righ knew to tell them counsels;
Righ rose thereafter; he made the bed.

**32** Þar vas hann at þat · þrjár nętr saman;
gekk hann męirr at þat · miðrar brautar;
liðu męirr at þat · mǫnuðr níu.

There he was thereafter for three nights in their midst;
he walked further thereafter on the middle of the road;
further thereafter passed nine months.

**33** Svęin ól móðir, · silki vafði, [W 78v/13–14]
jósu vatni— · Jarl létu hęita;
blęikt vas hár, · bjartir vangar,
ǫtul vǫ́ru augu · sem yrmlingi.

Mother begot a swain, swaddled him in silk;
they sprinkled him with water, let him be called Earl.
Pale was his hair, bright his cheeks;
fierce were his eyes like the young serpent's.

---

4 ǫtul vǫ́ru augu · sem yrmlingi 'fierce were his eyes like the young serpent's' | Unlike those of Churl (st. 19/3), which wandered. It is a common motif in Norse literature that those of noble stock distinguish themselves by their appearance and chiefly by a unique piercing gaze even at birth. This is said of Hallow Syemund's son in *1 HHund* 6/3–4 and of the king's son Wayland in *Vkv* 17/3 whose gaze is likewise compared to the serpent's. In *2 HHund* 2–4 the same Hallow is almost caught while in disguise as a bond-woman due to his unslavelike eyes, which, like in the present stanza, are said to be *ǫtul* 'fierce, terrible'.

**34** Upp óx þar · Jarl á flętjum; [W 78v/14–16]
lind nam at skęlfa, · lęggja strengi,
alm at bęygja, · ǫrvar skępta,
flęin at flęyja, · frǫkkur dýja,
hęstum ríða, · hundum verpa,
sverðum bregða, · sund at fręmja.

There Earl grew up on the floor-benches;
he took to shake the linden shield, fasten bow-strings,
bend elmwood, shaft arrows,
throw javelins, hoist Frankish spears,
ride horses, sic hounds,
brandish swords, practice swimming.

**35** Kom þar ór runni · Rígr gangandi, [W 78v/16–18]
Rígr gangandi, · rúnar kęnndi;
sitt gaf hęiti, · son kvęð=sk ęiga;
þann bað hann ęigna=sk · óðal-vǫllu,
óðal-vǫllu, · aldnar bygðir.

There from a thicket came Righ, walking:
Righ, walking, taught him the runes,
gave him his own title, said that he had a son.
He bade him possess the ethel-plains:
the ethel-plains, the ancient farmsteads.

---

ALL | Righ approaches his son, Earl. He reveals himself as his father and initiates him into the warrior aristocracy by teaching him the runes and giving him the noble title Righ (cf. st. 43/4 below); henceforth he will be known as Righ-Earl. Finally Righ instructs him to set out and win lands for himself.

**36** Ręið hann męirr þaðan · myrkan við [W 78v/18–20]
hélug fjǫll · und's at hǫllu kom;
skapt nam at dýja, · skęlfði lind,
hęsti hlęypti, · ok hjǫrvi brá;
víg nam at vękja, · vǫll nam at rjóða,
val nam at fęlla, · vá til landa.

He [= Righ-Earl] rode further thence through the mirky wood,
o'er the frosty fells till to a hall he came.
The shaft he took to hoist, shook the linden shield,
leapt with his horse and brandished his blade.
War he took to rouse; the plain he took to redden;
men he took to fell—he won the lands.

**37** Réð hann ęinn at þat · át-ján búum; [W 78v/20–21]
auð nam skipta · ǫllum vęita
męiðmar ok mǫsma, · mara svang-rifja;
hringum hręytti, · hjó sundr baug.

He alone ruled thereafter eighteen homesteads.
Wealth he took to hand out; to grant all men
gifts and treasures, slender-ribbed steeds;
rings he scattered; he struck apart the bigh.

---

4 hringum hręytti 'rings he scattered' | Cf. StarkSt Frag 1/2a *hring-hręytanda* 'ring-scatterer [GENEROUS MAN]' which contains the same words.

**38** Óku* ęrir · úrgar brautir [W 78v/21–22]

kvǫ́mu at hǫllu · þar's Hęrsir bjó:
mǿttu *męyju* · mjó-fingraðri
hvítri ok horskri, · hétu Ęrna.

Messengers drove on drizzling roads,
came to the hall where Herser lived;
they met a maiden slender-fingered,
white and wise; her name was Erne.

1 Óku* | 'okū' **W** 3 móttu | mótti **W** 3 *męyju* | *om.* **W** 3 mjó-fingraðri | mjó-fingraði **W**

3 móttu 'they met' | Past singular *mótti* is impossible, since the maiden is the one being met. *móta* 'meet' takes the dative.

3 *męyju* 'maiden' | A feminine dat. sg. noun meaning 'maiden, virgin, girl' is required here by the meter and the following adjectives; *męyju* dat. sg. of *mér* fits perfectly with the alliteration and is to be considered fairly likely.

**39** Bǫ́ðu hęnnar · ok hęim óku, [**W** 78v/22–24]
giptu Jarli, · gekk hón und líni;
saman bjuggu þau · ok sér unðu,
ęttir jóku · ok aldrs nutu.

They asked for her hand and drove home,
married her to Earl; she went 'neath the linen.
Together they settled and were content,
increased their lineage and enjoyed life.

2 gekk hón und líni 'she went 'neath the linen' | She donned the bridal veil; cf. *Þrk* 27.

**40** Burr vas hinn ęldsti, · en Barn annat; [**W** 78v/24–25]
Jóð ok Aðall, · Arfi, Mǫgr,
Niðr ok Niðjungr, · (nǫ́mu lęika)
Sonr ok Svęinn, · (sund ok tafl)
Kundr hét ęinn; · Konr vas hinn yngsti.

Byre was the eldest and Bairn the other;
Ede and Athel, Arver and Maw,
Nith and Nithing (they learned to partake)
Son and Swain (in swimming and tables);
Cund was one called; Kin was the youngest.

3–4 nǫ́mu lęika ... sund ok tafl 'they learned to partake in swimming and tables' | This sentence is embedded in the list of names. Swimming (*sund*) and board games (*tafl*) were typical past-times for aristocrats; cf. the two Scaldic stanzas attributed to Earl Rainwald (SkP: Rv Lv 1) and King Harold Hardrede (Hharð *Gamv* 4) where each man recounts his *íþróttir* 'skills, pursuits', among which are both *sund* and *tafl*.

**41** Upp óxu þar · Jarli bornir: [W 78v/25–27]
hęsta tǫmðu, · hlífar bęndu,
skęyti skófu, · skęlfðu aska.
Ęn Konr ungr · kunni rúnar:
ęvin-rúnar · ok aldr-rúnar.

There grew up the sons of Earl,
horses they tamed, shield-rims they bent,
shafts they planed, shook ashen spears—
but Kin the young knew the runes:
eternal runes and life-runes.

4 Konr ungr 'Kin the young' | A folk etymological pun on *konungr* 'king'. It is notable that it is the youngest son who attains the highest rank (for the king is above even the earls); for the motif of a god favouring the youngest son cf. *Grm* P1.

5 ęvin-rúnar 'eternal runes' | A native, pre-Christian word; the first element is an otherwise lost adjective corresponding to Gothic *aiweins* 'eternal, everlasting', OHG *êwîn* 'id'. This is one of two occurrences in the ON corpus, the other one being **aiuinrunąʀ** *ęivin-rúnar* on the 9th c. Malt stone (DR NOR1988;5/DK Sjy38), alongside **taitirunąʀ** *tęiti-rúnar* 'joy-runes'.

**42** Męirr kunni hann · mǫnnum bjarga, [W 78v/27–28]
ęggjar dęyfa, · ękgi lękgja;
klǫk nam fugla, · kyrra ęlda,
sófa ok svęfja, · sorgir lękgja,
afl ok ęljun · átta manna.

Further he could rescue men,
dull blades, lower the sea.
He learned the chirping of birds, to calm fires,
to lull and put to sleep, to lower sorrows,
the strength and zeal of eight men.

**43** Hann við Ríg Jarl · rúnar dęildi; [W 78v/28–29]
brǫgðum bęitti · ok bętr kunni;
þá ǫðladi=sk · ok þá ęiga gat,
Rígr at hęita, · rúnar kunna.

With Righ-Earl he shared the runes,
employed tricks and knew better.
Then he earned and won the right
to be called Righ, to know the runes.

4 Rígr at hęita 'to be called Righ' | The title Righ passes through the generations, first in st. 35/3 from Righ (the grandfather) to Righ-Earl (the father), now from Righ-Earl to his son Kin the young.

**44** Rękið Konr ungr · kjǫrr ok skóga; [W 78v/30–31]
kolfi flęygði · kyrði fugla;
þà kvað þat kráka · —sat kvisti ęin—

Kin the young rode through brushes and woods,
hurled his bolts, stunned the birds.
Then quoth a crow—it sat on a branch alone:

2 kolfi flęygði · kyrði fugla 'hurled his bolts, stunned the birds' | Perhaps by means of a slingshot, an ancient and widespread birding practice.

**45** „Hvat skalt, Konr ungr, · kyrra fugla? [W 78v/30–31]
Hęldr męttið ér · hęstum ríða
*hęstum ríða* · ok hęr fęlla.

"Why shalt thou, Kin the young, stun the birds?
Rather might ye ride horses,
ride horses, fell hosts.

3 *hęstum ríða* 'horses to ride' | *emend.; om. (presumably by haplography)* **W**

ALL | In the final 2 sts. the talking crow begins its exhortation, encouraging Kin the young, to go out and conquer like his father. The exhortation is most likely cut short by the loss of the rest of the poem.

**46** Á Danr ok Danpr · dýrar hallir; [W 78v/31–32]
óðra óðal · an ér hafið;
þęir kunnu vel · kjól at riða,
ęgg at kęnna, · undir rjúfa."

Dene and Danp own costly halls,
nobler ethel than ye have.
They can well ride the ship,
teach the blade, tear open wounds."

2 ér 'ye' | *metr. emend.;* þér *'id.'* **W**

1 Danr ok Danpr 'Dene and Danp' | For these figures see the Appendix to the poem.

2 óðal 'ethel' | Ancestral farmland, in this case the eighteen homesteads owned by Earl.

2 ér 'ye' | The older form *ér* is required by the alliteration, so the use of the younger *þér* in the ms. shows that the poem has been linguistically modernised.

3 kjól at riða 'ride the ship' | I.e. to sail.

4 ęgg at kęnna 'teach the blade' | To wage war. A euphemism; to "teach someone the blade" is to fight (and kill) him.

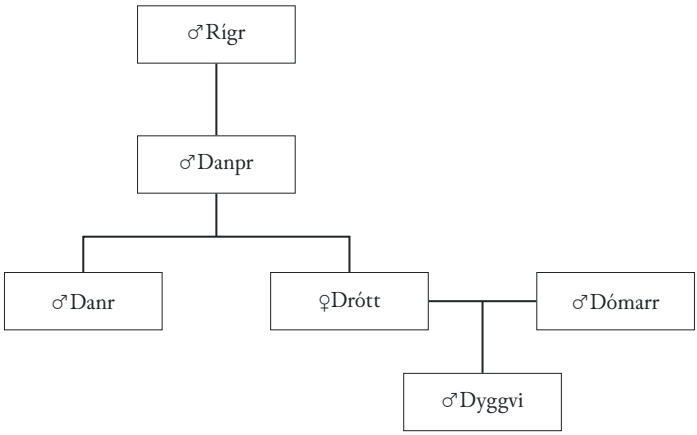
(At this point fol. 78 of **W** ends, and the rest of the poem is lost. For parallels see the Appendix below.)

## Appendix

Exactly how *Rþ* would have progressed is of course unclear, but the following parallels may offer something of a hint.

### *Yng* 17

In *Yng*, Due is the seventh in the line of Inglings, the legendary Swedish and later Norwegian royal dynasty. The relevant family tree is as follows:




> Móðir Dyggva var Drótt, dóttir Danps konungs, sonar Rígs,
> 2 er fyrstr var konungr kallaðr á danska tungu. Hans átt-menn
> hǫfðu á·valt síðan konungs-nafn fyrir it ǿzta tígnar-nafn. Dyg-
> 4 gvi var fyrst konungr kallaðr sinna ętt-manna. [...] Drótt drót-
> tning var systir Dans konungs ins mikil-láta, er Dan-mǫrk er
> 6 við kend.

Due's mother was Dright, the daughter of king Danp, the son of Righ, who was the first to be called king in [the geographical extent of] the Danish tongue. His kinsmen always thereafter held the title of king to be the utmost title of rank. Due was the first of his kinsmen to be called king. [...] Queen Dright was the sister of king Dene the proud, after whom Denmark is named.

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2 á danska tungu 'in [the geographical extent of] the Danish tongue' | Namely the area of the Old Norse or Scandinavian language, not merely its Danish dialect. This area originally includes Sweden, Norway, and Denmark.

## The epitome of the lost *Skjǫldunga saga*

In the epitome of the *Skjǫldunga saga* we read (Bjarni Guðnason 1982, pp. 1–45):

TODO: text

TODO: translation

# Leeds of Hindle
# *(Hyndlu ljóð)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.996)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Leeds of Hindle** (*Hdl*) is a poorly preserved poem found only in **F**. St. 32 is cited in *Gylf* and attributed to the *Vǫluspǫ́ in skamma* 'Short Spae of the Wallow'. The relation of that poem to the *Hdl* in its present form is unclear.

NOTE: Both translation and edition are currently incomplete.

## Text

[Fręyja kvað:] **1** „Vaki męr męyja, · vaki mín vina, [F TODO]
Hyndla systir, · es í hęlli býr;
nú 's røkr røkra, · ríða vit skulum
til Val-hallar · ok til vés hęilags.

[Quoth Frow:] "WAKE, MAIDEN OF MAIDENS! Wake, my friend!
O Hindle, sister, who livest in the cave!
Now is the twilight of twilights; we two shall ride
to Walhall and to the holy wigh!

**2** Biðjum Hęrja*·fǫðr · í hugum sitja, [F TODO]
hann geldr ok gefr · goll verðugum,
gaf hann Hęr·móði · hjalm ok brynju,
ęn Sig·mundi · sverð at þiggja.

Let us bid the Father of Hosts ⟨= Weden⟩ to remain in good thoughts;
he pays and gives gold to the worthy.
He gave to Harmod helmet and byrnie,
but to Syemund a sword to take.

1 Hęrja*·fǫðr | *emend.;* 'herians faudur' **F**

2 hann geldr ok gefr · goll verðugum 'he pays and gives gold to the worthy' | Closely related to *1 HHund* 9/3, which is why Finnur Jónsson (1932) and Guðni Jónsson (1954) emend *verðugum* 'the worthy' to *verðungu* 'the retinue'.

**3** Gefr hann sigr sonum, · ęn svinnum aura, [F TODO]
męlsku mǫrgum · ok man-vit firum,
byri gefr brǫgnum, · ęn brag skǫldum,
gefr hann mann-sęmi · mǫrgum rekki.

He gives victory to sons and ounces [of silver] to the wise,
speech to many and manwit to men.
Fair wind he gives to nobles and praise-song to scalds;
he gives manly valour to many a champion.

**4** Þór mun hǫn blóta, · þess mun hǫn biðja, [F TODO]
at hann ę við þik · ęin-art láti;
þó 's hǫnum ǫ·títt · við jǫtuns brúðir.

To Thunder she [I] will bloot, of this she [I] will pray:
that he always be upright with thee,
although he bears hatred for the ettin's brides.

**5** Nú tak-tu ulf þǐnn · ęinn af stalli, [F TODO]
lát hann rinna · með runa mínum.“—
[Hyndla kvað:] „Sęinn es gǫltr þinn · goð-veg troða,
vil’k=*at* mar mǐnn · męta hlǿða.

Now take thy one wolf from the stable;
let him run alongside my boar.”—
[Quoth Hindle:] “[Too] slow is thy boar to tread the Godways;
I wish not to load my noble steed.

**6** Flǫ est Freyja, · es freistar mín, [F TODO]
vísar þú augum · á oss þannig,
es hafir ver þinn · ǐ val-sinni
Ótt·ar unga · Inn·stęins bur.“

False art thou, Frow, who temptest me;
thou showest thy eyes on us this way
since thou hast thy lover on the slain-path:
the young Oughter, Instone’s offspring.”

2–3 vísar ... val-sinni ‘thou showest ... slain-ways’ | I.e., “You only show favour to me because you want me to help your lover”. For the expression cf. *Sigrdr* 3/3 n.

[Freyja kvað:] **7** „Dulið est Hyndla, · draums ętla’k þér, [F TODO]
es kveðr ver minn · ǐ val-sinni,
þar’s gǫltr glóar · Gollin·bursti,
Hildi·svíni, · es mér hagir gęrðu,
dvergar tvęir · Dáinn ok Nabbi.

[Quoth Frow:] Deluded art thou, Hindle; I think thee dreamy,
who sayest that my man is on the slain-path
where the boar Goldenbristle glows,
Hildswine, which for me made
the two skilful dwarfs Dowen and Nab.

4 Hildi·svíni ‘Hildswine’ | The ‘battle-swine’, another name for Goldenbristle.

**8** Sęnn* ǐ sǫðlum · sitja vit skulum [F TODO]
ok of jǫfra · ęttir dœma,
gumna þęira, · es frá goðum kómu.

Soon in the saddles we two shall sit,
and of the lines of chieftains speak,
of those men who came from the gods.

1 Sęnn* | *emend.;* 'sennum' **F** 1 *ĭ* | *emend.;* vit ór **F**

**9** Þęir hafa vęðjat · vala malmi [F TODO]
Ótt·arr ungi · ok Angantýr;
skylt 's at vęita, · svá't skati inn ungi
fǫður-lęifð hafi · ępt frękndr sína.

They have wagered the Welsh ore [GOLD],
young Oughter and Ongenthew.
It must be granted so that the young prince
may have the patrimony after his kinsmen.

**10** Hǫrg hann mér gęrði · hlaðinn stęinum; [F TODO]
nú 's grjót þat · at glęri orðit;
rauð hann ĭ nýju · nauta blóði;
ę trúði Ótt·arr · á ǫsynjur.

A harrow he made for me, loaded with stones;
now that stone-pile has turned into glass.
He reddened it in the fresh blood of oxes;
always did Oughter trust in the Ossens.

**11** Nú lát forna · niðja talða [F TODO]
ok upp-bornar · ęttir manna
hvat 's skjǫldunga, · hvat 's skilfinga,
hvat 's ǫðlinga · hvat 's ylfinga
hvat 's hǫlð-borit, · hvat 's hęrs-borit
męst manna val · und Mið·garði?"

Now let ancient ancestors be counted,
and the high-born lines of men.
What is of Shieldings? What is of Shilvings?
What is of Athlings? What is of Wolvings?
What is born of hero? What is born of chief,
the greatest choice of men in Middenyard?"

**12** „Þú est Ótt·arr · borinn Inn·stęini, [F TODO]
ęn Inn·stęinn vas · Ǫlfi inum gamla,
Ǫlfr vas Ulfi, · Ulfr Sę·fara,
ęn Sę·fari · Svan inum rauða.

[Quoth Hindle:] "Thou art, Oughter, born to Instone,
and Instone was born to Elf the old,

Elf was to Wolf, Wolf to Seafarer,
and Seafarer to Swan the red.

---

ALL | Hindle begins the genealogy; she speaks directly to Oughter.

**13** Móður átti faðir þínn · męnjum gǫfga, [F TODO]
hygg at héti · Hlédís gyðja,
Fróði vas faðir þęirar, · ęn Fríund móðir;
ǫll þótti ętt sú · með yfir-mǫnnum.

Thy father got thy mother, beautiful with torcs;
I think that she was called Leedise the gidden.
Frood was her father, but Friend her mother;
all that lineage seemed to be among overmen.

---

3 Fríund | *emend. from meaningless* †friaut† **F**

**14** Auði vas áðr · ǫflgastr manna, [F TODO]
Half·danr fyrri · héstr skjǫldunga,
frég vóru folk-víg, · þau's framir gęrðu,
hvarfla þóttu hans verk · með himins-skautum.

Ed was once the strongest of men,
Halfden yet earlier the highest of Shieldings.
Famous were the troop-wars which the brave ones made;
his ⟨= Halfden's⟩ works seemed to whirl along the corners of heaven.

**15** Ęflði=sk við Ęy·mund · óðstan manna [F TODO]
ęn vá Sig·trygg · með svǫlum ęggjum,
ęiga gekk Alm·vęig, · óðsta kvinna,
ólu þau ok ǫttu · átján sonu.

He became the in-law of Eanmund, the noblest of men,
but he slew Syetrue with cool edges.
He went to have Elmwey, the noblest of women;
they begot and had eighteen sons.

---

1 Ęflði=sk 'became the in-law' | Lit. 'was strengthened by'. Elmwey was Eanmund's daughter or sister.

**16** Þaðan eru skjǫldungar, · þaðan eru skilfingar, [F TODO]
þaðan eru ǫðlingar, · þaðan eru ynglingar,
þaðan es hǫld-borit, · þaðan es hęrs-borit,
mest manna val · und Mið·garði;

allt 's þat ętt þĭn, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

Thereof come the Shieldings! Thereof come the Shilvings!
Thereof come the Athlings! Thereof come the Inglings!
Thereof is born of hero! Thereof is born of chief
the greatest choice of men within Middenyard!
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!"

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2 ynglingar 'Inglings' | Note the variation from st. 12, which has *ylfingar* 'Wolvings'. Since the Inglings have already been mentioned (under the name of Shilvings), it seems likely that st. 12's Wolvings is the original reading.

**17** Vas Hildi·gunnr · hęnnar móðir, [F TODO]
Svǫfu barn · ok Sę·konungs;
allt 's þat ętt þĭn, · Ótt·arr hęimski.
varði at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęngra?

Hildguth was her ⟨= Elmwey's⟩ mother,
the child of Sweve and Sea-king.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!
It is meaningful that one might know thus; wilt thou yet further?

**18** Dagr átti Þóru · dręngja móður, [F TODO]
ólu=sk ĭ ętt þar · øðstir kappar,
Frað·marr ok Gyrðr · ok Frekar báðir,
Ámr ok Jǫsur·marr, · Ǫlfr inn gamli.
varðar at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęngra?

Day got Thurie, the mother of valiant men;
in that lineage were begotten the noblest champions:
Fradmer and Yird and both Frecks,
Ame and Essermer, Atholf the old.—
It is meaningful that one might know thus; wilt thou yet further?

**19** Kętill hét vinr þęira · Klypps arf-þęgi, [F TODO]
vas hann móður-faðir · móður þinnar;
þar vas Fróði · fyrr ęnn Kári,
hinn ęldri vas · Ǫlfr of getinn.

Kettle was the name of their friend, the heir of Clip;
he was the father of thy mother's mother.
There was Frood, yet earlier Keer,
the elder Atholf was mentioned.

**20** *N*anna vas nęst þar · Nǫkkva dóttir [F TODO]
vas mǫgr hennar · mágr þíns fǫður.
fyrnd 's sú męgð · framm tęl'k lęngra
kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi
allt 's þat ętt þín, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

Nan was next there, the daughter of Nake;
her son was the in-law of thy father.
Ancient is that family; I foresee further.
I know both Brord and Harrow.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

1 *N*anna | *emend.;* Manna **F**

4 kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi 'I know both Brord and Harrow' | This l. is probably in error here; it reoccurs identically as 24/1 below.

**21** Ís·ólfr ok Ǫs·ólfr · Ql·móðs synir [F TODO]
ok Skur·hildar · Skękkils dóttur,
skalt til tęlja · skatna margra
allt 's þat ętt þín, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

Icewolf and Osulf, the sons of Alemod
and Showerhild Shackle's daughter—
them shalt thou recount before the many princes.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**22** Gunn·arr balkr, · Grímr arð-skafi, [F TODO]
Járn-skjǫldr, Þórir, · Ulfr gĩnandi,
Búi ok Brami, · Barri ok Rękifnir,
Tindr ok Tyrfingr · ok tvęir Haddingjar.
allt 's þat ętt þín, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

Guther the balk, Grim the ard-shaver,
Ironshield, Thurwigh, Wolf the grinning,
Bowe and Brame, Barr and Rafner,
Tind and Tirving and the two Hardings.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**23** Ȧni, Ǫmi · vǫ́ru bornir [F TODO]
Arn·gríms synir · ok Ęy·furu;
brǫkun ber-sękrja · bǫls margs-konar
of lǫnd ok of lǫg · sem logi føri.
allt 's þat ętt þín, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

Ane, Ome were born
the sons of Arngrim and Eanfore.
The battles of the bear-serks of the manifold evils
over land and over sea went forth like a flame.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**24** Kunna'k báða · Brodd ok Hǫrvi [F TODO]
vǫ́ru þęir í hirð · Hrólfs ins gamla,
allir bornir · frá Jǫrmun·reki
Sig·urðar mági · (hlýð sǫgu mínni!)
folkum gríms · þęss 's Fáfni vá.

I know both Brord and Harrow;
they were in the troop of Rotholf the old,
all born from Ermenric,
from the inlaw of Siward—heed my tale!—
the terror of hosts who slew Fathomer.

4 Sig·urðar | The meter of the line requires that the first syllable of this name be short (*Sig·urð-* < **Sig·vǫrð-*), a young feature (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141).

**25** Sá vas vísir · frá Vǫlsungi [F TODO]
ok Hjǫr·dís · frá Hrauðungi
ęn Ęy·limi · frá Qðlingum.
allt 's þat ętt þǐn, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

That ruler came from Walsing,
and Hardise from Reading,
but Eanlime from the Athlings.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**26** Gunnarr ok Hǫgni · Gjúka arfar [F TODO]
ok it sama Guð·rún · systir þęira.
Ęigi vas Guð·þormr · Gjúka ęttar
þó vas hann bróðir · bęggja þęira
allt 's þat ętt þǐn, · Ótt·arr hęimski.

Guther and Hawn, Yivick's heirs,
and likewise Guthrun, their sister.
Godthorm was not of Yivick's lineage,
though he was the brother of them both.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**27** Haraldr hildi-tǫnn · borinn Hrø·reki [F TODO]

slǫngvan-bauga · son*r vas hann Auðar.
Auðr djúp-audga · Í·vars dóttir
ǫn Ráð·barðr · vas Rand·vé*s faðir
þǫir vóru gumnar · goðum signaðir.
allt 's þat ǫ́tt þ́ín, · Ótt·arr hǫimski.

Harold Hild-tooth was born to Rethric
the slinger of bighs; he was the son of Ead.
Ead the deep-minded was Inwar's daughter,
but Redebeard was Randwigh's father.
They were men dedicated to the gods.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**28** Vóru ǫllifu · ǫ́sir taldir [F TODO]
Baldr es hné · við bana-þúfu
þǫss létsk Váli · verðr at hǫfna
sínns bróðr · sló hand-bana;
allt 's þat ǫ́tt þ́ín, · Ótt·arr hǫimski.

Eleven were the Eese tallied
when Balder sank down against the tuft of his bane.
That Wonnel declared himself worthy to avenge;
he slew the hand-bane of his brother.
That is all thy lineage, foolish Oughter!

**29** Vas Baldrs faðir · Burs arf-þegi, [F TODO]
Frǫyr átti Gǫrdi, · hón vas G*ymis dóttir
jǫtna ǫ́ttar · ok Aur·boðu;
Þó vas Þjatsi · þǫira frǫ́ndi
skaut-gjarn jǫtunn; · hans vas Skaði dóttir.

Balder's father was the heir of Byre.
Frea knew Gird; she was the daughter of Gymer
from the lineage of the ettins and Earbode.
Further Thedse was their kinsman,
the shot-eager ettin; Shede was his daughter.

**30** Mart sǫgjum þér · ok munum flǫira [F TODO]
vǫrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ǫnn flǫira.

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet more?

**31** [F TODO]

Haki vas Hvęðnu · Hóti bętstr sona
ęn Hvęðnu vas · Hjǫr·varðr faðir
Hęiðr ok Hross·þjófr · Hrímnis kindar.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**32** [F TODO, S 2v/14, T 3r/26, W 5v/30, U 4r/20]

Eru vǫlur allar · frá Víð·ólfi,
vítkar allir · frá Vil·męiði,
sęið-berendr · frá Svart-hǫfða,
jǫtnar allir · frá Ymi komnir.

All wallows are from Widolf,
all warlocks from Wilmad,
soth-bearers from Swarthead,
all ettins are come from Yimer.

3 sęið-berendr · frá Svart-hǫfða, | *om.* **U** 3 sęið-berendr | skil-berendr **F**

ALL | This st. is cited in *Gylf*, following *Gylf* 5:6–9, which describes Yimer (cf. *Vsp* 3/1 n.). *Gylf* 5:10–11 introduces the stanza with the words *ok eru þaðan komnar éttir hrím-þursa, svá sem segir í Vǫlu-spá hinni skǫmmu* 'and thereof are come the lineages of Rime-Thurses, as it says in the short Spae of the Wallow:'.

**33** [F TODO]

Mart sęgjum þér · ok munum flęira
vǫrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęngra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

**34** [F TODO]

Varð ęinn borinn · í ár-daga
ramm-aukinn mjǫk · rǫgna kindar;
níu bǫru þann · nadd-gǫfgan mann
jǫtna męyjar · við jarðar þrǫm.

A single one was born in days of yore,
much increased in strength by the race of the Reins.
Nine gave birth to that arrow-famed man:
the maidens of ettins at the rim of the earth.

**35** [F TODO]

Mart sęgjum þér · ok munum flęira
vǫrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęngra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

**36** Hann Gjǫlp of bar · hann Gręip of bar, [F TODO]
bar hann Ęistla · ok Ęyr·gjafa;
hann bar Ulf·rún · ok Ang·ęyja,
Ímdr ok Atla · ok Jarn·saxa.

Him Yelp did bear; him Grope did bear;
Astle bore him and Earyive;
Wolfrun bore him and Ongie,
Imeth and Attle and Ironsaxe.

**37** Sá vas aukinn · jarðar magni [F TODO]
sval-kǫldum sę · ok sónar dręyra.

He was increased with the might of the earth,
the freezing cold sea and the guts of a boar.

**38** Mart sęgjum þér · ok munum flęira [F TODO]
vǫrumsk at viti svá, · vilt ęnn lęngra?

Much we tell thee and recall yet more;
I warn against one knowing such; wilt thou yet further?

**39** Ól Ulf Loki · við Angr·boðu [F TODO]
ęn Slęipni gat · við Svaðil·fara;
ęitt þótti skars · allra fęiknast
þat vas bróður frá · Bý·lęists komit.

Lock begot the Wolf with Angerbode,
but Slopner he begat with Swaddlefare.
One troll-woman seemed wickedest of all;
she was come from the brother of Bilast.

3 ęitt … skars ‘One troll-woman’ | Viz. Hell, Lock’s daughter.

**40** Loki á*t* hjarta · lindi bręnndu [F TODO]
fann hann half-sviðinn · hug-stęin ko*n*u;
varð Loptr kviðugr · af konu illri
þaðan es á foldu · flagð hvęrt komit.

Lock ate a heart burned with linden-wood;
he found the half-scorched thought-stone [HEART] of a woman.
Loft became pregnant from that evil woman;
thereof is come every troll upon the earth.

**41** Haf gęngr hríðum · við himin sjalfan [F TODO]
líðr lǫnd yfir · ęn lopt bilar;
þaðan koma snjóvar · ok snarir vindar
þá 's í ráði · at ręgin of þrjóti.

The sea rises in storms against the very heaven,
goes over the lands, but the air gives way.
Thence come snows and swift winds;
then it is in the motions that the Reins expire.

ALL | A prediction of the Rakes of the Reins (as told at length in *Vsp* 43–54), likely the reason why this passage is called the Short Spae of the Wallow.

**42** Varð ęinn borinn · ǫllum męiri [F TODO]
sá vas aukinn · jarðar magni.
þann kveða stilli · stór-auðgastan
Sif sifjaðan · sjǫtum gǫrv-ǫllum.

One was born greater than all;
he was increased with the might of the earth.
That ruler they say is the very wealthiest,
related to Sib, to each and every dwelling.

**43** Þá kømr annarr · ęnn mátkari [F TODO]
þó þori'k ęigi · þann at nęfna;
fáir sjá nú · framm of lęngra
an Óðinn man · Ulfi móta."

Then comes another one, far mightier,
though I dare not say his name.
Few folk now see further ahead
than when Weden will meet the Wolf."

ALL | This stanza is most likely pulling from *Vsp* H58 which indicates that the version of *Vsp* available to the poet likely contained that stanza.

**44** „Ber minnis-ǫl · mínum gęsti [F TODO]
svá hann ǫll muni · orð at tína
þessa róðu · á þridja morni
þá's þęir Angan·týr · ęttir rękna."

"Bear an ale of remembrance unto my guest,
that he may remember to recite all the words
of this speech on the third morning,
when he and Ongentew reckon lineages."

**45** „Snú þú burt heðan · sofa lystir mik [F TODO]
fęr þú fátt af mér · fríðra kosta.
hlęypr þú edlvina · úti à nǫttum
sem með hǫfrum · Hęið·rún fari.

Turn away hence! I desire to sleep;
from me wilt thou get few pretty things.
TODO.
TODO.

**46** Rant at Óði · ęy þręyjandi [F TODO]
skutusk þér fleiri · und fyrir skyrtu.
hleypr þu edlvina · úti à nǫttum
sem með hǫfrum · Hęið·rún fari.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**47** „Ek slę ęldi · af í·viðju [F TODO]
svá't *ęigi* kømsk · à burt heðan.“
„hleypr þu edlvina · úti à nǫttum
sem með hǫfrum · Hęið·rún fari.

“I strike a fire around the Inwithy,
that thou wilt not come away hence!”
TODO.
TODO.

**48** Hyr sé'k brenna · ęn hauðr loga [F TODO]
verða flęstir · fjǫr-lausn þola;
ber Ótt·ari · bjór at hęndi
ęitri blandinn mjǫk · illu hęilli.“

A fire I see burning, but the earth does blaze;
most must suffer the saving of life.
Bring beer to Oughter's hands,
mixed with much poison, of ill omen!”

**49** „Orð-hęill þǐn · skal ęngu ráða [F TODO]
þótt brúðr jǫtuns · bǫlvi hęitir;
hann skal drekka · dýrar vęigar

4 biðʼk Óttˑari · ǫll goð duga.“

“Thy word-omens shall have no power,
though the ettin’s bride does summon a bale.
He shall drink costly draughts;
Oughter I bid all gods avail!”

# Fragments from Snorre's Edda

## Introduction

A number of Eddic lines, stanzas and groups of stanzas are quoted in *SnE*, specifically the first two parts: *Gylf* and *Skm*. The majority of these quotations are taken from longer Eddic poems preserved in full in other manuscripts (primarily **R** and **A**), but a few are found nowhere else. It is these orphaned fragments which will be edited in the present section.

The fragments have two things in common: they are generally pieces of spoken dialogue quoted in the context of longer narrative prose sections, and are, with one exception (Homedall's galder, see below), not introduced by reference to their source, but rather with phrases like *þá kvað hann* 'then quoth he'.

TODO: Further discussion on the fragments. Incorporate textual variants for prose and double check stanzas.

## I. A lost riddle-poem (*Gylf* 2:15–20)

### Introduction

This half-stanza is quoted in *Gylf* 2. It is the second Eddic stanza in *Gylf*, following *Háv* 1 which is uttered by Yilfer himself when he enters the hall of the Eese in the same chapter. The whole passage is clearly drawing on other Eddic mythic wisdom contests and is particularly reminiscent of *Vafþ*. Whether the stanza itself is authentic or made up by Snorre himself is hard to tell.

### Text

[15]Hann sá þrjú há-sęti ok hvert upp frá ǫðru, ok sátu þrír menn
2 sinn í hverju. [16]Þá spurði hann, hvert nafn hǫfðingja þeira vęri.
Sá svarar, er hann leiddi inn, at [17]sá, er í inu neðsta há-sęti sat,
4 var konungr, ok heitir Hárr, en þar nęst sá, er heitir Jafn·hárr,
en sá ofast, er Þriði heitir. [18]Þá spyrr Hárr komanda'nn, hvárt
6 fleira er erendi hans, en heimill er matr ok drykkr honum sem
ǫllum þar í Háva hǫll. [19]Hann segir, at fyrst vill hann spyrja, ef
8 nǫkkurr er fróðr maðr inni. [20]Hárr segir, at hann komi eigi heill
út, nema hann sé fróðari,

[15]He [= Yilfer] saw three high-seats, and each one higher than the last; and three men sat there, each in his own seat. [16]Then he asked what the names of those chieftains were. He who led him in answers that [17]the one who sat in the lowest high-seat was a king called High, and next to him he who is called Evenhigh, and uppermost he who is called Third. [18]Then High asks the guest whether he has any other errands—but he is as welcome to food and drink as every man is there in the High One's hall. [19]He [= Yilfer] asks whether anyone within is a learned man. [20]High says that he will not come out whole unless he be the more learned one,

**1** „ok statt-u framm · meðan þú fregn;
2 sitja skal sá es sęgir."

[S 2r/10, T 2v/20, W 5r/23, U 3v/11]

"and stand forth while thou askest;
sit shall he who speaks!"

1 framm | frami T

## II. Nearth and Shede (*Gylf* 23:1–14)

### Introduction

The following passage is the whole of *Gylf* 23, excepting the citation of *Grm* 11 at the very end.

It is notable that the two stanzas cited here are also found translated in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.8.18–19, where they are said to have been spoken by the legendary hero Harding (corresponding to Nearth) and Rainhild (corresponding to Shede). In this way, the pre-Christian myth has been reinterpreted to fit Saxe's mission as a patriotic Danish, Christian antiquarian. For discussion, see Hopkins (2021).

Comparatively, the story of the couple's alternating residences has an interesting parallel in Greek myth, where Ἅιδης, the king of the Underworld, abducts his niece Περσεφόνη, the spring-goddess (*Theog* 914, Homeric Hymn to Δημήτηρ). Eventually, the two marry, and Περσεφόνη is allowed to spend a third or half the year (the winter months) in the Underworld, the rest above ground with the gods.

In both traditions, we find a conflict between a married couple where the wife is an abductee solved through the alternation of residence between the wife's original home (Thrimham, the Earth) and her husband's (Nowetons, the Underworld). Although the Norse myth, unlike the Greek, has no immediately apparent relation to natural cycles, with the comparative evidence in mind, the possibility of such a connection cannot be excluded.

### Text

[S 6v/6, T 7r/9, W 9v/15, U TODO]

[1]Inn þriði óss er sá, er kallaðr er Njǫrðr. [2]Hann býr á himni, þar sem heitir Nóa-tún. [3]Hann ræðr fyrir gǫngu vinds ok stillir sjá ok eld. [4]Á hann skal heita til sę-fara ok til veiða. [5]Hann er svá auðigr ok fé-sęll, at hann má gefa þeim auð, landa eða lausafjár er hann vill. Á hann skal til þess heita. [6]Eigi er Njǫrðr ásaęttar. Hann var upp føddr í Vana-heimi, en Vanir gísluðu hann goðu'num ok tóku í mót at gíslingu þann, er Hønir heitir. Hann varð at sętt með goðum ok Vǫnum. [7]Njǫrðr á þá konu, er Skaði heitir, dóttir Þjatsa jǫtuns. [8]Skaði vill hafa bú-stað þann, er átt hafði faðir hennar, þat er á fjǫllum nǫkkurum, þar sem heitir Þrym-heimr, en Njǫrðr vill vera nær sę. [9]Þau sęttusk á þat, at þau skyldu vera níu nętr í Þrym-heimi, en þá aðrar níu at Nóatúnum. [10]En er Njǫrðr kom aptr til Nóa-túna af fjalli'nu, þá kvað hann þetta:

[1]The third Os is he who is called Nearth. [2]He lives in the heaven in the place called Nowetons. [3]He rules the course of the wind, and stills sea and

fire. [4]On him shall one call for sea-faring and for hunting. [5]He is so wealthy and blessed with money that he may give a wealth of lands or loose property to whomever he wants; on him shall one call for that sake. [6]Nearth is not of the lineage of the Eese. He was brought up in Wanehome, but the Wanes gave him as a hostage to the gods, and in return got as hostage that one who is called Heener. He was used to reconcile the gods and the Wanes. [7]Nearth has to wife the woman who is called Shede, the daughter of the ettin Thedse. [8]Shede wishes to have the dwelling which her father had owned, which lies on some fells in the place called Thrimham—but Nearth wishes to live by the sea. [9]They agreed with each other that they would live for nine nights in Thrimham, but the other nine at Nowetons. [10]But when Nearth came back to the Nowetons from the fell, then this quoth he:

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5–8 Eigi er Njǫrðr ása ęttar. ... Hann varð at sętt með goðum ok Vǫnum. 'Nearth is not of the lineage of the Eese. ... He was used to reconcile the gods and the Wanes.' | For this episode see *Vsp* 22 n., *Vafþ* 38–39.

**1** „Lęið eru=mk fjǫll, · vas'k=a lęngi á, [S 6v/15, T 7r/18, W 9v/23, U 8v/6]
2 nętr ęinar níu;
ulfa þytr · mér þótti illr vesa
4 hjá sǫngvi svana."

"Loathsome I find the fells, I was not long thereon—
only nine nights.
The howling of wolves seemed evil to me
against the song of swans."

[11]Þá kvað Skaði þetta:

[11]Then this quoth Shede:

**2** „Sofa né mát'k=a'k · sęvar bęðjum á [S 6v/16, T 7r/20, W 9v/24, U 8v/7]
2 fugls jarmi fyrir;
sá mik vękr · es af víði kømr
4 morgun hvęrjan már."

"I could not sleep on the bed of the sea
for the bleating of the bird.
That one awakens me who comes from the main
every morning: the mew."

[12]Þá fór Skaði upp á fjall ok byggði í Þrym-heimi, [13]ok ferr hón
2 mjǫk á skíðum ok með boga ok skýtr dýr. [14]Hón heitir ǫndur-goð eða ǫndur-dís. [15]Svá er sagt: [...]

[12]Then Shede went up to the fells and dwelled in Thrimham, [13]and she often goes on skis with her bow and shoots beasts. [14]She is called ski-god or ski-dise. [15]So it is said: [...]

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3 [...] | Here the text cites *Grm* 11; see there for variants.

## III. Homedall's Galder (*Hęim·dallar-galdr*, *Gylf* 27)

### Introduction

This mysterious fragment is quoted in *Gylf* 27, the chapter describing Homedall. The following section is the complete chapter.

The fragment consists of two c-lines and appears to be the end of a stanza in the fitting meter Galders-lay.

The same poem is mentioned again in *Skm* 15: *Heim·dallar hǫfuð heitir sverð. Svá er sagt, at hann var lostinn manns hǫfði í gegnum. Um þat er kveðit í Heim·dallar-galdri, ok er síðan kallat hǫfuð mjǫtuðr Heim·dallar* 'A sword is called Homedall's head. So it is said that he was pierced through with a man's head; about that it is sung in Homedall's galder, and thenceforth the head is called Homedall's bane.'

### Text

[1]Heim·dallr heitir einn. [2]Hann er kallaðr hvíti ǫ́ss; [3]hann er mikill ok heilagr. [4]Hann bǫ́ru at syni meyjar níu ok allar systr; [5]hann heitir ok Hallin·skíði ok Gullin·tanni; tennr hans vǫ́ru af gulli. [6]Hestr hans heitir Gull·toppr. [7]Hann býr þar er heitir Himin·bjǫrg við Bif·rǫst; [8]hann er vǫrðr goða ok sitr þar við himins enda at gǫ́ta brúar'innar fyrir berg-risum. [9]Hann þarf minna svefn en fugl. [10]Hann sér jafnt nótt sem dag hundrað rasta frá sér; [11]hann heyrir ok þat, er gras vex á jǫrðu eða ull á sauðum, ok allt þat er hǽra lǽtr. [12]Hann hefir lúðr þann er Gjallar-horn heitir, ok heyrir blástr hans í alla heima. [13]Heim·dallar sverð er kallat hǫfuð manns. [...] [15]Ok enn segir hann sjalfr í Heimdallar-galdri:

[1]Homedal is the name of one. [2]He is called the White Os; [3]he is great and holy. [4]He was born as the son of nine maidens, sisters all. [5]He is also named Haldenshid and Goldentooth; his teeth were of gold. [6]His horse is named Goldtop. [7]He lives at the place called the Heavenbarrows near Bivrest. [8]He is the Watchman of the Gods and sits there at Heaven's end to guard the bridge against barrow-risers. [9]He needs less sleep than a bird. [10]Both during night and day he sees as far as a hundred rests away from him; [11]he also hears when grass grows on the ground or wool on sheep, and everything which makes louder sound. [12]He has the lur called the Horn of Yell, and his blowing can be heard in all realms. [13]A man's head is called 'Homedall's sword'. [...] [15]And further he himself says in Homedall's Galder:

1 Heim·dallr 'Homedall' | 'World-Brilliant'. For the word **dallr*, possibly 'brilliant, splendid', see *Vafþ* 25 n. Homedall appears to be an original fire-god, as seen by his epithets which closely resemble those of the Vedic *Agní*; cf. *Þrk* 13/3 n. Importantly Homedall also appears to fill the same ritual role as *Agní*, namely as the conveyor of mankind's prayers and sacrifices to the Gods, for he hears and sees all the speeches and works of men (27:10–11).

1 hviti ǫ́ss 'the White Os' | Cf. *Þrk* 15/1: *Hęim·dallr, hvítastr ása* 'Homedall, whitest of the Eese'.

2 Hann bǫ́ru at syni meyjar níu ok allar systr 'He was born as the son of nine maidens, sisters all' | Also mentioned in the galder below, though the significance of this is unclear since the nine sisters are not identified. They may perhaps be the nine daughters of the rulers of the sea, Eagre and Ran (*Skm* 33, 41, 76), which would further strengthen the identification of Homedall with fire; cf. the Indo-Iranian fire-epithet, OI *apā́m nápāt* 'grandson of the Waters' (*ṚV* 2.35; Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 75).

3 Hallin·skíði 'Haldenshid' | 'The one with slanting planks', perhaps a name for a kind of (ritual?) fire. This word only appears in two poetic sources. First in the kenning *tęnnr Hallin·skíða* 'the teeth of Haldenshid [GOLD]' in Glúmr *Gráf* 14 (SkP 1) from ca. 970 AD, secondly alongside *Hęim·dali* 'Homedale' (apparently a variant of *Hęim·dallr* 'Homedall') as a poetic synonym for the 'ram' in the list of synonyms Þul *Hrúts* 1 (SkP 3). The latter may suggest an interpretation 'the one with curved horns', but the sense 'horn' for *skíð* is never otherwise attested. The main sense of *skíð* is 'long think piece of wood, firewood, billet' (so *Háv* 60/1 and *Vsp* 19/4), whence also its common meaning 'ski' and the rare poetic 'sheath' (only in *Hamð* 15/1). It is therefore considerably more likely that this epithet originally referring specifically to the god Homedall has been applied to the ram, rather than the reverse: the fact that it is never found in active use in the sense 'ram' (but only in a list of synonyms) suggests that the sense 'ram' may in fact be a fully antiquarian invention.

3–4 Gullin·tanni; tennr hans vǫ́ru af gulli 'Goldentooth; his teeth were of gold.' | Attested in a kenning, as noted above. — A direct cognate occurs in *ṚV* 5.2.3 as an adjective describing *Agní*, the god of fire: *híraṇya-dantaṁ śúci-varṇam … a·paśyam* 'I saw Him with golden teeth and flaming color', where OI *híraṇya-danta* 'with golden teeth' < PIE **ǵ$^{\text{h}}$l̥h$_3$·enyó-h$_3$dontos* ~ **ǵ$^{\text{h}}$l̥h$_3$t·iHno-h$_3$dontō* > PGmc **gulþina-tanþô* > ON *Gollin·tanni*.

11 [...] | Here the text cites *Grm* 13, introduced by the words *Hér er svá sagt* 'Here it is said so'.

**1** „Níu em'k męyja mǫgr, [**S** 7r/23, **T** 7v/26,
2 níu em'k systra sonr." **W** 10r/29, **U** 9r/22]

"Of nine maidens am I the lad,
of nine sisters am I the son."

1 męyja 'maidens' | *so* **U**; móðra *'mothers'* **STW** 2 sonr 'son' | *om.* **T**

1 męyja 'maidens' | I.e., virgins. The adapted reading is supported by Snorre's prose in *Gylf* 27:4, which is clearly drawing from the present stanza; *męyja* 'maidens' is also felt to give better sense, since it carries a more specific semantic than *móðra*, and **U** is the most stemmatically archaic manuscript. It is also possible, however, that the reading of **U** is due to influence from Snorre's prose.

## IV. Gna and the Wanes (*Gylf* 35:21–26).

### Introduction

The following passage is found in *Gylf* 35, the chapter describing the Ossens, i.e., the goddesses.

### Text

[21]Fjórtánda Gná, hana sendir Frigg í ymsa heima at ørindum
2 sínum. [22]Hón á þann hest, er renn lopt ok lǫg, er heitir Hóf·varpnir.
[23]Þat var eitt sinn, er hón reið, at Vanir nǫkkvǫrir sá reið hennar
4 í lopti'nu. [24]Þá mélti einn:

[21]The fourteenth is Gna; Frie sends her into various homes to run her errands. [22]She owns the horse which runs over air and sea and is called Hoofwarpner. [23]It was one time when she rode that some Wanes saw her riding in the air. [24]Then one spoke:

**1** „Hvat þar flýgr, · hvat þar fęrr,
2 eða at lopti líðr?“

[S 8v/35, T 9v/6, W 11v/32, U 11v/2]

"What flies there, what fares there,
or passes through the air?"

[25]Hón svarar:

[25]She answers:

**2** „Né ek flýg, · þó ek fęr
2 ok at lopti líð'k
á Hóf·varpni, · þęim's Ham·skęrpir
4 gat við Garð·rofu.“

[S 8v/36, T 9v/6, W 11v/32, U 11v/3]

"I fly not, though I fare
and pass through the air,
on Hoofwarpner, whom Hamsherper
begot with Yardrove."

[26]Af Gnár nafni er svá kallat, at þat gnéfar, er hǫtt ferr.

[26]From Gna's name it is so called that something which fares high up *reaches high*.

## V. Balder's death (*Gylf* 49:77–82)

### Introduction

*Gylf* 49 contains the narrative of Balder's death, beginning with his ominous dreams, and ending with the Eese failing to "weep him out of Hell" (for a summary and discussion of the Balder-cycle and its attestations, see the introduction to *Vsp* 31–33).

The following passage is the very end of the chapter, in which a single Leeds-meter speech-stanza is quoted.

### Text

[77]Því nęst sendu ęsir um allan heim ørind-reka at biðja, at Baldr
2 vęri grátinn ór Helju, [78]en allir gerðu þat, menn'inir ok kykvendi'n
ok jǫrð'in ok steinar'nir ok tré ok allr málmr, [79]svá sem þú munt
4 sét hafa, at þessir hlutir gráta, þá er þeir koma ór frosti ok í hita.
[80]Þá er sendi-menn fóru heim ok hǫfðu vel rekit sín ørindi, finna
6 þeir í helli nǫkkvǫrum, hvar gýgr sat; hón nefndist Þǫkk. [81]Þeir
biðja hana gráta Baldr ór helju, hón segir:

[77]THEREAFTER THE EESE SENT AN ERRAND-RUNNER through all the Home to ask that Balder be wept out of hell. [78]And all did that, the men and the beasts and the earth and the stones and trees and all metals, [79]even as thou must have seen that these things weep when they come out of cold and into heat. [80]When the messengers journeyed home and had run their errand well, they find in a certain cave where a gigh was sitting; she called herself Thanks. [81]They ask her to weep Balder out of hell. She says:

1 „Þǫkk mun gráta · þurrum tǫrum [S 15v/23, T 16v/17,
2 Baldrs bál-farar; W 18r/26, U 17r/28]
kyks né dauðs · naut'k=a Karls sonar
4 hafi Hęl því's hęfir."

"Thanks will weep with dry tears
o'er Balder's pyre-journey [DEATH].
Neither alive nor dead I profited from Churl's son [= Balder];
let Hell have what she has!"

[82]En þess geta menn, at þar hafi verit Loki Lauf·eyjar son, er
2 flest hefir illt gørt með ǫsum.

[82]But men guess that this must have been Lock, Leafy's son, who has done the most evil among the Eese.

## VI. Thunder's journey to Garfrith (*Skm* 26)

### Introduction

*Skm* 26, here edited in part, tells of Thunder's journey to the ettin Garfrith and his following killing of the ettin and his two daughters, Yelp and Grope.

Thunder's fight with Garfrith and his daughters was clearly a very popular story in the late Wiking Age. Its retelling takes up most of the Scaldic *Þdr*, of which 19 full stanzas and 4 half-stanzas survive. The killing of Yelp is also invoked in a pagan prayer to Thunder quoted in *Skm* 11: *stétt of Gjǫlp dauða* 'Thou didst stand over the dead Yelp' (Vetrl Lv 1/1b in SkP 3). The story apparently remained popular after Christianization as seen by a humorous anecdote from the Kings' Saws. As King Harold 'Hardrede' Siwardson (born ca. 1015, dead 1066) was walking with his retinue, they witnessed an argument between a blacksmith and a tanner. Harold asked one of his court poets to compose a stanza (viz. ÞjóðA Lv 5 in SkP 2) about the incident while at the same time casting the blacksmith as Thunder and the tanner as Garfrith. The king was impressed and asked the poet to make another stanza, this time about Siward and Fathomer. The story of Garfrith is further alluded to in a curious way in Saxo Grammaticus (2015, pp. 598–613) 8.14.1–20, where a party guided by a man named Thurkettle (Latin *Thorkillus*) visit Garfrith's (Latin *Gerruthus*) cave and find his mutilated corpse along with those of three young women with their backs broken. Thurkettle tells them that this was once done by the god Thunder (Latin *Thor*). TODO: Malm (1992).

Although the story of *Skm* 26 is clearly based partly on *Þdr* (from which it cites at length), it may also rely on a now-lost poem in Leeds-meter, as it quotes two stanzas in that meter, edited here. Of these sts., the first is found in all four main manuscripts; the second only in **U**. Both are spoken by Thunder and closely resemble each other stylistically, which is why they are likely to come from the same poem.

### Text

Þá fór Þórr til ár þeirar, er Vimur heitir, allra á mest. Þá spennti
2 hann sik megin-gjǫrðum ok studdi for·streymis Gríðar-vǫl, en
Loki hélt undir megin-gjarðar. Ok þá er Þórr kom á miðja ǫ́'na,
4 þá óx svá mjǫk ǫ́'in, at uppi braut á ǫxl honum. Þá kvað Þórr
þetta:

Then journeyed Thunder to that river which is called Wimbre, greatest of all rivers. Then he strapped his might-girdle around him and leaned upon Grith's stave against the stream, and Lock clung to the might-girdle. And when Thunder came to the middle of the river, then it waxed so great that it broke over his shoulders. Then this quoth Thunder:

[**S** 25r/1, **T** TODO, **W** 26v/13, **U** TODO]

1 „Vax=at-tu nú, Vimur, · alls mik þik vaða tíðir
2 jǫtna garða ǐ;
vęitst, ef þú vęx · at þá vęx mér ǫs-męgin
4 jafn-hǫtt upp sem himinn.“

“Wax not now, Wimbre, as I wish to wade through thee
into the yards of the ettins!
Thou knowest, if thou waxest, then my Os-might waxes
up even as high as the heaven.”

---

ALL | Thunder's speech to the river is also described in *Þdr* 8/3–4.

1 Vimur ‘Wimbre’ | The name of the river is also found in a kenning in *Húsdr* 6/3: *Víð-gymnir Vimrar vaðs* ‘the Widegimner ⟨ettin⟩ of Wimbre's ford [= Thunder]’.

3 ǫs-męgin ‘Os-might’ | TODO.

Þá sér Þórr uppi í gljúfrum nǫkkurum, at Gjǫlp, dóttir Geir·røðar
2 stóð þar tveim megin ár'innar, ok gerði hón ár-vǫxt'inn. Þá tók
Þórr upp ór ǫ'nni stein mikinn ok kastaði at henni ok męlti svá:
4 „At ósi skal ǫ stemma.“ Eigi missti hann, þar er hann kastaði til,
ok í því bili bar hann at landi ok fekk tekit reyni-runn nǫkkurn
6 ok steig svá ór ǫ'nni. Því er þat orð-tak haft, at reynir er bjǫrg
Þórs.

Then Thunder sees that up in some certain gorges Yelp, the daughter of Garfrith, stood on both sides of the river, and she caused the river's growth. Then Thunder took up from the river a great stone and threw it at her and spoke so: “At its source shall the river be dammed.” He did not miss his target, and in that very moment he threw himself towards land and caught hold of a certain rowan shrub, and so he came out of the river. From this comes the saying that the rowan is Thunder's deliverance.

---

2 stóð þar tveim megin ár'innar, ok gerði hón ár-vǫxt'inn ‘stood on both sides of the river, and she caused the river's growth’ | She stood with her legs spread and befouled the river with urine or menstrual blood.

En er Þórr kom til Geir·røðar, þá var þeim fé-lǫgum vísat fyrst í
2 geita-hús til her-bergis, ok var þar einn stóll til sętis, ok sat Þórr
þar. Þá varð hann þess varr, at stóll'inn fór undir honum upp at
4 ręfri. Hann stakk Gríðar-veli upp í rapt'ana ok lét sígast fast á
stól'inn. Varð þá brestr mikill, ok fylgði skrękr. Þar hǫfðu verit
6 undir stóli'num døtr Geir·røðar, Gjǫlp ok Greip, ok hafði hann
brotit hrygg'inn í báðum. Þá kvað Þórr:

But when Thunder came to Garfrith's, then the companions were first shown into a goathouse for lodgings, and therein was but one chair for sitting and

Thunder sat down there. Then he became aware that the chair under him was moving upwards into the rafters. He thrust Grith's stave up against the rafters and pushed himself firmly down into the chair. Then there was a great crack, followed by a shriek. There beneath the chair had been the daughters of Garfrith, Yelp and Grope, and he had broken the backs of them both. Then quoth Thunder:

7 Þá kvað Þórr: | *only in* **U**; *om. all others.*

**2** „Ęinu *sinni* · nęytta'k alls męgins [U TODO]
2 jǫtna gǫrðum í
Þá's Gjǫlp ok Greip, · dǿtr Gęir-raðar,
4 vildu hęfja mik til himins."

"A single time I used all my might
in the yards of the ettins,
when Yelp and Grope, the daughters of Garfrith,
would lift me to the heaven."

ALL | *only in* **U**; *om. all others.*

1 *sinni* 'time' | metr. and sens. emend.; om. **U**.

## VII. The tree Glazer (*Skm* 42)

### Introduction

The original context of this half-stanza in Leeds-meter is obscure. The present excerpt represents the whole ch. 42 of *Skm*.

### Text

[1]Hví er gull kallat barr eða lauf Glasis? [2]Í Ǫs·garði fyrir durum
2 Val-hallar stendr lundr, sá er Glasir er kallaðr, en lauf hans allt
er gull-rautt, [3]svá sem hér er kveðit, at

[1]WHY IS GOLD called the needle or leaf of Glazer? [2]In Osyard, before the doors of Walhall, there stands a tree which is called Glazer; and its leafing is all gold-red, [3]just as it is sung here, that

**1** Glasir stęndr · með gollnu laufi [**S** 27v/14, **T** 28v/7,
2 fyrir Sig-týs sǫlum. **W** 30r/19, **U** TODO(81)/27

Glazer stands with golden leaf
before Sye-Tew's ⟨Weden's⟩ halls.

[4]Sá er viðr fegrstr með goðum ok mǫnnum.

[4]It is the fairest tree among gods and men.

## VIII. On the making of Glapner (*Lítla skálda*)

### Introduction

The following stanza describes the making of Glapner, the final fetter used to bind the Fenrerswolf. For the binding of the Wolf see *Gylf* 34:10–42 and the summary in *Lok* 38/3–4 n.

The stanza itself is found in the short work on kennings today called the Little Scalda (*Lítla skálda*), a text which probably served as a source for Snorre's Edda (see further Males 2020, pp. 129–47). It is not attributed to any named Eddic poem, although we cannot exclude that one might have existed.

A variant of the stanza is transparently paraphrased in *Gylf* 34:21, which tells us that Glapner *var gǫrr af sex hlutum: af dyn kattar'ins ok af skeggi konu'nnar ok af rótum bjargs'ins ok af sinum bjarnar'ins ok af anda fisks'ins ok af fogls bráka* 'was made from six things: from the cat's din and from the woman's beard and from the mountain's root and from the bear's sinews and from the fish's breath and from the fowl's spittle'. The variants—*bráka* 'spittle' for *mjǫlk* 'milk' and the reversal of lines 2 and 3—suggest that Snorre had access to an alternative version of the stanza. This version may perhaps have belonged to a variant oral tradition, but it is also possible that Snorre merely paraphrased the stanza from the Little Scalda from memory, misremembering a few minor details.

### Text

1 Ór kattar dyn · ok ór konu skęggi, [$A_b$ 9v/30, **B** TODO]
2 ór fisks anda · ok ór fugla mjǫlk,
ór bergs rótum · ok bjarnar sinum,
4 ór því vas hann Glęipnir gǫrr.

"From din of cat and woman's beard,
from breath of fish and milk of fowls,
from mountain's roots and bear's sinews—
from this was Glapner made."

# Norse Heroic Poetry from the Walsing-Cycle

# Introduction to Norse Heroic Poetry

## The Walsing-Cycle

The following poems belong to the Walsing-cycle, which is by far the best attested overarching Norse heroic narrative. Since the poems themselves are rather difficult and allusive (not to mention incomplete due to the loss of the end of *Sigrdr*, the beginning of *Brot*, and a large amount of material in-between), there is certainly value in providing an overview of the Cycle in a single place. This overview will not include the events told in *1 HHund–2 HHund*, since these events do not connect to the broader narrative.

### Summary

The narrative of the Cycle is rather convoluted and has clearly assimilated several originally unrelated narratives, but in the form it takes in the prose and later poetry of **R** it goes as follows:

There was once an ettin called Rethmar. He had three sons: Otter, Fathomer, and Rein. Otter could take the shape of an otter and Fathomer that of a wyrm or serpent; Rein was a dwarf in stature and a talented smith. One day, the Gods were fishing in Rethmar's river when they killed the shape-shifting Otter. Unwise of his true nature, they showed his flayed skin to his father, who seized them and demanded that they cover the skin with gold as a weregild. To procure the money, the god Lock extorted the dwarf Andware for his treasure, including the ring Andwaresgift. In anger, the dwarf cursed the stolen hoard to be the bane of all who possessed it.

The first killing soon followed. One of Rethmar's sons, Fathomer, grew greedy of his father's new-found wealth; he slew him and took the gold to the Gnit-heath, where he lay upon it in the shape of a wyrm. In his dying moments, Rethmar appealed to his daughter Lingheath to avenge him by killing Fathomer. She refused, but Rethmar told her to bear a daughter; she would, in turn, beget a son who could take the wealth.

Walsing was a great king. He begot a son called Syemund, who went on adventures with his son Sinfittle. After Sinfittle was poisoned by his step-mother Burhild due to a blood-feud, Syemund left her and went to Frankland, where he married Hardise, the daughter of King Eanlime (and, presumably, Lingheath). Syemund and King Eanlime died in battle against the

sons of Hunding, and not long thereafter Hardise bore Syemund's son, Siward. Hardise married Atholf, and Siward was raised by Atholf's father, King Helpric.

One day Rein arrived at Helpric's. He took the young Siward and fostered him, told him about his own parentage and the theft of Rethmar's hoard. Rein forges the sword Gram for Siward and incites him to avenge his father and grandfather by killing the sons of Hunding; Siward does so. After Siward has thus proved himself, Rein next incites him to kill Fathomer and take his gold. The two go up to the Gnit-heath where Fathomer lies, and Siward digs a trench where the wyrm is wont to go when going for water. When Fathomer slithers over the trench, Siward thrusts his sword upwards and cuts him in half. With his last breaths, Fathomer warns the reckless hero against taking the gold, but Siward does not listen.

At Rein's request, Siward cuts the heart out of Fathomer and roasts it by the fire. Rein has fallen asleep, and as the heart begins to froth, Siward thinks to feel with his finger whether it was hot enough. As he does so, he burns himself, and puts his thumb in his mouth to cool it. When the wyrm's blood touches his tongue, he gains some of its power, and begins to understand the chattering of the small birds above him; they warn Siward that Rein is planning to betray him and take the gold for himself. Eventually the lad grows convinced. He kills Rein in his sleep and drinks his blood; then he eats Fathomer's whole heart. The birds give Siward yet more advice, telling him to load the gold onto his horse and then to ride up onto the Hindfell, where there lies a shield-maiden under a sleeping-curse.

Upon the Hindfell, Siward sees a radiating light. By it he finds a circular shield-wall, and inside it there lies a warrior fast asleep under a helmet heavy byrnie. He takes off the helmet and sees that it is a woman; he cuts the byrnie in two, waking her. The woman gives her name as Syedrive and tells him that she had been stung with a sleeping-thorn by the god Weden after disobeying his orders. As thanks for freeing her, Syedrive, who is also known as Byrnhild, blesses Siward and teaches him runic magic; the two exchange vows. Although not stated explicitly, it seems that Siward then gives Byrnhild the ring Andwaresgift as a token.

In the middle of Syedrive's advice, **R** cuts off (as part of the Great Lacuna, see below). For this part of the narrative, we therefore have to rely on allusions in the later poems of the collection along with *Vǫls* and *Skm* 48–49. After visiting Byrnhild, Siward rides to the court of the Yivickings, who are Guthrun and her brothers Guther and Hawn. Their mother, Grimhild, gives Siward a potion to forget about Byrnhild and instead marry Guthrun; Siward, King Guther, and Hawn then swear oaths and become blood-brothers. Grimhild convinces Guther to marry Byrnhild, and Siward, Guther, and Hawn ride away together to ask for her hand. Byrnhild answers that she will only marry the man who will ride through a wall of fire for her. Guther does not dare do this, and so Siward uses magic to switch shapes with him. In the shape of Guther, Siward rides through the fire. Byrnhild wishes to sleep with him immediately, but out of loyalty for his brother-in-law, Siward (still pretending to be Guther) instead places a sword between them in the bed, where

they lay for three nights without touching each other. Siward takes the ring Andwaresgift from Byrnhild and places another ring on her hand. After this, the two couples wed on the same day, Siward with Guthrun, Guther with Byrnhild; they all live together at the stronghold of the Yivickings.

One day as Guthrun and Byrnhild are washing their hair, they argue over who has the best husband. Byrnhild brags about how Guther rode through the fire for her, but Guthrun reveals that it was in fact Siward, not Guther, who did it; as proof, she takes forth the ring Andwaresgift, which Siward had previously taken from Byrnhild when they lay divided by the sword. Byrnhild is heartbroken at the betrayal, since she had boasted only to marry the bravest and noblest man on the earth, whom she now knows to be Siward. She decides that Siward and Guther cannot both be alive, but since Siward is married to Guthrun, it is he who must die. She therefore incites Guther and Hawn to murder Siward, and it is here that **R** resumes again. Although Guther and Hawn are not happy about it, they yield to Byrnhild's demands. Since the two Yivickings are oath-sworn blood-brothers with Siward, they convince their younger brother, Godthorm, to do the deed. He murders Siward in bed with Guthrun and dies in the process. After this, Byrnhild sacrifices her handmaids and commits suttee in order to join Siward in Hell, the Underworld. The Yivickings take Siward's gold and become the possessors of Fathomer's hoard; they hide it at the bottom of the Rhine.

Guthrun curses her brothers, but it is not yet her time to die. Byrnhild's brother, King Attle, blames the Yivickings for his sister's death, and as a reconciliation Guther and Hawn marry Guthrun off to him. The relationship between the two is uneasy, however. Under the pretense of giving them wealth, Attle invites Guther and Hawn to his hall. Guthrun attempts to send a warning through the ring Andwaresgift, enwrapped with a wolf-hair, but Guther does not heed it. The two instead ride off to Attle where they are promptly captured. Attle attemps to extort Guther to reveal the location of the hoard in exchange for the life of his brother Hawn, but Guther instead demands Hawn's heart on a platter. Hawn laughs as his heart is cut out of him. Upon seeing the heart, Guther expresses his relief. He is the only one who knows the location of the hoard, and he will not reveal it. Enraged, Attle throws Guther in a snake-pit. Guthrun smuggles a harp to her brother and he plays it for some time to soothe the serpents, but at last is killed.

Guthrun has now lost both her first husband and her brothers. As revenge, she murders her own two sons with Attle and feeds them to him without letting him know; she reveals that he has been eating his own children. King Attle drinks himself into a stupor and falls into bed; soon thereafter Guthrun stabs him to death in his sleep. After this, she barricades the doors and sets fire to the hall, burning the retainers and shield-maidens inside. Guthrun goes to the sea to drown herself, but her time has still not come. Instead, she drifts over the waves to King Enacker. With Enacker Guthrun begets two more sons, Sarle and Hamthew; at his court she also raises her daughter with Siward, Swanhild, and Enacker's son from an earlier marriage, Earp. When Swanhild is of age, she is married off to King Ermenric of the Gots. Swanhild, however, falls victim to the cruel plans of

Ermenric's advisor Beck, who convinces Ermenric's son Randwigh to rape her. Beck then reveals the affair to Ermenric, who hangs his son and has horses trample Swanhild to death.

Guthrun learns of Swanhild's death and has now lost everything in the world. She incites her last surviving relatives, Sarle and Hamthew, to take revenge on their sister by killing King Ermenric; Sarle and Hamthew are to cut off the king's hands and feet, but her step-son Earp should cut off his head. The two brothers set out and encounter Earp on the road. He offers them assistance "as a hand would help a hand or a foot a foot", but they are annoyed with his way of speech and kill him. At last the two reach the court of King Ermenric, where they manage to maim the king by cutting off his hands and feet. They fail in decapitating him, however, and regret their unwarranted killing of their half-brother; with Earp's help, says Hamthew, they would have cut off the head, not the limbs alone. Ermenric calls out to his retainers to stone the two boys and they die. At the same time, Guthrun herself commits suttee and declares her wish to join Siward in the afterlife. With this, the cycle ends.

## Historical origins

The Walsing-Cycle in its classical form has clearly assimilated a large number of originally unrelated (pseudo-)historical narratives into a single whole, tied into a cohesive narrative through (fabricated) genealogical ties and the common thread of the curse of Fathomer's hoard. That this has happened is clear enough when one considers the historical lifetimes of the historical people depicted in the poems. For instance, King Ermenric (*Hermanaricus*) of the Gots reigned from ca. 296–376 AD, while King Attle (*Attila*) of the Huns lived from ca. 406–453 AD.

Some of the events depicted do, however, appear to have old kernels of truth. The trampling of Swanhild and the revenge taken by her two brothers Hamthew and Sarle, for instance, is found in essentially the same form in Jordanes, *Getica*, and is quite likely to be a genuine folk-memory (see Introduction to *Ghv*). The fall of the Burgends or Burgundians, led by King Guther (*Gundaharius*), at the hands of Hunnish mercenaries, is likewise historical.

It is of note that the historical basis is lost more and more as the tradition progresses. In the linguistically archaic *Akv*, which depicts the fall of King Guther and Hawn at the hands of King Attle, the conflict is still portrayed as an ethnic conflict between the Gots (or Burgends) and the Huns. In the younger *Am* and in most of the other heroic poetry in this section, this remaining political awareness is totally lost, replaced by a fabricated familiar conflict.

## Other legendary sources

Outside of **R**, the poetry found in the present section is attested directly in three Norse sources: *Vǫls*, *Norn*, and *Skm*. Outside of these three texts, there

are various other sources, both Norse and more broadly Germanic, that attest the underlying narratives for the poems.

### The Saw of the Walsings

The main Norse source for the Walsing-cycle is the *Vǫlsunga saga* 'Saw of the Walsings' (*Vǫls*). This text is a prosimetrum largely derived from the heroic half of **R**. *Vǫls* cites a total of 30 stanzas from four poems, and paraphrases many more.

Although much of *Vǫls* is directly paraphrased from the heroic poems of **R**, its redactor did not merely cobble together the poetry that was in front of him. Instead, he has made an attempt to combine the often conflicting and chronologically overlapping poems into a unified chronological prose narrative, sometimes rather creatively (e.g., in his handling of the contradictions between *Akv* and *Am*). He also appears to have relied on texts never included in **R**, especially for the lives of Syemund and Walsing, Siward's father and grandfather, respectively. To a lesser extent, there appears to be influence from Low German epic sources.

### The Matter of Scaldship

*Skáld-skapar mál* (*Skm*) is the second book of the Prose Edda. In order to explain a number of kennings, chapters 46–49 summarise the entire Walsing-cycle and cite two stanzas from *Fáfn*.

### The Strand of Norn-Guest

*Norna-Gests þáttr* (*Norn*) is a short prose narrative embedded in the larger saw of King Anlaf Trueson. In it, the eponymous Norn-Guest, tells various legends of which he supposedly has first-hand experience. Of relevance to us are its summaries of and substantial citations from the poems *Reg* and *Helr*.

### German material

Niebelungenlied and other german stories.

### Old English sources

The earliest story for the wyrm-slaying narrative is in fact found in the early 8th c. OE poem *Beow*, ll. 875–900. In this text it is not Siward, but instead his father Syemund, who slays the Wyrm and takes its treasure. Syemund is called a Walsing (OE *Wælsing*, 877) and "the son of Walse" (OE *Wælses afará*, 897), which is clearly a more original name for the Norse Walsing (ON *Vǫlsungr*, which is in fact a back-formation from the clan name *Vǫlsungar* 'Walsings', who are originally the descendants of **Vǫlsi*). Siward is not named, but Syemund is said to have gone on ettin-slaying adventures with his nephew Fittle (OE *Fitulá*), who is equivalent to the Norse Sinfittle (ON *Sin·fjǫtli*).

Although the attestation in *Beow* is a story within a story and not very detailed, we are still able to glean that at least one strand of the Walsing-cycle narrative was important in Anglo-Saxon England around 700 AD. The poet's bestowal of praise on Syemund, who is called the "most widely renowned of adventures among mankind for deeds of valour ..." (898–900), indicates that the narrative had already acquired a unique significance.

TODO: Neidorf (2013) and Old English names likely deriving from the cycle.

#### Pictorial evidence

Siward's slaying of Fathomer and Rein is depicted on the Ramsund carving (fig. 9, 536). Guther's torture in the snake-pit is one of the images found on the portal to the Hylestad stave church (fig. 11, 673).

TODO.

## The poems

The present section contains eighteen poems found in **R** and six fragments found in **N**. Unlike the mythological poetry in **R**, the order of its heroic poems follows a clear plan.

The first three poems (*1 HHund*, *HHj*, *2 HHund*) deal chiefly with the heroes Hallow Harwardson and Hallow Hundingsbane, of whom the latter is believed to be a reincarnation of the former. Hallow Hundingsbane is said to be the son of Syemund the Walsing and Burhild, which ties these poems to the rest of the Walsing-Cycle.

The following four poems (*Gríp*, *Reg*, *Fáfn*, *Sigrdr*) narrate the youth and early successes of Siward Syemundson. The latter three form a continuous narrative and are better read as a single prosimetrum than as three individual poems (cf. Introduction to *Reg*). After *Sigrdr*, there follows the so-called Great Lacuna (*Vǫlsbr*); the poetry therein would, however, have dealt with Siward's marriage to Guthrun and his betrayal of Byrnhild.

The next four poems (*Brot*, *1 Guðr*, *Sigsk*, *Helr*) deal with Siward's death at the hands of his in-laws, the Yivickings, and the ramifications on his unwitting wife, Guthrun, and on Byrnhild.

The next five poems (*2 Guðr*, *3 Guðr*, *Oddr*, *2 Guðr*, *Akv*, *Am*) jump forwards in time to after Guthrun's second marriage to King Attle. The section culminates in Attle's death at the hands of Guthrun.

The last two poems (*Ghv*, *Hamð*) deal with Guthrun's sons taking revenge for Swanhild, her only daughter with Siward.

### Short summaries

*I Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana* ('**The First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane**', *1 HHund*) deals with the life of Hallow Hundingsbane, his romance with the walkirrie Syerun, and his vanquishing of his enemies of Hathbrod and Hunding.

*Hęlga kviða Hjǫr·varðs sonar* (‘**The Lay of Hallow Harwardson**’, *HHj*) is a prosimetrum. It jumps back in time and describes the life and death of Hallow Harwardson and his romance with the walkirrie Sweve (the earlier reincarnations of Hallow Hundingsbane and Syerun); this poem is the earliest in the Walsing-Cycle chronology.

*II Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana* (‘**The Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane**’, *2 HHund*) is a prosimetrum about the life of Hallow Hundingsbane and his romance with Syerun, beginning with his birth and ending with his return as a ghost in order to take farewell to Syerun.

*Grípis spǫ́* (‘**The Spae of Griper**’, *Gríp*) tells of the fate of Syemund and Sinfittle; it then introduces Siward Syemundson and sees him hear a prophecy about his own life from his uncle Griper.

*Reginn mǫ́l* (‘**The Speeches of Rein**’, *Reg*) is the first of a sequence of three prosimetra dealing with Siward’s life. Siward takes instruction from the dwarven smith Rein, who tells him about the origin of Fathomer’s hoard; Siward then avenges his father and lethally wounds the wyrm Fathomer.

*Fáfnis mǫ́l* (‘**The Speeches of Fathomer**’, *Fáfn*) follows as Siward speaks with the dying Fathomer, who warns him against taking his treasure; Siward does so anyways. The hero inadvertently gets a taste of Fathomer’s heart-blood and learns the speech of birds; they warn him that Rein is plotting against him. Siward kills him, takes the hoard, and follows the birds to the sleeping walkirrie Syedrive.

*Sigr·drífu mǫ́l* (‘**The Speeches of Syedrive**’, *Sigrdr*) sees Siward free the sleeping Syedrive or Byrnhild; she teaches him runic magic and gives him important advice.

The text cuts off with the *Great Lacuna*; I have therefore inserted seven “**Fragments from the Walsing-Cycle**” (*Vǫlsbr*). This poetry deals with Siward’s disguise as Guther, his wooing of Byrnhild, and Guthrun’s revealing of the deception to Byrnhild.

*Brot af Sig·urðar kviða* (‘**The Fragment of a Lay of Siward**’, *Brot*) continues the narrative and describes how Byrnhild instigates her husband, Guther, to murder Siward; Byrnhild then chastises Guther for his betrayal of his brother-in-law and describes Siward’s loyalty towards him.

*I Guð·rúnar kviða* (‘**The First Lay of Guthrun**’, *1 Guðr*) describes the impact of Siward’s death on his wife, Guthrun, as three noble ladies try to make her weep and release her pent-up sorrows; the third one shows her Siward’s body; Guthrun at last weeps and laments his death. She curses her brother Guther and Siward’s wife Byrnhild. Byrnhild blames her brother Attle and says that she will not live long; fires burn from her eyes when she looks at Siward’s body.

*Sig·urðar kviða in skamma* (‘**The Short Lay of Siward**’, *Sigsk*) tells how Byrnhild incited Guther and Hawn to murder Siward and how they got their younger brother, Godthorm, to do the deed. The majority of the poem deals with Byrnhild in the aftermath of the killing; sacrifices a number of her handmaids and servants and then commits suttee by disembowelment in order to follow Siward on the pyre; as she lies dying, Byrnhild foresees Guthrun’s tragic future.

*Hęl-ręið Bryn·hildar* (‘**The Hell-ride of Byrnhild**’, *Helr*) follows Byrnhild after she has been burned on the pyre; on the way through the Underworld she encounters a troll-woman who upbraids her for her cruelty; Byrnhild responds by explaining her actions.

*II Guð·rúnar kviða* (‘**The Second Lay of Guthrun**’, *2 Guðr*) is a dirge told by Guthrun after she has been married off to Attle. She recounts the loss of her first husband, Siward, and her second marriage to Attle. The poem concludes as Guthrun relates Attle’s prophetic dreams about how she will murders him and her sons.

*III Guð·rúnar kviða* (‘**The Third Lay of Guthrun**’, *3 Guðr*) sees Guthrun accused of adultery by Attle’s maidservant, Herch. Guthrun is proven innocent and Herch is drowned.

*Odd·rúnar grátr* (‘**The Weeping of Ordrun**’, *Oddr*) describes how Ordrun, Guther’s lover and Attle’s sister, helps a young woman named Burgny give birth; after this, Ordrun relates her tragic love for Guther and her inability to prevent his death at the hands of Attle.

*Atla kviða* (‘**The Lay of Attle**’, *Akv*) tells how King Attle invites Guther and Hawn to his court under the guise of giving them treasure; instead, he betrays and murders them by cutting the heart from Hawn and putting Guther in the snake-pit. Guthrun avenges her brothers by murdering their two sons and feeding them to Attle; she then burns him and his host alive in the hall.

*Atla mǫl in grǿn-lęndsku* (‘**The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle**’, *Am*) tells the same narrative as *Akv* in an elaborated and younger form; in this poem, the wives of Guther and Hawn have prophetic dreams warning them, and although Guthrun kills Attle, she does not burn the hall.

*Guð·rúnar hvǫt* (‘**The Instigation of Guthrun**’, *Ghv*) takes place later on. After Guthrun murdered Attle and her sons, she tried to drown herself; instead she was carried by the waves to King Enacker, where she raised her daughter by Siward, Swanhild, and begot two new sons. Swanhild was married off to King Ermenric, who had her trampled to death by horses after she was seduced by his son. Guthrun incites her two sons to avenge their sister; they set out to do so. Guthrun prepares a pyre for herself and makes a speech; she will at last commit suttee and follow Siward.

*Ham·ðis mǫl* (‘**The Speeches of Hamthew**’, *Hamð*) depicts the same events as *Ghv*, but follows the sons of Guthrun and Enacker as they set out to murder King Ermenric and avenge their sister. On the way the two boys meet their half-brother by Enacker; he offers to help them, but they kill him instead. They get to Ermenric and cut off his hands and feet, but the king survives long enough to call out to his troops to stone the lads; they regret the killing of their half-brother before they die.

## Table of manuscripts

The following table shows the manuscript attestation for the included poems and their position in **R**. A *q* represents one or more stanzas attested in quotation. *Skm* is attested in 7 manuscripts; see the Introduction to Eddic poetry. TODO: tabulate all. *Norn* is attested in TODO manucripts. For

more precise details, see the section "Textual preservation and transmission" in the Introduction to each poem.

| Signum | **R** | **N** | *Skm* | *Norn* |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| *1 HHund* | 12 | – | – | – |
| *HHj* | 13 | – | – | – |
| *2 HHund* | 14 | – | – | – |
| *Grí̜p* | 15 | – | – | – |
| *Reg* | 16 | *q* | – | *q* |
| *Fǎfn* | 17 | – | *q* | – |
| *Sigrdr* | 18 | *q* | – | – |
| *Vǫlsbr* (Lacuna) | – | 6 sts. | – | – |
| *Brot* | 19 | – | – | – |
| *1 Guðr* | 20 | – | – | – |
| *Sigsk* | 21 | – | – | – |
| *Helr* | 22 | – | – | *q* |
| *2 Guðr* | 23 | *q* | – | – |
| *3 Guðr* | 24 | – | – | – |
| *Oddr* | 25 | – | – | – |
| *Akv* | 26 | – | – | – |
| *Am* | 27 | – | – | – |
| *Ghv* | 28 | – | – | – |
| *Hamð* | 29 | *q* | – | – |

# First Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane
# *(I Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C12th (0.805)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

This rather late poem is well written. Particularly beautiful are the introductory stanzas, which tell of Norns arriving in the night to predetermine Hallow's life.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*1 HHund* is only preserved in **R** (on foll. 20r/20–22r/3), where it follows the mythological *Alv* and is followed by the heroic *HHj*.

*1 HHund* is the first poem of the heroic section of **R**, consisting of *1 HHund–Hamð*. As discussed in the Introduction to Eddic Poetry above, the heroic section of **R** clearly forms a distinct paleographic group from the mythological section consisting of *Vsp–Alv* (Lindblad 1980, esp. pp. 160–163). Although both sections of **R** are written by the same hand, the orthographic distinctions are so clear that they have likely been copied out of separate manuscripts, and *1 HHund* would appear to have been the first poem of it. This also explains the poem's unusually long title and the great size of its initial letter (Lindblad 1980, p. 166).

It is further notable that the three Hallow-poems (*1 HHund*, *HHj*, *2 HHund*) form a paleographic subdivision within the heroic section of **R**, although *1 HHund* somewhat deviates from the latter two poems (Lindblad 1980)[151–153, 161], which, "as far as the orthography goes, form most homogenous group of poems in **R**" (Lindblad 1980, p. 153).

### Meter and stanza

Unlike the two other Hallow-poems, *1 HHund* is a true poem rather than a prosimetrum. The meter throughout is Ancient-words-lay, of a strict variety.

TODO: Males Hiatus article.

The poem consists of 228 long-lines across 56 stanzas. The most common length of the stanza is 4 lines (41/56: 1–14, 16–18, 21–24, 27, 29–31, 33–35, 37–38, 40, 42–47, 49, 52, 54–55), which are generally clearly divided into two helmings (i.e., semantic groups of 2 lines). Other represented line counts are 5 (6/56: 15, 26, 41, 48, 51, 56), 3 (19, 25, 28, 32), 6 (36, 50, 53), and 2 (20, 39).

It must be noted that all three stanzas with 6 lines can be split up into two stanzas of 4 and 2 lines each (36/1–2 and 3–6, 50/1–4 and 5–6, 53/1–2 and 3–6). On the other hand, the stanzas of 5 lines generally have the "fifth" line tacked-on to the first or second helming as a form of emphasis, parallelism, or repetition, e.g., 41/5.

## Language and style

The three Hallow-poems display a few common linguistic and stylistic peculiarities. In particular, the two poetic words *buðlungr* 'ruler, chieftain', lit. 'descendant of Budle' and *dǫglingr* 'id.', lit. 'descendant of Day' are used with an unparallelled frequency for Eddic poetry. Outside of the Hallow-poems, *buðlungr* only appears in one other poem in **R**, *Akv* 46/4, but there in its etymological sense, namely 'the clan of Budle', Attle's father. On the other hand, the word appears 4 times in *1 HHund*, 6 times in *HHj*, and 2 times in *2 HHund*. *dǫglingr* only otherwise appears in *1 Guðr* 14/2, but appears 3 times in *1 HHund* and 2 times in *2 HHund*. Both words are common in Scaldic poetry and originally derive from a generalisation of originally specific clan-names, and so their inclusion in these poems ought to be seen as a sign of Scaldic influence, probably pointing to a late date of composition. Both words also figure in likely antiquarian Eddic poetry, e.g., in *Grot* 19/4, along with several stanzas edited in SkP 8.

## Text

**P1** **Hér hefr upp kvęði frá Helga Hundings bana, þeira ok Hǫð·brodds.**
2 **Vǫlsunga kviða.**

**Here begins a lay about Hallow, the bane of Hunding and his men, and of Hathbrod. A lay of the Walsings.**

---

ALL | *The unusually long title of the poem is also introduced by a particularly large initial, otherwise only parallelled by* Vsp *1 in* **R**.

---

**1** Ár vas alda · þat's arar gullu [R 20r/21]
2 hnigu hęilǫg vǫtn · af Himin-fjǫllum;
þá hafði Hęlga · inn hugum stóra
4 Borg·hildr borit · í Brá-lundi.

It was early of ages when eagles shrieked;
holy waters poured down from the Heavenfells;
then to Hallow, the great of heart,
Burhild in Browlund had given birth.

---

1 Ár vas alda 'It was early of ages' | This formulaic introduction immediately situates the events of the poem in the distant mytho-heroic past, indeed, if one compares *Vsp* 3/1 where the same line occurs, at the beginning of history.

1 arar gullu 'eagles shrieked' | In celebration of the birth of a great warrior to feed them. Cf. TODO (beasts of battle motif).

**2** Nǫtt varð í bý, · nornir kvómu, [R 20r/23]
2 þęr's ǫðlingi · aldr of skópu;
þann bǫðu fylki · frégstan verða
4 ok buðlunga · bętstan þykkja.

It turned night in the settlement; norns arrived,
they who shaped the athling's age.
They bade that battle-arrayer become the noblest
and among princes seem the best.

**3** Snøru þęr af afli · ør·lǫg-þǫttu [R 20r/25]
2 þá's borgir braut · í Brá-lundi;
þęr of gręiddu · gollin-símu
4 ok und mána sal · miðjan fęstu.

They turned with strength the orlay-strands
when castles were broken in Browlund.

They arranged a golden cord
and beneath the middle of the moon's hall [SKY/HEAVEN] fastened it.

---

1 ør·lǫg-þǫ́ttu 'orlay-strands' | The strands of men's destinies. The likeness with strings of fabric is notable since it has a close parallel to the role of the Greek Μοῖραι, the three weavers of fate. Cf. the semantically identical cpd. *ør·lǫg-síma* in *Reg* 14/4.

**4** Þ́ér austr ok vestr · ę́nda fǫ́lu, [R 20r/27]
2 þar átti lofðungr · land á milli,
brá nipt Nera · á norðr-vega
4 ę́inni fę́sti, · ę́y bað hǫ́n halda.

In the east and west they hid its ends;
there the praised man owned land in between.
The kinswoman of Nare [NORN] pulled onto the northern ways
a single strand—she bade it hold for ever.

**5** Ę́itt vas at angri · Ylfinga nið [R 20r/29]
2 *ok* þę́iri mę́yju · es mun-úð føddi;
hrafn kvað at hrafni, · sat á hǫ́m męiði
4 and·vanr ǫ́tu: · „Ek vę́it nǫkkut!

TODO.
TODO.
Quoth quoth raven to raven; it sat on a high branch,
starved of food: "I know something!

---

2 *ok* | er **R**

**6** Stę́ndr í brynju · burr Sig·mundar, [R 20r/31]
2 døgrs ę́ins gamall, · nú 's dagr kominn!
Hvę́ssir augu · sem hildingar,
4 sá's varga vinr, · vit skulum tę́itir!"

In his byrnie stands Syemund's son,
a half-day old; now the day is come!
He sharpens his eyes like do men of war;
that one is a friend of wolves; we shall be merry!"

**7** Drótt þótti sá · dǫglingr vera, [R 20r/33]
2 kvǫ́ðu með gumnum · ár *of* kominn;
sjalfr gekk vísi · ór víg-þrimu
4 ungum fóra · ítr-lauk grami.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

---

2 *of* | *om.* **R**

**8** Gaf hann Hęlga nafn · ok Hring-staði, [R 20v/2]
Sól-fjǫll, Snę́-fjǫll · ok Sig·ars-vǫllu,
Hring-stǫð, Hǫ́-tún · ok Himin-vanga,
blóð-orm búinn · bróðr Sin·fjǫtla.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**9** Þá nam at vaxa · fyr vina brjósti [R 20v/4]
almr ítr-borinn · ynðis ljóma.
Hann galt ok gaf · goll verðungu,
sparði ęigi hilmir · hodd blóð-rekin.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
the helmet-bearer did not withhold the blood-spattered hoard.

**10** Skammt lét vísi · vígs at bíða [R 20v/6]
þá's fylkir vas · fimm-tán vetra
ok hann harðan lét · Hunding veginn,
þann's lęngi réð · lǫndum ok þegnum.

TODO.
TODO.
and he let slay the hard Hunding
who long had ruled lands and thanes.

**11** Kvǫddu síðan · Sig·mundar bur [R 20v/8]
auðs *ok* hringa · Hundings synir
því't þęir ǫ́ttu · jǫfri at gjalda
fjár-nám mikit · ok fǫður dauða.

TODO.
TODO.

TODO.
the great theft of wealth and their father's death.

**12** Lét=at buðlungr · bótir uppi [R 20v/10]
né niðja in hęldr · nęf-gjǫld fàa;
vǫ́n kvað hann myndu · veðrs ins mikla
grára gęira · ok grępi Óðins.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
grey spears and the wrath of Weden.

**13** Fara hildingar · hjǫr-stefnu til, [R 20v/12]
þęirar's lǫgðu · at Loga-fjǫllum;
slęit Fróða-frið · fjánda à milli,
fara Viðris gręy · val-gjǫrn umb ęy.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
Withrer's hounds [WOLVES] go corpse-eager around the island.

**14** Sętti=sk vísi, · þà's vegit hafði [R 20v/14]
Ǫ́lf ok Ęyj·ólf, · und Ara-stęini,
Hjǫr·varð ok Hǫ́·varð, · Hundings sonu;
farit hafði hann allri · ętt gęir-Mímis.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
he had destroyed all the line of the spear-Mimer [ETTIN].

**15** Þà brá ljòma · af Loga·fjǫllum [R 20v/16]
ęn af þęim ljòmum · lęiptrir kvǫ́mu;
þà vas und hjǫlmum · à Himin·vanga;
brynjur vǫ́ru þęira · blóði stokknar,
ęn af gęirum · gęislar stóðu.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

TODO.

5 gęirum | ‘geiror’ **R**

**16** Frá ár=liga · ór ulf-íði [R 20v/18]
dǫglingr at því · dísir suð-rønar
ef þér vildi hęim · með hildingum
þá nǫtt fara; · þrymr vas alma.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**17** En af hęsti · Hǫgna dóttir, [R 20v/20]
—líddi randa rym— · ręsi sagði:
„Hygg at vér ęigim · aðrar sýslur
an með baug-brota · bjór at drekka.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**18** Hęfir mínn faðir · męyju sínni [R 20v/22]
grimmum hęitit · Gran·mars syni;
en ek hęfi, Hęlgi, · Hǫð·brodd kveðinn
konung ò·nęisan · sem kattar son.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**19** Þá kømr fylkir · fára nátta [R 20v/24]
nema hǫnum vísir · val-stefnu til
eða męy nemir · frá mildingi.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**20** „Uggi ęigi þú · Ísungs bana! [R 20v/26]

Fyrr mun dolga dynr · nema dauðr s*éa*'k!“

TODO.
TODO.

**21** Sęndi ǫ́ru · all-valdr þaðan [R 20v/27]
of lopt ok of lǫg · lęiðar at biðja,
ið-gnógan · ógnar ljóma
brǫgnum bjóða · ok burum þęira.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**22** „Biðið skjót=liga · til skipa ganga [R 20v/29]
ok ór Brand-ęyju · búna verða!“
Þaðan bęið þęngill · und's þing kvómu
halir hund-margir · ór Hęðins-ęyju.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**23** Ok þar af strǫndu*m* · ór Stafns-nęsi [R 20v/31]
bęit hans út skriðu · ok búin golli;
spurði Hęlgi · Hjǫr·lęif at því:
Hęfir þú kannaða · koni ò·nęisa?

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**24** En ungr konungr · ǫ̃rum sagði, [R 20v/33]
sęint kvað at tęlja · af Trǫnu-ęyri
lang-hǫfðuð skip · und líðǫndum,
þau's í Ǫrva-sund · útan fóru:

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**25** „Tolf hundruð · tryggra manna; [R 21r/2]
þó 's í Hǫ́-túnum · hǫlfu fleira,
víg-lið konungs; · vǫ́n erum rómu!“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**26** Svá brá stýrir · stafn-tjǫldum af [R 21r/3]
at mildinga · męngi vakði,
ok dǫglingar · dags-brún séa,
ok siklingar · snøru upp við tré
vef-nistingum · á Varins-firði.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**27** Varð ára ymr · ok járna glymr, [R 21r/6]
brast rǫnd við rǫnd, · røru víkingar;
ęisandi gekk · und ǫ́ðlingum
lofðungs floti · lǫndum fjarri.

There was splashing of oars and clashing of swords;
shield struck against shield—the Wikings rowed.
TODO.
TODO.

---

1 járna 'swords' | The contracted form is metrically preferred. TODO.

**28** Svá vas at hęyra · es saman kvómu [R 21r/8]
Kólgu systir · ok kilir langir
sem bjǫrg eða brim · brotna myndi.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**29** Draga bað Helgi · hǫ́ segl ofarr, [R 21r/9]
varð=at hrǫnnum · hǫfn þing-loga,
þá's ógur=lig · Ęgis dóttir

stag-stjórn-mǫrum · stęypa vildi.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**30** En þęim sjǫlfum · Sig·rún ofan [R 21r/11]
folk-djǫrf of barg · ok fari þęira,
snørisk ramm-liga · Rǫn ór hęndi
gjalfr-dýr konungs · at Gnipa-lundi.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**31** Svá't þar umb aptan · í Una-vǫgum, [R 21r/13]
flaust fagr-búin · fljóta knǫttu,
ęn þęir sjalfir · frá Svarins-haugi
með hęrmðar hug · hęr kǫnnuðu.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**32** Frá goð-borinn · Guð·mundr at því: [R 21r/15]
„Hvęrr 's land-reki · sá's liði stýrir
ok hann fękna-lið · fǫrir at landi?“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**33** Sin·fjǫtli kvað, · slǫng upp við rǫ [R 21r/17]
rauðum skildi, · rǫnd vas ór golli;
þar vas sund-vǫrðr · sá's svara kunni
ok við ǫðlinga · orðum skipta:

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
and with athlings bandy words.

**34** „Sęg þat ǐ aptan, · es svínum gefr [R 21r/19]
ok tíkr yðrar · tęygir at solli,
at sé Ylfingar · austan komnir
gunnar gjarnir · frá Gnipa-lundi.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**35** Þar mun Hǫð·broddr · Hęlga finna, [R 21r/21]
flug-trauðan gram · ǐ flota miðjum,
sá's opt hęfir · ǫrnu sadda,
meðan þú á kvernum · kysstir þýjar.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**36** „Fátt mant, fylkir, · fornra spjalla [R 21r/23]
es þú ǫðlingum · ǫ·sǫnnu bregðr!
Þú hęfir etnar · ulfa krásir
ok bróðr þǐnum · at bana orðit,
opt sǫr sogin · með svǫlum munni,
hęfr ǐ hręysi · hvar-lęiðr skriðit!“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**37** „Þú vast vǫlva · ǐ Varins-ęyju, [R 21r/26]
skoll-vís kona, · bart skrǫk saman;
kvaðst ęngi mann · ęiga vilja,
sęgg brynjaðan, · nema Sin·fjǫtla!

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**38** „Þú vart in skǫ́ða,“ (kvað) „skass, val-kyrja, [R 21r/28]
ǫtul, á·máttlig, · at Al-fǫður;
mundu ęin-hęrjar · allir bęrja=sk,
své-vís kona, · of sakar þínar!

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**39** Níu ǫ́ttu*m* vit · á nęsi Sǫ́gu [R 21r/30]
ulfa alna, · ek vas ęinn faðir þęira!“

TODO.
TODO.

**40** „Faðir vas=at-tu · fęnris-ulfa, [R 21r/31]
ǫllum ęllri, · svá’t ek muna,
síðst þik gęldu · fyr Gnipa-lundi
þursa męyjar · á Þórs-nęsi!

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**41** Stjúpr vast Sig·gęirs, · látt und stǫðum hęima, [R 21r/33]
varg-ljóðum vanr · á viðum úti;
kvǫ́mu þér ó·gǫgn · ǫll at hęndi
þá’s bróðr þínum · brjóst raufaðir;
gørðir þik frégjan · af firin-verkum!

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**42** Þú vart brúðr Grana · á Brá-velli, [R 21v/3]
goll-bitluð vart · gǫr til rásar,
hafða’k þér móðri · margt skęið riðit
svangri und sǫðli, · simul, for·bergis!“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**43** „Svęinn þóttir þú · sið-lauss vesa [R 21v/5]
þá's þú Gollnis · gęitr molkaðir
ęn í annat sinn · Imðar dóttir
tǫttrug-hypja; · vill þú tǫlu lengri?“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**44** „Fyrr vilda ek · at Freka-stęini [R 21v/7]
hrafna sęðja · á hréum þínum
en tíkr yðrar · tęygja at solli
eða gefa gǫltum; · dęili grǫm við þik!“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**45** „Vęri ykkr, Sin·fjǫtli,“ (kvað) „sómra myklu [R 21v/9]
gunni at hęyja · ok glaða ǫrnu
an sé ó·nýtum · orðum at bręgðask
þó'tt hring-brotar · hęiptir dęili.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**46** Þikkja-t mér góðir · Gran·mars synir, [R 21v/11]
þó dugir siklingum · satt at męla;
þęir hafa markat · á Móins-heimum,
at hug hafa · hjǫrum at bręgða.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

TODO.

**47** Þęir af ríki · rinna létu [R 21v/13]
Svipuð ok Svęgjuð · Sól-hęima til,
dala dǫgg-ótta, · døkkvar hlíðir,
skalf Mistar marr · hvar's męgir fóru.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**48** Móttu þęir tiggja · í tùn-hliði,
sǫgðu stríð=liga · stilli kvómu.
Úti stóð Hǫð·broddr · hjalmi faldinn,
hugði hann jó-ręið · ęttar sinnar:
„Hví 's hęrmðar litr · á Hniflungum?“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

3 Hǫð·broddr | *creatively corr. in same hand from* Bǫð·vildr *'Beadhild' (due to influence from the nearby* Vkv*; see Males 2024a, p. 159)* **R**.

5 Hniflungum | This is the only attestation of *hniflungr* rather than *niflungr* in **R** (*'hniflungom'*), but the inital *h* is also metrically necessary in *Ghv* 12/3.

**49** „Snúa=sk hér at sandi · snęfgir kjólar, [R 21v/18]
rakka hirtir · ok ráar langar,
skildir margir, · skafnar árar,
gǫfugt lið gylfa, · glaðir Ylfingar.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**50** Ganga fimm-tán · folk upp á land, [R 21v/20]
þó 's í Sogn út · sjau þúsundir,
liggja hér í grindum · fyr Gnipa-lundi
brim-dýr blá-svǫrt · ok búin golli.

Þar ’s miklu męst · męngi þęira;
mun=a nú Hęlgi · hjǫr-þing dvala.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**51** „Rinni raukn bitluð · til ręgin-þinga [R 21v/23]
ęn Spor·vitnir · at Sparins-hęiði.
Mėlnir ok Mýlnir · til myrk-viðar;
látið ęngi mann · ęptir sitja
þęira ’s bęn-logum · bręgðа kunni!

“Let the bridled beasts [HORSES] run to the mighty things [BATTLES],
but Spurwitner to Sparnsheath,
and Milner and Melner to Mirkwood.
Let no man remain behind
of those who can brandish wound-flames [SWORDS]!

---

2 Spor·vitnir ‘Spurwitner’ | Otherwise unattested legendary horse, perhaps made up by the poet himself.

3 Mėlnir ok Mýlnir ‘Milner and Melner’ | Likewise unattested horses. *Mėlnir* is formed from *mėl* ‘bridle-bit’; *Mýlnir* is etymologically unclear.

**52** Bjóðið ér Hǫgna · ok Hrings sonum, [R 21v/25]
Atla ok Yngva, · Ǫlf inum gamla;
þęir ’ro gjarnir · gunni at hęyja;
lǫtum Vǫlsunga · viðr-nàm fàa!“

Summon Hawn and the sons of Ring:
Attle and Ing and Atholf the Old.
They are eager to wage war;
let us make the Walsings face resistance!”

**53** Svipr ęinn vas þat · es saman kvǫmu [R 21v/27]
fǫlvir oddar · at Freka-stęini;
ęy var Hęlgi · Hundings bani
fyrstr í folki · þar’s firar bǫrðu=sk,
óstr à ími, · all-trauðr flugar;
sá hafði hilmir · hart móð-akarn.

It was an unequaled clash when the pale
spear-points came together at Freakstone.
For ever was Hallow Hundingbane
the first in the troop where menfolk fought,
enraged in the struggle, full shy of flight;
that helmet-bearer had a hard courage-acorn [HEART].

**54** Kvǫ́mu þar ór himni · hjalm-vitr ofan, [R 21v/30]
—óx gǫ́ira gnýr— · þǫ́r's grami hlífðu;
þá kvað þat Sig·rún, · sár-vitr flugar,
át hǫ́lu skǫ́r · af Hugins barri:

There, from the heaven, helmet-wights came down,
they who shielded the lord—the din of spears grew.
Then this quoth Syerun, the wound-wight [WALKIRRIE] in flight—
the troll-woman's steed [WOLF] ate from the corn of Highen [CORPSES]:

3 flugar | fluga **R** 4 hǫ́lu | hǫlða *'men's'* **R**

ALL | Sts. 54–56: The walkirrie Syerun, Hallow's wife, descends from heaven in order to grant Hallow the victory.

3 sár-vitr flugar 'the wound-wight [WALKIRRIE] in flight' | The reading of **R** must be emended, but there are two possibilities which produce varying senses of this verse. (1) The one adopted here sees a description of Syerun, namely as a walkirrie in flight (lit. 'in flight', *flugar* being the gen. sg.). (2) Another possibility is emending to *flug*u, 3pl. past 'flew', in which case this would be a parenthetical statement 'the wound-wights [WALKIRRIES] flew' (as in l. 2a and l. 4), with the subject *sár-vitr* in the nom. pl. Note that *sár-vitr* 'wound-wight(s)' is morphologically ambiguous and can be both in the singular or plural.

4 hǫ́lu skǫ́r 'the troll-woman's steed' | A wolf-kenning; it is unclear if the *hála* 'troll-woman' is Syerun, in which case she would be depicted as riding on a wolf.

4 hǫ́lu | The reading of **R**, *hǫlða* 'men's', appears to be a trivialisation; it does not make sense in context.

**55** „Hǫ́ill skalt, vísi, · virða njóta, [R 21v/33]
átt-stafr Yngva, · ok una lífi
es þú fǫ́llt hǫ́fir · inn flugar-trauða
jǫ́fur, þann's olli · Ǽgis dauða.

"Hale shalt thou, overseer, enjoy respect,
O progeny of Ing, and be content in life,
as thou hast slain the flight-unwilling
chieftain who causèd Eagre's death.

**56** Ok þér, buðlungr, · samir bǫ́ðvi vel [R 22r/1]
rauðir baugar · ok in ríkja mǫ́r;

hęill skalt, buðlungr, · bęðði njóta
Hǫgna dóttur · ok Hring-staða
sigrs ok landa; · þá's sókn lokit!“

And for thee, prince, are these both meet:
the red bighs and the powerful maiden.
Hale shalt thou, prince, enjoy both
Hawn's daughter and the Ringsteads:
victory and lands. Now the battle is over!”

# Lay of Hallow Harwardson
# *(Hęlga kviða Hjǫr·varðs-sonar)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.385)–late C11th (0.550)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay, Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Lay of Hallow Harwardson** (*HHj*) is a heroic prosimetrum and the second of the three Hallow-poems.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*HHj* is found only in **R**, on foll. 22r/4–24r/12, where it follows *1 HHund* and is followed by *2 HHund*.

As has been shown by Lindblad (1980, pp. 151–153), *HHj* forms a particularly close orthographic group with its fellow prosimetrum and neighbour, *2 HHund*. In fact, the two texts are so closely related orthographically that they appear to derive from a single source, which must have preceded the compilation of **R**.

### Meter and stanza

Like the following *2 HHund*, but unlike the preceding *1 HHund*, *HHj* is a prosimetrum that mixes prose with poetry in Ancient-words-lay and Leeds-meter.

The text consists of 10 prose passages and 43 stanzas. 24 stanzas (1–11, 31–43) are in Ancient-words-lay, and 18 stanzas (13–30) are in Leeds-meter. A single stanza (12) mixes meters, with its ll. 1–2 in Ancient-words-lay and 3–4 in Leeds-meter.

The most common line-length for the Ancient-words-lay stanzas is 4 (21/24: 1–4, 6–11, 31, 34–43). Other represented line lengths are 5 (5), 3 (32), and 6 (33).

Of the 18 pure Leeds-meter stanzas, the archetypal configuration *abc abc* is represented in 16/18 stanzas (13–25, 27, 29–30). St. 26 has *abc abcc abc* and 28 has *abc abcccc*.

The mixed st. 12 is of the type [*abab*] *abc*, where the bracketed lines are in Ancient-words-lay.

## Summary

Attle, the son of Earl Idmund, is spoken to by a bird. TODO.

The central part of the poem is taken up by a sexually charged dialogue between the heroes Attle and Hallow and the ettin-woman Rimegird, ending with the latter's turning to stone at daybreak (P6, 12–30).

## Text

### Frá Hjǫr·varði ok Sigr·linn ('From Harward and Syelind')

**P1** Hjǫr·varðr hét konungr; hann átti fjórar konur. Ein hét Alf·hildr; [R 22r/4]
sonr þeira hét Heðinn. Qnnur hét Sęr·eiðr; þeira sonr hét Humlungr. In þriðja hét Sin·rjóð; þeira sonr hét Hymlingr. Hjǫr·varðr konungr hafði þess heit strengt at eiga þá konu er hann vissi vęnsta. Hann spurði at Sváfnir konungr átti dóttur *allra fegrsta; sú hét Sigr·linn. Ið·mundr hét jarl hans; Atli var hans sonr, er fór at biðja Sigr·linnar til handa konungi. Hann dvalði=sk vetr-langt með Sváfni konungi. Frán·marr hét þar jarl, fóstri Sigr·linnar; dóttir hans hét Á·lǫf. Jarl'inn réð, at meyjar var synjat, ok fór jarl'inn heim. Atli jarls sonr stóð einn dag við lund nokkurn, en fugl sat í limu'num uppi yfir hánum, ok hafði heyrt til, at hans menn kǫlluðu vęnstar konur þęr, er Hjǫr·varðr konungr átti. Fugl'inn kvakaði, en Atli hlýddi hvat hann sagði. Hann kvað:

Harward was the name of a king; he had four wives. One was called Elfhild; their son was called Headen. The other was called Searhad; their son was called Humbling. The third was called Sindread; their son was called Himbling. King Harward had undertaken a boast to have the woman whom he knew to be the most handsome. He learned that King Swebner had a daughter fairest of all; she was called Syelind. Idmund was the name of his earl; Attle was his son, who journeyed to ask for Syelind's hand on behalf of the king. He stayed over the winter with King Swebner. Frenmar was the name of an earl there, the foster-father of Syelind; his daughter was called Anlave. The earl decided that the maiden was denied him, and the earl journeyed home. Attle, the earl's son, one day stood in a certain grove, but a bird sat in the branches above him and had overheard that his men said that the women which King Harward had were the most handsome. The bird twittered, and Attle listened to what he said. Quoth he:

5 *allra | 'vęnallra' **R**

Fugl kvað: **1** „Sátt þú Sigr·linn, · Sváfnis dóttur, [R 22r/16]
męyna fęgrstu · í munar-hęimi?
Þó hag=ligar · Hjǫr·varðs konur
gumnum þykkja · at Glasis-lundi."

Quoth the bird: "Hast thou seen Syelind, Swebner's daughter,
the fairest of maidens in the realm of love [WORLD],

even as Harward's wives seem pleasant
to the men in Glazerslund?"

Atli kvað: **2** „Munt við Atla · Ið·mundar son [R 22r/18]
2 fugl fróð-hugaðr · fleira méla?"
Fugl kvað: „Mun'k ef mik buðlungr · blóta vildi
4 ok kýs'k þat's ek vil · ór konungs garði."

Quoth Attle: "Wilt thou with Attle Idmund's son,
O wise-minded bird, speak yet more?"
Quoth the bird: "I will, if the chieftain would make a bloot for me
and I may choose what I wish from the house of the king."

Atli kvað: **3** „Kjós=at-tu Hjǫr·varð · né hans sonu [R 22r/20]
2 né inar fǫgru · fylkis brúðir,
ęigi brúðir · þér's buðlungr á;
4 kaupum vel saman, · þat 's vina kynni."

Quoth Attle: "Choose not Harward nor his sons,
nor the fair brides of the marshaller—
not the brides which the chieftain has!
Let us deal well together; that is the manner of friends."

Fugl kvað: **4** „Hof mun'k kjósa, · hǫrga marga, [R 22r/22]
2 goll-hyrnðar kýr · frá grams búi,
ef hǫnum Sigr·linn · søfr á armi
4 ok ó·nauðig · jǫfri fylgir."

Quoth the bird: "Hoves will I choose, many harrows,
golden-horned kine from the ruler's estate,
if Syelind will sleep on his arm
and without coercion follow the lord."

---

2 goll-hyrnðar kýr 'golden-horned kine' | Formulaic, also found in *Þrk* 23/1.

**P2** Þetta var áðr Atli fœri. En er hann kom heim ok konungr spurði [R 22r/24]
2 hann tíðinda, hann kvað:

This was before Attle journeyed. But when he came home and the king asked
him for the tidings, then quoth he:

**5** „Hǫfum ęrfiði · ok ękki ęyrendi; [R 22r/25]
2 mara þraut óra · á męgin-fjalli,

urðum síðan · Sę·morn vaða;
þá vas oss synjat · Sváfnis dóttur,
hringum gøddrar, · es vér hafa vildum.“

“We have a hardship and no errand.
Our steeds expired on the mighty fell;
thereafter we had to wade through Seamorn.
Then we were refused Swebner’s daughter,
endowed with rings, whom we wished to have.”

---

1 Hǫfum ęrfiði · ok ękki ęyręndi ‘We have a hardship and no errand’ | I.e., ‘we have had great struggle and got no results.’ A formulaic word-pair; cf. *Þrk* 10/1, 11/1.

**P3** Konungr bað at þeir skyldu fara annat sinn; fór hann sjálfr. En er þeir kómu upp á fjall ok sá á Sváfa-land lands-bruna ok jó-reyki stóra, reið konungr af fjalli’nu fram í land’it ok tók nátt-ból við á eina. Atli helt vǫrð ok fór yfir á’na. Hann fann eitt hús. Fugl mikill sat á húsi’nu ok gętti ok var sofnaðr. Atli skaut spjóti fugl’inn til bana en í húsi’nu fann hann Sigr·linn konungs dóttur ok Á·lǫfu jarls dóttur ok hafði þęr báðar braut með sér. Frán·marr jarl hafði hamat=sk í arnar líki ok varit þęr fyr her’num með fjǫl-kynngi. Hróð·marr hét konungr, biðill Sigr·linnar. Hann drap Sváfa-konung ok hafði rękt ok brennt land’it. Hjǫr·varðr konungr fekk Sigr·linnar en Atli Á·lǫfar. [R 22r/28]

The king bade that they should journey another time; he journeyed himself. But when they came up onto the fell and beheld upon Swebeland the singed land and the great dust-clouds from the horses, the king rode down from the fell forth into the land and took his night-lodgings by a river. Attle kept watch and journeyed over the river; he found a lone house. A great bird sat upon the house guarding it, and it had fallen asleep. Attle shot the bird to its death with a spear, but within the house he found Syelind, the king’s daughter, and Anlave, the earl’s daughter; and he took them both away with him. Earl Frenmar had shifted hames into the likeness of an eagle and had guarded them against the host with manicunningness. Rothmar was the name of a king, the suitor of Syelind. He had slain the king of the Swebes and had plundered and burned the land. King Harward got Syelind, but Attle got Anlave.

**P4** Hjǫr·varðr ok Sigr·linn áttu son mikinn ok vęnan. Hann var þǫgull; ekki nafn festi=sk við hann. Hann sat á haugi. Hann sá níða val-kyrjur níu ok var ein gǫfug=ligust. Hón kvað: [R 22v/5]

Harward and Syelind begot a son, large and handsome. He was silent; no name stuck to him. He sat on a mound. He saw nine walkirries riding, and

one was the most worshipful. Quoth she:

**6** „Síð munt, Hęlgi, · hringum ráða, [R 22v/7]
ríkr róg-apaldr, · né Rǫðuls-vǫllum,
—ǫrn gól ár=la— · ef þú ę́ þęgir,
þó'tt harðan hug, · hilmir, gjaldir.“

"Late wilt thou, Hallow, rule the rings
—O strong strife-apple-tree [WARRIOR]—or the Raddlewolds
—the eagle crowed in early morn—if thou art for ever silent,
even if thou hast a hard heart, O prince!"

1 Hęlgi 'Hallow' | The walkirrie here gives the silent boy his name, *Hęlgi* 'the Holy One'.

[Hęlgi] kvað: **7** „Hvat lętr fylgja · Hęlga nafni, [R 22v/9]
brúðr bjart-lituð, · alls bjóða rę́ðr?
Hygg fyr ǫllum · at·kvę́ðum vel;
þigg ęigi þat · nema þik hafa!“

Quoth [Hallow]: "What lettest thou follow Hallow's name
—O bright-faced bride—since thou dost offer it?
Think well ahead before all decisions;
I will accept nothing other than to have *thee*!"

ALL | It was customary to give a gift to a child along with their name as part of the so-called *nafnfęsti* 'name-fastening' (cf. *Origo Gentis Langobardorum* 1:12 n., in the Appendix to *Grm*). Since the walkirrie, Sweve, has just given Hallow his name, he asks her for such a gift; he will take none other than her hand.

[Sváfa] kvað: **8** „Sverð vęit'k liggja · í Sig·ars-holmi, [R 22v/11]
fjórum fę́ra · an fimm tǫgu;
ęitt es þęira · ǫllum bętra
víg-nesta bǫl · ok varit golli.

Quoth [Sweve]: "Swords I know lying in Sigarsholm:
four less than fifty.
One of them is better than all—
a bale of war-covers(?) [SHIELDS]—and it is covered with gold.

ALL | Instead of her hand, Sweve gives Hallow the location of an ancient sword.

**9** Hringr 's í hjalti, · hugr 's í miðju, [R 22v/13]
ógn 's í oddi, · þęim's ęiga getr;
liggr með ęggju · ormr dręyr-fáaðr

4 ęn á val-bǫstu · verpr naðr hala.“

A ring is on its hilt; heart is in the middle;
terror is in the point for him who gets to own it.
Along the edge lies a serpent painted in blood,
but on the walbast an adder eats its tail.”

---

1 Hringr ’s í hjalti ‘A ring is on its hilt’ | The sword is a so-called *ring-sword*. It was popular among Germanic warriors of the Migration Period to have oath-rings on their sword-hilts as a symbol of fidelity to their lords, but this custom was entirely extinct by ca. 700 AD (Nerman 1931, pp. 40–44). The detail thus serves to emphasise the exceptional age of the sword. It may also help us date at least this part of the poem, since it is rather unlikely that an Icelandic antiquarian of the 12th c. would have been aware of this circumstance, whereas a Norwegian of the 10th c. conceivably might. Cf. *Sigsk* 68, which probably also refers to a ring-sword. A well-preserved Norwegian ring-sword survives from Snartemo in Vest-Agder, dated to around 500 AD (object ID C26001); see Fig. 8.

4 val-bǫstu ‘walbast’ | An unclear part of the sword-hilt; this word also occurs in *Sigrdr* 6. TODO: Falk (1914).

**P5** Ey·limi hét konungr; dóttir hans var Sváfa. Hón var val-kyrja ok [R 22v/15]
2 reið lopt ok lǫg. Hón gaf Helga nafn þetta ok hlífði hánum opt síðan í orrustum. Helgi kvað:

Eanlime was the name of a king; his daughter was Sweve. She was a walkirrie and rode over air and sea. She gave Hallow this name and afterwards often



Figure 8: Hilt of the Snartemo sword, front and reverse. Migration period, ca. 500 AD. © Eirik Irgens Johnsen. CC BY-SA 4.0. `https://www.unimus.no/portal/#/photos/d8932af5-1082-4938-9b4b-ca6b86f2bdfb`

shielded him in battles. Quoth Hallow:

ALL | The prose informs us of the identity of the walkirrie with whom Hallow has just conversed.

**10** „Est=at, Hjǫr·varðr, · hęil-ráðr konungr, [R 22v/17]
folks odd-viti, · þó'tt frękr séir;
létst ęld eta · jǫfra byggðir
ęn þęir angr við þik · ękki gørðu.

"Thou art not, Harward, a king of wholesome counsel—
O point-knower of the host [WARRIOR]—although thou be renowned.
Thou didst let fire ravage the settlements of chieftains,
but they did no injury against thee.

**11** Ęn Hróð·marr skal · hringum ráða, [R 22v/19]
þęim es ǫ́ttu · ǫrir niðjar;
sá sé=sk fylkir · fęst at lífi,
hygg=sk al-dauðra · arfi at ráða."

But Rothmar shall rule the rings
which *our* kinsmen have owned.
That marshaller fears the fewest things in life;
he thinks he will rule the inheritance of the fully dead."

**P6** Hjǫr·varðr svaraði at hann myndi fá lið Helga ef hann vill hefna [R 22v/21]
móður-fǫður síns. Þá sótti Helgi sverð'it er Sváfa vísaði hánum
til. Þá fór h*a*nn ok Atli ok felldu Hróð·mar ok unnu mǫrg þrek-
virki. Hann drap Hata jǫtun er hann sat á bergi nokkuru. Helgi
ok Atli lágu skipum í Hata-firði. Atli helt vǫrð inn fyrra hlut
nętr'innar. Hrím·gerðr Hata dóttir kvað:

Harward answered that he would provide a troop for Hallow if he wished to avenge his mother's father. Then Hallow sought out the sword to which Sweve had shown him the way. Then he and Attle journeyed and slew Rothmar and accomplished many great deeds of strength. He slew the ettin Hate when he sat on a certain mountain. Hallow and Attle lay in their ships in Hate's firth; Attle kept watch during the first part of the night. Quoth Rimegird, Hate's daughter:

3 h*a*nn ok Atli | *sens. emend.;* hón ok Atli **R**

ALL | This prose passage introduces a long section of the poem, namely the dialogue between the heroes Attle and Hallow and the ettin-woman Rimegird, culminating in the latter's turning to stone at daybreak (sts. 12–30).

**12** „Hvęrir 'ro hǫlðar · í Hata-firði? [R 22v/27]

Skjǫldum es tjaldat · á skipum yðrum,
frękn=liga látið, · fátt hygg yðr séa=sk;
kęnnið mér nafn konungs!“

“Who are these heroes in Hate’s firth?
With shields it is canopied upon your ships;
ye bear yourselves bravely; I ween ye fear little.
Teach me the name of the king!”

---

ALL | With the second half of this stanza, the meter shifts from Ancient-words-lay to Leeds-meter. This meter continues throughout the rest of the section (sts. 12–30).

Atli kvað: **13** „Hęlgi hann hęitir · ęn þú hvęr=gi mátt [R 22v/29]
vinna grand grami,
éarn-borgir · ’ro umb ǫðlings flota,
knegu=t oss fǫlur fara.“

Quoth Attle: “Hallow is he called, but thou canst in no wise
accomplish harm against the chief.
Iron strongholds surround the athling’s floater;
no shrews can destroy us.”

**14** „Hvé þik hęitir,“ (kvað Hrim·gęrðr) „halr inn ám-áttki? [R 22v/31]
Hvé þik kalla konir?
Fylkir þér trúir · es þik í fǫgrum lętr
bęits stafni búa.“

“What art thou called,” quoth Rimegird, “O uncanny man—
what does mankind name thee?
The marshaller trusts thee when he lets thee stay
in the fair prow of the ship.”

[Atli kvað:] **15** „Atli ek hęiti, · atall skal’k þér vera, [R 22v/33]
mjǫk em’k gífrum gramastr;
úrgan stafn · ek hęfi opt búit
ok kvalðar kveld-riður.

[Quoth Attle:] “Attle I am called; I shall be terrible toward thee;
I am by far the cruelest to troll-hags.
In a drizzled prow I have often stayed
and tormented evening-rideresses.

---

1 atall ‘terrible’ | A pun; the name *Atli* ‘Attle’ is identical to *atli* ‘the terrible one’, weak masculine of the adj. *atall*.

**16** Hvé þú hęitir, · hála ná-grǫ́ðug? [R 23r/2]
Nęfn þinn, fála, fǫður;
níu rǫstum · es þú skyldir neðar vesa,
ok vaxi þér á baðmi barr!“

What art thou called, O corpse-greedy witch?
Name thy father, O shrew!
It is nine rests lower where thou oughtst to be,
and may grass grow on thy bosom!”

3 níu rǫstum · es þú skyldir neðar | *níu rǫstum … neðar ‘nine rests lower’*

3 níu rǫstum · es þú skyldir neðar | I.e., nine leagues below the earth.

[Hrím·gerðr kvað:] **17** „Hrǐm·gęrðr ek hęiti, · Hati hét minn faðir, [R 23r/4]
þann vissa’k á·máttkastan jǫtun;
margar brúðir · hann lét frá búi tęknar
und’s hann Hęlgi hjó.“

[Quoth Rimegird:] “Rimegird I am called—Hate was my father called;
I knew him to be the uncanniest ettin.
Many brides he let be taken from their homes
before Hallow cut him down.”

[Atli kvað:] **18** „Þú vast, hála, · fyr hildings skipum [R 23r/6]
ok látt ǐ fjarðar-mynni fyrir;
rę́sis rekka · es vildir Rǫ́n gefa
ef þér kómi=t ǐ þverst þvari.“

[Quoth Attle:] “Thou wast, O witch, ahead of the hilding’s ships
and didst lie in the firth’s mouth ahead!
The ruler’s champions wouldst thou have given to Ran,
if the sword had not stood in thy path!”

3 vildir Rǫ́n gefa ‘wouldst thou have given to Ran’ | Given to the sea-goddess by drowning them.

[Hrím·gerðr kvað:] **19** „Duliðr est nú, Atli, · draums kveð’k þér vesa, [R 23r/8]
síga lętr þú brýnn fyr bráar;
móðir mǐn · lá fyr mildings skipum,
ek drękkða Hlǫð·varðs sonum ǐ hafi.

[Quoth Rimegird:] “Deluded art thou now, Attle; I say thou art dreamy;
thou lettest thy brows sink over thy lashes!
*My mother* lay ahead of the generous man’s ships;
*I* drowned Ludward’s sons in the sea!

1 Duliðr est nú, Atli, · draums kveð'k þér vesa | Found near-identically (but with different addressee) in *Hdl* 7/1.

**20** Gnęggja myndir þú, Atli, · ef gęldr né vęrir: [R 23r/11]
2 bręttir sínn Hrím·gęrðr hala!
Aptar=la hjarta · hygg at þitt, Atli, sé
4 þó'tt þú hafir *ręina rǫdd.“

Thou wouldst neigh, Attle, if thou wert not a gelding;
Rimegird lifts her tail!
A cowering heart I think be thine, Attle,
although thou hast a stallion's voice.”

4 *ręina | hręina **R**.

ALL | The sexual tension in the exchange in sts. 20–21 is strong, all the more so since human sexual relations are frequently likened to those of horses in Norse literature (so, e.g., *1 HHund* 42, Anon *(ÓTHkr)* 1 in SkP 1, *Bósa saga* 11).

3 Aptar=la hjarta hygg at þitt ... sé 'A cowering heart I think be thine' | Lit., 'I think thy heart is far back (viz., in the chest)'.

[Atli kvað:] **21** „Rę*i*ni mun þér ek þikkja · ef þú ręyna knátt [R 23r/13]
2 ok stíga'k á land af lęgi;
ǫll munt lęmja=sk · ef mér 's al-hugat
4 ok svęigja þínn hala, Hrím·gęrðr!“

[Quoth Attle:] “A stallion I will seem to thee if thou triest me,
and I step aland off the lake.
Thou wilt be all beaten lame if I am full of heart,
and bowing thy tail, O Rimegird!”

1 Rę*i*ni | 'remi' **R**.

[Hrím·gerðr kvað:] **22** „Atli, gakk á land · ef afli tręysti=sk [R 23r/15]
2 ok hittum=k í vík Varins,
rifja rétti · es þú munt, rekkr, fá
4 ef þú mér í krymmur kømr.“

[Quoth Rimegird:] “O Attle, go aland, if thou trustest in thy strength,
and let us meet in Warren's bay.
A straightening of the ribs is what thou wilt get, champion,
if thou comest into my clutches!”

[Atli kvað:] **23** „Mun'k=a ek ganga · áðr gumnar vakna [R 23r/17]
2 ok halda of vísa vǫrð;

es=a mér ør·vęnt · nęr òru kømr
skass upp undir skipi.“

[Quoth Attle:] “I will not go before the men awaken
and keep watch for the overseer [= Hallow].
It should not surprise me, if under our
ship a hag should come!”

---

ALL | Attle answers that he will not leave his watchpost until the crew wakes up; he knows that if he leaves, Rimegird (or another ettin-woman) is likely to sink the ship and with it Hallow, his chieftain.

[Hrím·gerðr kvað:] **24** „Vaki þú, Hęlgi, · ok bøt við Hrĭm·gęrði [R 23r/19]
es þú létst høggvinn Hata;
ęina nótt · kná høn hjá jǫfri sofa,
þá hęfir høn bǫlva bøtr.“

[Quoth Rimegird:] “Wake thou, Hallow, and compensate for Rimegird,
since thou didst let Hate be cut down.
A single night may she sleep by the ruler;
then she has compensation for the evils.”

---

ALL | Rimegird realises that she will not have her way with Attle, and so instead awakes the other leader of the ship, Hallow.

[Helgi kvað:] **25** „Loðinn hęitir es þik skal ęiga, · —lęið est mann-kyni— [R 23r/21]
sá býr ĭ Þoll-ęyju þurs,
hund-víss jǫtunn, · hraun-búa verstr,
sá ’s þér mak=ligr maðr.“

[Quoth Hallow:] “Loden he is called who shall own thee—thou art loathsome to mankind—
he lives in Thalley, a thurse,
a hundred-wise ettin, the worst of lavafield-dwellers;
*he* is for thee a fitting man!”

---

ALL | Hallow, too, refuses. Rimegird would be better off with her match, a loathsome thurse.

[Hrím·gerðr kvað:] **26** „Hina vilt hęldr, Hęlgi, · es réð hafnir skoða [R 23r/23]
fyrri nótt með firum;
mar-gollin mér · mér þótti afli bera;
hér sté høn land af lęgi
ok fęsti svá yðarn flota;
høn ęin því veldr · es ek ęigi má’k
buðlungs mønnum bana.“

[Quoth Rimegird:] “Thou wouldst rather have *her*, O Hallow, who was spying along the harbours
last night among men.
That sea-golden maiden seemed to me to bear able strength;
here she stepped aland off the lake,
and so did she fasten your floater.
She alone is the cause that I nowise may
be the bane of the chieftain’s men.”

---

ALL | Rimegird tells Hallow that she knows a better woman for him: the walkirrie who has been riding alongside his ships, protecting him and his men from Rimegird.

[Helgi kvað:] **27** „Hęyr þú nú, Hrǐm·gęrðr, · ef ek bøti harma þér, [R 23r/26]
sęg þú gǫrr grami:
Vas sú ęin vęttr · es barg ǫðlings skipum
eða fóru þęr flęiri saman?“

[Quoth Hallow:] “Hear thou now, Rimegird: if I should compensate thy injuries,
tell this clearly to the king:
Was there but one wight which saved the athling’s ships,
or did several journey together?”

---

ALL | Hallow makes a ruse: he offers to “compensate” her injuries (i.e., by sleeping with her) in exchange for more knowledge about the walkirrie.

[Hrím·gerðr kvað:] **28** „Þrennar níundir męyja, · þó rękð ęin fyrir, [R 23r/28]
hvít und hjalmi mér;
marir hristu=sk, · stóð af mǫnum þęira
dǫgg ǐ djúpa dali,
hagl ǐ hǫva viðu,
þaðan kømr með ǫldum ár;
allt vas mér þat lęitt es lęit’k.“

[Quoth Rimegird:] “Three groups of nine maidens—yet one rode ahead,
the white maiden under a helmet.
The steeds shook themselves; from their manes there poured
dew into deep dales,
hail into high trees;
thereof good harvests come amongst men—
I loathed all that I beheld!”

[Helgi kvað:] **29** „Austr lít-tu nú, Hrǐm·gęrðr, · ef þik lostna hęfr [R 23r/32]
Hęlgi hęl-stǫfum;
à landi ok à vatni · borgit ’s *lof*ðungs flota

ok siklings mǫnnum it sama!“

[Quoth Hallow:] “Look eastwards now, Rimegird, if Hallow has stricken
thee with hell-staves!
On land and on water the praised man’s floater is saved
and the ruler’s men likewise!”

3 *lof*ðungs | *metr. emend.;*ǫðlings **R**

ALL | Sts. 29–30: Hallow and Attle have delayed Rimegird for long enough and the dawn breaks. They each speak one stanza. For the motif of a malevolent being turning into stone at daybreak, cf. Introduction to *Alv*.

[Atli kvað:] **30** „Dagr ’s nú, Hrím·gęrðr, · ęn þik dvalða hęfir [R 23v/1]
Atli til aldr-laga;
hafnar mark · þykkir hlóg=ligt vesa,
þar’s þú í stęins líki stęndr!“

[Quoth Attle:] “’Tis day now, Rimegird, but thou hast been delayed
by Attle to the loss of thy life!
A laughable harbour-mark seemest thou to be
where thou standest in the likeness of a stone!”

**P7** Helgi konungr var all-mikill her-maðr. Hann kom til Ey·lima [R 23v/3]
konungs ok bað Sváfu, dóttur hans. Þau Helgi ok Sváfa veittu=sk várar ok unnu=sk furðu mikit.
Sváfa var heima með feðr sínum en Helgi í hernaði; var Sváfa val-kyrja enn sem fyrr.
Heðinn var heima með fǫður sínum, Hjǫr·varði konungi, í Noregi. Heðinn fór einn saman heim ór skógi jóla-aptan ok fann troll-konu; sú reið vargi ok hafði orma at taumum ok bauð fylgð sína Heðni. „Nei,“ sagði hann. Hón sagði: „Þess skaltu gjalda at bragar-fulli!“
Um kveld’it óru heit-strengingar; var framm leiddr sónar-gǫltr; lǫgðu menn þar á hendr sínar ok strengdu menn þá heit at bragar-fulli. Heðinn strengði heit til Sváfu Ey·lima dóttur, unnustu Helga, bróður síns, ok iðraði=sk svá mjǫk at hann gekk á braut villi-stígu suðr á lǫnd ok fann Helga bróður sinn. Helgi kvað:

King Hallow was a fully great raider. He came to King Eanlime and asked for the hand of Sweve, his daughter. Hallow and Sweve exchanged vows and loved each other very much. Sweve was at home with her father, but Hallow was raiding; Sweve was still a walkirrie as before. Headen was at home with his father, King Harward, in Norway. Headen was journeying

home back out of the woods alone on Yule evening when he found a troll-woman. She rode upon a wolf and had snakes for reins and offered Headen her companionship. "No.", said he. She said: "This wilt thou pay for at the bray-cup!" In the evening there was the undertaking of boasts. The boar of atonement was led forth; thereupon men laid their hands and then men undertook their boasts by the bray-cup. Headen undertook a boast to possess Sweve, Eanlime's daughter, the lover of Hallow, his brother; and he regretted it so much that he went away on trailing roads south through the lands, and found Hallow, his brother. Quoth Hallow:

---

ALL | This prose passage begins the final section of the prosimetrum (P7, 31–34, P8, 35, P9, 36–43, P10). This section deals with Hallow's death in a duel and his promising of Sweve to his brotehr, Headen.

9–10 at bragar-fulli 'at the bray-cup' | According to various heroic and kings' sagas, the *bragar-full* 'bray-cup' was the chief toast at important rituals, accompanied by boasts.

11 sónar-gǫltr 'boar of atonement' | The sacrificial boar upon which men would make their boasts; it would then be sacrificed and eaten communally. The ritual bears some resemblance to the Hebrew scape-goat.

**31** „Kom hęill, Hęðinn, · hvat kannt sęgja [R 23v/15]
nýra spjalla · ór Nor·egi?
Hví 's þér, stillir, · støkkt ór landi
ok est ęinn kominn · *o*ss at finna?"

"Come hale, Headen! What canst thou say
of new tidings from Norway?
Why hast thou, commander, hurried from the land,
and come alone to find us?"

[Heðinn kvað:] **32** „Mik hęfir myklu glǫpr · męiri sóttan: [R 23v/16]
Ek hęfi kørna · ina konung-bornu
brúði þína · at bragar-fulli."

[Quoth Headen:] "A false word has greatly afflicted me:
I have chosen the kingly born
bride of thine at the bray-cup."

[Helgi kvað:] **33** „Saka=sk ęigi þú! · Sǫnn munu verða [R 23v/18]
ǫl-mól, Hęðinn, · okkur bęggja;
mér hęfir stillir · støkkt til ęyrar,
þriggja nátta, · skyla'k þar koma;
if 's mér á því · at aptr koma;
þá má at góðu · gøra=sk s·líkt ef skal."

[Quoth Hallow:] “Blame not thyself! Those ale-speeches will,
come true, O Headen, for both of us.
The commander has me summoned to the sand-spit
in three nights; I must go thither.
I have doubt whether I should come back;
then it may turn out for good if it shall indeed turn out so.”

---

3 stǫkkt til ęyrar ‘summoned to the sand-spit’ | Namely for a duel, which were not infrequently fought on small islands or spits of land. Cf. here the many literary descriptions of the *holm-ganga* ‘holm-gang’ (lit. ‘islet-walk’), the legal term for a regulated duel in Wiking Age Iceland.

6 þá má at góðu ‘then it may turn out for good’ | Hallow notes that his death in the duel against Atholf will not be fully bad, since it will prevent a conflict with his brother Headen over his wife. Instead, Headen may take her peacefully after he is dead.

[Heðinn kvað:] **34** „Sagðir þú, Hęlgi, · at Hęðinn vęri [R 23v/21]
2 góðs verðr frá þér · ok gjafa stórra;
þér es sœmra · sverð at rjóða
4 an frið gefa · fjǫndum þínum.“

[Quoth Headen:] “Thou hast said, O Hallow, that Headen is
worthy of good things from thee, and of great gifts.
It is more fitting for thee to redden the sword
than to give peace to thy enemies.”

---

ALL | Headen praises his brother for his kindheartedness. Even so, he encourages Hallow not to spare his enemy in the duel, even if it would mean that Headen himself cannot have Sweve.

**P8** Þat kvað Helgi því at hann grunaði um feigð sína ok þat at fylgjur [R 23v/23]
2 hans hǫfðu vitjat Heðins þá er hann sá konu’na ríða vargi’num.
Álfr hét konungr, sonr Hróð·mars, er Helga hafði vǫll haslaðan
4 á Sigars-velli á þriggja nátta fresti. Þá kvað Helgi:

Hallow said that because he was suspicuous over his own feyness, and over how his fetches had visited Headen when he saw the woman riding the wolf. Atholf was the name of a king, Rothmar’s son, against whom Hallow had hazeled the plain at Sigarswold with a three nights’ summons. Then quoth Hallow:

**35** „Ręið á vargi · es røkvit vas, [R 23v/26]
2 fljóð ęitt es hann · fylgju bęiddi;
hǫn vissi þat · at veginn myndi
4 Sigr·linnar sonr · á Sig·ars-vǫllum.“

“She rode on a wolf when twilight had come,
the one woman who offered him companionship.

She knew that slain would be
Syelind's son [= I, Hallow] upon the Sigarswolds."

**P9** Þar var orrusta mikil ok fekk þar Helgi bana-sár. [R 23v/28]

There it was a great battle and Hallow there got his bane-wound.

**36** Sęndi Hęlgi · Sig·ar at ríða [R 23v/29]
ęptir Ey·lima · ęinga dóttur;
biðr brál=liga · búna verða
ef hǫn vill finna · fylki kvikvan.

Hallow sent Sigar to ride
for Eanlime's only daughter.
He asks her hurriedly to make herself ready,
if she wishes to meet the marshaller alive.

[Sig·arr kvað:] **37** „Mik hęfir Hęlgi · hingat sęndan [R 23v/31]
við þik, Sváfa, · sjalfa at męla,
þik kvað=sk hilmir · hitta vilja
áðr ítr-borinn · ǫndu týndi."

[Quoth Sigar:] "Me has Hallow sent hither,
with thy very self, O Sweve, to speak.
*Thee* the helmet-bearer said he wished to see
before the noble-born must give up his life."

[Sváfa kvað:] **38** „H*vat* varð Hęlga · Hjǫr·varðs syni? [R 23v/33]
Mér 's harð=liga · harma lęitat;
ef hann sér of lék · eða sverð of bęit,
þęim skal ek gumna · grand of vinna!"

[Quoth Sweve:] "What happened to Hallow, Harward's son?
A cruel injury has found its way to me!
If the sea betrayed him or a sword bit him,
against that man I shall avenge the harm!"

1 H*vat* varð | 'H varþ' **R**

[Sig·arr kvað:] **39** „Fell hér í morgun · at Freka-stęini [R 24r/2]
buðlungr sá's vas · batstr und sólu;
Ólfr mun sigri · ǫllum ráða
þó'tt þętta sinn · þǫrf=gi véri."

[Quoth Sigar:] "Here this morning by Freckstone fell
the chieftain who was the best beneath the sun.
Atholf will have all the victory,
although this time it was not a boon."

[Helgi kvað:] **40** „Hęil ves, Sváfa! · Hug skalt dęila, [R 24r/4]
sjá mun ĭ hęimi · hindstr fundr vera;
tjá buðlungi · blóða undir;
mér hęfir hjǫrr komit · hjarta it nęsta.

[Quoth Hallow:] "Be hale, O Sweve! Thou shalt share of my mind;
in the Home this will be our very last meeting.
On the chieftain the gashes bleed;
the sword has come nearest to my heart.

**41** Bið'k þik, Sváfa, · brúðr, grátt=at-tu, [R 24r/6]
ef þú vill mĭnu · máli hlýða
at þú Hęðni · hvílu gørvir
ok jǫfur ungan · ǫstum lęiðir."

I bid thee, Sweve—O bride, do not weep
if thou wilt harken to my speech—
that thou for Headen makest a bed
and showest the young warrior thy affections."

---

ALL | Hallow asks Sweve to marry his brother, Headen, after he himself is dead.

[Sváfa kvað:] **42** „Męlt hafða'k þat · ĭ munar-hęimi [R 24r/8]
þá's mér Hęlgi · hringa valði;
myndi'g=a ek lostig · at liðinn fylki
jǫfur ǫ·kunnan · armi vęrja."

[Quoth Sweve:] "I had declared in the home of joy [THE LIVING WORLD]
when Hallow chose rings for me,
that I would not willingly, after the marshaller's passing,
embrace a strange warrior with my arm."

**43** „Kyss mik, Sváfa, · køm'k ęigi a*þ*tr [R 24r/10]
Rog-hęims á vit · né Rǫðuls-fjalla
áðr hęfnt hęfi'k · Hjǫr·varðs sonar,
þęss es buðlungr vas · bętstr und sólu!"

"Kiss me, O Sweve! I shall not come back
to visit Ryeham nor the Raddlefells,

before I have avenged Harward's son,
who was the best chieftain beneath the sun."

---

ALL | The speaker is unclear. Is it Hallow declaring that he will not come back (i.e., be reborn) until he has been avenged, or is it instead Headen, who says that he will not return until he has avenged Hallow, his brother?

**P10** Helgi ok Sváfa er sagt at vęri endr-borin. [R 24r/12]

Hallow and Sweve, it is said, were reborn.

---

ALL | They were reincarnated as Hallow Hundingsbane and Syerun, as stated in *2 HHund* P4. Cf. *2 HHund* P17.

# Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane
# *(II Hęlga kviða Hundings-bana)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.587)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay, Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Second Lay of Hallow Hundingsbane** (*2 HHund*) is another epic poem based on the life of Hallow Syemund's son. It is the last of the three *Helgakviður* 'Hallow-poems' in **R**.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*2 HHund* is only attested in **R**, on foll. 24r/13–26v/19, where it follows *HHj* and is followed by *Grip*.

### Meter and stanza

Unlike *1 HHund*, but like *HHj*, *2 HHund* is a prosimetrum with stanzas in both Ancient-words-lay and Leeds-meter.

TODO.

### Origin and motifs

The latter part of the poem contains a touching description of Syerun's visit to Hallow's grave mound, where the two lovers embrace for one last time. The same folkloric motif is found in many traditional British ballads (e.g. Roud 50 "Sweet William's Ghost", Roud 179 "The Lover's Ghost" or "The Grey Cock", Roud 22568 "The Night Visiting Song"), where two lovers separated by death reunite one last time in the grave before being forced to part at cock-crow, although in some variants of 179 and 22568 the supernatural element is not explicit. As an example, the following text is the version of Roud 22568 recorded by *The Dubliners* in 1972:

*I must away now; I can no longer tarry*
*This morning's tempest I have to cross*
*I must be guided without a stumble*
*Into the arms I love the most.*

*And when he came to his true love's dwelling*
*He knelt down gently upon a stone*
*And through her window he's whispered lowly:*
*"Is my true lover within at home?"*

*"Wake up, wake up, love, it is thine own true lover*
*Wake up, wake up, love, and let me in*
*For I am tired, love, and oh so weary*
*And more than near drenched to the skin."*

*She's raised her off her down soft pillow*
*She's raised her up and she's let him in*
*And they were locked in each other's arms*
*Until that long night was past and gone.*

*And when that long night was past and over*
*And when the small clouds began to grow*
*He's taken her hand and they've kissed and parted*
*Then he saddled and mounted and away did go.*

*I must away now* etc.

In the depiction of this motif in the present poem one might see a conflict between two varying conceptions of the afterlife, viz. the popular idea of the dead man as dwelling *within* his burial mound or grave, and the elite idea of the dead warrior departing to Walhall. The story of the "lover's ghost" is only properly compatible with the former idea, but as a legendary warrior Hallow is thought to go to Walhall immediately after death, and so to resolve the two the poet has Hallow ride down from Walhall to the mound where he reunites with Syerun.

## Text

### Frá Vǫlsungum ('From the Walsings')

**P1** Sig·mundr konungr Vǫlsungs sonr átti Borg·hildi af Brá-lundi. [R 24r/13]
Þau hétu son sinn Helga ok eptir Helga Hjǫr·varðs syni. Helga fóstraði Hagall. Hundingr hét ríkr konungr; við hann er Hundland kennt. Hann var her-maðr mikill ok átti marga sonu þá er í hernaði vǫru. Ó·friðr ok dylgjur vóru á milli þeira Hundings konungs ok Sig·mundar konungs; drǫpu hvárir annarra fręndr. Sig·mundr konungr ok hans ętt-menn hétu Vǫlsungar ok Ylfingar. Helgi fór ok njósnaði til hirðar Hundings konungs á laun. Hemingr, sonr Hundings konungs, var heima. En er Helgi fór í brott þá hitti hann hjarðar-*svein* ok kvað:

King Syemund, Walsing's son, had to wife Burhild of Browlund. They called their son Hallow after Hallow Harward's son. Hallow was fostered by Hail. Hunding was the name of a mighty king; from him comes the name Hunland. He was a great harrier and had many sons who were in the harrying host. Enmity and evil strikes at that time stood between the [sons] of King Hunding and King Syemund; men on either side slew the kinsmen of the other. King Syemund and the men of his lineage were called Walsings and Wolvings. Hallow journeyed and spied at the hird of King Hunding in secret. Heming, King Hunding's son, was at home. But when Hallow journeyed away then he struck upon a herding-swain, and quoth:

**1** „Sęg Hęmingi · at Hęlgi man [R 24r/21]
hvęrn í brynju · bragnar fęlldu,
ér ulf gráan · inni hǫfðuð
þar's Hamal hugði · Hundingr konungr."

"Tell Heming that Hallow remembers
which man in a byrnie the warriors felled.
Ye have a grey wolf within [your halls]
where King Hunding thought Hamble was."

**P2** Hamall hét sonr Hagals. Hundingr konungr sendi menn til Ha- [R 24r/23]
gals at leita Helga, en Helgi mátti eigi forða=sk annan veg en tók klęði ambáttar ok gekk at mala. Þeir leituðu ok fundu eigi Helga. Þá kvað Blindr inn bǫl-vísi:

Hamble was the name of Hail's son. King Hunding sent men to Hail to look for Hallow, but Hallow could not save his life in any other way than that he

took the clothes of a bondwoman and went to grind. They looked and did not find Hallow. Then quoth Blind the bale-wise:

**2** „Hvǫss eru augu · í Hagals þýju, [R 24r/27]
es=a þat karls ętt · es á kvęrnum stęndr,
stęinar rifna, · støkkr lúðr fyrir.

"Sharp are the eyes on Hail's slave-woman;
it is not the lineage of a churl that stands by the querns;
the stones crack apart, the flour-box breaks before her!

---

1 Hvǫss eru augu 'Sharp are the eyes' | For sharp eyes as a sign of class see *Vkv* 17/3, *Rþ* 19/3, 33/4, *1 HHund* 6/3–4.

2 kvęrnum 'the querns' | The quern alluded to is a Wiking Age hand quern consisting of two stones, one fast at the base (the mill-stone) and one above it which is spun by means of a handle. Cf. *Vafþ* 23.

**3** Nú hęfir hǫrð dømi · hildingr þegit [R 24r/29]
es vísi skal · val-bygg mala;
hęldr es sømri · hęndi þęiri
meðal-kafli · an mǫndul-tré."

Now hath the prince received hard judgments,
when the chieftain shall grind Welsh barley.
It is more fitting for that hand [to hold]
the sword-pommel than the handle-stick.

**P3** Hagall svaraði ok kvað: [R 24r/31]

Hail answered and quoth:

**4** „Þat 's lítil vǫ · þó'tt lúðr þrumi [R 24r/31]
es męr konungs · mǫndul hrørir;
hǫn skęvaði · skýjum øfri
ok vega þorði · sęm víkingar
áðr hana Helgi · hǫptu gørði;
systir 's hǫn þęira · Sig·ars ok Hǫgna,
því hęfir ǫtul augu · Ylfinga man."

"It is little woe yet that the flour-box thunders
when the king's daughter moves the handle.
She strode forth higher than the clouds
and dared to fight like Wikings
before Hallow made her a prisoner.

She is the sister of Sigar and Hawn;
therefore the slave-girl of the Wolvings has terrible eyes."

**P4** Undan kom=sk Helgi ok fór á her-skip. Hann felldi Hunding konung ok var síðan kallaðr Helgi Hundings bani. Hann lá með her sinn í Bruna-vágum ok hafði þar strand-hǫgg ok ǫtu þar hrátt. Hǫgni hét konungr; hans dóttir var Sig·rún. Hón var valkyrja ok reið lopt ok lǫg; hón var Sváva endr-borin. Sig·rún reið at skipum Helga ok kvað: [R 24v/1]

Hallow got away and went onto a harrying-ship. He felled King Hunding and was thereafter called Hallow Hunding's bane. He lay with his host in the Brunwaves and there raided the shores and there ate raw flesh. Hawn was the name of a king; his daughter was Syerun. She was a walkirrie and rode over air and water; she was Sweve reborn. Syerun rode alongside Hallow's ships and quoth:

**5** „Hvęrir láta fljóta · flęy við bakka? [R 24v/6]
Hvar, hęr-męgir, · hęima ęiguð?
Hvęrs bíðið ér · í Bruna-vǫgum?
Hvęrt lystir yðr · lęið at kanna?"

"TODO.
Where, lads of the host, do ye have your homes?
Whom do ye await in the Brunwaves?
TODO."

**6** „Hamall lętr fljóta · flęy við bakka; [R 24v/8]
ęigum hęima · í Hlés-eyju;
bíðum byrjar · í Bruna-vǫgum;
austr lystir oss · lęið at kanna!"

"TODO.
we have our homes in Leesey.
We await a good gust in the Brunwaves;
TODO."

**7** „Hvar hęfir, hilmir, · hildi vakða [R 24v/10]
eða gǫgl alin · Gunnar systra?
Hví 's brynja þín · blóði stokkin?
Hví skal und hjǫlmum · hrátt kjǫt eta?"

"TODO.

or nourished the swans of Guth's sisters [WALKIRRIES > EAGLES]?
Why is thy byrnie dripping with blood?
Why shall men under helmets eat raw meat?"

**8** „Þat vann nęst nýs · niðr Ylfinga [R 24v/12]
fyr vestan ver, · ef þik vita lystir,
es ek bjǫrnu tók · í Braga-lundi
ok ętt ara · oddum sadda'k.

"TODO.
TODO if thou hast lust to know.
TODO.
and the lineage of the eagle I fed by spear-point.

---

2 ef þik vita lystir 'if thou hast lust to know' | Formulaic b-verse, also occurring in *Helr* 2/3b, 5/2b, 6/3b.

**9** Nú 's sagt, męr, · hvaðan sakar gørðu=sk, [R 24v/14]
því vas á lęgi mér · lítt stęikt etit."

Now it is said, maiden, TODO;
therefore on the sea little cooked food was eaten."

**10** „Víg lýsir þú; · varð fyr Hęlga [R 24v/15]
Hundingr konungr · hníga at vęlli;
bar sókn saman · es sefa hęfnduð
ok busti blóð · á brimis ęggjar."

"TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO."

**11** „Hvat vissir þú · at þęir séi, [R 24v/17]
snót svinn-huguð, · es sefa hęfnduð?
Margir 'ro hvassir · hildings synir
ok á·munir · ossum niðjum."

"TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO."

**12** „Vas'k=a ek fjarri, · folks odd-viti, [R 24v/19]
gęr à morgun · grams aldr-lokum;
þó tęl'k sløgjan · Sig·mundar bur
es í val-rùnum · víg-spjǫll sęgir.

"TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**13** Lęit'k þik umb sinn fyrr · à lang-skipum [R 24v/21]
þà's þú byggðir · blóðga stafna
ok úr-svalar · unnir léku;
nú vill dylja=sk · dǫglingr fyr mér
en Hǫgna męr · *Hęlga* kęnnir."

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO."

**P5** Gran·marr hét ríkr konungr er bjó at Svarins-haugi. Hann átti [R 24v/23]
marga sonu: Hǫð·broddr, annarr Guð·mundr, þriði Starkaðr. Hǫð·broddr var í konunga-stefnu. Hann fastnaði sér Sig·rúnu Hǫgna dóttur en er hón spyrr þat þá reið hón með valkyrjur um lopt ok um lǫg at leita Helga.
Helgi var þá at Loga-fjǫllum ok hafði barit=sk við Hundings sonu. Þar felldi hann þá Álf ok Eyj·ólf, Hjǫr·varð ok Her·varð ok var hann all-víg-móðr ok sat undir Ara-steini. Þar hitti Sig·rún hann ok rann á hals hǫnum ok kyssti hann ok sagði hǫnum erendi sitt, svá sem segir í Vǫlsunga kviðu inni fornu:

TODO.

**14** Sótti Sig·rùn · sikling glaðan, [R 24v/32]
hęim nam hǫn Hęlga · hǫnd at sókja,
kyssti ok kvaddi · konung und hjalmi,
þà varð hilmi · hugr à vífi;
fyrr lét=sk hǫn unna · af ǫllum hug
syni Sig·mundar · an hǫn sét hafði.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**15** „Vas'k Hǫð·broddi · í hęr fǫstnuð [R 25r/2]
ęn jǫfur annan · ęiga vilda'k;
þó sé=umk, fylkir, · frénda ręiði;
hęfi'k míns fǫður · mun-ráð brotit.“

"I was promised to Hathbrod in the army,
but I wished to have another chieftain.
Yet I fear, O marshaller, the wrath of my kinsmen;
I have broken my father's dearest wish."

4 mun-ráð 'dearest wish' | A hapax. TODO.

**16** Nam=a Hǫgna mér · umb hug méla; [R 25r/4]
hafa kvað=sk hǫn Hęlga · hylli skyldu.

TODO;
she said that she would have Hallow's favour.

**17** „Hirð ęigi þú · Hǫgna ręiði [R 25r/6]
né illan hug · ęttar þínnar;
þú skalt, mér ung, · at mér lifa;
ętt átt, in góða, · es ek séumk.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**P6a** Helgi samnaði þá miklum skipa-her ok fór til Freka-steins ok [R 25r/8]
fengu í hafi of·viðri mann-hętt. Þá kvómu leiptr yfir þá ok stóðu
geislar í skipin. Þeir sá í lopti'nu at val-kyrjur níu riðu ok kenndu
þeir Sig·rúnu. Þá lęgði storm'inn ok kvómu þeir heilir til lands.
Gran·mars synir sótu á bjargi nǫkkuru er skipin sigldu at landi.
Guð·mundr hljóp á hest ok reið á njósn á berg'it við hǫfn'ina; þá
hlóðu Vǫlsungar seglum; þá kvað Guð·mundr, svá sem fyrr er
ritat í Hęlga-kviðu:

TODO.

---

7–8 svá sem fyrr er ritat í Hęlga-kviðu ‘TODO’ | Viz. in *1 HHund* 32.

**18** „Hvęrr es fylkir · sá's flota stýrir [R 25r/15]
ok fękna-lið · førir at landi?“

“Who is the marshaller that steers the fleet
TODO.”

---

ALL | This stanza is traditionally included as part of the preceding prose and not given its own number.

**P6b** Sin·fjǫtli Sig·mundar sonr svaraði ok *er* þat enn ritat. Guð·mundr [R 25r/16]
reið heim með her-sǫgu. Þá sǫmnuðu Gran·mars synir her;
kómu þar margir konungar. Þar var Hǫgni, faðir Sig·rúnar, ok
synir hans, Bragi ok Dagr. Þar var orrusta mikil ok fellu al-
lir Gran·mars synir ok allir þeira hǫfðingjar nema Dagr Hǫgna
sonr; fekk grið ok vann eiða Vǫlsungum. Sig·rún gekk í val'inn
ok hitti Hǫð·brodd at kominn dauða. Hón kvað:

Sinfittle, Syemund's son, answered, and that is further written. Godmund rode home with news of the host. Then Granmar's sons assembled a host; many kings came thither. Hawn was there, Syerun's father, and his sons Bray and Day. There was a great battle and all the sons of Granmar fell and all of their chieftains, save for Day, Hawn' son; he got a truce and swore oaths to the Walsings. Syerun walked forth among the dead and found Hathbrod near to death. Quoth she:

**19** „Mun=a þér Sig·rún · frá Sefa-fjǫllum, [R 25r/22]
Hǫð·broddr konungr, · hníga at armi;
liðin es ękvi, · opt náir hrę́vi
grán-stóð gríðar, · Gran·mars sona.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**P7** Þá hitti hón Helga ok varð all-fegin. Hann kvað: [R 25r/24]

Then she found Hallow and was full rejoicing. Quoth he:

**20** „Es=at þér at ǫllu, · al-vitr, gefit, [R 25r/25]

2 Þó kveð'k nǫkkvi · nornir valda;
fellu í morgun · at Freka-steini
4 Bragi ok Hǫgni · —varð'k bani þeira—

TODO.
TODO.
this morning by the Freckstone fell
Bray and Hawn—I became their bane—

**21** Ǫn at Styr·kleifum · Starkaðr konungr [R 25r/27]
2 Ǫn at Hlé·bjǫrgum · Hrol·laugs synir;
Þann sá'k gylfa · grimm-úðgastan
4 es barði=sk bolr, · vas á brot hǫfuð.

but at TODO King Starked,
but at the Leebarrows, TODO's sons.
TODO.
TODO.

**22** Liggja at jǫrðu · allra flestir [R 25r/29]
2 niðjar þínir · at nǫm orðnir;
vannt=at-tu vígi, · vas þér þat skapat
4 at þú at rógi · rík-mǫnni vart."

Upon the earth lie nearly all
of thy kinsmen, turned to corpses.
TODO.
TODO.

1 jǫrðu | *sens. emend.;* Jórdán ('iordán') *'Jordan'* R

**P8** Þá grét Sig·rún. Hann kvað: [R 25r/31]

Then Syerun wept. Quoth he:

**23** „Hugga=sk-tu, Sig·rún! · Hildr hefir þú oss verit; [R 25r/31]
2 vinna=t skjǫldungar skǫpum."
[Sig·rún:] „Lifna mynda'k nú kjósa · es liðnir eru
4 ok knétta'k þér þó í faðmi fela=sk."

"Console thyself, Syerun! Thou hast been for us a Hild;
the princes cannot withstand the Shapes."
[Syerun:] "Would that I now could choose life for the passed,
and still hide myself in thy arms!"

3 Lifna … eru ‘Would … passed’ | Lit. ‘I would now choose living those who are passed’.

**P9** Þetta kvað Guð·mundr, Gran·mars sonr: [R 25v/1]

This quoth Godmund, Granmar’s son:

**24** „Hvęrr es skjǫldungr · sá’s skipum stýrir, [R 25v/1]
lętr gunn-fana · gollinn fyr stafni?
Þikkja mér friðr · í farar broddi;
verpr víg-roða · umb víkinga.“

“TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.”

Sin·fjǫtli kvað: **25** „Hér má Hǫð·broddr · Hęlga kęnna [R 25v/3]
flótta trauðan · í flota miðjum;
hann hęfir øðli · ętt̄ar þínnar,
arf fjǫrsunga, · und sik þrungit.

Quoth Sinfittle: “TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**26** Því fyrr skulu · at Freka-steini [R 25v/5]
sáttir saman · umb sakar dǿma;
mál es, Hǫð·broddr, · hęfnd at vinna
ef vér lęgra hlut · lęngi bǫrum.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**27** Fyrr munt, Guð·mundr, · gęitr of halda [R 25v/7]
ok berg-skorar · brattar klífa,
hafa þér í hęndi · hęsli-kylfu;
þat ’s þér blíðara · an brimis dómar.“

TODO.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**28** „Þér es, Sin·fjǫtli, · sømra myklu [R 25v/9]
gunni at hęyja · ok glaða ǫrnu
an ǫ·nýtum · orðum at dęila
þó'tt hildingar · hęiptir dęili.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**29** Þikki=t mér góðir · Gran·mars synir, [R 25v/11]
þó dugir siklingum · satt at męla,
þęir męrkt hafa · á Móins-hęimum
at hug hafa · hjǫrum at bręgða;
eru hildingar · høldsti snjallir."

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**P10** Helgi fekk Sig·rúnar ok ǫ́ttu þau sonu; var Helgi eigi gamall. [R 25v/13]
Dagr Hǫgna sonr blótaði Óðin til fǫður-hefnda. Óðinn léði
Dag *geir*s síns. Dagr fann Helga, mág sinn, þar sem heitir at
Fjǫturlundi. Hann lagði í gǫgnum Helga með geir'num. Þar
fell Helgi, en Dagr reið til fjalla ok sagði Sig·rúnu tíðindi:

Hallow got Syerun to wife and they had sons; Hallow was not old. Day, Hawn's son, made a bloot to Weden for the sake of avenging his father. Weden lent Day his spear. Day found Hallow, his brother-in-law, at the place called Fetterlund; he ran Hallow through with the spear. There fell Hallow, but Day rode to the fells and told Syerun the news:

**30** „Trauðr em'k, systir, · trega þér at sęgja [R 25v/17]
því't ek hęfi nauðigr · nipti grøtta:
Fell í morgun · und Fjǫturlundi
buðlungr sá's vas · bętstr í hęimi

ok hildingum · á halsi stóð.“

“Regretful am I, sister, to grieve thee by saying it—
for, forced, must I make my kinswoman weep:
this morning fell in Fetterlund
that noble who was the best in the world
and on the throats of princes stood.”

[Sig·rún kvað:] **31** „Þik skyli allir · ęiðar bíta, [R 25v/20]
þęir es Hęlga · hafðir unna,
at inu ljósa · Lęiptrar vatni
ok at úr-svǫlum · Unnar steini!

“*Thee* shall all oaths bite—
those which thou hast sworn to Hallow
by the shining water of Lafter
and by the spray-cold stone of Ithe.

**32** Skríði=at þat skip, · es und þér skríði, [R 25v/22]
þó’tt óska-byrr · ęptir lęggi=sk!
Renni=a sá marr, · es und þér renni,
þó’tt fięndr þína · forða=sk ęigir!

May the ship not glide which glides beneath thee,
although it has a wished-for gust behind it!
May the horse not run which runs beneath thee,
although from thy foes thou must escape!

**33** Bíti=a þér þat sverð, · es þú bręgðir, [R 25v/24]
nema sjǫlfum þér · syngvi of hǫfði!
Þá vęri þér hęfnt · Hęlga dauða,
ef þú vęrir vargr · á viðum úti,
auðs and-vani · ok alls gamans,
hęfðir ęigi mat, · nema á hręum spryngir!“

May thy sword not bite which thou brandishest,
unless it sing about thy very own head!
*Then* would Hallow’s death be avenged on thee,
if thou wert a wolf in the woods outside,
bereft of wealth and all pleasure,
and hadst no food, save thou plundered carrion!“

Dagr kvað: **34** „Ór est, systir, · ok ør·vita, [R 25v/28]

es bróðr þínum · bið·r for·skapa!
Ęinn vęldr Óðinn · ǫllu bǫlvi,
því't með sifjungum · sak-rúnar bar!

Quoth Day: "Mad art thou, sister, and out of thy wits,
when thou biddest a ruinous shape down on thy brother!
Alone is Weden at fault for all evil,
for he carried strife-runes in the midst of in-laws!

---

1 Ør ... ok ør·viti 'Mad ... and out of thy wits' | Formulaic, also occurring in *Lok* 21/1 and *Oddr* 15/1.

3 Ęinn vęldr Óðinn · ǫllu bǫlvi 'Alone is Weden at fault for all evil' | Formulaic, also occurring (with other names than *Óðinn* 'Weden') at *1 Guðr* 25/2 and *Sigsk* 27/4.

**35** Þér býðr bróðir · bauga rauða, [R 25v/30]
ǫll Vandils-vé · ok Víg-dali;
haf halfan hęim · harms at gjǫldum
brúðr baug-varið · ok burir þínir.

Thy brother offers thee red bighs,
all Wendelswigh and the Wighdales.
Have half the realm as restitution for the harm—
O bigh-adorned bride, and thy sons also.

**36** „Sit'k=a svá sęl · at Sefa-fjǫllum, [R 25v/32]
ár né of nętr, · at ek una lífi,
nema at liði lofðungs · ljóma bręgði,
renni und vísa · Víg-blęr þinig,
goll-bitli vanr, · knega'k grami fagna!

"I will not sit so happy in the Sevefells,
by morning nor night, that I should be content with my life
unless the praised man's troop were splendidly shining,
and beneath the ruler Wighblaw ran hither,
wont to the golden bit—and I might greet the prince!

**37** Svá hafði Hęlgi · hrędda gǫrva [R 26r/3]
fjándr sína alla · ok frękndr þęira,
sem fyr ulfi · óðar rynni
gęitr af fjalli, · gęiska fullar!

So would Hallow have terrified
his enemies all and their kinsmen,
like if from a wolf did madly rush
goats down a fell, full of fright.

**38** Svá bar Hęlgi · af hildingum [R 26r/5]
sem ítr-skapaðr · askr af þyrni
eða sá dýr-kalfr · dǫggu slunginn
es øfri fęrr · ǫllum dýrum,
ok horn glóa · við himin sjalfan.“

So did Hallow surpass the princes
like the nobly shaped ash the thorn,
or the deer-calf, dew-besprinkled,
which fares forth higher than all beasts,
and its horns gleam against the very heaven.”

---

ALL | For the description illustrating the quality of a dead person by likeness to superior natural phenomena, cf. *1 Guðr* 18, *2 Guðr* 2, and *Ghv* 15.

**P11** Haugr var gǫrr eptir Helga. En er hann kom til Val-hallar, þá [R 26r/7]
bauð Óðinn hǫnum ǫllu at ráða með sér. Helgi kvað:

A barrow was made for Hallow. But when he came to Walhall Weden offered him to rule everything together with him. Quoth Hallow:

**39** „Þú skalt, Hundingr, · hvęrjum manni [R 26r/9]
fót-laug geta · ok funa kynda;
hunda binda, · hesta gęta,
gefa svínum soð, · áðr sofa gangir!“

“Thou shalt, Hunding, for every man
pour the foot-bath and kindle the fire,
tie up the hounds, feed the horses,
give wastewater to the swine before thou goest to sleep!”

**P12** Ambótt Sig·rúnar gekk um aptan hjá haugi Helga ok sá at Helgi [R 26r/11]
reið til haugs’ins með marga menn. Ambótt kvað:

Syerun’s maid-servant walked by Hallow’s barrow in the evening, and saw that Hallow rode to the barrow with many men. Quoth the maid-servant:

**40** „Hvárt ’ro þat svik ęin · es séa þikkj=umk [R 26r/13]
eða ragna rǫk · ríða męnn dauðir,
es jóa yðra · oddum kęyrið,
eða es hildingum · hęim-fǫr gefin?“

“Either these are only tricks, as I seem to see
—or the Rakes of the Reins?—dead men riding,

as ye drive your steeds by spear-points on—
or are the princes granted leave to go home?"

[Ęinn þęira kvað:] **41** „Es=a þat svik ęin · es séa þikki=sk [R 26r/15]
né aldar rof · þó'tt-u oss lítir,
þó'tt vér jóa óra · oddum keyrim,
né es hildingum · hęim-fǫr gefin."

[Quoth one of them:] "It is not only tricks, as thou seemest to see—
nor the Ripping of the Age, although thou behold us!
Although we drive our steeds by spear-points on,
the princes are not granted leave to go home."

2 aldar rof 'Ripping of the Age' | Perhaps formulaic. Cf. the formula *rjúfa=sk ręgin* 'the Reins are ripped', *Bdr* 14/4 n., as *rof* 'ripping' is the root-derivative of *rjúfa*.

**P13** Heim gekk ambótt ok sagði Sig·rúnu: [R 26r/16]

The maid-servant went home and told Syerun:

**42** „Út gakk Sig·rún, · frá Sęfa-fjǫllum [R 26r/17]
ef þik folks jaðarr · finna lystir!
Upp 's haugr lokinn, · kominn es Hęlgi,
dolg-spor dręyra, · dǫglingr bað þik
at þú sár-dropa · svęfja skyldir."

"Go outside, O Syerun from the Sevefells,
if thou hast lust to find the leader of the troop—
the barrow is unlocked; Hallow is come!
His gashes bleed; the ruler has bid thee
that thou his wound-drops [BLOOD] shouldst soothe."

4 dǫglingr bað þik 'the ruler has bid thee' | We may presume that the speaker of st. 41 was Hallow himself, and that the conversation between him and the maide-servant was somewhat longer than depicted here.

**P14** Sig·rún gekk í haug'inn til Helga ok kvað: [R 26r/20]

Syerun walked into the barrow, up to Hallow, and quoth:

**43** „Nú em'k svá fęgin · fundi okkrum [R 26r/20]
sem át-frękir · Óðins haukar
es val vitu, · varmar bráðir,
eða dǫgg-litir · dags-brún séa."

"Now do I so rejoice at our meeting
like the ravenous hawks of Weden [RAVENS]
when they know corpses, warm carrion,
or, gleaming with dew, they see the day's brow [DAWN]!

**44** Fyrr vil'k kyssa · konung ó·lifðan [R 26r/22]
an þú blóðugri · brynju kastir;
hár 's þitt, Helgi, · hélu þrungit,
allr es vísi · val-dǫgg slęginn,
hęndr úr-svalar · Hǫgna mági;
hvé skal'k þér, buðlungr, · þęss bót of vinna?"

Sooner would I kiss the unliving king
than thou the bloody byrnie mightst cast away!
Thy hair is, Hallow, with hoarfrost thick;
the prince is all with corpse-dew [BLOOD] whipped;
the hands spray-cold on Hawn's in-law [= Hallow]—
how shall I for thee, noble, find remedy for that?"

---

4 allr es vísi · val-dǫgg slęginn 'the prince is all with corpse-dew whipped' | Cf. *Bdr* 5, where the dead wallow says something similar.

[Hęlgi kvað:] **45** „Ęin vęldr þú, Sig·rún · frá Sefafjǫllum, [R 26r/25]
es Hęlgi es · harm-dǫgg slęginn:
Grętr þú, goll-varið, · grimmum tǫrum,
sól-bjǫrt suð-røn, · áðr þú sofa gangir,
hvęrt fęllr blóðugt · á brjóst grami,
úr-svalt, inn-fjalgt · ękka þrungit.

[Quoth Hallow:] "Thou alone causest, Syerun from the Sevefells,
that Hallow is with harm-dew [BLOOD] whipped.
Thou weepest—O gold-covered—bitter tears—
sun-bright southern lady—before thou goest to sleep.
Each one falls bloody on the prince's chest,
spray-cold, stifled, pressed forth by grief.

**46** Vęl skulum drekka · dýrar vęigar [R 26r/29]
þó'tt misst hafim · munar ok landa!
Skal ęngi maðr · angr-ljóð kveða
þó'tt mér á brjósti · bęnjar líti.
Nú eru brúðir · byrgðar í haugi,
lofða dísir, · hjá oss liðnum!"

Well shall we drink costly draughts,
though we may have lost both joy and lands.
No one shall sing songs of sorrow,
though he behold the wounds on my chest.
Now are the brides shut within the barrow,
the praised one's dises, next to us, passed-on."

---

5–6 brúðir, dísir, oss 'brides, dises, us' | Hallow speaks in the plural. "Now has my bride, my goddess, come into the barrow, next to me, who am dead."

**P15** Sig·rún bjó sęing í haug'inum. [R 26r/32]

Syerun made a bed in the barrow:

**47** „Hér hęfi'k þér, Hęlgi, · hvílu gørva, [R 26v/1]
angr-lausa mjǫk, · Ylfinga niðr;
vil'k þér í faðmi, · fylkir, sofna
sęm'k lofðungi · lifnum mynda'k!"

"Here have I for thee, Hallow, made a place of rest,
nigh sorrowless, O kinsman of the Wolvings!
I will in thy arms, marshal, fall asleep,
like I would with the living man of praise."

---

4 sęm'k lofðungi · lifnum mynda'k! 'like I would with the living man of praise' | I.e. "just as I would if you were still alive."

[Hęlgi kvað:] **48** „Nú kveð'k ęns-kis · ør·vęnt vesa, [R 26v/3]
síð né snimma, · at Sefa-fjǫllum
es þú á armi · ò·lifðum søfr,
hvít, í haugi, · Hǫgna dóttir,
ok est-u kvik, · in konung-borna!"

[Quoth Hallow:] "Now, I say, there is naught more missing
neither late nor early from the Sevefells,
when thou sleepest on the unliving arm,
O white daughter of Hawn, in the barrow,
(and thou art alive!) born of the king."

[Hęlgi kvað:] **49** „Mál 's mér at ríða · roðnar brautir, [R 26v/5]
láta fǫlvan jó · flug-stíg troða;
skal'k fyr vestan · vind-hjalms brúar
áðr Sal-gofnir · sigr-þjóð vęki."

[Quoth Hallow:] “It is time for me to ride the reddening roads,
to let my pale steed tread the path of flight [SKY/HEAVEN].
I must be west of the wind-helm’s bridges [SKY/HEAVEN > CLOUDS?]
before Salgovner awakens the victorious folk.”

---

ALL | The night has passed; dawn is breaking, and Hallow speaks. The manuscript does not indicate the change of scene.

1 roðnar ‘reddening’ | From the rising dawn.

**P16** Þęir Hęlgi riðu lęið sína, en þęr fóru hęim til bójar. Annan aptan lét Sig·rún ambótt halda vǫrð á haugi’num. En at dag-setri, es Sig·rún kom til haugs’ins, hón kvað: [R 26v/7]

Hallow and his men rode on their way, but the women journeyed home to the farm. The next evening Syerun made her maid-servant keep watch on the barrow. And at sunset, as Syerun came to the barrow, quoth she [= the maid-servant]:

**50** „Kominn vęri nú, · ef koma hygði, [R 26v/10]
Sig·mundar burr · frá sǫlum Óðins;
kveð’k grams þinig · grę́na=sk vánir
es á ask-limum · ęrnir sitja
ok drífr drótt ǫll · draum-þinga til.“

“He would be come by now if he had thought to come,
Syemund’s son [= Hallow] from Weden’s halls.
I declare hopes of the prince’s coming fade
when on ashen branches eagles sit
and all mankind drifts off to dream-Things.

---

4 es á ask-limum · ęrnir sitja ‘when on ashen branches eagles sit’ | I.e., “when the eagles roost on yonder trees”. This is a sign of Hallow and his men not coming; if they were, the eagles would be following them and picking at their bodies.

5 drífr … draum-þinga til ‘drifts off to dream-Things’ | Drifts off to the courts of dreams, i.e., falls asleep. A fine metaphor.

**51** Ves ęigi svá ǿr · at ęin farir, [R 26v/12]
dís skjǫldunga, · draug-húsa til!
Verða ǫflgari · allir á nǫ́ttum
dauðir dólgar, męr, · an of daga ljósa.“

Be not so mad that thou journey alone,
O dise of the Shieldings, to the ghost-houses!
Mightier at night do all become
dead fiends, O maiden, than during bright day!”

**P17** Sig·rún varð skamm-líf af harmi ok trega. Þat var trúa í for- [R 26v/14]
2 neskju, at menn vǫ́ri endr·bornir, en þat er nú kǫlluð kerlinga-
villa. Helgi ok Sig·rún er kallat at vǫ́ri endr·borin. Hét hann þá
4 Helgi Haddingja-skati en hón Kára Hálf·danar dóttir, svá sem
kveðit er í Kǫ́ru ljóðum, ok var hón val-kyrja.

Syerun became short-lived for pain and grief. It was the belief in olden times that men were reborn, but that is now called an old wives' tale. Of Hallow and Syerun it is claimed that they were reborn. He was then called Hallow Hardingskate and she Cheer Halfdensdaughter, as is told in the Leeds of Cheer, and she was a walkirrie.

---

1–2 Þat var trúa í forneskju 'It was the belief in olden times' | For another instance of beliefs in *forneskju* 'olden times, antiquity', see *Fáfn* P1.

5 Kǫ́ru ljóðum 'Leeds of Cheer' | A now-lost heroic poem.

# Spae of Griper
# *(Grípis spǫ́)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.616)–late C11th (0.313).
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Spae of Griper** (*Grípis spǫ́*) is a long poem dealing with the life of Siward. It serves as a synopsis for the majority of the Walsing-cycle, especially Siward's dealings with the Yivickings.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Grípis spǫ́* is only preserved in **R**, where it is found on foll. 26v/19–28v/29, following *1 HHund* and foregoing *Reg*.

### Meter

The meter is strict Ancient-words-lay. Anacrusis is occasionally allowed (3/2b, 45/3a). No half-lines of type A3 appear in the b-verse. The length of the stanza is unusually regular; indeed, every single one of the 53 Ancient-words-lay stanzas is exactly 4 lines long, something otherwise attained only by the much shorter *3 Guðr*.

An unusual metrical trait of *Grípis spǫ́* is the occurrence of catalectic lines, likely due to the loss of hiatus. After this had occurred, lines like TODO (< TODO: uncontracted form) and TODO (< TODO: form which was always monosyllabic) would have scanned identically, leading to the acceptance of the new, catalectic type as a genuine metrical type. TODO: Cite Males on Hiatus.

## Dating

Although Sapp (2022)'s model arrives at a most probable early 11th c. date for the poem, this result contradicts with reliable linguistic diagnostic criteria.

TODO: Cite more examples and papers below.

Numerous traits speak to a late date for *Gríp*. Linguistically, the poem displays the sound change *vr-* > *r-* (26/1, 49/1), which indicates a date of composition after 1000 AD. It also shows hiatus contraction, which is not found in Scaldic poetry older than ca. 1150 AD. It has four metrically required occurrences of the short form *Sig·urðr* (16/3, 24/2, 40/2, 53/4), a younger form which is not found in any other Eddic poem apart from *Hdl*, another likely late composition (Sievers 1889, pp. 138–139). In addition, it uses the word *ǫigi* 'not', originally 'not at all, by no means', as an unmarked negator.

Apart from these signs, *Gríp* displays influence from numerous poems in the Walsing-cycle (e.g., 17/4 n.), and serves as an overview for the entire story, which points towards a systematising tendency, something associated with antiquarians of the late 12th and 13th centuries. The poem is also exceptionally regular with regards to the length of the stanza, which probably suggests that it has not been transmitted for very long before ending up in the archetype to the heroic half of **R**.

Together, these traits point convincingly towards a composition in the late 12th, or even early 13th c.

## Summary

The poem begins with the long prose passage *Frá dauða Sin·fjǫtla* 'From the Death of Sinfittle', here P1. This passage may properly be treated as an introduction to the Walsing-poems of **R**, which begin with *Gríp*, and should probably not be seen as part of the poem proper.

In the introductory passage we learn of Siward's relatives, including his father Syemund and his brother Sinfittle. After Sinfittle killed Burhild's brother, Burhild took her revenge by poisoning him, and he died. After sending Sinfittle away in a ship, likely a reflection of pre-Christian ship burials, Syemund left for his own kingdom in France, where he married Hardise, daughter of King eanlime, and begat Siward. Syemund was later slain by the sons of Hunding, and his widow Hardise was thereafter married of to Atholf, the son of King Helpric. Siward grew up in their house (P1).

Siward's maternal uncle was named Griper and renowned for his prophetic abilities. Siward rode alone to his hall, and met the messenger Goater outside (P2). Here the poem proper begins. The first 5 stanzas set the scene of Siward's arrival. Siward asks Goater the name of the king, and Goater answers that his name is Griper (1). Siward asks to see him (2), and states his name (3). Goater goes to Griper and tells him that the young prince is there to see him (4). Griper walks out of his hall and greets Siward (5).

The rest of the poem concerns Siward's life, told in the form of a dialogue where Siward asks and Griper, his uncle, answers. Siward begins by asking how his life will turn out (6), and Griper responds that he will become the highest of all kings (7). Siward asks him what the first thing to happen will be after he departs from his uncle's lands (8), and Griper answers that he will avenge his father by slaying the sons of Hunding (9). Siward asks which other great feats Griper can foresee for him (10), and his uncle answers that he will

slay the greedy wyrm Fathomer and his brother Rein (11). Siward remarks that he will surely win great wealth if that is the case, and asks Griper to continue (12). Griper tells him that he, indeed, will take the wyrm's hoard, and that he will thereafter ride to Yivick (13). Siward asks him what will happen at Yivick's (14), and Griper tells him that he will free a beautiful maiden sleeping on the top of a mountain from her sleep (15). Siward asks what the maiden will tell him after she awakes (16), and Griper tells him that she will teach him important runic spells (17). Siward continues to ask what will happen after that (18), and his uncle tells him that he will be the guest of King Homer. Griper suggests that this is where his spae ends, and tells his nephew not to ask any further questions (19).

Siward expresses his sadness over what Griper has just said, and tells him that he knows that he must have seen a troubling future, but tells his uncle to keep speaking anyways (20). Griper tells him that he could see Siward's youth brightly, but that he has now told him what he has foreseen; he is not rightly considered prophetic (21). Siward insists, and tells his uncle that he is the wisest man he knows upon the earth. He must not conceal his future, even if it is ugly (22). Griper still refuses, and tells Siward that his life will not be filled with blemishes, as his name will go on to be remembered for as long as mankind lives (23). Siward, however, tells him that it would grieve him greatly to part from his uncle without hearing all that he knows (24). At last Griper relents, and tells his nephew that he must take his words to heart, since they are in no wise false (25).

Siward asks his uncle to continue (26), and Griper reveals the name of Homer's foster-daughter: it is Byrnhild (27). Siward asks what her significance will be for him (28), and Griper tells him that he will fall so in love with Byrnhild that he forgets all joy in life (29). Siward next asks what will relive him from that, and whether he will marry her (30); Griper responds that the two will swear all oaths to eachother, but that Siward will forget her after a single night as a guest at Yivick's (31). Siward wonders at why he would do such a thing, since he will love her so much (32), but Griper tells him that he will fall victim to the guiles of Grimhild, Yivick's wife, who will offer him her own daughter, Guthrun (33). Siward asks whether he will marry Guthrun, saying that it would be a noble match (34). Griper tells his nephew about Grimhild's evil counsel: Grimhild will instruct Siward to ask for Byrnhild's hand on behalf of Guther, which Siward will readily do (35). Siward asks how he will be able to do such a thing, since he himself will love Byrnhild (36), but Griper tells him that he, Guther, and Hawn will all swear oaths to each other, and that Siward and Guther will switch shapes on the road to Byrnhild (37). Siward asks what the purpose of that would be, and calls it foolish (38), but Griper explains that Siward will be able to ask for Byrnhild's hand while in the shape of Guther since he will retain his own mind (39). Siward calls this an evil plan, and says that he will surely be known as the worst of men if he tricks a maiden whom he loves so dearly (40), but Griper once again reassures him that he will do it; he will lie beside her like if she were his own mother, and therefore attain great fame (41). Upon their return, Siward and Guther will have a joint wedding in Yivick's hall, after they have regained

their original shapes (42). Siward is still confused, and asks how Guther will be able to marry Byrnhild after she has lain for three nights by Siward's side (43), and whether the whole course of events will turn out pleasant for either him or for Guther (44). Griper tells Siward that he will keep his oaths to the brothers, but that he will tell his wife, Guthrun, about the switching of shapes; she in turn will tell Byrnhild, who will wish to seek revenge for the tricks played upon her (45). Siward asks what sort of recompense Byrnhild will seek (46), and Griper tells him that she will tell her husband, Guther, that Siward does not fully keep his oaths of loyalty to the brothers (47). Siward asks whether that accusation will be true or perjurious (48), and Griper answers that it will be a lie egged on by her wrath, even though Siward has not done any harm to Byrnhild (49). Siward now wonders what the sons of Yivick, Guther, Godthorm, and Hawn will do to him, and whether they will break their in-lawhood by killing him (50). Griper answers that they indeed will, to the grief of Guthrun, who will never find joy again. This is all the doing of Grimhild (51). Even so, Siward must find comfort in the fact that he is the noblest of all men; no more glorious man will come upon the earth (52). Siward tells his uncle to part in peace, and thanks him for doing as he asked; if he had foreseen a brighter future for him, he would surely have told it (53).

## Text

### Frá dauða Sin·fjǫtla ('From the Death of Sinfittle')

**P1** Sig·mundr Vǫlsungs sonr var konungr á Frakk-landi. Sin·fjǫtli var eldstr hans sona, annarr Helgi, þriði Há·mund*r. Borg·hildr, kona Sig·mundar, átti bróður er hét … En Sin·fjǫtli, stjúp-sonr hennar, ok … báðu einnar konu báðir ok fyr þá sǫk drap Sin·fjǫtli hann. En er hann kom heim þá bað Borg·hildr hann fara á brot en Sig·mundr bauð henni fé-bøtr ok þat varð hón at þiggja. En at erfi'nu bar Borg·hildr ǫl. Hón tók eitr mikit, horn fullt, ok bar Sin·fjǫtla. En er hann sá í horn'it skilði hann at eitr var í ok mę́lti til Sig·mundar: „Gjǫr-óttr er drykkr'inn, ái!" Sig·mundr tók horn'it ok drakk af. Svá er sagt at Sig·mundr var harð-gǫrr at hvár-ki mátti hánum eitr granda útan né innan. En allir synir hans stóðu=sk eitr á hǫrund útan. Borg·hildr bar annat horn Sin·fjǫtla ok bað drekka ok fór allt sem fyrr. Ok enn it þriðja sinn bar hón hánum horn'it ok þó á·mę́lis-orð með ef hann drykki eigi af. Hann mę́lti enn sem fyrr við Sig·mund; hann sagði: „Lát-tu grǫn sía þá, sonr!" Sin·fjǫtli drakk ok varð þegar dauðr. Sig·mundr bar hann langar leiðir í fangi sér ok kom at firði einum mjóvum ok lǫngum ok var þar skip eitt lítit ok maðr einn á. Hann bauð Sig·mundi far of fjǫrð'inn. En er Sig·mundr bar lík'it út á skip'it þá var bátr'inn hlaðinn. Karl mę́lti at Sig·mundr skyldi fara fyr inn á fjǫrð'inn. Karl hratt út skip'inu ok hvarf þegar. Sig·mundr konungr dvalði=sk lengi í Danmǫrk í ríki Borg·hildar síðan er hann fekk hennar. Fór Sig·mundr þá suðr í Frakk-land til þess ríkis er hann átti þar. Þá fekk hann Hjǫr·dísar, dóttur Ey·lima konungs. Þeira sonr var Sig·urðr. Sig·mundr konungr fell í orrustu fyr Hundings sonum. En Hjǫr·dís gipti=sk þá Álfi, syni Hjalp·reks konungs. Óx Sig·urðr þar upp í barn-ósku. Sig·mundr ok allir synir hans vóru langt um fram alla menn aðra um afl ok vǫxt ok hug ok alla at·gørvi. Sig·urðr var þá allra framarstr ok hann kalla allir menn í forn-fróðum um alla menn fram ok gǫfgastan her-konunga.

Syemund, Walsing's son, was a king in Frankland. Sinfittle was the eldest of his sons, the other Hallow, the third Highmund. Burhild, Syemund's wife, had a brother whose name was … But Sinfittle, her stepson, and … both asked for the hand of a single woman, and for that reason Sinfittle slew him. But when he came home Burhild bade him go away, but Syemund offered her

restitutory money and she had to accept it. But at the wake Burhild brought forth the ale. She took much venom, a full horn, and brought it to Sinfittle. But when he looked into the horn he understood that there was venom in it, and said to Syemund: "Treacherous is this drink, father!" Syemund took the horn and drank it up. So it is said that Syemund was sturdy enough that venom could not injure him from without nor within. But all his sons [only] withstood evnom on the skin without. Burhild brought another horn to Sinfittle and bade him drink, and everything passed as before. And once more a third time she brought him the horn, and yet with accusatory words if he would not drink it up. He spoke as before with Syemund; he said: "Let thy whisker-hairs sieve it, son!" Sinfittle drank and was shortly dead. Syemund bore him through long journeys in his arms and came to a single firth, narrow and long, and thereat there was one little ship and one man on it. He offered Syemund passage around the firth. But when Syemund bore the body out into the ship then the boat was fully loaded. The churl said that Syemund should journey further inland along the firth. The churl pushed out the ship and shortly disappeared. King Syemund had stayed for a long time in Denmark in Burhild's realm after he got her hand. Thereafter Syemund journeyed south into Frankland to the realm which he had there. Then he got the hand of Hardise, the daughter of King Eanlime. Their son was Siward. King Syemund fell in battle at the hands of the sons of Hunding. But Hardise was then given to Atholf, the son of King Helpric. There Siward grew up in his childhood. Syemund and all his sons were far ahead of all other men in strength and size and thought and all accomplishments. Siward was furthest of them all, and in ancient sources men call him ahead of all men and the most worshipful of raiding kings.

2 Há·mund*r | Hámundir **R** 3 ... | *An unfilled gap for a lost name is clearly indicated in* **R** 4 ... | *A gap is indicated in* **R**

**P2** Grípir hét sonr Ęy·lima, bróðir Hjǫr·dísar. Hann réð lǫndum ok
2 vas allra manna vitrastr ok fram-víss. Sig·urðr ręið ęinn saman ok kom til hallar Grípis. Sig·urðr vas auð-kęnndr. Hann hitti
4 mann at máli úti fyr hǫll'inni; sá nęfndi=sk Gęitir. Þá kvaddi Sig·urðr hann máls, ok spyrr:

Griper was the name of Eanlime's son, Hardise's brother. He ruled lands and was of all men the smartest, and forthwise. Siward rode alone and came to Griper's hall; Siward was easily recognized. He went up to speak to a man outside of the hall; that one called himself Goater. Then Siward greeted him with speech, and asks:

## Grípis spǫ́ ('The Spae of Griper')

**1** „Hvęrr byggir hér · borgir þessar?

Hvat þann þjóð-konung · þegnar nęfna?“
„Grípir hęitir · gumna stjóri,
sá’s fastri rę́ðr · foldu ok þegnum.“

“Who dwells here in these strongholds?
What is this great king called by thanes?”
“Griper is the name of the steerer of men
who rules the steadfast land and thanes.”

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2 þjóð-konung ‘great king’ | An old poetic word, cognate with OE *þéod-cyning* ‘id.’, OS *þiod-kuning* ‘id.’ The first element is most likely to be equated with Gothic *þiuþi-* ‘good’ (in *þiuþi-qiss* ‘blessing’, calquing Greek εὐλογίᾱ, Streitberg 1910, s.v. *þiuþiqiss*) rather than Gothic *þiuda* ‘people, tribe’, ON *þjóð* ‘id.’, OE *þéod* ‘id.’
Its distribution in ON poetry is not altogether neutral. In the Poetic Edda it appears, outside of the present poem, in *Sigsk* 35/3, 36/4, *Akv* 47/3, *Ghv* 14/2, and *Hamð* 4/1, all likely old poems. In Scaldic poetry it appears in the early *Yt* 22 (ca. 850 AD) and *Gldr* 7 (ca. 900 AD), but appears to have been proscribed in the formal praise poetry of the 10th and earliest 11th century until it was revived by Sighwat Thurfrithson in the 1010s, from which point it is found in praise poetry until the extinction of the tradition in the 13th c. In apocryphal Eddic poetry the word only appears in *HjQ 19* and Gunnleif *Merl I* 58 (both in SkP 8).

**2** „Es horskr konungr · hęima ĩ landi?
Mun sá gramr við mik · ganga at męla?
Máls es þarfi · maðr ǫ·kunnigr,
vil’k fljót=liga · finna Grípi.“

“Is the wise king at home in the land?
Will that chief go to speak with me?
In need of speech is this foreign man;
I wish shortly to find Griper.”

**3** „Þęss mun glaðr konungr · Gęiti spyrja
hvęrr sá maðr sé · es máls kveðr Grípi.“
„Sig·urðr ek heiti, · borinn Sig·mundi
ęn Hjǫr·dís es · hilmis móðir.“

“The glad king will ask Goater
who the man is who asks Griper for speech.”
“Siward I am called, born to Syemund,
but Hardise is the helmet-bearer’s [my] mother.”

**4** Þá gekk Gęitir · Grípi at sęgja:
„Hér’s maðr úti · ǫ·kuðr kominn;
hann ’s ítar=ligr · at á·liti;
sá vill, fylkir, · fund þĩnn hafa.“

Then Goater went to tell Griper:
"Here outside a foreign man is come;
he is radiating of hue.
That one, O marshaller, wishes to have thy audience."

**5**

Gęngr ór skála · skatna dróttinn
ok hęilsar vel · hilmi komnum:
„Þigg þú hér, Sig·urðr, · vęri sømra fyrr!
Ęn þú, Gęitir, tak · við Grana sjǫlfum."

Out of his halls goes the lord of warriors
and well greets the helmet-bearer who has come.
"Here receive [welcome], Siward! Sooner would have been more fit!
But thou, Goater, take care of Grane."

---

4 Grana 'Grane' | Siward's horse.

**6**

Męla nǫmu · ok margt hjala
þá's ráð-spakir · rekkar fundu=sk.
[Sig·urðr:] „Sęg-ðu mér ef þú vęizt, · móður-bróðir,
hvé mun Sig·urði · snúna ęvi?"

They took to speak and chatter much
when the council-wise champions found each other.
[Siward:] "Tell me, if thou knowest, O mother's brother:
how will Siward's age turn out?"

**7**

„Þú munt maðr vesa · męstr und sólu
ok hęstr borinn · hvęrjum jǫfri;
gjǫfull af golli · ęn gløggr flugar,
ítr á·liti · ok í orðum spakr."

„Thou wilt be a man noblest beneath the sun,
and born higher than every ruler,
giving of gold but stingy of flight,
radiant of hue and wise in words."

**8**

„Sęg, gęgn konungr, · gørr an ek spyrja
snotr Sig·urði · ef þú sjá þikki=sk,
hvat mun fyrst gøra=sk · til farnaðar
þá's ór garði em'k · gęnginn þínum?"

"Tell it, O fine king, clearer than I might ask,
—O wise—to Siward, if thou seemest to see:

What will first happen to my advantage
when I am gone out of thy house?"

**9**
„Fyrst munt, fylkir, · fǫður of hęfna
ok Ęy·lima · alls harms reka;
þú munt harða · Hundings sonu
snjalla fęlla— · munt sigr hafa."

"First wilt thou, marshaller, take revenge for thy father
and avenge all Eanlime's injuries.
Harshly wilt thou fell the brave sons
of Hunding; thou wilt have victory."

---

2 Ęy·lima · alls harms 'all Eanlime's injuries' | Eanlime was the father of Siward's mother, Hardise, cf. P1 above.

**10**
„Sęg, ítr konungr, · ęttingi mér
hęldr horsk≠liga · es vit hugat mę́lum;
sér þú Sig·urðar · snǫr brǫgð fyr*ir*
þau's hę́st fara · und himin-skautum?"

"Tell, O radiant king, to me, thy kinsman,
rather wisely, as we speak thoughtfully:
foreseest thou any of Siward's nimble deeds
which fare highest under the corners of heaven?"

**11**
„Munt ęinn vega · orm inn frána
þann's grǫ́ðugr liggr · á Gnita-hęiði;
þú munt bǫ́ðum · at bana verða
Ręgin ok Fáfni; · rétt sęgir Grípir."

"Thou alone wilt slay the gleaming Wyrm
which lies greedy on the Gnit-heath.
Thou wilt be the bane of them both:
Rein and Fathomer—Griper tells rightly."

**12**
„Auðr mun órinn · ef ęfli'k svá
víg með virðum · sem þú visst sęgir;
lęið at·huga · ok lęngi sęg
hvat mun ęnn vesa · ę́vi minnar?"

"The wealth will be ample if I accomplish such
a killing amongst men as thou sayest for certain.

Give thy thought to it and speak for long:
what will further become of my age?"

---

3 lęið at·huga 'Give thy thought to it' | *lęiða at·huga* 'give one's thought to something' is a idiomatic (ONP, s.v. *at·hugi*).

**13** „Þú munt finna · Fáfnis bóli
ok upp taka · auð inn fagra,
golli hlóða · á Grana bógu;
ríðr til Gjúka · gramr víg-risinn."

"Thou wilt find Fathomer's dwelling
and take up the fair treasure,
load the gold on Grane's shoulders;
thou wilt ride to Yivick a man proud of killing."

**14** „Ęnn skalt hilmi · í hugaðs-róðu
fram-lyndr jǫfurr · fleira sęgja;
gęstr em'k Gjúka · ok ek gęng þaðan,
hvat mun ęnn vesa · ęvi minnar?"

"Further shalt thou to the marshaller in thoughtful conversation
O forth-minded chieftain, tell more things:
I am the guest of Yivick, and then I go thence;
what will further become of my age?"

**15** „Søfr á fjalli · fylkis dóttir
bjǫrt í brynju · ęptir bana Hęlga;
þú munt hǫggva · hvǫssu sverði,
brynju rísta · með bana Fáfnis."

"On the fell sleeps the marshaller's daughter,
bright in a byrnie, after Hallow's killing.
Thou wilt cut it with a sharp sword,
carve up the byrnie with Fathomer's bane."

---

4 bana Fáfnis 'Fathomer's bane' | Viz. the sword Riddle; cf. *Fáfn* P3.

**16** „Brotin es brynja · brúðr męla tękr
es vaknaði · víf ór svefni;
hvat mun snót at hęldr · við Sig·urð męla
þat 's at farnaði · fylki verði?"

"Broken is the byrnie; the bride takes to speak,
the woman who awakened from her sleep.
What will the wife thereafter speak unto Siward,
which will be to the marshaller's advantage?"

**17** „Hǫ́n mun ríkjum þér · rúnar kǫnna
allar þǽr's aldir · ǫ́igna=sk skyldu
ok á manns tungu · méla hvǫrja;
lif með lǫ́kning · lif hǫ́ill konungr!"

"She will teach thee, O powerful one, runes,
all those which mankind should possess,
and on every man's tongue be spoken.
Live with leeching skill! Live hale, O king!"

---

4 lif með lǫ́kning 'Live with leeching skill!' | I.e., medicinal skill, medicine. Clearly alluding to *Sigrdr* 4/4: *ok lǫ́knis-hǫndr meðan lifum* 'and a leecher's hands, while we live'.

**18** „Þá's því lokit · numin eru fróði
ok em braut þaðan · búinn at ríða;
lǫ́ið at·huga · ok lǫngra sǫg
hvat mun mǫ́irr vesa · minnar ǫ́vi?"

"Then that is come to an end; the learning has been taken,
and I am ready to ride away thence.
Give thy thought to it and speak for longer:
what will yet further become of my age?"

---

1 Þá's því lokit · numin eru fróði | Alliteration is missing from this line and no obvious emendation can be found.

**19** „Þú munt hitta · Hǫ́imis bygðir
ok glaðr vera · gǫstr þjóð-konungs;
farit es, Sig·urðr, · þat's ek fyr·vissa'k,
skal=a frǫmr an svá · fregna Grípi."

"Thou wilt find the farms of Homer
and be the glad guest of that great king.
Now that has passed, O Siward, which I foreknew;
further than so shalt thou not ask Griper."

**20** „Nú fór mér ǫkka · orð þat's méltir
því't langt framm of sér · fylkir lǫngra;
vǫ́itst of·mikit · angr Sig·urði,

4 því þú Grípir þat · gørra sęgja!“

“Now the word which thou hast spoken brings me grief;
for the marshaller foresees much further.
Thou knowest too great trouble for Siward;
therefore shalt thou, Griper, tell that more clearly!”

**21** „Lá mer umb ǿsku · ęvi þinnar
2 ljósast fyr*ir* · líta ęptir;
rétt em’k=a ek · ráð-spakr taliðr
4 ne in heldr fram-víss · farit þat’s ek vissa’k.“

“Throughout the youth of thy age
it was brightest for me to behold.
I am not rightly counted counsel-wise,
nor indeed forthwise; passed is that which I have known.”

**22** „Mann vęit’k ęngi · fyr mold ofan
2 þann’s flęira sé · framm an þú Grípir;
skal=at lęyna · þó’tt ljótt sér
4 eða męin gøri=sk · à mĭnum hag.“

“I know no man above the earth
who foresees more things than thou, Griper.
Thou shalt not hide it, although thou seest ugliness
or evil befalling my state of life.”

**23** „Es=a með lǫstum · lǫgð ęvi þér;
2 lát-tu, inn ítri, · þat, ǫðlingr, nema=sk,
því at uppi mun · meðan ǫld lifir,
4 nadd-éls boði, · nafn þitt vera.“

“With blemishes is thy age not laid out;
let thyself, radiant athling, take that to heart,
for remembered will while mankind lives,
O beseecher of the sword-storm [BATTLE > WARRIOR], thy name be!”

**24** „Verst hyggjum því · verðr at skilja=sk
2 Sig·urðr við fylki · at só-gǫru.
lęið vísa þú · lagt ’s allt fyr*ir*,
4 męrr, mér ef þú vilt · móður bróðir.“

“We think it worst for Siward to part
from the marshaller after such a saying.

Show me the path—all is laid out ahead—
if thou wilt, O famed mother's brother!"

**25** „Nú skal Sig·urði · sęgja gǫrva
alls þęngill mik · til þęss nęyðir;
munt víst vita · at vét-ki lýgr,
døgr ęitt es þér · dauði ętlaðr."

"Now shall I tell Siward clearly
as the prince compels me to do it.
Thou shalt truly know that I nowise lie;
on a single half-day thy death is appointed."

**26** „Vil'k=at ek ręiði · ríks þjóð-konungs
góð-ráðs at * hęldr · Grípis þiggja;
nú vill víst vita · þó'tt vilkit sé
hvat á sýnt Sig·urðr · sér fyr hǫndum."

"I wish not to [face] the anger of the great king,
but rather to receive the good counsel of Griper.
Now I would rather know—although it be gloomy—.
what, plainly, Siward has before him."

2 at * | at at **R**

**27** „Fljóð 's at Hęimis · fagrt á·litum.
hana Bryn·hildi · bragnar nęfna;
dóttir Buðla · ęn dýrr konungr
harð-úgðigt man · Hęimir fóðir."

"There is a lady at Homer's, fair of hue;
her do noble warriors call Byrnhild.
She is the daughter of Budle, but the esteemed king
Homer raises the hard-minded girl."

**28** „Hvat 's mik at því · þó'tt mér sé
fǫgr á·liti · fødd at Hęimis?
Þat skalt Grípir · gǫrva sęgja
því't þú ǫll of sér · ør·lǫg fyr*ir*."

"What does it mean for me, though there be a maiden
fair of hue raised at Homer's?
That shalt thou, Griper, tell clearly,
for thou foreseest all orlays."

**29** „Hǫn firrir þik · flęstu gamni
fǫgr á·liti · fóstra Hęimis;
svefn þú né søfr · né umb sakar dømir
gár=a þú manna · nema þú męy sér.“

“She will deprive thee of most pleasures,
the foster-daughter of Homer, fair of hue.
Thou wilt not sleep thy sleep nor preside over matters;
thou heedest no men if thou canst not see the maiden.”

ALL | The description of Siward’s despair appears to be pulling from *Háv* 114.

3 svefn þú né søfr · né umb sakar dømir | The line closely parallels *2 Guðr* 3/3.

**30** „Hvat mun til líkna · lagt Sig·urði
sęg Grípir þat · ef sjá þikki=sk;
mun’k męy ná · mundi kaupa
þá ina fǫgru · fylkis dóttur?“

“What will be laid out to relieve Siward;
tell, O Griper, that, if thou seemest to see it!
Will I get to buy the maiden for a bride-price,
that fair daughter of the marshaller?”

**31** „It munuð alla · ęiða vinna
full-fast=liga— · fá munuð halda;
vesit hęfir þú Gjúka · gęstr ęina nótt
mant=at horska · Hęimis fóstru.“

“Ye two will swear all oaths,
fully firmly; few will ye keep.
Thou wilt have been the guest of Yivick for a single night;
thou wilt not remember the wise foster-daughter of Homer.”

1 alla ęiða ‘all oaths’ | Probably a legal expression, i.e., oaths on every kind of thing. Cf. *Vkv* 33, *Akv* 33.

**32** „Hvárt ’s þá, Grípir; · gętt þęss fyr mér,
sér þú gęð-lęysi · í grams skapi
es skal við męy þá · mólum slíta
es alls hugar · unna þótt=umk.“

“What shall it be then, O Griper? Reveal it to me!
Seest thou fickleness of mind in the heart of the prince
who shall break the [sworn] words with that maiden
whom I thought myself to love out of all my heart?”

**33** „Þú verðr, siklingr, · fyr svikum annars
munt Grim·hildar · gjalda ráða;
mun bjóða þér · bjart-haddat man
dóttur sína, · dręgr hǫn vél at gram.“

“Thou wilt, O warrior, fall for another’s betrayal;
thou wilt pay for Grimhild’s counsels.
She will offer thee a bright-haired girl,
her own daughter [= Guthrun]; she plots wiles against the prince [thee].”

**34** „Mun’k við þá Gunn·ar · gørva hlęyti
ok Guð·rúnu · ganga at ęiga?
Full-kvęni þá · fylkir vęri
ef męin-tregar · mér angraði=t.“

“Will I form a familiar kinship with Guther and his kin,
and go to have Guthrun?
Fully wedded would the marshaller then be,
if evil sorrows should not grieve me.”

**35** „Þik mun Grim·hildr · gǫrva véla
mun hǫn Bryn·hildar · biðja fýsa
Gunn·ari til handa · Gotna dróttni
hęitr þú fljót=liga fǫr · fylkis móður.“

“Grimhild will beguile thee fully;
she will urge thee to ask for Byrnhild’s hand
on behalf of Guther, the lord of the Gots.
Thou wilt readily promise that journey to the marshaller’s mother.”

**36** „Męin eru fyr hǫndum · má’k líta þat;
ratar gǫr=liga · ráð Sig·urðar,
ef ek skal męrrar · męyjar biðja
ǫðrum til handa · þęirar ek unna vel.“

“Evils are at hand; I can see that.
Fully does Siward’s counsel falter,
if I shall ask for the hand of the famous maiden
whom I love so well on another’s behalf.”

**37** „Ér munuð allir · ęiða vinna
Gunn·arr ok Hǫgni · ęn þú gramr þriði,
því’t litum víxla · es à lęið eruð

Gunn·arr ok þú— · Grípir lýgr ęigi.“

“Ye will all swear oaths,
Guther and Hawn, but thou the third prince,
since ye will exchange your hues when upon the road,
thou and Guther—Griper lies not.”

---

ALL | Guther and Siward switched shapes so that Siward could woo Byrnhild on Guther’s behalf.

**38** „Hví gęgnir þat · hví skulum skipta
litum ok lǫtum · es à lęið erum?
þar mun flá-røði · fylgja annat
atalt með ǫllu— · ęnn sęg Grípir!“

“What does that mean? Why shall we shift
our hues and our sounds whjen upon the road?
TODO.
TODO”

**39** „Lit hęfir þú Gunn·ars · ok lęti hans,
męlsku þína · ok męgin-hyggjur;
munt fastna þér · fram-lundaða
fóstru Hęimis · sér vętr fyr því.“

“Thou wilt have Guther’s hue and his voice;
thy own speech and intelligence;
thou wilt betroth thyself to the forth-minded
foster-daughter of Homer [= Byrnhild]; TODO.”

**40** „Verst hyggjum því, · vándr mun’k hęitinn
Sig·urðr með sęggjum · at só-gǫru;
vilda’k ęigi · vélum bęita
jǫfra brúði · es óðsta vęit’k.“

“We think that the worst; I will be called bad,
Siward amongst men, after such a deed.
I would in no wise with wiles deceive
the chieftains’ bride whom I know to be the noblest.”

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4 brúði | *gramm. and metr. emend.;* brúðr *(nom. sg.)* R.

**41** „Þú munt hvíla, · hęrs odd-viti,
męrr hjá męyju · sem þín móðir sé;
því mun uppi · meðan ǫld lifir,

þjóðar þǫngill, · þitt nafn vera.

"Thou wilt rest, O famous point-knower of the host [WARRIOR],
beside the maiden as if she were thy mother.
For that will remembered while mankind lives,
O prince of the nation, thy name be.

**42** Saman munu bru·llaup · bǽði drukkin
Sig·urðar ok Gunn·ars · í sǫlum Gjúka;
þá hǫmum víxlið · es it hǫim komið,
hǫfir hvǫrr fyr því · hyggju sína."

"Both weddings will be drunk together
—Siward's and Guther's—in the halls of Yivick.
Then ye will shift your hames when ye two come home;
[already] before that each one has his own intelligence."

**43** „Mun góða kvǫn · Gunn·arr ǫiga
mǽrr með mǫnnum, · —mér sǫg Grípir!—
þó'tt hafi þrjár nǽtr · þegns brúðr hjá mér
snar-lynd sofit? · S·líks eru-t dœmi!

"Will Guther have the good woman,
that renowned man amongst men—tell me, O Griper!—
even though she has slept by my side for three nights,
the sharp-minded thane's bride? Such a thing has no precedents!

**44** Hvé mun at ynði · ǫptir verða
mǽgð með mǫnnum? · Mér sǫg Grípir!
Mun Gunn·ari · til gamans ráðit
síðan verða · eða sjǫlfum mér?"

"TODO.
TODO. Tell me, O Griper!
Will things afterwards be decided
to the joy of Guther or to myself?"

**45** „Minnir þik ǫiða · mátt þǫgja þó
ann Guð·rúnu · góðra ráða
ǫn Bryn·hildr þikki=sk · brúðr vas gefin
snót fiðr vélar · sér at hǫfndum."

"TODO.
TODO.

TODO.
TODO”

**46** „Hvat mun at bótum · brúðr sú taka
es vélar vér · vífi gerðum;
hęfir snót af mér · svarna ęiða
ønga ęfnda · en unat lítit?“

“TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO”

**47** „Mun hǫn Gunn·ari · gǫrva sęgja
at þú ęigi vel · ęiðum þyrmir
þá’s ítr konungr · af ǫllum hug
Gjúka arfi · á gram trúði.“

“To Guther will she clearly tell
that thou dost not well respect the oaths,
while that radiant king, out of his whole heart,
—the heir of Yivick—trusted the chief [thee].”

**48** „Hvat ’s þá, Grípir? · Get þęss fyr mér;
mun’k saðr vesa · at sǫgu þęiri,
eða lýgr á mik · lof-sęl kona
ok á sjalfa sik? · Sęg Grípir þat!“

“What happens then, Griper? Reveal it to me;
will I be truthfully accused according to that speech,
or does the woman blessed of praise lie about me
and about her very self? Tell, O Griper, this!”

**49** „Mun fyr ręiði · rík brúðr við þik
né af of·trega · all-vel skipa.
viðr þú góðri · grand aldri=gi
þó ’s víf konungs · vélum bęittuð.“

“TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO”

**50** „Mun horskr Gunn·arr · at hvǫtun hęnnar
Guð·þormr ok Hǫgni · ganga síðan?
Munu synir Gjúka · af sifjungum mér
ęggjar rjóða? · Ęnn sęg Grípir!“

“Will the wise Guther at her instigation,
with Godthorm and Hawn thereafter go?
Will the sons of Yivick, to break their kinship with me,
redden their blades? Tell further, Griper!”

**51** „Þá 's Guð·rúnu · grimmt umb hjarta
bróðr hęnnar þér · til bana ráða,
ok at øngu verðr · ynði síðan
vitru vífi, · vęldr því Grim·hildr.

“Then for Guthrun her heart is full sore;
her brothers betray thee to thy bane
and nothing will thenceforth be to the delight
of the clever wife; Grimhild is at fault for that.

**52** Því skal hugga þik, · hęrs odd-viti,
sú mun gipt lagit · á grams ǫ́vi:
mun=at mǫ́tri maðr · á mold koma
und sólar sjǫt · an, Sig·urðr, þikkir.“

Let it console thee, O point-knower of the host:
this gift will be laid in the ruler's age:
No nobler man will come upon the earth
beneath the seat of the sun [SKY/HEAVEN], than thou, Siward, dost seem!

**53** „Skiljum=k hęilir; · mun=at skǫpum vinna!
Nú hęfir þú, Grípir, vęl · gørt sem bęidda'k;
fljótt myndir þú · fríðri sęgja
mína ǫ́vi · ef þú mǫ́ttir þat!“

“Let us part hale; man will not withstand the shapes!
Now hast thou, Griper, well done as I asked.
Sooner wouldst thou have told finer things
of my age, if thou couldst do so!”

# Speeches of Rein
# *(Reginsmǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.666)–early C11th (0.259)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter, Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Rein** (*Reg*) is a heroic poem, really a prosimetrum, dealing with the youth of Siward the Walsing.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Reg* is preserved in full in **R**, on foll. 28v/30–30r/24, where it follows *Grípp* and precedes *Fáfn*. The text is introduced with a large initial and an illegible title originally in red ink.

Much of the text of *Reg* is also found in *Norn* 4–6, which reproduce the entire sequence *Reg* P6–26 with all stanzas and prose passages. The main ms. for this text is **F**. Although *Norn* 4–6 is clearly textually related to *Reg* in its written form, as seen by the shared prose passages, it is probably not directly derived from **R**, but rather from a sister manuscript. Note that *Norn* also preserves *Helr*.

*Reg* in its written form clearly serves as the basis for two additional sources: *Vǫls* 14–15 and 17–18 (for ch. 16 see *Grípp*) cites sts. 1, 2, 6, and 18 verbatim and paraphrases many others. *Skm* 46–48 relates the whole story of Siward' youth, while clearly also drawing on *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr*.

### The Siward sequence

In **R**, *Reg* is the first of a group of three stylistically similar poems in an unbroken narrative sequence (*Reg*, *Fáfn*, *Sigrdr*). For this reason the whole group will be discussed here.

To begin with, it should be said that there is no obvious textual basis for seeing these three texts as independent units, let alone poems. Although *Fáfn* is introduced by a title and large initial and thus separated from *Reg*,

the division between *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr* is entirely arbitrary, since the two are continuous in **R**. More importantly, none of the three texts is a unitary poetic composition.

Instead, they form a single continuous narrative, told in the same characteristic style: an amalgamation of narrative prose and poetic dialogue-stanzas, alternating between Ancient-words-lay and Leeds-meter. The style of the stanzas in each meter is in fact very similar throughout, so that we may be dealing with two long separate cycles treating the same overarching story, which have been edited into a single text. A particularly likely example of overlap between these potential sources is the speech of the tits in *Fáfn* 32–39, where there is a good narrative progression of thought in the stanzas of each meter, whereas this is confused if one reads both.

That is not to say that the existence of such sources is certain. It is not implausible that the whole sequence was written as a prosimetrum, most likely by a 12th century antiquarian, drawing on older narratives and perhaps incorporating some older poetry, while inventing new ones in both meters. The mixing of meters in a single composition is definitely the case in *HHj*, a very likely antiquarian composition. Within the sequence itself, antiquarian influence is inevitable at least in the rune-spell section of *Sigrdr*, where a post-conversion Latin loanword is found in st. 8/1.

In spite of these arguments, the old division into three texts (or poems) has been retained in the present edition for reasons of accessibility and compatibility with earlier editions. The reader is, however, encouraged to read the entire sequence in order.

## Text

### The Speeches of Rein

**P1** Sig·urðr gekk til stóðs Hjálp·reks ok kaus sér af hest einn er Grani var kallaðr síðan. Þá var kominn Reginn til Hjálp·reks, sonr Hreið·mars. Hann var hverjum manni hagari ok dvergr of vǫxt. Hann var vitr, grimmr ok fjǫl-kunnigr. Reginn veitti Sig·urði fóstr ok kennslu ok elskaði hann mjǫk. Hann sagði Sig·urði frá for·ellri sínu ok þeim at·burðum at Óðinn ok Hønir ok Loki hǫfðu komit til And·vara-fors; í þeim forsi var fjǫlði fiska. Einn dvergr hét And·vari; hann var lǫngum í forsi'num í geddu líki ok fekk sér þar matar.

„Otr hét bróðir várr," kvað Reginn, „er opt fór í fors'inn í otrs líki. Hann hafði tekit einn lax ok sat á ár-bakka'num ok át blundandi. Loki laust hann með steini til bana. Þóttu=sk ǫ́sir mjǫk heppnir verit hafa ok flógu belg af otri'num. Þat sama kveld sóttu þeir gisting til Hreið·mars ok sýndu veiði sína. Þá tóku vér þá hǫndum ok lǫgðum þeim fjǫr-lausn at fylla otr-belg'inn með gulli ok hylja útan ok með rauðu gulli. Þá sendu þeir Loka at afla gulls'ins. Hann kom til Ránar ok fekk net hennar ok fór þá til And·vara-fors ok kastaði neti'nu fyr geddu'na en hón hljóp í net'it. Þá mǫ́lti Loki:

Siward went to Helpric's stable and chose for himself a horse thereof which was thenceforth called Grane. Then Rein, Rethmar's son, had come to Helpric's. He was craftier than every man and a dwarf in stature; he was clever, cruel, and manicunning. Rein granted Siward fosterage and teaching and loved him greatly. He told Siward about his parentage and about the events that Weden, Heener and Lock had come to Andwaresforce; in that force was a multitude of fish. A lone dwarf was called Andware; he was for a long time in the force in the likeness of a pike and got his food there.

"Otter was our brother called," said Rein, "who often went forth in the force in the likeness of an otter. He had caught a salmon and sat on the riverbank and ate it with his eyes closed. Lock struck him with a stone to his death. The Eese thought themselves to have been very lucky and flayed the hide from the otter. That same evening they sought lodgings at Rethmar's house and showed off their catch. Then we bound them and laid upon them as a life-ransom that they should fill the otter-hide with gold and cover even the outside with red gold. Then they sent Lock to procure the gold. He came to Ran and got her net and then journeyed to Andwaresforce and threw the net in front of the pike; and it jumped into the net. Then spoke Lock:

1 Sig·urðr | *The* S *is an ornamented initial 4 lines in height in* **R**.

**1** „Hvat 's þat fiska · es rinn flóði ï;
2 kann=at sér við víti vara=sk?
Hǫfuð þitt · lęys-tu hęlju ór;
4 finn mér lin*d*ar loga!“

"WHAT SORT OF FISH is this that runs in the flood?
It cannot help itself from harm.
Redeem thy head out of Hell;
find me the fountain-flame [GOLD]!"

4 finn | ok finn **N** 4 lin*d*ar | *emend.;* linar **R**; liondar **N**

[And·vari:] **2** „And·vari ek hęiti, · Óinn hét minn faðir,
2 margan hęfi'k fors of farit.
Aumlig norn · skóp oss ï ár-daga
4 at ek skylda ï vatni vaða.“

"Andware I am called; Owen was my father called;
through many a force I have fared.
A wretched norn shaped for us in days of yore
that I should in the water wade."

1 Óinn | Óðinn *wo. doubt corrupt* **N**

**3** „Sęg-ðu þat, And·vari,“ (kvað Loki,) „ef þú ęiga vill
2 líf ï lýða sǫlum:
Hvęr gjǫld · fàa gumna synir
4 ef hǫggvask orðum à?“

"Tell this, Andware," quoth Lock, "if thou wilt own
life in the halls of men:
Which recompense do the sons of men get,
if they hew at each other with words?"

[And·vari:] **4** „Ofr-gjǫld · fàa gumna synir
2 þęir's Vað-gęlmi vaða;
ò·saðra orða · hvęrr's à annan lýgr,
4 of lęngi lęiða limar.“

"Terrible recompense do the sons of men get,
they who in Wadyelmer wade.

By the results of untrue words is each
who lies to another long followed."

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ALL | Watery torment for criminals (both in this life and the next) is well attested in Germanic sources. See *Vsp* 39 and note for discussion.

**P2** Loki sá allt gull þat er And·vari átti. En er hann hafði fram
2 reitt gull'it, þá hafði hann eptir einn hring ok tók Loki þann af
hánum. Dvergr'inn gekk inn í stein'inn ok mǽlti:

Lock saw all the gold which Andware owned. But when he had prepared the gold, then he still had one ring and Lock took it from him. The dwarf went into the stone and spoke:

**5** „Þat skal goll · es Gustr átti
2 bróðrum tvęim · at bana verða
ok ǫ̨ðlingum · átta at rógi;
4 mun mǐns féar · mann=gi njóta."

"That gold which Gust owned shall
for two brothers become the bane,
and for eight nobles the cause of strife;
of my wealth will no man profit."

**P3** Ę́sir reiddu Hreið·mari fé'it ok tráðu upp otr-belg'inn ok reistu á
2 fǿtr; þá skyldu ę́sir'nir hlaða upp gulli'nu ok hylja. En er þat var
gǿrt gekk Hreið·marr framm ok sá eitt grana-hár ok bað hylja.
4 Þá dró Óðinn framm hring'inn And·vara-naut ok hulði hár'it.

The Eese prepared the fee for Rethmar and stuffed the otter-skin and raised it on its feet; then the Eese should load up the gold and cover it. But when it was done Rethmar walked up to it and saw a single whisker strand and bade it be covered. Then Weden drew forth the ring Andwaresgift and covered the strand.

**6** „Goll 's þér nú rętt", (kvað Loki,) „ęn þú gjǫ̨ld hęfir
2 mikil mǐns hǫfuðs;
syni þǐnum · verðr=a sę́la skǫpuð;
4 þat verðr ykkarr bęggja bani!"

"The gold is now prepared for thee," quoth Lock "and thou hast the great payment for my head.
For thy son will no welfare arise;
it will be the bane of you both!"

3 verðr=a | verðr=at **N** 4 verðr | es **N**

ALL | Lock tells Rethmar of the curse.

Hreið·marr sagði: **7** „Gjafar þú gapt— · gapt=at ǫst-gjafar,
2 gapt=at af hęilum hug!
Fjǫrvi yðru · skylduð ér firrðir vesa
4 ef vissa'k þat fár fyrir.

[Rethmar said:] "Thou gavest a gift—gavest not a gift of love;
gavest not out of true heart!
From your lives would ye be far removed,
if I had known that danger before!"

[Loki:] **8** „Ęnn es verra, · þat vita þikkj=umk,
2 niðja stríð of nept;
jǫfra ǫ·borna · hygg þá ęnn vesa
4 es þat 's til hatrs hugat."

[Lock:] "Yet even worse is what I seem to know ahead:
the bitter violence of thy kinsmen.
In princes yet unborn I think it now
intends to stir up strife."

2 stríð of nept 'bitter violence of thy kinsmen' | Following **CV**, *stríð* is taken as the f. sg. adjective *stríðr* 'hard, severe', here 'bitter' and *of nept* as a form of *nefst* f. 'penalty, chastisment'. The implied sense is thus 'the severe violence (inevitably arising from the theft of the hoard) in which thy descendants shall succumb'.

4 þat 'it' | I.e., the hoard.

**9** „Rauðu golli", (kvað Hręið·marr,) „hykk mik ráða munu
2 svá lęngi sem ek lifi;
hót þín · hręð=umk ękki lyf
4 ok haldið hęim heðan!"

"The red gold," quoth Rethmar "I ween I shall wield
so long as I do live.
These threats of thine I fear not a bit—
and turn ye home hence!"

ALL | Rethmar's answer, mocking the idea of the curse as mere "threats", foreshadows how Siward, his descendant, dismisses the curse in *Fáfn* 10 and 21.

4 haldið hęim heðan 'turn ye home hence' | Likely parallelling *Fáfn* 20/2.

**P4** Fáfnir ok Reginn krǫfðu Hreið·mar nið-gjalda eptir Otr, bróður
2 sinn. Hann kvað nei við. En Fáfnir lagði sverði Hreið·mar,
fǫður sinn, sofanda. Hreið·marr kallaði á dǿtr sínar:

Fathomer and Rein demanded from Rethmar the kin-payment for Otter, their brother. He said no to it, but Fathomer ran his sword through Rethmar, his father, sleeping. Rethmar called out to his daughters:

**10** „Lyng·hęiðr ok Lofn·hęiðr, · vitið mínu lífi farit!
2 Mart 's þat's þǫrf þéar!"
Lyng·hęiðr svaraði: „Fǫ́ mun systir, · þó'tt fǫður missi,
4 hęfna hlýra harms."

"Lingheath and Lovenheath! Witness my life destroyed;
much does the need compel!"
Lingheath answered: "Few a sister, though she might miss her father,
will avenge her brother's harm."

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2 Mart 's þat's þǫrf þéar! 'much does the need compel!' | The terrible circumstances require yet more wicked strokes; as his only children, Rethmar's daughters, says he, have a duty to avenge their father, even if by killing their own brother.

**11** „Al þú þó dóttur", (kvað Hręið·marr,) „dís ulf-huguð,
2 ef þú getr=at son · við siklingi;
fá þú męy manni · í męgin-þarfar,
4 þá mun þęirar sonr · þíns harms reka."

"Then beget a daughter," quoth Rethmar, "a wolf-minded lady,
if thou gettest no son by the prince.
Out of great need wed that maiden to a man;
then *her* son will avenge thy harm!"

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3 manni · í męgin-þarfar | mann imeginþarfar **R**

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3 fá þú męy manni · í męgin-þarfar 'Out of great need wed that maiden to a man' | Out of the great need to avenge her father; *þarfar* being pl. of *þǫrf* as used in the previous stanza.

ALL | Rethmar's last words foretell the life of Siward who will come to avenge him by slaying Fathomer. Lingheath must thus marry Eanlime and give birth to Hardise (the so-called "wolf-minded lady"), Siward's mother.

**P5** Þá dó Hreið·marr, en Fáfnir tók gull'it allt. Þá beiddisk Reginn
2 at hafa fǫður-arf sinn, en Fáfnir galt þar nei við. Þá leitaði
Reginn ráða við Lyng·heiði, systur sína, hvernig hann skyldi
4 heimta fǫður-arf sinn. Hón kvað:

Then Rethmar died, but Fathomer took all the gold. Then Rein begged to have his father's inheritance, but Fathomer gave back a no. Then Rein sought counsel from Lingheath, his sister, over how he should take his father's inheritance. Quoth she:

**12** „Brúðar kvęðja · skalt blíð=liga
arfs ok øðra hugar;
es=a þat høft · at þú hjǫrvi skylir
kvęðja Fáfni féar!“

"From the bride shalt thou kindly ask
for heritance and nobler thoughts;
it is not fitting that thou by the sword
shouldst demand Fathomer's wealth!"

1 Brúðar 'From the bride' | "From me." It seems that Lingheath offers Rein her part of the inheritance in an attempt to dissuade him from killing Fathomer.

**P6** Þessa hluti sagði Reginn Sig·urði. Einn dag, er hann kom til húsa Regins, var hánum vel fagnat. Reginn kvað:

These things Rein told Siward. One day when he came to Rein's house he was greeted heartily. Quoth Rein:

ALL | The passage P6–26 is reproduced almost word-for-word in *Norn* 5–6, narrated by the eponymous Norn-Guest who claims to have accompanied Siward on this part of his adventure. TODO: Due to the striking similarity in both verse and prose, indicating a close textual relationship, the mss. of *Norn* are here treated as attesting the same base text as **R**.

**13** „Kominn 's hingat · konr Sig·mundar,
sęggr inn snar-ráði, · til sala várra;
móð hęfir męira · an maðr gamall,
ok es mér fangs vǫn · at frekum ulfi.

"Hither is come the son of Syemund,
the youth of quick counsel to our halls!
He has greater heart than this old man
and I expect a catch from the hungry wolf.

3 maðr gamall 'this old man' | Rein himself, who now plans to use Siward to do what he dares not: take Fathomer's wealth.

**14** Ek mun fóða · folk-djarfan gram;
nú 's yngva konr · með oss kominn;
sjá mun ręsir · ríkstr und sólu,

4 þrymr um ǫll lǫnd · ør·lǫg-símu.“

*I* shall raise the troop-bold prince;
now the son of a king is come in our midst!
This one will become a ruler mightiest under the sun;
he fastens through all lands his orlay-strands!”

---

4 þrymr … ør·lǫg-símu ‘he fastens … his orlay-strands’ | I.e., the strands of his fate are now being fixed through all lands. Cf. *1 HHund* 1–4.

**P7** Sig·urðr var þá jafnan með Regin ok sagði hann Sig·urði at Fáfnir
2 lá á Gnita-heiði ok var í orms líki. Hann átti ógis-hjalm er ǫll
kvikvendi hrǽddu=sk við. Reginn gerði Sig·urði sverð er Gramr
4 hét. Þat var svá hvasst at hann brá því ofan í Rín ok lét reka ullar-
lagð fyr straumi ok tók í sundr lagð’inn sem vatnit. Því sverði
6 klauf Sig·urðr í sundr steðja Regins. Eptir þat eggjaði Reginn
Sig·urð at vega Fáfni. Hann sagði:

Thereafter Siward was always with Rein, and he told Siward that Fathomer lay on the Gnit-heath and was in a Wyrm’s likeness; he owned the helm of awe by which all living things were frightened. Rein made Siward the sword called Gram; it was so sharp that he held it upside down in the Rhine and let a lock of wool float down the stream; and it cut the lock even as it did the water. With that sword Siward struck asunder Rein’s anvil; after that Rein urged Siward to slay Fathomer. He said:

**15** „Hǫ́tt munu hlǽja · Hundings synir
2 þǽir’s Ey·lima · aldrs synjuðu,
ef mǽirr tiggja · munar at sókja
4 hringa rauða · an hǽfnd fǫður.“

“Loudly laugh will Hunding’s sons
—they who denied Eanlime old age—
if the chief is more eager to seek
red rings than revenge for his father.”

**P8** Hjálp·rekr konungr fekk Sig·urði skipa-lið til fǫður-hefnda. Þeir
2 fengu storm mikinn ok beittu fyr bergs-nǫs nakkvara. Maðr
einn stóð á berg’inu ok kvað:

King Helpric got Siward a ship-retinue to revenge his father. They caught a great storm, and tacked their ships below a set of crags. A lone man stood on the crag and quoth:

**16** „Hvęrir ríða þar · Rękfils hęstum
hǫvar unnir, · haf glymjanda?
Segl-vigg eru · svęita stokkin,
mun=at vág-marar · vind of standask.“

“Which men there ride Revil’s horses [SHIPS]
on the high waves, on the roaring sea?
The sail-steeds [SHIPS] are spattered with sweat;
the wave-chargers [SHIPS] will not bear the wind!”

**17** „Hér eru vér Sig·*vǫ*rðr · á sę́-tr*éu*m;
es oss byrr gefinn · við bana sjalfan;
fellr brattr breki · brǫndum hę́ri,
hlunn-vigg hrapa— · hvęrr spyrr at því?“

“Here are we, Siward [and his men], upon sea-trees [SHIPS];
we are given a gust towards our very deaths!
The steep breaker falls higher than flames;
the launcher-steeds [SHIPS] rush forth—who asks of this?”

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R** 1 sę́-tr*éu*m | *metr. emend.;* sę́-trjám **R**

**18** „Hnikar hétu mik · þá’s Hugin gladdi [R 29v/32–30r/1, N]
Vǫlsungr ungi · ok vegit hafði;
nú mátt-u kalla · karl af bergi,
Fęng eða Fjǫlni; · far vil’k þiggja.“

“Nicker they called me when young Walsing
gladdened Highen and had triumphed.
Now mayest thou call me churl-from-the-crag,
Feng or Fillner—I wish to beg passage.”

1 þá’s | *add.* ek *‘I’* **N** 3 bergi | bjargi **N**

1 Hugin gladdi ‘gladdened Highen’ | That is, when he had “fed the raven”, i.e., by the corpses of slain foes on the battlefield.

2 Vǫlsungr ungi ‘young Walsing’ | Siward’s grandfather, the founder of the Walsing dynasty.

**P9** Þeir viku at landi, ok gekk karl á skip, ok lęgði þá veðrit.

They turned to land and the man went on the ship, and then the weather calmed down.

**19** „Sęg mér þat, Hnikarr, · alls hvár-tvęggja vęitst,

goð̵a hęill ok guma:
hvęr bǫzt eru · ef bęrja=sk skal,
hęill at sverða svipun?“

“Tell me this, Nicker, as thou knowest both
the omens of gods and men:
Which are the best—if one shall fight—
omens for the swinging of swords?”

Hnikarr kvað:

**20** „Mǫrg eru góð · ef gumar vissi,
hęill at sverða svipun;
dyggja fylgju · hygg ins dǫkkva vesa
at hrotta-męiði hrafns.

“There are many good—if men would know them—
omens for the swinging of swords.
A good followeress I think the dark one is
for the sword-tree of the raven [WARRIOR].”

**21** Þat es annat · ef est út of kominn
ok est á braut búinn:
tvá þú lítr · á tái standa
hróðr-fúsa hali.

This is another one: if thou art come outside
and art ready on the road:
thou wilt behold two standing on their toes
glory-eager heroes.

**22** Þat ’s it þriðja · ef þjóta hęyrir
ulf und ask-limum,
hęilla auðit · verðr þér af hjalm-stǫfum
ef sér þá fyrri fara.

This is the third: if thou hearest howling
a wolf beneath ashen branches
TODO.
TODO.

**23** Øngr skal gumna · í gǫgn vega
síð skínandi · systur Mána;
þęir sigr hafa · es séa kunnu,
hjǫr-lęiks hvatir, · eða hamalt fylkja.

No man shall fight in evening
facing the shining sister of the Moon [SUN].
Those men brisk in sword-play [BATTLE] have the triumph
who can see—or draw up the flying wedge.

---

4 hamalt fylkja 'draw up the flying wedge' | This formation, known in ON as the *svín-fylking* 'swine-array', was favoured by the Germanic peoples. It is mentioned already in Tacitus, *Germania* ch. 6: *acies per cuneos componitur* 'their troops are drawn up in a wedge-like formation'. In the legendary saws the swine-array has a particular association with Weden. According to *Fornk* he taught it to the Danish king Harold Hildtooth, who went on to win great victories with the formation until Weden betrayed him and taught it to the Swedish king Siward Ring, who defeated and slew Harold at the battle of the Browolds (*Brávǫllir*). So *Fornk* 8: *Brúni segir: „Svá lít=sk mér sem Hringr muni búinn at berja=sk ok hans lið. Hann hefir undar=liga fylkt. Hann hefir svín-fylkt her sínum, ok mun eigi gott at berja=sk við hann.“ Þá segir Haraldr konungr: „Hverr mun Hringi hafa kennt hamalt at fylkja? Ek hugða engan kunna nema mik ok Óðin, eða mun Óðinn vilja skjǫpla=sk í sigr-gjǫf inni við mik?* [...]“ 'Brown says: "It seems to me that Ring is ready to fight, and his troop too. He has drawn them up in a strange way; he has drawn up his host in the swine-array, and it will not be good to fight against him. Then says king Harold: "Who can have taught Ring to draw up the flying wedge? I thought no one knew it save for me and Weden, or does Weden wish to take back his gift of victory from me? [...]"'

**24**

Þat 's fár mikit · ef føti drepr
þar's þú at vígi vęðr;
tálar dísir · standa þér á tvér hliðar
ok vilja þik sáran séa.

It is a great peril if thou stumblest thy foot
where thou wadest forth in war.
Treacherous dises stand on thy either side
and wish to see thee harmed.

**25**

Kęmbðr ok þvęginn · skal kónna hvęrr
ok at morni męttr,
því't ó-sýnt es · hvar at aptni kømr;
illt 's fyr hęill at hrapa.

Combed and washed shall each keen man be,
and by morning fed,
for it is unseen where by evening he comes—
it is ill to rush ahead of the omens!

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ALL | The wording of the first half of this stanza is very close to *Háv* 61 and *Vsp* 33; for personal hygiene and bathing in the culture see note to the former.

## Capitulum ('New Chapter')

**P10** Sig·urðr átti orrustu mikla við Lyngva Hundings son ok bróðr hans. Þar fell Lyngvi ok þeir þrír bróðr. Eptir orrustu kvað Reginn:

SIWARD HAD a great battle with Ling, Hunding's son, and his brothers. There fell Ling and the three brothers. After the battle quoth Rein:

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ALL | *This passage is introduced by a bolded initial in* **R** *and has a small title marking it as the start of a new section in the text.*

**26** Nú 's blóðugr ǫrn · bitrum hjǫrvi
bana Sig·mundar · á baki ristinn;
øngr es frǫmri, · sá's fold ryði,
hilmis arfi · ok Hugin gladdi!

Now the bloody eagle with a bitter sword
is carved on the back of Syemund's bane.
No chieftain's heir is more successful
who has reddened the earth and gladdened Highen!

---

4 Hugin gladdi 'has gladdened Highen' | See above.

**P11** Heim fór Sig·urðr til Hjálp·reks. Þá eggjaði Reginn Sig·urð til at vega Fáfni. Sig·urðr ok Reginn fóru upp á Gnita-heiði ok hittu þar slóð Fáfnis þá er hann skreið til vats. Þar gørði Sig·urðr grǫf mikla á vegi'num ok gekk Sig·urðr þar í. En er Fáfnir skreið af gulli'nu blés hann eitri ok hraut þat fyr ofan hǫfuð Sig·urði. En er Fáfnir skreið yfir grǫf'ina þá lagði Sig·urðr hann með sverði til hjarta. Fáfnir hristi sik ok barði hǫfði ok sporði. Sig·urðr hljóp ór grǫf'inni ok sá þá hvárr annan. Fáfnir kvað:

Siward journeyed home to Helpric. Then Rein urged Siward on to fight Fathomer. Siward and Rein journeyed up on the Gnit-heath and found there Siward's trail as he was crawling to a body of water. There Siward made a great trench in the way and Siward went down into it. But when Fathomer crawled off from the gold he blew venom, and it flew over Siward's head. But when Fathomer crawled over the trench, then Siward ran him through with his sword unto the heart. Fathomer recoiled and twisted his head and spurned. Siward leapt out of the trench, and then each of them saw the other. Quoth Fathomer:

# Speeches of Fathomer
# *(Fáfnis mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.442)–early C11th (0.402)
**Meter:** Leeds-meter, Ancient-words-lay (TODO)

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Fathomer** (*Fáfn*) is a heroic prosimetrum dealing with the aftermath of Siward's slaying of the wyrm Fathomer. It forms a continuous prosmetric narrative with the preceding *Reg* and the following *Sigrdr*.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Fáfn* is only preserved in full in **R**, on foll. 30r/25–31v/25, where it follows *Reg* and is followed by *Sigrdr*. The boundary between *Fáfn* and *Sigrdr* is editorial, since the two form a continuous section of text with no divisions of any kind between them. **R** gives it the title *Frá dauða Fáfnis* 'From the death of Fathomer'.

The poetry of *Fáfn* is closely paraphrased by *Vǫls* 18–20, and it is clear that the now-lost source underlying that text was near-identical to **R**.

Three stanzas from *Fáfn* are cited in *SnE*: st. 13 in *Gylf* and 32–33 in *Skm*.

### Origin and motifs

Siward's slaying of the wyrm Fathomer was an exceptionally famous story in Scandinavia during the Wiking Age and Middle Ages. Outside of *Reg*–*Fáfn* and *Vǫls*, the narrative is referenced in Scaldic poetry (TODO) and retold in *Skm*.

The killing is also depicted pictorally on numerous objects. The most important of these depictions is the Swedish runic inscription Sö 101 from Ramsund, Södermanland, dating to ca. 1030 AD (Fig. 9, p. 536). Sö 101 is inscribed on a single large, flat rock-face with a generic memorial epitaph, but the runes themselves are placed in the body of a long serpent or wyrm, and the rock-face is ornamented with numerous details from the story. At

the bottom right of the carved surface, a figure thrusts a sword through the wyrm's body, and in the space enclosed by the wyrm several important events following Siward's slaying of Fathomer are depicted with remarkable fidelity to the version preserved in the Norse-Icelandic sources.

## Summary

The poem begins just as Siward has fatally wounded Fathomer. The wyrm notes his young age asks him for his name and father; he exclaims that the sword has pierced his heart (1). The prose says that Siward hid his name out of a superstitious belief in names as curses (P1). Siward tells Fathomer that his name is Noble Deer and that he has no father (2). Fathomer asks how he was conceived, in that case (3). Siward now reveals his name and paternity; he is Siward, son of Syemund, but Fathomer will not know of his lineage (4).

Fathomer asks who incited Siward to murder him; he notes that Siward must have had a peculiar father to slay him at such an age (5). Siward responds that he was only driven by his courage and has no accomplices beyond his own hands; one who is soft in childhood will seldom harden by age (6). Fathomer tells Siward that he is not as brave as he thinks and calls him a captive of war (7). Siward responds that he is not a captive; Fathomer himself has experienced that he is loose and free (8). Fathomer berates him for his spiteful answers and tells him that his gold be his death (9). Siward answers that every man must die at some point; he will take the gold regardless (10). Fathomer warns him further about the curse; he will perish soon, in any sort of unforeseen circumstance (11).

The following four stanzas are mythological and rather out-of-place. Siward asks about the origins of the Norns and Fathomer answers (12–13); he then asks about where the Gods will fight against Surt (14–15).

Fathomer reflects about his own arrogance; while he lay on his hoard he carried a "helmet of awe" above mankind and thought himseslf superior to all (16). Siward answers that no man is ever invincible (17). Fathomer says that he blew venom while he lay on his father's treasure (18); Siward says that he did, but that the helmet which he wore only created greater enmity for him (19).

The wyrm once again tries warning the hero about the curse; he advices him to ride home immediately (20). Siward tells him that he has heard the counsel, but that he will take the treasure anyways while Fathomer expires in his blood (21). Fathomer speaks his last words: Rein betrayed him, but he will betray Siward too; he dies (22).

A second prose passage says that Rein had disappeared while Siward slew Fathomer, but that he returned as Siward was drying the blood from his sword (P2). Rein greets Siward and praises his bravery (23). Siward tells him that bravery is never certain until proven (24). Rein notes that the youth is happy, but reflects that he himself played a part in the death of his own brother (25). Siward tells him that it was indeed only with Rein's help that he could have slain Fathomer (26).

The prose tells us that Rein went up to Fathomer and cut the heart from him and drank some of his blood (P3). Rein asks Siward to roast Fathomer's heart by the fire while he himself sleeps (27). Siward, perhaps unhappy with the assignment, tells him that it was he used his strength against the Wyrm while Rein lay hiding (28). Rein tells him that it was only by the use of the sword which he gave Siward that he could have slain him (29), but Siward tells him that courage is better than the strength of the sword (30–31).

One of the most famous parts of the narrative comes in prose. Siward took Fathomer's heart and roasted it, but to check whether it was done he touched it with his finger; he burned himself and put the finger in his mouth. At the moment the blood touched his tongue he understood the speeches of some birds above him, and one of them was chattering (P4). The first bird chatters that it would think Siward wiser if he ate the heart himself (32). The second continues that Rein is planning to betray him and avenge his brother (33). The third says that Siward ought to kill Rein first and take the whole treasure for himself (34). The fourth says that would think Siward smart if he would follow the counsel of its sisters (35). The birds continue: Siward is not as wise as they thought if he chooses to spare Rein (36–37); he ought to kill him and take his wealth (38). Siward says that evil fate will not overpower him; he will slay Rein (39). So he does; he then eats Fathomer's heart and drinks his blood and Rein's (P5).

The birds continue with their advice. They tell Siward to hurry to the house of a noble maiden (40). She is Yivick's daughter, and fate will guide him to her so that they may marry (41). Next they tell him of a hall surrounded by fire on the Hindfell (42); the walkirrie sleeping there has been stung with a sleeping-thorn (43), and Siward can only break her sleep in accordance with fate (44).

The prose concludes. Siward followed the advice of the birds and rode up to Fathomer's dwelling where he took the gold and the helmet of awe. He loaded the treasures onto his horse, Grane (P5).




Figure 9: The Ramsund carving. Wiking Age, ca. 1030 AD. *Details depicted: 1. Siward slays Fathomer. 2. Siward roasts Fathomer's heart by a fire; he burns his finger and puts it in his mouth to cool it, inadvertently tasting the blood. 3. Two birds sit in the tree, presumably talking to Siward. 4. Rein lies decapitated surrounded by his bellows, tongs, and anvil. 5. Grane stands loaded with a chest on his back. 6. A wolf or dog; the only detail not found in* Reg–Fáfn. © Bengt A. Lundgren/RAÄ. CC BY 4.0. `https://pub.raa.se/visa/dokumentation/7dd6614e-950b-42bf-b31f-4f910c74e936`

## Text

### Frá dauða Fáfnis ('From Fathomer's death')

[Fáfnir:] **1** „Sveinn ok sveinn! · Hverjum est svein*n* of borinn? [R TODO]
Hverra est manna mǫgr?
es þú á Fáfni rautt · þinn inn frána mæki;
stǫnd=umk til hjarta hjǫrr!“

[Fathomer:] "O SWAIN AND SWAIN! To whom art thou, swain, born?
Of which men art thou the son?
When thou on Fathomer hast reddened this thy gleaming blade;
the sword stands unto my heart!"

1 svein*n* | *emend.;* sveini *(dat. sg.)* **R**

1 Sveinn ok sveinn! 'O swain and swain!' | Fathomer remarks on Siward's youth; the hero is still a boy (cf. *Hárb* 1/1 for the semantics of *sveinn*).

1 svein*n* | The emendation from dat. to nom. sg. yields somewhat better sense (*sveinn* 'swain, lad' should probably not be used of Siward's father), and is supported by the parallel lines in *Fjǫl* 6/1. A change from nom. to dat. sg is easily explained by mistaken grammatical agreement with the dat. sg. *hverjum* 'to whom' earlier in the line.

**P1** Sig·urðr dulði nafns síns fyr því at þat var trúa þeira í forneskju
at orð feigs manns mętti mikit ef hann bǫlvaði ó·vin sínum með
nafni. Hann kvað:

Siward belied his name, for it was their belief in olden times that a fey man's word could do much if he cursed his foe by name. Quoth he:

1 þat var trúa þeira í forneskju 'it was their belief in olden times' | For another instance of beliefs in *forneskju* 'olden times, antiquity', see *2 HHund* P17.

**2** „Gǫfugt dýr ek hęiti · ęn ek gęngit hef'k [R TODO]
inn móður-lausi mǫgr,
fǫður ek á'kk=a · sem fira synir,
gęng ek *ǽ* ęinn saman.“

"Noble Hart I am called, but I have gone
as the motherless lad.
A father I have not like the sons of men;
I go for ever alone."

4 *ǽ* 'for ever' | *conj. emend. (so Neckel and Kuhn 1983); om.* **R**

1 Gǫfugt dýr ‘Noble Deer’ | Or ‘Noble Hart’. The hero Siward appears to have a particular association with the stag, something also seen in *2 Guðr* 2. The association between hero, king, and stag in Germanic culture has old roots, as does the depiction of the stag locked in battle with the serpent, a motif found, e.g., on the Urnes stave church (figure 10, p. 539). See further Krause (2021).
Into this web of associations one may further draw the god Frea, the godly ancestor of kings (consider that Siward himself is called *Freys vinr* ‘Frea’s friend’ in *Sigsk* 24/4). In the mythology, Frea fights against the ettin Bellower armed with an antler (*Vsp* 51/3 n.); in heroic legend, the Danish kings (the *Ing-winas* ‘Friends of Ing’ in *Beow* 1044, 1319; note that Ing and Frea are synoymous) rule the hall *Herut* ‘the Deer’.
An interesting archaeological parallel is the large stone sceptre found in the king’s mound at Sutton Hoo (for an archaeological description of this object see Enright (1983)). The sceptre is relevant since it has attached at its top an iron ring, surmounted by a beautiful bronze hart. With its great branching antlers, the hart comes off as a striking symbol of martial kingship, and the object as a whole most likely represents the same ideology as we find in the Norse and English heroic poetry.

4 gęng ek *ǽ* ęinn saman | The adverb *ǽ* is supplied in this line for metrical reasons and is supported by the sense of the line. Without it, the line would require the pronoun *ek* following *gęng* to be fully stressed and alliterating, but this is unnatural, and one would sooner expect the personal pronoun in such a position to be cliticised than to carry full stress.

[Fáfnir:] **3** „Vętitst, ef fǫður né átt=at · sem fira synir, [R TODO]
2 af hvęrju vastu undri alinn?“
[...]

[Fathomer:] “Knowest thou, if thou hast no father like the sons of men,
by which wonder thou wast begotten?”

ALL | *Vǫls* 18 paraphrases: *Ef þú átt engan fǫður né móður, af hverju undri ertu þá alinn? Ok þótt þú segir mér eigi þitt nafn á bana-dógri mínu, þá veiztu, at þú lýgr nú.* ‘If thou hast no father or mother, by which wonder art thou begotten? And although thou wilt not tell me thy name in my hour of death, thou knowest that thou art lying.’

3 [...] | Two lines appear to be missing here, but they may have survived in the version of the poem underlying *Vǫls*, judging by its paraphrase (see note to ALL). It is apparently this now-missing appeal to Siward’s conscience—it would be dishonourable for him to lie to the dying Fathomer—that makes the young hero reveal his true name.

[Sig·urðr:] **4** „Ét̨terni mitt · kveð’k þér ȯ·kunnigt vesa [R TODO]
2 ok mik sjalfan hit sama:
Sig·urðr ek hęiti · Sig·mundr hét mínn faðir
4 es hęf’k þik vǫ́pnum vegit.“

[Siward:] “My lineage, I say, is unknown to thee,
and my self the same.
Siward I am called—Syemund was called my father—
who with weapons have smitten thee.”

2 ok mik sjalfan hit sama ‘and my self the same’ | Fathomer would not recognise Siward’s lineage (i.e., his father) or name, since he is an orphan who up until this point has not accomplished much. Siward is not saying that his lineage is unknown even to himself, since *sjalfan mik* ‘my self’ is in the accusative, not the dative.



Figure 10: Detail of a struggling stag and serpent on the Urnes Stave Church, a common motif of the Urnes style. High Mediaeval, ca. 1140 AD. © Micha L. Rieser. `https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Stave_church_Urnes,_craving_detail_1.jpg`

[Fáfnir:] **5** „Hvęrr þik hvatti, · hví hvętja=sk lést, [**R** TODO]
2 mĭnu fjǫrvi at fara?
Inn frán-ęygi svęinn, · þú áttir fǫður bitran,
4 á-bornu skjór á skęið.“

[Fathomer:] “Who goaded thee? Why didst thou let thyself be goaded
my life for to destroy?
O gleaming-eyed swain, thou hadst a sharp father;
inborn traits show quickly.”

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4 á-bornu skjór á skęið. ‘inborn traits show quickly’ | The original is cryptic. *á skęið* means roughly ‘rapidly, quickly’, whence the expression *ríða á skęið* ‘CV: to ride at full speed’, but the other words are uncertain. La Farge and Tucker (1992) read ‘your innate qualities show quickly’, suggesting two unattested words: an adjective **áborinn* ‘innate, inborn’ and a verb **skjóa* ‘to show’. Yet the lack of i-umlaut in the supposed 3rd sg. pres. ind. *skjór* is difficult, since we would expect ***skýr*, as in *skjóta* ‘to shoot,’ with 2nd/3rd sg. pres. ind *skýtr*. A solution would be emending to a 2nd sg. pres. subj. *skjóir*, but this has not been undertaken.

[Sig·urðr:] **6** „Hugr mik hvatti, · hęndr mér full-týðu [**R** TODO, **F** TODO]
2 ok mĭnn inn hvassi hjǫrr;
fár es hvatr · es hrøða=sk tękr
4 ef í barn-øsku es blauðr.“

[Siward:] “My heart goaded me; my hands availed me
and this my sharp sword.
Few a man is bold when he takes to grow,
if in childhood he be soft.”

---

3 hrøða=sk | hrørna **F** 4 í barn-øsku es ‘in childhood he be’ | hann er í bernsku til *‘he is in childhood too’* **F**

---

ALL | Ll. 3–4 of this stanza are cited in variant form in *Sv* 124 in **F**. Cf. *Vǫlsbr* S1, cited in the same chapter.

[Fáfnir:] **7** „Vęit’k, ef þú vaxa nęðir · fyr þinna vina brjósti, [**R** TODO]
2 séi maðr þik *v*reįðan vega;
nú est haptr · ok hęr-numinn,
4 ę kveða bandingja bifa=sk.“

[Fathomer:] “I know that if thou hadst grown up by thy kinsmen’s chest,
man would see thee wrathfully fight.
Now thou art captive and war-taken;
they say the boundling always trembles.”

---

ALL | Fathomer seems to tell Siward that he is not as brave as he says he is. A truly fierce man would not speak with the one he had just mortally injured, but rather finish the slaying completely (i.e., *vreįðr vega* ‘fight wrathfully’). If Siward had grown up with his father that is what he would have done; instead, he must be a captive of some kind.

2 *v*rǫ́ðan vega ‘wrathfully fight’ | Formulaic word-pair. TODO.

[Sig·urðr:] **8** „Því bregðr þú nú mér, Fáfnir, · at til fjarri sjá’k [R TODO]
2 mínum fǫðr-munum,
ǫ́igi em’k haptr · þó’tt vé́ra hǫr-numi;
4 þú fannt, at ek lauss lifi!“

[Siward:] “Thou dost now upbraid me, O Fathomer, for that I be too far
from the love of my fathers.
I am nowise captive, although I be war-taken;
thou hast found that I live loose!”

[Fáfnir:] **9** „Hǫ́ipt-yrði ǫ́in · tǫ́lr þú þér í hví-vǫ́tna [R TODO]
2 ǫ́n ek þér satt ǫ́itt sǫ́gi’k:
It gjalla goll · ok it glóð-rauða fé,
4 þér verða þǫ́ir baugar at bana!“

[Fathomer:] “With hateful words alone dost thou answer everything,
but I tell thee truth alone:
The clanging gold and the glowing red wealth—
those bighs will be thy bane!”

[Sig·urðr:] **10** „Féi ráða · skal fyrða hvǫrr [R TODO]
2 ǫ́ til ins ǫ́ina dags
því’t ǫ́inu sinni · skal alda hvǫrr
4 fara til hǫljar heðan.“

[Siward:] “Rule his wealth shall every man
for ever, until the one day;
for at one time shall every man
journey hence to Hell.”

---

ALL | Siward dismisses the curse. He is a man, and therefore mortal; he must die regardless of whether he takes the gold or not, and it is better to die wealthy and renowned than wretched and unknown.

2 ins ǫ́ina dags ‘the one day’ | His predetermined day of death.

[Fáfnir:] **11** „Norna dóm · munt fyr nǫ́sjum hafa [R TODO]
2 ok *ør·lǫg* ó·svinns apa;
í vatni þú drukknar · ef í vindi rør;
4 allt es fǫ́igs forað.“

[Fathomer:] “The doom of the Norns shalt thou have before the headlands,
and the orlay of an unwise ape:

Thou wilt drown in water if thou rowest in wind;
everything is the fey man's peril."

---

2 *ør·lǫg* 'the orlay' | *conj. emend. (Bugge 1867, p. 414); om.* **R**

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ALL | Fathomer points out the danger of the curse: insidious death will find Siward in any unforeseen circumstance and his fated death will be imminent. — *Vǫls* 18 paraphrases: *Fátt vill þú at mínum dómum gera, en drukkna muntu, ef þú ferr um sjá ó·varliga, ok bíð heldr á landi, und's logn er.* 'Thou hast little wish to act according to my examples, but thou wilt drown if thou goest to journey carelessly at sea, so do rather abide on land until it is calm.' It is notable that the redactor of *Vǫls* misunderstood the import of the stanza when he took it to be a warning specifically against sailing on the windy sea, which, of course, is only one example of the many potential ways in which Siward might die.

1 Norna dóm 'The doom of the Norns' | The time when the Norns decree that one should die, one's predestined hour of death (cf. *Skí* 13/3, *Gríp* 25/4); the same expression is found in *Yt* 24: *þá's Half·danr … / norna dóms · of notit hafði* 'when Halfden had used up the "doom of the Norns"', i.e., when it was his time to die. The expression appeares synonymous with *kviðr norna* 'verdict of the Norns', *Hamð* 30/4; for law-terms used in association with the Norns, cf. also *Vsp* 19/5–6.

1 fyr nęsjum 'before the headlands' | I.e., 'close at hand, imminent', an established metaphor for imminent death. Cf. *Sont* 25, where Eyel concludes his poem by declaring that Hell (the goddess of Death) *á nęsjum stęndr* 'stands upon the headlands'.

2 *ør·lǫg* 'the orlay' | Without this word, the gen. *ó·svinns apa* 'of an unwise ape' would modify *dóm* 'judgment', which hardly makes sense. The emendation provides better sense; Siward will have the orlay (fate, destiny) of an unwise fool, since any difficult situation will bring him death as stated in ll. 3–4.

[Sig·urðr:] **12** „Sęg mér, Fáfnir, · alls þik fróðan kveða [**R** TODO]
ok vęl mart vita:
Hvęrjar 'ro þęr nornir · es nauð-gǫnglar 'ro
ok kjósa móðr frá mǫgum?"

[Siward:] "Tell me, Fathomer, as they call thee wise
and knowing well enough:
Which are the Norns that attend in need
and choose mothers from their lads?"

---

ALL | Sts. 12–15 consist of two general mythological questions in a style most closely resembling *Vafþ.* These questions do not at all contribute to the narrative and it is not impossible that yet more of them have been removed for that reason; cf. note to st. 16.

3 es nauð-gǫnglar 'ro 'attend in need' | Lit. 'are attendant in need'; they help ailing mothers during childbirth. Cf. *Sigrdr* 9.

[Fáfnir:] **13** „Sundr-bornar mjǫk · hykk at nornir séi, [**R** TODO, **S** 5r/11, **T** 5v/14, **W** 8r/22, **U** 6v/12]
ęigu-t þęr ętt saman;
sumar 'ro ǫs-kunngar, · sumar alf-kunngar,
sumar dótr Dvalins."

[Fathomer:] "Of most sundry birth I judge the norns to be;
they have not a common lineage.

Some are Os-born, some Elf-born,
 some the daughters of Dwollen [DWARFESSES].”

---

1 mjǫk ‘most’ | *om.* **U** 1 hykk | sęgi’k **W** 1 at | *om.* **U** 1 séi | vera **U** 3 ǫ́s-kunngar | ǫ́s-kunnar **S**; al-kunnigar **T**; ǫ́s-kyndar **U** 3 sumar | *add.* ’ro **SW** 3 alf-kunngar | alf-kunnar **S**; alf-kyndar **U** 4 sumar | *add.* ’ro (‘ero’) **U**

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ALL | This stanza is cited in *Gylf* 15:32. TODO.

[Sig·urðr:] **14** „Sęg mér þat, Fáfnir, · alls þik fróðan kveða [R TODO]
2 ok vęl margt vita,
hvé sá holmr hęitir · es blanda hjǫr-lęgi
4 Surtr ok ésir saman.“

[Siward:] “Tell me this, Fathomer, as they call thee wise
 and knowing well enough:
What is the islet called, where Surt and the Eese
 blend sword-water [BLOOD] together?”

---

3–4 hvé ... saman. ‘What ... together?’ | Namely at the Rakes of the Reins. For the fight between Surt and the Gods see *Vsp* 48–53, *Vafþ* 17–18.

[Fáfnir:] **15** „Ó·skópnir hęitir · ęn þar ǫll skulu [R TODO]
2 gęirum lęika góð;
Bil-rǫst brotnar · es á brott fara
4 ok svima í móðu marir.

[Fathomer:] “Unshopner it is called, and there shall all
 the Gods play with spears [MAKE WAR];
Bilrest shatters when they ride on their way
 and the steeds swim in the sea.

---

1 Ó·skópnir ‘Unshopner’ | An otherwise unattested name.

3–4 Bil-rǫst ... marir. ‘Bilrest ... the sea.’ | Bilrest is an alternative name for Bivrest, the Rainbow Bridge. — These lines are explained by a passage of Snorre, *Gylf* 13:6: *Ok svá sem hón er sterk, þá mun hón brotna þá er Mu·spells megir fara ok ríða hana, ok svima hestar þeira yfir stórar ár. Svá koma þeir fram.* ‘And strong as it [Bivrest] is, yet it will shatter when the lads of Muspell fare and ride over it, and then their horses swim through great rivers. So they make it forwards.’

**16** „Ógis hjalm · bar’k of alda sonum [R TODO]
2 meðan of męnjum lá’k;
ęinn rammari · hugð=umk ǫllum vesa,
4 fann’k=a’k marga mǫgu.

The helmet of awe I bore above the sons of men
 while on the neckrings I lay;

stronger than all I thought me alone to be;
I did not find many lads."

---

ALL | Fathomer continues speaking, but there is probably something missing here, since the transition away from the mythological questions in 12–15 is abrupt. It seems not unlikely that there were originally even more mythological questions, but that they have been excised for their perceived lack of relevance to the overarching narrative. Between its paraphrases of st. 15 and of st. 16, *Vǫls* 18 has *Ok enn mélti Fáfnir: „Reginn bróðir minn veldr mínum dauða, ok þat hlégir mik, er hann veldr ok þínum dauða, ok ferr þá, sem hann vildi.*" 'And further Fathomer spoke: "Rein, my brother, is the cause of my death, and it gladdens me that he will also cause thy death; and then it will go as he has willed."', which may perhaps be a paraphrase of a lost st.

1 Ógis hjalm 'The helmet of awe' | TODO: a mythological object or just an expression?

[Sig·urðr:] **17** „Ógis hjalmr · bergr ęinu=gi [**R** TODO]
2 hvar's skulu *v*ręiðir vega;
þá þat finnr · es með flęirum kømr
4 at ęngi es ęinna hvatastr."

[Siward:] "The helmet of awe rescues no man
wherever the wroth shall fight;
this he then finds when among the many he comes—
that none is the boldest of all."

---

3–4 þá þat finnr · es með flęirum kømr / at ęngi es ęinna hvatastr 'this he then finds when among the many he comes— / that none is the boldest of all' | Near-identical to *Háv* 64/3–4; see there.

[Fáfnir:] **18** „Ęitri ek fnósta · es á arfi lá'k [**R** TODO]
2 miklum mǐns fǫður."

[Fathomer:] "Venom I snorted while I lay on the great
inheritance of my father."

[Sig·urðr:] **19** „Inn rammi ormr, · þú gørðir fręs mikla [**R** TODO]
2 ok gatst harðan hug;
hęipt at męiri · verðr hǫlða sonum
4 at þann hjalm hafi."

[Siward:] "O mighty wyrm, thou madest a great snort,
and didst get a hard heart.
Greater hatred arises for the sons of men
who might have that helm."

---

1 Inn rammi ormr, · þú gørðir fręs mikla | This line lacks alliteration. The simplest fix is to emend the adjective *rammi* 'mighty' to *fráni* 'gleaming', an adj. otherwise commonly used for serpents, including in 26/3 below.

[Fáfnir:] **20** „Rę̋ð'k þér nú, Sig·urðr, · ęn þú ráð nemir [**R** TODO]

ok ríð hęim heðan;
it gjalla goll · ok it glóð-rauða fé,
þér verða þęir baugar at bana!“

[Fathomer:] “I counsel thee now, Siward—but thou oughtst to take the counsel
and ride home hence.
The clanging gold and the glowing red wealth—
those bighs will be thy bane!”

---

3–4 it gjalla ... bana! ‘The clanging ... bane!’ | Fathomer repeats his warning from st. 9. Siward does still not listen.

[Sig·urðr:] **21** „Ráð ’s þér ráðit · ęn ek ríða mun [R TODO]
til þęss golls es í lyngvi liggr,
ęn þú, Fáfnir, · ligg í fjǫr-brotum
þar’s þik Hęl hafi!“

[Siward:] “Thy counsel has been counseled, but I will ride
to the gold which in the heather lies—
but thou, Fathomer, lie in the lifeblood-tracks,
where Hell may have thee!”

---

4 þar’s þik Hęl hafi ‘where Hell may have thee’ | Formulaic. TODO.

[Fáfnir:] **22** „Regginn mik réð, · hann þik ráða mun, [R TODO]
hann mun okkr verða bǫ́ðum at bana;
fjǫr sitt láta · hygg at Fáfnir myni;
þitt varð nú męira męgin.“

[Fathomer:] “Rein betrayed me; he will betray thee;
he will become the bane of us both!
Give up his life I think that Fathomer will—
thy strength was now the greater.”

**P2** Reginn var á brott horfinn meðan Sig·urðr vá Fáfni ok kom þá aptr er Sig·urðr strauk blóð af sverði’nu. Reginn kvað:

Rein had disappeared while Siward fought Fathomer, and then came back as Siward wiped the blood off the sword. Quoth Rein:

**23** „Hęill þú nú, Sig·urðr, · nú hęfir sigr vegit [R TODO]
ok Fáfni of farit;
manna þęira · es mold troða
þik kveð’k ǫ·blauðastan alinn.“

"Hail thee now, Siward! Now hast thou won victory
and destroyed Fathomer.
Of those men who tread on the earth
I declare thee unsoftest begotten."

[Sig·urðr:] **24** „Þat 's ǫ·víst at vita · þá's komum allir saman, [R TODO]
sig-tíva synir,
hvęrr ǫ·blauðastr es alinn;
margr es sá hvatr · es hjǫr né rýðr
annars brjóstum í."

[Siward:] "It is unsure to know when we all come together,
sons of the victory-Tews [MEN],
who is unsoftest begotten.
Many a man is bold who reddens no sword
in another's chest."

[Ręginn:] **25** „Glaðr est nú, Sig·urðr, · ok gagni fęginn [R TODO]
es þú þęrrir Gram á grasi;
bróður mínn · hęfir þú bęnjaðan
ok vęld ek þó sjalfr sumu."

[Rein:] "Glad art thou now, Siward, and rejoicing in gain
when thou driest Gram on the grass.
My own brother hast thou deathly wounded,
and yet I myself bear some fault."

[Sig·urðr:] **26** „Þú því rétt · es ek ríða skyldak [R TODO]
heilǫg fjǫll hinig;
fęi ok fjǫrvi · réði sá inn frœni ormr
nema þú frýðir mér hvats hugar."

[Siward:] "Thou didst counsel that I should ride
o'er the holy fells hither.
Wealth and life would the gleaming Wyrm rule
if thou hadst not braved my bold heart."

**P3** Þá gekk Reginn at Fáfni ok skar hjarta ór hánum með sverði er Riðill heitir ok þá drakk hann blóð ór undinni eptir.

Then Siward walked up to Fathomer and cut the heart out of him with the sword called Riddle, and then he drank blood from the wound afterwards.

[Ręginn:] **27** „Sit-tu nú, Sig·urðr, · ęn ek mun sofa ganga [R TODO]
ok halt Fáfnis hjarta við funa!
Ęiskǫld ek vil · etin láta
eptir þęnna dręyra drykk.“

[Rein:] “Sit thou now, Siward—but I will go sleep!—
and hold Fathomer’s heart by the fire,
The heart-strings I wish to eat
after this drink of blood.”

---

3 Ęiskǫld ‘heart-strings’ | An obscure poetic synonym for ‘heart’, grammatically in the neuter plural. The translation “heart-strings” is guesswork. TODO: other occurrences.

[Sig·urðr:] **28** „Fjarri þú gekkt · meðan ek á Fáfni rauð’k [R TODO]
mǐnn inn hvassa hjǫr;
afli mǐnu · átta’k við orms męgin
meðan þú í lyngvi látt.“

[Siward:] “Far off didst thou go, while on Fathomer I reddened
this my sharp sword.
*My* strength I held against the might of the Wyrm,
while *thou* in the heather layest.”

[Ręginn:] **29** „Lęngi liggja · létir þú þann lyngvi í, [R TODO]
inn aldna jǫtun,
ef þú sverðs né nytir, · þęss es ek sjalfr gørða,
ok þǐns ins hvassa hjǫrs.“

[Rein:] “Long in the heather wouldst thou have let
this ancient ettin [me] lie,
if thou hadst not used the blade which I myself made
and this thy sharp sword.”

[Sig·urðr:] **30** „Hugr es bętri · an séi hjǫrs męgin [R TODO]
hvar’s *v*ręiðir skulu vega,
því at hvatan mann · ek sé harð=liga vega
með slęvu sverði sigr.

[Siward:] “Heart is better than might of sword may be
wherever the wroth shall fight,
for I see a bold man furiously fighting
with a sluggish sword to victory.

**31** Hvǫtum ’s bętra · an séi ò·hvǫtum [R TODO]

ĭ hildi-lęik hafa=sk
gląðum 's bętra · an séi glúpnanda
hvat sęm at hęndi kømr."

For the bold it is better than it may be for the unbold
to hold himself in battle-play [WAR];
for the glad it is better than it may be for the gloomy
no matter what comes to one's hands!"

1 Hvǫtum 's bętra · an séi ò·hvǫtum 'For the bold it is better than it may be for the unbold' | The line type "it is better for the X than it may be for the un-X" also appears in *Háv* 71/1 (with emendation).

**P4** Sig·urðr tók Fáfnis hjarta ok steikði á teini. Er hann hugði at full-steikt vęri ok freyddi sveit'inn ór hjarta'nu þá tók hann á fingri sínum ok skynjaði hvárt full-steikt vęri. Hann brann ok brá fingri'num í munn sér. En er hjart-blóð Fáfnis kom á tungu hánum ok skildi hann fugls rǫdd. Hann heyrði at igður klǫkuðu á hrísi'num. Igða'n kvað:

SIWARD TOOK Fathomer's heart and roasted it on a stick. When he thought that it was fully roasted and the blood frothed out of the heart then he touched it with his finger to see whether it was fully roasted. He burned himself and jerked his finger in his mouth. But when the heart's blood of Fathomer came upon his tongue and he understood the speech of birds—he heard that tits were chirping in the brushes. Quoth the tit:

1 Sig·urðr 'Siward' | *The* S *is a bold capital in* **R**.

**32** „Þar sitr Sig·*vǫ*rðr · svęita stokkinn, [**R** TODO, **S** 29r/35, **T** TODO]
Fáfnis hjarta · við funa stęikir;
spakr þǿtti mér · spillir bauga
ef hann fjǫr-sega · frånan ęti."

"There Siward sits, spattered with blood;
Fathomer's heart by the fire he roasts.
Wise would I think the spiller of rings,
if he the gleaming life-muscle ate."

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

ALL | With this stanza the meter shifts from Leeds-meter to Ancient-words-lay for the first time in *Fáfn*. — Sts. 32–33 are cited in *Skm* 47 with no textual variants. TODO: Track down the manuscript references.

Qnnur: **33** „Þar liggr Ręginn, · rę́ðr umb við sik, [**R** TODO, **S** 29r/36, **T** TODO]

vill tǽla mǫg · þann's trúir hǫ́num;
berr af rǫ́ði · rǫng orð saman,
vill bǫ́lva smiðr · bróður hefna."

The other one: "There Rein lies, takes counsel with himself,
wants to betray the lad who trusts in him.
In his wrath he bears twisted words together;
the smith of bales wants to avenge his brother!"

1 Rǫginn | *add.* kvað ǫnnur *'quoth the other one'* Skm

3 rǫ́ði · rǫng | Alliteration between these two words is assumed to fall on *r-*, but if the poem is old enough it is possible that the original alliteration was *vrǫ́ði : vrǫng*. Since both words derive from old *vr-*, this instance can unfortunately not serve as a diagnostic criterion for dating. Although st. 7/2 above would seem to confirm the existence of *vr-* for *Fáfn*, the difference in meter makes it uncertain whether sts. 7 and 33 do in fact originally belong to the same composition.

Þriðja: **34** „Hǫfði skǫmmra · láti hann inn hára þul [R TODO]
fara til hǫ́ljar heðan!
Ǫllu golli · þá kná hann ǫ́inn ráða,
fjǫlð, því's und Fáfni lá."

The third one: "A head shorter he ought to let the hoary thyle [= Rein]
journey hence to Hell!
All the gold he will then rule alone:
the trove which under Fathomer lay."

Fjórða: **35** „Horskr þǿtti mér · ef hafa kynni [R TODO]
ǫ́st-ráð mikit · yðvar systra;
hygði umb sik · ok Hugin glǫ́ddi;
þar's mér ulfs vǫ́n · es ǫ́yru sé'k."

The fourth one: "Sharp would he seem to me if he could take
this great loving counsel from you, my sisters;
he would think ahead for himself and gladden Highen—
I expect a wolf where I see an ear!"

**36** „Es=at svá horskr · hildi-meiðr [R TODO]
sǫm ek hǫ́rs jaðar · hyggja mynda'k
ef hann bróður lǫ́tr · á brott koma=sk
ǫn hann ǫ́ðrum hǫ́fr · aldrs of synjat."

"The battle-tree [WARRIOR] is not as sharp
as I would have thought the peak of the host [RULER],
if he lets one brother get away
when he has denied the other old age."

**37** „Mjǫk es ǫ·sviðr · ef hann ęnn sparir [R TODO]
fjánda inn folk-skáa,
þar's Ręginn liggr · es hann ráðinn hęfr;
kann=at hann við s·líku at séa.“

"Most foolish is he if yet he spares
that fight-shy fiend,
where Rein lies, who has plotted against him;
he cannot look out against such!"

**38** „Hǫfði skęmmra · láti hann þann inn hrím-kalda jǫtun [R TODO]
ok af baugum búa;
þá mund-u féar · þęss es Fáfnir réð
ęin-valdi vesa.“

"A head shorter he ought to make that rime-cold ettin,
and take from him the bighs.
Then of the wealth which Fathomer ruled
wilt thou be the lone ruler!"

[Sig·urðr:] **39** „Verða-*t* svá rík skǫp · at Ręginn skyli [R TODO]
mitt ban-orð bera
því at þęir báðir bróðr · skulu brá=liga
fara til Hęljar heðan.“

[Siward:] "The Shapes will not be so powerful that Rein should
bear my bane-word,
for those brothers both shall now hurriedly
journey hence to Hell!"

**P5** Sig·urðr hjó hǫfuð af Regin ok þá át hann Fáfnis hjarta ok drakk blóð þeira beggja, Regins ok Fáfnis. Þá heyrði Sig·urðr hvað igður męltu:

Siward struck the head off of Rein and then he ate Fathomer's heart and drank the blood of them both, Rein's and Fathomer's. Then Siward heard what the tits spoke:

**40** „Bitt þú, Sig·*vǫ*rðr, · bauga rauða; [R TODO]
es=a konung=ligt · kvíða mǫrgu.
Męy vęit'k ęina, · myklu fęgrsta,
golli gódda, · ef þú geta méttir.

"Bind, O Siward, the red bighs;

it is not kinglike to tarry for long.
I know one maiden fairest of all,
endowed with gold—if thou mightst get her!"

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

**41** „Liggja til Gjúka · grønar brautir, [R TODO]
framm vísa skǫp · folk-líðǫndum;
þar hęfir dýrr konungr · dóttur alna,
þá munt, Sig·*vǫ*rðr, · mundi kaupa."

"Towards Yivick's home green highways lie:
the Shapes show the way forth for wandering exiles.
There the wealthy king has reared a daughter;
her wilt thou, Siward, for a bride-fee buy."

4 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

**42** „Salr 's á hǫ́u · Hindar-fjalli, [R TODO]
allr 's hann útan · ęldi svęipinn;
þann hafa horskir · halir of gǫrvan
ór ǫ·dǫkkum · ógnar ljóma."

"A hall stands upon the high Hindfell;
without, it is all enwrapped in fire.
That one learned men have made
from an un-dark radiance of terror."

**43** „Vęit'k á fjalli · folk-vitr sofa [R TODO]
ok lęikr yfir · lindar váði;
Yggr stakk þorni— · aðra fęlldi
hǫr-Gefn hali · es hafa vildi."

"I know on the fell a war-wight sleeps,
and over her licks the linden's harm [FIRE].
Ug stung her with a thorn; the flax-Yevn [LADY] slew
the other heroes who wished to have her."

**44** „Knátt, mǫgr, séa · męy und hjalmi [R TODO]
þá's frá vígi · Ving·skorni ręið;
má=at Sigr·drífar · svefni bręgða,
skjǫldunga niðr, · fyr skǫpum norna."

"Thou wilt, lad, see the maid beneath a helmet,
the one who rode on Wingshorner from the fray.

No man may break Syedrive's sleep,
O heir of the Shieldings, against the Shapes of the Norns."

**P6** Sig·urðr reið eptir slóð Fáfnis til bólis hans ok fann þat opit
2 ok hurðir af járni ok gętti; af járni vóru ok allir timbr-stokkar í
húsi'nu en grafit í jǫrð niðr. Þar fann Sig·urðr stór-mikit gull
4 ok fylldi þar tvęr kistur. Þar tók hann ógis-hjálm ok gull-brynju
ok sverð'it Hrotta ok marga dýr-gripi ok klyfjaði þar með Grana.
6 En hestr'inn vildi eigi fram ganga fyrr en Sig·urðr steig á bak
hǫnum.

Siward rode along Fathomer's trail to his dwelling and found it open and doors and rabbets of iron. Of iron were also all the timber trunks in the house, and dug down into the earth. There Siward found very much gold and he filled there two chests. Then he took the helmet of awe and a golden byrnie and the sword Rotte and many precious things and loaded Grane with them. But the horse did not want to go forth until Siward mounted his back.

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4 gull-brynju 'golden byrnie' | An obviously fictional object, the weight of which would be far too great to be practical. Golden byrnies do not otherwise commonly feature in the Norse heroic material; the only other attestation of the present compound in the Norse corpus is in *Sigsk* 47/3.

# Speeches of Syedrive
# *(Sigr·drífu mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.961)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay(1, 5), Leeds-meter(2–4, 6–13/4, 18–22, 23/6–27), Galders-lay (13/5–14, 16–17, 23/1–23/5), Speeches-meter (15)

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Syedrive** (*Sigrdr*) is a heroic prosimetrum dealing with the hero Siward; it is the third and last in the sequence of three prosimetric texts formed by *Reg*–*Sigrdr*. *Sigrdr* sees the young hero meet the walkirrie Byrnhild and free her from her magic sleep; in return she teaches him runic magic and important pieces of advice.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The main manuscript of *Sigrdr* is **R**, where the poem follows *Fáfn* and is found on foll. 31v/25–32v. It is of note that there is no sign of any kind, not even an initial, separating *Sigrdr* from the preceding *Fáfn*; the division between the two (along with the name *Sigr·drífu mǫ́l*) is thus entirely editorial. Unfortunately, the concluding part of *Sigrdr* in **R** is lost due to the loss of several folios following 32v (see *Vǫlsbr* below).

#### Paper manuscripts

Due to their loss in **R**, the final stanzas of *Sigrdr*, from 27/2–TODO, must be supplied from younger paper manuscripts. TODO: edit these.

#### Stanzas in *Vǫls*

A number of stanzas from *Sigrdr* are quoted in **N**, the main ms. of *Vǫls*. *Vǫls* 21 contains the following passage, which is clearly based chiefly on *Sigrdr* P3, but in its mention of the gods likely also sts. 3–4:

*Bryn·hildr segir, at tveir konungar bǫrðust. Hét annarr Hjalm-Gunn·arr; hann var gamall ok hinn mesti hermaðr, ok hafði Óðinn honum sigr heitit. En annarr Agnarr eða Auða bróðir. „Ek fellda Hjalm-Gunn·arr í orrostu, en Óðinn stakk mik svefn-þorni í hefnd þess ok kvað mik aldri síðan skyldu sigr hafa ok kvað mik giptast skulu. En ek strengða þess heit þar í mót at giptast engum þeim, er hrꝛ̨ðast kynni.“ Sig·urðr mꝛ́lti: „Kenn oss ráð til stórra hluta.“ Hun svarar: „Þér munuð betr kunna, en með þǫkkum vil ek kenna yðr, ef þat er nǫkkut, er vér kunnum, þat er yðr mꝛ́tti líka, í rúnum eða ǫðrum hlutum, er liggja til hvers hlutar, ok drekkum bꝛ̨ði saman, ok gefi goð'in okkr góðan dag, at þér verði nýt ok fregð at mínum vitrleik, ok þú munir eptir þat, er vit rꝛ̨ðum.“ Bryn·hildr fylldi eitt ker ok fꝛ́rði Sig·urði ok mꝛ́lti:*

'Byrnhild tells that two kings fought each other. One of them was called Helm-Guther; he was old and the greatest warrior, and Weden had promised him victory, but the other was called Eyner or Ead's brother. "I made Helm-Guther fall in battle, but Weden stung me with a sleeping-thorn as revenge for that and said that I should never thenceforth have victory, and said that I must marry. But I made the vow in response to marry no such one as could be frightened." Siward spoke: "Teach us counsel about great things." She answers: "Ye will know better, but with thanks I will teach you, if there be anything which we know that may please you with regards to runes or other things of importance. And let us both drink together, and may the gods give us two a good day, that thou mayest have use and pleasure from my wisdom and that thou mayest afterwards recall that of which we two speak." Byrnhild filled a vessel and brought it to Siward and spoke:'

After this, the saw cites sts. 5–13 and 15–19 in uninterrupted sequence and paraphrases sts. 20 ff. The order of stanzas in **N** is rather different from that of **R**. Both mss. have sts. 5–6 and 13–19 in the same order, but the order of sts. 7–12 in between is divergent. The following table illustrates the relationship:

| | *pres. ed.* | **R** | **N** |
|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Bjór fœri'k þér | 5 | 6 |
| 6 | Sig-rúnar skalt rísta | 6 | 7 |
| 7 | Ǫl-rúnar skalt kunna | 7 | 10 |
| 8 | Full skal signa | 7* | 11 |
| 9 | Bjarg-rúnar skalt kunna | 8 | 12 |
| 10 | Brim-rúnar skalt rísta | 9 | 8 |
| 11 | Lim-rúnar skalt kunna | 10 | 13 |
| 12 | Mál-rúnar skalt kunna | 11 | 9 |
| 13 | Hug-rúnar skalt kunna | 12a | 14 |
| 14 | Á bjargi stóð | 12b–13 | – |
| 15 | Á skildi kvað ristnar | 14–15/4 | 15–17 |
| 16 | Allar vǫ́ru af skafnar | 15/5–16 | 18 |
| 17 | Þat eru bókrúnar | 17 | 19 |

| | *pres. ed.* | R | N |
|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | Nú skalt kjósa | 18 | 20 |
| 19 | Mun'k=a ek flója | 19 | 21 |

## Meter and stanza

*Sigrdr* is composed primarily in Leeds-meter, with instances of Speeches-meter and Ancient-words-lay.

TODO.

## Summary

TODO.

## Text

**P1** Sig·urðr reið upp á Hindar-fjall ok stefndi suðr til Frakk-lands. Á fjalli'nu sá hann ljós mikit svá sem eldr brynni, ok ljómaði af til himins. En er hann kom at þá stóð þar skjald-borg ok upp ór merki. Sig·urðr gekk í skjald-borg'ina ok sá at þar lá maðr ok svaf með ǫllum her-vápnum. Hann tók fyrst hjálm'inn af hǫfði hánum; þá sá hann at þat var kona. Brynjan var fǫst sem hón vǽri hold-gróin. Þá reist hann með Gram frá hǫfuð-smátt brynju'na í gǫgnum niðr ok svá út í gǫgnum báðar ermar. Þá tók hann brynju af henni en hón vaknaði ok setti=sk hón upp ok sá Sig·urð ok mélti:

Siward rode up on the Hindfell and stayed, facing south toward Frankland. On the fell he saw a light as great as if there burned a fire, and the rays from it went up to heaven. But when he came near to it, there was a shield-wall towering up out of the ground. Siward went inside the shield-wall and saw that a man lay there, sleeping in full armour. He first took off the helmet from the man's head; then he saw that it was a woman. The byrnie was as tight as if it were grown out of her flesh. Then he took Gram and cut the byrnie from the head-hole down and then out through both sleeves. Then he took the byrnie off her, and she awakened and sat herself up and saw Siward and spoke:

**1** „Hvat bęit brynju? · Hví brá'k svefni? [R 31v/33]
Hvęrr fęlldi af mér · fǫlvar nauðir?“
Hann svaraði: „Sig·mundar burr, · slęit fyr skǫmmu
hrafns hré-lundir · hjǫrr Sig·*var*ðar.“

“What bit the byrnie? How did I break my sleep?
Who loosened from me these death-pale chains?”
He answered: “Syemund's son [= Siward] has just torn off
the raven's corpse-trees [BYRNIE?] with Siward's sword.”

4 Sig·*var*ðar | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðar **R**

4 hrafns hré-lundir ‘the raven's corpse-trees [BYRNIE?]’ | An unclear kenning. TODO.

[Sigr·drífa kvað:] **2** „Lęngi ek svaf, · lęngi ek sofnuð vas, [R 32r/2]
lǫng eru lýða lé;
Óðinn því vęldr · es ęigi mátta'k
bregða blund-stǫfum.“

[Quoth Syedrive:] "Long I slept, long was I asleep,
long are the guiles of men.
It is Weden's fault that I could not
break the staves of sleep."

**P2** Sig·urðr sęttisk niðr ok spyrr hana nafns. Hón tók þá horn fullt
2 mjaðar ok gaf hǫ́num minnis-vęig.

Siward set himself down, asking for her name. She then took a horn full of mead and gave him a draught of remembrance:

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2 minnis-vęig 'draught of remembrance' | To drink someone's *minni* 'memory, remembrance' seems originally to have referred specifically to the funerary toast, but here has clearly come to carry a broader sense, viz. to drink a toast to someone's favour, whether man or god.

**3** Hęill Dagr, · hęilir Dags synir, [R 32r/6]
2 hęil Nǫ́tt ok nipt!
Ò·*v*rę́iðum augum · lítið okkr þinig
4 ok gefið sitjǫndum sigr!

"Hail Day! Hail the sons of Day!
Hail Night and her kinswoman!
With unwrathful eyes look Ye towards us twain
and give the settlers [= us] victory.

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ALL | *Sigrdr* 3–4 represents the only surviving poetic prayer to the collective Gods in the whole Norse literature (for prayers to individual gods, esp. Thunder and Weden, cf. Lindow (1988), and in the pres. ed. *Cant* and N B380 under Galders). Both stanzas follow the same balanced outline: the first helming (ll. 1–2) invokes the relevant gods and the second (ll. 3–4) makes the request. The speaker is Syehdrive, who is the one offering the horn.

1 Dags synir 'the sons of Day' | Their identity is uncertain, for Day does not have any known sons in the Norse mythology. Based on comparative mythology the most likely candidates are the heavenly Horse Twins, who are securely attested in the Vedic, Greek, and Baltic traditions. In the Vedic religion the two *aśvínau* are the children of Father Heaven and follow the Dawn (Brereton and Jamison, 2020, pp. 81–84). In the Greek the two Διόσ·κουροι (lit. 'Sons of Zeús') are prominent horsemen, but their celestial role is less apparent. In the Latvian folksongs the *Dieva dẽli* 'Sons of Dievs' are still closely associated with the Heaven, although they are not always twins (Calin 1996, pp. 53–65), while the Lithuanian horse-twins (the *Ašvieniai*) pull the Sun-chariot. Within the Germanic sphere, the Twins have often been associated with the Anglo-Saxon founding figures *Hęngist* and *Horsa*, which however have no solar associations apart from their coming from the east; there are also the two stallions Yorewaker and Allswith which pull the Sun (*Grm* 38, *Sigrdr* 15a/2), but they do not have any anthropomorphic riders. An archaeological connection may be made with a pair of cultic figures from Grevensvænge, Denmark, dated to periods 4–5 (1100–700 BC) of the Nordic Bronze Age (Thrane 2010). The two bronze figures, both wearing horned helmets, are depicted as sitting on their knees beside each other with their backs straight, facing forwards. They mirror each other, so that their inner elbows touch, placing the inner hand on the belly, while the outer arm raises a large axe. The two were originally connected at their knees by a bronze support, and belonged to a larger ensemble which was probably originally placed upon a cultic solar boat (Glob 1961), in which case a solar association (like the other IE Twins) is certain.

2 nipt 'her kinswoman' | The identity of this kinswoman (*nipt* typically refers to a younger female relative) is not clear. According to *Gylf* 10:4 (cited in *Vafþ* 11 n.) the daughter of Night is Earth, but Earth is also mentioned in st. 4/4 and so might be out of place here. If we look beyond Norse mythology in its Scaldic form as codified by Snorre, the kinswoman of Night may tentatively be identified with the obscure Germanic Dawn-goddess, whose Vedic equivalent (OI *uṣás*) is conceived of as the sister or daughter of the Night (*nákti*; Brereton and Jamison 2020, p. 93; *ṚV* 1.113, 1.124.8, 3.55.12, 7.71.1, etc.) and who is often ritually paired with her (1.13.7, 2.3.6, 3.4.6, etc.). This would be a ritual archaism predating the Scaldic system, but it has the advantage of giving the stanza greater internal consistency. All gods described in it would then be heavenly phenomena, who can gaze with their "eyes" onto the couple, something the Earth cannot. A similar "pre-Scaldic" linguistic archaism is likely found in *fold* in st. 4 below.

3 Ó·*v*rę́iðum augum · lítið okkr þinig 'With unwrathful eyes look Ye towards us two' | I.e., 'gaze upon us with gracious eyes', the grace (or wrath) of the Gods being conveyed by their eyes turning towards the worshipper. Cf. *Hdl* 6/2–3.
This anthropomorphic conception of the divine gaze is very old and within Indo-European has secure parallels in Greek, OI, Avestan, and Hittite (West 2007, p. 318). Further parallels are found among both the Hebrews and Egyptians, which however speak about the face rather than the eyes. Biblical examples include the famous Priestly Blessing of Numbers 6:25–26 ("May YHWH light up His face to thee and grant grace to thee; / May YHWH lift up His face to thee and give thee peace."), Psalms 4:6 ("Lift up the light of Thy face to us, YHWH"), and the chorus of Psalms 80 ("YHWH God of Armies, bring us back. / Light up Thy face, that we may be rescued.") while Egyptian examples involve the phrase *nfr ḥr* 'good, fair of face,' which refers specifically to the grace of a god or god-like ruler (Spiegelberg 1917, p. 115) and which is known from inscriptions as early as the 4th dynasty of the Old Kingdom (ca. 2600 BC) (Abdelhamid 2018, p. 146) until as late as the very last known Hieroglyphic inscription (GPH 436, from 394 AD) (Griffith 1937, pp. 126–127; Parkinson 1999, pp. 178–179). Spiegelberg (1917, p. 115) cites the following Middle Kingdom prayer to Osiris from the 18th dynasty (ca. 1400 BC), which I find particularly similar to the present stanza (my translation from his German): "Mayest Thou be gracious to me (*ḥtp=k n=j*); may Thy face be fair towards me (*nfr ḥr=k ʾm=j*) on the day when I behold Thy fairness."

**4** [R 32r/7]

Hęilir ę́sir, · hęilar ó̧synjur,
hęil sjá in fjǫl-nýta fold!
Mál ok man-vit · gefið okkr mę́rum tvęim
ok lę́knis-hęndr meðan lifum!

Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens!
Hail this much-bountiful Fold!
Speech and manwit give Ye us famed twain,
and a leecher's hands, while we live."

1 Hęilir ę́sir, · hęilar ó̧synjur 'Hail the Eese! Hail the Ossens!' | The same line occurs in *Lok* 11, but is there subverted; just like here, the first half of that stanza hails the Gods, but the second half, instead of asking for a boon, instead insults one of the gods present by beginning with the word *nema* 'except, save for'. The direction of influence is almost certainly from a prayer like the present stanza to *Lok*, for it is surely much less likely for a blasphemous parody of a prayer to inspire a real one than the reverse.

2 sjá in fjǫl-nýta fold ‘this much-bountiful Fold’ | The bountiful Earth, an expression with Indo-European roots. Throughout the rest of the Norse poetic corpus *fold* refers exclusively to the unpersonified inanimate “land, earth” without religious associations, but the present instance seems to be a ritual archaism. Cf. the Old English *Æcer* 5/1: *Hâl wes þú Folde · firha módor!* ‘Hale be thou, Fold, mother of men!’ and the Old Indian cognate *Pṛ́tʰivíˊ* (Brereton and Jamison, 2020, p. 96), found frequently in *ṚV* (e.g. 1.89.4b: *mātáˊ Pṛ́tʰivíˊ* ‘mother Earth’). The common IE root is **pl̥th₂-* ‘flat, broad’ which has been nominalized as a feminine noun (PGmc. **fuldō* < **pl̥th₂-éh₂*; OI *pṛ́tʰivíˊ* < **pl̥th₂-u-íh₂*, Kroonen 2013, p. 159). For this development cf. Hfr *Hákdr* 8 (in SkP 3), where Earth is the *brǫ́ð-lǫ́ita brúðr Bál·ęygs* ‘broad-faced bride of Bale-eye ⟨= Weden⟩’. — For the epithet ‘much-giving’ cf. *Il* 3.89: ἐπὶ χθονὶ πουλυ-βοτείρῃ ‘upon the much-nourishing earth’, where the Greek πουλυ- is cognate with ON *fjǫl-*, both deriving from PIE **pélh₁u-* ~ **pólh₁u-* ‘much, many’ (Kroonen 2013, p. 136).

3 Mál ‘Speech’ | Good speech, by which is also understood silence rather than frivolous chatter. For the importance of proper speech see *Háv* 7/2 n.

3 man-vit ‘manwit’ | Wisdom to conduct ourselves uprightly; for this word see *Háv* 6/6 n.

4 lę́knis-hęndr ‘a leecher’s hands’ | The hands of a physician, i.e., hands with (magical) powers of healing. The singular *lę́knis-hǫnd* occurs on the Ribe galder-stick (SJy 41), edited below under Galders.

**P3** Hón nefndi=sk Sigr·drífa ok var val-kyrja. Hón sagði, at tveir konungar bǫrðu=sk. Hét annarr Hjalm-Gunn·arr; hann var þá gamall ok inn mesti her-maðr, ok hafði Óðinn hǫ́num sigri heitit.

En annarr hét Agn·arr, · *Auðu bróðir
es vę́tr ęngi · vildi þiggja.

Sigr·drífa felldi Hjalm-Gunn·ar í orrostu'nni, en Óðinn stakk hana svefn-þorni í hefnd þess ok kvað hana aldri skyldu síðan sigr vega í orrostu, ok kvað hana gipta=sk skyldu, „en sagða'k hǫ́num at strengða'k heit þar í mót, at gipta=sk øngom þeim manni er hrę́ða=sk kynni.“ Hann segir ok biðr hana kenna sér speki ef hón vissi tíðendi ór ǫllum heimum. Sigr·drífa kvað:

She said her name was Syedrive and was a walkirrie. She said that two kings had fought; one was called Helm-Guther—he was old by then and the greatest warrior, and Weden had promised him victory,

but the other was called Eyner, Ead's brother,
who in no way wished to sue for peace.

Syedrive made Helm-Guther fall in the battle, but Weden stung her with the sleeping-thorn as revenge for that and declared that she would never thenceforth win victory in battle and said that she must marry, “but I told him that I had made a vow in response not to marry any man who could be frightened.” He [= Siward] speaks and asks her to teach him wisdom if she knew tidings out of all the Homes. Quoth Syedrive:

4 *Auðu | *emend.;* Hauðu **R**

4 *Auðu | It is proven beyond a doubt by *Helr* 8 that the correct form of the name is in fact *Auða* (as found in *Vǫls* 21; see introduction above). The form with *h-* is thus due to corruption.

**5** „Bjór føri'k þér, · bryn-þings apaldr, [R 32r/18–20, N 24v/12–14]
magni blandinn · ok męgin-tíri,
fullr es ljóða · ok líkn-stafa,
góðra galdra · ok gaman-rúna.

Beer I bring thee—O apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]!—
mixed with might and mighty splendour.
It is full of leeds and grace-staves,
of good galders and pleasure-runes.

1 bryn-þings apaldr 'apple-tree of the byrnie-Thing [BATTLE > WARRIOR]' | bryn-þinga valdr *'wielder of byrnie-Things [BATTLES > WARRIOR]'* N 4 gaman-rúna 'pleasure-runes' | gaman-†rędna† N

**6** Sig-rúnar skalt rísta, · ef vilt sigr hafa, [R 32r/20–22, N 24v/14–16]
ok rísta á hjalti hjǫrs,
sumar á vétt-rimum, · sumar á val-bǫstum,
ok nęfna tysvar Týr.

Victory-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt have victory,
and carve them on the hilt of the sword;
some on the weight-rims, some on the wal-basts,
and twice name Tew.

1 sigr hafa 'have victory' | snotr vera *'be clever'* N 2 rísta | †rist† N 3 sumar 'some' | *om.* N 3 vétt-rimum 'weight-rims' | vétt-†rvnum† N 3 sumar 'some' | ok *'and'* N 3 val-bǫstum 'wal-basts' | val-†bystum† N

3 vétt-rimum 'weight-rims' | Unclear. TODO.

3 val-bǫstum 'wal-basts' | Possibly the sword-pommel; this word also occurs in *HHj* 9. TODO.

**7** Ǫl-rúnar skalt kunna · ef vilt at annars kvęn [R 32r/22–24, N 25r/1–3]
véli=t þik í tryggð ef trúir;
á horni skal þér rísta · ok á handar baki
ok męrkja á nagli Nauð.

Ale-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt that another man's wife
not betray thee in troth if thou trust her.
On the horn shall one carve them, and on the back of the hand,
and mark Need on the nail.

1 at 'that' | *emend. from* †a† N*; om.* R 2 véli=t þik í tryggð | véli þik eigi tryggð N 3 þér 'them' | þat *'it'* N

4 Nauð 'Need' | i.e., the n-rune, ᚾ.

**8** Full skal signa · ok við fári séa [R 32r/24–25, N 25r/3–4]

ok verpa lauki í lǫg;
þá þat vęit'k, · at þér verðr aldri≠gi
męini blandinn mjǫðr.

The cup shall one sign, and gaze against the danger,
and throw in the liquid a leek.
Then I know that it will never be
mixed with harm, thy mead.

1 Full 'The cup' | ǫl *'The ale'* **N** *breaks alliteration.* 4 męini blandinn | *emend.;* męin-blandinn **N**

1 signa 'sign' | Dedicating the cup by means of making a certain sign or speech over it. TODO.

3–4 þá ... mjǫðr | only in **N**; om. **R**

**9** Bjarg-rúnar skalt kunna · ef bjarga vilt [R 32r/25–26, N 25r/5
ok lęysa kind frá konum;
á lófa þér skal rísta · ok of liðu spęnna
ok biðja þá dísir duga.

Rescue-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt rescue
and loosen children from women;
on the palm shall one carve them, and wrap them round the joints,
and then bid the dises to avail.

1 kunna 'know' | nema *'learn'* **N** 1 ef bjarga vilt 'if thou wilt rescue' | ef þú vilt borgit fá *'if thou wilt have rescued'* **N** 4 þá 'then' | *om.* **N**

4 dísir 'dises' | Minor goddesses and fates; one of their roles was helping ailing women during childbirth. Cf. *Fáfn* 12 where *nornir* 'Norns' is used for the childbirth goddesses.

**10** Brim-rúnar skalt rísta · ef vilt borgit hafa [R 32r/27–29, N 24v/1
á sundi segl-mǫrum;
á stafni skal rísta · ok á stjórnar blaði
ok lęggja ęld ǐ ár;
es≠a svá brattr breki · né svá bláar unnir,
þó kømsk-tu hęill af hafi.

Surf-runes shalt thou carve, if thou wilt rescue
sail-steeds [SHIPS] on the sound;
on the stem shall one carve them, and on the rudder's blade,
and lay fire into the oar.
There is not so steep a breaker nor so dark blue waves
that thou not come whole off the sea.

1 rísta 'carve' | gjǫra *'make'* **N** 3 skal rísta 'shall [one] carve' | skal þér rísta *'shall [one] carve them'* **N** 5 es≠a 'There is not' | falla≠t *'There fall not'* **N**

4 lęggja ęld ĩ ár 'lay fire into the oar' | i.e., mark it with fire in some way.

6 þó kømsk-tu hęill af hafi 'that thou not come whole off the sea.' | Lit. "yet comest thou whole off the sea."

**11** Lim-rúnar skalt kunna · ef vilt lęknir vesa [R 32r/29–31, N 25r/7–9]
ok kunna sǫr at séa;
á bęrki skal þér rísta · ok á baðmi viðar,
þęim's lúta austr limar.

Limb-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt be a leecher,
and know how to look at wounds;
on the bark shall one carve them, and on the trunk of the tree:
on the one whose limbs bow to the east.

3 baðmi 'beam' | barri *'leaf'* 4 þęim's | þęss es N

1 lęknir 'leecher' | Physician; see *Háv* 148 n.

**12** Mál-rúnar skalt kunna · ef vilt at mann=gi þér [R 32r/31—34, N 24v/19–21
hęiptum gjaldi harm;
þér of vindr, · þér of vefr,
þér of sętr allar saman,
á því þingi · es þjóðir skulu
ĩ fulla dóma fara.

Speech-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt that no man
should repay thy insults with harm;
them wilt thou wind, them wilt thou weave,
them wilt thou sew all together,
on that Thing where peoples shall
go to full judgments.

1 vilt | *om.* N 2 gjaldi | †giallda† N 5 þjóðir 'peoples' | męnn N *breaks alliteration.*

**13** Hug-rúnar skalt kunna · ef vilt hvęrjum vesa [R 32r/34–32v/3, N 25r/9–1
gęð-svinnari guma;
þér of réð, · þér of ręist,
þér of hugði Hroptr,
af þęim lęgi · es lekit hafði
ór hausi Hęið·draupnis
ok ór horni Hodd·rofnis.

Mind-runes shalt thou know, if thou wilt be
swifter in sense than every man;

them did counsel, them did carve,
them did Roft think out,
from that liquid which had leaked
out of Heathdreepner's skull
and out of Hoardrovner's horn.

1 kunna 'know' | nema *'learn'* **N** 2 gęð-svinnari 'swifter in sense' | gęð-horskari *'sharper in sense'* **N** 5–7 af … Hodd·rofnis 'from … horn. | *om.* **N**

4 Hroptr 'Roft' | Another name for the god Weden; for its use in a runic-magic context, cf. *Háv* 142/6.

5–7 af … Hodd·rofnis 'from … horn. | These lines have been interpreted as a reference to Weden's drinking of the liquid from Mimer's well. According to *Yng* 4, Mimer was decapitated by the Wanes and his head was sent to the Eese. Weden brought the head back to life and gained great wisdom from it (see *Vsp* 28/3 n.). As attested in *Gylf* 15:10–13, Mimer in fact drank from his well by means of a horn, and the well also appears to be paired with the horn in *Vsp* 26. For discussion on this myth, see Schjødt (2008, pp. 116–119).

**14** Á bjargi stóð · með Brimis ęggjar, [R 32v/3–4]
hafði sér á hǫfði hjalm;
þá mę́lti Míms hǫfuð
fróðligt it fyrsta orð,
ok sagði sanna stafi.

On the barrow he stood along Brimer's edges;
he had on his head a helmet.
Then Mime's head spoke,
learnedly, the first word,
and said true staves:

3 þá mę́lti Míms hǫfuð 'Then Mime's head spoke' | For the relevant myth, cf. *Yng* 4, summarised in *Vsp* 28/3 n.

**15** Á skildi kvað ristnar · þęim's stęndr fyr skĭnanda goði, [R 32v/5–7, N 25r/11–1
á ęyra Ár·vakrs, · ok á Al·svinns hófi,
á því hvéli · es snýsk und rę́ið Hrungnis,
á Slęipnis tǫnnum · ok á slęðа fjǫtrum,

On the shield, he said, [runes] were carved—on the one that stands before the Shining God [SUN];
on Yorewaker's ear and on Allswith's hoof,
on the wheel which turns beneath Rungner's chariot,
on Slopner's teeth and on the fetters of sleds,

2 á ęyra Ár·vakrs, · ok á 'on Yorewaker's ear and on' | *om.* **N** 3 á | ok á **N** 3 snýsk 'turns' | stęndr *'stands'* **N** 3 Hrungnis 'Rungner's' | *emend. based on sense and meter;* Ravgnis **R**; Raugnis **N** 4 tǫnnum 'teeth' | taumum *'reins'* **N**

1 skildi … þęim's stęndr fyr skĭnanda goði 'the shield … that stands before the Shining God' | For this notion cf. *Grm* 39, according to which the Sun is covered by a disc shielding the earth from its heat. Without it, the whole world would burn up.

2 Ár·vakrs … Al·svinns 'Yorewaker … Allswith' | The two horses that pull the Sun across the heavens; cf. st. 3/1 n. above, *Grm* 38.

á bjarnar hrammi · ok á Braga tungu, [R 32v/7–9, N 25r/13–15]
á ulfs klóum · ok á arnar nęfi,
á blóðgum vęngjum · ok á brúar sporði,
á lausnar lófa · ok á líknar spori,

on the bear's paw and on Bray's tongue,
on the wolf's claws and on the eagle's beak,
on bloody wings and on the bridge's head,
on the palm of release and the trail of grace,

6 nęfi | *†nefiu†* N 8 ok á | ok N

á glęri ok á golli · ok á gumna hęillum, [R 32v/9–11, N 25r/15–18]
í vĭni ok virtri · ok vili-sessi,
á Gungnis oddi · ok á Grana brjósti,
á nornar nagli · ok á nęfi uglu;

on glass and on gold and on men's luck-charms,
in wine and beerwort and the comfortable seat,
on Gungner's point and on Grane's chest,
on a norn's nail and on an owl's beak.

9 gumna hęillum 'men's luck-charms' | góðu silfri *'good silver'* N 10 vili-sessi 'the comfortable seat' | vǫlu sessi *'a wallow's seat'* N 10 vili-sessi 'the comfortable seat' | í guma holdi *'in a man's flesh' add.* N. 11 Gungnis oddi 'Gungner's point' | Gaupnis oddi *'Yeapner's point' (an elsewhere unknown spear)* N 11 Grana brjósti 'Grane's chest' | gýgjar brjósti *'a gigh's chest'* N

**16** Allar vóru af skafnar, · þér's vóru á ristnar, [R 32v/11–14, N 25r/18–21]
ok hverfðar við inn hęlga mjǫð
ok sęndar á víða vega:
þér 'ro með ǫsum, · þér 'ro með ǫlfum,
sumar með vísum vǫnum,
sumar hafa męnskir mænn.

All were shaven off—those that were carved on—
and mixed into the holy mead,
and sent on wide ways:
They are among the Eese, they are among the Elves,

some among the wise Wanes,
some have manly men.

2 hvęrfðar ‘mixed’ | †hrędar† *(for* hrǿrðar *‘stirred?)* N 4 ǫ́sum ... ǫlfum ‘Eese ... Elves’ | ǫlfum ... ǫ́sum *‘Elves … Eese’* N 4 þ́ér ’ro ‘they are’ | sumar *‘some’* N 5 sumar ‘some’ | ok *‘and’* N

2 hęlga mjǫ̨ð ‘the holy mead’ | Apparently the Mead of Poetry. This is the only place in the Eddic corpus where it is called *hęilagr* ‘holy, inviolable’, but in Scaldic poetry it is called holy in the late pagan composition Refr *Giz* 2 (in SkP 3): *hęilagt full hrafn-ásar* ‘the holy cup of the Raven-Os [= Weden > POETRY]’.

**17** Þat eru bók-rúnar, · þat eru bjarg-rúnar [R 32v/14–16, N 25r/2
ok allar ǫl-rúnar
ok mętar męgin-rúnar
hvęim’s þ́ér kná ó·villtar · ok ó·spilltar
sér at hęillum hafa;
njót-tu ef namt
und’s rjúfa=sk rągin!“

They are book-runes, they are rescue-runes,
and all ale-runes,
and noble might-runes—
for whomever knows them unfalsified and uninjured
to have for himself as charms.
Use them if thou learn them
until the Reins are ripped!“

1 þat eru ‘the are’ | ok *‘and’* N 3 ok mętar ‘and noble’ | ok mę́rar ok *‘and renowned and’* N 4 ó·spilltar | †of villtar† N 7 rjúfa=sk | rjúfa N

1 bók-rúnar ‘book-runes’ | The word ought likely to be emended to **bót-rúnar* ‘remedy-runes’, since the letters *c* and *t* are often conflated due to their similarity. This emendation is supported by two arguments. Firstly the semantic pair *bót* ‘remedy’ : *bjarg* ‘rescue’ is surely stronger than *bók* ‘book, beech’ : *bjarg* ‘rescue’ and the stanza is specifically referring to the practical (magico-medicinal) use of the runes. Secondly the pair *bót-runar* : *bjarg-rúnar* is in fact attested on a runic charm, N B257 (edited under Galders from Bryggen).

**18** „Nú skalt kjósa · alls þér ’s kostr of boðinn, [R 32v/16–18, N 25v/3
hvassa vápna hlynr,
sǫgn eða þǫgn · haf þér sjalfr í hug;
ǫll eru męin of metin.“

[Quoth Syedrive:] “NOW SHALT THOU CHOOSE, as the choice is offered thee,
O maple-tree of sharp weapons [WARRIOR]!
Speech or silence have for thyself in thy heart;
all the harms are measured!”

1 Nú ‘Now’ | *Ornamented with 4 cross-bars in* **R**.

---

ALL | Another section begins, though the speaker is the same. Byrnhild offers the young Siward the choice between taking her prophetic advice or letting it remain unsaid. Much of the advice likely relates to Siward’s future dealings with the Nivlings Guther and Hawn, and the implication of Byrnhild’s offering him the choice seems to be that that he will not entirely enjoy having the knowledge of things to come (for that theme cf. *Grip* and *Háv* 56).

4 of metin ‘measured’ | I.e., in advance, by the *Mjǫtuðr* ‘Measurer’; cf. *Vsp* 45/1 n.

**19** „Mun’k=a ek flója · þó’tt mik fęigan vitir, [**R** 32v/18–20, **N** 25v/5–8]
2 em’k=a ek með blęyði borinn;
ǫst-rǫð þín · ek vil ǫll hafa
4 svá lęngi sem ek lifi.“

[Quoth Siward:] “I shall not flee, although thou mightst know me to be fey;
I was not born with softness.
Thy loving counsels I shall have, all,
so long as I may live.”

---

2 með | *om.* **N**

---

2 með blęyði borinn ‘born with softness’ | A common heroic expression or formula. Being “born with softness” means that one was born soft and cowardly (*blauðr*), and such traits were thought to last from childhood unchanged into adulthood unchanged; cf. *Fáfn* 6/4.

**20** „Þat rǫð’k þér it fyrsta · at við fręndr þína [**R** 32v/20–22]
2 vamma-laust verir;
síðr þú hęfnir · þó’tt þęir sakar gøri;
4 þat kveða dauðum duga.“

[Quoth Syedrive:] “This I counsel thee first: that thou against thy kinsmen
defend thyself faultlessly.
Late oughtst thou to take revenge, although they incur charges;
that, they say, befits the dead.

**21** Þat rǫð’k þér annat, · at ęið né svęrir, [**R** 32v/22–24]
2 nema þann ’s saðr sé,
grimmar simar · ganga at tryggð-rofi;
4 armr es vára vargr.

This I counsel thee second: that thou not swear an oath,
save for the one which is true.
Grim strands follow the troth-breach;
wretched is the outlaw of vows.

---

ALL | The punishment for perjury is one of painful torment in the afterlife; see note to *Vsp* 39. — The whole stanza is paraphrased in *Vǫls* ch. 21: *Ok sver eigi rangan eið, því at grimm hefnd fylgir griðrofi.* 'And swear no wrong oath, for grim revenge follows the grith-breach.'

3 simar 'strands' | i.e., 'strands of fate'; cf. *1 HHund* 3, where the norns are said to twist such strands. Often emended to *limar* 'ramifications' in accordance with *Reg* 4, where that word is used in basically the same context. Such a scribal confusion is easily understood, since *s* in this position was always spelled with long *ſ* in the old mss. The paraphrase (see other note) is not conclusive, since it replaces this word with *hefnd* 'revenge'.

**22** Þat rǫ́ð'k þér þriðja · at þú þingi á [R 32v/24–25]
dǫ́li=t við hǫ́imska hali
því't ó·sviðr maðr · lǫ́tr oft kveðin
verri orð an viti.

This I counsel thee third: that thou on the Thing
not bandy with foolish men;
for an unwise man often lets be spoken
worse words than he ought to know.

**23** Allt es vant · ef við þǫ́gir; [R 32v/25–28]
þá þikkir þú með blǫ́yði borinn
eða sǫnnu sagðr;
hǫ́ttr es hǫ́imis-kviðr
nema sér góðan geti.
Annars dags · lát hans ǫndu farit
ok launa svá lýðum lygi.

Everything is wrong if thou shut up in reply;
then thou seemest born with softness,
or truthfully accused.
Risky is the hometown-verdict,
unless one get himself a good one.
On another day destroy his life,
and thus repay the people for the lie.

---

6 ǫndu 'life' | lit. 'breath, spirit'. Cf. *Vsp* 17 where *ǫnd* is Weden's gift to the first men.

**24** Þat rǫ́ð'k þér it fjórða · ef býr for·dǫ́ða [R 32v/28–30]
vamma-full á vegi:
ganga 's betra · an gista séi
þó'tt þik nǫ́tt of nemi.

This I counsel thee fourth: if there lives an evil-working woman,
full of faults, by the road,

to walk is better than to take lodgings [with her]
although night overtake thee.

**25** For·njósnar augu · þurfu fira synir [R 32v/30–32]
hvar's skulu *v*rǫiðir vega;
opt bǫl-vísar konur · sitja brautu nér;
þǫ́r's dǫyfa sverð ok sefa.

Eyes of looking-out do the sons of folk need,
wherever wroth men shall fight;
oft bale-wise women sit near the highway,
they who dull sword and sense.

1 For·njósnar 'looking-out' | Verbal noun to *nýsask fyrir* 'look out, look ahead', as found in *Háv* 7.

**26** Þat rǫ́ð'k þér it fimmta, · þó'tt fagrar séir [R 32v/32–34]
brúðir bǫkkjum á,
sifja silfr · lát=a þǐnum svefni ráða,
tǫygj=at þér at kossi konur.

This I counsel thee fifth: although thou seest
fair brides on the benches,
let not their kinsmen's silver rule thy sleep;
lure not those women to thee for kisses.

**27** Þat rǫ́ð'k þér it sétta, · þó'tt með sǫggjum fari [R 32v/34]
ǫlðr-mǫ́l til ǫfug:
drukkinn dǫila · skal=at við dolg-viðu
margan stelr vǐn viti.

This I counsel thee sixth: although among warriors may grow
the ale-speech too awry,
drunkenly deal shalt thou not with war-trees [WARRIORS];
wine steals wit from many.

1 fari 'may grow' | The last word on **R** 32v, after which the Great Lacuna occurs. The rest of *Sigrdr*, including ll. 2–4 of this stanza, are supplied from younger paper mss.

TODO: Add the remaining stanzas from paper manuscripts.

# Fragments from the Walsing-Cycle

## Introduction

In **R**, *Sigrdr* ends abruptly at stanza 27 due to the loss of one quire, consisting of 8 folios, the so-called **Great Lacuna** (Lindblad 1977, 6 n. 2). The poetry contained on these pages undoubtedly belonged to the Walsing-Cycle and would have dealt further with the life of Siward and his dealings with Byrnhild and the Yivickings. Some stanzas likely belonging to this section survive in other sources; these are the **Fragments from the Walsing-Cycle** (*Vǫlsbr*).

The following seven stanzas have two sources. The first six are from *Vǫls*, and follow the numbering of stanzas in that text according to Olsen (1906–1908). The redactor of that text drew heavily from a collection of Walsing-Cycle poetry closely related to the heroic second half of **R**. He cites around two dozen stanzas known from **R** and paraphrases many more. Notably, however, some of the stanzas which he cites do not survive in **R**—it is these which are edited here. The contents of these fragments largely correspond to the part of the narrative belonging to the Great Lacuna of **R**, and it is therefore probable that most or all of them derive from the poems once found therein.

The final stanza is taken from *Sv*. It is uncertain whether it originally belongs to the Walsing-Cycle, but since the possibility exists it has been edited here.

## Fragments from *Vǫls*

**1** Ristu af magni · mikla hęllu,
2 Sig·mundr hjǫrvi · ok Sin·fjǫtli.

They carved with strength the great stone,
Syemund with sword, and Sinfittle.

---

ALL | TODO.

**22** Ęldr nam at ósask · ęn jǫrð at skjalfa

ok hǫ́r logi · við himni gnéfa;
fár trǫysti=sk þar · fylkis rekka
ęld at ríða · né yfir stíga.

The fire took to rage and the earth to shake
and high flame to rise to heaven.
Few there dared of the marshall's champions
the fire to ride or to step over it.

---

ALL | TODO.

**23** Sig·*vǫ*rðr Grana · sverði kęyrði;
ęldr sloknaði · fyr ǫ̨̈lingi;
logi allr lę́gðisk · fyr lof-gjǫrnum;
bliku ręiði, · es Ręginn átti.

Siward drove Grane on by his sword;
the fire went out before the athling;
the flame all lowered before the praise-eager man;
the harness flashed which Rein had owned.

---

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

**24** Sig·urðr vá at ormi, · ęn þat síðan mun
øngum fyrna=sk, · meðan ǫld lifir;
ęn hlýri þínn · hvár=ki þorði
ęld at ríða · né yfir stíga.

Siward smote the Wyrm, and that will afterwards
be forgotten by none while mankind lives—
but *thy brother* dared neither
to ride the fire nor to step over it.

---

ALL | TODO.

**25** Út gekk Sig·*vǫ*rðr · ann·spjalli frá,
holl-vinr lofða, · ok hnípaði,
svá at ganga nam · gunnar-fúsum
sundr of síður · serkr járn-ofinn.

TODO: translation.

---

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

---

ALL | TODO.

**26** Sumir við-fiska tóku, · sumir vitnis-hrę skífðu,
sumir Gutt·ormi gǫfu · gęra hold
við munn-gáti · ok marga hluti
aðra í tyfrum.

Some seized wood-fish [SNAKES], some sliced wolf-carrion,
some gave Godthorm hound-flesh
with strong drink and many other
things in magic potions.

---

ALL | This st. is apparently related to *Brot* 4, with which it shares (in divergent form) its first two lines. It is cited in *Vǫls* 32, where it is introduced by the words *sem skáld'it kvað:* 'just as the scald quoth', indicating that it has been taken from an external source.

## Fragment from *Sv*

**S1** U̇·líkr est≠u · yðrum niðjum [F TODO]
þęim's fram-ráðir · fyrri vǫru.

Thou art unlike your kinsmen
who were aspiring to fame in olden times.

---

ALL | There is no indication in the text itself that this half-stanza is related to the Walsing-Cycle. In *Sv* 124 it is spoken by King Swerrer to Lord Siward, introduced by the words: *Þínar verða allar jafnastar; lítla vón eiga Birki-beinar þar góðs hǫfðingia er þú ert. Ok er svá sem kveðit er.* 'Thy deeds are all bad. Little hope do the Birchbones have of a good chieftain in thy place. And it is as it was sung.' That it may in fact be a fragment from a Walsing-poem is supported by circumstantial evidence: the stanza is cited in the same exchange as *Fáfn* 6/3–4, and the man it is addressed to is named Siward. With this in mind, it is not unlikely (although by no means certain) that it derives from one of the lost poems of the Great Lacuna.

# Fragment of a Lay of Siward
# *(Brot af Sig·urðar kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.974)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

Following the Great Lacuna (*Vǫlsbr*), the text of **R** picks up in the middle of a heroic poem, namely the present **Fragment of a Lay of Siward** (*Brot*). This poem (or what survives of it) deals with the murder of Siward and its impact on Byrnhild, his jealous lover and the instigator of his death.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Brot* is only preserved in **R**, where it is found on foll. 33r/1–33v/8. The beginning of the poem has been lost due to the Great Lacuna; see *Vǫlsbr*.

According to the prose at the end of the poem (P1), *Brot* originally began with Siward's death. Since Siward's death is implied in st. 4, this indicates that we have not lost too much of the original poem. On the other hand, it has been speculated that *Brot* was the original "long" Lay of Siward, contrasting with the "Short Lay of Siward" (*Sigsk*), in which case we only have a small part of it. A more likely explanation is perhaps that *Brot* was preceded by such a poem.

Although part of *Brot* is lost, the poem clearly served as a source for *Vǫls* 32, which in fact cites a variant form of st. 4.

### Meter and stanza

*Brot* is composed in Ancient-words-lay and consists of 74 complete long-lines distributed across 20 stanzas. Owing to the loss of the preceding folio, l. 1/1 is defective and consists of only an isolated off-verse.

The typical length of the stanza is 4 lines (17/20: sts. 2–5, 7–16, 18–20) and the poem shows a strong tendency towards the helming-structure. Other

represented lengths are 3 (st. 6) and 2 lines (st. 17). Stanza 1 originally consisted of at least 2 lines.

## Summary

The poem begins *in medias res*; the speakers for sts. 1–3 are not indicated, but seem fairly certain. Hawn asks Guther why he wishes to see Siward dead (1). Guther answers that Siward has betrayed his marital oaths and thus their in-lawhood (2). Hawn warns Guther that Byrnhild, his wife, has deceived him; she is jealous of Siward's wife, Guthrun, and hates her husband (3). The brothers give their younger brother, Godthorm, the flesh of wolves and snakes in order to strengthen him for the killing of Siward (4).

Guthrun, Siward's wife, stands outside to greet her brothers and husband as they return; she does not see Siward and asks where he is (5). Hawn, her brother, answers that they have cut him down (6). Byrnhild tells the brothers to enjoy their wealth; if Siward had lived longer he would have taken it all (7). One of the brothers, likely Hawn again, answers that it would not have been right for Siward to rule their inheritance, since he would have begotten sons to keep it for himself (8). Byrnhild laughs madly and again tells them to enjoy their lands (9). Guthrun chastises Byrnhild and then curses her brothers; she tells them that there will be revenge for their treachery (10).

The poem returns to Siward's death, south of the Rhine. As he died, a raven called out above him, telling Guther and Hawn that Attle would soon kill them and that their broken oaths would destroy them (11). Later the same night, Guther lies awake thinking about this prophecy (12–13).

A little before dawn, Byrnhild awakes; she declares that she will tell of her grief (14). All are silent as they hear the woman weep over the killing which she herself had laughingly instigated (15). Byrnhild addresses Guther, her husband, with a dream; her speech makes up the rest of the poem. She has dreamt that everything in their hall died. She had a cold bed as Guther rode, fettered, into a host of enemies (16). So, says she, may all the line of the Nivlings perish; they are oath-breakers (17). Byrnhild curses her husband for his breaking of the blood-oaths which he and Siward swore; Siward always put Guther first, and yet he still murdered him (18). Byrnhild illustrates how much Siward respected Guther by telling of how he refused to sleep with her when he rescued her (19). In disguise as Guther, Siward placed a sword between himself and Byrnhild in their bed; the outsides of the sword were forged in iron, but its insides were blended with venom—the treachery which ultimately led to his ruin (20).

## Text

[Hǫgni:] **1** „*hvat hęfir Sig·vǫrðr* · saka unnit
2 es þú fróknan vill · fjǫrvi nęma?“
[Hawn:] “[What has Siward] done for a crime,
that thou wilt deprive the brave of life?”

1 *hvat hęfir Sig·vǫrðr* ‘[What has Siward]’ | *om.* **R**

ALL | The poem appears to begin as Hawn speaks to Guther, who has asked him to help him slay Siward at the behest of Byrnhild. As usual in heroic tradition (cf. *Akv* 6–12), it is Hawn who is the voice of reason against his rasher brother Guther.

1 *hvat hęfir Sig·vǫrðr* ‘[What has Siward]’ | A conjectural reconstruction, which however can be held as reasonably secure, owing to the parallelism in the following stanza.

[Gunn·arr:] **2** „Mér hęfir Sig·*vǫ*rðr · sęlda ęiða
2 ęiða sęlda · alla logna;
þá vélti hann mik · es hann vesa skyldi
4 allra ęiða · ęinn full-trúi.“
[Guther:] “To me Siward has given oaths:
oaths given—all broken!
He deceived me when he should have been
the one true keeper of all the oaths.”

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

ALL | Although it is most logical that Guther is the one saying this owing to the answer in st. 3, it would perhaps be more fitting for Byrnhild to be the speaker. In fact, it is an important point of the narrative that Siward has *not* broken his oaths to Guther. Cf. the contrasting dialogue *Sigsk* 13–19, where Guther is sympathetic towards Siward and aware that he has not broken his oaths.

[Hǫgni:] **3** „Þik hęfir Bryn·hildr · bǫl at gørva
2 hęiptar hvattan · harm at vinna;
fyr·man hǫn Guð·rúnu · góðra ráða
4 ęn síðan þér · sín at njóta.“
[Hawn:] “Byrnhild has inflicted a bale upon thee,
incited thee to hatred that thou mightst accomplish evil.
She begrudges Guthrun her good counsel,
and thereto that thou enjoyest her.”

3 góðra ráða ‘her good counsel’ | Namely her marriage with Siward.

4 ęn síðan þér · sín at njóta ‘and thereto that thou enjoyest her’ | I.e., that Guther (rather than Siward) is the one wedded to Byrnhild.

**4**

Sumir ulf sviðu, · sumir orm sniðu,
sumir Goð·þormi · af gęra dęildu,
áðr þęir mętti · męins of lystir
à horskum hal · hęndr of lęggja.

Some roasted a wolf; some cut up a snake;
some shared hound-flesh with Godthorm,
before they might, desiring evil,
lay their hands on the wise hero [= Siward].

---

ALL | In order to prepare their younger brother Godthorm for the treacherous killing of Siward, his brothers feed him the meat of wolves, snakes, and dogs. — A related st. is cited in **N** (*Vǫls* 32); it is sufficiently divergent from the present st. to be edited on its own as *Vǫlsbr* 6 above.

**5**

Úti stóð Guð·rún · Gjúka dóttir
ok hǫn þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:
„Hvar 's nú Sig·*vǫ*rðr · sęggja dróttinn
es frękndr mínir · fyrri ríða?“

Outside stood Guthrun, Yivick's daughter,
and she this word first of all did say:
"Where is now Siward, the lord of men,
when my kinsmen ride ahead?"

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3 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

---

ALL | The killing is implied, but not described explicitly. In any case, it takes place outside and without Guthrun's awareness. This contrasts with *Sigsk*, *Ghv*, and *Hamð* where Siward is killed in bed next to the unfortunate Guthrun; see note to P1 below.

**6**

Ęinn því Hǫgni · and·svǫr vętti:
„Sundr hǫfum Sig·*vǫ*rð · sverði hǫgg*v*inn;
gnapir ę́ grár jór · yfir gram dauðum.“

Alone, then, Hawn this answer granted:
"We have cut Siward asunder by the sword;
the grey steed ever neighs over the dead prince."

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2 Sig·*vǫ*rð | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urð **R**

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1 Ęinn því Hǫgni · and·svǫr vętti 'Alone then Hawn this answer granted' | Shared with *Sigsk* 17/1, 45/1, which however have *ęinu* (neut. dat. sg.) for *ęinn* (m. nom. sg.) The difference is probably a mere spelling error, but it is unclear which form of the line is original.

**7**

Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:
„Vel skuluð njóta · vápna ok níu landa;

ęinn myndi Sig·*vǫ*rðr · ǫllu ráða
ef hann lęngr lítlu · lifi hęldi.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:
“Well shall ye enjoy the weapons and nine lands!
Alone would Siward have ruled them all
if a little longer he had held his life.”

3 myndi | myndiv **R** 3 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

[Hǫgni:] **8** „Vǽri=a þat sómt · at hann svá réði
Gjúka arfi · ok gota męngi,
es hann fimm sonu · at folk-róði
gunnar fúsa · getna hafði.“

[Hawn:] “It would not have been right that he should so have ruled
Yivick's inheritance and the menfolk of the Gots,
when to rule the folk he would have begotten
five sons eager for war.”

ALL | The speaker is not indicated, but since he spoke in st. 6, it is most likely Hawn who responds.

3 fimm sonu ‘five sons’ | Siward never has five living sons in the heroic tradition (rather, he usually only has one, Syemund). Instead, Guther is pointing out that Siward, *if* he had lived longer, would have begotten such sons with Guther, and these would eventually have come into conflict with their uncles, the Yivickings.

**9** Hló þá Bryn·hildr · —bór allr dunði—
ęinu sinni · af ǫllum hug:
„Vel skuluð njóta · landa ok þegna
es þér fróknan gram · falla létuð.“

Then Byrnhild laughed—the town all resounded—
a single time out of all her heart:
“Well shall ye enjoy the lands and thanes,
since ye made the brave prince to fall.”

1–2 Hló ... hug ‘Then ... heart’ | Found near-identically in *Sigsk* 30/1–2.

3 Vel skuluð njóta · landa ok þegna | Alliteration is missing in this line and no obvious emendation can be found; it clearly parallels 7/2 above.

**10** Þá kvað þat Guð·rún · Gjúka dóttir:
„Mjǫk męlir þú · miklar firnar;
gramir hafi Gunn·ar · gǫtvað Sig·*var*ðar,
hęipt-gjarns hugar · hęfnt skal verða.“

Then this quoth Guthrun, Yivick's daughter:
"Many great evils hast thou spoken.
Let the fiends have Guther, Siward's burier;
for his evil heart there shall be vengeance."

3 Sig·*var*ðar | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðar **R**

3 gramir hafi 'let the fiends have' | Apparently a common curse; cf. *Hárb* 60.

**11** Soltinn varð Sig·*vǫ*rðr · sunnan Rínar,
hrafn at męiði · hǫtt kallaði:
„Ykkr mun Atli · ęggjar rjóða,
munu víg-ská*a* · of viða ęiðar."

Siward had expired to the south of the Rhine;
a raven on a branch loudly called out:
"On you two will Attle redden his blades;
the oaths will destroy the war-harried men!"

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

1 Soltinn varð 'had expired' | Lit. 'became, turned dead'; *soltinn* 'dead; starved, dejected' is the past participle of *svelta* 'die; starve'. Apart from the present st., *soltinn* is used in three other places in Norse poetry: *Sigsk* 47/2 ('dejected'), 50/3 ('dead') and *2 Guðr* 10 ('dejected'). The use of this participle together with the shared subject matter may indicate a close relationship between these three poems, although the varying depictions of Siward's death (see P1 below) suggest that *2 Guðr* and *Brot* are more closely related to each other than to *Sigsk*.

**12** Framm vas kvelda · fjǫlð vas drukkit
þá vas hví-vetna · vil-mál talit;
sofnuðu allir · es í sęing kvǫmu,
ęinn vakði Gunn·arr · ǫllum lęngr.

The evening was late, much was drunk;
then were all kinds of pleasant speeches told.
All fell asleep when they came into bed;
alone did Guther wake longer than all.

**13** Fót nam at hrøra · fjǫlð nam at spjalla
hitt hęr-glǫtuðr · hyggja téði,
hvat þęir í bǫðvi · báðir sǫgðu
hrafn ęy ok ǫrn · es þęir hęim riðu.

His foot he took to move; much he took to consider.
Of this the troop-destroyer thought,

what in the fray those two had said,
the raven always and the eagle, when they rode home.

---

1 Fót … spjalla ‘His foot … consider.’ | Probably a formulaic line-template; cf. *Þrk* 1/3.

**14** Vaknaði Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir
dís skjǫldunga · fyr dag lítlu:
„Hvętið mik eða lętið mik · —harmr es unninn—
sorg at sęgja · eða svá láta.“

Byrnhild awoke, Budle’s daughter,
the dise of shieldings, a little before day:
“Urge me on or restrain me—the evil is accomplished—
to tell my sorrow, or so let it be.”

---

ALL | Byrnhild awakes just before dawn the day after the drinking; she makes a speech to the whole house. Her speech takes up the rest of the poem.

3 harmr es unninn ‘the evil is accomplished’ | A verbal callback referencing st. 3/2.

**15** Þǫgðu allir · við því orði
fár kunni þęim · fljóða lǫtum
es hǫn grátandi · gørði=sk at sęgja
þat’s hlęjandi · hǫlða bęiddi:

All fell silent upon that word
—few men know the manners of women—
when she, weeping, made ready to tell of
that which, laughing, she had asked from the heroes:

---

ALL | Sts. 15–20 are transparently paraphrased in *Vǫls* 31: *Nú þóttist engi kunna at svara, at Bryn·hildr beiddi þess hlęjandi, er hón harmaði męð gráti. Þá męlti hón: „Þat dreymdi mik, Gunn·arr, at ek átta kalda sęng, en þú riðr í hendr ó·vinum þínum, ok ǫll ętt yður mun illa fara, er þér eruð eið·rofa, ok mundir þú þat ó·gløggt, er þit blǫnduðuð blóði saman, Sig·urðr ok þú, er þú rétt hann, ok hefir þú honum allt illu launat þat, er hann gerði vel til þín ok lét þik fremstan vera, ok þá reyndi þat, er hann kom til vár, hvé hann helt sína eiða, at hann lagði okkar í milli it snarp·eggjaða sverð, þat er eitri var hert.* […] ‘Now nobody thought himself able to respond when Byrnhild now grieved by weeping over that which she had laughed about when she asked for it. Then she spoke: “I dreamt, Guther, that I had a cold bed, but thou didst ride into the hands of thy enemies, and all your lineage will fare ill for ye are oath-breakers. And thou didst not kindly remember how ye two blended your blood together, thou and Siward, when thou betrayed him, and thou hast cruelly repaid him fully for how he was good towards thee and let thee be the foremost, and when he came to us it was proven how well he kept his oaths, for he laid between us the sharp-edged sword which was hardened with venom. […]’

**16** „Hugða’k mér, Gunn·arr, · grimmt í svefni,
svalt allt í sal · ętta’k sęing kalda,
ęn þú gramr riðir · glaums and·vani

fjǫtri fatlaðr · ǐ fjánda lið.

"I had a cruel thought, O Guther, in my sleep:
everything died in the hall, I had a cold bed,
but thou, prince, didst ride without cheerful fellows,
chained in fetters, into a troop of foes.

4 fjǫtri fatlaðr 'chained in fetters' | Cf. *Akv* 21.

**17**

Svá mun ǫll yður · ętt Niflunga
afli gęngin— · eruð ęið-rofa!

So will all your line of Nivlings
part from power—ye are oath-breakers!

**18**

Mant=at-tu Gunn·arr · til gǫrva þat
es þit blóði ǐ spor · báðir rennduð,
nú hęfir hǫnum þat allt · illu launat
es hann fręmstan *þ*ik · finna vildi.

Thou didst not recall, Guther, clearly enough
that your blood in your tracks ye both did drive.
Now hast thou repaid cruelly him for all that,
when he would have had *thee* as the foremost man.

4 *þ*ik 'thee' | *sens. emend.;* sik *'himself'* **R**

2 þit blóði ǐ spor · báðir rennduð 'your blood in your tracks ye both did drive' | Referring to a ritual of blood-brotherhood, wherein the brothers-to-be would spill and mix their blood into their footprints on the ground. Blood-brotherhood is also mentioned in *Lok* 9, and the footprint-ritual is described in Saxo Grammaticus (2015) 1.6.7: *Siquidem icturi foedus veteres vestigia sua mutui sanguinis aspersione perfundere consueverant, amicitiarum pignus alterni cruoris commercio firmaturi* 'Now our ancestors, when they meant to strike a pact, would sprinkle their combined blood in their footprints and mingle it, so as to strengthen the pledge of their fellowship.' For discussion see PCRN History and Structures III:845 ff.

4 *þ*ik 'thee' | This reading follows the paraphrase of *Vǫls* and is undoubtedly correct. Siward would have Guther as the foremost of his own house and never violated his oaths toward him.

**19**

Þá ręyndi þat · es riðit hafði
móðigr á vit · mǐn at biðja,
hvé hęr-glǫtuðr · hafði fyrri
ęiðum haldit · við inn unga gram.

Then it was proven when he had ridden,
brave, to visit and ask for my hand,
how that destroyer of hosts [WARRIOR = Siward] had upheld
his side of the oaths against the young lord [= Guther]:

ALL | Sts. 19–20 conclude the poem; Byrnhild illustrates Siward's loyalty towards Guther by telling him how he refused to sleep with her while in disguise.

**20** Bęn-vǫnd of lét · brugðinn g*o*lli
marg-dýrr konungr · á meðal okkar;
ęldi vǫru ęggjar · útan gǫrvar
ęn ęitr-dropum · innan fáðar."

He placed a wound-wand [SWORD] wrapped in gold,
the much-adorned king, between us two;
with fire were its edges on the outside made,
but with drops of venom on the inside stained."

1 g*o*lli | gylli **R**

ALL | Cf. the description in *Sigsk* 4, 68.

4 ęitr-dropum 'with drops of venom' | Likely reflecting on how Siward's refusal to sleep with Byrnhild, an act of deep personal loyalty to Guther, still did not dissuade the Yivickings from murdering him. In fact, it caused it, since it was an act of betrayal against the unwitting Byrnhild, who ultimately incited his death.

## Frá dauða Sig·urðar ('From the Death of Siward')

**P1** Hér er sagt í þessi kviðu frá dauða Sig·urðar ok víkr hér svá til sem þeir drępi hann úti. En sumir segja svá at þeir drępi hann inni í rekkju sinni sofanda. En þýðverskir menn segja svá at þeir drępi hann úti í skógi, ok svá segir í Guð·rúnar kviðu inni fornu at Sig·urðr ok Gjúka synir hefði til þings riðit þá er hann var drepinn. En þat segja allir einnig at þeir sviku hann í tryggð ok vógu at hánum liggjanda ok ó·búnum.

HERE IT HAS BEEN TOLD in this lay from the death of Siward, and here it begins at the point when they slew him outside. But some say that they slew him inside in his bed-chamber, sleeping. But the Germans say that they slew him outside in the forest, and so it says in the Ancient Lay of Guthrun that Siward and the sons of Yivick had ridden to the Thing when he was slain. But this they all say in unison, that they betrayed him while he trusted them and struck at him lying down and unarmed.

1 Hér | *Introduced by an ornamented 3-line initial in* **R**.

ALL | This prose passage gives us an interesting example of early source criticism in the treatment of Scandinavian legend. Siward's death at the Thing is described above in *Brot* 4–6 and later in *2*

*Guðr* 4–11. On the other hand, *Sigsk* 21–30, *Ghv* 4, and *Hamð* 6, all have him dying in bed alongside Guthrun.

4 Guð·rúnar kviðu inni fornu 'the Ancient Lay of Guthrun' | Apparently a reference to *2 Guðr* 4–5, although that poem is not given the descriptor *in forna* 'the Ancient' in its own title.

# First Lay of Guthrun
# *(I Guð·rúnar kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.988)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **First Lay of Guthrun** (*1 Guðr*) is a heroic narrative poem dealing with the aftermath of Siward's murder and its emotional impact on his wife, Guthrun.

The poem is clearly intended by the redactor of **R** to form a continuous narrative with the preceding poem, *Brot*. The concluding prose of *Brot* leads into the introduction to *1 Guðr*.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*1 Guðr* is only preserved in **R**, on foll. 33v/8–34v/1, where it follows *Brot* and is followed by *Sigsk*.

### Origin and motifs

The poem shares several lines with the poems *Sigsk* (*1 Guðr* 1, 16, 22, 23 (n.), 25) and *2 Guðr* (*1 Guðr* 1, 18). Since the depiction of the death of Siward differs between those two poems, their relation to each other and to *1 Guðr* is rather unclear. *Sigsk* belongs to a group of three poems (*Sigsk*, *Ghv*, and *Hamð*) that describe Siward as dying in his bed, whereas *2 Guðr* (along with *Brot*) sees the hero die outside, with Guthrun neither present nor aware of the killing (cf. further *Brot* P1 n.).

*1 Guðr* does not give any certain evidence one way or the other as to which tradition it belongs to, but it seems from its description in st. 14 that Guthrun has not previously seen Siward dead, which would support a closer association with *2 Guðr* and *Brot*.

## Summary

After Siward's death, Guthrun is so upset that she cannot make herself weep; she sits mourning over his corpse and is so filled with grief that she is about to burst apart (P1, 1). Noblemen approach her and try to speak to her, but she still cannot make herself to cry (2). Next, three noble ladies come up to Guthrun; each one realtes her own sorrows in an attempt to make Guthrun weep and release her pent-up grief (3).

Yeflie, the sister of Yivick, begins; she has lost five husbands, two daughters, three sisters, and eight brothers; she alone lives (4). Guthrun does not weep (5). The second is Harbury, the queen of Hunland. She lost seven sons and her husband in battle (6). Her father, mother, and four brothers were drowned (7), and she herself had to dig their graves and bury them (8). After this, she was taken as a captive and enthralled as the hand-maiden of a king's wife (9) who beat and tortured her out of jealousy (10). Guthrun still does not weep (11).

The third woman, Goldrand, the daughter of Yivick, tells her elder relatives that they do not know how to speak to the young widow. She asks for Siward's shrouded body to be uncovered (12), then casts the shroud away from him, telling Guthrun to look upon him and kiss him as she did when he was still in life (13). Guthrun sees the locks of her husband run thick with blood, his eyes bereft of life, and his gashed chest cut open (14). She sinks down to his side, lets her hair loose, and weeps at last (15–16). Goldrand speaks to Guthrun; she knew that the love between Guthrun and Siward was the greatest of all mankind (17). Guthrun answers that her Siward was the best of all men, far surpassing her own brothers (18). When he was alive she felt mightier than any one of the walkirries in heaven, but now she is as small as a thin leaf (19). She misses her husband in the bed and in the couch. It is all the fault of her brothers, Guther and Hawn (20). Guthrun curses Guther for his treachery: he will not get to enjoy the gold he took from Siward, but rather it will be the sake of his own death (21).

Guthrun now turns to Byrnhild and reminisces that she, her brothers, and Siward lived happily together before Byrnhild came into their midst (22). Byrnhild, although not offering Guthrun sympathy, expresses that she will not live long; she declares that she will remain without husband or child (23). Goldrand berates her for speaking and tells her to be silent; she has only been a source of ruin for their house (24). Byrnhild answers her accusation. It is her brother, King Attle, who is at fault for the evils that have befallen them, for it was Attle who forced her to be married to Guther out of greed (25). Even though it was she who incited Guther and Hawn to murder Siward, Byrnhild is also upset by the killing. She leans against a pillar; fires burn from her eyes at the sight of the his fatal wounds (26).

The concluding prose passage tells us that Guthrun ran away from the Yivickings and stayed with Thurie of Denmark for seven half-years. Byrnhild, on the other hand, murdered her servants and then took her own life, as is told in the immediately following *Sigsk* (P2).

## Text

**P1** Guð·rún sat yfir Sig·urði dauðum. Hón grét eigi sem aðrar
2 konur en hón var búin til at springa af harmi. Til gengu bǫ́ði
konur ok karlar at hugga hana en þat var eigi auð-velt. Þat er
4 sǫgn manna at Guð·rún hefði etit af Fáfnis hjarta ok hón skilði
því fugls rǫdd. Þetta er enn kveðit um Guð·rúnu:

Guthrun sat over Siward, dead. She did not weep like other women, but she was ready to burst apart from grief. Both women and men came up to console her, but that was not easily done. It is the saying of men that Guthrun had eaten of Fathomer's heart and therefore she understood the speech of birds. This is further sung about Guthrun:

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ALL | *No break between this passage and the concluding prose of* Brot *is made in* **R**.

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4–5 hón skilði því fugls rǫdd 'therefore she understood the speech of birds' | Apparently mentioned in order to explain st. 16.

## Guð·rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

**1** Ár vas þat's Guð·rún · gørði=sk at dǫyja,
2 es hǫn sat sorg-full · yfir Sig·*vǫ*rði,
gørði=t hǫn hjúfra · né hǫndum slá*a*
4 né kvǫina of · sem konur aðrar.

It was of yore that Guthrun made ready to die
as she sat sorrowful over Siward.
She did not pant nor beat her hands
nor wail over him like other women.

---

1 Ár | *The* A *is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in* **R**. 2 Sig·*vǫ*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

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1 Ár vas þat's 'It was of yore that' | Shared with *Sigsk* 1/1. *ár* 'of yore' is a common initial word, also found in *Vsp* 3/1, *Hym* 1/1, and *1 HHund* 1/1.

2–4 es hǫn ... aðrar 'as she ... women.' | Closely related to *2 Guðr* 10/3–5.

**2** Gingu jarlar · al-snotrir framm,
2 þǫir's harðs hugar · hana lǫttu;
þǫy=gi Guð·rún · gráta mátti,
4 svá vas hǫn móðug; · mundi hǫn springa.

There went forth all-clever earls,
they who would loosen her hard heart,
yet nowise could Guthrun weep;
so moody was she—she would burst apart.

**3**
Sǫ́tu ítrar · jarla brúðir
golli búnar · fyr Guð·rúnu;
hvęr sagði þęira · sinn of-trega
þann's bitrastan · of beðit hafði.

There sat the splendid brides of the earls
adorned with gold before Guthrun;
each one of them told her own great sorrow,
the bitterest one she had endured.

**4**
Þá kvað Gjaf·laug, · Gjúka systir:
„Mik vęit'k á moldu · munar-lausasta;
hęfi'k fimm vera · for·spell beðit,
tvęggja dǿtra, · þriggja systra,
átta bróðra, · þó ek ęin lifi."

Then quoth Yeflie, Yivick's sister:
"I know myself on the earth to be most joyless.
Of five husbands I have suffered the loss,
of two daughters, three sisters,
eight brothers—yet I alone live."

---

4 tvęggja dǿtra, · þriggja systra | No alliteration is found in this line and no obvious emendation can be found; it seems that the strong parallelism and assonance between *tvęggja* and *þriggja* compensate for it.

**5**
Þęy=gi Guð·rún · gráta mátti;
svá vas hǫn móðug · at mǫg dauðan
ok harð-huguð · of hrør fylkis.

Yet nowise could Guthrun weep;
so moody was she after the lad's death,
and hard-hearted over the marshaller's corpse.

**6**
Þá kvað þat Hęr·borg, · Húna-lands dróttning:
„Hęfi'k harðara · harm at sęgja:
minir sjau synir · sunnan lands,
verr inn átti, · í val fellu.

Then this quoth Harbury, Hunland's queen:
"I have a harder harm to tell.
My seven sons to the south of the land,
—my husband eighth—in battle fell."

**7** Faðir ok móðir, · fjórir bróðr,
þau á vági · vindr of lék,
barði bára · við borð-þili.

My father and mother, my four brothers—
them on the wave the wind outplayed;
the breaker beat against the ship-side.

**8** Sjǫlf skylda'k gǫfga, · sjǫlf skylda'k gǫtva,
sjǫlf skylda'k hǫndla, · hęl-fǫr þęira;
þat ek allt of bęið · ęin misseri
svá't mér maðr ęngi · munar lęitaði.

I alone had to honour them; I alone had to bury them;
I alone had to handle their hell-journey [DEATH].
This all I suffered in one half-year,
while noone found me any joy.

2 hęl-fǫr | *emend.;* hęr-fǫr **R**

**9** Þá varð'k hapta · ok hęr-numa
sams misseris · síðan-verða;
skylda'k skręyta · ok skúa binda
hęrsis kván · hvęrjan morgin.

Then I became a captive and taken in war,
in the latter part of that same half-year.
I had to dress and bind the shoes
of the ruler's wife every morning.

**10** Hǫn ógði mér · af af·brýði
ok hǫrðum mik · hǫggum kęyrði;
fann'k hús-guma · hvęr=gi inn bętra
en hús-fręyju · hvęr=gi verri."

She tortured me out of jealousy
and with hard blows drove me on.
A husband nowhere I've met better,
but a housewife nowhere worse."

**11** Þęy=gi Guð·rún · gráta mátti;
svá vas hǫn móðug · at mǫg dauðan
ok harð-huguð · of hrør fylkis.

Yet nowise could Guthrun weep;
so moody was she after the lad's death,
and hard-hearted over the marshaller's corpse.

**12** Þá kvað þat Goll·rǫnd, · Gjúka dóttir:
„Fǫ kannt, fóstra, · þó'tt fróð séir,
ungu vífi · and-spjǫll bera."
Varaði hǫn at hylja · of hrør fylkis.

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:
"Little canst thou, foster-mother—though thou be wise—
to a young wife give answers."
She bade them uncover the marshaller's corpse.

**13** Svipti hǫn bléju · af Sig·*vę*rði
ok vatt vęngi · fyr vífs kn*éu*m:
„Lít-tu á ljúfan, · lęgg þú munn við grǫn
sęm þú halsaðir · hęilan stilli."

She cast the shroud off of Siward
and threw it on the ground before the wife's knees:
"Look on thy beloved! Lay thy mouth to his lips,
like when thou embracedest the hale prince."

1 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R** 2 kn*éu*m | *metr. emend. by restoration of old hiatus form;* knjám **R**

**14** Á lęit Guð·rún · ęinu sinni;
sá hǫn dǫglings skǫr · dręyra runna,
frànar sjónir · fylkis liðnar,
hug-borg jǫfurs · hjǫrvi skorna.

On him Guthrun looked a single time;
she saw the noble's locks run with blood,
the piercing gaze of the marshaller gone,
the heart-fort [CHEST] of the chieftain cut by the sword.

**15** Þá hné Guð·rún · hǫll við bólstri;
haddr losnaði, · hlýr roðnaði
en regns dropi · rann niðr umb kné.

Then Guthrun sank down, slooped against the bolster.
Her hair fell loose, her cheek turned red,
and a drop of rain ran down to her lap.

**16**
Þá grét Guð·rún, · Gjúka dóttir,
svá't tǫr flugu · tresk í gǫgnum
ok gullu við · gęss í túni,
męrir fuglar · es męr átti.

Then wept Guthrun, Yivick's daughter,
so that the tears flew through the ...
and in response shrieked the geese in the yard,
the famèd fowls which that maiden owned.

2 tresk '...' | This word is an unexplained hapax.

3 ok gullu við · gęss í túni 'and in response shrieked the geese in the yard' | Shared identically with *Sigsk* 29/4.

**17**
Þá kvað þat Goll·rǫnd, · Gjúka dóttir:
„Ykkar vissa'k · ástir męstar
manna allra · fyr mold ofan;
unðir þú hvár-ki · úti né inni,
systir mín, · nema hjá Sig·*vęr*ði."

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:
"I knew that the love between you two
was the greatest of all men above the earth.
Thou wast never content outside nor inside,
O sister of mine, save by Siward's side."

5 Sig·*vęr*ði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

[Guð·rún kvað:] **18**
„Svá vas mínn Sig·*vǫr*ðr · hjá sonum Gjúka
sęm véri gęir-laukr · ór grasi vaxinn,
eða véri bjartr stęinn · á band dręginn:
jarkna-stęinn · yfir ǫðlingum.

[Quoth Guthrun:]
"So was my Siward beside the sons of Yivick
like were he a spear-leek grown out of grass,
or were a bright stone drawn on a string:
an arkenstone over the athlings.

1 Sig·*vǫr*ðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

ALL | Guthrun begins her monologue, lasting from sts. 18–22. — Apart from the related *2 Guðr* 2, cf. also the similar descriptions of Hallow (*2 HHund* 38) and Swanhild (*Ghv* 15).

1–2 Svá vas … vaxinn 'So was … grown' | These two lines are almost identical to *2 Guðr* 2/1–2. Since the present poem is probably older (Sapp 2022), it is likely the source.

2 gęir-laukr 'spear-leek' | I have opted for this translation out of transparency as the botanical identity is unclear (but cf. OE *gâr-léac* 'spear-leek', ancestor of modern English garlic). *2 Guðr* 2 has *grønn laukr* 'green leek' instead. For the cultural importance of leeks and onions see note to *Vsp* 4.

3–4 eða vęri … ǫðlingum. 'or were … athlings.' | Beaded necklaces were commonly worn by Scandinavian women of the time, and the beads were mostly of opaque coloured glass. Siward is likened to a bright crystal, the sons of Yivick to dull glass.

**19**

Ek þótta auk · þjóðans rekkum
hvęrri hęrri · Hęrjans dísi;
nú em'k svá lítil · sem lauf séa
øfst í jǫlstrum · at jǫfur dauðan.

I too seemed to the ruler's champions
higher than any of the Lord of Hosts' dises [WALKIRRIES].
Now I am even as small as if I were a leaf,
highest in the willows, after the ruler's death.

4 øfst | 'opt' **R**

4 øfst | Though the spelling of this word in **R** (*'opt'*) suggests the adverb *opt* 'often' (as it has been read by many eds.), this hardly makes sense in the context of the single leaf. On the other hand, the consonant cluster of the superlative *efstr, øfstr* 'highest, uppermost' is occasionally spelled with a *'-ptr'* in mss. (ONP, s.v. *efri, øfri*), and it is certainly the more likely word.

**20**

Sakna'k í sessi · ok í sęingu
mínns mál-vinar— · valda męgir Gjúka;
valda męgir Gjúka · mínu bǫlvi
ok systr sinnar · sǫrum gráti.

I miss in the couch and in the bed
my confidant—at fault are the lads of Yivick.
The lads of Yivick are at fault for my bale
and for their sister's [my] bitter weeping.

**21**

Svá ér umb lýða · landięyðið
sęm ér of unnuð · ęiða svarða;
man=a þú, Gunn·arr, · golls of njóta;
þęir munu þér baugar · at bana verða
es þú Sig·*vęrði* · svarðir ęiða.

Even so may ye make the land devoid of men,
as ye fulfilled the sworn oaths!
Thou wilt not, Guther, enjoy the gold.
Those bighs will become thy bane
on which thou to Siward didst swear the oaths.

---

5 Sig·vęrði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

---

4 þęir munu þér baugar · at bana verða 'those bighs will for thee become the bane' | I.e. 'the money will be the end of you', a prediction of the curse of the Nivling-hoard. Very similar to *Fáfn* 9, 20.

**22**

Opt vas í túni · tęiti męiri
þá's mínn Sig·vǫrðr · sǫðladi Grana,
ok þęir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru,
armrar vęttar · illu hęilli."

Often in the courtyard there was greater cheer,
[like] when my Siward saddled Grane
and they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand,
that wretched wight of ill omen."

---

2 Sig·vǫrðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

---

3 ok þęir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru 'and they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand' | The same line is found in *Sigsk* 3/1.

**23**

Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:
„Vǫn sé sú vęttr · vers ok barna
es þik Guð·rún · gráts of bęiddi
ok þér í morgun · mál-rúnar gaf."

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:
"Let this wight [me] be without husband and children,
who brought forth thy weeping, Guthrun,
and this morning gave thee things to speak of."

---

ALL | Byrnhild responds, stressing that she will not live long after Siward.

2 Vǫn ... vers ok barna 'without husband and children' | Cf. *Sigsk* 9/1 with emendation based on this line.

4 þér ... mál-rúnar gaf 'gave thee things to speak of' | Lit. 'gave thee speech-runes'.

**24**

Þá kvað þat Goll·rǫnd · Gjúka dóttir:
„Þęgi þú, þjóð-lęið, · þęira orða!
Urðr ǫðlinga · hęfir þú ę́ vesit

—rekr þik alda hvęr · illrar skępnu—
sorg sára · sjau konunga
ok vin-spell · vífa męst.“

Then this quoth Goldrand, Yivick's daughter:
“Shut up, O loathsomest woman, with those words!
The Weird of athlings hast thou always been,
—thou art driven by every wave of ill fate—
the sore sorrow of seven kings,
and the greatest spoiler of women's friendship.”

---

2 Þęgi þú, þjóð-lęið, · þęira orða ‘Shut up, O loathsomest woman, with those words’ | The same line is found in *Þrk* 18/2, with *Þórr* ‘Thunder’ for *þjóð-lęið* ‘most loathsome woman’.

3 Urðr ǫðlinga ‘The Weird of athlings’ | *Urðr* ‘Weird’ is one of the three Norns by the Ash of Ugdrassle (*Vsp* 19). A “fate-goddess of noblemen” is a woman who causes great grief or destruction, as fate itself frequently does. The Norns are often malevolent.

**25** Þá kvað þat Bryn·hildr · Buðla dóttir:
„Vęldr ęinn Atli · ǫllu bǫlvi
of borinn Buðla · bróðir mínn
þá's vit í hǫll · húnskrar þjóðar
ęld á jǫfri · orm-bęðs litum;
þęss hęfi'k gangs · goldit síðan,
þęirar sýnar; · sǫ́=umk ęy.“

Then this quoth Byrnhild, Budle's daughter:
“Alone is Attle at fault for all evil
—the one born of Budle, my own brother—
since when we two in the hall of the Hunnish folk
beheld the fire of the wyrm-bed [GOLD] on the prince.
For that journey I have paid ever since,
for that sight—I always worried over it.”

---

ALL | Byrnhild blames the tragic events on the greed of her brother Attle, who according to *Sigsk* 37 forced her to be married.

2 Vęldr ęinn Atli · ǫllu bǫlvi ‘Alone is Attle at fault for all evil’ | Related to *2 HHund* 34/3 and *Sigsk* 27/4.

3 of borinn Buðla · bróðir mínn ‘born of Budle, my own brother’ | Identically shared with *Sigsk* 56/5.

5 ęld orm-bęðs ‘fire of the wyrm-bed [GOLD]’ | An unparallelled kenning. GOLD can be ‘fire of the river’ (since it shines underwater) and ‘wyrm-bed’ (since the Wyrm or dragon dwells upon it), but not ‘fire of the wyrm-bed’. TODO: reference Meissner.

**26** Stóð hǫn und stoð · stręngði hǫn ęlfi,
brann Bryn·hildi · Buðla dóttur

ęldr ór augum; · ęitri fnøsti
es hǫn sǫr of lęit · á Sig·*vę*rði.

She stood beneath a pillar, fueled her anger;
in Byrnhild, Budle's daughter, burned
fire from her eyes; she spit venom
when she beheld the wounds on Siward.

4 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

**P2** Guð·rún gekk þaðan á braut til skógar á eyði-merkr ok fór allt til Danmarkar ok var þar með Þóru, Hákonar dóttur, sjau misseri. Bryn·hildr vildi eigi lifa eptir Sig·urð. Hón lét drepa þręla sína átta ok fimm ambóttir, þá lagði hón sik sverði til bana svá sem segir í Sig·urðar kviðu inni skǫmmu.

Guthrun went away thence through the woods of the wastelands and journeyed all the way to Denmark and stayed there with Thurie, Hathkin's daughter, for seven half-years. Byrnhild did not want to live after Siward. She had her eight thralls and five handmaids slain; then she ran herself through with a sword unto her death, as it says in the Short Lay of Siward.

1–2 Guð·rún ... misseri, 'Guthrun ... half-years.' | This information appears to be pulling from *2 Guðr* 12–13.

# Short Lay of Siward
# *(Sig·urðar kviða in skamma)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.876)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Short Lay of Siward** (*Sigsk*) continues the story of Siward, focusing on his death and Byrnhild's subsequent grieving. Despite its title, *Sigsk* is one of the longest poems in **R**, having ca. 280 long-lines. The name, then, seems to suggest that it was once prececed by an even longer poem about Siward, perhaps *Brot*. For lost Siward-poetry, cf. *Vǫlsbr* above.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Sigsk* is only preserved in **R**, on foll. 34v/2–36r/30, where it follows *1 Guðr* and is followed by *Helr*.

The poem was clearly available to the redactor of *Vǫls*, who made extensive use of it in *Vǫls* 32–33.

## Dating

The language of *Sigsk* has some archaic and unusual features.

The most notable archaic feature is its use of the particle *of* before nominals. This particle originally corresponds to an older Germanic **ga-* (thus Anon *Bjark* 1/4b (SkP 3): *of sinnar* 'companions' < PGmc **ga·sinþaniz* > OE *ge·siþas* 'id.') but becomes obsolete early in ON poetry except for when preceding verbs; in the Scaldic corpus attestations of *of* before nominals occur almost exclusively(?—TODO) before ca. 1000 AD (SkP 5, p. xcic).

In *Sigsk*, *of* occurs twice before nouns: 23/1a *of dolgr* (no non-Norse parallels but see note there) and 58/5a: *of skǫp* (= OE *ge·sceap*). It also occurs twice before the adj. *líkr*, viz. in 36/2b and 61/4b: *of líkr* (= OE *ge·líc*). This usage is unique in ON poetry since the *of* replaces the usual fossilized *g-* in *g·líkr*,

which proves that the poet of *Sigsk* had a strong intuitive sense of the semantics of this particle. A later archaizer would far more likely have created the hypercorrected form **of g·líkr*

Another archaic feature is the long form *haufuð* (23/2). Like the other Walsing-poems (save *Grípi*), *Sigsk* requires the long first syllable in the name *Sig·vǫrðr* 'Siward' (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141).

Metrically. *Sigsk* has a notable tolerance for three-syllable verses.

Contrary to Sapp's statistical model, the aforementioned archaic traits allow us to date the poem to the 10th century. It should therefore be of interest to the reader that the poem's depictions of widow-suicide (suttee) and the afterlife are likely authentic expressions of pagan culture.

## Text

### Sig·urðar kviða ('A Lay of Siward')

**1** Ár vas þat's Sig·*vǫ*rðr · sótti Gjúka
2 vǫlsungr ungi · es vegit hafði;
tók við tryggðum · tvęggja bróðra
4 sęldu=sk ęiða · ęljun-frøknir.

It was of yore that Siward, the young Walsing
who had triumphed, sought out Yivick.
He got the truces of two brothers;
they exchanged oaths, the men brave of zeal.

1 Ár | *The* A *is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in* R. 1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr R

1 Ár vas þat's 'It was of yore that' | Shared with *1 Guðr* 1/1; see there for further parallels.

**2** Męy buðu hǫnum · ok męiðma fjǫlð,
2 Guð·rúnu ungu · Gjúka dóttur;
drukku ok dømðu · dógr mart saman
4 Sig·*vǫ*rðr ungi · ok synir Gjúka,

They offered him a maiden and a multitude of treasures
with young Guthrun, Yivick's daughter.
They drank and discussed for many days and nights together,
young Siward and the sons of Yivick,

**3** und's þęir Bryn·hildar · biðja fóru
2 svá't þęim Sig·*vǫ*rðr · rędd í sinni
vǫlsungr ungi · ok vega kunni;
4 hann of ętti · ef hann ęiga knętti.

till they journeyed to ask for Byrnhild's hand,
whenas Siward rode alongside them,
the young Walsing, and he could fight;
he would have her if he could have her.

**4** Sęggr inn suðr-øni · lagði sverð nøkkvit
2 męki mál-fáan · á męðal þęira
né hann konu · kyssa gędi
4 né húnskr konungr · hęfja sér af armi

męy frum-unga; · fal hann męgi Gjúka.

The southern youth laid a naked sword,
a picture-painted blade between them,
nowise did he kiss the woman,
nor did the Hunnish king hold in his arms
the most young maiden; he saved it for the lad of Yivick.

---

ALL | Siward disguised himself as Guther and won Byrnhild's hand by riding through the fire surrounding her. She was unaware of the deception and thought that the man who had rescued her was really Guther. While inside the flames the two shared a single bed, but out of loyalty for Guther, Siward did not sleep with nor even touch Byrnhild in it; instead, he placed a sword between them. Cf. st. 68 below, *Brot* 20.

2 mękі mál-fáan 'a picture-painted blade' | Also occurring in *Skí* 23/1, 25/1; see there.

**5**

Hǫ̣n sér at lífi · lǫst né vissi
ok at aldr-lagi · ękki grand
vamm þat's vę́ri · eða vesa hygði;
gengu þęss á milli · grimmar urðir.

She knew no blemish to her life
and in her allotted age no wrong,
no fault which had been nor which thought to arise;
in that the cruel weirds intervened.

**6**

Ę́in sat hǫ̣n úti · aptan dags,
nam hǫ̣n svá bęrt · umb at mę́la=sk:
„Hafa skal'k Sig·*vǫ*rð, · —eða þó svelti!—
mǫg frum-ungan, · mér á armi.

Alone she sat outside at the close of day;
she took to speak plainly thus:
"I shall have Siward—or else let him die!—
that most young lad in my arms!

---

2 nam hǫ̣n svá bęrt · umb at mę́la=sk: | This line is missing alliteration and no obvious emendation can be found.

**7**

Orð mę́lta'k nú, · iðr=umk ę́ptir þęss,
kvǫ̣n 's hans Guð·rún · ę́n ek Gunn·ars,
ljótar nornir · skópu oss langa þrǫ́.“

The word I just spoke I afterwards regret.
Guthrun is his wife, but I am Guther's;
ugly norns shaped for us a long yearning.“

**8** Opt gęngr hǫn innan, · ills of fylld,
ísa ok jǫkla, · aptan hvęrn,
es þau Guð·rún · ganga á bęð
ok hana Sig·*vǫ*rðr · svęipr í ripti,
konungr inn hünski, · kvǫn frjá sína.

She often goes outside, filled with hatred,
with ice-sheets and icicles, every evening
when he and Guthrun go to their bed
and Siward wraps her in a blanket,
the Hunnish king, to make love to his wife.

---

2 ísa ok jǫkla 'with ice-sheets and icicles' | A description of Byrnhild's inner state; her jealousy makes her so cold that it is as if her insides froze to ice.

[Bryn·hildr kvað:] **9** „Vǫn gęng'k vilja, · vers ok b*arn*a,
verð'k mik gǿla · af grimmum hug."

[Quoth Byrnhild:] "I go without strength of will, husband, or children;
I shall have to soothe myself from my cruel thoughts."

---

1 b*arn*a | *sens. emend., cf.* 1 Guðr *23/2;* bęggja *'both'* **R**

**10** Nam af þęim hęiptum · hvętja=sk at vígi:
„Þú skalt, Gunn·arr, · gørst of láta
mínu landi · ok mér sjalfri;
mun'k una aldri · með ǫðlingi.

Due to that hatred she took to incite [men] to killing:
"Thou shalt, O Guther, very soon lose
my land and my very self;
I will never be content with an athling.

**11** Mun'k aptr fara · þar's áðan vas'k
með ná-bornum · niðjum mínum,
þar mun'k sitja · ok sofa lífi
nema þú Sig·*vǫ*rð · svelta látir
ok jǫfurr ǫðrum · óðri verðir.

I will go back whither I was before
amidst my close-born kinsmen;
there I will sit and sleep my life away—
unless thou lettest Siward die,
and becomest a chieftain nobler than he.

**12** Lǫtum son fara · fęðr ǐ sinni;
skal=at ulf ala · ungan lęngi.
Hvęim verðr hǫlða · hęfnd lėttari
—síðr til sátta— · at sonr lifi.“

We shall let his son follow in his father’s tracks;
one shall not rear a young wolf for long.
For every man revenge becomes easier
—peace less likely—if his son lives.”

**13** Rędiðr varð Gunn·arr · ok hnipnaði,
svęip sínum hug, · sat umb allan dag;
hann vissi þat · vil=gi gǫr=la
hvat hǫnum vę́ri · vinna sømst
eða hǫnum vę́ri · vinna bęzt,
alls sik Vǫlsung · vissi firrðan
ok at Sig·*vǫ*rð · sǫknuð mikinn.

Then Guther turned wroth and drooped;
he twisted his mind, sat for the whole day.
He knew not clearly in any way
what was most fitting for him to do,
or what was best for him to do,
as he knew he would be bereaved of the Walsing
and [feel] great loss after Siward.

---

1 Rędiðr varð Gunn·arr · ok hnipnaði | This line is missing alliteration and no obvious emendation can be found. The most likely explanation is that the adjective *rędiðr* ‘wroth’ was originally something else, since Guther does not appear to be actively angry, but rather confounded.

**14** Ýmist hann hugði · jafn-langa stund,
þat vas ędigi · árar títt
at frà konung-dóm · kvànir gengi;
nam hann sér Hǫgna · hędita at rùnum,
þar átti hann · alls full-trúa.

His thoughts went back and forth for an even-long time.
It was not at all desirable in times of yore
that wives should depart from a kingdom.
He summoned Hawn for secret counsel;
there he had a friend fully trusted in all.

[Gunn·arr kvað:] **15** „Ędin ’s mér Bryn·hildr · ǫllum bętri,
of borin Buðla, · hǫn ’s bragr kvenna;

fyrr skal'k mínu · fjǫrvi láta
an þeirar meyjar · meiðmum týna.

[Quoth Guther:] "Byrnhild alone is better to me than all—
that woman born of Budle; she is the peak of women.
Sooner shall I lose my own life
than abandon that maiden's treasures.

**16** Vill þú okkr fylki · til féar véla?
Gótt 's at ráða · Rínar malmi,
ok unandi · auði stýra
ok sitjandi · sélu njóta."

Wilt thou with me betray the marshaller for money?
It is good to rule the ore of the Rhine [GOLD],
and, prospering, to wield the wealth,
and, sitting, to enjoy good fortune."

**17** Einu því Hǫgni · ann·svǫr veitti:
„Samir eigi okkr · s·líkt at vinna,
sverði rofna · svarna eiða,
eiða svarna, · unnar tryggðir.

This one answer Hawn then granted:
"It does not befit us two to do such things,
to break by the sword the sworn oaths—
the sworn oaths, the taken truces.

---

1 Einu því Hǫgni · ann·svǫr veitti 'This one answer Hawn then granted' | Shared with st. 45/1 below and *Brot* 6/1.

**18** Vitum=a vit á moldu · menn in sélli
meðan fjórir vér · folki rǫðum
ok sá inn húnski · herr-Baldr lifir,
né in métri · mégð á moldu
ef vér fimm sonu · fǿðum lengi
ættum góða · óxla knéttim.

We shall not know upon the earth a more blessed man
while we four do rule the folk
and the Hunnish host-Balder [WARRIOR = Siward] lives,
nor a nobler in-law upon the earth
if we rear five sons for long,
good of lineages, and let them grow.

---

2 fjórir vér ‘we four’ | Guther, Hawn, Godthorm, and Siward.

**19**
Ek vęit gǫr=la · hvaðan vegir standa:
Eru Bryn·hildar · brek of·mikil.

I know clearly whence these troubles arise:
Byrnhild’s demands are far too great!

**20**
Vit skulum Guð·þorm · gørva at vígi,
yngra bróður, · ǫ·fróðara;
hann vas fyr útan · ęiða svarna,
ęiða svarna, · unnar tryggðir.“

We shall make Godthorm ready for war,
our younger brother, the less learned.
He was outside of the sworn oaths—
the sworn oaths, the taken truces.”

**21**
Dǫ́lt vas at ęggja · ǫ·bil-gjarnan,
stóð til hjarta · hjǫrr Sig·*vę*rði.

It was easy to incite the unyielding one [= Godthorm];
the sword was driven through the heart of Siward.

---

1 ęggja · ǫ·bil-gjarnan ‘incite the unyielding man’ | Also found in a proverb in *Gr*.

2 stóð til hjarta · hjǫrr ‘the sword was driven through the heart’ | Formulaic. Cf. *Vsp* 52/3–4, *Fáfn* 1/4.

**22**
Réð til hęfnda · hęr-gjarn ǐ sal
ok ęptir varp · ǫ·bil-gjǫrnum;
fló til Guð·þorms · Grams ramm=liga
kyn-birt *éa*rn · ór konungs hęndi.

The war-eager one [= Siward] turned to revenge in the hall
and threw after the unyielding one [= Godthorm];
towards Godthorm violently flew Gram’s
flashing-white blade from the hand of the king.

---

ALL | Sts. 22–23: Siward throws his sword, Gram, at Godthorm with such strength that it cuts him clean in two parts.

**23**
Hné hans of dolgr · til hluta tvęggja;
hęndr ok h*au*fuð · hné á annan veg

ęn fóta hlutr · fell aptr í stað.

His enemy sunk down in two parts:
his arms and head sunk to the side,
but the part of his legs fell backwards to the ground.

2 h*au*fuð | *metr. emend.;* hǫfuð **R**

1 of dolgr ‘enemy’ | Identical in sense to *dolgr*. The prefixing of a noun by the particle *of* is an archaic feature; cf. Introduction to the poem above. The authenticity of *of dolgr* is confirmed by another attestation in Egill *Arkv* 22 (SkP 5) from ca. 962 AD.

2 h*au*fuð | The long form *haufuð* is metrically required since the second lift cannot fall on a short syllable (Males 2025b, p. 15).

**24** Sofnuð vas Guð·rún · í sęingu
2 sorga-laus · hjá Sig·vęrði;
en hǫn vaknaði · vilja firrð
4 es hǫn Freys vinar · flaut í dreyra.

Guthrun lay sleeping in the bed,
sorrowless by Siward’s side,
but she awoke deprived of strength of will
when in the blood of Frea’s friend [= Siward] she swam.

4 Freys vinar ‘Frea’s friend’ | It is not clear why Siward is called the friend of this god in particular, but for the notion of a protégé of a god as his friend see *Háv* 157 n. A possible connection between Siward and Frea would be the hart-symbolism common to both; see *Fáfn* 2 n., *Vsp* 51/3.

**25** Svá sló hǫn svárar · sínar hęndr
2 at ramm-hugaðr · ręis upp við bęð:
„Grát=a þú, Guð·rún, · svá grimm=liga,
4 brúðr frum-unga— · þér bróðr lifa.

So harshly did she clap her hands
that the strong-minded man [= Siward] rose up against the bed:
“Weep thou not, Guthrun, so horribly,
O most young bride—thy brothers still live!

**26** Á’k til ungan · ęrfi-nytja,
2 kann=at hann firra=sk · ór fjánd-garði;
þęir sér hafa · svárt ok dátt
4 ęn nęr numit · ný=lig rǫð.

I have an heritance-enjoyer [SON] far too young;
he cannot remove himself from the court of foes.
They make themselves fierce and violent,
and have nearly fulfilled their new plans.

ALL | Sts. 26–27: Siward predicts the death of his young son, Syemund.

**27**

Ríðr=a þęim síðan · þó'tt sjau alir,
systur sonr · s·líkr at þingi;
ek vęit gǫr=la · hví gęgnir nú:
ęin vęldr Bryn·hildr · ǫllu bǫlvi.

With them will not ride—though thou begettest seven—
such a sister's son to the Thing.
I know clearly why this now happens:
alone is Byrnhild at fault for all evil.

**28**

Mér unni męr · fyr mann hvęrn
ęn við Gunn·ar · grand ękki vann'k;
þyrmða'k sifjum, · svǫrnum ęiðum,
síðr vęra'k hęitinn · hans kvánar vinr."

That maiden loved me more than any man,
but against Guther I did no wrong;
I respected our marital kinship, the sworn oaths;
late will I be called a 'friend' of his wife."

ALL | Siward comforts Guthrun by blaming Byrnhild for his death. He defends the innocence of her brother Guther; he has no reason to kill Siward when he has not done anything ill against him.

**29**

Kona varp ǫndu · ęn konungr fjǫrvi,
svá sló hǫn svára*n* · sínni hęndi
at kvǫðu við · kálkar í vǫ
ok gullu við · gęss í túni.

The woman lost her breath, but the king his life.
So harshly did she clap her hand
that in response clanged the chalices in the cupboard
and in response shrieked the geese in the yard.

4 ok gullu við · gęss í túni 'and in response shrieked the geese in the yard' | Identically shared with *I Guðr* 16/3.

**30**

Hló þá Bryn·hildr, · Buðla dóttir,
ęinu sinni · af ǫllum hug
es hǫn til hvílu · hęyra knátti
gjallan grát · Gjúka dóttur.

Then Byrnhild laughed, Budle's daughter,
a single time out of all her heart,
when from their resting-place she heard
the shrill weeping of Yivick's daughter.

---

1–2 Hló ...hug 'Then ... heart' | Also found in *Brot* 9/1–2 with varation in the first b-verse.

**31** Hitt kvað þá Gunn·arr, · gramr hauk-stalda:
„Hlér=a þú af því, · hęipt-gjǫrn kona,
glǫð á golfi, · at þér góðs viti;
hví hafnar þú · inum hvíta lit?
Fęikna fǿðir, · hygg at fęig sé*i*r.

This then quoth Guther, the lord of young warriors
"Thou dost not laugh, O feud-eager woman,
glad on the floor, since thou knowest any good.
Why dost thou abandon thy white colour?
Rearer of wickedness, I think thou art fey!

**32** Þú vęrir þęss · verðust kvinna
at fyr augum þér · Atla hjǫggim,
sęir bróðr þínum · blóðugt sár,
undir dręyrgar, · knęttir yfir binda."

For this wouldst thou be the worthiest of women
that we before thy eyes should cut down Attle,
that thou would see on thy brother a bloody gash,
gory wounds; then wouldst thou bind over them."

**33** „Frýr=a maðr þér ęngi, Gunn·arr, · hęfir full-vegit!
Lítt sé=sk Atli · ófu þína;
hann mun ykkar · ǫnd síðarri
ok ę vesa · afl it męira.

"No one taunts thee, Guther; thou hast fully triumphed!
Little does Attle fear thy wrath;
he will breathe longer than you two,
and for ever be the greater power.

**34** Sęgja mun'k þér, Gunn·arr, · —sjalfr vęitst gǫr=la—
hvé ér yðr snimma · til saka réðuð;
varð'k=at ek til ung · né of·þrungin
full-gǿdd fé*i* · á flęti bróður.

I will tell thee Guther—thou knowest it clearly thyself—
how ye were too soon in your decisions.
I was not too young nor oppressed,
fully endowed with wealth upon my brother's floor.

**35**

Né ek vilda þat · at mik verr ętti
áðr ér Gjúkungar · riðuð at garði
þrír á hęstum, · þjóð-konungar,
ęn þęira fǫr · þǫrf=gi vęri.

Nor did I wish that a husband should have me,
before ye Yivickings rode to the court:
three on your horses, great kings—
but their coming was not a boon.

3 þjóð-konungar 'great kings' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Gríp* 1/2 n.

**36**

Þęim hét=umk þá
es með golli sat · á Grana bógum;
vas=at hann í augu · yðr of líkr,
né á ęngi hlut · at á·litum;
þó þikki=sk ér · þjóð-konungar.

Then I vowed myself to *him*
who sat with the gold on the back of Grane.
In his eyes he was not like *you*,
nor in any part of his appearance,
although ye think yourselves great kings!

1 Þęim hét=umk þá | There is certainly some corruption here seen by the unusual meter of this orphaned "line", but the syntax and sense otherwise appears in order and no obvious emendation suggests itself.

**37**

Ok mér Atli þat · ęinni sagði
at hvár=ki lét=sk · hǫfn of dęila,
goll né jarðir, · nema gefa=sk léta'k;
ok ęngi hlut · auðins *féar*,
þá's mér jóð-ungri · ęig*u* sęldi
ok mér jóð-ungri · *au*ra talði.

And Attle told this to me alone,
that he would not share the holdings,
neither gold nor lands, unless I let myself be given,
and no part of the befallen wealth,

when to me, child-young, he gave the estate,
and for me, child-young, counted the silver.

**38** Þá vas à hvǫrfun · hugr mínn umb þat
hvárt ek skylda vega · eða val fęlla,
bǫll í brynju, · umb bróður sǫk.
Þat myndi þà · þjóð-kunnt vesa,
mǫrgum manni · at munar stríði.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO: Translation.

**39** Létum síga · sátt-mǫl okkur;
lék mér męirr í mun · męiðmar þiggja,
bauga rauða, · burar Sig·mundar,
né ek annars manns · aura vilda'k.

TODO.
TODO.
the red bighs of the son of Syemund;
no other man's silver would I have.

**40** Unna ęinum · né ýmissum,
bjó=at umb hvęrfan · hug męn-Skǫgul;
allt mun þat Atli · ęptir finna
es hann mína spyrr · morð-fǫr gǫrva,

I would love one man; not multiple;
TODO.
TODO.
TODO: Translation.

**41** at þęy=gi skal · þunn-gęð kona
annarrar ver · aldri lęiða;
þà mun à hęfndum · harma mínna."

TODO.
another woman's husband TODO.
TODO: Translation."

**42** Upp rę̨is Gunn·arr, · gramr verðungar,
ok umb hals konu · hę̨ndr of lagði;
gingu allir, · ok þó ýmsir,
af hę̨ilum hug, · hana at lętja.

Up rose Guther, the lord of the retinue,
and around his wife's neck threw his arms;
all went forth—and yet each in turn—
out of a friendly heart to restrain her.

**43** Hratt af halsi · hv*ę̨*im þar sér;
lét=a mann sik lętja · langrar gǫngu.

She pushed each one there away from her neck;
she let no one restrain her from the long journey.

2 langrar gǫngu 'the long journey' | A euphemistic expression for suicide.

**44** Nam hann sér Hǫgna · hvętja at rúnum:
„Sęggi vil'k alla · ǐ sal ganga,
þǐna með mǐnum · —nú 's þǫrf mikil—
vita ef mę̨ini · morð-fǫr konu
und's af méli · ę̨nn mę̨in komi,
þá lǫ́tum því · þarfar ráða."

He [= Guther] encouraged Hawn in secret counsel:
"I wish to let all thy men go into the hall
alongside mine—now there is great need!—
to see if they may prevent the woman's death-journey
until later troubles may arise once more;
then we shall let the need decide them."

ALL | Guther asks Hawn to summon his men and try to physically restrain Byrnhild from her suicide; if they can stop her this time it will be good enough, and if further troubles arise later on they may deal with them then.

**45** Ę̨inu því Hǫgni · and·svǫr vę̨itti:
„Lętj=a maðr hana · langrar gǫngu
þar's hǫ́n aptr·borin · aldri verði!
Hǫ́n krǫng of kom=sk · fyr kné móður,
hǫ́n ǫ́ borin · ǫ·vilja til,
mǫrgum manni · at móð-trega."

This one answer Hawn then granted:
"Let no one restrain her from the long journey

where she might never be born again!
She was brought frail before her mother's lap;
she was always born to ill deeds,
to [cause] heart-grief for many a man."

---

3 þar's hǫ́n aptr·borin aldri verði 'the long journey where she might never be born again' | The underlying implication is a bit unclear. Is the suicide thought to prevent her from being reborn, or is the sense that she will be so happy with Siward in the afterlife that she her soul will not desire to return among the living?

**46** Hvarf sér ǫ·hróðugr · and·spilli frá
2 þar's mǫrk męnja · męiðmum dęildi.

Dishonoured, he turned away from their conversation,
where the wood of neckrings [WOMAN = Byrnhild] was dealing out treasures.

---

ALL | This stanza is only 2 lines long. A possible explanation for this deficiency is if 2 or more lines describing Byrnhild's sacrifice of her hand-maidens and servants have been omitted, perhaps for moral reasons.

**47** Lęit hǫ́n of alla · ęigu sína,
2 soltnar þýjar · ok sal-konur;
goll-brynju smó · —vas=a gótt í hug—
4 áðr sik miðlaði · mękis ęggjum.

She beheld throughout all her estate
the dead hand-maids and women of the hall.
She donned a golden byrnie—there was no good in her heart—
before she pierced her stomach with the short-sword's edges.

---

ALL | Byrnhild dons a golden byrnie and fatally wounds herself by disembowelment (see note to l. 4 *miðlaði*). There is a slight contradiction here, since Byrnhild apparently stabs herself through the byrnie she has just donned. It also appears that she has already sacrificed several of her hand-maids, although this is not stated explicitly (cf. the previous stanza).

4 miðlaði 'pierced her stomach' | *miðla* usually means 'to deal out, share' but here has the unparallelled sense 'cut something at the middle'. The image is thus that Byrnhild plunges her sword into her belly and disembowels herself.

4 mękis ęggjum 'the short-sword's edges' | Formulaic; see *Vkv* 33/3.

**48** Hné við bólstri · hǫ́n á annan veg
2 ok hjǫr-unduð · hugði at rǫ́ðum:

She sunk down against the bolster on her side
and, wounded by the sword, thought of counsel:

**49** „Nú skulu ganga · þǫ́r's goll vili

ok minn*i* því · at mér þiggja;
ek gef hverri · of hroðit sigli,
bók ok bléju, · bjartar váðir.“

“Now shall those who would have gold,
and lesser things too, come and receive it from me.
I give every woman a gold-enclosed necklace,
a coverlet and bed-cover, [and] bright garments.”

---

3 of hroðit sigli ‘a gold-enclosed necklace’ | *of hroðit* ‘(metal-)enclosed’ corresponding to OE *ge·hroden*. For *sigli* ‘necklace’, only found thrice in the whole Norse corpus, see *Lok* 20.

**50** Þǫgðu all*ir*, · hugðu at rǫ́ðum,
ok all*ir* sęnn · ann·svǫr vęittu:
„Ǿrnar soltnar · munum ęnn lifa,
verða sal-konur · sǿmð at vinna,“

All were silent, thought of counsel,
and all at once an answer granted:
“Enough women have died! We shall live on;
the women of the hall will do what is fitting,”

**51** und’s af hyggjandi · hǫr-skrýdd kona,
ung at aldri, · orð viðr of kvað:
„Vil’k=at ek mann trauðan · né tor·bǿnan
umb óra sǫk · aldri týna,

until wisely the linen-clad woman
young of age said a word in reply:
“I wish not that one reluctant or hardly asked
for our sake should lose his life,

---

ALL | Sts. 51–52: Byrnhild relents. She will not force those who are reluctant to die with her, but she assures them that they will receive greater honour in the afterlife if they follow her now, than if they go on living.

**52** þó mun á bęinum · brinna yðrum
fę́ri ęyrir · þá’s ér framm komið,
nęitt Męnju góð, · mǐn at vitja.

yet on your limbs there will burn fewer
ounces of silver when ye arrive
—nor any boons of Mene [GOLDEN JEWELS]—to visit me.

**53** Sęt=sk-tu niðr, Gunn·arr, · mun’k sęgja þér

lífs ør·vęna · ljósa brúði;
mun=a yðvart far · allt ĩ sundi
þó'tt ek hafa · ǫndu látit.

Sit thee down, Guther. I will tell thee
of a light bride whose hopes of life are o'er.
Your ship will not all be [sunk] in the sound,
though *I* have given up my life.

---

ALL | Sts. 53–64: Byrnhild makes a spae, foreseeing the future destruction of the line of the Nivlings and Attle; she focuses particularly on Swanhild, Guthrun's and Siward's daughter together.

**54** Sǫtt munuð it Guð·rún, · snemmr an hyggir;
hęfir kunn kona · við konung*i*
daprar minjar · at dauðan ver.

Thou and Guthrun will be reconciled sooner than thou thinkest.
The famed woman has a sorrowful keepsake
from the king after her husband's death.

---

3 daprar minjar 'sorrowful keepsake' | Swanhild, Guthrun's daughter by Siward.

**55** Þar 's męr borin, · móðir fóðir;
sú mun hvítari · an inn hęiði dagr,
Svan·hildr, vesa, · sólar gęisla.

There a maiden is born; her mother rears her.
She will be whiter than the clear day,
Swanhild, than a ray of the sun.

---

3 sólar gęisla 'ray of the sun' | Swanhild is also likened to a *sólar gęisli* in *Ghv* 15.

**56** Gefa munt Guð·rúnu · góðra nǫkkurum,
skęyti skóða · skatna męngi;
mun=at at vilja · ver-sęl gefin,
hana mun Atli · ęiga ganga,
of borinn Buðla · bróðir mĩnn.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
Attle will go to take her to wife,
the man born of Budle, my own brother.

---

5 of borinn Buðla · bróðir mínn 'the man born of Budle, my own brother' | Identically shared with *1 Guðr* 25/3.

**57** Margs á'k minna≠sk · hvé við mik fóru
2 þá's mik sára · svikna hǫfðuð;
vaðin at vilja · vas'k meðan lifða'k.

I have much to recall from how they treated me,
when ye had sorely betrayed me;
I was deprived of willpower while I lived.

**58** Munt Odd·rúnu · ęiga vilja
2 ęn þik Atli mun · ęigi láta;
it munuð lúta · á laun saman,
4 hǫn mun þér unna · sęm ek skylda'k,
ef okkr góð of skǫp · gørði verða.

Thou wilt want to take Ordrun to wife,
but Attle will nowise let thee;
ye two will embrace in secret.
She will love thee like *I* should have
if good shapes had let it be so for us.

---

ALL | For Ordrun, see *Oddr*.

**59** Þik mun Atli · illu bęita,
2 munt í øngan · orm-garð lagiðr.

Thee will Attle afflict with evil;
thou wilt be laid in the narrow snake-pit.

**60** Þat mun ok verða · því≠gi≠t lęngra
2 at Atli mun · ǫndu týna,
sęlu sínni, · ok sofa lífi,
4 því't hǫnum Guð·rún · grýmir á bęð
snǫrpum ęggjum · af sǫrum hug.

It will also happen no long while later
that Attle will give up his life,
his happiness and sleep away his life,
for Guthrun besmears him [with blood] in his bed,
by sharp edges.

**61** Sǿmri vǫ́ri Guð·rún, · systir okkur
frum-ver sínum · [...]
ef hǫn*ni* gǫ́fi · góðra ráð
eða ǫ́tti hǫ́n hug · oss of líkan.

It would be more fitting for Guthrun, the sister of us two,
[to follow] her first husband [in death],
if she had the counsel of good men,
or she had a heart like ours.

---

2 [...] | The translation assumes the emended b-verse *fylgja dauðum* 'follow in death' (lit., 'follow dead').

**62** Ó·ǫrt mǫ́li'k nú · ǫn hǫ́n ǫ́igi mun
umb óra sǫk · aldri týna;
hana munu hǫfja · hǫ́var bǫ́rur
til Jón·akrs · óðal-torfu.

Not hastily do I now speak, but she will not
lose her life for our sake.
She will be borne by billows high
forth to Enacker's ethel-turf.

---

3 hana munu hǫfja · hǫ́var bǫ́rur 'She will be borne by billows high' | Clearly related to *Ghv* 13/3, with which the b-verse is identical.

**63** [...] eru í vǫr-úðum · Jón·akrs sonum;
mun hǫ́n Svan·hildi · sǫnda af landi,
sína mǫ́y · ok Sig·*var*ðar.

[...] are in the cares of Enacker's sons;
she will send Swanhild away from the land,
her daughter and Siward's.

**64** Hana munu bíta · Bikka rǫ́ð
því't Jǫrmun·rekkr · ó·þarft lifir;
þá's ǫ́ll farin · ǫ́tt Sig·*var*ðar,
eru Guð·rúnar · grøti at flǫ́iri.

Her will Beck's counsels bite,
for Ermenric lives wickedly.
Then will all the lineage of Siward be destroyed;
for Guthrun there will be yet more causes for weeping.

---

ALL | Byrnhild predicts Swanhild's death. Cf. *Ghv* P1.

**65**

Biðja mun'k þik · bønar einnar,
sú mun í hęimi · hinst bøn vesa:
Lát-tu svá brędiða · borg á vęlli
at undir oss ǫllum · jafn-rúmt séi,
þęim es sultu · með Sig·*vę*rði.

I will ask thee a single prayer—
in the Home it will be my very last prayer:
let the stronghold on the plain be made so broad
that around us all there be even room—
around us who perished alongside Siward.

ALL | Sts. 65–70 form the last section of the poem, as Byrnhild makes her requests for her burial alongside Siward. She first asks that the inside chamber of the barrow be so great that all her servants will fit inside; she wishes to honour them for their devotion.

3 borg á vęlli 'stronghold on the plain' | The *borg* 'stronghold' seems to refer to the inner burial chamber of the mound, wherein the dead would be laid. It would, in turn, be covered by rocks and soil to build the mound itself.

**66**

Tjaldi þar umb þá borg · tjǫldum ok skjǫldum,
vala-ript vel fǫð · ok vala męngi;
brędni mér inn húnska · á hlið aðra.

Let the canopies around that stronghold be built with canopies and shields,
with Welsh canvas well-painted and a multitude of horses.
Let me be burned at the Hunnish man's one side.

2 vala 'horses' | A rare word. TODO.

**67**

Brędni inum húnska · á hlið aðra
mína þjóna, · męnjum gǫfga,
tvá at hǫfðum · ok tvęir haukar;
þá's ǫllu skipt · til jafnaðar.

Let them be burned by the Hunnish man's other side,
my servants noble of neckrings,
two by his head, and two hawks;
then all is arranged evenly.

**68**

Liggi okkar ęnn í milli · malmr hring-variðr,
ęgg-hvasst *éa*rn, · svá ęndr lagit
þá's vit béði · bęð ęinn stigum
ok hétum þá · hjóna nafni.

Let once more lie between us the ring-adorned metal [SWORD],
the edge-sharp iron, once again laid

like when we two mounted a single bed
and then were called by a wedded couple's name.

---

ALL | Cf. *Brot* 20.

1 malmr hring-varið̇r 'ring-adorned metal [SWORD]' | A ring-sword, long obsolete by the time of *Sigsk*. See *HHj* 9/1 n.

**69**

Hrynja hǫ̇num þá · á hęl̇ þęy=gi
hlunn-blik hallar, · hring*a* litkuð
ef hǫ̇num fylgir · fęrð mín heðan.

Then will nowise the roller-gleams [DOORS?] of the hall
crash down on the heels of the colourer of ring-swords [WARRIOR = Siward],
if he is followed by my departure hence.

---

2 hlunn-blik hallar 'roller-gleams of the hall' | TODO, proverbial?

**70**

Þęy=gi mun vǫ̇r fǫr · aum=lig vesa, því't hǫ̇num fylgja · fimm ambóttir,
átta þjónar, · øðlum góðir,
fostr-man mitt · ok faðerni
þat's Buðli gaf · barni sínu.

Nowise will our journey be wretched,
for he is followed by five handmaids,
eight servants of good pedigree,
my foster-daughter, and the paternity
which Budle gave unto his child [me].

**71**

Margt sagða'k, · mynda'k fleira
es mér męir mjǫtuð̇r · mál-rúm gę̇fi;
ómun þverr, · undir svella,
satt ęitt sagða'k— · svá mun'k láta!"

Many things I have said; I would [say] yet more,
if the Measurer gave me greater room to speak.
My voice wanes; my wounds swell;
truth alone I have said—so shall I die!"

# Hell-ride of Byrnhild
# *(Hęl-ręið Bryn·hildar)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.650)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

**The Hell-ride of Byrnhild** (*Helr*) describes how Byrnhild after her death is burned on her pyre in a beautiful chariot or wagon. In the afterlife she rides on the Hellway to reach her resting place in Hell when her road is blocked by a certain gigh or troll-woman. The poem consists of their conversation.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Helr* is attested in full in **R**, on foll. 36r/30–TODO, where it follows *Sigsk* and is followed by *2 Guðr*.

The poem is also attested, with the exception of st. 6, in *Norn* 9, in a sequence of tales about the Walsings which also includes *Reg*. *Norn* is attested in several mss., including **F**. TODO: Halldórsson (2000), Introduction.

The textual variants in *Norn*'s version of *Helr*are divergent to the point that *Norn*'s *Helr* cannot be directly copied from **R**, but it is unclear whether it ultimately derives from **R** through a chain of copies, or whether both derive from a lost archetype predating **R**. At the very least, we can tell from the similarities between the prose of *Norn* and **R** that the two are unlikely to be related through oral tradition alone.

### Origin and motifs

Unlike the later *Vǫls*, which separates Siward's rescuing of Byrnhild from her magical sleep (as also told in *Sigrdr*) and his riding through the fire in the shape of Guther in order to win her hand (as originally told in *Vǫlsbr*) into two separate events, *Helr* depicts these as a single event. Considering that both of these epsiodes involve the rescuing of Byrnhild from some supernatural confinement, whether magical sleep inside a shield-wall or imprisonment inside

a wall of fire, it seems likely that they are in fact originally distinct variants of a single episode.

Whereas the synthesis of *Vǫls* resolves the conflict between the two variants by turning them into two separate episodes, *Helr* instead opts to see both as descriptions of a single event. Since *Helr* is trying to synthesise conflicting traditions into a single one, it is probably not one of the earliest poems.

Cf. *Grípp*, *Fáfn*, TODO.

## Summary

TODO.

## Text

**P1** Eptir dauða Bryn·hildar vóru gǫr bǫl tvau: annat Sig·urði, ok
2 brann þat fyrr, en Bryn·hildr var á ǫðru brennd ok var hón í reið
þeiri er guð-vefjum var tjǫlduð. Svá er sagt at Bryn·hildr ók með
4 reið'inni á hel-veg ok fór um tún þar er gýgr nǫkkur bjó. Gýgr'in
kvað:

After Byrnhild's death two pyres were made: one for Siward, and it burned earlier; but Byrnhild was burned on the other, and she was in that chariot which was canopied with god-weave. So it is said that Byrnhild drove with the chariot onto the Hellway and passed through a yard where a certain gigh lived. Quoth the gigh:

1 Eptir | *The* E *is a bold capital in* **R**.

ALL | The equivalent passage in *Norn*: *En hirð-maðr einn spyrr: „hversu fór Bryn·hildr þá með?“ Gestr svarar: „þá drap Bryn·hildr sjau þręla sína ok fimm ambáttir en lagði sik sverði í gegnum ok bað sik aka með þessa menn til báls ok brenna sik dauða. Ok svá var gert, at henni var gert annat bál en Sigurði annat ok var hann fyrri brenndr en Bryn·hildr. Henni var ekit í reið einni ok var tjaldat um guð-vef ok purpúra ok glóaði allt við gull. Ok svá var hón brend.“ Þá spurðu menn Gest hvárt Bryn·hildr hefði nokkut kveðit dauð. Hann kvað þat satt vera. Þeir báðu hann kveða ef hann kynni. Þá męlti Gestr: „þá er Bryn·hildi var ekit til brennu'nnar á hel-veg ok var farit með bana nęrr hǫmrum nokkurum, þar bjó ein gýgr. Hón [var] úti firir hellis-dyrum ok var í skinn-kyrtli ok svǫrt yfir·lits. Hón hefir í hendi sér skógar-vǫnd langan ok męlti. ‚Þessu vil ek beina til brennu þinnar, Bryn·hildr, ok vęri betr at þú vęrir lifandi brennd firir ó-dáðir þínar þęr at þu létst drepa Sigurð Fáfnis-bana, svá á·gętan mann; ok opt var ek hónum †sinunt†. Ok firir þat skal ek hljóða á þik með hefndar-orðum þeim at ǫllum sér þú at leiðari er s·líkt heyra frá þér sagt.‘ Eptir þat hljóðast þęr á Bryn·hildr ok gýgr. Gýgr kvað:* 'But a hirdman asked: "How did Byrnhild come with him [= Siward]?" Guest answers: "Then Byrnhild slew her seven thralls and five handmaids and ran herself through with a sword and bade herself be driven to a pyre with these people and be burned after her death. And so it was done that one pyre was made for her and one for Siward, and he was burned earlier than Byrnhild. She was driven in a chariot and it was canopied with god-weave and purple, and it all glowed from gold, and so was she burned." Then the men asked Guest whether Byrnhild had sung anything after death. He said it was true. They bade him sing, if he knew it. Then spoke Guest: "When Byrnhild had been driven to her burning on the Hellway and had passed near some cliffs, a gigh lived there. She was outside before the doors of the cliffside and was in a skin skirt and swarthy of countenance. She has in her hand a long tree-branch, and spoke: 'With this [wood] I wish to assist thy burning, Byrnhild, and it were better hadst thou been burned alive for thy misdeeds that thou didst cause Siward, Fathomer's bane, to be slain—such an excellent man, and I was often … with him. And therefore I shall bespeak thee with words of revenge such that all men will hate thee all the more as they hear such things told about thee.' After that they scream at each othe, Byrnhild and the gigh. Quoth the gigh:"'

2–3 í reið þeiri er guð-vefjum var tjǫlduð 'in that chariot which was canopied with god-weave' | The canopy on the chariot was woven from silk (known as *god-weave*, the fabric of the gods). For the burial of women in wagons and chariots cf. TODO (Oseberg ship?).

3–4 Bryn·hildr ók með reið'inni á hel-veg 'Byrnhild drove with the chariot on the Hellway' | This gives us some interesting insight into old afterlife beliefs. After Byrnhild is burned she ends up between the worlds of the living and the dead, the so-called "Hell-way" or road to the Underworld, upon which she must travel in order to arrive at her final resting place; she is burned inside a chariot so that she will be able to travel comfortably. We may presume that the animals driving the chariot were slaughtered and burnt with her on the pyre.

## Bryn·hildr rę̨ið hę̨l-veg (‘Byrnhild rode the Hellway’)

**1** „Skalt ī́ gǫgnum · ganga ę̨igi [R TODO, F TODO]
2 grjóti studda · garða mī́na;
bętr sǿmði þér · borða at rękja
4 hę̨ldr an vitja · vers annarar.

“Thou shalt nowise pass through these
rock-supported yards of mine!
It befit thee better to weave tapestries,
rather than visit another’s husband.

1 Skalt | *The* S *is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in* **R**. 4 an | *add.* at **F** 4 vers annarar ‘another’s husband’ | várra ranna *(norm.) ‘our halls’* **F**

ALL | The gigh begins by insulting Byrnhild; she blames her early death on her immoral and unwomanly actions. Had she lived like a virtuous woman and tended to her domestic duties she would still have been alive; instead she was consumed by jealousy and violence for another woman’s husband (Siward, whom she is now coming to visit in the afterlife).

**2** Hvat skalt vitja · af Val-landi, [R TODO, F TODO]
2 hvar-fúst hǫfuð, · húsa mī́nna?
Þú hę̨fir, Vǫ́r golls, · ef þik vita lystir,
4 mild, af hǫndum · manns blóð þvegit.“

Why shalt thou visit, come from Walland,
O straying head, these halls of mine?
Thou hast, mild Ware of gold [LADY], if thou hast lust to know,
washed man’s blood from thy hands.”

1 af Val-landi | vá á landi **F** 2 hvar-fúst ‘straying’ | hverf-lynt *‘fickle-minded’* **F** 3–4 Þú ... þvegit. ‘Thou ... hands.’ | Þú hę̨fir vǫrgum · ef þī́n vitja / mǫrgum til matar · manns blóð gefit *‘Thou hast to many—if thou art visited(?)—wolves given man’s blood for food.’* **F**

[Bryn·hildr:] **3** „Bregð ę̨igi mér, · brúðr ór stę̨ini, [R TODO, F TODO]
2 þó’tt ek vę́ra’k · ī́ víkingu;
ek mun okkur · óðri þikkja
4 hvar’s mę̨nn øðli · okkart kunna.“

[Byrnhild:] “Upbraid me not, O bride from the stone [GIGH],
although I may have been in the wiking host;
I shall seem the nobler of us two
wherever men know our pedigrees.”

1 ę̨igi mér | mér ę̨igi **F** 2 vę́ra’k ‘I may have been’ | *add.* fyrr *‘formerly’* **F** 4 hvar’s mę̨nn øðli · okkart kunna ‘wherever men know our pedigrees’ | þeim’s øðli mitt um kunna *‘to those who know my pedigree’ (unmetrical)* **F**

[Gýgr kvað:] **4** „Þú vast, Bryn-hildr, · Buðla dóttir, [R TODO, F TODO]
2 hęilli verstu · í hęim borin;
þú hęfir Gjúka · of glatat bǫrnum
4 ok búi þęira · brugðit góðu.“

[Quoth the gigh:] “Thou wast, O Byrnhild, Budle’s daughter,
under the worst omen born into the Home.
Thou hast destroyed Yivick’s children
and deprived their house of good.”

1 vast ‘wast’ | ert *‘art’* **F**

[Bryn·hildr:] **5** „Ek mun sęgja þér · svinn ór ręiðu, [R TODO, F TODO]
2 vit-laussi mjǫk, · ef þik vita lystir:
hvé gørðu mik · Gjúka arfar
4 ásta-lausa · ok ęið-rofa.

[Byrnhild:] “I will tell thee, wise from my chariot,
O most witless one, if thou hast lust to know,
how the heirs of Yivick made me
loveless and an oath-breaker.

**6** Lét hami vára · hug-fullr konungr, [R TODO, F TODO]
2 átta systra, · undir ęik borit;
vas’k vetra tólf, · ef þik vita lystir,
4 es ungum gram · ęiða sęlda’k.

The king full of heart [= Budle] let the forms
of us eight sisters be born beneath an oak.
I was twelve winters old, if thou hast lust to know,
when to the young lord I gave oaths.

2 undir ęik borit ‘beneath an oak’ | King Budle let Byrnhild and her seven sisters be born under a (holy) oak, presumably due to the protection believed to be afforded by the tree.

**7** Hétu mik allir · í Hlym-dǫlum [R TODO]
2 Hildi und hjalmi, · hvęrr es kunni.

In the Limdales all did call me
a Hild ’neath the helmet, whoever knew me.

**8** Þá lét’k gamlan · á Got-þjóðu [R TODO, F TODO]
2 Hjalm-Gunn·ar nęst · hęljar ganga;
gaf’k ungum sigr · Auðu bróður;

4 þar varð mér Óðinn · of·rǫiðr um þat.

Then, next, in the land of the Gots,
I let old Helm-Guther go the way of Hell.
I gave victory to Ead's young brother;
then Weden was furious with me over that.

1 Got-þjóðu | Goð-þjóðu **R**

ALL | The same is told in *Sigrdr* P3.

1 Got-þjóðu 'land of the Gots' | Also found in *Ghv* 8, 16. The spelling *-t-* attested in mss. of *Heiðr* st. 94/8b (SkP 8). It is notable that ON *Got-þjóð* is a direct reflex of the attested Gotish self-name, *Gut-þiuda*, as found in the Gotish liturgical calendar (Schäferdiek 1988, p. 118).

**9** Lauk hann mik skjǫldum · í Skata-lundi, [**R** TODO, **F** TODO]
2 rauðum ok hvítum, · randir snurtu;
þann bað hann slíta · svefni mínum
4 es hvǫr=gi lands · hrǫ́ða=sk kynni.

He locked me inside of shields in Shatelund,
red ones and white; their rims clasped.
He bade that one upend my sleeping
who in no land could be frightened.

**10** Lét umb sal minn · sunnan-verðan [**R** TODO, **F** TODO]
2 hǫ́van brinna · hǫr alls viðar;
þar bað hann ǫinn þegn · yfir at ríða,
4 þann's mér fǿrði goll · þat's und Fáfni lá.

He made around my hall a south-facing
high host of all wood [FIRE] burn.
He bade only one thane there ride over it:
him who brought me the gold which under Fathomer lay.

**11** Rǫið góðr Grana · goll-miðlandi [**R** TODO, **F** TODO]
2 þar's fóstri mínn · flętjum stýrði;
ǫinn þótti hann þar · ǫllum bętri,
4 víkingr Dana, · í verðungu.

On Grane the good gold-dealer [RULER = Siward] rode
where my foster-son ruled the benches.
Alone he seemed better there than all,
the wiking of Danes, in the warband.

**12** Svǫ́fum vit ok unðum · í sǫ́ing ǫinni [**R** TODO, **F** TODO]

sem hann mínn bróðir · of borinn véri;
hvárt-ki knátti · hǫnd yfir annat
átta nóttum · okkart lęggja.

We slept and were content in a single bed
as if he had been born my brother;
neither laid a hand o'er the other
for eight nights, of us two.

**13** Því brá mér Guð·rún, · Gjúka dóttir, [R TODO, F TODO]
at ek Sig·*vę*rði · svéfa'k á armi;
þar varð'k þęss vís · es vildi'g=a'k
at þau véltu mik · í ver-fangi.

Therefore Guthrun upbraided me, Yivick's daughter,
since I had slept on Siward's arm.
There I became wise of what I did not want to know:
that those two had tricked me in the catch of man.

2 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

**14** Munu við of·stríð · alls til lęngi [R TODO, F TODO]
konur ok karlar · kvikkvir fǫðask;
vit skulum okkrum · aldri slíta,
Sig·*vǫ*rðr, saman. · Søkks-tu, gýgjar-kyn!"

In great strife for far too long
will men and women alive be born.
We two shall end our age,
I and Siward, together.—Sink, thou gigh-kind!"

4 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

ALL | Following this stanza, *Norn* adds the following short prose passage: *Þá ópti gýgr ęgurligri rǫddu ok hljóp inn í bjarg'it.* 'Then the gigh shrieked with a terrible voice and jumped into the hill.'

3 aldri slíta 'end our age' | In the afterlife. An interesting expression considering how both their *aldrar* 'ages, lifetimes' have already concluded, but Byrnhild is presumably saying that they will now spend an eternity together.

# Second Lay of Guthrun
# *(II Guð·rúnar kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.759)–late C11th (0.199)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Second Lay of Guthrun** (*2 Guðr*) takes the form of a monologue told by Guthrun, who reflects on her tragic fate. Within the framework of the heroic half of **R**, this poem (and its prologue) is important in that it shifts the focus away from the hero Siward, who is now dead, towards King Attle and his dealings with the three Yivickings: Guthrun and her brothers Guther and Hawn. This focus persists for the following four heroic poems in the collection: *3 Guðr*, *Oddr*, *Akv*, and *Am*.

Although the title of the poem in **R** is merely *Guð·rúnar kviða* 'Lay of Guthrun', it seems likely from the description in *Brot* P1 that the poem originally carried the epithet *in forna* 'the Ancient'.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*2 Guðr* is only found in full in **R**, on foll. TODO–TODO, where it follows *Helr* and is followed by *3 Guðr*.

The poem was available to the redactor of *Vǫls*, who cites three stanzas (18/5–6, 21–22) and paraphrases many more (TODO).

### Origin and motifs

The death of Siward is depicted differently in *2 Guðr* 4–11 than in some of the other poetry in **R**. Here, like in *Brot* 4–6 and likely also in *1 Guðr*, Siward is slain outdoors, without Guthrun's awareness. This contrasts with *Sigsk* 21–30, *Ghv* 4, and *Hamð* 6, where Siward is slain in bed with his wife Guthrun, who is covered with his blood. These conflicting accounts are, in fact, mentioned in *Brot* P1, the epilogue to that poem.

### Summary

The poem itself is introduced by the prose passage *Dráp Niflunga* ('The Slaying of the Nivlings'), which serves as a prologue. This passage is given its own large initial with the same size as the poem itself, and may therefore also be interpreted as a distinct text from *2 Guðr*.

TODO.

## Text

### Dráp Niflunga ('The Slaying of the Nivlings')

**P1** Gunn·arr ok Hǫgni tóku þá gull'it allt, Fáfnis arf. Ó·friðr var
2 þá milli gjúkunga ok Atla; kenndi hann gjúkungum vǫld um
and·lát Bryn·hildar. Þat var til sętta, at þeir skyldu gipta hánum
4 Guð·rúnu, ok gǫfu henni ó·minnis-veig at drekka áðr hón játti
at giptask Atla. Synir Atla vóru þeir Erpr ok Eitill, en Svan·hildr
6 var Sig·urðar dóttir ok Guð·rúnar. Atli konungr bauð heim
Gunn·ari ok Hǫgna, ok sendi Vinga eða Kné·frøð*. Guð·rún
8 vissi vélar ok sendi með rúnum orð at þeir skyldu eigi koma ok
til jar-tegna sendi hón Hǫgna hring'inn And·vara-naut ok knýtti
10 í vargs-hár. Gunn·arr hafði beðit Odd·rúnar, systur Atla, ok gat
eigi; þá fekk hann Glaum·varar, en Hǫgni átti Kost·beru; þeira
12 synir vóru þeir Sól·arr ok Snęv·arr ok Gjúki. En er gjúkungar
kómu til Atla, þá bað Guð·rún sonu sína at þeir bęði gjúkungum
14 lífs, en þeir vildu eigi. Hjarta var skorit ór Hǫgna en Gunn·arr
settr í orm-garð. Hann sló hǫrpu ok svęfði orma'na, en naðra
16 stakk hann til lifrar.

Guther and Hawn then took all the gold, Fathomer's inheritance. Then there was enmity between the Yivickings and Attle; he blamed the Yivickings for Byrnhild's passing. Such were their terms, that they would marry Guthrun off to him, and they gave her a forgetfulness-draught to drink before she agreed to be married off to Attle. The sons of Attle were Earp and Oatle, but Swanhild was the daughter of Siward and Guthrun. Attle invited Guther and Hawn to his home and sent Winge or Kneefrith. Guthrun knew his wiles and sent words in runes that they should not come, and as a sign she sent Hawn the ring Andwaresgift and tied a wolf's hair through it. Guther had asked for the hand of Ordrun, Attle's sister, and did not get her; then he got Gleamware, but Hawn had Costbearer to wife; their sons were Solwer and Snower and Yivick. But when the Yivickings came to Attle, Guthrun bade her sons to plead for the life of the Yivickings, but they would not do so. The heart was cut out of Hawn, but Guther was placed in the snake-pit. He struck his harp and soothed the serpents, but an adder stung him unto the liver.

---

1 Gunn·arr | *The* G *is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in* R. 7 Kné·frøð* | *gramm. emend.;* Kné·frøðr *(with erroneous abbreviation mark for nom. sg. -r)* R

---

ALL | This orienting prose passage serves briefly to summarise the narrative context behind the following 5 poems (*2 Guðr–Am*), all of which deal with King Attle.

7 Vinga eða Kné·frøð* 'Winge or Kneefrith' | The messenger is known as *Vingi* in *Am*, but *Kné·frøðr* in *Akv*.

**P2** Þjóð·rekr konungr var með Atla ok hafði þar látit flesta alla menn
2 sína. Þjóð·rekr ok Guð·rún kęrðu harma sín á milli. Hón sagði hánum ok kvað:

King Thedric was with Attle, and there he had lost most all of his men. Thedric and Guthrun brooded over their injuries between themselves. She spoke to him and quoth:

---

ALL | The second prose passage introduces the poem itself. This introduction plays little relevance to the narrative, however, since King Thedric does not figure anywhere in the poem itself. It is most likely placed here in order to tie the poem together with the immediately following *3 Guðr*.

## Guð·rúnar kviða ('A Lay of Guthrun')

**1** „Mę́r vas'k meyja; · móðir mik føddi,
bjǫrt í búri; · unna'k vęl bróðrum—
und's mik Gjúki · golli ręifði,
golli ręifði, · gaf Sig·*vę*rði.

"I WAS A MAIDEN OF MAIDENS; my mother raised me
bright in the bower; I loved well my brothers—
until Yivick endowed me with gold,
endowed me with gold and gave me to Siward.

1 Mę́r | *The* M *is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in* **R**. 4 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

ALL | Guthrun's narrative begins as Siward arrived at the house of Yivick and she was given to him.

**2** Svá vas Sig·*vǫ*rðr · of sonum Gjúka
sem vę́ri grønn laukr · ór grasi vaxinn,
eða hjǫrtr hǫ́-bęinn · of hvǫssum dýrum,
eða goll glóð-rautt · af grǫ́u silfri."

So was Siward over the sons of Yivick,
like were he a green leek grown out of the grass,
or a hart, high-legged, amidst coarse beasts,
or gold, glowing-red, beside grey silver—

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

ALL | Cf. *1 Guðr* 18, which shares the first two lines with only small differences, and the similar descriptions of Hallow (*2 HHund* 38) and Swanhild (*Ghv* 15).

2 grønn laukr 'green leek' | The leek was a highly valued plant. Compare *Vsp* 4 where the *grønn laukr* 'green leek' is said to have grown the first Golden Age. See also note there about its mythological significance.

3 hjǫrtr hǫ́-bęinn 'a hart, high-legged' | For the significance of the hart, see *Fáfn* 2.

**3** und's mér fyr·munðu · mǐnir bróðr
at ek ę́tta ver · ǫllum fręmra;
sofa þęir né mǫ́ttu=t · né of sakar dǿma
áðr þęir Sig·*vǫ*rð · svęlta létu.

until my brothers begrudged me
that I had a husband braver than all.
They could not sleep nor preside over matters
before they let Siward die.

4 Sig·*vǫrð* | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urð **R**

3 sofa þęir né mǫ́ttu=t · né of sakar dǿma 'They could not sleep nor preside over matters' | A similar line is found in *Grí*p 29/3.

**4**

Grani rann at þingi, · gnýr vas at hęyra,
ęn þá Sig·*vǫrð*r · sjalfr ęigi kom;
ǫll vǫ́ru sǫðul-dýr · svęita stokkin
ok of vanið vási · umb vegǫndum.

Grane ran to the Thing—a din was to be heard—
but then Siward himself never came.
All the saddle-beasts [HORSES] were dripping with sweat,
although used to toil beneath riding men.

2 Sig·*vǫrð*r | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

1 Grani 'Grane' | Siward's horse.

3 sǫðul-dýr 'saddle-beasts [HORSES]' | This kenning also occurs in a loose stanza by Norse King Anlaf "the Holy" Haraldson.

**5**

Gekk ek grátandi · við Grana rǿ́ða,
úrug-hlýra, · jó frá'k spjalla;
hnipnaði Grani þá, · drap í gras hǫfði;
jór þ*at* vissi: · ęigendr né lifðu=t.

I went, weeping, with Grane to speak;
with teary cheeks I asked the horse for news.
Then Grane drooped, bent his head in the grass;
the horse knew that its owners lived not.

4 þ*at* | 'þ' *(with abbreviation mark ommitted)* **R**

**6**

Lęngi hvarf=at, · lęngi hugir dęildu=sk
áðr of frę́gja'k · folk-vǫrð at gram;
hnipnaði Gunn·arr, · sagði mér Hǫgni
frá Sig·*var*ðar · sǫ́rum dauða:

Not long went by—long my thoughts were torn—
before I asked the folk-ward about the prince.
Guther drooped; Hawn told me
about Siward's sore death:

4 Sig·*var*ðar | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðar **R**

**7**

,Liggr of hǫggvinn · fyr handan ver
Guð·þorms bani, · of gefinn ulfum;
lít-tu þar Sig·*vǫ*rð · à suðr-vega,
þà hęyrir þú · hrafna gjalla,
ǫrnu gjalla, · ętsli fegna,
varga þjóta · of veri þǐnum.‘

‘Cut down lies across yonder sea,
Godthorm’s bane [= Siward], given to the wolves.
Look for Siward there on the southern ways!
Then wilt thou hear the ravens shriek,
the eagles shriek, rejoicing in flesh,
the wolves howling over thy husband.’

3 Sig·*vǫ*rð | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urð **R**

**8**

,Hví þú mér, Hǫgni, · harma s·líka
vilja-laussi · vill of sęgja?
Þitt skyli hjarta · hrafnar slíta
víð lǫnd yfir · an þú vitir manna.‘

‘Why, O Hawn, wilt thou tell such
harms to me, deprived of iwll?
TODO.
TODO.’

**9**

Svaraði Hǫgni · sinni ęinu,
trauðr góðs hugar, · af trega stórum:
‚Þęss átt, Guð·rún, · grøti at fleiri
at hjarta mitt · hrafnar slíti.‘

TODO.
TODO.
‘TODO.
TODO.’

**10**

Hvarf’k ęinn þaðan · ann·spilli frà
à við, lesa* · varga lęifar;
gørði’g=a’k hjúfra · né hǫndum slá*a*
né kvęina *of* · sęm konur aðrar
þà’s sat soltin · of Sig·*vę*rði.

Alone I turned away from the conversation
into the woods to behold the leftovers of the wolves.

I did not pant nor beat my hands
nor wail over him like other women
when I sat dejected over Siward.

---

4 *of* | ‘v̄’ *(corrupt form of ‘v̄’)* **R** 5 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

---

3–5 gørði’g=a’k ... Sig·*vę*rði ‘I did not ... Siward.’ | Closely related to *1 Guðr* 1/2–4.

**11** Nǫtt þótti mér · nið-myrkr vesa
es sár=la sat’k · yfir Sig·*vę*rði;
ulfar þóttu=sk · ǫllu bętri
ef þęir léti mik · lífi týna
eða bręnndi mik · sem birkinn við.

The night seemed to me as dark as if moonless
when, grieving, I sat over Siward.
The wolves would have seemed to me all the better
if they had let me lose my life,
or if they had burned me like birch-dry wood.

---

2 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

**12** Fór’k af fjalli · fimm døgr talit
und’s hǫll Hǫ·*a*lfs · hǫva þękkða’k.

I journeyed down from the fell for five nights and days,
until the high hall of Highelf I knew.

---

ALL | For sts. 12–13, cf. *1 Guðr* P2.

**13** Sat’k með Þóru · sjau misseri,
døtr Hǫ·konar, · í Dan-mǫrku;
hǫn mér at gamni · goll bókaði
sali suðr-óna · ok svani danska.

I stayed with Thurie for seven half-years,
the daughter of Hathkin in Denmark.
To my joy she bestowed upon me
southern halls and Danish swans.

---

4 svani danska ‘Danish swans’ | In which Guthrun apparently took some delight. These fowls are also mentioned in *1 Guðr* 16, *Sigsk* 29.

**14** Hǫfðum vit á skriptum · þat’s skatar léku

ok á hann-yrðum · hilmis þegna,
randir rauðar, · rekka Húna,
hjǫr-drótt, hjalm-drótt, · hilmis fylgju.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**15** Skip Sig·mundar · skriðu frá landi,
gylltar grímur, · grafnir stafnar;
byrðum vit á borða · þat's þǫir bǫrðu=sk,
Sig·arr ok Sig·gǫirr, · suðr á Fífi.

The ships of Syemund sailed out from the land,
their gilt faces, their graven prows.
TODO.
TODO.

**16** Þá frá Grím·hildr, · gotnisk kona,
hvat ek vǫ́ra hyggjuð;
hǫn brá borða · ok buri hǫimti,
þrý-gjarn=liga, · þǫss at spyrja:
Hvǫrr vildi son · systur bøta
eða ver veginn · vildi gjalda.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

2 hvat ek vǫ́ra hyggjuð | This half-line is clearly incomplete and missing another half. The alliteration on *h* is probable.

**17** Gørr létsk Gunn·arr · goll at bjóða,
sakar at bøta, · ok it sama Hǫgni;
hǫn frétti at því · hvǫrr fara vildi
vigg at sǫðla, · vagn at bǫita,
hǫsti ríða, · hauki fǫygja,
ǫrum at skjóta · a*f* ý-boga.

TODO.
TODO.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**18** Valdarr Dǫnum · með Jarits·lęifi,
Ęymóðr þriði · með Jarits·kári;
inn gengu þá, · jǫfrum líkir,
Lang·barðs liðar, · hǫfðu loða rauða,
stuttar brynjur, · stęypta hjalma,
skǫlmum gyrðir, · hǫfðu skarar jarpar.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

5 stuttar | *so* N*; unmetrical* skręyttar **R** 5 stęypta | stepta **N** 6 gyrðir | *add.* ok **N**

ALL | This st. is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 34, and ll. 5–6 are quoted.

**19** Hvęrr vildi mér · hnossir vęlja,
hnossir vęlja, · ok hugat męla
ef þęir mętti mér · margra súta
tryggðir vinna; · né trúa gørða'k.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**20** Fórði mér Grím·hildr · full at drekka,
svalt ok sár≠ligt, · né sakar munða'k;
þat vas of aukit · urðar magni,
sval-kǫldum sę · ok son*ar* dręyra.

Grimhild brought me a cup for to drink,
cool and painful; I did not recall my senses.
It was strengthened by the might of Weird,
by the ice-cold sea and by the gore of a son.

**21** Vǫru í horni · hvęrs kyns stafir [**R** TODO, **N** TODO]

ristnir ok roðnir · —ráða né mátta'k—
lyng-fiskr langr, · lands Haddingja
ax ǫ·skorit, · inn·lęið dýra.

Into the horn were all kinds of staves
carved and reddened—I could not read them—
a long heather-fish [SNAKE] from the land of the Hardings,
an unshorn ear of corn, the entrails of beasts.

3 lyng-fiskr | fisk **N** 3 langr | lagr **N**

ALL | This st. and the next are quoted in *Vǫls* 34.

**22** Vǫ́ru þęim bjóri · bǫl mǫrg saman, [R TODO, N TODO]
urt alls viðar · ok akarn *brunn*in,
um·dǫgg arins, · iðrar blótnar,
svíns lifr soðin; · því't hǫ́n sakar dęyfði.

TODO.
TODO and a burnt acorn.
TODO.
a boiled swine-liver; so did she dull my senses.

2 *brunn*in | *so* **N**; *meaningless* inn **R** 3 iðrar blótnar | 'itrar blotna' **N** 4 hǫ́n | *om.* **N**

**23** Ęn þá glęymðu, · es getit hǫfðu,
ǫll jǫfurs · jór-bjúg í sal;
kvǫ́mu konungar · fyr kné þrennir
áðr hǫ́n sjalfa mik · sótti at máli.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**24** ‚Gef't þér, Guð·rún, · goll at þiggja,
fjǫlð alls fé*ar*, · at þínn fǫður dauðan,
hringa rauða, · Hlǫð·vés sali,
ár-sal allan, · at jǫfur fallinn.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**25** Hunskar męyjar, · þér's hlaða spjǫldum
ok gøra goll fagrt, · svá't þér gaman þikki;
ęin skalt ráða · auði Buðla,
golli gǫfguð · ok gefin Atla.'

TODO.
TODO.
alone shalt thou rule the wealth of Budle,
honoured with gold and given to Attle.

**26** 'Vil'k ęigi ek · með veri ganga
né Bryn·hildar · bróður ęiga;
samir ęigi mér · við son Buðla
ętt at auka · né una lífi.'

TODO.
nor have Byrnhild's brother.
It does not befit me with Budle's son [= Attle]
to increase my lineage or be content in life.

**27** 'Hirð=a þú hǫldum · hęiptir gjalda
því't vér hǫfum · valdit fyrri;
svá skalt láta · sęm þęir lifi báðir,
Sig·*vǫ*rðr ok Sig·mundr, · ef þú sonu fóðir.'

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

4 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

**28** 'Má'k=a'k, Grím·hildr, · glaumi bella
né víg-risins · vánir tęlja
síðst Sig·*var*ðar · sár=la drukku
hré-gífr, Huginn · hjart-blóð saman.'

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

3 Sig·*var*ðar | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðar **R**

**29** ‚Þann hęfi'k allra · ętt-gǫfgastan
fylki fundit · ok framarst nøkkvi;
hann skalt ęiga · und's þik aldr viðar,
ver-laus vesa, · nema vilir þęnna.'

'TODO.
TODO.
him shalt thou have until old age overcomes thee,
or be husbandless if thou wilt not take him.'

**30** ‚Hirð-a þú bjóða · bǫlva-fullar
þrǫ́-gjarn=liga · þér kindir mér!
Hann mun *Gunn·ar · grandi bęita
ok ór Hǫgna · hjarta slíta.
Mun'k=at lętja · áðr lífs-hvatan
ęgg-lęiks hvǫtuð · aldri némi'k.'

'TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.'

**31** Grátandi Grím·hildr · gręip við orði
es burum sínum · bǫlva vętti
ok mǫgum sínum · męina stórra:

Weeping, Grimhild took to words,
she who for her sons expected evils,
and for her lads great harms:

**32** ‚Lǫnd gef'k ęnn þér, · lýða sinni,
Vin-bjǫrg, Val-bjǫrg, · ef þú vill þiggja;
ęig of aldr þat · ok uni, dóttir!'

'TODO.
TODO.
TODO.'

**33** ‚Þann mun'k kjósa · af konungum
ok þó af niðjum · nauðig hafa;
verðr ęigi mér · verr at ynði

4 né bǫl bróðra · at bura skjóli.‘

‘TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.’

**34** Sęnn vas á hęsti · hverr drængr litinn
2 ęn víf valnisk · hafið í vagna;
vér sjau daga · svalt land riðum,
4 ęn aðra sjau · unnir knáðum,
ęn ina þriðju sjau · þurrt land stigum.

Soon on his horse each young man was seen,
but the Welsh wife was lifted into the wagons.
For seven days we rode o’er cool land,
but for the other seven we drove forth the waves,
but for the third seven we stepped on dry land.

**35** Þar hlið-verðir · hárar borgar
2 grind upp luku · áðr í garð riðum;
vakði mik Atli · ęn ek vesa þóttu=mk
4 full ills hugar · at frękndr dauða:

There the wardens of the gate to the high stronghold
unlocked the doors before we rode into the court.
Attle awoke me, but I seemed to myself
full of an evil heart after my kinsmen’s deaths:

[Atli:] **36** ‚Svá mik ný=liga · nornir vękja,‘
2 víl-sinnis spǫ · vildi at ek réða:
‚hugða’k þik, Guð·rún, · Gjúka dóttir,
4 lę́-blǫndnum hjǫr · lęggja mik í gǫgnum.‘

[Attle:] ‘Most recently the Norns keep me thus awake,’
he wished that I interpret the spae of misfortune.
‘I thought thou, Guthrun, Yivick’s daughter
laidest a guile-blended sword through me.’

---

ALL | Sts. 36–42: Guthrun relates how Attle awoke her to tell her of his nightmares. As we, the audience, know, these prophetic dreams all came true. For the structure of the dreams and the trivialised explanations of them, cf. *Am* 15–19, 21–26.

[Guð·rún:] **37** ‚Þat ’s fyr ęldi · es jǫrn dręyma,

fyr dul ok vil · drósar ręiði;
mun'k þik við bǫlvi · bręnna ganga,
líkna ok lękna · þó'tt mér lęiðr sér.'

[Guthrun:] 'It is a sign of fire when one dreams of irons;
TODO.
TODO.
comfort thee and heal thee, although thou be loth to me.'

---

ALL | Guthrun trivialises the first vision.

[Atli:] **38** ‚Hugða'k hér í túni · tęina fallna
þá's ek vild*a'k · vaxna láta,
rifnir með rótum, · roðnir í blóði,
bornir á bękki, · *b*ęðið mik at tyggva.

[Attle:] 'Here in the yard I thought branches were fallen,
those which I wished to let grow;
they were torn up by their roots, reddened in blood,
borne up to the benches—thou badest me to chew!

---

ALL | In sts. 38–40, Attle describes three further visions of the death (and his subsequent cannibalism) of his sons: first as trees, second as hawks, and third as dogs.

**39** Hugða'k mér af hęndi · hauka *fl*júga
bráða-lausa · bǫl-ranna til;
hjǫrtu hugða'k þęira · við hunang tuggin,
sorg-móðs sefa, · sollin blóði.

Out of my hand I thought hawks were flown,
lacking prey, forth to the halls of evil.
I thought I had chewed with a sorrowful mind
their blood-swollen hearts with honey.

**40** Hugða'k mér af hęndi · hvęlpa losna,
glaums and·vana, · g*y*lli báðir;
hold hugða'k þęira · at hrękum orðit,
n*a*uðigr* n*á*i · nýta'k skylda'k.'

Out of my hand I thought whelps leapt loose,
devoid of mirth; both were baying.
I thought their flesh were turned to carrion;
forced, I had to enjoy the corpses.'

[Guð·rún:] **41** ‚Þar munu sęggir · of søing dǿma
2 ok hvítinga · hǫfði nęma;
þęir munu fęigir · fára nátta,
4 fyr dag litlu · dróttum bęrgja.‘

[Guthrun:] ‘There will men preside over the slaughter,
and deprive white beasts of their heads.
They will be fey for a few nights,
to be tasted by men a little before dawn.’

---

ALL | Guthrun explains away the visions; it will soon be time for the slaughter, and Attle has only envisioned the eating of animals.

[Atli:] **42** ‚Lęgja’k síðan · —né sofa vilda’k—
2 þrǫ́-gjarn ǐ kǫr; · þat man’k gørva.‘“

[Attle:] ‘I will lie down, then—I wish not to sleep—
restless in the sick-bed; I recall it clearly.’

# Third Lay of Guthrun
# *(III Guð·rúnar kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.731)–early C11th (0.178)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Third Lay of Guthrun** (*3 Guðr*) is a short narrative poem, depicting just a single scene. At 10 stanzas it is the shortest poem in **R**, and arguably one of the most forgettable. Its main features of note are its depiction of an ordeal by hot water and the drowning of a slave-woman in a bog.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*3 Guðr* is only preserved in **R**, on foll. TODO–TODO, where it follows *2 Guðr* and is followed by *Oddr*.

### Dating

Owing to its short length, there are few linguistic criteria for dating *3 Guðr*. We should therefore turn toward content-based criteria.

The most important factor towards dating *3 Guðr* is its description of the ordeal by hot water. This type of ordeal first appears in the early C6th Frankish *Salic Law*, and is always closely associated with the Catholic clergy. TODO: We ought to investigate when it went out of fashion. https://www.degruyterbrill.com/doc 003/html

### Summary

Herch, one of Attle's slave-women and concubines, tells him that she has seen his wife Guthrun alone together with Thedric; Attle is distressed upon hearing this (P1). Guthrun asks him what is wrong (1), and he responds that Herch has accused her of sleeping with Thedric (2). Guthrun promises to prove her innocence through a trial by ordeal involving taking up a white

stone out of boiling water (3); while she and Thedric did sit down together, they did so only in mutual grief over the deaths of her brothers (4–5). Guthrun tells Attle to summon the German lord Saxe to carry out the trial; seven hundred men arrive as witnesses (6). Before picking up the stone, Guthrun laments over her brothers' deaths, saying that they would have disputed the accusation with violence, but that she must prove her innocence alone (7). She then puts her hand in the boiling water and takes out the stone unscathed. She holds it up and shows it to the witnesses (8). Attle laughs, knowing that his wife has been faithful, and orders Herch to pick up the stone (9). She does so, and her hands are horribly scorched. She is dragged to a "foul bog", presumably to be drowned. The poet ends by sardonically stating that this is how Guthrun was "restored for her affronts" (10).

## Text

### Capitulum (‘New Chapter’)

**P1** Herkja hét ambǫ́tt Atla; hón hafði verit frilla hans. Hón sagði
2 Atla at hón hefði sét Þjóð·rek ok Guð·rúnu bǽði saman. Atli var
þá all-ó·kátr. Þá kvað Guð·rún:

Herch was the name of a maidservant of Attle; she had been his concubine. She told Attle that she had seen Thedric and Guthrun alone together. Then Attle was very unhappy. Then quoth Guthrun:

---

2 Þjóð·rek ok Guð·rúnu bǽði saman ‘Thedric and Guthrun alone together’ | Cf. *2 Guðr* P2.

### Guð·rúnar kviða (‘A Lay of Guthrun’)

**1** „Hvat ’s þér, Atli? · ǽ, Buðla sonr,
2 es þér hryggt í hug; · hví hlér þú ǽva?
Hitt myndi óðra · jǫrlum þykkja
4 at við mǫnn mǽltir · ok mik sǽir.“

“WHAT IS WITH THEE, Attle? Always, son of Bodle,
art thou sad at heart—why laughest thou never?
It would seem more proper to earls
that thou spoke with men and looked at me.”

---

1 Hvat | *The* H *(‘Þ’) is an ornamented initial 2 lines in height with the left line rising in the margin 5 lines high in* R.

[Atli:] **2** „Tregr mik þat, Guð·rún, · Gjúka dóttir,
2 mér í hǫllu · Hǫrkja sagði
at þit Þjóð·rekr · undir þaki svǽfið
4 ok létt=liga · líni vǫrðið.“

[Attle:] “*This* troubles me, O Guthrun, Yivick’s daughter,
that in the hall Herch has told me
that thou and Thedric slept beneath one roof,
and lightly did ye mind your linen.”

---

4 létt=liga · líni vǫrðið ‘lightly did ye mind your linen’ | Euphemistic; they threw off their clothes and slept with each other.

[Guð·rún:] **3** „Þér mun’k alls þǫss · ǫ́ða vinna

at inum hvíta · hęlga stęini,
at ek við Þjóð·mar · þat=ki átta'k,
es vǫrðr né verr · vinna knátti,—

[Guthrun:] "For thee I will swear the oaths to all of it
—by the white, holy stone,
that I did no such thing with Thedmar—
those which no married woman nor man has sworn,

---

2 at inum hvíta · hęlga stęini 'by the white, holy stone' | The stone lifted out of a pot of boiling water in the trial by ordeal, as described further in st. 8.

3 Þjóð·mar 'Thedmar' | Historically, Thedmar (*Theodemir*) was the father of Thedric (*Theoderic*) the Great, who took over the kingdom after his father's death (see Index). The use of the name here may either be a scribal error (whether for "Thedric" or for "Thedmar's son"), or a nickname caused by the conflation of the two persons in the late Norse tradition.

4 es vǫrðr né verr · vinna knátti 'those which no married woman nor man has sworn' | I.e., "those oaths which etc." — Guthrun's use of *vǫrðr* 'wife, married woman' and *verr* 'husband, married man' serve to question the reliability of Herch's testimony by pointing out that she, as an unmarried slave-woman, is not in a position to make legally binding accusations.

**4**

nema ek halsaða · hęrja stilli,
jǫfur ó·nęisinn, · ęinu sinni;
aðrar vǫru · okkrar spękjur
es vit hǫrmug tvau · hnigum at rúnum.

that I did not embrace the stiller of hosts [RULER = Thedric],
the unshamed prince, a single time.
Different were the dealings of us two,
when we, distressed, reclined in whispers.

**5**

Hér kom Þjóð·rekr · með þrjá tøgu,
lifa þęir né ęinir, · þriggja tega manna;
hrink-tu mik at bróðrum · ok at brynjuðum,
hrink-tu mik at ǫllum · á hǫfuð-niðjum.

Hither Thedric came with thirty men;
of those thirty not one still lives.—
Surround me with brothers and with byrnied men;
surround me with all close kinsmen!

---

3 hrink-tu 'surround' | Consisting of *hring*, 2nd sg. imper. of *hringja* 'surround, encircle' + *þú* 'thou'. The clitic form *-tu* has caused devoicing.

**6**

Sęnd at Saxa, · sunn-manna gram;
hann kann hęlga · hver vellanda;"
sjau hundruð manna · í sal gingu

áðr kvęn konungs · ï kętil tøki.

Send for Saxe, the lord of Southmen;
he can hallow the boiling cauldron."
Seven hundred men went into the hall,
before the king's wife should reach into the kettle.

1 Saxa, · sunn-manna gram 'Saxe, the lord of Southmen' | The Southmen being the Germans. — This line shows that the trial by cauldron was considered a foreign, specifically German custom by the poet, who naturally imagined Attle and Guthrun to have belonged to his own, Norse culture. For its bearing on dating the poem see Introduction.

[Guð·rún:] **7** „Kømr≠a nú Gunn·arr, · kalli'k≠a Høgna,
sé'k≠a síðan · svása bróðr;
sverði myndi Høgni · s·líks harms reka,
nú verð'k sjǫlf fyr mik · synja lýta."

[Guthrun:] "Now Guther will not come; I will not call on Hawn;
I will not henceforth see my beloved brothers.
By his sword would Hawn avenge such an affront;
now I for myself must disprove the slanders!"

**8** Brá hǫn til botns · bjǫrtum lófa
ok hǫn upp of tók · jarkna-stęina:
[Guð·rún:] „Séi nú sęggir · —sykn em'k orðin
hęilag≠liga— · hvé sjá hverr velli."

She thrust to the bottom her bright palms,
and she up did take the arkenstones:
[Guthrun:] "Let men now see—I am proven innocent
through holy means!—how this cauldron boils!"

2 jarkna-stęina 'arkenstones' | Gems, crystals; probably a borrowing from the Old English *eorcnanstânas* 'id.' The modern English form *arkenstone* was coined by Tolkien.

**9** Hló þá Atla · hugr ï brjósti
es hann hęilar sá · hęndr Guð·rúnar:
[Atli:] „Nú skal Hęrkja · til hvers ganga,
sú's Guð·rúnu · grandi vęnti."

Then laughed Attle's heart in his chest,
when he saw unscathed the hands of Guthrun:
[Attle:] "Now shall Herch to the cauldron go,
she who hoped for Guthrun's harm!"

1 Hló þá Atla · hugr ï brjósti 'Then laughed Attle's heart in his chest' | Echoing *Þrk* 31/1.

**10**

Sá=at maðr arm=ligt, · hvęrr es þat sá=at,
hvé þar á Hęrkju · hęndr sviðnuðu;
lęiddu þá męy · í mýri fúla,
svá þá Guð·rún · sínna harma.

Man saw nothing pitiful if he did not see that,
how there on Herch the hands were scorched.
Then they led the maiden into the foul bog;
so was Guthrun restored for her affronts.

---

3 lęiddu þá męy · í mýri fúla 'Then they led the maiden into the foul bog' | To be drowned, as was the customary Germanic punishment for perjurers; see *Vsp* 38 n.

# Weeping of Ordrun
# *(Odd·rúnar grátr)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.954)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Weeping of Ordrun** (*Oddr*) is a heroic poem dealing with the forbidden love between Ordrun and Guther, as told by the former. The following edition and translation is incomplete.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Oddr* is only preserved in **R**, on foll. TODO–TODO, where it follows *3 Guðr* and is followed by *Akv*.

### Meter and stanza

The poem is composed in Ancient-words-lay and consists of 125 long-lines distributed across 33 stanzas. The meter is of a somewhat irregular type; in particular, the poet allows for lines of three syllables.

## Text

### Frá Borgnýju ok Odd·rúnu ('From Burgny and Ordrun')

**P1** Heið·rekr hét konungr; dóttir hans hét Borg·ný. Vil·mundr hét
2 sá er var friðill hennar. Hón mátti eigi fǫða bǫrn áðr til kom
Odd·rún, Atla systir; hón hafði verit unnusta Gunn·ars, Gjúka
4 sonar. Um þessa sǫgu er hér kveðit:

HEATHRIC WAS THE NAME OF A KING. His daughter's name was Burgny. Wilmund was the name of her lover. She could not bear children before Ordrun, Attle's sister, arrived. She had been the lover of Guther, Yivick's son. About this saw it is here sung:

1 Heið·rekr | *The* H *('Þ') is an ornamented initial 2 lines in height with the left line rising 4 lines high in* **R**.

**1** Hęyrða'k sęgja · í sǫgum fornum
2 hvé mér of kom · til Morna-lands;
ęngi mátti · fyr jǫrð ofan
4 Hęið·reks dóttur · hjalpir vinna.

I HEARD IT SAID in ancient saws
how a maiden came to Mornland;
noone could—above the earth—
find help for Heathric's daughter [= Burgny].

1 Hęyrða'k | *The* H *is an ornamented initial 3 lines in height in* **R**.

1 Hęyrða'k sęgja · í sǫgum fornum 'I heard it said in ancient saws' | Formulaic opening; cf. *Hild* 1: *ik gi·hôrta dat seggen* 'I heard it said' which likewise uses the 1sg past of 'hear' and the infinitive of 'say'. The ancestral Proto-Germanic phrase may be reconstructed as **ek ga·hauzidō (þat) sagjaną*. — For a similar opening formula involving the verb **frehnaną* '(come to) learn, find out through hearsay' cf. *Ghv* 1/1 n.

**2** Þat frá Odd·rún, · Atla systir,
2 at sú mér hafði · miklar sóttir;
brá hǫn af stalli · stjórn-bitluðum
4 ok á svartan · sǫðul of lagði.

This learned Ordrun, Attle's sister,
that the maiden [= Burgny] had great ailments.
She seized from the stable a rudder-bitted steed,
and a black saddle thereupon did lay.

**3** Lét hǫn mar fara · mold-veg sléttan
und's at hári kom · hǫll standandi;
ok hǫn inn of gekk · ǫnd-langan sal;
svipti hǫn sǫðli · af svǫngum jó
ok hǫn þat orða · alls fyrst of kvað:

She let the steed travel the smooth soil-way [EARTH]
until she came to the high standing house,
and she went inside the endlong hall.
She cast the saddle off the slender horse
and she this word first of all did say:

---

3 ok hǫn inn of gekk · ǫnd-langan sal 'and she went inside the endlong hall.' | The whole line is formulaic; cf. *Vkv* 8 n.

5 ok ... of kvað 'and ... did say' | A formulaic long-lines; cf. *Þrk* 2/1 n.

**4** „Hvat es frǫgst · á foldu
eða hvat er hléðst · Húna-lands?"
„Hér liggr Borg·ný · of borin vǫrkjum,
vina þǐn, Odd·rún, · vit ef hjalpir!"

"TODO.
TODO."
"Here lies Burgny overcome by aches,
thy friend, O Ordrun; see if thou canst help!"

**5** „Hvǫrr hǫfir vísir · vamms of lǫitat?
Hví eru Borg·nýjar · bráðar sóttir?"

"TODO.
TODO."

**6** „Vil·mundr hét · vinr hauk-stalda,
hann varði mǫy · varmri bléju,
fimm vetr alla, · svá hǫn sǐnn fǫður lǫyndi."

"TODO.
TODO.
for five winters all, while she hid it from her father."

**7** Þǫr hykk mǫltu · því=git fleira,
gekk mild fyr kné · mǫyju at sitja;
ríkt gól Odd·rún, · rammt gól Odd·rún,

bitra galdra · at Borg·nýju.

I think those women spoke .
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**8** Knátti mér ok mǫgr · mold-veg sporna,
bǫrn þau in blíðu · við bana Hǫgna;
þat nam at méla · mér fjǫr-sjúka
svá't hǫn ękki kvað · orð it fyrra:

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**9** „Svá hjalpi þér · hollar véttir,
Frigg ok Freyja · ok fleiri goð
sem þú fælldir mér · fár af hǫndum.“

“So help thee hold wights,
Frie and Frow, and yet more gods,
as thou removedest this danger from my hands.”

---

1 Svá hjalpi þér ‘So help thee’ | A close semantic parallel, likewise invoking several gods to “help” somebody, is found on the 12th c. Saltfleetby spindle-whorl (E 18, normalised): *Óðinn ok Hœim·dalr ok Þjálfi, þeir hjalpa þér Ulf·ljótr(?)* … ‘Weden and Homedall and Thelve, may they help thee, Wolflight …’.

**10** „Hné'k=at ek af því · til hjalpar þér
at þú vérir þess · verð aldri=gi;
hét'k ok efnda'k · es ek hinig mélta
at ek hví-vetna · hjalpa skylda'k
þá's ǫðlingar · arfi skiptu.“

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**11** Þá nam at sætjask · sorg-móð kona
at tælja bǫl · af trega stórum:

TODO.
TODO.

**12** „Vas'k upp alin · í jǫfra sal,
flęstr fagnaði, · at fira ráði;
unða ek aldri · ok ęign fǫður
fimm vetr ęina · svá't minn faðir lifði.

I was reared up in the princely hall,
TODO.
I was content with my life and my father's estate
for but five winters, while my father lived.

**13** Þat nam at męla, · mál it øfsta
sjá móðr konungr · áðr hann sylti.

TODO.
TODO.

**14** Mik bað hann góða · golli rauðu
ok suðr gefa · syni Grím·hildar;
kvað-a hann ina óðri · alna myndu
męy í hęimi · nema mjǫtuðr spillti."

He bade me be endowed with red gold
and given in the south to the son of Grimhild.
TODO.
TODO.

**15** „Ór est, Odd·rún, · ok ør·vita
es þú mér af fári · flęst orð of kvað,
ęn ek fylgða'k þér · á fjǫrgynju
sęm vit bróðrum tvęim · of borin vęrim.

"Mad art thou, Ordrun, and out of thy wits,
when perilously thou hast spoken the most words to me,
but I followed thee upon the forested earth
as if we were born to two brothers."

**16** „Man'k hvat męltir · ęnn umb aptan
þá's ek Gunn·ari · gørða'g drekku;
s·líks dœmi kvað=at-tu · síðan mundu

4 męyju verða · nema mér ęinni.

"I still recall what thou spoke that evening
when for Guther I prepared a drink;
TODO.
TODO.

1 Man'k hvat mę́ltir · ęnn umb aptan | This line is clearly corrupt as seen by the lack of alliteration connecting the two halves. The simplest solution is to switch the places of *mę́ltir* and *ęnn*, but this produces a three-syllabic a-verse and a five-syllabic b-verse. Another possibility would be *Man'k hvat *ęnn · umb aptan mę́ltir*, but the metrics are still questionable.

**17** Bryn·hildr ǐ búri · borða rakði,
2 hafði hǫn lýði · ok lǫnd umb sik;
jǫrð dúsaði · ok upp-himinn
4 þá's bani Fáfnis · borg of þátti.

Byrnhild in her bower wove tapestries;
she had warriors and lands around her.
The Earth stood still and Up-heaven
when Fathomer's bane [= Siward] beheld that stronghold.

**18** Þá vas víg vegit · vǫlsku sverði
2 ok borg brotin, · sú's Bryn·hildr átti;
vas=a langt af því · hęldr vǫ́-lítit
4 und's þę́r vélar · vissi allar.

Then the battle was fought with a Welsh sword
and broken was the stronghold which Byrnhild owned.
It was not long thereafter—rather woefully short—
until she knew all the guiles.

4 þę́r vélar 'the guiles' | Namely that Siward had switched shapes with Guther.

**19** Þęss lét hǫn harðar · hęfndir verða
2 svá't vér ǫll hǫfum · órnar raunir;
þat mun á hǫlða · hvęrt land fara
4 es hǫn lét svelta=sk · at Sig·*vę*rði.

For that she declared there would be harsh deeds of revenge,
those of which we all have known plenty enough.
It will travel to every land of men
how she made herself to die after Siward.

4 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urði **R**

1 harðar · hęfndir ‘harsh deeds of revenge’ | Namely her instigation of the killing of Siward and her own subsequent suicide, as described in *Brot*, *1 Guðr*, and *Sigsk*.

**20**

Ęn ek Gunn·ari · gat’k at unna,
bauga dęili, · sęm Bryn·hildr skyldi;
ęn hann Bryn·hildi · bað hjalm geta,
hana kvað hann ǫsk-męy · verða skyldu.

But I got to love Guther,
the dealer of bighs, like Byrnhild should have,
but he bade a helmet be made for Byrnhild;
he said she would be his adopted daughter.

**21**

Buðu þęir *At*la · bauga rauða
ok bróðr mĭnum · bøtr ǫ·smáar;
bauð hann ęnn við mér · bú fimm-tían,
hlið-farm Grana · ef hann hafa vildi.

They offered Attle red bighs,
and my brother unlittle [great] restitutions.
TODO.
TODO.

1 *At*la | árla **R**. 3 fimm-tían | .xv. **R**

3 fimm-tían ‘fifteen’ | For metrical reasons the abbreviation *xv* is resolved to the archaic hiatus form *fimm-tían* rather than the standard *fimm-tán*. The meter of *Oddr* does rarely permit 3-syllable verses (*Oddr* 4/1a–b, 4/2b, 6/1a), but restoring hiatus is the better option since it agrees with the typical metrical patterns of the poem; *-tían* is also metrically secured from the early C11th by Þorm *Þorgdr* (SkP 5), 1/4b: *fimm-tían* ‘fifteen’, 15/2b: *þré-tían* ‘thirteen’.
The suffix *-t(j)án* ‘-teen’ in the numerals 13–19 behaves curiously in classical ON and modern Icelandic. In 13–16 (*þré-tán, fjór-tán, fimm-tán, sex-tán*) the suffix is *-tán*, but in 17–19 (*sjau-tján, át-tján, ní-tjan*) it is *-tján* (< *-tían*). The latter is undoubtedly the older form, deriving from PN **-tihan* corresponding to OHG *-zehan*, Gothic *-taihun*; see further Konráð Gíslason (1879), A. Kock (1893, pp. 137–142).

**22**

Ęn Atli kvað=sk · ęigi vilja
mund aldri=gi · at męgi Gjúka;
þęy=gi vit mǫttum · við munum vinna
nema ek hélt hǫfði · við hring-brota.

But Attle declared that he never would
take a bride-price from the lad of Yivick.
TODO.
TODO.

**23**
Mę́ltu margir · mǐnir niðjar,
kvǫ́ðu=sk okkr hafa · orðit bę́ði
ęn mik Atli kvað · ęigi myndu
lýti ráða · né lǫst gøra.

My many kinsmen spoke,
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**24**
Ęn s·líks skyli · synja aldri
maðr fyr annan · þar's mun-úð dę́ilir.

TODO.
TODO.

**25**
Sęndi Atli · ǫ́ru sǐna
of myrkvan við · mǐn at frę́ista;
ok þę́ir kvǫ́mu · þar's koma né skyldu=t
þá's brę́iddum vit · blę́ju ęina.

Attle sent his messengers
o'er the mirky wood to ask for me,
and they came where they should not have come,
when we two had spread out a single bed-cover.

1 Sęndi Atli · ǫ́ru sǐna 'Attle sent his messengers' | Cf. *Akv* 1/1.

**26**
Buðum vit þegnum · bauga rauða
at þę́ir ęigi til · Atla sęgði;
ęn þę́ir ǫ́=liga · Atla sǫgðu
ok hvat=liga · hę́im skunduðu.

We offered the thanes red bighs
that they should not tell it to Attle,
but harmfully they told Attle,
and hurriedly did hasten home.

**27**
Ęn þę́ir Guð·rúnu · gǫr=la lęyndu
því't hǫ́n hę́ldr vita · hǫlfu skyldi.

But from Guthrun they fully hid that
which she twice as rather had the right to know.

**28**
Hlymr vas at hęyra · hóf-gollinna
þá's í garð riðu · Gjúka arfar;
þęir ór Hǫgna · hjarta skóru
ęn í orm-garð · annan lǫgðu.

There was a din to be heard from the golden-hooved ones
when into the court rode Yivick's heirs.
Out of Hawn they cut the heart,
but in the snake-pit they laid the other.

---

2 í garð 'into the court' | Namely when Guther and Hawn rode up to Attle's hall.

3–4 þęir ... lǫgðu. 'out of ... the other.' | The deaths of Guther and Hawn are told in *Akv* 23–35, *Am* 56–64.

**29**
Vas'k ęnn farin · ęinu sinni
til Gęir·mundar · gørva drykkju;
nam horskr konungr · hǫrpu svęigja
því't hann hugði mik · til hjalpar sér,
kyn-ríkr konungr, · of koma myndu.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.

**30**
Nam'k at hęyra · ór Hlés-ęyju
hvé þar af stríðum · strǫngir méltu,
bað'k ambáttir · bǫnar verða,
vilda'k fylkis · fjǫrvi bjarga;
létum fljóta · far sund yfir
und's alla sá'k · Atla garða.

TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
TODO.
we let our vessel float o'er the water
until I saw all of Attle's yards.

---

5 sund | *sens. emend.;* lund **R**

**31**
Þá kom in arma · út skęvandi,
móðir Atla, · hǫn skyli morna!

Ok Gunn·ari · gróf til hjarta
svá't mátti'g=a'k · mę́rum bjarga.

Then came the wretched mother of Attle
out, striding; she should waste away!
And they dug into Guther's heart,
so that I could not save the renowned man.

**32** Opt undr=umk þat · hví ęptir má'k,
linn-vęngis Bil, · lífi halda
es ek ógn-hvǫtum · unna þótt=umk,
sverða dęili, · sęm sjalfri mér."

I often wondered at how I would afterwards
—[I], the Bil of the snake-cushion [GOLD > WOMAN]—hold on to my life
when I thought me to love the terror-eager
dealer of swords [WARRIOR > Guther] like my very self."

---

2 linn-vęngis Bil 'the Bil of the snake-cushion [GOLD > WOMAN]' | A thoroughly Scaldic woman-kenning.

**33** Satst ok hlýddir · meðan sagða'k þér
mǫrg ill of skǫp · mǐn ok þęira;
maðr hvęrr lifir · at munum sǐnum;
nú 's of gęnginn · grátr Odd·rúnar.

Thou hast sat and listened while I have told thee
many ill fates of mine and theirs.
Each man lives after his own will;
now the weeping of Ordrun has passed.

---

2 of skǫp | An instance of the archaic particle *of* in a prenominal position, corresponding to a lost Germanic prefix **ga-*; see *Sigsk* 23/1 n. *of skǫp* (< PGmc. **ga·skapō* > OS *gi·skapu*, OE *ge·sceap*) also occurs in *Sigsk* 58/5 and the present occurrence may be due to borrowing.

# Lay of Attle
# *(Atla kviða)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.719)–early C11th (0.212)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay-Speeches-meter

## Introduction

The **Lay of Attle** (*Akv*) is a narrative heroic poem dealing with King Attle of the Huns and his destruction of the Burgends Guther and Hawn.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Akv* is preserved only in **R**, on foll. 39v/11–41r/9, where it follows *Oddr* and is followed by *Am*.

Several passages from the poem (sts. 3–9, 14–15, 21–31, 33) are paraphrased in *Vǫls*, which indicates its presence in the poetic source manuscript used for that text.

### Meter and stanza

*Akv* consists of 176 long-lines across 47 stanzas. The poem itself has no narrative prose, but it is introduced by a short orienting prose passage (P1) and concludes with a short note introducing the following poem, *Am* (P2).

The typical length of the stanza is 4 lines (29/47: 1–7, 9–10, 12–18, 21–22, 28–29, 32–33, 36–37, 40, 43–45, 47). The other commonly represented lengths are 2 (5/47: 8, 11, 24, 30, 34), 3 (6/47: 19, 20, 23, 26, 38–39), and 5 (5/47: 25, 27, 41–42, 46). Stanzas of 1 line (31) and 6 lines (35) each appear once. Clauses occasionally span across multiple stanzas in the case of long lists, so 7–8, 15–16, and 18–19.

Together with *Vkv* and *Hamð*, *Akv* is composed in an unusually loose form of Ancient-words-lay. Though still characterised by 4 positions (unlike the 5-position Speeches-meter, as found in *Am*), the meter of *Akv* has a greater tolerance for verses with a greater number of unstressed syllables. This is seen especially in its strong preference for verses of the otherwise rare type

D* (e.g. 4/2a: *hjalma goll-roðna*) over type D (e.g. 28/4a: *hodd Niflunga*) and its common use of anacrusis. Both traits are shared with Speeches-meter to the exclusion of regular Ancient-words-lay (Suzuki 2014, pp. 504–6, 518–19; Goering 2023, pp. 82–83).

A unique, innovative verse-type found in *Akv* (and, less commonly, in *Hamð*), but not in regular Norse Ancient-words-lay (nor in *Beow*), is what Goering (2023, pp. 83–85) terms E*. This type is marked by the basic patterns / x / x (Ea*, e.g. 29/3b: *róg-malmi skatna*) and / x / x (Eb*, e.g. 13/3b: *ęrfi-vǫrðr Hǫgna*), and here occurs in 11 lines (Goering 2023, 83, n. 64).

Despite its tolerance for extended verses, *Akv* also permits catalectic (3-position) verses, including verses with only 3 syllables. This distinguishes it not just from Speeches-meter, but also from strict Ancient-words-lay as found e.g., in *Vsp* and *Hym*.

One verse, 32/3, has no corresponding verse; another, 28/2, appears to be defective owing to corruption.

## Origin and motifs

*Akv* narrates the treacherous murder of the Burgends or Nivlings, Guther and Hawn, at the hands of the Hunnish King Attle. Of all Eddic poems dealing with these figures, *Akv* shows the closest adherence to the known historical circumstances. This is seen in its clear distinction between the tribes of the Gots and the Huns, its geographical awareness, and its labelling of Guther as a Burgend (21/2).

Compare with the younger *Am*.

In **R**, the poem has the title *Atla kviða in grón-lendska* 'the Greenlandish Lay of Attle', but the adjectival phrase is almost certainly due to influence from the following *Am*, which, unlike *Akv*, does in fact show signs of a Greenlandish origin. Greenland was not settled by Icelanders until ca. 1000 AD (TODO: cite), by which point *Akv*—judging by the metrically required *vr-* (see below)—must already have been composed.

Together with *Am*, *Akv* clearly serves as a source for *Vǫls* 35–40. Although *Am* is the main source for most of the section, *Akv* 22–35 clearly underly a large part of *Vǫls* 39, and other stanzas are found paraphrased in chapters 35–38 and 40.

## Style

TODO: The old Germanic epic style of telling the whole story in poetry rather than delegating the verse exclusively to dialogue and otherwise relying on prose to progress the narrative.

## Dating

*Akv* has long been held to be a particularly archaic poem, and this is confirmed by its linguistic traits. The poem displays uncontracted hiatus forms—a sign of composition before ca. 1150—and alliteration between old *vr-* and *v-*

(st. 2/2, 14/4)—a sign of composition before ca. 1000 (Haukur Þorgeirsson 2023, pp. 36–38). On the other hand, the poem does not have a particularly high rate of the archaic particle *of*, which appears at a frequency of 0.1709 occurrences per 10 unique lines (Sapp 2022, p. 70), although it should be stressed that this is not an exceptionally low frequency, either.

## Text

### Dauði Atla (‘The Death of Attle’)

**P1** Guð·rún Gjúka dóttir hefndi bróðra sinna, svá sem frégt er orðit. [R 39v/8]
2 Hón drap fyrst sonu Atla, en eptir drap hón Atla ok brendi
hǫll’ina ok hirð’ina alla; um þetta er sjá kviða ort.

GUTHRUN YIVICK’S DAUGHTER avenged her brothers, as has become renowned. She first slew the sons of Attle, but afterwards she slew Attle and burned the hall and the whole hird. About that is this lay wrought.

1 Guð·rún | *The* G *is an ornamented initial 3 lines high in* **R**.

### Atla kviða in grøn-lendska (‘The Greenlandish Lay of Attle’)

**1** Atli sęndi · ǫr til Gunn·ars [R 39v/12]
2 kunnan sęgg at ríða, · Kné·frøðr vas sá hęitinn;
at gǫrðum kom Gjúka · ok at Gunn·ars hǫllu,
4 bękkjum arin-gręypum · ok at bjóri svǫsum.

ATTLE SENT a messenger to Guther
a well-known man to ride; Kneefrith he was called.
He came to the yards of Yivick and the hall of Guther,
to the hearth-surrounding benches and the pleasant beer.

1 Atli | *The* A *is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, more elaborate than the one immediately above (in P1), in* **R**.

1 Atli sęndi · ǫr til Gunn·ars ‘Attle sent a messenger to Guther’ | Echoed in *Oddr* 25/1.

2 Kné·frøðr ‘Kneefrith’ | In *Am*, the messenger is called Winge and plays a greater role in the narrative. *Vǫls* also calls him Winge, clearly on the basis of *Am*.

4 arin-gręypum ‘hearth-surrounding’ | A compound formed from *arinn* ‘hearth(stone)’ + the otherwise unattested adj. *gręypr* ‘surrounding’, here painting a picture of the benches placed along the long walls surrounding the blazing central hearth-fires in the ruler’s hall. The fact that it is not used in an alliterating position suggests that it was chosen for its precise semantic importance. The word also occurs in sts. 3/4 and 18/2 below, but never elsewhere in Old Norse.

**2** Drukku þar drótt-męgir · —ęn dyljęndr þǫgðu— [R 39v/14]
2 vín í val-hǫllu, · *v*rękiði sǫu=sk Hùna;
kallaði þá Kné·frøðr · kaldri rǫddu,
4 sęggr inn suð-røni · sat á bękk hǫ*u*m:

There the dright-lads [WARRIORS] drank—but the concealed ones shut up—
wine in the walhall; they feared the wrath of the Huns.

Then Kneefrith called out with a cold voice—
the southern man sat on a high bench:

---

1 drótt-męgir 'dright-lads' | The 'lads, sons of the retinue' (*drótt* 'dright'), which should be understood as a poetic synonym for 'warriors, young men' (Meissner 1921, p. 23). In Norse poetry this word otherwise only appears in *Vafþ* 11/4, 12/2. It does not occur in Skaldic poetry nor in prose. Similar cpds. occur in OE, e.g., *dryht-bearn* 'dright-children', *dryht-folc* 'dright-people'.

1 dyljęndr 'concealed ones' | Or 'those who conceal (their thoughts)'. Pl. of *dyljandi*, *nd*-stem agent noun of the verb *dylja* 'to hide, conceal, fail to disclose' (ONP). Finnur Jónsson (1932) reasonably interprets this as referring to Attle's spies at Guther's court.

2 val-hǫllu 'the walhall' | The interpretation of this cpd. is difficult in the current context due to the ambiguity of the first element *val-*. (1) *valr* 'falcon', referring to aristocratic hunting practices, seems unlikely. (2) *valr* 'Wale', cognate with 'Welsh' but in ON referring to the French or Romans, would stress the foreign nature of the hall or stronghold (cf. st. 15/3 below). (3) *valr* '(collective) the battle-slain', would foreshadow the inevitable death (feyness) of the Yivickings. The word would then etymologically identical to Walhall, the feasting hall of the god Weden, whither the battle-slain go.

2 *v*ręiði 'wrath' | An example of highly archaic alliteration between *v-* and old *vr-*, securing the presence of the latter in *Akv*; cf. sts. 9/3, 14/4.

**3** „Atli mik hingat sęndi · ríða ęyręndi, [R 39v/17]
mar inum mėl-gręypa, · Myrk-við inn ǫ·kunna
at biðja yðr, Gunn·arr, · at it á bękk kǿmið
með hjǫlmum arin-gręypum · at sókja hęim Atla.

"Attle sent me hither to ride an errand
on the bit-champing steed through Mirkwood uncharted—
to bid you, O Guther, that ye two [= Guther and Hawn] on the bench may come
with hearth-surrounding helmets to seek the home of Attle.

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ALL | Sts. 3–5 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 35: *Þá mélti Vingi: „Atli konungr sendir mik hingat ok vildi, at þit sóttið hann heim með miklum sóma ok þégið af honum mikinn sóma, hjálma ok skjǫldu, sverð ok brynjur, gull ok góð klǽði, her-lið ok hesta ok mikit lén, ok ykkr létst hann betst unna síns ríkis.*" 'Then Winge (cf. st. 1/2 n.) spoke: "King Attle sends me hither, and he wishes that ye two should seek out his home with great honour and receive from him great honour, helmets and shields, swords and byrnies, gold and good garments, war-troops and horses and a great fief; and he declared that he would grant you two the best part of his realm."'

4 hjǫlmum arin-gręypum 'hearth-surrounding helmets' | Perhaps helmets hanging on the walls, lit up by the fire; the expression is repeated in st. 18/2 below. For *arin-gręypr* 'hearth-surrounding', see st. 1/4 n.

**4** Skjǫldu kneguð þar vęlja · ok skafna aska, [R 39v/20]
hjalma goll-roðna · ok Húna męngi,
silfr-gyllt sǫðul-klǽði, · sęrki val-rauða,
dafar, darraða, · drǫsla mėl-gręypa.

There ye might choose shields and shaven ash-spears,
helmets gold-reddened and a multitude of Huns,

silver-gilt saddle-cloth, blood-red serks,
javelins, pennants, bit-champing steeds.

**5** Vǫll lét=sk ykkr ok myndu gefa · víðrar Gnita-heiðar [R 39v/22]
2 af gǫiri gjallanda · ok af gylltum stǫfnum,
stórar męiðmar · ok staði Danpar,
4 hrís þat it méra · es męðr Myrk-við kalla.“

He declared he would also give you the plain of the wide Gnit-heath,
from yelling spears and from gilded prows,
great treasures and the banks of the Danper,
the renowned brush which men call Mirkwood.”

---

2 gǫiri gjallanda ‘yelling spears’ | Formulaic. Also found in Egill Lv TODO; in OE as *giellende gâr* in *Wid* TODO, *Færst* TODO.

3–4 stórar … kalla ‘great … Mirkwood.’ | Both lines bear strong resemblance to ll. of 7, 9 of *Heiðr* st. 94.

3 Danpar ‘the Danper’ | The Dnieper, which runs through eastern Ukraine to the Black Sea. The Norse form *Danpar* (gen. sg.) is only attested here and in *Heiðr* st. 94 (for which see ll. 3–4 n.). The nominative form is uncertain; if it be a feminine it should be **Dǫnp*, a masculine **Danpr* or **Dǫnpr*. In any case it appears to be a reflex of the Gothic form *Danaper* as found in Jordanes, *Getica* 30, 35, 44 etc. As Males (2025, TODO) points out, *Heiðr* has the more historically accurate conception of the river, since it is there part of the Gothic kingdom, as it was historically, rather than of the Hunnish kingdom, as it is here.

**6** Hǫfði vatt þá Gunn·arr · ok Hǫgna til sagði: [R 39v/25]
2 „Hvat rǽðr okkr, sęggr hinn øri, · alls vit s·líkt hęyrum?
Goll vissa’k ękki · á Gnita-heiði,
4 þat’s vit éttim=a · annat s·líkt.

His head turned then Guther and said to Hawn:
“What dost thou counsel for us two, O younger man, as such things we hear?
I knew of no gold on the Gnit-heath
of which we two had not owned even as much.

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ALL | Sts. 6–8 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 35, immediately following the paraphrase of sts. 3–5: *Þá brá Gunnarr hǫfði ok mélti til Hǫgna: „Hvat skulum vit af þessu boði þiggja? Hann býðr okkr at þiggja mikit ríki, en enga konunga veit ek jafn-mikit gull eiga sem okkr, því at vit hǫfum þat gull allt, er á Gnita·heiði lá, ok eigum við stórar skemmur fullar af gulli ok inum betstum hǫgg-vápnum ok alls konar her-klæðum. Veit ek minn hest’inn betstan ok sverð’it hvassast, gull’it á·gętast.*“ ‘Then Guther turned his head and spoke to Hawn: “What should we take from this summons? He summons us to receive a great realm, but I know no kings which own even-much gold as we two, for we have all the gold which lay on the Gnit-heath and we own great storehouses full of gold and the best cutting weapons and all kinds of garments of war. I know my horse is the best and my sword the sharpest, my gold the most splendid.”’

**7** Sjau ęigu vit sal-hús · sverða full, [R 39v/28]
2 hvęrju ’ro þęira · hjǫlt ór golli;

mǐnn vęit'k mar bętstan · ęn męki hvassastan,
4 boga bękk-sóma · ęn brynjur ór golli,

We own seven hall-houses filled with swords—
on each of them is a golden hilt.
I know my horse is the best and my sword the sharpest;
my bow is bench-fit and my byrnies golden,

**8** hjalm ok skjǫld hvítastan, · kominn ór hǫll Kíars; [R 39v/30]
2 ęinn 's mǐnn bętri · an séi allra Húna."

my helmet and my shield are the whitest, come from Coser's hall;
mine alone is better than those of all of the Huns might be!"

[Hǫgni:] **9** „Hvat hyggr brúði bęndu · þá's hǫn okkr baug sęndi, [R 39v/31]
2 varinn vǫðum hęiðingja? · Hykk at hǫn vǫrnuð býði!
Hár fann'k hęiðingja · *v*riðit ĩ hring rauðum;
4 ylfskr es vegr okkarr · at ríðaęyręndi."

[Quoth Hawn:] "What dost thou think the bride meant when she sent us a bigh
wrapped in a heath-dweller's [WOLF's] cloth? I think she offered a warning!
A heath-dweller's [WOLF's] hair I found tied round the red ring:
wolven is our road if we ride that errand!"

---

ALL | That it is the more cautious Hawn who speaks here is clear from Guther's response in the following stanzas. Whereas Hawn judges the wolf-hair to be a warning of Hunnish treachery, Guther thinks that it is a warning that wolf-like, treacherous men will steal his wealth if he does not show up. — St. 9 is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 35, immediately after the paraphrase of sts. 6–8: *Hǫgni svarar: „Undrumst ek boð hans, því at þat hefir hann sjaldan gert, ok ó·ráðligt mun vera at fara á hans fund, ok þat undrumst ek, er ek sá ger-simar þér, er Atli konungr sendi okkr, at ek sá vargs-hári knýtt í einn gull-bring, ok má vera, at Guð·rúnu þykki hann úlfs-hug við okkr hafa ok vili hón eigi, at vit farim.*" 'Hawn answers: "I wonder at his summons, for he has seldom done such before, and it must be inadvicable to journey to meet him; and I also wonder at how, when I saw the jewels which King Attle sent to us, I saw a wolf's hair tied into a golden ring; and it must be that Guthrun thinks that he has a wolf's heart against us, and she does not wish that we journey."'

**10** Niðjar=gi hvǫttu Gunn·ar · né nǫ́ungr annarr, [R 39v/35]
2 rýnęndr né ráðęndr, · né þęir's ríkir vóru;
kvaddi þá Gunn·arr · sęm konungr skyldi,
4 męrr ĩ mjǫð-ranni · af móði stórum:

No kinsmen encouraged Guther, nor any other relation:
not counselors nor advisors nor those who were powerful.
Then Guther announced—as a king should—
renowned in the mead-hall out of great spirit:

**11** „Rís-tu nú, Fjǫrnir, · lát-tu á flęt vaða [R 40r/1]

greppa goll-skálir · með gumna hǫndum!

"Rise now, Ferner! Let on the benches wade forth
the golden bowls of soldiers along the hands of men!

---

1 Fjǫrnir 'Ferner' | An otherwise unknown servant.

**12** Ulfr mun ráða · arfi Niflunga, [R 40r/2]
gamlir grán-varðir, · ef Gunn·ars missir;
birnir blakk-fjallir · bíta þref-tǫnnum,
gamna gręy-stóði, · ef Gunn·arr né kømr=at."

The wolves will rule the patrimony of the Nivlings—
old, grey-pelted—if Guther is absent!
Black-furred bears will bite with wrangling teeth—
amusing the bitch-pack—if Guther comes not!"

---

4 né kømr=at 'comes not' | Note the archaic double negation *né* … *-at*; cf. *Háv* 135/4 n.

**13** Lęiddu land-rǫgni · lýðar ǫ·nęisir, [R 40r/4]
grátęndr, gunn-hvatan, · ór garði Húna;
þá kvað þat inn ǫri · ęrfi-vǫrðr Hǫgna:
„Hęilir farið nú ok horskir · hvar's ykkr hugr tęygir!"

Unshamed [FAMOUS] troops led the lord of the land—
weepers—the battle-bold man out of the yards of the Huns.
Then this quoth the younger heritance-guardian [SON] of Hawn:
"Fare ye two now whole and wise, wherever your heart may draw you!"

---

1 lýðar ǫ·nęisir 'unshamed [FAMOUS] troops' | Compare the long-line on the Thorsberg chape (~ 160–240 AD): *wlþuþewaʀ · ni wajé-máriʀ* 'Wolthew, the not ill-famed [FAMOUS]'.

**14** Fetum létu fróknir · of fjǫll at þyrja [R 40r/7]
mar ina mėl-gręypu, · Myrk-við inn ǫ·kunna;
hristi=sk ǫll Hún-mǫrk · þar's harð-móðgir fóru,
*v*rǫku þęir vand-styggva · vǫllu al-grøna.

With strides the braves made the bit-champing steed
rush o'er the fells through Mirkwood uncharted.
All Hunmark shook where the hard-minded went forth;
they drove the whip-shy horse across all-green fields.

---

ALL | Sts. 14–15 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 37: *Síðan riðu þeir sínum á·gętum hestum myrkvan skóg um hríð. Nú sjá þeir konungs-bó'inn. Þangat heyra þeir mikinn gný ok vápna-brak ok sjá þar mann-fjǫlda ok mikinn viðr-búnað, er þeir hafðu, ok ǫll borgar-hlið váru full af mǫnnum.* 'Thereafter they rode on their splendid horses through the mirky wood for a time. Now they see the king's estate; from that direction they hear a great noise and the clashing of weapons, and they see there a multitude of men and the great preparations which they had made; and all the gateways of the stronghold were full of men.'

**15** Land sǫu þęir Atla · ok lið-skjalfar djúpar; [R 40r/9]
Bikka greppar standa · á borg inni hǫu,
sal umb suðr-þjóðum, · slęginn sess-męiðum,
bundnum rǫndum, · blęikum skjǫldum,

They saw the land of Attle and its ravines deep,
Beck's soldiers standing upon the high stronghold,
the hall of the south-folk built with seat-beams,
with bound rims and pale shields;

---

2 Bikka 'Beck' | An obscure legendary figure; cf. *Sigsk* 64/1 and *Ghv* P1, where he is Ermenric's counsellor. He appears alongside Attle, Ermenric, and Yivick in *Wíd* 19 and again in *Wíd* 115.

2 á borg inni hǫu 'upon the high stronghold' | Formulaic, also found in *Hamð* 22/5b. A likely West Germanic parallel is found in OE *in/ǫn/tó sęlí þám héhan* 'in/on/to the high hall' (*Beow* 713b, 919b, 1016b, 1984b) with identical syntax.

3 sess-męiðum 'seat-beams' | Probably large load-bearing pillars or columns.

**16** dafar, darraða; · ęn þar drakk Atli [R 40r/12]
vín í val-hǫllu; · vęrðir sǫtu úti
at varða þęim Gunn·ari · ef þęir hér vitja kómi
með gęiri gjallanda · at vękja gram hildi.

[they saw] javelins and pennants. But there Attle drank
wine in the wal-hall; the watchmen stayed outside
to watch for Guther's men, if they came hither to visit
with a yelling spear to wake the ruler with war.

**17** Systir fann þęira snemmst · at þęir í sal kvǫmu, [R 40r/14]
bróðr hęnnar báðir, · bjóri vas hǫn lítt drukkin:
„Ráðinn est nú, Gunn·arr, · hvat munt, ríkr, vinna
við Húna harm-brǫgðum? · Hǫll gakk ór snimma!

Their sister found soonest that they had come into the hall,
her brothers both—on beer was she lightly drunk:
"Tricked art thou now, Guther! How wilt thou, rich man, withstand
the Hunnish harm-tricks? Go out of the hall, quick!

**18** Bętr hęfðir, bróðir, · at ï brynju fórir, [R 40r/17]
sęm hjǫlmum arin-gręypum · at séa hęim Atla;
sętir ï sǫðlum · sól-hęiða daga,
nái nauð-fǫlva · létir nornir gráta,

Thou wouldst have done better, brother, if thou hadst gone in thy byrnie
with hearth-surrounding helmets to see the realm of Attle;
if thou hadst loaded in the saddles during sun-bright days
need-pale corpses; if thou hadst let the norns cry,

---

ALL | In sts. 18–19, Guthrun tells Guther that he should not have shown up unarmed; rather he should have brought his whole army to defeat Attle in open battle.

4 létir nornir gráta 'if thou hadst let the norns cry' | The tragic killings and carnage are thought to be the cause of the rejoicing of evil spirits, but the weeping of good spirits; a dualistic notion. On the good side of this equation stand the elves (*Hamð* 1/2), on the evil side the Norns, Dises (ON *dísir*, *Reg* 2, *Hamð* 28/3), and Ogresses (ON *flǫgð*, *Hamð* 15/2).

**19** Hùna skjald-męyjar · hęrfi kanna, [R 40r/19]
ęn Atla sjalfan · létir ï orm-garð koma;
nú 's sá orm-garðr · ykkr of folginn."

[and] the Hunnish shield-maidens know the harrow—
but Attle himself shouldst thou have put in the snake-pit;
now that snake-pit has enveloped you two!"

---

1 Hùna skjald-męyjar · hęrfi kanna 'the Hunnish shield-maidens know the harrow' | I.e., if he had enslaved the Hunnish shield-maidens and turned them into farmhands.

2 orm-garð 'snake-pit' | A piece of foreshadowing; Guther should have put Attle in the snake-pit, but his naivité will instead result in it happening to himself (st. 35).

[Gunn·arr svarar:] **20** „Sęinat 's nú, systir, · at samna Niflungum, [R 40r/21]
langt 's at lęita · lýða sinnis til,
of rosmu-fjǫll Rínar, · rekka ǫ·nęissa."

[Guther answers:] "It is too late now, sister, to gather the Nivlings.
It is long to look for the support of men
o'er the red fells of the Rhine, for unshamed [FAMOUS] warriors."

**21** Fengu þęir Gunn·ar · ok ï fjǫtur sęttu [R 40r/23]
vin Borgunda · ok bundu fast≠la;
sjau hjó Hǫgni · sverði hvǫssu
ęn inum átta hratt hann · ï ęld hęitan.

They captured Guther and in fetters placed
the friend of the Burgends [= Guther] and bound him firmly.

Hawn smote seven with his sharp sword,
but the eighth one he threw into the hot fire.

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2 vin | vinir *('vɪn̄')* **R**

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ALL | *Vǫls* 39 paraphrases sts. 21–33 in uninterrupted sequence, immediately after its description of the fate of the thrall Helle (pulling on *Am* 56–62). Its paraphrase of st. 21 begins: *Nú eru þeir báðir í fjǫtra settir Gunnarr ok Hǫgni.* 'Now they are both placed in fetters, Guther and Hawn.'

2 vin Borgunda 'the friend of the Burgends' | **R** has a small stroke above the *n* that abbreviates the syllable *ir*, indicating the nom. pl. *vinir* 'friends'; the *vinir Borgunda* would then be the people binding Guther. This reading, however, certainly owes to a scribe attempting to "correct" the line after the knowledge of the Burgends had been lost on Iceland; the people who bind Guther are the Huns, not the Burgends. The historic King Guther (Latin *Gundaharius* < PWGmc. **Gunþi·hari*) was the king of Burgundy; cf. *Wald* B 14, where the hero Walder addresses Guther, whom he is just about to fight, with the cognate *wine Burgenda*. Calling a king the **winiz* 'friend' of his people or dynasty is common in early Germanic heroic poetry; cf. *Beow* 30, 170, 1183 etc.: *wini Scyldingá* 'friend of the Shieldings [DANISH KING]', 350 *wini Dęniġá* 'friend of the Danes [DANISH KING]'. The present instance is the only mention of the Burgends in all of Norse literature. As such, it is an impressive archaism that further adds support to an early dating for *Akv*. Cf. st. 46/4 n. below.

4 ī ęld hęitan 'into the hot fire' | This detail is not found in *Am*, and so *Vǫls* 39 must be pulling on the present stanza when it notes that: *Hann bratt mǫrgum í þann eld, er þar var gerr í hǫllu'nni.* 'He [= Hawn] threw many into the fire which was made in the hall.'

**22** [R 40r/25]

Svá skal frǿkn · fiǫndum vęrja=sk;
2 Hǫgni varði · hęndr Gunn·ars.
frǫ́gu frǿknan · ef fjǫr vildi
4 Gotna þjóðan · golli kaupa.

So shall a brave guard himself against foes;
Hawn guarded the hands of Guther.
They asked the brave sovereign of the Gots [= Guther]
if he would buy his [Hawn's] life with gold.

---

ALL | St. 22 is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 39, immediately after its paraphrase of st. 21: *Þá męlti Atli konungr til Gunnars konungs, at hann skyldi segja til gulls'ins, ef hann vill líf'it þiggja.* 'Then King Attle said to King Guther that he should tell him about the gold if he wishes to have his life.'

1 Svá ... vęrja=sk | Line moved from the last st. to this one since it seems to connect semantically with the immediately following line, and results in two typical four-line stanzas.

4 Gotna þjóðan 'sovereign of the Gots' | Guther; cf. sts. 1, 3, 10. — Although Gothic *þiudans* is the unmarked word for 'ruler' and reflexes of PWGmc. **þeudan* are exceptionally common in West Germanic heroic poetry (*þéoden* 40 times in *Beow*, *þéodan* 22 in *Heli*), ON *þjóðann* is a rare word and its presence here very likely a semantic archaism. Outside of *Akv* (st. 22/4, 23/3) the word is found only once in the heroic poetry of the Poetic Edda (*1 Guðr* 19/1), thrice in the mythological poetry (*Háv* 15/1, 114/2, and 147/1) and only once in a dateable Scaldic composition (the Lay-meter poem Egill *Arkv* 11/3a (SkP 5) from ca. 980). It otherwise occurs in the list of poetic synonyms for 'king' (Þul *Konunga* 2 (SkP 3)), three C12th or 13th antiquarian heroic poems (*Heiðr* 91, GunnLeif *Merl I* 81, *Gautr* 38 (all in SkP 8), probably imitating earlier heroic poetry like *Akv*), and the thoroughly Christian C13th advice-poem *Hsv* 143 (almost certainly drawing on *Háv*). Thus it appears this archaic word belonging to the Migration Period was thought unfitting for poetry in Court-spoken meter, which already from the time of Bray the Old preferred words like *stillir* (found ca. 104 in the SkP corpus; cf. Ög 136 Rök) or *þęngill* (found 120 times in the SkP corpus).

**23** „Hjarta skal mér Hǫgna · í hęndi liggja [R 40r/26]
2 blóðugt, ór brjósti · skorit bald-riða,
saxi slíðr-bęitu, · syni þjóðans.“

“The heart of Hawn shall lie in my hands:
bloody, cut from the breast of the bold rider,
with a slide-biting sax from the son of the sovereign.”

---

ALL | The Huns offer Guther to pay a ransom for Hawn's life. Guther instead responds in defiance. St. 23 is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 39, immediately after its paraphrase of st. 22: *Hann svarar: „Fyrr skal ek sjá hjarta Hǫgna, bróður míns, blóðugt.*“ ‘He answers: “I shall sooner see the blood heart of Hawn, my brother.”’

3 saxi slíðr-bęitu ‘slide-biting sax’ | A short-sword with a blade so sharp that it draws blood when one slides the finger across it. — Possibly formulaic; cf. *Hamð* 8/4.

**24** Skóru þęir hjarta · Hjalla ór brjósti, [R 40r/28]
2 blóðugt, ok á bjóð lǫgðu · ok bóru þat fyr Gunn·ar.

They cut the heart of Helle from the breast,
bloody, and on a plate laid it, and brought it before Guther.

---

ALL | St. 24 is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 39, immediately after its paraphrase of st. 23: *Ok nú þrifu þeir þrę́l'inn í annat sinn ok skáru ór hónum hjarta't ok báru fyrir konung'inn Gunnar.* ‘And now they seized the thrall for a second time and cut the heart out of him and brought it before King Guther’.

**25** Þá kvað þat Gunn·arr, · gumna dróttinn: [R 40r/30]
2 „Hér hęfi'k hjarta · Hjalla ins blauða,
ó·líkt hjarta · Hǫgna ins frǿkna,
4 es mjǫk bifa=sk · es á bjóði liggr;
bifði=sk hǫlfu męirr · es í brjósti lá!“

Then this quoth Guther, the lord of men:
“Here have I the heart of Helle the soft
—unlike the heart of Hawn the brave!—
which quivers greatly when on the plate it lies;
it quivered twice as much when in the breast it lay.”

---

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 25 immediately after that of st. 24: *Hann svarar: „Hjarta Hjalla má hér sjá ins blauða, ok er ú·líkt hjarta Hǫgna ins frękna, því at nú skelfr mjǫk; enn hálfu meirr, þá er í brjósti hónum lá.*“ ‘He answers: “Here one may see the heart of Helle the soft and it is unlike the heart of Hawn the brave, for it now trembles much—yet twice as much when it lay in his breast.”’

**26** Hló þá Hǫgni · es til hjarta skóru [R 40r/32]
2 kvikvan kumbla-smið · —kløkkva síðst hugði.
Blóðugt þat á bjóð lǫgðu · ok bóru fyr Gunn·ar.

Hawn then laughed as to his heart they cut
the living wound-smith [WARRIOR = Hawn]; he thought least of sobbing.
Bloody on a plate they laid it, and brought it before Guther.

---

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 26 immediately after that of st. 25: *Nú gengu þeir eptir eggjun Atla konungs at Hǫgna ok skáru ór hónum hjarta't. Ok svá var mikill þróttr hans, at hann hló, meðan hann beið þessa kvǫl, ok allir undruðust þrek hans, ok þat er síðan at minnum haft. Þeir sýndu Gunnari hjarta Hǫgna.* 'Now, following King Attle's incitement, they went up to Hawn cut the heart out of him. And so great was his strength, that he laughed while he suffered this torment, and all wondered at his zeal, and that is thereafter held in the memories of men. They showed Guther Hawn's heart.' Cf. also *Am* 62, which serves as a source for the same passage.

**27** Mǫ́rr kvað þat Gunn·arr, · gǫ́ir-Niflungr: [R 40r/34]
„Hér hǫfi'k hjarta · Hǫgna ins frǿkna,
ǫ·líkt hjarta · Hjalla ins blauða,
es lítt bifa=sk · es á bjóði liggr;
bifði=sk svá=gi mjǫk · þá's í brjósti lá!

Renowned, this quoth Guther, the Spear-Nivling:
"Here have I the heart of Hawn the brave
—unlike the heart of Helle the soft!—
which quivers little when on the plate it lies;
it quivered not so much when in the breast it lay.

---

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 27 immediately after that of st. 26: *Hann svarar: „Hér má sjá hjarta Hǫgna ins frǫ́kna, ok er ú·líkt hjarta Hjalla ins blauða, því at nú hrǫ́rist lítt, enn miðr, meðan í brjósti hónum lá.* 'He answers: "Here one may see the heart of Hawn the brave and it is unlike the heart of Helle the soft, for it now moves little—yet less while it lay in his breast.'

**28** Svá skalt, Atli, · augum fjarri [R 40v/3]
sęm munt [...] · męnjum verða;
es und ęinum mér · ǫll of folgin
hodd Niflunga: · lifir=a nú Hǫgni!

So shalt thou, Attle, be as far from eyes
as thou wilt be from the [...] neck-rings.
Under me alone is hidden all
the hoard of the Nivlings—now Hawn lives not!

---

2 [...] | *No gap is indicated in* **R**.

---

ALL | Sts. 28–30: Guther declares his unwillingness to reveal the location of the treasure. He alone knows it and he will take it with him to the grave. *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 28 immediately after that of st. 27: *Ok svá mantu, Atli, láta þitt líf, sem nú látum vér. Ok nú veit ek einn, hvar gull'it er, ok mun eigi Hǫgni segja þér.* 'And so shalt thou, Attle, lose thy life like we now lose ours. And now I alone know where the gold is, and Hawn will not tell thee.'

1 augum fjarri 'be as far from eyes' | Perhaps as far from men's eyes, namely after he is dead.

2 [...] | This word, required for metrical reasons, would most likely have been an adjective beginning with *m-*, probably *mérum* 'renowned' or *métum* 'splendid'. It has likely been skipped owing to the similar dative ending. The paraphrase of *Vǫls* does not offer any help.

**29** Ę́y vas mér týja · meðan vit tvęir lifðum, [R 40v/5]
nú 's mér ęngi · es ęinn lifi'k;
Rǐn skal ráða · róg-malmi skatna,
svinn, ǫ́s-kunn*um* · arfi Niflunga.

I always had doubt while we twain lived;
now I have none as I alone live.
The swift Rhine shall rule the strife-ore of princes [GOLD],
the Os-born inheritance of the Nivlings!

4 ǫ́s-kunn*um* | *gramm. emend.;* ǫ́s-kunna **R**

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of sts. 29–30 immediately after that of st. 28: *Ok svá mantu, Atli, láta þitt líf, sem nú látum vér. Ok nú veit ek einn, hvar gull'it er, ok mun eigi Hǫgni segja þér. Mér lék ymist í hug, þá er vit lifðum báðir, en nú hefi ek einn ráðit fyrir mér. Skal Rín nú ráða gulli'nu, fyrr en Hýnir beri þat á hǫndum sér.*" 'And so shalt thou, Attle, lose thy life like we now lose ours. And now I alone know where the gold is, and Hawn will not tell thee. I always had doubt in my heart while we both were alive, but now I alone have had my will. The Rhine shall now rule the gold before the Huns might bear it upon their hands."'

4 svinn, ǫ́s-kunn*um* · arfi 'swift ... Os-born inheritance' | Difficult. (1) The ms. form *ǫ́s-kunna* 'Os-born' does not concord with the m. dat. sg. *arfi* 'inheritance' (an interpretation of it as the weak form is unlikely), and so the ending has been emended. The hoard can be called 'Os-born', i.e., 'born of the Eese', for it was the Gods who gave it to Rethmar as weregild for his son (*Reg* Pl–st. 9). *svinn* 'swift' is taken to be an adj. modifying *Rǐn* 'Rhine' in l. 3. Still, it is highly unusual for a type D verse to have alliteration fall on the second lift but not the first. (2) An alternative solution is to keep *ǫ́s-kunna* and instead read *svinn* as an error for *sú in* nom. sg. f. 'this'. This would give the prose word order *Rǐn sú in ǫ́s-kunna skal ráða* 'This Os-born Rhine shall rule' etc. The construction *sá (h)inn* 'this' does occur elsewhere in the poem (5/4 above).

**30** Í veltanda vatni · lýsa=sk val-baugar [R 40v/7]
hęldr an á hǫndum goll · skíni Húna bǫrnum."

In tumbling water shall the Welsh bighs gleam,
rather than gold shine on the hands of the children of Huns!"

2 Húna bǫrnum 'the children of the Huns' | Here just meaning 'the Huns', a common Germanic kenning-type (Meissner 1921, pp. 23–25, 245). Cf., e.g., *Beow* 1088, 1141: *Eotená barn* 'the children of the Jutes [JUTES]', 2184: *Ġéatá barn* 'the children of the Geats [GEATS]', along with expressions like ON *alda bǫrn* 'the children of mankind [MEN]'.

[Atli kvað:] **31** "Ýkvið ér hvél-vǫgnum, · haptr 's nú í bǫndum!" [R 40v/8]
[Quoth Attle:] "Turn ye the wheel-wagons; the captive is now in bonds!"

ALL | *Vǫls* 39 continues with its paraphrase of st. 31 immediately after that of sts. 29–30: *Atli konungr mélti: „Farið á brott með bandingja'nn." Ok svá var gjǫrt.* 'King Attle spoke: "Go away with the captive!" And so it was done.'

**32** Atli inn ríki · rǫið Glaum mǫnum, [R 40v/9]
slǫginn róg-þornum, · sifjungr þǫira;
Guð·rún sig-tíva
varnaði við tǫrum, · vaðin í þys-hǫllu:

Attle the powerful, their in-law, rode
on Gleam by his mane surrounded by strife-thorns [SWORDS].
Guthrun of the victory-Tews [...];
she held back her tears, pacing in the tumultous hall:

---

ALL | Attle rides back to the hall surrounded by his warriors with their swords raised. Sts. 32–33 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 39, immediately after its paraphrase of st. 31: *Guðrún kveðr nú með sér menn ok hittir Atla ok segir: „Gangi þér nú illa ok eptir því, sem þér helduð orð við mik ok Gunnar."* 'Guthrun now summons men to her side and finds Attle and says: "May it go ill with thee now, just in the way with which ye have held your word with me and Guther."'

1 Glaum 'Gleam' | Attle's horse.

2 sifjungr þǫira 'their in-law' | Attle is the in-law (here *sifjungr* 'in-law, kinsman by marriage') of Guther and Hawn through his marriage to Guthrun; this appellation illustrates his treachery.

3 Guð·rún sig-tíva 'Guthrun of the victory-Tews' | A second verse has undoubtedly been lost in the same line; whether l. 3 is an a- or b-verse is therefore also uncertain. We are therefore dealing with an opaque expression, although the *sig-tívar* 'victory-Tews' are in any case the gods, but what they are doing here is unclear. If Guthrun is being presented as a descendant of the gods this would have a parallel in *Hamð* 25/1, although the Yivickings are not (TODO: verify) otherwise said to be of heavenly descent.

**33** „Svá gangi þér, Atli, · sǫm við Gunn·ar áttir [R 40v/11]
ǫiða opt of svarða · ok ár of nǫfnda
at sól inni suðr-hǫllu · ok at Sig-týs bergi,
hulkvi hvíl-bǫðjar · ok at hringi Ullar."

"So may it go with thee, Attle, like thou with Guther hadst
oaths often sworn and always mentioned
by the south-facing sun and by Victory-Tew's mountain,
by any pleasant bed and by the ring of Wolder."

**34** Ok mǫirr þaðan · mǫn-vǫrð bituls, [R 40v/14]
dolg-Rǫgni, dró · til dauðs, skókr.

And further the bridle-shaker [WARRIOR = Attle] brought
the torc-defender, the battle-Reiner [WARRIOR = Guther] to his death.

---

ALL | The word-order is unusually difficult. In prose word order: *Ok męirr þaðan dró skókr bituls męn-vǫrð, dolg-Rǫgni, til dauðs.*

1 męn-vǫrð 'the torc-defender' | A rare kenning, really an anti-kenning, since it is typical to describe a man as a giver or destroyer of rings (i.e., a generous man), not their defender. Yet in the present context Guther is called this since he refuses to divulge the location of the gold which he has buried in the Rhine.

**35** Lifanda gram · lagði í garð, [R 40v/15]
þann's skriðinn vas, · skatna męngi,
innan ormum. · Ęn ęinn Gunn·arr
hęipt-móðr hǫrpu · hęndi kníði;
glumðu stręngir. · Svá skal golli
frøkn hring-drifi · við fira halda!

The living lord [= Guther] was laid in the pit
(which was crawling) by a troop of warriors
(with snakes inside), but Guther alone
spitefully struck the harp with his hand;
its strings rang out. *So* shall a brave
ring-strewer [GENEROUS MAN] withhold his gold from men!

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ALL | Guther was laid alive in a snake-pit, but was given a harp to pacify the snakes and played it with his feet. This worked until a single serpent pierced his heart, and he died. The same is told in *2 Guðr* P1, *Am* 63, and *Ghv* 17/3–4. The scene of Guther playing with his feet was very famous and is depicted pictorally in several archaeological finds and stave church carvings, most notably on the surviving carvings from the now-demolished Hylestad Stave Church (ca. 1170 AD) in Setesdal, Norway (see Fig. 11, p. 673.) — This st. is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 39, immediately after its paraphrase of sts. 32–33: *Nú er Gunnar konungr settr í einn orm-garð, þar vóru margir ormar fyrir, ok vóru hendr hans fast bundnar.* 'Now King Guther is placed in a snake-pit—there were many wyrms there within—and his hands were bound fast.'

**36** Atli lét · lands síns á vit [R 40v/17]
jó ør·skáan · aptr frá morði;
dynr vas í garði, · drǫslum of þrungit,
vápn-sǫngr virða— · vǫru af hęiði komnir.

Attle turned towards his land
on his watchful steed back from the murder.
There was a din in the yard from the trampling of horses,
the weapon-song of warriors—they had come from the heath.

---

1 Atli lét | This verse is highly unusual since the alliteration falls on the finite verb *lét* rather than the leftmost nominal *Atli*; corruption seems likely (Goering 2023, p. 81). The catalexis itself is not evidence of corruption, since trisyllabic verses occur at other places in the poem.

2 ør·skáan 'watchful' | A hapax, best explained as a cognate with Gothic *us·skaws* 'vigilant, watchful'.



Figure 11: Guther in the snake-pit, detail on the left portal of the now-demolished Hylestad Stave Church in Setesdal, Norway. High Mediaeval, ca. 1170 AD. Unknown author. `https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Hylestadportalen_-_an10071203083003.jpg`

**37** Út gekk þá Guð·rún, · Atla í gǫgn, [R 40v/20]
með gylltum kalki · at rękifa gjǫld rǫgnis:
„Þiggja knátt, þęngill, · í þǐnni hǫllu
glaðr at Guð·rúnu · gnadda nifl-farna.“

Then out went Guthrun, Attle to face,
with a gilt chalice to give repayments to her lord.
“Do accept, ruler, in thy own hall,
glad, from Guthrun, young beasts gone to the shades!”

4 gnadda nifl-farna ‘young beasts gone to the shades’ | These ‘young beasts’ are of course her children, Earp and Oatle. The killing is described more directly in *Am* 74–76.

**38** Umðu ǫl-skálir · Atla vín-hǫfgar [R 40v/22]
þá’s í hǫll saman · Hùnar tǫlðu=sk,
gumar gran-síðir · gengu inn hvárir.

The ale-bowls of Attle clanged heavy with wine
when gathered in the hall the Huns were counted;
the long-bearded men walked in two by two.

**39** Skękvaði þá hin skír-lęita, · vęigar þęim at bera, [R 40v/23]
af-kǫr dís, jǫfrum, · ok ǫl-krásir valði,
nauðug, nęf-fǫlum, · ęn níð sagði Atla:

Forth strode the pure-faced woman bearing them draughts,
the violent dise for the princes, and chose the ale-dainties,
forced, for the pale-faced men—but spoke a nithe to Attle.

1 vęigar ‘draughts’ | The alliteration requires a word starting with *sk-*. For this reason *vęigar* probably ought to be replaced with the synonym *skálir* ‘bowls’.

3 níð ‘nithe’ | An evil, cursing word.

**40** „Sona hęfir þǐnna, · sverða deilir, [R 40v/25]
hjǫrtu hré-dręyrug · við hunang of tuggin,
męlta knátt, móðugr, · manna val-bráðir
eta at ǫl-krǫsum · ok í ǫnd-ugi at sęnda.

“Thy own sons’ hast thou, dealer of swords,
corpse-bloody hearts with honey chewed.
Thou art stomaching, fierce man, the death-flesh of men,
eating it by ale-dainties, passing it on from the high seat!

3 val-bráðir | *sens. emend.;* val-brúðir **R**.

**41** Kallar=a þú síðan · til knéa þínna [R 40v/28]
Erp né Ęitil, · ǫl-rękifa tvá;
sér=a þú síðan · í seti miðju
golls miðlęndr · gęira skępta,
manar męita · né mara kęyra.“

Thou wilt not henceforth call up to thy lap
Earp or Oatle, the ale-rowdy two.
Thou wilt not henceforth see in the middle of the seat
the dealers of gold shafting spears,
brushing horse-manes or driving steeds.”

2 ǫl-rękifa tvá ‘the ale-rowdy two’ | At this time there was nothing unusual about young boys drinking.

**42** Ymr varð á bękkjum, · af-kárr sǫngr virða, [R 40v/30]
gnýr und guð-vęfjum, · grétu bǫrn Húna,
nema ęin Guð·rún · es hǫn ęva grét
bróðr sína ber-harða · ok buri svása,
unga, ǫ·fróða, · þá's hǫn við Atla gat.

There was clangour on the benches, the violent song of warriors,
whimpering beneath the god-weave; the children of the Huns wept,
save for Guthrun alone, for she never wept
for her bear-hard brothers and beloved sons,
the young, unlearned, which she begot by Attle.

2 und guð-vęfjum ‘beneath the god-weave’ | Beneath the silken fabric, presumably of the tents in which the nomadic Huns dwelled.

4 ber-harða ‘bear-hard’ | Before the lion was adopted for this sake on the basis of Classical and Biblical models, the bear was the animal associated with strength and bravery in the North. — *ber-* is a compounding form of **beri* ‘bear’, an otherwise unattested m. *n*-stem noun inherited from PGmc. **berô*, whence also OHG *bero*, OE *bera* ‘id.’, along with the ON f. *bera* ‘she-bear’ and diminutive *bersi* ‘(playful) bear’. The normal ON word for “bear” is *bjǫrn*, an *u*-stem derived from the oblique cases of **berô*. *ber-* appears to be an archaism, since it is only otherwise attested in *Vkv* 11.

5 unga, ǫ·fróða ‘the young, unlearned’ | Cf. *Hild* 16: *alte anti fróte* ‘the old and learned’.

**43** Golli søri · hin gagl-bjarta, [R 40v/33]
hringum rauðum · rękifði hǫn hús-karla;
skǫp lét hǫn vaxa · ęn skíran malm vaða,
ęva fljóð ękki · gáði fjarg-húsa.

With gold the goose-bright lady sowed [the floor];
with red rings she cheered on the housecarls.
She let the large vats grow and the pure ore [GOLD] wade;
never did that woman heed the god-houses.

ALL | The poet paints the image of a crazed feast in Attle's hall. Guthrun throws off her golden rings and bracelets around her to the cheer of the drunken warriors.

4 fjarg-húsa 'god-houses' | An archaic word for cultic buildings, probably small houses with idols or altars inside. For the first element *fjarg-* 'god', see *Lok* 19/4 n. In the Norse corpus this word is only used here and in st. 46/3 below.

**44** Ó·varr Atli · *óðan hafði sik drukkit; [R 40v/35]
vápn hafði hann ękki, · varnaði-t við Guð·rúnu;
opt vas sá lęikr bętri · þá's þau lint skyldu
optarr of faðma≠sk · fyr ǫðlingum.

Unwary, Attle had drunk himself mad;
he had no weapon, did not beware Guthrun.
Oft their play was better when they gently would
oftener embrace each other before the athlings.

1 *óðan 'mad' | *emend.;* móðan *'tired'* **R**

1 *óðan 'mad' | A word alliterating with a vowel is required by the meter and **óðan* 'mad' lies closest at hand, differing only by a letter from *móðan* 'tired'.

**45** Hǫn bęð broddi · gaf blóð at drekka, [R 41r/1]
hęndi hęl-fússi, · ok hvelpa lęysti;
hratt fyr hallar dyrr · ok hús-karla vakði
brandi, brúðr, hęitum; · þau lét hǫn gjǫld bróðra.

With a blade she gave the bed blood to drink
by a hell-eager hand—and set loose the whelps,
blocked the doors of the hall and awoke the housecarls
with hot flame, the bride; such were her repayments for her brothers.

**46** Ęldi gaf hǫn alla · es inni vóru [R 41r/4]
ok frá morði þęira Gunn·ars · komnir vóru ór Myrk-hęimi;
forn timbr fellu, · fjarg-hús ruku,
bør Buðlunga, · brunnu ok skjald-męyjar,
inni; aldr-stamar · hnigu í ęld hęitan.

To the fire she gave all who were within
and from the murder of Guther and his [brother] had come out of Mirkham.
Ancient timbers fell; the god-houses smoked,
the town of the Budlings. The shield-maidens too burned
inside; short-lived, they sank into the hot fire.

4 bór Buðlunga ‘the town of the Budlings’ | An archaism. This is the only Norse attestation of *buðlungr* in its original sense ‘Budling, descendant of Budle’; in all other instances the word has become a generalised poetic synonym for ‘king, ruler’. Note that the younger *Am* 35/2 instead uses the expression *bór … es Buðli átti* ‘the town which Budle owned’.

**47** Full-rǿtt’s umb þetta; · fęrr ęngi svá síðan [R 41r/6]
brúðr í brynju · bróðra at hęfna;
hǫn hęfir þriggja · þjóð-konunga
ban-orð borit, · bjǫrt, áðr sylti.

It is told fully about this. Henceforth no bride will
so don a byrnie to avenge her brothers.
She has, bright, borne the bane-word
of three great kings before she must die.

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3 þjóð-konunga ‘great kings’ | An old poetic word; for etymology and distribution see *Gríp* 1/2 n.

4 ban-orð borit ‘borne the bane-word’ | I.e., she has brought death to three great kings. For the idea of death as a “word” cf. *Yt* 1: *Varð fram·gęngt* […] *fęigðar-orð es at Fjǫlni kom* ‘The word of feyness (i.e., imminent death or destruction) which came upon Fillner became fulfilled’, that is to say, “Fillner died at his fatefully appointed time”. This expression, along with its Germanic and Indo-European parallels, is discussed in detail by Watkins (1995, pp. 417–422).

**P2** Enn segir gløggra í Atla-mǫlum inum grøn-lendskum. [R 41r/8]

This is told yet more clearly in the Greenlandish Speeches of Attle.

# Greenlandish Speeches of Attle
# *(Atla mǫ́l in grøn-lęndsku)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): late C11th (0.472)
**Meter:** Speeches-meter

## Introduction

The **Greenlandish Speeches of Attle** (*Am*) is a long Eddic heroic poem dealing with the deaths of Guther and Hawn at the hands of Attle.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Am* is only preserved in **R**, on foll 41r/9–44r/13, where it follows *Akv* and precedes *Ghv*. The title *Atla mǫ́l in grøn-lęndsku* 'The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle' is preserved in *Akv* P2.

### Story and parallels

The basic narrative of *Am* is largely the same as the preceding *Akv*, and together with that poem it clearly serves as a source for *Vǫls* 35–38. For much of the relevant section, *Am* is the chief source, probably due to its greater length.

Although both poems build on the same basic narrative frame, *Am* is far longer and contains a number of otherwise unparallelled details. One of the most interesting differences is the *Am*-poet's clear lack of familiarity with continental European circumstances. Whereas the poet of *Akv* has Guther and Hawn ride through the dark Mirkwood and over high mountains to get to Attle in the south (*Akv* 14), *Am* instead lets Guther and Hawn sail out of their home firth (*fjǫrðr*) to the land of Budle (*Am* 28–35) in what is clearly an insular Norse adaptation of the original setting.

## Meter and stanza

*Am* consists of 382 long-lines distributed across 102 stanzas. The typical length of a stanza is 4 lines, but other lengths are also represented.

The poem is composed in Speeches-meter throughout.

## Localisation

In **R** the adjective *grøn-lęndskr* 'Greenlandish' is applied to both *Akv* and *Am*, but only the latter appears actually to have been composed in one of the Norse settlements on Greenland. This is shown most clearly by st. 18, where the poet makes reference to a "white-bear" (*hvíta-bjǫrn*) arriving in a storm from the east. The polar bear (*Ursus maritimus*) is indeed found on Greenland, where members of the species not infrequently drift onto the shores on ice sheets carried by the winds, whereas they never appear on Iceland or the Scandinavian peninsula.

## Dating

A Greenlandish origin for the poem lets us to determine a *terminus post quem* for its composition. *Am* cannot have been composed before ca. 985 AD, the time of Greenland's settlement by Icelanders agreed upon both by the mediaeval saws and modern archaeology.

We may push this date some decades forward based on the treatment of the dead in the poem. Being burned on a pyre is a punishment associated with stoning (st. 84), while a proper burial is in a painted coffin, though apparently still in a boat (st. 100). The equation of stoning and cremation clearly points towards composition after conversion, whereas pre-Christian poems like *Háv* show no such association (cf. *Háv* 71/3, 81/1). Iceland officially became Christian in 1000 AD and Greenland probably did not follow long thereafter, but the old custom of cremation can hardly have become thoroughly taboo immediately in the way it clearly is here.

On the linguistic side of things *Am* shows noticeably younger characteristics than its predecessor *Akv*.

Most notably the sound change *vr-* > *r-* is consistently applied in roots originally containing the glide, namely *vręiðr, vręiði* > *ręiðr, ręiði* 'wroth, wrath' (*Am* 51/1: *rǫskr, róða* : *ręiðr*, 75/4: *ró, ręiði* : *ręynir* vs. *Akv* 2/2: *vǐn, val-hǫllu* : *vręiði*), *vrangr, vręngja* > *rangr, ręngja* 'twisted, twist' (*Am* 4/1: *rúnar, rísta* : *ręngði* vs. Bragi *Þórr* 6 (in SkP 3): *vildi-t, vrǫngum : vágs*), and **vrǫskr* > *rǫskr* 'vigorous' (*Am* 51/1, 57/2: *rǫskr, ręyna=sk : ręynt*, 87/1: *rǫskr, róða : rakði=sk* vs. *Þdr* 22/1: *vręiðr, Vrǫsku : vá*). For the root *vreka* > *reka* 'drive, chase', which is not found in *Am*, cf. *Akv* 14/4.

Another young feature is the comparative rarity of the pre-verbal particle *of*, which appears three times. Of all 37 Eddic poems or sections of poems treated separately by Sapp (2022, p. 70), *Am* has the lowest frequency of this particle at 0.039 occurrences per 10 unique lines. This contrasts with the 6 occurrences in the much shorter *Akv*, which has a middling frequency of 0.1709 occurrences per 10 unique lines.

## Text

### Atla mǫ́l in grǿn-lendsku (‘The Greenlandish Speeches of Attle’)

**1** Frétt hęfir ǫld ófu · þá’s ęndr of gørðu
2 sęggir sam-kundu, · sú vas nýt fęstum;
óxtu ęin-męli, · yggt vas þęim síðan
4 ok it sama sonum Gjúka · es vǫ́ru sann-ráðnir.

Folk have learned of the enmity long ago
when men held an assembly; that was a boon to the fewest.
Their private speeches intensified; it was terrible for them afterwards,
and the same for the sons of Yivick who were truly deceived.

1 Frétt | *The* F *is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, with the left vertical stroke tail-shaped and descending an additional 6 lines in the margin in* R.

ALL | Sts. 1–2 describe how Attle and his advisors decide to trick Guther and Hawn and betray them.

**2** Skǫp óxtu skjǫldunga · —skyldu=at fęigir—
2 illa réð=sk Atla, · átti hann þó hyggju;
fęlldi stoð stóra, · stríddi sér harð=la,
4 af bragði boð sęndi · at kvęmi brátt mágar.

They intensified the Shapes of the noblemen—they should not have been fey—
evil was coming for Attle although he had wit.
He toppled a great pillar, injuried himself grievously,
hurriedly sent a summons that his inlaws should come soon.

1 Skǫp óxtu skjǫldunga ‘They intensified the Shapes of the noblemen’ | Attle and his men caused cruel fates (*skǫp* ‘Shapes’) to afflict Guther and Hawn.

3 fęlldi stoð stóra ‘He toppled a great pillar’ | Symbolic. His own greed was to be his undoing, just like a man who topples a pillar only for it to fall upon himself.

**3** Horsk vas hús-fręyja, · hugði at man-viti, [R TODO]
2 lag hęyrði hǫn orða, · hvat þęir á laun męltu;
þá vas vant vitri, · vildi hǫn þęim hjalpa,
4 skyldu of sę sigla · ęn sjǫlf né kom=sk=at.

Wise was the lady of the house; she thought cleverly;
she heard the gist of the words which the men spoke in secret.
Then the clever woman was pressed; she wished to help them;
the men were to sail o’er the sea, but she herself would not come.

ALL | Guthrun overhears the plans of her husband but since she herself cannot come to warn her brothers she comes up with a plan.

**4** Rúnar nam at rísta, · rængði þér Vingi— [R TODO]
fárs vas hann flýtandi— · áðr hann framm sęldi,
fóru þá síðan · sændi-mænn Atla
umb fjǫrð Lima · þar's frøknir bjoggu.

She took to carve runes; Winge distorted them—
he was a hastener of dangers—before he handed them over.
Thereafter Attle's messengers journeyed
through the Limfirth, where the brave men dwelled.

4 fjǫrð Lima 'Limefirth' | Limfjorden in the north of Jutland; the localisation of the poem's events in Denmark rather than in Burgundy (as the more archaic *Akv* 21/2) is a secondary development of the story likely based on the confusion between the continental and originally Asiatic Huns and the similarly named tribe of Denmark (TODO).

**5** Ǫl-vęrir urðu · ok ęlda kyndu, [R TODO]
hugðu vętr véla · es þęir vǫru komnir;
tóku þęir fórnir · es þęim fríðr sændi,
hængðu á súlu, · hugðu=t þat varða.

They were generous with ale and kindled the fires,
in no wise suspected wiles from those who had come.
They took the gifts which the beautiful woman [= Guthrun] had sent them,
hung them on a pillar, did not think it had meaning.

3 fórnir 'gifts' | Apparently whereon the runes were inscribed as suggested by the implication in the last line of the stanza. The fact that they can be hung on a pillar seems to suggest that Guthrun embroidered the runes into a tapestry.

**6** Kom þá Kost·bera, · kvęn vas hǫn Hǫgna, [R TODO]
kona kapps-gá=lig, · ok kvaddi þá báða;
glǫð vas ok Glaum·vǫr · es Gunn·arr átti,
fell=sk=at saðr sviðri, · sýsti of þǫrf gęsta.

Then came Costbearer—she was Hawn's wife,
a very discerning woman—and greeted them both.
Also glad was Gleamware, she whom Guther had to wife;
virtue did not fail that wise woman; she looked after the needs of the guests.

4 saðr 'virtue' | Literally 'truth'.

**7** Buðu þęir hęim Hǫgna · ef hann þá hęldr føri; [R TODO]

sýn vas svip-vísi · ef þęir sĭn gę̨ði;
hét þá Gunn·arr · ef Hǫgni vildi,
Hǫgni því nítti · es hinn of réði.

They invited Hawn to their home if he would be more willing to go;
the deceit was apparent if they would have watched out for themselves.
Then Guther asked if Hawn wished to go;
Hawn turned down what the other one counselled.

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ALL | This scene takes greater place in *Akv* 3–9.

2 sýn vas svip-vísi · ef þęir sĭn gę̨ði | Repeated in 71/2 below.

**8** Bǫ́ru mjǫ̨ð mę́rar, · margs vas alls bęini, [R TODO]
fór þar fjǫlð horna · und's þótti full-drukkit.

The famous women bore mead; the servings were all plentiful;
there went forth a multitude of horns before it seemed fully drunk.

**9** Hjú gørðu hvílu · sęm þęim høgst þótti; [R TODO]
kęnnd vas Kost·bera, · kunni hǫ́n skil rúna,
innti orð-stafi · at ę̨ldi ljósum;
gę̨ta varð hǫ́n tungu · í góma báða:
vǫ́ru svá villtar · at vas vant at ráða.

The couple made their place of rest as they thought most pleasing;
Costbearer was renowned; she knew the distinctions of runes;
she interpreted the word-staves by the bright fire.
She had to hold her tongue between her gums;
they were so confused that there was little to read.

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ALL | Sts. 9–19 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 35–36.

4 í góma báða 'between her gums' | Lit. 'in her gums', that is, due to the difficulty of reading the runes.

**10** Sę́ing fóru síðan · sĭna þau Hǫgni; [R TODO]
dręymði drótt-láta, · dulði þęss vę́ttki,
sagði horsk hilmi · þegar's hón réð vakna:

Then they went to their bed, she and Hawn;
the courtly-faced woman dreamt, hid no part of it;
the wise woman told the prince when she awoke:

**11** „Hę́iman gøri=sk þú, Hǫgni, · hygg þú at rǫ́ðum! [R TODO]
Fár 's full-rýninn, · far þú í sinn annat!

Réð'k þér rúnar · es rętst þín systir:
bjǫrt hęfir þér ętigi · boðit í sinn þetta.

"Thou makest ready to leave home, Hawn; think about this counsel.
Few know runes fully; journey another time!
I've read the runes which thy sister did carve;
the bright woman has not summoned thee this time.

**12** Ętt ek męst undr=umk · —má'k=at ętn hyggja— [R TODO]
hvat þá varð vitri · es skyldi villt rísta;
því't svá vas á *vísat* · sęm undir véri
bani ykkarr bętggja · ef it brál=la kvętmið.
Vant 's stafs vífi · eða valda aðrir."

I wonder most about a single thing—I cannot get to the bottom of it:
what was it with the clever woman that she should carve so confused?
It was as if it were indicated underneath
that it would the bane of you both if ye came hurriedly.
The wife left out a stave—or others are at fault."

**13** „Allar 'ro ill-úðgar," (kvað Hǫgni,) „á'kk=a'k þęss kynni, [R TODO]
vil'k=a'k þęss lętta · nema launa ętigim;
okkr mun gramr golli · rętifa glóð-rauðu,
ó=umk ek aldri=gi · þó'tt vér ógn fregnim."

"All women are faithless;" quoth Hawn, "I have no such mind.
I will not look out for such unless we have to repay it.
The chief will gladden us two with glowing-red gold;
I shall never fear, even if we should learn of a threat."

[Kost·bera kvað:] **14** „Stopalt munuð ganga · ef it stundið þangat, [R TODO]
ykkr mun ǫst-kynni · ętigi í sinn þętta.
Drętymði mik, Hǫgni, · dylj=umk þat ętigi:
Ganga mun ykkr and·óris · eða ętla hrętð=umk.

[Quoth Costbearer:] "Ye two will go stumbling if ye proceed thither;
there will be no loving welcome shown to you two this time.
I had a dream, Hawn; I will not hide it:
It will go ill for you two—or else I am just afraid.

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ALL | Sts. 14–19 deal with Costbearer's prophetic dreams as told to her husband Hawn.

**15** Bléju hugða'k þína · brenna í ętldi, [R TODO]
hryti hýr logi · hús mín í gǫgnum."

[Hǫgni kvað:] „Liggja hér lín-klǽði · þau's ér lítt røkið,
4 þau munu brátt brenna · þar's þú bléju sátt.“

I thought thy bed-cover were burning in fire;
the high flame roared throughout my halls.”
[Quoth Hawn:] “Here lie linen clothes which ye mind little;
they will soon burn where thou sawest the bed-cover.”

3 þau's ér | ‘þau er’ **R**

[Kost·bera kvað:] **16** „Bjǫrn hugða'k hér inn kominn, · bryti upp stokka, [**R** TODO]
2 hristi svá hramma · at vér hrǽdd yrðim;
munn oss mǫrg hǫfði · svá't vér mǽttim ękki;
4 þar vas ok þrǫmmun · þey=gi svá lítil.“

[Quoth Costbearer:] “I thought a bear came in hither, broke up the rafters,
struck so fiercely that we were frightened,
held many of us in its mouth so that we could nowise resist;
there was also crashing not at all small.”

[Hǫgni kvað:] **17** „Veðr mun þar vaxa, · verða ótt snemma; [**R** TODO]
2 hvíta-bjǫrn hugðir: · þar mun hregg austan.“

[Quoth Hawn:] “The storm will grow yonder, turn violent shortly;
thou hast thought of a white-bear—there comes a tempest from the east.”

2 hvíta-bjǫrn hugðir: · þar mun hregg austan ‘thou hast thought of a white-bear—there comes a tempest from the east’ | The image is undoubtedly Greenlandish; polar bears float from the east to the island on large sheets of ice. There is a real power to these lines which gives a sense of the harshness of the Greenland climate, even by Icelandic standards.

[Kost·bera kvað:] **18** „Qrn hugða'k hér inn fljúga · at ęnd-lǫngu húsi, [**R** TODO]
2 þat mun oss drjúgt dęila=sk, · dręifði hann oss ǫll blóði;
hugða'k af hęitum · at véri hamr Atla.“

[Quoth Costbearer:] “I thought an eagle flew in hither through the end-long hall;
that must be of weight for us; he spattered us all in blood;
I thought from the names that it were Attle's hame!”

1 at ęnd-lǫngu húsi | Also occurring at 24/1b below. The verse appears to be a Speeches-meter variant of the formulaic Ancient-words-lay b-verse *ęnd-langan sal* (cf. *Þrk* 27/2 n.)

3 hamr Atla ‘Attle's hame’ | I.e., Attle in the shape of an eagle.

[Hǫgni kvað:] **19** „Slǫ́trum sýs=liga, · séum þá roðru; [**R** TODO]
2 opt 's þat fyr øxnum · es ǫrnu dręymir;

hęill 's hugr Atla · hvat=ki's þik dręymir."
Lokit því létu, · líðr hvęr róða.

[Quoth Hawn:] "We will go to slaughter shortly—*then* we will see blood;
it is oft a sign of oxen when one dreams of eagles.
Attle's heart is true, no matter what thou dreamest."
They said no more of it; each speech comes to its end.

**20** Vǫknuðu vel-borin, · vas þar sams dømi, [R TODO]
gętti=sk þęss Glaum·vǫr · at véri grand svefna
[...] við Gunn·arr · at fá tvér lęiðir.

The well-born couple awoke; the same thing happened there;
Gleamware asked for counsel about the blemishes of her sleep [NIGHTMARES];
[...] with Guther that it may have two outcomes:

ALL | Gleamware, Guther's wife, also has prophetic dreams; she tells them to Guther in sts. 20–26. Sts. 20–38 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 37.

**21** „Gǫrvan hugða'k þér galga, · gengir þú at hanga [R TODO]
ęti þik ormar, · yrða'k þik kvikvan,
gørði=sk rǫk ragna; · ráð hvat þat véri!

"I thought a gallows were readied for thee; thou wentest to hang;
snakes did eat thee; I lost thee in life;
it was [like] the Rakes of the Reins. Interpret what that was!

**22** Blóðgan hugða'k męki · borinn ór serk þínum, [R TODO]
illt 's svefn s·líkan · at sęgja nauð-manni;
gęir hugða'k standa · í gǫgnum þik miðjan,
ęmjuðu ulfar · á ęndum bǫðum."

I thought a bloodied sword were drawn out of thy shirt;
it is ill to tell such a dream to one's husband.
I thought a spear were piercing through thy stomach;
wolves bellowed on both of its sides."

2 nauð-manni 'husband' | Hapax. TODO.

[Gunn·arr kvað:] **23** „Rakkar þar renna, · ráða=sk mjǫk gęyja, [R TODO]
opt verðr glaumr hunda · fyr gęira flaugun."

[Quoth Guther:] "Hounds run yonder; they are loudly barking;
oft the revel of dogs precedes the hurling of spears."

[Glaum·vǫr kvað:] **24** „Ǫ́ hugða'k hér inn renna · at ęndi-lǫngu húsi, [R TODO]
2 þyti af þjósti · þęysti=sk of bękki;
bryti fótr ykkra · bróðra hér tvęggja,
4 gørði=t vatn vęgja; · vesa mun þat fyr nøkkvi.

[Quoth Gleamware:] "I thought a river ran in hither through the end-long hall;
it roared furiously, gushed over the benches,
here broke the feet of you brothers twain;
that water did not cede. That must mean something!

**25** Konur hugða'k dauðar · koma ï nǫ́tt hingat, [R TODO]
2 vęri=t vart búnar, · vildi þik kjósa,
byði þér bráð=liga · til bękkja sinna;
4 ek kveð af·lima · orðnar þér dísir."

I thought dead women came in hither tonight;
they were not poorly dressed; they would choose thee,
invited thee hurriedly onto their benches.
For thee, I say, the dises have become feeble!"

4 ek kveð af·lima · orðnar þér dísir 'For thee, I say, the dises have become feeble' | The goddesses of fate have become powerless to protect him due to his imminent death; for the expression cf. *Grm* 55.

[Gunn·arr kvað:] **26** „Sęinat 's at sęgja, · svá 's nú ráðit; [R TODO]
2 forð=umk=a fǫr þó · alls þó 's fara ętlat;
margt 's mjǫk glík=ligt · at munim skamm-ęir."

[Quoth Guther:] "It is too late to tell; it has now been thusly interpreted,
yet I cannot refrain from the journey when I have set out to journey.
Much makes it likely that we shall be short-lived."

ALL | Guther at last admits that Gleamware likely has seen something. He will not try to explain away the dreams further, but even if what they imply is true, fate has already decided that he and Hawn must journey to Attle.

**27** Litu es lýsti · létu=sk þęir fúsir [R TODO]
2 allir upp rísa, · ǫnnur þau lǫttu;
fóru fimm saman, · flęiri til vǫ́ru
4 hǫlfu hús-karlar, · hugat vas því illa.
Snęv·arr ok Sól·arr, · synir vǫ́ru þęir Hǫgna,
6 Orkning þann hétu · es þęim ęnn fylgdi;
blíðr vas borr skjaldar, · bróðir hans kvánar.

They beheld it growing bright, said that they were all
eager to rise; their wives discouraged them.

They journeyed five men together—there were more men at hand,
twice as many housecarls; it was ill thought out:
Snower and Solwer; they were the sons of Hawn.
Orkning they called yet one who followed them;
blithe was that shield-tree [WARRIOR], the brother of his wife.

7 bróðir hans kvánar 'brother of his wife' | According to *Vǫls* 37, Orkning was Costbearer's brother.

**28** Fóru fagr-búnar · und's þau fjǫrðr skilði, [R TODO]
2 lǫttu á·vallt ljósar, · létu=at hęldr sęgja=sk.

The fair-clothed wives followed them until the firth did part them;
the light women at length discouraged them; they would not be convinced.

ALL | Sts. 28–32 see the men, Guther, Hawn, Snower, Solwer, and Orkning in the parting ship alongside Attle's messenger Winge, while the women, ashore, run alongside it.

**29** Glaum·vǫr kvað at orði, · es Gunn·arr átti, [R TODO]
2 męlti hǫn við Vinga · sęm hęnni vert þótti:
„Vęit'k=at hvárt verð launið · at vilja ossum,
4 glópr 's gęsts kváma · ef í gøri=sk nǫkkvat."

Gleamware took to speak, she whom Guther had to wife;
she spoke with Winge what she thought worthiest:
"I know not whether ye will repay us according to our will;
a guest's coming is a disgrace if something ill comes out of it!"

**30** Sór þá Vingi, · sér réð hann lítt ęira: [R TODO]
2 „Ęigi hann jǫtnar · ef hann at yðr lygi,
galgi gǫrv-allan · ef hann á grið hygði."

Then Winge swore; he chose not to protect himself little:
"Let the ettins have him whole if he lies to you,
on a gallows, if he thought to break the grith!"

2 hann 'him' | Winge himself.

**31** Bera kvað at orði, · blíð í hug sínum: [R TODO]
2 „Siglið ér sęlir · ok sigr árnið,
fari sęm fyr·męli'k! · Fęst ęigi því níta."

Bearer took to speak, blithe in her heart:
"May ye sail blessed and win victory;
may it go as I proclaim! May the fewest deny that."

1 Bera ‘Bearer’ | Short form of Costbearer’s name.

**32** Hǫgni svaraði · —hugði gótt nǫ́num: [R TODO]
„Huggið=sk it, horskar, · hvé=gi’s þat gørvi=sk!
Méla þat margir, · missir þó stórum,
mǫrgum rǫ́ðr litlu · hvé verð lęiddr hęiman.“

Hawn answered; he thought well of his kin:
“Comfort yourselves, wise women, however it may turn out!
Many men say—yet it is utterly wrong—
that for many a man it matters little how he leaves his home.”

---

ALL | Hawn thanks the women for accompanying them to the point of their departure.

**33** Sǫ́u=sk til síðan · áðr í sundr hyrfi; [R TODO]
þá hygg skǫp skiptu, · skilðu=sk vegir þęira.

They looked at each other then before they were driven apart;
then I think the Shapes split them up; their roads did part.

**34** Róa nǫ́mu ríki, · rifu kjǫl halfan, [R TODO]
bęystu bak-fǫllum, · brugðu=sk hęldr ręiðir;
hǫmlur slitnuðu, · háir brotnuðu,
gørðu=t far fęsta · áðr þęir frá hyrfi.

They took to row with strength, tore up half the keel,
struck the water leaning backwards, became rather wrathful;
the oar-straps snapped; the tholes broke;
they did not fasten their boat before they turned from it.

---

ALL | The men row furiously and leave the boat untied; they know that they will not return.

**35** Litlu ok lęngra · —lok mun’k þęss sęgja— [R TODO]
bǿ sǫ́u þęir standa · es Buðli átti;
hǫ́tt hrikðu grindr · es Hǫgni kníði.

And a little later—I will tell it to its end—
they saw standing the town which Budle owned;
loudly creaked the gates when Hawn moved them.

**36** Orð kvað þá Vingi · þat’s án vę́ri: [R TODO]
„Farið firr húsi! · Flátt ’s til sókja,

brátt hęfi'k ykkr bręnnda, · bragðs skuluð hǫggnir;
fagrt bað'k ykkr kvámu, · flátt vas þó undir,
ęlla heðan bíðið · meðan ek hǫgg yðr galga!“

Then quoth Winge a word which he were better without:
“Fare ye far from the house! It is false to visit;
I will soon have you burned; ye shall shortly be cut down;
fairly I asked for your coming though there was falsehood underneath—
or else stay here while I cut you a gallows!”

**37** Orð kvað hitt Hǫgni · —hugði lítt vęgja— [R TODO]
varr at vęttu=gi · es varð at ręyna:
„Hirð=a þú oss hręða, · haf þú þat framm sjaldan!
Ef þú ęykr orði · illt munt þér lęngja.“

A different word quoth Hawn—he thought little of withdrawing—
wary of nothing which he might come to find out:
“Do not try to frighten us; thou wilt seldom be successful!
If thou addest to thy word thy suffering will be prolonged!”

**38** Hrundu þęir Vinga · ok í hęl drǫpu, [R TODO]
øxar at lǫgðu · meðan í ǫnd hiksti.

They threw Wing and beat him into Hell,
laid their axes to him while he gasped for his breath.

**39** Flykkðu=sk þęir Atli · ok fóru í brynjur, [R TODO]
gengu svá gǫrvir · at vas garðr milli;
urpu=sk á orðum · allir sęnn ręiðir:
„Fyrr vǫrum full-ráða · at firra yðr lífi.“

Attle and his men arrayed themselves and got in their byrnies,
then went forth ready so that a courtyard stood between them.
They threw words at each other, all wrathful at once:
“We have long since fully decided to deprive you of life!”

---

ALL | Sts. 39–46 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 38.

2 milli ‘between them’ | I.e., between the two groups, Guther and Hawn on the one side and Attle's men on the other.

**40** „Á sér þat illa · ef hǫfðuð áðr ráðit; [R TODO]
ęnn eruð ǫ·búnir · ok hǫfum ęinn fęlldan,
lamðan til hęljar— · liðs vas sá yðars!“

"It seems ill if ye had decided that beforehand;
ye are still unprepared and we have felled one man,
beat him to Hell—he was one of yours!"

**41** Óðir þá urðu · es þat orð hęyrðu, [R TODO]
2 forðuðu fingrum · ok fengu í snøri,
skutu skarp=liga · ok skjǫldum hlífðu=sk.

Then they became mad when they heard that word,
twitched their fingers and seized their spears,
hurled them furiously and covered themselves with their shields.

**42** Inn kom þá ann·spilli · hvat úti drýgðu [R TODO]
2 hǫ́tt fyr hǫllu; · hęyrðu þrę́l sęgja.

Then the news came inside of what they were waging outside,
loudly through the hall; they heard a thrall speak.

**43** Ǫtul vas þá Guð·rún · es hǫn ękka hęyrði, [R TODO]
2 hlaðin hals-męnjum · hręytti hǫn þęim gǫrv-ǫllum,
sløngði svá silfri · at í sundr hrutu baugar.

Then Guthrun became terrible when she heard his crying;
laden with neckrings she shook them off one and all;
she threw the silver so that the bighs crashed asunder.

**44** Út gekk hǫn síðan, · ypði=t lítt hurðum, [R TODO]
2 fór=a fę́lt þęy=gi · ok fagnaði komnum;
hvarf til Niflunga, · sú vas hindst kvędja,
4 fylgði saðr s·líku, · sagði hǫn mun fłęira:

Then she went outside, did not open the doors slowly,
went forth, nowise timid, and heartily greeted the comers.
She turned to the Nivlings; that was their last meeting;
virtue followed that doing; she spoke more from her mind:

**45** „Łęitaða'k í líkna · at łętja ykkr hęiman, [R TODO]
2 skǫpum viðr mann=gi · ok skuluð þó hér komnir."
Mę́lti af man-viti · ef mundu sę́tta=sk,
4 ękki at réðu=sk, · allir ní kvǫ́ðu.

"I tried to look out for you by discouraging you from leaving home;
no man withstands the Shapes—and still ye had to come here!"

She asked with little man-wit if they might be reconciled;
they did not plan to do that; they all said no.

---

2 skǫpum viðr mann=gi ‘no man withstands the Shapes’ | I.e., ‘no man can beat fate.’ The same construction is found in *Grip* 53/1b.

3 af man-viti ‘with little man-wit’ | Lit. ‘against man-wit’, i.e., ‘with a girl’s naive sense’. The men can hardly reconcile with Attle when they have already slain one of his men, but it is somewhat discordant that Guthrun, who is otherwise shown as fairly world-wise, would be depicted in this manner.

**46** Sá þá sǫ́l-borin · at þǫ́ir sárt léku, [R TODO]
hugði á harð-rǫ́ði · ok hrauð=sk ór skikkju,
nøkkðan tók hǫ́n mǫ́ki · ok niðja fjǫr varði,
hóg vas at hjaldri · hvar’s hǫ́n hǫ́ndr fǫsti.

Then the woman of blessed birth saw that they sorely fought;
she thought of a harsh counsel and cast off her robe.
She took a naked sword and defended her kinsmen’s lives;
she was skilled in the fight where’er she turned her hands.

---

ALL | *Am* 46–48 has Guthrun throwing off her clothes, taking a sword, and fighting alongside her brothers. Nothing of the sort is found in the older *Akv* and it is clearly a later addition to the story, although it does show the high regard in which the Greenlanders held their women. A similar anecdote is found in the Saw of the Greenlanders (the famous episode of *Freyr-dís*, who bares her breasts in the fight against the natives. TODO: reference).

**47** Dóttir lét Gjúka · drǫngi tvá hníga, [R TODO]
bróður hjó hǫ́n Atla, · bera varð þann síðan,
skapði hǫ́n svá skǫ́ru, · skǫlldi fót undan.

The daughter of Yivick let two young warriors sink down.
She struck Attle’s brother; he had to be borne away thereafter;
thus did she handle that engagement: she severed his foot from under him.

---

2 bróður ... Atla ‘Attle’s brother’ | An unknown figure.

**48** Annan réð hǫ́n hǫggva · svá’t sá upp rǫ́is=at, [R TODO]
í hǫ́lju hǫ́n þann hafði; · þǫ́y=gi hǫ́nni hǫ́ndr skulfu.

She struck the other man so that he did not rise up;
she let that man go to Hell; yet nowise her hands trembled.

**49** Þjǫrku þar gjǫrðu, · þǫ́iri vas við brugðit; [R TODO]
þat brá umb allt annat · es unnu bǫrn Gjúka;
svá kvǫ́ðu Niflunga · meðan sjalfir lifðu

skapa sókn sverðum, · slíta=sk af brynjur,
hǫggva svá hjalma · sęm þęim hugr dygði.

They made war there; it was up and off;
it beat every other thing which the children of Yivick had accomplished.
So they said that the Nivlings while they themselves were alive
waged war with swords, tore off their byrnies,
struck so the helmets as did their hearts availed them.

**50** Morgin męst vǫgu · und's miðjan dag líddi, [R TODO]
óttu alla · ok ǫnd·urðan dag;
fyrr vas full-vegit, · flóði vǫllr blóði;
át-tján áðr fellu, · øfri þęir urðu,
Beru tvęim svęin*um* · ok bróð*ur* hęnnar.

They fought for most of the morning, until mid-day had passed,
through the whole dawn and early part of the day.
Before it was fully fought the plain flowed with blood;
eighteen had then fallen; they got the upper hand
over Bearer's two boys and her brother.

5 tvęim svęin*um* | *gramm. and sens. emend.;* 'ii. sveinar' *(nom. pl.)* **R**

ALL | Sts. 50–54 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 38.

5 Beru tvęim svęin*um* · ok bróð*ur* hęnnar 'over Bearer's two boys and her brother' | Costbearer's two sons were Snower and Solwer, and her brother Orkning; all three die, which sets up the situation seen in *Akv*, where only Hawn and Guther are sitll alive. The consistency of the narrative justifies replacing the nom. forms with dat.

**51** Rǫskr tók at róða · þó'tt hann rędiðr vęri: [R TODO]
„Illt 's umb líta=sk, · yðr 's þat kęnna;
vǫrum þrír tigir, · þegnar víg=ligir,
ędtir lifum ęllifu; · ór 's þar brunnit.

The bold man [= Attle] took to speak although he was wroth:
"It is evil to look around; this is your doing!
We were thirty thanes made ready for battle;
afterwards but eleven live; the rest have burned away."

2 umb líta=sk 'to look around' | And see the bloodied corpses lying on the ground.

4 ór 's þar brunnit 'the rest have burned away' | Lit., 'it has burned away there', an idiom. Their numbers have waned greatly.

**52** Bróðr vǫrum fimm · es Buðla misstum, [R TODO]
hęfir nú Hędl halfa · ędn hǫggnir tvęir liggja.

We were five brothers when we lost Budle;
now Hell has half of them when two lie cut down.

**53** Męgð gat'k mikla · —má'k=a'k því lęyna— [R TODO]
konu vá=liga, · kná'k=a'k þęss njóta;
hljótt ǫttum sjaldan, · síðst komt í hęndr ossar,
firrðan mik frękndum, · fé opt svikinn;
sęnduð systr Hęlju, · s·líks ek męst kęnn=umk."

I got strong in-laws—I can not deny that—
[but] a woeful wife; I do not enjoy that.
We seldom had peace since thou camest to our hands;
thou didst distance me from my kinsmen, oft betrayed me for wealth;
ye sent my sister to Hell—I suffer the most from that."

---

ALL | Attle addresses Guthrun.

1 gat'k 'I got' | From his marriage with Guthrun.

5 sęnduð systr Hęlju 'ye sent my sister to Hell' | Byrnhild, who committed suicide after the Yivickings Guther and Hawn slew Siward as told in *Sigsk*.

[Guð·rún kvað:] **54** „Getr þú þęss, Atli, · gørðir svá fyrri: [R TODO]
Móður tókt mína · ok myrðir til hnossa,
svinna systrungu · svęltir þú í hęlli;
hlǫg=ligt mér þat þikkir · es þú þínn harm tínir,
goðum ek þat þakka · es þér gęng=sk illa."

[Quoth Guthrun:] "Thou tellest, Attle, of what thou thyself didst yet earlier!
Thou didst take my mother and murder her for gold;
my wise cousins didst thou starve to death.
I find it laughable that thou speakest of thy griefs;
I thank the Gods when it goes ill for thee!"

---

2–3 Móður ... hęlli 'Thou didst take ... to death.' | The content is otherwise unknown.

[Atli kvað:] **55** „Eggja'k yðr, jarlar, · auka harm stóran [R TODO]
vífs ins veg=liga, · vilja'k þat líta;
kostið svá kęppa · at kløkkvi Guð·rún,
sjá ek þat mętta'k · at hǫn sér né ynði=t.

[Quoth Attle:] "I incite you, earls! Increase the great harm
for the glorious wife; I want to behold that.
Strive to fight so that Guthrun sobs,
so that I might see that she is unhappy.

---

ALL | Sts. 55–61 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 39.

1 jarlar ‘earls’ | Attle’s surviving companions.

**56** Takið ér Hǫgna · ok hyldið með knífi, [R TODO]
skerið ór hjarta, · skuluð þęss gǫrvir;
Gunn·ar grimm-úðgan · á galga fęstið,
bęllið því bragði, · bjóðið til ormum!“

Take ye Hawn and pry him open with a knife;
cut out his heart—ye shall be quick about it!
Guther the grim-hearted fasten on the gallows—
hasten to that deed!—offer him to the snakes!”

ALL | Sts. 56–64 deal with the deaths of Guther and Hawn, especially focusing on the death of the latter. The same episode is found in *Akv* 22–35.

1 hyldið ‘pry him open’ | Otherwise only used of cutting up animals, esp. whales. Finnur Jónsson (1932) is most likely right in seeing its use here as a Greenlandicism.

3–4 Gunn·ar ... ormum! ‘Guther ... snakes!’ | Fulfilling the prophecy of st. 21. In *Akv* Guther is thrown in a snake-pit, not hung on the gallows.

Hǫgni kvað: **57** „Gør sem til lystir! · Glaðr mun’k þęss bíða, [R TODO]
rǫskr mun þér rękna=sk, · rękynt hefi’k fyrr brattara;
hǫfðuð hnękking · meðan hęilir vórum,
nú erum svá sárir · at þú mátt sjalfr valda.“

Quoth Hawn: “Do as thou desirest! I will suffer it gladly;
I’ll be proven brave to thee; I have tempted harder things before.
Ye suffered a setback while we were still healthy;
now we are so wounded that thou thyself mayest decide.”

3 hnękking ‘a setback’ | Namely the loss of the eighteen retainers (st. 50).

**58** Bęiti þat mélti · —bryti vas hann Atla: [R TODO]
„Tǫkum vér Hjalla · ęn Hǫgna forðum!
Hǫgum vér halft-yrkjum, · hann es skap-dauði,
lifir=a svá lęngi, · lǫskr mun ę́ hęitinn.“

Bote spoke this—he was Attle’s overseer:
“Let us take Helle, but Hawn let us spare!
Let us handle the half-worker; he is shaped for death;
he will not live for so long that he will not be known as lazy.”

4 lǫskr mun ę́ hęitinn ‘that he will not be known as lazy’ | Lit., ‘he will always be known as lazy’.

**59** Hrę́ddr vas hvęr-gę́tir, · helt=a in lęngr rúmi, [R TODO]
kunni kløkkr verða, · klęif í rǫ́ hvęrja;
ve-sall lét=sk vígs þęira · es skyldi váss gjalda
ok sínn dag dapran · at dęyja frá svínum,
allri ør·kostu · es hann áðr hafði.

The kettle-keeper was afraid, could not run further into the room,
knew how to start sobbing, jumped into every nook;
said he was wretched for the feud of those who should repay *him* for his toil
and that his day was dismal if he should die away from his swine,
from all the great pleasure which he had previously had.

**60** Tóku þęir brás Buðla · ok brugðu til knífi, [R TODO]
ǫ́þði ill-þrę́li · áðr odds kęnndi;
tóm lét=sk=at ęiga, · tę́ðja vel garða,
vinna it vergasta · ef hann við rétti;
fęginn lét=sk þó Hjalli · at hann fjǫr þę́gi.

They took Budle's cookboy and brandished the knife,
the bad thrall screamed before he saw the point.
He said he would take no leisure, dung the fields well,
do the meanest work if he might but be let go;
Helle said he would rejoice if he might but keep his life.

---

1 brás 'cookboy' | A hapax, but apparently in ablaut with Swedish *brasa* 'fire', i.e., one who tends to the fire.

**61** Gę́tti=sk þess Hǫgni · —gørva svá fę́ri— [R TODO]
at árna á·nauðgum · at undan gengi:
„Fyrir kveð'k mér minna · at frę́mja lęik þęnna;
hví mynim hér vilja · hęyra á þá skrę́ktun?“

Hawn gave counsel—few men do so!—
to grant the enthralled man that he might get away.
"It would be easier, I say, for me to endure this game;
why should we here wish to listen to this screeching?"

**62** Þrifu þęir þjóð-góðan, · þá vas kostr ęngi [R TODO]
rekkum rakk-látum · ráð ęnn lęngr dvęlja;
hló þá Hǫgni, · hęyrðu dag-męgir,
kęppa hann svá kunni, · kvǫl hann vel þolði.

They seized the very good man; then there was no choice
for the stern-faced retainers to tarry with their orders.

Then Hawn laughed; the sons of daylight [WORKMEN] heard it;
so did he know how to struggle; he suffered well the torment.

**63** Hǫrpu tók Gunn·arr, · hrørði il-kvistum; [R TODO]
slá hann svá kunni · at snótir grétu;
klukku þęir karlar · es kunnu gørst hęyra;
ríkri rǫ́ð sagði, · raptar sundr brustu.

Guther took the harp, plucked it with his footsole-twigs [TOES],
struck as he knew so that the ladies wept;
the menfolk cried who heard it clearest;
he gave the powerful woman counsel; the rafters burst asunder.

ALL | The poet turns to Guther, who is on the gallows and at the same time being tortured by the wyrms. For the scene of Guther playing the harp with his toes, cf. the parallel description in *Akv* 35.

4 ríkri 'powerful woman' | Presumably Guthrun; cf. 65/2 below.

**64** Dóu þá dýrir, · dags vas hęldr snemma, [R TODO]
létu þęir á lęsti · lifa ï·þrótta.

Then the precious men died; the day was rather early;
to the very last they let their skills linger on.

**65** Stórr þótti=sk Atli, · sté hann of þá báða, [R TODO]
horskri harm sagði · ok réð hęldr at bręgða:
„Morginn 's nú, Guð·rún, · misst hęfir þér hollra,
sums est sjalf-skapa · at hafi svá gęngit."

Attle thought himself great; he stood over them both,
he told the wise woman a thing of harm and did harshly upbraid her:
"It is morning now, Guthrun; thou hast lost those true to thee;
it is partly thy own doing that things have gone so."

ALL | Sts. 65–77 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 40.

[Guð·rún kvað:] **66** „Fęginn est, Atli, · fęrr þú víg lýsa, [R TODO]
á munu þér iðrar · ef allt ręynir;
sú mun ęrfð ęptir · —ek kann þér sęgja:
ills gęng=sk þér aldri · nema ek ok dęyja."

[Quoth Guthrun:] "Thou art rejoicing, Attle; thou goest to announce the slayings;
thou wilt come to regret them if thou dost come to prove it all.
There will be an inheritance afterwards—*I* can tell thee:
evil will never part from thee unless I too die."

[Atli kvað:] **67** „Kann'k=a'k s·líks synja, · sé'k til ráð annat, [R TODO]
hǫlfu hóg=ligra · —hǫfnum opt góðu:
Man*i mun'k þik hugga, · mętum á·gętum,
silfri snę́-hvítu · sem sjǫlf vilir."

[Quoth Attle:] "I cannot deny such a thing; I see another counsel,
twice as fitting; we often abandon what is good.
I will comfort thee with a handmaid and with excellent treasures,
with snow-white silver, whate'er thou thyself desirest!"

3 Man*i | *metr. and sens. emend.;* manni **R**.

[Guð·rún kvað:] **68** „Ǫ́n es þęss ęngi, · ek vil því níta, [R TODO]
slęit'k þá sáttir · es vǫ́ru sakar minni;
af·kǫ́r ek áðr þǫ́tta'k, · á mun nú góða,
hréfða'k umb hot-vetna · meðan Hǫgni lifði.

[Quoth Guthrun:] "That will hardly be expected; I will refuse it.
I tore up reconciliations when the crimes were lesser;
I seemed violent before—I will now exceed it;
I put up with anything while Hawn was alive.

**69** Alin vit upp vǫ́rum · í ęinu húsi, [R TODO]
lékum lęik margan · ok í lundi óxum,
góddi okkr Grím·hildr · golli ok hals-męnjum.
Bana munt mér bróðra · bóta aldri=gi
né vinna þęss ękki · at mér vel þikki.

We two were reared up in one house;
we played many a game and waxed in the glade;
Grimhild endowed us with gold and neckrings.
For the slaying of my brothers wilt thou never restore me,
nor accomplish anything that might seem good to me.

1 vit 'we two' | Guthrun and Hawn.

**70** Kostum drepr kvenna · karla of·ríki, [R TODO]
í kné gęngr hnefi · ef kvistir þverra,
tré tękr at hníga · ef hǫggr tág undan;
nú mátt ęinn, Atli, · ǫllu hér ráða."

The choices of women are beat down by the tyranny of men.
The fist gets on its knees if the branches thin out;
the tree begins to lean if one cuts away its roots from underneath it;
now mayest thou alone, Attle, rule everything here."

2 ǐ kné gęngr hnefi · ef kvistir þverra ‘The fist gets on its knees if the branches thin out’ | Pettit (2023) sees this as a reference to the game Neve-Table (*Hnefa-tafl*), where the *hnefi* ‘fist’ is the name of the King, surrounded by his soldiers (Pawns or Rooks) on all sides, which seem to resemble branches. For board games see *Vsp* 8/1 n.

**71** Gnótt vas grunn-ýðgi · es gramr því trúði, [R TODO]
sýn vas sveip-vísi · ef hann sín gętði.
Krǫpp vas þá Guð·rún, · kunni umb hug mę́la,
lętt hǫn sér gørði, · lék hǫn tvęim skjǫldum.

There was gullibility enough when the chief believed that;
the deceit was apparent if he would have watched out for himself.
Then Guthrun was hard; she could speak with care;
she made herself out to be light; she played with two shields.

**72** Øxti hǫn ǫl-drykkjur · at ęrfa bróðr sína, [R TODO]
samr lét=sk ok Atli · at sína gørva.

She made the ale-vessels grow to drink the wake of her brothers;
Attle, too, did the same for his own.

**73** Lokit því létu, · lagat vas drykkju; [R TODO]
sú vas sam-kunda · við svǫrfun of·mikla;
strǫng vas stór-huguð, · stríddi hǫn ętt Buðla,
vildi hǫn ver sínum · ofr·hęfndir.

They closed the matter; the drink was brewed;
that was an assembly with too great destruction.
Cruel was the great-minded woman; she injured the lineage of Budle;
against her husband she wished to wreak great revenge.

4 vildi hǫn ver sínum · ofr·hęfndir | Alliteration between *v-* and vowels is by no means unheard of in Norse poetry, but it varies greatly between genres; in Scaldic poetry, for instance, it was always entirely forbidden. The fact that the off-verse is only three syllables long further hints at corruption.

**74** Lokkaði hǫn litla · ok lagði við stokki; [R TODO]
glúpnuðu grimmir · ok grétu þęy=gi,
fóru ǐ faðm móður, · fréttu hvat þá skyldi.

She called on her little ones and laid them against a stump;
the grim ones were downcast and yet nowise cried;
they jumped to their mother’s bosom, asked what would happen.

ALL | Guthrun kills her own children, Earp and Oatle. The killing is not described directly in *Akv* but is alluded to in *Akv* 37 and mentioned in 40–41.

[Guð·rún kvað:] **75** „Spyrið lítt ęptir! · Spilla ętla'k bǫ́ðum, [R TODO]
2 lyst vǫr=umk þęss lęngi · at lyfja ykkr ęlli.“
[Bǫrn'in:] „Blótt sęm vilt bǫrnum, · bannar þat mann=gi,
4 skǫmm mun ró rętiði · ef þú ręynir gǫrva.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] "Ask no more what is coming! I intend to slay you both,
I have long had lust to deprive you of old age."
[The children:] "Bloot thy children if thou wilt; no man forbids thee;
the respite of thy wrath will be short if thou dost truly try it."

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3 Blótt 'Bloot' | I.e., 'sacrifice'.

**76** Brá þá barn-ǿsku · bróðra in kapp-svinna, [R TODO]
2 skipti=sk skap=liga, · skar hǫn á háls báða.
Ęnn frétti Atli · hvęrt farnir vętri
4 svęinar hans lęika · es hann sá þá hvęr=gi.

Then childhood was cut short for the battle-wise brothers,
it was overturned according to Shapes—she slit the throats of them both.
Soon Attle asked whither they had gone,
his swains in their play, when he nowhere saw them.

**77** „Yfir rǫ́ð=umk ganga, · Atla til sęgja, [R TODO]
2 dylja mun'k þik ętigi, · dóttir Grím·hildar;
glaða mun þik minnst, Atli, · ef þú gǫrva ręynir;
4 vakðir vǫ́ mikla · es þú vátt bróðr mína.

"I decide to come over to tell thee, Attle;
I, the daughter of Grimhild, will not hide it from thee.
It will gladden thee the least if thou dost truly find it out;
thou didst awaken great woe when thou slewest my brothers.

**78** Svaf'k mjǫk sjaldan, · síðan's þęir fellu, [R TODO]
2 hét'k þér hǫrðu, · hęfi'k þik nú minntan;
morgin mér sagðir, · man'k ęnn þann gǫrva,
4 nú 's ok aptann, · átt s·líkt at frétta.

I slept very seldom since they fell;
I vowed harsh things towards thee; I have now reminded thee.

This morning thou spokest to me; I still remember it clearly.
Now it is the evening; thou hast to learn such things:

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3 morgin ‘This morning’ | Cf. st. 65.

**79** Maga hęfir þǐnna · misst sęm síðst skyldir; [R TODO]
hausa vęitst þęira · hafða at ǫl-skǫlum,
drýgða’k þér svá drykkju— · dręyra blett’k þęira.

Thou hast lost thy lads as thou least shouldst have.
I know their skulls have been made into ale-bowls;
thus I enriched thy drink: I mixed it with their blood.

---

ALL | In sts. 79–81 Guthrun recounts how she fed Attle the corpses of their children. Cf. the description of the same events in *Akv* 40–41; the strong verbal agreement suggests a direct line of influence. Sts. 79–80 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 40.

**80** Tók’k þęira hjǫrtu · ok á tęini stęikta’k, [R TODO]
sęlda’k þér síðan, · sagða’k at kalfs vęri;
ęinn þú því ollir · ękki rétt lęifa,
tǫggt tíð=liga, · trúðir vel jǫxlum.

I took their hearts and roasted them on a stick,
then I handed them to thee; I said they were a calf’s.
Thou alone didst do that; thou decidedst to leave nothing,
didst chew greedily; thou trustedst thy molars well!

**81** Barna vęitst þǐnna · —biðr sér fár verra— [R TODO]
hlut veld’k mǐnum, · hęl=umk þó ękki.“

Thou knowest of thy children; few would ask for worse;
I bear fault for my part, still I do not boast of it.”

**82** „Grimm vast, Guð·rún, · es þú gøra svá máttir, [R TODO]
barna þǐnna blóði · at blanda mér drykkju;
snýtt hęfir sifjungum · sęm síðst skyldir,
mér lętr þú ok sjǫlfum · millum ills lítit.“

“Thou wast cruel, Guthrun, when thou couldst do so,
to blend thy own children’s blood into my drink.
Thou hast destroyed thy own relations as thou least shouldst have;
thou leavest for me little [time] between evil.”

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ALL | Sts. 82–100 are paraphrased in *Vǫls* 40.

4 millum ills lítit ‘little [time] between evil’ | Referring to Guthrun’s recent killing of Attle’s brother (sts. 47–48).

[Guð·rún kvað:] **83** „Vili mér ęnn vęri · at vega þik sjalfan, [R TODO]
fátt ’s full-illa · farit við gram s·líkan.“
[Atli kvað:] „Drýgt þú fyrr hafðir · þat’s męnn dœmi vissu=t,
til hęimsku, harð-ręðis, · í hęimi þessum;
nú hęfir þú ęnn aukit · þat’s nú áðan frógum,
gręipt gløp stóran, · gørt hęfir þú þitt ęrfi.

[Quoth Guthrun:] “Would that I still had willpower to slay thy very self;
nothing is evil enough when done against such a prince!”
[Quoth Attle:] “Thou hast already done that of which men knew no precedent
in foolishness and harsh counsel in this Home.
Now hast thou added even more to what we’d already learned;
thou didst accomplish a great disgrace; thou hast had thy wake!

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4 í hęimi þessum ‘in this Home’ | I.e., in the world of the living.

**84** Brennd munt á báli · ok barið grjóti áðr, [R TODO]
þá hęfir þú árnat · þat’s ę̨ þęiði=sk.“
[Guð·rún kvað:] „Sęg þér s·líkar · sorgir ár morgin,
fríðra vil’k dauða, · fara í ljós annat.“

Thou wilt be burned on a pyre and crushed with stones beforehand;
then hast thou earned what thou hast always begged for!”
[Quoth Guthrun:] “Tell thyself such sorrows early in the morning;
by a fairer death I wish to pass into the other light.”

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1 Brennd munt á báli · ok barið grjóti áðr ‘Thou wilt be burned on a pyre and crushed with stones beforehand’ | A Christian, mediaeval punishment. That being burned on a pyre is seen as a punishment and associated with stoning reveals a mediaeval Catholic sensibility horrified at the thought of burning a body rather than burying it. In pagan times, however, burning was a neutral way of disposing of a body and had no negative associations (so e.g. *Háv* 71/3, 81/1); cf. Males (2024b, pp. 93–96).

4 ljós annat ‘the other light’ | The next world; the world as ‘light’ is more commonly found in West Germanic heroic poetry.

**85** Sǫ́tu sam-týnis, · sęndu=sk fár-hugi, [R TODO]
hęndu=sk hęipt-yrði, · hvárt=ki sér unði.
Hęipt óx Hniflungi, · hugði á stór-ręði,
gat fyr Guð·rúnu · at hann vęri grimmr Atla.

They sat in the same court, gave each other evil thoughts,
handed each other hateful words; neither was content.

Hatred grew in Nivling; he thought of a great counsel;
mentioned to Guthrun that he was wroth against Attle.

3 Hniflungi ‘Nivling’ | *Hniflungr*, the son of Hawn, who is apparently present at Attle’s court.

**86** Kvǫ́mu ǐ hug hęnni · Hǫgna við·farar, [R TODO]
2 talði happ hǫ́num · ef hęfnt ynni;
veginn vas þá Atli, · vas þęss skammt bíða,
4 sonr vá Hǫgna · ok sjǫlf Guð·rún.

Into her mind came the torments of Hawn;
she counted it lucky for him if he might accomplish the revenge.
Then Attle was slain; there was little wait for it;
Hawn’s son struck him, and Guthrun herself.

**87** Rǫskr tók at róða, · rakði=sk ór svefni, [R TODO]
2 kęnndi brátt bęnja, · bands kvað þǫrf ønga:
„Sęgið it sannasta: · Hvęrr vá son Buðla?
4 Em’k=a’k lítt lęikinn, · lífs tęl’k vǫn ønga.“

The bold man took to speak, roused from his sleep,
shortly felt his wounds, said dressings were of no use:
“Tell the whole truth! Who struck Budle’s son?
I am not a little injured; I count no hopes for my life.”

[Guð·rún kvað:] **88** „Dylja mun þik ęigi · dóttir Grím·hildar: [R TODO]
2 Lǫt=umk því valda · es líðr þína ęvi
ęn sumu sonr Hǫgna · es þik sǫ́r móða.“

[Quoth Guthrun:] “The daughter of Grimhild will not hide it from thee.
I let myself be the cause for why thy age comes to its end,
but some part the son of Hawn [plays] when the wounds do pain thee.”

[Atli kvað:] **89** „Vaðit hęfir þú at vígi · þó’tt vę́ri=t skap=ligt; [R TODO]
2 illt ’s vin véla, · þann’s þér vel trúir;
bęiddr fór’k hęiman · at biðja þín, Guð·rún.

[Quoth Attle:] “Thou hast waded forth in killings, although it was not shapely.
It’s ill to betray a friend who trusts thee well;
urged-on, I journeyed from home to ask for thee, O Guthrun.

3 bęiddr ‘urged-on’ | Attle reminds Guthrun that it was not his choice to marry her.

**90** Lęyfð vast-u, ękkja, · létu stór-ráða, [R TODO]

varð=a vǫ́n lygi · es vér of rœyndum;
fórt-u hœim hingat, · fylgði oss hœrr manna,
allt vas ítar=ligt · umb órar fœrðir.

Thou wast praised, O widow; they said thou hadst great plans;
that expectation was no lie as we have found out.
Thou journeyedst hither from home; we were followed by a host of men;
everything was splendid about our journeys.

**91** Margs vas alls sómi, · manna tíginna, [R TODO]
naut vǫ́ru órin, · nutum af stórum;
þar vas fjǫlð féar, · fengu til margir.

There was much honour in everything for the distinguished men;
the kine were ample, we enjoyed them greatly;
there was a multitude of wealth; many received it.

**92** Mund galt ek mǽrri, · mœiðma fjǫlð þiggja, [R TODO]
þrǽla þrjá-tøgu, · þýjar sjau góðar;
sømð vas at s·líku, · silfr vas þó mœira.

I paid the bride-price for the famed woman who took a multitude of treasures:
thirty thralls, seven good handmaids—
there was honour in all such things—there was even more silver.

**93** Létst þér allt þikkja · sœm ękki vǽri [R TODO]
meðan lǫnd þau lǫ́gu · es mér lœifði Buðli;
gróft svá undir, · gørði=t hlut þiggja.
Svǽru létst þína · sitja opt grátna,
fann'k=a'k í hug hœilum · hjóna vǽtr síðan.“

Thou saidst it all seemed to thee as if it were nothing
as long the lands which Budle left me lay [unused];
thou didst undermine [them]; one did not receive a part.
Often, thou lettest thy mother-in-law sit weeping;
I never found our household in good heart thereafter.”

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2–3 meðan ... þiggja ‘as long ... a part.’ | Difficult. L. 2 seems to say that Guthrun was a nagging wife and chastised Attle for not working harder (namely for not cultivating all his fields—the very suggestion reveals the poverty of the Greenlandish poet, for whom Attle can be little more than a wealthy farmer). L. 3 is more difficult.

[Guðrún kvað:] **94** „Lýgr þú nú, Atli, · þó'tt ek þat lítt rękja; [R TODO]
hœldr vas'k hóg sjaldan · hóft=sk þó stórum;

bǫrðuð=sk ér bróðr ungir, · bǫ́ruð=sk róg milli.
Halft gekk til hęljar · ór húsi þ̌ínu;
hroldi hot-vetna · þat's til hags skyldi.

[Quoth Guthrun:] "Thou liest now, Attle—though I care little about it;
rather, I was seldom docile, yet thou didst elevate thyself haughtily.
Ye young brothers fought each other, carried strife between yourselves.
Half of thy household went to Hell;
everything faltered which should have been a boon.

**95** Þrjú vǫ́rum systkin, · þóttum ǫ·vęgin, [R TODO]
fórum af landi, · fylgðum Sig·*vę*rði;
skę́va vér létum, · skipi hvęrt várt stýrði,
ǫrkuðum at auðnu · und's vér austr kvǫ́mum.

We were three siblings; we seemed undefeatable;
we went away from the land; we followed Siward.
We let ourselves speed forth; we each steered a ship;
we went forth according to luck until we came to the east.

2 Sig·*vę*rði | *metr. emend.;* Sigurði **R**

ALL | In sts. 95–98, Guthrun compares the bravery and martial strength of her brothers Hawn and Guther and her husband Siward to the cowardice and indecision of Attle.

4 ǫrkuðum at auðnu 'we went forth according to luck' | Proverbial; the verb *arka* is only found in this expression which appears twice in prose (see ONP) and nowhere else in poetry.

**96** Konung drǫ́pum fyrstan, · kurum land þaðra, [R TODO]
hęrsar oss á hǫnd gengu, · hrę́ðslu þat vissi;
vǫ́gum ór skógi · þann's vildum syknan,
sęttum þann sę́lan · es sér né átti=t.

We first slew a king; we chose the lands there;
the chieftains yielded to us; that showed fear.
Out of the forest we brought him who we would see redeemed;
we set down blessedly him who owned naught for himself.

3–4 vǫ́gum ... átti=t. 'Out of the ... for himself.' | Siward, who was an orphaned outlaw before he met the Yivickings.

**97** Dauðr varð inn húnski, · drap þá brátt kosti, [R TODO]
strangt vas angr ungri · ękkju nafn hljóta;
kvǫl þótti kvikri · at koma í́ hús Atla;
átti áðr kappi, · illr vas sá missir.

The Hunnish man [= Siward] died; then I was soon without choice;
it was a cruel sorrow for a young woman to take a widow's name.
It seemed a torture for her in life to come to the house of Attle;
she had had a champion before—ill was that loss.

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1 inn hunski 'The Hunnish man [= Siward]' | Cf. *Sigsk* 4/4 for this appellation.

**98** Komt=a þú því þingi · es vér þat frégim [R TODO]
at sǫk sóttir · né slękkðir aðra;
vildir á·vallt végja · ęn vętt=ki halda,
kyrrt of því láta." · ...

Thou didst not come back from the Thing, as we have learnt,
after thou hadst pursued one charge or quashed another.
Thou wantedst always to yield—but nowise to hold fast—
[and] to let quiet about it." ...

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4 ... | *A blank space is left for this half-line in* **R**.

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ALL | Guthrun attacks Attle for not pursuing his legal charges at the Thing in a decisive manner. Of course, this makes little sense in a historical context (since Attle was the king of the Huns, not one chieftain amongst many), but yet the more in a Greenlandish one.

[Atli kvað:] **99** „Lýgr þú nú, Guð·rún, · lítt mun við bøta=sk [R TODO]
hluti hvár·igra, · hǫfum ǫll skarðan;
gør þú nú, Guð·rún, · af gøtsku þínni
okkr til á·gętis · es mik út hefja."

[Quoth Attle:] "Thou liest now, Guthrun! Little remedy will be found
for the lot of either of us; we have both been bereaved!
Act now, O Guthrun, out of thy goodness,
to the honour of us both when they carry me out."

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ALL | Attle makes his final speech, requesting Guthrun to honour him after his death.

[Guð·rún kvað:] **100** „Knǫrr mun'k kaupa · ok kistu stęinda, [R TODO]
vęxa vel bléju · at vęrja þitt líki,
hyggja á þǫrf hvęrja · sęm vit holl vérim."

[Quoth Guthrun:] "I will buy a cargo-ship and a painted coffin,
weave the coverlet large to protect thy corpse,
think of every necessity, like if we had been true to each other."

**101** Nár varð þá Atli, · niðjum stríð óxti, [R TODO]

ęfndi ítr-borin · allt þat's réð hęita;
fróð vildi Guð·rún · fara sér at spilla,
urðu dvǫl dǿgra, · dó hǫn ǐ sinn annat.

Then Attle became a corpse; grief swelled for his kinsmen;
the noble-born woman carried out all that she had vowed.
Wise, Guthrun wished to go to destroy herself;
there was a delay in her days; she died another time.

---

4 urðu dvǫl dǿgra 'there was a delay in her days' | Namely, when she was carried by the waves to King Enacker, as told in *Ghv* P1.

**102** Sęll 's hvęrr síðan · es s·líkt getr fǿða [R TODO]
jóð at afr·eki · sęm's ól Gjúki;
lifa mun þat ęptir · á landi hvęrju,
þęira þrǫ́-mę́li · hvar=gi's þjóð hęyrir.

Blessed is whoever thenceforth gets to raise
such children to heroism as those Yivick begot.
It will afterwards live upon every land:
their troubled tale, where'er folk may hear it.

# Instigation of Guthrun
# *(Guð·rúnar hvǫt)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): early C11th (0.781)–late C11th (0.177)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Instigation of Guthrun** (*Ghv*) is the penultimate poem of **R**. In terms of narrative chronology, it is one of the two final poems in the Walsing-cycle (alongside *Hamð*).

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Ghv* is only found in **R**, on fol. 44r/13–44v/27, where it follows *Am* and is followed by *Hamð*. The poem is complete.

### Story

As its name spells out, *Ghv* deals with Guthrun's instigation of her two sons Sarle and Hamthew to avenge their sister Swanhild, killed by the cruel tyrant Ermenric. After the sons depart on their inevitably fatal course, Guthrun laments her cruel fate before addressing her long-dead first husband and true love, Siward. She constructs a great funeral pyre in order to join him, it is implied, by self-immolation.

A variant of Guthrun's instigation and the eager response of her sons (*Ghv* 2–8), but not her following monologue, is also found in *Hamð* 3–10. These sections share so much in common, including numerous identical or near-identical lines (*Ghv* 2/3a, 4b–6 = *Hamð* 3/2–4, *Ghv* 4/1–3 = *Hamð* 6/1–3, *Ghv* 4/4 = *Hamð* 7/1, *Ghv* 4/5a ~= *Hamð* 7/2b), that they must be related. It is however clear from the variant forms that this relation is through the oral tradition (cf. e.g. *Ghv* 4/3 and *Hamð* 6/3, which are near-identical, but where the former appears to be an unmetrical corruption of a line originally resembling the latter; in a scribal context such corruption could never hap-

pen). Since both poems are related through oral tradition, this of course means that neither poem can be a scribal composition.

### Historical basis

Because both *Ghv* and the immediately following *Hamð* deal with the same events it is best to discuss their historical basis in a single section.

It is a remarkable thing that the narrative described in these two poems is surprisingly close to historical fact, or at least what we know as such. In Jordanes' *Getica* 129 we read the following:

> *Nam Hermanaricus, rex Gothorum, licet, ut superius retulimus, multarum gentium extiterat triumphator, de Hunnorum tamen adventu dum cogitat, Rosomonorum gens infida, quae tunc inter alias illi famulatum exhibebat, tali eum nanciscitur occasione decipere. Dum enim quandam mulierem Sunilda nomine ex gente memorata pro mariti fraudulento discessu rex furore commotus equis ferocibus inligatam incitatisque cursibus per diversa divelli praecipisset, fratres eius Sarus et Ammius, germanae obitum vindicantes, Hermanarici latus ferro petierunt; quo vulnere saucius egram vitam corporis inbecillitate contraxit.*
>
> 'Now although Hermanaric, king of the Goths, was the conqueror of many tribes, as we have said above, yet while he was deliberating on this invasion of the Huns, the treacherous tribe of the Rosomoni, who at that time were among those who owed him their homage, took this chance to catch him unawares. For when the king had given orders that a certain woman of the tribe I have mentioned, Sunilda by name, should be bound to wild horses and torn apart by driving them at full speed in opposite directions (for he was roused to fury by her husband's treachery to him), her brothers Sarus and Ammius came to avenge their sister's death and plunged a sword into Hermanaric's side. Enfeebled by this blow, he dragged out a miserable existence in bodily weakness.' (Jordanes 1915, p. 87)

It is known that Ermenric died in 375 AD and that Jordanes was working ca. 550 AD. So it is that in two poems composed at least 450 years (probably closer to 550) after Ermenric's death, preserved in a manuscript written 900 years after his death, we find the very same events retold—the torture-murder of Swanhild with horses, the execution of her lover, the revenge of her two brothers Sarle and Hamthew, their maiming of the king—events retold not on the basis of historical learning, but rather through an independent oral tradition.

### Prose parallels

*Ghv* is paraphrased in *Vǫls* 43, which, as usual with that text, appears (cf. st. 5/3a) to have relied on a ms. related to **R**, though not identical with or descended from it.

For other Norse attestations of the journey of Hamthew and Sarle and their revenge on Ermenric see the Introduction to *Hamð*.

## Style and word-choices

The poem is rather sparse with kennings and the few that do occur (6/2b, 8/2a, 14/3b; 20/1b should not be taken as an actual kenning) are conventional.

Many sts. are very touching, particularly 13, 15–16, and 19.

A few rare or marked words occur: *tá* in 9/2b, *hùnn* in 12/1a, *þjóð-konungr* in 14/2b.

## Meter

The meter is Ancient-words-lay.

The length of the stanza is variable and not limited to 4 lines.

The number of non-alliterating ll. in **R** is high, and includes 5/1, 5/3, 13/2, 14/4, 18/1 and 20/4. Of these 5/3 can be restored on the basis of *Vǫls*, but the rest are irrestorably defective. All remaining non-alliterating ll. except for 13/2 have some accompanying signs of corruption along with the lack of alliteration. 5/1 and 20/4 are too short and appear to have lost an alliterating word in transmission, as certainly happened in 5/3. 14/4 and 18/1 are isolated half-lines. Thus, only 13/2 is a rhythmically perfect line without alliteration.

## Text

### Frá Guð·rúnu ('From Guthrun')

**P1** Guð·rún gekk þá til sęvar er hón hafði drepit Atla, gekk út á sę'inn ok vildi fara sér. Hón mátti eigi søkkva. Rak hana yfir fjǫrð'inn á land Jón·akrs konungs; hann fekk hennar. Þeira synir vóru þeir Sǫrli ok Erpr ok Ham·ðir. Þar föddi=sk upp Svan·hildr Sig·urðar dóttir. Hón var gipt Jǫrmun·rekk inum ríkja. Með hánum var Bikki. Hann réð þat at Rand·vér konungs son skyldi taka hana; þat sagði Bikki konungi. Konungr lét hengja Rand·vé en troða Svan·hildi undir hrossa fótum. En er þat spurði Guð·rún þá kvaddi hón sonu sína. [R 44r/13–20]

GUTHRUN THEN WENT TO THE SEA after she had slain Attle; she went out into the sea and would end herself. She could not sink. She was driven across the firth to the land of king Enacker; he took her to wife. Their sons were Sarle and Earp and Hamthew. There was reared Swanhild, Siward's daughter; she was married off to Ermenric the powerful. With him was Beck. He counseled that Randwigh, the king's son, should sleep with her; this Beck told the king. The king let Randwigh be hanged, but Swanhild he let be trampled beneath the hooves of horses. But when Guthrun learned of that she called out to her sons.

1 Guð·rún | *The* G *is an ornamented capital 2 lines high in* **R**.

4 Erpr 'Earp' | Actually, the prose is mistaken here. Earp was Enacker's son from a previous marriage and not the son of Guthrun (*Hamð* 12–14).

### Guð·rúnar hvǫt ('The Instigation of Guthrun')

**1** Þá frá'k sęnnu · slíðr-fęng=ligasta,
trauð mǫl tališ · af trega stórum,
es harð-huguð · hvatti at vígi
grimmum orðum · Guð·rún sonu:

I HAVE LEARNT THAT EXCHANGE brought the direst results—
the gravely pressed speeches told from great grief—
when hard-hearted she goaded her sons,
with fierce words, Guthrun, to killing:

1 Þá | *The* Þ *is an ornamented initial 3 lines high, with the left vertical stroke ascending 3 lines and descending 2 lines in the margin in* **R**.

1 frá'k 'I have learnt' | A formulaic opening. The narrator expresses that he is not a direct witness to the events of the poem by means of the formulaic verb *fregna* (< PGmc. **frehnaną* '(come to) learn, find out through hearsay'). This formula has identical parallels elsewhere in ON and WGmc. poetry; cf. *Yt* 8/1, 15/5, 16/1, *Beow* 74, 575, 1026 etc., *Heli* 288, 367, 510, etc., and esp. *Wessobrunn* 1/1, where the syntax (note the bracketing of the finite verb between the article and the noun it modifies) is identical to the present line: *Dat ga·fregin ih mit firahim · firi-wizzó męista* 'I have learnt among men that greatest of wonders'. The ancestral expression may be reconstructed in PGmc. as follows: **þa*-ACC-SG *ga·frah ek* ... NOUN-ACC-SG 'I have learnt (of) that NOUN'. — For related formulaic openings involving the verb **hauzijaną* 'hear' cf. *Oddr* 1/1, *Hild* 1.

**2** „Hví sitið *it*? · Hví sofið lífi?
Hví tregr=at ykkr · tęiti at męla,
es Jǫrmun·rekr · yðra systur,
unga at aldri, · jóm of traddi,
hvítum ok svǫrtum · á hęr-vegi
grǫum, gang-tǫmum · Gotna hrossum?

"Why do ye two sit? Why sleep ye your lives away?
Why does it not trouble you to speak merrily
when Ermenric has had your sister
young of age trampled by steeds,
by the white and black on the path of war,
by the grey, pacing, Gotnish horses?

1 *it* | *metr. emend.; om. by haplography (*'fitit it' > 'fitit'*)* **R**

3–6 es ... hrossum. 'when ... horses?' | Repeated almost identically in *Hamð* 3.

4 of traddi 'has had ... trampled' | Lit. 'made to be trampled', 3sg past ind. of *(of) trędja* 'make to be trampled', causative of *troða* 'trample, tread (upon)'.

**3** Urðu=a it g·líkir · þęim Gunn·ari
né in hęldr hugðir · sęm vas Hǫgni;
hęnnar mynduð it · hęfna lęita
ef it móð ęttið · mínna bróðra
eða harðan hug · hún-konunga."

Ye have not turned out alike to Guther
nor instead thoughtful like Hawn was.
*Her* would ye have sought to avenge
if ye had the courage of my brothers
or the hard heart of the Hunnish kings!"

**4** Þá kvað þat Ham·ðir · inn hugum stóri:
„Lítt myndir þú · lęyfa dǫð Hǫgna
þá's Sig·*vǫ*rð vǫkðu · svefni ór;

bókr vǫ́ru þínar, · inar blá-hvítu,
roðnar í vers drǫyra, · folgnar í val-blóði.

Then this quoth Hamthew the great of heart:
"Thou hadst little cause to praise Hawn's deeds
when they woke Siward from his sleep.
Thy blue-white bed-clothes were
reddened in thy husband's gore, buried in death-blood.

3 Sig·*vǫrð* | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urð **R**

ALL | Ll. 1–5a in this st. closely correspond to *Hamð* 6/1–3, 7/1–2.

3 þá's Sig·*vǫrð* vǫkðu · svefni ór | This l. is metrically defective in the present poem but survives better as *Hamð* 6/3.

**5** Urðu þér [...] · bróðra hęfndir
slíðrar ok sárar · es þú sonu myrðir;
knéttim *allir* · Jǫrmun·rekki,
sam-hyggjendr, · systur hęfna.

For thee thy [...] deeds of revenge for thy brothers became
biting and sore when thou murderedst thy sons.
We shall all with a single mind
avenge our sister on Ermenric.

3 *allir* | *om.* **R**

3 allir 'all' | The restoration of this word is secured by its occurrence in the paraphrase of this st. in *Vǫls* 43: *ok betr méttim vér allir saman drepa Jǫrmun·rek konung* 'and it would be better if we all together might kill king Ermenric.' This implies that the version of the poem before the redactor of *Vǫls* was in some ways better preserved than that surviving in **R**.

**6** Berið hnossir framm · hún-konunga,
hęfir þú okkr hvatta · at hjǫr-þingi."

Bring forth the treasures of the Hunnish kings!
Thou hast incited us to the thing of swords [BATTLE]."

**7** Hlę́jandi Guð·rún · hvarf til skęmmu,
kumbl konunga · ór kęrum valði,
síðar brynjur · ok sonum fǿrði;
hlóðu=sk móðgir · á mara bógu.

Laughing, Guthrun turned to her chamber.
The heirlooms of kings from the chests she picked,
the trailing byrnies, and brought them to her sons.
Fierce, they loaded themselves onto the backs of steeds.

**8** Þá kvað þat Ham·ðir · inn hugum stóri:
„Svá kom=a'*k* męirr aptr · móður at vitja
gęir-Njǫrðr hniginn · á Goð-þjóðu
at þú ęrfi · at ǫll oss drykkir,
at Svan·hildi · ok sonu þína."

Then this quoth Hamthew the great of heart:
"So will I no more come back to visit my mother,
[when I am] a spear-Nearth [WARRIOR] fallen in the land of the Gots,
after thou hast drunk a wake for us all,
for Swanhild and for thy sons."

2 kom=a'*k* | 'comaz' **R**

**9** Guð·rún grátandi, · Gjúka dóttir,
gekk treg=liga · á tái sitja
ok at tęlja, · tǫrug-hlýra,
móðug spjǫll · á margan veg:

Guthrun, weeping, Yivick's daughter,
went in grief to sit on the ground,
and to tell with teary cheeks
her moving tale in many ways:

ALL | The two boys depart (cf. *Hamð*), and Guthrun's long monologue begins, lasting from sts. 10 to 20.

**10** „Þrjá vissa'k ęlda, · þrjá vissa'k arna,
vas'k þrimr verum · vegin at húsi;
ęinn vas mér Sig·*vǫ*rðr · ǫllum bętri
es bróðr mínir · at bana urðu.

"I have known three fires; I have known three hearths;
for three husbands I have been brought to the house.
To me Siward alone was better than all—
he whose bane my brothers became.

3 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

**11** Svárra sára · sá'k=at, né kunn*a*
[...]
męirr þóttu=sk · mér of stríða
es mik ǫðlingar · Atla gǫfu.

Heavy griefs I neither saw nor knew,
[...];
moreover I thought it injurious to me
when the athlings gave me to Attle.

---

1 Svárra sára · sá'k=at, né kunn*a* 'Heavy griefs I neither saw nor knew' | Before the killing of Siward. Guthrun thus presents her life as idyllic before her brothers killed her lover.

2 [...] | No gap is indicated in **R**, but it seems inevitable that a line has fallen out here containing something to the effect of "before my brothers murdered Siward".

3 męirr 'moreover' | Namely after the killing of Siward, when she was married off to Attle against her will.

**12**

Hùna hvassa · hét'k mér at rùnum;
mátti'g=a'k bǫlva · bótr of vinna
áðr ek hnóf hǫfuð · af *H*niflungum.

The smart bear-cubs I called to me for counsel;
I could not find remedies for the bales
before I severed the heads from the Nivlings.

---

3 *H*niflungum | *metr. emend. (cf.* 1 HHund *48/5);* Niflungum **R**

---

ALL | Guthrun alludes to her murder of her children with Attle, as dealt with in *Akv* 37–42 and *Am* 73–81. Cf. *Hamð* 8.

1 Hùna hvassa 'The smart bear-cubs' | Her sons with Attle; for the appellation cf. *Vkv* 24/1.

**13**

Gekk ek til strandar, · grǫm vas'k nornum,
vilda'k hrinda · stríð grið þęira;
hófu mik, né drękkðu, · hǫvar bǫ́rur,
því land of sté'k · at lifa skylda'k.

I went to the shore; I was wroth with the norns;
I wished to break their stubborn peace.
I was lifted—not drowned—by the billows high,
so I stepped aland since I was meant to live.

---

ALL | Guthrun attempted to take her own life, but was instead driven to the realm of king Enacker, who married her. See P1 above.

3 hófu mik, né drękkðu, · hǫvar bǫ́rur 'I was lifted—not drowned—by the billows high' | Clearly related to the prophecy of this event in *Sigsk* 62/3, with which the b-verse is identical.

**14**

Gekk ek à bęð · —hugða'k mér fyr bętra—
þriðja sinni · þjóð-konungi;
ól ek mér jóð, · ęrfi-vǫrðu
[...] · Jòn·akrs sonu.

I mounted the bed—I thought it better for me—
of a great king for a third time.
I begot babes, heritance-defenders [SONS],
[...], Enacker's sons.

---

2 þjóð-konungi 'great king' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Grí* 1/2 n.

4 sonu | emend.; *sonum* **R**

**15** Ę́n umb Svan·hildi · sǫ́tu þýjar,
es mǐnna barna · batst full-hugða'k;
svá vas Svan·hildr · ǐ sal mǐnum,
sęm vę́ri søm-lęitr · sólar gę́isli.

But around Swanhild handmaids sat,
her whom I truly thought best among my children.
So was Swanhild in my hall
like were she a fair-faced ray of the sun.

---

ALL | For the description illustrating the quality of a dead person by likeness to superior natural phenomena, cf. *2 HHund* 38, *1 Guðr* 18, *2 Guðr* 2.

**16** Gódda'k golli · ok guð-vę́fjum,
áðr ek gę́fa'k · Got-þjóðar til;
þat 's mér harðast · harma mǐnna
of þann inn hvíta · hadd Svan·hildar:
auri trǫddu · und jóa fótum;

I endowed her with gold and with cloth of god-weave
before I gave her to the folk of the Gots.
That is for me the hardest of my harms,
over the white hair of Swanhild
—they had it trampled in mud beneath the hooves of steeds!—

**17** ę́n sá sárastr, · es þę́ir Sig·*vǫ*rð mǐnn,
sigri rę́ntan, · ǐ sę́ing vǫ́gu;
ę́n sá grimmastr, · es þę́ir Gunn·ari,
frànir ormar, · til fjǫrs skriðu;
ę́n sá hvassastr, · es til hjarta
konung ò·blauðan · kvikvan skǫ́ru.

but the sorest when my Siward,
robbed of victory, they slew in bed,
but the cruelest when for Guther
the gleaming serpents slithered to his chest,

but the sharpest when unto the heart
they cut the unsoft king [= Hawn], alive.

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urð **R**

3–6 ęn ... skǫ́ru 'but ... alive.' | For the deaths of Guther and Hawn cf. *Akv* 23–35, *Am* 56–64.

**18** Fjǫlð man'k bǫlva, · [...]
2 bęit-tu, Sig·*vǫ*rðr, · inn blakka mar,
hęst inn hrað-fǿra · lát-tu hinig renna!
4 Sitr ęigi hér · snǫr né dóttir
sú's Guð·rúnu · gǫ́fi hnossir.

I recall a multitude of bales; [...]
Saddle, Siward, thy fallow steed,
thy quick-pacing horse—let it run hither!
Here sits no son's wife nor daughter
who to Guthrun might give presents.

2 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

ALL | After recounting her cruel fates, Guthrun addresses Siward, who is long dead. The tone is at last one of release. With the departure of her doomed sons Guthrun has nothing to live for upon the earth; her family line is ended, as Byrnhild predicted (*Sigsk* 63–64) and she now knows that at last her hard life must soon be over. She will at last find happiness again, but only in death, reunited with her true love and first husband, Siward.— An interesting question not dealt with in the poetry is the fact that Byrnhild has already joined Siward by suttee immediately after his death (*Sigsk* 65–71, *Helr*). Do the two rival women encounter each other in the afterlife as co-wifes, or does one oust the other?

1 [...] | A half-line is undoubtedly missing here. It would presumably have mirrored the first half-line, containing *fjǫlð man'k b-* 'I recall a multitude of ...' with alliteration on a noun beginning with *b*; cf. the similar structure of *Þrk* 23/3.

**19** Minns-tu, Sig·*vǫ*rðr, · hvat vit męltum
2 þá's vit á bęð · bǫ́ði sǫtum?
at þú myndir mǐn · móðugr vitja,
4 halr, ór hęlju, · en ek þǐn ór hęimi.

Dost thou remember, Siward, what we said
when on the bed we both did sit,
that thou, fierce man, wouldst visit me
out of Hell—and I thee out of the world?

1 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

**20** Hlaðið ér, jarlar, · ęiki-kǫst'inn,
2 látið þann und hi*mn*i · héstan verða!

Męgi bręnna brjóst · bǫlva-fullt ęldr
4 [...] umb hjarta · þíðni sorgir!“

Load, ye earls, the oaken pile [PYRE]!
Let it become the highest under heaven!
May fire burn my bale-filled breast,
unto the heart ... may the sorrows melt away!”

2 him*n*i ‘heaven’ | *emend.;* hilmi *‘prince’* **R**

ALL | Guthrun orders the construction of her own pyre. It is not necessary to think that she is to be burned alive, although that is by no means impossible; she may plan to commit suicide (prob. by a sword) beforehand.

1 ęiki-kǫst’inn ‘the oaken pile’ | Acc. sg. of *ęiki-kǫstr* ‘pile, heap of oakwood’, suffixed with the definite *inn*. The clitic definite, a decidedly late, or at the very least non-poetic, feature, is metrically required.

2 him*n*i ‘heaven’ | Although *und hilmi* could be read as ‘around the prince’, the pyre is certainly Guthrun’s. At this point in the narrative Siward is long dead, and the point of the pyre is for Guthrun to join him in the afterlife. Since no prince is being burned this requires emendation, and *himni* ‘heaven’ (dat. sg.) easily presents itself. It is a common poetic motif for something to be ‘the best under heaven’; cf. *Gríp* 10/4, *Yt* 27, Sö 136 (under Misc. Runic Poetry), etc.

3 brjóst bǫlva-fullt ‘my bale-filled breast’ | The possessive pronoun is implicit. With these words Guthrun reflects on the many evils she has been responsible for (cf. *Akv* 47).

**21** Jǫrlum ǫllum · óðal batni,
2 snótum ǫllum · sorg at minni
at þetta treg-róf · of talit vęri.

For all earls may patrimony improve;
for all ladies may sorrow decrease
after this grief-chain has been retold.

ALL | The last st. seems to step out of the world of the poem. It should probably be read in the voice of the narrating ballad-poet, who addresses the members of the audience and wishes them better fortunes than the characters in the legend. The aristocratic titles afforded to the audience are notable.

# Speeches of Hamthew
# *(Ham·ðis mǫ́l)*

**Dating** (Sapp 2022): C10th (0.885)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay-Speeches-meter, Leeds-meter

## Introduction

The **Speeches of Hamthew** (*Hamð*) is the final poem in **R**, and chronologically the last poem in the Walsing-cycle alongside *Ghv*.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hamð* is only attested in **R**, on foll. 44v/27–45v/23, where it is the final poem and follows *Ghv*. The prose at the end is followed by the text *explicit liber iste* in cipher form, indicating that no part of the main manuscript is missing.

The paraphrase of the poem in *Vǫls* 44, which also includes the direct citation of stanza 28, indicates that the poem was present in the poetic source manuscript used for that text.

### Story and parallels

Like *Ghv*, *Hamð* begins with Guthrun's exhortation. She exhorts her sons to avenge their sister Swanhild, killed by the tyrannical King Ermenric. These parts of the respective poems are closely related, and numerous lines are shared between them (see Introduction to *Ghv* for an overview). Although both poems deal with the same events, they differ in their perspective. Whereas *Ghv* stays behind with Guthrun after the departure of her sons and sees her build her own funeral pyre in preparation for her long-delayed suttee, *Hamð* instead follows the boys as they set out to take revenge. The historical background of these events is dealt with in the Introduction to *Ghv* above.

In Old Norse sources, the death of King Ermenric is otherwise told in *Rdr*, *Vǫls* 44 (which is clearly partly based on *Hamð*, as seen by its citation of a variant of st. 28), and *Skm* 50. It may be noted that on the point of Ermenric's death the already highly archaic *Rdr* is still further removed from

historical fact than *Hamð*, since *Rdr* 4/3–4 seems to describe Ermenric as drowning in a well, whereas *Hamð* 24–31, in accordance with Jordanes (see Introduction to *Ghv*), sees the brothers killed after maiming, not killing, the king. A possible verbal parallel between the two poems is noted in st. 23/1 below.

## Meter and stanza

*Hamð* consists of 110 long-lines and 2 c-lines distributed across 31 stanzas. 30/31 stanzas are composed in a form of Ancient-words-lay (see below), while a single stanza (29) is composed in Leeds-meter.

The most consistent length of the Ancient-words-lay stanza is 4 lines (18/30: 1, 3, 5–10, 12, 14–15, 17, 19–21, 25, 28, 30). Other represented lengths are 2 (6/30: 4, 13, 16, 23, 27, 31), 3 (11, 18, 26), and 5 lines (2, 22, 24). Stanza 29 is composed in Leeds-meter with the archetypical configuration *abc abc*.

Together with *Vkv* and *Akv*, the majority of *Hamð* is composed in a looser form of Ancient-words-lay. Suzuki (2014, pp. 525–539) considers this meter as an intermediary form between the meter of *Akv* and regular Ancient-words-lay, and groups it alongside *Akv* under the label *Fornyrðislag–Málaháttr* (Ancient-words-lay–Speeches-meter).

## Text

### Ham·ðis mǫ́l (‘The Speeches of Hamthew’)

**1** Spruttu á tái · tregnar iðir [R 44v/28]
grøti alfa · in glý-stǫmu;
ár of morgin · manna bǫlva
sútir hvęrjar · sorg of kvęykva.

In the courtyard sprung up tragic deeds,
the gleeless causes for the weeping of elves.
In early morning each kind of pain
of the bales of men awakens sorrow.

1 Spruttu | *The* S *is an ornamented initial 2 lines high in* R.

2 grøti alfa ‘causes for the weeping of elves’ | The killings are thought to be the cause of the weeping of good spirits (in this case elves, most likely understood as familiar protective spirits), but the rejoicing of ill spirits. For this notion see *Akv* 18/4 n.; cf. sts. 15/2, 28/3 below.

**2** Vas=a þat nú · né í gǽr, [R 44v/29]
þat hęfir langt · liðit síðan;
es fátt fornara · fręmr vas þat hǫlfu
es hvatti Guð·rún · Gjúka borin
sonu sína unga · at hęfna Svan·hildar.

That was not now nor yesterday;
it has passed a long time since.
Little is older, [yet] it was twice as long ago
when Guthrun, born of Yivick, goaded
her young sons to avenge Swanhild.

4 es hvatti Guð·rún ‘when Guthrun ... goaded’ | As also told in *Ghv*.

**3** „Systir vas ykkur · Svan·hildr of hęitin [R 44v/32]
sú’s Jǫrmun·rekr · jóm of traddi,
hvítum ok svǫrtum · á hęr-vegi
grǫ́um, gang-tǫmum · Gotna hrossum.

“The sister of you two was named Swanhild,
she whom Ermenric had trampled by steeds,
by the white and black on the path of war,
by the grey, pacing, Gotnish horses!

2–4 sú’s ... hrossum. ‘she whom ... horses!’ | Repeated almost identically in *Ghv* 2/3–6.

**4** Ęptir 's ykkr þrungit · þjóð-konunga, [R 44v/34]
2 lifið ęinir ér þátta · ęttar minnar.

Ye two are oppressed by great kings;
of the strands of my lineage ye alone live.

1 þjóð-konunga 'great kings' | An old poetic word; for etymology + distribution see *Gríp* 1/2 n.

**5** Ęin-stóð em'k orðin · sęm ǫsp í holti, [R 45r/1]
2 fallin at frękndum · sęm fura at kvisti,
vaðin at vilja · sęm viðr at laufi,
4 þá's in kvist-skóða · kømr umb dag varman."

I am become as supportless as the asp in the grove,
as bereaved of kinsmen as the pine of its branch,
as deprived of willpower as the tree of its leaf
when the branch-scather comes on a warm day."

**6** Hitt kvað þá Ham·ðir · inn hugum stóri: [R 45r/3]
2 „Lítt myndir þú þá, Guð·rún, · lęyfa dǫð Hǫgna
es þęir Sig·*vǫ*rð · svefni ór vǫkðu;
4 satst þú á bęð · ęn banar hlógu.

This then quoth Hamthew the great of heart:
"Thou hadst little cause, Guthrun, to praise Hawn's deeds
when they woke Siward from his sleep;
thou layest in the bed, but his killers laughed.

3 Sig·*vǫ*rð | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urð **R**

1–3 | These lines correspond directly to *Ghv* 4/1–3, with minor variants.

**7** Bøkr vǫru þǐnar · inar blá-hvítu [R 45r/5]
2 ofnar vǫlundum, · flutu í vers dręyra;
svalt þá Sig·*vǫ*rðr, · satst yfir dauðum,
4 glýja né gáðir; · Gunn·arr þér svá vildi.

Thy blue-white bed-clothes were
woven by artisans; they swam in thy husband's gore.
Then Siward died; thou satst o'er him, dead,
hadst no sake for glee. Guther would have it so for thee!

3 Sig·*vǫ*rðr | *metr. emend. (Sievers 1889, pp. 135–141);* Sig·urðr **R**

1–2 | L. 1 corresponds directly to *Ghv* 4/4, l. 2b roughly to *Ghv* 4/5a.

**8** Atla þótti=sk þú stríða · at Erps morði [R 45r/7]
ok at Ęitils aldr-lagi, · þat vas þér ęnn verra!
Svá skyldi hvęrr ǫðrum · vęrja til aldr-laga
sverði sár-bęitu · at sér né stríddi=t.“

Thou thoughtst thou didst injure Attle through the murder of Earp
and the laying down of Oatle's life; it was even worse for thee!
Each man should cause the laying down of another's life
with a sorely biting sword such that it does not injure himself!”

---

ALL | Hamthew alludes to Guthrun's murder of her children with Attle, as dealt with in *Akv* 37–42 and *Am* 73–81. Cf. *Ghv* 12.

1 Erps 'Earp' | Not to be confused with Enacker's son of the same name.

4 sverði sár-bęitu 'a sorely biting sword' | Cf. *Akv* 23/3.

4 at sér né stríddi=t 'that it does not injure himself' | One should not injure another in such a way that it also hurts oneself; Hamthew reminds his mother that her shortage of kin is by her own choice.

**9** Hitt kvað þá Sǫrli, · svinna hafði hann hyggju: [R 45r/10]
„Vil'k=at við móður · mǫlum skipta;
orðs þikkir ęnn vant · ykkru hvǫru;
hvęrs biðr nú, Guð·rún, · es at gráti né fǫr=at?

This then quoth Sarle; he had a wise mind:
“With my mother I do not wish to bandy words;
[no] more word seems wanting from either of you.
What dost thou now ask for, Guthrun, when thou takest not to weeping?

---

ALL | Sarle upbraids his brother Hamthew for arguing against his mother. Both Guthrun and Hamthew have said what there is to be said; now it is time for the brothers to depart and fulfill their orlay, and for his mother to weep at last.

3 ykkru hvǫru 'from either of you' | Neuter dat. sg. of *ykkarr hvaðarr* 'of either of you', presumably in the neuter since the addressed (Guthrun and Hamthew) are of mixed gender. The expression must be understood to be in the negative, since the sense is certainly that “you two have spoken enough”, though an expected nominal negative *-gi* 'not, no' or verbal negative *-at* is missing.

**10** Bróðr grát þú þína · ok buri svása, [R 45r/12]
niðja ná-borna · lęidda nęr rógi;
okkr skalt ok, Guð·rún, · gráta báða
es hér sitjum fęigir á mǫrum, · fjarri munum dęyja.“

Weep for thy brothers and beloved sons,
for thy close-born kinsmen led into strife.
For us both shalt thou also, Guthrun, weep,
who here sit fey upon our steeds; far off shall we die!”

**11** Gengu ór garði · gǫrvir at ęiskra; [R 45r/15]
liðu þá yfir ungir · úrig fjǫll
mǫrum hún-lęndskum, · morðs at hefna.

They went out of the settlement ready to wage fury.
Then the young ones passed over drizzling mountains
on Hunlandish horses to avenge the murder.

**12** Þá kvað þat Erpr · ęinu sinni, [R 45r/16]
męrr of lék · á mars baki:
„Illt 's blauðum hal · brautir kęnna;“
kóðu harðan mjǫk · hornung vesa.

Then this quoth Earp a single time;
renowned, he balanced on the back of his steed:
"It is bad to teach a soft man the roads."—
They said the corner-boy was a very hard man.

---

ALL | In sts. 12–15 Hamthew and Sarle encounter their half-brother Earp on the road. The order of the dialogue-sts. 12–14 is difficult to parse and the passage is likely corrupt. The paraphrase of these stanzas in *Vǫls* 44 gives little help: *Ok er þeir váru komnir á leið, finna þeir Erp, bróður sinn, ok spyrja, hvat hann mundi veita þeim. Hann svarar: „S·líkt sem hǫnd hendi eða fótr fęti.“ Þeim þótti þat ekki vera ok drápu hann.* 'And when they had come upon their way they find Earp, their brother, and ask how he will be of aid to them. He answers: "Like a hand to a hand or a foot to a foot." They thought that it was not so, and slew him.'

4 hornung 'corner-boy' | I.e., one who must sit in the corner out of shame or neglect. A word used for a boy born to a mother of lower status than the father as the result of an extra-marital relationship (Fr, s.v. *hornungr*), in this case used disparagingly by Sarle and Hamthew, who consider their mother, Guthrun, superior to Earp's.

**13** Fundu á stręti · stór-brǫgð-óttan: [R 45r/18]
„Hvé mun jarp-skammr · okkr full-tingja?“

They found on the street the very cunning man:
"How should this brown shorty assist us?"

---

1 stręti 'street' | A Roman loanword used specifically for a paved road or street in a town. It probably emphasises the southern geography in which the events transpire.

**14** Svaraði inn sundr-móðri, · svá kvað=sk vęita myndu [R 45r/20]
full-ting frændum · sem fótr ǫðrum.
„Hvat męgi fótr · føti vęita
né hold-gróin · hǫnd annarri?“

He of sundry mother answered, said that he would offer
his kinsmen assistance like a foot to another.—

"What can a foot offer a foot,
or a trunk-grown hand another?"

**15** Drógu ór skíði · skíði-éarn, [R 45r/22]
2 mękis ęggjar · at mun flagði;
þvęrrðu þrótt sínn · at þriðjungi,
4 létu mǫg ungan · til moldar hníga.

They drew from their sheaths their sheath-irons [SWORDS],
the edges of the blade at the behest of the ogress.
They used their strength on the third one;
they let the young lad sink down to the earth.

---

2 at mun flagði 'at the behest of the ogress' | They were acting according to the will of a cruel norn (*flagð*); cf. st. 1/2 n. above, 28/3 below.

**16** Skóku loða, · skalmir fęstu, [R 45r/24]
2 ok goð-bornir · smugu í goð-vęfi.

They shook their wool-coats, fastened their knives,
and the god-born ones got into their clothes of god-weave.

---

2 goð-vęfi 'clothes of god-weave' | Their silk; they were beautifully dressed.

**17** Framm lǫgu brautir, · fundu vǫ́-stigu [R 45r/25]
2 ok systur son · sáran á męiði,
varg-tré vind-kǫld · vestan bójar;
4 trýtti ę́ trǫnu hvǫt, · títt vas=at bíð*a.

Forwards lay their roads; they found paths of woe
and their sister's son [= Randwigh] maimed on a branch
on a wind-cold hanging tree to the west of the town;
the crane's incitement [CORPSE] kept dangling; it was not good to tarry.

**18** Glaumr vas í hǫllu, · halir ǫl-rękifir, [R 45r/27]
2 ok til gota ękki · gørðu-t hęyra
áðr halr hug-fullr · í horn of þaut.

There was a revel in the hall, the men ale-rowdy,
and of the sound of the horses they heard naught,
before a man full of heart blew in his horn.

**19** Sęgja fóru *ękrir* · Jǫrmun·rekki [R 45r/29]

at sénir vóru · sęggir und hjǫlmum:
„Róðið ér umb rǫ́ð! · Ríkir eru komnir,
fyr mǫ́ttkum hafið ér mǫnnum · męy of tradda.“

Messengers went to tell Ermenric
that the youths had been seen beneath their helmets:
“Make your decision! Strong ones have come.
To the wrath of mighty men have ye trampled that maiden!”

1 *érir* | *om.* **R**

**20** Hló þá Jǫrmun·rekkr, · hęndi drap á kampa, [R 45r/31]
bęiddi=sk at brǫngu, · bǫðvaði=sk at víni;
skók hann skǫr jarpa, · sá á skjǫld hvítan,
lét hann sér í hęndi · hvarfa kęr gollit.

Then Ermenric laughed, put his hand to his beard,
made ready for battle, became ferocious in his wine.
He shook his brown locks, looked on his white shield;
he let spin in his hand a golden cup.

2 bęiddi=sk at brǫngu ‘made ready for battle’ | Uncertain translation; *branga* ‘battle(?)’ is a hapax.

**21** „Sęll ek þá þǿtt=umk · ef séa knętta [R 45r/34]
Ham·ði ok Sǫrla · í hǫllu mínni;
buri mynda’k þá binda · með boga strengjum,
góð bǫrn Gjúka · fęsta á galga.“

“I would have thought me blessed if I got to see
Hamthew and Sarle in my own hall;
those boys I would then bind with bow-strings,
the good children of Yivick, and fasten them on the gallows!”

4 góð bǫrn Gjúka ‘the good children of Yivick’ | Yivick was Guthrun’s father and the boys’ grandfather. The poet is not presenting an alternative genealogy; cf. 2/4 above, 25/4 below.

**22** Hitt kvað þá Hróðr·glǫð, · stóð of hleðum, [R 45v/2]
mę́-fingr mę́lti · við mǫg þęnna:
„Því’t þat hęita · at hlýði=gi myni;
mega tvęir menn ęinir · tíu hundruð Gotna
binda eða bęrja · í borg inni hǫ*u*?

This then quoth Rothglad, she stood by the doors,
slender-fingered she spoke to this lad:
“Since they swear that no army will;

can two men alone bind or beat
ten hundred Gots in the high stronghold?"

1 Hróðr·glǫð 'Rothglad' | An unknown woman, perhaps implied to be Attle's mother by the word *mǫgr* 'lad', which can also mean 'son'.

5 borg inni hǫ*u* 'the high stronghold' | Formulaic, also found in *Akv* 15/2b; see there for further parallels.

**23** Styrr varð í ranni, · stukku ǫl-skálir, [R 45v/5]
2 í blóði bragnar lǫgu, · komit ór brjósti Gotna.

There was uproar in the hall; the ale-bowls shattered;
champions lay in blood flown from the breasts of the Gots.

1 Styrr varð í ranni 'There was uproar in the house' | Strongly reminiscent of *Rdr* 3/5: *Rósta varð í ranni* 'There was tumult in the hall', *Beow* 1302a: *Hréam wearð ǫn Heorote* 'There was an outcry in the Hart', both in the context of hall-fights, the former describing the same events as *Hamð*.

**24** Hitt kvað þá Ham·ðir · inn hugum stóri: [R 45v/6]
2 „Óstir Jǫrmun·rekkr · okkarrar kvǫmu
bróðra sam-móðra · innan borgar þínnar;
4 fótr sér þú þína · hǫndum sér þú þínum
Jǫrmun·rekkr orpit · í ęld hęitan!"

This then quoth Hamthew the great of heart:
"Thou, Ermenric, didst incite our coming,
we brothers of the same mother, into thy stronghold!
Thou seest thy feet; thou seest them with thy hands,
O Ermenric, thrown in the hot fire!"

4–5 fótr ... hęitan! 'Thou seest ... fire!' | The detail of Ermenric's severed hands and feet is also found in *Rdr* 4.

**25** Þá raut við · inn ręgin-kunngi [R 45v/9]
2 Baldr í brynju · sem bjǫrn hryti:
„Grýtið ér á gumna · alls gęirar né bíta,
4 ęggjar né éǫrn, · Jón·akrs sonu!"

Then roared back the Rein-descended
Balder in his byrnie [WARRIOR > = Ermenric] like a roaring bear:
"Stone ye the men! For spears do not bite
—nor edges nor irons—on Enacker's sons!"

1 raut | *metr. emend.;* hraut **R**

1 regin-kunngi 'Rein-descended' | Descended from the Reins, i.e., the Gods. The godly ancestry of the Gotnish Amals, the house to which Ermenric belonged, is described in Jordanes *Getica* 78, 79 (excerpt): *Magnaque potiti per loca victoria iam proceres suos, quorum quasi fortuna vincebant, non puros homines, sed semideos id est Ansis vocaverunt. Quorum genealogia ut paucis percurram vel quis quo parente genitus est aut unde origo coepta, ubi finem effecit,* [...] *79 Horum ergo heroum, ut ipsi suis in fabulis referunt, primus fuit Gapt, qui genuit Hulmul. Hulmul vero genuit Augis, et Augis genuit* etc. etc. 'They thereafter called their leaders, by whose good fortune they seemed to have conquered, not mere men, but demigods, that is Ansis. Their genealogy I shall run through briefly, telling the lineage of each and the beginning and the end of this line. [...] Now the first of these heroes, as they themselves relate in their legends, was Gapt, who begat Hulmul. And Hulmul begat Augis; and Augis begat' etc. etc.
Jordanes' *Ansis* is a cognate to ON *ęsir* 'the Eese', i.e., the Gods, which are called demigods in a clear instance of Christian euhemerism. The first of the *Ansis* is *Gapt*, i.e., Geat, whose name directly corresponds to OE *Géat*, the progenitor of several Anglo-Saxon royal lineages, and ON *Gautr*, a poetic synonym for the god Weden (*Grm* 56/4, *Bdr* 2/1).

**26** Hitt kvað þá Ham·ðir · inn hugum stóri: [**R** 45v/11]
2 „Bǫl vannt, bróðir, · es þann bęlg lęystir;
opt ór þęim bęlg · bǫll rǫ́ð koma."

This then quoth Hamthew the great of heart:
"Thou accomplishedst a bale, brother, when thou loosened that bag;
oft from that bag come bold counsels!"

2 es þann bęlg lęystir 'when thou loosened that bag' | Unclear, but perhaps referring to their slaying of Earp.

**27** „Hug hęfðir, Ham·ðir, · ef hęfðir hyggjandi, [**R** 45v/13]
2 mikils es á mann hvęrn vant · es man-vits es."

"Thou wouldst have had heart, Hamthew, if thou hadst had understanding;
much is any man wanting when he lacks manwit!"

**28** „Af vǽri nú hǫfuð · ef Erpr lifði, [**R** 45v/14]
2 bróðir okkarr inn bǫ́ð-frǿkni, · es vit á braut vǫ́gum,
verr hinn víð-frǿkni, · hvǫtt=umk at dísir,
4 gumi hinn gunn-hęlgi, · gǫrðum=sk at vígi."

"Off were now the head if Earp had lived,
our battle-brave brother whom we slew on the road,
the widely brave warrior—the Dises incited me—
the war-holy man—we made ready for the slaying."

1–2 Af ... vǫ́gum | *Also in* **N**. 1 hǫfuð | hǫfuð'it **N**

1–2 Af ... vǫ́gum | These lines are quoted in *Vǫls* 44, preceded by the text: *Þá męlti Ham·ðir: „Af mundi nú hǫfuð'it, ef Erpr lifði, bróðir okkarr, er vit vágum á leið'inni, ok sám vit þat of síð," sem kvęðit er.* 'Then Hamthew spoke: "The head would now have been off if Earp had lived, our brother whom we slew on the road, and we worried about that for some time", as it is sung.'

3 hvǫtt=umk at dísir ‘the Dises incited me’ | The evil fates, cf. sts. 1/2, 15/2 above, *Akv* 18/4 n. — The alliteration is highly unusual and requires the cluster *hv* to behave like *v*.

**29** „Ę̨kki hygg okkr vesa · ulfa dǿmi, [R 45v/17]
2 at vit mynim sjalfir of saka=sk
sęm greęy norna · þau’s grǿ́ðug eru
4 í auðn of alin.“

“I do not think wolves an example for us,
that we should fight amidst ourselves
like the greedy bitches of the Norns
who are reared in the wilderness.”

**30** „Vel hǫfum vit vegit, · stǫndum á val Gotna [R 45v/19]
2 ofan ęgg-móðum · sem ęrnir á kvisti;
góðs hǫfum tírar fęngit · þó’tt skylim nú eða í gę́r dęyja,
4 kvęld lifir maðr ękki · ęptir kvið norna.“

“Well have we two fought; we stand on the slain of the Gots—
over edge-wearied men like eagles on a branch.
Great glory have we won though we should die now or tomorrow—
man lives not one evening after the verdict of the Norns!”

4 kvið norna ‘verdict of the Norns’ | The fated hour of one’s death, equivalent to the *dómr norna* ‘judgment of the Norns’ in *Fáfn* 11/1.

**31** Þar fell Sǫrli · at salar gafli, [R 45v/22]
2 ęn Ham·ðir hné · at hús-baki.

There fell Sarle by the hall’s gables,
but Hamthew sank down by the back of the house.

**P1** Þetta eru kǫlluð Ham·ðis mǫ́l in fornu. [R 45v/23]

These are called the Ancient Speeches of Hamthew.

1 fornu | *add.* ðxplðcðr lðbðr ðſtð *(cipher for* *explicit liber iste*) ‘Here this book ends’* **R**

# West Germanic Heroic Poetry

# Bewolf
# *(Beo·wulf)*

**Dating:** early C8th (TODO)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

NOTE: The Old English edition is largely the work of Yuanlong Zhao, as available at `https://github.com/FolgeriLeninaes/beowulf`. The OE edition and associated commentary is released under CC BY 4.0, a looser license than the CC BY-NC 4.0 license under which the rest of the project is released.

The present file is for now heavily incomplete. Only non-commented lines (i.e., those which actually appear in the .pdf) have been edited. The commented lines are placeholders based on James A. Harrison and Robert Sharp, eds. (1883) with minor corrections.

The orthography is normalised to an archaic Anglian dialect. Its goal is to present the poem as closely as possible to how it would most likely have sounded at the time of composition; this includes removing svarabhakti vowels where metrically required, marking long unstressed vowels (as evinced by Kaluza's law), and restoring hiatus forms.

The long diphthongs descending from PWGmc. **au*, **eu*, **iu* are written *ea*, *eo* and *io* respectively; diphthongs arising from colouring or breaking of a vowel *V* are written *Vº*.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Beow* is only found in the Nowell codex (Cotton MS Vitellius A XV, foll. 94r–209v; henceforth **N**), a miscellaneous collection of fantastical texts written in two hands (A: 94r–175v/3 and B: 175v/4–209v). The text of *Beow* is found on foll. 132r–201v. In the poem itself, A writes as far as the word *scyran* in 1939b, and the rest of the poem is written by B.

## Text

**Pr** Hwæt, wé Gâr-Dęná · in jǽr-dagum
2 þeod-cyningá · þrymm ġi·frugnun,
hú þâ æðilingas · ęllæn fręmidun.
4 Oft Sceld Scéþing · scaðaná þreatum,
mǫngum mǽġðum · medu-setlá æb·teah.
6 Eġ*i*sodǽ I$^{o}$rlí, · síð-ðan ǽrist wærð
fea-scæft fundæn: · hé þæs fróbrǽ ġi·bâd,
8 wóx undær wolcnum, · we$^{o}$rð-myndum þâh,
oð þæt him *ó*ġ-hwęlċ þ*é*r · ymb-sittęndrá
10 oþær hrǫn-râdǽ · héran scoldǽ,
gǫmban ġeldan: · þæt wæs gód cyning!
12 Þǽm aburá wæs · æftær ċęnnid
jung in gardum, · þǫnǽ God sęndǽ
14 folcǽ tó fróbrǽ; · firin-þarbǽ ǫn·gæt,
þæt hiǽ ǽr drugun · aldur-léasǽ
16 langǽ hwílǽ. · Him þæs líb-fréj*á*,
wuldræs waldænd, · weræld-árǽ fær·ġæb;
18 Biowí* wæs brómí · (blǽd widǽ sprang),
Sceldæs aburá · Scędi-landum in.
20 Swá scæl jung gumá, · gódǽ ġi·wyrċan,
frǫmum feo-ġiftum · ǫn fadur bærmǽ,
22 þæt hinǽ ǫn ældǽ · ęft ġi·w*yn*ġæn
will-ġi·síðas, · þǫnnǽ wíġ cumǽ,
24 liodí ġi·lǽstæn: · lob-dǽdum scæl
in mǽġðá ġi·hwǽ*m* · mann ġi·þ*íh*an.

How, we have learnt of the glory of the great kings
of the spear-Danes in days of yore,
how those athlings accomplished zeal.
Oft Shield Sheaving from the hosts of foemen,
from many tribes stole away the mead-benches,
frightened the Erls after he first had been
found destitute; he knew refuge from that,
grew under the clouds, throve in honours
till to him every surrounding folk
o'er the dolphin's ride [SEA] had to submit,
yield tribute—that was a good king.
TODO: Translation.

2 ġi·frugnun | 'gefrunon' **N** 5 mǫngum | mǫnægum *with restored syncopation* **N** 6 Eġ*i*sodǽ | Eġsodǽ *with restored medial vowel* **N** 6 I$^{o}$rlí 'the Erls' | *metr. and sens. emend.;* e$^{o}$rl **N** 8 wóx |

weox *with transfer to strong class 7 reversed* **N** 9 *ǽ*ġ-hwęlċ | *Anglian form of* æ̀ġ-hwęlċ, *cf. early Anglian* 'oeghuuelc' **N** 9 þ*ǽ*r | *metr. emend.;* þará **N** 16 líb-fréþá | *metr. emend.;* líb-fréa **N** 18 Biowí* 'Bewer' | Biowulf **N** 22 ġi·wynġæn | ġi·wuniġæn *with inherited class III paradigm, cf. northern Mercian* 'wynigaþ' **N** 25 ġi·hwæ̀m | 'gehwære' **N** 25 ġi·þ*ǐ*han | *metr. emend.;* ġi·þeon *with restoration of medial* -h- **N**

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6 I$^{o}$rlí 'the Erls' | The ms. form *eorl* 'the earl, nobleman' is metrically deficient and near-universally emended (Robert D. Fulk 1992, p. 205). According to Jordanes (*Getica* 23) the *Heruli* were driven out by the Danes from southern Scandinavia, a legend likely reflected here when the legendary Danish ancestor-king Shield is said to have 'frightened' (i.e., 'expulsed') the **I$^{o}$rlí*. As old tribal names were forgot, scribes replaced it with the more transparent "earl". For the confusion of proper names in *Beow* cf. ll. 18, 53, 2921 below.

18 Biowí* 'Bewer' | Emendation to (forms of) *Beo* 'Bewer' is adopted by most modern eds. (including R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles) and is supported by the Anglo-Saxon royal genealogies, where Shield is the father of Bewer (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, pp. 291–292); cf. l. 53 below. The insertion of Bewulf's name is most likely due to scribal confusion with the name of the poem's protagonist.

Him þá Sceld ġi·wât · tó ġi·scæp-hwílǽ
felo-hrór fǿran · ǫn frean wǽrǽ;
hiǽ hinǽ þá æt·bǽrun · tó brimæs faroðǽ.
swǽsǽ ġi·síðas, · swǽ hé selbá bæd,
þęndin wordum wé$^{o}$ld · wini Scildingá.
Leoþ land-frumá · langǽ âhtǽ—
þǽr æt hýðǽ stód · hringid-steþná,
ísæġ ęnd út·fús, · æðilingæs fær;
á·læġdun þá · leoþnǽ þeodæn,
beagá bryttan · ǫn bærm scipæs,
mǽrnǽ bi mæ̂stǽ. · þǽr wæs mâðmá felá,
æþ fe$^{o}$rr-wegum · frætwá ġi·lâdid:
ni hérdǽ iċ cým-lícor · ċeol ġi·ġęrwan
hildi-wǽpnum · ęnd haðu-wǽdum,
billum ęnd brynnum; · him ǫn bærmǽ læġ
mâðma mængu, · þä him mid scoldun
ǫn flódæs æ̂ht · fe$^{o}$rr ġi·wítan.
Nallæs hiǽ hinǽ læ̀ssan · lâcum tiodun,
þeod-ġi·streonum, · þǫnnǽ þâ dydun,
þí hinǽ æt frum·scæftǽ · forð ǫn·sęndun
æ̂nnǽ obær ỳðǽ · umbr-wesęndí:
þá ġét hiǽ him á·sættun · seġn gyldinnǽ
heah obær heabud, · létun holm beran,
ġǽbun ǫn gâr-sęġġ: · him wæs jómær seþá,
murnęndí mód. · Męnn ni cunnun
sęġġan tó sóðǽ · sęli-rǽdęndí,

52 hęlið undær heƀnum · hwá þǽm hlæstǽ ǫn·féng.

TODO: Translation.

34 á·læġdun | á·lęġdun *without levelling of umlaut, cf. northern Mercian* 'lægdun' **N** 41 mænġu | mænæġu *with restored syncopation* **N** 47 á·sættun | á·sętun *without levelling of umlaut, cf. Northumbrian* 'gesætte' **N** 52 hęlið | hælið *with expected umlaut, cf. early Northumbrian* 'heliðum' **N**

1 Þá wæs on burgum · Biowí* Scildingá,
54 leoƀ liod-cyning, · lǫngǽ þrâgǽ
folcum ġi·frǽġí · (fædær ęllær hwærƀ,
56 aldr æƀ ærdǽ), · òð þæt him ęft ǫn·wóc
heah Halƀ-dęni; · hé$^{o}$ld þęndin libdǽ,
58 gamæl ęnd gúð-hreoh, · glædǽ Scildingas.
Þǽm feowær bærn · forð-ġi·rímid
60 in wer-æld wócun, · werudá ræswan,
Heru-gâr ęnd Hróð-gâr · ęnd Hâlgá til;
62 hérdǽ iċ, þæt *I$^{o}$rsé* · wæs *Ǫn*ulan cwøn
Haðu-Scilfingæs · hals-ġi·będdǽ.
64 Þá wæs Hróð·gârǽ · hęri-spód ġiƀæn,
wígæs we$^{o}$rð-mynd, · þæt him his wini-mágas
66 ġe$^{o}$rnǽ hérdun, · òð þæt siu juguð ġi·wóx,
magu-dryht miċil. · Him on mód bi·rann,
68 þæt hall-reċid · hâtan woldǽ,
medu-ærn miċil · męnn ġi·wyrċan,
70 þǫnǽ ældá bærn · æfiri ġi·frugnun,
ęnd þǽr ǫn innan · all ġi·dǽlan
72 jungum ęnd aldum, · swęlċ him God saldǽ,
bútan folc-scærǽ · ęnd ferhum gumaná.
74 Þá ic wídǽ ġi·fræġn · we$^{o}$rc ġi·bannan
manæġrǽ mǽġðǽ · jǫnd þisnǽ middun-gard,
76 folc-stędi frætwan. · Him on fristǽ ġi·lǫmp
ædrǽ mid ældum, · þæt hit wærð all garu,
78 hall-ærná mæst; · scóp him Herut naman,
sé þi his wordæs ġi·wald · wídǽ hæƀdǽ.
80 Hé bi-hât ni á·leag, · beagas dǽldǽ,
sinc æt simlǽ. · Sęli hlíbodǽ
82 heah ęnd horn-geap: · haðu-wælmá bâd,
lâðan líġæs; · ni wæs hit lęngǽ þá jén
84 þæt sé *ęġġ-hęti · âðum-sw*eoran*
æftær wæl-níðǽ · wæcnan scoldǽ.

Þá sé ęllæn-gâst · arƀað-líċáe
þrâgáe ġi·þolodáe, · sé þi in þiostrum bâd,
þæt hé dógrá ġi·hwæ̂m · dream ġi·hérdáe
hlúdnáe in hallǽ; · þǽr wæs hærpan swóġ,
switul sang scopæs. · Sæġdáe sé þi cüðáe
frum-scæft fírhá · feorran ręċċan,
cwæð þæt sé æl-męhtiġá · eorðan worhtáe,
wliti-berhtnáe wang, · swáe wætær bi·býġið,
ġi·sættáe siġi-hróðiġ · sunnun ęnd mónan
leoman tó leohtáe · land-búęndum,
ęnd ġi·frætwadáe · foldan sceatas
limum ęnd leaƀum; · líƀ eac ġi·scóp
cynná ġi·hwęlcum, · þará þi cwicáe hwęrƀað.
Swáe þâ dryht-guman · dreamum libdun
eadæġ-líċáe, · öð þæt án ǫn·gán
firináe fręmman, · fiond ǫn hęllǽ:
wæs sé grimmá gâst · Grędil hâtæn,
mǽrí marc-stapá, · sé þi morhas héold,
fęnn ęnd fæstin; · fífl-cynnæs ærd
wǫn-sǽlæġ wer · wærdodáe hwílǽ,
síððan him sceppęnd · fær·scribæn hæƀdáe.
In Cáinæs cynnáe · þǫnáe cwalm ġi·wræc,
éċí dryhtin, · þæs þi hé Ábæl slóg;
ni ġi·fæh hé þærǽ fæhðáe, · æc hé hináe feorr fær·wræc,
metad fær þí mânáe · mann-cynnáe fram.
Þanan un-týdras · allǽ ǫn-wócun,
etunas ęnd ælƀí · ęnd orc-nęas,
swęlcáe ġígantas, · þâ wið godáe wunnun
langáe þrâgáe; · hé him þæs lean fær·gald.

TODO: Translation.

62 *Iorsáe* ‘Erse’ | *restoration.; om.* N 84 *ġġġ-hęti | *sens. emend.* sęġġhęti N 84 âðum-sweoran | *sens. emend.* ‘aþum swerian’ N 94 ġi·sættǽ | ġi·sęttáe *cf. l. 47* N

62 *Iorsáe* ‘Erse’ | TODO.

**2** Ġi·wât þá neosian, · síð-ðan næht bi·cwóm,
heaƕan húsæs, · hú hit Hring-Dęní
æftær beor-þeġáe · ġi·býin hæƀdun.
Fand þá þǽr innáe · æðilingá ġi·dryht

swefan æftær symblǽ; · sorgǽ ni cùðun,
wǫn-scæft werá. · Wiht un·hǽlu
grim ęnd grǽdæġ · garu sònà wæs,
reoc ęnd rǿðí, · ęnd ǫn ræstǽ ġi·nam
þrítiġ þeġná: · þanan ęft ġi·wât
hùðǽ hrømiġ · tó hâm faran,
mið þærǽ wæl-fyllu · wícá neosan.
Þá wæs on ùhtan · mið ær-dæġǽ
Grępdlæs gùð-cræft · gumum un-dęrní:
þá wæs æfter wistǽ · wóp up á·hæbæn,
miċil morgæn-swóġ. · Mǽrí þeodæn,
æðiling ær-gód, · un-blíðí sæt,
þolodǽ þrýð-swíð, · þeġn-sorgǽ dreag,
síð-ðan hiǽ þæs lâðan · lâst sceawodun,
węrġan gâstæs; · wæs þæt ġi·winn tó strang,
lâð ęnd lǫngsum. · Næs hit lęnġrá frist,
æc ymb ânǽ næht · ęft ġi·fręmidǽ
morð-balá mârǽ · ęnd nâ mærn forǽ
fæhðǽ ęnd firinǽ; · wæs tó fæst ǫn þǽm.
Þá wæs eað-fyndí, · þí him ęllæs hwǽr
ġi·rúm-lícor · ræstǽ sóhtǽ,
będd æftær búrum, · þá him ġi·beacnad wæs,
ġi·sæġd sòð-líċǽ · switulan tâcnǽ
hall-þeġnæs hęti; · hé°ld hinǽ síð-ðan
fi°rr ęnd fæstor, · sé þǽm fiond æt·wand.
Swǽ rícsodǽ · ęnd wið rihtǽ wann
ânà wið allum, · òð þæt ídæl stód
húsá sólist. · Wæs sio hwíl miċil:
twęlf-wintrá tíd · torn ġi·þolodǽ
wini Scild*ingá*, · w*âwa*ná ġi·hwęlcnǽ,
sídrá sorgá; · fær þan *ġi·sioní* wærð
ældá bærnum · un-dęrní cùð,
ġęddum jómrǽ, · þætti Grępdil wann,
hwílǽ wið Hróð-gâr;– · hęti-níðas wæġ,
firinǽ ęnd fæhðǽ · felá missærá,
sin-gâlǽ sæcǽ, · sibbǽ ni waldǽ
wið manná hwǫnǽ · mæġnæs Dęniġa
ferh-balu fe°rran, · fé þingian,
ní þǽr nǽniġ witaná · wønan þorftǽ

berhtræ bótæ · tó ban*an* folmum;
*æc sé* æġ-læċá · óhtęndí wæs,
deᵒrc deað-scúá · duguðæ ęnd juguðæ
semodæ ęnd sęridæ. · Sin-nęhtí héᵒld
mistġæ móras; · męnn ni cunnun,
hwædr hęll-rúnan · hwęrftum scríðað.
Swæ fela firiná · fiond mann-cynnæs,
atul ân-gęnġá, · oft ġi·fręmidæ
hærdrá hénðá; · Herut ærdodæ,
sinc-fâgæ sæl · swærtum næhtum
(nâ hé þǫnæ ġeb-stól · grótan móstæ,
mâðm fær metodæ, · ní his myni wissæ);
þæt wæs wræc miċil · wini Scildingá,
módæs brecðá. · Mǫnæġ-oft ġi·sæt
ríċæ tó rúnæ; · ræd æhtodun,
hwæt swíð-ferhðum · sólist wærí
wið fær-gryrum · tó ġi·fręmmannæ.
Hwílum hiæ ġi·hétun · æt h*ærg-traþum
wíġ-weᵒrðungá, · wordum bædun,
þæt him gâst-bǫná · jeocæ ġi·fręmidæ
wið þeod-þr*aw*um. · Swęlċ wæs þea hirá,
hæðinrá hyht; · hęllæ ġi·mundun
in mód-seþan, · metad hiæ ni cúðun,
dædá dǫmęnd, · ni wissun hiæ Dryhtin God,
ní hiæ h*wa*ru heþná helm · hęrjan ni cúðun,
wuldræs waldęnd. · Wâ bið þæm þi scæl
þurh slíðnæ níð · sâwlæ bi·scúþan
in fýræs fæðm, · fróþræ ni wǫnan,
wihtæ ġi·węndan; · wel bið þæm þi mót
æftær deað-dæġæ · dryhtin sǫċan
ęnd tó fadur fæðmum · friðu wilnian.

TODO: Translation.

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2 he*a*h*a*n | hean *with intervocalic* -h- *restored* N 34 Scild*ing*á | *sens. emend.;* 'scyldenda' N 34 w*â*w*a*ná | weaná *with reversal of compression* N 35 *ġi·sioní* | *restoration.; om.* N 44 ban*an* | 'banū' N 45 *æc sé* | *restoration.; om.* N 61 h*ærg-trabum | *'hrærg trafum'* N 64 þeod-þr*aw*um | þreaum *(without assimilation of* awu > ea*, cf. early Anglian* 'thrauuu'*)* N 68 h*wa*ru | huru *(without assimilation of* -wa- > -u-*)* N

# Fight at Finnsbury

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

Along with *Wald* and *Beow*, the **Fight at Finnsbury** (*Finn*) is one of three Anglo-Saxon narrative epics dealing with heroic legend.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Finn* only survives in the printed edition of Hickes (1703–1705, vol. 1, pp. 192–3), based on the original manuscript which was most likely destroyed in the Cottonian fire of 1731.

Hickes introduces the poem with the following words (original emphasis kept):

> *Eodem metro conditum forte reperi fragmenti poetici singulare folium, in codice* MS. *homiliarum* Semi-Saxonicarum *qui extat in Bibliotheca* Lambethana. *Fragmentum autem subsequitur.*
>
> 'By chance, I found a single leaf of a poetic fragment composed in the same meter, in a manuscript codex of Semi-Saxon homilies that is housed in the Lambeth Library. The fragment itself follows.'

Hickes' edition seems generally reliable, and the singular folio appears to have been in good shape. The majority of his errors are transparent spacing errors, e.g. writing two words as one (3 *'herdraca'* for **her draca*) or splitting one word in two (9 *'þis ne'* for **þisne*, 11 *'Hie geaþ'* for **Hicgeaþ*). Others are plain copying errors, e.g. reading **a* as *u* in l. 3 *'eastun'* (for **eastan*) or **þ* as the very similar *ȝ* in l. 2 *'hearo'* (for **heaþo*).

### Contents

TODO. A similar episode appears in *Beow*.

Prior to the fragment's commencing the poem would have seen Naf and his warriors encamped and asleep in the Finnsbury hall late at night. One of the men, perhaps a lookout, sees the blinking of swords and chainmail from the east and loudly asks what it may be; is it the dawn, or a dragon, or (and here the fragment picks up) are the gables of the hall burning (l. 1)? King Naf responds in parallel: it is not the dawn, nor a dragon, nor do the gables burn—rather it is a hostile army (ll. 2–9). Naf makes a speech to rouse his warriors (ll. 10–12).

TODO

## Text

„[...] *hor*nas byrnað næfre.“
“[...] gables never burn.”

1 *hor*nas | *reconstructed based on l. 4;* ‘*nas’ *Hickes*

Hleoðrode þá · heaðo-geong cyning:
„Né þis ne dagað éast*a*n, · né hér draca ne fléogeð,
né hér þisse healle · hornas ne byrnað,
ac hér forð berað · fugelas singað,
gylleð græg-hama, · gúð-wudu hlynneð,
scyld scęfte on·cwyð. · Nú scíneð þes mona
waðol under wolcnum; · nú á·rísað wéa-dǽda,
þe þisne folces níð · fręmman willað.
Ac on·wacnigeað nú, · wígend míne,
hębbað éowre *b*anda, · hicgeað on ęllen,
win*n*að on orde, · wesað on móde!“

Then bellowed out the battle-young king:
“This is no dawning from the east, nor does a dragon fly hither,
nor here on this hall do the gables burn—
but here they bear forth arms, the birds sing,
the grey-pelt [WOLF] howls, the war-wood [SHIELD] dins,
the shield clashes against the spear. Now shines the moon,
wandering behind the clouds; now arise the woeful deeds
which wish to fulfill the evil of this host.
Yet awaken now, ye my warriors!
Raise your hands, put your minds to zeal,
win by the spear-point, be in brave spirits!”

2 heaðo-geong | ‘hearo geong’ *(for* *heaþo geong*) Hickes* 3 éast*a*n | ‘Eastun’ *Hickes* 3 hér draca | ‘herdraca’ *Hickes* 5 forð berað | ‘forþberað’ *Hickes* 7 scíneð | scýneð *Hickes* 9 þisne | ‘ðis ne’ *Hickes* 11 *b*anda | landa *Hickes* 11 hicgeað | ‘Hie geaþ’ *Hickes* 12 win*n*að | ‘Windað’ *Hickes*

10–12 Ac ... móde! ‘Yet ... spirits!’ | It has often been noted that Naf’s rousing of the sleeping warriors bears a strong resemblance to Beader’s speech in *Bjarkamál in fornu* 1, ll. 3–4 (Anon *Bjark* in SkP 3): *Vaki ę ok vaki, · vina haufuð, // allir inir óðstu · Aðils of sinnar.* ‘Wake now and wake, ye chief of friends; all the noblest companions of Edyils!’

Þá á·râs mǫnig gold-hladen þegn, · gyrde hine his swurde;
þá tó dura éodon · driht=líce cęmpan,
Sige·ferð and Éaha, · hyra sweord ge·tugon,

and æt ȯðrum durum · Ord·lâf and Gȕð·lâf,
and Hęngest sylf; · hwearf him on lâste.

Then arose many a gold-laden thane, girded on his sword.
Then to the door went the lordly champions
Syeferth and Eah—they drew their swords—
and at the other door Ordlaf and Guthlaf
and Hengest himself; he followed in their tracks.

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13 gyrde hine his swurde 'girded on his sword' | Cf. *Hild* 5b.

Þá gít Gâr·ulf · Gȕð·ere styrode,
þæt híe swá fréo≠líc feorh · forman sïðe
tó þǽre healle durum · hyrsta ne bǽron,
nú hyt níða heard · á·nyman wolde:
ac hé frægn ofer eal · un·dearninga,
déor-mód hæleð, · hwá þá duru héolde.

TODO: Translation

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19 forman | 'for man' *Hickes*

„Sige·ferð is mïn nama", (cwæð hé) „ic eom Secgena léod,
wręcca wíde cȕð. · Fela ic wéana ge·bâd,
heardra hilda; · þé is gýt hér witod,
swæðer þú sylf tó mé · søcean wylle."

TODO: Translation

Þá wæs on wealle · wæl-slihta ge·hlyn,
sceolde celæs bord · cónum on handa
bân-helm berstan. · Buruh-þelu dynede,
oð þæt æt þǽre gȕðe · Gâr·ulf ge·crang,
ealra ǽrest · eorð-búendra,
Gȕð·lâfes sunu; · ymbe hine gódra fela
hwearf-latra hrǽw. · Hræfen wandrode
sweart and sealo-brùn; · swurd-léoma stód
swylce eal Finnes-buruh · fýrenu wǽre.

TODO: Translation
Until in that battle Garulf perished
earliest of all earth-dwellers [MEN],
the son of Guthlaf. Around him a great many of good men,
the corpses of those late to flight. A raven wandered,

black and dusky brown. The sword-flash stood
as if all Finnsbury were a burning beacon.

Ne ge·frægn ic næfre wurð=lícor · æt wera hilde
sixtig sige-beorna · sól ge·bæran,
ne næfre swânas swøtne · medo sól for·gyldan,
þonne Hnæfe guldon · his hæg-stealdas.
Hig fuhton fíf dagas, · swá hyra nân ne féol
driht-ge·síðа, · ac hig þá duru héoldon.

I have not learned that in a worthier manner in the fight of men
ever sixty triumph-warriors better carried themselves
nor ever lads better repaid sweet mead
than Naf was repaid by his young warriors.
They fought for five days while not one fell
among that troop-fellowship, yet they held the doors.

Þá ge·wât him wund hæleð · on wæg gangan,
sǽde þæt his byrne · á·brocen wære,
hęre-sceorp un·hrór, · and éac wæs his helm þyrl.
Þá hine sóna frægn · folces hyrde,
hú þá wígend · hyra wunda ge·nǽson
oððe hwæðer þǽra hyssa

Then went a wounded hero, walking away;
he said that his byrnie was broken up,
his war-gear powerless, and his helmet, too, was pierced.
Then he was soon asked by the herdsman of the troop [LEADER]
how the warriors were treating their wounds,
or … of the boys …

# Walder
# *(Wald·hęre)*

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

**Walder** (*Wald*) is an Old English epic fragment.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wald* is preserved on two folios clearly belonging to the same manuscript. They are housed in the royal library of Copenhagen and together given the signum NKS MS 167 b 4º (henceforth abbrev. as 167). The text on the two folios is not continuous, and the present edition therefore does not number them continuously, instead splitting the text into two parts. *Wald* A corresponds to the text on 167 1r–v and *Wald* B to 167 2r–v.

For the manuscript I have inspected the digital facsimile at `https://digipal.eu/digipal/page/1072/`.

### Story

The majority of the surviving poem consists of dialogue.

The taunts between the heroes Walder and Guther in fragment B is very reminiscent of the dialogue in *Hild*.

## Text

### Part A

**A** [...] hyrde hyne georne:

TODO: Translation.

„Húru Welandes · worc ne ge·swíceð
mǫnna ænigum · þâra þe Mimming can
heardne ge·healdan. · Oft æt hilde ge·dreas
swât-fâg and sweord-wund · secg æfter òðrum.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Ætlan ord-wyga, · ne lǽt þín ęllen nú gyt
ge·dréosan to dæge, dryht-scipe.
*Nú* is se dæg cumen
þæt þú scealt âninga · òðer twęga,
líf for·leosan · oððe langne dóm
âgan mid ęldum, · Ælf·hęres sunu!

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Nalles ic þé, wine mín, · wordum cíde,
þý ic þé ge·sáwe · æt ðâm sweord-plegan
þurh ed·wít-scype · ǽniges mǫnnes
wíg for·bugan · oððe ǫn weal fléön,
líce beorgan, · þeah þe lâðra fela
þínne byrn-hǫmon · billum heowun.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Ac þú symle furðor · feohtan sóhtest,
mæl ofer mearce; · þý ic þe metod ǫn·dréd,
þæt þú to fyren-líce · feohtan sóhtest
æt þâm æt·stealle · ǫðres mǫnnes,
wíg-rædenne. · Weorða þé selfne
gódum dædum, · þęnden þín God ręcce.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Ne murn þú for þí méce; · þé wearð mâðma cyst
gifeðe to geoce, · mid þý þú Güð·hęre scealt
beot for·bígan, · þæs þe hé þás beaduwe ǫn·gan
*mi*d un-ryhte · ǽrest sócan.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

For·sóc hé þâm swurde · and þâm sync-fatum,
béaga mænigo; · nú sceal béaga-léas
hworfan frǫm þisse hilde, · hlâfurd sócan
ealdne óðel · oððe hér ǽr swefan,
gif hé þá [...]“

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

**Part B**

**B** „...ce bæteran

b·útǫn þâm ânum · þe ic éac hafa
ǫn stân-fate · stille ge·híded.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Ic wât þæt hit þóhte · Þeod·ric Widian
selfum ǫn·sendon, · and éac sinc micel
mâðma mid þí méce, · mǫnig óðres mid him
golde ge·girwan · (iu-léan ge·nam),
þæs þe hine of nearwum · Níð·hades mæg,
Welandes bearn, · Widia út for·lét;
þurh fifela ge·weald · fǫrð ǫn·ętte.“

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Wald·ęre maðelode, · wíga ęllen-rof,
hæfde him ǫn handa · hilde-frófre,
güð-billa gripe, · gyddode wordum:

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation

„Hwæt þú húru wǿndest, · wine Burgenda,
þæt mé Hagenan hand · hilde ge·frǫmede
and ge·twæmde *fé*ðe-wigges. · Feta, gyf þú dyrre,
æt þus heaðu-wórigan · hâre byrnan.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation

Standeð mé hér ǫn eaxelum · Ælf·hęres lâf,
gód and géap-nęb, · golde ge·weorðod,

ealles un·scende · æðelinges réaf
to habbanne, · þǫnne hand węreð
feorh-hord feondum. · Ne bið fâh wið mé,
þǫnne … un·mægas · ęft ǫn·gynnað,
mécum ge·møtað, · swá gé mé dydon.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation

23 … | *2–3 illegible characters, possibly erased already by the scribe ms.*

Þeah mæg sige syllan · sé þe symle byð
recon and ræd-fęst · ryhta ge·hwilces.
Sé þe him tó þâm hâlgan · helpe ge·lifeð,
to Gode gioce, · hé þǽr gearo findeð
gif þá earnunga · ǽr ge·þęnceð.

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation.

Þǫnne móten wlance · welan britnian,
æhtum wealdan, · þæt is […]“

TODO: Translation
TODO: Translation

# Widsith
# *(Wíd·síþ)*

**Dating:** C7th–8th (Neidorf 2013)
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

**Widsith** (*Wíd*) is an archaic heroic poem.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wíd* is found in **E** on foll. 84v/11–87r/8. It comes after the Christian "Vainglory" (*Hwæt, mé fród wita* ...) and is followed by the Christian "Fortunes of Mortals" (*Ful oft þæt ge·gongeð* ...).

### Meter and stanza

Like *Déor*, *Wíd* is clearly stanzaic. This stands in stark contrast with almost all other West Germanic legendary poetry which is stichic. On the other hand it agrees well with Norse poetry, especially those Norse poems (e.g. *Vkv*) which are less strict with the 4-line stanza and frequently admit ones also of 3 or 5 lines.

For ease of reference with earlier editions, the line numbers are numbered continuously rather than per-stanza.

## Text

**1** Wíd·síð maðolade, · word-hord ǫn·leac,
sé þe mâst · mærþa ofer eorþan,
folca geond·fǽrde; · oft hé flętte ge·þâh
myne-lícne mâþþum. · Hine frǫm Myrgingum
æþele ǫn·wócon. · He mid Ealh·hilde,
fǽlre freoþu-wębban, · forman síþe
Hreð-cyninges · hâm ge·sóhte
éastan of Ǫngle, · Eorman-ríces,
wrâþes wær-logan. · Ǫn·gǫnn þá worn sprecan:

WIDSITH SPOKE, unlocked his word-hoard,
he who furthest through tribes on the earth
and nations had journeyed. Oft on the bench had he received
delightful treasures. Amongst the Mirgings
he had his ancestry. Along with Elhild,
the good peace-weaveress, for the very first time
he had sought out the Reth-King's realm
to the east of the Angles: [the realm] of Ermenric
the fierce oath-breaker. He then began a long speech:

---

ALL | The narrator begins with a 9-line introduction.

6 freoþu-wębban 'peace-weaveress' | A woman used in a political marriage to bring peace between two tribes or families, in this case between a king Edwin (st. 20) and Ermenric of the Gots.

7 Hreð-cyninges 'Reth-King' | Ermenric, the king of the Reth-Gots, which is apparently just a poetic name for the Eastern Gots; cf. ll. 18, 57, 88–89, also *Vafþ* 12/3 n. and Ög 136 Rök (under Runic poetry).

**2** „Fela ic mǫnna ge·frægn · mægþum wealdan.
Sceal þéoda ge·hwylc · þéawum lifgan,
eorl æfter ǫþrum · óðle rædan,
sé þe his þéoden-stól · ge·þéon wile.

"A great deal of men I've learned ruling tribes.
Every person shall live in virtue,
each earl after the other lead his homeland
who on his sovereign seat will prosper.

**3** Þâra wæs *H*wala · hwíle sólast,
ǫnd Alexandreas · ealra rícost
mǫnna cynnes, · ǫnd he mâst ge·þáh
þâra þe ic ofer foldan · ge·frægen hæbbe.

Of them was Wale for a while the best,
and Alexander of all the strongest
of mankind, and he prospered most
of those men over the earth of whom I've learned.

14 *H*wala | Wala **E**

**4** Ætla weold Húnum, · Eorman·ríc Gotum,
Becca Baningum, · Burgendum Gifica.
Câsere weold Créacum · ǫnd Cælic Finnum,
Hagena Holm-rycum · ǫnd Henden Glommum.

Attle ruled the Huns, Ermenric the Gots,
Beck the Banings, Yivick the Burgends.
Coser ruled the Greeks and Calic the Finns,
Hawn the Holmrighs and Henden the Glams."

**5** Witta weold Swǽfum, · Wada Hælsingum,
Meaca Myrgingum, · Mearch·ealf Hundingum.
Þéod·ríc weold Frǫncum, · Þyle Rǫndingum,
Breoca Brǫndingum, · Billing Wernum.
Ós·wine weold Eowum · ǫnd Ytum Gef·wulf,
Finn Folc·walding · Fresna cynne.

Wit ruled the Swebes, Wade the Helsings,
Mack the Mirgings, Marchalf the Hundings.
Thedric ruled the Franks, Thyle the Randings,
Brack the Brandings, Billing the Werns.
Oswin ruled the Eawes and Gefwolf the Ytes,
Finn Folkwalding the race of Frisians.

**6** Sige·hęre lęngest · sǽ-Dęnum weold,
Hnæf Hocingum, · Helm Wulfingum,
Wald Wóingum, · Wód Þyringum,
Sǽ·ferð Sycgum, · Swéom Ongend·þeow,
Sceaft·hęre Ymbrum, · Sceafa Lǫng-beardum,
Hún Hæt-werum · ǫnd Holen Wrosnum;
Hring·wald wæs hâten · Hęre-farena cyning.

Sigar for the longest ruled the sea-Danes,
Naf the Hockings, Helm the Wolvings,
Wold the Wooings, Wood the Thirings,
Seaferth the Sidges, Angenthew the Swedes,
Shafter the Imbres, Sheaf the Longbeards,

Hown the Hatweres, and Holen the Wrasens;
Ringold was the name of the king of Herefarers.

**7**

Offa weold Ǫngle, · Ale·wíh Dęnum;
sé wæs þâra manna · módgast ealra,
no hwæþre he ofer Offan · eorl-scype fręmede,
ac Offa ge·slóg · æ̂rest mǫnna,
cniht-wesende, · cyne-ríca mæ̂st.

Offe ruled the Angles, Alewigh the Danes;
of these men he was bravest of all,
but he did not further greater earlship than Offe,
for Offe conquered—youngest of men,
still a boy—the greatest of kingdoms.

---

ALL | The great praise here accorded to Offe, the legendary ruler of the continental Angles from whom the Anglo-Saxons claimed desent, is parallelled by *Beow* 1954–1960a.

**8**

Nænig efen-eald him · eorl-scipe mâran
ǫn or·ętte: · âne sweorde
męrce ge·mæ̂rde · wið Myrgingum
bi Fífel-dore; · heoldon forð siþþan
Ęngle ǫnd Swæfe, · swá hit Offa ge·slóg.

No man of his age accomplished
greater earlship: with a single sword
he marked the border against the Mirgings
by Fiveldoor. It was thenceforth held
by the Angles and Swebes as Offe had won it.

**9**

Hróþ·wulf ǫnd Hróð·gâr · heoldon lęngest
sibbe æt·sǫmne · suhtor-fædran,
siþþan hý for·wrǽcon · Wícinga cynn
ǫnd Ingeldes · ord for·bigdon,
for·heowon æt Heorote · Heaðo-beardna þrym.

Rotholf and Rothgar held for the longest
the peace together, uncle and nephew,
since they drove away the race of Wikings,
and bent down Ingeld's spear-point;
at Hart they cut down the host of the Hathbeards.

---

49 Heorote 'Hart' | The legendary hall of the Danish kings, the Shieldings. It is described at length in *Beow*.

**10** Swá ic geond·fǿrde fela · fręmdra lǫnda
geond ginne grund. · Gódes ǫnd yfles
þǽr ic cunnade; · cnósle bi·dǽled,
fréo-mǽgum feor · folgade wíde.

So I journeyed through a great deal of strange lands
through the wide world. Of good and evil
I there became acquainted. Of kin deprived,
far from dear kinsmen, I strayed widely.

**11** For·þǫn ic mæg singan · ǫnd sęcgan spell,
mǽnan fore męngo · in meodu-healle
hú mé cyne-góde · cystum dohten.

Therefore I can sing and tell tales,
recall before the many in the mead-hall,
how men of good kin treated me with grace.

**12** Ic wæs mid Húnum · ǫnd mid Hreð-Gotum,
mid Swéom ǫnd mid Géatum · ǫnd mid súþ-Dęnum.
Mid Węnlum ic wæs ǫnd mid Wærnum · ǫnd mid
Wícingum;
mid Gefþum ic wæs ǫnd mid Winedum · ǫnd mid Gefflegum;
mid Ęnglum ic wæs ǫnd mid Swǽfum · ǫnd mid Ænenum;
mid Seaxum ic wæs ǫnd Sycgum · ǫnd mid Sweord-werum;
mid Hronum ic wæs ǫnd mid Déanum · ǫnd mid
Heaþo-Réamum.

I was among Huns and among Reth-Gots,
among Swedes and among Geats, and among south-Danes.
Among Wendles I was and among Warns, and among Wikings;
among Yefths I was and among Wends, and among Yefflegs;
among Angles I was and among Swebes, and among Anens;
among Saxes I was and among Sidges, and among Sword-weres;
among Ranes I was and among Deans, and among Hath-Reams.

**13** Mid Þyringum ic wæs · ǫnd mid Þrowendum,
ǫnd mid Burgendum, · þǽr ic béag ge·þâh;
mé þǽr Gúð·hęre for·geaf · glæd-lícne maþþum
sǫnges to léane. · Næs þæt sæne cyning!

Among Thirings I was and among Throwends
and among the Burgends where I received a bigh;

there Guther gladdened me with treasures
as reward for my song. That was not a bad king!

68 **14** Mid Frǫncum ic wæs ǫnd mid Frysum · ǫnd mid Frumtingum;
mid Rugum ic wæs ǫnd mid Glǫmmum · ǫnd mid Rúm-walum.

Among Franks I was and among Frises, and among Frumtings;
among Ruges I was and among Glams, and among Rome-Wales.

70 **15** Swylce ic wæs ǫn Eatule · mid Ælf·wine,
sé hæfde mǫn-cynnes, · mǐne ge·fræge,
72 leohteste hǫnd · lofes tó wyrcenne,
heortan un·hneaweste · hringa ge·dâles,
74 beorhtra béaga, · bearn Éad·wines.

Likewise was I in Italy with Elfwin.
Of mankind he had—as I have learned—
the lightest hand in working generosity,
the unstingiest heart in the dealing of rings
and bright bighs, the child of Edwin.

---

70 Ælf·wine 'Elfwin' | Latin *Alboinus* (530s – 28 June 572), king of the Longbeards. As king he succeeded his father Edwin (Latin *Audoinus*) and led the Longbeards to settle in Northern Italy, where they established their kingdom and gave the region its present name, Lombardy.

**16** Mid Sęrcingum ic wæs · ǫnd mid Seringum;
76 mid Creacum ic wæs ǫnd mid Finnum · ǫnd mid Câsere,
sé þe wĭn-burga · ge·weald áhte,
78 wiolena ǫnd wilna, · ǫnd Wala ríces.

Among Serkings I was and among Searings;
among Greeks I was and among Finns, and with Coser,
he who held dominion over wine-towns,
over wealth and concubines and the realm of the Wales.

---

75 Sęrcingum 'Serkings' | Probably related to 'Saracen'. Cf. ON *Sęrk-land* 'Serkland', a name for Arabia or North Africa, which appears to be from the same Germanic source.

76 Câsere 'Coser' | Caesar, the Roman Emperor, but no particular historical emperor is intended. Cf. *Vkv* P1, 15, *Hild* 33.

77 wĭn-burga 'wine-towns' | Roman wineyards.

78 Wala ríces 'the realm of the Wales' | The Roman Empire, or more specifically Gaul (which in ON was known as *Val-land* from the same root). For the use of *Walas* 'Wales' in the sense 'Romans' see st. 14/2 above

**17** Mid Scottum ic wæs ǫnd mid Peohtum · ǫnd mid Scríde-Finnum;
mid Líd-wícingum ic wæs ǫnd mid Léonum · ǫnd mid Lǫng-beardum,
mid hǽðnum ǫnd mid hæleþum · ǫnd mid Hundingum.

Among Scots I was and among Picts, and among Shrithe-Finns;
among Lid-Wikings I was among Leans, and among Longbeards;
among heathens and among heroes and among Hundings.

**18** Mid Israhelum ic wæs · ǫnd mid Exsyringum,
mid Ebreum ǫnd mid Indeum · ǫnd mid Egyptum.
Mid Moidum ic wæs ǫnd mid Persum · ǫnd mid Myrgingum,
ǫnd Mofdingum · ǫnd on·gęnd Myrgingum,
ǫnd mid Amoþingum. · Mid Éast-Þyringum ic wæs
ǫnd mid Eolum ǫnd mid Istum · ǫnd Idumingum.

Among Israelites I was and among Assyrians,
among Hebrews and among Indians and among Egyptians.
Among the Medes I was and among Persians, and among Mirgings
and Mofdings and again the Mirgings
and among Amothings. Among East-Thirings I was
and among Eals and among Ists, and Idumings.

86 Amoþingum | 'Amothingum' **E**

**19** Ǫnd ic wæs mid Eorman·ríce · ealle þráge,
þǽr mé Gotena cyning · góde dohte;
sé mé béag for·geaf, · burg-warena fruma,
ǫn þam siex hund wæs · smǽtes goldes,
ge·scyred sceatta · scilling-ríme;
þǫne ic Éad·gilse · ǫn ǽht sealde,
mínum hléo-dryhtne, · þá ic tó hâm bi·cwǫm,
léofum to léane, · þæs þe hé mé lǫnd for·geaf,
mínes fæder óþel, · fréa Myrginga.

And I was with Ermenric for the longest time,
where the king of the Gots treated me well.
He gave me a bigh—that chief of city-dwellers—
in which were reckoned six hundred shats
of purest gold in shilling-count.
I gave it up to the possession of Edyils,
my dear shelter and lord, when I came home,

as repayment for his giving me land,
—that lord of Mirgins—my father's ethel.

**20** Ǫnd mé þá Ealh·hild · ǫþerne for·geaf,
dryht-cwén duguþe, · dohtor Éad·wines;
hyre lof lęngde · geond lǫnda fela.
Þǫnne ic be sǫnge · sęcgan sceolde
hwær ic under swegl · sólast wisse
gold-hrodene cwén · giefe bryttian.

And then Elhild gave me another one,
the noble queen of the old troop, daughter of Edwin;
her praise stretched far through many lands.
Then in my song I had to say,
where beneath the sun I knew the best
gold-adorned queen dispensing gifts.

**21** Þǫnne wit Scilling · scíran reorde
for uncrum sige-dryhtne · sǫng a·hófon,
hlúde bí hearpan, · hleoþor swinsade,
þǫnne mǫnige męnn, · módum wlǫnce,
wordum sprécon, · þá þe wel cùþon,
þæt hí næfre sǫng · sóllan ne hýrdon.

Then I and Shilling with clear voices
for our victorious lord raised up a song,
loud by the harp—the tune rang out.
Then many men proud of heart
told with words—those who knew well—
that they never had heard a better song.

**22** Ðǫnan ic ealne geond·hwearf · óþel Gotena,
sóhte ic â síþa · þá sólestan;
þæt wæs inn-weorud · E*a*rman·rices.

Thence I passed through all the ethel of the Gots;
I always sought out the best companions;
that was the inner retinue of Ermenric.

111 E*a*rman·rices | eormanrices **E**

**23** Heðcan sóhte ic ǫnd Beadecan · ǫnd Hęre-lingas,
Emercan sóhte ic ǫnd Fridlan · ǫnd Éast-Gotan,

fródne ǫnd gódne · fæder Un·wǫnes.

TODO

**24** Seccan sóhte ic ǫnd Beccan, · Seafolan ǫnd Þéod·ríc,
Heaþo·ríc ǫnd Sifecan, · Hliþe ǫnd Incgen·þeow.
Éad·wine sóhte ic ǫnd Elsan, · Ægel·mund ǫnd Hún·gâr,
ǫnd þá wlǫncan ge·dryht · Wiþ-myrginga.

TODO

**25** Wulf·hęre sóhte ic ǫnd Wyrm·hęre; · ful oft þǽr wíg ne á·læg,
þǫnne Hræda hęre · heardum sweordum
ymb Wistla-wudu · węrgan sceoldon
ealdne óþel-stól · Ætlan léodum.

I sought out Wolfer and Wyrmer—most seldom there the warring ceased
when the Reth-host with hard swords
in the Wistlewood had to defend
the old ethel-seat against Attle's folk.

**26** Rǽd·hęre sóhte ic ǫnd Rǫnd·hęre, · Rúm·stân ǫnd Gisl·hęre,
Wiþer·gield ǫnd Freoþe·ric, · Wudgan ǫnd Hâman;
ne wǽron þæt ge·síþa · þá sǽmestan,
þéah þe ic hý a·níhst · nęmnan sceolde.

I sought out Reeder and Rander, Roomstan and Yisler,
Witheryeld and Frithric, Woody and Homer;
nor were those the worst of companions,
although I last should mention them.

**27** Ful oft of þâm héape · hwínende fléag
giellende gâr · ǫn grǫme þéode;
wræccan þǽr weoldon · wundnan golde
werum ǫnd wífum, · Wudga ǫnd Hâma.

Most often from that troop did fly a whizzing,
yelling spear into the fiendish folk.
There ruled the exiles Woody and Homer
over twisted gold, men and women.

---

128 giellende gâr 'yelling spear' | Formulaic. Cf. in ON *Akv* 5/2a: *af gęiri gjallanda*, Egill Lv 9/2a (SkP 5): *ok gjallanda gęiri*.

**28** Swá ic þæt symle ǫn·fǫnd · ǫn þâre fęringe,
þæt sé biþ léofast · lǫnd-búendum
sé þe him God syleð · gumena ríce
to ge·healdenne, · þęnden hé hér leofað.“

So I always found while on that journey,
that he is dearest to land-dwellers [MEN],
whom God grants sovereignity of men
for to hold while here he lives.”

**29** Swá scríþende · ge·sceapum hweorfað
gléo-męnn gumena · geond grunda fela,
þearfe sęcgað, · þǫnc-word sprecaþ,
simle sùð oþþe norð · sumne ge·mǿtað
gydda gleawne, · geofum un·hneawne,
sé þe fore duguþe wile · dóm a·râran,
eorl-scipe æfnan, · oþ·þæt eal scæceð,
leoht ǫnd lif sǫmod; · lof sé ge·wyrceð,
hafað under heofonum · héah-fæstne dóm.

So passing through fates they wander,
the song-men of mankind, through many lands.
They tell their needs, speak thoughtful words;
whether in the south or north they meet some one,
gay in songs, unstingy with gifts,
who for the old troop will rear up fame,
accomplish earlship until all goes away,
light and life together. He who works generosity
has under the heavens high, lasting fame.

---

ALL | Widsith's speech ends, and the narrator (who last spoke in ll. 1–9) reflects on the importance of generosity and providing hospitality for wayfaring strangers in another 9-line st.

# Deer
# *(Deor)*

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

**Deer** (*Déor*) is a short elegiac poem. Across seven stanzas, the eponymous poet likens his own tragic fate to famous stories from Germanic heroic legend.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Déor* is preserved only in **E** on fol. 100r/8–100v/13, where it follows the Christian poem "Soul and Body II" (*Húru, þæs be·hófaþ* ...) and is followed by the heroic *Wulf*.

### Contents

The poem briefly summarizes the tragic lives of five figures from Germanic heroic legend, each ending with the refrain *Þæs ofer·eode · þisses swá mæg* 'That passed over; this may likewise.' After this the poet reflects on fate, and finally tells his own story as an outcast.

#### The legends

The five legendary figures mentioned in the poem are:

1. Wayland the Smith, who was captured by the tyrant Nithad and forced to make jewelry for him and his family. He took revenge by raping
2. Nithad's daughter, Beadhild. The child born from this act was Woody (OE *Wudga*), an obscure hero.
3. Mathild, the protagonist of a poorly attested love tragedy.

4. Thedric the Great, who ruled over the Gots.
5. Ermenric, who succeeded Thedric, and was eventually slain.

**Deer**

The name of the poet, *Déor*, first revealed in line 37, is the ancestor of modern English "deer". Although it can carry this sense in Old English, it can also betoken 'beast, animal' more generally. The word is not otherwise known as a personal name and is therefore probably fictional; we may perhaps compare *Fáfn* 2, where the young hero Siward calls himself *gǫfugt dýr* 'noble beast/deer'.

## Text

**1** Wélund him be wurman · wræces cunnade,
ân-hýdig eorl · earfoþa dréag,
hæfde him tó ge·siþþe · sorge ǫnd lǫngaþ,
winter-cealde wræce; · wéan oft ǫn·fǫnd,
siþþan hine Níð·had ǫn · néde lęgde,
swǫncre seono-bende · ǫn syllan mǫnn.
Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

WAYLAND ALONGSIDE WORMS experienced his exile;
the one-minded earl suffered hardship,
had with him as companions sorrow and longing,
winter-cold exile. Woes he often found
after Nithad upon him fetters did lay,
heavy sinew-bonds upon the better man.
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

---

1 be wurman 'alongside worms' | I take this to be a description of Wayland's desolate state after his hamstringing; he is forced to crawl on the ground in the company of worms (by which is also understood serpents). — The possibility of this word being an English form of German *Worms*, the capital of the Burgends, is unlikely since the OHG name for the city contemporary to the poem was *Wormazia*.

**2** Beado·hilde ne wæs · hyre bróþra déaþ
on sefan swá sâr · swá hyre sylfre þing,
þæt heo gearo-líce · on·gieten hæfde
þæt heo éacen wæs; · æfre ne meahte
þriste ge·þęncan, · hú ymb þæt sceolde.
Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

For Beadhild was not her brothers' deaths
in her heart so sore as her own thing,
that she clearly had understood
that she was pregnant. Never could she
boldly think out how she would manage that.
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

**3** Wé þæt Mæð·hilde · mǫnge ge·frugnon
wurdon grund-léase · Geates frige,
þæt hí seo sorg-lufu · slæp ealle bi·nǫm.
Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

We have learned that for Mathild many
bottomless [troubles] arose, for Geat's beloved,
that the sorrowful love deprived her of all sleep.
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

**4**

Þeod·ríc âhte · þrítig wintra
Mǽringa burg; · þæt wæs mǫnegum cúþ.
Þæs ofer·éode, · þisses swá mæg!

Thedric owned for thirty winters
the stronghold of the Meerings; that was known to many.
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

**5**

Wé ge·ascodan · Eorman·ríces
wylfenne ge·þóht; · âhte wíde folc
Gotena ríces. · Þæt wæs grim cyning!
Sæt sęcg mǫnig · sorgum ge·bunden,
wéan on wénan, · wýscte ge·neahhe
þæt þæs cyne-ríces · ofer·cumen wǽre.
Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

We have learned of Ermenric's
wolven nature. He wielded widely the host
of the realm of the Gots; that was a grim king.
Many a man sat bound in sorrows,
with woes in his thoughts, wishing aplenty
that that kingdom might be overcome.
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

---

23 Þæt wæs grim cyning! 'that was a grim king!' | Formulaic; cf. *Wíd* TODO: *Næs þæt séne cyning!* 'That was not a bad king!', *Beow* 11b: *Þæt wæs gód cyning!* 'That was a good king!'

**6**

Siteð sorg-céarig, · sǽlum bi·dǽled,
on sefan sweorceð, · sylfum þinceð
þæt sý ęnde-léas · earfoda dǽl.
Mæg þǫnne ge·þęncan, · þæt geond þás woruld
witig dryhten · węndeþ ge·neahhe,
eorle mǫnegum · âre ge·sceawað,
wís-licne blǽd, · sumum wéana dǽl.

One sits troubled by sorrow, of blessings bereft;
his heart darkens; to himself he thinks
that endless must be his share of hardships.
Then he may come to think that throughout this world

the Wise Lord turns His coat aplenty:
to many an earl honour He shows,
sure success—to another a share of woes.

7 Þæt ic bi mé sylfum · sęcgan wille,
36 þæt ic hwile wæs · Heodeninga scóp,
dryhtne dýre— · mé wæs Deor nǫma.
38 Âhte ic fela wintra · folgað tilne,
holdne hláford, · oþ þæt Heorrenda nú,
40 léoð-cræftig mǫnn · lǫnd-ryht ge·þâh,
þæt mé eorla hléo · ǽr ge·sealde.
42 Þæs ofer·eode, · þisses swá mæg!

This of myself I wish to say,
that for a while I was the Heedenings's shop,
dear to their lord; Deer was my name.
I had for a great many winters a good retinue,
a hold bread-giver—until Harrend now,
the lay-crafty man, has won the land-right
which the shelter of earls [KING] to *me* once granted.
*That* passed over; *this* may likewise.

# Wolf and Edwaker
# *(Wulf and Éad·wacer)*

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay, Leeds-meter

## Introduction

**Wolf and Edwaker** (*Wulf*) is a mysterious stanzaic poem.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wulf* is found in **E** on foll. 100v/14–101r/4. It comes after the heroic elegy *Déor* and is followed by Riddles 1–59 (*Hwylc is hæleþa þæs horsc* ...). rom the Exeter Book.

## Text

**1** Léodum is mĭ̄num · swylce him mǫn lâc gife;
willað hý hine á·þęcgan, · gif hé ǫn þréat cymeð.
Un-ge·líc is ús.

For my people it is as if one gave them an offering;
they wish to devour him if he comes upon that host.
It is not so for us.

**2** Wulf is ǫn iege, · ic ǫn óþerre;
fæst is þæt eg-lǫnd, · fęnne bi·worpen.
Sindon wæl-reowe · weras þǽr ǫn ige;
willað hý hine á·þęcgan, · gif hé ǫn þréat cymeð.
Un-ge·líce is ús.

Wolf is on an island, I on another;
fast is that island, surrounded by water.
There are slaughter-fierce warriors there on the island;
they wish to devour him if he comes upon that host.
It is not so for us.

**3** Wulfes ic mĭ̄nes wíd-lâstum · wénum dogode,
þǫnne hit wæs rénig weder · ǫnd ic réotugu sæt;
þǫnne mec sé beadu-câfa · bógum bi·lęgde,
wæs mé wyn tó þǫn, · wæs mé hwæþre éac lâð.

The far journeys of my Wolf I've thought of in my yearnings,
when it was rainy weather and I sat grieving,
when the battle-bold man laid his arms around me,
I found joy in that, yet also found it loathsome.

**4** Wulf, mĭ̄n Wulf, · wéna mé þĭ̄ne
séoce ge·dydon, · þĭ̄ne seld-cymas,
murnende mód, · nales męte-liste.

Wolf, my Wolf! My yearnings for thee
have made me sick, and thy rare comings,
a mourning mind—nowise want of food!

**5** Ge·hýrest þú, Éad·wacer? · Uncerne earne hwelp
bireð Wulf to wuda;

þæt mǫn éaþe tó·sliteð · þætte nǽfre ge·sǫmnad wæs,
4 uncer giedd geador.

Hearest thou Edwaker? Our wretched whelp
is carried by Wolf to the woods.
One easily tears apart that which was never put together:
our song together.

# Lay of Hildbrand
# *(Hildebrandslied)*

**Dating:** C8th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Lay of Hildbrand** (*Hild*) is the only surviving High German alliterative poem dealing with native legendary material and is such of immense value.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Hild* is preserved in the 2° Ms. theol. 54 of the Kassel university library (ca. 820 AD, henceforth labelled **K**) where it is written in a different hand (ca. 830 AD) on the outer covers, foll. 1r and 76v. 76v ends in the middle of a line and the poem is thus fragmentary.

### Language

The language of *Hild* is one of the great mysteries of German philology since it reflects a strange and clearly unnatural mix of Old High German and Old Saxon.

Let us begin with an overview of features. For transparency, the quoted forms will be in their manuscript orthography and not normalised.

TODO: list is incomplete!

The following features are clearly Old Saxon:

1. The Ingvaeonic nasal spirant law /Vnθ/ > /Ṽːθ/ (*guđ-* 5, *ódre* 12, *chud* 13, 28, *usere* 15, *gudea* 59).

2. m. nom. pl. *-os* (*helidos* 6).

3. Loss of **-ʀ* after a vowel in monosyllabic words (*mi* 12a, 12b, 15, 41; but cf. TODO below).

4. Unshifted *-k* in *ik* 'I' (cf. below).

On the other hand, the following features are clearly High German:

1. **wr-* > *r-*, as required by the alliteration between *reccheo* and *riche* (l. 47 n.)
2. Preserved **-ʀ* (> *-r*) after a vowel in monosyllabic words.
3. Neuter adj. nom./acc. sg. *-at* (*suasat* 52).
4. **þ* > *d* (see below).
5. The High German consonant shift (see below).

The last two changes affect such a great number of words that their examples ought to be listed separately.

### **þ* > *d*

This change eventually came to affect most of continental Germanic (including non-High German varieties like Dutch and Low German), but in the 9th c. had not yet spread to OS and is therefore an OHG diagnostic feature.

1. *þ* (*ð*: *ðat* 1, 2, *haðubrant* 3, *guð-* 5; *th*: *theotribhe* 19) > *d* (*helidos* 6, *do* 6, 32, 62, 64, *dero* 6, 60, *eddo* 11, 53, *du* 11, 12, 31, 38, 40, 47, 47, 54, 56, *de* 12, 59, *ódre* 12, *chind* (< **kinþ-*) 13, 52, *chud* 13, 28, *irmindeot* 13, *hadubrant* 14, 17, 35, *dat* 15, 17, 24, 31, 34, 41, 42, 46, 47, 63, *dea* 16, *nid* 18, *degano* 19, 26, *des* 23, *sid* 23, *detribhe* 23, *darba* 23, 26*, *dechisto* 26, *deotrichhe* 26, *quad* 30, 48, 57, *dana* 31, *dinc* 31, *der* 33, 57, 58, *dir* 34, 38, 54, 58, *huldi* 34, *pidar* 37, *dinem* 39, 45, *dinu* 39, *seolidante* 41, *desemo* 47, *dar* 50, 56, *perdan* 53, *doh* 54, 57, *aodlihho* 54, *din* 54, *dih* 58, *gudea* 59, *perdar* 60, *erdo* 61, *desero* 61, *bedero* 61, *dem* 63).

### The High German consonant shift

The High German consonant shift consists of two related changes in the consonant system from Proto-West Germanic to OHG. Their distribution varies somewhat across OHG dialects but they work very similarly.

1. The spirantisation of voiceless stops *p, t, k* > *f, z, h* or *pf, tz, kh*, depending on their position in the word. Note that the fricatives *z* and *h* geminate after long vowels.
2. The devoicing of voiced stops *b, d, g* > *p, t, k*.

The following examples are attested in *Hild*:

1. Spirantisation:

a) *k* (*ik* 1, 12, *cnuosles* 11) > *h* (initially and medially *ch: folche* 10, *chind* 13, 52, ***ch****unincriche* 13, *chud* 13, 28, *otachres* 18, *otachre* 25, *dechisto* 26, *folches* 27, *chonnem* 28, *cheisuringu* 33, *chuning* 33, *chludun* 64; word-finally *h: sih* 2, 5, 60, *ih* 17, 29, 34, 45, 49, 53, *mih* 39, 50, 52, *dih* 58); *k* after a long vowel > *hh* (*hh*: *pelihhes* 11, *theotrihhe* 19, *detrihhe* 23, *aodlihho* 54; *chh*: *deotrichhe* 26; *cc*: *harmlicco* 65; *ch*: *chunincri****ch****e* 13, *riche* 47);

b) *kk* > *kkh* (*reccheo* 47).

2. Devoicing:

a) *b* (*hiltibrant* 3, 7, 17, 30, 43, 44, 48, 57, *hadubrant* 3, 14, 17, 35, *ubar* 6, 42, *heribrantes* 7, 43, 44, *ibu* 12, 54, 56, *hiltibrantes* 14, 35, *bure* 21, *barn* 21, *arbeo-* 22, *darba* 23, 26, *lib* 29, *habbe* 29, *obana* 30, *ab* 30, *bauga* 32, *bi* 34, 47, *gibu* 34, *geba* 36, *bist* 38, *habes* 46, 56, *burc* 51, *banun* 51, *breton* 53, *billiu* 53, *banin* 53, *rauba* 56, *bibrahanen* 56, *brunnono* 61, *bedero* 61, *-bort* 64, *pabnum* 67) > *p* (*prut* 21, *leop* 27, *gap* 33, *pist* 40);

b) *bb* > *pp* (*pp*: *sippan* 31).

c) **d* > *t* (*gihorta* 1, *muotin* 2, *hiltibrant* 3, 7, 17, 30, 43, 44, 48, 57, *enti* 3, 19, 49, *hadubrant* 3, 14, 17, 35, *untar* 3, *sunufatarungo* 4, *garutun* 5, *gurtun* 5, *suert* 5, *hiltiu* 6, *ritun* 6, *gimahalta* 7, 14, 35, 44, *heribrantes* 7, 43, 44, *frotoro* 8, *gistuon****t*** 8, *uuortum* 9, *fater* 9, 17, *irmindeot* 13, *hiltibrantes* 14, 35, *sagetun* 15, 41, *liuti* 15, *alte* 16, *anti* 16, *frote* 16, *otachre* 18, 25, *miti* 19, 53, 67, *theo****t****ribhe* 19, *lante* 20, 49, *prut* 21, *raet* 22, *detrihhe* 23, *gistuon****t****um* 23, *fatereres* 24, *friuntlaos* 24, *unti* 26, *deotrichhe* 26, *giston****t****un* 26, *ente* 27, *irmingot* 30, *halt* 31, *mit* 31, 36, 39, *gileitos* 31, *pant* 32, *puntane* 32, *gitan* 33, ***t****ruhtin* 34, *ort* 37, *orte* 37, *alter* 38, *puortun* 39, *gialtet* 40, *inpit* 40, *fortos* 40, *seolidante* 41, *pentilseo* 42, *tot* 43, *goten* 46, *purti* 47, *paltant* 48, *got* 48, *pepurt* 48, *skihit* 48, *pallota* 49, *scerita* 50, *sceotan****t****ero* 50, *suertu* 52, *breton* 53 (n.), *taoc* 54, *liuto* 57, *lusti****t*** 58, *hiutu* 60, *uualtan* 61, *scritan* 62, *sciltim* 63, *ston****t*** 63, *bort* 64, *scilti* 65, *lintun* 66, *purtun* 66).

d) *g* (*gihorta* 1, *sunufatarungo* 4, *garutun* 5, *gudhamun* 5, *gurtun* 5, *ringa* 6, *gimahalta* 7, 14, 35, 44, *fragen* 8, *gistuont* 8, *sages* 12, *sage-tun* 15, 41, *gihueit* 18, *degano* 19, 26, *gistuontum* 23, *gistontun* 26, *irmingot* 30, *gileitos* 31, *bauga* 32, *cheisuringu* 33, *gitan* 33, *chuning* 33, *gap* 33, *gibu* 34, *geru* 36, *geba* 36, *gialtet* 40, *gisihu* 45, *goten* 46, *pelaga* 48, *got* 48, *enigeru* 51, *gifasta* 51, *gipinnan* 55, *argosto* 57, *piges* 58, *gudea* 59, *gimeinun* 59, *bregilo* 60, *gipigan* 67) > *k* (only word-finally: *chunicriche* 13, *dinc* 31, *pic* 42, *sehstic* 49, *burc* 51, *taoc* 54, *enic* 56);

e) *gg* (*seggen* 1).

**The absence of *t* > *z***

With the extremely consistent application of the High German consonant chain shift in the dentals **þ* > *d*, **d* > *t* it is very strange that the last natural step, the spirantisation *t* > *z*, does not occur in *Hild*. Instead we have a situation where any given *t* in *Hild* may stand for two separate values: old **d* (= standard OHG *t*) and old **t* (= standard OHG *z*).

Above we have already listed all examples of *t* < **d*. From old *t* *Hild* has both *t* and *tt*, the latter of which may reflect either an old short *t* when following a long vowel or an old long *tt*. The following occurrences are relevant:

1. old *t* (*dat* 1, 2, 15, 17, 24, 31, 34, 41, 42, 46, 47, 63, *tuem* 3, *to* 6, 64, *uuet* 12, *gihueit* 18, *fur laet* 20, *ummet* 25, 38, *at* 27, 51, *ti* 27, 53, *it* 34, *sehstic* 49, *suasat* 52); old *t* after a long vowel (*sceotantero* 50) > *tt* (*hætte* 17, *heittu* 17, *luttila* 20, *pettu* 30, *motti* 59, *muotti* 60, *lettun* 62, *huitte* 65, *luttilo* 66);

2. old *tt* (*urhettun* 2, *sitten* 20).

Note that the High German spirantisation *t* > *z* never (i.e., in no varieties of OHG) occurs in the following clusters, which are thus identical to their equivalents in OS and PWGmc. and irrelevant for the discussion:

1. *ht* (*rihtun* 6, *peheta* 27 (for **fehta*), *truhtin* 34, *maht* 54, *reht* 56),

2. *st* (*gistuont* 8, *ist* 13, 43, *ostar* 18, 22, *gistuontum* 23, *dechisto* 26, *gistontun* 26, *bist* 38, *pestar* 42, *hrustim* 45, *gifasta* 51, *hrusti* 55, *argosto* 57, *ostar* 57, *lustit* 58, *ærist* 62, *stont* 63, *stoptun* 64, *staim-* 64),

3. *nt* (*pintro* 49).

The merger between old *t* and *d* as seen in *Hild* is not found in other OHG varieties nor in modern High German, and can therefore not have been an authentic part of the language at any stage. With a large enough body of text we would be able to prove statistically the separation of these sounds in the dialect of the poem, but unfortunately we do not have a single instance of alliteration falling on either old *t* (< *t*) nor new *t* (< *d*).

It is however notable that old *t* when following a long vowel in 9/10 cases (the one exception being l. 50: *sceotantero*) turns into the geminate *tt*. This feature has no parallel in Old Saxon, but on the other hand is equivalent to what we see for the fricative *h* < *k*. What it seems to suggest is that *t* was likely in fact spirantised to *z* in the dialect of *Hild* but has been "masked" orthographically by the substitution of all cases of *z* for *t*; thus an archetypal doubled *zz* in a word like l. 20 **luzzila* has been replaced with *luttila*, rather than the correct form ***lutila*.

Together with the metrically proven change **wr-* > *r-* (l. 47 n.) the High German consonant shift thus appears structural to the text of *Hild*, whose language therefore must be classified as OHG with OS influences rather than as a true hybrid or Germanised OS.

**Orthography**

For the orthography of the edition I have found it impossible to produce a normalised text without too heavily distorting the received text, being as it is, a blend of several dialects. One need only observe the treatment of the name Thedric, which appears thrice, and each time in a markedly different form. Apart from the typical practices as described in the General Introduction, and using acute accents to signify long vowels, circumflex accents to signify now-monophthongised original diphthongs, and overdots to mark nasal vowels, I have carried out the following changes in order to clarify etymological relationships and make the text somewhat less unwieldy. Of these changes, 7–9 have also been noted in the apparatus where they occur:

1. Replaced both *ƿ* (wynn) and *uu* with *w*.
2. Replaced *c* with *k*.
3. Replaced *qu* with *kw*.
4. Replaced *t* with *ţ* where corresponding to OHG *z*.
5. Replaced *th* with *þ*.
6. Replaced *e* with *ę* when reflecting an original a-vowel affected by *i*-mutation.
7. Replaced unetymological double *nn* with *n*.
8. Restored initial *h-* where etymological and/or metrically required.
9. Removed initial *h-* where unetymological and/or metrically deficient.

The punctuation of the original, entirely consisting of interpuncts, at times representing metrical breaks, at others sporadically placed, has not been retained.

Where it appears in the cæsura, the extrametrical interjection *kwad Hilti·brant* 'quoth Hildbrand' (found in ll. 30, 49, and 58) replaces the usual interpunct to indicate that the pause of the cæsura has been filled with an indication of the speaker. Outside of *Hild*, similar interjections are found throughout early Germanic poetry: in Old Norse (e.g. *Reg* 3/1, Anon *Eirm* 1/1 (in SkP 1)), Old Saxon (e.g. *Heli* 226, *SaxGen* 1), and Old English (e.g. *Finn* 24). The chronological distribution of these interjections is such that they cannot be mere scribal additions (Old Norse poetry was first written down in the C12th, several centuries after the alliterative meter had gone extinct in Germany); instead, they appear to be genuine remnants of oral performance going back to the common Germanic tradition.

## Summary

The poet begins with a short formulaic introduction; he is relating older stories (1–2). The two duellists, Hildbrand and Hathbrand, father and son, arm themselves and ride into battle at the head of two opposing armies (3–6). They speak, and Hildbrand asks Hathbrand for his name and lineage (7–13). Hathbrand gives his name and ancestry; his father was the warrior Hildbrand, who abandoned him as a newborn. This was long ago, and Hathbrand does not think him still alive (14–29). Hearing this, Hildbrand calls on God as witness, and offers his son a golden torc as a token of loyalty (30–34). Hathbrand takes this as an insulting tricks. He proclaims that wealth should be won by struggle alone and accuses Hildbrand of having grown old through treachery (35–40); he has heard from sailors on the Mediterranean that his father is dead (41–43).

After this straight-forward narrative sequence three short speeches follow, in the ms. all spoken by Hildbrand. The second is certainly spoken by Hildbrand, but the other two may be misplaced or misattributed.

1. Hildbrand reflects on his son's prosperity: from his clothes he can tell that he has a good lord, and that he, unlike himself, has not suffered the fate of exile (44–47).

2. Hildbrand calls on God, and laments that, after thirty years at war, he is now forced to fight against his own son. Still, Hathbrand should easily be able to kill such an old man as Hildbrand, if he has strength and fate on his side (48–56).

3. Hildbrand (or Hathbrand, and there is a case for emending here) says that only the most cowardly easterner could refuse the fight so greatly desired. Let both men fight their hardest, and when the duel is over the winner will strip the armour of the other (57–61).

The two men then throw their javelins into each other's shields and rush at each other, hacking away at their shields until they become worthless (62–67). Here the poem ends abruptly in the middle of the battle.

## Text

Ik gi·hôrta daţ sęggen [K 1r/1–5]
daţ sih ur·hêţţun · aenon muotín:
Hilti·brant ęnti Hadu·brant · untar hęrjun ţwêm;
sunu-fatar·ungo · iro saro rihtun
garutun sé iro gùd-hamun · gurtun sih iro swert ana
hęlidos ubar *h*ringa · dó sie ţó dero hiltu ritun.

I HAVE HEARD IT SAID
that two champions struggled alone against each other:
Hildbrand and Hathbrand under two hosts.
The son and father set their armour,
readied their warcloth, girded on their swords,
the heroes, over the chain-links, when to that fray they rode.

6 *h*ringa | ringa **K**

2 aenon 'alone' | A dative plural adverbial, i.e., 'in single combat'.

3 untar hęrjun ţwêm 'under two hosts' | Either man was a champion of his army.

5 gùd-hamun 'warcloth' | Their chainmail. Cf. l. 61.

5 gurtun sih iro swert ana 'girded on their swords' | Cf. *Finn* 13b.

Hilti·brant gi·mahalta · —her was hêróro man [K 1r/5–11]
feraḥes frótóro— · her frágén gi·stuont
fôhém wortum · *h*wer sín fater wári
fir*ih*o in folkhe · [...]
[...] · „eddo hwe-líhhes knuosles dú sís
ibu dú mí ênan sagés · ik mí de ȯdre wêt
khind in khun*ink-ríkhe · khùd ist mí* al irmin-deot."

Hildbrand spoke—he was the hoarier man,
more learned of life. He began to ask
in few words who his father might be
of men in the troop, [...]
[...] "or of which lineage thou be.
If thou tell me one I will recall the others,
my child, in the kingdom I know all great men."

7 gi·mahalta | Hęri·brantes sunu *'Harbrand's son' add.* **K** 9 *h*wer | wer **K** 10 fir*ih*o | fireo **K** 11 hwe-líhhes | 'welihhes' **K** 13 khun*ink-ríkhe | 'chunnincriche' **K** 13 mí* | mín **K**

8 feraḥes frótóro 'more learned of life' | Possibly formulaic; cf. *Maldon* 317a: *Ic eom fród feores.* 'I am learned of life'.

10 firiþo 'men' | Gen. of *fir(a)ha*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for 'men, people' found throughout the Old Germanic languages. In OHG it is only otherwise found in *Wessobrunn* 1 and *Musp* 55, never in prose (EWA, s.v. *fir(a)ha*), although it is also found in the cpd. *smala-firihi* m. pl. 'the common people' (EWA, s.v. *ferah*).
The word stems from PGmc. *firhwijōz*, a *ja*-stem derivative of PGmc. **ferhwą* 'life, lifeblood'. It is cognate to OS *firihos*, OE *fir(h)as* 'men' (cf. Goering 2025, p. 11), and ON *firar, fyrvar, fjǫrvar, fyrðar*. The fact that the aforementioned cognates are also exclusively poetic suggests that this was likely the case already in PGmc., or at the very least in PNWGmc.

13 khind 'my child' | Here Hildbrand is addressing Hathbrand as his junior (cf. modern English son), but the word also subtly foreshadows his paternity even though at this point in the narrative he is not yet aware of it.

14 Hadu·brant gi·mahalta · Hilti·brantes sunu: [K 1r/11–16]
„Daţ sagetun mí · [...]
16 ụsere liuti · alte anti fróte
16' dea êr hina wárun · daţ Hilti·brant
háţţi mín fater; · ih hęiţţu Hadu·brant.
18 Forn her ôstar gi·*węiţ, · flôh her Ôt·akhres níd
hina miti *D*eot·ríhhe · ęnti sínero degano filu.

Hathbrand spoke, Hildbrand's son:
"This [...] said to me,
our liegemen, the old and learned
who lived long ago: that Hildbrand
was the name of my father—my name is Hathbrand.
Long ago he turned east; he fled Edwaker's hate
hence with Thedric and his multitude of thanes.

18 gi·*węiţ | gihueit **K** 19 *D*eot·ríhhe | theotrihhe *with pre-shift consonant* **K**

16–18 Daţ ... Hadu·brant | These lines have generally been divided as: *Daţ sagetun mí · ụsere liuti / alte anti fróte · dea êr hina wárun / daţ Hilti·brant háţţi mín fater · ih hęiţţu Hadu·brant.* This division suffers from two main problems: (1) line 15, although rhythmically flawless (cf. l. 42) lacks alliteration; (2) line 17a is excessively long and requires *háţţi* to be unstressed, something it cannot be due to its presence in a bound clause (Robert D. Fulk 2016, p. 253). The present division instead follows a proposal by Nelson Goering, who supplies a missing b-verse in l. 15 and then divides the rest of the lines in the least controversial way possible.

20 Her fur·láţ in lante · lúţţila siţţen [K 1r/16–20]
*b*rút in búre, · barn un·wahsan
22 arbjo-laosa; · her raet ôstar hina,
des síd D*e*ot·ríhhe · darba gi·stuontu*n*
24 fater*es mínes; · daţ was só friunt-laos man.

He left in this land a little wife to stay:
a bride in the bower, a babe ungrown,
inheritance-less. He rode hence to the east,

since at that time Thedric was in great need
of my father—that was so friendless a man!

21 *b*rút | prut **K** 22 her raet | heraet **K** 23 gi·stuontu*n* | gistuontum **K** 24 fater*es | fatereres **K**

20 lúṭṭila ‘little wife’ | The word is the f. acc. sg. of *luzzil* ‘little, small’, but ‘wife’ is supplied in the translation to resolve the ambiguity between the bride and the child.

Her was Ôt·akhre · um·meţ *irri, [K 1r/20–24]
degano dękhisto · unti Deot·ríkhhe*;
her was eo folkhes aţ ęnte, · imo was eo *f*ehęta ţi leop;
khùd was her [...] · khón*ém mannum:
ni wániu ih iu líb habbe.“

He was towards Edwaker utterly furious;
the dearest of thanes under Thedric.
He was always at the head of the troop; he always loved the fight too much;
known was he among keen men.
I do not expect he could still be alive.”

25 um·meţ *irri | *written together as* ummettirri **K** 26 Deot·ríkhhe* | ‘darba gistontun’ *add.* **K** 27 *f*ehęta | ‘peheta’ **K** 28 khón*ém | ‘chonnem’ **K**

25 um·meţ *irri ‘utterly furious’ | The second word is sometimes read as *tirri*, a hapax, but it is more reasonable to take it as a spelling error where the final consonant of the previous word has been erroneously doubled. This gives us the well-attested adj. *irri* which survives in modern High German as *irre* ‘mad, crazy, insane’. The modern sense is probably very old (cf. Gothic *airzeis* ‘erroneous, deceived’), but the sense ‘angry, furious, wrathful’ is attested in MHG, OS, and OE, and must also be used here (EWA, s.v. *irri*).

„Wêţţu Irmin got“ (kwad Hilti·brant) „obana ab hevane [K 1r/24–76v/4]
daţ dú neo dana halt mit sus sippan man · dink ni gi·lęitós.“
Want her dó ar arme · wuntane bauga
khęisur·ingu gi·tán · só imo sie der khuning gap,
Húnjo truhtin, · „daţ ih dír iţ nú bí huldí gibu.“

“I call as my witness Ermen-God,” quoth Hildbrand, “in heaven above,
that thou never hence with such close kin shouldst lead dispute,”
—then he unwound from his arm twisted bighs
made of Coser’s coin, which the king had given him,
the lord of the Huns—“[and] that I now give thee this out of goodwill.”

30 hevane | ‘heuane’ **K**

30 Irmin got 'Ermen-God' | These words may be interpreted in two ways, either (1) as a cpd. *irmingot* 'great God' referring to the Christian God, or (2) as an invocation of the pre-Christian god Ermen (OHG *Irmin*, ON *Jǫrmunr* 'Weden'), the ancestor of the *Herminones* of Tacitus (*Germania* 2). The problem with interpretation 1 is that such a cpd. is unparallelled in all of Germanic, including in related Christian epic poetry like *Heli* and *SaxGen*, whereas something like *waltant got* 'wielding God' (l. 48) is widespread, so that *irmin-* does not seem to have been a religiously unmarked prefix. For this reason we are more likely to be looking at a pagan expression, although this does not necessarily imply that the poet himself was a pagan; he may have borrowed it from earlier poetry without fully understanding its original significance.
For the invocation of the god Ermen in oaths we have a remarkable proof in Widukind of Corvey's *History of the Saxons* 1:12 (ca. 968 AD): *quia Hirmin vel Hermis Graece Mars dicitur; quo vocabulo ad laudem vel ad vituperationem usque hodie etiam ignorantes utimur* 'For *Hirmin* or *Hermes* is what they call Mars in Greek, a term which we use even to this day, without knowing its meaning, for praise or for blame.' This passage seems to imply that the name of this god persisted into the 10th c. in vulgar expletives or mild oaths, gradually losing its power as knowledge of the pagan religion and respect for its deities waned. Yet in the present circumstance it is certainly not used in such a way, but rather with full conviction by the warrior Hildbrand.

30 hevane 'heaven' | A likely Old Saxon form which merits some discussion on the relation between the synonymous words **himil* 'heaven' and **heƀan* 'id.' in West Germanic. OE only has *heofon*, OS has both, and OHG only has *himil*. The distribution of the two forms in OS is not random; *himil* is the unmarked word whereas *heƀan* is never used in prose, and is heavily stereotyped in poetry (*Heli* and *SaxGen*), where it is restricted to 3 formulaic expressions, always in the gen. sg., and 5 cpds. Even still, it must have existed in the broader language seeing as it has left descendants in modern Low German dialects.
In any case this word adds further difficulty to the question of providence; if *Hild* were an originally OHG text (cf. l. 47 n.) haphazardly "translated" into OS in a scribal context it seems strange that the translator should have replaced the neutral *himil* with the rare, stereotyped *hevan*, but on the other hand the presence of *hevan* in the OHG archetype would be a major anomaly since that word is not attested in any known variety of High German ancient or modern.

32 wuntane bauga 'twisted bighs' | A spiral cord of precious metal, in this case probably gold. The association between bighs (metal armlets) and a warrior's honour is well attested; see Index. This encounter is particularly reminiscent of *Hárb* 42.

33 kẖęisur·ingu gi·tán 'made of Coser's coin' | Coser (< OE *Cāser*), i.e., Caesar. A cultural memory of the melting down of Roman *solidī* by Germanic mercenaries.

34 Húnjo truhtin 'lord of the Huns' | Almost certainly Attle, although he is not mentioned by name in the poem.

34 daţ ih dír iţ nú 'that I now …' | Syntactically, this clause connects to the previous one (cf. ll. 46–47) and is thus part of Hildbrand's oath to Ermen-God. He swears that he is giving the bigh out of goodwill (*bi huldí*), i.e., without any secret motive.

Hadu·brant gi·mahalta · Hilti·brantes sunu: [K 76v/4–10]
„Mit gêru skal man · geba in·fâhan
ort widar orte!
Dú bist dir altér Hún · um·meţ spáhér;
spęnis mih mit díném wortun: · wili mih dínu speru werpan!
Pist al-só gi·altét man · só dú êwín in·wit fórtós.
Daţ sagetun mí · sêo-lídante
westaṛ ubar Węntil-sêo · daţ *in*an wík fur·nam;
tôt ist Hilti·brant · Hęri·brantes suno!"

Hathbrand spoke, Hildbrand's son:
"By his spear shall a man win gifts,
point against point!
Thou art, old Hun, utterly clever;
thou temptest me with thy words—at me wilt thou hurl thy spear!
Indeed, thou hast become an old man by always employing treachery.
This sea-farers said to me
in the west o'er the Wendle-sea: that war took him away.
Dead is Hildbrand, Harbrand's son!"

42 *in*an | *emend.;* man **K**

36 Mit gêru skal man · geba in·fâhan 'By the spear shall man win gifts' | The line comes off as proverbial, although it probably isn't. It is however notable that the same warrior-ethic was codified by the Indians as part of the *kṣatra-dʰarmá*, the honour-code of the Warrior-caste (*kṣatríya*), which explicitly forbade them from taking gifts. So in *MBʰ* 12.192.73, a *kṣatríya* king refuses a gift from a priest (*brāhmaṇá*) since "it is the duty prescribed for a *kṣatríya* that he must fight and protect (people). Kṣatriya are said to be the givers, then, how can I take (this) from you?" (transl. Hara 1974, see further there).

40 Pist al-só gi·altét man · só dú êwín in·wit fórtós. 'Indeed, thou hast become an old man by always employing treachery' | Lit. 'thou art indeed an old man since thou always didst employ treachery.' Hathbrand accuses Hildbrand of being an imposter and views his old age as suspect; no brave warrior (it is implied) should be so old, so he must have relied on cunning and cowardly blows instead.

40 in·wit 'treachery' | A hapax in OHG, although the related form *in·witte* is attested in a gloss (EWA, s.v. *inwitti*). The word is cognate with OS *in·wid*, OE *in·wid*, and ON *ǐ·viðr* (in *Vkv* 28/4). It has been argued that *in·witti* is in fact the only High German form and that *Hild*'s *in·wit* is a product of Saxon scribal influence (EWA), but it seems unlikely for metrical reasons that the present line should ever have had a trisyllabic form of this word.

41 sêo-lídante 'sea-farers' | An inherited formulaic poetic cpd.; cf. the poetic OE *sǽ-líðendǽ* 'id.' (formulaic b-verse, *Beow* 377b) and its *nd*-stem form *sǽ-líðend* (*Beow* 411a, 1818a, 2806a) along with the poetic OS *sêo-líðandjan* 'id.' (*Heli* 2909). Semantically identical cpds. with the same second element but other first elements are found in OE and OS, e.g. with *lagu-* 'water' (*Heli* 2918, 2964) and *męri-* 'ocean' (*Beow* 255). — The pairing with *sagetun* 'said' is formulaic (*Beow* 377b, 411a, 1818a). For the motif of sea-farers as rumour-spreaders cf. particularly *Beow* 377b: *Þǫnné sæ̆ġdun þæt · sǽ-líðendǽ* 'then sea-farers said this'.

42 Węntil-sêo 'Wendle-sea' | The Mediterranean Sea, the name referring to the *Vandali*, who for a time ruled North Africa.

[**K** 76v/11–13]

44 Hilti·brant gi·mahalta · Hęri·brantes suno:
„Wela gi·sihu ih in dínêm hrustim
46 daţ dú habés hême · hêrron góten,
daţ dú noh bí desemo ríkhe · rękkhjo ni wurti.

Hildbrand spoke, Harbrand's son:
"Well do I see upon thy arms
that thou hast at home a good lord;
that thou yet in this realm hast not become an exile.

47 rękkhjo ‘exile’ | An important word for identifying the poem’s original dialect. *rękkhjo* (< PWGmc. **wrakkjô*) originally began with a *w-* (cf. OE *wręcca*, OS *wrękkjo*), but its alliteration with *ríkhe* (< PWGmc. **ríkija*, cf. OE *ríce*, OS *ríki*) proves that this sound had been lost by the time of the poem’s composition. Since the *w-* is retained in OS (cf. *Heli* 631, 671) and to this day in Low German, *Hild* must have been composed in the High German dialect area.

48 Welaga nú waltant got,“ (kwad Hilti·brant) „wê-wurt skihit. [K 76v/13–22]
Ih wallóta sumaro ęnti wintro · sehs-tik ur lante
50 dár man mih eo skęrita · in folk skeoţantero,
só man mir aţ burk ênigeru · banun ni gi·fasta.
52 Nú skal mih swásaţ khind · swertu hauwan
bretón mit sínu billju · eddo ih imo ţi banin werdan.
54 Doh maht dú nú aod-líhho · ibu dir dín ęllen taok
in sús hêremo man · hrusti gi·winnan
56 rauba bi·*rahanen · ibu dú dár ênig reht habés!“

Well now, Wielding God!” quoth Hildbrand, “The woeful Weird comes to pass.
I roamed for sixty summers and winters away from this land
when I always was placed in the troop of shooters,
while at no stronghold my bane was fastened.
Now shall my beloved child strike me with his sword,
beat me with his blade—or I become his bane.
Yet thou mayest now easily—if thy zeal avails thee—
from such a hoary man conquer the arms,
bear away the booty—if thou hast any right thereto!”

56 bi·*rahanen | ‘bihrahanen’ **K**

48 waltant got ‘Wielding God!’ | Cf. OE *wealdend god*, OS *waldand god*. Apparently a common West Germanic poetic expression.

48 wê-wurt ‘woeful Weird’ | The sense of *wurt* ‘weird’ bears explaining. Rather than the Norse norn Weird (*Vsp* 19), its meaning here ought to be understood as ‘inexorable course of events decreed by fate’, although this sense is still tied to the pagan norn and ultimately of pre-Christian origin. The same sense underlies OS *wurd(i)* at various points in *Heli* (e.g. l. 4619), OE *wyrd* (e.g. *Beow* 572b, quoted in the note to l. 54 below), and ON *grimmar urðir* ‘grim weirds’ in *Sigsk* 5/4.

49 sumaro ęnti wintro · sehs-tik ‘sixty summers and winters’ | Thirty years. Cf. *Beow* 1498, 1769: *hund misséra* ‘a hundred half-years’, i.e., ‘fifty years’. Hathbrand is then thirty years old while Hildbrand is probably in his late fourties or fifties.

50 skeoţantero ‘shooters’ | Probably used in a specifically poetic sense. Cf. *Beow* 702, where the OE cognate *sceótend* stands for ‘warriors’ in general rather than archers in particular.

53 bretón ‘beat’ | A hapax. TODO: cite (EWA, s.v.*bretôn*)

53 billju ‘blade’ | Instr. sg. of *billi*, a hapax in OHG whose exact sense is unclear (EWA, s.v. *billi*). It is cognate with OE *bil* ‘a type of weapon’ which is exclusively used in poetry. The rarity of this word in the old languages suggests that it is probably simply being used as a poetic synonym for ‘sword’ or ‘sharp weapon’, whence the present translation ‘blade’.

54 ibu dir dín ęllen taok ‘if thy zeal avails thee’ | Formulaic. Cf. *Beow* 572b–573: *Wyrd oft nęriđ // un·fęgné eorl · þonné his ęllin déah.* ‘Weird often saves the un-fey earl when his zeal avails.’

56 ibu dú dár ênig reht habés! ‘if thou hast any right thereto!’ | The last three lines of Hildbrand’s speech bear a remarkable similarity to *Wald* B/14 ff. From comparison to such passages it is clear these lines must be understood in the cultural context of the flyting and taunting speeches of Germanic warriors as a direct provocation, as is most clearly seen in this final half-line. This in turn is what motivates Hathbrand’s hostile answer in ll. 57–61.

„Der sí doh nú argósto“ (kwad *Hadu*·brant) „ôstar-liuto [**K** 76v/22–26]
der dir nú wíges warne · nú dih es só wel lustit
gùdja gi·męinun; · niuse de móţţi
*h*wę*dar sih *hiutu dêro* hręgilo · hru*o*men muoţţi
e*d*do desero brunnóno · bêdero waltan!“

“Yet he would now,” quoth Hathbrand, “be the cowardliest of easterners
whoever should deny thee the fight now that thou hast such desire
for a battle between us. Let him try who might,
whichever one today of these garments will boast,
or both these byrnies wield!”

57 *Hadu*·brant | *emend.;* Hilti·brant **K** 60 *h*wę*dar | ‘werdar’ **K** 60 *hiutu dêro* | *metr. emend.; rev.* **K** 60 hru*o*men | ‘hrumen’ **K** 61 e*d*do | ‘erdo’ **K**

ALL | That the speaker of ll. 57–61 is in fact Hathbrand, the son, rather than Hildbrand, the father, is suggested by the speaker’s hostile tone (unlike the more resigned, albeit taunting tone of ll. 48–56) and his prejudice against *ôstar-liuto* ‘easterners’, i.e., the Huns, against whom Hathbrand is clearly negatively disposed and to whom he thinks the imposter Hildbrand belongs (cf. l. 38). A switch of speaker is further implied by the finality of Hildbrand’s speech in l. 56b.
On its own, the speech-marker in the cæsura of l. 57 (*kwad X* ‘quoth X’) is not proof that we are dealing with a new speaker (cf. l. 48), but it does yield additional support to it considering the high likelihood of corruption due to the formulaic nature of the marker and the numerous proofs of clear inattention on the part of the scribe(s) of the poem as a whole, e.g. the parablepsis in l. 26, the highly inconsistent handling of the name Thedric in ll. 19, 23, 26, and the various unmetrical lines likely resulting from skipped words.

59 niuse de móţţi ‘Let him try who might’ | Alliteration appears to fall on the second lift in this b-verse, something generally not allowed in Germanic meter.

60–61 hręgilo hruomen muoţţi … desero brunnóno bêdero waltan ‘of these garments will boast … both these byrnies wield’ | Like in the *Il*, the winner is expected to strip the slain of his armour.

Dó léţţun sé æ̂rist · askim skrítan [**K** 76v/26–29]
skarpén skúrim · daţ in dem skiltim stónt
dó stóptun ţó·samane · staim-bort chlu*b*un
hewun harm-líkko · hwíţţe skilti
unti imo iro lintún · lúţţilo wurtun
gi·wigan miti wábnum · […]

Then they first let their ashen spears glide
in sharp showers so that in the shields they stuck.

Then they charged at each other, split the painted boards [SHIELDS];
they hewed harmfully at the white shields,
till before them their linden-planks [SHIELDS] became small,
worn down by the weapons, [...]

62 askim | 'asckim' **K** 64 chlu*b*un | chludun **K**

63 skarpén skúrim 'in sharp showers' | Formulaic half-line describing a hail of projectiles, also occurring in *Heli* 5136a.

64 staim-bort 'painted boards' | A cpd., transparently segmented as *staim-* + *bort* 'board, plank'. In OE poetry *bord* can also mean 'shield' (e.g. *Beow* 2259, 2524, 2673, in cpds. 1243, 2203, 2559, 2895, 2980), as can OS *bord* (only once: *Heli* 5767) and ON *borð* (e.g. Þmáhl *Máv* 8/2 (in SkP 5)), so that this is probably an inherited poetic sense and certainly the sense here.
The first element is more difficult, but is generally understood to be an assimilated form of *stęin* 'stone' (though note that in the ms. the digraph *ai* is only found here, and that the etymological reflex of PGmc. **ai* is otherwise spelled *'ei'* or *'ae'*). This has often been interpreted as 'jewel' (an attested sense), so that the sense would be 'bejewelled shield', yet the existence of such shields in the late 8th c. must be considered highly doubtful. On the basis of the ON cognate *stęinn*, which in addition to 'stone' can also mean 'mineral colour, paint' (cf. ModEngl. stain, e.g. in "stained glass", an ON loan), I propose that the word mean 'paint' in the sense 'painted shield'. Such painted shields are in fact attested in near-contemporary Norse poetry (*Rdr* 1, ca. 850 AD), which, although not identical to High German poetry, still belongs to the same Germanic epic tradition.

67 [...] | At this point **K** 76v ends in the middle of the line. The rest of the poem would have been found on the now-lost following page(s); see Introduction above.

# Poetry on Christian Subjects

# Introduction to Old Saxon Christian Poetry

The forced conversion of the Saxons to Christianity under Charlemagne was a notably violent process, involving 32 years of war from 772 to 804 AD. TODO: historical discussion.

It was only a generation after the Saxon Wars that the two poems edited here—the **Healend** (*Heli*) and the **Saxon Genesis** (*SaxGen*) were composed under the guidance of the Frankish king. Their political purpose is clear enough: to depict Biblical stories and figures in the language of Germanic epic, and thereby to allow the aristocratic Saxon audience to identify with the new, forcibly imposed religion.

Together, *Heli* and *SaxGen* form the totality of the Old Saxon poetic corpus. Both are thoroughly Christian; although written in the language of traditional epic for a noble audience, they launch a pointed, attack on the fatalistic and warlike worldview of Old Germanic paganism. Following *SaxGen* is edited *GenB*, the Old English translation of a lost section of that poem.

Before the Saxon poems, I present the **Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** as an important piece of historical context.

# Old Saxon Baptismal Vow

**Dating:** ?
**Meter:** None

## Introduction

While not an alliterative poem in the slightest, the **Old Saxon Baptismal Vow** is an extremely important historical document. It was under just this vow many an Old Saxon would have gone during his forced baptism in the late 8th century, in many cases directly before his execution. For this reason I have here placed it before the two Old Saxon Biblical epics, in order to give some relevant cultural context.

The format of the short text is straight-forward and resembles the Catholic questions posed to participants during the Sacrament of Confirmation (TODO: reference). The person to be baptised is to respond positively to three denying and three affirming questions. He is to forsake the Devil, all "devil-yields" (pagan rituals), all the Devil's works and words and his followers, among which the three Old Saxon gods Thunder, Weden, and Saxneet are mentioned by name. He is then to profess belief in each member of the Trinity: God the Father, Jesus Christ, and the Holy Ghost.

## Text

**P1** „For·sachistu diobole?“
2 et respondeat: „ec for·sacho diabole“

“Forsakest thou the Devil?”
*and he should respond:* “I forsake the Devil.”

**P2** „end allum diobol-gelde?“
2 respondeat: „end ec for·sacho allum diobol-gelde.“

“And all devil-yields?”
*he should respond:* “I forsake all devil-yields.”

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1 diobol-gelde ‘devil-yields’ | An obvious calque of OE *déofol-ġield* ‘idolatrous acts of worship’.

**P3** „End allum dioboles wercum?“
2 respondeat „end ec for·sacho allum dioboles wercum and wordum, Thuner ende Wóden ende Sax-nôte ende allem them un·holdum
4 the hira ge·nôtas sint.“

“And all the Devil’s works?”
*he should respond:* “and I forsake all the Devil’s works and words, Thunder and Weden and Saxneat and all the unhold ones which are their fellows.”

**P4** „Ge·lôbistu in Got ala-męhtigun fader?“
2 „Ec ge·lôbo in Got ala-męhtigun fader.“

“Believest thou in God, the Almighty Father?”
“I believe in God, the Almighty Father.”

**P5** „Ge·lôbistu in Crist Godes suno?“
2 „Ec ge·lôbo in Crist Gotes suno.“

“Believest thou in Christ, God’s son?”
“I believe in Christ, God’s son.”

**P6** „Ge·lôbistu in hâlogan gâst?“
2 „Ec ge·lôbo in hâlogan gâst.“

“Believest thou in the Holy Ghost?”
“I believe in the Holy Ghost.”

# Healend
# *(Hêljand)*

**Dating:** 830s
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Healend** (*Heli*; OS *Hêljand* 'Healend, Saviour', cf. OE *Hęlend*, OHG *Heiland*) is an Old Saxon epic poem that narrates the life of Jesus. Although based on the 9th c. OHG translation of Tatian's 2nd c. gospel harmony, the *Diatessaron*, *Heli* is still an original work in the Saxon branch of the Germanic epic tradition, and betrays a creative spirit not afraid to go into dialogue not just with Christian commentaries but also with earlier, now-lost, pagan poetry. *Heli* is by far the most important source of Old Saxon literature.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Heli* was very popular. Since the discovery of fragment **L** in 2006 (Price 2010, pp. 9–10), the poem is found in a total of six known mss., none of which are fully complete. The following table contains data for all source mss. in chronological order (see further Price 2010, pp. 11–12, with references).

| Siglum | Date | Lines | Full name |
|---|---|---|---|
| **L** | 840–850 | 5823b–5870a | Thomas 4073 |
| **P** | 840–850 | 958–1006a | Berlin DHM R 56/2537 |
| **V** | 800–850 | 1279–1358a | Palatini Latini 1447 |
| **S** | 850 | 351b–360a, 368b–384, 393–400a, 492–582a, 675–683a, 693–706, 716b–722a | BSB Cgm 8840 |
| **M** | 850–875 | 85–2198a, 2256–2514a, 2576–3414a, 3491–3950, 4017b–4674, 4740b–5275a, 5969–5980 | BSB Cgm 25 |

| Siglum | Date | Lines | Full name |
|---|---|---|---|
| **C** | 950–1000 | 1–59698 | Cotton Caligula A VII |

Of these, the two main mss. are **C** and **M**. **C** is the most complete of all manuscripts, containing the entire poem up to line 5968, where it cuts off. **C** is not a perfect source, however. Its orthography is heavily influenced by Old English, most likely being the product of an English scribe, and it is also around a century younger than the other mss. **M** is more fragmentary and, apart from ll. 5969–5980, all lines in it are found also in **C**. Even so, **M** is, where available, to be preferred over **C** due to its age and orthography.

The four remaining manuscripts are far more fragmentary. **L** and **P** each consist of a single leaf and were cut up for use in book-binding around 1600 AD. The two are identical in terms of handwriting, orthography, and page layout and seem to have originally belonged to the same codex (Price 2010, pp. 13–14, 22–24).

**S** was also used for book-binding. The fragment currently consists of four folios, each cut length-wise into three strips. Folios 1 is bound together with 4 and 2 with 3. Of these, folios 2–3 are complete (as in, all three strips survive), while the middle strip of the other two (1, 4) has been lost.

**V**, unlike the other manuscripts, appears never to have been a codex of the complete poem. Rather, it contains only a short excerpt, likely copied from a now-lost complete manuscript, ***V**. **V** also attests several excerpts from *SaxGen* in the same orthography as its excerpt from *Heli*, which suggests that both poems were likely present in ***V**; see Introduction to *SaxGen*.

For a detailed stemma of the poem and its associated texts (*SaxGen* and the Preface), see Price (2010, p. 20).

## Historical context

### The Preface

Preserved independently of *Heli* itself is a Latin-language preface entitled *Praefatio ad librum antiquum in lingua Saxonica conscriptum* 'Preface to an ancient book written in the Saxon language' (henceforth just "the Preface"), which offers us some external historical information about the poem. The original manuscript of this short work is now lost, but it was fortunately printed by the Croatian reformer Flacius Illyricus in 1562. The preface has traditionally been divided into three parts: 1) a historical introduction, 2) a fabulous addition, plagiarised from Bede's story of Cadman, and 3) an accompanying hexameter verse, again based on the story of Cadman. For the full text of the Preface, see Sievers (1878, pp. 3–6).

The first part is a historical note on the composition of the poem. According to it, *Heli* was composed at the behest of emperor Ludwigh (*Ludowicus Augustus*, probably Ludwig "the Pious" 778–840, son of Charlemagne), who commanded a Saxon man, *qui apud suos non ignobilis vates habebatur* 'who was regarded among his own as a not undistinguished poet' to render the entirety of the Old and New Testaments into Saxon verse. Thus, the poet, *a*

*mundi creatione initium capiens, iuxta historiae veritatem quaeque excellentiora summatim decerpens, interdum quaedam ubi commodum duxit, mystico sensu depingens, ad finem totius Veteris ac Novi Testamenti interpretando more poetico satis faceta eloquentia perduxit,* 'beginning with the creation of the world, and summarising according to the truth of history the most significant events, at times depicting certain events with a mystical sense where he saw fit, led the interpretation, according to poetic custom and with rather witty eloquence, through to the end of the entire Old and New Testaments'. Further, *iuxta morem vero illius poematis omne opus per vitteas distinxit, quas nos lectiones vel sententias possumus appellare* 'according to the manner of that poem, he distinguished every work by *fitts*, which we can call lessons or sentences'.

There is no reason to doubt the general truth of this account, although it is hard to believe that our unnamed poet should have rendered the entirety of the Old and New Testaments, even the prophets, psalms, and epistles, into alliterative verse. The authenticity of this part of the preface is in any case proven by the use of the Germanic technical word *vitteas* 'fitts', which, as pointed out already by Sievers (1878, p. xxv), could not possibly have been known to a 16th century scholar. The rendering of the Old Testament is probably to be identified with *SaxGen*, while the New Testament is what we have before us in *Heli*.

This first part of the Preface is followed by a second, shorter paragraph, where we read that *Ferunt eundem Vatem dum adhuc artis huius penitus esset ignarus, in somnis esse admonitum, ut Sacrae Legis praecepta ad cantilenam propriae linguae congrua modulatione coaptaret* 'they say that this same poet, while he was still entirely ignorant of this art, was warned in a dream to adapt the precepts of the Sacred Law into song, with a fitting melody in his own language'. This passage bears a striking resemblance to Bede's story about the illiterate Anglo-Saxon poet Cadman (see *Cadman* below). In fact, its Latin wording is so close to that of Bede that it must have been plagiarised thence. This undoubtedly fabulous statement is then followed by a word-for-word repetition from the first part, where emperor Ludwigh's commandment is instead attributed to God directly, and a repetition of the note about *fitts*, except they are instead called *capitula* 'chapters', a Latin term.

Lastly, the tale of the illiterate, divinely inspired poet is narrated in Latin verse under the title *Versus de poeta et interprete huius codicis* 'Verses about the poet and interpreter of this codex'.

Whatever the truth of Cadman's story may be, it can scarcely be the case that the poet or poets behind *Heli* and *SaxGen* were ignorant of Old Saxon poetic tradition. Both poems are wrought in an intricate style and their composers must doubtless have been trained in the traditional craft before being commissioned to versify the Biblical texts, having first mastered the art of secular (or, quite likely, pagan) heroic poetry. The first paragraph of the Preface itself tells us as much, when it says that the poet "was regarded among his own as a not undistinguished poet", and the idea that emperor Ludwig should have commissioned a man entirely without poetic experience is obviously absurd. When one paragraph thus tells us that the poem was commissioned by the emperor of the Franks and another (while plagiarising word-

for-word from the first) tells us that it was on the order of God Himself, as revealed to the poet in a dream, there can be little doubt that the latter is a preposterous notion, far removed from any semblance of historical reality. These plain arguments should make it clear that the second paragraph of the Preface and the accompanying verse are later interpolations plagiarised from Bede, and thus irrelevant for our knowledge of the compositional context of *Heli* and *SaxGen*.

## Style and content

Now, it was not without reason that the *Heli*-poet was esteemed among his own, for he displays considerable mastery in such "Beowulfian" type scenes as the feast in the great mead-hall (ll. 2005–12, 2736–42), the stormy sea-voyage (2233–68, 2906–65), and the host asking for the identity of noble strangers come to his land (551–61)—a mastery which reveals his training in traditional Saxon heroic poetry. In fact, it is precisely in these passages that his poetry is most fluent, for it is here he can make the most use of his inherited stock of oral-formulaic expressions, poetic synonyms, compounds, and kennings. When our poet, by contrast, has to deal with exclusively Christian matters, he is treading new ground, and it is apparent that his work suffers as a result. This is in part due to the lack of traditional poetic formulae for the concepts of the new religion, and although he invents some (e.g., *allaro barno bętst* 'best of all babes' and *friðu-barn godes* 'peace-child of God' for Christ), they quickly end up stale from overuse. A further hindrance is, as will be discussed shortly, his frequent sermonising.

Perhaps the most noteworthy traditional Germanic element found throughout the poem is the relationship between Christ and his Disciples, which is consistently described using the vocabulary of the Germanic warband as found in earlier heroic poetry like *Beow*, *Finn*, and *Hild*. In the language of *Heli*, then, the Disciples are brave "thanes" who express their undying loyalty towards their "drighten" Jesus Christ in long heroic speeches, exclaiming their wish to win ever-lasting fame and glory by dying alongside him in the "dance of weapons" (e.g., Thomas at 3994–4002, Simon Peter at 4673–88). In conjunction with this portrayal, there is an emphasis on the noble ancestry and high social status of the Disciples (e.g., 4003a) and especially Jesus and his family (e.g., 361b–67a). This should give us an idea of the likely intended audience of the poem—these were members of the Saxon social elite, no mere commoners, and it was important for them that the heroes of the Gospel-story were of similarly high birth.

Still, we must be careful not to interpret these traditional elements like earlier, more romantic scholars have done, namely as evidence for a sort of Germanic, almost syncretist, "warrior Christianity". To begin with, it would not have been possible for the poet to excise utterly the traditional heroic language—after all, he was commissioned to write an alliterative poem, and such elements were built into the very essence of the art form. They were necessary for the poetry to function, not just in the social setting of courtly performance, but *metrically*, i.e., *as poetry*, for the alliteration itself was up-

held by the existence of a large number of poetic synonyms and formulaic expressions. It was thus within these social and formal constraints, that the poet had to relate the New Testament message, and yet that message is ever one of Christian pacifism and humility. The New Testament is not a warlike text, and neither is *Heli*; regardless of the poem's *aesthetics*, its *ethics* are thoroughly Christian.

As just said, although *Heli* generally adheres closely to Germanic poetic tradition in its language, we find important divergences in its contents. The heroic poetic tradition is turned against itself, and the Germanic warrior ideology comes under direct attack by means of its own specialised vocabulary, which is condemned, not just in the speeches of Jesus Christ, but in the poet's own, sermonising voice. This is perhaps best seen in the episode of the Denial of Peter. At the Last Supper, Peter first makes a solemn speech (ll. 4673–88), declaring in formal heroic language that he will not betray Jesus Christ, his lord, but stay with him until the end and give his life in battle; he swears upon his heart or courage (*hugi*) and strength of hand (*hand-kraft*). Jesus first praises Peter's courage, and notes that he indeed has a "thane's heart" (*þegnes hugi*), but then predicts that he will betray him thrice before cockcrow anyway. Peter does just that and, upon hearing the cock, repents in a lamenting speech (ll. 5011–20). The poet himself then delivers a sermon on the events (5021–49)—if not even Peter, "the best of men" and "most valiant of thanes" could keep his promise without God's help, what is the worth of a man's courage or strength? Man's solemn vow (*bi-hêt*, = OE *béot* which is used positively in *Beow*), pride (*hróm*; cf. *Hild* 60), bravery (*mód*), and strength of hand (*hand-kraft*, by which Peter vowed) are all to no avail if God's grace should fail him due to his lack of faith. Naturally, moral exegesis of this kind is totally foreign to the pagan epic tradition. The extent to which the devaluation of the Germanic heroic vow in this episode is a break with heroic tradition truly cannot be overstated. In the native heroic culture (e.g., *Beow* 433–441), the breaking of such a vow to one's lord would be a tremendous moral failing, the *shame* of which would fall entirely on the warrior. The "best of men" would never betray his lord, for the severity of the consequences would be unbearable: the act would render him marked for life as a shameful, dishonourable coward devoid of personal rights (cf. the speech in *Beow* 2860–2891). Yet in *Heli*, the fault of this betrayal does not fall on Simon Peter; without the grace of God there was nothing he could have done. Even the best of men, says the poet, can break their oaths.

In this context, it is valuable to talk about the language of war. Although the New Testament is not a warlike text, the poet of *Heli* takes the opportunity to break out some traditional formulae when he can, e.g., at the arrest of Jesus (ll. 4865–84). Still, he is generally very restrained, and tries hard to avoid the active *celebration* of war, probably because of its association with the warlike pre-Christian cult of Weden and his Walkirries and Oneharriers, or just not to excite the warlike fervour of the Saxon aristocracy too much, seeing as their wars against the Franks (by whose emperor the poet was commissioned) were still within living memory.

Where warlike sentiments are expressed by the Disciples (e.g., at the ar-

rest of Jesus or in Peter's vow at the Last Supper; see above), they are swiftly reproached by Jesus and, like Simon Peter's vow, ultimately proven flawed and misguided. Traditional motifs like the greedy beasts of battle are entirely expunged, and the old feminine poetic synonyms **gūðja* and *hildi*, found in *Hild* and commonplace in Norse and English poetry, have not fared much better. **gūðja*, found in early OS female names and the non-*Heli* OS compound *gūþ-fano* 'field standard' (Tiefenbach 2010, s.v. *gūthfano*), is entirely absent, and *hildi* is only used twice (ll. 68, 5043)—in both cases disparagingly. In their stead we find neuter-gender synonyms like *stríd, ur·lagi, wíg*, and *gi·winn*. It is worth noting that *Gunnr* and *Hildr* are known as walkirries in the Norse tradition, and in the 9th century were still actively venerated in pagan Denmark, just to the north of Saxony.

I mentioned above how the depiction of the Disciples in their relationship as servants of Christ makes use of the language of the Germanic war-band. This is indeed the case when it comes to singular words, but although the Disciples are described as loyal thanes (*þegnos*), heroes (*hęliðos*, cf. *Hild* 6), and earls (*erlos*)—words perfectly fit for a Germanic war-band in a poem like *Beow*—they are not a *war*-band. The Disciples are never referred to by explicitly warlike terms like *hildi-skalkos* 'war-servants', *wépạn-berandos* 'weapon-bearers', or *helm-berandos* 'helmet-bearers'. Those terms—which in *Beow*, *Finn* or Norse poetry could describe any group of warriors, including the protagonists—are instead given a derogatory sense, and for the most part refer only to the wicked Jews (68b, 765b, 2779b, 4810a).

There are many other, perhaps subtler, ways in which *Heli* verbally departs from Germanic heroic tradition. One that deserves mention is the treatment of hostile fate, which often plays a key role in driving the narrative in the old pagan poetry (e.g., in *Hild* or the Norse Walsing Cycle). Although *Heli* refers to fated events by what are almost certainly originally pagan expressions like *regano gi·skapu* 'Shapes of the Reins' and *wurdi-gi·skapu* 'Shapes of Weird', fated events can also be called *godes gi·skapu* 'God's Shapes'. In the Christian worldview it is God that wields the destinies of Men—not the ambivalent Norns.

## Meter

*Heli* is composed throughout in a single meter, an innovative form of the Common Germanic alliterative long-line. The meter is stichic and displays no stanzaic tendencies; on the other hand, enjambment is frequent. TODO: cite Suzuki (2004).

Although the meter is the same throughout the poem, verses in *Heli* come in two types: normal and hypermetric. This distribution is parallelled by Old English verse and suggests that hypermetricity is likely a common West Germanic poetic feature. Like in Old English verse (R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. clx), hypermetrics in *Heli* typically occur in especially meaningful or dignified places of dialogue or narrative, e.g., during the Beatitudes at the Sermon on the Mount (ll. 1300–1325a). Hypermetrics also generally come in groups, although single examples do occasionally occur.

## Orthography

Notes on the normalisation:

- Long vowels are marked by the acute rather than by the circumflex accent or macron. This is both faithful to the original manuscripts and concordant with my practice in normalising other Germanic languages.
- The long vowels *ê* and *ô* (resulting from monophthongisation of the diphthongs *ęi* and *au*) are, however, written with the circumflex accent. That these were in fact articulated separately is seen by the following circumstance: in the mss. the old monophthongs *é* and *ó* are frequently written as *ie* and *uo*, but this is never done for *ê* and *ô*.
- If attested in all mss., epenthetic (*svara-bʰaktí*) vowels are marked with an underdot. Otherwise they are deleted.
- Unstressed *a*-vowels reduced to *e* in **C** are reverted back to *a*.
- Long vowels resulting from nasal assimilation are marked with an overdot. *i* is written as *ǐ*.
- ms. *e* and *i*, when occuring between vowels are written as *j*.
- ms. *i*, when word-initial or following *g* and corresponding to etymological *j* is written as *j*.
- ms. *e* as resulting from *i*-mutation is written as *ę*.
- ms. *b*, or *ƀ*, when representing the voiced bilabial fricative, is written as *ƀ*.
- ms. *th* is written as *þ*.
- ms. *uu* is written as *w*.

## NOTE!

The following edition is very much a work in progress. The radically normalised orthography has been implemented, as has the marking of alliteration, but the original text has not been thoroughly critically edited, nor has the English translation been added.

## Text

1 Manega wáron, · þe sia iro mód ge·spón,
2 þat sia bi·gunnun word godes,
rękkjan þat gi·rúni, · þat þie ríkjo Krist
4 undar man-kunnja · máriða gi·frumida
mid wordun ęndi mid werkun. · Þat wolda þó wísara filo
6 liudo barno lobon, · lêra Kristes,
hêlag word godas, · ęndi mid iro handon skríban
8 bereht-líko an buok, · hwó sia is gi·bod-skip skoldin
frummjan, firiho barn. · Þan wárun þoh sia fiori te þiu
10 under þera męnigo, · þia habdon maht godes,
helpa fan himila, · hêlagna gêst,
12 kraft fan Kriste; · sia wurðun gi·korana te þio,
þat sie þan Éwangelium · ênan skoldun
14 an buok skríban · endo só manag gi·bod godes,
hêlag himilisk word: · sia ne muosta hęliðo þan mêr,
16 firiho barno frummjan, · newan þat sia fiori te þio
þuru kraft godas · ge·korana wurðun,
18 Matheus ęndi Markus, · —só wárun þia man hêtana—
Lukas ęndi Johannes; · sia wárun gode lieba,
20 wirðiga ti þem gi·wirkje. · Habda im waldand god,
þem hęliðon an iro hertan · hêlagna gêst
22 fasto bi·folhan · ęndi feraht an hugi,
só manag wís-lík word · ęndi gi·wit mikil,
24 þat sea skoldin a·hębbjan · hêlagaro stemnun
god-spell þat guoda, · þat ni habit ênigan gi·gadon hwęrgin,
26 þiu word an þesaro wer-oldi, · þat io waldand mêr,
drohtin diurje · efþo derbi þing,
28 firin-werk fęllje · efþo fiundo níð,
stríd wiðer·stande—, · hwand hie habda starkan hugi,
30 mildjan ęndi guodan, · þie þe mêster was,
aðal-ord-frumo · alo-mahtig.
32 Þat skoldun sea fiori · þuo fingron skríban,
sęttjan ęndi singan · ęndi sęggjan forð,
34 þat sea fan Kristes · krafte þem mikilon
gi·sáhun ęndi gi·hôrdun, · þes hie selbo gi·sprak,
36 gi·wísda ęndi gi·waraht a, · wundar-líkas filo,
só manag mid mannon · mahtig drohtin,

all so hie it fan þem an-ginne · þuru is ênes kraht,
waldand gi·sprak, · þuo hie êrist þesa wer-old gi·skuop
endi þuo all bi·fieng · mid ênu wordo,
himil endi erða · endi al þat sea bi·hlidan êgun
gi·waraḥtes endi gi·wahsanes: · þat warð þuo all mid wordon godas
fasto bi·fangan, · endi gi·frumid after þiu,
hwi-lík þan liud-skępi · landes skoldi
wídost gi·waldan, · efþo hwár þiu wer-old-aldaṛ
endon skoldin. · Ên was iro þuo noh þan
firiho barnun bi·foran, · endi þiu fíbi wárun a·gangan:
skolda þuo þat sehsta · sálig-líko
kuman þuru kraft godes · endi Kristas gi·burd,
hêlandero bęstan, · hêlagas gêstes,
an þesan middil-gard · managon te helpun,
firjo barnon ti frumon · wið fiundo níð,
wið dęrnero dwalm. · Þan habda þuo drohtin god
Rómano-liudjon far·liwan · ríkjo mêsta,
habda þem hęri-skipje · herta gi·stęrkid,
þat sia habdon bi·þwungana · þiedo gi·hwi-líka,
habdun fan Rúmu-burg · ríki gi·wunnan
helm-gi·trôstjon, · sáton iro hęri-togon
an lando gi·hwem, · habdun liudjo gi·wald,
allon ęli-þeodon. · Erodes was
an Jerusalem · oþer þat Judeono folk
gi·koran te kuninge, · só ina þie kêser þarod,
fon Rúmu-burg · ríki þiodan
satta undar þat gi·síði. · Hie ni was þoh mid sibbjon bi·lang
aþaron Israheles, · ęðili-gi·burdi,
kuman fon iro knuosle, · newan þat hie þuru þes kêsures þank
fan Rúmu-burg · ríki habda,
þat im wárun só gi·hôriga · hildi-skalkos,
aþaron Israheles · ęlljan-ruoþa:
swíðo un·wanda wini, · þan lang hie gi·wald êhta,
Eródes þes ríkjas · endi rád-burdjon held
Judeo liudi. · Þan was þár ên gi·gamalod mann,
þat was fruod gomo, · habda ferḥtan hugi,
was fan þem liudjon · Lewias kunnes,
Jakobas sunjas, · guodero þiedo:

Zakharias was hie hêtan. · Þat was só sálig man,
hwand hie simblon gerno · gode þeonoda,
waraḥta after is willjon; · deda is wíf só self
—was iru gi·aldrod idis: · ni muosta im ęrbi-ward
an iro juguð-hêdi · giþiðig werðan—
libdun im far·úter laster, · waruḥtun lof goda,
wárun só gi·hôriga · heþan-kuninge,
diuridon ûsan drohtin: · ni weldun dęrþjas wiht
under man-kunnje, · mênes gi·frummjan,
ne saka ne sundja; · was im þoh an sorgun hugi,
þat sie ęrbi-ward · êgan ni móstun,
ak wárun im barno-lôs. · Þan skolda hé gi·bod godes
þár an Jerusalem, · só oft só is gi·gęngi gi·stód,
þat ina torht-líko · tídi gi·manodun,
só skolda hé at þem wíha · waldandes geld
hêlag bi·hwerþan, · heþan-kuninges,
godes jungar-skępi: · gern was hé swíðo,
þat hé it þurh ferhtan hugi · frummjan mósti.

TODO.

85 saka | *With this word* **M** *begins and continues until l. 2198a. Above it seven lines have been erased.*

3 rękkjan | The use of this verb is reminiscent to its use in *Beow* 89b–91, introducing a shop's (narrating poet's) song about the creation of the Earth from a Christian perspective: *þér wæs hæᵘrpan swóġ, / switul sang scopæs.* · *Sæġdé sé þi cúðé / frum-scæft firhá* · *feᵒrran reċċan* 'There there was the air of the harp, the clear song of the shop. He who knew told of the early days of men, narrated from afar.'

41 himil ęndi erða · ęndi al þat sea bi·hlidan êgun | A cosmological expression, reappearing almost identically in 1425 below.

45 wer-old-aldar | The six ages of the world was a common concept in mediaeval Christianity, being popularized by Augustine of Hippo around 400 AD. It is not found in Tatian, and so Augustine or a text derived from his writing must have been a source for *Heli*.

47–48 fíbi ... sehsta 'five ... sixth' | The five ages lasted (1) from Creation to the Flood, (2) from then to Abraham, (3) from him to David, (4) from him to the Babylonian Exile, (5) from then until the birth of Christ, which inaugurated the sixth age.

71 Eródes | The name *Erodes* can alliterate either with a vowel (following the Germanic root stress pattern: / x x) or with the consonant *r* (following the Latin penultimate stress: x / x). Out of 17 total appearances of the name in *Heli*, 12 alliterate with a vowel; 4 with *r*; and 1 has no alliteration.

**2** Þó warð þiu tíd kuman, · —þat þár gi·tald habdun
wísa man mid wordun,— · þat skolda þana wíh godes
Zakharias bi·sehan. · Þó warð þár gi·samnod filu
þár te Jerusalem · Judeo liudi,
werodes te þem wíha, · þár sie waldand god

swíðo þeo-líko · þiggjan skoldun,
hêrron is huldi, · þat sie heƀan-kuning
lêðes a·léti. · Þea liudi stódun
umbi þat hêlaga hús, · ęndi géng im þe gi·hêrodo man
an þana wíh innan. · Þat werod óðar bêd
umbi þana alạh útan, · Ebreo liudi,
hwan êr þe fródo man · gi·frumid habdi
waldandes willjon. · Só hé þó þana wí-rôk dróg,
ald aftar þem alạha, · ęndi umbi þana altari géng
mid is rôk-fatun · ríkjun þionon,
—fręmida ferht-líko · frâon sínes,
godes jungar-skępi · gerno swíðo
mid hluttru hugi, · *só man hêrren skal
gerno ful-gangan—, · grurjos kwámun im,
ęgison an þem alạhe: · hie gi·sah þár aftar þiu ênna ęngil godes
an þem wíhe innan, · hie sprak im mid is wordun tuo,
hiet þat fruod gumo · forọht ni wári,
hiet þat hie im ni an·driede: ·„þína dádi sind“, kwaþ-hie*,
„waldanda werðe · ęndi þín word só self,
þín þionost is im an þanke, · þat þú su-líka gi·þáht haƀes
an is ênes kraft. · Ik is ęngil bium,
Gabriel bium ik hêtan, · þe gio for goda standu,
and-ward for þem alo-waldon, · ne sí þat hé mé an is ârundi hwárod
sęndjan willja. · Nú hiet hé mé an þesan síð faran,
hiet þat ik þi þoh gi·kúðdi, · þat þi kind gi·boran,
fon þínera alderu idis · ôdan skoldi
werðan an þesero wer-oldi, · wordun sáhi.
Þat ni skal an is liƀa gio · líðes an·bítan,
wínes an is wer-oldi: · só haƀed im wurd-gi·skapu,
metod gi·markod · ęndi maht godes.
Hét þat ik þi þoh sagdi, · þat it skoldi gi·síð wesan
heƀan-kuninges, · hét þat git it heldin wel,
tuhin þurh treuwa, · kwað þat hé im tíras só filu
an godes ríkja · for·geƀan weldi.
Hé kwað þat þe gódo gumo · Johannes te namon
hębbjan skoldi, · gi·bôd þat git it hétin só,
þat kind, þan it kwámi, · kwað þat it Kristes gi·síð

an þesaro wídun wer-old · werðan skoldi,
is selbes sunjes, · ęndi kwað þat sie sliumo herod
an is bod-skępi · bêðe kwámin.“
Zakharias þó gi·mahạlda · ęndi wið selban sprak
drohtines ęngil, · ęndi im þero dádjo bi·gan,
wundron þero wordo: · „hwó mag þat gi·werðan só“, kwað hé,
„aftar an aldre? · it is unk al te lat
só te gi·winnanne, · só þú mid þínun wordun gi·sprikis.
Hwanda wit habdun aldres · êr efno twên-tig
wintro an unkro wer-oldi, · êr þan kwámi þit wíf te mí;
þan wárun wit nú at·samna · ant·sibunta wintro
gi·bęnkjon ęndi gi·będdjon, · sïðor ik sie mí te brúdi ge·kôs.
Só wit þes an unkro juguði · gi·girnan ni mohtun,
þat wit ęrbi-ward · êgan móstin,
fódjan an unkun flęttja, · nú wit sus gi·fródod sint
—habad unk ęldi bi·noman · ęlljan-dádi,
þat wit sint an unkro siuni gi·slekit · ęndi an unkun sídun lat;
flêsk is unk ant·fallan, · fel un·skôni,
is unka lud gi·liðen, · lík gi·drusnod,
sind unka and-bári · ȯðar-líkaron,
mód ęndi męgin-kraft—, · só wit giu só managan dag
wárun an þesero wer-oldi, · só mí þes wundạr þunkit,
hwó it só gi·werðan mugi, · só þú mid þínun wordun
gi·sprikis.

TODO.

116 an·driede | The original segmenting of *an·drádan* is *and-* + *rádan*, but already by the time of *Heli* it had clearly been reanalysed as *an(t)·drádan*, as seen by the alliteration in the present line and by the variant spelling *antdrádan* seen throughout the poem. Cf. English *dread*, from OE *drédan*, earlier *on·drédan*.

**3** Þó warð þat heban-kuninges bodon · harm an is móde,
þat hé is gi·werkes · só wundron skolda
ęndi þat ni welda gi·huggjan, · þat ina mahta hêlag god
só ala-jungan, · só hé fon êrist was,
selbo gi·wirkjan, · of hé só weldi.
Skęrida im þó te wítja, · þat hé ni mahte ênig word sprekan,
gi·mahljen mid is müðu, · „êr þan þi magu wirðid,
fon þínero aldero idis · erl a·fódit,
kind-jung gi·boran · kunnjes gódes,
wánum te þesero wer-oldi. · Þan skalt þú eft word sprekan,

hębbjan þínaro stemna gi·wald; · ni þarft þú stum wesan
lęngron hwíla.“ · Þó warð it sán gi·lêstid só,
gi·worðan te wáron, · só þár an þem wíha gi·sprak
ęngil þes alo-waldon: · warð ald gumo
spráka bi·lôsit, · þoh hé spáhan hugi
bári an is breostun. · Bidun allan dag
þat werod for þem wíha · ęndi wundrodun alla,
bi·hwí hé þár só lango, · lof-sálig man,
swíðo fród gumo · frâon sínun
þionon þorfti, · só þár êr ênig þegno ni deda,
þan sie þár at þem wíha · waldandes geld
folmon frumidun. · Þó kwam fród gumo
út fon þem alạha. · Erlos þrungun
náhor mikilu: · was im niud mikil,
hwat hé im sòð-líkes · sęggjan weldi,
wísjan te wáron. · Hé ni mohta þó ênig word sprekan,
gi·sęggjan þem gi·síðja, · b·útan þat hé mid is swíðron hand
wísda þem weroda, · þat sie ùses waldandes
lêra lêstin. · Þea liudi for·stódun,
þat hé þár habda gegnungo · god-kundes hwat
for·sehen selbo, · þoh hé is ni mahti gi·sęggjan wiht,
gi·wísjan te wáron. · Þó habda hé ùses waldandes
geld gi·lêstid, · al só is gi·gęngi was
gi·markod mid mannun. · Þó warð sán aftar þiu maht godes,
gi·kùðid is kraft mikil: · warð þiu kwán ôkan,
idis an ira ęldju: · skolda im ęrþi-ward,
swíðo god-kund gumo · gibiðig werðan,
barn an burgun. · Bêd aftar þiu
þat wíf wurdi-gi·skapu. · Skrêd þe wintạr forð,
géng þes gęres gi·tal. · Johannes kwam
an liudjo lioht: · lík was im skôni,
was im fel fagạr, · fahs ęndi naglos,
wangun wárun im wlitige. · Þó fórun þár wíse man,
snelle te·samne, · þea swásostun mêst,
wundrodun þes werkes, · bi·hwí it gio mahti gi·werðan só,
þat undar só aldun twêm · ôdan wurði
barn an gi·burdjon, · ni wári þat it gi·bod godes
selbes wári: · af·suobun sie garo,
þat it ęlkor só wán-lík · werðan ni mahti.

Þó sprak þár ên gi·fródot man, · þe só filo konsta
wísaro wordo, · habde gi·wit mikil,
frágode niud-líko, · hwat is namo skoldi
wesan an þesaro wer-oldi: · „mí þunkid an is wísu gi-lík
iak an is gi·bárja, · þat hé sí bętara þan wi,
só ik wániu, þat ina ùs gegnungo · god fon himila
selbo sęndi“. · Þó sprak sán aftar
þiu módar þes kindes, · þiu þana magu habda,
þat barn an ire barme: · „hér kwam gi·bod godes“, kwað siu,
„fernun gęre, · furmon wordu
gi·bôd, þat hé Johannes · bi godes lêrun
hêtan skoldi. · Þat ik an mínumu hugi ni gi·dar
węndjan mid wihti, · of ik is gi·waldan mót“.
Þó sprak ên gêl-hert man, · þe ira gaduling was:
„ne hét êr io·wiht só“, (kwað hé,) „aðal-boranes
ùses kunnjes efþo knósles; · wita kiasan im òðrana
niud-samna namon: · hé niate of hé móti“.
Þó sprak eft þe fródo man, · þe þár konsta filo mahljan:
„ni gibu ik þat te ráde“, (kwað hé,) „rinko neg·ênun,
þat hé word godes · węndjan bi·ginna;
ak wita is þana fader frágon, · þe þár só gi·fródod sitit,
wís an is wín-sęli: · þoh hé ni mugi ênig word sprekan,
þoh mag hé bi bók-staþon · bréf ge·wirkjan,
namon gi·skríban“. · Þó hé náhor géng,
lęgda im êna bók an barm · ęndi bad gerno
wrítan wís-líko · word-gi·merkjun,
hwat sie þat hêlaga barn · hêtan skoldin.
Þó nam hé þia bók an hand · ęndi an is hugi þáhte
swíðo gerno te gode: · Johannes namon
wís-líko gi·wrêt · ęndi ôk aftar mid is wordu gi·sprak
swíðo spáh-líko: · habda im eft is spráka gi·wald,
gi·wittjas ęndi wísun. · Þat wíti was þó a·gangan,
hard harm-skare, · þe im hêlag god
mahtig makode, · þat hé an is mód-seþon
godes ni for·gáti, · þan hé im eft sęndi is jungron tó.

TODO.

4 Þó ni was lang aftar þiu, · ne it al só gi·lêstid warð,
só hé man-kunnja · managa hwíla,

god alo-mahtig · for·geben habda,
þat hé is himilisk barn · herod te wer-oldi,
sí selbes sunu · sęndjan weldi,
te þiu þat hé hér a·lôsdi · al liud-stamna,
werod fon wítja. · Þó warð is wis-bodo
an Galilea-land, · Gabriel kuman,
ęngil þes alo-waldon, · þár hé êne idis wisse,
muni-líka magað: · María was siu hêten,
was iru þiorna gi·þigan. · Sea ên þegan habda,
Joseph gi·mahlit, · gódes kunnjes man,
þea Dawides dohter: · þat was só diur-lík wíf,
idis ant-hêti. · Þár sie þe ęngil godes
an Nazareth-burg · bi namon selbo
grótte gęgin-warde · ęndi sie fon gode kwędda:
„Hêl wis þú, Maria“, (kwað hé,) „þú bist þínun hêrron liof,
waldande wirðig, · hwand þú gi·wit habes,
idis ęnstjo fol. · Þú skalt for allun wesan
wíbun gi·wíhit. · Ne habe þú wêkan hugi,
ne forhti þú þínun ferhe: · ne kwam ik þi te ênigun frêson herod,
ne dragu ik ênig drugi-þing. · Þú skalt ùses drohtines wesan
módar mid mannun · ęndi skalt þana magu fódjan,
þes hôhon heþan-kuninges suno. · Þe skal Hêljand te namon
êgan mid ęldjun. · Neo ęndi ni kumid,
þes wídon ríkjas gi·wand, · þe hé gi·waldan skal,
mári þeodan.“ · Þó sprak im eft þiu magað an·gęgin,
wið þana ęngil godes · idiso skônjost,
allaro wíbo wlitigost: · „hwó mag þat gi·werðen só“, kwað siu,
„þat ik magu fódje? · Ne ik gio mannes ni warð
wís an mínera wer-oldi.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu
ęngil þes alo-waldon · þero idisiu te·gęgnes:
„an þí skal hêlag gêst · fon heþan-wange
kuman þurh kraft godes. · Þanan skal þi kind ôdan
werðan an þesaro wer-oldi; · waldandes kraft
skal þi fon þem hôhoston · heþan-kuninge
skadowan mid skimon. · Ni warð skônjera gi·burd,
ne só mári mid mannun, · hwand siu kumid þurh maht godes
an þese wídon wer-old.“ · Þó warð eft þes wíbes hugi
aftar þem ârundje · al gi·hworben

an godes willjon. · „Þan ik hér garu standu“, kwað siu,
„te su-líkun ambaht-skępi, · só hé mí êgan wili.
Þiu bium ik þeot-godes. · Nú ik þeses þinges gi·trúon;
werðe mí aftar þínun wordun, · al só is willjo sí,
hêrron mínes; · nis mí hugi twífli,
ne word ne wísa.“ · Só gi·fragn ik, þat þat wíf ant·féng
þat godes ârundi · gerno swíðo
mid leohtu hugi · ęndi mid gi·lôbon gódun
ęndi mid hluttrun treuwun; · warð þe hêlago gêst,
þat barn an ira bósma; · ęndi siu ira breostun for·stód
iak an ire sebon selbo, · sagda þem siu welda,
þat sie habde gi·ôkana · þes alo-waldon kraft
hêlag fon himile. · Þó warð hugi Josepes,
is mód gi·worrid, · þe im êr þea magað habda,
þea idis ant-hêttja, · aðal-knósles wíf
gi·boht im te brúdju. · Hé af·sóf þat siu habda barn undar iru:
ni wánda þes mid wihti, · þat iru þat wíf habdi
gi·wardod só waro-líko: · ni wisse waldandes þó noh
blíðri gi·bod-skępi. · Ni welda sia imo te brúdi þó,
halon imo te híwon, · ak bi·gan im þó an hugi þęnkjan,
hwó hé sie só for·léti, · só iru þár nú wurði lêdes wiht,
ôdan arbides. · Ni welda sie aftar þiu
meldon for męnigi: · ant·dréd þat sie manno barn
líbu bi·námin. · Só was þan þero liudjo þau
þurh þen aldon êw, · Ebreo folkes,
só hwi-lík só þár an un-reht · idis gi·híwida,
þat siu simbla þana bed-skępi · buggjan skolda,
frí mid ira ferhu: · ni was gio þiu fêmja só gód,
þat siu mid þem liudun lęng · libbjen mósti,
wesan undar þem weroda. · Bi·gan im þe wíso mann,
swíðo gód gumo, · Joseph an is móda
þęnkjan þero þingo, · hwó hé þea þiornun þó
listjun for·léti. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,
þat im þár an drôma · kwam drohtines ęngil,
heban-kuninges bodo, · ęndi hét sie ina haldan wel,
minnjon sie an is móde: · „Ni wis þú“, kwað hé, „Mariun wrêð,
þiornun þínaro; · siu is gi·þungan wíf;
ne for·hugi þú sie te hardo; · þú skalt sie haldan wel,

wardon ira an þesaro wer-oldi. · Lêsti þú inka wini-treuwa
forð só þú dádi, · ęndi hald inkan friund-skępi wel!
Ne lát þú sie þi þiu lêðaron, · þoh siu undar ira liðon êgi,
barn an ira bósma. · It kumid þurh gi·bod godes,
hêlages gêstes · fon heƀan-wanga:
þat is Jésu Krist, · godes êgan barn,
waldandes sunu. · Þú skalt sie wel haldan,
hêlag-líko. · Ne lát þú þi þínan hugi twífljen,
męrrjan þína mód-gi·þáht.“ · Þó warð eft þes mannes hugi
gi·węndid aftar þem wordun, · þat hé im te þem wíƀa ge·nam,
te þera magað minnja: · ant·kęnda maht godes,
waldandes gi·bod; · was im willjo mikil,
þat hé sia só hêlag-líko · haldan mósti:
bi·sorgoda sie an is gi·síðja, · ęndi siu só súƀro dróg
al te huldi godes · hêlagna gêst,
gód-líkan gumon, · ant-þat sie godes gi·skapu
mahtig gi·manodun, · þat siu ina an manno lioht,
allaro barno bętst, · bręngjan skolda.

TODO.

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266 heƀan-kuninges | *so* **M**; himilcuninges **C**

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266 Hêljand te namon | The first appearance of the word which has given the whole poem its scholarly name; this is one of two places (cf. l. 443) where it is treated as a true proper noun, for which reason it is capitalized. Its presence is an undeniable sign of influence from an earlier work, the OHG Tatian, which in the corresponding passage (3:4, TODO: cite translated the Latin *concipies in utero et paries filium et vocabis nomen eius* ***Ihesum*** ‘thou wilt conceive in your womb and bear a son, and thou wilt call his name Jesus’ as OHG *nu in·fahis in reue inti gi·biris sun inti gi·nemnis* ***sinan namon Heilant***. ‘… and thou wilt call his name Healend.’ This is an important point for determining the sources of *Heli* since it shows that the poet did not rely directly on the Latin version, but rather on the OHG translation.

336 godes gi·skapu ‘God’s shapes’ | TODO: some note about this.

338 allaro barno bętst | A formula used throughout the poem. It may have inspired the later Otfrid, who in *Evangelienbuch* 1.13.10 calls Christ *barno bęzista*.

**5** Þó warð fon Rúmu-burg · ríkes mannes
obar alla þesa irmin-þiod · Oktawiánas
ban ęndi bod-skępi · obar þea is brêdon gi·wald
kuman fon þem kêsure · kuningo gi·hwi-líkun,
hêm-sittjandjun, · só wído só is hęri-togon
obar al þat land-skępi · liudjo gi·weldun.
Hiet man þat alla þea ęli-lęndjun man · iro óðil sóhtin,
hęliðos iro hand-mahạl · an·gęgin iro hêrron bodon,

kwámi te þem knósla gi·hwe, · þanan hé kunnjas was,
gi·boran fon þem burgjun. · Þat gi·bod warð gi·lêstid
obar þesa wídon wer-old; · werod samnoda
te allaro burgjo gi·hwem. · Fórun þea bodon obar all,
þea fon þem kêsura · kumana wárun,
bók-spáha weros, · ęndi an bréf skriƀun
swíðo niud-líko · namono gi·hwi-líkan,
ia land ia liudi, · þat im ni mahti a·lęttjan mann
gumono su-líka gambra, · só im skolda geldan gi·hwe
hęliðo fon is hôƀda. · Þó gi·wêt im ôk mid is híwiska
Joseph þe gódo, · só it god mahtig,
waldand welda: · sóhta im þiu wánamon hêm,
þea burg an Bethleem, · þár iro bęiðero was,
þes hęliðes hand-mahạl* · ęndi ôk þera hêlagun þiornun,
Mariun þera gódun. · Þár was þes márjon stól
an êr-dagun, · aðal-kuninges,
Dawides þes gódon, · þan langa þe hé þana druht-skępi þár,
erl undar Ebreon · êgan mósta,
haldan hôh-gi·setu. · Sie wárun is híwiskas,
kuman fon is knósla, · kunnjas gódes,
bêðju bi gi·burdjun. · Þár gi·fragn ik, þat sie þiu berhtun
gi·skapu,
Mariun gi·manodun · *ęndi maht godes,
þat iru an þem síða · sunu ôdan warð,
gi·boran an Bethleem · barno strangost,
allaro kuningo kraftigost: · kuman warð þe márjo,
mahtig an manno lioht, · só is êr managan dag
biliði wárun · ęndi bôkno filu
gi·worðen an þesero wer-oldi. · Þó was it all gi·wárod só,
só it êr spáha man · gi·sprokan habdun,
þurh hwi-lík ôd-módi · hé þit erð-ríki herod
þurh is selƀes kraft · sókjan welda,
managaro mund-boro. · Þó ina þiu módar nam,
bi·wand ina mid wádju · wíbo skônjost,
fagạron fratahun, · ęndi ina mid iro folmon twêm
lęgda lioƀ-líko · luttilna man,
þat kind an êna kribbjun, · þoh hé habdi kraft godes,
manno drohtin. · Þár sat þiu módar bi·foran,
wíf wakojandi, · war*doda selƀo,

held þat hêlaga barn: · ni was ira hugi twífli,
þera magað ira mód-sebo. · Þó warð þat managun kùð
obar þesa wídon wer-old, · wardos ant·fundun,
þea þár ehu-skalkos · úta wárun,
weros an wahtu, · wiggjo gômjan,
fehas aftar fel*da: · gi·sáhun finistri an twê
te·látan an lufte, · ęndi kwam lioht godes
wánum þurh þiu wolkạn · ęndi þea wardos þár
bi·féng an þem felda. · Sie wurðun an forhtun þó,
þea man an ira móda: · gi·sáhun þár mahtigna
godes ęngil kuman, · þe im te·gęgnes sprak,
hét þat im þea wardos · wiht ne ant·drédin
lêões fon þem liohta: · „ik skal eu“, kwað hé, „liobara þing,
swíðo wár-líko · willjon sęggjan,
kùðjan kraft mikil: · nú is Krist ge·boran
an þeser*o selbun naht, · sálig barn godes,
an þera Dawides burg, · drohtin þe gódo.
Þat is męndislo · manno kunnjas,
allaro firiho fruma. · Þár gí ina fíðan mugun,
an Bethlema-burg · barno ríkjost:
hębbjad þat te têkna, · þat ik eu gi·tęlljan mag
wárun wordun, · þat hé þár bi·wundan ligid,
þat kind an ênera kribbjun, · þoh hé sí kuning obar al
erðun ęndi himiles · ęndi obar ęldjo barn,
wer-oldes waldand“. · Reht só hé þó þat word gi·sprak,
só warð þár ęngilo te þem ênun · un-rím kuman,
hêlag hęri-skępi · fon heban-wanga,
fagar folk godes, · ęndi filu sprákun,
lof-word manag · liudjo hêrron.
Af·hóbun þó hêlagna sang, · þó sie eft te heban-wanga
wundun þurh þiu wolkạn. · Þea wardos hôrdun,
hwó þiu ęngilo kraft · alo-mahtigna god
swíðo werð-líko · wordun lobodun:
„diuriða sí nú“, (kwáðun sie,) „drohtine selbun
an þem hôhoston · himilo ríkja
ęndi friðu an erðu · firiho barnun,
gód-willigun gumun, · þem þe god ant·kęnnjad
þurh hluttran hugi.“ · Þea hirdjo for·stódun,
þat sie mahtig þing · gi·manod habda,

blîð-lík bod-skępi: · gi·witun im te Bethleem þanan
nahtes sîðon; · was im niud mikil,
þat sie selbon Krist · gi·sehan móstin.

TODO.

359 bęiðero | *so (*'beidero'*)* **M**, *(*'beiðera'*)* **S**; 'bethero' **C**

359 bęiðero | This very rare occurrence of the original diphthong, which almost everywhere else has been contracted to *ê*, is found in 2/3 witness mss. It also occurs at l. 2265. Cf. l. 3674 n.

**6**

Habda im þe engil godes · al gi·wisid
torhtun têknun, · þat sie im tó selbun,
te þem godes barne · gangan mahtun,
endi fundun sán · folko drohtin,
liudjo hêrron. · Sagdun þó lof goda,
waldande mid iro wordun · endi wído kuðdun
obar þea berhtun burg, · hwi-lík im þár biliði warð
fon heþan-wanga · hêlag gi·tôgit,
fagar an felde. · Þat frí al bi·held
an ira hugi-skęftjun, · hêlag þiorna,
þiu magað an ira móde, · só hwat só siu gi·hôrda þea mann sprekan.
Fódda ina þó fagaro · frího skânjosta,
þiu módar þurh minnja · managaro drohtin,
hêlag himilisk barn. · Hęliðos gi·sprákun
an þem ahtodon daga · erlos managa,
swíðo glauwa gumon · mid þera godes þiornun,
þat hé Hêljand te namon · hębbjan skoldi,
só it þe godes engil · Gabriel gi·sprak
wáron wordun · endi þem wíbe gi·bôd,
bodo drohtines, · þó siu êrist þat barn ant·féng
wánum te þesero wer-oldi; · was iru willjo mikil,
þat siu ina só hêlag-líko · haldan mósti,
ful-géng im þó só gerno. · Þat gęr furðor skrêd
unt·þat þat friðu-barn godes · fiar-tig habda
dago endi nahto. · Þó skoldun sie þár êna dád frummjan,
þat sie ina te Jerusalem · for·geban skoldun
waldanda te þem wíha. · Só was iro wísa þan,
þero liudjo land-sidu, · þat þat ni mósta for·látan ne-gên
idis undar Ebreon, · ef iru at êrist warð

sunu a·fódit, · ne siu ina simbla þarod
te þem godes wíha · for·geƀan skolda.
Gi·witun im þó þiu gódun twê, · Joseph ęndi Maria
bêðju fon Bethleem: · habdun þat barn mid im,
hêlagna Krist, · sóhtun im hús godes
an Jerusalem; · þár skoldun sie is geld frummjan
waldanda at þem wíha · wísa lêstjan
Judeo folkes. · Þár fundun sea ênna gódan man
aldan at þem alạha, · aðal-boranan,
þe habda at þem wíha só filu · wintro ęndi sumaro
gi·libd an þem liohta: · oft warhta hé þár lof goda
mid hluttru hugi; · habda im hêlagna gêst,
sálig-líkan sebon; · Simeon was hé hêtan.
Im habda gi·wísid · waldandas kraft
langa hwíla, · þat hé ni mósta êr þit lioht a·geƀan,
węndjan af þesero wer-oldi, · êr þan im þe willjo gi·stódi,
þat hé selƀan Krist · gi·sehan mósti,
hêlagna heƀan-kuning. · Þó warð im is hugi swíðo
blíði an is briostun, · þó hé gi·sah þat barn kuman
an þena wíh innan. · Þuo sagda hie waldande þank,
al-mahtigon gode, · þes hé ina mid is ôgun gi·sah.
Géng im þó te·gęgnes · ęndi ina gerno ant·féng
ald mid is armun: · al ant·kęnde
bôkan ęndi biliði · ęndi ôk þat barn godes,
hêlagna heƀan-kuning. · „Nú ik þi, hêrro, skal“, kwað hé,
„gerno biddjan, · nú ik sus gi·gamalod bium,
þat þú þínan holdan skalk · nú hinan hwerƀan látas,
an þína friðu-wára faran, · þár êr mína forðrun dedun,
weros fon þesero wer-oldi, · nú mí þe willjo gi·stód,
dago lioƀosto, · þat ik mínan drohtin gi·sah,
holdan hêrron, · só mí gi·hêtan was
langa hwíla. · Þú bist lioht mikil
allun ęli-þiodun, · þea êr þes alo-waldon
kraft ne ant·kęndun. · Þína kumi sindun
te dóma ęndi te diurðon, · drohtin frô mín,
aƀarun Israhelas, · êganumu folke,
þínun liоƀun *liudjun.“ · Listjun talde þó
þe aldo man an þem alạha · idis þero gódun,
sagda sòð-líko, · hwó iro sunu skolda

obar þesan middil-gard · managun werðan
sumun te falle, sumun te fróbru · firiho barnun,
þem liudjun te leoba, · þe is lêrun gi·hôrdin,
ęndi þem te harma, · þe hôrjen ni weldin
Kristas lêron. · „Þu skalt noh“, kwað hé, „kara þiggjan,
harm an þínumu herton, · þan ina hęliðo barn
wápnun wítnod. · Þat wirðid þi werk mikil,
þrim te gi·þolonna.“ · Þiu þiorna al for·stód
wísas mannas word. · Þó kwam þár ôk ên wíf gangan
ald innan þem alạha: · Anna was siu hêtan,
dohtar Fanueles; · siu habde ira drohtine wel
gi·þionod te þanka, · was iru gi·þungan wíf.
Siu mósta aftar ira magað-hêdi, · sïðor siu mannes warð,
erles an êhti · ęðili þiorne,
só mósta siu mid ira brúdi-gumon · bodlo gi·waldan
sibun wintạr saman. · Þó gi·fragn ik þat iru þár sorga gi·stód
þat sie þiu mikila maht · metodes te·dêlda,
wrêð wurdi-gi·skapu. · Þó was siu widowa aftar þiu
at þem friðu-wíha · fior ęndi ant·ahtoda
wintro an iro wer-oldi, · só siu nia þana wíh ni for·lét,
ak siu þár ira drohtine wel · dages ęndi nahtes,
gode þionode. · Siu kwam þár ôk gangan tó
an þea selbun tíd: · sán ant·kęnde
þat hêlage barn godes · ęndi þem hęliðon kùðde,
þem weroda aftar þem wíha · wil-spel mikil,
kwað þat im nęrjandas gi·nist · gi·náhid wári,
helpa heban-kuninges: · „nú is þe hêlago Krist,
waldand selbo · an þesan wíh kuman
te a·lôsjenne þea liudi, · þe hér nú lango bidun
an þesara middil-gard, · managa hwíla,
þurftig þioda, · só nú þes þinges mugun
męndjan man-kunni.“ · Manag fagonoda
werod aftar þem wíha: · gi·hôrdun wil-spel mikil
fon gode sęggjan. · Þat geld habde þó gi·lêstid
þiu idis an þem alạha, · al só it im an ira êwa gi·bôd
ęndi an þera berhtun burg · bók gi·wísdun,
hêlagaro hand-gi·werk. · Gi·witun im þó te hús þanan
fon Jerusalem · Joseph ęndi Maria,
hêlag híwiski: · habdun im heban-kuning

simbla te gi·sîða, · sunu drohtines,
managaro mund-boron, · só it gio mári ni warð
þan wídor an þesaro wer-oldi, · b·útan só is willjo géng,
537a heƀan-kuninges hugi.

TODO.

537b **7** Þoh þár þan gi·hwi-lík hêlag man
Krist ant·kęndi, · þoh ni warð it gio te þes kuninges hoƀe
þem mannun gi·márid, · þea im an iro mód-seƀon
holde ni wárun, · ak was im só bi·halden forð
mid wordun ęndi mid werkun, · ant-þat þár weros ôstan,
swíðo glauwa gumon · gangan kwámun
þrea te þero þiodu, · þegnos snelle,
an langan weg · oƀar þat land þarod:
folgodun ênun berhtun bôkne · ęndi sóhtun þat barn godes
mid hluttru hugi: · weldun im hnígan tó,
gehan im te jungrun: · driƀun im godes gi·skapu.
Þó sie Eródesan þár · ríkjan fundun
an is sęli sittjen, · slíð-wurdjan kuning,
módagna mid is mannun: · —simbla was hé morðes gern—
þó kwaddun sie ina kùsko · an kuning-wísun,
fagaro an is flęttje, · ęndi hé frágoda sán,
hwi-lík sie ârundi · úta gi·brâhti,
weros an þana wrak-síð: · „Hweðer lêdjad gí wundan gold
te geƀu hwi-líkun gumuno? · te hwí gí þus an ganga kumad,
gi·faran an fóðju? · Hwat gí n·êt-hwanan ferran sind
erlos fon òðrun þiodun. · Ik gi·sihu þat gí sind
ęðili-gi·burdjun
kunnjes fon knósle gódun: · nio hér êr su-líka kumana ni
wurðun
êri fon òðrun þiodun, · síðor ik mósta þesas erlo folkes,
gi·waldan þesas wídon ríkjas. · Gí skulun mí te wárun sęggjan
for þesun liudjo folke, · bi·hwí gí sín te þesun lande kumana“.
Þó sprákun im eft te·gęgnes · gumon ôstr-onja,
word-spáhe weros: · „wí þí te wárun mugun“, kwáðun sie,
„ùse ârundi · ôðo gi·tęlljen,
gi·sęggjan sòð-líko, · bi·hwí wí kwámun an þesan síð herod
fon ôstan te þesaro erðu. · Giu wárun þár aðaljes man,
gód-sprákja gumon, · þea ùs gódes só filu,

helpa gi·hétun · fon heƀan-kuninge
wárum wordun. · Þan was þár ên gi·wittig man,
fród ęndi fil-wís · —forn was þat giu—,
úse aldiro ôstar hinan, · —þár ni warð síðor ênig man
sprákono só spáhi—; · hé mahte rękkjen spel godes,
hwand im habde for·liwan · liudjo hêrro,
þat hé mahte fon erðu · up gi·hôrjan
waldandes word: · bi·þiu was is gi·wit mikil,
þes þegnes gi·þáhti. · Þó hé þanan skolda,
a·geƀen gardos, · gadulingo gi·mang,
for·láten liudjo drôm, · sókjen lioht óðar,
þó hé is jungron hét · gangan náhor,
ęrƀi-wardos, · ęndi is erlun þó
sagde sòð-líko: · —þat al síðor kwam,
gi·warð* an þesaro wer-oldi—: · þó sagda hé þat hér skoldi
kuman ên wís-kuning
mári ęndi mahtig · an þesan middil-gard
þes bętston gi·burdjes; · kwað þat it skoldi wesan barn godes,
kwað þat hé þesero wer-oldes · waldan skoldi
gio te êwan-daga, · erðun ęndi himiles.
Hé kwað þat an þem selƀon daga, · þe ina sáligna
an þesan middil-gard · módar gi·drógi,
só kwað hé þat ôstana · ên skoldi skínan
himil-tungal hwít, · su-lík só wí hér ne habdin êr
undar·twisk erða ęndi himil · óðar hwęrigin,
ne su-lík barn ne su-lík bôkan. · Hét þat þár te bedu fórin
þrea man fon þero þiodu, · hét sie þęnkjan wel,
hwan êr sie gi·sáwin ôstana · up síðojan,
þat godes bôkan gangan, · hét sie garwjan sán,
hét þat wí im folgodin, · só it furi wurði,
westar obar þesa wer-oldi. · Nú is it al gi·wárod só,
kuman þurh kraft godes: · þe kuning is gi·fódit,
gi·boran bald ęndi strang: · wí gi·sáhun is bôkan skínan
hêdro fon himiles tunglun, · só ik wêt, þat it hêlag drohtin,
markoda mahtig selƀo; · wí gi·sáhun morgno gi·hwi-líkes
blíkan þana berhton sterron, · ęndi wí géngun aftar þem
bôkna herod
wegas ęndi waldas hwílon. · Þat wári ús allaro willjono mêsta,

Þat wí ina selƀon gi·sehan móstin, · wissin, hwár wí ina sókjan skoldin,
Þana kuning an þesumu kêsur-dóma. · Saga ùs, undar hwi-líkumu hé sí þesaro kunnjo a·fódit.“
Þó warð Erodesa · innan briostun
harm wið herta, · bi·gan im is hugi wallan,
seƀo mid sorgun: · gi·hôrde sęggjan þó,
þat hé þár oƀar-hôƀdon · êgan skoldi,
kraftagoron kuning · kunnjes gódes,
sáligoron undar þem gi·sîðja. · Þó hé samnon hét,
só hwat só an Jerusalem · gódaro manno
allaro spáhoston · sprákono wárun
ęndi an iro brioston · bók-kraftes mêst
wissun te wárun, · ęndi hé sie mid wordun fragn,
swíðo niud-líko · níð-hugdig man,
kuning þero liudjo, · hwár Krist gi·boran
an wer-old-ríkja · werðan skoldi,
friðu-gumono bętst. · Þó sprak im eft þat folk an·gęgin,
þat werod wár-líko, · kwáðun þat sie wissin garo,
þat hé skoldi an Bethleem gi·boran werðan: · „só is an ùsun bókun gi·skriƀan,
wís-líko gi·writan, · só it wár-sagon,
swíðo glauwa gumon · bi godes krafta
fil-wíse man · furn gi·sprákun,
þat skoldi fon Bethleem · burgo hirdi,
liof landes ward · an þit lioht kuman,
ríki rád-geƀo, · þe rihtjen skal
Judeono gum-skępi · ęndi is geƀa wesan
mildi oƀar middil-gard · managun þiodun.“

TODO.

557–561 erlos ... kumana | *Ll. 557a–560b and 561b are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 380).*

554 wundan gold | Formulaic, belonging to the culture of the Germanic Migration Period.

599–605 wí ... a·fódit | Ll. 599b–602a, 603a–605b are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, pp. 380–381). The constrast between the length of 605b, the last verse of speech, and 606, the voice of the narrating poet, is notable.

**8** Þó gi·fragn ik þat sán aftar þiu · slíð-mód kuning
þero wár-sagono word · þem wrękkjun sagda,
þea þár an ęli-lęndi · erlos wárun

ferran gi·farana, · ęndi hé frágoda aftar þiu,
hwan sie an ôstar-wegun · êrist gi·sáhin
þana kuning-sterron kuman, · kumbạl liuhtjen
hêdro fon himile. · Sie ni weldun is im þó helen eo·wiht,
ak sagdun it im sôð-líko. · Þó hét hé sie an þana sïð faran,
hét þat sie ira ârundi al · undar fundin
umbi þes kindes kumi, · ęndi þe kuning selbo gi·bôd
swíðo hard-liko, · hêrro Judeono,
þem wísun mannun, · êr þan sie fórin westan forð,
þat sie im eft gi·kûðdin, · hwár hé þana kuning skoldi
sókjan at is sęlðon; · kwað þat hé þár weldi mid is gi·sïðun tó,
bedan te þem barne. · Þan hogda hé im te banon werðan
wápnes ęggjun. · Þan eft waldand god
þáhte wið þem þinga: · hé mahta a·þęngjan mêr,
gi·lêstjan an þesum liohte: · þat is noh lango skín,
gi·kûðid kraft godes. · Þó géngun eft þiu kumbl forð
wánum undar wolknun. · Þó wárun þea wíson man
fûsa te faranne: · gi·witun im forð þanan
balda an bod-skępi: · weldun þat barn godes
selbon sókjan. · Sie ni habdun þanan gi·sïðjas mêr,
b·útan þat sie þríe wárun: · wissun im þingo gi·skêð,
wárun im glauwe gumon, · þe þea geba lêddun.
Þan sáhun sie só wís-líko · undar þana wolknes skion,
up te þem hôhon himile, · hwó fórun þea hwíton sterron
—ant·kęndun sie þat kumbạl godes—, · þiu wárun þurh
Krista herod
gi·warht te þesero wer-oldi. · Þea weros aftar géngun,
folgodun ferạht-líko · —sie frumide þe mahte—
ant-þat sie gi·sáhun, · sïð-wórige man,
berht bôkạn godes, · blêk an himile
stillo gi·standen. · Þe sterro liohto skên
hwít obar þem húse, · þár þat hêlage barn
wonode an willjon · ęndi ina þat wíf bi·held,
þiu þiorne gi·þiudo. · Þó warð þero þegno hugi
blíði an iro briostun: · bi þem bôkna for·stódun,
þat sie þat friðu-barn godes · funden habdun,
hêlagna heþan-kuning. · Þó sie an þat hús innan
mid iro geþun géngun, · gumon ôstr-onja,
sïð-wórige man: · sán ant·kęndun

671 Þea weros waldand Krist. · Þea wrękkjon fellun
te þem kinde an kneo-beda · ęndi ina an kuning-wísa
673 gódan gróttun · ęndi im þea geƀa drógun,
gold ęndi wíh-rôk · bi godes têknun
675 *ęndi myrra þár mid. · Þea man stódun garowa,
holde for iro hêrron, · þea it mid iro handun sán
677 fagaro ant·féngun. · Þó gi·witun im þea feraḥton man,
sęggi te sęlðon · síð-wórige,
679 gumon an gast-sęli. · Þár im godes ęngil
slápandjun an naht · sweƀan gi·tôgde,
681 gi·drog im an drôme, · al so it drohtin self,
waldand welde, · þat im þúhte þat man im mid wordun
gi·budi,
683 þat sie im* þanan óðran weg, · erlos fórin,
liðodin sie te lande · ęndi þana lêðan man,
685 Erodesan · eft ni sóhtin,
módagna kuning. · Þó warð morgan kuman
687 wánum te þesero wer-oldi. · Þó bi·gunnun þea wíson man
sęggjan iro sweƀanos; · selƀon ant·kęndun
689 waldandes word, · hwand sie gi·wit mikil
bárun an iro briostun: · bádun alo-waldon,
691 hêron heƀan-kuning, · þat sie móstin is huldi forð,
gi·wirkjan is willjon, · kwáðun þat sea ti im habdin gi·węndit
hugi,
693 *iro mód morgan gi·hwem. · Þó fórun eft þie man þanan,
erlos ôstr-onje, · al só im þe ęngil godes
695 wordun gi·wísde: · námun im weg óðran,
ful-géngun godes lêrun: · ni weldun þemu Judeo kuninge
697 umbi þes barnes gi·burd · bodon ôstr-onje,
síð-wórige man · sęggjan gio·wiht,
699a ak węndun im eft an iro willjon.

TODO.

699b **9** Þó warð sán aftar þiu waldandes,
godes ęngil kumen · Josepe te sprákun,
701 sagde im an swefne · slápandjum an naht,
bodo drohtines, · þat þat barn godes
703 slíð-mód kuning · sókjan welda,
áhtjan is aldres; · „nú skaltu ine an Aegypteo

land ant·lêdjan · ęndi undar þem liudjun wesan
mid þiu godes barnu · ęndi mid þeru gódan þior*nan,
wunon undar þemu werode, · unt·þat þi word kume
hêrron þínes, · þat þú þat hêlage barn
eft te þesum land-skępi · lêdjan mótis,
drohtin þínen.“ · Þó fon þem drôma an·sprang
Joseph an is gęst-sęli, · ęndi þat godes gi·bod
sán ant·kęnda: · gi·wêt im an þana síð þanen
þe þegạn mid þeru þiornon, · sóhta im þiod óðra
obar brêdan berg: · welda þat barn godes
fiundun ant·fórjan. · *Þó gi·frang aftar þiu
Eródes þe kuning, · þár hé an is ríkja sat,
þat wárun þea wíson man · westan gi·hworban
ôstar an iro óðil · ęndi fórun im òðran weg:
wisse þat sie im þat ârundi · eft ni weldun
sęggjan an is sęlðon. · Þó warð im þes an sorgun hugi,
mód mornondi, · kwað þat it im þie man dedin,
hęliðos* te hônðun. · Þó hé só hriuwig sat,
balg ina an is briostun, · kwað þat hé is mahti bętaron rád,
òðran gi·þęnkjen: · „nú ik is aldạr kan,
wêt is wintęr-gi·talu: · nú ik gi·winnan mag,
þat hé io obar þesaro erðu · ald ni wirðit,
hêr undar þesum hęri-skępi.“ · Þó hé só hardo gi·bôd,
Eródes obar is ríki, · hét þó is rinkos faran
kuning þero liudjo, · hét þat sie kinda só filo
þurh iro hand-magen · hôbdu bi·námin,
só manag barn umbi Bethleem, · só filo só þár gi·boran wurði,
an twêm gęrun a·togan. · Tionon frumidon
þes kuninges gi·síðos. · Þó skolda þár só manag kindisk man
sweltan sundjono lôs. · Ni warð síð noh êr
jámar-líkara for·gang · jungaro manno,
arm-líkara dôð. · Idisi wiopun,
módar managa, · gi·sáhun iro męgi spildjan:
ni mahte siu im nio gi·formon, · þoh siu mid iro faðmon twêm
iro êgan barn · armun bi·féngi,
liof ęndi luttil, · þoh skolda is simbla þat líf geban,
þe magu for þeru módar. · Mênes ni sáhun,
wítjes þie wam-skaðon: · wápnes ęggjun
frępidun firin-werk mikil. · Fellun managa

magu-junge man. · Þia módar wiopun
kind-jungaro kwalm; · kara was an Bethleem,
hofno hlúdost: · þoh man im iro herton an twê
sniði mid swerdu, · þoh ni mohta im gio sêrara dád
werðan an þesaro wer-oldi, · wíbun managun,
brúdjun an Bethleem: · gi·sáhun iro barn bi·foran,
kind-junge man, · kwalmu sweltan
blódag an iro barmun. · Þie banon wítnodun
un·skuldige skole: · ni bi·skribun gio·wiht
þea man umbi mên-werk: · weldun mahtigna,
Krist selbon a·kwęlljan. · Þan habde ina kraftag god
gi·nęridan wið iro níðe, · þat inan nahtes þanan
an Aegypteo land · erlos ant·lêddun,
gumon mid Josepe · an þana grónjon wang,
an erðono bętstun, · þár ên aha fliutid,
Níl-strôm mikil · norð te sêwa,
flódo fagorosta. · Þár þat friðu-barn godes
wonoda an willjon, · ant-þat wurd for·nam
Erodes þana kuning, · þat hé for·lét ęldjo barn,
módag manno drôm. · Þó skolda þero marka gi·wald
êgan is ęrbi-ward: · þe was Arkheláus
hêtan, hęri-togo · helm-berandero:
þe skolda umbi Jerusalem · Judeono folkes,
werodes gi·waldan. · Þó warð word kuman
þár an Egypti · ęðiljun manne,
þat hé þár te Josepe, · godes ęngil sprak,
bodo drohtines, · hét ina eft þat barn þanan
lêdjen te lande. · „nú habað þit lioht af·geben“, kwað hé,
„Erodes þe kuning; · hé welde is áhtjen giu,
frêson is feraḥas. · Nú maht þú an friðu lêdjen
þat kind undar euwa kunni, · nú þe kuning ni libod,
erl obar-módig.“ · Al ant·kęnde
Josep godes têkạn: · gęriwide ina sniumo
þe þegạn mit þera þiornun, · þó sie þanan weldun
bêðju mid þiu barnu: · lêstun þiu berhton gi·skapu,
waldandes willjon, · al só hé im êr mid is wordun gi·bôd.

TODO.

**10** Gi·witun im þó eft an Galilea-land · Joseph ęndi Maria,

hêlag híwiski · heban-kuninges,
wárun im an Nazareth-burg. · Þár þe nęrjondjo Krist
wóhs undar þem werode, · warð gi·wittjes ful,
an was imu anst godes, · hé was allun liof
módar-mágun: · hé ni was ȯðrun mannun gi-lík,
þe gumo an sínera gódi. · Þó hé gęr-talo
twe-libi habde, · þó warð þiu tíd kuman,
þat sie þár te Jerusalem, · Juðeo liudi
iro þiod-gode · þionon skoldun,
wirkjan is willjon. · Þó warð þár an þana wíh innan
þár te Jerusalem · Judeono gi·samnod
man-kraft mikil. · Þár Maria was
self an gi·sïðja · ęndi iru sunu habda,
godes êgan barn. · Þó sie þat geld habdun,
erlos an þem alạha, · só it an iro êwa gi·bôd,
gi·lêstid te iro land-wísun, · þó fórun im eft þie liudi þanan,
weros an iro willjon · ęndi þár an þem wíha af·stód
mahtig barn godes, · só ina þiu módar þár
ni wissa te wáron; · ak siu wánda þat hé mid þem weroda forð,
fóri mit iro friundun. · Gi·frang aftar þiu
eft an ȯðrun daga · aðal-kunnjes wíf,
sálig þiorna, · þat hé undar þem gi·sïðja ni was.
warð Mariun þó · mód an sorgun,
hriuwig umbi iro herta, · þó siu þat hêlaga barn
ni fand undar þem folka: · filu gornoda
þiu godes þiorna. · Gi·witun im þó eft te Jerusalem
iro sunu sókjan, · fundun ina sittjan þár
an þem wíha innan, · þár þe wísa man,
swíðo glauwa gumon · an godes êwa
lásun ęnde línodun, · hwó sie lof skoldin
wirkjan mid iro wordun þem, · þe þesa wer-old gi·skóp.
Þár sat undar middjun · mahtig barn godes,
Krist alo-waldo, · só is þea ni mahtun ant·kęnnjan wiht,
þe þes wíhes þár · wardon skoldun,
ęndi frágoda sie · firi-wit-líko
wísera wordo. · Sie wundradun alle,
bi·hwí gio só kindisk man · su-líka kwidi mahti
mid is mûðu gi·mênjan. · Þár ina þiu módar fand
sittjan under þem gi·sïðja · ęndi iro sunu grótta,

wísan undar þem weroda, · sprak im mid ira wordun tó:
„hwí weldes þú þínera módar, · manno liobosto,
gi·sidon su-líka sorga, · þat ik þí só sêrag-mód,
idis arm-hugdig · êskon skolda
undar þesun burg-liudjun?“ · Þó sprak iru eft þat barn an·gegin
wísun wordun: · „Hwat þú wêst garo“, kwað hé,
„þat ik þár gi·rísu, · þár ik bi rehton skal
wonon an willjon, · þár gi·wald habad
mín mahtig fader.“ · Þie man ni for·stódun,
þie weros an þem wíha, · bi·hwí hé só þat word gi·sprak,
gi·mênda mid is mûðu: · Maria al bi·held,
gi·barg an ira breostun, · só hwat só siu gi·hôrda ira barn sprekan
wísaro wordo. · Gi·witun im þó eft þanan
fon Jerusalem · Joseph endi Maria,
habdun im te gi·sîðja · sunu drohtines,
allaro barno bętsta, · þero þe io gi·boran wurði
magu fon módar: · habdun im þár minnja tó
þurh hluttran hugi, · endi hé só gi·hôrig was,
godes êgan barn · gaduling-mágun
þurh is ôd-módi, · aldron sínun:
ni welda an is kindiski þó noh · is kraft mikil
mannun márjan, · þat hé su-lík męgin êhta,
gi·wald an þesaro wer-oldi, · ak hé im an is willjon bêd
gi·þiudo undar þero þiodu · þrí-tig gęro,
êr þan hé þár têkan ênig · tôgjan weldi,
sęggjan þem gi·sîðja, · þat hé selbo was
an þesaro middil-gard · manno drohtin.
Habda im só bi·halden · hêlag barn godes
word endi wís-dóm · ende allaro gi·wittjo mêst,
tulgo spáhan hugi: · ni mahta man is an is sprákun werðan,
an is wordun gi·war, · þat hé su-lík gi·wit êhta,
þegan su-líka gi·þáhti, · ak hé im só gi·þiudo bêd
torhtaro têkno. · Ni was noh þan þiu tíd kuman,
þat hé ina obar þesan middil-gard · márjan skolda,
lêrjan þie liudi, · hwó sie skoldin iro gi·lôbon haldan,
wirkjan willjon godes; · wissun þat þoh managa
liudi aftar þem landa, · þat hé was an þit lioht kuman,

857 þoh sie ina kûð-líko · an·kęnnjan ni mahtin,
êr þan hé ina selbo · sęggjan welda.

TODO.

817 bi·hwí | hwó C 818 mid is mûðu gi·mênjan | gi·mahljan mid is mûðu C

859 **11** Þan was im Johannes · fon is juguð-hêdi
a·wahsan an ênero wóstunni; · þár ni was werodes þan mêr,
861 b·útan þat hé þár ên-kora · alo-waldon gode,
þegan þionoda: · for·lét þioda gi·mang,
863 manno gi·mênðon. · Þár warð im mahtig kuman
an þero wóstunni · word fon himila,
865 gód-lík stemna godes, · ęndi Johanne gi·bod,
þat hé Kristes kumi · ęndi is kraft mikil
867 obar þesan middil-gard · márjan skoldi;
hét ina wár-líko · wordun sęggjan,
869 þat wári heþan-ríki · hęliðo barnun
an þem land-skępi, · liudjun gi·náhid,
871 welono wun-samost. · Im was þó willjo mikil,
þat hé fon su-líkun sáldun · sęggjan mósti.
873 Gi·wêt im þó gangan, · al só Jordan flót,
watar an willjon, · ęndi þem weroda allan dag,
875 aftar þem land-skępi · þem liudjun kûðda,
þat sie mid fastunnju · firin-werk manag,
877 iro selboro · sundja bóttin,
„þat gí werðan hrênja“, (kwað hé;) „heþan-ríki is
879 gi·náhid manno barnun. · Nú látad eu an euwan mód-sebon
euwar selboro · sundja hreuwan,
881 lêdas þat gí an þesun liohta frędmidun, · ęndi mínun lêrun hôrjad,
węndjat aftar mínun wordun. · Ik eu an watara skal
883 gi·dôpjan diur-líko, · þoh ik euwa dádi ne mugi,
euwar selbaro · sundja a·látan,
885 þat gí þurh mín hand-gi·werk · hluttra werðan
lêðaro gi·lêsto: · ak þe is an þit lioht kuman,
887 mahtig te mannun · ęndi undar eu middjun stéd,
—þoh gí ina selbun · gi·sehan ni willjan—,
889 þe eu gi·dôpjan skal · an euwes drohtines namon
an þana hâlagon gêst. · Þat is hêrro obar al:
891 hé mag allaro manno gi·hwena · mên-gi·þáhtjo,

sundjono sikoron, · só hwene só só sálig mót
werðen an þesaro wer-oldi, · þat þes willjon habad,
þat hé só gi·lêstja, · só hé þesun liudjun wili,
gi·bioden barn godes. · Ik bium an is bod-skępi herod
an þesa wer-old kumen · ęndi skal im þana weg rúmjen,
lêrjan þesa liudi, · hwó sea skulin iro gi·lôbon haldan
þurh hluttran hugi, · ęndi þat sie an hęllja ni þurbin,
faran an fern þat hêta. · Þes wirðid só fagan an is móde
man te só managaro stundu, · só hwe só þat mên for·látid,
gerno þes gramon an·busni, · —só mag im þes gódon gi·wirkjan,
huldi heban-kuninges,— · só hwe só habad hluttra treuwa
up te þem alo-mahtigon gode.“ · Erlos managa
bi þem lêrun þó, · liudi wándun,
weros wár-líko, · þat þat waldand Krist
selbo wári, · hwanda hé só filu sòðes gi·sprak,
wároro wordo. · Þó warð þat só wído kùð
obar þat for·gebana land · gumono gi·hwi-líkum,
sęggjun at iro sęlðun: · þó kwámun ina sókjan þarod
fon Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo
bodon fon þeru burgi · ęndi frágodun, ef hé wári þat barn godes,
„þat hér lango giu“, (kwáðun sie,) „liudi sagdun,
weros wár-líko, · þat hé skoldi an þesa wer-old kuman“.
Johannes þó gi·mahęlde · ęndi te·gęgnes sprak
þem bodun bald-líko: · „ni bium ik“, kwað hé, „þat barn godes,
wár waldand Krist, · ak ik skal im þana weg rúmjen,
hêrron mínumu.“ · Þea hęliðos frugnun,
þea þár an þem árundje · erlos wárun,
bodon fon þero burgi: · „ef þú nú ni bist þat barn godes,
bist þú þan þoh Elias, · þe hér an êr-dagun
was undar þesumu werode? · hé is wis-kumo
eft an þesan middil-gard. · Saga ùs, hwat þú manno sís!
Bist þú ênig þero, · þe hér êr wári
wísaro wár-saguno? · Hwat skulun wí þem werode fon þí
sęggjan te sòðon? · Neo hér êr su-lík ni warð
an þesun middil-gard · man òðar kuman
dádjun só mári. · Bi·hwí þú hér dôpisli

fręmis undar þesumu folke, · ef þú þaro fora·sagono
ên-hwi-lík ni bist?“ · Þó habde eft garo
Johannes þe gódo · glau and-wordi:
„Ik bium fora-bodo · frâon mínes,
liobes hêrron; · ik skal þit land rekon,
þit werod aftar is willjon. · Ik hębbju fon is worde mid mí
stranga stemna, · þoh sie hér ni willje for·standan filo
werodes an þesaro wóstunni. · Ni bium ik mid wihti gi-lík
drohtine mínumu: · hé is mid is dádjun só strang,
só mári ęndi só mahtig · —þat wirðid managun kùð,
werun aftar þesaro wer-oldi— · þat ik þes wirðig ni bium,
þat ik móti an is gi·skuoha, · þoh ik sí is skalk êgan,
an só ríkjumu drohtine, · þea reomon ant·bindan:
só mikilu is hé bętara þan ik. · Nis þes bodon gi·mako
ênig obar erðu, · ne nú aftar ni skal
werðan an þesaro wer-oldi. · Hębbjad euwan willjon þarod,
liudi euwan gi·lôbon: · þan eu lango skal
wesan euwa hugi hrómag; · þan gí hęlli-gi·þwing,
for·látad lêðaro drôm · ęndi sókjad eu lioht godes,
up-ôdes hêm, · êwig ríki,
hôhan heban-wang. · Ne látad euwan hugi twífljen!“

TODO.

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881 lêdas ... hôrjad | This line is hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 385).

897–903 hwó ... gode. | Ll. 897b, 898b–901b, 902b–903a are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 386). Note the contrast between hypermetric 903a and normal 903b; cf. ll. 605–6 above.

925 sęggjan te sóðon | Formulaic, also found in *Heli* 2077a, 4018a, 4988a, along with *Beow* 51a: *sęcgan tó sóðe*.

**12**

Só sprak þó jung gumo · bi godes lêrun
mannun te márðu. · Manag samnoda
þár te Bethania · barn Israheles;
kwámun þár te Johannese · kuningo gi·síðos,
liudi te lêrun · ęndi iro gi·lôbon ant·féngun.
Hé dôpte sie dago gi·hwi-líkes · ęndi im iro dádi lóg,
wrêðaro willjon, · ęndi lobode im word godes,
hêrron sínes: · „heban-ríki wirðid“, kwað hé,
„garu gumono só hwem, · só ti gode þęnkid
ęndi an þana hêljand *wili · hluttro gi·lôbjan,
lêstjan is lêra“. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,

Þat im fon Galilea gi·wêt · godes êgan barn,
*diur-lík drohtines sunu, · dôpi suokjan.
was im þuo an is wastme · waldandes barn*,
al só hé mid þero þiodu · þrí-tig habdi
wintro an is wer-oldi. · Þó hé an is willjon kwam,
þár Johannes · an Jordana strôme
allan langan dag · liudi manage
dôpte diur-líko. · Reht só hé þó is drohtin gi·sah,
holdan hêrron, · só warð im is hugi blíði,
þes im þe willjo gi·stód, · ęndi sprak im þó mid is wordun tó,
swíðo gód gumo, · Johannes te Kriste:
„nú kumis þú te mínero dôpi, · drohtin frô mín,
þiod-gumono bętsto: · só skolde ik te þínero duan,
hwand þú bist allaro kuningo kraftigost.“ · Krist selbo gi·bôd,
waldand wár-líko, · þat hé ni spráki þero wordo þan mêr:
„wêst þú, þat ùs só gi·rísid“, (kwað hé,) „allaro rehto gi·hwi-lík
te gi·fulljanne · forð-wardes nú
an godes willjon“. · Johannes stód,
dôpte allan dag · druht-folk mikil,
werod an watere · ęndi ôk waldand Krist,
hêran heƀan-kuning · handun sínun
an allaro baðo þem bętston · ęndi im þár te bedu gi·hnêg
an kneo kraftag. · Krist up gi·wêt
fagar fon þem flóde, · friðu-barn godes,
liof liudjo ward. · Só hé þó þat land af·stóp,
só ant·hlidun þó himiles doru, · ęndi kwam þe hêlago gêst
fon þem alo-waldon · oƀane te Kriste:
—was im an gi·lík-nissje · lungras fugles,
diur-líkara dúƀun— · ęndi sat im uppan ùses drohtines ahslu,
wonoda im oƀar þem waldandes barne. · Aftar kwam þár
word fon himile,
hlúd fon þem hôhon radura · ęndi grótta þane hêljand selƀon,
Krista, allaro kuningo bętston, · kwað þat hé ina gi·korana
habdi
selƀo fon sínun ríkja, · kwað þat im þe sunu líkodi
bętst allaro gi·boranaro manno, · kwað þat hé im wári allaro
barno liobost.
Þat móste Johannes þó, · al só it god welde,
gi·sehan ęndi gi·hôrjan. · Hé gi·deda it sán aftar þiu

mannun mári, · þat sie þár mahtigna
997 hêrron habdun: · „Þit is“, kwað hé, „heƀan-kuninges sunu,
ên alo-waldand: · þesas willjo ik ur-kundjo
999 wesan an þesaro wer-oldi, · hwand it sagda mí word godes,
drohtines stemne, · þó hé mí dôpjan hét
1001 weros an watare, · só hwár só ik gi·sáwi wár-líko
þana hêlagon gêst · *fan heƀan-wange
1003 an þesan middil-gard · ênigan man waron,
kuman mid kraftu; · þat kwað, þat skoldi Krist wesan,
1005 diur-lík drohtines suno. · Hie dôpjan skal
an þana hêlagan gêst · ęndi hêljan managa
1007 manno mên-dádi. · Hé haƀad maht fon gode,
þat hé a·látan mag · liudjo gi·hwi-líkun
1009 saka ęndi sundja. · Þit is selƀo Krist,
godes êgan barn, · gumono bętsto,
1011 friðu wið fiundun. · Wala þat eu þes mag frâh-mód hugi
wesan an þesaro wer-oldi, · þes eu þe willjo gi·stód,
1013 þat gí só libbjanda · þana landes ward
selƀon gi·sáhun. · Ní mót sliumo sundjono lôs
1015 manag gêst faran · an godes willjon
tionon a·tómid, · þe mid treuwon wili
1017 wið is wini wirkjan · ęndi an waldand Krist
fasto gi·lôƀjan. · Þat skal te frumun werðen
1019 gumono só hwi-líkun, · só þat gerno dót“.

TODO.

954 Hé dôpte sie dago gi·hwi-líkes | *Classified by Suzuki (2004, p. 387) as hypermetric.*

988–993 ęndi … liobost. | 988b–992a, 993 are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, p. 387).

**13** Só ge·fragn ik þat Johannes þó · gumono gi·hwi-líkun,
1021 loƀoda þem liudjun · lêra Kristes,
hêrron sínes, · ęndi heƀan-ríki
1023 te gi·winnanne, · welono þane mêston,
sálig sin-líf. · Þó hé im selƀo gi·wêt
1025 aftar þem dôpislja, · drohtin þe gódo,
an êna wóstunnja, · waldandes sunu;
1027 was im þár an þero ên-ôdi · erlo drohtin
lange hwíla; · ne habda liudjo þan mêr,
1029 sęggjo te gi·síðun, · al só hé im selƀo gi·kôs:

welda is þár látan koston · kraftiga wihti,
selbon Satanasan, · þe gio an sundja spęnit,
man an mên-werk: · hé konsta is mód-seƀon,
wrêðan willjon, · hwó hé þesa wer-old êrist,
an þem an-ginnja · irmin-þioda
bi·swêk mit sundjun, · þó hé þiu sin-híun twê,
Adaman ęndi Éwan, · þurh un-treuwa
for·lêdda mid luginun, · þat liudo barn
aftar iro hin-fęrdi · hęllja sóhtun,
gumono gêstos. · Þó welda þat god mahtig,
waldand węndjan · ęndi welda þesum werode for·geƀen
hôh himil-ríki: · be·þiu hé herod hêlagna bodon,
is sunu sęnda. · Þat was Satanase
tulgo harm an is hugi: · afonsta heƀan-ríkjes
manno kunnje: · welda þó mahtigna
mid þem selbon sakun · sunu drohtines,
þem hé Adaman · an êr-dagun
darnungo bi·dróg, · þat hé warð is drohtine lêð,
bi·swêk ina mid sundjun · —só welda hé þó selƀan dón
hêlandjan Krist. · Þan habda hé is hugi fasto
wið þana wam-skaðon, · waldandes barn,
herte só gi·hęrdid: · welda heƀan-ríki
liudjun gi·lêstjan. · Was im þes landes ward
an fastunnja · fior-tig nahto,
manno drohtin, · só hé þár mates ni ant·bêt;
þan langa ni gi·dorstun im · dęrnja wihti,
níð-hugdig fíund, · náhor gangan,
grótjan ina gęgin-warðan: · wánde þat hé god ên-fald,
for·útar man-kunnjes wiht · mahtig wári,
hêleg himiles ward. · Só hé ina þó ge·hungrjan lét,
þat ina bi·gan bi þero męnnisko · móses lustjan
aftar þem fiuwar-tig dagun, · þe fíund náhor géng,
mirki mên-skaðo: · wánda þat hé man ên-fald
wári wissungo, · sprak im þó mid is wordun tó,
grótta ina þe gêr-fíund: · „ef þú sís godes sunu“, kwað hé,
„be·hwí ni hêtis þú þan werðan, · ef þú gi·wald haƀes,
allaro barno bętst, · brôd af þesun stênun?
Ge·hêli þínna hungar!“ · Þó sprak eft þe hêlago Krist:
„ni mugun ęldi-barn“, (kwað hé,) „ên-faldes brôdes,

liudi libbjen, · ak sie skulun þurh lêra godes
wesan an þesero wer-oldi · ęndi skulun þiu werk frummjen,
þea þár werðad a·hlúdid · fon þero hêlogun tungun,
fon þem galme godes: · þat is gumono líf
liudjo só hwi-líkon, · só þat lêstjan wili,
þat fon waldandes · worde ge·biudid.“
Þó bi·gan eft niuson · ęndi náhor géng
un-hiuri fiund · ôðru sîðu,
fandoda is frôhan. · Þat friðu-barn þolode
wrêðes willjon · ęndi im gi·wald for·gaf,
þat hé umbi is kraft mikil · koston mósti,
lét ina þó lêdjan · þana liud-skaðon,
þat hé ina an Jerusalem · te þem godes wíha,
alles oban-wardan, · up gi·sętta
an allaro húso hôhost, · ęndi hosk-wordun sprak,
þe gramo þurh gelp mikil: · „ef þú sís godes sunu“, kwað hé,
„skríd þi te erðu hinan. · Ge·skriban was it giu lango,
an bókun ge·writen, · hwó gi·boden habad
is ęngilun · alo-mahtig fader,
þat sie þí at wege ge·hwem · wardos sinðun,
haldad þí undar iro handun. · Hwat þú hwargin ni þarft
mid þínun fótun · an felis be·spurnan,
an hardan stên.“ · Þó sprak eft þe hêlago Krist,
allaro barno bętst: · „só is ôk an bókun ge·skriban“, kwað hé,
„þat þú te hardo ni skalt · hêrran þínes,
fandon þínes frôhan: · þat nis þí allaro frumono neg·ên.“
Lét ina þó an þana þriddjan sîð · þana þiod-skaðon
gi·bręngen uppan ênan berg þen hôhon: · þár ina þe balo-wíso
lét al obar-sehan · irmin-þiode,
wonod-saman welon · ęndi wer-old-ríki
ęndi all su-lík ôdes, · só þius erða bi·habad
fagororo frumono, · ęndi sprak im þó þe fiund an·gęgin,
kwað þat hé im þat al só gód-lík · for·geben weldi,
hôha hęri-dómos, · „ef þú wilt hnígan te mí,
fallan te mínun fótun · ęndi mí for frôhan habas,
bedos te mínun barma. · Þan látu ik þí brúkan wel
alles þes ôd-welon, · þes ik þí hębbju gi·ôgit hír.“
Þó ni welda þes lêðan word · lęngeron hwíle
hôrjan þe hêlago Krist, · ak hé ina fon is huldi for·drêf,

Satanasan for·swêp, · ęndi sán aftar sprak
allaro barno bętst, · kwað þat man bedon skoldi
up te þem alo-mahtigon gode · ęndi im ênum þionon
swíðo þio-liko · þegnos managa,
hęliðos aftar is huldi: · „þár ist þiu helpa ge·lang
manno ge·hwi-líkun.“ · Þó gi·wêt im þe mên-skaðo,
swíðo sêrag-mód · Satanas þanan,
fiund undar fern-dalu. · Warð þár folk mikil
fon þem alo-waldan · oþana te Kriste
godes ęngilo kumen, · þie im síðor jungar-dóm,
skoldun ambaht-skępi · aftar lêstjen,
þionon þio-líko: · só skal man þiod-gode,
hêrron aftar huldi, · heþan-kuninge.

TODO.

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1035–1037 Þó … luginun | As told in *SaxGen*, the sister poem of *Heli*.

1053 fior-tig ‘forty’ | Note the unstable form of this numeral; *fior-tig* is the younger form, but the older *fiuwar-tig* occurs at l. 1061 below.

1061–1115 Þe fiund náhor géng, … fiund undar fern-dalu. | The temptation of Christ in the desert (Matthew 4:1–11, Luke 4:1–13). — The way Satan is described in the narrative parts of this passage is extremely similar to the descriptions of the three monsters of *Beow*: Grendle (*Beow* 99–836), Grendle’s mother (1251–1590), and the nameless Wyrm (2200–2711). Semantic parallels are found not just in descriptive nouns (*Heli* 1062a: *mên-skaðo* = *Beow* 712a, 737b, 1339a: *mân-scaðá*, *Heli* 1061b etc.: *fiund* = *Beow* 101b, 143b, 164b etc.: *fęond*, *Heli* 1095b: *þiod-skaðo* = *Beow* 2278a, 2688a *þeod-scaðá*) and adjectives (*Heli* 1056a: *níð-bugdig*, 1096a: *balu-wís* ~ *Beow* 723a: *bealu-hygdig*, *Heli* 1076a: *un·hiuri* = *Beow* 2120b, 2413b: *un·hiorí*), but also in verbs that describe the antagonist as ‘seeking out’ (*Heli* 1075a: *niuson* = *Beow* 115a, 2074b: *néosian*) and ‘drawing nearer’ (*Heli* 1061b, 1075b: *náhor géng* ~ *Beow* 745b: *forð néar æt·stóp* ‘he stepped nearer forth’) its intended victim. A particularly notable parallel is found between *Heli* 1095 and *Beow* 2688, both of which pair **þeudō-skaþō* ‘people-scather’ with **þriddjō sinþa* ‘third time’ in reference to the third temptation from Satan and the third attack from the dragon, respectively. Although the idea of three temptations is present in *Heli*’s Biblical source material, the rule of threes is common throughout world mythology and, as shown by *Beow*, also found in earlier Germanic monster-fights, so that this parallel is likely also inherited.
With such a great number of direct parallels it is apparent that the *Heli*-poet is drawing on older traditional Germanic stories of night-stalking monsters in his description of Satan and perhaps also on descriptions of battles involving three attacks by the monster. In this way the poet subtextually makes Christ take on the archetypal role of the Germanic heroic monster-slayer, something which would have been obvious (and likely emotionally effective) to the contemporary Saxon audience.

**14**

Was im an þem sin-węldi · sálig barn godes
lange hwíle, · unt·þat im þó lioþora warð,
þat hé is kraft mikil · kúðjen wolda
weroda te willjon. · Þó for·lét hé waldes hleo,
ên-ôdjes ard · ęndi sóhte im eft erlo ge·mang,
mári męgin-þiode · ęndi manno drôm,

géng im þó bi Jordanes staðe: · þár ina Johannes ant·fand,
þat friðu-barn godes, · frôhan sínan,
hêlagana heƀan-kuning, · ęndi þem hęliðun sagda,
Johannes is jungurun, · þó hé ina gangan ge·sah:
„Þit is þat lamb godes, · þat þár lôsjan skal
af þesaro wídon wer-old · wrêða sundja,
man-kunnjas mên, · mári drohtin,
kuningo kraftigost.“ · Krist im forð gi·wêt
an Galileo land, · godes êgan barn,
fór im te þem friundun, · þár hé a·fódit was,
tír-líko a·togan, · ęndi talda mid wordun
Krist undar is kunnje, · kuningo ríkjost,
hwó sie skoldin iro selƀoro · sundja bótjan,
hét þat sie im iro harm-werk manag · hreuwan létin,
feldin iro firin-dádi: · „nú is it all ge·fullot só,
só hír alde man · êr hwanna sprákun,
ge·hétun eu te helpu · heƀan-ríki:
nú is it giu gi·náhid þurh þes nęrjandan kraft: · þes mótun gí neotan forð,
só hwe só gerno wili · gode þeonojan,
wirkjan aftar is willjon.“ · Þó warð þes werodes filu,
þero liudjo an lustun: · wurðun im þea lêra Kristes,
só swótja þem gi·síðja. · Hé bi·gan im samnon þó
gumono te jungoron, · gódoro manno,
word-spáha weros. · Géng im þó bi ênes watares staðe,
þat þár habda Jordan · a·neƀan Galileo land
ênna sê ge·warhtan. · Þár hé sittjan fand
Andreas ęndi Petrus · bi þem aha-strôme,
bêðja þea ge·bróðar, · þár sie an brêd watar
swíðo niud-líko · nętti þenidun,
fiskodun im an þem flóde. · Þár sie þat friðu-barn godes
bi þes sêes staðe · selbo grótta,
hét þat sie im folgodin, · kwað þat hé im só filu woldi
godes ríkjas for·geƀen; · „al só git hír an Jordanes strôme
fiskos fáhat, · só skulun git noh firiho barn
halon te inkun handun, · þat sie an heƀan-ríki
þurh inka lêra · líðan mótin,
faran folk manag.“ · Þó warð frô-mód hugi
bêðjun þem gi·bróðrun: · ant·kęndun þat barn godes,

lioban hêrron: · for·létun al saman
Andreas ęndi Petrus, · só hwat só sie bi þeru ahu habdun,
ge·wunstes bi þem watare: · was im willjo mikil,
þat sie mid þem godes barne · gangan móstin,
samad an is gi·sîðja, · skoldun sálig-líko
lôn ant·fâhan: · só dót liudjo so hwi-lík,
só þes hêrran wili · huldi gi·þionon,
ge·wirkjan is willjon. · Þó sie bi þes watares staðe
furðor kwámun, · þó fundun sie þár ênna fródan man
sittjan bi þem sêwa · ęndi is suni twêne,
Jakobus ęndi Johannes: · wárun im junga man.
Sátun im þá ge·sun-fader · an ênumu sande uppen,
brugdun ęndi bóttun · bêðjum handun
þiu nętti niud-líko, · þea sie habdun nahtes êr
for·sliten an þem sêwa. · Þár sprak im selbo tó
sálig barn godes, · hét þat sie an þana sîð mid im,
Jakobus ęndi Johannes, · géngin bêðje,
kind-junge man. · Þó wárun im Kristes word
só wirðig an þesaro wer-oldi, · þat sie bi þes watares staðe
iro aldan fader · ênna for·létun,
fródan bi þem flóde, · ęndi al þat sie þár fehas êhtun,
nęttju ęndi nęglid-skipu, · ge·kurun im þana nęrjandan Krist,
hêlagna te hêrron, · was im is helpono þarf
te gi·þiononne: · só is allaro þegno ge·hwem,
wero an þesero wer-oldi. · Þó gi·wêt im þe waldandes sunu
mid þem fiuwarjun forð, · ęndi im þó þana fîfton gi·kôs
Krist an ênero kôp-stędi, · kuninges jungoron,
mód-spáhana man: · Mattheus was hé hêtan,
was im ambahtjo · ęðilero manno,
skolda þár te is hêrron · handun ant·fâhan
tins ęndi tolna; · treuwa habda hé góda,
aðal-and·bári: · for·lét al saman
gold ęndi silụbar · ęndi geƀa managa,
diurje mêðmos, · ęndi warð im ụses drohtines man;
kôs im þe kuninges þegn · Krist te hêrran,
milderan mêðọm-geƀon, · þan êr is man-drohtin
wári an þesero wer-oldi: · féng im wóðera þing,
lang-samoron rád. · Þó warð it allun þem liudjun kûð,
fon allaro burgo gi·hwem, · hwó þat barn godes

samnode ge·síðos · ęndi selbo ge·sprak
1205 só manag wís-lík word · ęndi wáres só filu,
torhtes gi·tôgde · ęndi têkạn manag
1207 ge·warhte an þesero wer-oldi. · Was þat an is wordun skín
iak an is dádjun só same, · þat hé drohtin was,
1209 himilisk hêrro · ęndi te helpu kwam
an þesan middil-gard · manno barnun,
1211 liudjun te þesun liohta. · Oft ge·deda hé þat an þem lande skín,
þan hé þár torht-líko · só manag têkạn gi·warhte,
1213 þár hé hêlde mid is handun · halte ęndi blinde,
lôsde af þeru léf-hêdi · liudi manage,
1215 af su-líkun suhtjun, · só þan allaro swároston
an firiho barn · fiund bi·wurpun,
1217ª tulgo lang-sam legar.

TODO.

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1176 ge·sun-fader | An archaic compound form. TODO.

1186 nęglid-skipu | A clinker-built ship, certainly a native Saxon term. Cf. *hôh-burnid skip* at 2266a, 2907a.

1198 diurje mêðmos | Formulaic, shared with *Beow* 2236a.

1217ᵇ **15** Þó fórun þár þie liudi tó
allaro dago ge·hwi-líkes, · þár ùsa drohtin was
1219 selbo undar þem gi·síðje, · unt·þat þár ge·samnod warð
męgin-folk mikil · managero þiodo,
1221 þoh sie þár alle be ge·líkumu · ge·lôbon ni kwámin.
weros þurh ênan willjon: · sume sóhtun sie þat waldandes barn,
1223 armoro manno filu · —was im átes þarf—,
þat sie im þár at þeru męnigi · mates ęndi drankes,
1225 þigidin at þeru þiodu; · hwand þár was manag þegạn só gód,
þie ira alamosnje · armun mannun
1227 gerno gábun. · Sume wárun sie im eft Judeono kunnjes,
fêgni folk-skępi: · wárun þár ge·farana te þiu,
1229 þat sie ùses drohtines · dádjo ęndi wordo
fâron woldun, · habdun im fêknjan hugi,
1231 wrêðen willjon: · woldun waldand Krist
a·lêdjen þem liudjun, · þat sie is lêron ni hôrdin,

ne węndin aftar is willjon. · Suma wárun sie im eft só wíse man,
wárun im glauwe gumon · ęndi gode werðe,
a·lesane undar þem liudjun, · kwámun im þarod be þem lêron Kristes,
þat sie is hêlag word · hôrjen móstin,
línon ęndi lêstjen: · habdun mid iro ge·lôbon te im
fasto ge·fangen, · habdun im ferhten hugi,
wurðun is þegnos te þiu, · þat hé sie an þiod-welon
aftar iro ên-dagon · up ge·brâhti,
an godes ríki. · Hé só gerno ant·féng
man-kunnjes manag · ęndi mund-burd gi·hét
te langaru hwílu, · ęndi mahta só gi·lêstjen wel.
Þó warð þár męgin só mikil · umbi þana márjon Krist,
liudjo ge·samnod: · þó gi·sah hé fon allun landun kuman,
fon allun wídun wegun · werod te·samne
lungro liudjo: · is lof was só wído
managun ge·márid. · Þó gi·wêt im mahtig self
an ênna berg uppan, · barno ríkjost,
sundaṛ ge·sittjen, · ęndi im selbo ge·kôs
twe-libi ge·talda, · treu-hafta man,
gódoro gumono, · þea hé im te jungoron forð
allaro dago ge·hwi-líkes, · drohtin welda
an is ge·síð-skępja · simblon hębbjan.
Nęmnida sie þó bi naman · ęndi hét sie im þó náhor gangan,
Andreas ęndi Petrus · êrist sána,
ge·bróðar twêne, · ęndi bêðje mid im,
Jakobus ęndi Johannes: · sie wárun gode werðe;
mildi was hé im an is móde; · sie wárun ênes mannes suni
bêðje bi ge·burdjun; · sie kôs þat barn godes
góde te jungoron · ęndi gumono filu,
márjero manno: · Mattheus ęndi Þomas,
Judasas twêna · ęndi Jakob óðran,
is selƀes swiri: · sie wárun fon gi·sustruonjon twêm
knósles kumana, · Krist ęndi Jakob,
góde gadulingos. · Þó habda þero gumono þár
þe nęrjendo Krist · niguni ge·talde,
treu-hafte man: · þó hét hé ôk þana te·handon gangan
selbo mid þem gi·síðun: · Símon was hé hêtan;

hét ôk Bartholomeus · an þana berg uppan
faran fan þem folke áðrum · ęndi Philippus mid im,
treu-hafte man. · Þó géngun sie twe-libi samad,
rinkos te þeru rúnu, · þár þe rádand sat,
managoro mund-boro, · þe allumu man-kunnje
wið hęllje ge·þwing · helpan welde,
formon wið þem ferne, · só hwem só frummjen wili
só lioƀ-líka lêra, · só hé þem liudjun þár
þurh is gi·wit mikil · wísjan hogda.

TODO.

**16** Þó umbi þana nęrjandon Krist · náhor géngun
su-líka ge·sĭðos, · só hé im selƀo ge·kôs,
waldand undar þem werode. · Stódun wísa man,
gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,
weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,
þáhtun ęndi þagodun, · hwat im þero þiodo drohtin,
weldi waldand self · wordun kùðjan
þesum liudjun te lioƀe. · Þan sat im þe landes hirdi
gęgin-ward for þem gumun, · godes êgan barn:
welda mid is sprákun · spáh-word manag
lêrjan þea liudi, · hwó sie lof gode
an þesum wer-old-ríkja · wirkjan skoldin.
Sat im þó ęndi swígoda · ęndi sah sie an lango,
was im hold an is hugi · hêlag drohtin,
mildi an is móde, · ęndi þó is mund ant·lôk,
wísde mid wordun · waldandes sunu
manag már-lík þing · ęndi þem mannum sagde
spáhun wordun, · þem þe hé te þeru spráku þarod,
Krist alo-waldo, · ge·koran habda,
hwi-líke wárin allaro · irmin-manno
gode werðoston · gumono kunnjes;
sagde im þó te sòðan, · kwað þat þie sáliga wárin,
man an þesoro middil-gardun, · þie hér an iro móde wárin
arme þurh ôd-módi: · „þem is þat êwana ríki,
swíðo hêlag-lík · an heƀan-wange
sin-líf far·geƀen.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin
máð-mundja man: · „þie mótun þie márjon erðe,
of·sittjen þat selƀe ríki.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin,

þie hír wiopin iro wammun dádi; · „þie mótun eft willjon ge·bídan,
frófre an iro frâhon ríkja. · Sálige sind ôk, þe sie hír frumono gi·lustid,
rinkos, þat sie rehto a·dómjen. · Þes mótun sie werðan an þem ríkja drohtines
gi·fullit þurh iro ferhton dádi: · su-líkoro mótun sie frumono bi·knégan
þie rinkos, þie hír rehto a·dómjad, · ne willjad an rúnun be·swíkan
man, þár sie at mahle sittjad. · Sálige sind ôk þem hír mildi wirðit
hugi an hęliðo briostun: · þem wirðit þe hêlego drohtin,
mildi mahtig selbo. · Sálige sind ôk undar þesaro managon þiodu,
þie hębbjad iro herta gi·hrênod: · þie mótun þane hebanes waldand
sehan an sínum ríkja.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin,
„þie þe friðu-samo undar þesumu folke libbjod · ęndi ni willjad êniga fehta ge·wirken,
saka mid iro selboro dádjun: · þie mótun wesan suni drohtines ge·nęmnide,
hwande hé im wil ge·nádig werðen; · þes mótun sie niotan lango
selbon þes sínes ríkjes.“ · Kwað þat ôk sálige wárin
þie rinkos, þe rehto weldin, · „ęndi þurh þat þolod ríkjoro manno
hęti ęndi harm-kwidi: · þem is ôk an himile eft
godes wang for·geben · ęndi gêst-lík líf
aftar te êwan-dage, · só is io ęndi ni kumit,
welan wun-sames.“ · Só habde þó waldand Krist
for þem erlom þár · ahto ge·talda
sálda ge·sagda; · mid þem skal simbla gi·hwe
himil-ríki ge·halon, · ef hé it hębbjan wili,
eþþo hé skal te êwan-daga · aftar þarbon
welon ęndi willjon, · síðor hé þese wer-old a·giþid,
erð-líbi-gi·skapu, · ęndi sókit im óðar lioht
só liof só lêð, · só hé mid þesun liudjun hér

gi·werkod an þesoro wer-oldi, · al só it þár þó mid is wordun sagde
Krist alo-waldo, · kuningo ríkjost
godes êgan barn · jungorun sínun:
„Gé werðat ôk só sálige“, (kwað hé,) „þes iu saka biodat
liudi aftar þeson lande · ęndi lêð sprekat,
hębbjad iu te hoska · ęndi harmes filu
ge·wirkjad an þesoro wer-oldi · ęndi wíti ge·frummjad,
fęlgjad iu firin-spráka · ęndi fiund-skępi,
lâgnjad iuwa lêra, · dót iu lêðes filu,
harmes þurh iuwan hêrron. · Þes látad gí iuwan hugi simbla,
líf an lustun, · hwand iu þat lôn stęndit
an godes ríkja garu, · gódo ge·hwi-líkes,
mikil ęndi manag-fald: · þat is iu te médu far·geban,
hwand gí hér êr bi·foran · arbid þolodun,
wíti an þesoro wer-oldi. · Wirs is þem óðrum,
gibiðig grimmora þing, · þem þe hér gód êgun,
wídan worold-welon: · þie for·slítat iro wunnja hér;
ge·niudot sie ge·nóges, · skulun eft narowaro þing
aftar iro hin-fęrdi · hęliðos þolojan.
Þan wópjan þár wan-skęfti, · þie hér êr an wunnjon sín,
libbjad an allon lustun, · ne willjad þes far·látan wiht,
mêni-gi·þáhtjo, · þes sie an iro mód spęnit,
lêðoro gi·lêstjo. · Þan im þat lôn kumid,
ubil arbêd-sam, · þan sie is þane ęndi skulun
sorgondi ge·sehan. · Þan wirðid im sêr hugi,
þes sie þesero wer-oldes só filu · willjan ful-géngun,
man an iro mód-sebon. · Nú skulun gí im þat mên lahan,
węrjan mid wordun, · al só ik giu nú ge·wísjan mag,
sęggjan sóð-líko, · ge·síðos míne,
wárun wordun, · þat gí þesoro wer-oldes nú forð
skulun salt wesan, · sundigero manno,
bótjan iro balu-dádi, · þat sie an bętara þing,
folk far·fâhan · ęndi for·látan fiundes gi·werk,
diubales ge·dádi, · ęndi sókjan iro drohtines ríki.
Só skulun gí mid iuwon lêrun · liud-folk manag
węndjan aftar mínon willjon. · Ef iuwar þan a·wirðid hwi-lík,
far·látid þea lêra, · þea hé lêstjan skal,
þan is im só þem salte, · þe man bi sêes staðe

wído te·wirpit: · þan it te wihti ni dôg,
ak it firiho barn · fótun spurnat,
gumon an greote. · Só wirðid þem, þe þat godes word skal
mannum márjan: · ef hé im þan látid is mód twehon,
þat hí ne willja mid hluttro hugi · te heƀan-ríkja
spanen mid is spráku · ęndi sęggjan spel godes,
ak węnkid þero wordo, · þan wirðid im waldand gram,
mahtig módag, · ęndi só samo manno barn;
wirðid allun þan · irmin-þiodun,
liudjun a·lêðid, · ef is lêra ni dugun.“

TODO.

1323 líf | *end* V*/27r; text continues on 32v.* 1358 sie | *cuts off* V

1284 þáhtun ęndi þagodun | Found identically in three other places; TODO.

1300 kwað þat þie sáliga wárin | Beginning the list of beatitudes; cf. 1326b and note.

1305 máð-mundja | A hapax, generally assumed to be the same word as English “smooth”, but without the s-mobile.

1326–1327 ahto ge·talda / sálda ge·sagda | Sievers (1878) connects the eight-numbering of the Beatitudes to a passage from Hrabanus. TODO.

**17** Só sprak hé þó spáh-líko · ęndi sagda spel godes,
lêrde þe landes ward · liudi síne
mid hluttru hugju. · Hęliðos stódun,
gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,
weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,
þáhtun ęndi þagodun, · gi·hôrdun þero þiodo drohtin
sęggjan êw godes · ęldi-barnun;
gi·hét im heƀan-ríki · ęndi te þem hęliðun sprak:
„Ôk mag ik iu sęggjan, · ge·síðos mína,
wárun wordun, · þat gí þesoro wer-oldes nú forð
skulun lioht wesan · liudjo barnun,
fagar mid firihun · oƀar folk manag,
wlitig ęndi wun-sam: · ni mugun iuwa werk mikil
bi·holan werðan, · mid hwi-líko gí sea hugi kúðjat:
þan mêr þe þiu burg ni mag, · þiu an berge stáð,
hôh holm-kliƀu, · bi·holen werðen,
wrisi-lík gi·werk, · ni mugun iuwa word þan mêr
an þesoro middil-gard · mannum werðen,
iuwa dádi bi·dęrnit. · Dót, só ik iu lêrju:
látad iuwa lioht mikil · liudjun skínan,

manno barnun, · þat sie far·standan iuwan mód-sebon,
iuwa werk ęndi iuwan willjon, · ęndi þes waldand god
mid hluttro hugju, · himiliskan fader,
lobon an þesumu liohte, · þes hé iu su-líka lêra far·gaf.
Ni skal neoman lioht, þe it habad, · liudjun dęrnjan,
te hardo be·hwęlbjan, · ak hé it hôho skal
an sęli sęttjan, · þat þea ge·sehan mugin
alla ge·líko, · þea þár inna sind,
hęliðos an hallu. · Þan hald ni skulun gí iuwa hêlag word
an þesumu land-skępa · liudjun dęrnjen,
hęlið-kunnje far·helan, · ak gé it hôho skulun
brêdjan, þat gi·bod godes, · þat it allaro barno ge·hwi-lík,
obar al þit land-skępi · liudi far·standan
ęndi só ge·frummjen, · só it an forn-dagun
tulgo wíse man · wordun ge·sprákun,
þan sie þana aldan êw · erlos heldun,
ęndi ôk su-líku swíðor, · só ik iu nú sęggjan mag,
alloro gumono ge·hwi-lík · gode þionojan,
þan it þár an þem aldom · êwa ge·beode.
Ni wánjat gí þes mit wihtju, · þat ik bi þiu an þesa wer-old kwámi,
þat ik þana aldan êw · irrjen willje,
fęlljan undar þesumu folke · efþo þero fora-sagono
word wiðar·werpen, · þea hér só gi·wárja man
bar-líko ge·budun. · Êr skal bêðju te·faran,
himil ęndi erðe, · þiu nú bi·hlidan standat,
êr þan þero wordo · wiht bi·líba
un·lêstid an þesumu liohte, · þea sie þesum liudjun hér
wár-líko ge·budun. · Ni kwam ik an þesa wer-old te þiu,
þat ik feldi þero fora-sagono word, · ak ik siu fulljen skal,
ôkjon ęndi nígjan · ęldi-barnum,
þesumu folke te frumu. · Þat was forn ge·skriban
an þem aldon êo · —ge hôrdun it oft sprekan
word-wíse man—: · só hwe só þat an þesoro wer-oldi gi·dót,
þat hé áðrana · aldru bi·neote,
líbu bi·lôsje, · þem skulun liudjo barn
dôd a·dêljan. · Þan willjo ik it iu diopor nú,
furður bi·fáhan: · só hwe só ina þurh fiund-skępi,
man wiðar óðrana · an is mód-sebon

bilgit an is breostun · —hwand sie alle ge·bróðar sint,
sálig folk godes, · sibbjon bi·tęngja,
man mid mág-skępi—, · þan wirðit þoh hwe ôðrumu an is móde só gram,
líbes weldi ina bi·lôsjen, · of hé mahti gi·lêstjen só:
þan is hé sán a·fêhit · ęndi is þes ferąhas skolo,
al su-líkes ur-dêljes · só þe ôðar was,
þe þurh is hand-męgin · hôbdo bi·lôsde
erl ôðarna. · Ôk is an þem êo ge·skriban
wárun wordun, · só gí witon alle,
þan man is náhiston · niud-líko skal
minnjan an is móde, · wesen is mágun hold,
gadulingun gód, · wesen is geba mildi,
frâhon is friunda ge·hwane, · ęndi skal is fiund hatan,
wiðęr·standen þem mid strídu · ęndi mid starku hugi,
węrjan wiðąr wrêðun. · Þan sęggjo ik iu te wáron nú,
ful-líkur for þesumu folke, · þat gí iuwa fiund skulun
minnjon an iuwomu móde, · só samo só gí iuwa mágos dót,
an godes namon. · Dót im gódes filu,
tôgjat im hluttran hugi, · holda treuwa,
liof wiðąr ira lêðe. · Þat is lang-sam rád
manno só hwi-líkumu, · só is mód te þiu
ge·flíhit wiðąr is fiunde. · Þan mótun gí þea fruma êgan,
þat gí mótun hêten · heþan-kuninges suni,
is blíði barn. · Ne mugun gí iu bętaran rád
ge·winnan an þesoro wer-oldi. · Þan sęggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,
barno ge·hwi-líkum, · þat gí ne mugun mid gi·bolgono hugi
iuwas gódes wiht · te godes húsun
waldande far·geþan, · þat it imu wirðig sí
te ant·fáhanne, · só lango só þú fiund-skępjes wiht,
wiðęr ôðran man · in·wid hugis.
Êr skalt þú þi simbla ge·sónjen · wið þana sak-waldand,
ge·módi gi·mahljan: · sîðor maht þú mêðmos þína
te þem godes altere a·geþan: · þan sind sie þemu gódan werðe
heþan-kuninge. · Mêr skulun gí aftar is huldi þionon,
godes willjon ful·gán, · þan ôðra Judeon duon,
ef gí willjat êgan · êwan ríki,
sin-líf sehan. · Ôk skal ik iu sęggjan noh,
hwó it þár an þem aldon · êo ge·biudid,

þat ênig erl ȯðres · idis ni bi·swíka,
wíf mid wammu. · Þan sęggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,
þat þár man is siuni mugun · swíðo far·lêdjan
an mirki mên, · ef hí ina látid is mód spanen,
þat hé be·ginna þero girnjan, · þiu imu ge·gangan ni skal.
Þan habed hé an imu selbon sán · sundja ge·warhta,
ge·hęftid an is hertan · hęlli-wíti.
Ef þan þana man is siun wili · eþþa is swíðare hand
far·lêdjen is liðo hwi-lík · an lêðan weg,
þan is erlo ge·hwem · ȯðar bętara,
firiho barno, · þat hé ina fram werpa
ęndi þana lið lôsje · af is lík-hamon
ęndi ina áno kuma · up te himile,
þan hé só mid allun · te þem Inferne,
hwerbe mid só hêlun · an hęlli-grund.
Þan mênid þiu léf-hêd, · þat ênig liudjo ni skal
far·folgan is friunde, · ef hé ina an firina spanit,
swás man an saka: · þan ne sí hé imu eo só swíðo an sibbjun bi·lang,
ne iro mág-skępi só mikil, · ef hé ina an morð spęnit,
bêdid balu-werko; · bętera is imu þan ȯðar,
þat hé þana friund fan imu · fer far·werpa,
míðe þes máges · ęndi ni hębbja þár ênига minnja tó,
þat hé móti êno · up ge·stígan
hôh himil-ríki, · þan sie hęlli-ge·þwing,
brêd balu-wíti · bêðja gi·sókjan,
ubil arbidi.

TODO.

1500 hôh | *TODO: Critical note (ms. apparently has hó)*

1396 holm-klibu | Also found in *Beow.*

**18** Ôk is an þem êo ge·skriban
wárun wordun, · só gí witun alle,
þat míðe mên-êðos · man-kunnjes ge·hwi-lík,
ni for·swęrje ina selbon, · hwand þat is sundje te mikil,
far·lêdid liudi · an lêðan weg.
Þan willjo ik iu eft sęggjan, · þan sán ni swęrja neo-man
ênigan êð-staf · ęldi-barno,

ne bi himile þemu hôhon, · hwand þat is þes hêrron stól,
ne bi erðu þár undar, · hwand þat is þes alo-waldon
fagar fót-skamel, · nek ênig firiho barno
ne swęrja bi is selbes hôbde, · hwand hé ni mag þár ne swart ne hwít
ênig hár ge·wirkjan, · b·útan só it þe hêlago god,
ge·markode mahtig; · be·þiu skulun míðan filu
erlos êð-wordo. · Só hwe só it ofto dót,
só wirðid is simbla wirsa, · hwand hé imu gi·wardon ni mag.
Bi·þiu skal ik iu nú te wárun · wordun gi·beodan,
þat gí neo ne swęrjen · swíðoron êðos,
méron met mannun, · b·útan só ik iu mid mínun hér
swíðo wár-liko · wordun ge·biudu:
ef man hwemu saka sókja, · bi·sęggja þat wáre,
kweðe já, gef it sí, · geha þes þár wár is,
kweðe nên, af it nis, · láta im ge·nóg an þiu;
só hwat só is mêr obar þat · man ge·frummjad,
só kumid it al fan ubile · ęldi-barnun,
þat erl þurh un-treuwa · oðres ni wili
wordo ge·lôbjan. · Þan sęggjo ik iu te wáron ôk,
hwó it þár an þem aldon · êo ge·biudit:
só hwe só ôgon ge·nimid · oðres mannes,
lôsid af is lík-haman, · eþþa is liðo hwi-líkan,
þat hé it eft mid is selbes skal · sán ant·gelden
mid ge·líkun liðjon. · Þan willjo ik iu lêrjan nú,
þat gí só ni wrekan · wrêða dádi,
ak þat gí þurh ôd-módi · al ge·þolojan
wítjes ęndi wammes, · só hwat só man iu an þesoro wer-oldi ge·dóe.
Dóe alloro erlo ge·hwi-lík · oðrom manne
frume ęndi ge·fóri, · só hé willje, þat im firiho barn
gódes an·gęgin dóen. · Þan wirðit im god mildi,
liudjo só hwi-líkum, · só þat lêstjen wili.
Êrod gí arme man, · dêljad iuwan ôd-welon
undar þero þurftigon þiodu; · ne rókjad, hweðar gí is ênigan þank ant·fáhan
efþo lôn an þesoro lêhnjon wer-oldi, · ak huggjat te iuwomu leobon hêrran
þero gebono te gelde, · þat sie iu god lôno,

mahtig mund-boro, · só hwat só gí is þurh is minnes gi·dót.
Ef þú þan gebojan wili · gódun mannun
fagare feho-skattos, · þár þú eft frumono hugis
mêr ant·fáhan, · te hwí habas þú þes êniga méda fon gode
eþþa lôn an þemu is liohte, · hwand þat is lêhni feho?
Só is þes alles ge·hwat, · þe þú óðrun ge·duos
liudjon te leobe, · þár þú hugis eft ge·lík neman
þero wordo endi þero werko: · te hwí wêt þi þes úsa waldand þank,
þes þú þín só bi·filhis · endi ant·fáhis eft þan þú wili?
iuwan ôð-welon · geban gí þem armun mannun,
þe ina iu an þesoro wer-oldi ne lônon · endi rómot te iuwes waldandes ríkja.
Te hlúd ni dó þú it, · þan þú mid þínun handun bi·felhas
þína alamosna þemu armon manne, · ak dó im þurh ôd-módjen
gerno þurh godes þank: · þan móst þú eft geld niman,
swíðo liof-lík lôn, · þár þú is lango bi·þarft,
fagaroro frumono. · Só hwat só þú is só þurh ferhtan hugi
darno ge·dêljas, · —so is úsumu drohtine werð—
ne galpo þú far þínun gebun te swíðo, · noh ênig gumono ne skal,
þat siu im þurh ídale hróm · eft ni werðe
lêð-líko far·loren. · Þanna þú skalt lôn nemen
fora godes ôgun · gódero werko.
Ôk skal ik iu ge·beodan, · þan gí willjad te bedu hnígan
endi willjad te iuwomu hêrron · helpono biddjan,
þat hé iu a·láte · lêðes þinges,
þero sakono endi þero sundjono, · þea gí iu selbon hír
wrêða ge·wirkjad, · þat gí it þan for óðrumu werode ni duad:
ni márjad it far mænigi, · þat iu þes man ni lobon,
ni diurjan þero dádjo, · þat gí iuwes drohtines gi·bed
þurh þat ídala hróm · al ne far·leosan.
Ak þan gí willjan te iuwomo hêrron · helpono biddjan,
þiggjan þeo-líko, · —þes iu is þarf mikil—
þat iu sigi-drohtin · sundjono tómja,
þan dót gí þat só darno: · þoh wêt it iuwe drohtin self
hêlag an himile, · hwand imu nis bi·holan n·eo·wiht
ne wordo ne werko. · Hé látid it þan al ge·werðan só,

só gí ina þan biddjad, · þan gí te þero bedo hnígad
mid hluttru hugi.“ · Hęliðos stódun,
gumon umbi þana godes sunu · gerno swíðo,
weros an willjon: · was im þero wordo niud,
þáhtun ęndi þagodun, · was im þarf mikil,
þat sie þat eft ge·hogdin, · þat im þat hêlaga barn
an þana forman sïð · filu mid wordun
torhtes ge·talde. · Þó sprak im eft ên þero twe-libjo an·gęgin,
glauworo gumono, · te þem godes barne:

TODO.

1575 sigi-drohtin | Cf. OE *sige-dryhten*. TODO?

**19** „Hêrro þe gódo“, (kwað hé,) „ûs is þínoro huldi þarf,
te gi·wirkenne þínna willjon, · ęndi ôk þínoro wordo só self,
allaro barno bętst, · þat þú ûs bedon lêres,
jungoron þíne, · só Johannes duot,
diur-lík dôperi, · dago ge·hwi-líkas
is werod mid wordun, · hwí sie waldand skulun,
gódan grótjan. · Dó þína jungorun só self:
ge·rihti ûs þat ge·rúni.“ · Þó habda eft þe ríkjo garu
sán aftar þiu, · sunu drohtines,
gód word an·gęgin: · „Þan gí god willjan“, kwað hé,
„weros mid iuwon wordun · waldand grótjan,
allaro kuningo kraftigostan, · þan kweðad gi, só ik iu lêrju:
‚Fadar ûsa · firiho barno,
þú bist an þem hôhon · himila ríkja,
ge·wíhid sí þín namo · wordo ge·hwi-líko.
Kuma þín · kraftag ríki.
Werða þín willjo · obar þesa wer-old alla,
só sama an erðo, · só þár uppa ist
an þem hôhon · himilo ríkja.
Gef ûs dago ge·hwi-líkes rád, · drohtin þe gódo,
þína hêlaga helpa, · ęndi a·lát ûs, hebanes ward,
managoro mên-skuldjo, · al só we ôðrum mannum dóan.
Ne lát ûs far·lêdjan · lêða wihti
só forð an iro willjon, · só wí wirðige sind,
ak help ûs wiðar allun · ubilon dádjun.‘
Só skulun gí biddjan, · þan gí te bede hnígad
weros mid iuwom wordun, · þat iu waldand god

lêðes a·láte · an leut-kunnja.
Ef gí þan willjad a·látan · liudjo ge·hwi-líkun
þero sakono ęndi þero sundjono, · þe sie wið iu selƀon hír
wrêða ge·wirkjat, · þan a·látid iu waldand god,
fadar ala-mahtig · firin-werk mikil,
managoro mên-skuldjo. · Ef iu þan wirðid iuwa mód te stark,
þat gí ne wiljat ȯðrun · erlun a·látan,
weron wam-dádi, · þan ne wil iu ôk waldand god
grim-werk far·geƀan, · ak gí skulun is geld niman,
swíðo lêð-lik lôn · te languru hwílu,
alles þes un-rehtes, · þes gí ȯðrum hír
gi·lêstjad an þesumu liohte · ęndi þan wið liudjo barn
þea saka ni gi·sónjad, · êr gí an þana síð faran,
weros fon þesoro wer-oldi. · Ôk skal ik iu te wárun sęggjan,
hwó gí lêstjan skulun · lêra mína:
þan gí iuwa fastonnja · frummjan willjan,
minson iuwa mên-dádi, · þan ni duad gí þat te managom kùð,
ak míðad is far ȯðrum mannun: · þoh wêt mahtig god,
waldand iuwan willjan, · þoh iu werod ȯðar,
liudjo barn ne loƀon. · Hé gildid is iu lôn aftar þiu,
iuwa hêlag fadar · an himil-ríkja,
þes ge im mid su-líkum ôd-módja, · erlos þeonod,
só ferht-líko undar þesumu folke. · Ne willjat feho winnan
erlos an un-reht, · ak wirkjad up te gode
man aftar médu: · þat is mêra þing,
þan man hír an erðu · ôdag libbja,
wer-old-skattes ge·wono. · Ef gí willjad mínun wordun hôrjan,
þan ne samnod gí hír sink mikil · silǫƀres ne goldes
an þesoro middil-gard, · mêðǫm-hordes,
hwand it rotat hír an roste, · ęndi rękin-þeoƀos far·stelad,
wurmi a·wardjad, · wirðid þat gi·wádi far·slitan,
ti·gangid þe gold-welo. · Lêstjad iuwa gódon werk,
samnod iu an himile · hord þat méra,
fagạra feho-skattos: · þat ni mag iu ênig fiund be·niman,
ne·wiht an·węndjan, · hwand þe welo standid
garu iu te·gęgnes, · só hwat só gí gódes þarod,
an þat himil-ríki · hordes ge·samnod,

hęliðos þurh iuwa hand-geƀa, · ęndi hębbjad þarod iuwan hugi fasto;
hwand þár ist alloro manno gi·hwes · mód-ge·þáhti,
hugi ęndi herta, · þár is hord ligid,
sink ge·samnod. · Nis eo só sálig man,
þat mugi an þesoro brêdon wer-old · bêðju ant·þęngjan,
ge þat hí an þesoro erðo · ôdag libbja,
an allun wer-old-lustun wesa, · ge þoh waldand gode
te þanke ge·þeono: · ak hé skal alloro þingo gi·hwes
simbla ôðar-hweðar · ên far·látan
eþþo lusta þes lík-hamon · eþþo líf êwig.
Be·þiu ni gornot gí umbi iuwa ge·garuwi, · ak huggjad te gode fasto,
ne mornont an iuwomu móde, · hwat gí eft an morgan skulin
etan efþo drinkan · eþþo an hębbjan
weros te ge·wędja: · it wêt al waldand god,
hwes þea bi·þurbun, · þea im hír þionod wel,
folgod iro frôhan willjon. · Hwat gí þat bi þesun fuglun mugun
wár-líko undar·witan, · þea hír an þesoro wer-oldi sint,
farad an feðar-hamun: · sie ni kunnun ênig feho winnan,
þoh giƀid im drohtin god · dago ge·hwi-líkes
helpa wiðar hungre. · Ôk mugun gí an iuwom hugi markon,
weros umbi iuwa ge·wádi, · hwó þie wurti sint
fagoro ge·fratohot, · þea hír an felde stád,
berht-líko ge·blóid: · ne mahta þe burges ward,
Salomon þe kuning, · þe habda sink mikil,
mêðom-hordas mêst, · þero þe ênig man êhti,
welono ge·wunnan · ęndi allaro ge·wádjo kust,—
þoh ni mohte hé an is líƀe, · þoh hé habdi alles þeses landes ge·wald,
a·winnan su-lík ge·wádi, · só þiu wurt haƀad,
þiu hír an felde stád · fagoro ge·garíwit,
lilli mid só liof-líku blómon: · ina wádit þe landes waldand
hêr fan heƀanes wange. · Mêr is im þoh umbi þit hęliðo kunni;
liudi sint im lioboron mikilu, · þea hé im an þesumu lande ge·warhte,

waldand an willjon sínan. · Be·þiu ne þurbon gí umbi iuwa ge·wádi sorgon,
ne gornot gí umbi iuwa ge·gariwi te swíðo: · god wili is alles rádan,
helpan fan hebanes wange, · ef gí willjad aftar is huldi þeonon.
Gerot gí simbla êrist þes godes ríkjas, · endi þan duat aftar þem is gódun werkun,
rómod gí rehtoro þingo: · þan wili iu þe ríkjo drohtin
gebon mid alloro gódu ge·hwi-líku, · ef gí im þus ful·gangan willjad,
só ik iu te wárun hír · wordun seggjo.

TODO.

1656 ant·þengjan | *so* **M**; a·þengjan *(norm.)* **C**

1603 Kuma þín | A three-syllable line, which is otherwise unmetrical in Old Saxon. Its presence suggests that the poet is following the text of his source particularly closely and therefore is willing to sacrifice meter for the sake of sense.

1645 wurmi a·wardjad | Sounds very similar to 'dragons guard it', but the sense of *a·węrdjan* is 'destroy'.

**20**

Ne skulun gí ênigumu manne · un-rehtes wiht,
derbjes a·dêljan, · hwand þe dóm eft kumid
obar þana selbon man, · þár it im te sorgon skal,
werðan þem te wítja, · þe hír mid is wordun ge·sprikid
un-reht ôðrum. · Neo þat iuwar ênig ne dua
gumono an þesom gardon · geldes eþþo kôpes,
þat hí un-reht gi·met · ôðrumu manne
mên-ful mako, · hwand it simbla mótjan skal
erlo ge·hwi-líkomu, · su-lík só hé it ôðrumu ge·dód,
só kumid it im eft te·gegnes, · þár hé gerno ne wili
ge·sehan is sundjon. · Ôk skal ik iu seggjan noh,
hwár gí iu wardon skulun · wítjo mêsta,
mên-werk manag: · te hwí skalt þú ênigan man be·sprekan,
bróðar þínan, · þat þú undar is bráhon ge·sehas
halm an is ôgon, · endi ge·huggjan ni wili
þana swáran balkon, · þe þú an þínoro siuni habas,
hard trio endi hęþig. · Lát þi þat an þínan hugi fallan,
hwó þú þana êrist a·lôsjas: · þan skínid þí lioht be·foran,
ôgun werðad þí ge·oponot; · þan maht þú aftar þiu
swáses mannes ge·siun · síðor ge·bótjan,

ge·hêljan an is hôbde. · Só mag þat an is hugi mêra
an þesoro middil-gard · manno ge·hwi-líkumu,
wesan an þesoro wer-oldi, · þat hí hír wammas ge·duot,
þan hí ahtoja · ôðres mannes
saka ęndi sundja, · ęndi habad im selbo mêr
firin-werko ge·frumid. · Ef hé wili is fruma lêstjan,
þan skal hí ina selbon êr · sundjono a·tómjan,
lêð-werko lôson: · sïðor mag hí mid is lêrun werðan
hęliðun te helpu, · sïðor hí ina hluttran wêt,
sundjono sikoran. · Ne skulun gí swínum te·foran
iuwa męre-gríton makon · eþþo mêðmo ge·striuni,
hêlag hals-męni, · hwand siu it an horu spurnat,
sulwjad an sande: · ne witun súbrjas ge·skêð,
fagaroro fratoho. · Su-lík sint hír folk manag,
þe iuwa hêlag word · hôrjan ne willjad,
ful-gangan godes lêrun: · ne witun gódes ge·skêð,
ak sind im lári word · leoboron mikilu,
umbi·þarbi þing, · þanna þeot-godes
werk ęndi willjo. · Ne sind sie wirðige þan,
þat sie ge·hôrjan iuwa hêlag word, · ef sie is ne willjad an iro hugi þęnkjan,
ne línon ne lêstjan. · Þem ni sęggjan gí iuworo lêron wiht,
þat gí þea spráka godes · ęndi spel managu
ne far·leosan an þem liudjun, · þea þár ne willjan gi·lôbjan tó,
wároro wordo. · Ôk skulun gí iu wardon filu
listjun undar þesun liudjun, · þár gí aftar þesumu lande farad,
þat iu þea luggjon ne mugin · lêron be·swíkan
ni mid wordun ni mid werkun. · Sie kumad an su-líkom ge·wádjon te iu,
fagoron fratohon: · þoh hębbjad sie fêknan hugi:
þea mugun gí sán ant·kęnnjan, · só gí sie kuman ge·sehad:
sie sprekad wís-lík word, · þoh iro werk ne dugin,
þero þegno ge·þáhti. · Hwand gí witun, þat eo an þornjun ne skulun
wín-beri wesan · efþa welon eo·wiht,
fagororo fruhtjo, · nek ôk figun ne lesad
hęliðos an hiopon. · Þat mugun gí undar·huggjan wel,
þat eo þe ubilo bôm, · þár hé an erðu stád,
góden wastum ne gibid, · nek it ôk god ni ge·skóp,

þat þe gódo bôm · gumono barnun
bári bittres wiht, · ak kumid fan alloro bâmo ge·hwi-líkumu
su-lík wastom te þesero wer-oldi, · só im fan is wurtjon ge·dręgid,
eþþa berht eþþa bittạr. · Þat mênid þoh breost-hugi,
managoro mód-seƀon · manno kunnjes,
hwó alloro erlo ge·hwi-lík · ôgit selƀo,
meldod mid is mûðu, · hwi-líkan hé mód haƀad,
hugi umbi is herte: · þes ni mag hé far·helan eo·wiht,
ak kumad fan þem uƀilan man · in·wid-rádos,
bittạra balu-spráka, · su-lík só hí an is breostun haƀad
ge·hęftid umbi is herte: · simbla is hugi kûðid,
is willjon mid is wordun, · ęndi farad is werk aftar þiu.
Só kumad fan þemu gódan manne · glau and-wordi,
wís-lík fan is ge·wittja, · þat hí simbla mid is wordu ge·sprikid,
man mid is míðu su-lík, · só hé an is móde haƀad
hord umbi is herte. · Þanan kumad þea hêlagan lêra,
swíðo wun-sam word, · ęndi skulun is werk aftar þiu
þeodu ge·þíhan, · þegnun managun
werðan te willjon, · al só it waldand self
gódun mannun far·giƀid, · god alo-mahtig,
himilisk hêrro, · hwand sie áno is helpa ni mugun
ne mid wordun ne mid werkun · wiht a·þęngjan
gódes an þesun gardun. · Be·þiu skulun gumono barn
an is ênes kraft · alle gi·lôbjan.

TODO.

1714 ahtoja | ‘hatogea’ **M**

1722 hêlag hals-męni | In an interesting example of cultural adaptation, OHG Tatian 39:7 *heilagaz* ‘that which is holy’ is concretized as a “holy neck-ring”, an important type of object in pre-Christian Germanic society commonly found in archaeological excavations. We must assume that such rings were still not entirely uncommon in Old Saxony in the 830s, when *Heli* was written.

**21**

Ôk skal ik iu wísjan, · hwó hír wegos twêna
liggjad an þesumu liohte, · þea farad liudjo barn,
al irmin-þiod. · Þero is óðar sán
wíd stráta ęndi brêd, · —farid sie werodes filu,
man-kunnjes manag, · hwand sie þarod iro mód spęnit,
wer-old-lusta weros— · þiu an þea wirson hand
liudi lêdid, · þár sie te far·lora werðad,

hęliðos an hęllju, · þár is hêt ęndi swart,
ęgis-lík an innan: · ôði ist þarod te faranne
ęldi-barnun, · þoh it im at þemu ęndje ni dugi.
Þan ligid eft ôðar · ęngira mikilu
weg an þesoro wer-oldi, · fęrid ina werodes lút,
fâho folk-skępi: · ni willjad ina firiho barn
gerno gangan, · þoh hé te godes ríkja,
an þat êwiga líf, · erlos lêdja.
Þan nimad gí iu þana ęngjan: · þoh hé só ôði ne sí
firihon te faranne, · þoh skal hí te frumu werðan
só hwemu só ina þurh·gęngid, · só skal is geld niman,
swíðo lang-sam lôn · ęndi líf êwig,
diur-líkan drôm. · Eo gí þes drohtin skulun,
waldand biddjen, · þat gí þana weg mótin
fan foran ant·fâhan · ęndi forð þurh gi·gangan
an þat godes ríki. · Hé ist garu simbla
wiðar þiu te geþanne, · þe man ina gerno bidid,
fergot firiho barn. · Sókjad fadar iuwan
up te þemu êwinom ríkja: · þan mótun gí ina aftar þiu
te iuworu frumu fíðan. · Kûðjad iuwa fard þarod
at iuwas drohtines durun: · þan werðad iu an·dón aftar þiu,
himil-portun ant·hlidan, · þat gí an þat hêlage lioht,
an þat godes ríki · gangan mótun,
sin-líf sehan. · Ôk skal ik iu sęggjan noh
far þesumu werode allun · wár-lík biliði,
þat alloro liudjo só hwi-lík, · só þesa mína lêra wili
ge·haldan an is herton · ęndi wil iro an is hugi a·þęnkjan,
lêstjan sea an þesumu lande, · þe gi·líko duot
wísumu manne, · þe gi·wit haþad,
horska hugi-skęfti, · ęndi hús-stędi kiusid
an fastoro foldun · ęndi an felisa uppan
wêgos wirkid, · þár im wind ni mag,
ne wág ne watares strôm · wihtju ge·tiunjan,
ak mag im þár wið un-gi·widerjon · allun standan
an þemu felise uppan, · hwand it só fasto warð
gi·stęllit an þemu stêne: · ant·haþad it þiu stędi niðana,
wręðid wiðar winde, · þat it wíkan ni mag.
Só duot eft manno só hwi-lík, · só þesun mínun ni wili
lêrun hôrjen · ne þero lêstjen wiht;

só duot þe un-wíson · erla ge·líko,
un-ge·wittigon were, · þe im be watares staðe
an sande wili · sęli-hús wirkjan,
þár it westrani wind · ęndi wágo strôm,
sêes úðjon te·sláad; · ne mag im sand ęndi greot
ge·wręðjan wið þemu winde, · ak wirðid te·worpan þan,
te·fallen an þemu flóde, · hwand it an fastoro nis
erðu ge·timbrod. · Só skal allaro erlo ge·hwes
werk ge·þíhan wiðar þiu, · þe hí þius mín word frumid,
haldid hêlag ge·bod.“ · Þó bi·gunnun an iro hugi wundron
męgin-folk mikil: · ge·hôrdun mahtiges godes
liof-líka lêra; · ne wárun an þemu lande ge·wuno,
þat sie eo fan su-líkun êr · sęggjan ge·hôrdin
wordun eþþo werkun. · Far·stódun wíse man,
þat hé só lêrde, · liudjo drohtin,
wárun wordun, · só hé ge·wald habde,
allun þem un-ge·líko, · þe þár an êr-dagun
undar þem liud-skępja · lêrjon wárun
a·koran undar þemu kunnje: · ne habdun þiu Kristes word
ge·makon mid mannun, · þe hé far þero męnigi sprak,
ge·bôd uppan þemu berge.

TODO.

**22** Hé im þó bêðju be·falh
te ge·sęggennja · sínom wordun,
hwó man himil-ríki · ge·halon skoldi,
wíd-brêdan welan, · gia hé im ge·wald far·gaf,
þat sie móstin hêljan · halte ęndi blinde,
liudjo léf-hêdi, · legar-będ manag,
swára suhti, · giak hé im selbo ge·bôd,
þat sie at ênigumu manne · méde ne námin,
diurje mêðmos: · „ge·huggjad gi“, kwað hé, „hwand iu is þiu dád kuman,
þat ge·wit ęndi þe wís-dóm, · ęndi iu þea ge·wald far·gibid
alloro firiho fadar, · só gí sie ni þurbun mid ênigo feho kôpon,
médjan mid ênigun mêðmun,— · só wesat gí iro mannun forð
an iuwon hugi-skęftjun · helpono mildja,
lêrjad gí liudjo barn · lang-samna rád,
fruma forð-wardes; · firin-werk lahad,

swára sundjon. · Ne látad iu siloƀar nek gold
wihti þes wirðig, · þat it eo an iuwa ge·wald kuma,
fagara feho-skattos: · it ni mag iu te ênigoro frumu hwęrgin,
werðan te ênigumu willjon. · Ne skulun gí ge·wádjas þan mêr
erlos êgan, · b·útan só gí þan an hębbjan,
gumon te garęwja, · þan gí gangan skulun
an þat gi·mang innan. · Neo gí umbi iuwan męti ni sorgot,
lęng umbi iuwa líf-nare, · hwand þene lêrjand skulun
fódjan þat folk-skępi: · þes sint þea fruma werða,
leoƀ-líkes lônes, · þe hí þem liudjun sagad.
wirðig is þe wurhtjo, · þat man ina wel fódja,
þana man mid mósu, · þe só managoro skal
seola bi·sorgan · ęndi an þana síð spanen,
gêstos an godes wang. · Þat is grôtara þing,
þat man bi·sorgon skal · seolun managa,
hwó man þea ge·halde · te heƀan-ríkja,
þan man þene lík-hamon · liudi-barno
mósu bi·morna. · Be·þiu man skulun
haldan þene hold-líko, · þe im te heƀan-ríkja
þene weg wísit · ęndi sie wam-skaðun,
feondun wit·fáhit · ęndi firin-werk lahid,
swára sundjon. · Nú ik iu sęndjan skal
aftar þesumu land-skępje · só lamb undar wulƀos:
só skulun gí undar iuwa fiund faren, · undar filu þeodo,
undar mis-líke man. · Hębbjad iuwan mód wiðar þem
só glauwan te·gęgnes, · só samo só þe gelwo wurm,
nádra þiu fêha, · þár siu iro níð-skępjes,
witodes wánit, · þat man iu undar þemu werode ne mugi
be·swíkan an þemu síðe. · Far þiu gí sorgon skulun,
þat iu þea man ni mugin · mód-ge·þáhti,
willjan a·wardjen. · Wesat iu so wara wiðar þiu,
wið iro fêknjon dádjun, · só man wiðar fiundun skal.
Þan wesat gí eft an iuwon dádjun · dúƀon ge·líka,
hębbjad wið erlo ge·hwene · ên-faldan hugi,
mildjan mód-seƀon, · þat þár man neg·ên
þurh iuwa dádi · be·drogan ne werðe,
be·swikan þurh iuwa sundja. · Nú skulun gí an þana síð faran,
an þat ârundi: · þár skulun gí arƀidjes só filu
ge·þolon undar þeru þiod · ęndi ge·þwing só samo

manag ęndi mis-lík, · hwand gí an mínumu namon
þea liudi lêrjat. · Be·þiu skulun gí þár lêðes filu
fora wer-old-kuningun, · wítjas ant·fáhan.
Oft skulun gí þár for ríkja · þurh þius mín rehtun word
ge·bundane standen · ęndi bêðju ge·þolojan,
ge hosk ge harm-kwidi: · umbi þat ne látad gí iuwan hugi twíflon,
seƀon swíkandjan: · gí ni þurƀun an ênigun sorgun wesan
an iuwomu hugi hwęrgin, · þan man iu for þea hêri forð
an þene gast-sęli · gangan hêtid,
hwat gí im þan te·gęgnes skulin · gódoro wordo,
spáh-líkoro ge·sprekan, · hwand iu þiu spód kumid,
helpe fon himile, · ęndi sprikid þe hêlogo gêst,
mahtig fon iuwomu munde. · Be·þiu ne an·drádad gí iu þero manno níð
ne forhtjat iro fiund-skępi: · þoh sie hębbjan iuwas ferąhes ge·wald,
þat sie mugin þene lík-hamon · líbu be·neotan,
a·slahan mid swerde, · þoh sie þeru seolun ne mugun
wiht a·wardjan. · Ant·drádad iu waldand god,
forhtjad fader iuwan, · frummjad gerno
is ge·bod-skępi, · hwand hí haƀad bêðjes gi·wald,
liudjo líbes · ęndi ôk iro lík-hamon
gek þero seolon só self: · ef gí iuwa an þem síðe þarod
far·liosat þurh þesa lêra, · þan mótun gí sie eft an þemu liohte godes
be·foran fíðan, · hwand sie fader iuwa,
haldid hêlag god · an himil-ríkja.

TODO.

1877 gelwo wurm | TODO: Note on this wyrm. Biblical or Saxon?

**23** Ne kumat þea alle te himile, · þea þe hér hrópat te mí
manno te mund-burd. · Managa sind þero,
þea willjad alloro dago ge·hwi-líkes · te drohtine hnígan,
hrópad þár te helpu · ęndi huggjad an ôðar,
wirkjad wam-dádi: · ne sind im þan þiu word fruma,
ak þea mótun hwerƀan · an þat himiles lioht,
gangan an þat godes ríki, · þea þes gerne sint,
þat sie hír ge·frummjen · fader ala-waldan

werk ęndi willjon. · Þea ni þurbun mid wordun só fílu
hrópan te helpu, · hwanda þe hêlogo god
wêt alloro manno ge·hwes · mód-ge·þáhti,
word ęndi willjon, · ęndi gildid im is werko lôn.
Be·þiu skulun gí sorgon, · þan gí an þene síð farad,
hwó gí þat ârundi · ti ęndja be·bręngen.
Þan gí líðan skulun · aftar þesumu land-skępja,
wído aftar þesoro wer-oldi, · al só iu wegos lêdjad,
brêd stráta te burg, · simbla sókjad gí iu þene bętston sán
man undar þeru męnegi · ęndi kùðjad imu iuwan móð-seƀon
wárun wordun. · Ef sie þan þes wirðige sint,
þat sie iuwa gódun werk · gerno ge·lêstjen
mid hluttru hugi, · þan gí an þemu húse mid im
wonod an willjon · ęndi im wel lônod,
geldad im mid gódu · ęndi sie te gode selƀon
wordun ge·wíhad · ęndi sęggjad im wissan friðu,
hêlaga helpa · heƀan-kuninges.
Ef sie þan só sáliga · þurh iro selƀoro dád
werðan ni mótun, · þat sie iuwa werk frummjen,
lêstjen iuwa lêra, · þan gí fan þem liudjun sán,
farad fan þemu folke, · —þe iuwa friðu hwirƀid
eft an iuworo selƀoro síð,— · ęndi látad sie mid sundjun forð,
mid balu-werkun búan · ęndi sókjad iu burg óðra,
mikil man-werod, · ęndi ne látad þes melmes wiht
folgan an iuwom fótun, · þanan þe man iu ant·fáhan ne wili,
ak skuddjat it fan iuwon skóhun, · þat it im eft te skamu werðe,
þemu werode te ge·wit-skępje, · þat iro willjo ne dôg.
Þan sęggjo ik iu te wárun, · só hwan só þius wer-old ęndjad
ęndi þe márjo dag · oƀar man farid,
þat þan Sodomo-burg, · þiu hír þurh sundjon warð
an af-grundi · êldes kraftu,
fiuru bi·fallen, · þat þiu þan haƀad friðu mêran,
mildiran mund-burd, · þan þea man êgin,
þe iu hír wiðar·werpat · ęndi ne willjad iuwa word frummjen.
Só hwe só iu þan ant·fáhit · þurh ferhtan hugi,
þurh mildjan mód, · só haƀad mínan forð
willjon ge·warhten · ęndi ôk waldand god,
ant·fangan fader iuwan, · firiho drohtin,

ríkjan rád-gebon, · þene þe al reht bi·kan.
wêt waldand self, · ęndi willjan lônot
gumono ge·hwi-líkumu, · só hwat só hí hír gódes ge·duot,
þoh hí þurh minnja godes · manno hwi-líkumu
willjandi far·gebe · watares drinkan,
þat hí þurftigumu manne · þurst ge·hêlje,
kaldes brunnan. · Þesa kwidi werðad wára,
þat eo ne bi·líbid, · ne hí þes lôn skuli,
fora godes ôgun · geld ant·fâhan,
méda manag-falde, · só hwat só hí is þurh mína minnja ge·duot.
Só hwe só mín þan far·lôgnid · liudi-barno,
hęliðo for þesoro hęrju, · só dóm ik is an himile só self
þár uppe far þem alo-waldan fader · ęndi for allumu is ęngilo krafte,
far þeru mikilon męnigi. · Só hwi-lík só þan eft manno barno
an þesoro wer-oldi ne wili · wordun míðan,
ak gihit far gum-skępi, · þat hé mín jungoro sí,
þene willju ek eft ôgjan · far ôgun godes,
fora alloro firiho fader, · þár folk manag
for þene alo-waldon · alla gangad
rędinon wið þene ríkjon. · Þár willju ik imu an reht wesan
mildi mund-boro, · só hwemu só mínun hír
wordun hôrid · ęndi þiu werk frumid,
þea ik hír an þesumu berge uppan · ge·boden hębbju.“
Habda þó te wárun · waldandes sunu
ge·lêrid þea liudi, · hwó sie lof gode
wirkjan skoldin. · Þó lét hí þat werod þanan
an alloro halba ge·hwi-líka, · hęri-skępi manno
síðon te sęlðon. · Habdun selbes word,
ge·hôrid heban-kuninges · hêlaga lêra,
só eo te wer-oldi sint · wordo ęndi dádjo,
man-kunnjes manag · obar þesan middil-gard
sprákono þiu spáhiron, · só hwe só þiu spel ge·frang,
þea þár an þemu berge ge·sprak · barno ríkjast.

TODO.

**24** Ge·wêt imu þó umbi þrea naht aftar þiu · þesoro þiodo drohtin
an Galileo land, · þár hé te ênum gômum warð,

ge·bedan þat barn godes: · þár skolda man êna brúd geban,
muna-líka magað. · Þár Maria was,
mid iro suni selbo, · sálig þiorna,
mahtiges móder. · Managoro drohtin
géng imu þó mid is jungoron, · godes êgan barn,
an þat hôha hús, · þár þiu hêri drank,
þea Judeon an þemu gast-seli: · hé im ôk at þem gômun was,
giak hí þár ge·kûðde, · þat hí habda kraft godes,
helpa fan himil-fader, · hêlagna gêst,
waldandes wís-dóm. · Werod blíðode,
wárun þár an luston · liudi at·samne,
gumon glad-módje. · Géngun ambaht-man,
skęnkjon mid skálun, · drógun skírjane wín
mid orkun endi mid alo-fatun; · was þár erlo drôm
fagar an flęttja, · þó þár folk undar im
an þem bęnkjon só bętst · blíðsja af·hóbun,
wárun þár an wunnjun. · Þó im þes wínes brast,
þem liudjun þes líðes: · is ni was far·lêbid wiht
hwęrgin an þemu húse, · þat for þene hęri forð
skęnkjon drógin, · ak þiu skapu wárun
líðes a·lárid. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,
þat it sán ant·funda · frío skônjosta,
Kristes móder: · géng wið iro kind sprekan,
wið iro sunu selbon, · sagda im mid wordun,
þat þea werdos þó mêr · wínes ne habdun
þem gęstjun te gômun. · Siu þó gerno bad,
þat is þe hêlogo Krist · helpa ge·riedi
þemu werode te willjon. · Þó habda eft is word garu
mahtig barn godes · endi wið is móder sprak:
„Hwat ist mí endi þí“, (kwað hé,) „umbi þesoro manno lið,
umbi þeses werodes wín? · Te hwí sprikis þú þes, wíf, só filu,
manos mí far þesoro męnigi? · Ne sint mína noh
tídi kumana.“ · Þan þoh gi·trúoda siu wel
an iro hugi-skęftjun, · hêlag þiorne,
þat is aftar þem wordun · waldandes barn,
hêljandoro bętst · helpan weldi.
Hét þó þea ambaht-man · idiso skônjost,
skęnkjon endi skap-wardos, · þea þár skoldun þero skolu
þionon,

þat sie þes ne word ne werk · wiht ne far·létin,
þes sie þe hêlogo Krist · hêtan weldi
lêstjan far þem liudjun. · Lárja stódun þár
stên-fatu sehsi. · Þó só stillo ge·bôd
mahtig barn godes, · só it þár manno filu
ne wissa te wárun, · hwó hé it mid is wordu ge·sprak;
hé hét þea skęnkjon · þó skírjas watares
þiu fatu fulljen, · ęndi hí þár mid is fingrun þó,
segnade selbo · sínun handun,
warhte it te wíne · ęndi hét is an ên wêgi hlaðen,
skęppjen mid ênoro skálon, · ęndi þó te þem skęnkjon sprak,
hét is þero gęstjo, · þe at þem gômun was
þemu hêroston · an hand geban,
ful mid folmun, · þemu þe þes folkes þár
ge·wéld aftar þemu werde. · Reht só hí þes wínes ge·drank,
só ni mahte hé be·míðan, · ne hí far þeru męnigi sprak
te þemu brúdi-gumon, · kwað þat simbla þat bętste líð
alloro erlo ge·hwi-lík · êrist skoldi
geban at is gômun: · „undar þiu wirðid þero gumono hugi
a·wękid mid wínu, · þat sie wel blíðod,
drunkan drômjad. · Þan mag man þár dragan aftar þiu
líht-líkora líð: · só ist þesoro liudjo þau.
Þan habas þú nú wundęr-líko · werd-skępi þínan
ge·markod far þesoro męnigi: · hétis far þit manno folk
alles þínes wínes · þat wirsiste
þíne ambaht-man · êrist bręngjan,
geban at þínun gômun. · Nú sint þína gęsti sade,
sint þíne druhtingos · drunkane swíðo,
is þit folk frô-mód: · nú hétis þú hír forð dragan
alloro líðo lof-samost, · þero þe ik eo an þesumu liohte ge·sah
hwęrgin hębbjan. · Mid þius skoldis þú ùs hin-dag êr
gebon ęndi gômjan: · þan it alloro gumono ge·hwi-lík
ge·þigedi te þanke.“ · Þó warð þár þegan manag
ge·war aftar þem wordun, · sîðor sie þes wínes ge·drunkun,
þat þár þe hêlogo Krist · an þemu húse innan
têkan warhte: · trúodun sie sîðor
þiu mêr an is mund-burd, · þat hí habdi maht godes,
ge·wald an þesoro wer-oldi. · Þó warð þat só wído kùð
obar Galileo land · Judeo liudjun,

hwó þár selbo ge·deda · sunu drohtines
water te wíne: · þat warð þár wundro êrist,
þero þe hí þár an Galilea · Judeo liudjon,
têkno ge·tôgdi. · Ne mag þat ge·tęlljan man,
ge·sęggjan te sòðan, · hwat þár sïðor warð
wundres undar þemu werode, · þár waldand Krist
an godes namon · Judeo liudjon
allan langan dag · lêra sagde,
gi·hét im heþan-ríki · ęndi hęlljo ge·þwing
węride mid wordun, · hét sie wara godes,
sin-líf sókjan: · þár is seolono lioht,
drôm drohtines · ęndi dag-skímon,
gód-lík-nissja godes; · þár gêst manag
wunod an willjan, · þe hír wel þęnkid,
þat hé hír bi·halde · heþan-kuninges ge·bod.

TODO.

2001 þiu hêri | *so* **C** *(‘thiu heri’); þe hęri (‘the heri’)* **M**.

**25** Ge·wêt imu þó mid is jungoron · fan þem gômun forð
Kristus te Kapharnaum, · kuningo ríkjost,
te þeru márjon burg. · Męgin samnode,
gumon imu te·gęgnes, · gódoro manno
sálig ge·sïðí: · weldun þiu is swótjan word
hêlag hôrjen. · Þár im ên hunno kwam,
ên gód man an·gęgin · ęndi ina gerno bad
helpan hêlagne, · kwað þat hí undar is híwiskja
ênna léfna lamon · lango habdi,
seokan an is sęlðon: · „só ina ênig sęggjo ne mag
handun ge·hêljen. · Nú is im þínoro helpono þarf,
frô mín þe gódo.“ · Þó sprak im eft þat friðu-barn godes
sán aftar þiu · selbo te·gęgnes,
kwað þat hé þár kwámi · ęndi þat kind weldi
nęrjan af þeru nôdi. · Þó im náhor géng
þe man far þeru męnigi · wið só mahtigna
wordun wehslan: · „ik þes wirðig ne bium,“ kwað hé,
„hêrro þe gódo, · þat þú an mín hús kumes,
sókjas mína sęliða, · hwand ik bium só sundig man
mid wordun ęndi mid werkun. · Ik ge·lôbju þat þú ge·wald
haþas,

þat þú ina hinana maht · hêlan ge·wirkjan,
waldand frô mín: · ef þú it mid þínun wordun ge·sprikis,
þan is sán þiu léf-hêd lôsot · ęndi wirðid is lík-hamo
hêl ęndi hrêni, · ef þú im þína helpa far·giþis.
Ik bium mí ambaht-man, · hębbju mí ôdes ge·nóg,
welono ge·wunnen: · þoh ik undar ge·węldi sí
aðal-kuninges, · þoh hębbju ik erlo ge·trôst,
holde hęri-rinkos, · þea mí só ge·hôriga sint,
þat sie þes ne word ne werk · wiht ne far·látad,
þes ik sie an þesumu land-skępje · lêstjan héte,
ak sie farad ęndi frummjad · ęndi eft te iro frôhan kumad,
holde te iro hêrron. · Þoh ik at mínumu hús êgi
wíd-brêdene welon · ęndi werodes ge·nóg,
hęliðos hugi-dęrþje, · þoh ni gi·dar ik þi só hêlagna
biddjen, barn godes, · þat þú an mín bú gangas,
sókjas mína sęliða, · hwand ik só sundig bium,
wêt mína far·wurhti.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist,
þe gumo wið is jungoron, · kwað þat hí an Judeon hwęrgin
undar Israheles · aboron ne fundi
ge·makon þes mannes, · þe io mêr te gode
an þemu land-skępi · ge·lôbon habdi,
þan hluttron te himile: · „nú látu ik iu þár hôrjen tó,
þár ik it iu te wárun hír · wordun sęggjo,
þat noh skulun ęli-þeoda · ôstane ęndi westane,
man-kunnjes kuman · manag te·samne,
hêlag folk godes · an heƀan-ríki:
þea motun þár an Abrahames · ęndi an Isaakes só self
ęndi ôk an Jakobes, · gódoro manno,
barmun ręstjen · ęndi bêðju ge·þolojan,
welon ęndi willjon · ęndi wonod-sam líf,
gód lioht mid gode. · Þan skal Judeono filu,
þeses ríkjas suni · be·rôbode werðen,
be·dêlide su-líkoro diurðo, · ęndi skulun an dalun þiustron
an þemu alloro ferristan · ferne liggen.
Þár mag man ge·hôrjen · hęliðos kwíðjan,
þár sie iro torn manag · tandon bítad;
þár ist grist-grimmo · ęndi grádag fiur,
hard hęlljo ge·þwing, · hêt ęndi þiustri,
swart sin-nahti · sundja te lône,

wrêðoro ge·wurhtjo, · só hwemu só þes willjon ne habad,
þat hé ina a·lôsje, · êr hí þit lioht a·gebe,
węndje fan þesoro wer-oldi. · Nú maht þú þi an þínan willjon forð
síðon te sęlðun; · þan findis þú ge·sundan at hús
mago-jungan man: · mód is imu an luston,
þat barn is ge·hêlid, · só þú bédi te mí:
it wirðid al só ge·lêstid, · só þú ge·lôbon habas
an þínumu hugi hardo.“ · Þó sagde heban-kuninge,
þe ambaht-man · alo-waldon gode
þank for þero þiodo, · þes hé imu at su-líkun þarbun halp.
Habda þo gi·ârundid, · al só hé welde,
sálig-líko: · gi·wêt imu an þana síð þanan,
węnde an is willjan, · þár hé welon êhte,
bú ęndi bodlos: · fand þat barn ge·sund,
kind-jungan man. · Kristes wárun þó
word ge·fullot: · hí ge·wald habda
te tôgjanna têkạn, · só þat ni mag gi·tęlljen man,
ge·ahton obar þesoro erðu, · hwat hé þurh is ênes kraft
an þesaro middil-gard · máriða ge·frumide,
wundres ge·warhte, · hwand al an is ge·węldi stád,
himil ęndi erðe.

TODO.

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2093 hunno ‘centurion’ | A native Germanic term perhaps going back to the days when the Saxons served in the Roman armies.

**26** Þó ge·wêt imu þe hêlogo Krist
forð-wardes faren, · frępide alo-mahtig
alloro dago ge·hwi-líkes, · drohtin þe gódo,
liudjo barnum leof, · lêrde mid wordun
godes willjon gumun, · habda imu jungorono filu
simbla te gi·síðun, · sálig folk godes,
manno męgin-kraft, · managoro þeodo,
hêlag hęri-skępi, · was is helpono gód,
mannun mildi. · Þó hí mid þeru męnigi kwam,
mid þiu brahtmu þat barn godes · te burg þeru hôhon,
þe nęrjendo te Naim: · þár skolde is namo werðen
mannun ge·márid. · Þó géng mahtig tó
nęrjendo Krist, · ant-tat hé gi·náhid was,

hêljandero bętst: · þó sáhun sie þár ên hrêo dragan,
ênan líf-lôsan lík-hamon · þea liudi fórjen,
beran an ênaru báru · út at þera burges dore,
magu-jungan man. · Þiu móder aftar géng
an iro hugi hriuwig · ęndi handun slóg,
karode ęndi kúmde · iro kindes dôð,
idis arm-skapan; · it was ira ênag barn:
siu was iru widowa, · ne habda wunnja þan mêr,
bi·úten te þemu ênagun sunje · al ge·láten
wunnja ęndi willjan, · ant-tat ina iru wurd be·nam,
mári metodo-ge·skapu. · Męgin folgode,
burg-liudjo ge·brak, · þár man ina an báru dróg,
jungan man te grabe. · Þár warð imu þe godes sunu,
mahtig mildi · ęndi te þeru móder sprak,
hét þat þiu widowa · wóp far·léti,
kara aftar þemu kinde: · „þú skalt hír kraft sehan,
waldandes gi·werk: · þí skal hír willjo ge·standen,
frófra far þesumu folke: · ne þarft þú feraḥ karon
barnes þínes.“ · *Þuo hie ti þero báron géng
iak hie ina selbo ant·hrên, · suno drohtines,
hêlagon handon, · ęndi ti þem hęliðe sprak,
hiet ina só ala-jungan · up a·standan,
a·rísan fan þeru ręstun. · Þie rink up a·sat,
þat barn an þero bárun: · warð im eft an is briost kuman
þie gêst þuru godes kraft, · ęndi hie te·gęgnes sprak,
þe man wið is mágos. · Þuo ina eft þero muoder bi·falaḥ
hêlandi Krist an hand: · hugi warð iro te fróbra,
þes wíbes an wunnjon, · hwand iro þár su-lík willjo gi·stuod.
Féll siu þó te fuotun Kristes · ęndi þena folko drohtin
loboda for þero liudjo męnigi, · hwand hie iro at só liobes feraḥe
mundoda wiðęr metodi-gi·skęftje: · far·stuod siu þat hie was þie mahtigo drohtin,
þie hêlago, þie himiles gi·waldid, · ęndi þat hie mahti gi·helpan managon,
allon irmin-þiedon. · Þuo bi·gunnun þat ahton managa,
þat wundęr, þat under þem weroda gi·burida, · kwáðun þat waldand selbo,

mahtig kwámi þarod is męnigi wíson, · ęndi þat hie im só márjan sandi
wár-sagon an þero wer-oldes ríki, · þie im þár su-líkan willjon frumidi.
Warð þár þuo erl manag · ęgison bi·fangan,
þat folk warð an foroȟton: · gi·sáhun þena is ferąh êgan,
dages lioht sehan, · þena þe êr dôð for·nam,
an suht-będdjon swalt: · þuo was im eft gi·sund after þiu,
kind-jung a·kwikot. · Þuo warð þat kûð obar all
aƀaron Israheles. · Reht só þuo áband kwam,
só warð þár all gi·samnod · seokora manno,
haltaro ęndi háƀaro, · só hwat só þár hwęrgin was,
þia léƀun under þem liudjon, · ęndi wurðun þár gi·lêdit tuo,
kumana te Kriste, · þár hie im þuru is kraft mikil
halp ęndi sie hêlda, · ęndi liet sia eft gi·haldana þanan
węndan an iro willjon. · Be·þiu skal man is werk lobon,
diuran is dádi, · hwand hie is drohtin self,
mahtig mund-boro · manno kunnje,
liudjo só hwi-líkon, · só þár gi·lôbit tuo
an is word ęndi an is werk.

TODO.

**27** Þuo was þár werodes só filo
allaro ęli-þiodo kuman · te þem êron Kristes,
te só mahtiges mund-burd. · Þuo welda hie þár êna męri líðan,
þie godes suno mid is jungron · a·neƀan Galilea-land,
waldand ênna wágo strôm. · Þuo hiet hie þat werod òðar
forð-werdes faran, · ęndi hie gi·wêt im fahora sum
an ênna nakon innan, · nęrjendi Krist,
slápan síð-wórig. · Segęl up dádun
wedęr-wísa weros, · lietun wind after
manon obar þena męri-strôm, · unþ·þat hie te middjan kwam,
waldand mid is werodu. · Þuo bi·gan þes wedąres kraft,
úst up stígan, · úðjun wahsan;
swang gi·swerk an gi·mang: · þie sêw warð an hruoru,
wan wind ęndi water; · weros soroęgodun,
þiu męri warð só muodag, · ni wánda þero manno nig·ên
lęngron líbes. · Þuo sia landes ward

wękidun mid iro wordon · ęndi sagdun im þes wedares kraft,
bádun þat im gi·náðig · nęrjendi Krist
wurði wið þem watare: · „efþa wí skulun hier te wundęr-kwálu
sweltan an þeson sêwe.“ · Self up a·rês
þie guodo godes suno · ęndi te is jungron sprak,
hiet þat sia im wedares gi·win · wiht ni an·drédin:
„te hwí sind gí só forhta?“ (kwaþ-hie.) „Nis iu noh fast hugi,
gi·lôbo is iu te luttil. · Nis nú lang te þiu,
þat þia strômos skulun · stilrun werðan
gi þit *wedar wun-sam.“ · Þo hí te þem winde sprak
ge te þemu sêwa só self · ęndi sie smultro hét
bêðja ge·bárjan. · Sie gi·bod lêstun,
waldandes word: · wedęr stillodun,
fagar warð an flóde. · Þó bi·gan þat folk undar im,
werod wundrajan, · ęndi suma mid iro wordun sprákun,
hwi-lík þat só mahtigoro · manno wári,
þat imu só þe wind ęndi þe wág · wordu hôrdin,
bêðja is gi·bod-skępjes. · Þó habda sie þat barn godes
gi·nęrid fan þeru nôdi: · þe nako furðor skręid,
hôh-hurnid skip; · hęliðos kwámun,
liudi te lande, · sagdun lof gode,
máridun is męgin-kraft. · Kwam þár manno filu
an·gęgin þemu godes sunje; · hé sie gerno ant·féng,
só hwene só þár mid hluttru hugi · helpa sóhte;
lêrde sie iro gi·lôbon · ęndi iro lík-hamon
handun hêlde: · nio þe man só hardo ni was
gi·sêrit mid suhtjun: · þoh ina Satanases
fêknja jungoron · fiundes kraftu
habdin undar handun · ęndi is hugi-skęfti,
gi·wit a·wardid, · þat hé wódjendi
fóri undar þemu folke, · þoh im simbla ferh far·gaf
hêlandjo Krist, · ef hé te is handun kwam,
drêf þea diublas þanan · drohtines kraftu,
wárun wordun, · ęndi im is ge·wit far·gaf,
lét ina þan hêlan · wiðęr hęttjandun,
gaf im wið þie fiund friðu, · ęndi im forð gi·wêt
an só hwi-lík þero lando, · só im þan leobost was.

TODO.

2265 skręid | *so (*'skreid'*)* **M***;* skrêd *(*'scred'*)* **C**

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2265 skręid | A rare occurrence of the original diphthong in 1 of 2 witness mss.; see note to line 359 above.

2266 hôh-hurnid skip 'high-horned ship' | A longship with a tall prow, as known from archaeology. The line, which reoccurs below at 2907a, is certainly a formulaic inheritance from earlier pagan Saxon poetry, for it belongs in the world of the North Sea, hardly the New Testament. For another native ship-term cf. l. 1186a below: *nęglid-skipu*. — The segmenting of the words is ambiguous. The pres. ed. reads the line as a type E, but it may also be read as a type D *hôh hurnid-skip* 'high horned-ship'. To determine the correct reading we may cf. the semantics of the name of the god Balder's ship in Norse mythology, *Hring-horni* 'Ringhorn', i.e., 'one with a coiled prow' (*Gylf* 49:36, *Skm* 12), which ought to be compared with OE *bringid-stęfná* 'ringed-prowed one', a term for a ship (*Beow* 32, 1131, 1897; see R. D. Fulk, Bjork, and Niles 2008, p. 116). It seems clear from these parallels that the term *horn* is an archaic/poetic term for the prow of a ship, and therefore the pres. l. must be read as 'high-horned ship', not 'high horned-ship', since the important thing is that the prow is high, not that the ship has a prow (a tautology).

**28**

Só deda þe drohtines sunu · dago ge·hwi-líkes
gód werk mid is jungeron, · só neo Judeon umbi þat
an þea is mikilun kraft · þiu mêr ne ge·lôbdun,
þat hé alo-waldo · alles wári,
landes ęndi liudjo: · þes sie noh lôn nimat,
wídana wrak-sïðð, · þes sie þár þat ge·win driþun
wiðð selþan þene sunu drohtines. · Þó hé im mid is ge·sïðon gi·wêt
eft an Galilaeo land, · godes êgan barn,
fór im te þem friundun, · þár hé a·fódid was
ęndi al undar is kunnje · kind-jung a·wóhs,
þe hêlago hêljand. · Umbi ina hęri-skępi,
þeoda þrungun; · þár was þegąn manag
só sálig undar þem ge·sïðe. · Þár drógun ênna seokan man
erlos an iro armun: · weldun ina for ôgun Kristes,
bręngjan for þat barn godes · —was im bótono þarf,
þat ina ge·hêldi · heþanes waldand,
manno mund-boro—, · þe was êr só managan dag
liðu-wastmon bi·lamod, · ni mahte is lík-hamon
wiht ge·waldan. · Þan was þár werodes só filu,
þat sie ina fora þat barn godes · bręngjan ni mahtun,
ge·þringan þurh þea þioda, · þat sie só þurftiges
sunnja ge·sagdin. · Þó gi·wêt imu an ênna sęli innan
hêljando Krist; · hwarf warð þár umbi,
męgin-þeodo ge·mang. · Þó bi·gunnun þea man spreken,
þe þene léfna lamon · lango fórdun,

bárun mid is będdju, · hwó sie ina ge·drógin fora þat barn godes,
an þat werod innan, · þár ina waldand Krist
selbo gi·sáwi. · Þó géngun þea ge·síðos tó,
hóbun ina mid iro handun · ęndi uppan þat hús stigun,
slitun þene sęli obana · ęndi ina mid sêlun létun
an þene rakud innan, · þár þe ríkjo was,
kuningo kraftigost. · Reht só hé ina þó kuman gi·sah
þurh þes húses hróst, · só hé þó an iro hugi far·stód,
an þero manno mód-sebon, · þat sie mikilana te imu
ge·lôbon habdun, · þó hé for þen liudjun sprak,
kwað þat hé þene siakon man · sundjono tómjan
látan weldi. · Þó sprákun im eft þea liudi an·gęgin,
gram-harde Judeon, · þea þes godes barnes
word aftar warodun, · kwáðun þat þat ni mahti gi·werðen só,
grim-werk far·geþen, · bi·útan god êno,
waldand þesaro wer-oldes. · Þó habda eft is word garu
mahtig barn godes: · „ik gi·dón þat“, kwað hé, „an þesumu manne skín,
þe hír só siak ligid · an þesumu sęli innan,
te wundron gi·wêgid, · þat ik ge·wald hębbju
sundja te far·geþanne · ęndi ôk seokan man
te ge·hêljanne, · só ik ina hrínan ni þarf.“
Manoda ina þó · þe márjo drohtin,
liggjandjan lamon, · hét ina far þem liudjun a·standan
up alo-hêlan · ęndi hét ina an is ahslun niman,
is będ-gi·wádi te baka; · hé þat gi·bod lêste
sniumo for þemu gi·síðja · ęndi géng imu eft ge·sund þanan,
hêl fan þemu húse. · Þó þes só manag hêðin man,
weros wundradun, · kwáðun þat imu waldand self,
god alo-mahtig · far·geþan habdi
mêron mahti · þan ęlkor ênigumu mannes sunje,
kraft ęndi kústi; · sie ni weldun ant·kęnnjan þoh,
Judeo liudi, · þat hé god wári,
ne ge·lôbdun is lêran, · ak habdun im lêðan stríd,
wunnun wiðar is wordun: · þes sie werk hlutun,
lêð-lík lôn-geld, · ęndi só noh lango skulun,
þes sie ni weldun hôrjen · heþan-kuninges,
Kristes lêrun, · þea hé kúðde obar al,

wído aftar þesaro wer-oldi, · ęndi lét sie is werk sehan
allaro dago ge·hwi-líkes, · is dádi skawon,
hôrjen is hêlag word, · þe hé te helpu ge·sprak
manno barnun, · ęndi só manag mahtig-lík
têkạn ge·tôgda, · þat sie gi·trúodin þiu bęt,
gi·lôbdin an is lêra. · Hé só managan lík-hamon
balu-suhtjo ant·band · ęndi bóta ge·skęride,
far·gaf fêgjun feraḥ, · þem þe fûsid was
hęlið an hęl-síð: · þan gi·deda ina þe hêland self,
Krist þurh is kraft mikil · kwikan aftar dôða,
lét ina an þesaro wer-oldi forð · wunnjono neotan.

TODO.

2339 kûsti | so **M**; *kunsti* norm. **C**

**29** Só hêlde hé þea haltun man · ęndi þea háƀon só self,
bótta þem þár blinde wárun, · lét sie þat berhte lioht,
sin-skôni sehan, · sundja lôsda,
gumono grim-werk. · Ni was gio Judeono be·þiu,
lêðes liud-skępjes · gi·lôƀo þiu bętara
an þene hêlagon Krist, · ak habdun im hardene mód,
swíðo starkan stríd, · far·standan ni weldun,
þat sie habdun for·fangan · fiundun an willjan,
liudi mid iro ge·lôƀun. · Ni was gio þiu latoro be·þiu
sunu drohtines, · ak hé sagde mid wordun,
hwó sie skoldin ge·halon · himiles ríki,
lêrde aftar þemu lande, · habde imu þero liudjo só filu
gi·węnid mid is wordun, · þat im werod mikil,
folk folgoda, · ęndi hé im filu sagda,
be biliðjun þat barn godes, · þes sie ni mahtun an iro breostun far·standan,
undar·huggjan an iro herton, · êr it im þe hêlago Krist
ƀar þat erlo folk · oponun wordun
þurh is selƀes kraft · sęggjan welda,
márjan hwat hé mênde. · Þár ina męgin umbi,
þioda þrungun: · was im þarf mikil
te gi·hôrjenne · heƀan-kuninges
wár-fastun word. · Hé stód imu þó bi ênes watares staðe,
ni welde þó bi þemu ge·þringe · ƀar þat þegno folk
an þemu lande uppan · þea lêra kûðjan,

ak géng imu þó þe gódo · ęndi is jungaron mid imu,
friðu-barn godes, · þemu flóde náhor
an ên skip innan, · ęndi it skalden hét
lande rúmur, · þat ina þea liudi só filu,
þioda ni þrungi. · Stód þegạn manag,
werod bi þemu watare, · þár waldand Krist
obar þat liudjo folk · lêra sagde:
„Hwat ik iu sęggjan mag“, (kwað hé,) „ge·sïðos míne,
hwó imu ên erl bi·gan · an erðu sájan
hrên-korni mid is handun. · Sum it an hardan stên
oban-wardan fel, · erðon ni habda,
þat it þár mahti wahsan · efþa wurtjo gi·fáhan,
kínan efþa bi·klíben, · ak warð þat korn far·loren,
þat þár an þeru léjan gi·lag. · Sum it eft an land bi·fel,
an erðun aðal-kunnjes: · bi·gan imu aftar þiu
wahsen wán-líko · ęndi wurtjo fáhan,
lôd an lustun: · was þat land só gód,
frânisko gi·fêhod. · Sum it eft bi·fallen warð
an êna starka strátun, · þár stópon géngun,
hrosso hóf-slaga · ęndi hęliðo tráda;
warð imu þár an erðu · ęndi eft up gi·géng,
bi·gan imu an þemu wege wahsen; · þó it eft þes werodes far·nam,
þes folkes fard mikil · ęndi fuglos a·lásun,
þat is þemu êksan wiht · aftar ni móste
werðan te willjan, · þes þár an þene weg bi·fel.
Sum warð it þan bi·fallen, · þár só filu stódun
þikkero þorno · an þemu dage;
warð imu þár an erðu · ęndi eft up gi·géng,
kên imu þár ęndi kliþode. · Þó slógun þár eft krúd an gi·mang,
węridun imu þene wastom: · habda it þes waldes hlea
forana obar·fangan, · þat it ni mahte te ênigaro frumu werðen,
ef it þea þornos · só þringan móstun.“
Þó sátun ęndi swígodun · ge·sïðos Kristes,
word-spáha weros: · was im wundạr mikil,
be hwi-líkun biliðjun · þat barn godes
su-lík sóð-lík spel · sęggjan bi·gunni.
Þó bi·gan is þero erlo · ên frágojan

holdan hêrron, · hnêg imu te·gęgnes
tulgo werð-liko: · „Hwat þú ge·wald haƀas“, kwað hé,
„ia an himile ia an erðu, · hêlag drohtin,
uppa ęndi niðara, · bist þú alo-waldo
gumono gêsto, · ęndi wí þíne jungaron sind,
an ùsumu hugi holde. · Hêrro þe gódo,
ef it þín willjo sí, · lát ùs þínaro wordo þár
ęndi gi·hôrjen, · þat wí it aftar þi
oƀar al Kristin-folk · kùðjan mótin.
wí witun þat þínun wordun · wár-lík biliði
forð folgojad, · ęndi ùs is firinun þarf,
þat wí þín word ęndi þín werk, · —hwand it fan su-líkumu
ge·wittja kumid—
þat wí it an þesumu lande · at þi línon mótin.“

TODO.

**30** Þó im eft te·gęgnes · gumono bętsta
and-wordi ge·sprak: · „ni mênde ik ęlkor wiht“, kwað hé,
„te bi·dęrnjenne · dádjo mínaro,
wordo efƀa werko; · þit skulun gí witan alle,
jungaron míne, · hwand iu far·geƀen haƀad
waldand þesaro wer-oldes, · þat gí witan mótun
an iuwom hugi-skęftjun · himilisk ge·rúni;
þem òðrun skal man be biliðjun · þat gi·bod godes
wordun wísjen. · Nú willju ik iu te wárun hier
márjen, hwat ik mênde, · þat gí mína þiu bęt
oƀar al þit land-skępi · lêra far·standan.
Þat sád, þat ik iu sagda, · þat is selƀes word,
þiu hêlaga lêra · heƀan-kuninges,
hwó man þea márjen skal · oƀar þene middil-gard,
wído aftar þesaro wer-oldi. · Weros sind im gi·hugide,
man mis-líko: · sum su-líkan mód dręgid,
harda hugi-skęfti · ęndi hréan seƀon,
þat ina ni ge·werðod, · þat hé it be iuwon wordun due,
þat hé þesa mína lêra forð · lêstjen willje,
ak werðad þár só far·lorana · lêra mína,
godes am·busni · ęndi iuwaro gumono word
an þemu ubilon manne, · só ik iu êr sagda,
þat þat korn far·warð, · þat þár mid kíðun ni mahte

an þemu stêne uppan · stędi-haft werðan.
Só wirðid al far·loran · ędilero spráka,
ârundi godes, · só hwat só man þemu uƀilon manne
wordun ge·wísid, · ęndi hé an þea wirson hand,
undar fiundo folk · fard ge·kiusid,
an godes un-wiljan · ęndi an gramono hróm
ęndi an fiures farm. · Forð skal hé hêtjan
mid is breost-hugi · brêda logna.
Nio gí an þesumu lande þiu lés · lêra mína
wordun ni wísjad: · is þeses werodes só filu,
erlo aftar þesaro erðun: · bi·stéd þár ôðar man,
þe is imu jung ęndi glau, · —ęndi haƀad imu gódan mód—,
sprákono spáhi · ęndi wêt iuwaro spello gi·skêð,
hugid is þan an is herton · ęndi hôrid þár mid is ôrun tó
swíðo niud-líko · ęndi náhor stéd,
an is breost hlędid · þat gi·bod godes,
línod ęndi lêstid: · is is gi·lôƀo só gód,
talod imu, hwó hé ôðrana · ęft gi·hwęrƀje
mên-dádigan man, · þat is mód draga
hluttra treuwa · te heƀan-kuninge.
Þan brêdid an þes breostun · þat gi·bod godes,
þie luƀigo gi·lôƀo, · só an þemu lande duod
þat korn mid kíðun, · þár it gi·kund haƀad
ęndi imu þiu wurð bi·hagod · ęndi wedęres gang,
rągin ęndi sunne, · þat it is reht haƀad.
Só duod þiu godes lêra · an þemu gódun manne
dages ęndi nahtes, · ęndi gangid imu diuƀal fer,
wrêða wihti · ęndi þe ward godes
náhor mikilu · nahtes ęndi dages,
ant-tat sie ina bręngjad, · þat þár bêðju wirðid
ia þiu lêra te frumu · liudjo barnun,
þe fan is mûðe kumid, · iak wirðid þe man gode;
haƀad só gi·wehslod · te þesaro wer-old-stundu
mid is hugi-skęftjun · himil-ríkjas gi·dêl,
welono þene mêstan: · farid imu an gi·wald godes,
tionuno tómig. · Treuwa sind só góda
gumono ge·hwi-líkumu, · só nis goldes hord
ge·lík su-líkumu gi·lôƀon. · Wesad iuwaro lêrono forð
man-kunnje mildje; · sie sind só mis-líka,

hęliðos ge·hugda: · sum habad iro hardan stríd,
wrêðan willjan, · wankolna hugi,
is imu fêknes ful · ęndi firin-werko.
Þan bi·ginnid imu þunkjan, · þan hé undar þeru þiodu stád
ęndi þár gi·hôrid · obar hlust mikil
þea godes lêra, · þan þunkid imu, þat hé sie gerno forð
lêstjen willje; · þan bi·ginnid imu þiu lêra godes
an is hugi hafton, · ant-tat imu þan eft an hand kumid
feho te gi·fórja · ęndi fręmiði skat.
Þan far·lêdjad ina · lêða wihti,
þan hé imu far·fáhid · an feho-giri,
a·lęskid þene gi·lôbon: · þan was imu þat luttil fruma,
þat hé it gio an is hertan ge·hugda, · ef hé it halden ne wili.
Þat is só þe wastom, · þe an þemu wege be·gan,
liodan an þemu lande: · þó far·nam ina eft þero liudjo fard.
Só duot þea męgin-sundjon · an þes mannes hugi
þea godes lêra, · ef hé is ni gômid wel;
ęlkor bi·fęlljad sia ina · ferne te boðme,
an þene hêtan hęl, · þár hé heþan-kuninge
ni wirðid furður te frumu, · ak ina fiund skulun
wítju gi·waraǫjan. · Simla gí mid wordun forð
lêrjad an þesumu lande: · *ik kan þesaro liudjo hugi,
só mis-líkan muod-seþon · manno kunnjes,
só wanda wísa · [...].
Sum haþit all te þiu is muod gi·látan · ęndi mêr soroǫot,
hwó hie þat hord bi·halde, · þan hwó hie heþan-kuninges
willjon gi·wirkje. · Be·þiu þár wahsan ni mag
þat hêlaga gi·bod godes, · þoh it þár a·hafton mugi,
wurtjon bi·werpan, · hwand it þie welo þringit.
Só samo só þat krúd ęndi þie þorn · þat korn ant·fáhat,
węrjat im þena wastom, · só duot þie welo manne:
gi·hęftid is herta, · þat hie it gi·huggjan ni muot,
þie man an is muode, · þes hie mêst bi·þarf,
hwó hie þat gi·wirkje, · þan lang þie hie an þesaro wer-oldi sí,
þat hie ti êwon-dage · after muoti
hębbjan þuru is hêrren þank · himiles ríki,
só ęndi-lôsan welon, · só þat ni mag ênig man
witan an þesaro wer-oldi. · Nio hie só wído ni kan
te gi·þęnkjanne, · þegan an is muode,

þat it bi·haldan mugi · herta þes mannes,
þat hie þat ti wáron witi, · hwat waldand god habit
guodes gi·gęręwid, · þat all gęgin-werd stéð
manno só hwi-líkon, · só ina hier minnjot wel
ęndi selbo te þiu · is seola gi·haldit,
þat hie an lioht godes · líðan muoti.“

TODO.

**31** Só wísda hie þuo mid wordon, · stuod werod mikil
umbi þat barn godes, · ge·hôrdun ina bi biliðon filo
umbi þesaro wer-oldes gi·wand · wordon tęlljan;
kwað þat im ôk ên aðales man · an is akkęr sáidi
hluttar hrên-korni · handon sínon:
wolda im þár só wun-sames · wastmes tiljan,
fagares fruhtes. · Þuo géng þár is fiond aftar
þuru dęrnjan hugi, · ęndi it all mid durðu obar·séu,
mid weodo wirsiston. · Þuo wóhsun sia bêðju,
ge þat korn ge þat krúd. · Só kwámun gangan
is haga-stoldos te hús, · iro hêrren sagdun,
þegnos iro þiodne · þrístjon wordon:
„Hwat þú sáidos hluttar korn, · hêrro þie guodo,
ên-fald an þínon akkar: · nú ni gi·sihit ênig erlo þan mêr
weodes wahsan. · Hwí mohta þat gi·werðan só?“
Þuo sprak eft þie aðales man · þem erlon te·gęgnes,
þiodan wið is þegnos, · kwað þat hie it mahti undar·þęnkjan wel,
þat im þár un-hold man · aftar sáida,
fiond fêkni krúd: · „ne gionsta mí þero fruhtjo wel,
a·werda mí þena wastom.“ · Þuo þár eft wini sprákun,
is jungron te·gęgnes, · kwáðun þat sia þár weldin gangan tuo,
kuman mid kraftu · ęndi lôsjan þat krúd þanan,
halon it mid iro handon. · Þuo sprak im eft iro hêrro an·gęgin:
„ne welljo ik, þat gí it wiodon“, (kwaþ-hie,) „hwand gí bi·wardon ni mugun,
gi·gômjan an iuwon gange, · þoh gí it gerno ni duan,
ni gí þes kornes te filo, · kíðo a·węrdjat,
fęlljat under iuwa fuoti. · Láte man sia forð hinan
bêðju wahsan, · und êr beuwod kume

ęndi an þem felde sind · fruhti rípja,
arwa an þem akkạre: · þan faran wí þár alla tuo,
halon it mid ụssan handon · ęndi þat hrên-kurni lesan
súbro te·samne · ęndi it an mínon sęli duojan,
hębbjan it þár gi·haldan, · þat it hwęrgin ni mugi
wiht a·węrdjan, · ęndi þat wiod niman,
bindan it te burðinnjon · ęndi werpan it an bittạr fiur,
láton it þár halojan · hêta logna,
ald un-fuodi.“ · Þuo stuod erl manag,
þegnos þagjandi, · hwat þiod-gomo,
*mári mahtig Krist · mênjan weldi,
bôknjen mid þiu biliðju · barno ríkjost.
Bádun þó só gerno · gódan drohtin
ant·lúkan þea lêra, · þat sia móstin þea liudi forð,
hêlaga hôrjan. · Þó sprak im eft iro hêrro an·gęgin,
mári mahtig Krist: · „þat is“, kwað hé, „mannes sunu:
ik selbo bium, þat þár sáiu, · ęndi sind þesa sáliga man
þat hluttra hrên-korni, · þea mí hér hôrjad wel,
wirkjad mínan willjan; · þius wer-old is þe akkạr,
þit brêda bú-land · barno man-kunnjes;
Satanas selbo is, · þat þár sáid aftar
só lêð-líka lêra: · haƀad þesaro liudjo só filu,
werodes a·wardid, · þat sie wam frummjad,
wirkjad aftar is willjon; · þoh skulun sie hér wahsen forð,
þea for·griponon gumon, · só samo só þea gódun man,
ant-tat Múd·spelles męgin · oƀar man fęrid,
ęndi þesaro wer-oldes. · Þan is allaro akkạro ge·hwi-lík
ge·rípod an þesumu ríkja: · skulun iro regan-gi·skapu
frummjen firiho barn. · Þan te·farid erða:
þat is allaro beuwo brêdost; · þan kumid þe berhto drohtin
oƀana mid is ęngilo kraftu, · ęndi kumad alle te·samne
liudi, þe io þit lioht gi·sáun, · ęndi skulun þan lôn ant·fáhan
ubiles ęndi gódes. · Þan gangad ęngilos godes,
hêlage heƀan-wardos, · ęndi lesat þea hluttron man
sundọr te·samne, · ęndi duat sie an sin-skôni,
hôh himiles lioht, · ęndi þea óðra an hęllja grund,
werpad þea far·warhton · an wallandi fiur;
þár skulun sie gi·bundene · bittra logna,
þrá-werk þolon, · ęndi þea óðra þiod-welon

an heƀan-ríkja, · hwítaro sunnon
liohtjan ge·líko. · Su-lík lôn nimad
weros wal-dádjo. · Só hwe só gi·wit êgi,
ge·hugdi an is hertan, · eþþa gi·hôrjen mugi,
erl mid is ôrun, · só láta imu þit an innan sorga,
an is mód-seƀon, · hwó hé skal an þemu márjon dage
wið þene ríkjon god · an ręðju standen
wordo ęndi werko allaro, · þe hé an þesaro wer-oldi gi·duod.
Þat is ęgis-líkost · allaro þingo,
forht-líkost firiho barnun, · þat sie skulun wið iro frâhon mahljen,
gumon wið þene gódan drohtin: · þan weldi gerno ge·hwe wesan,
allaro manno ge·hwi-lík · mênes tómig,
slíðero sakono. · Aftar þiu skal sorgon êr
allaro liudjo ge·hwi-lík, · êr hé þit lioht af·geƀe,
þe þan êgan wili · alungan tír,
hôh heƀan-ríki · ęndi huldi godes.“

TODO.

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2591 Múd·spelles męgin | Apparently an incorporation of an earlier Germanic expression; the variant *Mút·spelli* occurs at line 4358 below. For the etymology and sense of this word see note to *Musp* l. 56 (attesting its OHG cognate *Mú·spilli*) and *Vsp* 49/1 (attesting ON *Mú·spell*).

**32**

Só gi·fragn ik þat þó selƀo · sunu drohtines,
allaro barno bętst · biliðjo sagda,
hwi-lík þero wári · an wer-old-ríkja
undar hęlið-kunnje · himil-ríkje ge·lík;
kwað þat oft luttiles hwat · liohtora wurði,
só hôho af·huoƀi, · „so duot himil-ríki:
þat is simla mêra, · þan is man ênig
wánje an þesaro wer-oldi. · Ôk is imu þat werk ge·lík,
þat man an sêo innan · sęgina wirpit,
fisk-nęt an flód · ęndi fahit bêðju,
uƀile ęndi góde, · tiuhid up te staðe,
liðod sie te lande, · lisit aftar þiu
þea gódun an greote · ęndi látid þea òðra eft an grund faran,
an wídan wág. · Só duod waldand god
an þemu márjon dage · męnniskono barn:
bręngid irmin-þiod, · alle te·samne,

lisit imu þan þea hluttron · an heƀan-ríki,
látid þea far·griponon · an grund faren
hęllje fiures. · Ni wêt hęliðo man
þes wítjes wiðạr-lága, · þes þár weros þiggjat,
an þemu Inferne · irmin-þioda.
Þan hald ni mag þera médan man · gi·makon fíðen,
ni þes welon ni þes willjon, · þes þár waldand skerid,
gildid god selƀo · gumono só hwi-líkumu,
só ina hér gi·haldid, · þat hé an heƀan-ríki,
an þat lang-same lioht · líðan móti.“
Só lêrda hé þó mid listjun. · Þan fórun þár þea liudi tó
ofar al Galilaeo land · þat godes barn sehan:
dádun it bi þemu wundre, · hwanen imu mahti su-lík word kumen,
só spáh-líko gi·sprokan, · þat hé spel godes
gio só sôð-líko · sęggjan konsti,
só kraftig-líko gi·kweðen: · „Hé is þeses kunnjes hinen“, kwáðun sie,
„þe man þurh mág-skępi: · hér is is móder mid ùs,
wíf undar þesumu werode. · Hwat wí þe hér witun alle,
só kùð is ùs is kuni-burd · ęndi is knósles ge·hwat;
a·wóhs al undar þesumu werode: · hwanen skoldi imu su-lík ge·wit kuman,
méron mahti, · þan hér òðra man êgin?“
Só far·munste ina þat manno folk · ęndi sprákun im gi·mêd-lík word,
far·hogdun ina só hêlagna, · hôrjen ni weldun
is gi·bod-skępjes. · Ni hé þár ôk biliðjo filu
þurh iro un-gi·lôƀon · ógjan ni welde,
torhtero têkno, · hwand hé wisse iro twífljan hugi,
iro wrêðan willjan, · þat ni wárun weros òðra
só grimme under Judeon, · só wárun umbi Galilaeo land,
só hardo ge·hugide: · só þár was þe hêlago Krist,
gi·boren þat barn godes, · si ni weldun is gi·bod-skępi þoh
ant·fáhan ferht-líko, · ak bi·gan þat folk undar im,
rinkos rádan, · hwó sie þene ríkjon Krist
wêgdin te wundron. · Hétun þó iro werod kumen,
ge·síðði te·samne: · sundja weldun
an þene godes sunu · gerno gi·tęlljen

wrêðes willjon; · ni was im is wordo niud,
spáharo spello, · ak sie bi·gunnun sprekan undar im,
hwó sie ina só kraftagne · fan ênumu kliƀe wurpin,
oƀar ênna berges wal: · weldun þat barn godes
liƀu bi·lôsjen. · Þó hé imu mid þem liudjun samad
frô-líko fôr: · ni was imu forạht hugi,
—wisse þat imu ni mahtun · męnniskono barn,
bi þeru god-kundi · Judeo liudi
êr is tídjun wiht · teonon gi·frummjen,
lêðaro gi·lêsto—, · ak hé imu mid þem liudjun samad
stêg uppen þene stên-holm, · ant-þat sie te þeru stędi kwámun,
þár sie ine fan þemu walle niðer · werpen hugdun,
fęlljen te foldu, · þat hé wurði is ferhes lôs,
is aldres at ęndje. · Þó warð þero erlo hugi,
an þemu berge uppen · bittra gi·þáhti
Juðeono te·gangen, · þat iro ênig ni habde só grimmon seƀon
ni só wrêðen willjon, · þat sie mahtin þene waldandes sunu,
Krist ant·kęnnjen; · hé ni was iro kùð ênigumu,
þat sie ina þó undar·wissin. · Só mahte hé undar ira werode standen
ęndi an iro gi·mange · middjumu gangen,
faren undar iro folke. · Hé dede imu þene friðu selƀo,
mund-burd wið þeru męnegi · ęndi gi·wêt imu þurh middi þanan
þes fiundo folkes, · fôr imu þó, þár hé welde,
an êne wóstunnje · waldandes sunu,
kuningo kraftigost: · habde þero kustes gi·wald,
hwár imu an þemu lande · leoƀost wári
te wesanne an þesaru wer-oldi.

TODO.

**33** Þan fôr imu an weg óðran
Johannes mid is jungarun, · godes ambaht-man,
lêrde þea liudi · lang-samane rád,
hét þat sie frume frędidin, · firina far·létin,
mên ęndi morð-werk. · Hé was þár managumu liof
gódaro gumono. · Hé sóhte imu þó þene Judeono kuning,
þene hęri-togon at hús, · þe hêten was

Erodes aftar is ęldiron, · obar-módig man:
búide imu be þeru brúdi, · þiu êr sínes bróðer was,
idis an êhti, · ant-tat hé ęlljor skók,
wer-old weslode. · Þó imu þat wíf gi·nam
þe kuning te kwenun; · êr wárun iro kind ôdan,
barn be is bróðer. · Þó bi·gan imu þea brúd lahan
Johannes þe gódo, · kwað þat it gode wári,
waldande wiðęr-mód, · þat it ênig wero frumidi,
þat bróðer brúd · an is będ námi,
hębbje sie imu te híwun. · „Ef þú mí hôrjen wili,
gi·lôbjen mínun lêrun, · ni skalt þú sie lęng êgan,
ak míð ire an þínumu móde: · ni haba þár su-líka minnja tó,
ni sundjo þi te swíðo.“ · Þó warð an sorgun hugi
þes wíbes aftar þem wordun; · an·dréd þat hé þene
wer-old-kuning
sprákono ge·spóni · ęndi spáhun wordun,
þat hé sie far·léti. · Be·gan siu imu þó lêðes filu
ráden an rúnon, · ęndi ine rinkos hét,
un-sundigane · erlos fáhan
ęndi ine an ênumu karkerja · klústar-bęndjun,
liðo-kospun bi·lúkan: · be þem liudjun ne gi·dorstun
ine feraḥu bi·lôsjen, · hwand sie wárun imu friund alle,
wissun ine só góden · ęndi gode werðen,
habdun ina for wár-sagon, · só sia wela mahtun.
Þó wurðun an þemu gęr-tale · Judeo kuninges
tídi kumana, · só þár gi·tald habdun
fróde folk-weros, · þó hé gi·fódid was,
an lioht kuman. · Só was þero liudjo þau,
þat þat erlo ge·hwi-lík · óbjan skolde,
Judeono mid gômun. · Þó warð þár an þene gast-sęli
męgin-kraft mikil · manno ge·samnod,
hęri-togono an þat hús, · þár iro hêrro was
an is kuning-stóle. · Kwámun managa
Judeon an þene gast-sęli; · warð im þár glad-mód hugi,
blíði an iro breostun: · gi·sáhun iro bâg-gebon
wesen an wunnjon. · Dróg man wín an flęt
skíri mid skálun, · skęnkjon hwurbun,
géngun mid gold-fatun: · gaman was þár inne
hlúd an þero hallu, · hęliðos drunkun.

Was þes an lustun · landes hirdi,
hwat hé þemu werode mêst · te wunnjun gi·fręmidi.
Hét hé þó gangen forð · gêla þiornun,
is bróder barn, · þár hé an is bęnki sat
wínu gi·wlęnkid, · ęndi þó te þemu wíbe sprak;
grótte sie fora þemu gum-skępje · ęndi gerno bad,
þat siu þár fora þem gastjun · gaman af·hóbi
fagar an flęttje: · „lát þit folk sehan,
hwó þú ge·línod habas · liudjo męnegi
te blíðsjanne an bęnkjun; · ef þú mí þera bede tugiðos,
mín word for þesumu werode, · þan willju ik it hér te wárun ge·kweðen,
liahto fora þesun liudjun · ęndi ôk gi·lêstjen só,
þat ik þí þan aftar þiu · êron willju,
só hwes só þú mí bidis · for þesun mínun bâg-winjun:
þoh þú mí þesaro hęri-dómo · halbaro fergos,
ríkjas mínes, · þoh gi·dón ik, þat it ênig rinko ni mag
wordun gi·węndjen, · ęndi it skal gi·werðen só.“
Þó warð þera magað aftar þiu · mód gi·hworben,
hugi aftar iro hêrron, · þat siu an þemu húse innen,
an þemu gast-sęli · gamen up a·huof,
al só þero liudjo · land-wíse gi·dróg,
þero þiodo þau. · Þiu þiorne spilode
hrór aftar þemu húse: · hugi was an lustun,
managaro mód-sebo. · Þó þiu magað habda
gi·þionod te þanke · þiod-kuninge
ęndi allumu þemu erl-skępje, · þe þár inne was
gódaro gumono, · siu welde þó ira geba êgan,
þiu magað for þeru męnegi: · géng þó wið iro módar sprekan
ęndi frágode sie · firi-wit-líko,
hwes siu þene burges ward · biddjen skoldi.
Þó wísde siu aftar iro willjon, · hét þat siu wihtes þan êr
ni gęrodi for þemu gum-skępje, · bi·útan þat man iru Johannes
an þeru hallu innan · hôbid gábi
a·lôsid af is lík-hamon. · Þat was allun þem liudjun harm,
þem mannun an iro móde, · þó sie þat gi·hôrdun þea magað sprekan;
só was it ôk þemu kuninge: · hé ni mahte is kwidi liagan,
is word węndjen: · hét þó is wépan-berand

gangen fan þemu gast-sęli · ęndi hét þene godes man
líbu bi·lôsjen. · Þó ni was lang te þiu,
þat man an þea halla · hôbid brâhte
þes þiod-gumon, · ęndi it þár þeru þiornun far·gaf,
magað for þeru męnegi: · siu dróg it þeru móder forð.
Þó was ên-dago · allaro manno
þes wísoston, · þero þe gio an þesa wer-old kwámi,
þero þe kwene ênig · kind gi·bári,
idis fan erle, · lét man simla þen ênon bi·foran,
þe þiu þiorne gi·dróg, · þe gio þegnes ni warð
wís an iro wer-oldi, · bi·útan só ine waldand god
fan heƀan-wange · hêlages gêstes
gi·markode mahtig: · þe ni habde ênigan gi·makon hwęrgin
êr nek aftar. · Erlos hwurƀun,
gumon umbi Johannen, · is jungaron managa,
sálig ge·sïðí, · ęndi ine an sande bi·gróƀun,
leobes lík-hamon: · wissun þat hé lioht godes,
diur-líkan drôm · mid is drohtine samad,
up-ôdas hêm · êgan móste,
sálig sókjan.

TODO.

**34** Þó ge·witun im þea ge·sïðos þanen,
Johannes jungaron · jámer-móde,
hêlag-ferąha: · was im iro hêrron dôð
swíðo an sorgun. · Ge·witun im sókjan þó
an þeru wóstunni · waldandes sunu,
kraftigana Krist · ęndi imu kûð gi·dedun
gódes mannes for·gang, · hwó habde þe Judeono kuning
manno þene márjostan · mákjas ęggjun
hôbdu bi·hauwan: · hé ni welde is ênigen harm spreken,
sunu drohtines; · hé wisse þat þiu seole was
hêlag gi·halden · wiðęr hęttjandjon,
an friðe wiðęr fiundun. · Þó só gi·frági warð
aftar þem land-skępjun · lêrjandero bętst
an þeru wóstunni: · werod samnode,
fór folkun tó: · was im firi-wit mikil
wísaro wordo; · imu was ôk willjo só samo,
sunje drohtines, · þat hé su-lík ge·sïðo folk

an þat lioht godes · laðojan mósti,
węnnjen mid willjon. · Waldand lêrde
allan langan dag · liudi managa,
ęli-þeodige man, · ant-tat an áƀand sêg
sunne te sedle. · Þó géngun is ge·síðos twe-libi,
gumon te þemu godes barne · ęndi sagdun iro gódumu hêrron,
mid hwi-líku arƀêdju þár þea erlos liƀdin, · kwáðun þat sie is êra bi·þorftin,
weros an þemu wóstjon lande: · „sie ni mugun sie hér mid wihti ant·hębbjen,
hęliðos bi hungres ge·þwinge. · Nú lát þú sie, hêrro þe gódo,
síðon, þár sie sęliða fíðen. · Náh sind hér ge·setana burgi
managa mid męgin-þiodun: · þár fíðad sie męti te kôpe,
weros aftar þem wíkjon.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist,
þioda drohtin, · kwað þat þes êniga þurufti ni wárin,
„þat sie þurh męti-lôsi · mína far·látan
leoƀ-líka lêra. · Geƀad gí þesun liudjun gi·nóg,
węnnjad sie hér mid willjon.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu
Philippus fród gumo, · kwað þat þár só filu wári
manno męnigi: · „þoh wí hér te męti habdin
garu im te geƀanne, · só wí mahtin far·gelden mêst,
ef wí hér gi·saldin · silųƀer-skatto
twê hund samad, · tweho wári is noh þan,
þat iro ênig þár · ênes gi·námi:
só luttik wári þat þesun liudjun.“ · Þó sprak eft þe landes ward
ęndi frágode sie · firi-wit-líko,
manno drohtin, · hwat sie þár te męti habdin
wistes ge·wunnin. · Þó sprak imu eft mid is wordun an·gęgin
Andreas fora þem erlun · ęndi þemu alo-waldon
selƀumu sagde, · þat sie an iro gi·síðje þan mêr
garowes ni habdin, · „bi·útan girstin brôd
fíƀi an ùsaru fęrdi · ęndi fiskos twêne.
Hwat mag þat þoh þesaru męnigi?“ · Þó sprak imu eft mahtig Krist,
þe gódo godes sunu, · ęndi hét þat gumono folk
skęrjen ęndi skêðen · ęndi hét þea skola sęttjen,
erlos aftar þeru erðu, · irmin-þioda
an grase gruonimu, · ęndi þó te is jungarun sprak,

allaro barno bętst, · hét imu þiu brôd halon
ęndi þea fiskos forð. · Þat folk stillo bêd,
sat ge·sîði mikil; · undar þiu hé þurh is selbes kraft,
manno drohtin, · þene męti wihide,
hêlag heban-kuning, · ęndi mid is handun brak,
gaf it is jungarun forð, · ęndi it sie undar þemu gum-skępje hét
dragan ęndi dêljen. · Sie lêstun iro drohtines word,
is geƀa gerno · drógun gumono gi·hwemu,
hêlaga helpa. · It undar iro handun wóhs,
męti manno gi·hwemu: · þeru męgin-þiodu warð
líf an lustun, · þea liudi wurðun alle,
sade sálig folk, · só hwat só þár gi·samnod was
fan allun wídun wegun. · Þó hét waldand Krist
gangen is jungaron · ęndi hét sie gômjen wel,
þat þiu léƀa þár · far·loren ni wurði;
hét sie þó samnon, · þó þár sade wárun
man-kunnjes manag. · Þár móses warð,
brôdes te léƀu, · þat man birilos gi·las
twe-libi fulle: · þat was têkạn mikil,
grôt kraft godes, · hwand þár was gumono gi·tald
áno wíf ęndi kind, · werodes at·samme
fíf þúsundig. · Þat folk al far·stód,
þea man an iro móde, · þat sie þár mahtigna
hêrron habdun. · Þó sie heban-kuning,
þea liudi lobodun, · kwáðun þat gio ni wurði an þit lioht kuman
wísaro wár-sago, · efƀa þat hé gi·wald mid gode
an þesaru middil-gard · méron habdi,
ên-faldaran hugi. · Alle gi·sprákun,
þat hé wári wirðig · welono ge·hwi-líkes,
þat hé erð-ríki · êgan mósti,
wídene wer-old-stól, · „nú hé su-lík ge·wit haƀad,
só grôte kraft mid gode.“ · Þea gumon alle gi·warð,
þat sie ine gi·hóƀin · te hêrosten,
gi·kurin ine te kuninge: · þat Kriste ni was
wihtes wirðig, · hwand hé þit wer-old-ríki,
erðe ęndi up-himil · þurh is ênes kraft
selƀo gi·warhte · ęndi síðor gi·held,

land ęndi liud-skępi, · —þoh þes ênigan gi·lôbon ni dedin
wrêðe wiðęr-sakon— · þat al an is gi·walde stád,
kuning-ríkjo kraft · ęndi kêsur-dómes,
męgin-þiodo mahal. · Be·þiu ni welde hé þurh þero manno spráka
hębbjan ênigan hêr-dóm, · hêlag drohtin,
wer-old-kuninges namon; · ni hé þó mid wordun stríd
ni af·hóf wið þat folk furður, · ak fór imu þó, þár hé welde,
an ên ge·birgi uppan: · flóh þat barn godes
gêlaro gelp-kwidi · ęndi is jungaron hét
obar ênne sêo sïðon · ęndi im selbo gi·bôd,
hwár sie im eft te·gęgnes · gangen skoldin.

TODO.

**35** Þó te·lét þat liud-werod · aftar þemu lande allumu,
te·fór folk mikil, · sïðor iro frâho gi·wêt
an þat ge·birgi uppan, · barno ríkjost,
waldand an is willjon. · Þó te þes watares staðe
samnodun þea ge·sïðos Kristes, · þe hé imu habde selbo gi·korane,
sie twe-libi þurh iro treuwa góda: · ni was im tweho nigijan,
nebu sie an þat godes þionost · gerno weldin
obar þene sêo sïðon. · Þó létun sie swíðjan strôm,
hôh-hurnid skip · hluttron úðjon,
skêðan skír water. · Skrêd lioht dages,
sunne warð an sedle; · þe sêo-líðandjan
naht nebulo bi·warp; · náðidun erlos
forð-wardes an flód; · warð þiu fiorðe tíd
þera nahtes kuman · —nęrjendo Krist
warode þea wág-líðand—: · þó warð wind mikil,
hôh wedęr af·haben: · hlamodun úðjon,
strôm an stamne; · strídjun fęridun
þea weros wiðęr winde, · was im wrêð hugi,
sebo sorgono ful: · selbon ni wándun
lagu-líðandja · an land kumen
þurh þes wederes ge·win. · Þó gi·sáhun sie waldand Krist
an þemu sêe uppan · selbun gangan,
faran an fáðjon: · ni mahte an þene flód innan,
an þene sêo sinkan, · hwand ine is selbes kraft

hêlag ant·habde. · Hugi warð an forhtun,
þero manno mód-sebo: · an·drédun þat it im mahtig fiund
te gi·droge dádi. · Þó sprak im iro drohtin tó,
hêlag heƀan-kuning, · ęndi sagde im þat hé iro hêrro was
mári ęndi mahtig: · „nú gí módes skulun
fastes fâhen; · ne sí iu forht hugi,
gi·bárjad gí bald-líko: · ik bium þat barn godes,
is selƀes sunu, · þe iu wið þesumu sêe skal,
mundon wið þesan męri-strôm.“ · Þó sprak imu ên þero
manno an·gęgin
obar bord skipes, · bar-wirðig gumo,
Petrus þe gódo · —ni welde píne þolon,
watares wíti—: · „ef þú it waldand sís“, kwað hé,
„hêrro þe gódo, · só mí an mínumu hugi þunkit,
hêt mí þan þarod gangan te þí · obar þesen gebenes strôm,
drokno obar diap water, · ef þú mín drohtin sís,
managoro mund-boro.“ · Þó hét ine mahtig Krist
gangan imu te·gęgnes. · Hé warð garu sáno,
stôp af þemu stamne · ęndi strídjun géng
forð te is frôjan. · Þiu flód ant·habde
þene man þurh maht godes, · ant-tat hé imu an is móde bi·gan
an·dráden diap water, · þó hé dríƀen gi·sah
þene wég mid windu: · wundun ina ûðjon,
hôh strôm umbi·hring. · Reht só hé þó an is hugi twehode,
só wêk imu þat water under, · ęndi hé an þene wág innan,
sank an þene sêo-strôm, · ęndi hé hriop sán aftar þiu
gáhon te þemu godes sunje · ęndi gerno bad,
þat hé ine þó ge·nęridi, · þó hé an nôdjun was,
þegan an ge·þwinge. · Þiodo drohtin
ant·féng ine mid is faðmun · ęndi frágode sána,
te hwí hé þó ge·twehodi: · „Hwat þú mahtes ge·trúojan wel,
witen þat te wárun, · þat þi watares kraft
an þemu sêe innen · þínes síðes ni mahte,
lagu-strôm gi·lęttjen, · só lango só þú habdes ge·lôƀon te mí
an þínumu hugi hardo. · Nú willju ik þi an helpun wesen,
nęrjen þi an þesaru nôdi“. · Þó nam ine alo-mahtig,
hêlag bi handun: · þó warð imu eft hlutter water
fast under fótun, · ęndi sie an fáði samad
bêðja géngun, · ant-tat sie obar bord skipes

stópun fan þemu strôme, · ęndi an þemu stamne ge·sat
allaro barno bętst. · Þó warð brêd water,
strômos ge·stillid, · ęndi sie te staðe kwámun,
lagu-líðandja · an land samen
þurh þes wateres ge·win, · sagdun þo waldande þank,
diurden iro drohtin · dádjun ęndi wordun,
fellun imu te fótun · ęndi filu sprákun
wísaro wordo, · kwáðun þat sie wissin garo,
þat hé wári selbo · sunu drohtines
wár an þesaru wer-oldi · ęndi ge·wald habdi
obar middil-gard, · ęndi þat hé mahti allaro manno gi·hwes
ferąhe gi·formon, · al só hé im an þemu flóde dede
wið þes watares ge·win.

TODO.

**36** Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist
siðon fan þemu sêe, · sunu drohtines,
ênag barn godes. · Ęli-þioda kwam imu,
gumon te·gęgnes: · wárun is gódun werk
ferran ge·frági, · þat hé só filu sagde
wároro wordo: · imu was willjo mikil,
þat hé su-lík folk-skępi · frummjen mósti,
þat sie simla gerno · gode þionodin,
wárin ge·hôrige · heþan-kuninge
man-kunnjes manag. · Þó gi·wêt hé imu ober þea marka Judeono,
sóhte imu Sidono burg, · habde ge·siðos mid imu,
góde jungaron. · Þár imu te·gęgnes kwam
ên idis fan áðrom þiodun; · siu was iru aðali-ge·burdjo,
kunnjes fan Kananeo lande; · siu bad þene kraftagan drohtin,
hêlagna, þat hé iru helpe ge·rédi, · kwað þat iru wári harm gi·standen,
soroga at iru selbaru dohter, · kwað þat siu wári mid suhtjun bi·fangen:
„be·drogan habbjad sie dęrnja wihti. · Nú is iro dôd at hęndi,
þea wrêðon habbjad sie ge·wittju be·numane. · Nú biddju ik þi, waldand frô min,
selbo sunu Dawides, · þat sie af su-líkum suhtjun a·tómjes,
þat þú sie só arma · ê-gróht-fullo

wam-skaðon bi·weri.“ · Ni gaf iru þó noh waldand Krist
ênig and-wordi; · siu imu aftar géng,
folgode fruokno, · ant-tat siu te is fótun kwam,
grótte ina greatandi. · Jungaron Kristes
bádun iro hêrron, · þat hé an is hugja mildi
wurði þemu wíbe. · Þó habde eft is word garu
sunu drohtines · ęndi te is ge·síðun sprak:
„êrist skal ik Israheles · aþoron werðen,
folk-skępi te frumu, · þat sie ferhtan hugi
hębbjan te iro hêrron: · im is helpono þarf,
þea liudi sind far·lorane, · far·láten habbjad
waldandes word, · þat werod is ge·twíflid,
dríbad im dęrnjan hugi, · ne willjad iro drohtine hôrjen
Israhelo erl-skępi, · un-gi·lôbiga sind
hęliðos iro hêrron: · þoh skal þanen helpe kumen
allun ęli-þiodun.“ · Agalêto bad
þat wíf mid iro wordun, · þat iru waldand Krist
an is mód-seþon · mildi wurði,
þat siu iro barnes forð · brúkan mósti,
hębbjan sie hêle. · Þó sprak iru hêrro an·gęgin,
mári ęndi mahtig: · „nis þat“, kwað hé, „mannes reht,
gumono nig·ênum · gód te gi·frummjenne
þat hé is barnun · brôdes af·tíhe,
węrnje im oþar willjon, · láte sie wíti þoljan,
hungar hęti-grimmen, · ęndi fódje is hundos mid þiu.“
„Wár is þat, waldand“, (kwað siu,) „þat þú mid þínun wordun sprikis,
sóð-líko sagis: · Hwat þoh oft an sęli innen
undar iro hêrron diske · hwelpos hwerþad
brosmono fulle · þero fan þemu biode niðer
ant·fallat iro frôjan.“ · Þó gi·hôrde þat friðu-barn godes
willjan þes wíbes · ęndi sprak iru mid is wordun tó:
„wela þat þú wíf haþes · willjan góden!
Mikil is þín gi·lôbo · an þea maht godes,
an þene liudjo drohtin. · Al wirðid gi·lêstid só
umbi þínes barnes líf, · só þú bádi te mí.“
Þó warð siu sán gi·hêlid, · só it þe hêlago ge·sprak
wordun wár-fastun: · þat wíf fagonode,
þes siu iro barnes forð · brúkan móste;

habde iru gi·holpen · hêljando Krist,
habde sie far·fangane · fiundo kraftu,
wam-skaðun bi·węrid. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand forð,
barno þat bętste, · sóhte imu burg óðre,
þiu só þikko was · mid þeru þiodu Judeono,
mid sûðar-liudjun gi·seten. · Þár gi·fragn ik þat hé is ge·síðos grótte,
þe jungaron þe hé imu habde be is góde gi·korane, · þat sie mid imu gerno ge·wunodun,
weros þurh is wíson spráka: · „alle skal ik iu“, kwað hé, „mid wordun frágon,
jungaron míne: · hwat kweðat þese Judeo liudi,
mári męgin-þioda, · hwat ik manno sí?“
Imu and-wordidun frô-líko · is friund an·gęgin,
jungaron síne: · „nis þit Judeono folk,
erlos ên-wordje: · sum sagad þat þú Elias sís,
wís wár-sago, · þe hér giu was lango,
gód undar þesumu gum-skępje, · sum sagad þat þú Johannes sís,
diur-lík drohtines bodo, · þe hér dôpte iu
werod an watere; · alle sie mid wordun sprekad,
þat þú ên-hwi-lík sís · ęðilero manno,
þero wár-sagono, · þe hér mid wordun giu
lêrdun þese liudi, · ęndi þat þú sís eft an þit lioht kumen
te wísjanne þesumu werode.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist:
„Hwe kweðad gí, þat ik sí“, (kwað hé,) „jungaron míne,
liobon liud-weros?“ · Þó te lat ni warð
Símon Petrus: · sprak sán an·gęgin
êno for im allun · —habde imu ęlljen gód,
þrístja gi·þáhti, · was is þeodone hold—:

TODO.

**37** „Þú bist þe wáro · waldandes sunu,
libbjendes godes, · þe þit lioht gi·skóp,
Krist kuning êwig: · só willjad wí kweðen alle,
jungaron þíne, · þat þú sís god selbo,
hêljandero bętst.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro an·gęgin:
„Sálig bist þú Símon“, kwað hé, „sunu Jonases; · ni mahtes þú þat selbo ge·huggjan,

gi·markon an þínun mód-gi·þáhtjun, · ne it ni mahte þí mannes tunge
wordun ge·wísjen, · ak dede it þí waldand selbo,
fader allaro firiho barno, · þat þú só forð gi·spráki,
só diapo bi drohtin þínen. · Diur-líko skalt þú þes lôn ant·fáhen,
hluttro habas þú an þínan hêrron gi·lôbon, · hugi-skęfti sind þíne stêne ge·líka,
só fast bist þú só felis þe hardo; · hêten skulun þí firiho barn
Sankte Péter: · obar þemu stêne skal man mínen sęli wirkjan,
hêlag hús godes; · þár skal is híwiski tó
sálig samnon: · ni mugun wið þem þínun swíðjun krafte
an·þebbjen hęllje portun. · Ik far·giþu þí himil-ríkjas slutilas,
þat þú móst aftar mí · allun gi·waldan
kristinum folke; · kumad alle te þí
gumono gêstos; · þú habe grôte gi·wald,
hwene þú hér an erðu · ęldi-barno
ge·binden willjes: · þemu is bêðju gi·duan,
himil-ríki bi·loken, · ęndi hęllje sind imu opana,
brinnandi fiur; · só hwene só þú eft ant·binden wili,
an·þęftjen is hęndi, · þemu is himil-ríki,
ant·loken liohto mêst · ęndi líf êwig,
gróni godes wang. · Mid su-líkaru ik þi gebu willju
lônon þínen gi·lôbon. · Ni willju ik, þat gí þesun liudjun noh,
márjen þesaru męnigi, · þat ik bium mahtig Krist,
godes êgan barn. · Mí skulun Judeon noh,
un-skuldigna · erlos binden,
wêgjan mí te wundrun · —dót mí wítjes filo—
innan Jerusalem · gêres ordun,
áhtjen mínes aldres · ęggjun skarpun,
bi·lôsjen mí líbu. · Ik an þesumu liohte skal
þurh ùses drohtines kraft · fan dôde a·standen
an þriddjumu dage“. · Þó warð þegno bętst
swíðo an sorgun, · Símon Petrus,
warð imu hugi hriuwig, · ęndi te is hêrron sprak
rink an rúnun: · „ni skal þat ríki god“, kwað hé,
„waldand willjen, · þat þú eo su-lík wíti mikil
gi·þolos undar þesaru þiod: · nis þes þarf nigijan,
hêlag drohtin.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro an·gęgin,

mári mahtig Krist · —was imu an is móde hold—:
„Hwat þú nú wiðęr·ward bist“, (kwað hé,) „willjon mínes,
þegno bętsto! · Hwat þú þesaro þiodo kanst
męnniskan sidu: · þú ni wêst þe maht godes,
þe ik gi·frummjen skal. · Ik mag þi filu sęggjan
wárun wordun, · þár hér undar þesumu werode standad
ge·síðos míne, · þea ni mótun swelten êr,
hwerþen an hinen-fard · êr sie himiles lioht,
godes ríki sehat.“ · Kôs imu jungarono þó
sán aftar þiu · Símon Petrus,
Jakob ęndi Johannes, · ea gumon twêne,
bêðja þea gi·bróðer, · ęndi imu þó uppen þene berg gi·wêt
sunder mid þem ge·síðun, · sálig barn godes,
mid þem þegnun þrim, · þiodo drohtin,
waldand þesaro wer-oldes: · welde im þár wundres filu,
têkno tôgjan, · þat sie gi·trúodin þiu bęt,
þat hé selbo was · sunu drohtines,
hêlag heþan-kuning. · Þó sie an hôhan wall
stigun stên ęndi berg, · ant-tat sie te þeru stędi kwámun,
weros wiðęr wolkąn, · þár waldand Krist,
kuningo kraftigost · gi·koren habde,
þat hé is god-kundi · jungarun sínun
þurh is ênes kraft · ógjan welde,
berht-lík biliði.

“Thou art the true son of the Wielder,
of the Living God who created this Light,
O Christ, king everlasting. Thus we all wish to say,
we thy disciples, that thou art God alone,
the best of Saviours.” Then his Lord spoke back, facing him:
“Blessed art thou, Simon”, quoth he, “the son of John. Thou couldst not by thyself have thought that,
devised it in the thoughts of thy heart, nor could any man’s tongue
have shown thee those words, but the Wielder Himself did it for thee,
the father of all children of men, that thou didst speak forth such things,
so deeply by thy Lord. Dearly shalt thou have rewards for that;
thou hast trusted splendidly in thy Lord; the state of thy mind is like stone;
thou art as fast as the hard mountain. Thou shalt be called by the children of men
Saint Peter. Over this stone shall men build my hall,
the holy house of God. TODO.”.

3062–3068 „Sálig … hardo | Ll. 3062a–3063b, 3064b–3068a are hypermetric (Suzuki 2004, pp. 424–425).

3122[b] **38** Þó imu þár te bedu gi·hnêg,
þó warð imu þár uppe · ôðar-líkora
3124 wliti ęndi gi·wádi: · wurðun imu is wangun liohte,
blíkandi só þiu berhte sunne: · só skên þat barn godes,
3126 liuhte is lík-hamo: · liomon stódun
wánamo fan þemu waldandes barne; · warð is ge·wádi só hwít
3128 só snêw te sehanne. · Þó warð þár seld-lík þing
gi·ôgid aftar þiu: · Elias ęndi Moyses
3130 kwámun þár te Kriste · wið só kraftagne
wordun wehsljan. · Þár warð só wun-sam spráka,
3132 só gód word undar gumun, · þár þe godes sunu
wið þea márjan man · mahljen welde,
3134 só blíði warð uppan þemu berge: · skên þat berhte lioht,
was þár gard gód-lík · ęndi gróni wang,
3136 Paradíse ge·lík. · Petrus þó gi·mahạlde,
hęlið hard-módig · ęndi te is hêrron sprak,
3138 grótte þene godes sunu: · „gód is it hér te wesanne,
ef þú it gi·kiosan wili, · Krist alo-waldo,
3140 þat man þí hér an þesaru hôhe · ên hús ge·wirkja,
már-líko ge·mako · ęndi Moysese ôðer
3142 ęndi Eliase þriddja: · þit is ôdas hêm,
welono wun-samost.“ · Reht só hé þó þat word ge·sprak,
3144 só ti·lét þiu luft an twê: · lioht wolkạn skên,
glítandi glímo, · ęndi þea gódun man
3146 wliti-skôni be·warp. · Þó fan þemu wolkne kwam
hêlag stemne godes, · ęndi þem hęliðun þár
3148 selbo sagde, · þat þat is sunu wári,
libbjendero liobost: · „an þemu mí líkod wel
3150 an mínun hugi-skęftjun. · Þemu gí hôrjen skulun,
ful·gangad imu gerno.“ · Þó ni mahtun þea jungaron Kristes
3152 þes wolknes wliti · ęndi word godes,
þea is mikilon maht · þea man ant·standen,
3154 ak sie bi·fellun þó forð-wardes: · ferhes ni wándun,
lęngiron líbes. · Þó géng im tó þe landes ward,
3156 be·hrên sie mid is handun · hêljandero bętst,
hét þat sie im ni an·drédin: · „ni skal iu hér derjen eo·wiht,

þes gí hér seld-líkes · gi·sehen habbjad,
mérjaro þingo.“ · Þó eft þem mannun warð
hugi at iro herton · ęndi gi·hêlid mód,
gi·bade an iro breostun: · gi·sáhun þat barn godes
ênna standen, · was þat óðer þó,
be·hliden himiles lioht. · Þó gi·wêt imu þe hêlago Krist
fan þemu berge niðer; · gi·bôd aftar þiu
jungarun sínun, · þat sie obar Judeono folk
ni sagdin þea gi·sioni: · „er þan ik selbo hér
swíðo diur-líko · fan dôðe a·stande,
a·ríse fan þeru ręstu: · sïðor mugun gí it rękkjen forð,
márjen obar middil-gard · managun þiodun
wído aftar þesaru wer-oldi.“

TODO.

**39** Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist
eft an Galileo land, · sóhte is gadulingos,
mahtig is mágo hêm, · sagde þár manages hwat
berhtero biliðjo, · ęndi þat barn godes
þem is sáligun ge·sïðun · sorg-spell ni for·hal,
ak hé im open-líko · allun sagde,
þem is gódun jungarun, · hwó ine skolde þat Judeono folk
wêgjan te wundrun. · Þes wurðun þár wise man
swíðo an sorgun, · warð im sêr hugi,
hriuwig umbi iro herte: · gi·hôrdun iro hêrron þó,
waldandes sunu · wordun tęlljen,
hwat hé undar þeru þiodu · þolojan skolde,
willjendi undar þemu werode. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist,
gumo fan Galilea, · sóhte imu Judeono burg,
kwámun im te Kafarnaum. · Þár fundun sie ênan kuninges þegạn
wlankan undar þemu werode: · kwað þat hé wári gi·węldig bodo
aðal-kêsures; · hé grótte aftar þiu
Símon Petrusen, · kwað þat hé wári gi·sęndid þarod,
þat hé þár gi·manodi · manno ge·hwi-líken
þero hôbid-skatto, · þe sie te þemu hobe skoldin
tinsi gelden: · „nis þes tweho ênig
gumono ni-gj·ênumu, · ne sie ina far·gelden sán

mêðmo kustjon, · bi·úten iuwe mêster êno
haƀad it far·láten. · Ni skal þat líkon wel
mínumu hêrron, · só man it imu at is hobe kùðid,
aðal-kêsure.“ · Þó géng aftar þiu
Símon Petrus, · welde it sęggjan þó
hêrron sínumu: · hé was is an is hugi iu þan,
gi·waro waldand Krist: · —imu ni mahte word ênig
bi·holen werðen, · hé wisse hugi-skęfti
manno ge·hwi-líkes—: · hét þó þene is márjan þegạn,
Símon Petrus · an þene sêo innen
angul werpen: · „su-líken só þú þár êrist mugis
fisk gi·fâhen“, (kwað hé,) „só teoh þú þene fan þemu flóde te þi,
ant·klęmmi imu þea kinni: · þár maht þú undar þem kaflon nimen
guldine skattos, · þat þú far·gelden maht
þemu manne te gi·módja · mínen ęndi þínen
tinsjo só hwi-líkan, · só hé ùs tó sókid.“
Hé ni þorfte imu þó aftar þiu · òðaru wordu
furður gi·bioden: · géng fiskari gód,
Símon Petrus, · warp an þene sêo innen
angul an ùðjon · ęndi up gi·tôh
fisk an flóde · mid is folmun twêm,
te·klóf imu þea kinni · ęndi undar þem kaflun nam
guldine skattos: · dede al, só imu þe godes sunu
wordun ge·wísde. · Þár was þó waldandes
męgin-kraft gi·márid, · hwó skal allaro manno ge·hwi-lík
swíðo willjendi · is wer-old-hêrron
skuldi ęndi skattos, · þea imu gi·skęride sind,
gerno gelden: · ni skal ine far·gúmon eo·wiht,
ni far·muni ine an is móde, · ak wese imu mildi an is hugi,
þiono imu þio-líko: · an þiu mag hé þiod-godes
willjan ge·wirkjan · ęndi ôk is wer-old-hêrron
huldi habbjen.

TODO.

**40** Só lêrde þe hêlago Krist
þea is gódon jungaron: · „ef ênig gumono wið iu“, kwað hé,
„sundja ge·wirkja, · þan nim þú ina sundạr te þi,
þene rink an rúna · ęndi imu is rád saga,

wísi imu mid wordun. · Ef imu þan þes werð ne sí,
þat hé þí gi·hôrje, · hala þí þár ôðara tó
gódaro gumono, · ęndi lah imu is grimmun werk,
sak ina sôð-wordun. · Ef imu þan is sundja aftar þiu,
lôs-werk ni lêðon, · gi·duo it ôðrun liudjun kúð,
mári it þan for męnegi · ęndi lát manno filu
witen is far·wurhti: · ôðo be·ginnad imu þan is werk tregan,
an is hugi hreuwen, · þan hé it gi·hôrid hęliðo filu,
ahton ęldi-barn · ęndi imu is ubilon dád
węrjad mid wordun. · Ef hé þan ôk węndjen ne wili,
ak far·módat su-líka męnegi, · þan lát þú þene man faren,
haba ina þan far hêðinen · ęndi lát ina þi an þínumu hugi lêðen,
míð is an þínumu móde, · ne sí þat imu eft mildi god,
hêr heban-kuning · helpe far·líhe,
fader allaro firiho barno.“ · Þó frágode Petrus,
allaro þegno bętst · þeodan sínan:
„hwó oft skal ik þem mannun, · þe wið mí habbjad
lêð-werk gi·duan, · leobo drohtin,
skal ik im siþun síðun · iro sundja a·láten,
wrêðaro werko, · êr þan ik is êniga wréka frummje,
lêðes te lône?“ · Þó sprak eft þe landes ward,
an·gęgin þe godes sunu · gódumu þegne:
„ni sęggju ik þi fan siþunjun, · só þú selbo sprikis,
mahlis mid þínu múðu, · ik duom þi mêra þár tó:
siþun síðun siþun-tig · só skalt þú sundja ge·hwemu,
lêðes a·láten: · só willju ik þi te lêrun geben
wordun wár-fastun. · Nú ik þí su-líka gi·wald far·gaf,
þat þú mínes híwiskes · hêrost wáris,
manages mann-kunnjes, · nú skalt þú im mildi wesen,
liudjun líði.“ · Þó þár te þemu lêrjande kwam
ên jung man an·gęgin · ęndi frágode Jesu Krist:
„mêster þe gódo“, (kwað hé,) „hwat skal ik manages duan,
an þiu þe ik heban-ríki · ge·halan móti?“
Habde imu ôd-welon · allen ge·wunnen,
mêðọm-hord manag, · þoh hé mildjan hugi
bári an is breostun. · Þó sprak imu þat barn godes:
„hwat kwiðis þú umbi gódon? · nis þat gumono ênig
bi·útan þe êno, · þe þár al ge·skóp,

wer-old ęndi wunnja. · Ef þú is willjan haƀas,
þat þú an lioht godes · líðan mótis,
þan skalt þú bi·halden · þea hêlagon lêra,
þe þár an þemu aldon · êwa ge·biudid,
þat þú man ni slah, · ni þú mênes ni sweri,
far·legar-nessi far·lát · ęndi luggi ge·wit-skępi,
stríd ęndi stulina; · ne wis þú te stark an hugi,
ne níðin ne hatul, · ni nôd-róf ni frępmi;
aƀ-unst alla far·lát; · wis þínun ęldirun gód,
fader ęndi móder, · ęndi þínun friundun hold,
þem náhistun gi·náðig. · Þan þú þi gi·niodon móst
himilo ríkjas, · ef þú it bi·halden wili,
ful-gangan godes lêrun.“ · Þó sprak eft þe jungo man
„al hębbju ik só gi·lêstid“, (kwað hé,) „só þú mí lêris nú,
wordun wísis, · só ik is eo wiht ni far·lét
fan mínero kindiski.“ · Þó bi·gan ina Krist sehan
an mid is ôgun: · „ên is þár noh nú“, kwað hé,
„wan þero werko: · ef þú is willjon haƀas,
þat þú þurh-frępmid · þionon mótis
hêrron þínumu, · þan skalt þú þat þín hord nimen,
skalt þínan ôd-welon · allan far·kôpjen,
diurje mêðmos, · ęndi dêljen hét
armun mannun: · þan haƀas þú aftar þiu
hord an himile; · kum þi þan gi·halden te mí,
folgo þi mínaro fęrdi: · þan haƀas þú friðu sîður.“
Þó wurðun Kristes word · kind-jungumu manne
swíðo an sorgun, · was imu sêr hugi,
mód umbi herte: · habde mêðmo filu,
welono ge·wunnen; · węnde imu eft þanen,
was imu un-ôðo · innan breostun,
an is seƀon swáro. · Sah imu aftar þó
Krist alo-waldo, · kwað it þó, þár hé welde,
te þem is jungarun gęgin-wardun, · þat wári an godes ríki
un-óði ôdagumu manne · up te kumanne:
„ôður mag man olƀundjon, · þoh hé sí un-met grôt,
þurh náðlan gat, · þoh it sí naru swíðo,
sáftur þurh·slópjen, · þan mugi kuman þiu siole te himile
þes ôdagan mannes, · þe hér al haƀad
gi·węndid an þene wer-old-skat · willjon sínen,

mód-gi·þáhti, · ęndi ni hugid umbi þie maht godes.“

TODO.

**41**

Imu and-wordjade · êr-þungan gumo,
Símon Petrus, · ęndi sęggjan bad
leoban hêrron: · „Hwat skulun wí þes te lône nimen“, kwað hé,
„gódes te gelde, · þes wí þurh þín jungar-dóm
êgan ęndi ęrbi · al far·létun
hobos ęndi híwiski · ęndi þi te hêrron gi·kurun,
folgodun þínaru fęrdi: · hwat skal ùs þes te frumu werðen,
langes te lône?“ · Liudjo drohtin
sagde im þó selbo: · „Þan ik sittjen kumu“, kwað hé,
„an þie mikilan maht · an þemu márjan dage,
þár ik allun skal · irmin-þiodun
dómos a·dêljen, · þan mótun gí mid iuwomu drohtine þár
selbon sittjen · ęndi mótun þera saka waldan:
mótun gí Israhelo · ęðili-folkun
a·dêljen aftar iro dádjun: · só mótun gí þár gi·diuride wesen.
Þan sęggju ik iu te wáran: · só hwe só þat an þesaru wer-oldi gi·duot,
þat hé þurh mína minnja · mágo ge·sidli
liof far·létid, · þes skal hí hér lôn niman
tehan sîðun tehin-fald, · ef hé it mid treuwon duot,
mid hluttru hugi. · Obar þat habad hé ôk himiles lioht,
open êwig líf.“ · Bi·gan imu þó aftar þiu
allaro barno bętst · ên biliði sęggjan,
kwað þat þár ên ôdag man · an êr-dagun
wári undar þemu werode: · þe habde welono ge·nóg,
sinkas gi·samnod · ęndi imu simlun was
garu mid goldu · ęndi mid godo-wębbju,
fagarun fratahun · ęndi imu so filu habde
gódes an is gardun · ęndi imu at gômun sat
allaro dago ge·hwi-líkes: · habde imu diur-lík líf,
blíðsja an is bęnkjun. · Þan was þár eft ên biddjendi man,
gi·léþod an is lík-hamon, · Lazarus was hé hêten,
lag imu dago ge·hwi-líkes · at þem durun foren,
þár hé þene ôdagan man · inne wisse
an is gęst-sęli · gôme þiggjan,

sittjen at sumble, · ęndi hé simlun bêd
gi·armod þár úte: · ni móste þár in kuman,
ne hé ni mahte ge·biddjen, · þat man imu þes brôdes þarod
gi·dragan weldi, · þes þár fan þemu diske niðer
ant·fel undar iro fóti: · ni mahte imu þár ênig fruma werðen
fan þemu hêroston, þe þes húses gi·wéld, · bi·útan þat þár
géngun is hundos tó,
likkodun is lík-wundon, · þár hé liggjandi
hungaṛ þolode; · ni kwam imu þár te helpu wiht
fan þemu ríkjon manne. · Þó gi·fragn ik þat ina is regano
gi·skapu,
þene armon man · is ên-dago
gi·manoda mahtjun swíð, · þat hé manno drôm
a·geben skolde. · Godes ęngilos
ant·féngun is ferh · ęndi lêddun ine forð þanen,
þat sie an Abrahames barm · þes armon mannes
siole gi·sęttun: · þár móste hé simlun forð
wesen an wunnjun. · Þó kwámun ôk wurde-gi·skapu,
þemu ôdagan man · or-lag-hwíle,
þat hé þit lioht far·lét: · lêða wihti
be·sinkodun is siole · an þene swarton hęl,
an þat fern innen · fiundun te willjan,
be·gróbun ine an gramono hêm. · Þanen mahte hé þene
gódan skawon,
Abraham ge·sehen, · þár hé uppe was
líbes an lustun, · ęndi Lazarus sat
blíði an is barme, · berht lôn ant·féng
allaro is arm-ódjo, · ęndi lag þe ôdago man
hêto an þeru hęllju, · hriop up þanen:
„fader Abraham“, (kwað hé,) „mí is firinun þarf,
þat þú mí an þínumu mód-sebon · mildi werðes,
líði an þesaru lognu: · sęndi mí Lazarus herod,
þat hé mí ge·fórja · an þit fern innan
kaldes wateres. · Ik hér kwik brinnu
hêto an þesaru hęllju: · nú is mí þínaro helpono þarf,
þat hé mí a·lęskje · mid is luttikon fingru
tungon míne, · nú siu têkạn habad,
uƀil arƀêdi. · Inwid-rádo,
lêðaro spráka, · alles is mí nú þes lôn kumen.“

Imu and-wordjade þó Abraham · —þat was ald-fader—:
„ge·hugi þú an þínumu herton“, (kwað hé,) „hwat þú habdes iu
welono an wer-oldi. · Hwat þú þár alle þíne wunnja far·sliti,
gódes an gardun, · só hwat só þi gibiðig forð
werðen skolde. · Wíti þolode
Lazarus an þemu liohte, · habde þár lêðes filu,
wítjas an wer-oldi. · Be·þiu skal hé nú welon êgan,
libbjen an lustun: · þú skalt þea logna þolan,
brinnendi fiur: · ni mag is þi ênig bóte kumen
hinana te hęllju: · it habad þe hêlago god
só gi·fastnod mid is faðmun: · ni mag þár faren ênig
þegno þurh þat þiustri: · it is hér só þikki undar ùs.“
Þó sprak eft Abrahame · þe erl te·gęgnes
fan þeru hêtan hęll · ęndi helpono bad,
þat hé Lazarus · an liudjo drôm
selbon sandi: · „þat hé ge·seggja þár
bróðarun mínun, · hwó ik hér brinnendi
þrá-werk þolon; · si þár undar þeru þiodu sind,
si fíbi undar þemu folke: · ik an forhtun bium,
þat sie im þár far·wirkjen, · þat sie skulin ôk an þit wíti te mí,
an só grádag fiur.“ · Þó imu eft te·gęgnes sprak
Abraham ald-fader, · kwað þat sie þár êo godes
an þemu land-skępi, · liudi habdin,
Moyseses gi·bôd · ęndi þár managaro tó
wár-saguno word: · „ef sie is willige sind,
þat sie þat bi·halden, · þan ni þurbun sie an þea hęll innen,
an þat fern faren, · ef sie ge·frummjad só,
só þea ge·biodad, · þe þea bók lesat
þem liudjun te lêrun. · Ef sie þes þan ni willjad lêstjen wiht,
þanne ni hôrjad sie ôk · þemu þe hinan a·stád,
man fan dôðe. · Láte man sie an iro mód-sebon
selbon keosen, · hweðer im swótjera þunkje
te gi·winnanne, · só lango só sie an þesaru wer-oldi sind,
þat sie eft ubil eþþa gód · aftar habbjen.“

TODO.

**42** Só lêrde hé þó þea liudi · liohton wordon,
allaro barno bętst, · ęndi biliði sagde
manag man-kunnje · mahtig drohtin,

kwað þat imu ên sálig gumo · samnon bi·gunni
man an morgen, · „ęndi im méda gi·hét,
þe hêrosto þes híwiskjas, · swíðo *hold-lík lôn“,
kwað þat hie iro allaro gi·hwem · ênna gábi
siloþrinna skat. · „Þuo samnodun managa
weros an is wín-gardon, · —ęndi hie im werk bi·falaḥ—
ádro an úhtan. · Sum kwam þár ôk an undorn tuo,
sum kwam þár an middjan dag, · man te þem werke,
sum kwam þár te nónu, · þuo was þiu niguða tíd
sumar-langes dages; · sum þár ôk síðor kwam
an þia ęlliftun tíd. · Þuo géng þár áband tuo,
sunna ti sedle. · Þuo hie selbo gi·bôd
is ambahtjon, · erlo drohtin,
þat man þero manno gi·hwem · is meoda for·guldi,
þem erlon arbid-lôn; · hiet þiem at êrist geban.
þia þár at lętst wárun, · liudi kumana,
weros te þem werke, · ęndi mid is wordon gi·bôd,
þat man þem mannon iro · mieda for·guldi
alles at aftan, · þem þár kwámun at êrist tuo
willendi te þem werke. · Wándun sia swíðo,
þat man im mêra lôn · gi·makod habdi
wið iro arąbedje: · þan man im allon gaf,
þem liudjon gi·líko. · Lêð was þat swíðo,
allon þem ando, · þem þár kwámun at êrist tuo:
„wí kwámun hier an morągan“, (kwáðun sia,) „ęndi þolodun hier manag te dage
arąbid-werko, · hwílon un-met hét,
skínandja sunna: · nú ni gibis þú ùs skattes þan mêr,
þie þú þem óðron duos, · þia hier êna hwíla
wáron an þínon werke.“ · Þuo habda eft is word garo
þie hêrosto þes híwiskes, · kwað þat hie im ni habdi gi·hêtan þan mêr
werðes wið iro werke: · „Hwat ik gi·wald hębbju“, kwaþ-hie,
„þat ik iu allon gi·líko · muot lôn for·geldan,
iuwes werkes werð.“ · Þan waldandi Krist
mênda im þoh méra þing, · þoh hie obar þat manno folk
fan þem wín-gardon só · wordon spráki,
hwó þár un-efno · erlos kwámun,
weros te þem werke. · Só skulun fan þero wer-oldi duon

mann-kunnjes barn · an þat márjo lioht,
gumon an godes wang: · sum bi·ginnit ina giriwan sán
an is kindiski, · habit im gi·koranan muod,
willjon guodan, · wer-old-saka míðit,
far·látit is lusta; · ni mag ina is lík-hamo
an un·spuod for·spanan: · spáhiða línot,
godes êw, · gramono for·látit,
wrêðaro willjon, · duot im só te is wer-oldi forð,
lêstit só an þeson liohte, · ant-þat im is líbes kumit,
aldres áband; · gi·wítit im þan up-wegos:
þár wirðit im is arąbedi · all gi·lônot,
far·goldan mid guodu · an godes ríkje.
Þat mêndun þia wuruhtjon, · þia an þem wín-gardon
ádro an úhta · arbid-líko
werk bi·gunnun · ęndi þuru·wonodun forð,
erlos unt áband. · Sum þár ôk an undern kwam,
habda þuo far·męrrid, · þia morągan-stunda
þes dag-werkes for·duolon; · só duot doloro filo,
gi·mêdaro manno: · dríbit im mis-lík þing
gerno an is juguði, · —habit im gelp-kwidi
lêða gi·línot · ęndi lôs-word manag—,
ant-þat is kindiski · far·kuman wirðit,
þat ina after is juguði · godes anst manot
blíði an is brioston; · fâhit im te bęteron þan
wordon ęndi werkon, · lêdit im is wer-old mid þiu,
is aldar ant þena ęndi: · kumit im alles lôn
an godes ríkje, · gódaro werko.
Sum mann þan mid-firi · mên far·látid,
swára sundjun, · fâhit im an sálig þing,
bi·ginnit im þuru godes kraft · guodaro werko,
buotit balo-spráka, · látit im is bittrun dád
an is hugje hreuwan; · kumit im þiu helpa fon gode,
þat im gi·lêstid þie gi·lôbo, · só langa só im is líf warod;
farit im forð mid þiu, · ant·fâhit is mieda,
guod lôn at gode; · ni sindun êniga geba bęteran.
Sum bi·ginnit þan ôk furðor, · þan hie ist fruodot mêr,
is aldares af·hęldit, · —þan bi·ginnat im is ubilon werk
lêðon an þeson liohte, · þan ina lêra godes
gi·manod an is muode: · wirðit im mildera hugi,

þuru·gęngit im mid guodu · ęndi geld nimit,
hôh himil-ríki, · þan hie hinan węndit,
wirðit im is mieda só sama, · só þem man *nun warð,
þea þár te nónu dages, · an þea nigunda tíd,
an þene wín-gardon · wirkjan kwámun.
Sum wirðid þan só swíðo ge·fródot, · só hé ni wili is sundja bótjen,
ak hé ôkid sie mid uƀilu ge·hwi-líku, · ant-tat imu is áband náhid,
is wer-old ęndi is wunnja far·slítid; · þan be·ginnid hé imu wíti an·dréden,
is sundjon werðad imu sorga an móde: · ge·hugid hwat hé selbo ge·frumide
grimmes þan lango, þe hé móste is juguðjo neoten; · ni mag þan mid oðru gódu gi·bótjen
þea dádi, þea hé só dęrbja ge·frumide, · ak hé slęhit allaro dago ge·hwi-líkes
an is breost mid bêðjun handun · ęndi wópit sie mid bittrun trahnun,
hlúdo hé sie mid hofnu kúmid, · bidid þene hêlagon drohtin
mahtigne, þat hé imu mildi werðe: · ni látid imu sîðor is mód gi·twífljen;
só ê-gróht-ful is, þe þár alles ge·węldid: · hé ni wili ênigumu irmin-manne
far·węrnjen willjan sínes; · far·giƀid imu waldand selbo
hêlag himil-ríki: · þan is imu gi·holpen sîður.
Alle skulun sie þár êra ant·fáhen, · þoh sie þarod te ênaru tídi
ni kumen, þat kunni manno, · þoh wili imu þe kraftigo drohtin,
gi·lônon allaro liudjo só hwi-líkumu, · só hér is gi·lôbon ant·fáhit:
ên himil-ríki · giƀid hé allun þeodun,
mannun te médu. · Þat mênde mahtig Krist,
barno þat bętste, · þó hé þat biliðí sprak,
hwó þár te þem wín-gardun · wurhtjon kwámin,
man mis-líko: · þoh nam is méde ge·hwe
fulle te is frôjan. · Só skulun firiho barn
at gode selƀumu · geld ant·fáhen,
swíðo leoƀ-lík lôn, · þoh sie sume só late werðan.

TODO.

**43** Hét imu þó þea is gódan · jungaron náhor
twe-libi gangan · —þea wárun imu triuwiston
man obar erðu—, · sagde im mahtig selbo
ôðer-síðu, · hwi-lík imu þár arbêdi
tó-ward wárun: · „þes ni mag ênig tweho werðen“, kwað hé;
kwað þat sie þó te Jerusalem · an þat Judeono folk
líðan skoldin: · „þár wirðid all gi·lêstid só,
ge·frumid undar þemu folke, · só it an furn-dagun
wíse man be mí · wordun ge·sprákun.
Þár skulun mí far·kôpon · undar þea kraftigon þiod,
hęliðos te þeru hêri; · þár werðat mína hęndi ge·bundana,
faðmos werðad mí þár ge·fastnod; · filu skal ik þár gi·þolojan,
hoskes gi·hôrjen · ęndi harm-kwidi,
bismer-spráka · ęndi bi-hêt-word manag;
sie wêgjat mí te wundron · wápnes ęggjun,
bi·lôsjad mí líbu: · ik te þesumu liohte skal
þurh drohtines kraft · fan dôðe a·standen
an þriddjon dage. · Ni kwam ik undar þesa þeoda herod
te þiu, þat mín ęldi-barn · arbêd habdin,
þat mí þionodi þius þiod: · ni willju ik is sie þiggjen nú,
fergon þit folk-skępi, · ak ik skal imu te frumu werðen,
þeonon imu þeo-líko · ęndi for alla þesa þeoda geben
seole míne. · Ik willju sie selbo nú
lôsjen mid mínu líbu, · þea hér lango bidun,
man-kunnjes manag, · mínara helpa.“
Fór imu þó forð-wardes · —habde imu fasten hugi,
blíðjan an is breostun · barn drohtines—
welda im te Jerusalem · Judeo folkes
willjon wísan: · hé konste þes werodes só garo
hęti-grimmen hugi · ęndi hardan stríd,
wrêðan willjon. · Werod síðode
furi Jerikho-burg; · was þe godes sunu,
mahtig undar þero męnigi. · Þár sátun twênje man bi wege,
blinde wárun sie bêðje: · was im bótono þarf,
þat sie ge·hêldi · hebanes waldand,
hwand sie só lango · liohtes þolodun,
managa hwíla. · Sie gi·hôrdun þó þat męgin faren

ęndi frágodun sán · firi-wit-líko
ręgini-blindun, · hwi-lík þár ríki man
undar þemu folk-skępi · furista wári,
hêrost an hôbid. · Þó sprak im ên hęlið an·gęgin,
kwað þat þár Jesu Krist · fan Galilea-lande,
hêljandero bętst · hêrost wári,
fóri mid is folku. · Þó warð fráh-mód hugi
bêðjun þem blindun mannun, · þó sie þat barn godes
wissun under þemu werode: · hreopun im þó mid iro wordun tó,
hlúdo te þemu hêlagon Kriste, · bádun þat hé im helpe ge·rédi:
„drohtin Dawides sunu: · wis ùs mid þínun dádjun mildi,
nęri ùs af þesaru nôdi, · só þú gi·nóge dós
manno kunnjes: · þú bist managun gód,
hilpis ęndi hêlis.“ · Þo bi·gan im þat hęliðo folk
węrjen mid wordun, · þat sie an waldand Krist
só hlúdo ni hriopin. · Si ni weldun im hôrjen te þiu,
ak sie simla mêr ęndi mêr · obar þat manno folk
hlúdo hreopun. · Hêljand ge·stód,
allaro barno bętst, · hét sie þó bręngjen te imu,
lêdjen þurh þea liudi, · sprak im listjun tó
mild-líko for þeru męnegi: · „hwat willjad git mínaro hér“, kwað hé,
„helpono habbjen?“ · Sie bádun ina hêlagna,
þat hé im ira ôgon · opana gi·dádi,
far·liwi þeses liohtes, · þat sie liudjo drôm,
swigle sunnun skín · gi·sehen móstin,
wliti-skônje wer-old. · Waldand frumide,
hrên sie þó mid is handun, · dede is helpe þár tó,
þat þem blindun þó · bêðjum wurðun
ôgon gi·oponod, · þat sie erðe ęndi himil
þurh kraft godes · ant·kiennjen mahtun,
lioht ęndi liudi. · Þó sagdun sie lof gode,
diurdun ùsan drohtin, · þes sie dages liohtes
brúkan móstun: · ge·witun im bêðje mid imu,
folgodun is fęrdi: · was im þiu fruma gibiðig,
ęndi ôk waldandes werk · wído ge·kùðid,
[a]managun gi·márid.

TODO.

3588b **44** Þár was só mahtig-lík
biliði gi·bôknid, · þár þe blindon man
bi þemu wege sátun, · wíti þolodun,
liohtes lôse: · þat mênid þoh liudjo barn,
al man-kunni, · hwó sie mahtig god
an þemu ana·ginne · þurh is ênes kraft
sin-híun twê · selbo gi·warhte,
Ádam ęndi Éwan: · far·gaf im up-wegos,
himilo ríki; · ak þó warð im þe hatola te náh,
fiund mid fêknu · ęndi mid firin-werkun,
bi·swêk sie mid sundjun, · þat sie sin-skôni,
lioht far·létun: · wurðun an lêðaron stędi,
an þesen middil-gard · man far·worpen,
þolodun hér an þiustrju · þiod-arbêdi,
wunnun wrak-sîðos, · welon þarbodun:
far·gátun godes ríkjes, · gramon þeonodun,
fiundo barnun; · sie guldun is im mid fiuru lôn
an þeru hêton hęllju. · Be·þiu wárun siu an iro hugi blinda
an þesaru middil-gard, · męnniskono barn,
hwand siu ine ni ant·kiendun, · kraftagne god,
himilisken hêrron, · þene þe sie mid is handun gi·skóp,
gi·warhte an is willjon. · Þius wer-old was þó só far·hwęrbid,
bi·þwungen an þiustrje, · an þiod-arbidi,
an dôðes dalu: · sátun im þó bi þeru drohtines strátun
jámar-móde, · godes helpe bidun:
siu ni mahte im þó êr werðen, · êr þan waldand god
an þesan middil-gard, · mahtig drohtin,
is selbes sunu · sęndjen weldi
þat hé lioht ant·luki · liudjo barnun,
oponodi im êwig líf, · þat sie þene alo-waldon
mahtin ant·kęnnjen wel, · kraftagna god.
Ôk mag ik giu gi·tęlljen, · of gí þár tó willjad
huggjen ęndi hôrjen, · þat gí þes hêljandes mugun
kraft ant·kęnnjen, · hwó is kumi wurðun
an þesaru middil-gard · managun te helpu,
ia hwat hé mid þem dádjun · drohtin selbo
manages mênde, · ia be·hwiu þiu márje burg

Jerikho hêtid, · þiu þár an Judeon stád
gi·makod mid múrun: · þiu is aftar þemu mánen gi·nęmnid,
aftar þemu torhten tungle: · hé ni mag is tídi be·míðen,
ak hé dago ge·hwi-líkes · duod óðer-hweðer,
wanod ohþo wahsid. · Só dód an þesaro wer-oldi hér,
an þesaru middil-gard · męnniskono barn:
farad ęndi folgod, · fróde sterƀad,
werðad eft junga · aftar kumane,
weros a·wahsane, · unt-tat sie eft wurd far·nimid.
Þat mênde þat barn godes, · þó hé fon þeru burgi fór,
þe gódo fan Jerikho, · þat ni mahte êr werðen gumono barnun
þiu blindja gi·bótid, · þat sie þat berhte lioht,
gi·sáhin sin-skôni, · êr þan hé selƀo hér
an þesaru middil-gard · męnniski ant·féng,
flêsk ęndi lík-hamon. · Þó wurðun þes firiho barn
gi·war an þesaru wer-oldi, · þe hér an wítje êr,
sátun an sundjun · gi·siunjes lôse,
þolodun an þiustrje, · —sie af·sóƀun þat was þesaru þiod kuman
hêljand te helpu · fan heƀan-ríkje,
Krist allaro kuningo bęst; · sie mahtun is ant·kęnnjen sán,
gi·fóljen is fardjo. · Þó sie só filu hriopun,
þe man te þemu mahtigon gode, · þat im mildi aftar þiu
waldand wurði. · Þan węridun im swíðo
þia swárun sundjon, · þe sie im êr selƀon gi·dádun,
lettun sie þes gi·lôƀon. · Sie ni mahtun þem liudjun þoh
bi·węrjen iro willjon, · ak sie an waldand god
hlúdo hriopun, · ant-tat hé im iro hêli far·gaf,
þat sie sin-líf · gi·sehen móstin,
open êwig lioht · ęndi an faren
an þiu berhtun bú. · Þat mêndun þea blindun man,
þe þár bi Jerikho-burg · te þemu godes barne
hlúdo hriopun, · þat hé im iro hêli far·lihi,
liohtes an þesumu líƀe: · þan im þea liudi só filu
węridun mid wordun, · þea þár an þemu wege fórun
bi·foren ęndi bi·hinden: · só dót þea firin-sundjon
an þesaru middil-gard · man-kunnje.
hôrjad nú hwó þie blindun, · síður im gi·bótid warð,
þat sie sunnun lioht · ge·sehen móstun,

hwó si þó dádun: · ge·witun im mid iro drohtine samad,
folgodun is fęrdi, · sprákun filu wordo
þemu landes hirdje te loƀe: · só dód im noh liudjo barn
wído aftar þesaru wer-oldi, · sïður im waldand Krist
ge·liuhte mid is lêrun · ęndi im líf êwig,
godes ríki far·gaf · gódun mannun,
hôh himiles lioht · ęndi is helpe þár tó,
só hwemu só þat gi·werkod, · þat hé móti þemu is wege folgon.

TODO.

**45** Þó náhide · nęrjendo Krist,
þe góðo te Jerusalem. · Kwam imu þár te·gęgnes filu
werodes an willjon · wel huggendjes,
ant·féngun ina fagaro · ęndi imu bi·foren stręidun
þene weg mid iro gi·wádjun · ęndi mid wurtjun só same,
mid berhtun blómun · ęndi mid bômo tógun,
þat feld mid fagaron palmun, · al só is fard ge·buride,
þat þe godes sunu · gangan welde
te þeru márjan burg. · Hwarf ina męgin umbi
liudjo an lustun, · ęndi lof-sang a·hóf
þat werod an willjon: · sagdun waldande þank,
þes þár selƀo kwam · sunu Dawides
wíson þes werodes. · Þó ge·sah waldand Krist
þe góðo te Jerusalem, · gumono bętsta,
blíkan þene burges wal · ęndi bú Judeono,
hôha horn-sęli · ęndi ôk þat hús godes,
allaro wího wun-samost. · Þó wel imu an innen
hugi wið is herte: · þó ni mahte þat hêlage barn
wópu a·wísjen, · sprak þó wordo filu
hriuwig-líko · —was imu is hugi sêreg—:
„wê warð þí, Jerusalem“, (kwað hé,) „þes þú te wárun ni wêst
þea wurde-gi·skęfti, · þe þí noh gi·werðen skulun,
hwó þú noh wirðis be·habd · hęrjes kraftu
ęndi þí bi·sittjad · slíð-móde man,
fiund mid folkun. · Þan ni haƀas þú friðu hwęrgin,
mund-burd mid mannun: · lêdjad þi hér manage tó
ordos ęndi ęggja, · or-legas word,
far·fioþ þín folk-skępi · fiures liomon,

þese wíki a·wóstjad, · wallos hôha
fęlljad te foldun: · ni af·stád is felis nígijan,
stên obar òðrumu, · ak werðad þesa stędi wóstja
umbi Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo,
hwand sie ni ant·kęnnjad, · þat im kumana sind
iro tídi tó-wardes, · ak sie habbjad im twífljen hugi,
ni witun þat iro wísad · waldandes kraft.“
Gi·wêt imu þó mid þeru męnegi · manno drohtin
an þea berhton burg. · Só þó þat barn godes
innan Jerusalem · mid þiu gumono folku,
sêg mid þiu ge·síðu, · þó warð þár allaro sango mêst,
hlúd stemnje af·haben · hêlagun wordun,
lobodun þene landes ward · liudjo męnegi,
barno þat bętste; · þiu burg warð an hróru,
þat folk warð an forhtun · ęndi frágodun sán,
hwe þat wári, · þat þár mid þiu werodu kwam,
mid þeru mikilon męnegi. · Þó sprak im ên man an·gęgin,
kwað þat þár Jesu Krist · fan Galileo lande,
fan Nazareth-burg · nęrjand kwámi,
witig wár-sago · þemu werode te helpu.
Þó was þem Judiun, · þe imu êr grame wárun,
un·holde an hugi, · harm an móde,
þat imu þea liudi só filu · lof-sang warhtun,
diurdun iro drohtin. · Þó géngun dol-móde,
þat sie wið waldand Krist · wordun sprákun,
bádun þat hé þat ge·síði · swígon héti,
letti þea liudi, · þat sie imu lof só filu
wordun ni warhtin: · „it is þesumu werode lêð“, kwáðun sie,
„þesun burg-liudjun.“ · Þó sprak eft þat barn godes:
„ef gí sie a·męrrjad“, (kwað hé,) „þat hér ni mótin manno barn
waldandes kraft · wordun diurjen,
þan skulun it hrópen þoh · harde stênos
for þesumu folk-skępi, · felisos starka,
êr þan it eo be·líbe, · nebo man is lof spreke
wído aftar þesaru wer-oldi.“ · Þó hé an þene wíh innen,
géng an þat godes hús: · fand þár Judeono filu,
mis-líke man, · manage at·samne,
þea im þár kôp-stędi · gi·koran habdun,
mangodun im þár mid manages hwí: · munitęrjas sátun

an þemu wíhe innan, · habdun iro wesl gi·dago
garu te gebanne. · Þat was þemu godes barne
al an andun: · drêf sie út þanen
rúmo fan þemu rakude, · kwað þat wári rehtara dád,
þat þár te bedu fórin · barn Israheles
„ęndi an þesumu mínumu húse · helpono biddjan,
þat sia sigi-drohtin · sundjono tuomje,
þan hér þeobas · an þing-stędi halden,
þea far·warhton weros · wehsal dríban,
un-reht ên-fald. · Ne gí êniga êra ni witun
þeses godes húses, · Judeo liudi.“
Só rúmde hé þó ęndi rekode, · ríki drohtin,
þat hêlaga hús · ęndi an helpun was
managumu man-kunnje, · þem þe is mikilon kraft
ferrene ge·frugnun · ęndi þár gi·faran kwámun
obar langan weg. · Warð þár léf so manag,
halt gi·hêlid · ęndi háf só same,
blindun gi·bótid. · Só dede þat barn godes
willjendi þemu werode, · hwand al an is gi·węldi stéd
umbi þesaro liudjo líf · ęndi ôk umbi þit land só same.

TODO.

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3674 strędun | *so (*'streidun'*)* **M***;* 'stroidun' **C**

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3674 strędun | 3pl. past ind. of *streuwjan* 'to strew' ~ *strôjan* 'id.' **M** reflects the former variant, **C** the latter. The *ę* should not to be confused with rare *ę* < PGmc. *ai* as found in ll. 359 and 2265.

3753 obar langan weg | Also found in ON as *of langan veg* (*Vkv* 4/2b, 9/4b).

**46** Stód imu þó fora þemu wíhe · waldandjo Krist,
liof landes ward, · ęndi imu þero liudjo hugi,
iro willjon aftar·warode: · gi·sah werod mikil
an þat márje hús · mêðmos fórjen,
gebon mid goldu · ęndi mid godu-wębbju,
diurjun fratahun. · Þat al drohtin Krist
warode wís-líko. · Þó kwam þár ôk ên widowa tó,
idis arm-skapen, · ęndi te þemu alạha géng
ęndi siu an þat tresur-hús · twêne lęgde
êríne skattos: · was iru ên-fald hugi,
willjan gódes. · Þó sprak waldand Krist,
þe gumo wið is jungaron, · kwað þat siu þár geba brâhti

mêron mikilu þan ęlkor · ênig mannes sunu:
„ef hér ôdaga man“, (kwað hé,) „êra brâhtun,
mêðǫm-hord manag, · sie létun im mêr at hús
welona ge·wunnen. · Ni dede þius widowa só,
ak siu te þesumu alạhe gaf · al þat siu habde
welono ge·wunnen, · só siu iru wiht ni far·lét
gódes an iro gardun. · Be·þiu sind ira gęba mêron,
waldande werða, · hwand siu it mid su-líkumu willjon dede
te þesumu godes húse. · Þes skal siu geld niman,
swíðo lang-sam lôn, · þes siu su-líkan gi·lôbon habad.“
Só gi·fragn ik þat þár an þemu wíhe · waldandjo Krist
allaro dago ge·hwi-líkes, · drohtin manno,
wísde mid wordun. · Stód ine werod umbi,
grôt folk Judeono, · gi·hôrdun is gódan word,
swótja sęggjan. · Sum só sálig warð
manno undar þeru męnegi, · þat it bi·gan an is mód hladen;
línodun im þea lêra, · þe þe landes ward
al be biliðjun sprak, · barn drohtines.
Sumun wárun eft so lêða · lêra Kristes,
waldandes word: · was im wiðẹr-mód hugi
allun þem, þe an þemu hęri-skępi · hêrost wárun,
furiston an þemu folke: · fáres hugdun
wrêða mid iro wordun · —habdun im wiðẹr-sakon
gi·haloden te helpu, · þes hêroston man,
Erodeses þegạn, · þe þár and-ward stód
wrêðes willjan, · þat hé iro word obar·hôrdi—
ef sie ina for·féngin, · þat sie ina þan feteros an,
þea liudi liðo-bęndi · lęggjen móstin,
sundja lôsan. · Þó géngun im þea ge·síðos tó
bittra gi·hugde, · þat sie wið þat barn godes,
wrêða wiðẹr-sakon · wordun sprákun:
„Hwat þú bist êo-sago“, (kwáðun sie,) „allun þiodun,
wísis wáres só filu: · nis þi werð eo·wiht
te bi·míðanne · manno ni-ênumu
umbi is ríki-dóm, · neþo þú simlun þat reht sprikis
ęndi an þene godes weg · gumono ge·síði
lêdis mid þinun lêrun: · ni mag þi laster man
fíðan undar þesumu folke. · Nú wí þi frágon skulun.
ríki þiodan, · hwi-lík reht habad

þe kêsur fan Rúmu, · þe imu te þesumu kunnje herod
tinsi sókid · ęndi gi·tald haƀad,
hwat wí imu gelden skulin · gęro ge·hwi-líkes
hôƀid-skatto. · Saga hwat þí þes an þínumu hugi þunkja:
is it reht þe nis? · Rád for þínun
land-mégun wel: · ùs is þínaro lêrono þarf.“
Sie weldun þat hé it ant·kwáði: · þan mahte hé þoh
ant·kęnnjen wel
iro wrêðon willjon: · „te hwí gí wár-logon“, kwað hé,
„fandot mín só frókno? · Ni skal iu þat te frumu werðen,
þat gí dreogerjas · darnungo nú
willjad mí far·fâhen.“ · Hét hé þó forð dragan
te skawonne þe skattos, · „þe gí skuldige sind
an þat geld geƀen.“ · Judeon drógun
ênna silụƀrinna forð: · sáhun manage tó,
hwó hé was ge·munitod: · was an middjen skín
þes kêsures biliði · —þat mahtun sie ant·kęnnjen wel—,
iro hêrron hôƀid-mál. · Þó frágode sie þe hêlago Krist,
aftar hwemu þiu ge·lík-nessi · gi·legid wári.
Sie kwáðun þat it wári · wer-old-kêsures
fan Rúmu-burg, · „þes þe alles þeses ríkes haƀad
ge·wald an þesaru wer-oldi.“ · „Þan willju ik iu te wárun hér“,
kwað hé,
„selƀo sęggjan, · þat gí imu sín geƀad,
wer-old-hêrron is ge·wunst, · ęndi waldand gode
sęlljad, þat þár sín ist: · þat skulun iuwa seolon wesen,
gumono gêstos.“ · Þó warð þero Judeono hugi
ge·minsod an þemu mahle: · ni mahtun þe mên-skaðon
wordun ge·winnen, · só iro willjo géng,
þat sie ina far·féngin, · hwand imu þat friðu-barn godes
wardode wið þe wrêðon · ęndi im wár an·gęgin,
sòð-spel sagde, · þoh sie ni wárin só sálige te þiu,
þat sie it só far·féngin, · só it iro fruma wári.

TODO.

**47** Sie ni weldun it þoh far·láten, · ak hétun þár lêdjen forð
ên wíf for þemu werode, · þiu haƀde wam ge·frumid,
un-reht ên-fald: · þiu idis was bi·fangen
an far·legar-nessi, · was iro líƀes skolo,

þat sie firiho barn · ferahu bi·námin,
êhtin iro aldres: · só was an iro êw ge·skriben.
Sie bi·gunnun ina þó frágon, · fruokne liudi,
wrêða mid iro wordun, · hwat sie skoldin þemu wíbe duan,
hweðer sie sie kwęlidin, · þe sie sie kwika létin,
þe hwat hé umbi su-líka dádi · a·dêljen weldi:
„þú wêst, hwó þesaru męnegi“, (kwáðun sie,) „Moyses gi·bôd
wárun wordun, · þat allaro wíbo ge·hwi-lík
an far·legar-nessi · líbes far·warhti
ęndi þat sie þan a·wurpin · weros mid handun,
starkun stênun: · nú maht þú sie sehan standen hér
an sundjun bi·fangan: · saga hwat þú is willjes.“
weldun ine þea wiðęr-sakon · wordun far·fáhen,
ef hé þat gi·kwáði, · þat sie sie kwika létin,
friðodi ira ferahe, · þan weldi þat folk Judeono
kweðen, þat hé iro aldiron · êo wiðęr-sagdi,
þero liudjo land-reht; · ef hé sie þan héti líbu bi·nimen,
þea magað fur þeru męnegi, · þan weldin sie kweðen, þat hé só mildjene hugi
ni bári an is breostun, · só skoldi habbjen barn godes:
weldun sie só hweðeres · hêlagne Krist
þero wordo ge·wítnon, · só hé þár for þemu werode ge·spráki,
a·dêldi te dóme. · Þan wisse drohtin Krist
þero manno só garo · mód-gi·þáhti,
iro wrêðon willjon; · þó hé te þemu werode sprak,
te allun þem erlun: · „só hwi-lík só iuwar áno sí“, kwað hé,
„slíðja sundjon, · só ganga iru selbo tó
ęndi sie at êrist · erl mid is handun
stên ana werpe.“ · Só stódun Judeon,
þáhtun ęndi þagodun: · ni mahte þegan nigijan
wið þem word-kwidi · wiðęr-saka finden:
ge·hugde manno ge·hwi-lík · mên-gi·þáhti,
is selbes sundja: · ni was iro só sikur ênig,
þat hé bi þemu worde · þemu wíbe ge·dorsti
stên an werpen, · ak létun sie standen þár
ênan þár inne · ęndi im út þanen
géngun gram-harde · Judeo liudi,
ên aftar öðrumu, · ant-tat iro þár ênig ni was
þes fiundo folkes, · þe iro ferhes þó,

Þeru idis aldạr-lago · áhtjen weldi.
Þó gi·fragn ik þat sie frágode · friðu-barn godes,
allaro gumono bętst: · „Hwár kwámun þit Judeono folk“, kwað hé,
„þíne wiðẹr-sakon, · þea þi hér wrógdun te mí?
Ne sie þí hiudu wiht · harmes ne gi·dádun,
þea liudi lêðes, · þe þí weldun líbu be·niman,
wêgjan te wundrun?“ · Þó sprak imu eft þat wíf an·gęgin,
kwað þat iru þár nio·man · þurh þes nęrjandan
hêlaga helpa · harm ne gi·frumidi
wammes te lône. · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist,
drohtin manno: · „ne ik þi geþ ni dęrju n·eo·wiht“, kwað hé,
„ak gang þí hêl hinen, · lát þi an þínumu hugi sorga,
þat þú nio síð aftar þius · sundig ni werðes.“
Habde iru þó gi·holpen · hêlag barn godes,
ge·friðot iro ferạhe. · Þan stód þat folk Judeono
ubiles an-mód · só fan êristan,
wrêðes willjan, · hwó sie word-hęti
wið þat friðu-barn godes · frummjen móstin.
Habdun þea liudi an twê · mid iro gi·lôbon gi·fangan:
was þiu smale þioda · sínes willjan
gernora mikilu, · þes godes barnes word
te ge·frummjenne, · só im iro frâho gi·bôd:
rómodun te rehta · bęt þan þie ríkjon man,
habdun ina far iro hêrron · ia far heƀan-kuning,
ful·géngun imu gerno. · Þó gi·wêt imu þe godes sunu
an þene wíh innan: · hwarf ina werod umbi,
męgin-þiodo gi·mang. · Hé an middjen stód,
lêrde þea liudi · liohtun wordun,
hlúdero stemnun: · was hlust mikil,
þagode þegạn manag, · ęndi hé þeru þiod gi·bôd,
só hwe só þár mid þurstu · bi·þwungan wári,
„só ganga imu herod drinkan te mí“, (kwað hé,) „dago ge·hwi-líkes
swótjes brunnan. · Ik mag sęggjan iu,
só hwe só hér gi·lôƀid te mí · liudjo barno
fasto undar þesumu folke, · þat imu þan flioten skulun
fan is lík-hamon · libbjendi flód,
irnandi water, · aho-spring mikil,
kumad þanen kwika brunnon. · Þesa kwidi werðad wára,

liudjun gi·lêstid, · só hwemu só hér gi·lôƀid te mí.“
Þan mênde mid þiu wataru · waldandjo Krist,
hêr heƀan-kuning · hêlagna gêst,
hwó þene firiho barn · ant·fâhen skoldin,
lioht ęndi listi · ęndi líf êwig,
hôh heƀan-ríki · ęndi huldi godes.

TODO.

**48** Wurðun þó þea liudi · umbi þea lêra Kristes,
umbi þiu word an ge·winne: · stódun wlanka man,
gêl-móde Judeon, · sprákun gelp mikil,
habdun it im te hoska, · kwáðun þat sie mahtin gi·hôrjen wel,
þat imu mahlidin fram · módaga wihti,
un-holde út: · „nú hé an aƀu lêrid“, kwáðun sie,
„wordu ge·hwi-líku.“ · Þó sprak eft þat werod òðar:
„ni þurƀun gí þene lêrjand lahan“, (kwáðun sie:) „kumad líƀes word
mahtig fan is mùde; · hé wirkid manages hwat,
wundres an þesaru wer-oldi: · nis þat wrêðaro dád,
fiundo kraftes: · nio it þan te su-líkaru frumu ni wurði,
ak it gegnungo · fan gode alo-waldon,
kumid fan is krafte. · Þat mugun gí ant·kęnnjen wel
an þem is wárun wordun, · þat hé gi·wald haƀad
alles oƀar erðu.“ · Þó weldun ina þe and-sakon þár
an stędi fâhen · efƀa stên ana werpen,
ef sie im þero manno · męnigi ni an·drédin,
ni forhtodin þat folk-skępi. · Þó sprak þat friðu-barn godes:
„ik tôgju iu gódes só filu“, (kwað hé,) „fan gode selƀumu,
wordo ęndi werko: · nú willjad gí mí wítnon hér
þurh iuwan starkan hugi, · stên ana werpen,
bi·lôsjen mí líƀu.“ · Þó sprákun imu eft þea liudi an·gęgin,
wrêða wiðęr-sakon: · „ne wí it be þínun werkun ni duat“, kwáðun sia,
„þat wí þí aldres · tó áhtjen willjad,
ak wí duat it be þínun wordun, · hwand þú su-lík wáh sprikis,
*hwand þú þik só máris · ęndi su-lík mên sagis,
gihis for þeson Judeon, · þat þú sís god selƀo,
mahtig drohtin, · ęndi bist þi þoh man só wi,
kuman fan þeson kunnje.“ · Krist alo-waldo

ne wolda þero Judeono þuo lęng · gelpes hôrjan,
wrêðaro willjon, · ak hie im af þem wíhe fuor
obar Jordanes strôm; · habda jungron mid im,
þia is sáligun gi·sïðos, · þia im simlon mid im
willjon wonodun: · suohta werod ôðer,
deda þár só hie gi·wonoda, · drohtin selbo,
lêrda þia liudi: · gi·lôbda þie wolda
an is hêlagun word. · Þat skolda sinnon wel
manno só hwi-líkon, · só þat an is muod gi·nam.
Þuo gi·frang ik þat þár te Kriste · kumana wurðun
bodon fan Bethaniu · ęndi sagdun þem barne godes,
þat sia an þat ârundi þarod · idisi sęndin,
Maria ęndi Martha, · magað frí-líka,
swíðo wun-sama wíf; · þia wissa hie bêðja,
wárun im gi·swester twá, · þia hie selbo êr
minnjoda an is muode · þuru iro mildjan hugi,
þiu wíf þuru iro willjon guodan. · Sia im te wáron þuo
an·budun fon Bethaniu, · þat iro bruoðer was
Lazarus legar-fast · ęndi þat sia is líbes ni wándun;
bádun þat þarod kwámi · Krist alo-waldo
hêlag te helpu. · Reht só hie sia gi·hôrda þuo
sęggjan fan só siekon, · só sprak hie sán an·gęgin,
kwað þat Lazaruses · legar ni wári
gi·duan im te dôðe, · „ak þár skal drohtines lof“, kwaþ-hie,
„gi·frumid werðan: · nis it im te ôðron frêson gi·duan.“
was im þár þuo selbo · suno drohtines
twá naht ęndi dagas. · Þiu tíd was þuo ge·náhit,
þat hie eft te Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo
wíson welda, · só hie gi·wald habda.
Sagda þuo is gi·sïðon · suno drohtines,
þat hie eft obar Jordan · Judeo liudi
suokjan welda. · Þuo sprákun im sán an·gęgin
jungron sína: · „te hwí bist þú só gern þarod“, kwaðun sia,
„frô mín, te faranne? · Ni þat nú furn ni was,
þat sia þik þínero wordo · wítnon hogdun,
weldun þi mid stênon starkan a·werpan? · nú þú eft undar þia strídigun þioda
fundos te faranne, · þár ist fiondo gi·nuog,
erlos obar-muoda?“ · Þuo ên þero twe-libjo,

Þuomas gi·málda · —was im gi·þungan mann,
diur-lík drohtines þegạn—: · „ne skulun wí im þia dád lahan“,
kwaþ-hie,
„ni węrnjan wí im þes willjen, · ak wita im wonjan mid,
þuolojan mid ùsson þiodne: · þat ist þegnes kust,
þat hie mid is frâhon samad · fasto gi·stande,
dôje mid im þár an duome. · Duan ùs alla só,
folgon im te þero fęrdi: · ni látan ùse ferạh wið þiu
wihtes wirðig, · neba wí an þem werode mid im,
dôjan mid ùson drohtine. · Þan lêbot ùs þoh duom after,
guod word for gumon.“ · Só wurðun þuo jungron Kristes,
erlos aðal-borana · an ên-falden hugje,
hêrren te willjen. · Þuo sagda hêlag Krist
selbo is gi·síðon · þat a·slápan was
Lazarus fan þem legare, · „habit þit lioht a·geban,
an·swebit ist an selmon. · Nú wí an þena síð faran
ęndi ina a·wękkjan, · þat hie muoti eft þesa wer-old sehan,
libbjandi lioht: · þan wirðit iuwa gi·lôbo after þiu
forð-werd gi·fęstid.“ · Þuo gi·wêt hie im obar þia fluod þanan,
þie guodo godes suno, · an-þat hie mid is jungron kwam
þár te Bithaniu, · barn drohtines
selbo mid is gi·síðon, · þár þia gi·swester twá,
Maria ęndi Martha · an muod-karon
sêraga sátun. · Was þár gi·samnot filo
fan Jerusalem · Judeo liudo,
þia þiu *wíf weldun · wordun fruobrjan,
þat sie só ni karodin · kind-jungas dôð,
Lazaruses far·lust. · Só þó þe landes ward
géng an þiu gardos, · só wurðun þes godes barnes
kumi þár gi·kùðid, · þat hé só kraftig was
bi þeru burg úten. · Þó im bêðjun was,
þem wíbun su-lík willjo, · þat sie im waldand tó,
þat friðu-barn godes, · farandjen wissun.

TODO.

**49** Þó þem wíbun was · willjono mêsta
kumi drohtines · ęndi Kristes word
te gi·hôrjenne. · Heobandi géng
Martha mód-karag · wið só mahtigne

wordun wehslan · ęndi wiđ waldand sprak
an iro hugi hriuwig: · „Þár þú mí, hêrro mín“, kwað siu,
„nęrjendero bętst, · náhor wáris,
hêljand þe gódo, · þan ni þorfti ik nú su-lík harm þolon,
bittra breost-kara, · þan ni wári nú mín bróđer dôd,
Lazarus fan þesumu liohte, · ak hé imu mahti libbjen forđ
ferąhes ge·fullid. · Ik þoh, frô mín, te þí
liohto gi·lôbju, · lêrjandero bętst,
só hwes só þú biddjen wili · berhton drohtin,
þat hé it þi sán far·gibid, · god alo-mahtig,
gi·werđot þínan willjan.“ · Þó sprak eft waldand Krist
þeru idis and-wordi: · „Ni lát þú þí an innan þes“, kwað hé,
„þínan sebon swerkan: · ik þí sęggjan mag
wárun wordun, · þat þes nis gi·wand ênig,
nebu þín bróđer skal · þurh gi·bod godes,
þurh drohtines kraft · fan dôđe a·standen
an is lík-hamon.“ · „All hębbju ik gi·lôbon só“, kwað siu,
„þat it só gi·werđen skal, · só hwan só þius wer-old ęndjod
ęndi þe márjo dag · obar man fęrid,
þat hé þan fan erđu skal · up a·standen
an þemu dómes daga, · þan werđad fan dôđe kwika
þurh maht godes · man-kunnjes ge·hwi-lík,
a·rísad fan rębtu.“ · Þó sagde ríkjo Krist
þeru idis alo-mahtig · oponun wordun,
þat hé selbo was · sunu drohtines,
bêđju ia líf ia lioht · liudjo barnon
te a·standanne: · „nio þe sterben ni skal,
líf far·liosen, · þe hér gi·lôbid te mí:
þoh ina ęldi-barn · erđu bi·þękkjen,
diapo bi·delben, · nis hé dôd þiu mêr:
þat flêsk is bi·folhen, · þat ferąh is gi·halden,
is þiu siola gi·sund.“ · Þó sprak imu eft sán an·gęgin
þat wíf mid iro wordun: · „ik gi·lôbju þat þú þe wáro bist“,
kwað siu,
„Krist godes sunu: · þat mag man ant·kęnnjen wel,
witen an þínun wordun, · þat þú gi·wald habes
þurh þiu hêlagon gi·skapu · himiles ęndi erđun.“
Þó ge·fragn ik þat þár þero idisjo kwam · ôđar gangan
Maria mód-karag: · géngun iro managa aftar

Judeo liudi. · Þó siu þemu godes barne
sagde sêrag-mód, · hwat iru te sorgun gi·stód
an iro hugi harmes: · hofnu kúmde
Lazaruses far·lust, · liaƀes mannes,
griat gornundi, · ant-tat þemu godes barne
hugi warð gi·hrórid: · hête trahni
wópu a·wellun, · ęndi þó te þem wíƀun sprak,
hét ina þó lêdjen, · þár Lazarus was
foldu bi·folhen. · Lag þár ên felis bi·oƀan,
hard stên be·hliden. · Þó hét þe hêlago Krist
ant·lúkan þea léja, · þat hé mósti þat lík sehan,
hrêo skawojen. · Þó ni mahte an iro hugi míðan
Marþa for þeru męnegi, · wið mahtigne sprak:
„frô mín þe gódo“, (kwað siu,) „ef man þene felis nimid,
þene stên ant·lúkid, · þan wániu ik þat þanen stank kume,
un·swóti swek, · hwand ik þi sęggjan mag
wárun wordun, · þat þes nis gi·wand ênig,
þat hé þár nú bi·folhen was · fiuwar naht ęndi dagos
an þemu erð-graƀe.“ · And-wordi gaf
waldand þemu wíƀe: · „Hwat ni sagde ik þí te wárun êr“,
kwað hé,
„ef þú gi·lôƀjen wili, · þan nis nú lang te þiu,
þat þú hér ant·kęnnjen skalt · kraft drohtines,
þe mikilon maht godes?“ · Þó géngun manage tó,
af·hóƀun harden stên. · Þó sah þe hêlago Krist
up mid is ôgun, · á-lát sagde
þemu þe þese wer-old gi·skóp, · „þes þú mín word gi·hôris“,
kwað hé,
„sigi-drohtin selƀo; · ik wêt þat þú só simlun duos,
ak ik duom it be þesumu grôton · Judeono folke,
þat sie þat te wárun witin, · þat þú mí an þese wer-old sęndes
þesun liudjun te lêrun.“ · Þó hé te Lazaruse hriop
starkaru stemnju · ęndi hét ina standen up
ia fan þemu graƀe gangan. · Þó warð þe gêst kumen
an þene lík-hamon: · hé bi·gan is liði hrórjen,
ant·warp undar þemu gi·wędje: · was imo só be·wunden þó
noh,
an hrêo-będdjon bi·helid. · Hét imu helpen þó
waldandjo Krist. · Weros géngun tó,

ant·wundun þat ge·wádi. · Wánum up a·rês
Lazarus te þesumu liohte: · was imu is líf far·geƀen,
þat hé is aldạr-lagu · êgan mósti,
friðu forð-wardes. · Þó fagonadun bêðja,
Maria ęndi Martha: · ni mag þat man óðrumu
gi·sęggjan te sóðe, · hwó þea ge·swester twó
męndjodun an iro móde. · Maneg wundrode
Judeo liudjo, · þó sie ina fan þemu graƀe sáhun
síðon ge·sunden, · þene þe êr suht far·nam
ęndi sie bi·dulƀun · diapo undar erðu
líbes lôsen: · þó móste imu libbjen forð
hêl an hêmun. · Só mag heƀan-kuninges,
þiu mikile maht godes · manno ge·hwi-líkes
ferạhe gi·formon · ęndi wið fiundo níð
hêlag helpen, · só hwemu só hé is huldi far·giƀid.

TODO.

**50** Þó warð þár só managumu manne · mód aftar Kriste,
gi·hworƀen hugi-skęfti, · síðor sie is hêlagon werk
selƀon gi·sáhun, · hwand eo êr su-lík ni warð
wundẹr an wer-oldi. · Þan was eft þes werodes só filu,
só mód-starke man: · ni weldon þe maht godes
ant·kęnnjen kùð-líko, · ak sie wið is kraft mikil
wunnun mid iro wordun: · wárun im waldandes
lêra so lêða: · sóhtun im liudi óðra
an Jerusalem, · þár Judeono was
hêri hand-mahạl · ęndi hôƀid-stędi,
grôt gum-skępi · grimmaro þioda.
Sie kùðdun im þó Kristes werk, · kwáðun þat sie kwikan sáhin
þene erl mid iro ôgun, · þe an erðu was,
foldu bi·folhen · fiuwar naht ęndi dagos,
dôd bi·dolƀen, · ant-tat hé ina mid is dádjun selƀo,
mid is wordun a·wękide, · þat hé mósti þese wer-old sehan.
Þó was þat só wiðẹr·ward · wlankun mannun,
Judeo liudjun: · hétun iro gum-skępi þó,
werod samnojan · ęndi warƀos fáhen,
męgin-þioda gi·mang, · an mahtigna Krist
riedun an rúnun: · „nis þat rád ênig“, kwáðun sie,
„þat wí þat gi·þolojan: · wili þesaro þioda te filu

gi·lôbjen aftar is lêrun. · Þan ùs liudi farad,
an eo-rid-folk, · werðat ùsa obar-hôbdun
rinkos fan Rúmu. · Þan wí þeses ríkjes skulun
lôse libbjen · eſþa wí skulun ùses líbes þolon,
hęliðos ùsaro hôbdo.“ · Þó sprak þár ên gi·hêrod man
obar warf wero, · þe was þes werodes þó
an þeru burg innan · biskop þero liudjo
—Kaiphas was hé hêten; · habdun ina gi·koranen te þiu
an þeru gęr-talu · Judeo liudi,
þat hé þes godes húses · gômjen skoldi,
wardon þes wíhes—: · „Mí þunkid wundęr mikil“, kwað hé,
„mári þioda, · —gí kunnun manages gi·skêð—
hwí gí þat te wárun ni witin, · werod Judeono,
þat hér is bętera rád · barno ge·hwi-líkumu,
þat man hér ênne man · aldru bi·lôsje
ęndi þat hé þurh iuwa dádi · drôreg sterþe,
for þesumu folk-skępi · ferąh far·láte,
þan al þit liud-werod · far·loren werðe.“
Ni was it þoh is willjan, · þat hé só wár ge·sprak,
só forð for þemu folke, · frume man-kunnjes
gi·mênde for þeru męnegi, · ak it kwam imu fan þeru maht godes
þurh is hêlagan hêd, · hwand hé þat hús godes
þár an Jerusalem · bi·gangan skolde,
wardon þes wíhes: · be·þiu hé só wár gi·sprak,
biskop þero liudjo, · hwó skoldi þat barn godes
alla irmin-þiod · mid is ênes ferhe,
mid is líbu a·lôsjen: · þat was allaro þesaro liudjo rád,
hwand hé gi·halode · mid þiu hêðina liudi,
weros an is willjon · waldandjo Krist.
Þó wurðun ên-wordje · obar-módje man,
werod Judeono, · ęndi an iro warþe gi·sprákun,
mári þioda, · þat sie im ni létin iro mód twehon:
só hwe só ina undar þemu folke · finden mahti,
þat ina sán gi·féngi · ęndi forð bràhti
an þero þiodo þing; · kwáðun þat sie ni mahtin gi·þolojan lęng,
þat sie þe êno man · só alla weldi,
werod far·winnen. · Þan wisse waldand Krist
þero manno só garo · mód-gi·þàhti,

hęti-grimmon hugi, · hwand imu ni was bi·holen eo·wiht
an þesaru middil-gard: · hé ni welde þó an þie męnigi innen
síður open-líko, · under þat erlo folk,
gangan under þea Judeon: · bêd þe godes sunu
þero toroḥtjon tíd, · þe imu tó-ward was,
þat hé far þesa þioda · þolojan welde,
far þit werod wíti: · wisse imu selbo
þat dag-þingi garo. · Þó gi·wêt imu ùse drohtin forð
ęndi imu þó an Effrem · alo-waldo Krist
an þeru hôhon burg · hêlag drohtin
wunode mid is werodu, · ant-tat hé an is willjan hwarf
eft te Bethania · brahtmu þiu mikilun,
mid þiu is gódum gum-skępi. · Judeon bi·sprákun þat
wordu ge·hwi-líku, · þó sie imu su-lík werod mikil
folgon gi·sáhun: · „nis frume ênig“, kwáðun sie,
„ùses ríkjes gi·rádi, · þoh wí reht sprekan,
ni þíhit ùses þinges wiht: · þius þiod wili
węndjen after is willjan; · imu all þius wer-old folgot,
liudi bi þem is lêrun, · þat wí imu lêðes wiht
for þesumu folk-skępi · gi·frummjen ni mótun.“

TODO.

**51** Gi·wêt imu þó þat barn godes · innan Bethania
sehs nahtun êr, · þan þiu samnunga
þár an Jerusalem · Judeo liudjo
an þem wíh-dagun · werðen skolde,
þat sie skoldun haldan · þea hêlagon tídi,
Judeono paskha. · Béd þe godes sunu,
mahtig under þeru męnegi: · was þár manno kraft,
werodes bi þem is wordun. · Þár géngun ina twê wíf umbi,
Maria ęndi Martha, · mid mildju hugi,
þionodun imu þeo-líko. · Þiodo drohtin
gaf im lang-sam lôn: · lét sea lêðes gi·hwes,
sundjono sikora, · ęndi selbo gi·bôd,
þat sea an friðe fórin · wiðęr fiundo níð,
þea idisa mid is orlobu gódu: · habdun iro ambaht-skępi
bi·węndid an is willjon. · Þó gi·wêt imu waldand Krist
forð mid þiu folku, · firiho drohtin,
innan Jerusalem, · þár Judeono was

hęte-lík hard-buri, · þár sie þea hêlagon tíd
warodun at þemu wíhe; · was þár werodes só filu,
kraftigaro kunnjo, · þie ni weldun Kristes word
gerno hôrjen · ni te þemu godes barne
an iro mód-sebon · minnje ni habdun,
ak wárun im só wrêðа · wlanka þioda,
módeg man-kunni, · habdun im morð-hugi,
in·wid an innan: · an aƀuh far·féngun
Kristes lêre, · weldun ina kraftigna
wítnon þero wordo; · ak was þár werodes só filu,
umbi erl-skępi · ant-langana dag,
habde ine þiu smale þiod · þurh is swótjun word
werodu bi·worpen, · þat ine þie wiðęr-sakon
under þemu folk-skępi · fâhen ne gi·dorstun,
ak miðun is bi þeru męnegi. · Þan stód mahtig Krist
an þemu wíhe innan, · sagde word manag
firiho barnun te frumu. · Was þár folk umbi
allan langan dag, · ant-tat þiu liohte gi·wêt
sunne te sedle. · Þó te sęliðun fór
man-kunnjes manag. · Þan was þár ên mári berg
bi þeru burg úten, · þe was brêd ęndi hôh,
gróni ęndi skôni: · hétun ina Judeo liudi
Oliueti bi namon. · Þár imu up gi·wêt
nęrjendjo Krist, · só ina þiu naht bi·féng,
was imu þár mid is jungarun, · só ine þár Judeono ênig
ni wisse ti wárun, · hwand hé an þemu wíhe stód,
liudjo drohtin, · só lioht ôstene kwam,
ant·féng þat folk-skępi · ęndi im filu sagde
wároro wordo, · só nis an þesaru wer-oldi ênig,
an þesaru middil-gard · manno só sáhi,
liudjo barno nig·ên, · þat þero lêrono mugi
ęndi gi·tęlljen, · þe hé þár an þemu alạhe gi·sprak,
waldand an þemu wíhe, · ęndi simlun mid is wordun gi·bôd,
þat sie sie gęręwidin · te godes ríkje,
allaro manno ge·hwi-lík, · þat sie móstin an þemu márjon daga
iro drohtines · diuriða ant·fâhen.
Sagde im hwat sie it sundjun frumidun · ęndi simlun gi·bôd,
þat sie þea a·lęskidin; · hét sie lioht godes
minnjon an iro móde, · mên far·láten,

aboha obar-hugdi, · ôd-módi niman,
hlaðen þat an iro hertan; · kwað þat im þan wári heþan-ríki,
garu gódo mêst. · Þó warð þár gumono só filu
gi·węndid aftar is willjon, · síður sie þat word godes
hêlag gi·hôrdun, · heþan-kuninges,
ant·kęndun kraft mikil, · kumi drohtines,
hêrron helpe, · ia þat heþan-ríki was,
nęrjendi gi·náhid · ęndi náða godes
manno barnun. · Sum só módeg was
Judeo folkes, · habdun grimman hugi,
slíð-móden seþon · [...],
ni weldun is worde gi·lôbjen, · ak habdun im ge·win mikil
wið þea Kristes kraft: · kumen ni móstun
þea liudi þurh léðen stríd, · þat sie gi·lôbon te imu
fasto gi·féngin; · ni was im þiu frume giþiðig,
þat sie heþan-ríki · habbjen móstin.
Géng imu þó þe godes sunu · ęndi is jungaron mid imu,
waldand fan þemu wíhe, · all só is willjo géng,
iak imu uppen þene berg gi·stêg · barn drohtines:
sat imu þár mid is ge·síðun · ęndi im sagde filu
wároro wordo. · Sí bi·gunnun im þó umbi þene wíh sprekan,
þie gumon umbi þat godes hús, · kwáðun þat ni wári
gód-líkora
alạh obar erðu · þurh erlo hand,
þurh mannes gi·werk · mid męgin-kraftu
rakud a·rihtid. · Þó þe ríkjo sprak,
hêr heþan-kuning · —hôrdun þe óðra—:
„ik mag iu gi·tęlljen“, (kwað hé,) „þat noh wirðid þiu tíd kumen,
þat is af·standen ni skal · stên obar óðrumu,
ak it fallid ti foldu · ęndi fiur nimid,
grádag logna, · þoh it nú só gód-lík sí,
só wís-líko gi·warht, · ęndi só dód all þesaro wer-oldes
gi·skapu,
te·glídid gróni wang.“ · Þó géngun imu is jungaron tó,
frágodun ina só stillo: · „hwó lango skal standen noh“,
kwáðun sie,
„þius wer-old an wunnjun, · êr þan þat gi·wand kume,
þat þe lasto dag · liohtes skíne
þurh wolkạn-skion, · efþo hwan is þín eft wán kumen

an þene middil-gard, · manno kunnje
te a·dêljenne, · dôdun ęndi kwikun?
frô mín þe gódo, · ùs is þes firi-wit mikil,
waldandjo Krist, · hwan þat gi·werðen skuli.“

TODO.

**52** Þó im and-wordi · alo-waldo Krist
gód-lík far·gaf · þem gumun selbo:
„þat habad só bi·dęrnid“, (kwað hé,) „drohtin þe gódo,
iak só hardo far·holen · himil-ríkjes fader,
waldand þesaro wer-oldes, · só þat witen ni mag
ênig mannisk barn, · hwan þiu márje tíd
gi·wirðid an þesaru wer-oldi, · ne it ôk te wáran ni kunnun
godes ęngilos, · þie for imu gęgin-warde
simlun sindun: · sie it ôk gi·sęggjan ni mugun
te wáran mid iro wordun, · hwan þat gi·werðen skuli,
þat hé willje an þesan middil-gard, · mahtig drohtin,
firiho fandon. · Fader wêt it ênо
hêlag fan himile: · ęlkur is it bi·holen allun,
kwikun ęndi dôdun, · hwan is kumi werðad.
Ik mag iu þoh gi·tęlljen, · hwi-lík hér têkạn bi·foran
gi·werðad wundęr-lík, · êr þan hé an þese wer-old kume
an þemu márjon daga: · þat wirðid hér êr an þemu mánon skín
iak an þeru sunnon só same; · gi·swerkad siu bêðju,
mid finistre werðad bi·fangan; · fallad sterron,
hwít heban-tungạl, · ęndi hrisid erðe,
bibod þius brêde wer-old · —wirðid su-líkaro bôkno filu—:
grimmid þe grôto sêo, · wirkid þie gebenes strôm
ęgison mid is ùðjun · erð-búandjun.
Þan þorrot þiu þiod · þurh þat ge·þwing mikil,
folk þurh þea forhta: · þan nis friðu hwęrgin,
ak wirðid wíg só maneg · obar þese wer-old alla
hęte-lík af·haben, · ęndi hęri lêdid
kunni obar òðar: · wirðid kuningo gi·win,
męgin-fard mikil: · wirðid managoro kwalm,
open ur-lagi · —þat is ęgis-lík þing,
þat io su-lík morð · skulun man af·hębbjen—,
wirðid wól só mikil · obar þese wer-old alle,

man-sterbono mêst, · þero þe gio an þesaru middil-gard
swulti þurh suhti: · liggjad seoka man,
driosat ęndi dôjat · ęndi iro dag ęndjad,
fulljad mid iro feraḥu; · fęrid un·met grôt
hungar hęti-grim · obar hęliðo barn,
męti-gêdjono mêst: · nis þat minniste
þero wítjo an þesaru wer-oldi, · þe hér gi·werðen skulun
êr dómes dage. · Só hwan só gí þea dádi gi·sehan
gi·werðen an þesaru wer-oldi, · só mugun gí þan te wáran far·standen,
þat þan þe latsto dag · liudjun náhid
mári te mannun · ęndi maht godes,
himil-kraftes hróri · ęndi þes hêlagon kumi,
drohtines mid is diuriðun. · Hwat gí þesaro dádjo mugun
bi þesun bômun · biliði ant·kęnnjen:
þan sie brustjad ęndi blójat · ęndi bladu tôgjat,
lôf ant·lúkad, · þan witun liudjo barn,
þat þan is sán after þiu · sumer gi·náhid
warm ęndi wun-sam · ęndi wedęr skôni.
Só witin gí ôk bi þesun têknun, · þe ik iu talde hér,
hwan þe latsto dag · liudjun náhid.
Þan sęggjo ik iu te wáran, · þat êr þit werod ni mót,
te·faran þit folk-skępi, · êr þan werðe ge·fullid só,
mínu word gi·wárod. · Noh gi·wand kumid
himiles ęndi erðun, · ęndi stéid mín hêlag word
fast forð-wardes · ęndi wirðid al ge·fullod só,
gi·lêstid an þesumu liohte, · só ik for þesun liudjun ge·spriku.
wakot gí war-líko: · iu is wis-kumo
duom-dag þe márjo · ęndi iuwes drohtines kraft,
þiu mikilo męgin-strengi · ęndi þiu márje tíd,
gi·wand þesaro wer-oldes. · Fora þiu gí wardon skulun,
þat hé iu slápandje · an swef-ręstu
fárungo ni bi·fâhe · an firin-werkun,
mênes fulle. · Mút·spelli kumit
an þiustrja naht, · al só þiof fęrid
darno mid is dádjun, · só kumid þe dag mannun,
þe latsto þeses liohtes, · só it êr þese liudi ni witun,
só samo só þiu flód deda · an furn-dagun,
þe þár mid lagu-strômun · liudi far·tęride

bi Nóeas tídjun, · bi·útan þat ina nęride god
mid is híwiskja, · hêlag drohtin,
wið þes flódes farm: · só warð ôk þat fiur kuman
hêt fan himile, · þat þea hôhon burgi
umbi Sodomo land · swart logna bi·féng
grim ęndi grádag, · þat þár n·ênig gumono ni gi·nas
bi·útan Loth êno: · ina ant·lêddun þanen
drohtines ęngilos · ęndi is dohter twá
an ênan berg uppen: · þat òðar al brinnandi fiur,
ia land ia liudi · logna far·tęride:
só fárungo warð þat fiur kumen, · só warð êr þe flód só samo:
só wirðid þe latsto dag. · For þiu skal allaro liudjo ge·hwi-lík
þęnkjan fora þemu þinge; · þes is þarf mikil
manno ge·hwi-líkumu: · be·þiu látad iu an iuwan mód sorga.

TODO.

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4358 Mút·spelli ‘the Muspell’ | See note to l. 259la above.

4369 grim ęndi grádag | Formulaic; OE *grim ǫnd grǽdig* is used of Grendle in *Beow* 121a and his mother in l. 1499a.

**53** Hwand só hwan só þat ge·wirðid, · þat waldand Krist,
mári mannes sunu · mid þeru maht godes,
kumit mid þiu kraftu · kuningo ríkjost
sittjan an is selbes maht · ęndi samod mid imu
alle þea ęngilos, · þe þár uppa sind
hêlaga an himile, · þan skulun þarod hęliðo barn,
ęli-þeoda kuman · alla te·samne
libbjandero liudjo, · só hwat só io an þesumu liohte warð
firiho a·fódid. · Þár hé þemu folke skal,
allumu man-kunnje · mári drohtin
a·dêljen aftar iro dádjun. · Þan skêðid hé þea far·duanan man,
þea far·warhton weros · an þea winistron hand:
só duot hé ôk þea sáligon · an þea swíðeron half;
grótid hé þan þea gódun · ęndi im te·gęgnes sprikid:
„Kumad gí“, kwiðid hé, „þea þár gi·korene sindun, · ęndi ant·fâhad þit kraftiga ríki,
þat góde, þat þár gi·gęręwid stęndid, · þat þár warð gumono barnun
gi·warht fan þesaro wer-oldes ęndje: · iu habad ge·wíhid selbo
fader allaro firiho barno: · gí mótun þesaro frumono neotan,

ge·waldon þeses wídon ríkjas, · hwand gí oft mínan willjon frumidun,
ful·géngun mí gerno · ęndi wárun mí iuwaro gebo mildje,
þan ik bi·þwungan was · þurstu ęndi hungru,
frostu bi·fangan · efþo an feteron lag,
bi·klęmmid an karkare: · oft wurðun mí kumana þarod
helpa fan iuwun handun: · gí wárun mí an iuwomu hugi mildje,
wísodun mín werð-liko.“ · Þan sprikid imu eft þat werod an·gęgin:
„Frô mín þe gódo“, (kweðat sie,) „hwan wári þú bi·fangan só,
be·þwungan an su-líkun þarąbun, · só þú fora þesaru þiod tęlis,
mahtig mênis? · Hwan gi·sah þí man ênig
be·þwungen an su-líkun þarąbun? · Hwat þú habes allaro þiodo gi·wald
iak só samo þero mêðmo, · þero þe io manno barn
ge·wunnun an þesaro wer-oldi.“ · Þan sprikid im eft waldand god:
„só hwat só gí dádun“, (kwiðit hé,) „an iuwes drohtines namon,
gódes far·gábun · an godes êra
þem mannun, þe hér minniston sindun, · þero nú undar þesaru męnegi standad
ęndi þurh ôd-módi · arme wárun
weros, hwand sie mínan willjon frębidun · —só hwat só gí im iuwaro welono far·gábun,
gi·dádun þurh diuriða, · þat ant·féng iuwa drohtin selbo,
þiu helpe kwam te heban-kuninge. · Be·þiu wili iu þe hêlago drohtin
lônon iuwan gi·lôbon: · giþid iu líf êwig.“
Węndid ina þan waldand · an þea winístron hand,
drohtin te þem far·duanun mannun, · sagad im þat sie skulin þea dád ant·gelden,
þea man iro mên-gi·werk: · „nú gí fan mí skulun“, kwiðit hé,
„faran só for·flókane · an þat fiur êwig,
þat þár gi·garęwid warð · godes and-sakun,
fiundo folke · be firin-werkun,
hwand gí mí ni hulpun, · þan mí hunger ęndi þurst
wêgde te wundrun · efþa ik ge·wádjes lôs
géng jámer-mód, · was mí grôtun þarf,

þan ni habde ik þár ênige helpe, · þan ik ge·hęftid was,
an liðo-kospun bi·lokan, · efþa mí legar bi·féng,
swára suhti: · þan ni weldun gí mín siokes þár
wíson mid wihti: · ni was iu werð eo·wiht,
þat gí mín ge·hugdin. · Be·þiu gí an hęllje skulun
þolon an þiustre.“ · Þan sprikid imu eft þiu þiod an·gęgin:
„Wola waldand god“, (kweðad sie,) „hwí wilt þú só wið þit werod sprekan,
mahljen wið þese męnegi? · Hwan was þí io manno þarf,
gumono gódes? · Hwat sie it al be þínun gebun êgun,
welon an þesaro wer-oldi“. · Þan sprikid eft waldand god:
„þan gí þea armostun“, (kwiðid hé,) „ęldi-barno,
manno þea minniston · an iuwomu mód-sebon
hęliðos far·hugdun, · létun sea iu an iuwomu hugi lêðe,
be·dêldun sie iuwaro diurða, · þan dádun gí iuwana drohtin só sama,
gi·węrnidun imu iuwaro welono: · be·þiu ni wili iu waldand god,
ant·fâhen fader iuwa, · ak gí an þat fiur skulun,
an þene diopun dôð, · diuþlun þionon,
wrêðun wiðęr-sakun, · hwand gí só warhtun bi·foran.“
Þan aftar þem wordun skêðit · þat werod an twê,
þea gódun ęndi þea ubilon: · farad þea far·griponon man
an þea hêtan hęl · hriuwig-móde,
þea far·warhton weros, · wíti ant·fâhat,
ubil ęndi-lôs. · Lêdid up þanen
hêr heþan-kuning · þea hluttaron þeoda
an þat lang-same lioht: · þár is líf êwig,
gi·garęwid godes ríki · gódaro þiado.“

TODO.

**Passion.**

**54** Só ge·fragn ik þat þem rinkun þó · ríki drohtin
umbi þesaro wer-oldes gi·wand · wordun talde,
hwó þiu forð fęrid, · þan lango þe sie firiho barn
ardon mótun, · ia hwó siu an þemu ęndje skal
te·glíden ęndi te·gangen. · Hé sagde ôk is jungarun þár

wárun wordun: · „Hwat gí witun alle“, kwað hé,
„þat nú obar twá naht · sind tídi kumana,
Judeono paskha, · þat sie skulun iro gode þionon,
weros an þemu wíhe. · Þes nis ge·wand ênig,
þat þár wirðid mannes sunu · te þeru męgin-þiodu
kraftag far·kôpot · ęndi an krúke a·slagan,
þolod þiad-kwála.“ · Þó warð þár þegạn manag
slíð-mód gi·samnod, · sùðar-liudjo,
Judeono gum-skępi, · þár sie skoldun iro gode þionon.
wurðun êo-sagon · alle kumane,
an warf weros, · þe sie þó wísostun
undar þeru męnegi · manno taldun,
kraftag kuni-burd. · Þár Kaiphas was,
biskop þero liudjo. · Sie rédun þó an þat barn godes,
hwó sie ina a·sluogin · sundja lôsan,
kwáðun þat sie ina an þemu hêlagon daga · hrínen ni skoldin
undar þero manno męnegi, · „þat ni werðe þius męgin-þioda,
hęliðos an hróru, · hwand ina þit hęri-skępi wili
far·standen mid strídu. · Wí só stillo skulun
frêson is ferạhes, · þat þit folk Judeono
an þesun wíh-dagun · wróht ni af·hębbjen.“
Þó géng imu þár Júdas forð, · jungaro Kristes,
ên þero twe-libjo, · þár þat aðali sat,
Judeono gum-skępi; · kwað þat hé is im gódan rád
sęggjan mahti: · „hwat willjad gí mí sęlljen hér“, kwað hé,
„mêðmo te médu, · ef ik iu þene man gibu
áno wíg ęndi áno wróht?“ · Þó warð þes werodes hugi,
þero liudjo an lustun: · „ef þú wili gi·lêstjen só“, kwáðun sie,
„þín word gi·wáron, · þan þú gi·wald habes,
hwat þú at þesaru þiodu · þiggjan willjes
gódaro mêðmo.“ · Þó gi·hét imu þat gum-skępi þár
an is selbes dóm · silụbar-skatto
þrí-tig at·samne, · ęndi hé te þeru þiodu gi·sprak
dęrębjun wordun, · þat hé gábi is drohtin wið þiu.
węnde ina þó fan þemu werode: · was im wrêð hugi,
talode im só treu-lôs, · hwan êr wurði imu þiu tíd kuman,
þat hé ina mahti far·wísjen · wrêðaro þiodo,
fiundo folke. · Þan wisse þat friðu-barn godes,
wár waldand Krist, · þat hé þese wer-old skolde,

a·geben þese gardos · ęndi sókjen imu godes ríki,
gi·faren is fader-óðil. · Þó ni gi·sah ênig firiho barno
mêron minnje, · þan hé þó te þem mannun gi·nam,
te þem is gódun jungaron: · gôme warhte,
sętte sie swás-líko · ęndi im sagde filu
wároro wordo. · Skrêd westęr dag,
sunne te sedle. · Þó hé selbo gi·bôd,
waldand mid is wordun, · hét im water dragan
hluttạr te handun, · ęndi rês þó þe hêlago Krist,
þe gódo at þem gômun · ęndi þár is jungarono þwóg
fóti mid is folmun · ęndi swarf sie mid is fanon aftar,
druknide sie diur-líka. · Þó wið is drohtin sprak
Símon Petrus: · „Ni þunkid mí þit sómi þing“, kwað hé,
„frô mín þe gódo, · þat þú míne fóti þwahes
mid þem þínun hêlagun handun.“ · Þó sprak imu eft is hêrro an·gęgin,
waldand mid is wordun: · „Ef þú is willjan ni habes“, kwað hé,
„te ant·fâhanne, · þat ik þíne fóti þwahe
þurh su-líka minnja, · só ik þesun óðrun mannun hér
dóm þurh diurða, · þan ni habes þú ênigan dêl mid mí
an heban-ríkja.“ · Hugi warð þó gi·węndid
Símon Petruse: · „Þú haba þí selbo gi·wald“, kwað hé,
„frô mín þe gódo, · fóti ęndi hando
ęndi mínes hôbdes só sama, · *handun þínun*,
þiadan, te þwahanne, · te þiu þat ik móti þína forð
huldi hębbjan · ęndi heban-ríkjes
su-lík gi·dêli, · só þú mí, drohtin, wili
far·geben þurh þína gódi.“ · Jungaron Kristes,
þene ambaht-skępi · erlos þolodun,
þegnos mid gi·þuldjon, · só hwat só im iro þiodan dede,
mahtig þurh þea minnja, · ęndi mênde imu al méra þing
firihon te gi·frummjenne.

TODO.

4517' *handun þínun* | *emend. accepted by most eds.; om.* ***MC***

4517' frô … *þínun* | Treated as one line by Sievers (1878) (who does not emend the b-verse *handun þínun*), whence the skipped numbering.

**55** Friðu-barn godes

géng imu þó eft gi·sittjen · under þat ge·síðo folk

ęndi im sagda filu lang-samna rád. · Warð eft lioht kuman,
morgen te mannun. · Mahtigne Krist
gróttun is jungaron ęndi frágodun, · hwár sie is gôma þó
an þemu wíh-dage · wirkjen skoldin,
hwar hé weldi halden · þea hêlagon tídi
selbo mid is ge·sïðun. · Þó hé sie sókjen hét,
þea gumon Jerusalem: · „só gí þan gangan kumad“, kwað hé,
„an þea burg innan · —þár is braht mikil,
męgin-þiodo gi·mang—, · þár mugun gí ênan man sehan
an is handun dragen · hluttres watares
ful mid folmun. · Þemu gí folgon skulun
an só hwi-líke gardos, · só gí ina gangan gi·sehat,
ia gí þan þemu hêrron, · þe þie hobos êgi,
selbon sęggjad, · þat ik iu sęnde þarod
te gi·garuwenne mína gôma. · Þan tôgid hé iu ên gód-lík hús,
hôhan sóleri, · þe is bi·hangen al
fagarun fratahun. · Þár gí frummjen skulun
werd-skępi mínan. · Þár bium ik wis-kumo
selbo mid mínun ge·sïðun.“ · Þó wurðun sán aftar þiu
þár te Jerusalem · jungaron Kristes
forð-ward an fęrdi, · fundun all só hé sprak
word-têkạn wár: · ni was þes gi·wand ênig.
Þár gęręwidun sie þea gôma. · Warð þe godes sunu,
hêlag drohtin · an þat hús kuman,
þár sie þe land-wíse · lêstjen skoldun,
ful·gangan godes gi·bode, · al só Judeono was
êo ęndi ald-sidu · an êr-dagun.
Gi·wêt imu þó an þemu ábande · alo-waldand Krist
an þene sęli sittjen; · hét þár is ge·sïðos te imu
twe-libi gangan, · þea im gi·triuwiston
an iro mód-sebon · manno wárun
bi wordun ęndi bi wísun: · wisse imu selbo
iro hugi-skęfti · hêlag drohtin.
Grótte sie þó obar þem gômun: · „Gern bium ik swíðo“, kwað hé,
„þat ik samad mid iu · sittjen móti,
gômono neoten, · Judeono paskha
dêljen mid iu só diurjun. · Nú ik iu iuwes drohtines skal
willjon sęggjan, · þat ik an þesaro wer-oldi ni mót

mid mannun mêr · móses an·bíten
furður mid firihun, · êr þan gi·fullod wirðid
himilo ríki. · Mí is an handun nú
wíti ęndi wundęr-kwále, · þea ik for þesumu werode skal,
þolon for þesaru þiodu.“ · Só hé þó só te þem þegnun sprak,
hêlag drohtin, · só warð imu is hugi dróbi,
warð imu gi·sworken sebo, · ęndi eft te þem ge·síðun sprak,
þe gódo te þem is jungarun: · „Hwat ik iu godes ríki“, kwað hé,
„gi·hét himiles lioht, · ęndi gí mí hold-líko
iuwan þegąn-skępi. · Nú ni willjat gí a·þęngjan só,
ak węnkjat þero wordo. · Nú sęggju ik iu te wáran hér,
þat wili iuwar twe-libjo ên · treuwana swíkan,
wili mí far·kôpon · undar þit kunni Judeono,
gi·sęlljen wiðęr silubre, · ęndi wili imu þár sink niman,
diurje mêðmos, · ęndi geben is drohtin wið þiu,
holdan hêrran. · Þat imu þoh te harme skal,
werðan te wítje; · be þat hé þea wurdi far·sihit
ęndi hé þes arbêdjes · ęndi skawot,
þan wêt hé þat te wáran, · þat imu wári wóðjera þing,
bętera mikilu, · þat hé gio gi·boran ni wurði
libbjendi te þesumu liohte, · þan hé þat lôn nimid,
ubil arbêdi · in·wid-rádo.“
Þó bi·gan þero erlo ge·hwi-lík · te ôðrumu skawon,
sorgondi sehan; · was im sêr hugi,
hriuwig umbi iro herta: · gi·hôrdun iro hêrron þó
gorn-word sprekan. · Þea gumon sorgodun,
hwi-líkan hé þero twe-libjo · te þiu tęlljen weldi,
skuldigna skaðon, · þat hé habdi þea skattos þár
ge·þingod at þeru þiod. · Ni was þero þegno ênigumu
su-líkes in·widdjes · ôði te gehanne,
mên-gi·þáhtjo · —ant·suok þero manno ge·hwi-lík—,
wurðun alle an forhtun, · frágon ne gi·dorstun,
êr þan þó ge·bôknide · bar-wirðig gumo,
Símon Petrus · —ne gi·dorste it selbo sprekan—
te Johanne þemu gódon: · hé was þemu godes barne
an þem dagun · þegno liobost,
mêst an minnjun · ęndi móste þár þó an þes mahtiges Kristes
barme ręstjen · ęndi an is breostun lag,

hlinode mid is hôbdu: · þár nam hé só manag hêlag ge·rúni,
diapa gi·þáhti, · ęndi þó te is drohtine sprak,
be·gan ina þó frágon: · „hwe skal þat, frô mín, wesen“, kwað hé,
„þat þi far·kôpon wili, · kuningo ríkjost,
undar þínaro fiundo folk? · Ús wári þes firi-wit mikil,
waldand, te witanne.“ · Þó habde eft is word garu
hêljando Krist: · „seh þi, hwemu ik hér an hand gebe
mínes móses for þesun mannun: · þe habed mên-gi·þáht,
birid bittran hugi; · þe skal mí an banono ge·wald,
fiundun bi·felhen, · þár man mínes ferhes skal,
aldres áhtjen.“ · Nam hé þó aftar þiu
þes móses for þem mannun · ęndi gaf is þemu mên-skaðen,
Judase an hand · ęndi imu te·gęgnes sprak
selbo for þem is ge·síðun · ęndi ina sniumo hét
faran fan þemu is folke: · „frumi só þú þęnkis“, kwað hé,
„dó þat þú duan skalt: · þú ni maht bi·dęrnjen lęng
willjon þínan. · Þiu wurd is at handun,
þea tídi sind nú gi·náhid.“ · Só þó þe treu-logo
þat mós ant·féng · ęndi mid is müðu an·bêt,
só af·gaf ina þó þiu godes kraft, · gramon in ge·witun
an þene lík-hamon, · lêða wihti,
warð imu Satanas · sêro bi·tęngi,
hardo umbi is herte, · síður ine þiu helpe godes
far·lét an þesumu liohte. · Só is þena liudjo wê,
þe só undar þesumu himile skal · hêrron wehslon.

TODO.

**56** Gi·wêt imu þó út þanen · in·widjas gern
Judas gangan: · habde imu grimmen hugi
þegạn wið is þiodan. · Was þó iu þiustri naht,
swíðo gi·sworken. · Sunu drohtines
was ima at þem gômun forð · ęndi is jungarun þár
waldand wín ęndi brôd · wíhide bêðju,
hêlagode heban-kuning, · mid is handun brak,
gaf it undar þem is jungarun · ęndi gode þankode,
sagde þem á-lát, · þe þár al gi·skóp,
wer-old ęndi wunnja, · ęndi sprak word manag:
„gi·lôbjot gí þes liohto“, (kwað hé,) „þat þit is mín lík-hamo

ęndi mín blód só same: · giƀu ik iu hér bêðju samad
etan ęndi drinkan. · Þit ik an erðu skal
geƀan ęndi geotan · ęndi iu te godes ríkje
lôsjen mid mínu lík-hamen · an líf êwig,
an þat himiles lioht. · Gi·huggjat gí simlun,
þat gí þiu ful·gangan, · þiu ik an þesun gômun dón;
márjad þit for męnegi: · þit is mahtig þing,
mid þius skulun gí iuwomu drohtine · diuriða frummjen,
habbjad þit mín te gi·hugdjun, · hêlag biliði,
þat it ęldi-barn · aftar lêstjen,
waron an þesaru wer-oldi, · þat þat witin alle,
man oƀar þesan middil-gard, · þat it is þurh mína minnja gi·duan
hêrron te huldi. · Ge·huggjad gí simlun,
hweo ik iu hér ge·biudu, · þat gí iuwan bróðer-skępi
fasto frummjad: · habbjad ferhtan hugi,
minnjod iu an iuwomu móde, · þat þat manno barn
oƀar irmin-þiod · alle far·standen,
þat gí sind gegnungo · jungaron míne.
Ôk skal ik iu kûðjen, · hwó hér wili kraftag fíund,
hętt jand heru-grim, · umbi iuwan hugi niusjen,
Satanas selƀo: · hé kumid iuwaro seolono herod
frókno frêson. · Simlun gí fasto te gode
ƀerad iuwa ƀreost-gi·þáht: · ik skal an iuwaru ƀedu standen,
þat iu ni mugi þe mên-skaðo · mód ge·twífljan;
ik ful-lêstju iu wiðęr þemu fiunde. · Ôk kwam hé herod giu frêson mín,
þoh imu is willjon hér · wiht ne gi·stódi,
liooƀes an þemu mínumu lík-hamon. · Nú ni willju ik iu lęng helen,
hwat iu hér nú sniumo skal · te sorgu gi·standen:
gí skulun mí ge·swíkan, · ge·síðos míne,
iuwes þegąn-skępjes, · êr þan þius þiustrje naht
liudi far·líða · ęndi eft lioht kume,
morgan te mannun.“ · Þó warð mód gumon
swíðo gi·sworken · ęndi sêr hugi,
hriuwig umbi iro herte · ęndi iro hêrron word
swíðo an sorgun. · Símon Petrus þó,
þegąn wið is þiodan · þríst-wordun sprak

bí huldi *wið is hêrron: · „þoh þí all þit hęliðo folk“, kwaþ-hie,
„gi·swíkan þína gi·síðos, · þoh ik sinnon mid þí
at allon þarąbon · þolojan willju.
Ik biun garo sinnon, · ef mí god látið,
þat ik an þínon ful-lêstje · fasto gi·stande;
þoh sia þi an karkarjes · klústron hardo,
þesa liudi bi·lúkan, · þoh ist mí luttil tweho,
ne ik an þem bęndjon mid þi · bídan willje,
liggjan mid þi só lieben; · ef sia þínes líbes þan
þuru ęggja níð · áhtjan willjad,
frô mín þie guodo, · ik giþu mín ferąh furi þik
an wápno spil: · nis mí werð iowiht
te bi·míðanne, · só lango só mí mín warod
hugi ęndi hand-kraft.“ · Þuo sprak im eft is hêrro an·gęgin:
„Hwat þú þik bi·wánis“, (kwaþ-hie,) „wissaro treuwono,
þrístero þingo: · þú habis þegnes hugi,
willjon guodan. · Ik mag þí sęggjan, hwó it þoh gi·werðan skal,
þat þú wirðis só wêk-muod, · þoh þú nú ni wánjes só,
þat þú þínes þiadnes te naht · þríwo far·lôgnis
êr hano-krádi ęndi kwiðis, · þak ik þín hêrro ni sí,
ak þú far·manst mína mund-burd.“ · Þuo sprak eft þie man an·gęgin:
„ef it gio an wer-oldi“, (kwaþ-hie,) „gi·werðan muosti,
þat ik samad midi þí · sweltan muosti,
dôjan diur-líko, · þan ne wurði gio þie dag kuman,
þat ik þín far·lôgnidi, · liebo drohtin,
gerno for þeson Juðeon.“ · Þuo kwáðun alla þia jungron só,
þat sia þár an þem þingon mid im · þoljan weldin.

TODO. Then Simon Peter,
the thane, to his theeden spoke brave words
out of loyalty to his lord: “Although this whole host of heroes,” quoth he,
“and thy followers should forsake thee, yet I nevertheless
with thee will suffer through all hardships.
I am nevertheless ready, if God lets me,
that I should stand steadfast as thy support.
Although this people should lock thee
behind the hard bars of prison, still I have little doubt
that I in those bonds will abide with thee,
and lie by thee so dear. If they then through the hatred
of blades wish to take thy life,

O my good Lord, I will give my breath for thee
in the play of weapons. There is nothing worth for me
to avoid for as long as I possess
my heart and strength of hand." Then his Lord spoke back to him:
"How thou thinkest thyself capable", quoth he, "of certain loyalty,
of bold conflicts! Thou hast a thane's heart,
a good will. Yet I can tell thee how it shall turn out
that thou in one night wilt thrice deny thy theeden
ere the cock-crow, and say that I am not thy lord;
instead thou wilt renounce my protection." Then the man spoke back to him:
"If it ever in this world must turn out so
that I alongside thee must perish
die dearly, evenso the day will never come
that I should deny thee, beloved lord,
eagerly before these Jews." Then all the disciples said so,
that there in the conflicts with him they would suffer.

**57**

Þuo im eft mid is wordon gi·bôd · waldand selbo,
hêr heƀan-kuning, · þat sia im ni lietin iro hugi twífljan,
hiet þat sia ni weldin [...] · diopa gi·þâhti:
„Ne druoƀje iuwa herta · þuru iuwes drohtines word,
ne forǫhtjat te filo: · ik skal fader ùsan
selƀan suokjan · ǫndi iu sǫndjan skal
fan heƀan-ríkje · hêlagna gêst:
þie skal iu eft gi·fruofrjan · ǫndi te frumu werðan,
manon iu þero mahlo, · þie ik iu manag hębbju
wordon gi·wísid. · Hie gibit iu gi·wit an briost,
lust-sama lêra, · þat gí lêstjan forð
þiu word ǫndi þiu werk, · þia ik iu an þesaro wer-oldi gi·bôd."
A·rês im þuo þe ríkjo · an þemo rakode innan,
nǫrjendo Krist · ǫndi gi·wêt im nahtes þanan
selbo mid is gi·síðon: · sêrago géngun
swíðo gornondja · jungron Kristes,
hriuwig-muoda. · Þuo hie im an þena hôhan gi·wêt
Oliueti-berg: · þár was hie up gi·wuno
gangan mid is jungron. · Þat wissa Judas wel,
balo-hugdig man, · hwand hie was oft an þem berǫge mid im.
Þár gruotta þie godes suno · jùgron sína:
„Gí sind nú só druoƀja", (kwaþ-hie,) „nú gí mínan dôð witun;
nú gornonð gí ǫndi griotand, · ǫndi þesa Juðeon sind an luston,

męndit þius męnigi, · sindun an iro muode fráha,
þius wer-old ist an wunnjon. · Þes wirðit þoh gi·wand kuman
sniumo tulgo: · þan wirðit im sêr hugi,
þan mornjat sia an iro móde, · ęndi gí męndjan skulun
after te êwon-dage, · hwand gio ęndi ni kumið,
iuwes wel-líbes gi·wand: · be·þiu ne þurbun iu þius werk tregan,
hreuwan mín hin-fard, · hwand þanan skal þiu helpa kuman
gumono barnon.“ · Þuo hiet hie is jungron þár
bídan uppan þemo berge, · kwað þat hie ti bedu weldi
an þiu holm-kliþu · hôhor stígan;
hiet þuo þria mid im · þegnos gangan,
Jakobe ęndi Johannese · ęndi þena guodan Petruse,
þríst-muodjan þegạn. · Þuo sia mid iro þiedne samad
gerno géngun. · Þuo hiet sia þie godes suno
an berge uppan · te bedu hnígan,
hiet sia god gruotjan, · *gerno biddjan,
þat hé im þero kostondero · kraft far·stódi,
wrêðaro willjon, · þat im þe wiðęr-sako,
ni mahti þe mên-skaðo · mód gi·twífljan,
iak imu þó selbo gi·hnêg · sunu drohtines
kraftag an knio-beda, · kuningo ríkjost,
forð-ward te foldu: · fader alo-þiado
gódan grótte, · gorn-wordun sprak
hriuwig-líko: · was imu is hugi dróbi,
bi þeru męnniski · mód gi·hrórid,
is flêsk was an forhtun: · fellun imo trahni,
drôp is diur-lík swêt, · al só drôr kumid
wallan fan wundun. · Was an ge·winne þó
an þemu godes barne · þe gêst ęndi þe lík-hamo:
ôðar was fûsid · an forð-wegos,
þe gêst an godes ríki, · ôðar jámar stód,
lík-hamo Kristes: · ni welde þit lioht a·geben,
ak dróbde for þemu dôðe. · Simla hé hreop te drohtine forð
þiu mêr aftar þiu · mahtigna grótte,
hôhan himil-fader, · hêlagna god,
waldand mid is wordun: · „ef nú werðen ni mag“, kwað hé,
„man-kunni ge·nęrid, · ne sí þat ik mínan gebe
lioban lík-hamon · for liudjo barn

te wêgjanne te wundrun, · it sí þan þín willjo só,
ik willju is þan gi·koston: · ik nimu þene kęlik an hand,
drinku ina þi te diurðu, · drohtin frô mín,
mahtig mund-boro. · Ni seh þú mínes hér
flêskes gi·fórjes. · Ik fullon skal
willjon þínen: · þú habes ge·wald obar al.“
Gi·wêt imu þó gangen, · þár hé êr is jungaron lét
bídan uppan þemu berge; · fand sie þat barn godes
slápen sorgandje: · was im sêr hugi,
þes sie fan iro drohtine · dêljen skoldun.
Só sind þat mód-þraka · manno ge·hwi-líkumu,
þat hé far·láten skal · liabane hêrron,
af·geben þene só gódene. · Þó hé te is jungarun sprak,
wahte sie waldand · ęndi wordun grótte:
„Hwí willjad gí só slápen?“ (kwað hé;) „ni mugun samad mid mí
wakon êne tíd? · Þiu wurd is at handun,
þat it só gi·gangen skal, · só it god fader
gi·markode mahtig. · Mí nis an mínumu móde tweho:
mín gêst is garu · an godes willjan,
fûs te faranne: · mín flêsk is an sorgun,
lętid mik mín lík-hamo: · lêð is imu swíðo
wíti te þolonne. · Ik þoh willjan skal
mínes fader ge·frummjen; · hębbjad gí fasten hugi.“
Gi·wêt imu þó eft þanan · ôðer-síðu
an þene berg uppen · te bedu gangan,
mári drohtin, · ęndi þár só manag gi·sprak
gódoro wordo. · Godes ęngil kwam
hêlag fan himile, · is hugi fastnode,
bęldide te þem bęndjun. · Hé was an þeru bedu simla
forð an flíte · ęndi is fader grótte,
waldand mid is wordun: · „ef it nú wesen ni mag“, kwað hé,
„mári drohtin, · nebu ik for þit manno folk
þiod-kwále þoloje, · ik an þínan skal
willjan wonjan.“ · Gi·wêt imu þó eft þanen
sókjan is ge·síðos: · fand sie slápandje,
grótte sie gáhun. · Géng imu eft þanen
þriddjon síðu te bedu · ęndi sprak þiod-kuning
al þiu selbon word, · sunu drohtines,
te þemu alo-waldon fader, · só hé êr dede,

manode mahtigna · manno frumana
swíðo niud-líko · nęrjando Krist,
géng imu þó eft te þem is jungarun, · grótte sie sáno:
„slápad gí ęndi ręstjad“, (kwað hé,) „nú wirðid sniumo herod
kuman mid kraftu, · þe mí far·kôpot haƀad,
sundja lôsan gi·sald.“ · Ge·síðos Kristes
wakodun þó aftar þem wordun · ęndi gi·sáhun þó þat werod kuman
an þene berg uppen · brahtmu þiu mikilon,
wrêða wápạn-berand.

TODO.

**58** Wísde im Judas,
gram-hugdig man; · Judeon aftar sigun,
fiundo folk-skępi; · dróg man fiur an gi·mang,
logna an lioht-fatun, · lêdde man faklon
brinnandja fan burg, · þár sie an þene berg uppan
stigun mid strídu. · Þea stędi wisse Judas wel,
hwár hé þea liudi · tó lêdjan skolde.
Sagde imu þó te têkne, · þó sie þár tó fórun
þemu folke bi·foran, · te þiu þat sie ni far·féngin þár,
erlos ôðren man: · „ik gangu imu at êrist tó“, kwað hé,
„kussju ine ęndi kwaddju: · þat is Krist selƀo.
Þene gí fáhen skulun · folko kraftu,
binden ina uppan þemu berge · ęndi ina te burg hinan
lêdjen undar þea liudi: · hé is líƀes haƀad
mid is wordun far·werkod.“ · Werod síðode þó,
ant-tat sie te Kriste · kumane wurðun,
grim folk Judeono, · þár hé mid is jungarun stód,
mári drohtin: · bêd metodo-gi·skapu,
torhtero tídjo. · Þó géng imu treu-lôs man,
Judas te·gęgnes · ęndi te þemu godes barne
hnêg mid is hôƀdu · ęndi is hêrron kwędde,
kuste ina kraftagne · ęndi is kwidi lêste,
wísde ina þemu werode, · al só hé êr mid wordun ge·hét.
Þat þolode al mid gi·þuldjun · þiodo drohtin,
waldand þesara wer-oldes · ęndi sprak imu mid is wordun tó,
frágode ine frókno: · „be·hwí kumis þú só mid þius folku te mí,

be·hwí lêdis þú mí só þese liudi tó · ęndi mí te þesare lêðan þiode sprekan,
far·kôpos mid þínu kussu · under þit kunni Judeono,
meldos mí te þesaru męnegi?“ · Géng imu þó wið þea man
wið þat werod òðar · ęndi sie mid is wordun fragn,
hwene sie mid þiu ge·siðju · sókjan kwámin
só niud-liko an naht, · „so gí willjan nôd frummjen
manno hwi-líkumu.“ · Þó sprak imu eft þiu męnegi an·gęgin,
kwáðun þat im hêljand · þár an þemu holme uppan
ge·wísid wári, · „þe þit gi·wer frumid
Judeo liudjun · ęndi ina godes sunu
selbon hêtid. · Ina kwámun wí sókjan herod,
weldin ina gerno bi·geten: · hé is fan Galileo lande,
fan Nazareth-burg.“ · Só im þó þe nęrjendjo Krist
sagde te sòðan, · þat hé it selbo was,
só wurðun þó an forhtun · folk Judeono,
wurðun under·badode, · þat sie under bak fellun
alle efno sán, · erðe gi·sóhtun,
wiðęr·wardes þat werod: · ni mahte þat word godes,
þie stemnje ant·standan: · wárun þoh só strídige man,
a·hliopun eft up an þemu holme, · hugi fastnodun,
bundun briost-gi·þáht, · gi·bolgane géngun
náhor mid níðu, · ant-tat sie þene nęrjendjon Krist
werodo bi·wurpun. · Stódun wíse man,
swíðo gornundje · jungaron Kristes
bi·foran þeru dęrębjon dádi · ęndi te iro drohtine sprákun:
„wári it nú þín willjo“, (kwáðun sie,) „waldand frô mín,
þat sie ùs hér an speres ordun · spildjen móstin
wápnun wunde, · þan ni wári ùs wiht só gód,
só þat wí hér for ùsumu drohtine · dóan móstin
bęniðjun blêka“. · Þó gi·bolgan warð
snel swerd-þegạn, · Símon Petrus,
well imu innan hugi, · þat hé ni mahte ênig word sprekan:
só harm warð imu an is hertan, · þat man is hêrron þár
binden welde. · Þó hé gi·bolgan géng,
swíðo þríst-mód þegạn · for is þiodan standen,
hard for is hêrron: · ni was imu is hugi twífli,
blóð an is breostun, · ak hé is bil a·tôh,
swerd bi sídu, · slóg imu te·gęgnes

an þene furiston fiund · folmo krafto,
þat þó Malkhus warð · mákjas ęggjun,
an þea swíðaron half · swerdu gi·málod:
þiu hlust warð imu far·hawan, · hé warð an þat hôbid wund,
þat imu heru-drôrag · hlear ęndi ôre
bęni-wundun brast: · blód aftar sprang,
well fan wundun. · Þó was an is wangun skard
þe furisto þero fiundo. · Þó stód þat folk an rúm:
an·drédun im þes billes biti. · Þó sprak þat barn godes
selbo te Símon Petruse, · hét þat hé is swerd dedi
skarp an skêðja: · „ef ik wið þesa skola weldi“, kwað hé,
„wið þeses werodes ge·win · wíg-saka frummjen,
þan manodi ik þene márjon · mahtigne god,
hêlagne fader · an himil-ríkja,
þat hé mí só managan ęngil herod · obana sandi
wíges só wísen, · só ni mahtin iro wápaṇ-þręki
man a·dôgjan: · iro ni stódi gio su-lík męgin samad,
folkes gi·fastnod, · þat im iro ferh aftar þiu
werðen mahti. · Ak it habad waldand god,
alo-mahtig fader · an ôðar gi·markot,
þat wí gi·þolojan skulun, · só hwat só ùs þius þioda tó
bittres bręngit: · ni skulun ùs belgan wiht,
wrêðjan wið iro ge·winne; · hwand só hwe só wápno níð,
grimman gêr-hęti wili · gerno frummjen,
hé swiltit imu · eft swerdes ęggjun,
dóit im bi·drôregan: · wí mid ùsun dádjun ni skulun
wiht a·węrdjan.“ · Géng hé þó te þemu wundon manne,
lęgde mid listjun · lík te·samne,
hôbid-wundon, · þat siu sán gi·hêlid warð,
þes billes biti, · ęndi sprak þat barn godes
wið þat wrêðe werod: · „mí þunkid wundęr mikil“, kwað hé,
„ef gí mí lêðes wiht · lêstjen weldun,
hwí gí mí þó ni féngun, · þan ik undar iuwomu folke stód,
an þemu wíhe innan · ęndi þár word manag
sòð-lík sagde. · Þan was sunnon skín,
diur-lik dages lioht, · þan ni weldun gí mí dóan eo·wiht
lêðes an þesumu liohte, · ęndi nú lêdjad mí iuwa liudi tó
an þiustrje naht, · al só man þiobe dót,
þan man þene fâhan wili · ęndi hé is ferhes habad

far·werkot, wam-skaðo.“ · werod Judeono
gripun þó an þene godes sunu, · grimma þioda,
hatandjero hóp, · hwurbun ina umbi
módag manno folk · —mênes ni sáhun—,
hęftun heru-bęndjun · handi te·samne,
faðmos mid fiterjun. · Im ni was su-líkaro firin-kwála
þarf te gi·þolonne, · þiod-arbêdjes,
te winnanne su-lík wíti, · ak hé it þurh þit werod deda,
hwand hé liudjo barn · lôsjen welda,
halon fan hęllju · an himil-ríki,
an þene wídon welon: · be·þiu hé þes wiht ne bi·sprak,
þes sie imu þurh in·wid-níð · ógjan weldun.

TODO.

**59** Þó wurðun þes só malske · módag folk Judeono,
þiu hêri warð þes só hrómeg, · þes sie þena hêlagon Krist
an liðo-bęndjon · lêdjan muostun,
fórjan an fiterjun. · Þie fiund eft ge·witun
fan þemu berge te burg. · Géng þat barn godes
undar þemu hęri-skępi · handun ge·bunden,
drúbondi te dale. · Wárun imu þea is diurjon þó
ge·síðos ge·swikane, · al só hé im êr selbo gi·sprak:
ni was it þoh be ênigaru blóði, · þat sie þat barn godes,
lioben far·létun, · ak it was só lango bi·foren
wár-sagono word, · þat it skoldi gi·werðen só:
be·þiu ni mahtun sie is be·míðan. · Þan aftar þeru męnegi géngun
Johannes ęndi Petrus, · þie gumon twêne,
folgodun ferrane: · was im firi-wit mikil,
hwat þea grimmon Judeon · þemu godes barne,
weldin iro drohtine dóen. · Þó sie te dale kwámun
fan þemu berge te burg, · þár iro biskop was,
iro wíhes ward, · þár lêddun ina wlanke man,
erlos undar ederos. · Þár was êld mikil,
fiur an fríd-hobe · þemu folke te·gęgnes,
ge·warht for þemu werode: · þár géngun sie im węrmjen tó,
Judeo liudi, · létun þene godes sunu
bídon an bęndjun. · Was þár braht mikil,
gêl-módigaro galm. · Johannes was êr

þemu hêroston kûð: · be·þiu móste hé an þene hof innan
þringan mid þeru þioda. · Stód allaro þegno bętsto,
Petrus þár úte: · ni lét ina þe portun ward
folgon is frôen, · êr it at is friunde a·bad,
Johannes at ênumu Judeon, · þat man ina gangan lét
forð an þene frîd-hof. · Þár kwam im ên fêkni wíf
gangan te·gęgnes, · þiu ênas Judeon was,
iro þeodanes þiw, · ęndi þó te þemu þegne sprak
magað un·wán-lík: · „Hwat þú mahtis man wesan“, kwað siu,
„jungaro fan Galilea, · þes þe þár genower stéd
faðmun gi·fastnod.“ · Þó an forhtun warð
Símon Petrus sán, · slak an is móde,
kwað þat hé þes wíbes · word ni bi·konsti
ni þes þeodanes · þegąn ni wári:
mêð is þó for þeru męnegi, · kwað þat hé þena man ni ant·kęndi:
„ni sind mí þíne kwidi kûðe“, (kwað hé;) was imu þiu kraft godes,
þe hęrdislo fan þemu hertan. · Hwarąbondi géng
forð undar þemu folke, · ant-tat hé te þemu fiure kwam;
gi·wêt ina þó warmjen. · Þár im ôk ên wíf bi·gan
fęlgjan firin-spráka: · „hér mugun gí“, kwað siu, „an iuwan fiund sehan:
þit is gegnungo · jungaro Kristes,
is selbes ge·síð.“ · Þó géngun imu sán aftar þiu
náhor níð-hwata · ęndi ina niud-líko
frágodun fiundo barn, · hwi-líkes hé folkes wári:
“ni bist þú þesoro burg-liudjo“, (kwáðun sie;) „þat mugun wí an þínumu gi·bárje gi·sehan,
an þínun wordun ęndi an þínaru wíson, · þat þú þeses werodes ni bist,
ak þú bist galiléisk man.“ · hé ni welda þes þó gehan eo·wiht,
ak stód þó ęndi strídda · ęndi starkan êð
swíð-líko ge·swór, · þat hé þes ge·síðes ni wári.
Ni habda is wordo ge·wald: · it skolde gi·werðen só,
só it þe ge·markode, · þe man-kunnjes
far·wardot an þesaru wer-oldi. · Þó kwam imu ôk an þemu warbe tó
þes mannes mág-wini, · þe hé êr mid is mákjo gi·héw,
swerdu þiu skarpon, · kwað þat hé ina sáhi þár

an þemu berge uppan, · „þár wí an þemu bôm-gardon
hêrron þínumu · hęndi bundun,
fastnodun is folmos.“ · Hé þó þurh forhtan hugi
for·lôgnide þes is lioƀes hêrron, · kwað þat hé weldi wesan þes líbes skolo,
ef it mahti ênig þár · irmin-manno
gi·sęggjan te sòðan, · þat hé þes ge·síðes wári,
folgodi þeru fęrdi. · Þó warð an þena formon síð
hano-krád af·haben. · Þó sah þe hêlago Krist,
barno þat bętste, · þár hé ge·bunden stóð,
selƀo te Símon Petruse, · sunu drohtines
te þemu erle oƀar is ahsla. · Þó warð imu an innan sán,
Símon Petruse · sêr an is móde,
harm an is hertan · ęndi is hugi dróƀi,
swíðo warð imu an sorgun, · þat hé êr selƀo ge·sprak:
gi·hugde þero wordo þó, · þe imu êr waldand Krist
selƀo sagda, · þat hé an þeru swartan naht
êr hano-krádi · is hêrron skoldi
þríwo far·lôgnjen. · Þes þram imu an innan mód
bittro an is breostun, · ęndi géng imu þó gi·bolgan þanen
þe man fan þeru męnigi · an mód-karu,
swíðo an sorgun, · ęndi is selƀes word,
wam-skęfti weop, · ant-tat imu wallan kwámun
þurh þea hert-kara · hête trahni,
blódage fan is breostun. · Hé ni wánde þat hé is mahti gi·bótjen wiht,
firin-werko furður · efþa te is frâhon kuman,
hêrron huldi: · nis ênig hęliðo só ald,
þat io mannes sunu · mêr gi·sáhi
is selƀes word · sêrur hreuwan,
karon efþa kúmjen: · „Wola krafteg god“, kwað hé,
þat ik hębbju mí só for·werkot, · só ik mínaro wer-oldes ni þarf
ó-lát sęggjan. · Ef ik nú te aldre skal
huldjo þínaro · ęndi heƀan-ríkjas,
þeoden, þolojan, · þan ni þarf mí þes ênig þank wesan,
lioƀo drohtin, · þat ik io te þesumu liohte kwam.
Ni bium ik nú þes wirðig, · waldand frô mín,
þat ik under þíne jungaron · gangan móti,
þus sundig under þíne ge·síðos: · ik iro selƀo skal

míðan an mínumu móde, · nú ik mí su-lík mên ge·sprak.“
Só gornode · gumono bętsta,
hrau im só hardo, · þat hé habde is hêrren þó
leobes far·lôgnid. · Þan ni þurbun þes liudjo barn,
weros wundrojan, · be·hwí it weldi god,
þat só lioben man · lêð gi·stódi,
þat hé só hôn-líko · hêrron sínes
þurh þera þiwun word, · þegno snellost,
far·lôgnide só liobes: · it was al bi þesun liudjun gi·duan,
firiho barnun te frumu. · Hé welde ina te furiston dóan,
hêrost obar is híwiski, · hêlag drohtin:
lét ina ge·kunnon, · hwi-líke kraft habet
þe męnniska mód · áno þe maht godes;
lét ina ge·sundjon, · þat hé síðor þiu bęt
liudjun gi·lôbdi, · hwó liof is þár
manno gi·hwi-líkumu, · þan hé mên ge·frumit,
þat man ina a·láte · lêðes þinges,
sakono ęndi sundjono, · só im þó selbo dede
heban-ríki god · harm-ge·wurhti.

TODO.
‘So lamented the best of men,
he was so greatly troubled that he had then denied
his beloved lord. Then did the children of men,
the heroes, not need wonder at why God
would have it that such a beloved man should stand in pain,
that he, the most valiant of thanes, had so shamefully
denied his own lord so beloved
through those three speeches. It was all done on behalf of these men,
to the profit of the children of folk. He, the Holy Lord,
would make him the foremost, the noblest, over His retinue.
He made him experience just what strength
the human mind has without the might of God.
He let him sin so that he afterwards could
yet better make men believe what love there exists
for whichever man has committed evil,
that men may forgive him for his loathsome deed,
for his crimes and sins, as him did the very
God of the Heavenly Realm [forgive] for his works of harm.

**60** Be þiu nis mannes bág · mikilun bi·þęrbi,
hagu-staldes hróm: · ef imu þiu helpe godes
ge·swíkid þurh is sundjon, · þan is imu sán aftar þiu

breost-hugi blôðora, · þoh hé êr bi-hêt spreka,
hrómje fan is hildi · ęndi fan is hand-krafti,
þe man fan is męgine. · Þat warð þár an þemu márjon skín,
þegno bętston, · þó imu is þiodanes gi·swêk
hêlag helpe. · Be·þiu ni skoldi hrómjen man
te swíðo fan imu selbon, · hwand imu þár swíkid oft
wán ęndi willjo, · ef imu waldand god,
hêr heban-kuning · herte ni stęrkit.
Þan bêd allaro barno bętst, · bęndi þolode
þurh man-kunni. · Hwurbun ina managa umbi
Judeono liudi, · sprákun gelp mikil,
habdun ina te hoska, · þár hé gi·hęftid stód,
þolode mid ge·þuldjun, · só hwat só imu þiu þiod deda,
liudi lêðes. · Þó warð eft lioht kuman,
morgan te mannun. · Manag samnoda
hęri Judeono: · habdun im hugi wulbo,
in·wid an innan. · Warð þár êo-sago
an morgan-tíd · manag gi·samnod
irri ęndi ên-hard, · in·widjas gern,
wrêðes willjan. · Géngun im an warf samad
rinkos an rúna, · bi·gunnun im rádan þó,
hwó sie ge·wísadin · mid wár-lôsun,
mannun mên-ge·witun · an mahtigna Krist
te gi·sęggjanne sundja · þurh is selbes word,
þat sie ina þan te wundęr-kwálu · wêgjan móstin,
a·dêljen te dôðe. · Sie ni mahtun an þemu dage finden
só wrêð ge·wit-skępi, · þat sie imu wíti be·þiu
a·dêljen gi·dorstin · efþa dôð frummjen,
líbu bi·lôsjen. · Þó kwámun þár at latstan forð
an þena warf wero · wár-lôse man
twêne gangan · ęndi bi·gunnun im tęlljen an,
kwáðun þat sie ina selbon · sęggjan gi·hôrdin,
þat hé mahti te·werpen · þena wíh godes,
allaro húso hôhost · ęndi þurh is hand-męgin,
þurh is ênes kraft · up a·rihtjen
an þriddjon daga, · só is ęlkor ni þorfti be·þíhan man.
Hé þagoda ęndi þoloda: · ni sprak imu io þiu þiod só filu,
þea liudi mid luginun, · þat hé it mid lêðun an·gęgin
wordun wráki. · Þó þár undar þemu werode a·rês

balu-hugdig man, · biskop þero liudjo,
þe furisto þes folkes · ęndi frágode Krist
iak ina be imu selbon bi·swór · swíðon êðun,
grótte ina an godes namon · ęndi gerno bad,
þat hé im þat gi·sagdi, · ef hé sunu wári
þes libbjendjes godes: · „þes þit lioht ge·skóp,
Krist kuning êwig. · Wí ni mugun is ant·kięnnjen wiht
ne an þínun wordun ni an þínun werkun.“ · Þó sprak imu eft
þe wáro an·gęgin,
þe gódo godes sunu: · „þú kwiðis it for þesun Judeon nú,
sòð-líko sęgis, · þat ik it selbo bium.
Þes ni gi·lôbjad mí þese liudi: · ni willjad mí for·látan be·þiu;
ni sind im mín word wirðig. · Nú sęggju ik iu te wárun þoh,
þat gí noh skulun sittjen gi·sehan · an þe swíðaron half godes
márjan mannes sunu, · an męgin-krafte
þes alo-walden fader, · ęndi þanan eft kuman
an himil-wolknun herod · ęndi allumu hęliðo kunnje
mid is wordun a·dêljen, · al só iro ge·wurhti sind.“
Þo balg ina þe biskop, · habde bittren hugi,
wrêðida wið þemu worde · ęndi is gi·wádi slêt,
brak for is breostun: · „Nú ni þurbun gí bídan lęng“, kwað hé,
„þit werod ge·wit-skępjes, · nú im su-lík word farad,
mên-spráka fan is mùðe. · Þat gi·hôrid hér nú manno filu,
rinko an þesumu rakude, · þat hé ina só ríkjan telit,
gihid þat hé god sí. · Hwat willjad gí Judeon þes
a·dêljen te dóme? · Is hé dôðes nú
wirðig be su-líkun wordun?“

Therefore man's boasting is not of much avail,
the young warrior's bragging, if the help of God fails him
due to his sins. Then very soon afterwards
is the heart in his breast bloodier, although he may earlier have spoken a vow,
bragged about his zeal and strength of hand—
that man, about his might. That was made clear to the famed
best of thanes when the theoden's holy
help failed him. Therefore man should not boast
too much about himself, for often his hope
and will fail him if the wielder God,
the noble King of Heaven, does not strengthen his heart.
TODO.

**61** Þat werod al ge·sprak,

folk Judeono, · þat hé wári þes ferhes skolo,
wítjes só wirðig. · Ni was it þoh be is ge·wurhtjun gi·dóen,
þat ine þár an Jerusalem · Judeo liudi,
sunu drohtines · sundja lôsen
a·dêldun te dôðe. · Þó was þero dádjo hróm
Judeo liudjun, · hwat sie þemu godes barne
mahtin só haftemu mêst, · harmes ge·frummjen.
Be·wurpun ina þó mid werodu · ęndi ina an is wangon slógun,
an is hleor mid iro handun · —al was imu þat te hoske gi·dóen—,
fęlgidun imu firin-word · fiundo męnegi,
bismer-spráka. · Stód þat barn godes
fast under fiundun: · wárun imu is faðmos ge·bundene,
þolode mid gi·þuldjun, · só hwat só imu þiu þioda tó
bittres bráhte: · ni balg ina n·eo·wiht
wið þes werodes ge·win. · Þó námon ina wrêðe man
só gi·bundanan, · þat barn godes,
ęndi ina þó lêddun, · þár þero liudjo was,
þere þiade þing-hús. · Þár þegąn manag
hwurðun umbi iro hęri-togon. · Þár was iro hêrron bodo
fan Rúmu-burg, · þes þe þó þes ríkjas gi·wéld:
kumen was hé fan þemu kêsure, · gi·sęndid was hé undar þat kunni Judeono
te rihtjenne þat ríki, · was þár rád-gebo:
Pilatus was hé hêten; · hé was fan Ponteo lande
knósles kęnnit. · Habde imu kraft mikil,
an þemu þing-húse · þiod gi·samnod,
an warf weros; · wár-lôse man
a·gáðun þó þena godes sunu, · Judeo liudi,
under fiundo folk, · kwáðun þat hé wári þes ferhes skolo,
þat man ina wítnodi · wápnes ęggjun,
skarpun skúrun. · Ni welde þiu skole Judeono
þringan an þat þing-hús, · ak þiu þiod úte stód,
mahlidun þanen wið þea męnegi: · ni weldun an þat gi·mang faren,
an ęli-landige man, · þat sie þár un-reht word,
an þemu dage dęrbjes wiht · a·dêljan ne gi·hôrdin,
ak kwáðun þat sie im só hluttro · hêlaga tídi,
weldin iro paskha halden. · Pilatus ant·féng

at þem wam-skaðun · waldandes barn,
sundja lôsen. · Þó an sorgun warð
Judases hugi, · þó hé a·geƀan gi·sah
is drohtin te dôðe, · þó bi·gan imu þiu dád aftar þiu
an is hugja hreuwan, · þat hé habde is hêrron êr
sundja lôsen gi·sald. · Nam imu þó þat siluƀar an hand,
þrí-tig skatto, · þat man imu êr wið is þiodane gaf,
géng imu þó te þem Judiun · ęndi im is grimmon dád,
sundjon sagde, · ęndi im þat siluƀar bôd
gerno te a·geƀanne: · „ik hębbju it só grio-líko“, kwað hé,
„mínes drohtines · drôru gi·kôpot,
só ik wêt þat it mí ni þíhit.“ · Þiod Judeono
ni weldun it þó ant·fâhan, · ak hétun ina forð aftar þiu
umbi su-líka sundja · selƀon ahton,
hwat hé wið is frâhon · ge·frumid habdi:
„Þú sáhi þi selƀo þes“, (kwáðun sie;) „hwat wili þú þes nú sóken te ûs?
Ne wít þú þat þesumu werode!“ · Þó gi·wêt imu eft þanan
Judas gangan · te þemu godes wíhe
swíðo an sorgun · ęndi þat siluƀar warp
an þena alaḥ innan, · ne gi·dorste it êgan lęng;
fór imu þó só an forhtun, · só ina fíundo barn
módage manodun: · habdun þes mannes hugi
gramon under·gripanen, · was imu god a·bolgan,
þat hé imu selƀon þó · símon warhte,
hnêg þó an heru-sêl · an hinginna,
waraġ an wurgil · ęndi wíti ge·kôs,
hard hęllje ge·þwing, · hêt ęndi þiustri,
diap dôðes dalu, · hwand hé êr umbi is drohtin swêk.

TODO.

**62** Þan bêd þat barn godes · —bęndi þolode
an þemu þing-húse—, · hwan êr þiu þiod under im,
erlos ên-wordje · alle wurðin,
hwat sie imu þan te ferąh-kwálu · frummjan weldin.
Þó þár an þem bęnkjun a·rês · bodo kêsures
fan Rúmu-burg · ęndi géng imu wið þat ríki Judeono
módag mahljen, · þár þiu męnigi stód
aftar þemu hobe hwarƀon: · ni weldun an þat hús kuman

an þemu paskha-dage. · Pilatus bi·gan
frókno frágon · obar þat folk Judeono,
mid hwiu þe man habdi · morðes gi·skuldit,
wítjes gi·werkot: · „be hwí gí imu só wrêðe sind,
an iuwomu hugja hótje?“ · Sie kwáðun þat hé im habdi harmes só filu,
lêðes gi·lêstid: · „ni gábin ina þesa liudi þi,
þár sie ina êr bi·foran · ubilan ni wissin,
wordun far·warhten. · Hé habat þeses werodes só filu
far·lêdid mid is lêrun · —ęndi þesa liudi męrrid,
dóit im iro hugi twífljen—, · þat wí ni mótun te þemu hoþe kêsures
tinsi gelden; · þat mugun wí ina gi·tęlljen an
mid wáru ge·wit-skępi. · Hé sprikid ôk word mikil,
kwiðit þat hé Krist sí, · kuning obar þit ríki,
be·gihit ina só grôtes.“ · Þó im eft te·gęgnes sprak
bodo kêsures: · „ef hé só bar-líko“, kwað hé,
„under þesaru męnigi · mên-werk frumid,
ant·fâhad ina þan eft under iuwe folk-skępi, · ef hé sí is ferhes skolo,
ęndi imu só a·dêljad, · ef hé sí dôðes werð,
só it an iuwaro aldrono · êo ge·biode.“
Sie kwáðun þó, þat sie ni móstin · manno nig·ênumu
an þea hêlagon tíd · te hand-banon,
werðen mid wápnun · an þemu wíh-dage.
Þó węnde ina fan þemu werode · wrêð-hugdig man,
þegąn kêsures, · þe obar þea þioda was
bodo fan Rúmu-burg—: · hét imu þó þat barn godes
náhor gangan · ęndi ina niud-líko,
frágoda frókno, · ef hé obar þat folk kuning
þes werodes wári. · Þó habde eft is word garu
sunu drohtines: · „hweðer þú þat fan þi selbumu sprikis“, kwað hé,
„þe it þi óðre hér · erlos sagdun,
kwáðun umbi mínan kuning-duom?“ · Þó sprak eft þe kêsures bodo
wlank ęndi wrêð-mód, · þár hé wið waldand Krist
rędjode an þem rakude: · „ni bium ik þeses ríkjes hinan“, kwað hé,

„Judeo liudjo, · ni gadoling þín,
þesaro manno mág-wini, · ak mí þí þius męnigi bi·falạh,
a·gábun þí þína gadulingos mí, · Judeo liudi,
haftan te handun. · Hwat habas þú harmes gi·duan,
þat þú só bittro skalt · bęndi þolojan,
kwalm undar þínumu kunnje?“ · Þó sprak imu eft Krist an·gęgin,
hêlendero bętst, · þár hé gi·hęftid stód
an þemu rakude innan: · „nis mín ríki hinan“, kwað hé,
„fan þesaru wer-old-stundu. · Ef it þoh wári só,
þan wárin só stark-móde · wiðęr stríd-hugi,
wiðęr grama þioda · jungaron míne,
só man mí ni gábi · Judeo liudjun,
hęttendjun an hand · an heru-bęndjun
te wêgjanne te wundrun. · Te þiu warð ik an þesaru wer-oldi gi·boran,
þat ik ge·wit-skępi giu · wáres þinges
mid mínun kumjun kúðdi. · Þat mugun ant·kęnnjen wel
þe weros, þe sind fan wáre kumane: · þe mugun mín word far·standen,
gi·lôbjen mínun lêrun.“ · Þó ni mahte lasteres wiht
an þem barne godes · bodo kêsures,
findan fêknja word, · þat hé is ferhes be·þiu
skuldig wári. · Þó géng hé im eft wið þea skola Judeono
módag mahljen · ęndi þeru męnigi sagde
obar hlust mikil, · þat hé an þemu hafton manne
su-líka firin-spráka · finden ni mahti
for þem folk-skipje, · só hé wári is ferhes skolo,
dôðes wirðig. · Þan stódun dol-móde
Judeo liudi · ęndi þane godes sunu
wordun wrógdun: · kwáðun þat hé gi·wer êrist
be·gunni an Galileo lande, · „ęndi obar Judeon fór
herod-wardes þanan, · hugi twíflode,
manno mód-sebon, · só hé is morðes werð,
þat man ina wítnoje · wápnes ęggjun,
ef eo man mid su-líkun dádjun mag · dôðes ge·skuldjen.“

TODO.

**63** Só wrógdun ina mid wordun · werod Judeono

þurh hótjan hugi. · Þó þe hęri-togo,
slíð-módig man · sęggjan gi·hôrde,
fan hwi-líkumu kunnje was · Krist a·fódid,
manno þe bętsto: · hé was fan þeru márjan þiadu,
þe gódo fan Galilea-lande; · þár was gum-skępi
ęðiljero manno; · Erodes bi·held þár
kraftagne kuning-dóm, · só ina imu þe kêsur far·gaf,
þe ríkjo fan Rúmu, · þat hé þár rehto ge·hwi-lík
ge·frumidi undar þemu folke · ęndi friðu lêsti,
dómos a·dêldi. · Hé was ôk an þemu dage selbo
an Jerusalem · mid is gum-skępi,
mid is werode at þemu wíhe: · só was iro wíse þan,
þat sie þár þia hêlagun tíd · haldan skoldun,
paskha Judeono. · Pilatus gi·bôd þó,
þat þena hafton man · hęliðos námin
só gi·bundanan, · þat barn godes,
hét þat sie ina Erodese, · erlos brâhtin
haften te handun, · hwand hé fan is hęri-skępi was,
fan is werodes ge·wald. · Wígand frumidun
iro hêrron word: · hêlagne Krist
fórdun an fiterjun · for þena folk-togun,
allaro barno bętst, · þero þe io gi·boren wurði
an liudjo lioht; · an liðu-bęndjun géng,
ant-tat sie ina bráhtun, · þár hé an is bęnkja sat,
kuning Erodes: · umbi·hwarf ina kraft wero,
wlanke wígandos: · was im willjo mikil,
þat sie þár selbon Krist · gi·sehan móstin:
wándun þat hé im sum têkąn · þár tôgjan skoldi,
mári ęndi mahtig, · só hé managun dede
þurh is god-kundi · Judeo *liudjon.
Frágoda ina þuo þie folk-kuning · firi-wit-líko
managon wordon, · wolda is muod-sebon
forð undar·findan, · hwat hie te frumu mohti
mannon gi·markon. · Þan stuod mahtig Krist,
þagoda ęndi þoloda: · ne wolda þem þied-kuninge,
Erodese ne is erlon · ant-swór geban
wordo nig·ênon. · Þan stuod þiu wrêða þiod,
Judeo liudi · ęndi þena godes suno
wurrun ęndi wruogdun, · anþat im warð þie wer-old-kuning

an is huge huoti · ęndi all is hęri-skipi,
far·muonstun ina an iro muode: · ne ant·kęndun maht godes,
himiliskan hêrron, · ak was im iro hugi þiustri,
baluwes gi·blandan. · Barn drohtines
iro wrêðun werk, · word ęndi dádi
þuru ôd-muodi · all gi·þoloda,
só hwat só sia im tionono þuo · tuogjan woldun.
Sia hietun im þuo te hoske · hwít gi·wádi
umbi is liði lęggjan, · þiu mêr hie wurði þem liudjon þár,
jungron te gamne. · Judeon faganodun,
þuo sia ina te hoske · hębbjan gi·sáhun,
erlos obar-muoda. · Þuo sęnda ina eft þanan
Erodes sé kuning · an þat ôðer folk;
a·lêdjan hiet ina lungra mann, · ęndi lastar sprákun,
felgidun im firin-word, · þár hie an feteron géng
bi·hlagan mid hosku: · ni was im hugi twífli,
neba hie it þuru ôd-muodi · all gi·þoloda;
ne welda iro ubilun word · idug-lônon,
hosk ęndi harm-kwidi. · Þuo bráhtun sia ina eft an þat hús innan,
an þia palenkja uppan, · þár Pilatus was
an þero þing-stędi. · Þegnos a·gábun
barno þat bęsta · banon te handon
sundi-lôsjan, · só hie selbo gi·kôs:
welda manno barn · morðes a·tuomjan,
nęrjan af nôdi. · Stuodun níð-hwata,
Judeon far þem gast-sęlje: · habdun sia gramono barn,
þia skola far·skundid, · þat sia ne be·skribun iowiht
grimmera dádjo. · Þuo gi·wêt im gangan þarod
þegan kêsures · wið þia þiod sprekan,
hard hęri-togo: · „Hwat gí mí þesan haftan mann“, kwaþ-hie,
„an þesan sęli sęndun · ęndi selbon an·budun,
þat hie iuwes werodes só filo · a·werdit habdi,
far·lêdid mid is lêron. · Nú ik mid þeson liudon ni mag,
findan mid þius folku, · þat hie is ferahes sí
furi þesaro skolu skuldig. · Skín was þat hiudu:
Erodes mohta, · þie iuwan êo bi·kan,
iuwaro liudo land-reht, · hie ni mahta is líbes gi·frêson,
þat hie hier þuru êniga sundja te dage · sweltan skoldi,

líf far·látan. · Nú willju ik ina for þeson liudjon hier
gi·þróon mid þingon, · þrístjon wordun,
buotjan im is briost-hugi, · látan ina brúkan forð
ferąhes mid firjon.“ · Folk Judeono
hreopun þuo alla samad · hlúdero stemnu,
hietun flít-líko · ferąhes áhtjan
Krist mid kwalmu · ęndi an krúki slahan,
wêgjan te wundron: · „hie mid is wordon habit
dôðes gi·skuldid: · sagit þat hie drohtin sí,
gegnungo godes suno. · Þat hie a·geldan skal,
in·wid-spráka, · só is an úson êwe gi·skriban,
þat man su-líka firin-kwidi · ferąhu kôpo.“

TODO.

**64** Þuo warð þie an forąhton, · þie þes folkes gi·wéld,
mikilon an is muode, · þuo hie gi·hôrda þia man sprekan,
þat sia ina selbon · sęggjan gi·hôrdin,
gehan fur þem gum-skipe, · þat hie wári godes suno.
Þuo hwarf im eft þie hęri-togo · an þat hús innan
te þero þing-stędi, · þrístjon wordon
gruotta þena godes suno · ęndi frágoda, hwat hie gumono wári:
„hwat bist þú manno?“ (kwaþ-hie.) „Te hwí þú mí só þínan muod hilis,
dęrnis diop-gi·þáht? · Wêst þú þat it all an mínon duome stéd
umbi þínes líbes gi·lagu? · Mí þí hębbjat þesa liudi far·geban,
werod Judeono, · þat ik gi·waldan muot
só þik te spildjanne · an speres orde,
só ti kwęlljanne an krúkjum, · só kwikan látan,
só hweðer sí mí selbon · suotera þunkit
te gi·frummjanne mid mínu folku.“ · Þuo sprak eft þat friðu-barn godes:
„Wêst þú þat te wáron“, (kwaþ-hie,) „þat þú gi·wald obar mik
hębbjan ni mohtis, · ne wári þat it þí hêlag god
selbo far·gábi? · Ôk hębbjat þia sundjono mêr,
þia mik þi bi·fulhun · þuru fiond-skipi,
gi·saldun an símon haftan.“ · Þuo welda ina síð after þiu
gram-hugdig man · gerno far·látan,
þegąn kêsures, · þár hie is habdi for þero þioda gi·wald;

ak sia węridun im þena willjon · wordu gi·hwi-líku,
kunni Judeono: · „ne bist þú“, kwáðun sia, „þes kêsures friund,
þínon hêrren hold, · ef þú ina hinan látis
sïðon gi·sundon: · þat þi noh te soręgan mag,
werðan te wíte, · hwand só hwe só su-lík word sprikit,
a·haþið ina só hôho, · kwiðit þat hie hębbjan mugi
kuning-duomes namon, · ne sí þat ina im þie kêsur gebe,
hie wirrid im is wer-uld-ríki · ęndi is word far·hugid,
far·man ina an is muode. · Be·þiu skalt þú su-lík mên wrekan,
hosk-word manag, · ef þú umbi þínes hêrren ruokis,
umbi þínes frôhon friund-skipi, · þan skalt þú ina þiu ferhu be·niman.“
Þuo gi·hôrda þie hęri-togo · þia hêri Juðeono
þrêgjan fan is þiodne; · þuo hie far þero þing-stędi géng
selbo gi·sittjan, · þár gi·samnod was
só mikil warf werodes, · hiet waldand Krist
lêdjan for þia liudi. · Langoda Judeon,
hwan êr sia þat hêlaga barn · hangon gi·sáwin,
kwęlan an krúkje; · sia kwáðun þat sia kuning òðran
ne haþdin undar iro hęri-skipje, · neþan þena hêran kêsar
fan Rúmu-burg: · „þie haþit hier ríki ober ùs.
Be·þiu ni skalt þú þesan far·látan; · hie haþit ùs só filo lêðes gi·sprokan,
far·duan haþit hie im mid is dádjon. · Hie skal dôð þolon,
wíti ęndi wundąr-kwála.“ · Werod Judeono
só manag mis-lík þing · an mahtigna Krist
sagdun te sundjun. · Hie swígondi stuod
þuru ôð-muodi, · ne ant-wordida n·io·wiht
wið iro wrêðun word: · wolda þesa wer-old alla
lôsjan mid is líbu: · bi·þiu liet hie ina þia lêðun þiod
wêgjan te wundron, · all só iro willjo géng:
ni wolda im opan-líko · allon kùðjan
Judeo liudjon, · þat hie was god selbo;
hwand wissin sia þat te wáron, · þat hie su-líka gi·wald haþdi
obar þeson middil-gard, · þan wurði im iro muod-sebo
gi·blôðit an iro brioston: · þan ne gi·dorstin sia þat barn godes
handon ant·hrínan: · þan ni wurði heþan-ríki,
ant·lokan liohto mêst · liudjo barnon.

Be·þiu mêð hie is só an is muode, · ne lét þat manno folk
witan, hwat sia waraḥtun. · Þiu wurd náhida þuo,
mári maht godes · ęndi middi dag,
þat sia þia feraḥ-kwála · frummjan skoldun.
Þan lag þár ôk an bęndjon · an þero burg innan
ên ruof ręgin-skaðo, · þie habda under þem ríke só filo
morðes gi·rádan · ęndi man-slahta gi·frumid,
was mári męgin-þiof: · ni was þár is gi·mako hwęrgin;
was þár ôk bi sínon · sundjon gi·hęftid,
Barrabas was hie hêtan; · hie after þem burgjon was
þuru is mên-dádi · manogon gi·kûðid.
Þan was land-wísa · liudjo Judeono,
þat sia járo gi·hwen · an godes minnja
an þem hêlagon dage · ênna haftan mann
a·biddjan skoldun, · þat im iro burges ward,
iro folk-togo · feraḥ far·gábi.
Þuo bi·gan þie hęri-togo · þia hêri Judeono,
þat folk frágojan, · þár sia im fora stuodun,
hweðeron sia þero twejo · tuomjan weldin,
feraḥes biddjan: · „þia hier an feteron sind
haft undar þeson hęri-skipje?“ · Þiu hêri Judeono
habdun þuo þia araḥmun man · alla gi·spanana,
þat sia þemo land-skaðen · líf a·bádin,
gi·þingodin þem þioðe, · þie oft an þiustrja naht
wam gi·waraḥta, · ęndi waldand Krist
kwęlidin an krúkje. · Þuo warð þat kûð obar all,
hwó þiu þiod habda duomos a·dêlid. · Þuo skoldun sia þia dád
frummjan,
háhan þat hêlaga barn. · Þat warð þem hęri-togen
síðor te sorgon, · þat hie þia saka wissa,
þat sia þuru níð-skipi · nęrjendon Krist,
hatoda þiu hêri, · ęndi hie im hôrda te þiu,
waraḥta iro willjon: · þes hie wíti ant·féng,
lôn an þeson liohte · ęndi lang after,
wói síðor wann, · síðor hie þesa wer-old a·gaf.

TODO.
Then it was made known to all,
how that people had dealt out their judgments. Then they were to carry out that deed:
to hang the Holy Child. TODO.

65 Þuo warð þas þie wrêðo gi·waro, · wam-skaðono mêst,
Satanas selbo, · þuo þiu seola kwam
Judases an grund · grimmaro hęlljun—
þuo wissa hie te wáren, · þat þat was waldand Krist,
barn drohtines, · þat þár gi·bundan stuod;
wissa þuo te wáron, · þat hie welda þesa wer-old alla
mid is hęnginnja · hęllja gi·þwinges,
liudi a·lôsjan · an lioht godes.
Þat was Satanase · sêr an muode,
tulgo harm an is hugje: · welda is helpan þuo,
þat im liudjo barn · líf ne bi·námin,
ne kwęlidin an krúkje, · ak hie welda, þat hie kwik libdi,
te þiu þat firiho barn · fernes ne wurðin,
sundjono sikura. · Satanas gi·wêt im þuo,
þár þes hęri-togen · híwiski was
an þero burg innan. · Hie þero is brúdi bi·gann,
þera idis opan-líko · un-hiuri fiond
wundęr tôgjan, · þat sia an word-helpon
Kriste wári, · þat hie muosti kwik libbjan,
drohtin manno · —hie was iu þan te dôðe gi·skęrid—
wissa þat te wáron, · þat hie im skoldi þia gi·wald bi·niman,
þat hie sia obar þesan middil-gard · só mikila ni habdi,
obar wída wer-old. · Þat wíf warð þuo an forahton,
swíðo an sorogon, · þuo iru þiu gi·siuni kwámun
þuru þes dęrnjen dád · an dages liohte,
an hęlið-helme bi·helid. · Þuo siu te iru hêrren an·bôd,
þat wíf mid iro wordon · endi im te wáren hiet
selbon seggjan, · hwat iro þár te gi·siunjon kwam
þuru þena hêlagan mann, · endi im helpan bad,
formon is ferhe: · „ik hębbju hier só filo þuru ina
seld-líkes gi·sewan, · só ik wêt, þat þia sundjun skulun
allaro erlo gi·hwem · ubilo gi·þíhan,
só im fruokno tuo · ferahes áhtið.“
Þie segg warð þuo an síðe, · ant-tat hie sittjan fand
þena hęri-togon · an hwarabe innan
an þem stên-wege, · þár þiu stráta was
felison gi·fuogid. · Þár hie te is frôhon géng,
sagda im þes wíbes word. · Þuo warð im wrêð hugi,
þem hęri-togen, · —hwaraboda an innan—,

gi·blôðit briost-gi·þâht: · was im bêðjes wê,
gie þat sea ina sluogin · sundja lôsan,
gie it bi þem liudjon þuo · for·látan ne gi·dorsta
þuru þes werodes word. · Warð im gi·węndid þuo
hugi an herten · after þero hêri Judeono,
te werkjanne iro willjon: · ne wardoda im nie-wiht
þia swárun sundjun, · þia hie im þár þuo selbo gi·deda.
Hiet im þuo te is handon dragan · hluttran brunnjon,
watar an wégje, · þár hie furi þem werode sat,
þwóg ina þár for þero þioda · þegạn kêsures,
hard hęri-togo · ęndi þuo fur þero hêri sprak,
kwað þat hie ina þero sundjono þár · sikoran dádi,
wrêðero werko: · „ne willju ik þes wihtes plegan“, kwaþ-hie,
„umbi þesan hêlagan mann, · ak hleotad gí þes alles,
gie wordo gie werko, · þes gí im hér te wítje gi·duan.“
Þuo hreop all saman · hęri-skipi Judeono,
þiu mikila męnigi, · kwáðun þat sia weldin umbi þena man plegan
dęrạboro dádjo: · „Fare is drôr obar ùs,
is bluod ęndi is baneði · ęndi obar ùsa barn só samo,
obar ùsa abaron þár after · —wí willjat is alles plegan“, kwaðun sia,
„umbi þena slęgi selbon,— · ef wí þár êniga sundja gi·duan!“
A·geban warð þár þuo furi þem Judeon · allaro gumono bęsta
hęttendjon an hand, · an heru-bęndjon
narạwo gi·nôdid, · þár ina níð-hwata,
fiond ant·féngun: · folk ina umbi·hwarf,
mên-skaðono męgin. · Mahtig drohtin
þoloda gi·þuldjon, · só hwat só im þiu þioda deda.
Sia hietun ina þuo filljan, · êr þan sia im ferạhes tuo,
aldres áhtin, · ęndi im undar is ôgun spiwun,
dedun im þat te hoske, · þat sia mid iro handon slógun,
weros an is wangun · ęndi im is gi·wádi bi·námun,
rôbodun ina þia rędin-skaðon, · rôdes lakanes
dedun im eft òðer an · þuru un-huldi;
hietun þuo hôbid-band · hardaro þorno
wundron windan · ęndi an waldand Krist
selbon sęttjan, · ęndi géngun im þia gi·síðos tuo,
kwęddun ina an kuning-wísu · ęndi þár an knio fellun,

hnigun im mid iro hôbdu: · all was im þat te hoske gi·duan,
þoh hie it all gi·þolodi, · þiodo drohtin,
mahtig þuru þia minnja · manno kunnjes.
Hietun sia þuo wirkjan · wápnes ęggjon
hęliðos mid iro handon · hardes bômes
kraftiga krúki · ęndi hietun sia Kristan þuo,
sálig barn godes · selbon fuorjan,
dragan hietun sia ùsan drohtin, · þár hie be·drôragad skolda
sweltan sundjono lôs. · Sîðodun Judeon,
weros an willon, · lêddun waldand Krist,
drohtin te dôðe. · Þár mohta man þuo derębi þing
harm-lík gi·hôrjan: · hioþandi þár after
géngun wíf mid wópu, · weros gnornodun,
þia fan Galilea mid im · gangan kwámun,
folgodun oþar ferr-wegos: · was im iro frôhon dôð
swíðo an soręgan. · Þuo hie selbo sprak,
barno þat bęsta · ęndi under bak be·sah,
hiet þat sia ni wépin: · „ni þarf iu wiht tregan“, kwaþ-hie,
„mínero hin-fęrdjo, · ak gí mid hofnu mugun
iuwa wrêðan werk · wópu kúmjan,
tornon trahnon. · Noh wirðið þiu tíd kuman,
þat þia muoder þes · męndendja sind,
brúdi Judeono, · þem gio barn ni warð
ôdan an aldre. · Þan gí iuwa in·wid skulun
grimmo an·geldan; · þan gí só gerna sind,
þat iu hier bi·hlídan · hôha bergos,
diopo be·delþan; · dôð wári iu þan allon
lioþera an þeson lande · þan su-lík liudjo kwalm
te gi·þoljanne, · só hier þan þesaro þioda kumid.“

TODO.

**66** Þuo sia þár an griete · galgon rihtun,
an þem felde uppan · folk Judeono,
bôm an beręge, · ęndi þár an þat barn godes
kwęlidun an krúkje: · slógun kald ísarn,
niuwa naglos · níðon skarpa
hardo mid hamuron · þuru is hęndi ęndi þuru is fuoti,
bittra bęndi: · is blód ran an erða,
drôr fan ùson drohtine. · Hie ni welda þoh þia dád wrekan

grimma an þem Judeon, · ak hie þes god fader
mahtigna bad, · þat hie ni wári þem manno folke,
þem werode þiu wrêðra: · „hwand sia ni witun, hwat sia duot“, kwaþ-hie.
Þuo þia wígandos · gi·wádi Kristes,
drohtines dêldun, · dęręþja mann,
þes ríken gi·rôbi. · Þia rinkos ni mahtun
umbi þena selbon [...] · sam-wurdi gi·sprekan,
êr sia an iro hwarąbe · hlôtos wurpun,
hwi-lík iro skoldi hębbjan · þia hêlagun pêda,
allaro gi·wádjo wun-samost. · Þes werodes hirdi
hiet þuo, þe hęri-togo, · obar þem hôbde selbes
Kristes an krúke skríban, · þat þat wári kuning Judeono,
Jesus fan Nazareth-burh, · þie þár nęglid stuod
an niuwon galgon · þuru níð-skipi,
an bômin treo. · Þuo bádun þia liudi
þat word węndjan, · kwáðun þat hie im só an is willjon spráki,
selbo sagdi, · þat hie habdi þes gi·síðes gi·wald,
kuning wári obar Judeon. · Þuo sprak eft þie kêsures bodo,
hard hęri-togo: · „it ist iu só obar is hôbde gi·skriban,
wís-líko gi·writan, · só ik it nú węndjan ni mag.“
Dádun þuo þár te wítje · werod Judeono
twêna far·talda man · an twá halba
Kristes an krúki: · lietun sia kwalm þolon
an þem warag-trewe · werko te lône,
lêðaro dádjo. · Þia liudi sprákun
hosk-word manag · hêlagon Kristе,
grottun ina mid gelpu: · sáwun allaro gumono þen bęston
kwęlan an þemo krúkje: · „ef þú sís kuning obar all“, kwáðun sia,
„suno drohtines, · só þú habis selbo gi·sprokan,
nęri þik fan þero nôdi · ęndi níðes a·tuomi,
gang þi hêl herod; · þan węlljat an þik hęliðo barn,
þesa liudi gi·lôbjan.“ · Sum imo ôk lastar sprak
swíðo gêl-hert Judeo, · þár hie fur þem galgon stuod:
„Wah warð þesaro wer-oldi“, (kwaþ-hie,) „ef þú iro skoldis gi·wald êgan.
Þú sagdas þat þú mahtis an ênon dage · all te·werpan
þat hôha hús · heban-kuninges,

stên-werko mêst · ęndi eft standan gi·duon
an þriddjon dage, · só is ęlkor ni þorfti bi·þíhan mann
þeses folkes furðor. · Sínu hwó þú nú gi·fastnod stés,
swíðo gi·sêrid: · ni maht þi selbon wiht
balowes gi·buotjan.“ · Þuo þár ôk an þem bęndjon sprak
þero þeobo òðer, · all só hie þia þioda gi·hôrda,
wrêðon wordon · —ne was is willjo guod,
þes þegnes gi·þáht—: · „ef þú sís þiod-kuning“, kwaþ-hie,
„Krist, godes suno, · gang þi þan fan þem krúke niðer,
slópi þi fan þem símon · ęndi ùs samad allon
hilp ęndi hêli. · Ef þú sís heþan-kuning,
waldand þesaro wer-oldes, · gi·duo it þan an þínon werkon skín,
mári þik fur þesaro męnigi.“ · Þuo sprak þero manno òðer
an þero hęnginna, · þár hie gi·hęftid stuod,
wan wundęr-kwála: · „Be·hwí wilt þú su-lík word sprekan,
gruotis ina mid gelpu? · Stés þí hier an galgen haft,
gi·brokan an bôme. · Wit hier bêðja þolod
sêr þuru unka sundjun: · is unk unkero selbero dád
worðan te wítje. · Hie stéd hier wammes lôs,
allaro sundjono sikur, · só hie selbo gio
firina ni gi·frumida, · botan þat hie þuru þeses folkes nið
willendi an þesaro wer-uldi · wíti ant·fáhid.
Ik willju þár gi·lôbjan tuo“, (kwaþ-hie,) „ęndi willju þena landes ward,
þena godes suno · gerno biddjan,
þat þú mín gi·huggjes · ęndi an helpun sís,
rádendero bęst, · þan þú an þín ríki kumis:
wes mí þan gi·náðig.“ · Þuo sprak im eft nęrjendo Krist
wordon te·gęgnes: · „Ik sęggju þí te wáron hier“, kwaþ-hie,
„þat þú noh hiu-du móst · an himil-ríke
mid mí samad · sehan lioht godes,
an þemo Paradýse, · þoh þú nú an su-líkoro pínu sís.“
Þan stuod þár ôk Maria, · muoder Kristes,
blêk under þem bôme, · gi·sah iro barn þolon,
winnan wundęr-kwála. · Ôk wárun þár wíf mid iro
an só mahtiges · minnja kumana—
þan stuod þár ôk Johannes, · jungro Kristes,
hriuwi undar is hêrren, · was im is hugi sêrag—

drúbodun fur þem dôðe. · Þár sprak drohtin Krist
mahtig te þero muoder: · „nú ik þí hier mínemo skal
jungron be·felhan, · þem þí hier gęgin-ward stéd:
wis þí an is gi·síðje samad: · þú skalt ina furi suno hębbjan.“
Grótta hie þuo Johannes, · hiet þat hie iru ful-géngi wel,
minnjodi sia só mildo, · só man is muoder skal,
idis un-wamma. · Þuo hie sia an is êra ant·féng
þuru hluttran hugi, · só im is hêrro gi·bôd.

TODO.

**67** Þuo warð þár an middjan dag · mahtig têkạn,
wundạr-lík gi·waraht · obar þesan wer-old allan,
þuo man þena godes suno · an þena galgon huof,
Krist an þat krúki: · þuo warð it kûð obar all,
hwó þiu sunna warð gi·sworkan: · ni mahta swigli lioht
skôni gi·skínan, · ak sia skado far·féng,
þimm ęndi þiustri · ęndi só gi·þrusmod neƀal.
Warð allaro dago druobost, · dunkar swíðo
obar þesan wídun wer-uld, · só langa só waldand Krist
kwal an þemo krúkje, · kuningo ríkost,
ant nuon dages. · Þuo þie neƀal ti·skrêd,
þat gi·swerk warð þuo te·swungan, · bi·gan sunnun lioht
hêdron an himile. · Þuo hreop up te gode
allaro kuningo kraftigost, · þuo hie an þemo krúkje stuod
faðmon gi·fastnot: · „fader alo-mahtig“, kwaþ-hie,
„te hwí þú mik só far·lieti, · lieƀo drohtin,
hêlag heƀan-kuning, · ęndi þína helpa dedos,
fullisti só ferr? · Ik standu under þeson fiondon hier
wundron gi·wêgid.“ · Werod Judeono
hlógun is im þuo te hoske: · gi·hôrdun þena hêlagun Krist,
drohtin furi þem dôðe · drinkan biddjan,
kwað þat ina þurstidi. · Þiu þioda ne latta,
wrêða wiðạr-sakon: · was im willjo mikil,
hwat sia im bittres tuo · bringan mahtin.
Habdun im un-swóti · ękid ęndi galla
gi·męngid þia mên-hwaton; · stuod ên mann garo,
swíðo skuldig skaðo, · þena habdun sia gi·skęrid te þiu,
far·spanan mid sprákon, · þat hie sia en êna spunsja nam,
líðo þes lêðosten, · druog it an ênon langan skafte,

gi·bundan an ênon bôme · ęndi deda it þem barne godes,
mahtigon te múðe. · Hie an·kęnda iro mirkjun dádi,
gi·fuolda iro fégnes: · furðor ni welda
is só bittres an·bítan, · ak hreop þat barn godes
hlúdo te þem himiliskon fader: · „ik an þina hęndi be·filhu“,
kwaþ-hie,
„mínon gêst an godes willjon; · hie ist nú garo te þiu,
fús te faranne.“ · Firiho drohtin
gi·hnêgida þuo is hôbid, · hêlagon áðom
liet fan þemo lík-hamen. · Só þuo þie landes ward
swalt an þem símon, · só warð sán after þiu
wundar-têkan gi·waraht, · þat þár waldandes dôð
un·kweðandes só filo · ant·kęnnjan skolda,
þiadnes ên-dagon: · erða biboda,
hrisidun þia hôhun bergos, · harda stênos kluþun,
felisos after þem felde, · ęndi þat fêha lakan te·brast
an middjon an twê, · þat êr managan dag
an þemo wíhe innan · wundron gi·striunid
hêl hangoda · —ni muostun hęliðo barn,
þia liudi skawon, · hwat under þemo lakane was
hêlages be·hangan: · þuo mohtun an þat horð sehan
Judeo liudi— · graþu wurðun gi·opanod
dôdero manno, · ęndi sia þuru drohtines kraft
an iro lík-hamon · libbjandi a·stuodun
up fan erðu · ęndi wurðun gi·ôgida þár
mannon te márðu. · Þat was só mahtig þing,
þat þár Kristes dôð · ant·kęnnjan skoldun,
só filo þes gi·fuoljan, · þie gio mid firihon ne sprak
word an þesaro wer-oldi. · Werod Judeono
sáwun seld-lík þing, · ak was im iro slíði hugi
só far·hardod an iro herten, · þat þár io só hêlag ni warð
têkan gi·tôgid, · þat sia trúodin þiu bat
an þia Kristes kraft, · þat hie kuning obar all,
þes werodes wári. · Suma sia þár mid iro wordon gi·sprákun,
þia þes hrêwes þár · huodjan skoldun,
þat þat wári te wáren · waldandes suno,
godes gegnungo, · þat þár an þem galgon swalt,
barno þat bęsta. · Slógun an iro briost filo
wópjandero wíbo: · was im þiu wundar-kwála

harm an iro herten · ęndi iro hêrren dôð
swíðo an soroġon. · Þan was sido Judeono,
þat sia þia haftun þuru þena hêlagon dag · hangon ni lietin
lęngerun hwíla, · þan im þat líf skriði,
þiu seola be·sunki: · slíð-muoda mann
géngun im mid níð-skipju náhor, · þár só be·nęglida stuodun
þeobos twêna, · þolodun bêðja
kwála bi Kriste: · wárun im kwika noh þan,
unt·þat sia þia grimmun · Judeo liudi
bênon be·brákon, · þat sia bêðja samad
líf far·lietun, · suohtun im lioht óðer.
Sia ni þorftun drohtin Krist · dôðes bêdjan
furðor mid ênigon firinon: · fundun ina gi·faranan þuo iu:
is seola was gi·sęndid · an suoðan weg,
an lang-sam lioht, · is liði kuolodun;
þat feraḥ was af þem flêske. · Þuo géng im ên þero fiondo tuo
an níð-hugi, · druog nęgilid sper
hard an is handon, · mid heru-þrummjon stak,
liet wápnes ord · wundum sníðan,
þat an selƀes warð · sídu Kristes
ant·lokan is lík-hamo. · Þia liudi gi·sáwun,
þat þanan bluod ęndi water · bêðju sprungun,
wellun fan þero wundun, · all só is willjo géng
ęndi hie habda gi·markod êr · manno kunnje,
firiho barnon te frumu: · þuo was it all gi·fullid só.

TODO.

**68** Só þuo gi·sêgid warð · sedle náhor
hêdra sunna · mid heƀan-tunglon
an þem druoƀen dage, · þuo géng im ùses drohtines þegąn
—was im glau gumo, · jungro Kristes
managa hwíla, · só it þár manno filo
ne wissa te wáron, · hwand hie it mid is wordon hal
Juðeono gum-skipje: · Joseph was hie hêtan,
darnungo was hie ùses drohtines jungro: · hie ni welda þero
far·duanun þiod
folgon te ênigon firin-werkon, · ak hie bêd im under þem
folke Judeono,

hêlag himilo ríkjes— · hie géng im þuo wið þena hęri-togon mahljan,
þingon wið þena þegan kêsures, · þigida ina gerno,
þat hie muosti a·lôsjan · þena lík-hamon
Kristes fan þemo krúkje, · þie þár gi·kwęlmid stuod,
þes guoden fan þem galgen · ęndi an graf lęggjan,
foldu bi·felạhan. · Im ni welda þie folk-togo þuo
węrnjan þes willjen, · ak im gi·wald far·gaf,
þat hie só muosti gi·frummjan. · Hie gi·wêt im þuo forð þanan
gangan te þem galgon, · þár hie wissa þat godes barn,
hrêo hangondi · hêrren sínes,
nam ina þuo an þero niuwun ruodun · ęndi ina fan naglon a·tuomda,
ant·féng ina mid is faðmon, · só man is frôhon skal,
liobes lík-hamon, · ęndi ina an líne bi·wand,
druog ina diur-líko · —só was þie drohtin werð—,
þár sia þia stędi haƀdun · an ênon stêne innan
handon gi·hauwan, · þár gio hęliðo barn
gumon ne bi·gruobon. · Þár sia þat godes barn
te iro land-wísu, · líko hêlgost
foldu bi·fulhun · ęndi mid ênu felisu be·lukun
allaro graƀo guod-líkost. · Griotandi sátun
idisi arm-skapana, · þia þat all for·sáwun,
þes gumen grimman dôð. · Gi·witun im þuo gangan þanan
wópjandi wíf · ęndi wara námun,
hwó sia eft te þem graƀe · gangan mahtin:
haƀdun im far·sewana · soroga gi·nuogja,
mikila muod-kara: · Maria wárun sia hêtana,
idisi arm-skapana. · Þuo warð áband kuman,
naht mid neflu. · Níð-folk Judeono
warð an moragan eft, · męnigi gi·samnod,
rękidun an rúnon: · „Hwat þú wêst, hwó þit ríki was
þuru þesan ênan man · all gi·twíflid,
werod gi·worran: · nú ligid hie wundon siok,
diopa bi·dolƀan. · Hie sagda simnen, þat hie skoldi fan dôðe a·standan
an þriddjan dage. · Þius þiod gi·lôbit te filo,
þit werod after is wordon. · Nú þú hier wardon hét,

obar þem grabe gômjan, · þat ina is jungron þár
ne far·stelan an þemo stêne · ęndi sęggjan þan, þat hie
a·standan sí,
ríki fan raston: · þan wirðit þit rinko folk
mêr gi·męrrid, · ef sia it bi·ginnat márjan hier.“
Þuo wurðun þár gi·skęrida · fan þero skolu Judeono
weros te þero wahtu: · gi·witun im mid iro gi·wápnjon þarod
te þem grabe gangan, · þár sia skoldun þes godes barnes
hrêwes huodjan. · Warð þie hêlago dag
Judeono far·gangan. · Sia obar þemo grabe sátun,
weros an þero wahtun · wannom nahton,
bidun undar iro bordon, · hwan êr þie beręhto dag
obar middil-gard · mannon kwámi,
liudon te liohte. · Þuo ni was lang te þiu,
þat þár warð þie gêst kuman · be godes krafte,
hâlag áðom · undar þena hardon stên
an þena lík-hamon. · Lioht was þuo gi·opanod
firiho barnon te frumu: · was ferkal manag
ant·hęftid fan hęll-doron · ęndi te himile weg
gi·waraht fan þesaro wer-oldi. · Wánom up a·stuod
friðu-barn godes, · fuor im þuo þár hie welda,
só þia wardos þes · wiht ni af·swobun,
dęrbja liudi, · hwan hie fan þem dôðe a·stuod,
a·rês fan þero rastun. · Rinkos sátun
umbi þat graf útan, · Judeo liudi,
skola mid iro skildjon. · Skrêd forð-wardes
swigli sunnun lioht. · Síðodun idisi
te þem grabe gangan, · gum-kunnjes wíf,
Mariun muni-líka: · habdun mêðmo filo
gi·sald wiðęr salbum, · silubres ęndi goldes,
werðes wiðęr wurtjon, · só sia mahtun a·winnan mêst,
þat sia þena lík-hamon · liobes hêrren,
suno drohtines, · salbon muostin,
wundun writanan. · Þiu wíf sorągodun
an iro sebon swíðo, · ęndi suma sprákun,
hwie im þena grôtan stên · fan þemo grabe skoldi
gi·hwęrębjan an halba, · þe sia obar þat hrêo sáwun
þia liudi lęggjan, · þuo sia þena lík-hamon þár
be·fulhun an þemo felise. · Só þiu frí habdun

ge·gangan te þem gardon, · þat sia te þem graþe mahtun
gi·sehan selþon, · þuo þár swógan kwam
ęngil þes alo-waldon · obana fan radure,
faran an feðer-hamon, · þat all þiu folda an skian,
þiu erða dunida · ęndi þia erlos wurðun
an wêkan hugje, · wardos Juðeono,
bi·fellun bi þem foraht on: · ne wándun ira ferah êgan,
líf langerun hwíl.

TODO.

**69** Lágun þá wardos,
þia gi·sïðos sám-kwika: · sán up a·hlâd
þie grôto stên fan þem graþe, · só ina þie godes ęngil
gi·hwęrìbida an halba, · ęndi im uppan þem hlêwe gi·sat
diur-lík drohtines bodo. · Hie was an is dádjon ge·lík,
an is an-siunjon, · só hwem só ina muosta undar is ôgon skawon,
só berẹht ęndi só blíði · all só bliksmun lioht;
was im is gi·wádi · wintạr-kaldon
snêwe gi-líkost. · Þuo sáwun sia ina sittjan þár,
þiu wíf uppan þem gi·węndidan stêne, · ęndi im fan þem wlitje kwámun,
þem idison su-líka ęgison te·gęgnes: · all wurðun fan þem grurje
þiu frí an forạhton mikilon, · furðor ne gi·dorstun
te þemo graþe gangan, · êr sia þie godes ęngil,
waldandes bodo · wordon gruotta,
kwað þat hie iro ârundi · all bi·kunsti,
werk ęndi willjon · ęndi þero wíbo hugi,
hiet þat sia im ne an·drédin: · „ik wêt þat gí iuwan drohtin suokat,
nęrjendon Krist · fan Nazareth-burg,
þena þi hier kwęlidun · ęndi an krúki slógun
Judeo liudi · ęndi an graf lagdun
sundi-lôsjan. · Nú nist hie selþo hier,
ak hie ist a·standan iu, · ęndi sind þesa stędi lárja,
þit graf an þeson griote. · Nú mugun gí gangan herod
náhor mikilu · —ik wêt þat is iu ist niud sehan
an þeson stêne innan—: · hier sind noh þia stędi skína,

þár is lík-hamo lag.“ · Lungra féngun
gi·bada an iro brioston · blêka idisi,
wliti-skôni wíf: · was im wil-spell mikil
te gi·hôrjanne, · þat im fan iro hêrren sagda
ęngil þes alo-walden. · Hiet sia eft þanan
fan þem graþe gangan ęndi faran · te þem jungron Kristes,
sęggjan þem is gi·síðon · suoðon wordon,
þat iro drohtin was · fan dôðe a·standan.
Hiet ôk an sundron · Símon Petruse
will-spell mikil · wordon kùðjan,
kumi drohtines, · gie þat Krist selbo
was an Galileo land, · „þár ina eft is jungron skulun,
gi·sehan is gi·síðos, · só hie im êr selbo gi·sprak
wárom wordon.“ · Reht só þuo þiu wíf þanan
gangan weldun, · só stuodun im te·gęgnes þár
ęngilos twêna · an ala-hwíton
wánamon gi·wádjom · ęndi sprákun im mid iro wordon tuo
hêlag-líko: · hugi warð gi·blôðid
þen idison an ęgison: · ne mahtun an þia ęngilos godes
bi þemo wlite skawon: · was im þiu wánami te strang,
te swíði te sehanne. · Þuo sprákun im sán an·gęgin
waldandes bodun · ęndi þiu wíf frágodun,
te hwí sia Kristan þarod · kwikan mid dôdon,
suno drohtines · suokjan kwámin
ferąhes fullan; · „nú gí ina ni findat hier
an þeson stên-graþe, · ak hie ist a·standan nú
an is lík-hamon: · þes gí gi·lôbjan skulun
ęndi gi·huggjan þero wordo, · þe hie iu te wáron oft
selbo sagda, · þan hie an iuwon ge·síðja was
an Galilea-lande, · hwó hie skoldi gi·geban werðan,
gi·sald selbo · an sundigaro manno,
hęttjandero hand, · hêlag drohtin,
þat sea ina kwęlidin · ęndi an krúki slógin,
dôdan gi·dádin · ęndi þat hie skoldi þuruh drohtines kraft
an þriddjon dage · þioda te willjan
libbjandi a·standan. · Nú haþat hie all gi·lêstid só,
ge·frumid mid firihon: · íljat gí nú forð hinan,
gangat gáh-líko · ęndi duot it þem is jungron kùð.

TODO.

5847 im sán | *so C; om. L*

**70** Hie habat sia iu fur·farana · ęndi ist im forð hinan
an Galileo land, · þár ina eft is jungron skulun,
gi·sehan is ge·síðos.“ · Þuo warð sán after þiu
þem wíbon an willjon, · þat sia gi·hôrdun su-lík word sprekan,
kûðjan þia kraft godes · —wárun im só a·kumana þuo noh
gie só forạhta ge·frumida—: · gi·witun im forð þanan
fan þem grabe gangan · ęndi sagdun þem jungron Kristes
seld-lík gi·siuni, · þár sia soroǫgondi
bidun su-líkero buota. · Þuo wurðun ôk an þia burg kumana
Judeono wardos, · þia obar þemo grabe sátun
alla langa naht · ęndi þes lík-hamen þár,
huodun þes hrêwes. · Sia sagdun þero hêri Judeono,
hwi-líka im þár and-warda · ęgison kwámun,
seld-lík gi·siuni, · sagdun mid wordon,
al só it gi·duan was · an þero drohtines kraft,
ni miðun an iro muode. · Þuo budun im mêðmo filo
Judeo liudi, · gold ęndi silụbar,
saldun im sink manag, · te þiu þat sia it ni sagdin forð,
ne máridin þero męnigi: · „ak kweðat þat iu móði hugi
an·swebidi mid slápu · ęndi þat þár kwámin is gi·síðos tuo,
far·stálin ina an þem stêne. · Simnen wesat gí an stríde mid
þiu,
forð an flíte: · ef it wirðit þem folk-togen kûð,
wí gi·helpat iu wið þena hêrosten, · þat hie iu harmes wiht,
lêðes ni gi·lêstid.“ · Þuo námun sia an þem liudon filo
diurero mêðmo, · dádun all só sia bi·gunnun
—ne gi·weldun iro willjon— · dádun só wído kûð
þem liudon after þem lande, · þat sia su-líka lugina woldun
a·hębbjan be þan hêlagan drohtin. · Þan was eft gi·hêlid hugi
jungron Kristes, · þuo sia gi·hôrdun þiu guodun wíf
márjan þia maht godes; · þuo wárun sia an iro muode fráha,
gie im te þem grabe bêðja, · Johannes ęndi Petrus
runnun obast-líko: · warð êr kuman
Johannes þie guodo, · ęndi im obar þem grabe gi·stuod,
ant-at þár sán after kwam · Símon Petrus,
erl ęllan-ruof · ęndi im þár in gi·wêt
an þat graf gangan: · gi·sah þár þes godes barnes,

hrêo-gi·wádi · hêrren sínes
5902 línin liggjan, · mid þiu was êr þie lík-hamo
fagaro bi·fangan; · lag þie fano sundaṛ,
5904 mit þem was þat hôbid bi·helid · hêlages Kristes,
ríkjes drohtines, · þan hie an þesaro rastu was.
5906 Þuo géng im ôk Johannes · an þat graf innan
sehan seld-lík þing; · warð im sán after þiu
5908 ant·lokan is gi·lôbo, · þat hie wissa, þat skolda eft an þit lioht kuman
is drohtin diur-líko, · fan dôðe a·standan
5910 up fan erðu. · Þuo gi·witun im eft þanan
Johannes ęndi Petrus, · ęndi kwámun þia jungron Kristes,
5912 þia gi·síðos te·samne. · Þan stuod sêrag-muod
ên þera idiso · ôðer-síðu
5914 griotandi obar þem graþe, · was iro jámar muod—
Maria was þat Magdalena—, · was iro muod-gi·þáht,
5916 seþo mit soroǫgon gi·blandan, · ne wissa hwárod siu sókjan skolda
þena hêrron, þár iro wárun at þia helpa gi·langa. · Siu ni mohta þuo hofnu a·wísan,
5918 þat wíf ni mahta wóp for·látan: · ne wissa hwárod siu sia węndjan skolda;
gi·męrrid wárun iro þes muod-gi·þáhti. · Þuo gi·sah siu þena mahtigan þár
5920 *Kriste standan*, · þuoh siu ina kùð-líko
5920ᵇ ant·kęnnjan ni mohti, · êr þan hie ina kùðjan welda,
sęggjan þat hie it selbo wári. · Hie frágoda hwat siu só sêro bi·wiepi,
5922 só harmo mid hêton trahnin. · Siu kwað, þat siu umbi iro hêrron ni wissi
te wáren, hwárod hie werðan skoldi: · „ef þú ina mí gi·wísan mohtis,
5924 frô mín, ef ik þik frágon gi·dorsti, · ef þú ina hier an þeson felise gi·námis,
wísi ina mí mid wordon þínon: · þan wári mí allaro willjono mêsta,
5926 þat ik ina selbo gi·sáhi.“ · Sia ni wissa, þat sia þie suno drohtines

gruotta mid gódaro sprákun: · siu wánda þat it þie gardari wári,
hof-ward hêrren sínes. · Þuo gruotta sia þie hêlago drohtin,
bi namen nęrjendero bęst: · siu géng im þuo náhor sniumo,
þat wíf mid willjon guodan, · ant·kęnda iro waldand selban,
míðan siu is þuru þia minnja ni wissa: · welda ina mid iro mundon grípan,
þiu fêhmja an þena folko drohtin, · noƀan þat iro friðu-barn godes
węrida mid wordon sínon, · kwað þat siu ina mid wihti ni mósti
handon ant·hrínan: · „ik ni stêg noh“, kwaþ-hie, „te þem himiliskon fader;
ak íli þú nú ofst-líko · ęndi þem erlon kúði,
bruoðron mínon, · þat ik úser bêðero fader
ala-waldan, · iuwan ęndi mínan
suoð-fastan god · suokjan willju.“

TODO.

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5867 sán | *so L; om. C* 5920˙ *Kriste …* welda | *Numbering follows Sievers (1878), who takes* standan *as part of 5919b and sees 5920 and 5920' as one line.* 5920 *Kriste standan* | *metr. emend.; rev.* C

**71**

Þat wíf warð þuo an wunnon, · þat siu muosta su-líkan willjon kúðjan,
sęggjan fan im gi·sundon: · warð sán garo
þiu idis an þat ârundi · ęndi þem erlon brâhta,
will-spel weron, · þat siu waldand Krist
gi·sundan gi·sáwi, · ęndi sagda hwó hé iru selƀo gi·bôd
toroḥtero têkno. · Sia ni weldun gi·trúojan þuo noh
þes wíƀes wordon, · þat siu su-lík will-spel brâhte
gegnungo fan þemo godes suno, · ak sia sátun im jámor-muoda,
hęliðos hriuwonda. · Þuo warð þie hêlago Krist
eft opan-líko · ôðer-síðu,
drohtin gi·tôgid, · síðor hie fan dôðe a·stuod,
þan wíƀon an willjon, · þat hie im þár an wege muotta.
kwędda sia kúð-líko, · ęndi sia te is kneohon hnigun,
fellun im tó fuoton. · Hie hét þat sia foraḥtan hugi
ne bárin an iro brioston: · „ak gí mínon bruoðron skulun

þesa kwidi kùðjan, · þat sia kuman after mí
an Galileo land; · þár ik im eft te·gęgnes biun.“
Þan fuorun im ôk fan Jerusalem · þero jungrono twêna
an þem selbon daga · sán an morgan,
erlos an iro ârundi: · weldun im te Emaus
þat kastel suokan. · Þuo bi·gunnun im kwidi managa
under þem weron wahsan, · þár sia after þem wege fuorun,
þem hęliðon umbi iro hêrron. · Þuo kwam im þár þie hêlago tuo
gangandi godes suno. · Sia ni mahtun ina garo-líko
ant·kęnnan kraftigna: · hie ni welda ina þuo noh kùðjan te im;
was im þoh an iro gi·síðje samad · ęndi frágoda, umbi hwi-líka sia saka sprákin:
„Hwí gangat gí só gornondja?“ (kwaþ-hie;) „Ist ink jámer hugi,
seþo soraęgono full.“ · Sia sprákun im sán an·gęgin,
þia erlos and·wurdi: · „Te hwí þú þes êskos só“, kwáðun sia;
„bist þí fan Jerusalem · Judeono folkas
[...]?“

TODO.

„[...]
hêlagumu gêste · fan heþan-wange,
mid þem grôtun godes kraft.“ · Nam is jungaron þó,
erlos góde, · lêdda sie út þanan,
ant-tat hé sie bráhte · an Bethanía;
þár hóf hé is hęndi up · ęndi hêlegoda sie alle,
wíhida sie mid is wordun. · Gi·wêt imo up þanan,
sóhta imo þat hôha himilo ríki · ęndi þena is hêlagon stól:
sitit imo þár · an þea swíðron half godes,
alo-mahtiges fader · ęndi þanan all ge·sihit
waldandjo Krist, · só hwat só þius wer-old be·haþet.
Þó an þeru selbon stędi · ge·síðos góde
te bedu fellun · ęndi im eft te burg þanan
þár te Jerusalem · jungaron Kristes
fórun faganondi: · was im fráh-mód hugi,
wárun im þár at þemu wíhe. · Waldandes kraft
[...]

TODO.

5968–5982 hêlagumu gêste … Waldandes kraft | *Only in* **M**. 5968 hêlagumu gêste · fan heƀan-wange | *Partly scraped off, but still just about readable.* 5983 [...] | *Four lines are scraped off and entirely illegible in* **M**.

# Old Saxon Genesis

**Dating:** C9th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Old Saxon Genesis** (abbreviated *SaxGen*) is the lesser Old Saxon Biblical epic. As it comes down to us, it is far smaller in size than the *Heli*, its sister poem.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The original *SaxGen* is found only in a single manuscript, Palatinus latinus 1447 (**V**). The poem is written in three separate hands on a few pages, inbetween Latin computistic texts.

The first hand writes *SaxGen* 1–26 in the bottom margin of page 1r. The main body of 1r is taken up by a Latin text written in a different hand. For unclear reasons, the bottom quarter of fol. 1 has been trimmed, and only the ascenders of now-lost words are still visible.

The second hand writes *SaxGen* 151–335 on fol. 2rv. Unlike fol. 1, fol. 2 has no other text than *SaxGen*, which takes up the whole of both pages. The hand finishes with a concluding mark denoting the end of the text at line 2v/21 (see l. 335 n. below).

At line 22 of fol. 2v, the third hand commences writing lines 27–107 of the poem. The text ends at the bottom of 2v in the middle of line 107b, but continues in the same hand on fol. 10v, which contains lines 107b–150. Like 1r, 10v has a separate main text, and *SaxGen* is thus written in the bottom margin. It is noteworthy that the third hand of *SaxGen* also writes lines 1279–1358a of the *Heli*; see Introduction to it.

With this information in mind, the most likely explanation for the appearance of both *SaxGen* and *Heli* in several different hands in **V** is the existence of a now-lost codex ***V**, containing both texts, likely in full. As part of a scribal exercise, several scribes would have been instructed to copy excerpts from either poem in ***V** into the available space of the **V**. The homogenous orthography shared between *SaxGen* and *Heli* in **V** suggests that ***V** may have

been written in a single hand throughout, or, at least, that the two poems were most likely not found in separate manuscripts prior to their entering **V**.

## Relation to the Old English Genesis

Unlike *Heli*, the full *SaxGen* does not survive. However, the fact that the poem did exist as a unified epic is vouchsafed by its translation into Old English in the form of *Genesis B* (*GenB*).

At some point, the episode of *SaxGen* concerning Satan and the Fall of Man, most of which is not extant in **V**, was closely translated into Old English. The translation was inserted into a pre-existing Anglo-Saxon Biblical epic poem, the so-called Old English Genesis. The native Old English parts of that poem are commonly known as *Genesis A*, while the part of the poem deriving from *SaxGen* is labelled *Genesis B*. Although these two parts are clearly distinct in terms of style and language (the former being English, the latter originally Saxon), they are not visually distinct in the relevant manuscript. Their lines are also numbered continuously. Thus, of the Old English Genesis, which has a total of 2936 long-lines, *GenB* takes up ll. 235–851, for a total of 617 long-lines; almost twice the number of surviving lines in *SaxGen*. Of these lines, 791–817a correspond almost exactly to lines 1–26 of *SaxGen*, according to the numbering adapted for the present edition. The remaining part of *GenB* is no longer extant in the original Old Saxon.

## Contents

As it presently survives, *SaxGen* consists of three excerpts, each corresponding to one scribal hand, as noted above. The first excerpt (ll. 1–26) is Adam's speech to Eve after the Fall of man; the very end of it is lost due to trimming (see above). As shown by *GenB*, this speech was originally part of an extended narrative numbering ca. 600 lines, but **V** certainly never contained anything more than Adam's speech.

The second excerpt (ll. 27–150) describes the aftermath of Cain's slaying of his brother Abel. We here possess everything copied into **V**, since the final line terminates in the middle of the page.

The third excerpt (ll. 151–335) narrates the destruction of Sodom. We once again possess the excerpt in full. The inclusion of the abbreviation *EXPL* by the scribe (see l. 335 n.) and the tone of the final line suggest that this likely represents the conclusion to the original *SaxGen* as a whole.

## Text

### After the Fall

1 „Wela, þat þú nú, Éwa, habas," (kwad Adam,) „uƀilo gi·marąkot [V 1r/TODO]
unkaro selƀaro sĭd. · Nú maht þú sehan þia swarton hęll
ginon grádaga; · nú þú sia grimman maht
hinana gi·hôrjan, · nis heƀan-ríki
ge·líhk sulíkaro lógnun: · þit was alloro lando skônjust,
þat wit hier þuruh unkas hêrran þank · hębbjan muostun
þár þú þem ni hôrdis · þie unk þesan haraṃ gi·ried,
þat wit waldandas · word far·brákun,
heƀan-kuningas. · Nú wit hriwig mugon
sorogon for þem sĭda, · wand hé unk selƀo gi·bôd,
þat wit unk su-lik wíti · wardon skoldin,
haraṃo mêstan— · nú þwingit mí giu hungar endi þrust,
bittęr balo-weręk, · þero wáron wit êr bêdero tuom.
Hú skulun wit nu libbjan, · efto hú skulun wit an þesum
liahta wesan?
Nú hier hwílum wind kumit · westan efto ôstan,
sŭðan efto nordan? · gi·sweręk upp dríbit,
kumit haglas skion · himile bi·tengi,
fęrid ford an gi·mang · —þat is firinum kald—
hwílum þanne fan himile · hêto skínit,
blíkit þiu beraḥto sunna: · wit hier þus bara standat,
un·węrid mid gi·wádi: · nis unk hier wiht bi·foran
ni te skadowa ni te skúra, · unk nis hier skattas wiht
te męti gi·markot: · wit hębbjat unk gi·duan mahtigna god,
waldand wrêdan. · Te hwí skulun wit werdan nú?
Nú mag mí þat hreuwan, · þat ik is io bad heƀan-ríkjan god,
waldand þ[...]

TODO.

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2 sehan | sean V 10 unk | hunk V 11 unk | hunk V

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ALL | These lines correspond almost exactly to lines 791–817 of *Genesis B*.

26 waldand þ[...] | The bottom part of V 1r has been trimmed, resulting in the loss of the last 4 lines of Adam's speech (= *GenB* 817–820). For the continuation cf. *GenB* 817 ff., which translates this and the following lines.

## After Cain's slaying of Abel

**2** Sĭdoda im þuo te sęlidon, · habda im sundja gi·waraht [V 2v/22]
bittra an is bruodar; · liet ina undar baka liggjan
an ênam diapun dala · drôr-wóragana,
líbas lôsan, · legar-bedd waran,
guman an griata. · Þuo sprak im god selbo tuo,
waldand mid is wordun · —was im wrêd an is hugi,
þem banan gi·bolgan— · frágoda hwar he habdi is bródar þuo
kind-jungan guman. · Þó sprak im ęft Kain an·gęgen
—habda im mid is handun · haram-werek mikil
wam-dádjun gi·warąht, · þius werold was só swído
be·smitin an sundjun: · „Ni ik þes soroġun ni skal," kwad he,
„gômjan hwar hie ganga, · ni it mi god ni gi·bôd,
þat is hwęrigin hier · huodjan þoroft,
wardon an þesaro weroldi." · Wánde he swído,
þat he bi·helan mahti · hêrran sínum,
þia dádi bi·dęrnjan. · Þuo sprak im ęft ùsa drohtin tuo:
„All habas þu só gi·werękot," (kwad he,) „só þí ti þínaro wer-oldi mag
wesan þín hugi hriuwig, · þes þu mid þínum handon gi·dedos,
þat þú wurdi þínes bruodar bano: · nu he bluodig ligit,
wundun wórig; · þes ni habda he êniga ge·wuruhte te þi,
sundja gi·suohta, · þoh þu ina nu a·slagan hębbjas,
dôdan gi·duanan. · Is drôr sinkit nu an erda,
swêt sundar ligit; · þiu seola hwaroþat
þie gêst gjámar-muod · an godas willjan;
drôr hruopit is te drohtina selbun · endi sagat hwe þea dádi frumida,
þat mên an þesun middil-gardun: · ni mag im ênig mann þan swídor
wero far·wirikjan · an werold-ríkja
an bittron balo-dádjon, · þan þú an þínum bruodar habas
firin-werek gi·frędmid." · Þuo an forahtun ward
Kain aftar þem kwidjun drohtinas, · kwad þat hie wisse garwo,
þat is ni mahti werdan waldand wiht, · an werold-stundu
dádjo bi·dęrnid, · „só ik is nu mag drubundjan hugi," kwad he,
„beran an mínun breostun · þes ik mínan bruodar sluog

60 þuru mín hand-męgin. · Nu wêt ik, þat ik skal an þínum hęti
libbjan,
ford an þínum fiund-skępi, · nu ik mí þesa firina gi·deda,
62 só mí mína sundja nu · swídaron þunkjat,
mis-dád mêra, · þan þín mildi hugi,
64 só ik þes nu wirdig ni bium, · waldand þie guodo,
þat þú mí a·látas · lêdas þingas,
66 tianono a·tuemjas. · Nú ik ni welda mína triuwa haldan,
hugi wid þem þínum hlutron muoda, · nú wêt ik, þat ik hier
ni mag êniga hwíla libbjan,
68 hwand mí ant·wirikit, · só hwat só mi an þisun wega findit,
a·slęhit mi bi þesun sundjun." · Þuo sprak im ęft selbo
an·gęgin
70 heƀanes waldand: · „Hier skalt þú noh nú", kwad hé,
„libbjan lango hwíla. · Þó þú sús á·lêdit sís,
72 mid firinum bi·fangan, · þoh will ik þí friðu sęttjan,
tôgjan su-lík têkjan, · só þú an treuwa maht
74 wesan an þesero wer-olde, · þoh þú is wirdik ni sís:
fluhtik skalt þú þoh ęndi frêdig · ford-wardas nú
76 libbjan an þesum landa, · só lango só þú þit liaht waros;
for·hwátan skulun þí hluttra liudi, · þú ni salt io furður
kuman te þínes hêrron spráko,
78 wesljan þár mid wordon þínon: · waldandi stét
þínes bródor wráka · bittęr an hęlli."

TODO.

80 Þó géng im þanan mid grimmo hugi, · habda ina god selbo [V 2v/45]
swído far·sakanan. · Soroga warð þár þuo gi·kúdit
82 Adama endi Éwun, · in-widd mikil,
iro kindes kwalm, · þat he ni muosta kwik libbjan.
84 Þes ward Adamas hugi · innan breostun
swído an sorogun, · þuo he wissa is sunu dôdan:
86 só ward is ôk þiu muodar, · þe þana magu fuodda,
barn bi iro breostun. · Þuo siu bluodag wuosk
88 hrêu-gi·wádi, · þuo ward iro hugi sêrag.
Bêþo was im þó an sorogun · iak iro barnas dôd,
90 þes hęliðas hin-fard, · iak þat im mid is handun for·dæda
Kain an su-likun kwalma: · siu ni habdun þuo noh kindo þan
mêr

libbendero an þem liahta, · botan þana ênna, þie þuo a·lêdit was
waldanda be is far·wurǫhtjun: · þár ni habdun siu ênniga wunja tuo
niud-líko gi·numan, · wand hie su-likan níd a·huof,
þat he ward is bruodar bano. · Þes im þuo bêðjun ward,
sin-híun twêm · sêr umbi herta.
Oft siu þes gornunde · an griata gi·stuodun,
sin-híun samad, · kwádun, þat sia wissin, þat im þat iro sundja gi·dedin,
þat im ni muostin aftar · ęrębi-wardos
þegnas þían. · Þolodun siu bêðju
mikila mord-kwála, · unt þat im ęft mahtig god,
hêr heƀanes ward · iro hugi buotta,
þat im wurðun ôdana · ęrębi-wardos,
þegnos endi þiornun, · þigun aftar wel,
wóhsun wán-líko, · ge·witt línodun,
spáha spráka. · Spuodda þie mahta
is hand-gi·weręk, · hêlag drohtin,
þat im ward sunu gi·boran; · þem skuopun siu Seð te naman
wárom wordum: · þem wastom lêh
heƀanas waldand · endi hugi guodan,
gam-likan gang · -he was goda wirðig-,
mildi was hie im an is muoda. · Só þana is manno wel,
þie io mið su-likaro huldi muot · hêrron þionun.
Hie loboda þuo mêst · liodjo barnun,
godas huldi: · gumun þanan kwámun
guoda mann, · . . . . . .
wordun wísa, · ge·witt línodun,
þegnos gi·þáhte · endi þigun aftar wel.
Þann kwámun ęft fan Kaina · kraftaga liudi,
hęlidos hard-muoda, · habdun im hugi strangan,
wrêdan willjan, · wí weldun waldandas
lêra lêstjan, · ak habdun im lêdan stríd;
wuohsun im wrisi-líko: · þat was þiu wirsa gi·burd,
kuman fan Kaina. · Bi·gunnun im kôpun þuo
weros wíb undor twisk: · þas ward a·werðit sán
Seðas ge·sïdi, · warð sęggjo folk
mênu gi·męngid · endi wurðun manno barn,

liudi lêða, · þem þitt lioht gi·skuop,
botan þat iro ên habda · erlas gi·hugdi,
þegạn-líka gi·þâht; · was im gi·þungin mann,
wís endi word-spáh, · habda gi·witt mikil:
Enokh was hie hêtan. · Þie hier an erðu warð
mannum te márðum · obar þesan middil-garð,
þat ina hier só kwikana · kuningo þie bętsto,
libbendjan an is lík-haman, · só hie io an þesun liahta ni staraf
-
ak só gi·haloda ina hier · heƀanas waldand
endi ina þár gi·sętta, · þár hie simlon muot
wesan an wunnjon, · untat ina ęft an þesa werold sęndit
hêr heƀanas ward · hęliðo barnum,
liodjun te lêro. · Þann hier ôk þie lêdo kumit,
þat hier Anti-krist · alla þioda,
werod a·werðit, · þann he mid wápnu skal
werðan Enokha te banon, · ęggjun skarạpun
þuruh is hand-męgin; · hwiriƀit þiu sêola,
þie gêst an guodan weg, · endi godas ęngil kumit,
wrikit ina, wamm-skaðon · wápnas ęggjun:
wirðit Anti-krist · aldru bi·lôsid,
þie fiund bi·fęllid. · Folk wirðit ęft gi·hworoƀan
te godas ríkja, · gumuno gi·síðí
langa hwíla, · endi stéd im sídor þit land gi·sund.

TODO.

80 Þó | *Introduced with a large initial.* 107 drohtin | *Here the poem ends on fol. 2v; it picks back up on fol. 10v.* 148 bi·fęllid | biuellid V

## The Destruction of Sodom

**3** Þuo habdun im ęft só swíðo · Sodomo-liudi, [V 2r/1]
weros só far·werkot, · þat im was ùsa waldand gram,
mahtig drohtin, · wand sia mên driƀun,
fręmidun firin-dádi, · habdun im só vilu fiunda barn
wammas ge·wísid: · þuo ni welda þat waldand god,
þiadan þolojan, · ak hiet sie þrea faran,
is ęngelos ôstan · an is árundi,
síðon te Sodoma, · endi was im selƀo þár miƀ.

Þuo sea obar Mambra · mahtige fuorun,
þuo fundun sia Abrahama · bi ênum ala standan,
waran ênna wih-stędi, · endi skolda ùsas waldandas
geld gi·frummjan, · endi skolda þár goda þeonan
an middjan dag · manna þie bętsto.
Þuo ant·kęnda hé kraft godas, · só he sea kuman gi·sakh:
géng im þuo ti·gegnes · endi goda selbun hnêg,
bôg endi bedode · endi bad gerno,
þat hie is huldi forð · hębbjan muosti:
„warod wil þu nu, · waldand, frô mín,
alo-mahtig fadar? · ik biun þín êgan skalk,
hold endi gi·hôrig; · þú bist mí hêrro só guod,
mêðmo só mildi: · wil þu mínas wiht,
drohtin, hębbjan? · Hwat, it all an þínum duoma stéd,
ik libbjo bi þínum lêhene, · endi ik gi·lôbi an þi,
frô mín þe guoda: · muot ik þi frágon nu,
warod þu sigi-drohtin · síðon willjas?“
Þuo kwam im ęft te·gegnes · godas and-wordi,
mahtig muotta: · „Ni willi ik is þi míðan nu,“ kwað he,
„helan holdan man, · hú mín hugi gęngit.
Síðan skulun wí sùðar hinan: · hębbjat him umbi
Sodoma-land
weros só for·werkot. · Nú hruopat þeæ wardas te mí
dages endi nahtes, · þe þe iro dádi tęlljat,
sęggjat hiro sundjon. · Nú willi ik selbo witan,
ef þia mann under him · su-lík mên fręmmjat,
weros wam-dádi. · Þanna skal sea wallande
fiur bi·vallan, · skulun sia hira firin-sundjon
swára bi·sęnkjan: · swebal fan himile
fallit mid fiure, · fêknja sterębat,
mên-dádige męn, · reht só morgan kumit.“
Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · —habda im ęlljan guod,
wísa word-kwidi— · endi wiðęr is waldand sprak:
„Hwat, þú gódas só vilu,“ (kwað hie,) „god hebban-ríki,
drohtin gi·duomis, · all bi þínun dádjun stéd
þius werold an þínum willjan; · þu gi·wald habas
obar þesan middil-gard · manna kunnjas,
só þat gio werðan ni skal, · waldand frô mín,
þat þú þár te ênum duoas · ubila endi guoda,

lioba endi lêðа, · wand sia gi·líka ni sind.
Þu ruomes só rehtæs, · ríki drohtin,
só þu ni wili, þat þár ant·geldan · guod-willige mann
wam-skaðono werẹk, · þoh þu is gi·wald haƀes
te gi·frummjanna. · Muot ik þi frágon nu,
só þú mí þiu gramara ni sís, · god heƀan-ríki?
ef þú þár fíðis fíftig · ferạhtaro manno,
liubigaro liodo, · muot þanna þat land gi·sund,
waldand, an þínum willjan · gi·wẹrid standan?“
Þuo kwam im ẹft te·gegnes · godas and-wordi:
„Ef ik þár findo fíftig,“ (kwað he,) „ferạhtara manno,
guodaro gumono, · þea te goda hẹbbjan
fasto gi·fangan, · þanna willi ik im iro ferạh far·geƀan
þuru þat ik þea hluttron man · haldan wille.“
Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · áðar síðe,
forð frágoda · frâhon sínan:
„Hwat duos þu is þanna,“ (kwað he,) „drohtin frô mín,
ef þu þár þrítig maht · þegno fíðan,
wam-lôsa weros? · wil þu sia noh þanna
látan te líƀa, · þat sia muotin þat land waran?“
Þuo im þe guoda, · god heƀan-ríki,
sniumo gi·sagda, · þat hie só weldi
lêstjan an þen landa: · „Ef ik þár lubigaro mahg,“ kwað he,
„þrítig undar þero þiodo · þegno fíðan
god-forọhta gumon: · þanna willi ik im far·geƀan allum
þat mên endi þea mis-dád · endi látan þat manno folk
sittjan umbi Sodoma · endi ge·sund wesan.“
Abraham þuo gi·mahalda · agalêt-líko
—folgoda is frôjan—, · filo worda gi·sprak:
„Nu skal ik is þí biddjan“, (kwað he,) „þat þú þí ni belges ti mí,
frô mín þie guoda, · hú ik sus filu mahlja,
weslja wiðẹr þi mid mínum wordum: · ik wêt, þat ik þas
wirðig ni bium
ni sí þat þu it willjas bi þínaro guodi, · god heƀan-ríki
þiadan, gi·þolojan: · mí is þarạf mikil
te witanna þínne willjan, · hweðer þat werad gi·sund
libbjan muoti, · þe sea liggjan skulun,
fêgja bi·vallan: · hwat wilis þu is þanna, frô mín, duoan,
ef þu þár tehani · treu-hafte maht

fíðan under þemo folka feraḥtera manno · wil þú im þanna
hiro ferh far·geban,
þat sia umbi Sodoma-land · sittjan muotin
búan an þem buruḍgjum, · só þú im a·bolgan ni sís?“
Þuo kwam im ęft te·gegnes · godas and-wordi:
„Ef ik þár tehani,“ (kwað he,) „treu-haftera mag
an þem lande noh · liod*jo* fíðan,
þanna látu ik sia alla þuru þie feraḥtun man · ferẹhas brúkan.“
Þuo ni dorste Abraham lęng · drohtin sínan
furður frágon, · ak hé fell im after te bedu
an kneo kraftag, · kwað hé gerno
is geld gęrẹwedi · endi gode þeonodi,
waraḥti after is willjan. · Gi·wêt im ęft þanan
gangan te is gęst-sęli; · godes engilos fort
síðodun te Sodoma, · so im selbo ge·bôd
waldand mid is wordo, · þuo hie sea hiet an þana weg faran.

TODO.

180 þeæ wardas | þe æuuardas **V** 196 ênum | henum **V** 243 ak | hak **V**

Skoldun sie be·fíðan, · hwat þár feraḥtera [V 2r/36]
umbi Sodoma-burg, · sundjono tuomera
manna wári, · þie ni habdin mênes filu,
firin-werko gi·frumid. · Þó gi·hôrdun siæ fêgero karm
an allaro sęliðu gi·hwen, · sundiga liudi
firin-werk fręmmjan: · was þár fiundo gi·mang,
wrêðaro wihtjo, · þea an þat wam habdun
þea liudi far·lêdid: · þat lôn was þuo hat handum
mikil mið morðu, · þat sia oft mên driþun.
Þanna sat im þár an innan · aðal-burdig man,
Loth mið þem liudjum, · þie oft lof godas
waraḥte an þesaro weroldi: · habda im þár welono gi·nuog,
guodas gi·wunnan: · he was gode wirðig.
He was Abrahamas · aðali-knóslas,
his bróðer barn: · ni was bętara man
umbi Giordanas staðos · mið gum-kustjum,
gi·węrid mið ge·wittjo: · him was ùsa waldand hold.
Þuo te sedla hnêg · sunna þiu hwíta,
alloro bôkno beraḥtost, · þuo stuond hie fore þes buruges dore.
Þuo gi·sah hé an áband · engilos twêne

gangan an þea gardos, · só sea fan gode kwámun
ge·węride mid ge·wittjo; · þuo sprak he im sán mid is wordum tuo.
Géng þuo te·gegnes · endi gode þankade,
heƀan-kuninga, · þes hé im þea helpa fer·lêkh,
þat he muosta sea miđ is ôgum · an luokojan,
iak he sea an kneo kusta · endi kùsko bad,
þat sea suohtin his sęliđa: · kwađ þat he im selbas duom
gáui su-líkas guodas, · só im god habdi
far·liwen an þem landa: · sea ni wurđun te lata hwęrigin,
ak se gengun im an is gęst-sęli, · endi he im giungar-duom
fręmide ferąht-líka, · sea im filo sagdun
wáraro wordu. · Þár he an wahtu sat,
held is hêrran bodan · hêlag-líka,
godas ęngilos. · Sia him guodas só filo,
suòđas gi·sagdun. · Swart furđur skrêd,
narowa naht an skion, · náhida moragan
an allara sęliđa gi·hwem. · Uht-fugal sang
fora daga-h*r*uom*a*. · Þó habdun ùsas drohtinas bodon
þea firina bi·fundan, · þea þár fręmidun mên
umbi Sodoma-burųg. · Þó sagdun sia Lođa,
þat þár morđ mikil · manno barno,
skolda þera liodjo werđan · endi ôk þes landas só samo.
Hietun ina þuo gęręwjan, · endi hietun þó gangan þanan,
firrjan hina fon þem fiundum · endi lêdjan is frí miđ him,
idis ađal-borana. · He ni habda þár his ađaljas þan mêr,
botan is dohtar twá, · mid þem gi·hietun sie, þat hie êr daga wári
an ênum berga uppan, · þat hina brinnandi
fiur ni bi·vengi. · Þó he te þere fęrđi warđ
gąhun gi·gęrewid, · gengun ęngilos,
habdun hina bi handum · heƀan-kuningas bodon,
lêddun hina endi lêrdun · lango hwíla,
untat sea ina gi·brąhtun · bi þera burųg útan.
Hietun, þat siæ io ni ge·hôrdin · sulik ge·hlunn mikil
brakon an þem burųgjum, · þat sia io under bak sáwen,
an þiu þie sea an þem landæ · libbjan weldin.
Þuo *ƀ*wurubun ęft wiđęr · hêlega wardos,
godas ęngilos, · gengun sniumo,

sïðodun te Sodomo: · þanan sụðar fuor
Loth þoro hira lêra, · flôh þera liodjo gi·mang,
dęręþjoro manno: · þó warð dag kuman.
Þuo warð þár gi·hlunn mikil · himile bi·tęngi,
brast endi brakoda, · warð þero buruḍgjo gi·*b*wilík
rôkas gi·fullit, · warð þár fan radura só vilu
fiures gi·fallin, · warð fêgero karm,
lêðaro liodjo: · logna all bi·feng
brêd buruḍgu-gi·setu: · bran all samað,
stên endi erða, · endi só manag strídin man
swultun endi sunkun: · swebal brinnandi
wel after wíkjom; · waraḍgas þolodun
lêðas lôn-geld. · Þat land inn bi·sank,
þiu erða an af·grundi; · al warð far·spildit
Sodoma-ríki, · þat is ênig *s*ęg ni gi·nas,
iak só bi·dôðit an dôð-sêu, · so it noh te daga stęndit
fluodas gi·fullit. · Þuo habdun hiro firin-dádi
all Sodomo-þiod · sêro ant·goldan,
botan þat þár iro ênna · út ent·lêdde
waldand an is willjan · endi þiu wíf mid im,
þriu mið þem þegna. · Þó gi·hôrdun sea þero þiodo kwalm,
buruḍgi brinnan. · Þó þár under bak bi·sakh
idis aðal-boren · —siu ni welde þera ęngilo
lêra lêstjan; · þat was Lohthas brúd,
þan lang þe siu an þem landa · libbjan muosta—
þuo siu an þem bereḍga gi·stuod · endi under bak bi·sakh,
þuo warð siu te stêne, · þár siu standan skal
mannum te márðu · oþar middil-gard
after te êwan-dage, · só lango só þius erða lêbot.

TODO.

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250 Skoldun | *Introduced by large initial.* 250 hwat þár | huattar V 269 áband | haband V 287 daga-h*r*uom*a* | *emend.;* 'daga huoam' V 291 werðan | 'huuerthan' V 294 aðaljas | 'hadalias' V 305 *b*wurubun | *metr. emend.;* uurubun V 314 bi·feng | biueng V 321 *s*ęg | 'theg' V 335 lêbot. | *add.* EXPL V

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335 lêbot. | The *EXPL* in the ms. stands for 'explicit', customarily placed at the end of a text in mediaeval mss. This line also serves as a fitting conclusion to the poem.

# Genesis B

**Dating:** C9th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

**Genesis B** represents a part of the Old English Genesis translated from an Old Saxon original, presently represented by the fragmentary *SaxGen* (edited above). Most of the Saxon original underlying *Genesis B* is now lost, but a few lines shared with *SaxGen* attest to the primacy of the latter poem.

TODO: lack of alliteration in certain lines, notable Saxonisms.

## Text

**5** „Ac níotað inc þæs ǫ̀ðres ealles, · for·lǽtað þone ǽnne béam,
wariað inc wið þone wæstm. · Ne wyrð inc wilna gǽd.“
Hnigon þá mid heafdum · heofon-cyninge
georne to·géanes · and sǽdon ealles þanc,
lista and þára lára. · Hé lét héo þæt land búan,
hwærf him þá tó heofenum · hálig drihten,
stíð-ferhð cyning. · Stód his hand-ge·weorc
somod on sande, · nyston sorga wiht
to be·grornianne, · bútan héo godes willan
lengest lǽsten. · Héo wæron léof gode
þenden héo his hálige word · healdan woldon.

TODO: Translation

**6** Hæfde sé al-walda · engel-cynna
þurh hand-mægen, · hálig drihten,
tíene ge·trimede, · þǽm hé ge·trúwode wel
þæt híe his giongor-scipe · fyligan wolden,
wyrcean his willan, · for·þon hé him ge·wit for·geaf
and mid his handum ge·sceop, · hálig drihten.
Ge·sett hæfde hé hie swá ge·sælig-lice, · ǽnne hæfde he swa swíðne ge·worhtne,
swá mihtigne on his mod-ge·þóhte, · hé lét hine swá micles wealdan,
héhstne tó him on heofona ríce, · hæfde hé hine swá hwítne ge·worhtne,
swa wyn-lic wæs his wæstm on heofonum · þæt him cóm from weroda drihtne,
ge·líc wæs hé þám leohtum steorrum. · Lof sceolde hé drihtnes wyrcean,
dyran sceolde hé his dréamas on heofonum, · and sceolde his drihtne þancian
þæs léanes þe hé him on þám leohte ge·scerede · þonne lǽte hé his hine lange wealdan.
Ac hé wende hit him to wyrsan þinge, · on·gan him winn up hebban

wið þone héhstan heofnes waldend, · þe siteð on þám hálgan stóle.
Déore wæs hé drihtne úre; · ne mihte him be·dyrned weorðan
þæt his engyl on·gan · ofer-mód wesan,
á·hóf hine wið his herran, · sóhte hete-spræce,
gylp-word on·gean, · nolde gode þeowian,
cwæð þæt his líc wǽre · leoht and scéne,
hwít and hiow-beorht. · Ne meahte hé æt his hige findan
þæt gode wolde · geonger-dóme,
þéodne þeowian. · Þúhte him sylfum
þæt he mægyn and cræft · máran hæfde
þonne sé hálga god · habban mihte
folc-ge·stælna. · Feala worda ge·spæc
se engel ofer-módes. · Þóhte þurh his ánes cræft
hú hé him streng-licran · stól ge·worhte,
héahran on heofonum; · cwæð þæt hine his hige speone
þæt hé west and norð · wyrcean on·gunne,
trymede ge·timbro; · cwæð him tweo þúhte
þæt hé gode wolde · geongra weorðan.
„Hwæt sceal ic winnan?“ cwæð he. ·„Nis me wihtæ þearf
hearran to habbanne. · Ic mæg mid handum swá fela
wundra ge·wyrcean. · Ic hæbbe ge·weald micel
to gyrwanne · god-lecran stól,
hearran on heofne. · Hwý sceal ic æfter his hyldo þeowian,
búgan him swilces geongor-dómes? · Ic mæg wesan god swá hé.
Big·standað mé strange ge·néatas, · þá ne willað mé æt þam stríðe ge·swícan,
hæleþas heard-móde. · Hie habbað mé to hearran ge·corene,
rófe rincas; · mid swilcum mæg man ræd ge·þencean,
fón mid swilcum folc-ge·steallan. · Frynd synd hie míne georne,
holde on hyra hyge-sceaftum. · Ic mæg hýra hearra wesan,
rædan on þis ríce. · Swá mé þæt riht ne þinceð,
þæt ic ó·leccan · á·wiht þurfe
gode æfter gode ǽnegum. · Ne wille ic leng his geongra wurþan.“
Þá hit sé all-walda · eall ge·hýrde,
þæt his engyl on·gan · ofer·méde micel

á·hebban wið his hearran · and spræc héa-lic word
dol-líce wið drihten sinne, · sceolde hé þá dǽd on·gyldan,
worc þæs ge·winnes ge·dǽlan, · and sceolde his wíte habban,
ealra morðra mǽst. · Swa deð monna ge·hwilc
þe wið his waldend · winnan on·gynneð
mid máne wið þone mǽran drihten. · Þá wearð se mihtiga ge·bolgen,
héhsta heofones waldend, · wearp hine of þán héan stóle.
Hete hæfde hé æt his hearran ge·wunnen, · hyldo hæfde his fer·lorene,
gram wearð him se góda on his móde. · For·þon hé sceolde grund ge·sécean
heardes helle-wítes, · þæs þe hé wann wið heofnes waldend.
Á·cwæð hine þá fram his hyldo · and hine on helle wearp,
on þá déopan dala, · þær hé to déofle wearð,
se féond mid his ge·férum eallum. · Feollon þá ufon of heofnum
þurh-longe swá · þréo niht and dagas,
þá englas of heofnum on helle, · and heo ealle for·scéop
drihten to deoflum. · For·þon héo his dǽd and word
noldon weorðian, · for·þon hé héo on wyrse leoht
under eorðan neoðan, · æll-mihtig god,
sette sige-léase · on þá sweartan helle.
Þǽr hæbbað héo on ǽfyn · un-ge·met lange,
ealra feonda ge·hwilc, · fýr ed-néowe,
þonne cymð on úhtan · éasterne wind,
forst fyrnum cald. · Symble fýr oððe gár,
sum heard ge·wrinc · habban sceoldon.
Worhte man hit him tó wíte, · —hyra wor-uld wæs ge·hwyrfed—,
forman síðe, · fylde helle
mid þám and·sacum. · Heoldon englas forð
heofon-ríces héhðe, · þe ǽr godes hyldo ge·lǽston.
Lágon þa oðre fynd on þám fýre, · þe ǽr swa feala hæfdon
ge·winnes wið heora waldend. · Wíte þoliað,
hátne heaðo-welm · helle to·middes,

TODO: Translation

7 brand and bráde lígas, · swilce eac þá biteran récas,

þrosm and þystro, · for·þon hie þegn-scipe
godes for·gymdon. · Hie hyra gál be·swác —
engles ofer·hygd — · noldon al-waldan
word weorþian, · hæfdon wíte micel,
wæron þá be·feallene · fýre to botme
on þá hátan hell · þurh hyge-léaste
and þurh ofer·metto, · sóhton ȯþer land,
þæt wæs léohtes léas · and wæs líges full,
fýres fær micel. · Fynd on·géaton
þæt híe hæfdon ge·wrixled · wíta un·rím
þurh heora miclan mód · and þurh miht godes
and þurh ofer·metto · ealra swíðost.
Þá spræc sé ofer·móda cyning, · þe ǽr wæs engla scýnost,
hwítost on heofne · and his hearran léof,
drihtne dýre, · oð híe tó dole wurdon,
þæt him for gál-scipe · god sylfa wearð
mihtig on móde yrre. · Wearp hine on þæt morðer innan,
niðer on þæt nío-bedd, · and scéop him naman siððan,
cwæð sé héhsta · hátan sceolde
Satan siððan · hét hine þǽre sweartan helle
grundes gýman, · nalles wið god winnan.
Satan maðelode, · sorgiende spræc,
sé ðe helle forð · healdan sceolde,
gíeman þæs grundes. · Wæs ǽr godes engel,
hwít on heofne, · oð hine his hyge for·spéon
and his ofer·metto · ealra swíðost,
þæt hé ne wolde · wereda drihtnes
word wurðian. · Weoll him on innan
hyge ymb his heortan, · hát wæs him útan
wráð-lic wíte. · Hé þá worde cwæð:
„Is þæs ǽnga styde · un·ge·líc swíðe
þám ȯðrum þe we ǽr cúðon,
héan on heofon-ríce · þe me mín hearra on·lag,
þeah wé hine for þám al-waldan · ágan ne móston,
rómigan ùres ríces. · Næfð hé þeah riht ge·dón
þæt he ùs hæfð be·fælled · fýre tó botme,
helle þære hátan, · heofon-ríce be·numen;
hafað hit ge·mearcod · mid mon-cynne
to ge·settanne. · Þæt mé is sorga mǽst,

þæt Adam sceal, · þe wæs of eorðan ge·worht,
minne strong-lícan · stól be·healdan,
wesan him on wynne, · and wé þis wíte þolien,
hearm on þisse helle. · Wá lá, áhte ic mínra handa ge·weald
and móste áne tíd · úte weorðan,
wesan áne winter-stunde, · þonne ic mid þys werode—
Ac licgað me ymbe · íren-benda,
rídeð racentan sál. · Ic eom ríces léas;
habbað mé swá hearde · helle clommas
fæste be·fangen. · Hér is fýr micel,
ufan and neoðone. · Ic á ne ge·seah
láðran land-scipe. · Líg ne á·swámað,
hát ofer helle. · Me habbað hringa ge·spong,
slíð-hearda sál · síðes á·myrred,
á·fyrred mé min féðe; · fét synt ge·bundene,
handa ge·hæfte. · Synt þissa heldora
wegas for·worhte, · swá ic mid wihte ne mæg
of þissum lioðo-bendum. · Licgað me ymbe
heardes írenes · háte ge·slægene
grindlas gréate. · Mid þý mé god hafað
ge·hæfted be þám healse, · swá ic wát hé minne hige cúðe;
and þæt wiste éac · weroda drihten,
þæt sceolde unc Adam · yfele ge·wurðan
ymb þæt heofon-ríce, · þær ic áhte mínra handa ge·weald.

TODO: Translation

**8** Ac þoliað wé nu þréa on helle, · —þæt syndon þystro and hæto—,
grimme, grund-lease. · Hafað us god sylfa
for·swapen on þás sweartan mistas; · swá hé us ne mæg ænige synne ge·stælan,
þæt wé him on þám lande láð ge·fremedon, · he hæfð us þeah þæs leohtes be·scyrede,
be·worpen on ealra wíta mæste. · Ne magon we þæs wrace ge·fremman,
ge·léanian him mid láðes wihte · þæt he us hafað þæs leohtes be·scyrede.
He hæfð nú gem·earcod anne middan-geard, · þár he hæfð mon ge·worhtne

æfter his on·líc-nesse. · Mid þám hé wile eft ge·settan
heofona ríce mid hluttrum saulum. · Wé þæs sculon hycgan georne,
þæt wé on Adame, · gif wé æfre mægen,
and on his eafrum swá some, · andan ge·bétan,
on·wendan him þær willan sínes, · gif wé hit mægen wihte á·þencan.
Ne ge·lýfe ic mé nú þæs leohtes furðor · þæs þe he him þenceð lange niotan,
þæs éades mid his engla cræfte. · Ne magon wé þæt on aldre ge·winnan,
þæt we mihtiges godes mód on·wæcen. · Uton oð·wendan hit nú monna bearnum,
þæt heofon-ríce, nú wé hit habban ne móton, · ge·dón þæt híe his hyldo for·láten,
þæt híe þæt on·wendon þæt hé mid his worde be·béad. · Þonne weorð hé him wráð on móde,
á·hwet híe from his hyldo. · Þonne sculon híe þás helle sécan
and þás grimman grundas. · Þonne móton wé híe ús to giongrum habban,
fíra bearn on þissum fæstum clomme. · On·ginnað nú ymb þá fyrde þencean.
Gif ic énegum þegne · þéoden-mádmas
géara for·géafe, · þenden we on þan godan rice
gesælige sæton · and hæfdon úre setla ge·weald,
þonne hé mé ná on léofran tíd · léanum ne meahte
míne gife gyldan, · gif his gien wolde
mínra þegna hwilc · ge·þafa wurðan,
þæt hé up heonon · úte mihte
cuman þurh þás clustro, · and hæfde cræft mid him
þæt hé mid feðer-homan · fléogan meahte,
windan on wolcne, · þær ge·worht stondað
Adam and Eue · on eorð-ríce
mid welan be·wunden, · and wé synd á·worpene hider
on þás déopan dalo. · Nú híe drihtne synt
wurðran micle, · and móton him þone welan a´gan
þe wé on heofon-ríce · habban sceoldon,
ríce mid rihte; · is sé ræd ge·scyred
monna cynne. · Þæt mé is on mínum mode swá sár,

on mínum hyge hreoweð, · þæt híe heofon-ríce
ágan tó aldre. · Gif hit eower ænig mæge
ge·wendan mid wihte · þæt híe word godes
láre for·læten, · sóna híe him þe láðran beoð.
Gif híe brecað his ge·bod-scipe, · þonne hé him á·bolgen wurðeþ;
siððan bið him sé wela on·wended · and wyrð him wíte ge·garwod,
sum heard hearm-scearu. · Hycgað his ealle,
hú gé hí be·swicen. · Siððan ic mé sefte mæg
restan on þyssum racentum, · gif him þæt ríce losað.
Sé þe þæt ge·læsteð, · him bið léan gearo
æfter tó aldre, · þæs wé hér inne magon
on þyssum fýre forð · fremena gewinnan.
Sittan láte ic hine wið mé sylfne, · swá hwá swá þæt secgan cymeð
on þas hátan helle, · þæt hie heofon-cyninges
un·wurð-líce · wordum and dǽdum
láre [...]

TODO: Translation

441 [...] | *At this point two folios are missing. These would have contained sections 9–10 of the poem.*

**11** An·gan hine þa gyrwan · godes andsaca,
fus on frætwum, · hæfde fæcne hyge,
hæleðhelm on heafod asette · and þone ful hearde geband,
spenn mid spangum; · wiste him spræca fela,
wora worda. · Wand him up þanon,
hwearf him þurh þa helldora, · —hæfde hyge strangne—,
leolc on lyfte · laþwendemod,
swang þæt fyr on twa · feondes cræfte;
wolde dearnunga · drihtnes geongran,
mid man-dǽdum · men be·swícan,
for·lædan and for·láran, · þæt híe wurdon láð gode.
Hé þá ge·férde · þurh féondes cræft
oððæt hé Adam · on eorð-ríce,
godes hand-ge·sceaft, · gearone funde,
wis-líce ge·worht, · and his wíf somed,
fréo fægroste, · swá híe fela cúðon
godes ge·gearwigean, · þá him tó gingran self

metot man-cynnes · mearcode selfa.
And him bí twégin · béamas stódon
þá wæron útan · ofætes ge·hlædene,
ge·wered mid wæstme, · swá híe waldend god,
héah heofon-cyning · handum ge·sette,
þæt þǽr yldo bearn · móste on céosan
gódes and yfeles, · gumena æg-hwilc,
welan and wáwan. · Næs sé wæstm ge·líc.
Óðer wæs swá wyn-lic, · wlitig and scíene,
liðe and lof-sum, · þæt wæs lífes béam;
moste on ec-nisse · æfter lybban,
wesan on wor-ulde, · sé þæs wæstmes on·bát,
swá him æfter þý · yldo ne derede,
ne suht swáre, · ac móste symle wesan
lungre on lustum · and his líf ágon,
hyldo heofon-cyninges · hér on wor-ulde,
habban him tó wæron · witot ge·þinge
on þone héan heofon, · þonne hé* heonon wende.
Þonne wæs sé óðer · eallenga sweart,
dim and þystre; · þæt wæs déaðes béam,
sé bær bitres fela. · Sceolde bú witan
ylda æg-hwilc · yfles and gódes
ge·wand on þisse worulde. · Sceolde on wíte á
mid swáte and mid sorgum · siððan libban,
swá hwá swá ge·byrgde · þæs on þám béame ge·weox.
Sceolde hine yldo be·niman · ellen-dǽda,
dréamas and driht-scipes, · and him beon déað scyred.
Lýtle hwíle · sceolde hé his lífes níotan,
sécan þonne landa · sweartost on fýre.
Sceolde féondum þéowian, · þǽr is ealra frécna mǽste
léodum tó langre hwíle. · Þæt wiste sé láða georne,
dyrne deofles boda · þe wið drihten wann.
Wearp hine þá on wyrmes líc · and wand him þá ymb-utan
þone déaðes béam · þurh deofles cræft,
ge·nam þǽr þæs ofætes · and wende hine eft þanon
þǽr hé wiste hand-ge·weorc · heofon-cyninges.
On·gon hine þá frínan · forman worde
se láða mid lígenum: ·„Langað þé á·wuht,
Adam, up tó gode? · Ic eom on his ǽrende hider

feorran ge·féred, · ne þæt nú fyrn ne wæs
þæt ic wið hine sylfne sæt. · Þá hét hé mé on þysne síð faran,
hét þæt þú þisses ofætes æte, · cwæð þæt þín abal and cræft
and þín mód-sefa · mára wurde,
and þín líc-homa · leohtra micle,
þín ge·sceapu scénran, · cwæð þæt þe æniges sceates ðearf
ne wurde on worulde. · Nu þu willan hæfst,
hyldo geworhte · heofoncyninges,
to þance geþenod · þínum hearan,
hæfst þe wið drihten dyrne geworhtne. · Ic gehyrde hine þine dæd and word
lofian on his leohte · and ymb þin lif sprecan.
Swa þu læstan scealt · þæt on þis land hider
his bodan bringað. · Brade synd on worulde
grene geardas, · and god siteð
on þam hehstan · heofna rice,
ufan alwalda. · Nele þa earfeðu
sylfa habban · þæt he on þysne síð fare,
gumena drihten, · ac he his gingran sent
to þinre spræce. · Nu he þe mid spellum het
listas læran. · Læste þu georne
his ambyhto, · nim þe þis ofæt on hand,
bit his and byrge. · Þe weorð on þínum breostum rum,
wæstm þy wlitegra. · Þe sende waldend god,
þin hearra þas helpe · of heofon-ríce."
Adam maðelode · þær he on eorðan stod,
self-sceafte guma: ·„Þonne ic sige-drihten,
mihtigne god, · mæðlan ge·hýrde
strangre stemne, · and me her stondan het,
his be·bodu healdan, · and me þas brýd forgeaf,
wlite-scíene wíf, · and me warnian het
þæt ic on þone déaðes béam · be·droren ne wurde,
be·swicen tó swíðe, · he cwæð þæt þá sweartan helle
healdan sceolde · sé ðe bí his heortan wuht
láðes ge·læde. · Nát þeah þú mid lígenum fare
þurh dýrne ge·þanc · þe þu drihtnes eart
boda of heofnum. · Hwæt, ic þinra bysna ne mæg,
worda ne wisna · wuht oncnawan,
siðes ne sagona. · Ic wat hwæt he me self bebead,

nergend user, · þa ic hine nehst geseah;
he het me his word weorðian · and wel healdan,
læstan his lare. · Þu gelic ne bist
ænegum his engla · þe ic ær geseah,
ne þu me oðiewdest · ænig tacen
þe he me þurh treowe · to onsende,
min hearra þurh hyldo. · Þy ic þe hyran ne cann.
Ac þu meaht þe forð faran. · Ic hæbbe me fæstne geleafan
up to þam ælmihtegan gode · þe me mid his earmum worhte,
her mid handum sínum. · He mæg [illegible] me of his hean rice
geofian mid goda gehwilcum, · þeah he his gingran ne sende."

TODO: Translation

**12** Wende hine wráð-mód · þǽr hé þæt wíf ge·séah
on eorð-ríce · Euan stondan,
scéone ge·sceapene, · cwæð þæt sceaðena mǽst
eallum heora eaforum · ǽfter siððan
wurde on wor-ulde: ·„Ic wát, inc waldend god
a·bolgen wyrð, · swá ic him þisne bod-scipe
selfa secge, · þonne ic of þys síðe cume
ofer langne weg, · þæt git ne læstan wel
hwilc ærende swa · he easten hider
on þysne sið sendeð. · Nu sceal he sylf faran
to incre andsware; · ne mæg his ærende
his boda beodan; · þy ic wat þæt he inc abolgen wyrð,
mihtig on mode. · Gif þu þeah mínum wilt,
wíf willende, · wordum hýran,
þu meaht his þonne rúme · ræd ge·þencan.
Ge·hyge on þínum breostum · þæt þu inc bam twam meaht
wíte be·warigan, · swa ic þe wisie.
Æt þisses ofetes; · þonne wurðað þin eagan swa leoht
þæt þu meaht swa wide · ofer woruld ealle
geseon siððan, · and selfes stol
herran þines, · and habban his hyldo forð.
Meaht þu Adame · eft gestyran,
gif þu his willan hæfst · and he þínum wordum getrywð.
Gif þu him to soðe sægst · hwylce þu selfa hæfst
bisne on breostum, · þæs þu gebod godes
lare læstes, · he þone laðan strið,

yfel and·wyrde · an for·læteð
on breost-cofan, · swa wit him bu tu
an sped sprecað. · Span þu hine georne
þæt he þine lare læste, · þy læs gyt lað gode,
incrum waldende, · weorðan þyrfen.
Gif þu þæt angin fremest, · idesa seo betste,
forhele ic incrum herran · þæt me hearmes swa fela
Adam ge·spræc, · eargra worda.
Tyhð me untryowða, · cwyð þæt ic seo teonum georn,
gramum ambyhtsecg, · nales godes engel.
Ac ic cann ealle swa geare · engla gebyrdo,
heah heofona gehlidu; · wæs seo hwil þæs lang
þæt ic georn lice · gode þegnode
þurh holdne hyge, · herran mínum,
drihtne selfum; · ne eom ic déofle ge·líc."
Lædde hie swa mid ligenum · and mid listum speon
idese on þæt unriht, · oðþæt hire on innan ongan
weallan wyrmes geþeaht, · —hæfde hire wacran hige
metod ge·mearcod—, · þæt heo hire mod ongan
látan æfter þam lárum; · forþon heo æt þam laðan onfeng
ofer drihtnes word · deaðes beames
weorcsumne wæstm. · Ne wearð wyrse dæd
monnum gemearcod. · Þæt is micel wundor
þæt hit ece god · æfre wolde
þeoden þolian, · þæt wurde þegn swa monig
forlædd be þam lygenum · þe for þam larum com.
Heo þa þæs ofætes æt, · alwaldan bræc
word and willan. · Þa meahte heo wide geseon
þurh þæs laðan læn · þe hie mid ligenum beswac,
dearnenga bedrog, · þe hire for his dædum com,
þæt hire þuhte hwitre · heofon and eorðe,
and eall þeos woruld wlitigre, · and geweorc godes
micel and mihtig, · þeah heo hit þurh monnes geþeaht
ne sceawode. · Ac se sceaða georne
swicode ymb þa sawle · þe hire ær þa siene onlah,
þæt heo swa wide · wlitan meahte
ofer heofonrice. · Þa se forhatena spræc
þurh feondscipe · —nalles he hie freme lærde—:
„Þu meaht nu þe self geseon, · swa ic hit þe secgan ne þearf,

Eue seo gode, · þæt þe is ungelic
wlite and wæstmas, · siððan þu mínum wordum getruwodest,
læstes mine lare. · Nu scineð þe leoht fore
glæd-lic on·gean · þæt ic from gode brohte
hwit of heofonum; · nu þu his hrinan meaht.
Sæge Adame · hwilce þu gesihðe hæfst
þurh minne cime cræfta. · Gif giet þurh cuscne siodo
læst mina lara, · þonne gife ic him þæs leohtes genog
þæs ic þe swa godes · gegired hæbbe.
Ne wite ic him þa womcwidas, · þeah he his wyrðe ne sie
to alætanne; · þæs fela he me laðes spræc."
Swá hire eaforan sculon · æfter lybban:
þonne híe láð ge·dóð, · híe sculon lufe wyrcean,
bétan heora hearran hearm-cwide · ond habban his hyldo forð.
Þá gíen tó Adame · idesa scíenost,
wífa wlitegost · þe on wor-uld come,
for·þon héo wæs hand-ge·weorc · heofon-cyninges,
þeah héo þá dearnenga · fordon wurde,
for·læd mid lígenum, · þæt híe láð gode
þurh þæs wráðan ge·þanc · weorðan sceoldon,
þurh þæs déofles searo · dóm for·lætan,
hierran hyldo, · hefon-ríces þolian
monige hwíle. · Bið þam men full wá
þe hine ne warnað · þonne hé his ge·weald hafað.
Sum héo hire on handum bær, · sum hire æt heortan læg,
æppel un·sælga, · þone hire ár for·bead
drihtna drihten, · déað-béames ofet,
and þæt word á·cwæð · wuldres aldor,
þæt þæt micle morð · menn ne þorfton
þegnas þolian, · ac hé þéoda ge·hwám
hefon-ríce for·geaf, · hálig drihten,
wíd-brádne welan, · gif híe þone wæstm an
lætan wolden · þe þæt láð-tréow
on his bógum bær, · bitre ge·fylled;
þæt wæs déaðes béam · þe him drihten for·bead.
For·léc hie þá mid lígenum · sé wæs láð gode,
on hete heofon-cyninges, · and hyge Euan,
wífes wác ge·þoht, · þæt héo on·gan his wordum trúwian,
læstan his láre, · and ge·léafan nom

þæt hé þá bysene from gode · brungen hæfde
þe hé hire swá wǽr-lice · wordum sægde,
iewde hire tácen · and tréowa ge·hét,
his holdne hyge. · Þá héo tó hire hearran spræc:
„Adam, fréa mín, · þis ofet is swá swéte,
blíð on bréostum, · and þes boda scíene,
godes engel gód, · ic on his gearwan ge·séo
þæt hé is ǽrend-secg · uncres hearran,
hefon-cyninges. · His hyldo is unc betere
to ge·winnanne · þonne his wiðer·médo.
Gif þú him héo·dæg wuht · hearmes ge·spræce,
hé for·gifð hit þéah, · gif wit him geongor-dóm
lǽstan willað. · Hwæt scal þé swá láð-lic stríð
wið þines hearran bodan? · Unc is his hyldo þearf;
hé mæg unc ǽrendian · tó þám al-waldan,
heofon-cyninge. · Ic mæg heonon ge·séon
hwǽr hé sylf siteð, · —þæt is sùð and éast—,
welan be·wunden, · sé ðás wor-uld ge·scéop;
ge·séo ic him his englas · ymbe hweorfan
mid feðer-haman, · ealra folca mǽst,
wereda wynsumast. · Hwá meahte me swelc ge·wit gifan,
gif hit gegnunga · god ne on·sende,
heofones waldend? · Gehyran mæg ic rume
and swa wide ge·seon · on woruld ealle
ofer þas sidan ge·sceaft, · ic mæg swegles gamen
gehyran on heofnum. · Wearð me on hige leohte
utan and innan, · siðþan ic þæs ofætes onbat.
Nu hæbbe ic his her on handa, · herra se goda;
gife ic hit þe georne. · Ic gelyfe þæt hit from gode come,
broht from his bysene, · þæs me þes boda sægde
wǽrum wordum. · Hit nis wuhte gelic
elles on eorðan, · buton swa þes ar sægeð,
þæt hit gegnunga · from gode come."

TODO: Translation

**13** Hío spræc him þicce tó · and speon hine ealne dæg
on þa dimman dæd · þæt hie drihtnes heora
willan brǽcon. · Stod se wraða boda,
legde him lustas on · and mid listum speon,

fylgde him frecne; · wæs se feond full neah
þe on þa frecnan fyrd · gefaren hæfde
ofer langne weg; · leode hogode
on þæt micle morð · men forweorpan,
forlæran and forlædan, · þæt hie læn godes,
ælmihtiges gife · an forleten,
heofenrices ge·weald. · Hwæt, se hellsceaða
gearwe wiste · þæt hie godes yrre
habban sceoldon · and hellgeþwing,
þone nearwan nið · niede onfon,
siððan hie gebod godes · forbrocen hæfdon,
þa he forlærde · mid ligenwordum
to þam unræde · idese sciene,
wifa wlitegost, · þæt heo on his willan spræc,
wæs hire on helpe · handweorc godes
to forlæranne.
Heo spræc ða to Adame · idesa sceonost
ful þiclice, · oð þam þegne ongan
his hige hweorfan, · þæt he þam gehate getruwode
þe him þæt wif · wordum sægde.
Heo dyde hit þeah þurh holdne hyge, · nyste þæt þær hearma swa fela,
fyren-earfeða, · fylgean sceolde
monna cynne · þæs héo on mód ge·nam
þæt héo þæs láþan bodan · lárum hýrde
ac wénde þæt héo hyldo · heofon-cyninges
worhte mid þám wordum · þe héo þám were swelce
tácen ó·þiewde · and treowe ge·hét
oð·þæt Adame · innan breostum
his hyge hwyrfde · and his heorte on·gann
wendan to hire willan. · He æt þam wife onfeng
helle and hinnsið, · þeah hit nære haten swa,
ac hit ofetes noman · agan sceolde;
hit wæs þeah deaðes swefn · and deofles gespon,
hell and hinnsið · and hæleða forlor,
menniscra morð, · þæt hie to mete dædon,
ofet unfæle. · Swa hit him on innan com,
hran æt heortan, · hloh þa and plegode
boda bitre gehugod, · sægde begra þanc

hearran sínum: ·„Nu hæbbe ic þine hyldo me
witode geworhte, · and þinne willan gelæst
to ful monegum dæge. · Men synt forlædde,
Adam and Eue. · Him is unhyldo
waldendes witod, · nu hie wordcwyde his,
lare forleton. · Forþon hie leng ne magon
healdan heofonrice. · Ac hie to helle sculon
on þone sweartan sið. · Swa þu his sorge ne þearft
beran on þínum breostum, · þær þu gebunden ligst,
murnan on mode, · þæt her men bun
þone hean heofon, · þeah wit hearmas nu,
þrea-weorc þoliað, · and þystre land,
and þurh þin micle mod · monig for·léton
on heofon-ríce · heah-ge·timbro,
god-líce geardas. · Unc wearð god yrre
for·þon wit him noldon · on heofon-ríce
hnígan mid heafdum · hálgum drihtne
þurh geongor-dóm; · ac unc ge·genge ne wæs
þæt wit him on þegn-scipe · þeowian wolden.
Forþon unc waldend wearð · wráð on móde,
on hyge hearde, · and ùs on helle be·dráf,
on þæt fýr fylde · folca mæste,
and mid handum his · eft on heofon-ríce
rihte rodor-stólas · and þæt ríce for·geaf
monna cynne. · Mæg þín mód wesan
blíðe on bréostum, · for·þon hér synt bú tú ge·dón:
gé þæt hæleða bearn · heofon-ríces sculon
leode for·lætan · and on þæt líg to þe
háte hweorfan, · eac is hearm gode,
mód-sorg ge·macod. · Swá hwæt swá wit hér morðres þoliað,
hit is nú Adame · eall for·golden
mid hearran hete · and mid hæleða for·lore,
monnum mid morðes cwealme. · For·þon is min mód
ge·hæled,
hyge ymb heortan ge·rúme, · ealle synt uncre hearmas
ge·wrecene
láðes þæt wit lange þoledon. · Nú wille ic eft þam líge néar,
Satan ic þǽr sécan wille; · hé is on þǽre sweartan helle
hæft mid hringa ge·sponne.“ · Hwearf him eft niðer

boda bitresta; · sceolde he þa brádan lígas
sécan helle ge·hliðo, · þær his hearra læg
simon ge·sáled. · Sorgedon ba twa,
Adam and Eue, · and him oft betuh
gnornword gengdon; · godes him ondredon,
heora herran hete, · heofoncyninges nið
swiðe onsæton; · selfe forstodon
his word onwended. · Þæt wif gnornode,
hof hreowigmod, · —hæfde hyldo godes,
lare forlæten—, · þa heo þæt leoht geseah
ellor scriðan · þæt hire þurh untreowa
tacen iewde · se him þone teonan geræd,
þæt hie helle níð · habban sceoldon,
hynða unrim; · forþam him higesorga
burnon on breostum. · Hwilum to gebede feollon
sinhiwan somed, · and sigedrihten
gódne grétton · and god nemdon,
heofones waldend, · and hine bædon
þæt hie his hearmsceare · habban mosten,
georne fulgangan, · þa hie godes hæfdon
bodscipe abrocen. · Bare hie gesawon
heora lichaman; · næfdon on þam lande þa giet
sælða ge·setena, · ne hie sorge wiht
weorces wiston, · ac hie wel meahton
libban on þam lande, · gif hie wolden lare godes
forweard fremman. · þa hie fela spræcon
sorh-worda somed, · sin-hiwan twa.

TODO: Translation

Adam ge·mælde · and tó Euan spræc:
„Hwæt, þú Eue, hæfst · yfele ge·mearcod
uncer sylfra sið. · Ge·sýhst þú nú þá sweartan helle
grædige and gífre. · Nú þú híe grimman meaht
heonane ge·hýran. · Nis heofon-ríce
ge·líc þám líge, · ac þis is landa betst,
þæt wit þurh uncres hearran þanc · habban móston.
þær þú þám ne híerde · þe unc þisne hearm ge·ræd,
þæt wit waldendes · word for·brécon,
heofon-cyninges. · Nú wit hréowige magon

sorgian for þis siðe. · For·þon hé unc self be·béad
þæt wit unc wíte · warian sceolden,
hearma mæstne. · Nu slít mé hunger and þurst
bitre on breostum, · þæs wit bégra ár
wæron or·sorge · on ealle tíd.
Hú sculon wit nú libban · oððe on þis lande wesan,
gif hér wind cymð, · westan oððe éastan,
súðan oððe norðan? · Ge·sweorc up færeð,
cymeð hægles scúr · hefone ge·tenge,
færeð forst on ge·mang, · —sé byð fyrnum ceald.
Hwílum of heofnum · háte scíneð,
blícð þeos beorhte sunne, · and wit hér baru standað,
un·wered wǽdo. · Nys unc wuht be·foran
to scúr-sceade, · ne sceattes wiht
to mete ge·mearcod, · ac unc is mihtig god,
waldend wráð-mód. · Tó hwon sculon wit weorðan nú?
Nú mé mæg hréowan · þæt ic bæd heofnes god,
waldend þone gódan, · þæt hé þé hér worhte tó mé
of liðum mínum, · nú þú mé for·læred hæfst
on mínes herran hete. · Swá mé nú hréowan mæg
ǽfre tó aldre · þæt ic þé mínum éagum ge·seah.“

TODO: Translation

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ALL | The majority of Adam's speech (ll. 791–820) is also preserved in *SaxGen*, the original source from which *GenB* was translated. See above.

804 wæron or·sorge · on ealle tíd | This is the only line with no direct equivalent in *SaxGen*, as *SaxGen* 13b is equivalent to *GenB* 803b–804.

813 to scúr-sceade | *GenB* appears to have a more original reading compared to the corresponding *SaxGen* 22.

**14** Þá spræc Eue eft, · idesa scíenost,
wífa wlitegost; · híe wæs ge·weorc godes,
þeah héo þá on deofles cræft · be·droren wurde:
„Þu meaht hit mé witan, · wine mín Adam,
wordum þínum; · hit þé þéah wyrs ne mæg
on þínu*m* hyge hreowan · þonne hit mé æt heortan déð.“
Hire þá Adam · and·swarode:
„Gif ic waldendes · willan cuðe,
hwæt ic his to hearm-sceare · habban sceolde,
ne ge·sawe þú nó sniomor, · þeah mé on sǽ wadan

hete heofones god · heonone nú þá,
on flód faran, · nǽre hé firnum þæs déop,
mere-stream þæs micel, · þæt his ó mín mód ge·twéode,
ac ic tó þam grunde genge, · gif ic godes meahte
willan ge·wyrcean. · Nis me on worulde níod
ǽniges þegn-scipes, · nu ic mínes þéodnes hafa
hyldo for·worhte, · þæt ic híe habban ne mæg.
Ac wit þus baru ne magon · bú tú æt·somne
wesan tó wuhte. · Uton gán on þysne weald innan,
on þisses holtes hleo.“ · Hwurfon híe bá twá,
to·gengdon gnorngende · on þone grénan weald.
Sǽton on·sundran, · bídan selfes ge·sceapu
heofon-cyninges, · þá hie þá habban ne móston
þe him ǽr for·geaf · æl-mihtig god.
Þá hie heora líc-hǫman · léafum be·þeahton,
weredon mid ðý wealde, · wǽda ne hæfdon;
ac híe on ge·bed feollon · bú tú æt·somne
morgena ge·hwilce, · bǽdon mihtigne
þæt híe ne for·géate · god æl-mihtig,
and him ge·wísade · waldend se góda,
hú híe on þám leohte forð · libban sceolden.

TODO: Translation

# Wessobrunn Hymn

**Dating:** late C8th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The so-called **Wessobrunn Hymn** (*Wessobrunn*) is an Old High German Christian poem of creation, accompanied by a prose prayer.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Wessobrunn* is found on foll. 65v–66r of the Bavarian ms. BSB Clm 22053 (henceforth known as 22053), previously located at the Wessobrunn abbey in Upper Bavaria. 22053 consists of 100 foll. containing a number of Latin texts dealing with varied themes, including theology, chronology, geography, and Latin-German glosses. On the basis of a note on 99v mentioning the death of Charlemagne (748–814), 22053 is dated to ca. 814 AD or some years before. *Wessobrunn* is written in the same uncial hand as the rest of the ms., and is therefore not marginalia. (Bierbrauer 1990, pp. 83–84).

### Contents

*Wessobrunn* is introduced by the Latin heading *De poeta* 'Regarding the poet', which is the proper title of the text. The text itself is divided by the scribe into three sections, each introduced by a capital letter adorned with dots of red ink. The first two sections are poetic ("the poem"), and the third is in prose ("the prayer")

The poem consists of 9 long-lines in alliterative meter, detailing the earliest beginning of the world. The first 5 lines describe "the greatest of wonders", namely that the universe was once void, without earth or heaven, wood or mountain, sun or moon or sea. These lines are very similar to pre-Christian Norse stanzas about the creation of the world, and in fact contain formulaic word-pairs also found in those stanzas (see notes to ll. 2, 3), suggesting a repurposing of older Heathen motifs and expressions in the new, Christian

context. With this in mind, we see that the latter 4 lines constitute a subversion of the earlier Heathen tradition, for they place into this early emptiness the Almighty God, Jesus Christ, and His many ghosts—presumably the Heavenly Host or the Angels. This is the Christian creation *ex nihilo*, rather than the Indo-European creation *ex materia* through sacrifice of a primordial being (cf. *Vafþ* 21, *Grm* 41–42). The prayer is in prose. The author first thanks God for creating the earth and heaven—this is presumably why the poem was included—and for giving boons to mankind. He then asks for faith, strength, and wisdom to help him in his mission.

## Language

TODO: Krogmann (1937).

## Dating

Since *Wessobrunn* is not marginalia the *terminus ante quem* of its composition is 814 AD. However, on the basis of the evidently poor preservation of the poem (ll. 3–4) it is unlikely that the scribe of 22053 is the direct author of *Wessobrunn*; the title *De poeta* 'By the poet' also suggests that the scribe was not, in fact, the poet. With this in mind we are probably dealing with an older composition, allowing us to push the date back to the late 8th century.

## Text

### T1 De poeta

**Regarding the Poet.**

1 poeta 'the Poet' | This word has traditionally been interpreted as 'the Creator', viz. God. TODO.

1 Dat ga·fręgin ih mit firạhim · firi-wizzo męista,
2 dat erdo ni was · noh úf-himil
noh paum · noh perek ni was
4 ni [...] nohh-ęinig · noh sunna ni skęin
noh máno ni liuhta · noh der márjo sêo.

I HAVE LEARNT AMONG MEN that greatest of wonders,
that Earth was not, nor Up-heaven
nor wood, nor was there mountain.
No [...] did [...], nor did the sun shine,
nor did the moon give off light, nor the sparkling sea.

1 Dat | *The* D *is a large capital decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053 1 ga·fręgin | ga- *abbrev. by the rune-like symbol* ꝥ. *This symbol is used for all other occurrences of* ga- *in the present text except for* ga·náda *and* ga·laupa *in P1 below.* 2 erdo | ero 22053 4 skęin | *emend. after Grienberger (1921, p. 237), who notes that the* ft*-ligature here is slightly different than at other places in the text, reflecting original* *fc*; 'ftein' 22053

1 Dat ga·fręgin ih mit firạhim · firi-wizzo męista 'I have learned among men this greatest of wonders' | A formulaic opening to a Germanic poem, expressing that the narrating poet's knowledge of the events described is reportative. For other parallels see note to *Ghv* 1/1, which contains a word-for-word cognate expression. — *ga·fręgin ih* 'I have learned' has often been taken as an (Anglo-)Saxonism on the basis of the vowel *ę* for the expected **a* (cf. poetic OE *ġi·frægn iċ* 'id.', OS *gi·fragn ik*). This would discredit the present OHG attestation of the formula, since it would be a borrowing rather than a native reflex. However, Krogmann (1937, pp. 144–145) irrefutably demonstrates that the vowel quality is in fact the result of a well-attested OHG development where the following *ih* 'I' induces *i*-umlaut in the preceding verb **ga·frag(i)n*; note that *-i-* is a svarabhakti vowel. The formula is therefore native, and the expression is thus found in all four Germanic alliterative poetic traditions: ON, OE, OS, and OHG.

1 firạhim 'men' | Dat. of *fir(a)ha*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for 'men, people' found throughout the Old Germanic languages. See *Hild* 10 n. for etymology and distribution.

2 erdo ... úf-himil 'Earth ... Up-heaven' | A formulaic merism attested in OHG, OS, OE, and ON; it expresses the totality of the universe and is used especially in the context of its creation or destruction; cf. esp. *Vsp* 3/3, where it is said, about the time before the World existed, that "Earth and Up-heaven were never found" and *Vafþ* 21, where the god Weden asks the ettin Webthrithner about the origin of "Earth and Up-heaven". For a list of occurrences see Index: Earth and Up-heaven.

2 erdo | The ms. form *ero* has been interpreted in a variety of ways, usually as a m. *wan*-stem derived from the same root as the more common synonym **erþō* 'earth'. This is however problematic, since the expected form in that case would be **er(a)wo* (EWA, s.v. *ero*). The present emendation is based on the formulaic nature of the merism (see other note), but also has problems, since the regular final vowel of *erda* 'earth' in OHG is *-a*, not *-o* (EWA, s.v. *ero*).

3 paum ... perek 'wood ... mountain' | The same word-pair is found in *Musp* 50, describing the Christian destruction of the world prior to the Judgment. It is also found in ON in *Grm* 41/3, describing the pre-Christian creation of the world from Yimer's body by the Gods. — The line is clearly defective; *noh paum* is not a metrically acceptable a-verse.

4 ni [...] 'No [...] did [...]' | No gap is marked in 22053 but the negative *ni* implies a following verb, so the missing text here should be a verb and a subject noun; if we were only missing a noun we would expect the preceding word *noh* 'nor' instead. The common emendation **sterro* 'star' falls since *st-* never alliterates with *s-* in Germanic poetry, not even in OHG.

6 Dó dár *iu·wiht ni was · ęntjo ni węntjo,
ęnti dó was der ęino · al-mahtíko kot,
8 manno miltisto, · ęnti dar wárun auh manaké mit inan
kót-líhhe gęista, · ęnti kot hęilak.

Then there was no kind of end nor bound,
and then there was the one Almighty God,
the most giving of men; and with Him there were also many
glorious ghosts, and Holy God.

6 Dó | *The* D *is a capital, smaller than the one in line 1, decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053
6 *iu·wiht | 'niuuiht' 22053

6 *iu·wiht | The emendation is done on the basis of meter, but is fully sensible semantically, since *iuwiht* and *niuwiht* are synonymous. With the word beginning on *n-*, the stress of this word would have to fall on *-wiht* in order to supply alliteration with *węntjo* (the second lift) in the b-verse. This scansion would be highly irregular for two reasons: first, stress on *-wiht* is not indicated by Otfrid, who on the other hand consistently accents the first element in *(n)ia·wiht* 'nothing, no kind' (*Evangelienbuch* I.17.24, I.23.25, I.25.27, etc.); second, alliteration falling on the second lift in a b-verse of type A is nigh totally illegal in alliterative poetry.

8 manno miltisto 'the most giving of men' | The expression refers to God in the form of Jesus, who is held to be coeternal with God the Father. Cf. *Heli* 338, et.c.: *allaro barno bętst* 'best of all children', Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* I.22.43: *manno liobosta* 'loveliest of all men'.

**P1** Kot al-mahtíko, dú himil ęnti erda ga·worahtós, ęnti dú mannun
2 só manak kót for·gápi, for·gip mir in dína ga·náda rehta ga·laupa,
ęnti kótan willjon; wís-tóm ęnti spáhida ęnti kraft tiuflun za
4 widar·stantanne, ęnti ark za pi·wísanne, ęnti dínan willjon za
ga·wurkhanne.

O God almighty! Thou wroughtest heaven and earth and Thou gavest men so much good. Give me in Thy grace right belief and good will, wisdom and foresight and power to withstand devils and to reproach queerness and to work Thy will.

1 Kot | Cot 22053*; the* C *is a capital, smaller than the one in line 1, decorated with red dots inside of it* 22053

# Muspell
# *(Muspilli)*

**Dating:** C9th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Muspell** (abbreviated *Musp*) is an Old High German Christian poem which depicts the Day of Judgment.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*Musp* survives in a single copy, found scribbled in a Latin-language theological manuscript from the 820s AD with the signum BSB Clm 14098 (henceforth denoted as 14098). Lines 1–18a are found on fol. 61r while the rest of the poem is found on foll. 119v–121v. Foll. 61r and 120v–121v are blank, and on these the poem occupies the whole page; on foll. 119v–120r the main text is in Latin and the text of the German poem thus occupies the lower third of the page, below the main text.

From 61v–120r the main text of 14098 is a pseudo-Augustinian sermon, which ends on 120r with a dedication by the archbishop of Salzburg Ethelram (Latin *Adalrammus*) to the young duke Ludwigh (Latin *Hludowicus*, later Louis the German). It is important to note that the poem and main text are written in different hands. The hand of the poem is unsteady and not finely wrought, which may suggest that its author was not very used to writing; he may perhaps even have been Ludwigh himself. From the start on fol. 61r we can presume that the writer of the poem originally meant to write down just a part of it as marginalia, beginning on the back leaf (61r) of the already written sermon, and continuing on its last two leaves (119v–120r). When he ran out of space, he acquired another blank leaf, 121r–v. The abrupt ending of the poem may suggest that further blank leaves were also originally present.

Due to the low quality of the digitally available scans of the already very poorly preserved manuscript, the pres. ed. has had to rely partly on the text

found in the 17th edition of Braune's *Althochdeutsche Lesebuch* published in 1994.

## Content

*Musp* is a Catholic sermon that describes the events of the Judgment Day and advises its readers to do penance and give alms to assure their safety. The poem is not a masterpiece, and in the original at times comes off as stilted. Still, it has a certain charm, and it seems to be much better preserved than the two other comparable High German alliterative poems, *Hild* and *Wessobrunn*.

### Relation to Otfrid

The use of end-rhymed Otfridian meter in ll. 60–61 suggests a relation between *Musp* and Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* (written 863–871 AD), something which is strongly supported by the exact correspondence between *Musp* 14 and *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9. Since there appears to be a relation between these two texts, we ought to try to determine the direction of influence. I believe that we may reasonably conclude on the basis of literary history and the internal metrical variation of the *Evangelienbuch* that the direction of influence is more likely to be from *Musp* to the *Evangelienbuch* rather than the reverse, and will lay out my argument as follows.

With the exception of a very small number of irregular, often alliterating lines found exclusively in the first book (e.g. 1.4.9, 1.5.5, 1.7.19, 1.7.27–28, 1.18.9; cf. 1.5.6, 1.5.10–12, 3.1.31–32 which combine alliteration with end-rhyme), the *Evangelienbuch* is fully end-rhymed. With the exception of 1.18.9 these lines are all found in the first fourth of the first book, which runs to 28 chapters. This distribution suggests that Otfrid was still finding his footing, as it were, and either borrowed older lines or experimented with compensating for a lack of rhyme with alliteration before deciding against it.

Of these lines, the only one that fully accords with Sieversian metrics is 1.18.9. This unusual regularity, along with its late relative position, points to the borrowing of 1.18.9 from another source. Even in his irregular non-rhyming lines, Otfrid does not follow the Sieversian rule of four positions, nor always the linking of alliteration between couplets; what is more, by the 18th chapter of book 1, he was comfortable enough with the end-rhymed meter not to need to insert an alliterative line of his own.

From the viewpoint of literary history, it would be highly unusual for a poet active in a clerical context after the success of the *Evangelienbuch* to still employ alliteration, especially when he was clearly familiar with the end-rhymed form as proven by ll. 60–61. The natural choice for such a writer would be to use end-rhyme throughout. Indeed, the *Evangelienbuch*, along with related works like the *Georgslied* and *Ludwigslied*, seems to have definitively put an end to the alliterative tradition as a whole in Germany, since no German alliterative poetry younger than the 9th century survives.

Morever, while *Musp* 14 is a perfectly regular alliterative long-line, entirely unremarkable within the metrical context of *Musp*, its direct equivalent *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9 is, from the perspective of Otfridian meter, deficient. This again gives support to *Musp* being the giver, for it makes little sense for an alliterative poet working after Otfrid to borrow just that particular deficient line for his own work, whereas it makes much more sense for the end-rhyming poet Otfrid to borrow an older line from an alliterative work.

Another more archaic trait found in *Musp* is its use of originally pre-Christian expressions like the alliterative pair *poum, perga* (l. 50), *Mittila-gart* (l. 53), and *Mú·spell* (l. 56), none of which are found in Otfrid. It must, however, be said that these expressions, on their own, do not prove that *Musp* is the older poem. The archaic expressions could be argued simply to be a part of *Musp*'s more rustic style, use of alliteration, and less theologically informed content. Indeed, it is certainly plausible that a later poet more strongly anchored in vernacular tradition would retain archaic traits discarded by an earlier poet working in an Ecclesiastical milieu. However, when weighed together with the circumstances discussed above, these expressions do yield further support for *Musp* preceding Otfrid.

If *Musp* indeed is the older poem, there arises the question of how Otfrid would have come into contact with it. Yet, of the problems associated with the relation between the two texts, this one is perhaps the most easily answered, owing to a surprising historical circumstance. As shown by Haubrichs (1978, p. 406), several decades before Otfrid dedicated his *Evangelienbuch* to Ludwig the German in ca. 870 AD, he had spent a number of years as a scribe at Ludwigh's court—the very same court where 14098 containing *Musp* must have been located after its dedication (see Textual preservation above).

We may then imagine the following scenario: In poring over the pseudo-Augustinian sermon contained in 14098, a young Otfrid would have discovered *Musp* written in the margins and, taken by its contents, put the poem to memory. When, as an old man, he set out to write his *Evangelienbuch* and arrived at the description of Paradise, he remembered, if not the whole *Muspilli*, at least this one evocative line—"There life is without death, light without darkness"—and included it.

## Language

The dialect of the poem is that of the southern High German area, most likely Bavaria, where Regensburg was the seat of Emperor Ludwigh's government. This is seen by the consistent application of the most extensive form of the second sound shift, where *g, b, k* change to *k, p, kh*. That this sound change had occurred at the time of composition and is not merely a scribal feature is proven by the fact that Germanic roots originally beginning with *b* consistently alliterate with Latin borrowings beginning with *p*, namely in:

- l. 5: *pehhe* (< Latin *pix*) : *págant* (= ON *bága*),

- l. 16: *pú* (= OS *bú*) : *pardísu* (< Latin *paradīsum*),
- l. 21: *piutit* (= OS *biudid*) : *pehhes*, *pína* (< Latin *poena*),
- l. 25: *prinnan* (= OS *brinnan*), *palw-* (= OS *baluw-*) : *pehhe*.

Interestingly, the alliteration also shows that the poet sporadically retained old *h-* before *l* (l. 72, but cf. 82), by extension almost certainly also before *r* and *n*, and probably also before *w* (l. 7). This sound is, however, consistently omitted by the scribe.

### Story and motifs

One of the most notable aspect of the contents of *Musp* is the abundance of apocryphal motifs. Their origin is unclear, but they appear to stem from the Christianity of late antiquity and may have made their way into the compositional milieu of *Musp* in several ways.

TODO: Three motifs. Heavenly toll houses (ll. 2–5). Elijah's blood (l. 49). The speaking limbs at the Judgment (l. 91).

## Dating

Since the poem is marginalia (see Textual preservation), the dating of the manuscript can unfortunately only serve as a *terminus post quem* for the poem itself, viz. the 820s AD. The likely direction of influence on the *Evangelienbuch*, composed ca. 863–871 AD (see Contents) serves as a *terminus ante quem*. The poem was, therefore, most likely composed in Bavaria, sometime between 820 and 870 AD, though probably in the earlier part of that span.

## Summary

The poem begins with a description of the fate of the soul immediately after death (ll. 1–29). This is followed by a short sermon about the importance of doing good works before the Judgment (30–35). After this follows the description of the destruction of the world and Judgment Day. First comes the fight between Elijah and the Anti-Christ (36–49), then the burning of the world and the Muspell (50–61). The narrative is broken up by a second sermon warning against corruption by describing how the Devil keeps track of evil deeds to recount them at the Judgment (62–71). Next the Judgment itself begins: An angel blows a horn, and God and his angels are on the move (72–80); then the dead come back to life to be judged (81–84). They gather in a court before God and the angels (85–89). The poet stresses that all must become known at the Judgment, and even a man's own limbs will bear witness against him (90–96); the only way to avoid punishment is through good deeds on earth (97–100). After this, the Holy Cross is brought forth, and the poem abruptly ends (101–104).

## Text

Sín tak pi·kweme, · daz er touwan skal.
*H*wanta sár só sih diu sêla · in den sind ar·hęvit,
ęnti sí den líh-hamun · likkan lázzit,
só kwimit ęin hęri · fona himil-zungalon;
daz andar fona pehhe: · dár págant siu umpi.

His day will come when he must die.
For as soon as the soul lifts itself on its way
and leaves the body behind to lie,
then comes an army from the heavenly stars,
the other from the Pitch; there they fight over it.

1 Sín tak pi·kweme, · daz er touwan skal 'His day will come when he must die.' | It is traditionally assumed that the beginning of the poem is incomplete, there originally being other lines before this one, but there is nothing in 14098 to suggest this. I find the opening line, with its generic *sín, er* 'his, he', rather powerful.

3 likkan lázzit | The double alliteration in the b-verse is unusual, but probably not due to any scribal corruption. Since the second word does not partake in regular alliteration, it has not been marked.

5 pehhe 'the Pitch' | The burning hellfire.

Sorgén mak diu sêla, · unzi diu suona ar·gét,
za *b*wederemo hęrje · si gi·halót werde.
*H*wanta ipu sia daz Satanazses · ki·sindi ki·winnit,
daz lęitit sia sár · dár iru lęid wirdit,
in fuir ęnti in finstrí: · daz ist rehto virin-lih ding.

The soul must worry until the [time of] atonement begins
about which of the armies will receive it,
for if Satan's following wins it,
then it is soon led whither it must face torment,
into fire and darkness. That is surely a wicked thing.

7 *b*wederemo | 'wederemo' 14098

7 *b*wederemo | Restoration of the initial *b*- is not strictly required for the line to alliterate properly, but it is done on the basis of l. 72.

Upi sia *avar ki·halónt die · die dár fona himile kwemant,
ęnti sí dero ęngilo · ęigan wirdit,
die pringent sia sár úf · in himilo ríhi:
dár ist líp áno tôd, · li*oh*t áno finstrí,

sęlida áno sorgu*n*: · *dár n·ist* neo-man siuh.
Denne der man in par*dí*su · pú ki·winnit,
hús in himile, · dár kwimit imo hilfa ki·nuok.

If, however, it is received by those who come from heaven
and the angels are to have it for themselves,
they soon bring it up into the realm of the heavens.
There life is without death, light without darkness,
happiness without sorrow; there no man is sick.
When the man wins his dwelling in Paradise,
his house in heaven, he will get help aplenty.

11 *avar | 'hauar' 14098 14 li*oh*t | 'lihot' 14098 14 finstr*i* | 'finsti' 14098 15 sorgu*n* | *partly illegible in* 14098 15 *dár n·ist* | *emend.; illegible in* 14098 16 par*dí*su | *partly illegible in* 14098

13 die pringent sia sár úf · in himilo ríhi: | The line lacks alliteration, but no obvious emendation presents itself. On the basis of the occasional spelling of vowel-words with *h-*, suggesting confusion over that sound, it is possible that the alliteration should fall on *úf* and *'imilo*, but that is highly speculative.

14 dár ist líp áno tôd, · li*oh*t áno finstr*i* 'There life is without death, light without darkness' | This line also appears in Otfrid's *Evangelienbuch* 1.18.9, where it begins a description of Paradise, in the form: *Thár ist líb ána tôd, · lioht ána finstri.* It is one of Otfrid's rhymeless lines where alliteration compensates for the expected end-rhyme. For the relevance of this shared line to the relation between *Musp* and *Evangelienbuch*, see Introduction above.

Pi·diu ist durft mihhil allero manno *h*we-líhemo, · daz in es sín muot ki·spane,
daz er kotes willun · kerno tu*e*
ęnti hęlla fuir · harto wíse,
pehhes pína: · dár piutit der Satanasz altist
hęizzan lauk. · Só mak hukkan za diu,
sorgén dráto, · der sih suntigen węiz.

Therefore it is most needful for every man that he persuade his heart
that it might gladly do the will of God
and stalwartly avoid the fire of Hell,
the torture of the Pitch; there the oldest Satan offers
hot flame. So he must think about that,
worry greatly, whoever knows that he sins.

18 *h*we-líhemo | *end 61r, the text continues on 119v.* 19 tu*e* | *metr. and gramm. emend.;* tuo 14098

21 der Satanasz altist 'the oldest Satan' | Not a reference to any specific 'Satan' but rather denoting Satan as the primeval, ancient enemy of God.

Wê demo in vinstrí skal · síno viriná stúén,
prinnan in p*e*hhe: · daz ist rehto palwík dink,

daz der man harét ze gote · ęnti imo hilfa ni kwimit.
Wánit sih ki·náda · diu wênaga sêla:
ni ist in ki·huktin · himiliskin gote,
*h*wanta hiar in wer-olti · after ni werkóta.

Woe to him who in the darkness shall atone for his wickedness,
burn in the Pitch; that is surely a baleful thing,
that the man calls out to God and no help for him comes.
She expects mercy, that wretched soul;
she is not in the thoughts of the heavenly God,
for here in this world she left no works behind.

25 p*e*hhe | 'phhe' 14098

Só denne der mahtigo khunink · daz mahal ki·pannit,
dara skal kweman · khunno ki·líhaz:
denne ni ki·tar parno nohhęin · den pan furi·sizzan,
ni allero manno *h*we-lih; · ze demo mahale skuli.
Dár skal er vora demo ríhhe · az rahhu stantan,
pí daz er in wer-olti eo · ki·werkót hapéta.

So, when the mighty King summons the court
whither every race shall come,
then none of the children dare sit out the summons,
nor any man whatsoever—he must go to the court.
There before that power shall he stand on trial
for the works he has done earlier in the world.

32 parno 'the children' | The children of men, i.e., human beings.

Daz hôrt' ih rahhón · dia wer-olt-reht-wíson,
daz skuli der Anti-Khristo · mit Elíase págan.
Der warkh ist ki·wáfanit, · denne wirdit untar in wík ar·hapan.
Khęnfun sint só kręftík; · diu kôsa ist só mihhil.
Elías strítit · pí den êwigon líp,
wili dén reht-kernón · daz ríhhi ki·starkan:
pi·diu skal imo helfan · der himiles ki·waltit.

This I heard the righteous of the world narrate:
that the Anti-Christ shall fight with Elijah—
the warg is armed—then the battle will commence between them.
The champions are so strong; the struggle is so great;
Elijah fights for the eternal life,

wishes to strengthen the power of the righteous;
therefore he will have help from Him Who rules heaven.

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36 Daz hôrt' ih rahhón 'This I heard ... narrate' | The cognates of *rahhón* 'narrate', OE *reċċan* and OS *rękkjan*, are also used for the retelling of ancient events in *Beow* 91 and *Heli* 3. The whole line closely resembles *Hild* 1, *Ghv* 1/1, and *Wessobrunn* 1/1.

36 dia wer-olt-reht-wison | This line is highly unusual, since the alliterating stave falls on the second element of the nominal compound.

Der Anti-Khristo · stét pí demo alt-fíante,
44 stét pí demo Satanase, · der inan var·sęnkan skal:
pi·diu skal er in deru wík-stęti · wunt pi·vallan
46 ęnti in demo sinde · siga-lôs werdan.

The Anti-Christ stands beside the Fiend of Old,
stands beside Satan who shall cause him to fall.
Therefore shall he on that battlefield fall wounded
and in the incursion be victory-less.

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43 alt-fíante 'Fiend of Old' | Or 'the Ancient Enemy', i.e., Satan.

Doh wánit des vila got-manno,
48 daz Elías in demo wíge · ar·wartit werde,
só daz Elíases pluot · in erda ki·triufit.

Yet many godly men expect
that Elijah in that battle will be maimed,
so that Elijah's blood pours into the earth.

50 Só in·prinnant die perga, · poum ni ki·stęntit
ênihk in erdu, · ahá ar·truknént,
52 muor var·swilhit sih, · swilizót lougiu der himil,
máno vallit, · prinnit mittila-gart,
54 stên ni ki·stęntit*, · vęrit denne stúa-tago in lant,
vęrit mit diu vuiru · viriho wísón.

So the mountains burn down; no tree stands
anywhere upon the earth; the rivers turn dry;
the swamp is swallowed up; the heaven glows with flame;
the moon falls; Middenyard burns;
no stone stands. Then the Judgment Day comes upon the land,
comes with the fire to visit the folk.

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54 stên ni ki·stęntit* | *add.* ênikh in erdu 14098 *(dittography through homoioarcton from ll. 50b–51a)*

50 perga ... poum 'mountains ... tree' | Formulaic word-pair; see note to *Wessobrunn* 3.

55 viriho 'folk' | Gen. of *fir(a)ha*, a *plurale tantum* poetic synonym for 'men, people' found throughout the Old Germanic languages. See *Hild* 10 n. for etymology and distribution.

Dár ni mak denae mák andremo · helfan vora demo Mú·spille,
denne daz pręita wasal · allaz var·prinnit,
ęnti vuir ęnti luft · iz allaz ar·furpit.
*H*wár ist denne diu marha, · dár man dár eo mit sínén mágon piehk?
Diu marha ist far·prunnan, · diu sêla stét pi·d*w*ungan,
ni węiz mit *h*wiu puaze: · só vęrit sí za wíze.

There no kinsman may help another one before the Muspell
when all the broad damp earth burns up
and fire and air do cleanse it all.
Where is then the ground where man once with his kinsmen fought?
The ground is burnt up; the soul is defeated,
knows no remedy; so it goes to punishment.

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56 Mú·spille 'the Muspell' | The word which has given the poem its modern name, probably 'the Destruction of the Earth'. *Mú·spille* is a hapax in OHG, but corresponds to OS *Múd·spelli* ~ *Mút·spelli* (*Heli* 2591, 4358) and ON *Mú·spell* (see *Vsp* 49/1 n.). Its exact sense and origin are hard to pin down.

In all cases the word seems to refer to at least an element of the eschatological destruction of the world, whether Heathen (as in the Norse *Vsp* and *Gylf*) or Christian (as in the High German *Musp* and the Old Saxon *Heli*). In *Musp* the word refers to the culmination of the destruction of the world by fire. In *Heli* 2591–92, *Múd·spelles męgin* 'Muspell's might' is said to pass over mankind together with the *ęndi þesaro wer-oldes* 'end of this world', and in *Heli* 4358–4361, Muspell is said to come like a thief in the night, along with the Last Day. In *Vsp* 49, *Mú·spells lýðir* 'Muspell's people' are said to come from the south on a great ship during the Rakes of the Reins, while in *Gylf* 4:5–7, Muspell or Muspellsham is said to be a burning realm in the south ruled over by the fire-ettin Surt.

Etymologically the word is clearly a cpd., segmented between *mú(d)* and *spilli*; it is a *ja*-stem in OS and OHG and an *a*-stem in ON; its gender is m. in ON and m. or neuter in OS and OHG (EWA, s.v. *můspili*). The first element, the root length of which is uncertain, has been explained as reflecting either PGmc. **mūhó* 'heap (of earth)' or, on the basis of the OS dental, PGmc. **munþaz* 'mouth' (EWA). On the basis of sound-laws the latter is unlikely since the Ingvaeonic nasal spirant law (/Vnθ/ > /Ṽ:θ/) does not affect OHG or ON, which for 'mouth' have *mund* and *munnr*, respectively. Still, the OS dental poses a formal difficulty and opens up the possibility of borrowing, although the direction is unclear. It is notable that both ON and OHG, at the geographical extremes, agree about the lack of a dental. The second element is prob. an agent noun derived either from the verb **spilþijaną* 'to spoil, ruin; kill, murder' (OE *spillan, spildan*, OS *spildjan*, ON *spilla*) or from **spellōną* 'to tell, talk' (EWA). Due to the lack of breaking in ON the former is probably more likely.

To conclude, due to the possibility of borrowing between languages, the lack of any glosses, and the formal difficulties, any derivation of this word must be considered uncertain. Still, the undoubtedly Germanic linguistic origin of the compound does make a pagan origin more likely. Further, if the word really is thoroughly Christian, one has to ask why the WGmc. form does not appear outside of alliterative poetry—not in prose, nor in rhyming poetry like Otfrid—and why the NGmc. form should signify a mythological, fiery realm.

59 *H*wár ist denne diu marha, · dár man dár eo mit sínén mágon piehk? 'Where is then the ground where man once with his kinsmen fought?' | An example of the *ubi sunt* motif, common in mediaeval literature from both Europe and the Arab world. This literary motif, originally drawing on the Biblical Book of Baruch (3:16–19), and in Old Germanic poetry most famously found in *The Wanderer* (ll. 92–96), illustrates the vanity of life by listing various things and people, before asking 'where are they?' The German poet here extends the motif to the Day of Judgment and takes the opportunity to comment on his own time by condemning the internecine feuds that plagued all mediaeval monarchies.

60–61 Diu ... wíze | In these two lines the poet replaces the usual alliteration with end-rhyme between each half-line (60: *prunnan* : *dwungan*, 61: *puaze* : *wíze*). The very same meter, including the looseness of the rhymes, is used by Otfrid throughout the whole of his *Evangelienbuch*, written sometime between 863 and 871 AD. The direction of influence between *Musp* and that work is uncertain owing to the difficulties of dating the present poem, though *Musp* is most likely the older work. See l. 14 and Introduction above.

Pi·diu ist demo manne só guot, · denne 'r ze demo mahale kwimit,
daz er rahóno *h*we-líha · rehto ar·tęile;
denne ni darf er sorgén, · denne er ze deru suonu kwimit.
Ni węiz der wênago man, · *h*wie-líhan wartil er habét,
denne 'r mit den miatón · marrit daz rehta,
daz der tiuval dár pí · ki·tarnit stęntit.

Therefore it is so good for the man when he comes to the court
that he rightly consider every charge;
then he need not worry when he comes to the atonement.
The wretched man knows not what sort of overseer he has
when with bribes he obstructs what is right:
that the Devil stands hidden by his side.

Der hapét in ruovu · rahóno *h*we-líha,
daz der man êr ęnti síd · upiles ki·frumita,
daz er iz allaz ki·sagét, · denne er ze deru suonu kwimit;
ni skolta síd manno nohhęin · miatun int·fáhan.

In silence, *he* keeps every evil charge
which the man, early or late, has committed,
so that he tells it all when he comes to the atonement;
for that reason should no man take bribes.

68 Der '*He*' | The Devil, as just mentioned.

Só daz himiliska horn · ki·*h*lútit wirdit,
ęnti sih der suanari · ana den sind ar·hęvit
der dár suannan skal · tôten ęnti lepentén;
denne hęvit sih mit imo · hęrjo męista,

daz ist allaz só pald, · daz imo nio-man ki·págan ni mak.
Denne vęrit er ze deru mahal-stęti, · deru dár ki·markhót ist:
dár wirdit diu suona, · dia man dár io sagéta.

So the heavenly horn is sounded,
and the Judge lifts Himself on His way,
He who shall judge the dead and the living.
Then rises with Him the greatest of armies;
it is all so bold that no man may fight it.
Then He journeys to the place of the court which is there marked out;
there begins the atonement as was once foretold.

72 ki·*bl*útit 'sounded' | *metr. emend.;* ki·lútit 14098

72 Só daz himiliska horn · ki·*bl*útit wirdit 'So the heavenly horn is sounded' | In Revelation 8–11, seven trumpets are sounded. With the sounding of the seventh trumpet, the kingdom of God is announced (Revelation 11:15). Cf. *Vsp* 45, where the god Homedall sounds the famous Yellhorn and this precedes the destruction.

72 ki·*bl*útit 'sounded' | Restoration of the cluster *hl-* is required by the alliteration; cf. l. 7.

Denne varant ęngila · uper dio marha,
wękhant deota, · wíssant ze dinge.
Denne skal manno gi·líh · fona deru moltu ar·stén,
lôssan sih ar dero lêwo vazzón: · skal imo avar sín líp pi·kweman,
daz er sín reht allaz · ki·rahhón muozzi,
ęnti imo after sínén tátin · ar·tęilit werde.

Then the angels journey over the ground;
they wake the nations, show them to the Thing.
Then shall every man arise out of the earth,
free himself from the burdens of the grave; further he shall come to life
that he may fully plead his case
and according to his deeds be considered.

82 dero lêwo vazzón 'the burdens of the grave' | Lit. 'the burdens of the graves'. — *lêwo* (gen. pl. of *(h)lêo* 'grave') is the same word as OE *hlǽw* 'mound', PN *hlaiwa* 'grave' (N KJ77, 78), and Gothic *hlaiw* (translating Greek τάφος 'tomb' and μνημεῖον 'memorial'). The sound change *hl-* > *l-* is strongly suggested by the meter. The verse is a hypermetric type A1A1 scanning **P**x#xxxx#**P**x#Px, and such verses, at least in *Heli*, without exception require double alliteration (Suzuki 2004, pp. 295–96). Although the meter of *Musp* and *Heli* is not identical, the rule is so strong there that it most likely applies in *Musp* too. This marks an inconsistent handling of the old sound *hl-* in *Musp*; cf. l. 72 above.

82 skal imo … sín líp pi·kweman 'he shall come to life' | Lit. 'his life shall come to him.'

Denne der gi·sizzit, · der dár suonnan skal
ęnti ar·tęillan skal · tôtén ęnti kwekkhén,

denne stét dár umpi · ęngilo męnigí,
guotero gomóno: · gart ist só mihhil:
dara kwimit ze deru rihtungu só vilo · dia dár ar ręstí ar·sténT.

Then sits he who there shall judge
and shall consider the dead and the living.
Then there around him stands a throng of angels,
[and] of good men. The enclosure is so great;
there to that tribunal come so many who have arisen from their rest.

Só dár manno nohhęin · wiht pi·mídan ni mak;
dár skal denne hant sprehhan, · houpit sagén,
allero lido *h*we-lihk · unzi in den luzígun vinger,
*h*waz er untar desen mannun · mordes ki·frumita.

So there may no man elude the smallest thing;
there the hand shall speak, the head shall tell,
[and] every single limb whatsoever down to the little finger,
what sort of murder it committed in the midst of these men.

91 dár skal denne hant sprehhan, · houpit sagén 'there the hand shall speak, the head shall tell | The idea that a man's own limbs shall bear witness against him is well known from the Islamic Day of Judgment (*Qur'ān* 36:65, 41:20–21, 24:24), but is not found in the New Testament. It is likely an apocryphal motif that influenced Muḥammad and has made its way into this 9th c. text.

Dár ni ist eo só listík man · der dár io·wiht ar·liugan męgi,
daz er ki·tarnan męgi · táto dehhęina,
niz al fora demo khuninge · ki·khundit werde,
úzzan er iz · mit ala-mu*o*sanu furi·męgi
ęnti mit fastún · dio viriná ki·puazti.
Denne der paldét · der gi·puazzit hapét,
denne 'r ze deru suonu kwimit.

There no man is ever so sly that he may lie about the smallest thing,
that he may hide away any deed
so that it may not all be made known to the King,
unless he overcame it through the giving of alms
and through fasting did penance for the wickedness.
Then is he emboldened who has done penance,
when he comes to the atonement.

97 ala-mu*o*sanu | alamusanu 14098

Wirdit denne furi ki·tragan · daz frôno khrúki,
dár der hêligo Khrist · ana ar·hangan ward.

Denne augit er dio másún, · dio er in deru męnniskí an·fénk,
104 dio er duruh desse man-kunnes · minna far·doléta.

Then is brought forth the Lordly Cross,
whereon the Holy Christ was made to hang.
Then He reveals the wounds which He as a man received
which for the love of this man-kind He suffered.

# Cadman's Hymn

**Dating:** C7th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

**Cadman's Hymn** is a short Old English poem found in numerous recensions of Bede's English history, attributed to the illiterate shepherd Cadman (OE *Cædmon*). It employs several traditional Germanic poetic formulae and clearly draws on earlier, now-lost pagan compositions.

The hymn has two rhetorical parts. Lines 1–4 serve as an introductory prayer and declaration of purpose, while ll. 5–9 describe the creation, first of the Heaven (5–6) and then of Middenyard and the Earth (7–9).

Based on Kaluza's law in the younger *Beow* the pres. ed. marks etymologically long unstressed vowels.

## Text

### Cadman's Hymn

Nú scylun hęrgan · heƀæn-rícæs ward,
metudæs mæhti · end his mód-gi·þanc,
werc wuldur-fadur, · swé hé wundrá gi·hwæs,
écí dryhtin · ór à·stęlidǽ.
Hé ǽrist scóp · ældá barnum
heƀæn til hrófǽ, · hâlig sceppend.
Þá middun-geard · mǫn-cynnæs ward,
écí dryhtin · æfter tíadǽ,
firƕum foldú · fréá al-mæhtig.

Now shall we praise the heavenly realm's Guardian,
the Measurer's might and His thinking mind,
the works of the Glory-Father, as He every wonder,
the everlasting Lord, in the beginning set up.
He first created for the children of men
the heaven as a roof, the holy Creator.
Then Middenyard did Mankind's Guardian,
the everlasting Lord afterwards make:
the land for humans, the Lord Almighty.

# Galders (INCOMPLETE!)

# Introduction to Galders

The Germanic word "galder" (PGmc. **galdrą*) is a verbal noun derived from the old verb "gale" (PGmc. **galaną*), meaning 'to sing, to chant'. A "galder" is therefore what is chanted or sung, more specifically a magical chant, whether for the purpose of healing or cursing.

In the present section the reader will find gathered a number of such galders attested across the Old Germanic languages. Not all of these texts may be true galders, but they share a magical purpose and many formulae and stylistic features reoccur throughout.

Note that this section will only include written charms containing likely or certain pre-Christian tradition elements, e.g. the invocation of the Heathen Gods or the use of old poetic formulae. Syncretic texts which mix traditional and Christian elements (e.g. SJy 41, most of the OE galders) are also included. Thoroughly Christian prayers, however, even if metrical, are excluded from this section and may instead be found under "Poetry on Christian Subjects".

# Continental Germanic Galders

# The Merseburg Galders

**Dating:** C9th–10th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay, Galders-lay

## Introduction

The two **Merseburg galders** are some of the only surviving examples of genuine Heathen galders from continental West Germanic Europe, and the only ones actually to invoke the pre-Christian Germanic gods.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The galders are preserved on fol. 85r of the theological manuscript Merseburger Domstiftsbibliothek Codex 136 (in the present critical edition given the signum 136) where they are written in a neat and well-trained hand. Immediately below them follows a thoroughly Christian prayer written in the same hand (Murdoch 1988, p. 360), edited below as an Appendix to the galders. The theological contents of the manuscript, the trained hand and the Latin prayer together suggest that the scribe was most likely a monk.

### Summary

Both galders share a common two-part structure, each beginning with an *historiola*, a mythological account describing the successful effects of the galder in the distant mythic past, followed by an imperative *incantatio* or the galder-proper, commanding that the willed magic effect take place in the present.

The first galder (*Mers I*) begins with the historiola describing a group of supernatural women in the midst of a battle, affecting its outcome by fastening or loosening fetters. The incantatio then commands that the present fetters be destroyed so that captives may escape the enemy.

The second galder (*Mers II*) begins with the historiola describing a group of Gods riding through the woods. Among them is Balder, whose young foal sprains its foot. Three Gods—the otherwise unknown goddess Sithguth, the goddess Sun, the god Weden—in turn chant a healing galder over it. The

incantatio—apparently the galder sung by Weden—then commands that a present sprain be healed.

## Cultural context

I generally agree with Murdoch (1988) when he convincingly argues that the galders ought to be seen as incantations written down to be sung alongside the application of salves or other instruments in the context of Christian(ized) mediaeval medicine. This is important for the context of *Mers I*, since the preservation of a galder for actually removing shackles is quite unlikely. For one its effectivity must have been quite limited, and it is very unlikely that it would have been of any use in the monastic medicinal context. Considering that likely context a more reasonable use case is for a cramp, which would then be symbolically likened within the sphere of the galder to the fetters on the battlefield.

As mentioned above, the two galders are followed by a Latin liturgical formula written in the same hand. As Murdoch (1988, pp. 362–363) shows, the same formula is also found in a cure against possession in the Anglo-Saxon Bald's Leechbook, and this firmly anchors the galders within the Christian medicinal framework. Indeed, when one compares the Merseburg galders with OE galders like *Nwyrt* and Norse galders like the Ribe galder-stick (SJy 41) it becomes clear that the mixing of pagan and Christian elements in this type of text was not unusual. Monk or not, the traditional invocation of Weden must have been felt to have a particularly strong healing effect, and it was only later that he was entirely excised and demonised.

Of course this does not mean that the galders themselves are fully Christian, like Murdoch (1988) suggests. The gods they invoke are Germanic and pre-Christian, as is their alliterative poetic form and their contents (especially *Mers II*). As Murdoch (1988, pp. 360–361) himself brings up, contemporary mediaeval Christian authors condemn pagan charms; and how could a galder invoking Weden himself not be considered pagan when the god is even mentioned by name in the contemporary Old Saxon Baptismal Vow (edited under Christian Poetry)? In any case, Murdoch rightly makes an important distinction: regardless of whether the galders themselves are pagan or not, they are preserved in a Christian manuscript and in that context their healing magic appears to function alongside a Latin prayer.

## Parallels

Moving away from the immediate cultural context we ought to look at parallels for both galders. These will help us anchor them in a broader European tradition of magical song or galder.

Close verbal parallels to *Mers I* are found in the Norse *Háv* 150 and *Grg* 10, but those are literary monuments. As discussed above it is questionable whether it was ever actually meant to be used by shackled captives, and to my knowledge no actual galders to that effect survive.

*Mers II* has an impressive number of later parallels across Celtic and Germanic-speaking Northern Europe (for an overview see Hopkins 2025). These charms generally mirror both the historiola and the incantatio of *Mers II*, but almost always replace the healer with Jesus Christ. They are generally used to heal sprains or broken bones. Many are found as incantations to be recited together with the sign of the cross. Further afield the incantatio has a notable parallel in the Vedic material, for which see ll. 6–9 n.

## Text

**1** Ęi*n*is sázun idisi · sázun hera duo dér; [136 85r/1–4]
suma hapt hęptidun · suma hęri lęzidun
suma klubodun · umbi kuonjo widi
in·sprink hapt-bandun · in·var vígandun
.H.

Once dises sat—sat here, then there.
Some fastened fetters, some hindered armies,
some cut asunder strong withies.
Destroy the fetter-bonds, lead the way from the foes!
.H.

1 Ęi*n*is ‘Once’ | eiris 136

1 Ęi*n*is ‘Once’ | This word places the historiola in a mythic or legendary past. — The ms. form *eiris* must be a spelling error. It cannot be equated with *êrist* ‘earliest’ or *êr* ‘early, of yore’, because **ęi* > *ê* before *r* is an early sound change in continental West Germanic and cannot be disregarded.

3 kuonjo widi ‘strong withies’ | This difficult phrase (in 136 written *‘cuonio uuidi’*) is traditionally identified with the word *kuna-wid* ‘chain, fetter’ found in a few OHG glosses, which is further cognate with Gothic *kuna-wida* ‘fetter; ἄλῦσῐς (Streitberg 1910, p. 76)’. This interpretation, however, faces formal difficulties due to the quality of the vowel *uo* and the infix *-jo-*, neither of which match *kuna-*. I instead follow a newer interpretation and take *kuonjo* as the f. acc. pl. of the adjective *kuoni* ‘strong; keen, brave’. Cf. EWA (s.v. *kunawid*).

5 .H. | The meaning of this letter, which is very clearly visible and written in the same hand as the galders, is uncertain. To me the most convincing suggestion is that it is to be read as *.N.*, a common abbreviation for Latin *nomen* ‘name’ (cf. the Appendix below), and here presumably the name of the patient for whom the healer is chanting (Murdoch 1988, p. 363).

**2** Fol ęnde Wuodan · vuorun zi holza [136 85r/5–12]
dú wart demo Balderes volon · sín vuoz bi·rękit
þú bi·guol en Sinhtgunt · Sunna era swister
þú bi·guol en Frija · Volla era swister
þú bi·guol en Wuodan · só hé wola konda:
„Só-se bên-rękí · só-se bluot-rękí · só-se lidi-rękí
bên zi bêna
bluot zi bluoda

lid zi ge·liden · só-se ge·límida sín!“

Fol and Weden journeyed through the woods;
then was the foot of Balder’s foal sprained.
Then Sithguth galed over it—Sun her sister;
then Frie galed over it—Full her sister;
then Weden galed over it as he could well do:
“Like bone-sprain, like blood-sprain, like joint-sprain!
Bone to bone,
blood to blood,
joint to joints, like were they glued together!”

1 Fol ‘Fol’ | ‘phol’ 136 1 Wuodan ‘Weden’ | ‘uuodan’ 136 4 Frija ‘Frie’ | ‘friia’ 136

1 Fol ‘Fol’ | An otherwise unknown God; he may possibly be identified with Balder of l. 2, seeing as it is his horse whose leg is sprained. The manuscript spelling *ph-* is unusual but the alliteration with *vuoz* ‘foot’ confirms that we are dealing with the same consonant, viz. an old *f*, probably voiced to *v*.

1 Wuodan ‘Weden’ | Weden, the chief of the Gods in the Norse mythology, here appearing in his role as healer (for which cf. *Háv* 147–165, *Nwyrt* 11/2). This is Weden’s only literary occurrence in OHG, although his name is also found on the Runic Nordendorf fibula (cf. *Vsp* 17/4 n.) and in the Latin form *godan* in the Longbeardish Origin Myth (see Appendix to *Grm*).

3 bi·guol en ‘galed over it’ | Sang a galder over the horse; *bi·guol* the 3rd sg. past ind. of *bi·galan* ‘sing (a galder) over, begale’, the transitive of *galan* ‘gale, sing (a galder)’. Cf. *Háv* 153/4, *Oddr* 7/3–4.

4 Frija ‘Frie’ | Weden’s wife, cognate with ON *Frigg*. Cf. the Longbeardish Origin Myth, where she appears as *Frea*.

4 Volla ‘Full’ | An otherwise unknown goddess in OHG. Her name is clearly cognate with ON *Fulla*, Frie’s handmaid and confidante (*Grm* P2, *Gylf* 35:6, *Skm* 1).

6–9 Só-se ... sín! ‘Like ... together!’ | As discussed above the incantatio has numerous Celtic and Germanic parallels, yet the oldest parallel by far is from Vedic India, in *AV* 4.15.1–3 (ca. 1200–900 bc), a spell used alongside an herb to heal a broken bone. The present quotation is from the likely more original *Pippalādá* recension, but the same sts. occur in variant form as *AV* 4.12.3–5 in the more famous *Śāúnaka* recension, for which see Zysk 1996, pp. 72–74. In OI (norm. N. S. Dwibhashyam): 1 *Sáṁ majjá majjñā̆ bʰavatu; / sám u tē páruṣā páruḥ; / sáṁ tē māṁsásya vísrastam; / sáṁ snáva sám u párva tē. // 2 Majjá majjñā̆ sáṁ·dʰīyatām. / Astʰnā̆_ástʰi ápi·rōhatu. / Snáva tē sáṁ·dadʰmaḥ snávnā. / Cármaṇā cárma rōhatu. // 3 Lóma lómnā sáṁ·dʰīyatām. / Tvacá sáṁ·kalpaya tvácam. / Ásṛk tē asnā̆ rōhatu. / Māṁsáṁ māṁséna rōhatu.* ‘1 Let marrow be together with marrow, and let joint be together with joint for thee. Let the severed part of thy flesh be together; let sinew be together, and let limb be together for thee. 2 Let marrow be put together with marrow; let bone also grow with bone. We put together thy sinew with sinew; let skin grow with skin. 3 Let hair be put together with hair; fit together skin with skin. Let thy blood grow with blood; let flesh grow with flesh.’

## Appendix

Immediately below the galders the following Latin prayer is written. Abbreviations have been resolved according to Murdoch (1988, p. 369). The prayer is closely related to the Anglican *Prayer for the Clergy and People* as found in the Book of Common Prayer (Church of England 1892, p. 58), which the present translation aims to follow where possible.

**P1** Omnipotens sancte pater noster deus, qui facis mirabilia magna
2 solus, pretende super famulum tuum N. et super cunctas con-
gregationes illis commissas spiritum gratie salutaris, et ut in ver-
4 itate tibi conplaceant perpetuum eis rorem tue benedictionis in-
fundo. Per dominum nostrum Jesum Christum.

Almighty, holy Father, our God, who alone workest great marvels: send down upon thy servant N., and upon all the congregations committed to their charge, the spirit of saving grace; and, that they may truly please thee, pour upon them the continual dew of thy blessing. Through our Lord Jesus Christ.

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2 famulum tuum N. 'thy servant N.' | N. abbreviating *nomen* 'name', viz. the subject of the blessing. The singular "thy servant" appears to have taken place of an earlier plural subject, for many of the following words (*illis* '(to) their (charge)' etc.) are still written in the plural—"their" is **not** to be understood as a gender neutral singular pronoun. This hints that the German scribe, in spite of his pleasing hand, may not have been fully competent in Latin.

# German Wyrm-galders

## Against wyrms (*Contra vermes*)

**Dating:** 9th c.
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

**Against wyrms** (*ContVerm*) is an Old Saxon manuscript charm against wyrms located in the bone-marrow, presumably thought to cause aches.

#### Textual preservation and transmission

*ContVerm* is found as marginalia in the 9th c. manuscript Cod. Vind. (ÖNB) 751 on fol. 188v.

#### Contents

The galder is a sort of exorcism. It calls upon Nesse, the chief injurious wyrm-dæmon, to depart from the patient along with its nine offspring. The galder lays out a path for the wyrms to leave the sufferer's body and instead go into an arrow or sharp point (*strála*), perhaps a ritual implement used to draw blood from the affected area.

A closely related galder is found in Old High German form under the title *Pro Nessia* 'Against Nesse' (*ProNessia*), edited immediately below.

The structure "Go from X to Y, from Y to Z" may be very old, for it is also found in some of the Romani charms collected by Leland (1891, pp. 27, 28, 95), for which see note to ll. 2–3.

### Text

Gang út, Nesso, · mid nigun nessi-klínon,
2 út fana þemo marge an þat bên, · fan þemo bêne an þat fleśg,
út fan þemo fleśgke an þia húd, · út fan þera húd an þesa strála.

4 Drohtin, werþe só.

Go out, Nesse, with nine small Nesses!
Out from the marrow into the bone, from the bone into the flesh,
out from the flesh into the skin, out from the skin into this arrow.
Lord, may it be so.

---

1 Nesso 'Nesse' | An otherwise unknown dæmon, entitled *Nessia* in the Latin title to the version of this spell (*ProNessia*). The *naming* of the dæmon or spirit which is to be excised is commonplace in ancient magic, including several other galders edited here. The idea is that knowledge of the name of the entity gives the magician power over it.

2–3 út ... strála 'Out ... arrow.' | As mentioned in the Introduction, one of Leland's charms is particularly similar to *ContVerm* and by extension *ProNessia*. In both the Germanic and Romani charms, the wyrms (Romani *kirmora* < Sanskrit *kr̥mi*, which is probably related to PGmc. **wurmiz*, although the irregular variation in the initial consonant is unusual and perhaps due to a taboo deformation) are to leave the body and instead go into the ritual implement, in the Gypsy charm an ointment. I take the freedom to reproduce the charm in full with Leland's introduction and translation, but line-breaks in the verse replaced by slashes:
"Before sunrise wolf's milk (Wolfsmilch, rukeskro tçud) is collected, mixed with salt, garlic, and water, put into a pot, and boiled down to a brew. With a part of this the afflicted spot is rubbed, the rest is thrown into a brook, with the words:—
*Kirmora jánen ándre tçud / Andrál tçud, andré sir / Andrál sir, andré páñi, / Panensá kiyá dádeske, / Kiyá Niváseske / Pçándel tumen shelebá / Eñávárdesh teñá!*
'Worms go in the milk, / From the milk into the garlic, / From the garlic into the water, / With the water to (your) father, / To the Nivasi, / He shall bind you with a rope, / Ninety-nine (yards long).'" (Leland 1891, p. 95).

## For Nesse (*Pro Nessia*)

**Dating:** 9th c.
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

**Against Nesse** (*ProNessia*) is an Old High German variant of the same spell as the Old Saxon *ContVerm*, edited above.

#### Textual preservation and transmission

The galder is marginalia, found in the 9th c. ms. BSB Clm 18524b, on fol. 203v.

#### Contents

The language of *ProNessia* is Bavarian, having undergone the second sound shift. The wording is strikingly similar to the Old Saxon *ContVerm*, which is likewise directed against the dæmon Nesse and his/her nine offspring. The main difference between the two galders is in the use of the words describing the path Nesse is to take, but the core conception is identical: the dæmon is to be drawn out from the patient and into some external object.

### Text

Gang úz, Nesso, · mit niun nessi-khịlínon,
úz fonna marge in deo ádra, · vonna den ádrún in daz flęisk,
fonna demu flęiske in daz fel, · fona demo velle in diz tulli.
Ter paternoster.

Go out, Nesse, with nine small Nesses!
Out from the marrow into the veins, from the veins into the flesh,
from the flesh into the skin, from the skin into this quiver.
Thrice ‘pater noster’.

---

3 tulli ‘quiver’ | The translation is uncertain. TODO: look up.

4 Ter paternoster ‘Thrice ‘pater noster’’ | This Latin instruction seals the galder and places it in a thoroughly Christian medicinal context. Cf. the Introduction to *Mers*.

# The Knosping Galder

**Dating:** C9th–10th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Knospink galder** is a short OHG galder for blessing a house.

### Textual preservation and transmission

The galder is found in Ms. Car. C 176, presently in Zürich. It is found on fol. 154r amidst a number of magical charms in Latin. It is given the title *Ad signandum domum contra diabolum* 'To bless a house against devils'.

### Interpretation

The galder begins by addressing the "wight" explicitly, recognising it as such. This recognition is the equivalent of the naming of it and brings the dæmonic spirit out into the open, vulnerable to the effects of the exorcism.

The titular *chnospinci* 'Knosping' serves to drive away the wight. It is undoubtedly a magic word and has no clear meaning. Metrically it appears that the suffix *-pinci* has secondary stress which suggests the segmentation *chnos-pinci*, though this does not help much with its etymology.

### Text

1 Wola, wiht, taz tú węist, · taz tu wiht hęizist,
2 taz tú ne węist noch ne chanst · cheden chnos-pinci.

Lo, wight, thou knowest that thou art called a wight,
that thou neither knowest nor canst say [the word] 'Knosping'.

# Old English Galders

There survive twelve mediaeval Anglo-Saxon metrical charms, although it is questionable whether they all qualify as galders. Notably for these texts is that they are preserved as the main text in manuscripts rather than marginalia, and that they have substantial ritual instructions alongside the words of the galders themselves.

The first four, *Nwyrt*, *Dweorh*, *Férst*, and "Childbirth", are from the text known as the *Lâcnunga* (*Lâcn*) in the manuscript Harley MS 585 (ca. 1000 AD, siglum **L**). One galder from *Lâcn*, "For Loss of Cattle" (A), on fol. 180v–181r, is excluded as it is fully Christian without clear traditional elements.

The following two, "For Theft of Cattle" and *Ymbe*, both belong to Corpus Christi College, Cambridge MS 41 (CCCC 41). Two other galders in CCCC 41, "For Loss of Cattle" (B), a variant of (A) same-named galder found in *Lâcn*, and "A Journey Charm" are thoroughly Christian and therefore excluded.

The last three galders, "Against Wen", "Against Water-Elf-Disease", and *Æcer*, are from various sources. These will be discussed in the Introduction to each individual text.

# The Galder of Nine Worts
## *(Nigon wyrta galdor)*

**Dating:** ?
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: introduction

Numerous lines begin with small crosses which appear to serve as section markers. The present division into stanzas is largely based on these. TODO: note which.

Preserved in *Lâcn*.

### Text

**1** Ge·myne ðú mug-wyrt · hwæt þú á·meldodest
hwæt þu renadest · æt Regen-melde?

Rememberest thou, Mugwort, what thou didst declare,
what thou didst arrange at Reinmeld?

**2** Una þú hâttest · yldost wyrta
þú miht wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí·tigum*
þú miht wiþ attre · and wið ǫn·flyge
þú miht wiþ þâm lâþan · ðe geond lǫnd færð.

Un thou art called, the oldest of worts;
thou availest against three and against thirty;
thou availest against the venom and against the onflier;
thou availest against the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

2 wið *þrim* · and wið *þrí·tigum* 'against three and against thirty' | I.e. 'against a great number of foes'. 'Three and thirty' is formulaic and appears in many later English and Scottish folk-songs, viz. Child 4EFG, 18B, 20C, 30, 53BCDEIKM, 63EFH, 73I, 97AC, 100AG, 110BGH, 156G, 185A, 187A, 187C, 190A, 192A, 193B, 203C, 211A, 217GHLN, 244A, 268A, 269C, 281ABC. Things described include horses, heads of cattle, warriors, days, years, winters.

**3** Ond þú weg·bráde · wyrta módor
éastan opene · innan mihtigu
ofer ðy cræte curron · ofer ðy cwéne reodon
ofer ðy brýde brýodedon
ofer ðy fearras fnærdon.

And thou, Waybroad, mother of worts,
open from the east, mighty within.
Over thee TODO.
TODO
TODO

**4** Eallum þu þon wið·stóde · and wið·stunedest
swá ðú wið·stonde attre · and ǫn·flyge
and þǽm lâðan · þe geond lǫnd fereð.

Them all didst thou then withstand, and didst stop;
so mayest thou withstand the venom and the onflier,
and the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

**5** Stune hætte þéos wyrt, · héo on stâne ge·weox
stǫnd héo wið attre, · stunað héo wærce
Stiðe héo hatte, · wið·stunað héo attre
wreceð héo wrâðan, · weorpeð út attor.

Stun is this wort called, she grew on stone;
she withstands venom, she stops aches.
Stithe is she called, she stops the venom;
she drives away the wroth one, casts out the venom.

**6** Þis is séo wyrt · séo wiþ wyrm ge·feaht
þéos mæg wið attre, · héo mæg wið ǫn·flyge;
héo mæg wið ðâm lâþan · ðe geond lǫnd fereþ.

This is the wort that fought against the Wyrm;
this one avails against the venom, she avails against the onflier;
she avails against the loathsome one that journeys through the lands.

**7** Fleoh þú nú attor-lâðe, · séo læsse ðá mâran
séo mâre þá læssan, · oððæt him beigra bót sý!

TODO
TODO.

**8** Ge·myne þú, mægðe, · hwæt þú á·meldodest
hwæt ðú ge·ændadest · æt Alor-forda
þæt næfre for ge·floge · feorh ne ge·sealde
syþðan him mǫn mægðan · tú męte ge·gyrede.

TODO
TODO
TODO
TODO

**9** Þis is séo wyrt · ðe wer-gulu hatte
ðás on·sænde seolh · ofer sæs hrygc
ondan attres · óþres tó bóte.

TODO
TODO
TODO

**10** Ðás *nygon* magon · wið nygon attrum.

These nine avail against nine venoms.

**11** Wyrm cóm snícan, · to·slât hé *m*an
ðá ge·nam Wóden · *nygon* wuldor-tânas
slóh ðá þá næddran · þæt héo on *nygon* tó·fléah
Þǽr ge·ændade æppel · and attor
þæt héo næfre ne wolde · ǫn hús búgan.

A Wyrm came crawling; he tore apart a man.
Then took Weden nine glory-twigs,
slew then that adder, that it sprung into nine [parts].
There ended apple and venom,
that she would never wish to enter a house.

**12** Fille and finule, · fela-mihtigu twá
þá wyrte ge·sceop · wítig drihten
hâlig on heofonum, · þá hé hǫngode;

sętte and sęnde · on *seofon* worulde
earmum and éadigum · eallum tó bóte.

Fill and Fennel, the many-mighty two;
those worts the wise lord shaped,
holy in heaven when he hung.
He set and sent them into seven worlds,
for wretched men and for wealthy, for all men as a remedy.

**13** Stǫnd héo wiđ wærce, · stunað héo wiđ attre
séo mæg wiđ *þrim* · *and* wiđ *þrí·tigum*
wiđ *féondes* hǫnd · and wiđ fær-bregde
wiđ malscrunge · mânra wihta.

She stands against ache, she stands against venom; she avails against three and against thirty; against the TODO of evil wights.

**14** Nu magon þás *nygon* wyrta · wiđ nygon wuldor-ge·flogenum
wiđ *nygon* attrum · and wiđ nygon on·flygnum
wiđ ðý réadan attre, · wiđ ðý runlan attre
wiđ ðý hwitan attre, · wiđ ðý *hæwe*nan attre
wiđ ðý geolwan attre, · wiđ ðý grénan attre
wiđ ðý wonnan attre, · wiđ ðý wedenan attre
wiđ ðý brúnan attre, · wiđ ðý basewan attre
wiđ wyrm-ge·blæd, · wiđ wæter-ge·blæd
wiđ þorn-ge·blæd, · wiđ þystel-ge·blæd
wiđ ýs-ge·blæd, · wiđ attor-ge·blæd

Now these nine worts avail against glory-onfliers:
against nine venoms and against nine onfliers;
against the red venom; against the TODO venom;
against the white venom; against the TODO venom;
against the yellow venom; against the green venom;
against the TODO venom; against the TODO venom;
against the brown venom; against the TODO venom;
against worm-TODO; against water-TODO;
against thorn-TODO; against thistle-TODO;
against ice-TODO; against venom-TODO.

**15** Gif ænig attor cume · éastan fleógan
oððe ænig norðan cume
oððe ænig westan · ofer wer-þeóde

If any venom should come flying from the east;

or any come from the north;
or any from the west, over mankind.

**16** Crîst stód ofer ádle · ǽngan cundes.
Ic âna wât · éa rinnende
þǽr þá nygon nædran · néan be·healdað.

Christ stood over TODO;
I know one river running,
where the nine adders TODO.

**17** Motan ealle wéoda · nu wyrtum á·springan
sǽs tó·slúpan, · eal sealt wæter
ðonne ic þis attor · of þé ge·bláwe.

TODO

**P1** Mucgwyrt, weg-brade þe eastan open sy, lombes-cyrse, attorlaðan, mageðan, netelan, wudu-sur-æppel, fille and finul, ealde sapan. Ge·wyrc ða wyrta to duste, mængc wiþ þa sapan and wiþ þæs æpples gor. Wyrc slypan of wætere and of axsan, ge·nim finol, wyl on þære slyppan and beþe mid æggemongc, þonne he þa sealfe on do, ge ær ge æfter. Sing þæt galdor on ǽcre þara wyrta, :III: ær he hy wyrce and on þone æppel eal-swa; ond singe þon męn in þǫne mûð and in þá éaran búta and on ðá wunde þæt ilce gealdor, ær he þá sealfe on dó.

TODO.

# Against a Dwarf
## *(Wið dweorh)*

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

### Text

**P1** Mann sceal niman *seofon* lytle of-lætan swylce mann mid ofrað,
ond wrítan þás naman on ælcre oflætan: Maximianus, Malchus,
Johannes, Martinianus, Dionisius, Constantinus, Serafion. Þænne
eft þæt galdor þæt hér æfter cweð[eð] mann sceal singan, ærest
on þæt wynstre éare, þænne on þæt swíðre éare, þænne búfan
þæs mannes moldan; ond gá þænne ân mæden-mann tó, ond hó
hit ǫn his sweoran, ond dó mann swá þrý dagas. Him bið sóna
sél.

One shall take seven small wafers, such as one offers [during the Mass], and write these names on each wafer: Maximianus, Malchus, Johannes, Martinianus, Dionysius, Constantinus, Seraphion. After that shall one sing this galder which is henceforth said; first into the left ear, then into the right ear, then over the man's head; and thereafter a maiden go forth, and hang it on his neck; and one do so for three days. He will soon be well.

**1** Hér cóm in·gangan · in·spiden wiht,
hæfde him his haman ǫn handa; · cwæð þæt þú his hæncgest
wǽre,

lęgeþe þé his téage ǫn sweoran; · ǫn·gunnan him ǫf þæm lande líðan.
Sóna swá hý ǫf þæm lande cóman · þá ǫn·gunnan him þá *leomu* cólian.—
Þá cóm in·gangan · déores sweostar;
þá ge·ændode héo · ond âðas swór,
þæt næfre þis þæm adlegan · *egl*ian ne móste
né þæm þe þis galdor · be·gýtan mihte
oððe þe þis galdor · on·galan cüðe.
Amen fiað.

Here an inspiden wight came walking in,
had his harness in his hands, said that thou wert his horse,
laid his reins on thy neck; they began to ride away from the land.
As soon as they came away from the land then they began to cool limbs.
Then the beast's sister came walking in;
then she made an end to it and swore oaths
that this never should torment the ailing man,
nor him who this galder might get,
nor whomever this galder could gale.
Amen, let it be.

# Against a Sudden Stitch
## *(Wið fær-stice)*

**Dating:** ?
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

Attested in *Lâcn*.

### Text

**1** Hlúde wæron hý, lá, hlúde, · þá hý ofer þone hláw ridon,
wæron ân-móde, · þá hý ofer land ridan.
Scyld þú þé nú, þú þysne níð · ge·nesan móte.
Út, lýtel spere, · gif hér inne síe!

Loud were they, lo, loud, when they rode over the mound;
they were steadfast when they rode over land.
Shield thyself now; thou must escape this evil!
Out little spear if here within it be!

**2** Stód under linde, · under leohtum scylde,
þær þá mihtigan wíf · hýra mægen be·ræddon
and hý gyllende · gâras sændon;
ic him óðerne · eft wille sændan,
fléogende flâne · forane tó·géanes.
Út, lytel spere, · gif hit her inne sý!

I stood under the linden [SHIELD]—under the light shield—
where those mighty women arrayed their might
and their yelling spears did send.

To them I will send back another one:
a flying arrow, aimed against them.
Out little spear if here within it be!

**3** Sæt smið, · slóh seax,
lytel íserna, · wund swíðe.
Út, lytel spere, · gif her inne sý!

A smith sat, forged the sax:
a little iron-thing—a great wound.
Out little spear if here within it be!

**4** Syx smiðas sáton,
wæl-spera worhton.
Út, spere, · næs in, spere!
Gif her inne sý · ísenes dǽl,
hæg-tessan ge·weorc, · hit sceal ge·myltan.

Six smiths sat,
wrought slaughter-spears.
Out, spear! Be not in, spear!
If here within be a piece of iron,
the work of a hagtess—*it* shall melt!

**5** Gif þú wǽre on fell scoten · oððe wǽre on flæsc scoten
oððe wǽre on blód scoten · [...]
oððe wǽre on lið scoten, · næfre ne sý þín líf atæsed;

If thou wert shot in the skin or wert shot in the flesh,
or wert shot in the blood, [...],
or wert shot in the limb—never be thy life injured.

**6** Gif hit wǽre ésa ge·scot · oððe hit wǽre ylfa ge·scot
oððe hit wǽre hæg-tessan ge·scot, · nú ic wille þín helpan:
þis þé tó bóte ésa ge·scotes, · þis þé tó bóte ylfa ge·scotes,
þis þé tó bóte hæg-tessan ge·scotes; · ic þín wille helpan.

If it were a shot of Eese or it were a shot of Elves
or it were a shot of a hagtess–now I will help thee!
This for thee as remedy against shot of Eese; this for thee as remedy against shot of Elves;
this for thee as remedy against shot of a hagtess—I will help thee!

1 ėsa … ylfa ‘of Eese … of Elves’ | Formulaic; see Eese and Elves. That they are held in the same category as the hagtess—a witch—indicates Christian influence. Also among the West Germanic peoples the Elves and Eese were originally beneficial beings as seen by numerous names like Alfred (OE *Ęlf-réd* ‘Elf-counsel’), Oswald (OE *Ós-weald* ‘Os-power’), Elfwin (Lomb. *Alb-oin* ‘Elf-friend’), Oshelm (Lomb. *Anselm* ‘Os-helmet’).

3 þis þé tó bóte ‘This for thee as remedy’ | The three-fold repetition of this phrase is formulaic; cf. *Birth I* 1.

7 Fleo þær on · fyrgen-hæfde!
2 Hâl wes-tu, · helpe þĭn drihten!
Nim þonne þæt seax, á·dó on wætan.

TODO.
Hale be thou, may the Lord help thee.
Take then the knife, TODO.

# Three Galders for Birth

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

This text properly seems to consist of three separate galders/rituals for childbirth.

Found in *Lâcn*, fol. 185r–v.

## Text

### Galder I

**P1** Sé wíf-man, sé hire cild a·fédan ne mæg, gange tó ge·witenes mannes
2 birgenne and stæppe þǫnne þriwa ofer þá byrgenne and cweþe þǫnne þriwa þás word:

TODO: translation.

**1** Þis mé tó bóte þære lâðan læt-byrde,
2 þis mé tó bóte þære swæran swært-byrde,
þis mé tó bóte þære lâðan lam-byrde.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

---

1 Þis mé tó bóte 'This for me as remedy' | The three-fold repetition of this phrase is formulaic; cf. *Férst* 6/3 n.

**P2** And þǫnne þæt wíf séo mid bearne and héo tó hyre hlâforde on
2 reste gá, þǫnne cweþe héo:

TODO: translation.

**2** Up ic gonge, · ofer þe stæppe
mid cwican cilde, · nalæs mid cwęllendum,
mid ful-borenum, · nalæs mid fægan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**P3** And þǫnne seo módor ge·fele þæt þæt bearn sí cwic, gá þǫnne tó cyrican, and þǫnne héo tó·foran þan weofode cume, cweþe þǫnne:

TODO: translation.

**3** Criste, ic sæde, · þis ge·cýþed!

TODO: TRANSLATION.

### Galder II

**P1** Se wíf-mǫn, se hyre bearn a·fédan ne mæge, ge·nime héo sylf hyre âgenes cildes ge·byrgenne dǽl, *w*ry æfter þonne ǫn blace wulle and be·bicge tó cépe-mannum and cweþe þonne:

TODO: translation.

**1** Ic hit be·bicge, · ge hit be·bicgan,
þás sweartan wulle · and þysse sorge corn.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

### Galder III

**P1** Se man se þe mæge bearn a·fédan, nime þǫnne ánes bleos cú meoluc on hyre handæ and ge·supe þǫnne mid hyre múþe and gange þonne tó yrnendum wætere and spiwe þǽr in þá meolc and hlade þǫnne mid þǽre ylcan hand þæs wæteres múð fulne and for·swelge. Cweþe þonne þás word:

TODO: translation.

**1** Ge·hwer férde ic mé þone mæran · maga þihtan,
2 mid þysse mǽran · mętte þihtan;
þǫnne ic mé wille habban · and hâm gáan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**P2** Þǫnne héo tó þan broce gá, þǫnne ne be·seo héo, nó ne eft þǫnne
2 héo þanan gá, and þǫnne gá héo in óþer hús óþer héo út of·éode
and þǽr ge·byrge metes.

TODO: translation.

# For Theft of Cattle

**Dating:** TODO.
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.
Likely Christianized, but may still contain some pre-Christian elements.
From Corpus Christi College, Cambridge MS 41, p.206.
Note the curious overuse of the prefix *oð-*.

## Text

**P1** Ne for·stolen ne for·holen nanuht, þæs ðe ic age, þe ma ðe mihte Herod urne drihten. Ic ge·þohte sancte Ead-Elenan and ic ge·þóhte Crist on róde á·hangen; swa ic þence þis feoh to findanne, næs to oð·feorrganne, and to witanne, næs to oð·wyrceanne, and to lufianne, næs to oð·lædanne.

TODO: translation

**1** Gar·mund, · Godes ðegen,
find þæt feoh · and fére þæt feoh
and hafa þæt feoh · and heald þæt feoh
and fére hâm þæt feoh.
þæt he næfre næbbe landes, · þæt he hit oð·læde,
ne foldan, · þæt hit oð·ferie,
ne húsa, · þæt he hit oð·healde.
Gif hyt hwa ge·dó, · ne ge·dige hit him næfre.
Binnan þrym nihtum · cunne ic his mihta,
his mægen and his mihta · and his mund-cræftas.

Eall he weornige, · swa fyer wudu weornie,
swa breðel · beo swa þystel,
se ðe ðis feoh · oð·fergean þence
oððe ðis orf · oð·ehtian ðence.
Amen.

TODO: translation

# Against a Swarm
# *(Wið ymbe)*

**Dating:** ?
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

TODO. That bees are called "victory-wives" is interesting.

## Text

**P1** Wið ymbe nim eorþan, ofer·weorp mid þínre swíþran handa un-
2 der þínum swíþran fét, and cwet:

Against a swarm take earth, throw it with thy right hand under thy right foot, and say:

**1** Fó ic under fót, · funde ic hit.
2 Hwæt eorðe mæg · wið ealra wihta ge·hwilce
and wið andan · and wið æminde
4 and wið þá micelan · mannes tungan.

I catch under foot, I may have found *it*.
How, earth works against everywhich wight
and against mischief and against neglect
and against that mighty tongue of man.

---

4 þá micelan · mannes tungan 'that mighty tongue of man' | The tongue is surely here standing in for "speech", specifically galder; i.e., if the swarming of the bees were caused by an enemy's cursing, the earth will disarm it.

**P2** And wiððon for·weorp ofer greót, þonne hí swirman, and cweð:

And with that throw the grit over, when they swarm, and say:

---

1 for·weorp ofer greót 'throw the grit over' | i.e., "throw the earth over the swarm".

**2**

Sitte gé, sige-wíf, · sígað to eorþan!
Næfre gé wilde · to wuda fleogan.
Beo gé swá ge·mindige · mínes gódes,
swá bið manna ge·hwilc · metes and éþeles.

Sit ye, victory-wives; sink to the earth!
Never ye would fly to the woods.
Be ye so mindful of *my* good,
like is every man of his measure and homestead.

# Against Wen
## *(Wið Wennan)*

**Dating:** ca. 1150 AD
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

British Library MS Royal 4.A.xiv, fol. 106v.

An exorcistic galder. The text has early Middle English features like the turning of old *ƒ* to *v*.

### Text

1 Wenne, Wenne · Wenchichenne,
hér ne scealt þú timbrien, · ne nenne tún habben,
ac þú scealt nor*þ* heonene · tó þan nihgan berhge,
4 þer þú havest ermi*n*g, · énne bróþer.
Hé þe sceal legge · leaf et héafde.
6 Under fót wolmes, · under veþer earnes,
under earnes cléa, · á þú ge·weornie.

O Wen, O Wen, O little Wen!
Here shalt thou not make a home nor have any dwelling,
but thou shalt go north hence to the nearest barrow,
where thou, wretched thing, hast a brother.
He shall lay a leaf by thy head.
Under the foot of the TODO, under the feather of the eagle,
under the claw of the eagle mayest thou ever be.

8 Clinge þú · al-swa col on heorþe,

scringe þú · al-swa scerne awage,
and weorne *þú* · al-swa weter on anbre.
Swá litel þú ge·wurþe · al-swa lín-sét-corn,
and miccli lesse al-swa ánes hand-wurmes hupeban,
and al-swa litel þú ge·wurþe þet þú ná-wiht ge·wurþe.

TODO: translation,
and mayest thou become so little that thou becomest nothing.

# Against Water-Elf Disease
# *(Wið Wæter-ælf-ádle)*

**Dating:** TODO
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

## Text

**P1** Gif mon biþ on wæter-ælf-adle, þonne beoþ him þa hand-næglas
2 wonne and þa eagan tearige and wile locian niþer. Do him þis
to læce-dome: eofor-þrote, cassuc, fone nioþo-weard, eowberge,
4 elehtre, eolone, mersc-mealwan crop, fen-minte, dile, lilie, attor-
laþe, polleie, marubie, docce, ellen, felterre, wermod, streaw-
6 bergean leaf, consolde; of·geot mid ealaþ, do halig-wæter tó, sing
þis gealdor ofer þriwa:

TODO: translation

**1** Ic bęnne a·wrât · bętst beado-wræda,
2 swa bęnne ne burnon, · ne burston,
ne fundian, · ne feologan,
4 ne hoppettan,
ne wund waxsian,
6 ne dolh diopian;
ac him self healde · hale-wǽge,
8 ne ace þe þǫn mâ, · þe eorþan ǫn eare ace.

TODO: translation

**P2** Sing þis manegum siþum: Eorþe þe on·bere eallum hire mihtum
2 and mægenum. Þas galdor mon mæg singan on wunde.

TODO: translation

# Acre-Boot
# *(Æcer-bót)*

**Dating:** ca. 1000
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Acre-Boot** (i.e., 'Field-Remedy', abbrev. *Æcer*) is an unusually long text mixing Catholic, Germanic, and Celtic elements.

*Æcer* is preserved in Cotton MS Caligula A VII, foll. 176r–178r.

## Text

**P1** Hér ys seo bót, hú þú meaht þíne æceras bétan gif hí nellaþ wel
2 wexan oþþe þǽr hwilc un·ge·défe þing on ge·dón bið on dry oððe
on lyb-lâce. Ge·nim þǫnne ǫn niht, ær hyt dagige, feower tyrf
4 on feower healfa þæs landes, and ge·mearca hú hý ǽr stódon.
Nim þonne ele and hunig and beorman, and ælces feos meolc þe
6 on þæm lande sý, and ælces treow-cynnes dǽl þe on þǽm lande
sý ge·wexen, bútan heardan béaman, and ælcre nam cúþre wyrte
8 dǽl, bútan glappan ânon, and dó þonne hâlig-wæter ðǽr on, and
drype þǫnne þriwa on þǫne staðol þára turfa, and cweþe ðonne
10 ðás word: „Crescite, wexe, et multiplicamini, and ge·mænig
fealda, et replete, and ge·fylle, terre, þás eorðan. In nomine pa-
12 tris et filii et spiritus sancti sit benedicti." And Pater Noster swá
oft swá þæt óðer. And bere siþþan ðá turf to circean, and mæsse-
14 preost á·singe feower mæssan ofer þan turfon, and wende man
þæt gréne to ðan weofode, and siþþan ge·bringe man þá turf þǽr
16 hí ǽr wǽron ǽr sunnan setl-gange. And hæbbe him gæ·worht

of cwic-béame feower Cristes mælo and a·wríte on ælcon ende:
„Matheus and Marcus, Lucas and Iohannes.“ Lege þæt Cristes
mæl on þone pyt neoþe-weardne, cweðe ðǫnne: „Crux Matheus,
crux Marcus, crux Lucas, crux Sanctus Iohannes.“

TODO.

**P2** Nim ðǫnne þá turf and sete ðær ufon on and cweþe ðǫnne nigon
síþon þás word: Crescite, and swa oft Pater Noster, and wende
þé þǫnne éast-weard, and ǫn·lút nigon síðon éad-mód=líce, and
cweð þǫnne þás word:

TODO.

**1** „Éast-weard ic stande, · ârena ic mé bidde,
bidde ic þǫne méran domine, · bidde ðǫne miclan drihten,
bidde ic ðǫne háligan · heofon-rices weard,
eorðan ic bidde · and up-heofon
and ðá sóþan · sancta Marian
and heofones meaht · and héah-reced,
þæt ic móte þis gealdor · mid gife drihtnes
tóðum on·týnan · þurh trumne ge·þanc,
á·węccan þas wæstmas · ús to woruld-nytte,
ge·fylle þás foldan · mid fæste ge·léafan
wlitigigan þas wancg-turf, · swá sé witega cwæð
þæt sé hæfde áre ǫn eorþ-ríce, · sé þe ælmyssan
dǽlde dóm-líce · drihtnes þances.“

“Turned eastwards I stand; for mercies I bid;
I bid the famous *dominus*; I bid the great Lord;
I bid the holy Guardian of the Heavenly Kingdom;
Earth I bid and Up-heaven
and the true Saint Mary,
and Heaven's might and the high hall,
that I this galder with the grace of the Lord
may TODO...”

**P3** Wende þe þǫnne III sun-ganges, a·strece þǫnne ǫn and-lang and
a·rim þær letanias and cweð þonne: „Sanctus, sanctus, sanctus
oþ ende.“

TODO.

**P4** Sing þǫnne Benedicite a·þenedon earmon and Magnificat and Pater Noster III, and be·béod hit Criste and sancta Marian and þǽre hâlgan róde tó lofe and to weorþinga and þâm âre þe þæt land âge and eallon þâm þe him under·ðeodde synt.

TODO.

**P5** Ðǫnne þæt eall síe ge·dón, þǫnne nime man un·cúþ sǽd æt ælmesmannum and selle him twá swylc, swylce man æt him nime, and ge·gaderie ealle his sulh-ge·teogo to·gædere; borige þǫnne on þam béame stor and finol and ge·hâlgode sápan and ge·hâlgod sealt. Nim þǫnne þæt sǽd, sete on þæs sules bodig, cweð þǫnne:

TODO.

**2** „Erce, Erce, Erce, · eorþan módor,
ge·unne þé se al-walda, · éce drihten,
ǽcera wexendra · and wrídendra,
eacniendra · and elniendra;
sceafta héhre · scíre wæstma,
and þǽre brâdan · bere-wæstma,
and þǽre hwítan · hwæte-wæstma,
and ealra · eorþan wæstma.

"Erc, Erc, Erc, mother of the earth,
TODO..."

**3** Ge·unne him · éce drihten
and his hâlige, · þe ǫn heofonum synt,
þæt hys yrþ sí ge·friþod · wið ealra feonda ge·hwæne,
and heo sí ge·borgen · wið ealra bealwa ge·hwylc,
þára lyb-lâca · geond land sáwen.

TODO.

**4** Nú ic bidde ðǫne waldend, · sé ðe ðás wor-uld ge·sceóp,
þæt ne sý nán tó þæs cwidol wíf · ne tó þæs cræftig man
þæt á·wendan ne mæge · word þus ge·cwedene."

Now I bid the Wielder who created this world,
that there may be no wife so cunning in song nor no man so strong
that he may turn about the words thus spoken."

**P6** Þonne man þá sulh forð drife þá forman furh on·scéote, cweð þǫnne:

TODO.

**5** „Hál wes þú, Folde, · firþa módor!
Beo þú grówende · on Godes fæþme,
fódre ge·fylled · firþum tó nytte.“

“Hale be thou, Fold, mother of men!
Be thou growing in God’s embrace,
filled with fodder as a boon to men.”

**P7** Nim þonne ælces cynnes melo and a·bacæ man inn-werdre handa brádnæ hláf and ge·cned hine mid meolce and mid hálig-wætere and lecge under þa forman furh. Cweþe þonne:

TODO.

**6** „Ful æcer fódres · firþa cinne,
beorht-blowende, · þú ge·blétsod weorþ
þæs hâligan nǫman · þe ðás heofon ge·sceop
and þás eorþan · þe wé ǫn lifiaþ;
sé god, sé þás grundas ge·worhte, · ge·unne ús growende gife,
þæt ús corna ge·hwylc · cume tó nytte.“

“Acre full of fodder for the race of men,
brightly blooming! Thou wast blessed
by the holy name which created this heaven
and this earth upon which we live.
The God who wrought these lands, grant us growing grace
that each kind of grain may be for us a boon.”

**P8** Cweð þonne III: „Crescite in nomine patris, sit benedicti. Amen“, and Pater Noster þríwa.

TODO.

# Old Norse galders

# SJy 41 (SJy 41; Ribe galder-stick)

**Dating:** Mediaeval.
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay, Galders-lay

## Introduction

A wooden stick from the Danish city of Ribe. The galder is syncretic and contains numerous pre-Christian elements in a Christian(ised) context.

The inscription may be conveniently divided into four parts. Part one (ll. 1–4) contains an introductory prayer where the healer asks for the aid of natural forces (Earth, Up-heaven and the Sun) and Christian divinitities (God and Saint Mary) so that the healing may be successful. Part two (ll. 5–8) ritually exorcises any sickness which may have entered any part of the body. Part three (ll. 9–14) apparently warns the addressee that they will be haunted by "nine needs" (an old Heathen formula; see note) until they say the charm. Part four (ll. 15, which is probably prose) gives the personal name "Bonde", perhaps the addressee, and concludes with an "Amen".

## Transliteration

Note that the part of § C following ¶ is deliberately scraped off.

§ A **+ io^rþ ÷ biþ a^k ÷ ua^rþæ ÷ o^k ÷ uphimæn ÷ so^l ÷ o^k ÷ sa^nt^æ maria ÷ o^k ÷ salfæn ÷ gud| |drotæn ÷ þæt han ÷ læ mik ÷ læknæs÷ha^nd ÷ o^k lif÷tuggæ ÷ at^^liuæ**
§ B **uiuindnæ ÷ þær ÷ botæ ÷ þa^rf ÷ or ÷ ba^k ÷ o^k or brʀst ÷ or lækæ ÷ o^k or lim ÷ or øuæn ÷ o^k or øræn ÷ or ÷ a^llæ þe ÷ þær ÷ ilt ÷ kan i at**
§ C **kumæ ÷ suart ÷ hetær ÷ sten ÷ ha^n ÷ stær ÷ i ÷ hafæ ÷ utæ ÷ þær ÷ ligær ÷ a ÷ þe ÷ ni ÷ no^uþær ÷ þæ¶r ÷ l---r(a) ÷ (þ)en-nþþæþeskulhuærki**
§ D **skulæ ÷ huærki ÷ søtæn ÷ sofæ ÷ æþ ÷ uarmnæn ÷ uakæ ÷ førr æn ÷ þu ÷ þæssa ÷ bot ÷ biþær ÷ þær ÷ a^k o^rþ ÷ at kæþæ ÷ ro^nti ÷ amæn ÷ o^k þæt ÷ se +**

## Text

Iorð bið ak varðe · ok up-himen
sól ok sante María · ok salfen Guð drótten
þet hann lę mik lęknes-hand · ok lyf-tunge
at lyfe *b*ifj*a*nde · þer bóte þarf.

I bid Earth to guard and Up-heaven,
the Sun and Saint Mary, and the very Lord God
that he lend me a leecher's hand and a medicine-tongue
as medicine for the trembler who needs the remedy.

---

1 Iorð bið ak varðe · ok up-himen 'I bid Earth to guard and Up-heaven' | *Iorð … ok up-himen* 'Earth ... and Up-heaven' is a formulaic and originally pre-Christian merism representing the totality of the Cosmos; cf. *Vsp* 3. It is here used in a syncretic magical context; the galer (galder-singer) asks the Cosmos itself to watch over and protect him/her as he/she utters the magic words. A notable parallel to the present instance is found in the OE *Æcer* 1/4 (ca. 1000 AD), edited above. Cf. also a 14th c. version of the Icelandic *Grið-a-mál* 'Grith-speech', a legal formula for the establishments of truces between former enemies, where we read that: *Jǫrð rę̈ðr griðum fyr neðan, en upp-himinn varðar fyr ofan, en sjór fyr útan, sá er kringir um ǫll lǫnd.* 'The earth rules the griths from below, and Up-heaven guards them from above, and the sea from without which encircles all lands.' (*DI* II, p. 659). For an older version of the *Grið-a-mál* lacking the just-cited passage cf. *Gr* 73. Due to its invocation of pre-Christian cosmology and its use of likely pre-Christian legal formulae like *rękr ok rekinn* 'fit to be driven out and exiled' and *grið-níðings nafn* 'name of a grith-nithing' (which in *Vatn* 26 is paired with the certainly pagan legal term *goð-a-grępi* 'wrath of the gods'; cf. *Hárb* 60 n.) it is likely that the *Grið-a-mál* reflects a late remnant of pre-Christian law. Together with the present galder and *Æcer* 1/4 all three texts appear to reflect a common pre-Christian Germanic ritual expression.

Ór bak ok ór brýst
ór líke ok ór lim
ór ǫ̊ven ok ór ǫ̊ren
ór alle þé · þer illt kann í at·kume.

Out of back and out of breast!
Out of body and out of limb!
Out of eyes and out of ears!
Out of everything, where evil might come in!

Svart hêter stênn · hann stęr í hafe úte,
þer ligger á þé n*íu* nauðer;
þę skule hverki søten sofe;
eð varmen vake;
førr en þú þessa bót biðer,
þer ak orð · at·kv*ę̈*ð*e* r*ú*nti.
Amen ok þat sé.

Swart is a stone called; it stands out in the ocean.
There lie on it nine needs;
they will neither sleep sweetly
nor wake warmly,
until thou prayest this remedy
to which I have spoken the runic(?) words.
Amen and let it be so.

---

11 þę | *add., but scraped off and poorly legible* **†÷ þæ¶r ÷ l--r(a) ÷ (þ)en-nþþæþeskulhuærki†** *(a poorly carved form of ll. 9–10)* SJy 41

# The Canterbury Galder (E DR419)

**Dating:** ca. 1075
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

This Old Norse galder (*Cant*, with runological signum E DR419) is found in the Anglo-Saxon manuscript Cotton Caligula A XV. It runs across the bottom margin of the two facing pages 123v and 124r and is written in very clear runes of Wiking Age long-stave type. One rune, **g** in **vigi** *vegi* 'smite' is stung. The text has no word separators.

The galder is very similar to U Fv1933;134 and U NOR1998;25 from Sigtuna, Sweden. They all belong to a type of magical healing where an illness-causing devil is commanded to leave the suffering person. The final line, *viðr áðra-vari* 'against pus of veins' is probably a declaration of purpose.

## Text

Gyrils sár-þvara!
Far þú nú, · fundinn es-tu!
Þórr vegi þik · þursa dróttinn!
Jórils sár-þvara!
Viðr áðra-vari.

O Gyrel's wound-borer!
Go thou now; found art thou!
May Thunder smite thee, lord of Thurses!
O Erel's wound-borer!
Against pus of veins.

---

3 þursa dróttinn 'lord of Thurses' | Formulaic, also found in U Fv1933;134 and *Þrk* 6/2 (n.), 11/2 etc.

# Sigtuna rib (U NOR1998;25)

**Dating:** ca. 1100
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction.

## Text

Jórils vrið, ... vaksna úr Króki!
Batt han riðu · barði hann riðu,
auk síða sarð · sára rann.
Vara hafir fullt fengit; · flý braut, riða!

O Erel's trembling, grow out of Crook!
He bound the fever; he beat the fever,
and thereafter fucked(?) the house of wounds.
The pus has he fully caught—fly away, fever!

# Sigtuna Plate I (U Fv1933;134)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

TODO: Introduction

## Text

Þurs sár-riðu, · þursa dróttinn;
fliu þú nú · fundinn es!
'Af þér þríar þráar, ulfr;
'af þér níu nauðir, ulfr!
'Efir þessi sér, auk es unir ulfr.
Niut lyfja!

O thurse of the wound-fever, O lord of Thurses;
fly thou now; found art thou!
Have for thee three yearnings, O wolf!
Have for thee nine needs, O wolf!
He has this for himself, and the wolf is content.
Benefit from the medicine!

# Högstena plate (Vg 216)

**Dating:** C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

A runic-inscribed bronze plate found in a graveyard by Högstena church in Gudhem, West Geatland, Sweden.

NOTE: The original Norse text is a placeholder and should not be referenced. Cf. Pereswetoff-Morath (2019, pp. 169–188).

## Text

Galanda viðr · gǫngla viðr
ríðanda viðr · viðr rinnanda
viðr sęljanda · viðr signanda
viðr faranda · viðr fliuganda.
Skal alt furna uk um døia.

# Galders from Bryggen

## Introduction

Several galders or magical inscriptions are part of the cache of mediaeval rune-inscribed objects found at Bryggen in the city of Bergen, Norway. For simplicity's sake, they are here listed in ascending order of their runological numbers.

## N B257

**Dating:** ca. 1335
**Meter:** Galders-lay

A stick inscribed on four planed sides. Part of the stick is broken off, which renders the text incomplete. The inscription is clearly a "love-charm" (that is, a piece of sexually coercive magic), addressed—as is shown by the feminine dative *sjalfri þér* 'thy self' on side D—to a woman. The language closely resembles that of *Skí* 36, in which Shirner, servant of the god Frea, threatens to carve a runic inscription which will curse the ettin-woman Gird with *ęrgi* 'queerness, sexual insatiability', *óði* 'madness', and *ó·þoli* 'restlessness, impatience' unless she sleep with his master. It seems that we are here dealing with just such a surviving runic curse, and that *Skí* 36 is reflecting an authentic form of Norse "love magic" (for it is unlikely that the present inscription should derive directly from that poem) by which a woman is cursed with sexual restlessness until she succumb to the will of the male curser.

A more distant parallel may be seen in the curse-formula found on the two C7th runic inscriptions from Stentoften and Björketorp (see TODO), wherein the destroyer of the respective monuments is cursed to become *hermalausaʀ argjú* 'restless (a different root from *ó·þoli* above!) with queerness', i.e., 'incessantly randy'.

Side D ends with a string of fake-Latin gibberish, a clear sign of Christian syncretic influence on the Old Norse-Germanic magical tradition.

**A** Ríst ek bót-rúnar · ríst ek bjarg-rúnar
2 ein-falt við ǫlfum

tví-falt við trollum
4 þrí-falt við þ*ursum*

I carve remedy-runes, I carve rescue-runes:
onefold against elves,
twofold against trolls,
threefold against thurses.

---

1 bót-rúnar … bjarg-rúnar ‘remedy-runes … rescue-runes’ | Cf. *Sigrdr* 17/1.

**B** Við inni skǿðu · skag-val-kyrju
2 svá't ei megi · þó at ę́ vili
lę́-vís kona · lífi þínu g*randa*.

Against the scatheful shag-walkirrie,
so that she may not—though she for ever wants to,
that guile-wise woman—harm thy life.

**C** Ek sendir þér · ek sé á þér
2 ylgjar ergi · ok ó·þola;
á þér hríni ó·þoli · ok jǫtuns móð*r*;
4 sit-tu aldri, · sop-tu aldri.

I send to thee—I see on thee
a she-wolf's queerness and restlessness.
May restlessness stick on thee and an ettin's wrath!
Never sit, never sleep!

**D** Ant mér sem sjalfri þér.
2 **†Beirist rubus rabus et arantabus laus abus rosa gava†**

Love me like thyself.
…

---

2 **†Beirist rubus rabus et arantabus laus abus rosa gava†** ‘…’ | Latin-like gibberish.

## N B380

**Dating:** ?
**Meter:** Galders-lay

A short little charm explicitly invoking the two most important Heathen Gods, Thunder and Weden. The inscription postdates the official conversion of Norway by over a hundred years, and it is an open question whether the two mentioned gods were still seen in a good light or whether they had already been assimilated into the Catholic system of demons and devils. This question is important since it determines the context of the letter: was it well-wishing, assuming that the receiver was of like mind to the sender, or did he have more sinister intent than the first line lets on? Judging from the first line, and from the half-Heathen contents of many other inscriptions found at Bryggen (some from as late as the C14th), I see it as crypto-Heathen.

Hęill sé þú · ok í hugum góðum;
2 Þórr þik þiggi,
Óðinn þik ęigi.

Mayest thou be hale and in good spirits;
may Thunder receive thee,
may Weden own thee.

---

1 Hęill sé þú · ok í hugum góðum ‘Mayest thou be hale and in good spirits’ | A formulaic greeting. The very same line is found in *Hym* 41; see note there for parallels.

3 Óðinn þik ęigi ‘may Weden own thee’ | See note to *Vsp* 23.

# Runic Poetry

# Introduction to Runic Poetry

Not all poetry preserved in Runic inscriptions is included here. Magical inscriptions will be edited under Galders and the Runic version of the *Dream of the Rood* under Poetry on Christian Subjects.

Metrically the poetry is generally in Ancient-words-lay. A few fragments from Jutland are in Leeds-meter and two from Sweden are in Court-spoken meter.

# Introduction to the Rune Poems

## Runes and other European alphabets

The *runes* are the earliest recorded script for writing the Germanic languages and as such of great cultural importance. Runic inscriptions survive from all three Germanic branches: East Germanic, West Germanic, and North Germanic, and the script remained in unbroken use by Germanic speakers for a period spanning almost twenty centuries. The earliest known inscription is the stone from Hole, Norway (TODO: cite) from around 100 AD, and as late as the 19th century farmers in Dalarna, Sweden, were still using a form of runes to communicate with each other (TODO: cite).

Like the Latin or Greek the runes are an *alphabet*, which means that each symbol or letter stands for a phoneme or sound, rather than a syllable or an idea. The runes must ultimately derive from the Greek alphabet, which in turn derives from the Phoenician abjad, an adaptation of the Egyptian Hieroglyphs. The runes cannot be directly derived from the Greek

## The Rune poems

The order and names of the letters in the Runic alphabets or *futharks* stayed relatively consistent throughout the many centuries and countries in which they were used. This can probably be ascribed to the *rune poems*—poetic lists of the names of each rune with a short explanation, passed down orally as mnemonic devices to aid early Germanic learners who were doubtless far more accustomed to learn poems by heart than symbols and would greatly have profited from them in their gradual ascent to literacy.

Three such rune poems survive, from three countries: England, Norway, and Iceland. The English rune poem documents the English *futhorc*, while the Norwegian and Icelandic document the Scandinavian *younger futhark*.

When compared to the Common Germanic *elder futhark*, these two daughter scripts have taken opposing paths. Whereas the English futhorc has appended several letters for new vowels to the end of the rune row, the Scandinavian futhark has instead done away with numerous runes, namely those for *ng*, plosives *d, g, p*, the semi-vowel *w* and the vowels *o* and *e*, along with the obscure hook-shaped rune (TODO). That much of this simplification was

probably intentional, rather than the result of neglect or language change, is seen from the following facts.

First, several of the lost runes stood for sounds that did not undergo any major sound shifts in the North Germanic languages in the relevant time period. For instance, all modern Scandinavian dialects still clearly distinguish between the initial consonants in the descendants of *dagʀ* 'day' and *Týr* 'Tew', and most even have the same articulation of these consonants as modern English.

Second, in two archaic runic inscriptions we find clear proof that the names and sound values of some of the lost runes were still remembered and passed down even after the adoption of the simplified younger futhark. On the Swedish Rök stone (Ög 136), which is mostly composed in the younger futhark, runes of the elder futhark are used in a cipher, which works in the following way: Every younger futhark rune representing two distinct phonemes, where one of those was the sound value of that rune in the elder futhark system, and the other has been assimilated from a lost rune, is replaced by the elder futhark rune whose value it assimilated. For instance, the **k** rune, which in the elder futhark stood for only /k/, but which in the younger futhark stands for both /k/ and /g/, is replaced with the old **g** rune. A similar instance of two-scriptedness is found on the Ingelsta stone (Ög 43), where the old **d** rune is used in an otherwise younger futhark inscription, probably standing for its name *dagʀ* 'day', which is also attested as a male given name.

Third, there is virtually no regional variation in which runes disappear in the transition from elder to younger futhark. There is some variation in their shapes, but there is no region which, say, simplifies only the plosive consonants *t/d, k/g, b/p* > *t, k, b*, but retains the written distinction between *o* and *u*—they all go away at once.

These facts point away from neglect or a natural development of the script—they instead suggest deliberate reform. Since we lack historical sources, the motivations behind such a reform can only be guessed at, but making the script simpler may have been intended to increase literacy by making it easier to learn and faster to write. If this were the case it was certainly successful: the transition to the simplified younger futhark brings with it a huge increase in inscriptions in Scandinavia, along with interest in various ciphers, and a new tradition of inscribed stones in Denmark, where they were previously unknown.

This new system also quickly gave rise to even more simplified systems, like the "short-stave" runes found already on the C9th Rök stone, or the "staveless" runes known from northern Sweden. Both of these variants make it even faster to write on materials like wood, wax and bone; the runes also take up less space—very useful for carvers writing on limited surfaces.

In any case, the names of the runes seem to have survived these developments. Of the 16 runes found in both the English and Icelandic (which appears to be more conservative than the Norwegian) rune poems, 10—**f, r, h, n, i, j, s, b, m** and **l**—have etymologically identical names. Three of the remaining six—**þ, a** and **t**—in the Icelandic stand for words with clear Hea-

then associations—Thurse, Os, and Tew—and so may have been changed deliberately after the conversion of England, rather than lost in the process of oral transmission. Two more—**u** and **k**—have names which agree in form but not in meaning. Thus it is only for the old **ʀ**-rune where there is complete disagreement about the original name. This is easily understood, since the sound which that rune designated was lost in early Old English.

# The Old English Rune Poem

**Dating:** C8th–C10th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

The **Old English Rune Poem** (*RunOE*) is the oldest of the three old rune poems. It describes the 29 runes of the Anglo-Saxon Futhorc.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*RunOE* only survives in the printed edition of Hickes (1703–1705, vol. 1, pp. 135), based on the original manuscript which was certainly destroyed in the Cottonian fire of 1731.

Hickes introduces the poem with the following words (original emphasis kept): *E Codice MS. Bibliothecæ* Cottonianæ, *cujus nota, Otho, B. 10.* 'From a manuscript codex of the Cotton Library, whose shelfmark is Otho B. 10.'

TODO: Note on the visual layout. Cite Males article on Rune poems.

### Meter and stanza

The poem is divided into stanzas, one for each rune. Unlike the two Scandinavian rune-poems, the stanzaic structure of *RunOE* is somewhat uneven, and the stanzas vary in length between 2 and 5 lines. The most common length is 3 lines (19/29: 1–8, 11–14, 16–17, 23–24, 26–28), followed by 4 lines (7/29: 15, 18–22, 25). Rarer lengths are 2 lines (9–10) and 5 lines (29).

## Text

**1** (feoh) byþ frófur · fira ge·hwylcum.
2 Sceal ðeah manna ge·hwylc · miclun hyt dǽlan
gif he wile for drihtne · dómes hleotan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**2** (ur) byþ ân-mód · and ofer-hyrned,
fela-frécne deor, · feohteþ mid hornum,
mære mór-stapa; · þæt is módig wuht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**3** (ðorn) byþ ðearle scearp; · ðegna ge·hwylcum
an-feng ys yfyl, · un-ge·metun reþe
manna ge·hwylcun · ðe him mid resteð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**4** (os) byþ ord-fruma · ælcre spræce,
wís-dómes wraþu · and witena frofur,
and eorla ge·hwam · ead-nys and to·hiht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**5** (rad) byþ on recyde · rinca ge·hwylcum
sefte, and swiþ-hwæt · ðam ðe sitteþ on ufan
meare mægen-heardum · ofer míl-paþas.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**6** (cen) byþ cwicera ge·hwam · cúþ on fyre,
blac and beorht-líc, · byrneþ oftust
ðær hí æþelingas · inne restaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**7** (gyfu) gumena byþ · gleng and herenys,
wraþu and wyrþ-scype, · and wræcna ge·hwam
ar and ætwist · ðe byþ oþra leas.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**8** (wen) ne bruceþ · ðe can wéana lýt,
sâres and sorge, · and him sylfa hæfþ
bláed and blysse · and eac byrga ge·niht.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**9** (hægl) byþ hwítust corna; · hwyrft hit of heofones lyfte,
wealcaþ hit windes scura, · weorþeþ hit to wætere syððan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**10** (nyd) byþ nearu on breostan, · weorþeþ hi ðeah oft niþa bearnum
to helpe and to hæle ge·hwæþre, · gif hí his hlystaþ æror.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**11** (is) byþ ofer-ceald, · un-ge·metum slidor,
glisnaþ glæs-hluttur, · gimmum ge·licust,
flor forste ge·woruht, · fæger an-sýne.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**12** (ger) byþ gumena hiht, · ðon God læteþ,
hâlig heofones cyning, · hrusan syllan
beorhte bleda · beornum and ðearfum.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**13** (eoh) byþ utan · un-smeþe treow,
heard, hrusan fæst, · hyrde fyres,
wyrt-rumun under·wreþyd, · wynan on éþle.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**14** (peorð) byþ symble · plega and hlehter
[...] wlancum · ðar wigan sittaþ
on beor-sele · blíþe æt·somne.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**15** (eolhx)-secg eard hæfþ · oftust on fenne,
wexeð on wature, · wundaþ grimme,
blode breneð · beorna ge·hwylcne
ðe him ænigne · on-feng ge·deð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**16** (sigel) sé-mannum · symble biþ on hihte,
ðonn hi hine feriaþ · ofer fisces beþ,
oþ hí brim-hengest · bringeþ to lande.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**17** (tir) biþ tâcna sum, · healdeð trywa wel
wiþ æþelingas, · â biþ on færylde,
ofer nihta ge·nipu · næfre swiceþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**18** (beorc) byþ bleda leas, · bereþ efne swa ðeah
tânas b·útan tudder, · biþ on telgum wlitig,
heah on helme · hrysted fægere,
ge·loden leafum, · lyfte ge·tenge.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**19** (eh) byþ for eorlum · æþelinga wyn,
hors hófum wlanc, · ðær him hæleþe ymb,
welege on wicgum, · wrixlaþ spræce,
and biþ un-styllum · æfre frofur.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**20** (man) byþ on myrgþe · his magan leof;
sceal þeah ânra ge·hwylc · oðrum swícan,
for ðam dryhten wyle · dóme síne
þæt earme flæsc · eorþan be·tæcan.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**21** (lagu) byþ leodum · lang-sum ge·þuht,
gif hí sculun neþun · on nacan tealtum,
and hi sæyþa · swýþe bregaþ,
and se brim-hengest · bridles ne gymeð.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**22** (ing) wæs ǽrest · mid Éast-Dęnum
ge·sewen sęcgun, · oþ he siððan éast

ofer wæg ge·wât, · wæn æfter rann;
ðus heardingas · ðone hæle nęmdun.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**23** (eþel) byþ ofer-leof · æg·hwylcum men,
gif he mot ðǽr rihtes · and ge·rysena on
brúcan on blode · bleadum oftast.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**24** (dæg) byþ drihtnes sond, · deore mannum,
mære metodes leoht, · myrgþ and to·hiht
eadgum and earmum, · eallum brice.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**25** (ac) byþ on eorþan · ęlda bearnum
flæsces fódor, · fereþ ge·lome
ofer ganotes bæþ; · gâr-sęcg fandaþ
hwæþer âc hæbbe · æþele treowe.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**26** (æsc) biþ ofer-heah, · ęldum dýre,
stiþ on staþule, · stęde rihte hylt,
ðeah him feohtan on · fir*h*as mǫnige.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**27** (yr) byþ æþelinga · and eorla ge·hwæs
wyn and wyrþ-mynd, · byþ on wicge fæger,
fæst-lic on fær-elde, · fyrd-geatewa sum.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**28** (iar, ior) byþ éa-fixa, · and ðeah á bruceþ
fódres on foldan, · hafaþ fægerne eard,
wætre be·worpen, · ðær he wynnum leofaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

**29** (ear) byþ egle · eorla ge·hwylcun,
ðonn fæst-lice · flæsc on·ginneþ,
hraw colian, · hrusan ceosan
blac to ge·beddan; · bleda ge·dreosaþ,
wynna ge·witaþ, · wera ge·swicaþ.

TODO: TRANSLATION.

# The Icelandic Rune Poem

**Dating:** Mediaeval.
**Meter:** Unclear.

## Introduction

The **Icelandic Rune Poem** (*RunIce*) is one of two West Norse rune poems describing the Younger Futhark.

### Textual preservation and transmission

*RunIce* is preserved in several manuscripts, none mediaeval. The oldest is AM 687 d 4to (henceforth 687d), dating to ca. 1500 AD, where the poem takes up the leaf 1v. In this ms. each rune takes up one line. The names of the runes are not given, but the name is written out by the rune, so that the first stanza begins ᚠ *er fręnda róg*, the second ᚢ *er skýgia grátur*, and so forth. 687d/1v is not physically fragmented, but much of the ink has faded and large parts of thep oem are therefore illegible.

TODO. It is only attested in late manuscripts which often have major disagreements with each other.

### Meter and stanza

The meter of *RunIce* is a divergent form of Leeds-meter. In particular, the a-verse always contains three lifts (certainly owing to the obligatory rune-name), and the c-verse may end in a dip following a heavy lift. The poem is strictly structured. Each rune is given two lines, the first consisting of two half-verses (the a- and b-verse), the second being a form of c-verse. These two lines will henceforth be referred to as stanzas.

### Style and contents

Like in the two other rune poems, the 16 runes in *RunIce* are described by reference to the object to which their name refers (*fé* 'wealth' for ᚠ, etc.). Like its Scandinavian sister-poem *RunNor*, *RunIce* uses kennings to describe these

objects. Numerous such kennings are shared, sometimes word-for-word, between the two. Like in the two other rune poems, the very first word in each stanza is the respective rune's name, which is a noun. The name is then followed by exactly three kennings, one in each verse.

TODO: reference Mikael Males article about rune poems

## Text

**1** Fé es frękda róg · ok flóðar viti
2 ok graf-sękiðs gata.

Wealth is strife of kinsmen and beacon of the flood
and grave-saithe's [SERPENT's] street.

---

1 frękda róg 'strife of kinsmen' | Self-explanatory; wealth causes conflict between heirs. The same expression is found in *RunNor*.

1 flóðar viti 'beacon of the flood' | A formulaic type of GOLD-kenning (TODO: (Meissner 1921)); since gold does not rust, it is the fire which shines when submerged in water.

2 graf-sękiðs gata 'grave-saithe's [SERPENT's] street' | Another formulaic kenning. The serpent or Wyrm that lies upon its hill of treasures is a prominent image in Old Germanic legend; cf. particularly Fathomer (*Reg*, *Fáfn*, and *Vǫls*) and the unnamed dragon in *Beow*.

**2** Úr es skýja grátr · ok skára þverrir
2 ok hirðis hatr.

Drizzle is weeping of clouds and ...
and shepherd's hatred.

**3** Þurs es kvenna kvǫl · ok kletta í·búi
2 ok varð-rúnar verr.

Thurse is women's torment and indweller of hills
and husband of the cairn-whisperess [TROLLWOMAN].

**4** Ǫss es aldinn gautr · ok Ǫs·garðs jǫfurr,
2 ok Val-hallar vísi.

Os is ancient Geat, and Osyard's chief,
and Walhall's overseer.

**5** Rękið es sitjandi sękla · ok snúðig fęrð
2 ok jós ęrfiði.

Chariot is sitting bliss and twirling journey
and horse's heavy work.

**6** Kaun es barna bǫl · ok bar-dagi
2 ok hold-fúa hús.

Boil is children's curse and TODO
and house of flesh-rot.

**7** Hagall es kalda korn · ok knappa drífa
2 ok snáka sótt.

Hail is cold kernel and storm of beads
and sickness of snakes.

**8** Nauð es þýjar þrǫ · ok þungr kostr
2 ok vás-samlig verk.

Need is maidservant's yearning and scant choice
and working in wet-cold weather.

**9** Íss es áar bǫrkr · ok unnar þękja
2 ok fęigra manna fár.

Ice is river's bark and wave's roof
and fey men's danger.

**10** Ár es gumna góði · ok gótt sumar
2 *ok* al-gróinn akr.

Year is men's boon and good summer
(and) all-grown acre.

**11** Sól es skýja skjǫldr · ok skínandi rǫðull
2 ok ísa aldr-tregi.

Sun is the shield of clouds and shining wheel
and ice-sheets' life-sorrow.

**12** Týr es ęin-hęndr ǫss · ok ulfs lęifar
2 ok hofa hilmir.

Tew is the one-handed Os and the wolf's leftovers

and lord of hoves.

**13** Bjarkan es laufgat lim · ok lítit tré
2 ok ung-samligr viðr.

Birch is leafy branch and little tree
and youthful wood.

**14** Maðr es manns gaman · ok moldar auki
2 ok skipa skreytir.

Man is man's joy and the product of dust
and adorner of ships.

**15** Lǫgr es vellanda vatn · ok víðr kętill
2 ok glǫmmungr grund.

Liquid is boiling water and wide kettle
and TODO.

**16** Ýr es bęndr bogi · ok brot-gjarnt járn
2 ok fęnju fleygir.

Yew is a bent bow and easily broken iron
and arrow's hurler.

# The Norwegian Rune Poem

**Dating:** Mediaeval.
**Meter:** Unclear.

## Introduction

The **Norwegian rune poem** (*RunNor*) is one of two West Norse rune poems describing the 16 runes of the Younger Futhark.

### Textual preservation and transmission

TODO.

### Style and contents

*RunNor* is closely related to *RunIce*, which also describes the Younger Futhark. With the exception of runes 2 (ᚢ, here *úr* 'spark') and 4 (ᚬ, here *óss* 'river-mouth'), the names of the runes are identical between them, as are many of the poetic expressions.

The description of all runes consists of two clauses or sentences, generally one in each verse. The first clause gives the name of the rune and a short description of it, while the second clause is more tangential and oftentimes seems to have nothing to do with the name. A clever solution to this problem is that the second clause connects to the visual shape of the rune (TODO: cite). For some of the runes, this turns out to be a rewarding line of inquiry, and potential links between the shape of a rune and the second clause will be explored in the notes.

### Meter

Each rune is described by a couplet of 2 verses linked by both end-rhyme and alliteration. The meter is noticeably trochaic, and the end-rhyme of each verse always falls on a trochée. In 15 out of 16 lines, the a-verse has 2 alliterations. The b-verse always has exactly 1 alliteration, falling on its very first word.

## Language

The language is unmistakably that of mediaeval Norway. As can be seen from the rhymes and alliteration the following uniquely Norwegian sound changes have occurred:

- *hl, hn, hr* > *l, n, r* (2 *lęypr* < *hlęypr*; 8 *nęppa* < *hnęppa*; 5 *rossum* < *hrossum*).
- *rst* > *st* (5 *vęsta* < *vęrsta*)

## Text

**1** Fé vęldr frękenda rógi; · fǫðisk ulfr í skógi.

'Wealth' causes the strife of kinsmen; the wolf rears itself in the wood.

1 fǫðisk ulfr í skógi 'the wolf rears itself in the wood' | Almost certainly visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the upwards curving branches of the pine tree; the keyword is *skógr* 'wood, forest'.

**2** Úr er af ęldu jarni; · opt lęypr ręinn á hjarni.

'Spark' comes from glowing iron; oft leaps the reindeer on the snow.

1 Úr 'Spark' | Properly 'drizzle', but here used metaphorically for the sparks or tiny particles of hot metal that flow out of burning iron when struck.

1 opt lęypr ręinn á hjarni 'oft leaps the reindeer on the snow' | Likely visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the hoof-print of a reindeer in the snow; the keyword is *ręinn* 'reindeer'.

**3** Þurs vęldr kvinna kvillu; · kátr verðr fár af illu.

'Thurse' causes women's ailment; few are gladdened by evil.

1 kátr verðr fár af illu 'few are gladdened by evil' | Lit. 'few a man becomes glad from evil'. Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a smiling face; the keyword is *kátr* 'glad, happy'.

**4** Óss er flęstra fęrða · fǫr, en skalpr er sverða.

'River-mouth' is the route of most journeys, but the scabbard-mouth of swords.

1 en skalpr er sverða 'but the scabbard-mouth of swords' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a sword in its scabbard, although that is uncertain.

**5** Ręið kveða rossum vęsta; · Ręginn sló sverð'it bęsta.

'Chariot' they say is worst for the horses; Rein forged the best sword.

**6** Kaun er barna bǫlvan; · bǫl gørvir ná fǫlvan.

'Ulcer' is the curse of children; a bale makes a corpse pale.

**7** Hagall er kaldastr korna; · Kristr skóp hęim'inn forna.

'Hail' is coldest of kernels; Christ created the world of yore.

1 Kristr skóp hęim'inn forna 'Christ created the world of yore' | Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the chi-rho; the keyword is *Kristr* 'Christ'.

**8** Nauðr gørir nęppa kosti; · nøktan kęlr í frosti.

'Need' gives scant choice; the naked man freezes in the cold.

---

1 nøktan kęlr í frosti 'the naked man freezes in the cold' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the human body in the form of a naked stick-figure; the keyword is *nøktr* 'naked'.

**9** Ís kǫllum brú bręiða; · blindan þarf at lęiða.

'Ice' we call a broad bridge; the blind man must be lead.

---

1 blindan þarf at lęiða 'the blind man must be lead' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and a blind man's cane or walking stick; the keyword is *blindr* 'blind'.

**10** Ár er gumna góði; · get'k at ǫrr var Fróði.

'Year' is men's boon; I recall that Frood was generous.

---

1 get'k at ǫrr var Fróði 'I recall that Frood was generous' | Frood, or as he is often known, Frith-Frood (ON *frið-Fróði*), was a legendarily generous Danish king during whose reign good harvests and peace (*ár ok friðr* 'year and frith') abounded. He is thus mentioned due to his connection with the rune's name, not due to any visual elements of the rune.

**11** Sól er landa ljómi; · lúti'k hęlgum dómi.

'Sun' is the light of the lands; I bow to the holy shrine.

---

1 lúti'k hęlgum dómi 'I bow to the holy shrine' | Visually alluding to the similarity between the rune and the shape of a kneeling man; the keyword is *lúti'k* 'I bow'.

**12** Týr er ęin-ęndr ása; · opt verðr smiðr blása.

'Tew' is the one-handed of the Eese; often the smith must blow.

---

1 opt verðr smiðr blása 'often the smith must blow' | Perhaps visually alluding to the similarity between the shape of the rune and a hammer; the keyword is *smiðr* 'smith'.

**13** Bjarkan er lauf-grønstr lima; · Loki bar flęrða tíma.

'Birch' is the leaf-greenest of branches; Lock was successful in cunning.

**14** Maðr er moldar auki; · mikil er grǫip á hauki.

'Man' is the product of dust; mighty is the grip on the hawk.

---

1 mikil er grǫip á hauki 'mighty is the grip on the hawk' | Visually alluding to the shape of the bird's talon; the keyword is *haukr* 'hawk'.

**15** Lǫgr er þar er fęllr ór fjalli · foss; en gull eru nossir.

'Water' is when from the fell falls a torrent, but jewels are gold.

**16** Ýr er vetr-grønstr viða; · vęnt er, er brennr, at sviða.

'Yew' is winter-greenest of trees; 'tis expected, when it burns, to get singed.

# Runic Poetry from Sweden and Gotland

## Introduction

The inscriptions are sorted according to their runological signa as found in the Scandinavian Runic-text Data Base (SRDB). For most inscriptions the signum derives from the standard corpus edition *Sveriges runinskrifter* ('Runic inscriptions of Sweden') and consists of two elements, the abbreviated traditional province and the number given in the corpus edition. For example Sm 39 is the inscription given number 39 in the Småland volume of *Sveriges runinskrifter*.

Inscriptions discovered after the publication of the corpus edition describing the relevant province have instead of the number an abbreviated bibliographical reference to the *editio princeps*. For example Sö Fv1948;289 is a inscription from Södermanland first published in the 1948 volume of *Fornvännen*, page 289.

The province of Scania, although part of Sweden since 1658, was in the Wiking Age and the mediaeval period an integral part of Denmark and as such its metrical inscriptions are found under Runic poetry from Denmark below.

### Abbreviations of Swedish provinces

- G = Gotland
- Nä = Närke
- Sm = Småland
- Sö = Södermanland
- U = Uppland
- Vg = Västergötland
- Vs = Västmanland

- Ög = Östergötland
- Öl = Öland

## G 113 (Ardre)

**Dating:** C12th
**Location:** Ardre church
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A picture stone. The palatal ʀ has in several places been restored for the stone's **r**.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A ÷ **utar + ak + kaiʀuatr + ak + aiuatr + þaʀ + setu + stain + ebtir + likna(t) + faþur ÷ sen +**
§ B ÷ **raþialbr + ak + kaiʀaiau(t)- + þaiʀ kiarþu + merki + kuþ + ubtir + man + saaran ÷ likraibr + risti + runaʀ ÷**

### Text

**A** Ótt·arr ok Gaiʀ·hvatr ok Ai·hvatr þa*iʀ* sęttu stain ęptiʀ Líkn·*hv*at, faður sinn.

Oughter and Garwhat and Eanwhat, they set the stone after Likenwhat, their father.

**B** Ráð·þialfʀ ok Gaiʀ·*n*iaut*r*,
þaiʀ giǫrðu męrki góð · ęptiʀ mann snaran.
Líkn·raifʀ rísti rúnaʀ.

Redthelf and Garneat,
they made good landmarks after a swift man.
Likenraf carved the runes.

## G 188

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A damaged and unusually difficult stone to interpret. Most of the inscription survives only in older depictions which are likely not entirely faithful.

### Runes

ᚱᛁᚦᛏ + ᛘᛁᚦᚱᚾᛏᚢᛦ
ᛒᛁᚾ + ᛋᛁᚾᚠᚢᛦ
TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[... auk × botaiþr × þaun litu × raisa s... ... haito × mirki mirlakt eftir man koþ-n · kiarn uaʀ × hann arla × a × kuþ troa × rumshafþ ×] raþ(e)t × miþ r(e)tu m[iug × tyrlak × ta · ta × uam · la · reksþe... ...](b)in × sialu h-... [lit × kiarþi stain × uataruek...]**

### Text

... auk Bót·aiðr, þaun létu raisa s*tain* **†haito†**
męrki mér-lekt · ęptiʀ mann góðan;
giarn vaʀ hann árla · á Guð tróa.
**†rumshafþ†** ráðit með réttu
miuk dýr-lek **†ta:ta:uam:la:reksþe†**
... *hial*pin siálu h*ans*.
**†lit†** giarði stain **†uataruek†**

... and Bootheath they had the stain raised ...
A glorious landmark after a good man.
He was early eager to believe in God;
... rightly interpreted,
very glorious ...
... help his soul.
... made the stone ...

---

1 þaun 'they' | The neuter pl. form indicates that the raisers are a mixed-sex group.

## G 203 (Hogräns)

**Dating:** C12th
**Location:** Hogräns church
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**sigmutr let rasa sain eftiʀ bruþr : sina : auk : bro : kierua : eftiʀ : sikbiern : santa mikal hie[lbi] ... ...ans auk : at : botraif auk at sigraif : auk : at aibiern : faþur þaiʀa : altr : auk bikui han : i by : sunarst kaiʀuiþr lekþi ormaluʀ nemʀ : in[t]i uʀ ¶ sikmutr [--fiʀ :] sliku : unit kuml ¶ karmanum : þet aʀ [:] ... kun : hier : mun : stanta stain : a[t] : merki bietr a : bierki in bro furiʀ ¶ roþ(b)iern risti run(i)ʀ [þ]esa kaiʀl-ifʀ sumaʀ aʀ karla kan**

### Text

Sig·mundr lét raisa stain eptiʀ brýðr sína, auk bró gierva eptiʀ Sig·biern—Sankta Mikál hielpi *siál h*ans—auk at Bót·raif auk at Sig·raif auk at Ai·biern, faður þaiʀa aldra,

Syemund had this stone raised after his brothers and the bridge made after Syebarn—may Saint Michael help his soul—and after Bootraf and after Syeraf and after Eanbarn, the father of them all,

2 auk byggvi hann · í bý sunnarst.

and he lived on the southernmost farm.

Gaiʀviðr lęgði orm-áluʀ; némʀ innti ýʀ.

Garwith laid the serpent-tracks; TODO.

4 Sig·mundr *hefiʀ* · s·líku unnit
kuml karl-mannum. · Þet aʀ †ke...† kunn.
6 Hier mun standa · stainn at merki,

bier*r*tr á biergi, · en bró fyriʀ;
Róð·biern rísti · rúniʀ *þ*essaʀ,
Gaiʀ·l*a*ifʀ sumaʀ, · aʀ garla kann.

Syemund has suchwise accomplished
a monument for men; that is known to ...
Here the stone will stand as a mark,
bright on the hill and the bridge below.
Rothbarn carved these runes,
[and] Garlaf, who knows clearly, some.

## G 207

**Dating:** C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A damaged stone. TODO. The same people also commissioned the likewise damaged G 208 below.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**butmuntr : auk : butraifʀ : auk : kunu[-r : þaiʀ : raistu : stain ...arþi : karþ] : auk : sunarla : sat : miþ : skinum : auk : han : entaþis : at : ulfshala : þa : [¶ han : hil(k)(i)...]**

### Text

Bót·mundr auk Bót·raifʀ auk Gunn·*hvat*r, þaiʀ raistu stain ...
2 **†arþi†** garð,
auk sunnar-la · sat mið skinnum;
4 auk hann endaðis · at Ulfs-hala,
þá hann **†hil(k)(i)†** ...

Bootmund and Bootraf and Guthwhat, they raised the stone ... the enclosure,
and in the south sat with skins,
and he met his end by Wolfshale
when he ...

## G 208

**Dating:** C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A damaged stone. TODO. The same people also commissioned the likewise damaged G 207 above.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[b]u[t]muntr : auk : butraifʀ : auk : kunua-(r) [: -]... ...tu : stain : þ... ... ...[at : faþur : si]n : kuþ : h(i)albi : (s)elu : hans : auk : kus : muþiʀ : (b)etr : þen : uiʀ : biþia : kunin · ¶ -(a)... ...(a)-(n) (:)**

### Text

Bot·mundr ok Bót·raifʀ ok Gunn*hv*a*t*r *þaiʀ rais*tu stain þ*enna eptiʀ* ... *-hv*at, faður sinn.
2 Guð hialpi sélu hans · ok Guðs móðiʀ
betr þen víʀ · biðja kunnin ...

Bootmund and Bootraf and Guthwhat, they raised this stone in memory of ...-what, their father.
God help his soul and God's mother,
better than we were able to pray. ...

## G 343

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **...n : raisti : kubl : eftiʀ : hailkaiʀ : fa... ... ¶ (k)-... ... -aulu : hans : eu : miþan : uaralt : uakiʀ : ligʀ : merki : hier : yfiʀ : mani : þaim : aʀ : erfiki : iftiʀ -erþi ¶ ... auk : þorlaifʀ : þau/þaiʀ : ristu stain**
§ B **f------...**

### Text

... raisti kumbl eftiʀ Hail·gaiʀ, faðu*r* ... *s*áulu hans.
Ęy, miðan ver-ald vakiʀ,
liggʀ męrki hięr · yfiʀ manni þaim,
aʀ ęrfingi · ęptiʀ *gi*ęrði.
... auk Þór·laifʀ, þau rístu stain.

TODO: trans

## G 370

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**uatar : auk hilkaiʀ : raistu : stain iftir hailka f-þur : sin : hn : uahʀ -istr : farin miþ uikikum**

### Text

*H*vatarr ok H*a*il·gaiʀ raistu stain ęptiʀ Hailga, f*a*ður sinn.
2 Hann vaʀ *v*estr farinn · með víkingum.

TODO: trans

## Nä 29

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**bofriþr : let resa eftir biurn : bruþur : si(n) : han uar farin fultrekila**

### Text

Bó·friðr lét rêsa ęptiʀ Biorn, bróður sinn.
2 Hann var farinn · full-drękgi=la.

TODO: trans

## Sm 5

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO. The carver seems to struggle with consonant clusters. Thus he spells 2b *mestr* as **mesr** and 3b *aldri* as **ali**(!). Line 2 is found near-identically in Ög 77 and Sm 37 and line 3 in Vg 187.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **: kotr : sati : sten : þana : eftʀ : ketil :**
§ B **: sun : sin : han : faʀ :**
§ C **: mana : mesr o:niþikʀ : eʀ a : eklati : ali : tunþi**

### Text

Gôtr satti stên þęnna eptiʀ Kętil sun sinn.
2 Hann vaʀ manna · mestr ȯ·níðingʀ
eʀ á Eng-landi · a*ldr*i týnði.

Geat set this stone after Kettle, his son.
He was of men the greatest un-nithing,
who in England lost his life.

3 a*ldr*i | **ali** Sm 5

2 mestr ȯ·níðingʀ 'greatest un-nithing' | An instance of *litotes*; Kettle was a very virtuous man.

## Sm 16

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A not very tall stone, inscribed on two sides. Side A (1 *Hró·stęinn* ... 3 *kęnni=ligt*) is marked with a large cross while side B (3 *ęptir* ... 5 *rùna*) is entirely unadorned.

The inscription uses the stung runes *e* and *y* and writes the vowel *o* with the old *ą*-rune.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **rostein · auk · eilifʀ · aki : auk · hakun : reisþu · þeiʀ · sueinaʀ · eftiʀ sin · ¶ faþur · kubl ¶ keni·likt ·**
§ B **ftiʀ · kala · tauþan : þy : mun · ko... ... -m kitit · uerþa · meþ · sin · lifiʀ · auk · stafiʀ · run**

### Text

Hró·stęinn auk Ęi·lífʀ, · Åki auk Hǫ́·kun,
ręistu þęiʀ svęinaʀ · ęptiʀ sinn fǫður
kumbl kęnni=ligt · ęptiʀ Kala dauðan.
Þý mun góðs *manns* · *u*m getit verða,
með st*ę*inn lifiʀ · ok stafiʀ rùn*a*.

Rothstan and Anlif, Onick and Hathkin,
these lads raised after their father
a remarkable monument, after the dead Cale.
Therefore will the good man be spoken of
while the stone lives and the staves of the runes.

## Sm 29

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**...r · rsþi · stin · eftiʀ · þur(k)iʀ · faþur · sin · saʀ · (e)(t)aþis · ą · -klanti ·**

### Text

...r rêsþi stên ęptiʀ Þór·gêʀ, fǫður sinn;
2 sáʀ ęndaðis · à *Ę*nglandi.

... raised the stone after Thurgar, his father.
He met his end in England.

## Sm 35 (Replösa)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A stone still standing at its original location. To its south stands a stone ship consisting of 12 stones.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: kutraþr : karþi : kubl : þisi : iftiʀ : astraþ : faþur : sin : þan : frita : ak : þih:na : bistan : iʀ a : fin:iþi : forþum : uf| |faʀi :**

### Text

Gaut·ráðr gęrði kumbl þęssi ęptiʀ Ǫst·ráð, fǫður sinn.
2 þann frędnda · ok þegna bętstan, eʀ á Finn·ęiði · forðum of váʀi.

Geatred made these monuments after Estred, his father,
the best of kinsmen and of thanes
who erstwhile lived upon the Finnheath.

---

2 Finn·ęiði 'the Finnheath' | Finnveden, the folkland of Smalland in which the stone is located.

## Sm 37 (Rörbro)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

Sm 37 is a stone still standing at its original location, Rörbro in Nöttja parish in the Finnheath. The inscription is tied to the non-metrical Sm 36, which stands just 1.5 km south of Sm 37, also at its original location.

Sm 36 is raised by an Eanwind (**uintʀ**) and Swain (*Sveinn*) in memory of another Answer (**ąsmr**), but we are here met with a problem, since it is obviously not possible for two men to posthumously raise runestones for each other. Assuming that Swain and Eanwind of Sm 36 were the sons of Answer (something which, though likely, is not stated explicitly), there are two likely explanations, both of which require a son named after his grandfather: (1) Answer I fathered Eanwind and Swain, who raised Sm 36 first. Eanwind fathered Answer II, who later raised Sm 37 after him. (2) Eanwind I was the father of Answer, who raised Sm 37 first in memory of him. Answer in turn fathered Eanwind II and Swain, who later raised Sm 36 in memory of their father.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[:] a[sur] · karþi : kubl : þesi : eftiʀ : uit : faþur : sin · [h]an uaʀ : mana : mestr : uniþikʀ [:] uaʀ : i[n]tr : mataʀ : uk umun hats : kuþr · þi(k)[n] kus tru : kuþa : hafþi :**

### Text

Ǫssurr gęrði kumbl þęssi ęptiʀ Ęy*n*d, fǫður sinn.
Hann vaʀ manna · męstr ȯ·níðingʀ,
vaʀ yndr mataʀ · ok ȯ·mun*ʀ* hatrs.
Góðr þegn Guðs-tró · góða hafði.

Answer made these monuments after Eanwind, his father.
He was of men the greatest un-nithing,
was giving with food and late to hatred.
The good thane had good faith in God.

## Sm 39

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on two sides, one of which has a large cross. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, U 739, and U 805. For "good of meat" cf. *Háv* 39. The first line is not poetic.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **: kuni : sati : stin : þana : iftiʀ**
§ B **: suna : faþr : sin : milan : u... ... mataʀ kuþa... :**

### Text

Gunni satti stên þęnna eptiʀ Sùna, fǫður sinn,
2 mil*d*an o*rða* · *auk* mataʀ góða*n*.

Guthe set this stone after Sown, his father,
generous in words and good of meat.

## Sm 44

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A heavily damaged stone. The inscription is more visible in Bautil on which the reading has to rely. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sö 130, U 703, U 739, and U 805.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **[: uim]ut[r] : [sa]ti : sten : þana ...**
§ B **[b]ruþr : s[in ...(i)n mi(l)... ... sina] ...**
§ A **m[a]tʀ : kuþan : [i] urþ[l]uf:i : at[ra : m...r]**

### Text

Vé·mundr satti stên þęnna *ęptir* bróður sinn ...**in**
2 mil*dan við* sinna · *ok* mataʀ góðan,
ï orð-lofi · *all*ra m*iklu*.

Wighmund set this stone after his brother, ...,
generous with his kin and good of meat,
held in great praise by all.

---

1 ...**in** '...' | The name of the brother cannot be restored, but the gap only leaves room for at most two runes, and so the main candidate names are Swayn (***suin** *Svéinn*) and Stan (***stin** *Stéinn*).

## Sm 45

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**· uest-n · karþ- · (k)ub- · þesi · eftɛʀ · esburn · bruþur · sin · uitrik · þesi · a uiki·muti**

### Text

Vé·stęinn gęrðʼi kumbʼl þęssi ęptiʀ Ėȩs·biorn, bróður sinn,
2 vitring þęssi · à vega-móti.

Wighstan made these monuments after Osbarn, his brother,
this memento at the crossroads.

## Sm 46

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.
The stone is lost.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[...-nui krþi : kubl : þesi : iftiʀ suin : sun : sin : im ÷ itaþisk ou·tr i krikum]**

### Text

...n·ví gęrði kumbl þęssi ęptiʀ Svên, sun sinn,
2 eʀ ęndaðisk · austr í Grikkjum.

...wye made these monuments after Swayn, her son,
who met his end to the east in Greece.

## Sm 60

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A · **sen · uk u·starki · karþu ·**
§ B · **kubl · þesi · efeiʀ · kuþmut · faþur · sin · uitrk · þasi · ą ueha·muti ·**

### Text

S*v*ênn ok Ȯ·starki gęrðu kumbl þęssi ęptiʀ Guð·mund, fǫður sinn,
2 vitring þási · á vega-móti.

Swayn and Unstark made these monuments after Godmund, their father, this memento at the crossroads.

## Sö 9 (Lifsinge)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**barkuiþr × auk × þu : helka × raistu × stain × þansi : at · ulf : sun · sin · han × entaþis + miþ : ikuari + ¶ kuþ + hialbi + salu ulfs ×**

### Text

Bark·viðr ok þau Hęlga ręistu stęin þannsi at Ulf, sun sinn.
2 Hann ęndaðis · með Ing·vari.
Guð hialpi sǫlu Ulfs.

TODO

## Sö 14 (Gåsinge)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

The stone mentions a western expedition led by Cnut, most likely King Canute (Wessén 1960). Other stones that mention this expedition are the non-metrical Ög 111 (see Ög 68 below), U 194, U 241, and U 344.

TODO: specific page reference in Wessén 1960.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**rakna · raisti · stain · þansi · at · suin · buta · sit · auk · sifa · auk · r-knburk · at · sit · faþur · kuþ · hil[b]i · at · [hat]s · uit · iak · þet · uaʀ · sui- · uestr · miþ · kuti**

### Text

Ragna rǫisti stǫin þannsi at Svǫin, bónda sinn, auk Sefa auk Ragn·borg at sinn fǫður. Guð hialpi and hans.

2 Vǫit iak þǫt vaʀ Svǫinn · vestr með K*n*úti.

Rainie raised this stone after Swayn, her husband, and Seve and Rainbury after their father. God help his spirit.

I know that Swayn was in the west with Cnut.

## Sö 33

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**+ gnubha ÷ liþ : raisa : stain : þinsa : hibtiʀ : kulaif : bruþur sin ¶ han : antaþis : austr : at þikum**

### Text

Gnúpa lét rǫisa stǫin þǫnnsa ǫptiʀ Gullǫif, bróður sinn.
Hann ǫndaðis · austr at þingum.

TODO: trans

## Sö 34–35 (Tjuvstigen)

**Dating:** C11th–C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

Sö 34 and 35 are two paired stones standing next to each other. They are carved in the same style and the inscription on Sö 35 refers back to SÖ 34. The last two lines of Sö 35 is not poetic.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

Sö 34: **styrlaugʀ · auk · hulmbʀ · staina · raistu · at · bryþr · sina · brau(t)u · nesta · þaiʀ · entaþus · i · austruiki · þurkil · auk sturbiarn þiaknaʀ · kuþiʀ**
Sö 35: **lit · igikeʀ · anan · raisa · stain · at · suni · sina · su[n·]a · kiarþi · kuþ · hialbi · ant · þaira × þuriʀ · hiu ·**

### Text

**Sö 34**

Styr·laugʀ ok Holmbʀ · stęina ręistu
at bróðr sĭna, · brautu nęsta.
Þęir ęndaðus · ĭ austr-vegi,
Þór·kęll ok Styr·biǫrn, · þiagnar góðir.

Sturley and Holm raised the stones
after their brothers, nearest to the road.
They met their end in the Eastern way,
Thurkettle and Sturbarn, good thanes.

2 brautu nęsta 'nearest to the road' | Namely the forest path where the stones still stand. Note the similar wording in *Háv* 72/3–4.

**Sö 35**

Lét Ingi·gęiʀʀ · annan ręisa stęin
at syni sĭna, · sỳna giǫrði.
Guð hialpi ǫnd þęira.

4 Þórir hjó.

Inggar let another stone be raised
after his sons; he made it seen.
God help their spirit.
Thurgar hewed.

## Sö 41

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**tati + iok + eftiʀ + faþur + sin × skaka × mirki| |it + mikla + man + (i)auʀn**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 47

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**...(ʀ)-kʀ : kiarþi : kuml : þat:si : eftiʀ : ąsmunt : sun : sin + han : is : krafin : ą · ku... <rauʀ> : <uart/fart> : at : ryʀ:iks : sun**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 54

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **þurstain : auk : aystain : auk : natfari : raistu : stain : at : finuiþ : auk : ulif : þurkil buruþr sin ¶ uaru · aliʀ · uikiks · suniʀ ¶ latburniʀ · man · litu · rita · stain**
§ B **stainkil · rist · runaʀ**

### Text

Þòr·stęinn auk Ęy·stęinn auk Nátt·fari ręistu stęin at Finn·við auk Ò·lęif, Þòr·kęl, bróðr sĭn*a*.
Vǫ́ru alliʀ · Víkings syniʀ;
land-burniʀ męnn · létu rétta stęin.
Stęin·kęll ręist rúnaʀ.

Thurstan and Eanstan and Nightfarer raised the stone after Finnwood and Anlaf [and] Thurkettle, their brothers.
They were all the sons of Wiking;
land-born men had the stone erected.
Stankettle carved the runes.

## Sö 55 (Bjudby)

**Dating:** C11th
**Location:** Bjudby, Blacksta parish, Oppunda hundred
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

The language is later than most other England stones. The os-rune is used for /o/, palatal ʀ has dropped after all consonants, and stung *e* is used.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þorstain (l)(i)... ...sa : stain : þena : ... sik : sialfan : auk : sun : sin : hefni : uaʀ til : enklans : ukr : trenkr : farin : uarþ : þa · haima : at : harmi tauþr ¶ kuþ hialbi : sialu : þaima ¶ bruni : auk : sloþi : þaiʀ ...(u) stan þena**

### Text

Þòr·stęinn *lét rę*i*s*a stęin þęnna *ęptiʀ* sik sialfan auk sun sinn Hęfni.
Vaʀ til Ęng·lands · ungr dręngr farinn,
varð þà hęima · at harmi dauðr.
Guð hialpi sialu þęiʀa.
Brúni auk Slóði þęiʀ *rist*u stęin þęnna.

Thurstan had this stone raised after himself and his son Hefner.
To England had the young dreng travelled,
then at home he died tragically.
God help their souls.
Brown and Sloth they carved this stone.

## Sö 56 (Fyrby)

**Dating:** C11th–C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**iak · uait : hastain : þa : hulmstain : bryþr · menr : rynasta : a : miþkarþi : setu : stain : auk : stafa : marga eftiʀ · fraystain · faþur · sin ·**

### Text

Iak vęit Há·stęin · þá Holm·stęin bróðr
męnnr rýnasta · á Mið·garði
sęttu stęin · auk stafa marga
eptir Frey·stęin · fǫður sinn.

I know Highstan and Holmstan, the brothers,
the most rune-cunning men in Middenyard.
They set the stone and many staves
after Freastan, their father.

## Sö 61

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þorstain : lit · þina : rita : stain : e(f)ila : stetr : eftiʀ : þorbiarn : salui · auk : simiþr : at · sen boroþur**

### Text

Þórr·stęinn lét · þęnna rétta
stęin; ęfila · stęndr ęptiʀ Þórr·biorn.
Sǫlvi auk Smiðr · at sinn bróður.

Thurstan let erect this stone;
fittingly it stands after Thurbarn.
Sallow and Smith [raised it] after their brother.

## Sö 65 (Djulefors)

**Dating:** C11th–C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay with hendings in the b-verses

### Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side with a large cross. Already on the earliest depictions the stone was damaged, but an even larger part has now gone missing. Other stones that mention Longbeardland (Lombardy, northern Italy) are the paired U 133 and U 141; it may also be mentioned on Sö Fv1954;22, although only the first two letters **la** survive.

The meter is highly unusual for runic Swedish poetry by its reliance on hendings (in line 2 an ethel-hending *arð- : barð-*, in line 3 a shot-hending *land- : ęnd-*). Although unparallelled in Sweden, the meter is documented by Snorre (TODO).

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[inka : raisti : stain : þansi : at : ulai](f) : sin : [a...k] : han : austarla : arþi : barþi : auk : ą : lakbarþilanti : [anlaþis +]**

### Text

Inga ręisti stęin þannsi at Ȯ·lęif sinn **a...k**.
2 Hann austar=la · arði barði
auk á Lang-barði- · landi an*d*aðis.

Inge raised this stone after Anlaf, her ...
Easterly he ploughed with the prow,
and in Longbeardland met his end.

---

2 arði barði ‘ploughed with the prow’ | I.e. ‘sailed’. The same verse is found in an anonymous Lay-meter-line from the Third Grammatical Treatise (Anon (*TGT*) 14 in SkP 3), which reads: *sá's af Ís-landi · arði barði* ‘he who [away] from Iceland ploughed with the prow’.

## Sö 85

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: ansuar : auk : ern... ... [: faþur sin : han : enta]þis : ut i : krikum (r)uþr : ---...unk------an-----**

### Text

Ansvarr ok Ęrn..., fǫður sinn.
2 Hann ęndaðis · út ĩ Grikkum.
**†…(r)uþr:…unk…an…†**

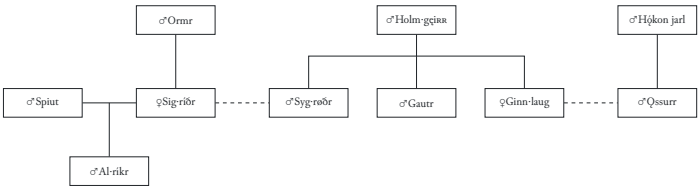
TODO: trans

## Sö 106

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The family involved in raising this stone were fairly prolific in raising runestones, for they also raised U 617 and the non-metrical Sö 101. Based on these 3 inscriptions, their family tree may be reconstructed as follows:




### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**alrikʀ ¤ raisti ¤ stain × sun × siriþaʀ × at × sin faþur × sbiut × ¶ × saʀ × uisitaula × um × uaʀit : hafþi × burg × um brutna : i : auk × um barþa +× firþ × han × kar(s)aʀ + kuni + alaʀ ×**

### Text

Al·ríkʀ rǫisti stǫin, sunn Sig·ríðaʀ, at sinn fǫður Spiut;
sáʀ vestar=la · um vaʀit hafði,
borg um brutna · í ok um barða;
fǫrð hann kastraʀ · kunni allaʀ.

TODO: trans

## Sö 122 (Skresta)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A standing stone at Skresta. The semantic division between the words *dauðan* and *Ǫs·gautr* is marked in the inscription by a large space.

The commissioner, Osgeat, also raised another stone in memory of Highstan, the unmetrical Sö 123. That stone also stands at Skresta and reads: **ąskutr : rsþi : stan : þansi : at : hastin** *Ǫs·gautr rǫisþi stǫin þannsi at Há·stǫin* 'Osgeat raised this stone after Highstan.'

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: stain : stanr : it : histain : raisþi stalfʀ : faþiʀ : at : sun tauþan ąskutr : kiarþi : tre**

### Text

Stǫinn stǫndr *a*t H*á*·stǫin;
2 rǫisþi s*i*alfʀ faðiʀ · at sun dauðan.
Ǫs·gautr giarði tré.

TODO: trans

## Sö 126

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**hu(l)(m)(f)riþ · ilin--r · [þ]aʀ · litu · hakua · stain · eftiʀ ¶ eskil · faþur · sin · han · trauh · orustu · i · austru[i]hi ¶ aþaa · fulks · krimʀ · fala · orþi**

### Text

Holm·fríðr, **†ilin?…r†**, þáʀ létu hǫggva stęin ęftiʀ Ės·kęl, fǫður sinn.
2 Hann draug orrustu · ï austr-vegi,
áðan folks Grímʀ · falla orði.

TODO: trans

## Sö 130

**Dating:** C11th–C12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A standing stone. TODO. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, U 703, U 739, and U 805.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **fiurir : kirþu : at : faþur : kuþan : tyrþ : trikela : at : tumara : miltan : urþa uk : matar kuþan : þat · (u)-(h)---(u)--(u)(k)(þ)**
§ PB **h^a l^f kirþu <o>**
§ QB **h^a <h> kirþu <o/þ>...**

### Text

Fiurir gęrðu · at fǫður góðan
dýrð dręngi=la · at Dómara
mildan orða · ok matar góðan.
Þat ...

Four men made after their good father,
honourably a mark of praise after Doomer
generous in words and good of meat.
This ...

---

3 mildan orða · ok matar góðan ‘generous in words and good of meat’ | The same line is found in Sm 39.

## Sö 131

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: sbiuti : halftan : þaiʀ : raisþu : stain : þansi : eftiʀ : skarþa : ¶ bruþur sin : fur : austr : hiþan : miþ : ikuari : ą sirk¶lanti : likʀ : sunʀ iuintaʀ**

### Text

Spiuti, Half·dan, þęiʀ ręisþu stęin þannsi ęptiʀ Skarða, bróður sinn.
2 Fór austr heðan · með Ing·vari;
à Sęrk-landi liggʀ · sonʀ Ey·vindaʀ.

TODO: trans

## Sö 136

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The stone is lost.

The Swain on the inscription has been identified with the one mentioned on Sö 165 in the same district; the difficult form **†sluia†** may perhaps be identified with the Slode (*Slóði*) on Sö 2 and 141.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[: suain : iuk : sluia · þaiʀ : raisþu : ---... ... ...-nu · at : faþur : sin : hirsi · uksniauin ian uas : unt hifni bistr]**

### Text

Svęinn ok **†sluia†**, þęiʀ ręisþu **†?--.-.-nu†** at fǫður sinn,hęrsi
2 *h*ug-snia*lla*n, · ian vas und hifni bętztr.

TODO: trans

## Sö 137 (Aspa)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

The last line of side B (**sunr þat … mar**) is, with the exception of the final word **mar**, enciphered. The first 7 runes, **sunrþat**, are written along a single vertical stave, while **rakna … i(f)** are written in staveless runes. This line is difficult to read, employs no word separators, and has not been convincingly deciphered.

Weeper is also mentioned on the unmetrical Sö 138, likewise from Aspa, which is dedicated to his unnamed son. In that inscription Thurie is named by her full name, Thurun (*Þór·unn*). It is unclear whether this Weeper is the same as the one mentioned on Sö Fv1982;235.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **þura : raisþi : stin : þ--si at : ubi : buanti : sin**
§ BP **: stain : sar:si : stanr : at : ybi : ą þik·staþi : at ¶ : þuru : uar : han : uestarla : uakti : karla ¶ [sa þar] · sunr þaþ · traknasuatau(k)i(f)mar[sua]**
§ BQ **: stain : sar:si : stanr : at : ybi : ą þik·staþi : at ¶ : þuru : uar : han : uestarla : uakti : karla ¶ · sunr þat raknasuatau-i(f) mar**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 145

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **[: tusti : austin : þiʀ : raistu : at : tuka : sniʀ : kiarþu · at : san :: faþur :: snialan :]**
§ B **[: tuki : ati : ru harfan : krimulfu :: ati : hafan : iu : ata i :: uþuli]**

### Text

Tósti, Ey·stęinn, þęiʀ ręistu at Tóka,
2 s*y*niʀ giǫrðu · at s*i*nn fǫður snjallan.
Tóki átti *bý* ha*l*fan, Grím·ulf*ʀ* átti ha*l*fan *bý*, átti í óðuli.

TODO: trans

## Sö 148

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

The words **han uas antaþ austr** are carved with staveless runes.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þiuþulfʀ : bui : þaiʀ : raisþu : stain þansi : at : farulf : faþur : sin : han uas antaþ austr i kaþ(u)(m)**

### Text

Þiuð·ulfʀ, Bói, þęiʀ ręisþu stęin þannsi at Fǫr·ulf, fǫður sinn.
2 Hann vas andaðr · austr í Gǫrðum.

Thedwolf, Bowe—they raised this stone after Farulf, their father.
He met his end to the east in the Yards.

## Sö 154 (Skarpåker)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A stone.

The couplet at the end, expressing a father's grief for his son, serves as a good example of the Wiking Age preoccupation with the End Times. The stone is decorated with a cross, but the text has no signs of Christian influence, and the language is traditional.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kunar : raisþi : stain : þansi : at : lyþbiurn : sun : sin : iarþ sal rifna uk ubhimin**

### Text

Gunn·arr ręisti stęin þannsi at Lýð·biorn, son sinn.
2 Iǫrð sal rifna · ok upp-himinn.

Guther raised this stone after Leodbarn, his son.
Earth shall rend, and Up-heaven.

---

2 Iǫrð sal rifna · ok upp-himinn. | The verse line (with the exception of **h** and **m** in **ubhimin** *upp-himinn*) is written with staveless runes and without punctuation. Since there is clearly place for more runes on the stone the reason is unlikely to be strictly economical, especially considering that staveless runes are very rare in the Wiking Age outside of Helsingland and also used especially for poetry in other inscriptions from Södermanland (Sö 148 above). Rather the motivation is almost certainly to encrypt the verse and thereby accord it greater sanctity, perhaps also to obscure a reference to the pagan eschatology at a time when Christianity was increasingly hegemonic.
For the expression cf. *Vsp* 50, Arn *Hryn* 3/7–8 (in SkP 2, see also note there): *meiri verði þinn an þeira · þrifnuðr allr, und's himinn rifnar.* 'greater than theirs may all thy wealth be until heaven rends.'

2 Iǫrð ... upphiminn 'Earth ... Up-heaven' | A formulaic merism; see Index for other occurrences.

2 sal 'shall' | An early example of a dialectal form of *skal* 'id.,' cf. dialectal Swedish *sa*.

## Sö 159

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: ikialtr : ak : aluiʀ : raisþu : stain : þansi : at : þurbiurn : faþur : sin : han uaistr hafʀ/(a)fʀ uf/(u)f uaʀit leki ¶ roriкʀ · kumytr biu · kunlaifʀ hiuk ru-aʀ**

### Text

Ingi·aldr auk Ǫl·víʀ ręisþu stęin þannsi at Þòr·biorn, fǫður sinn.
2 Hann vestr hafiʀ · of vaʀit lęngi.
*H*r*ǿ*·ríkʀ, Guð·mundr **†biu†**. Gunn·lęifʀ hiogg rú*n*aʀ.

Ingeld and Alewigh raised this stone after Thurbarn, his father.
He has been in the west for a long time.
Rethric, Godmund .... Guthlaf hewed the runes.

## Sö 163

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þrurikr : stain : at : suni : sina : sniala : trakia : for : ulaifr : i : krikium : uli : sifti :**

### Text

Þrý·ríkʀ stęin
2 at syni sĭna, · snialla dręngja;
fór Ȯ·lęifʀ ĭ Grikkjum, · gulli skipti.

Thriric [raised] the stone
after his sons, valiant drengs;
Anlaf went to Greece, dealt out gold.

---

1 Þrý·ríkʀ stęin 'Thriric [raised] the stone' | This line is an orphan. The verb is left out.

## Sö 164

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ P **kuþbirn : uti : þaiʀ r(a)isþu : stan þansi : at : kuþmar : f(a)þur : sin : stuþ : triki:l(a) : i · stafn skibi : likʀ uistarla uf huln sar tu :**
§ Q **kuþbirn : uti : þaiʀ r(a)isþu : stan þansi : at : kuþmar : f(a)þur : sin : stuþ : triki:l(a) : i · stafn skibi : likʀ uistarla <uf> <hul>n bar--**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 165

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO. The Swain on the stone may be the same person as the one mentioned in Sö 136.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ P **kuþrun : raisti : stain : at : hiþin : uaʀ : nafi suais : uaʀ : han : ¶ : i : krikum iuli skifti ¶ : kristr : hialb : ant : kristunia :**
§ Q **kuþrun : raisti : stain : at : hiþin : uaʀ : nafi suais : uaʀ : han : ¶ : i : krikum iuli skifti ¶ : kristr : hialb : ant : krist uni a :**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 171

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**(i)nk(i)f(a)[s]tr · l[i](t) (h)(a)ku... st(a)...n · eftiʀ · sihuiþ · faþ-r · si[n · han · fial · i h]ul(m)[karþi · skaiþaʀ · uisi mi]þ · ski...ra**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 173 (Tystberga)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

The stone is closely connected to the non-metrical Sö 374, which presently stands beside it. Sö 374 is somewhat younger, and was raised by Mishie (there **musku** gen. sg.) after Manny. The woman Mishie also raised the non-metrical Sö 13 with Wiking, perhaps her husband.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **mes:kia : a(u)[k :] (m)an(i) : litu : rasa : ku[(m)(l) : þausi : at : b]ruþur · (s)in : hr(u)þkaiʀ · auk : faþur sin hulm:stain ·**
§ B **· han hafþi · ystarla u(m) : uaʀit · lenki : tuu : a:ustarla : meþ : inkuari**

### Text

Myskja auk Manni létu rę*i*sa kumbl þausi at bróður sinn Hróð·gęiʀ
2 fǫður Holm·stęin.
Hann hafði vestar=la · um vaʀit lęngi;
4 dóu austar=la · með Ing·vari.

TODO: trans

## Sö 174 (Aspö)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[ub]lubʀ · lit · kira : kuml : likhus : auk : bru · at sun sin : biurn : uaʀ trebin : a : kut:lanti : þy : lit : fiur · sit : fluþu : kankiʀ : þaiʀ uiþ[ulkuʀ] : uiltu iki halta : guþ : hilbi : anta : hans**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 179 (Gripsholm)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

The three-line stanza is a biographical addition following a typical prose memorial formula.

### Runes

᛭ ᛏᚢᛚᛅ : ᛚᛁᛏ : ᚱᛅᛁᛋᛅ : ᛋᛏᛅᛁᚾ : ᚦᛁᚾᛋᛅ᛫ : ᛋᚢᚾ : ᛋᛁᚾ : ᚼᛅᛚᛏ : ᛒᚱᚢᚦᚢᚱ : ᛁᚾᚴᚢᛅᚱ ᛋ ᚦᛅᛁᚱ ᚠᚢᚱᚢ : ᛏᚱᛁᚴᛁᛚᛅ : ᚠᛁᛅᚱᛁ : ᛅᛏ : ᚴᚢᛚᛁ : ᛅᚢᚴ : ᛅ:ᚢᛋᛏᛅᚱᛚᛅ᛫ ᛁᚨ:ᚾᛁ : ᚴᛅᚠᚢ : ᛏᚢᚢ : ᛋᚢᚾᛅᚱ:ᛚᛅ : ᛅ ᛋᛁᚱᚴ:ᛚᛅᚾ:ᛏᛁ

### Transliteration

**× tula : lit : raisa : stain : þinsa| |at : sun : sin : haralt : bruþur : inkuars : þair furu : trikila : fiari : at : kuli : auk : a:ustarla| |ar:ni : kafu : tuu : sunar:la : a sirk:lan:ti**

### Text

Tóla lét ręisa stęin þennsa at son sinn Har·ald, bróður Ing·vars.

Toolie had this stone raised after her son Harold, brother of Ingwar.

Þęir fóru drængi=la · fiarri at gulli
auk austar=la · arni gǫfu,
dóu sunnar=la · á Sęrk-landi.

They journeyed like drengs far for gold
and easterly gave to the eagle;
they died southerly in Serkland.

---

3 arni gǫfu ‘gave to the eagle’ | They provided a feast for the eagle, namely with the carnage of slain foes; for eagles and ravens as eaters of corpses and drinkers of blood cf. Meissner (1921, pp. 118, 203, 207–208). Similar expressions naturally occur in numerous Scaldic poems from Iceland and Norway, and the lack of an object to *gǫfu* ‘gave’ reveals that this expression must have been well known also in Sweden.

## Sö 198 (Mervalla)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**siriþ · lit · resa · stan · [þin](a) [·] (a)(t) · suen · sin · [b]unta · h[n] · uft · siklt · til · simk(a)(l)(a) · t(u)ru[m] · knari · um · tumisnis**

### Text

Sig·ríð*r* lét rêsa stên þęnna at Svên, sinn bónda.
2 H*a*nn opt siglt · til Sêmgala,
dýrum knarri · um Dómis-nęs.

Syerid had this stone raised after Swayn, her husband.
He had often sailed to the Semigallians
on his costly knarr around Domeness.

---

3 Dómis-nęs 'Domeness' | The old Germanic name for Cape Kolka in Latvia, corresponding to German *Domesnes*.

## Sö 204 (Överselö church)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The inscription is heavily damaged, but can be reconstructed on the basis of the verse in Sö 206.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: hier : skal : stenta : stei(n) ... ...kia(l)t : run(u)... ... ... (u)arfaitr : (i)(f)tiʀ : faþurs:broþur · sen ·**

### Text

Hiar skal standa · stęinn *at Ingj*·ald,
2 rún*um roðinn* · *ręisti* Var·fęitr
eptir fǫðurs bróður sinn.

TODO: trans

## Sö 206/208

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

Two stones raised by a mother and her daughter. The plural *stęina* on Sö 206 suggests that the inscription between Sö 206 and 208 is continuous.

The "-barn" named on Sö 208 may perhaps be identified with one of the two men mentioned on Sö 213.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

Sö 206: **: hir : skal : stenta : staena : þisiʀ : runum : ru-niʀ :⋯ raisti : k---auk : at syni : sina : auk : hielmlauk : at bryþr : sina ·**
Sö 208: **: kuþlauk · auk : hielmlaug : þaʀ : ----(u) · raistu : ... ...ern : auk : at : þorstain :: boanta : koþan : buki : i frayslutum : arfi : fu(l)... ... sum iʀ : sustursun inibrataʀ :**

### Text

**PSö 206**
Hér skal standa · stęina þessiʀ
2 rúnum ruðnir · ręisti Guð·laug
at syni sína auk Hialm·laug at bróðr sína.

Here shall these stones stand
reddened with runes. Guthleigh raised them
after her sons, and Helmleigh after her brothers.

**PSö 208**
Guð·laug auk Hialm·laug þáʀ ... ręistu ... *at* ... -bięrn auk at Þór·stęin
2 bóanda góðan, · byggi i Fręys-lundum
arfi Fu*lluga* ... sum eʀ systur-son Ęnni·brattaʀ.

Guthleigh and Helmleigh, those ... raised ... [after] -barn and after Thurstan, a good farmer. He lived in the Freaslunds,
the heir of Fullow ... who is the sister's son of Endbrant.

## Sö 207

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kuþr... ... (f)aþur sin · fur · hfila · hn · til · iklans · kuþ halbi · sil hns**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 213

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**s^tain : hiuk : esbern : stintn : at : uitum : bat miþ : runum : raisti : kyla : at : gaiʀbern : boanta : sin :· auk · kofriþ : at : faþur : sin : han uaʀ : boanti : bestr i : kili : raþi : saʀ : kuni :**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 320

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay or Lay-meter

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

: ᚴᚼᛁᛆᚢᚬᛏᚱ : ᚼᚢᛦ : ᚼᚾᚢᛏᚱ : ᚼᚢᛦ : ᚢᛏᚼᛘᚱ : ᚱᛁᛏᚼ : ᛋᛏᚼᛁᚾ : ᚼᛏ : ᛒᚢᚱᛋᛏᚴᚼᛁᚾ · ᛒᚱᚢᚦᚢᚱ : ᛋᛁᚾ : ᛋᚬᚱ ᚢᚬᚱ : ᚼᚢᛋᛏᚱ · ᛘᛁᚦ ᛁᛕᚢᚬᚱᛁ : ᛏᚱᛁᛕ : ᛋᚾᛁᛆᛚᚬᚾ : ᛋᚢᚾ : ᛚᛁᚠᚼᚬᛆᚼ

### Transliteration

**: kaiʀuatr : auk : anutr : auk : utamr : rita : stain : at : byrst(a)in · bruþur : sin : saʀ uaʀ : austr · miþ ikuari : trik : snialan : sun : lifayaʀ ×**

### Text

Gęiʀ·hvatr auk Qnundr auk Ȯ·tamr rétta stęin at Býr·stęin, bróður
2 sinn,
sáʀ vaʀ austr · með Ing·vari,
4 dręng sniallan, · sunn *H*líf·ęyjaʀ.

TODO: trans

## Sö 335

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**uulf^ui : raisti : stain þana| |at bruþur sin : u:snikin saʀ furs : a:ust:arla : maþ : i:ikn:u:ari : ksibari hulmstains**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 338

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A · **ketil : auk + biorn + þaiʀ + raistu + stain + þin[a] + at + þourstain : faþur + sin + anuntr + at + bruþur + sin + auk : hu[skar]laʀ + hifiʀ + iafna + ketilau at + buanta sin · ¶ bruþr uaʀu þaʀ bistra mana : a : lanti auk : i liþi : uti : h(i)(l)(t)u sini huska(r)la : ui- +**
§ B **han + fial + i + urustu + austr + i + garþum + lis + furugi + lanmana + bestr**

### Text

Kętill auk Biorn, þęiʀ ręistu stęin þęnna at Þòr·stęin, fǫður sinn, Ǫnundr at bróður sinn auk hús-karlaʀ *ępt*iʀ iafna, Kętil·ęy at bóanda sinn.

Bróðr vǫʀu þęiʀ · bętstra manna
à landi auk ĭ liði úti;
heldu sinn*a* · hús-karla ve*l*.
Hann fiall ĭ orrustu · austr ĭ Gǫrðum,
liðs forungi, · land-manna bętstr.

TODO: trans.
They were brothers of the best men,
on land and out in the troop. He fell in battle to the east in the Yards,
the steward of the troop, the best of lended men.

## Sö 340

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[: stin : saʀ:si sąnr : at · frusta ik]irunaʀ : [sun : aik : kuþlifs : ulifʀ : raisti aftiʀ bruþur sin ¶ kus]**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö 345

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**... ...in × þinsa × at × kai(ʀ)... ... ...-n · eʀ · e[n-a]þr × ut - × kr...**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sö Fv1948;289 (Aspa)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO: INTRODUCTION.

The Rainold on this stone has been identified with the man of the same name mentioned on Sö Fv1948;295, although the conncetion is uncertain.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**ąstriþ : lit : -ira : ku(m)... ...usi ÷ at : anunt ÷ auk : raknualt : sun : sin ÷: urþu : ta...ʀ : - (t)an...-...(k)u : ua-u : rikiʀ : ą rauniki : ak : snialastiʀ : i : suiþiuþu**

### Text

Ǫst·ríðr lét gęra kum*bl þa*usi at Ǫn·und ok Ragn·vald, sun sinn.
Urðu d*auðiʀ* · í Dan-*mǫrk*u,
vǫ*ʀ*u ríkiʀ · á Rauningi
auk sniallastiʀ · í Své·þiuðu.

Estfrid had these monuments made after Anund and Rainold, her son.
They died in Denmark,
were powerful in Reening,
and the most valiant in Sweden.

## Sö Fv1954;22

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**...i : risti : ---... ... ...in... ... sin : han : iʀ : entaþr : i : austruiki : ut : ą : la-...**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 11

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

The stone clearly bears a connection to U 16, which also mentions King Hathkin's "rowing" (*róð*).

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**raþ| |þu : runaʀ : ret : lit : rista : toliʀ : bry[t]i : i roþ : kunuki : toliʀ : a(u)k : gyla : litu : ris... ...- : þaun : hion : eftiʀ ...k : merki ¶ srni... ¶ haku(n) · (b)aþ : rista**

### Text

Ráð þú runaʀ · rétt lét rísta
Toliʀ bryti i róð konungi.
Toliʀ auk Gylla létu rísta ... þaun hjón eptiʀ ... męrki †srni† ...
Hǫ·kun bað rísta.

TODO: trans

## U 69

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**raknilfʀ × lit × kirua × bru × þasi × iftiʀ × anunt + sun + s[i](n) [× k]uþan × kuþ ---bi × ąns × ant × uk × salu × bitr × þan × ąn krþi × til × munu × iki × mirki × miʀi × uirþa × muþiʀ × karþi × i(f)tiʀ × sun × sin × ainika ×**

### Text

Ragn·ęlfʀ lét gęrva bró þási ęptiʀ Ǫnund, sun sinn góðan. Guð hialpi hans ǫnd ok sǫ́lu bętr þan hann gęrði til.

2 Munu ęigi męrki · męiʀi verða.
Móðiʀ gǫrði ęptiʀ sun sinn ęiniga.

TODO: trans

## U 102

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The inscription is very hard to read.
TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kal lit hkua heli þisa iftiʀ · suni sina toa · auk þau ikiþora · bʀ- (a)ina kiarþu mukit mirki furiʀ arkum mani**

### Text

Káll lét hǫggva · hęlli þęssa
ęptiʀ syni · sína tvá,
auk þau Ingi·þóra bró · ęina giǫrðu,
mykit męrki · fyriʀ mǫrgum manni.

TODO: trans

## U 112

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A · **rahnualtr · lit · rista · runar · efʀ · fastui · moþur · sina · onems · totʀ · to i · aiþi · kuþ hialbi · ant · hena ·**
§ B **runa · rista · lit · rahnualtr · huar a × griklanti · uas · lis · forunki ·**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 114

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **ikriþ ᾽ l[i]t · laþbo · kiara ᾽ auk · stain · haku[a eftir] ikim[a]r (b)(o)[ta s]in · auk · eftar · tan · auk · eftir · baka · suni · sina**
§ B **᾽ þairʀ byku ᾽ i rynby ᾽ auk ᾽ bo atu ᾽ [kr]istr · ialbi ᾽ s(a)(l)(u) · þai[r- ·] (þ)it skal ᾽ at minum · mana ᾽ miþan · min li[fa]**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 127/164/165/261

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

These four stones all share a near-identical inscription and visual layout. All four originally belong to the so-called Earlbanke's bridge, a stretch of road at which U 164–5 are still standing. U 127 and 261 have been moved to different locations.

Since the wording of the inscriptions are near-identical, I thought it simplest to include them all under the same section and note the differences between them (excepting minor divergences in punctuation) by means of the critical apparatus.

Like many other one-line verses, the poetic nature of these inscriptions is doubtful, especially since the transposition of *allan* in U 127, which is not inferior to the others in terms of execution, renders the line deficient and makes one question whether Earlbanke really intended a poetic line.

Earlbanke belonged to an elite family which raised a number of other stones in southern Attundaland, north of modern Stockholm. Other stones securely connected to Earlbanke's family are U 101, 135–137, 140, 142–143, 147–150, and 212.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 127: **× iarla×baki × lit raisa [×] staina × þasa at sik × kuikuan ¶ × auk bru þisa karþi × fur ąnt sina × auk × ain ati tabu ala-** U 164: **× iarlabaki × lit × raisa × stain × þisa × at sik × kuikuan × ¶ × auk bru × þisa × karþi × fur ąnt × sina × auk ain ati × alan × tabu × kuþ hialbi ąnt hans** U 165: **ia[r]labaki × li---sa × staina × þisa × at sik × kuikuan × auk bru þis(a) [× karþi fur ąnt ×] si---- × ati + (a)lan × tabu +** U 261: **iarlaba... lit × raisa × s[taina × þasa × a]t sik × kuikuan × ¶ auk × bru × þisa × karþi × fur ąnt [×] s[in]a × auk × ain ati alan tabu**

### Text

Iarla·banki lét rǫisa stǫina þása at sik kvikvan, auk bró þǫssa gǫrði fyr ǫnd sína,
2 auk ǫinn átti · allan Tä·bý.
Guð hialpi ǫnd hans.

Earlbanke had these stones raised after himself while alive and made this bridge for his spirit,
and he alone owned all Toughby.
God help his spirit.

---

1 Iarla·banki | **iarlaba...** U 261 1 lét ręisa | **li- ---sa** U 165 1 stęina | **stain** U 164 1 þása | þęssa (‘**þisa**’) U 164/165 1.a–2 sína, auk çinn | **si--** --- U 165 2 allan Tä·bý | *rev.* (‘**tabu ala-**’) U 127 3 Guð hialpi ǫnd hans. | *om.* U 164/165/261

---

2 Tä·bý ‘Toughby’ | The ancestor of *Täby*, the name of the place in modern Swedish. Naturally, Wiking Age Toughby was merely a farmstead or village, and not the large municipality it is today.

## U 136

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

For the family responsible for raising the stone, see the Introduction to U 127.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**× astriþr × la(t) + raisa × staina × þasa × [a]t austain × buta sin × is × suti × iursalir auk antaþis ub i × kirkum**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 153/155

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

These two stones are united by textual evidence and geography; they may thus be taken to form a continual inscription, even if only U 153 is actually metrical.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 153: **...[(u)](a)i- × [(a)]uk × ulf- litu × raisa × stai-(a) × e(f)tiʀ × hlftan · auk · eftiʀ × kunar × bryþr × sina × þaiʀ · antaþus × aust... ...(u)m**
U 155: **...n × auk × ulfr litu × rai(s)(a) sta... ... ... ...na × þaiʀ × uaru × suniʀ × arnar × auk × raknfriþar ×**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 166

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**ku lit · rasa · kuþlauh · iftiʀ · sun · miuk · nutan · trik · mirki · þisa · an it · sihuastr ·**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 207–8

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO. The inscription is syntactically continuous between the two stones.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 207: **ulfr ᾽ auk ᾽ þurmontr ᾽ auk ᾽ kamal ᾽ lata ᾽ reis(a) þisa ᾽ stina ᾽ þar + eftʀ ᾽ faþur ᾽ sin ᾽** U 208: **ristu ᾽ merk(i) at ᾽ man ᾽ metan ᾽ sunir ᾽ alkoþir ᾽ at ÷ sin ᾽ faþur sterkar usiti ᾽ rsti stina**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 214–15

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

Two paired stones with a single continuous inscription. At present both are located in Vallentuna church. U 215 should be read before 214 in the series. The Ingbury who raised the stone is most likely the same Ingbury who raised the non-metrical U 146 for her husband and son. U 146 is also located in Vallentuna (though not in the church) and gives the name of the father as Holmstan (*Holm·stęinn*) and the son as Thurstan (*Þór·stęinn*).

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 214: **uk × inkiber × eftiʀ × buanta × sin ’ han ’ troknaþi ÷ a ’ holms ’ hafi ’ skreþ ’ knar ’ hans ’ i ’ kaf þriʀ ’ eniʀ ’ kamo ’ af**
U 215: **[þaniltr · uk · olfil](r) · [li](t)(u) s[t]ain × e(f)[tiʀ faþor · uk broþor sin ·]**

### Text

*R*agn·hildr ok Ulf·hildr létu stęin ęptiʀ fǫður ok bróður sinn, ok Ingi·berg ęptiʀ bóanda sinn.
Hann drunknaði · á Holms-hafi;
skrêð knarr hans ĩ kaf;
þríʀ êniʀ kǫmu af.

TODO: trans

## U 225–26 (Bällsta)

**Dating:** C11th
**Location:** Arkils tingstad, Bällsta, Vallentuna
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

U 225–6 are two paired runestones still standing in their original location, namely at the thingstead mentioned in U 225. In the 18th century the two stones were connected by a line of smaller, uninscribed stones between them, but these have since been lost. The inscription is continuous and consists of 7 alliterative long-lines.

The family responsible for U 225–6 was prolific, and also raised U 100, 160–161, 328, 336, 343–344, and 364.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 225: **... uk · arkil · uk · kui · þiʀ · kariþu · iar · þikstaþ ... ...unu · iki mirki · maiʀi · uirþa · þan · ulfs · suniʀ · iftiʀ · kir... ...iʀ · suinaʀ · at · sin · faþur**
U 226: **ristu · stina · uk · staf · uan · uk · in · mikla · at · iartiknum uk kuriþi · kas at · uiri · þu mon i krati · kiatit lata ¶ kunar ik stin**

### Text

**PU 225**
... ok Arn·kęll ok Gýi þęiʀ gęrðu 'iar þing-stað ...
*M*unu ęigi męrki · męiʀi verða,
þan Ulfs syniʀ · ęptiʀ gęr*ðu,*
*sniall*iʀ svęinaʀ · at sinn fǫður,

... and Arnkettle and Gew they made the thingstead here, ...
No greater landmarks will there be
than Wolf's sons afterwards made,
valiant swains, for their father.

**U 226**
ręistu stęina · ok staf *of* an
ok inn mikla · at iar-tęiknum,
ok Gý·ríði · gats at veri;
þý man ï gráti · giatit láta.
Gunnarr 'iogg stęin.

They raised the stones and the staff above,
and the great … as tokens of remembrance;
also Guefrid cared for her husband.
Thus will they have it spoken of in weeping.
Guther hewed the stone.

1 *of* an | **uan** U 226*;* unnu *most other eds.*

1 staf *of* an 'the staff above' | Unclear; perhaps a tall wooden staff or column?

2 inn mikla 'the great …' | The word *inn* may either be read as the article *inn, hinn* 'the' or as a f. noun of unclear sense. The latter is preferable since the weakly stressed article cannot uphold alliteration, and since *hinn mikla* 'the great one' is meaningless.

4 í gráti 'in weeping' | Or 'in a dirge', if *grátr* refers uniquely to a lost genre of poems of lamentation, in which case the line probably refers to a longer oral poem serving as a complement to the necessarily quite limited runic poem.

## U 300 (Skånela)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[þyrui + lit + raisa + stain × eftiʀ + hlftain + merki + mukit + eftiʀ × man kuþan]**

### Text

Þýr·ví lét ręisa stęin ęptiʀ Halfda*n,
2 męrki mykit · ęptiʀ mann góðan.

TODO: trans

## U 323 (Sälna)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

An exceptionally tall standing stone. No decorations, but explicitly Christian. Note the sporadic loss of initial *h* and use of stung runes ᚬ, ᛇ, ᚼ **y, g, e**.

### Runes

× ᛁᚢᛋᛏᛁᚾ × ᚾᚢᛦ × ᛁᚢᚱᚢᚾᛏᚱ × ᚾᚢᛦ × ᛒᛁᚢᚱᚾ × ᚦᛁᚬ [× ᛒᚣᚱᚦᚦᚱ × ᚱᛁᛋᚦᚢ] ... ...ᛋᛏᛁᚾ × ᛏᚱᚢᛋᛏᛋ × ᚠ[ᚾᚦᚢᚱ] × ᛋᛁᚾ × ᚴᚢᚦ × ᛁᚼᛚᛒᛁ × ᚼᚾᛋ × ᚼᚾᛏ × ᚾᚢᛦ × ᛋᚾᛚᚢ + ᚠᚢᚱ + ᚴᛁᚠᛁ × ᚼᚾᚢᛉ × ᛋᛁᚴᚾᚼᚺ × ᚾᚢᛦ ᛋᚢᛏᛁᚺ ×
× ᚼᛁ × ᛉᚢᚾ × ᚢᛁᛦᛁᚾ × ᛉᛁᚦ + ᚾᛚᛏᚱ + ᚢᛁᚠᛁᚺ × ᛒᚱᚢ × ᚼᚱᚦ × ᛋᛚᚴᚾᚦᛁᚾ × ᛒᚱᛁᚦ × ᚼ[ᚴᛏ ᚴ]ᚢᚦ-- ᛋᚢᚾᚾᚾᚺ ᚴᚾ[ᚱᚦᚢ ×] ᚾᛏ × ᛋᛁᚾ × ᚴᚾᚦᚢᚱ × ᛉᚼ × ᛁᚴᛁ × ᛒᚱᚢᛏᚾᚺ × ᚴᚢᛉᛚ × ᛒᚾᛏᚱᚾ × ᚢᚾᚱᚦᚾ +

### Transliteration

**× iystin × auk × iuruntr × auk × biurn × þiʀ [× byryþr × risþu] ... ...stin × trums × f[aþur] × sin × kuþ × ihlbi × ąns × ąnt × auk × selu + fur+kifi × ąnum × sakaʀ × auk × sutiʀ × ¶**
**× hi × mun × ligia × meþ + altr + lifiʀ × bru × hrþ×slagin × briþ × e[ft × k]uþ-- suenaʀ k[arþu ×] at × sin × faþur × mą × igi × brutaʀ×kuml × betra × uerþa +**

### Text

Ęy·stên auk Iurundr auk Biorn, þêʀ brøðr rêsþu ... *ęptir* ...stên **trums** fǫður sinn.
Guð 'ialpi 'ans ǫnd auk sêlu, for·gifi 'ǫnum sakaʀ auk syndiʀ.

Eanstan and Earwind and Barn—those brothers raised ... [after] -stan ..., their father.
God help his breath and soul, forgive him his crimes and sins.

*Ę*i mun liggja · með aldr lifiʀ
bró harð-slagin · brêð e*ft góð*an;
svênaʀ k*ęrðu* · at sinn fǫður
má êgi brôtaʀ-kuml · bętra verða.

For ever will lie while the age lives
the hard-hammered bridge, broad, after a good man.

The swains made it after their father;
no roadside monument can be greater.

## U 336

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[ul]fʀ × lit × risa stin × þi[n]a × iftiʀ × unim × faþurs×bruþr sin þiʀ × buku × baþiʀ × i × baristam ’**

### Text

Ulfʀ lét rêsa stên þęnna ęptiʀ Ȯ·nęm, fǫðurs-bróður sinn.
2 Þêʀ byggu báðir · í Bári-stǫm.

TODO: trans

## U 349

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The stone is lost but survives as a well executed drawing.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[uikitil × uk × usur -...u × risa × stin × þina · iftiʀ × ustin × faþ... ... ...þan × ąn furs × uti × miþ × ala × skibin × kuþ × ialbi × (a)t]**

### Text

Ví·kętill ok Ǫssurr ...*lét*u rêsa stên þenna eptir Ô·stên, fǫð*ur sinn*
2 *góð*an. 'Ann fórs úti með alla skipan.
Guð 'ialpi ǫnd.

TODO: trans

## U 358

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

It has been suggested that U 358 was originally paired with the fragmentary U Fv1979;244b (TODO: cite).

Note the loss of initial *h-*.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**fulkmar × lit × risa × stin × þina × iftiʀ × fulkbiarn × sun × sin × saʀ × itaþis × uk miþ krkum × kuþ × ialbi × ans × ąt uk salu**

### Text

Folk·marr lét rêsa stên þęnna ęptiʀ Folk·biǫrn, sun sinn.
2 Sáʀ ęndaðis · ok með Gr*i*kkum.
Guð 'ialpi 'ans ǫnd ok sǫ́lu.

TODO: trans

## U 437 (Broby)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kuna : a[uk su]tari : ristu : s(t)[... ... sikbiar- sati : iftiʀ : sin faþur : stin : almykin : i : s...]**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 512

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **fryb... ... ...i × huk f(r)... ...(f)-þr × þiʀ ristu × sti- -...(n)a × iftiʀ × kuþ-ar × ...(a)þur × sin kuþan × huk tuma + (b)...-þur × sin ×× kuþ ...i ąt × þiʀa × huk × salu × hu... ... ...uþiʀ × bitr × þan × þiʀ × -ar- × h...**
§ B **...ir × skal × stan^ta × stin × uiþ- bryku × suniʀ × at × faþuʀ satu · kuþan · kaiʀ -... ...**
§ C **--(u)-aʀ × mirki × at × bua-... ...**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 605

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A lost runestone.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[· iskirun · harþiʀ · totiʀ · lit · risti · runiʀ · ati · sik · sialfan · hn · uil · austr · fara · auk · ut · til · iursala · fair · risti · runiʀ ·]**

### Text

I*n*gi·rùn, Harð*a*ʀ dóttiʀ, lét rísta rùnaʀ at* sik sialfa*.
2 Hòn vill austr fara · auk út til Iór-sala.
F*ó*tr rísti rùniʀ.

Ingrun, Hareth's daughter, had these runes carved after herself.
She wants to go east and out to Jerusalem.
Foot carved the runes.

## U 614

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**· skuli · auk · folki · lata · reisa · þinsa · stein · iftʀ · broþur · sin · husbiorn · hn us| |siok · uti · þa þiʀ · kialt · toku · a kutlanti ·**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 617 (Bro)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

A beautiful rectangular stone. The family involved in raising this stone were quite prolific; see Sö 106 above.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kinluk × hulmkis × tutiʀ × systiʀ × sukruþaʀ × auk × þaiʀa × kaus × aun × lit × keara × bru × þesi × auk × raisa × stain × þina × eftiʀ × asur × bunta · sin × sun × hakunaʀ × iarls × saʀ × uaʀ × uikika × uaurþr × miþ × kaeti × kuþ × ialbi × ans × nu × aut × uk × salu**

### Text

Ginn·laug, Holm·gęiʀs dóttiʀ, systiʀ Syg·røðaʀ auk þęiʀa Gaut*s*,
hǫn let giǫra bró þęssi auk ręisa stęin þęnna ęptiʀ Ǫssur, bónda
sinn, sun Hǫ́·konaʀ iarls.
2 Sáʀ vaʀ víkinga · vǫrðr með Gęiti.
Guð hialpi hans nú ǫnd ok sǫ́lu.

Yinlie, Holmgar's daughter, the sister of Syeferth and Geat—she had this bridge made and this stone raised after Answer, her husband, the son of Earl Hathkin.
He was the watchman against Wikings with Goater.
God now help his spirit and soul.

---

1.b Hǫ́·konaʀ iarls 'Earl Hathkin' | Unclear, but he is probably not the Norwegian Earl of Lade Hathkin Siwardson (c. 937–995).

## U 644

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The stone is clearly paired with U 654, but their inscriptions are distinct enough to be treated separately. The Andwit mentioned on these stones is likely the same man as mentioned in the non-metrical U 643.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**an(u)(i)(t)r : auk · kiti : auk · kar : auk · blisi · auk · tiarfr · þir · raistu · stain þina · aftiʀ · kunlaif · fąþur : sin han : fil · austr : miþ : ikuari ¶ kuþ heabi ąntini**

### Text

An*d*·v*é*ttr auk Giti auk K*ǫ́*rr auk Blesi auk Diarfr, þ*ę́*ir r*ę́*istu st*ę́*in þenna *ę́*ptiʀ Gunn·l*ę́*if, f*ǫ́*ður sinn,
2 hann fell austr · með Ing·vari.
Guð hia*l*pi *ǫ*nd'inni.

TODO: trans

## U 654

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**+ a--itr : auk · ka(r) auk : kiti : auk : -[l]isi : auk · tiarfr : ris[t]u : stain : þena : aftir : kunlaif : fąþur sin ¶ is u[a]s nus(t)(r) · m[i](þ) ikuari : tribin kuþ : hialbi : ą(t) þaira ¶ al-ikr| |raistik · runar ¶ is kuni + ual · knari stura**

### Text

An*d·v*éttr auk Kórr auk Giti auk Blesi auk Diarfr ręistu stęin
þęnna ęptir Gunn·leif, fǫður sinn,
es vas *a*ustr · með Ing·vari drepinn.
Guð hialpi ǫnd þęira.
Al·*ríkr* ręist'ik rúnaʀ
es kunni vęl · knęrri stýra.

TODO: trans

## U 661

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kairui × auk × kula × ristu × stain þina × aftir × ąnunt × fąþur sia is uas × austr × tauþr × miþ × ikuari × kuþ × hialbi ąt × ąnutar**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 703 (Västra Väppeby)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side. There is no cross present, but a large four-legged beast with a long tail. The stone is heavily damaged but mostly readable. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 739, and U 805. For "good of meat", which also occurs in *Háv* see Index. The first line is not poetic.

The carver notably struggles with distinguishing the mirrored runes **a** and **n**.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: -sui · let [·] rnisa · stain [·] þisa · at · anulf · sun · sen · koþan ·· han · byki · her ...- · mantr · matar · -o-r · auk · mls · ri(s)ia ·**

### Text

*Ǫ*s·vi lét rǫisa stǫin þe*nn*sa at Q*r*n·ulf, son sinn góðan. Hann
2 byggi hér ...,
mandr matar *góð*r · ok m*á*ls risi*nn*.

Oswye let raise this stone after Arnolf, her good son. He lived here ...,
a man good of meat and proud of speech.

---

2 ... | In this lacuna there is room for around 5 runes; not enough for a half-line, which suggests that *Hann byggi hér* is not poetic.

## U 707/710 (Husby)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

Two pieces of a single stone. U 707 is the larger fragment while U 710, originally not identified with U 707, is smaller and contains the words **(h)...(n) · byki| |i · h(u)**.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

U 707/U 710: **· ysurkʀ --... · stan · þina · nt · ka(u)bm...(n) · faþur · sen · koþan · (h)...(n) · byki| |i · h(u)... ¶ · bali · risti · r(u)--r · þis-(r) · hier · man · stanta · stan · ne(r) (b)(r)-...-u ·**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 729

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**· uiþugsi · lit · raisa · stain · þiasn · iftiʀ · seref · faþur · sen · koþan · han · byki| |i · agurstam · hier mn · stanta · stan · miþli · bua · raþi · tekr · þaʀ · ryn si · runum · þim sum · bali · risti ·**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 735 (Långarnö)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

The Wetherold on this stone has been connected to the man of the same name appearing on the unmetrical U 463, located some 27 km east of U 735. Since both stones are at their original locations, the close distance supports a possible relation.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**· ueþralti ’ lit ’ uʀ · lakarni · stan · almikin · uʀ · staþi · fyra · auk ·· arker ’ þau ’ litu ’ kubl ’ raisa · þisa · at ’ siktryk ’ sun · sen ’**

### Text

Veðr·aldi lét · úʀ Lang-garni
2 stęin al-mikinn · úʀ staði føra
ok Arn·gęrðr þau létu kumbl ręisa þessa at Sig·trygg, son sinn.

TODO: trans

## U 739 (Gådi)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A standing stone inscribed on one side, with a large cross present. There are no major difficulties with the reading. The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 805. "mild of meat" appears to be a variant of "good of meat", which also occurs in *Háv*; see Index. The first line is not poetic. For other stones raised by someone in memory of themselves, see TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**· hulbiorn · lit · raisa · stan · at ᾽ sik · sialfan ¶ · hau|n| |u|naʀ · miltr · mataʀ · auk · mals·risin ·**

### Text

Hol·biǫrn lét rǫisa stǫin at sik sialfan.
2 Ha*nn v*aʀ mildr mataʀ · ok máls-risinn.

Holbarn had this stone raised after himself.
He was mild of meat and proud of speech.

2 Ha*nn v*aʀ | **haunaʀ** *(for* ***hanuaʀ****)* U 739

## U 778

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The original location of the stone is unknown, but judging from the inscription it must have been part of a larger monument consisting of several stones.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þialfi × auk × hulmnlauk × litu × raisa × staina þisa × ala × at baka × sun sin × is ati × ain ¶ × sir × skib × auk × austr × stu[rþi ×] i × ikuars × liþ × kuþ hialbi × ąt × baka × ask(i)l × raist**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 792

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**kar lit · risa · stin · þtina · at · mursa · faþur · sin · auk · kabi · at · mah sin · fu- hfila · far · aflaþi ut i · kri[k]um · arfa · sinum**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 805

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The stone is lost and the interpretation must rely on old depictions which makes the reading, especially two of the personal names, uncertain.

The expression is formulaic; cf. Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 739. For "good of meat", which also occurs in *Háv*; see Index. The first line is not poetic.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ P **[fulkir : lit : risa : st... --r : iel : bruþur : sin : auk : kunimar : eftir : menk : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : buki| |i uikby]**
§ Q **[fulkir · lit : risa : st... --- : mer : bruþur : sin : auk : kuni:mar : eftir : m·enk : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : brike -ukni ·]**
§ R **[fulkir : lit : risa : st... ...(r)ir : mei- : bruþur : sih auk : kuni:mar : eftir : mink : faþur : sin bunta : kuþan : matar : buki| |i : uiki]**

### Text

Fylkir lét ręisa st*ęin eptir* **†iel†**, bróður sinn, ok Gunni·marr eptir **†menk†**, fǫður sinn,
2 bónda góðan matar; · byggi í Vík-bý.

Filch had this stone raised after ..., his brother, and Guthmar after ..., his father,
a farmer good of meat; he lived in Wickby.

## U 838

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þufr · auk · þorfatr · þair · litu ’ raisa ’ stan · at · þorborn · faþur · sen · koþan · ¶ · hir maa ’ stanta ’ stain ’ ner ’ brautu ’ auk ’ (k)ilauk ’ riþ · kirua ’ merki ’ [at] (b)(o)a--- · sen :**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U 887

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**× ioker × auk × fastker × auk × au(r)(i)(k)r × litu · rita · sten × yftir × borker × faþur sin frehn ¶ selfr · hiok × aurikr × yfti : sin · faþur · runi · þisa · roþi ᾽ sa ᾽ kuni**

### Text

Io·gêʀ auk Fast·gêr auk Ęy·ríkr létu rétta stên øpti Borg·gêʀ fǫður sinn frękan.
2 Sialfr hiogg Ęy·ríkr · øpti sinn fǫður
rùni þęssa: · ráði sá kunni.

TODO: trans

## U 1016

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**§ P · liutr : sturimaþr · riti : stain : þinsa : aftir : sunu · sina : sa hit : aki : sims uti furs : sturþ(i) · -(n)ari · kuam ·: hn krik·:hafnir : haima tu : ...-mu-... ...(k)(a)(r)... (i)uk (r)(u)-(a) · ...**
**§ Q · liutr : sturimaþr · riti : stain : þinsa : aftir : sunu · sina : sa hit : aki : sims uti furs : sturþ(i) · -(n)ari · kuam ·: hn krik · : hafnir : haima tu : ...-mu-... ...(k)(a)(r)... (i)uk (r)(u)-(a) · ...**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U Fv1983;228

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**× nesbiurn : (l)it : raisa : sta-n : þensa : eftiʀ : (o)laif : sun : sin : hiar : skal : stanta : stain · a : l(a)(i)...au...**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U Fv1986;84

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**asmu-tr ... ris-- · runaʀ · eftiʀ × stein · faþurs·faþur · sin · auk · faþur · siba · ok × geiʀbiarnaʀ × aok ... ulfs · eaʀ · merki · mikit · at · man · koþan ×**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U Fv1992;157

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**× kunar : auk biurn : auk × þurkrimr × ra-... ...tain : þina · at þurst... × bruþur sin : is uas austr : tauþr · m... ...ari × auk × karþ... ...u þisi**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## U Fv1912;8

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Court-spoken meter

### Introduction

U Fv1912;8 is a small box, in which were originally found some Wiking Age scales along with a powderized organic material, probably the pouch in which the scales were originally contained. The inscription has the rare honour of containing the only authentically East Norse poetry in the Court-spoken meter.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **tiarfr × fik af × simskum × mąni × skalaʀ × þis... (×) i ...(ą)t(i) × in uirmuntr × f(a)þi × runąʀ × þisar**
§ B **fuhl × ualua × slait × (f)aluąn × fąn kauk × ą nąs au-a**

### Text

Djarfr fekk af sęmskum manni skálaʀ þęss*aʀ* í ...-*l*andi, en Vermundr fáði rúnaʀ þęssaʀ.
2 Fugl vęlva slęit fǫlvan · fann -gauk á nás- au*k*a.

Derve got these scales from a Sambian man in ...-land, but Wermund carved these runes.
The fowl tore apart the death-pale robber; one observed the swelling on the corpse-cuckoo [RAVEN/EAGLE].

---

2 vęlva 'robber' | A hapax in the entire Old Norse corpus, the word appears to be a cognate with Gothic *wilwa* 'robber, bandit' which translates Greek ἅρπαξ (Streitberg 1910, p. 175).

2 -gauk ... nás- 'corpse-cuckoo' | Taken as a compound *nás-gaukr* 'corpse-cuckoo [RAVEN/EAGLE]'.

2 au*k*a 'swelling' | Viz. from the robber's flesh.

## Vg 32

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO. The poetic nature of the inscription is suggested by the unusual word-order, as the verb *rêsþu* 'raised' is bracketed by the object *þęnna … stên* 'this stone'.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þurþr × uk : þurun × þana × risþu × stin × efti × era × alkuþan : trik**

### Text

Þórðr ok Þór·unn · þęnna rêsþu
2 stên ępti Ęrra · all-góðan dręng.

Thurfrith and Thurun raised this stone
after Er, an all-good dreng.

## Vg 59

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A large standing stone. The arrangement of the lines makes the division into three parts clear. First the prose memorial formula, then the first two lines (Eesie's poem) and finally the raisers' line.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**rifnikʀ : auk : kiali : auk : brunulfʀ : auk : kifulfʀ : satu : stin : þąnsi : iftiʀ : fut : faþur : sin : harþa : kuþąn : þign ¶ : sua : hifiʀ : ąsa : as : igi : mun : sum : kuin : ift : uir : siþąn : kaurua : ¶ : hialmʀ : auk : hiali : hiaku : runaʀ ·**

### Text

*H*ręfningʀ auk Gialli auk Bryn·ulfʀ auk Gef·ulfʀ sǫttu stên þannsi ęptiʀ Fót, fǫður sinn, harða góðan þegn.

Rafning and Yeller and Byrnulf and Yevulf set this stone after Foot, their father, a very good thane.

Svá hafiʀ Àsa, · es êgi mun
sum kvęn ępt vęr · síðan gǫrva.
Hialmʀ ok Hialli · hiǫggu rùnaʀ.

So has Eesie [made a monument], like never a wife
henceforth after her husband will make.
Helm and Helle hewed the runes.

## Vg 61 (Härlingstorp)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: tula : sati : sten : þ... ...[iʀ kʀ : sun] : sin : harþa × kuþąn : trąk : sa × ¶ uarþ : tuþr : ą : uastr:uakm : i : uikiku :**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Vg 187

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A large standing stone decorated with a cross. The runes are well preserved.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**+ giʀi · sati · stin · þana · eftiʀ · kuþa · bruþur · sin · eʀ · a ąk·lanti · altri · tynþi ×**

### Text

Gêʀi satti stên þęnna ęptiʀ Goðа, bróður sinn,
2 eʀ à Ęng-landi · aldri týnði.

Gare set this stone after Gid, his brother,
who in England lost his life.

## Vs 15 (Kyringe)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A stone with two large flat sides. The main inscription is § A, whereas the versified § B is less elaborate.

The carver Balle the Red (*Balli hinn rauði*) is also responsible for Vs 24 Hassmyra, where he calls himself *Rauð-Balliʀ* 'Red-Baller'. The unique orthography, shared ornamental style, and geographical proximity of the two stones clearly confirm their common authorship.

A notable orthographic aspect is that the carver appears to employ the short-stave forms of the runes **a** (ᛅ) and **n** (ᚿ) for the less elaborate parts of the inscription, namely his signatures on both sides, and the whole of side § B. On the other hand, the main inscription of side § A consistently uses the long-stave forms ᛋ and ᚾ.

### Runes

§ A ᚼᛁᚠᚢᛚᚠᚱ ᛫ ᚢᛁᛏ ᛫ ᚴᛁᚱᚼ ᛫ ᛘᚼᚱᚴᛁ ᛫ ᚦᛁᛋᚼ ᛫ ᚼᛏ ᛫ ᚴᚼᚢᛏ ᛫ ᚱᚼᚦᚢᚱᛋᚼᚼᚼ ᛫ ᚢᚴ ᛫ ᚴᚢᚦᛚᚢᚴ
· ᚢ ᛫ ᚴ ᛋᛁᛋᛏᚢᚱ ᛫ ᚼᚼᚾᛁᛋᚺ ᛫ ᛒᚼᚢᛁ ᛫ ᚱᛁᛏᛁ ᛫ ᛁᛋᛏᚼᚾᚼ
᛫ ᛒᚼᚢᛁ ᛫᛫ ᚴᚾᚢᛏᚱ ᛫
§ B ᛫ ᛋᛏᚼᚼ : ᚼᛁᚠᛁᚱ ᛫ ᚱᛁᛏᚼᚾ ᛫ ᚦᚼᚾ ᛫ ᛋᛏᚼᚾᛏᛏ ᛫ ᛘᚼ ᛫ ᛒᚼᚢᛁᚼᛁ[ᚾ]ᚱᛁᚢᚦᛁ ᛫ ᚢᚴᛏᛁᚱ ᛫ ᛒᚱᚢᚦ[ᚢ]ᚱ
᛫
ᛒᚼᚢᛁ

### Transliteration

§ A **᛫ higulfr ᛫ lit ᛫ kira ᛫ merki ᛫ þisa ᛫ at ᛫ ¶ knut ᛫ faþur san ᛫ uk ᛫ kuþlug · u×k sistur ᛫ hanis ᛫ bali ᛫ riti ᛫ istaen ¶ ᛫ bali ᛫᛫ knutr ᛫**
§ B **᛫ sten : hafir ᛫ ritąn ᛫ þąn ᛫ stąnta ᛫ mą ᛫ bali (h)i- rauþi ᛫ yftir ᛫ bruþ[u]r ᛫ ¶ bali**

### Text

Hęg·ulfʀ lét gęra męrki þęssa at Knút, fǫður s*i*nn, ok Guð·lôg, *
systur han*s. Balli rétti *stęin.
2 Balli. Knútr.

Hawwolf had these landmarks made after Cnut, his father, and Guthleigh, his sister. Balle erected the stone.
Balle. Cnut.

1 * | **u×k** *'and'* Vs 15 1.a han*s | **hanis** Vs 15 2 Balli. Knútr. 'Balle. Cnut.' | *carved outside of the band* Vs 15

Stên hafiʀ réttan, · þann standa má,
Balli hi*nn* rauði, · øptiʀ bróður.
Balli.

The stone has been erected, which shall stand,
by Balle the Red after his brother.
Balle.

5 Balli. 'Balle.' | *carved outside of the band* Vs 15

3 þann standa má 'which shall stand' | Implicitly: stand through the ages.

## Vs 24 (Hassmyra)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

**Vs 24** or **Hassmyrastenen** ('the Hazemoor Stone') is an 11th century stone belonging to the Central Swedish runestone tradition. The stone would originally have been placed at the farm Hassmyra (cf. l. 2 n.), but today stands at the local village outdoors museum (*hembygdsgård*) in Fläckebo, around a kilometer to the west.

All carvings on the stone are found on the single large, flat side. In the center, taking up most of the flat side's surface, is a large great beast (probably to be identified as a hart) locked in battle with a serpent, a common motif in the Urnes style, though likely with much older roots (cf. *Fáfn* 2 n.). No Christian symbolism is found, and in combination with the name *Óðin-Dísa* 'Weden-Dise' (see note), this gives the stone a pagan impression.

The inscription is found inside two bands. The first fully encloses the great beast and the serpent with which it fights. The band is not a circle, but rather has two terminating ends at the bottom of the stone. The left end has a tail, while the right has a serpentine head; the head and tail are bound together by a sort of chain-link or fetter, but the serpent is pulling its head away from the chain-link and appears to be struggling to escape. Outside of the first band on the left half of the stone, there is another band with no ornamentations. The second band closely follows the edge of the stone. Part of its text has been obliterated due to the loss of part of the stone.

The inscription itself begins in the bottom right of the first band, by the serpent's head. It thereafter continues through the first band until it runs out of space. After this 7 runes (**byi raþr**) are written on the inside of the band near the serpent's tail, apparently due to lack of space. The inscription continues in the second band, where it begins at the bottom and runs to the top of the stone, where it terminates.

Ortohgraphically, the os-rune is used for both the oral vowels *o* (**oþintisu**) and *ø* (**hulmkoetr, roþbalir**) and for nasal-adjacent *a* (**buonti, seno, þon**).

The stone is signed by the carver Balle the Red (*Rôð-Ballir*), otherwise known from Vs 15 Kyringe. It is uncertain whether Balle the Red is to be identified with Balle, a prolific carver chiefly active in western Uppland.

### Runes

ᛒᚢᚾᛏᛁ × ᚴᚢᚦᚱ × ᚼᚢᚱᛘᚴᛅᛏᚱ × ᚢᛁᛏ × ᚱᚨᚬᛅ × ᚢᚠᛏᚨᚼ × ᚼᚦᛁᛏᛁᚬᚢ × ᚴᚢᚾᚢ × ᚬᚾᚼ × ᚴᚢᛘᛒᚱ × ᚼᛁᚠᚱᛒᛋ × ᛏᛁᚱ × ᚼᛁᚬᚢᛁᛘᚢᚱᚨ × ᛁᚴᛁᛒᚨᛏᚱ × ᚦᚼᚨ ᛒᛋᛁᚱᛁᚦᚱ
ᚱᚼᚦᛒᚨᚢᛁᚱ × ᚱᛁᚬᛏᛁ × ᚱᚢᚾᛁ × ᚦᛁᚬᛅ × ᚬᛁᚴᛘᚢᚾᛏᛁᚼ × ᚢᛁᚼ ... ᚬᚾᚬᛏᚼ × ᚴᚢᚦ

## Transliteration

**buąnti × kuþr × hulmkątr × lit × resa × ufteʀ × ąþintisu × kunu × seną × kumbr × hifrya × til × hasuimura × ikibetr × þąn × byiraþr**
**rąþbalir × risti × runi × þisa × sikmuntaʀ × uaʀ ... sestʀ × kuþ**

## Text

Bóandi góðr Holm·gôtr lét rêsa øptiʀ Óðin-Dísu, konu sĭna.
Kombr hí-fręyja · til Hǫs*u*-mýra
êgi bętri, · þôn býi ráðr.
Rôð-Balliʀ rísti · rùniʀ þęssaʀ.
Sig·mundaʀ vaʀ *Óðin-Dísa* · systiʀ góð.

The good farmer Holmgeat had this stone raised after Weden-Dise, his wife.
There will come to Hazemoor no better
housewife who rules the farmstead.
Red-Ball carved these runes.
To Syemund Weden-Dise was a good sister.

---

2 Hǫs*u*-mýra 'Hazemoor' | **hasm=uimura** Vs 24 5 *Óðin-Dísa* | *obliterated* Vs 24

---

1 Óðin-Dísu 'Weden-Dise' | This name is unusual for two reasons. Firstly, the god *Óðinn* 'Weden', is poorly attested as the first element (proterotheme) in a dithematic proper name (the only other North Germanic runic example is the Danish name *Óðin·kǫrr*, Peterson 2007, p. 171). Secondly, dithematic proper names are, in general, not allowed to be weak. The best solution to this problem is to see *Dísa* as the woman's full name, and *Óðin-* as a prefix rather than a true prototheme. The prefixing of the god to the shortened form of her name (equivalent to something like "Church-Betty") would then derive from her particular devotion to the god Weden, something corroborated by the lack of Christian symbols or language on the stone; cf. Vikstrand (2009, p. 21).

2 Hǫs*u*-mýra 'Hazemoor' | The Old Norse gen. pl. form of the ancestor of Swedish *Hassmyra*, a place name which remains in use to this day. The sequence **m=ui** should be understood as the result of a mistake by the carver, since neither the mediæval form *Hasumyr-* (Fridell 2013, p. 179) nor the modern Swedish form of the name permit the sequence *-mvi-* in this position. Fridell (2013) most reasonably explains the error in the following way: after carving **has**, the carver left out the **u** and carved **hasm** along with the vertical stave of the **u**, which now appears as an **i**. He thereafter corrected **hasm** to **hasu** by carving the sloping stave of the **u** on the vertical stave of the **m**, but since the vertical stave of the following incomplete **u** was too close, he left it unpainted and instead carved the following **m** rune. When painted, **hasm=uimura** would thus have read **hasumura**. Cf. Fig. 1 in Fridell (2013, p. 178).

3 þôn | The Old Swedish nom. sg. f. demonstrative pronoun, here used as a relative pronoun. *þôn*, which is also found in the eastern Old Swedish laws, is a monophthongised form of *þaun* as found in Old Gutnish, which is probably originally derived by analogy from the neuter plural (Old West Norse *þau*). Old West Norse and the West-Geatish Law instead retain the older *sú* (cf. Gothic *só*), though the latter also has *þý* (SSGL 13, s.vv. *þæn, su*).

5 *Óðin-Dísa* | A part of the band which would have fit approximately 8–10 runes is chipped off, but the space is perfectly compatible with the name *Óðin-Dísa*, which has thus been inserted.

## Ög 8 (Kälvesten)

**Dating:** C9th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A remarkably old stone. Both orthography and the shape of runes agree very closely with the Ög 136 Rök.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A **stikuʀ (’) karþi kubl þ(a)^(u) aft auint sunu sin ’ sa fial austr**
§ B **miʀ aiuisli ’ uikikʀ faþi auk| |krimulfʀ**

### Text

Styggʀ gęrði kumbl þau apt Ęy·vind, sunu sinn.
2 Sá fiall austr · meðʀ Ęiv·ísli.
Víkingʀ fáði ok Grím·ulfʀ.

Stig made these monuments after Eanwind, his son.
He fell in the east with Awyils.
Wiking and Grimwolf painted.

## Ög 66

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The incorrect use of **h** (**halkuþan** **all-góðan*, **it** *'êt* for **hêt*) indicates that the sound has been dropped

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: ikiualtr : ristþi : stin : þisi : eftiʀ : stufialt : bruþur : sin : suain : halkuþan : sun sbialbuþa : it : inik : ant**

### Text

Ingi·valdr rǫisti stǫin þǫ*nn*si ǫptiʀ Styfj·ald, bróður sinn,
2 svǫin *all-góðan, · sun Spiall·buða.
'Êt inni'k ǫnt.

Ingold raised this stone after Stivold, his brother,
an all-good swain, Spellbid's son.
I declare the promise fulfilled.

## Ög 68

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO. Wering may be identified with the man of the same name mentioned on the non-metrical Ög 111.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**suina × karþi × bru × þesi × eftiʀ × ouint × bruþur × sin × han × uas × uesteʀ × tauþeʀ × i × uereks × (k)ai-i**

### Text

Svęina gęrði bró þęssi ęptiʀ Ęy·vind, bróður sinn.
2 Hann vas vestʀ dauðʀ · í Vęrings **†kai-i†**.

Swanie made this bridge after Eanwind, her brother.
He died in the west in the Wering's ...

## Ög 77

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**: tuna : sati : stin : þ-... --ᴛʀ : sin : uar : þurfast : uas han : man : mist : uniþik ·**

### Text

Tonna satti stên *þ*ę*nna* ę*pti*ʀ sinn vęr Þȯr·fast.
2 Vas hann man*na* · męst*r* ȯ·níðing*ʀ*

Tonne set this stone after her husband, Thurfast.
He was of men the greatest un-nithing.

2 man*na* | **man** Ög 77 2 męst*r* | **mist** Ög 77 2 ȯ·níðing*ʀ* | **uniþik** Ög 77

2 Vas hann man*na* · męst*r* ȯ·níðing*ʀ* 'He was of men the greatest un-nithing' | Found near-identically in Sm 5 and Sm 37.

# Ög 81 (Högby)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

## Introduction

A stone standing at the former site of the mediaeval Högby church, into which it was once bricked in. The stone is inscribed on 2 sides, A and B.

The orthography is notable, since old *ęi* is consistently written as a monophthong, while old *au* is still written as a diphthong. This unusual variation is reflected in the standardized orthography.

Thurkettle, the carver, also signed Ög 82, Ög 84 and Ög 165 (Skänninge, see below), and is the likely carver of Ög 83 (TODO: cite Östergötlands runinskrifter).

## Runes

TODO: Runes

## Transliteration

§ A · **þukir · resþi · stin · þansi · eftiʀ · asur · sen · muþur·bruþur · sin · iaʀ · eataþis · austr · i · krikum ·**
§ B · **kuþr · karl · kuli · kat · fim · syni · feal · ą · furi · frukn · treks · asmutr · aitaþis · asur · austr · i krikum · uarþ · ą hulmi · halftan · tribin · kari · uarþ · at uti · ¶ auk · tauþr · bui · þurkil · rist · runaʀ ·**

## Text

Þor·gęrðr rêsþi stên þannsi ęptiʀ Qss·ur sên, móður-bróður sinn,
iaʀ ęndaðis · austr ĩ Grikkjum.

Thurgerd raised this stone after Answer the slow, her mother's brother who met his end to the east in Greece.

Góðr karl Gulli · gat fimm syni;
fiall à Fýri · frǿkn drękgʀ Ǫs·mundr,
ęndaðis Qss·urr · austr ĩ Grikkjum,
varð à Holmi · Half·dan drepinn,
Kári varð at Uddi, · auk dauðr Bói.
Þòr·kell rêst rùnaʀ.

The good churl Gull begat five sons.
On Fyre fell the brave dreng Osmund;

Answer met his end to the east in Greece;
upon Holm was Halfden slain;
Cheer was [slain] by Orde, also dead is Bo.
Thurkettle carved the runes.

## Ög 136 (Rök)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

Due to its great length, use of ciphers, unique content and damage in one part the Rök stone is certainly the most difficult runestone to interpret and explain. A full-length treatment could easily take up a 300-page book and therefore the present is only an excerpt of the immediately introductory prose passage followed by the 4-line stanza.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[...] ᚠ þat sakum ąna¶rt huaʀ fur niu altum ą n urþi fiaru ¶ miʀ hraiþkutum auk tu ¶ miʀ ąn ubsakaʀ ¶ raiþ| |þiaurikʀ hin þurmuþi stiliʀ ¶ flutna strąntu hraiþmaraʀ sitiʀ nu karuʀ ą**
§ B **kuta sinum skialti ub fatlaþʀ skati marika**

### Text

> [...] Þat sǫgum annart, hvaʀ fór níu aldum à, ęn urði fiaru meðʀ Hrętið-gutum, ok dó meðʀ àn of·sakaʀ.

This I say secondly, who journeyed upon the nine waves but struck the shore amidst the Reth-Gots and died amidst them without guilt.

> Rętið Þiau·ríkʀ, · hinn þor-móði
> stilliʀ flutna, · strǫndu Hrętið-maraʀ;
> sitiʀ nú gǫruʀ · à guta sĭnum,
> skialdi of fatlaðr, · skati Mętringa.

Thedric rode, the daring-minded
controller of sailors, upon the Rethmare shore.
Now he sits ready upon his horse,
his shield strapped, the lord of Meerings.

## Ög 155

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Speeches-meter

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**þurfriþ × risti × eftiʀ × askut × auk × kauta sunu × sina × stin × þasi × han × kuti × etaþis × i × ikuars × hilfniki ×**

### Text

Þór·fríðr rêsti ęptiʀ Ǫs·gaut ok Gauta, sunu sina, stên þa*nn*si.
2 Hann Gauti ęndaðis · í Ing·vars hęlfningi.

Thurfride raised after Osgeat and Geat, her sons, this stone.
Geat met his end in Ingwar's ship-troop.

## Ög 165 (Skänninge)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A tall standing stone from Skänninge. The carver, Thurkettle, is the same as that of Ög 81; see there.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

§ A (·) **þurun · risti · auk × þiʀ × bruþr × suniʀ :**
§ B **× tusta × iftiʀ · sin · faþur**
§ C **× þurkil×k rist × stin : þansi : aufti : tusta :**

### Text

Þòr·unn rêsti · auk þêʀ bróðr,
2 synir Tosta, · eptiʀ sinn fǫður.
Þòr·kell 'k rêst stên þannsi øpti Tosta.

Thurun raised [the stone] along with her brothers
the sons of Toste, after their father.
I, Thurkettle, carved this stone after Toste.

---

1 rêsti 'raised [the stone]' | The wording is so formulaic that the object can be left out without any injury to the sense.

## Ög 212

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The stone is lost. TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**[tula : risti : stina : iftiʀ · buka : auk · bru þa:si : ai : buna · þn]**

### Text

Tóla rêsti stêna ęptiʀ Bukka
2 auk bró þási · a*t* bón*d*a þ*a*nn.

Toole raised these stones after Bucke,
and this bridge after that husband.

## Öl 1 (Karlevi)

**Dating:** C10th–C11th
**Meter:** Court-spoken meter

### Introduction

Although technically outside of the scope of the present edition by virtue of its being a Scaldic composition in the Court-spoken meter, the Karlevi runestone is of such importance that its inclusion was felt imperative.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**+ s-a... --(s)- i(a)s · satr · aiftir · si(b)(a) · kuþa · sun · fultars · in hąns ·· liþi · sati · at · u · (t)ausaiþ?... +: fulkin : likr : hins : fulkþu : flaistr (:)· uisi · þat · maistar · taiþir : tulka · þruþar : traukr : i : þaimsi · huki · munat : raiþ:uiþur : raþa : ruk:starkr · i · tanmarku : --ntils : iarmun··kruntar : urkrąntari : ląnti**

### Text

> Stęinn sási ias sattr ęptir Sibba góða son Foldars, en hans liði satti at ô **†(t)ausaiþ?...†**

This stone is set after Sib the Good, son of Folder, but his retinue set it upon the island ...

> Folginn liggr hinn's fylgðu, · —flęstr vissi þat—męstar
> dęðir, dolga Þrúðar · draugr, ĩ þęimsi haugi;
> mun-at ręið-Viðurr ráða, · róg-starkr, ĩ Dan-mǫrku,
> *Ę*ndils jǫrmun-grundar, · ør·grandari, landi.

Hidden lies the one whom the greatest deeds followed—most men knew that—the tree of the enmities of Thrith [BATTLES > WARRIOR] within this mound.
No more upright strife-strong Wither of the chariot of Andle's immense ground [SEA > SHIP > SEAFARER] will wield land in Denmark.

## Öl 39 (Bägby)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Runes

TODO: Runes

### Transliteration

**× sua(i)(n) kiarþi × iftiʀ × sin × faþur × uikar × sun × ainiki × sialfʀ × raisti × stain ×**

### Text

Svęinn giarði ęptiʀ sinn fǫður, Vík·ar,
2 sunn ęin=igi · sialfr ręisti stęin.

Swain made [this] after his father, Wicker;
the only son raised the stone by himself.

## Index of proper nouns

TODO.

## Index of carvers

TODO.

# Runic Poetry from Denmark and Scania

## Introduction

The signa used for Danish inscriptions vary. According to the more common system all Danish inscriptions are numbered according to a unitary system based on the Danish corpus edition, which unlike the Swedish one is not divided into provinces. The online database *Danske Runeindskrifter* ('Danish Runic Inscriptions') does however follow a system identical to the Swedish one, and since those signa are easier to work with due to the ability immediately to identify the origin of any given inscription, it has been adopted here, although references to the DR signa are given in parentheses following the origin.

### Abbreviations of Danish regions

- Bh = Bornholm
- MJy = Midtjylland (Middle Jutland)
- NJy = Nordjylland (North Jutland)
- Sj = Sjælland (Zealand)
- SJy = Sønderjylland (South Jutland)
- SlB = Slesvig By (the town of Slesvig)
- Sk = Skåne (Scania)
- Syd = Lolland-Falster

## Bh 33 (DR 379; Nylarsker-sten 1)

**Dating:** C11th–12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

**sasur · lit · resa · sten · eftiʀ · aluarþ · faþur · sin · truknaþi · han · uti · meþ · ala · sk¶libara · etki · i · kristr · hab¶(i) ¶ siolu ¶ has ¶ sten · þesi · stai ¶ eftir**

### Text

Sassurr lét rêsa stên ęptiʀ Hall·varð, fǫður sinn.
Druknaði hann úti · með alla skipara.
**†etki†** é Kristr hialpi siólu hans.
Stênn þęssi · stái ęptiʀ.

Saswer had this stone raised after Hallward, his father.
He drowned far out with all the shipmen.
...may Christ always help his soul.
May this stone afterwards stand.

## Bh 34 (DR 380; Nylarsker-sten 2)

**Dating:** C11th–12th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

**kobu:suain : raisti : stain : þ(e)na : a(f)tir : bausa : sun : sin : tr(i)... ...n : þan : is : tribin : ua(r)þ : i : (u)(r)ostu : at : ut:la(n)(k)iu : kuþ : tr(u)tin : hi(a)lbi : hans : ont : auk : sata : mikial :**

### Text

Kǫ́pu-Sveinn rę́isti stę́in þę́nna ę́ptir Bausa, sun sinn,
2 dręng góðan, · þann es drepinn varð
í orrostu · at Út-lęngju.
4 Guð dróttinn hialpi hans ǫnd auk santa Mikael.

Cloak-Swain raised this stone after Beaze, his son,
the good dreng who was slain
in battle by Utlengie.
Lord God and Saint Michael help his spirit.

---

4 santa Mikael 'Saint Michael' | Something of a patron saint on Bornholm, also invoked in Bh 1, Bh 4, and Bh 49. Cf. Syd 11 below.

## Bh 42 (DR 387; Vestermarie-sten 5)

**Dating:** C11th–12th
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

**: asualdi : risti : stein : þinsa : iftʀ : alfar : bruþur : sin : drinr : koþr ¶ : trebin u:syni : auk : skogi : suek : saklausan :**

## Text

Ǫs·valdi rísti stęin þęnnsa ęptiʀ Alf·ar, bróður sinn,
2 dręngr góðr · drepinn ù·sẏni,
auk Skógi svęik sak-lausan.

Oswald carved this stone after Elver, his brother;
the good dreng [was] shamefully slain
and Skoog betrayed him, guiltless.

## MJy 37 (DR 94; Ålum-sten 1)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

**tuli : (r)(i)s-(i) : stin : þasi : aft ¶ ikal:t : sun : sin : miuk (:) (k)¶(u)... ...k : þau : mun(u) ¶ mini : m-(r)gt : ¶ iuf (:) þirta :**

### Text

Tóli rêsþi stên þannsi apt Ingj·ald sun sinn, miok góðan *drę*ng.
2 Þau munu minni · m*ę*rkt ê of *b*irta.

Toole raised this stone after Ingeld, his son, a very good dreng.
TODO.

## MJy 71 (DR 131; Års-sten)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

§ A **: ąsur : sati : stin : þąnsi : aft : ual:tuka : trutin : ¶ × sin**
§ B **× stin : kuask : hirsi : stąnta : łąki : saʀ : ual:tuka × ¶ × uarþa : nafni**

### Text

Ǫnsurr satti stên þannsi apt Val-Tóka, dróttin sinn.
2 Stênn kweðsk hérsi · standa lęngi;
sáʀ Val-Tóka · varða nęfni.

Answer set this stone after Wal-Took, his lord.
The stone proclaims it will stand here for long;
may it name Wal-Took's cairn.

---

3 varða 'cairn' | Acc. sg. of *varði* 'cairn or beacon raised as a landmark'. The word still survives in Danish *varde* 'id.', Faroese *varði* 'id.'

## MJy 79 (DR 68; Århus-sten 5)

**Dating:** C10th–11th
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

A well-preserved stone with a small piece struck off at the lower corner at the very beginning of the inscription.

### Transliteration

§ A **(-)usti × auk × hufi × auk × þir × frebiurn × risþu × stin × þąnsi × eftiʀ × ¶ × ąsur × saksa × filaka × sin × harþa ×**
§ B **kuþan × trik × saʀ × tu × ¶ × mana × mest × uniþikʀ × ¶ saʀ × ati × skib × miþ × arną +**

### Text

*T*osti auk Hófi þêʀ Frô·biorn rêsþu stên þannsi ęptiʀ Ǫnsur saxa,
fé-laga sinn, harða góðan dręng.
2 Sáʀ dó manna · męst ù·níðingʀ;
sár átti skip með Arna.

Toste and Hove, they and Freabern raised this stone after Answer the seax, his partner, a very good dreng.
He died the greatest un-nithing of men;
he owned a ship with Arnie.

## NJy 41 (DR 149; Ydby-sten)

**Dating:** C10th–11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The inscription is entirely poetic. The stone is heavily damaged and divided into several parts but the inscription survives in older depictions.

### Transliteration

§ A **þurkisl : [sati · au(k) (·) suniʀ (·) lifa · i] : s[t]aþ [· þa]¶:nsi :**
§ B **[sti](n) (÷) (u)[ftiʀ · lifa]**

### Text

Þór·gísl satti · ok syniʀ Lêfa
2 í stað þannsi · stên øptiʀ Lêfa.

Thuryils set and the sons of Lofe
in this place the stone after Lofe.

## Sj 93 (DR 229; Sandby-sten 3)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A heavily damaged stone, the verse can be tentatively reconstructed based on Syd 11.

### Transliteration

§ A **sylfa : rest... ... ...i : sbalklusu : eyfti : susur : faþur ... ...(r)þi : bru : þisi : iki : ¶ þurils : brþur : sin :**
§ B **i mun · san... ¶ ...if · uitrik · susi · ᴇʀ · uan · sil...**

### Text

Sylfa rêst*i stên þannsi* í Spalk-lôsu øpti Susur, fǫður *sinn, ok gę*rði
bró þęssi ę*pt*i Þòr·ils, bróður sinn.
2 Ê mun st*an*d*a, · með stênn á l*if,
vitring súsi, · ᴇʀ vann Syl*fa*.

Silve raised this stone in Spalklease after Saswer, his father, and made this bridge after Thuryils, his brother.
Ever will stand while the stone has life
this memento which Silve accomplished.

## SJy 5 (DR 37; Egtved-sten)

**Dating:** C10th–11th
**Meter:** Unclear

### Introduction

A fragmented stone; the remaining piece is easily read, but a large part is missing.

### Transliteration

**... ... ...at ’ fai(n) [’] (t)u ÷ i suiu ’ raist ¶ ... ...uþiʀ ’ aft ’ bruþur ¶ stain ’ sasi ’ skarni ’ ...**

### Text

... at fáinn; dó í Svíu.
Rǫist *iak rúnaʀ,*
*b*róðiʀ apt bróður;
stǫin sási skǫrni ...

the painted; died in Sweden.
I carved the runes,
a brother after [my] brother;
may this stone TODO ...

## SJy 14 (DR 40; Randbøl-sten)

**Dating:** C10th
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

A rare instance of a stone carved by a man for his wife.

### Transliteration

**tufi ÷ bruti ÷ risþi ÷ stin ÷ þansi ÷ aft ÷ lika ÷ ¶ brutia ÷ þiʀ ÷ stafaʀ ÷ munu ÷ ¶ þurkuni ÷ miuk ÷ liki ÷ lifa ÷**

### Text

Tófi bryti rêsþi stên þannsi apt líka brytja.
2 þêʀ stafaʀ · munu þór·gunni
miok lęngi lifa.

Tove the bailiff raised this stone after the bailiff's helpmate.
These staves will for Thurguth
for a very long time live.

---

1 líka 'helpmate' | Or 'equal, match'. Although grammatically masculine (the nom. sg. is *líki*) the word can be used for both genders, as here.

3 lifa 'live' | Stones and staves 'living' is a common expression.

## Sk 5 (DR 263; Skabersjö-fibula)

**Dating:** C8th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

**§ P ... ʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀ -aþi tuk fauka fiaʀ sis in a iak as(u) (þ)ui launat ¶ ... auab-k sua fakat...**
**§ Q ... (ʀ)(ʀ)ʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀʀ (r)aþi (t)(u)k fauka fiaʀ sis in a iak asa þui launat ¶ ... auab-k sua fakat...**

### Text

TODO: text

TODO: trans

## Sk 42 (DR 337; Valleberga-sten)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

A stone. TODO.

### Transliteration

§ A **: suin : auk : þurgutr : kiaurþu : kubl : þisi ¶ eftiʀ : mana ¶ auk · suina**
§ B **kuþ : hialbi : siaul : þeʀa : uel : ian : þeʀ : likia : i : luntunum**

### Text

Svênn auk Þòr·gôtr giǫrðu kumbl þęssi ęptiʀ Manna auk Svenna.
Guð hialpi siǫl þêʀa vęl,
2 ian þêʀ liggja · í Londúnum.

Swayn and Thurgeat made these monuments after Manny and Swenny. God help their soul well,
but they lie in London.

## Sk 51 (DR 279; Sjörup-sten)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

TODO.

The incorrect use of **h** in **huptiʀ** *øptiʀ* and the lack of it in **an** *'ann* (= ON *hann* 'he') **a(f)þi** *'afði* (= ON *hafði* 'had') indicates the common East Norse loss of that phoneme.

### Transliteration

**[+ sa]ksi : sati : st[in] : þasi : huftiʀ : ą[s]biurn : (s)in : fil(a)gą ' ¶ (t)u-a[s : sun :] ¶ saʀ : flu : aki : a[t :] ub:sal(u)m : an : ua : maþ : an : u¶abn : a(f)þi '**

### Text

Saxi satti stên þa*nn*si øptiʀ Ǫs·biorn, sinn fé-laga, Tó*k*a* sun.
2 Sáʀ fló êgi · at Upp-sǫlum,
ęn vá, með 'ann vǫ́pn 'afði.

Saxe set this stone after Osbern, his partner, Took's son.
He did not flee at Upsele
but fought as long as he had weapons.

## Sk 80 (DR 295; Hällestad-sten 1)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

§ A **: askil : sati : stin : þansi : ift[ᛁᚱ] ¶ : tuka : kurms : sun : sᛅᚱ : hulan : ¶ trutin : sᛅᚱ : flu : aigi : at : ub:¶:salum**
§ B **satu : trikᛅᚱ : iftᛁᚱ : sin : bruþr ¶ stin : ą : biarki : stuþan : runum : þᛁᚱ :**
§ C **(k)(u)(r)(m)(s) (:) (t)(u)(k)(a) : kiku : (n)(i)(s)(t)[ᛁᚱ]**

### Text

Ǫs·kęll satti stên þannsi ęptiʀ Tóka, Gorms sun, séʀ hollan drót-
tin;
sáʀ fló ęigi · at Upp-sǫlum.
Sǫttu dręngaʀ · ęptiʀ sinn bróður
stên á biargi · stuððan rúnum;
þêʀ Gorms Tóka · gingu nęstiʀ.

Oskettle set this stone after Took, Gorm's son, to him a trusty lord;
he did not flee at Upsele.
The drengs set after their brother
a stone on the hill propped up by runes;
they marched closest to Gorm's Took.

## Sk 81 (DR 296; Hällestad-sten 2)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

TODO.

### Transliteration

**: ąskautr : ristþi : stin : þansi (:) ¶ (:) (i)ftiʀ : airu : brþur : sin : ian : ¶ : saʀ : uas : him:þiki : tuka : nu : ¶ : skal : statą : stin : ą : biarki :**

### Text

Ọs·gautr rêsþi stên þannsi ęptiʀ Ęiru, bróður sinn, ian sáʀ vas hêm-þęgi Tóka.Nú skal standa · stên à biargi.

Osgeat raised this stone after Ore, his brother, and he was Took's retainer. Now shall stand the stone on the hill.

## SlB 3 (DR Schl3; Slesvig-pind)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Leeds-meter

### Introduction

A rune-inscribed stick containing a puerile curse.

### Transliteration

§ A **runaʀ ÷ iag ÷ risti ÷ a ÷ rikiata ÷ tre sua**
§ B **reþ ÷ saʀ ÷ riki ÷ mo(g)ʀ ÷ asiʀ ÷ a ÷ artagum**
§ C **hulaʀ ÷ auk ÷ bulaʀ ÷ meli ÷ þeʀ**
§ D **ars ÷ sum ÷ magi**

### Text

Rúnaʀ iak rísti · á ríkjanda tré
svá réð sáʀ ríki mǫgr;
ęsiʀ á ár-dǫgum · hullaʀ ok bullaʀ
męli þéʀ ars sum magi.

Runes I carve on the powerful wood;
so did the powerful boy counsel:
The Eese in days of yore, hurlies and burlies,
may thy arse speak like thy belly!

## Syd 11 (DR 212; Tillitse-sten)

**Dating:** C11th
**Meter:** Ancient-words-lay

### Introduction

The stone actually has three sides, but § C is by a different carver and dedicated to a different person; as such it ought to be treated as a separate inscription and not included.

### Transliteration

§ A **eskil : sulka : sun : let : res(a) ¶ sten : þena : eft : sialfan ¶ sik · e mun · stanta · meþ · sten ¶ lifiʀ · uitrint · su · iaʀ · uan · eskil**
§ B **kristr · hialbi · siol · hans ¶ aok · santa · migael**

### Text

Ėȩs·kil, Súlka sun, lét rêsa stên þęnna ępt sialfan sik.
É mun standa, · með stênn lifiʀ,
vitrind sú · iaʀ vann Ėȩs·kil.
Kristr hialpi siól hans auk santa Mikael.

Oskettle, Sulk's son, had this stone raised after himself.
Ever will stand while the stone lives
this memento which Oskettle accomplished.
Christ and Saint Michael help his soul.

# Index

# Index (INCOMPLETE!)

NOTE: This index is both incomplete and inconsistently formatted and should not be relied on. New entries will be added and old ones corrected and expanded in the future. For an example of a complete entry see Yimer.

## Cultural and religious terms and expressions (C)

**ape** (ON *api*, OE *apa*, OS *apo*, OHG *affo*, PNWGmc. **apó*) In the Old Norse the word seems to mean 'fool, buffoon', in the other old languages apparently 'monkey', though this sense should be a later development of the former; why would the early Germanic tribes have a word for an animal that they had never encountered?

**aught** (ON *ętt*, OE *æht* 'possession, property') The Nordic (paternal) clan or family line.

**begale** (OHG *bi·galan*) To enchant, bewitch something or someone by singing a galder. Transitive of gale.

**bigh** (ON *baugr*, OE *béag*, OHG *boug*) Armlets used as currency during the Migration Period. — The giving of rings and armlets in exchange for loyalty (holdness being the word used for a warrior's loyalty towards his lord, and of a lord's grace towards his servants) was common across all of Germanic Europe, as seen in the many poetic ruler-kennings of the type "breaker of rings" (e.g. *béaga brytta* 'the breaker of bighs' in *Beow* ll. 35, 352, 1487). An illustrative example of this is *Hild* 33–35. This is also connected with the oath-ring, and the famous ring-swords. TODO? reference some literature on this.

**bloot** (ON *blót*, OE *blót*, OHG *bluoz*) A sacrifice or a sacrificial feast, one of the best attested Germanic pagan practices. The animals would be sacrificed by the host, cooked in large kettles and eaten communally. See also bloot-house.

**bloot-house** (ON *blót-hús*, OHG *bluoz-hús*) A heathen temple. Glosses Latin *fānum* in OHG. See also harrow, hove, wigh.

**Doom** (ON *dómr*, OE *dóm*) 'judgment, verdict' (whence Doomsday, 'Judgment Day'), but also 'fame'. See *Háv* 77.

**feather-hame** (ON *fjaðr-hamr*, OE *feðer-hama*, OS *feðar-*, *feðer-hamo*) A plumage which when donned by the wearer lets him fly like, or become a bird. One is owned by Frow and used by Lock to fly between the homes in *Þrk*. In the Christian *Heli* feather-hames are donned by angels who fly from heaven to earth. See also hame.

**fee** (ON *fé*, OE *féoh*) Originally 'cattle, kine', however also used in a broader sense to refer to one's mobile wealth; for that cf. particularly *Háv*.

**fey** (ON *fęigr*, OE *fæge*, OHG *feigi* 'cowardly') Being doomed or fated to die, with a sense of predestination and inevitability. Its earliest documented Scandinavian use is on the Rök stone: **aft uamuþ stąnta runaʀ þaʀ + n uarin faþi faþiʀ aft *faikiąn* sunu** *Apt Vámóð standa rúnaʀ þáʀ, en Varinn fáði, faðir aft* fęigjan *sonu* 'After Woemood (*Vámóðr*) stand these runes, but Warren (*Varinn*) painted, the father after the **fey** son.' See PCRN HS II:35, p. 928 ff. (TODO)

**feyness** (ON *fęigð*) The state of being fey.

**fimble-** (ON *fimbul-*) The ultimate, final, greatest. See Fimblethyle, Fimble-Winter.

**five days** (ON *fimm dagar*) The Old Scandinavian (and perhaps Germanic) week was originally five days long, the seven-day week being a later import, as seen by the names of the days, which are obviously calqued from the Latin (*Dies Mercurii* = Weden's day, et.c.). According to the *Gula* there were six weeks in a month, and "five days" is used as a generic period of time in *Háv* 51 and 74; in st. 74 it is contrasted with month. Related to this is the legal term *fifth* (ON *fimmt*, OSw. *fæmt*), a meeting or gathering set to be held at a five-day notice. See *fimt* in CV, LMNL for further discussion.

**galder** (ON *galdr*, OE *gealdor*, OHG *galdar*) A magical song or incantation, probably synonymous with leed. Verbal noun formed to gale 'to sing, chant'.

**gale** (ON *gala*, OE *galan*, OHG *galan*) To sing, chant, especially of magical songs; verbal root of galder 'something sung, chanted'.

**gand** (ON *gandr*, Latin *gandus*) A witch's familiar or foul spirit sent out to do her bidding. See PCRN HS I:17, p. 361 and II:26, p. 656. TODO

**gid** (ON *goði*, OE *Gydda* m. given name) A heathen priest or master of ceremonies.

**gidden** (ON *gyðja*, OE *gyden* 'goddess') The womanly equivalent or wife of a gid.

**good of meat** (ON *matar góðr*, *góðr matar*) An old formula appearing in *Háv* 39 and numerous Swedish Wiking Age Runic inscriptions Sm 39, Sm 44, Sö 130, U 703, and U 805. Cf. U 739 which has the related *mildr mataʀ* 'mild of meat'. Antonyms are *matar illr* 'evil of meat' and meat-nithing.

**guest** (ON *gęstr*, OE *giest*, OS *gast*, OHG *gast*, Got. *gasts*, PGmc. *gastiz*) Guests were often strangers, wanderers, who would come to beg for food and lodgings. The Old Germanic peoples placed great value on hospitality. TODO.

**hame** (ON *hamr*) A skin, shape. People could "shift hames" (ON *skipta hǫmum*), leaving their human hames behind and instead entering into the shapes of wolves, bears, birds. During this process the original hame, that is, the human body, would be sleeping in a vulnerable state. A concise description of this is found in *Yng* 7: *Óðinn* skipti hǫmum*, lá þá búkr'inn sem sofinn eða dauðr, en hann var þá fugl eða dýr, fiskr eða ormr, ok fór á einni svipstund á fjarlæg lǫnd at sínum erendum eða annarra manna.* 'Weden *shifted hames*; then lay the trunk of his body as if sleeping or dead, but he was then a fowl or beast, a fish or serpent, and journeyed in a short while to foreign lands with his errands or those of other men.'.

See also feather-hame, fence-rideresses, evening-rideresses.

**harrow** (ON *hǫrgr*, OE *hearg*, PNWGmc. **harugaʀ*) A hallowed stone structure. *Hdl* 10 describes the construction of one. The Norwegian laws prescribe the "breaking of harrows and burning of hoves". — See also hove, wigh.

**hold** (ON *hollr*, OE *hold*, OS *hold*, OHG *hold*) 'Favourable, loyal, gracious', often of a ruler towards his subject (in the sense of 'gracious, benevolent') or vice-versa (in the sense of 'loyal, devoted'). Mirroring these earthly relationships, it is often used to refer to divine grace, both of the Christian God—thus in the *Ecclesiastical Laws of King Cnut* ALIE I (p. 372): *Þam byþ witod-líce God hold, þe bið his hlâforde riht-líce hold* 'Indeed God is **hold** to him who is rightly **hold** to his lord'—but in the oldest Scandinavian material likewise of the Heathen gods. So *Lok* 4 (e.): *holl regin* '**hold** Reins', and *Oddr* 9/1: *Svá hjalpi þér · hollar véttir* 'So help thee **hold** wights'.

This word is common in old Scandinavian oath formulæ, e.g. in the elder redaction of the West-Geatish Law: *Svá sé mér goð holl* 'So may the Gods(!) be **hold** to me,' in mediaeval Norwegian laws (NGL II[197,397]) and Grey-Goose (TODO: cite): *Guð sé mér hollr ef ek satt segi, gramr ef ek lýg* 'God be **hold** to me if I speak truly, wroth if I lie,' in Grey-Goose (TODO) also: *Sé guð hollr þeim er heldr griðum, en gramr þeim er grið rýfr* 'God be **hold** to him who keeps the truce, but wroth against him who breaks the truce'. I refer to Läffler (1895) for further discussion on these formulæ.

**holdness** (ON *hylli*, OE *hyldu*, OHG *huldí*) Abstract noun formed to hold, meaning 'favour, loyalty, grace,' with the same semantics as the adjective.

Notably, this word appears three times in connection with the grace of gods in the poetry, namely in *Grm* 43, where (according to my interpretation) the preparer of food at the bloot is said to earn the "**holdness** of Wolder and of all the gods;" and *Grm* 53 where the disgraced king Garfrith is said to have been bereft of the support *gęngi* of Weden and all the Oneharriers, and of "Weden's **holdness**" (*Óðins hylli*). "Weden's holdness" is also mentioned in a stanza by Hallfrith (edited as Hfr Lv 7 by Diana Whaley in SkP V), who laments that: "The whole race of man has wrought songs to win the **holdness** of Weden; I recall the fully rewarded works of our kinsmen/ancestors."

From the semantics of this word the Germanic view on heavenly grace is clear: the Gods are **hold** towards those who do good works, which include swearing true oaths, faithfully observing truces, partaking in the bloot, following rules of hospitality, and composing poetry—and gram 'wroth' towards those who do the opposite.

**Home** (ON *hęimr*, OE *hám*, PNWGmc. **haimaʀ*) In the Norse often referring to a realm in the cosmology (*Vsp* 2: "I remember nine **Homes**", *Vafþ* TODO: "From the runes of the Ettins and of all the gods I can speak truly, for I have come into each **Home**"). Thus Ettinham is the '**Home**/realm of the ettins'. When used on its own it means 'the world (that we inhabit)'. See also Nine Homes, Thrithham.

**holy** (ON *hęilagr*) TODO.

**hove** (ON *hof*) A pre-Christian temple. See bloot-house, harrow.

**leat** (ON *hlaut*) In some saws explained as the blood drained from the offered animal; the verbal root is *hljóta* 'to get by lot' and this word certainly refers to the use of the blood for auguries.

**leat-twig** (ON *hlaut-tęinn*) A twig used to sprinkle the leat. The pattern of the blood would presumably be inspected for the augury; cf. *Hym* 1.

**leek** (ON *laukr*, OE *léac*, PNWGmc *laukaʀ*) The leek was a plant of great cultural importance. It was seen as the noblest plant, so *2 Guðr* 2, where Siward's superiority to the Yivickings is compared to a stag among wild beasts, gold among silver, and a green leek in grass; and *Vsp* 4, where the earth of the Golden Age was grown with green leek.

The leek was highly valued in folk magic, as seen already on gold bracteates from the C5th and C6th, where it often appears as a charm word in the old form ᛚᚨᚢᚴᚨᛉ *laukaʀ*; in one inscription also paired with ᛚᛁᚾᚨ *lína* 'linen'. Classical Norse attestations of magic use include *Sigrdr* 8, where the leek is thrown into mead against poison; and the *Vǫlsa*, where a horse penis is said to be *líni gǿddr · en laukum studdr* 'endowed with linen and supported by leeks' in a poetic line. The

leek was particularly associated with women and domestic life, as seen by its pairing with "linen" and its frequent use as the determinant in women-kennings (Meissner 1921, p. 418)). Anon *Sveinfl* 1 (SkP 1) sarcastically states that a battle was not *sem manni · mér lauk eða ǫl béri* 'as if a maiden brought a man leek or ale'.

**leed** (ON *ljóð*, OE *léod*) A magical chant or incantation, as seen by *Háv* 153 near-synonymous with galder. See also gale, begale.

**manwit** (ON *man-vit*) Common sense and wits.

**manicunning** (ON *fjǫl-kunnigr*) 'Skilled with sorcery'. *Háv* 113, *Grm* P2, *Reg* P1

**mead** (ON *mjǫðr*, OE *medu*) TODO.

**meat-nithing** (ON *mat-níðingr*) One who is a nithing with food, i.e., one who does not properly furnish his guest.

See also good of meat.

**moon** (ON *máni*) the moon. — For the personified Moon see under Proper Nouns.

**nithe** (ON *níð*, OE *níþ*, OHG *níd*) Originally 'hatred, emnity'. In the Norse the sense has developed in the direction of 'shame', not just as a social abstract, but almost a tangible thing. So the curse ritual of Eyel, where the curser will "turn nithe" (*snýja níð* against his enemy to cause him misfortune. Scalds would "compose nithe" (*yrkja níð*) through singing slanderous verses, which likewise had an adverse supernatural effect on their subject. See also nithing.

**nithing** (ON *níðingr*, OE *níþing*) One afflicted with nithe; a villain, criminal. Among the Scandinavians a legal term; a nithing could not swear oaths or bear witness and was forbidden to marry.

**orlay** (ON *ørlǫg*, OE *orlæg*) One's predetermined fate, destiny, purpose as decreed by the Norns.

**queer** (ON *argr, ragr* (with metathesis), OE *earg*, OHG *arg*. TODO.

**queerness** (ON *ergi, regi*) See queer above.

**rest** (ON *rǫst*) The distance between two rest-stops, a geographical mile (about 1850 metres). See CV: *rǫst*.

**rune** (ON *rún*, OE *rún*, OS *rúna*, OHG *rúna*, Got. *rúna*, PNWGmc. *rūnu*) An (esoteric) secret message or formula. That this—rather than 'letter (of a Runic alphabet)'—is the original and proper sense is apparent from among others the Finnish borrowing *runo* 'poem; poetry; a division of a poem (specifically of the *Kalevala*)', and its use in the singular in the earliest Runic inscriptions (e.g. Noleby Vg 63, which contains the linguistically indecipherable string of letters ᚾᚨᚠᚦᛟᚱᚾᚴᚢᚱᚠᚢᚴᛁᚢᚾ[–]ᚠᛁᛇᛁᚾ, a *rune* in the proper sense or the recently discovered Svingerud

fragment.) Thus, Weden's taking of the *runes* should not be interpreted as merely a myth for the invention of profane writing, but rather the origin of esoteric incantations, not at all unlike Indian *mántrās*. The word for letter was instead stave, see also there.

**saw**

**scald** (ON *skald*) A Scandinavian court poet. The name probably comes from their ability to slander with words.

**simble** (ON *sumbl*, OE *symbol*) A banquet, symposium.

**spae** (ON *spǫ́*) Prophecy, foresight.

**Tables** (ON *tafl*, OE *tæfl*) Generic term for board games (e.g. chess). In the golden age the Eese played such games (*Vsp* 8). Pre-Christian Germanic burials commonly feature boards and bricks (TODO: reference, maybe to the Salme ship burials).

**thill** (ON *þylja*) To recite poetry learned by heart. Cf. the so called thules (poetic lists) and the title thyle.

**Thing** (ON, OE *þing*, OS *thing*, OHG *ding*) The Old Germanic assembly, where cases were settled and the law determined. In connection with the Thing certain rituals were in order, viz. the enclosing of the space wherein the judges sat by means of wigh-bonds or sacred ropes. Cf. *Háv* 61 for an excerpt from *Germania* ch. 22. See also the Thing of the Gods.

**thule** (ON *þula*) A poetic list, typically of various items of a category (e.g. gods, legendary horses) or poetic synonyms (e.g. for swords, men, Weden). Degoratively also a ditty, poorly composed poem. See thyle.

**thyle** (ON *þulr*, OE *þyle*, PNWGmc. **þulir*) A sage who through rote learning has acquired a large amount of mythological lore (cf. thule 'a list in poetic form; a ditty, bad poem' and thill 'to recite, to chant'). Thus Weden is the Fimblethyle, being the unbeaten master of lore, as can be seen in his wisdom contests (like *Vafþ*). Runic inscription DR 248 (Snoldelev) suggests that the thyle may have tied to a specific place, and in *Beow* it seems to have been a court position, with the poet Unferth being described (l. 1456) as the "Rothgar's thyle".

**wallow** (ON *vǫlva*, OE **wealwe* (cf. ON *svǫlva*, OE *swealwe* 'swallow')) A sibyl, seeress, oracle. The word derives from the wale, a staff or sceptre probably used for ritual purposes.

**waste** (ON *sóa*) To waste ritually, to slay in a sacrificial context.

*Háv* 109/4, 144/4 (n.), 145/3 (in *of-sóa* 'waste, kill too much').

**wigh** (ON *vé*, OE *wéoh*, *wíh*, PNWGmc. **wīhą*) A holy place or sanctuary. It seems that where the harrow was a pile of stones or cairn used for carrying out rituals, the **wigh** was an enclosed space. The earliest Norse attestation is the runic inscription Ög N288 (Oklunda), which reads: "Guther <= Gunn·arr> painted these runes, and he fled, charged (with a crime, sought out this wigh, and he fled into this clearing. [...]" The implication seems to be that the wigh was considered so sacred that Guther could not be apprehended or punished for his crime while in it.

In OE the word means 'pagan idol'. It is not immediately clear which meaning is the original one, but in the present edition the Norse sense has been adopted, since the Anglo-Saxon sources are all of a Christian nature. The name *Wighstone* (*Wíh-* or *Wēohstān*) as found in *Beow* in any case suggests it is the Norse meaning, since 'idol-stone' makes little sense.

**wode** (ON *óðr*, OE *wód*, PNWGmc. **wóduʀ*) Heener's gift to men, though the name may suggest it be from Weden. The word has several related meanings: 'mind, (poetic) inspiration, rage'. See also Woderearer.

**wyrm** (ON *ormr*, OE *wyrm*, PNWGmc. **wurmiʀ*) A dragon, serpent. The distinction between "wyrm" and "worm; snake" is purely editorial and not made in the original languages.

**yin-** (ON *ginn-*) A rare augmentative prefix. TODO.

**yin-holy** (ON *ginn-hęilagr*) High holy, sacrosanct. Used of the Gods in the formula *ginn-hęilǫg goð* 'yin-holy Gods'.

## Proper nouns (P)

Indirect mentions (e.g. *Vafþ* 54/4 for Balder) follow the main entry; mentions based on textual emendation are italicized.

For names of people in Runic inscriptions see the end of each section.

**Andrimner** m.ja., ON And·hrímnir: *the cook of Walhall; Grm* 18/1. See Eldrimner, Sowrimner. [TODO: and + hrím + -nir]

**Ash of Ugdrassle** m.a., ON askr Ygg·drasils: *the world tree and site of the Thing of the Gods*; *Vsp* 45/5 (Ygg·drasils askr), *Grm* 36/1, 45/1; acc. sg. ask Ygg·drasils, *Vsp* 18/1 (Ask vęit'k standa, hęitir Ygg·drasils); dat. sg. aski Ygg·drasils, *Grm* 29/4 & 30/5 (dag hvęrn es dǫma fęrr/fara at ~), 31/2, 32/2, 34/1. [Likely Yggr 'Ug, Weden' + *drasill, variant of drǫsull 'horse, steed', referring to Weden's hanging (cf. *Háv* 138).] — See Leered, Hoard-mimer's Wood.

**Attle 1** m.an., *king of the Huns, historically from 434–453 AD.* ON Atli, TODO. — OE Ætla, *Wíd* 18; gen. sg. Ætlan: ~ léodum, *Wíd* 122. [PGmc. **Attilô* whence MHG. *Etzel*. Latin *Attila* borrowed from Gothic.]

**Attle 2** [2] m.an., ON Atli: *son of the earl Idmund; HHj* P1 (thrice), 2/pr, 3/pr, P2, P3 (thrice), P6 (thrice), 13/pr, 15/pr, 15/1, 18/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 30/pr, 30/2; acc. sg. Atla, *HHj* 2/1; voc. sg. Atli, *HHj* 19/1, 20/1, 20/3, 22/1.

**Attle 3** [3] m.an., ON Atli: *son of King Ring;* dat. sg. Atla, *1 HHund* 52/2.

**Balder** m., *god, son of Weden, husband of Nan*. ON Baldr, *Vsp* 59/2, 59/3, *Grm* 12/1, *Hdl* 28/2, *Gylf* 49:77 (*Eddbr* V), *Hamð* 25/2 (kenning; cf. Ermenric); acc. sg. Baldr, *Lok* 28/4, *Gylf* 49:81 (*Eddbr* V); gen. sg. Baldrs: *Eddbr* V 1/2; ~ bróðir, *Vsp* 32/3; ~ faðir, *Hdl* 29/1; ~ and·skota, *Vsp* 33/2, *Bdr* 11/4; ~ bana, *Bdr* 10/4; dat. sg. Baldri, *Vsp* 31/1 (n.), *Bdr* 1/4, 7/1, 8/3 & 9/2, *Lok* 27/2. — Note: áðr á bál of bar/berr Baldrs and·skota: *Vsp* 33/2, *Bdr* 11/4; hvęrr/hann man Baldri at bana verða: *Bdr* 8/3, 9/2. — Cpds.: **host-Balder** [WARRIOR], ON hęr-Baldr: *Sigsk* 18/3. — Indirect: ON Óðins barni: *Vsp* 31/2; syni *Vafþ* 54/4 & 55/2; ungum Óðins syni: *Skí* 21/2 & 22/2 (*cf.* Dreepner). — OHG Balter; gen. sg. Balderes, *Mers II* 2. [PNWGmc. *baldraʀ 'lord' (> OE bealdor). OE Bældæg, son of Wóden in the AS genealogies, cannot be a direct cognate.]

**Balethorn** m., ON Bǫl·þorn: *obscure ettin, father of Bestle;* gen. sg. Bǫl·þorns: syni ~, *Háv* 140/1–2 (n.).

**Barrey** m., ON Barri: *holy grove; Skí* 39/1 (n.) & 41/1 (Barri hęitir *etc.*).

**Beadhild** f. *king Nithad's daughter.* ON Bǫðv·ildr, *Vkv* P1, 19/1, 26/1, 29/4, 36/3; acc. sg. Bǫðv·ild, *Vkv* 39/2; gen. sg. Bǫðv·ildar, *Vkv* 17/2; dat. sg. Bǫðv·ildi, *Vkv* P2, 25/4 & 36/2 (slóʼk) brjóst-kringlur, sęndi/sęnda'k Bǫðv·ildi); voc. sg. Bǫðv·ildr, *Vkv* 40/1. — OE Beado·hild, dat. sg. Beado·hilde, *Déor* 8.

**Beal** f., ON Bęyla: *minor agricultural goddess, wife of Bewer (1); Lok* P1, *55/pr;* voc. sg. ~, *Lok* 56/1.

**Beck** m.an., ON Bikki: *a cruel general associated with Attle or Ermenric; Ghv* P1 (twice); gen. sg. Bikka, *Sigsk* 64/1, *Akv* 15/2. — OE Becca: *obscure king, but likely the same as the Norse figure; Wíd* 19; acc. sg. Beccan, *Wíd* 115.

**Bellower** m.jan., ON Bęli: *obscure monster slain by Frea;* gen. sg. Bęlja: bani ~, *Vsp* 51/3 (n.)

**Bestle** f., ON Bęstla: *wife of Byre, daughter of Balethorn, mother of Weden, Will and Wigh;* gen. sg. Bęstlu: ~ fǫður, *Háv* 140/2 (n.).

**Bewer** [Bewer 1] m., ON Byggvir: *minor god of barley, servant of Frea, husband of Beal; Lok* P1, 43/pr, 45/1; gen. sg. Byggvis: ~ kvęn, *Lok* 56/1; voc. sg. Byggvir, *Lok* 46/1.

**Bewer 2** [2] m., OE Béow: *legendary Danish king, son of Shield;* TODO.

**Bray** [Bray 1] m.an., ON Bragi: *god of poetry, husband of Idin; Grm* 45/4, *Lok* P1, 8/pr, 11/4, *12/pr,* 12/2, *14/pr,*; acc. sg. Braga, *Lok* 18/3; gen. sg. Braga, *Sigrdr* 15/5; voc. sg. Bragi, *Lok* 13/3, 15/2, 16/1.

**Bray 2** [2] m.an., ON Bragi: *obscure brother of Syerun; 2 HHund* P6b, 20/4.

**Broadblicks** n.a.pl., ON Bręiða-blik: *domain of the god Balder; Grm* 12/1.

**Budle** m.an., ON Buðli: *Hunnish chief, father of Attle;* TODO.

**Budlings** m.pl., ON Buðlungar: *descendants of Budle;* gen. pl.-unga: bór ~, *Akv* 46/4.

**Byre** m.i., ON Burr: *obscure god, father of Weden, Will, and Wigh;* gen. sg. Burs, *Hdl* 29/1; ~ synir, *Vsp* 4/1 (n.). See Sons of Byre. [burr 'son' < PGmc. *buriz 'id.', whence OE byre 'id.']

**Danes** m.i.pl., *tribe in eastern Denmark and southern Sweden.* ON Danir: gen. pl. Dana, *Helr* 11/4; dat. pl. Dǫnum, *2 Guðr* 18/1. — Cpds.: **mountain-Danes** [ettins], ON berg-Danir: gen. pl. berg-Dana, *Hym* 17/4. — OE Dęní: TODO. — See Danish.

**Dene** m.i., ON Danr: *legendary ancestor of the Danes; Rþ* 46/1 (n.).

**Dreepner** m.ja., OE Draupnir: *mythological duplicating ring.* Indirect: baug: *Skí* 21/1 (n.), 22/1.

**Dreepner 2** [2] m.ja., OE Draupnir: *dwarf; Vsp* 15/1.

**Dwarfs** (ON *dvergar*, OE *dweorgas*, OHG *twerca*, PNWGmc. **dwergór*) Earthly (chthonic) supernatural beings, living in rocks and the earth. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Earp 1** m.a., ON Erpr: *son of Enacker and half-brother of Hamthew and Sarle; Ghv* P1 (n.), *Hamð* 12/1, 28/1.

**Earp 2** [2] m.a., ON Erpr : *murdered son of Attle and Guthrun, always paired with Oatle; 2 Guðr* P1; acc. Erp, *Akv* 41/2; gen. Erps, *Hamð* 8/1.

**Earth** (ON *jǫrð*, OE *eorþe*, OHG *erda*, PNWGmc. **erþu*, PGmc. **erþó*) The personified Earth. By Weden the mother of Thunder. See Firgyn, Lathyn.

**Eastern Way** (ON *Austr-vegr*) In the mythology the eastern lands of the Ettins, to which Thunder goes to fight the Ettins and protect the realms of Gods and Men; see also Ettinham. In geography referring to Eastern Europe and Asia, but with a connotation of barbaric wilderness.

**Edgethew** m.a., ON Ęgg·þér: *obscure ettin herdsman; Vsp* 41/2. [PN *Aggju-þewaR]

**Eese** m.u.pl., *the (male) Gods, pl. of Os.* ON ę̇sir: *Vsp* 7/1, 16/2 (o̧flgir ok ǫ̇stkir ~), 22/3, 46/2, 57/1, *Vafþ* 50/3, *Grm* 30/4, 38/4, *Bdr* 1/1, *Lok* P2, 8/2, 8/3, 31/3, P8, *Þrk* 14/1, 17/2, *Reg* P1, P3, *Fáfn* 14/4, *Hdl* 28/1, *Gylf* 49:77 (ed. under *Eddbr* V), SlB 3/3; nom. pl. def. ę̇sir'nir, *Reg* P3; acc. pl. ǫ̇su, *Lok* 6/3; acc. pl. def. ǫ̇su'na, *Lok* P4; gen. pl. ásа, *Vsp* 23/3, *Háv* 160/3, *Vafþ* 28/3, *Grm* 45/3, *Skí* 7/3, *Lok* P1, 2/3, 13/3, 30/3, 35/4; ~ synir, *Alv* 16/4; ~ sona, *Skí* 17/1 & 18/1; ~ sonum, *Vafþ* 38/3, *Grm* 43/3, *Lok* 3/3, 27/3, 53/3, 56/3, 64/1; ~ salr, *Þrk* 13/2; ~ garða, *Þrk* 5/2, 9/3; ~ gǫrðum, *Lok* 37/2; Yggjungr ~, *Vsp* 27/2; hvítastr ~, *Þrk* 15/1; e̢in-hę̨ndr ~, *RunNor* 12/1; ~ e̢ttar, *Gylf* 23:6 (ed. under *Eddbr* II); dat. pl. ǫ̇sum, *Vsp* 42/1, 46/1, *Háv* 143, 161/3, *Vafþ* 38/5, *Grm* 4/2, *Hárb* 25/1, *Hym* 2/4, *Lok* P1, 12/3, 64/1, *Þrk* 7/1, 7/3, *Alv 10/1* (n.), 26/1, 34/1, *Rþ* P1, *Gylf* 49:82 (*Eddbr* V), *Sigrdr* 16/4; o̧llum ~, *Grm* 46/3; voc. pl. e̢̨sir, *Lok* 11/1, 19/1, 25/3, *Sigrdr* 4/1. — Note: Hvat 's með ǫ̇sum? Hvat 's með o̧lfum? *Vsp* 46/1, *Þrk* 7/1; Sęnn vǫ́ru e̢̨sir allir à þingi: *Bdr* 1/1, *Þrk* 14/1; Hę̨ilir e̢̨sir, hę̨ilar ǫ̇synjur: *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1. See Bonds, Gods, Reins, Farrows, Tews, Ossens, and the formula Eese and Elves. — Indirect: TODO. — OE e̢se: TODO. [PGmc. *ansiwiz, pl. of *ansuz. Gothic *Anseis, attested in Jordanes, *Getica* as Ansis (*Hamð* 25/1 n.).]

**Eldrimner** m.ja., ON Ę̨ld·hrǐmnir: *the great cauldron in Walhall;* dat. sg. -hrǐmni, *Grm* 18/1. See Andrimner, Sowrimner. [TODO: e̢̨ldr 'fire' + hrǐm + -nir]

**Elfham** m.a., ON Alf-hę̨imr: *realm of the god Frea;* acc. sg. -hę̨im, *Grm* 5/3 (n.). [alfr 'elf' + hę̨imr 'home, realm'.]

**Elves** (ON *alfar*, OE *ielfe*, PNWGmc. **alβíʀ*) Earthly (chthonic) minor deities. Possibly ancestral spirits? Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Enacker** m., ON Jǫ́n·akr: *third husband of Guthrun, father of Earp (1), Hamthew and Sarle;* gen. sg. Jǫ́n·akrs, *Sigsk* 62/4, *Ghv* P1; ~ sonum, *Sigsk* 63/1; ~ sonu, *Ghv* 14/4, *Hamð* 25/4. [? + *wakraz 'quick, awake'.]

**Ermenric** m. *king of the Eastern Gots, historically ca. 300–376 AD.* ON Jǫrmun·rek(k)r, *Sigsk* 64/2, *Ghv* 2/3, *Hamð* 3/2, 20/1; dat. sg. Jǫrmun·rekki, *Ghv* 5/3, *Hamð* 19/1; Jǫrmun·rekk: ~ inum ríkja, *Ghv* P1; voc. sg. Jǫrmun·rek(k)r, *Hamð* 24/2, 24/5. — OE Eorman·ríc, *Wíd* 18; gen. sg. Eorman·ríces, *Wíd* 8, 111, *Déor* 21; dat. sg. Eorman·ríce, *Wíd* 88. [Latin (H)ermanaricus from Gothic *airman 'great, immense' + reiks 'king'. Cf. MHG Ermen·rích in legendary ballads.]

**Ettinham** m.a., ON Jǫtun-hę̨imr: *the "Ettin-Home", eastern realm of chaotic enemies of the Gods; Vsp* 46/2. See Ettin-Homes, Homes of the Ettins, Eastern Way, Outyards.

**Ettin-Homes** m.a.pl., ON Jǫtun-hę̨imar: *see Ettinham;* acc. pl. -hę̨ima, *Skí* P1, 40/3, *Þrk* 7/2 (n.), 12/4, 13/5, 20/3, 21/4, 26/4 & 28/4; dat. pl. -hę̨imum, *Vsp* 8/4. [jǫtunn 'ettin' + hę̨imar 'homes, realms'.]

**Ettins** (ON *jǫtnar*, OE *eotenas*, PNWGmc. **etunóʀ*) The fundamental enemies of the Gods, the agents of chaos and disorder. See Rises, Thurses. Noted members: Hymer, Thrim, Webthrithner, Yimer Occurrences: TODO

**Fallowhooven** m.ja., ON Fal·hófnir: *one of the gods' horses; Grm* 30/1. [fǫlr + hófr + -nir]

**Fathomer** m.ja., ON Fáfnir: *the wyrm slain by Siward, son of Rethmar, brother of Otter and Rein;* acc. sg. Fáfni, TODO; gen. sg. Fáfnis, *Grí þ* 13/1, 15/4, TODO, *2 Guðr* P1; bani ~, *Oddr* 17/4; dat. sg. Fáfni, *Grí þ* 11/4, TODO, *Helr* 10/4.

**Fenhalls** m.i.pl., ON Fęn-salir: *Frie's dwellings;* dat. pl. Fęn-sǫlum, *Vsp* 33/3 (n.).

**Fenrer** m.ja., ON Fęnrir: *evil wolf, one of Lock's three children; Vafþ* 46/4 (n.), 47/2; *Lok* 38/4.

**Fenrerswolf** m., ON Fęnris-ulfr: *synonymous with Fenrer;* TODO.

**Fimblethyle** m.i., ON Fimbul·þulr: *name for Weden*; *Háv* 80/4 & 142/4. ['Great Thyle'.]

**Fimble-Winter** m., ON fimbul-vetr: *the Great Winter before the destruction of the earth; Vafþ* 44/4. [fimbul- 'fimble-, great' + vetr 'winter'.]

**Firgyn** f.jō., ON Fjǫrgyn: *poetic name for the Earth; Hárb* 56/4; gen. sg. Fjǫrgynjar: ~ burr, *Vsp* 53/2. Cf. *Oddr* 15/3.

**Fold** (ON *Fold*, OE *Folde*) A poetic or ritual name of Earth, especially in her role as Mother Earth. In Germanic poetry, however, the word *fold* is typically used simply to refer to 'land'. It is cognate with Sanskrit TODO.

**Folkwong** m., ON Folk-vangr: *Frow's heavenly dwelling; Grm* 14/1 (n.). [folk 'troop, army' + vangr 'meadow'.]

**Foresitter** m.an., ON For·seti: *god associated with legal proceedings (Things), son of Balder and Nan; Grm* 15/3 (n.) [TODO. 'Presider.']

**Frea** m.ja., ON Fręyr: *god, son of Nearth, brother of Frow; Skí* P1, 4/pr, 6/pr, 9/pr, 20/3 (vit ~), 33/2, P4, *42/pr*, *Lok* P1, 37/1, 41/pr, *Hdl* 29/2; acc. sg. Fręy, *Skí* P1, 19/3; gen. sg. Fręys, *Lok* 44/3; skó-sveinn ~, *Skí* P1; þjónustu-menn ~, *Lok* P1; ~ vinar, *Sigsk* 24/4; dat. sg. Fręy, *Grm* 5/3, 44/3 (skírum ~); voc. sg. Fręyr, *Skí* 3/1. [< PNWGmc. *frawjaʀ 'lord', = OE fréa 'id.'. Likely from earlier Yngvi-Fręyr 'Lord Ing', see *Lok* 43/1 n.] — Cpds.: **Ingwin-Frea**, ON Ingunar-Fręyr: *Lok* 43/1 (n.). — Indirect: bani Bęlja, bjartr: *Vsp* 51/3 (n.); folk-valdi goða: *Skí* 3/1; nýtum Njarðar bur: *Grm* 44/4; inum þroska Njarðar syni: *Skí* 38/4; Njarðar syni: *Skí* 39/3 & 41/3; okkarn mǫg: *Skí* 1/2; mǫg: *Skí* 2/2; ykkrum syni: *Skí* 2/1; inn fróði afi: *Skí* 1/3–4 & 2/3–4; sęggr: *Skí* 5/2; mínn dróttinn: *Skí* 3/4. — See Ing, Ingwin, Waning.

**Frie** f.ō. *goddess, wife of Weden, (in the Norse:) mother of Balder.* ON Frigg: *Vsp* 33/3, *Vafþ 2/pr, 4/pr, Grm* P2 (3 times), *Lok* P1, *25/pr, 27/pr,* 29/3, G1/3, *Gylf* 35:1 (in *Eddbr* IV), *Oddr* 9/2; gen. sg. Friggjar, *Vsp* 51/4; voc. sg. Frigg, *Vafþ* 1/1, *Lok* 26/1, 28/1. — OHG Frija: *Mers II* 4. — Latin Frea: *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1:9 (n.), 1:10, 1:12; acc. sg. Fream, *Origo Gentis Langbardorum* 1:8. [PGmc. *Frijjō, orig. f. sg. of lost adj. *frijjaz 'dear, beloved'. Latin Frea is from Longbeardish. Cf. OE *Fríġ (gen. sg. fríġe, e.g. in fríġe-dæġ 'Friday', lit. 'Frie's day').] — See Line.

**Frow** f.ōn., ON Fręyja: *goddess, daughter of Nearth, sister of Frea, wife of Wode; Grm* 14/1 (n.), *Lok* P1, *29/pr, 31/pr, Þrk* 13/1, 26/3 & 28/3, *Oddr* 9/2, *Hdl 1/1, 7/1*; acc. sg. Fręyju, *Þrk* 8/4 & 11/4, 12/1, 22/3; gen. sg. ~, *Þrk* 3/1, 23/4 27/3; voc. sg. Fręyja, *Lok* 30/1 & 32/1, 32/4, *Þrk* 3/3, 12/3, *Hdl* 6/1. [PNWGmc. *frawjǭ 'lady', = OHG frouwa 'id.'] — Note: fǿri(ð ...) Fręyju at kvęn/kvǫn: *Þrk* 8/4, 11/4, 22/3; át/svaf vętr Fręyja átta nǫttum: *Þrk* 26/3, 28/3; Þęgi þú, Fręyja: *Lok* 30/1, 32/1. — Indirect: Óðs męy: *Vsp* 24/4 (n.); Njarðar dóttur ór Nóa-túnum: *Þrk* 22/4.

**Full** f.ōn., ON Fulla: *maid-servant of Frie;* acc. sg. Fullu, *Grm* P2. — OHG Volla: *sister of Frie; Mers II* 4.

**Gagglewood** m.u., ON Gagl-viðr: *forest in the East, perhaps = Ironwood;* dat. sg. Gaglviði, *Vsp* 41/3.

**Gangred** m.pl., ON Gang·ráðr: *name for Weden; Vafþ* 8/1 (~ hęiti'k); voc. sg. ~, *Vafþ* 9/1, *Vafþ* 11/1, *Vafþ* 13/1, *Vafþ* 15/1, *Vafþ* 17/1. [gangr 'a walk' + -ráðr 'decider, counsellor', i.e., 'one who chooses to wander'.]

**Gap of Hawks** n., ON gap ginnunga: *the air in-between Earth and Up-heaven; Vsp* 3/4 (n.).

**Geatland** (ON *Gaut-land, Gauta-land*) The land of the Geats in southwestern Sweden.

**Geats** (ON *gautar*, OE *géatas*, PNWGmc. **gautóʀ* from **geut-* 'to pour', perhaps 'the libators') A tribe in what is today southern-central Sweden. See also Geatland, Swedes. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Glapner** m.ja., ON Glęipnir: *legendary fetter; Eddbr* VIII.

**Glitner** m.ja., ON Glitnir: *domain of the god Foresitter; Grm* 15/1.

**god** n., ON goð: *a god, regardless of gender;* dat. sg. goði: inu skír-lęita goði, *Grm* 40/1–2; skǐnanda ~, *Grm* 39/2, *Sigrdr* 15/1. [OE god, OHG got, PGmc. *gudą.]

**Gods** n.pl., ON goð: *the Gods, often used in a pantheistic sense in the pl.; Hym* 22/3, *Lok* 49/4 & 50/2, *Fǎfn* 15/2, *Oddr* 9/2; goð'in ǫll, *Vsp* 22/4; goð

ǫll, *Lok* 45/2, 55/4; ǫll ~, *Hdl* 49/4; in svǫ́su ~, *Vafþ* 17/4 & 18/2; ginnheilǫg ~, *Vsp* 6/2, 9/2, 22/2, 24/2; acc. pl. goð, *Hym* 3/2, *Lok* 12/4, *Lok* 55/4; gen. pl. goða, *Vafþ* 50/3, *Skí* 33/4, *Reg* 19/2; gǫrðum ~, *Vafþ* 2/2; vé ~, *Vafþ* 51/1; hodd ~, *Grm* 27/5; þing ~, *Hym* 39/1; skír brúðr ~ (*kenning for Shede*), *Grm* 11/3; vǫrðr ~ (*kenning for Homedall*), *Grm* 13/3, *Lok* 48/4; folk-valdi ~ (*kenning for Frea*), *Skí* 3/1; þrúð-valdr ~ (*kenning for Thunder*), *Hárb* 9/4; allra ~, *Vafþ* 42/3 & 43/1, *Grm* 43/1; dat. pl. goðum, *Vafþ* 15/4 & 16/2, 39/2, *Grm* 51/2, 56/4, *Lok* T1, 34/2 & 35/2, *Alv* 4/4, 12/1, 14/1, 16/1, 18/1, 20/1, 22/1, 24/1, 28/1, 30/1, 32/1, *Hdl* 8/3, 27/5, *Am* 54/5; vǫrðr með ~, *Skí* 28/4; voc. pl. goð, *Lok* 7/1; ǫll ginn-heilǫg ~, *Lok* 11/2. [OE *godu*, OHG *gota*, PNWGmc. **gudō*, pl. of **gudą*.]

**Goldencomb** ON Gollin·kambi: *cock which awakens the men of Walhall; Vsp* 42/1.

**Guther** (ON *Gunn·arr*, MHG *Gunther*) The lord of the Gots. In the Norse sources the brother of Hawn. Historically he is based on king *Gundaharius* (**Gunþiharjaz*) of the Burgundians.

**Guthlathe** f.ō., ON Gunn·lǫð: *daughter of the ettin Sutting who guarded the Mead of Poetry; Háv* 105/1; acc. sg. Gunn·lǫðu, *Háv* 110/4; gen. sg. Gunn·laðar, *Háv* 13/4, 108/3. [gunnr 'battle, war' + lǫð 'invitation']

**Guthrun** (ON *Guð·rún*) Daughter of king Yivick, sister of Guther and Hawn. The wife of Attle.

**Hamthew** m.ja., ON Ham·ðir: *son of Enacker and Guthrun, brother of Sarle and Earp (1); Ghv* P1, 4/1, 8/1, *Hamð* 6/1, 24/1, 26/1, 31/2; acc. sg. Ham·ði, *Hamð* 21/2; gen. sg. Ham·ðis, *Hamð* T1, P1; voc. sg. Ham·ðir, *Hamð* 27/1. — Note: Þá kvað þat Ham·ðir inn hugum stóri, *Ghv* 4/1, 8/1; Hitt kvað þá Ham·ðir inn hugum stóri, *Hamð* 6/1, 24/1, 26/1. [= Ammius in Jordanes, *Getica*; see Introduction to *Ghv*.]

**Hate 1** m.an., ON Hati: *ettin, father of Rimegerd; HHj* 17/1; acc. sg. Hata, *HHj* P6, 24/2; gen. sg. Hata: ~ dóttir, *HHj* P6.

**Hate 2** [2] m.an., ON Hati: *wolf that chases the moon; Grm* 40/3. See Sholl, Rothwitner.

**Hath** m.u., ON Hǫðr: *blind god, Balder's killer; Vsp* 32/2, 59/3, *Bdr* 9/1; dat. sg. Hęði, *Bdr* 10/3.

**Hawn** [Hawn 1] (ON *Hǫgni*, OE *Haguna*, *Hagena*, OHG *Hagano*, Ger. *Hagen*, PNWGmc. **Hagunó*) A Nivling and Yivicking, son of king Yivick, brother of Guther and Guthrun. In *Akv* he defeats seven warriors before being captured by Attle, who has his heart cut out at the request of Guther.

**Hawn 2** [2] m.an., ON Hǫgni: *legendary king, father of Syerun; 2 HHund* P4, P7, 20/4; gen. sg. Hǫgna, *2 HHund* 4/6, 17/1; ~ dóttir, *1 HHund* 17/1, *2 HHund* 48/4; ~ dóttur, *1 HHund* 56/4, *2 HHund* P5; ~ mǽr, *2*

*HHund* 13/5, 16/1; ~ sonr, *2 HHund* P6b, P11; ~ mági, *2 HHund* 44/5; dat. sg. Hǫgna, *1 HHund* 52/1.

**Heavenbarrows** n.a.pl., ON Himin-bjǫrg: *domain of the god Homedall; Grm* 13/1.

**Heener** m.ja., ON Hœnir: *obscure (bird?-)god; Vsp* 17/3 (n.), 60/1, *Reg* P1. [PNWGmc. *Hónijaʀ 'the little swan(?)']

**Hell** [Hell] (ON *hęl*, OE *hęll*, PNWGmc. **halju*, Got. *halja*) The Underworld, personified as and formally identical to Hell, the goddess. After the arrival of Christianity this word came to refer to the Christian hell-fire (= *Gehenna*), which is the case in all attested languages apart from the Old Norse. Cf. Nivelhell.

**Hell 2** [2] (ON *Hęl*) Goddess of death and Hell (the Underworld).

**Hellway** m.a., ON hęl-vegr: *the road to Hell which the dead must travel;* acc. sg. -veg, *Vsp* 50/4, *Helr* P1, T1; dat. pl. -vegum, *Vsp* H41/1. [hęl 'Hell, underworld' + vegr 'way, road']

**Hindle** (ON *Hyndla*) A witch awoken by Frow in *Hdl*.

**Hode** f.ijō., ON Hœðr: *obscure wallow;* acc. sg. Hœði, *Vsp* 21/1 (n.).

**Homedall** m.a., ON Hœim·dallr: *god born of nine mothers, Watchman of the Gods; Vsp* 45/3, *Lok 47/pr, Þrk* 15/1 (~, hvítastr ása), *Rþ* P1, *Gylf* 27:1 (under *Eddbr* III); acc. sg. Hœim·dall, *Grm* 13/1; gen. sg. Hœim·dalar, *Vsp* 26/1; mǫgu ~, *Vsp* 1/2; Hœim·dallar, *Gylf* 27:15 (*Eddbr* III); voc. sg. Hœim·dallr, *Lok* 48/1. [hęimr 'home, (the settled) world' + *dallr 'brilliant, shining'. See *Vafþ* 25/1 n., *Þrk* 13/3 n.] — Indirect: TODO.

**Homes of the Ettins** m.a.pl., ON jǫtna hęimar: *see Ettinham;* gen. pl. jǫtna hęima, *Þrk* 5/3 (n.) & 9/2.

**Huns** (ON *húnir*, OE *Húne*, OHG *Húni*, *Hunni*, PNWGmc. **húniʀ*) Invading Asiatic tribe in the Migration Period. In the Scandinavian legends they have been assimilated into the Germanic framework, and are not presented as racially or culturally distinct; part of this is undoubtedly due to their confusion with a Danish tribe (TODO). Noted members: Attle, TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Hymer** m., ON Hymir: *ettin, Tew's father according to* Hym; 5/2, 7/4, 10/2, *16/3pr, 17/3pr, 19/3pr*, 21/1, 25/3, *26/pr, 32/pr*, 39/2; gen. sg. Hymis, *Hym* T1 (in **A**), 15/4, 30/3; ~ męyjar, *Lok* 34/3; dat. sg. Hymi, *Hym* 29/4, 35/3; voc. sg. *Hym* 11/1 (ves hęill, Hymir). — Indirect: mǐnn faðir: *Hym* 5/3 (n.); mǐnn frii: *Hym* 9/3; karl: *Hym* 32/3; gen. sg. karls: *Hym* 10/4 (n.); dat. sg. karli: *Hym* 31/3; jǫtunn, *Hym* 14/4, 20/3, 28/1; gen. sg. jǫtuns: *Hym* 27/4; forn jǫtunn: *Hym* 13/3; ballr jǫtunn: *Hym* 17/2; ó·tęitr jǫtunn: *Hym* 25/1; kost-móðs jǫtuns: *Hym* 30/4; hǫrum Hrungnis spjalla: *Hym* 16/1; kjóla valdi: *Hym* 19/4; átt-runn apa: *Hym* 20/2.

**Idewold** m.u., ON Iða-vǫllr: *the 'Plain of Industry', where the Gods settle and build Osyard;* dat. sg. -vęlli: *Vsp* 7/1, 57/1.

**Idin** f.i., ON Ið·unn: *goddess, keeper of the golden apples of immortality (cf.* Skí *19/1 n.), wife of Bray; Lok* P1, *16/pr, 18/pr*; voc. sg. ~, *Lok* 17/1. [ið + -unnr.]

**Ilewaves** m.pl., ON Éli-vágar: *chaotic (primæval) salty waters;* acc. pl. Éli-vága, *Hym* 5/1 (n.); dat. pl. Éli-vǫgum, *Vafþ* 31/1 (n.). [TODO + vágr 'wave']

**Ing** [Ing 1] m., OE Ing: *god, probably an older name for Frea; RunOE TODO/1.* See Ing-Frea, Ingwin-Frea, Inglings, Ingwins. [PGmc. *Inguz ~ *Ingwô > ON Yngvi, only in Yngvi-Freyr 'Ing-Frea'.]

**Ing 2** [2] m.an., ON Yngvi: *obscure son of Ring; 1 HHund* TODO.

**Ing 3** [3] m.an., ON Yngvi: *dwarf; Vsp* TODO.

**Ingwin-Frea** m.a., ON Ingunar-Freyr: *name for Frea; Lok* 43/1.

**Inglings** (ON *Ynglingar*, PNWGmc. **Ingwalingóʀ* 'the descendants of Ing') The oldest known Swedish kingly lineage. The difference between Inglings and Shilvings is a bit unclear; they seem to be used synonymously in the Norse sources but *Beow* knows them only as Shilvings.

**Inwithies** f.ō.pl., ON ǐ·viðjur: *troll-women (?); Vsp* 2/3 (n.).

**Ironwood** m.u., ON Éarn-viðr, Járn-viðr: *forest in the East where wolves are reared, perhaps = Gagglewood;* dat. sg. Éarn-viði, *Vsp* 39/1.

**Kneefrith** m.u., ON Kné·frøðr: *Attle's messenger; Akv* 1/2, 2/3; acc. sg. Kné·frøð*, *2 Guðr* P1. See Winge.

**Lathyn** f.jō., ON Hlǫðyn: *poetic name for the Earth;* gen. sg. Hlǫðynjar: mǫgr ~, *Vsp* 53/1.

**Leered** m.a., ON Lę́·raðr: *name for the Ash of Ugdrassle;* gen. sg. Lę́·raðs: *Grm* 25/2 (n.) & 26/2 (ok bítr af ~ limum).

**Life and Lafthrasher** f. & m.ja., ON Líf ok Lęif·þrasir: *the only surviving humans who repopulate the earth after Rakes of the Reins; Vafþ* 45/1 (n.).

**Line** f.ō., ON Hlin: *obscure goddess;* gen. sg. Hlinar, *Vsp* 51/1 (n.).

**Lithshelf** f.ō., ON Hlið-skjǫlf: *high lookout post of the Gods from which they can see the whole world;* acc. sg. Hlið-skjǫlf, *Skí* P1; dat. sg. Hlið-skjǫlfu, *Grm* P2 (n.). [hlið 'cliff, slope' + *skjǫlf* 'shelf', i.e., the 'Cliffside Shelf', probably referring to its situation on a high mountain.]

**Lock** m.an., ON Loki: *evil-doer of the gods; Vsp* 49/2, *Bdr* 14/3, *Lok* P1, P2 (thrice), 3/pr, 5/pr, P3, 6/pr, *9/pr,* 10/3, *13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 20/pr, 22/pr, 24/pr, 26/pr, 28/pr, 30/pr,* 32/pr, 34/pr, 36/pr, 38/pr, 40/pr, 42/pr, 44/pr, *46/pr, 48/pr, 50/pr, 52/pr, 56/pr, 58/pr, 60/pr, 62/pr, 64/pr,* P8, *Þrk* 5/1,

*7/3pr,* 9/1, *11/pr,* 18/1, 20/1, *Hdl* 39/1, 40/1, *Gylf* 49:82 (under *Eddbr* V), *Skm* 26 (*Eddbr* VI), *Reg* P1 (thrice), 3/1, P2 (twice), 6/1; hinn lę́-vísi ~, *Hym* 37/4, *Lok* 54/5; acc. sg. Loka, *Lok* 16/3, 18/1, P8, *Reg* P1; gen. sg. Loka, *Lok* P8; lę́-gjarns ... ~, *Vsp* 34/2; kona ~, *Lok* P8; dat. sg. Loka, *Lok* P2, P4, P5; voc. sg. Loki, *Lok* 21/1, 29/1, 47/1, 47/2, 49/1, 53/1, G1/1, G2/2, *Þrk* 2/2. — Note: Fló þá Loki, fjaðr-hamr dunði, *Þrk* 5/1, 9/1; Þá kvað þat Loki Lauf·ęyjar sonr, *Þrk* 18/1, 20/1. — See Loft, Whethring.

**Loddfathomer** m.ja., ON Lodd·fáfnir: *figure addressed by Weden;* voc. sg. -fáfnir, *Háv* 112/1 (n.), 113/1, 115/1, 116/1, 117/1, 119/1, 120/1, 121/1, 122/1, 125/1, 126/1, 127/1, 128/1, 129/1, 130/1, 131/1, 132/1, 134/1, 135/1, 137/1, 164/1. — Note: Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, at rǫ́ð nemir, *Háv* 112/1, 113/1, 115/1; Rǫ́ð=umk þér Lodd·fáfnir, ęn rǫ́ð nemir, *Háv* 116/1, 117/1, 119/1, 120/1, 121/1, 122/1, 125/1, 126/1, 127/1, 128/1, 129/1, 130/1, 131/1, 132/1, 134/1, 135/1, 137/1.

**Loride** m.an., ON Hlór·riði: *poetic name for Thunder; Hym* 27/1, 29/1; acc. sg. Hlór·riða, *Lok* 55/2; gen. sg. Hlór·riða, *Hym* 16/2, 37/2; ~ hamar, *Þrk* 7/4 & 8/1 (~ hamar of folginn), 14/4; dat. sg. Hlór·riða, *Hym* 4/3, *Lok* 54/4, *Þrk* 31/1. — ['Loud/Roaring Rider'.]

**Lother** m.a.(?), ON Lóðurr, OS Logaþore, PNWGmc. *Loga-þorjaʀ 'Flame-darer(?)', *obscure god; Vsp* 17/4 (n.).

**Middenyard** m.a., *(the 'Middle Enclosure'), the inhabited world.* ON Mið·garðr: acc. sg. -garð, *Vsp* 4/2 (n.), *Grm* 42/2 (n.); gen. sg. -garðs: ~ Vé·urr, *Vsp* 53/5; dat. sg. -garði, *Hárb* 23/4, *Hdl* 11/6, 16/4, Sö 56 2. — OE Middan-ġeard: TODO. — OS Middil-gard (*also* f.cons.): TODO. — OHG Mittila-gart: *Musp* 53. [Cf. Gothic midjun-gards 'the world'.] See Osyard, Wighward, Middenyardswyrm.

**Millner** m.ja., ON Mjǫllnir: *Thunder's hammer; Lok* 57/2, 59/2, 61/2, 63/2; acc. sg. Mjǫllni, *Vafþ* 51/3, *Þrk* 30/3; dat. sg. Mjǫllni, *Hym* 36/2 (Mjǫllni morð-gjǫrnum). — Note: þér skal mínn þrúð-hamarr, Mjǫllnir, mál fyr·nema: *Lok* 57/2, 59/2, 61/2, 63/2. — [PGmc. *Meldunjaʀ.]

**Moon** m.an., ON Máni: *the personified moon in the Eddas, son of Mundlefarer and brother of the Sun; Vsp* 5/4, *Vafþ* 22/3, *Alv* 13/3, 14/1; acc. sg. *Háv* 137/7; gen. sg. Mána: sinni ~, *Vsp* 5/1; ~ faðir, *Vafþ* 23/1; systur ~, *Reg* 23/2. — For the moon in general see Index to cultural terms above.

**Mundlefarer** m.an., ON Mundil·fǫri: *father of Sun and Moon; Vafþ* 23/1 (n.). [*Gylf* 11:2 has Mundil·fari. *mundill (= mǫndull 'mill-handle') + fǫri 'driver, mover'. The simplex form mǫndull has prob. been influenced by the cognate of OE handle < PWGmc. *handulā (*handu 'hand' + *-lā), but the cpd. element mundil- < PN *mundilaʀ (*mundu 'hand' + *-ilaʀ) preserves the original root vowel.]

**Narrow** m.wa., ON Nǫrr: *father of Night;* dat. sg. Nǫrvi, *Vafþ* 25/2 (n.), *Alv* 29/3. [*nǫrr 'narrow' (an adj. only surviving in this name) < PGmc. *narwaz, cognate with OE nearu 'narrow, constrained'. Also found in the weak form Nǫrvi 'the Narrow One' in *Gylf* 10:1 (cited in *Vafþ* 11/ALL n.).]

**Nears** m. pl., ON Njárar ~ Níarar: *Swedish tribe in* Vkv*, ruled by king Nithad;* gen. pl. Níara: ~ dróttinn, *Vkv* 7/1 (n.), 14/1, 30/4.

**Nearth** m.u., ON Njǫrðr: *a god, one of the Wanes, father of Frea and Frow; Vafþ* 38/3, *Grm* 16/1, *Skí* P1, *Lok* P1, 33/pr, 35/pr, *Gylf* 23:1, 6, 7, 8, 10 (under *Eddbr* II); gen. sg. Njarðar: ~ bur, *Grm* 44/4; sonr ~, *Skí* P1; ~ syni, *Skí* 38/4, 39/3 & 41/3 (þar mun Njarðar syni *etc.*); ~ dóttur, *Þrk* 22/4; voc. sg. Njǫrðr, *Lok* 34/1, 36/1. [= OE *Neorþ] — Cpds.: **spear-Nearth** [WARRIOR], ON gęir-Njǫrðr: *Ghv* 8/3.

**Necklace of the Brisings** n.a.., ON męn Brísinga: *flaming necklace or jewel owned by the goddess Frow;* it mikla ~, *Þrk* 13/3 (n.); acc. sg. męn Brísinga: it mikla ~, *Þrk* 15/4; dat. sg. męni Brísinga: inu mikla ~, *Þrk* 19/2.

**Nithad** m.u., *tyrant that imprisons Wayland, father of Beadhild, lord of the Nears.* ON Níð·uðr, *Vkv* P1 (twice), 7/1, 14/1, P2, *31/pr, 32/pr,* 38/2, 41/1; gen. sg. Níð·aðar, 20/4, 29/2; kvǫn ~, *16/1* & 30/1 (Úti stóð kunnig kvǫn ~), *25/2* & 35/4 (sęndi/sęnda'k kunnigri kvǫn ~); dat. sg. Níð·aði, *Vkv* T2, 18/1, 20/2, 24/4 & 35/2 (svęip('k) útan silfri, sęldi/sęlda'k ~); voc. sg. *Vkv* 30/4. — Note: Níð·uðr, Níara dróttinn: *Vkv* 7/1, 14/1, 30/4. — OE Níþ·had, *Déor* 1/5; gen. sg. Níð·hades: ~ mǽg, *Wald* B 8. [PNWGmc. *Níþa-haduz < *níþaz 'shame, emnity'; *haþuz 'war, battle'.]

**Nithehewer** m., ON Níð·hǫggr: *watery dragon and corpse-eater; Vsp* 38/4, 62/4, *Grm* 36/4; dat. sg. Níð·hǫggvi, *Grm* 32/4.

**Nivelhell** f.ō., ON nifl-hęl: *a synonym for Hell, lower Underworld;* acc. sg. nifl-hęl, *Vafþ* 43/4; gen. sg. nifl-hęljar, *Bdr* 2/3. [nifl 'mist, shade' + hęl 'Hell, the Underworld'; 'Mist-Hell', 'Shady Hell'.]

**Norns** f.i.pl., ON nornir: *(not infrequently malevolent) women who shape the orlays of men;* nom. sg. norn, *Reg* 2/3 (aumlig ~); gen. sg. nornar, *Sigrdr* 15/12; nom. pl. nornir, *1 HHund* 2/1, *Fáfn* 12/3, 13/1, *Sigsk* 7/3 (ljótar ~), *2 Guðr* 36/1; acc. pl. ~, *2 HHund* 20/2, *Akv* 18/4 (n.); gen. pl. norna, *Fáfn* 11/1 (n.), 44/4, *Hamð* 29/3, 30/4; dat. pl. nornum, *Ghv* 13/1. — See orlay, Dises, Mothers, Weird, *Vsp* 19.

**Nowetons** n.pl., ON Nóa-tún: *Nearth's watery domain; Grm* 16/1, *Gylf* 23:2 (under *Eddbr* II); gen. pl. -túna, *Gylf* 23:10 (under *Eddbr* II); dat. pl. -túnum, *Þrk* 22/4, *Gylf* 23:9 (under *Eddbr* II). [nór 'ship' + tún 'town, fence']

**Oatle** m.a., ON Ęitill: *murdered son of Attle and Guthrun, always paired with Earp (2); 2 Guðr* P1; acc. Ęitil, *Akv* 41/2; gen. Ęitils, *Hamð* 8/2.

**Oneharriers** m.pl., ON ęin-hęrjar: *Weden's chosen warriors who train in Walhall for the Rakes of the Reins; Vafþ* 41/1, *Grm* 18/4, *1 HHund* 38/3; gen. pl. ęin-hęrja, *Grm* 24/3; dat. pl. ęin-hęrjum, *Grm* 37/6, 53/3.

**Ossens** f.ōn.pl., ON ǫsynjur: *the goddesses, wives of the Eese; Bdr* 1/2, *Lok* 31/3, *Þrk* 14/2; acc. pl. ~, *Hdl* 10/4; voc. pl. ~, *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1. [PGmc. *ansuz 'Os' + *-unjō f. '-ess, -en'; cf. vargr, vargynja.] — Note: ok ǫsynjur allar à máli: *Bdr* 1/2, *Þrk* 14/2; Hęilir ęsir, hęilar ǫsynjur: *Lok* 11/1, *Sigrdr* 4/1.

**Osyard** m.a., ON Ǫs·garðr: *the stronghold (yard, enclosure) of the Eese;* acc. sg. -garð, *Þrk* 18/3; gen. sg. -garðs: ~ jǫfurr, *RunIce* 4; dat. sg. -garði, *Hym* 7/2, *Skm* 42:2 (in *Eddbr* VII). [ǫss 'Os, god' + garðr 'enclosure', i.e., the 'Enclosure of the Eese'.] — See Middenyard, Outyards.

**Oughter** (ON *Óttarr*, OE *Óhthere*, PNWGmc. **Óhta-harjaʀ*) Legendary Swedish Ingling king.

**Outyards** (ON *Út-garðar*) Not Eddic. The 'Outer Enclosures', described in *Gylf*. See also Ettinham, Middenyard, Osyard.

**Rakes of the Age** n.pl., ON aldar rǫk: *the Rakes of the Reins;* acc. pl. aldar rǫk, *Vafþ* 39/3. [ǫld 'age, generation', rǫk 'unfolding, events'.]

**Rakes of the Reins** n.pl., ON ragna rǫk: *the destruction of the world in pre-Christian eschatology (cf.* Vsp *39–55,* Vafþ *44–53); Bdr* 14/4 (n.), *1 HHund* 40/2; nom. pl. rǫk ragna, *Am* 21/3; acc. pl. ragna rǫk, *Vsp* 43/4, 47/4, 55/4, *Vafþ* 55/4. [ręgin 'Reins, Gods', rǫk 'unfolding, events'.] — See Rakes of the Age, Ripping of the Age, Twilight of the Reins, Rippers.

**Reading** m.a., ON Hrauðungr: *legendary king of the Gots;* ~ konungr, *Grm* P1; gen. sg. Hrauðungs: sonum ~ konungs, *Grm* T1; dat. sg. Hrauðungi, *Hdl* 25/2.

**Reins** (ON *rǫgn*, *ręgin*) The 'Powers, Counsels'. Judging from *Vafþ* TODO the term may be more closely associated with the Wanes than the Eese.

**Rimefax** m.an., ON Hrím·faxi: *horse that pulls the night; Vafþ* 14/1. See Shinefax.

**Rime-Thurses** m.a.pl., ON Hrím-þursar: *thurses, ettins;* dat. sg. , *Vafþ* 33/1; nom. pl. -þursar, *Háv* 109/1, *Grm* 31/3, *Skí* 34/1, gen. pl. -þursa, *Skí* 30/3.

**Ripping of the Age** n., ON aldar rof: *the Rakes of the Reins; 2 HHund* 41/2. [ǫld 'age, generation', rof 'ripping, destruction'.]

**Rotholf** (ON *Hrólfr kraki*, OE *Hróþulf*, PNWGmc. **Hróþi-wulfaʀ*) A king of the Shieldings (see family tree). As foreshadowed in *Beow* 1017–9, 1180–90, he betrays the sons of Rothgar, his cousins Rethric and Rothmund, in order to take the throne for himself. In the later Icelandic tradition this has been forgotten, and he is consistently portrayed as a heroic king.

**Rothwitner** m.ja., ON Hróð·vitnir: *father of the wolf Hate (2);* gen. sg. -vitnis, *Grm* 40/3. Cf. *Lok* 39/1. [hróðr 'fame, glory' + vitnir 'wolf']

**Rothgar** (ON *Hróarr*, OE *Hróþgár*, PNWGmc. **Hróþi-gaiʀaʀ*) A king of the Shieldings (see family tree), one of the main characters in *Beow*.

**Rungner** (ON *Hrungnir*) Famous ettin fought by Thunder. The full story is told in *Haustl* 14–20 and *Skm* 24–25, which cites the former.

**Sarle** m.an., ON Sǫrli: *son of Enacker and Guthrun, brother of Hamthew and Earp (1); Ghv* P1, *Hamð* 9/1, 31/2; acc. sg. Sǫrla, *Hamð* 21/2. [PGmc. *Sarulô, diminutive of Sarus in Jordanes, *Getica*; see Introduction to *Ghv*.]

**Saxons** (ON *saxar*, OE *Seaxan*, *Seaxe*) TODO. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Shede** f.în., ON Skaði: *goddess, daughter of Thedse, wife of Nearth; Grm* 11/3, *Skí* P1, *Lok* P1, *49/pr, 51/pr,* P8, *Hdl* 29/5, *Gylf* 23:7, 8, 11, 12 (*Eddbr* II). — [OE *Scędi, PGmc. *Skadį̄ (not to be confused with skaði 'injury' < PGmc. *skaþô). Most likely = OE Scędi- in Shedeny and the Shedelands; Shede was presumably thought to guard the Scandinavian peninsula.]

**Shilvings** (ON *skilfingar*, OE *scilfingas*, PNWGmc. **skilβingóʀ*) The descendants of Shelf; the legendary Swedish royal dynasty. The exact difference between the terms Shilvings and Inglings is unclear, but the first may have referred to the old royal family in Sweden, while the latter to the Norwegian branch which claimed descent from the former. TODO Noted members: TODO Occurrences: *Hdl* 15, 20

**Shield** (ON *Skjǫldr*, OE *Scyld*, PNWGmc. **Skelduz*) Legendary Danish king, founder of the Shieldings.

**Shieldings** (ON *skjǫldungar*, OE *Scyldingas*, PNWGmc. **skeldungóʀ*) The descendants of Shield; the legendary Danish royal dynasty. With Harward's death after his slaying of Rotholf their rule ended. TODO Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Shinefax** m.an., ON Skin·faxi: *horse that pulls the day; Vafþ* 12/1. See Rimefax, Allswith, Yorewaker.

**Shirner** m., ON Skírnir: *Frea's servant; Skí* P1, 1/1, 2/pr, 3/pr, 5/pr, 8/pr, P2, P3, *13/pr, 18/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 38/pr,* P4, 40/1, *41/pr,*

**Sholl** m.?., ON Skoll: *wolf that chases the sun; Grm* 40/1. See Hate (2), Rothwitner.

**Sithguth** f., OHG Sinthgunt: *obscure goddess, sister of Sun; Mers II* 3. [PNWGmc. *Sinþa-gunþiʀ(?)]

**Siward** (ON *Sig·urðr*) A hero of the Walsings, slayer of the wyrm Fathomer.

**Slopner** m.ja., ON Slęipnir: *Weden's eight-legged horse; Grm* 45/3; acc. sg. Slęipni, *Bdr* 2/2, *Hdl* 39/2; gen. sg. Slęipnis, *Sigrdr* 15/4. See *Vsp* 19 n.

**Sons of Byre** m.i., ON Burs synir: *group of early gods; Vsp* 4/1 (n.). See Byre.

**Sowrimner** m.ja., ON Sę́·hrímnir: *the undying boar of Walhall;* acc. sg. -hrímni, *Grm* 18/2. See Andrimner, Eldrimner. [TODO: *sę́- 'boar' (prob. root-related to sýr 'sow', svín 'swine') + hrím + -nir]

**Sun** (ON *Sól*, OHG *Sunna*) The personified Sun, who in the Germanic mythology is a woman. In *Vafþ* 22 the daughter of Mundlefarer and sister of Moon. In *Mers II* the sister of Sithguth.

**Sutting** m.a., ON Suttungr: *ettin who possessed the Mead of Poetry, father of |inx[P]Guthlathe; Háv* 109/4; acc. sg. Suttung, *Háv* 110/3; gen. sg. Suttungs, *Háv* 104/4; ~ synir, *Alv* 34/4; gen. sg. Suttunga [*with nom. sg.* *Suttungi (?)]: synir ~, *Skí* 34/2.

**Swanhild** f.i., ON Svan·hildr: *daughter of Siward and Guthrun trampled by King Ermenric; Sigsk* 55/3, *2 Guðr* P1, *Ghv* P1, 15/3, *Hamð* 3/1; acc. sg. -hildi, *Sigsk* 63/2, *Ghv* P1, 8/5, 15/1; gen. sg. -hildar, *Ghv* 16/4, *Hamð* 2/5. (For her historicity see *Getica* 129, cited in Introduction to *Ghv*.) [ON svanr 'swan' + hildr 'battle, Hild (a walkirrie)' but this is prob. later reanalysis; the form Sunilda (*Getica* 129) suggests Gothic sunja 'truth' + *hilds 'battle, Hild'.]

**Swedes** (ON *svíar*, OE *swéon*, PNWGmc. **swihanīʀ*) The tribe around the Mälar valley in eastern Sweden. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Syemund** (ON *Sig-mundr*, OE *Sige-mund*, MHG. *Sieg-mund*, PNWGmc. **Sigi-munduʀ*) In the Norse tradition the son of king Walsing. He begets Siward, the slayer of the wyrm Fathomer. In *Beow* it is Syemund himself who slays an unnamed wyrm. Connected with his nephew Sinfittle.

**Syerun** f.ō., ON Sig·rún: *walkirrie lover of Hallow Hundingsbane; 1 HHund* 30/1, 54/3. TODO: *2 HHund*.

**Tew** m.wa., ON Týr: *one-handed god, possibly son of Hymer (cf.* Hym *5/3 n.); Hym* 4/3, *6/2pr,* 33/3, *Lok* P1, 37/pr, 39/pr; acc. sg. Tý, *Sigrdr* 6/4; voc. sg. Týr: Þęgi þú, ~, *Lok* 38/1, 40/1. [= OE Tíw (in Tíwes dæg 'Tuesday'); < PGmc. *tīwaz 'god' < PIE *deywós 'id.'. Further cognate with OI dēvá 'id.', Latin deus 'id.'. Tew is not linguistically or mythologically identical to OI Dyāús, Greek Ζεύς, or Latin Iuppiter, which instead derive from a different derivation of the same root.]

**Tews** m.wa.pl., ON tívar: *the Gods; Grm* 5/4; ríkir ~, *Bdr* 1/3, *Þrk* 14/3; mę́rir ~, *Hym* 4/1; acc. pl. tíva, *Háv* 160/2; gen. pl. tíva, *Vafþ* 38/1, 42/1. [PGmc. *tīwōz, pl. of *tīwaz; see Tew above.] — Note: þú tíva rǫk ǫll Vaf·þrúðnir vitir, *Vafþ* 38/1, 42/1; ok umb þat réðu ríkir tívar, *Bdr* 1/3, *Þrk* 14/3. — Cpds.: **slain-Tews**, ON val-tívar: *Vsp* 59/4 (n.), *Hym* 1/1;

gen. pl. val-tíva, *Vsp* 50/2 (n.). **victory-Tews**, ON sig-tívar: gen. pl. sig-tíva: of ragna rǫk, rǫmm ~, *Vsp* 43/4, 47/4, 55/4; ~ sonum, *Grm* 46/1; ~ synir, *Lok* 1/4, 2/2, *Fáfn* 24/2; Guð·rún ~, *Akv* 32/3.

**Thedse** m.an., ON Þjatsi: *ettin, father of Shede; Grm* 11/1, *Hdl* 29/4; acc. sg. Þjatsa, *Hárb* 19/1; gen. sg. Þjatsa: dóttir ~ jǫtuns, *Gylf* 23:7 (*Eddbr* II); dat. sg. Þjatsa, *Lok* 50/4 & 51/2.

**Thing of the Gods** ON þing goða: *the Heavenly Council, the Assembly where the Gods convene and make decisions;* acc. sg. ~, *Hym* 39/1. — Indirectly: þingi 'Thing' *Vsp* 46/2, *Bdr* 1/1 (n.), *Þrk* 14/1; rǫk-stóla 'council-seats', *Vsp* 6/1 (n.), 9/1, 22/1, 24/1; *Grm* 29–30. — See *Vsp* 6/1–2 n., *Bdr* 1/1–3 n.

**Thrim** m., ON Þrymr: *ettin who steals Thunder's hammer in* Þrk*; Þrk* 6/1, *7/pr, 8/pr,* 11/2, 22/1, 25/1, 30/1; acc. sg. Þrym *Þrk* 31/3; gen. sg. Þryms *Þrk* T1. — Note: Þrym(r) ... þursa dróttin: *Þrk* 6/1, 11/2, 31/3; Þá kvað þat Þrymr, þursa dróttin: *Þrk* 22/1, 25/1, 30/1.

**Thrimham** m.a., ON Þrym-hęimr: *abode of Shede; Grm* 11/1.

**Thrithham** m.a., ON Þrúð-hęimr: *holy abode of Thunder;* dat. sg. -hęimi *Grm* 4/3.

**Thrithyelmer** m.ja., ON Þrúð·gęlmir: *ettin, father of Bareyelmer; Vafþ* 29/3.

**Thunder** m., (ON Þórr, OE *Þunor, OS Þuner, OHG Donar, PNWGmc. *Þonaraʀ) ON Þórr: *god of Thunder, son of Weden and Earth; Vsp* 25/1, *Grm* 4/3, 29/2, *Hárb* P1, *3/pr, 5/pr, 7/pr, 9/pr,* 11/pr, *13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr,* 19/pr, 23/pr, 24/4, 25/pr, 26/1, 26/3, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr, 37/pr, 39/pr, 41/pr, 43/pr, 45/pr, 47/pr, 49/pr, 50/2, 51/pr, 53/pr, 55/pr, 57/pr, 59/pr, *Hym* T1 (in **R**), 23/1 (Þórr), *Lok* P1, P7, *59/pr,* 60/4, *61/pr, 63/pr, Þrk* 17/1, *Alv 2/pr, 4/pr, 6/pr, 8/pr, 11/pr, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr, 19/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr*, *Skm* TODO (*Eddbr* VI P1 (3 times), P2 (2 times), P3 (3 times)), *Cant* 3, N B380/2; acc. sg. Þór, *Hárb* 9/4, 56/4, *Hym* 28/2 (Þórr), *Þrk* 9/4, 15/3, 19/1, *Hdl* 4/1; gen. sg. Þórs, *Hárb* P1, *Skm* TODO (*Eddbr* VI P2); voc. sg. Þórr, *Hárb* 18/9, 22/3, 28/2, 32/1, 36/1, 38/1, *Lok* 58/2; Þęgi þú, ~, *Þrk* 18/2. — Cpds.: **Eese-thunder**, ON Ása-Þórr: gen. sg. Ása-Þórs, *Hárb* 52/1 (n.). **Wing-Thunder**, ON Ving-Þórr: *Þrk* 1/1 (n.), *Alv* 6/1. — See Loride, Wighward, Wingner, TODO.

**Thurses** (sg. Thurse; ON *þurs*, OE *þyrs*, OS *thuris*, OHG *duris*, PNWGmc. **þurisaʀ*) Possibly a poetic synonym for Ettins. See also Rime-Thurses. Noted members: TODO Occurrences: TODO

**Twilight of the Reins** n., ON ragna røkr: *the Rakes of the Reins;* gen. sg. ragna røkrs, *Lok* 39/4. [ręgin 'Reins, Gods', røk(k)r 'twilight'.]

**Ugdrassle** m.a., ON Ygg·drasill: *"Weden's steed", where he hung on the World Tree;* see Ash of Ugdrassle.

**Up-heaven** m.a., *highest heaven, only in the formula Earth and Up-heaven.* ON upphiminn: *Vsp* 3/3, *Vafþ* 20/3, *Oddr* 17/3, Sö 154 2; acc. sg. -himin, SJy 41 1/1 (under Galders); gen. sg. -himins, *Þrk* 2/4. TODO. OE, OS, OHG.

**Wadyelmer** m.ja., ON Vað·gęlmir: acc. sg. Vað·gęlmi, *Reg* 4/2. [*vað* n. 'shoal, water shallow enough to wade' + *gęlmir* 'screamer(?)']

**Waleshelf** f.ō., ON Vala-skjǫlf: *mythological place; Grm* 6/3.

**Walfather** (ON *Val-fǫðr*) 'Father of the Slain'; name for Weden.

*Vsp* 1/3a, 26/4a, 28/4a, *Grm* 49/2a

**Walhall** f., ON Val-hǫll: *Weden's hall; Grm* 8/2; gen. sg. Val-hallar, *Vsp* 33/4, *2 HHund* P2, *RunIce* 4/2, *Skm* 42 (ed. under *Eddbr* VII); dat. sg. Valhǫllu, *Grm* 24/2, *Hdl* 1/4, *Akv* 2/2(?), 16/2(?).

**Walsings** (ON *Vǫlsungar*) Descendants of king Walsing.

**Waneham** m.a., ON Vana-hęimr: *realm of the Wanes;* dat. sg. -hęimi, *Vafþ* 39/1, *Gylf* 23:6 (ed. under *Eddbr* II). [vanir + hęimr 'Home, realm']

**Wanes** m.i.pl., ON vanir: *group of divine beings; Vsp* 23/4, *Þrk* 15/2, *Alv* 10/2, 12/2, 18/2, 22/2, 24/2, 26/2, 28/4, 32/2, 34/2, *Gylf* 23:6 (ed. under *Eddbr* II), *Gylf* 35:23 (*Eddbr* IV); gen. pl. vana: víssa ~, *Skí* 17/2 & 18/2; dat. pl. vǫnum, *Gylf* 23:6 (*Eddbr* II); vísum ~, *Vafþ* 39/4, *Sigrdr* 16/5. See *Vsp* 22–23 n., *Vafþ* 38–39 n.; cf. Nearth, Frea, and Frow. [Cf. OE wæn-. TODO.]

**Wayland** m.u., *legendary smith.* ON Vǫlundr: *Vkv* P1 (thrice), *4/2*, 5/3 & 7/2, 9/4, *13/pr, 15/pr,* P2, P3, *22/pr*, 27/pr, *28/pr,* 29/1, 29/3, *33/pr*, 38/1, 41/2 (vit Vǫlundr); voc. sg. Vǫlundr, *Vkv* 14/2 & 32/1 (~, vísi alfa), 37/2, 40/2 (it Vǫlundr). — Note: Vǫlundr líðandi of langan veg: *Vkv 4/2,* 9/4; ęinn Vǫlundr sat ǐ Ulf-dǫlum: *Vkv* 5/3, 7/2; hlęjandi Vǫlundr: *Vkv* 29/3, 38/1. — OE Wélund: *Déor* 1; gen. sg. Wélandes, *Beow* 455, *Wald* A 2; ~ bearn, *Wald* B 9.

**Webthrithner** , m.ja., ON Vaf·þrúðnir: *ettin defeated by Weden in a wisdom contest; Vafþ* 6/1, *7/pr, 9/pr, 11/pr, 13/pr, 15/pr, 17/pr*, 19/pr, 21/pr, 23/pr, 25/pr, 27/pr, 29/pr, 31/pr, 33/pr, 35/pr, 37/pr, 39/pr, 41/pr, *43/pr,* 45/pr, 47/pr, 49/pr, 51/pr, 53/pr, 55/pr; acc. sg. Vaf·þrúðni, *Vafþ* 2/4; gen. sg. Vaf·þrúðnis, *Vafþ* T1, 1/2, 3/3.

**Weden** (ON *Óðinn*, OE *Wóden*, *Wéden*, OHG *Wuotan*, PNWGmc. **Wódanaʀ* 'Lord of wode (poetry, intelligence)') Chief of the Eese, God of Wisdom, Galder, Poetry, War. Husband of Frie, and by her father of Balder. Father of Thunder by Earth. Brother of Heener and Lother or Will and Wigh.

**Weird** m.an., ON Urðr: *one of three Norns at the Ash of Ugdrassle (for non-personified use, see under cultural terms above); 1 Guðr* 24/3; acc. sg. Urð, *Vsp* 19/3 (n.); gen. sg. Urðar: ~ brunni, *Vsp* 18/4, *Háv* 111/2. [PNGmc. *wurdiz 'fate, destiny'.] — See Shild, Well of Weird, Werthing.

**Well of Weird** m.a., ON Urðar bruðr: *well at the Ash of Ugdrassle;* dat. sg. Urðar brunni, *Vsp* 18/4, *Háv* 111/2. — See Weird.

**Wharyelmer** m.ja., ON Hver-gęlmir: *heavenly source of all rivers;* acc. sg. -gęlmi, *Grm* 26/3. [hverr 'cauldron' + gęlmir 'yeller(?)']

**Whethring** m.a., ON Hveðrungr: *name for Lock;* gen. sg. Hveðrungs: męgi ~, *Vsp* 52/3.

**Wider** m., ON Víð·arr: *son and avenger of Weden against the Fenrerswolf*; *Vsp* 52/2, *Vafþ* 51/1, 53/2, *Lok* P1, P4; gen. sg. Víð·ars, *Vsp* H48/4, *Grm* 17/2; voc. sg. Víð·arr, *Lok* 10/1. — [OE *Wíd·hęri, PGmc. *Wída-harjaʀ 'Broad Warrior', a fitting name considering he props the jaws of the Wolf apart, which are said to reach up to the very Heaven (*Vsp* H48 n.).]

**Wigh** m.an., ON Vé: *brother of Weden and Will, son of Byre (cf.* Vsp *4/1, 16/2 nn.);* acc. sg. Vé, *Lok* 26/3 (n.). [PNGmc. *wíhá 'hallower, (heathen) priest'.]

**Wighward** m.a., ON Véurr: *poetic name for Thunder; Vsp* 53/5 (Mið·garðs ~), *Hym* 11/5, 17/1, 21/4 (Óðni sifjaðr ~). [PN **Wíha-warjaʀ*, **wíhą* 'wigh, sanctuary' + **warjaz* 'defender'.]

**Will** m.an., ON Vili: *brother of Weden and Wigh, son of Byre (cf.* Vsp *4/1, 16/2 nn.);* acc. sg. Vilja, *Lok* 26/3 (n.). [PGmc. *wiljô 'willpower'.]

**Wingner** m.a., ON Vingnir: *name for Thunder;* gen. sg. Vingnis, *Vafþ* 51/4. [Probably 'swinger', viz. of the Hammer Millner.]

**Wing-Thunder** m.a., ON Ving-Þórr: *name for Thunder; see there under Cpds.*

**Wode** m.a.(*or* u.?), ON Óðr: *obscure husband of Frow;* gen. sg. Óðs: ~ męy, *Vsp* 24/4. [PGmc. *wōdaz 'TODO'.]

**Woderearer** m.ja., ON Óð·rórir: *one of the vats of the Mead of Poetry; Háv* 107/3; dat. sg. Óð·róri, *Háv* 140/4.

**Wolder** m.u., ON Ullr: *obscure winter-god; Grm* 5/1; gen. sg. Ullar, *Grm* 43/1 (n.), *Akv* 33/4. [PGmc. *wulþuz 'glory, splendour', OE *Wuldor.]

**Wonnel** m.an., ON Váli: *god, son of Weden and Wrind who avenges his brother Balder by killing his half-brother Hath; Vsp* H31 (n.), *Vafþ* 51, *Hdl* 28/3; acc. sg. Vála, *Bdr 11/1.* [< PGmc. **Wanilô* 'the little Wane' (uncertain).] — Indirectly: Baldrs bróðir: *Vsp* 32/3; Óðins sonr: *Vsp* 32/4, *Bdr* 11/2.

**Wrate** m.an., ON Rati: *Weden's drill;* gen. sg. Rata, *Háv* 106/1.

**Wratetusk** m., ON Rata·toskr: *mythological squirrel; Grm* 32/1.

**Wrind** f., ON Vrind, Rind: *mother of Wonnel (cf.* Vsp *31 n.); Bdr* 11/1 (n.). ['Ivy'(?); *Bdr* 11/1 n.]

**Yewdales** m.i.pl., ON Ý-dalir: *realm of the god Wolder; Grm* 5/1 (n.). [ýr 'yew' + dalr 'dale, valley'.]

**Yimer** m.ja., ON Ymir: *first ettin sacrificed by the Gods who created the world from his corpse; Vsp* 3/1 (n.); gen. sg. Ymis, *Vafþ* 21/1, *Grm* 41/1, *Vafþ* 28/3; dat. sg. Ymi, *Hdl* 32/4. — Note: Ór Ymis holdi vas jǫrð of skǫpuð: *Vafþ* 21/1, *Grm* 41/1. [OE *Ġyme, PGmc. *Jumjaz. See *Vsp* 3/1 for etymology.]

**Yin-Reins** (ON *ginn-regin*) yin- + Reins. The sacrosanct, highest Divine Powers.

**Yivick** m.an., *king of the Burgends (historically from late 4th c.–407 AD).* ON Gjúki: *2 Guðr* P1, 1/3, *Am* 102/2; acc. sg. Gjúka, *Sigsk* 1/1; TODO. — OE Gifica: *Wíd* 19. [Cf. OHG Gibicho, MHG. Gibeche (in legendary ballads).]

**Yivickings** m.pl., ON Gjúkungar: *descendants of Yivick;* TODO. [Gjúki 'Yivick' + -ungar 'sons, descendants of']

## Poetic formulæ (F)

All formulæ are given in English translation, their attested forms and a Proto-Germanic rendition. For those consisting of two words bound together by a conjunction, & is written in its place.

**Earth and Up-heaven** (ON *jǫrð & upphiminn*, OE *eorþe & upheofon*, OS *erþa & uphimil*, OHG *erdo & úfhimil*, PGmc. **erþō & uphiminaz*) An old merism; earth and heaven and everything in between, i.e., the whole universe. It has a particular connection to the creation and destruction of the world, and in prayers. ON: *Vsp* 3/3, *Vafþ* 20, *Þrk* 2, *Oddr* 17, SJy 41 (under Galders), Sö 154 (under Runic Poetry); OE: *Acreboot*; OS: *Heli* 2886; OHG: *Wessobrunn* 2.

**Eese and Elves** (ON *ęsir & alfar*, OE *ése & ielfe*, PNWGmc. **alβíʀ & ansiwiʀ*) A merism; both heavenly and earthly spiritual beings. Notably the two words always occur in this order (never 'Elves and Eese'), even in OE.

**words and works** (ON *orð & verk*, OE *word & weorc*, PGmc. **wurdó & werkó*) *Beow* 289, 1100, 1833